

The Slayer & the Dragon

Chaoskampf Myths Across Cultures



For the nerd, by the robot

Chaoskampf Across Cultures

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Chapter 1. Introduction: What Chaoskampf Is, and Why the Word Is Contested

1.1. I. What the book is about

In Babylon, probably some time in the late second millennium BCE, a scribe copied a poem called *Enūma Eliš* — "When on High" — onto a clay tablet.^[1] Over the next thousand years his colleagues would copy it again and again, until more than seventy manuscripts of it sat in temple libraries and private archives from Assur in the north to Uruk in the south.^[2] On the fourth day of every New Year, a priest in the great temple of Marduk at Babylon would read it out loud from end to end while the king stood in the courtyard.^[3]

The poem is a story about a fight. In its opening, there are no gods yet and no world — only two primordial waters, the fresh-water Apsû and the salt-sea Tiamat, mingled together. From them the first gods are born, and the younger gods are noisy, and Apsû decides to kill them to get some rest. The wisdom-god Ea hears the plan and kills Apsû first. Tiamat is furious. She assembles an army of monsters, promotes her consort Qingu to command it, and hangs on him the Tablet of Destinies — the document that decrees what happens in the cosmos.^[4] The gods are terrified. Several of them try to face Tiamat and turn back. Finally the young storm-god Marduk agrees to fight her, on one condition: if he wins, he will be king of the gods forever.

The combat itself takes about fifty lines. Marduk drives a hurricane into Tiamat's open mouth so she cannot close it, shoots an arrow that splits her belly, cuts her heart, and stands on her corpse. Then the real work begins. He splits her body in half "like a dried fish," lifts one half to make the sky, pegs down the other to make the earth, and uses her spittle and her eyes to make clouds and rivers.^[5] He measures out the stations for the sun and moon, plants mountains, opens springs. He kills Qingu, takes the Tablet of Destinies, and uses Qingu's blood to make the first humans, whose job will be to work for the gods so the gods can rest. At the end of the poem the other gods give him fifty names, each of them a previous god's title, and build him the temple of Esagil at the centre of Babylon as the literal centre of the world.^[6]

That structure — a sovereign or would-be sovereign defeats a monstrous adversary, and the combat does the work of making, legitimating, or preserving an order — shows up, in recognisable form, in most of the major ancient literatures. It is what this book is about. The Sumerian war-god Ninurta cuts down the demon Asag in his mountain stronghold and reorganises the Tigris so it can irrigate fields.^[7] The Ugaritic storm-god Baʿlu (called Baal in the Hebrew-Bible reception) smashes the sea-god Yam with a pair of named maces and is made king of the gods.^[8] The Vedic Indra drinks three bowls of soma and strikes the serpent Vṛtra with his thunderbolt, releasing the dammed-up waters and, in the same blow, separating the sky from the earth and producing the first dawn.^[9] In the Egyptian *Book of the Dead* and in the temple liturgy at Heliopolis, the sun-god Ra has to fight the serpent Apep every night so the sun can rise in the morning.^[10] In a late-second-millennium Hittite spring festival at Nerik, a priest recited the story of how the storm-god Tarḫunna bound the serpent Illuyanka — and the festival was the point of the story.^[11] In the Hebrew Bible, Yahweh crushes the heads of Leviathan in the sea.^[12] In the Book of Revelation, the archangel Michael hurls a seven-headed red dragon out of heaven.^[13] In the Norse *Hymiskviða*, Thor almost manages to pull the world-encircling Midgard Serpent out of the sea on a fishing line; in Snorri's account of Ragnarök,

he finally kills it, and dies of its venom nine paces later.^[14] At the centre of the Aztec capital Tenochtitlan, the twin pyramid called Templo Mayor was built in the shape of the mountain Coatepec, where the sun-god Huitzilopochtli, born fully armed, had killed his sister the moon-goddess Coyolxauhqui and dismembered his four hundred brothers the stars.^[15]

Nobody has to argue that these stories resemble each other. The resemblance is obvious, and the scholars of the 1880s and 1890s who first read *Enūma Eliš* in cuneiform and had already spent a generation reading the Rigveda and the *Poetic Edda* saw it immediately. The question that has produced a hundred and thirty years of argument is what the resemblance means. Are these all the same story, told in different costumes? Are some of them copies of others, carried by trade and conquest? Do they reflect a shared deep structure of how human societies think about order and disorder? Or are the similarities superficial, and have modern scholars been mapping one narrow Mediterranean template onto everything in sight?

The book ahead of you takes the stories seriously one by one — forty-three chapters covering roughly fifteen traditions in depth and another thirty in shorter form — and then tries, in a second Part, to sort out which of those comparative answers is defensible. But the first thing to do is to say what the category *is*: what scholars have meant by "Chaoskampf" since 1895, what they now think is wrong with that word, and what this book is going to do about it.

1.2. II. The word — Gunkel 1895

The word "Chaoskampf" is German. It means, literally, "chaos-combat" or "struggle with chaos." A thirty-three-year-old Protestant Old-Testament scholar named Hermann Gunkel put it into scholarly circulation in a book published in 1895, *Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit* ("Creation and Chaos in Primordial and Final Times").^[16] The subtitle gives the plan: Gunkel was going to read Genesis 1 and Revelation 12 side by side, as the two ends of a single mythic arc, and argue that both of them were parts of a pre-biblical Near Eastern combat myth that the biblical authors had inherited, half-disguised, from older Mesopotamian sources.

To understand why the book hit its audience the way it did, you have to put it back in its moment. Two things had just happened. The first was German biblical criticism. For most of the nineteenth century, Protestant scholars in Göttingen, Tübingen, and Halle had been taking the Bible apart and arguing about where its pieces came from — the Documentary Hypothesis about the Pentateuch was a generation old by 1895, and the consensus was that Genesis 1 was a late, priestly text reflecting a long editorial history.^[17] The question was where the editorial history had started. The second thing that had just happened was Mesopotamia. In 1872 a young British Museum assistant named George Smith had deciphered a cuneiform tablet containing what is now called the *Epic of Gilgamesh* and announced a flood story that looked like Noah's flood. Over the next two decades, tablet after tablet came out of the excavations at Nineveh and Nimrud, including, eventually, manuscripts of *Enūma Eliš*. The public read about the discoveries in the newspapers. Scholars read the texts in raw transliteration as fast as the Assyriologists could produce them.

Gunkel's move was to put the two things together. If Genesis 1 began with the word *tehôm* — "the deep," the primordial watery chaos that God's wind hovers over — and if the Babylonians had a goddess named Tiamat who was the primordial salt-sea and who had to be defeated so the world could be made, then *tehôm* and Tiamat might be linguistically cognate (they are), and the defeat-of-the-watery-chaos might be a pattern that Israel had inherited from Babylon.^[18] The defeat had been

smoothed away in Genesis 1, where God creates by speech and the deep is only a passive scene-setting. But in the poetic books of the Hebrew Bible — in the Psalms, in Isaiah, in Job — the imagery of Yahweh crushing the heads of Leviathan, cutting Rahab in pieces, rebuking the sea, was still there, half-buried, as traces of the earlier combat. And at the far end of the canon, in Revelation 12, the combat was back in full force: the woman clothed with the sun, the red seven-headed dragon, Michael's battle in heaven. *Urzeit und Endzeit* — the combat at the beginning of time and the combat at the end — were two ends of the same myth.

Gunkel called this myth *Chaoskampf*, and the name stuck. It stuck partly because he made it the organising category of an ambitious book, and partly because the word was useful for what it did: it named, in a single compound, a pattern that was otherwise visible only as a cluster of dispersed motifs. It stuck, too, because the next generations of scholars found the pattern was harder to ignore once Gunkel had named it. The Ugaritic tablets, excavated in the 1920s and 1930s, gave the Canaanite background Gunkel had guessed at — the storm-god Baal killing the sea-god Yamm, the seven-headed serpent Lôtan whose name is Hebrew Leviathan with an Ugaritic pronunciation.^[19] The Hurro-Hittite tablets from Boğazköy gave the Kumarbi cycle, with its storm-god-versus-stone-monster combat that looks like it fed into Hesiod's *Theogomachy*.^[20] The comparative Indo-European work of Calvert Watkins reconstructed a formula — *áhann áhim*, "he slew the serpent" — running from Vedic Indra through Hittite Illuyanka through Greek Zeus-slays-Typhon to Old Norse Thor-kills-Jörmungandr, all the way into Beowulf.^[21] Michael Fishbane, Neil Forsyth, John Day, M.L. West, Bruce Lincoln — the central books of twentieth-century mythography and biblical criticism are, in important part, an extended engagement with Gunkel's 1895 hypothesis, sometimes to support it, sometimes to qualify it, but almost always with the word "Chaoskampf" somewhere in the argument.^[22]

That is the first thing to know about the category. It has a history. It was not dug up with the tablets; it was put on the tablets, in good faith and with genuine explanatory power, by a specific scholar in a specific moment. The word is old enough to be a fixture and new enough to be checked against the texts it names.

1.3. III. The critique — Scurlock, Beal, Ballentine

Nothing in scholarship stays settled for long, and by the late twentieth century a new wave of scholarship had begun to push back. The pushback is not a denial that the combats are real or that they resemble each other. The combats are on the tablets; the resemblances are on the page. The pushback is about the word "chaos" — about what work that word is doing in the analysis, and about what it imports that the ancient texts do not contain.

Two landmarks mark the shift. The first is a 2013 volume of essays edited by JoAnn Scurlock and Richard Beal, *Creation and Chaos: A Reconsideration of Hermann Gunkel's Chaoskampf Hypothesis*.^[23] Scurlock, Beal, and their contributors go back through the Mesopotamian, Hebrew, and Ugaritic material and ask, text by text, whether the adversaries in the combats actually function as "chaos" in the sense the word carries in modern European usage — a formlessness, a lack of structure, an undifferentiated void. Their answer, broadly, is no. Tiamat in *Enūma Eliš* is not a formless void; she is a rival queen with a husband, a second husband, an army, a chain of command, a catalogue of monstrous subordinates, and a strategy. She rules. Her problem in the story is that she wants to kill the younger gods and hand the kingship to Qingu. When Marduk defeats her, he is not defeating non-order; he is defeating an alternative order and replacing it with

his own.

The second landmark, and the most consequential for the terminological argument, is Debra Scoggins Ballentine's 2015 book *The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition*.^[24] Ballentine works through the Ugaritic and Hebrew combat corpora in detail and argues that the standard Gunkelian reading — victor-god defeats chaos to found or preserve order — consistently misdescribes what the texts are doing. The adversaries in the Baal Cycle and in the Hebrew Leviathan passages, she shows, are presented as legitimate or would-be-legitimate sovereigns: Yamm is literally "Sea," a god with a court and messengers; at the beginning of the Baal Cycle the high god El initially confirms Yamm's kingship, and Baal is in the position of a rival, not a rescuer.^[25] Leviathan in Psalm 74 is not an amorphous darkness; he has heads, plural, which Yahweh *crushes* — a specific victor's gesture performed on a specific defeated body. The texts consistently present these fights as conflicts between rival sovereign powers, each with retinues, each with claims. They do not present them as order-versus-formlessness.

Ballentine's argument goes further. "Chaos" as a category, she points out, has a history of its own. It enters scholarly language through Greek philosophy — through Hesiod's *χάος* as the primordial gap and through the Stoic and later Platonic tradition that made "chaos" the philosophical opposite of "cosmos." When Gunkel uses the word in 1895, she argues, he is bringing that Hellenistic philosophical category back to texts that did not share it. Babylonian, Ugaritic, and Hebrew scribes did not think in a chaos-versus-order binary. They thought in a this-king-or-that-king-holds-the-Tablet-of-Destinies binary, or in a Yahweh-is-sovereign-not-Baal binary, or in a *ma'at*-versus-*isfet* binary in Egypt (which is a moral and political category, not a cosmological one).^[26] Gunkel's word, in short, was too philosophically loaded for the material he was trying to describe, and the century of scholarship that followed him inherited the load without always checking the freight.

Presented in its strongest form, the Ballentine critique is not a dismissal of Gunkel's hypothesis. This characterisation of Ballentine's own framing draws together her introduction and concluding remarks; she presents the argument as a refinement. The pattern Gunkel noticed — storm-god, serpent, combat, order-making consequences — is still there, tablet by tablet, text by text. What Ballentine is asking for is a more careful name for it. Call it a "conflict myth" or a "combat myth" rather than a chaos-combat myth, and the analysis changes. Tiamat is no longer the inchoate void out of which creation must be wrested; she is the defeated rival sovereign whose body the new sovereign uses for building material. Leviathan is no longer a personification of chaos; he is the enemy king whose heads Yahweh displays as trophies. The stories become less mythic and more political, and their resemblance to each other starts to look less like a shared metaphysics of chaos and more like a shared grammar of divine sovereignty.

There is also a third critique worth naming here, though it is distinct from the Scurlock-Ballentine line. Bruce Lincoln and a cluster of other historians of religion have been pointing out, since at least the 1980s, that combat myths are typically attached to political interests: they are recited at coronations, at temple dedications, at New-Year festivals where the king's legitimacy is being re-staged. To read them only as cosmological allegory is to miss what the priests who recited them and the kings who paid for them were actually using them for.^[27] On that reading, the combat myth is not a mirror of some deep human anxiety about chaos; it is a political technology for authorising whoever has just won the latest real-world fight.

The Scurlock-Beal volume, the Ballentine monograph, and the Lincoln-style political-ideological reading do not agree with each other on everything, and they do not between them demolish

Gunkel's hypothesis. What they have done is to put the word "chaos" under pressure and force anyone who uses it to justify it. A reader coming into this field today has to know both sides. The combats are real, the resemblances are real, and the pattern is worth naming. But the name Gunkel gave it has to be used with care.

One further consequence of the critique is worth flagging, because it will recur in the individual chapters. If the adversaries are read as rival sovereigns rather than as chaos, then the combat narrative becomes readable as a genre of political argument — a way of saying, in mythic form, which god (and by extension, which king, which city, which priesthood) has the right to rule. On that reading, *Enūma Eliš* is not only a cosmogony; it is also a piece of second-millennium Babylonian political theology, produced when Babylon was consolidating its claim to theological primacy in southern Mesopotamia and needed a charter for Marduk's promotion over the older gods.^[28] The Baal Cycle is not only a story about a storm-god; it is also a Ugaritic claim that Baʿlu, not Yamm and not Mot, holds the right kind of kingship. The Vedic Indra hymns are ritual invocations used to get rain and cattle from Indra, who has to be reminded of his Vātra-slaying credentials every time. Reading the combat myths as *political-theological artefacts* rather than as transparent windows onto a primordial imagination of chaos is part of what the Ballentine critique opens up. The book will take the point and show, chapter by chapter, where the political dimension is on the surface of the text and where it has to be argued for.

1.4. IV. The operational definition this book uses

Here is the working definition this book uses, and will keep using across forty-three chapters.

A *combat myth* — the book's default body-prose term, following the second half of the Ballentine critique — is a narrative in which:

1. A sovereign or would-be sovereign deity, or a heroic champion acting for one, defeats
2. a monstrous, serpentine, or otherwise explicitly adversarial figure (which the book calls "the adversary" as a neutral category label, reserving "the dragon" for morphologically draconic cases), and
3. that combat does one or more of four kinds of *order-making work*: cosmogonic, sovereignty, cyclical-maintenance, or eschatological.

The book will continue to use the word *Chaoskampf* in its title, in headings, and in direct discussion of Gunkel's thesis and its reception. The reasons are practical. *Chaoskampf* is what readers will search for when they come looking for this material; it is what an undergraduate will find on the reading list; it is the word that a hundred and thirty years of scholarship has written itself into. Retiring the word by fiat would produce a book nobody could find. Using the word everywhere, on the other hand, would prejudice the Ballentine question. The compromise — *Chaoskampf* in headings and technical contexts, *combat myth* in body prose — lets the book engage the terminological debate substantively rather than cosmetically. Where a chapter's argument turns on whether "chaos" is the right word, the chapter will say so and give both readings.

The word "adversary" in the definition is doing deliberate work. Not every figure the champion confronts is a dragon. Asag in *Lugal-e* is a stone-demon with an army of stone soldiers. Anzû in the Ninurta tradition is a lion-headed bird who steals the Tablet of Destinies. Yamm is the sea as a god, not a serpent. Typhon has a hundred serpent-heads but also arms and legs. Coyolxauhqui is not

draconic at all; she is a moon-goddess sister. A neutral category term is needed if the book is not going to smuggle in its conclusions through its nouns — and "chaos-figure," the term some comparativists have used, is exactly what Ballentine is complaining about.^[29]

The four subtypes in the definition are the book's own framework, not Gunkel's. Gunkel had two: *Urzeit* and *Endzeit*, the primordial combat and the eschatological combat. That framework is too coarse for the material that has come in since, particularly once the Egyptian, Hittite, and Mesoamerican combats are on the table. The four-subtype scheme used here is reviewed in the next section.

1.5. V. Four subtypes, previewed

The four subtypes are not mutually exclusive. A given combat can do two or three kinds of order-making work at once; *Enūma Eliš* is famously cosmogonic *and* sovereignty-establishing *and* ritual-aetiological. The subtypes are offered as analytic categories, not as containers into which each story fits exactly once.

Cosmogonic combat. The cosmos — sky, earth, mountains, rivers, time, humans — is made out of or immediately after the combat. Marduk builds the world out of Tiamat's body.^[30] Ninurta reorders the Tigris and ranks the stones of the mountain after killing Asag.^[31] The Chinese water-god Gonggong loses his fight with the sky-emperor Zhuanxu, smashes his head against Mount Buzhou in rage, breaks the sky-pillar, and the cosmos tilts permanently — heaven slips northwest, earth slips southeast, and rivers flow east to the sea because they do.^[32] Huitzilopochtli is born fully armed at Coatepec and dismembers his siblings, and the Mexica built their capital's central pyramid as a literal scale model of that mountain.^[33] In each of these cases, the combat is not a metaphor for creation; it is creation, and specific features of the observable world — the tilt of the Chinese cosmos, the course of the Tigris, the layout of Tenochtitlan, the sky and earth themselves in the Babylonian case — are explained by reference to it.

Sovereignty combat. The victor's kingship is what the combat establishes or confirms. The Ugaritic Baal defeats Yamm and is elevated to the divine kingship; the palace he is granted after the victory is the narrative point of the cycle.^[34] Zeus defeats Typhon in Hesiod's *Theogony* and becomes the settled king of the gods.^[35] Indra's defeat of Vṛtra, in the Rigveda, is cited again and again in later hymns as the event that confirms his status as king of the gods.^[36] The Hittite storm-god Teshub's victory over the stone-monster Ullikummi in the Kumarbi cycle resolves a succession crisis in the divine court.^[37] The Iranian hero Thraētaona's defeat of the three-headed dragon-tyrant Aži Dahāka, in the Avestan hymns, is the mythic charter of legitimate kingship against usurpation.^[38] The Mesopotamian Ninurta's defeat of the lion-headed Anzû, who has stolen the Tablet of Destinies from Enlil, restores the cosmic decree-document to its rightful holder.^[39] In each of these, the combat answers the political question "who gets to rule?" more than the cosmological question "how did the world get here?"

Cyclical-maintenance combat. The combat is never won once for all; it is won on a schedule, and the schedule is the point. Ra fights Apep every night so that the sun can rise the next morning, and at the temple of Ra a priestly liturgy called the Book of Overthrowing Apep re-performed that fight daily.^[40] The Hittite storm-god Tarḫunna fights the serpent Illuyanka, and a Hittite spring festival called the *purulli*, celebrated at the cult-centre of Nerik, re-performed the combat annually — the ritual colophon of the surviving tablet says so in so many words.^[41] What these combats have in

common is that the adversary is not finally destroyed. The cosmos keeps being threatened and keeps being saved, and the ritual that re-enacts the saving is itself load-bearing: if the priests stop performing the ritual, on the Egyptian reading, the sun does not rise.

Eschatological combat. The combat closes cosmic time rather than beginning or preserving it. At Ragnarök, Thor strides out to meet the Midgard Serpent, Jörmungandr, who has been curled in the ocean around the world since the beginning; he kills the serpent and dies of its venom, and the world as we know it ends.^[42] In Revelation 12, the red dragon who is "the ancient serpent" is thrown down from heaven by Michael and then, later in the text, bound in the abyss for a thousand years before being released for a final defeat.^[43] In the Zoroastrian Frashokereti — the "final renovation" at the end of time — Aži Dahāka, bound under Mount Damāvand by the hero Thraētaona ages earlier, breaks free, is killed a second and final time by the revived hero Kərəsāspa, the dead rise, and the cosmos is remade.^[44] Gunkel's *Endzeit* is this subtype. It is striking that the combat can sit at either end of cosmic time — or at both ends, as in Revelation's echoing of Genesis — and that the same imagery does both jobs.

Each of the four subtypes has a dedicated comparative chapter in Part II (C1 through C4). The Part I chapters treat each story in its own tradition, in its own language, and each chapter is flagged for which subtype or subtypes it belongs to.

Two points of caution about the subtypes are worth making here, before Part I begins. The first is that the subtypes do not always map onto the cultural significance of the combat in the way a reader might expect. A cyclical-maintenance combat that is performed daily in temple ritual — Ra against Apep — can be more load-bearing in the priestly and political life of its culture than a cosmogonic combat that is recited once a year — *Enūma Eliš* at the Babylonian New Year. The frequency of the combat's ritual re-performance is a separate dimension from its narrative placement in cosmic time. The book will try to track both.

The second point is that subtype-assignment is an interpretive act, and reasonable scholars disagree. The Baal Cycle is plainly a sovereignty combat at KTU 1.1–1.2, where Baʿlu defeats Yamm and is elevated to kingship; but Baʿlu's fight with the serpent Lôtan — alluded to in retrospect, not narrated — looks structurally more like Apep's nightly combat or like Leviathan's eschatological defeat in Isaiah 27. The Vedic combat looks cosmogonic in Rigveda 1.32, where the fight separates heaven and earth and produces dawn, but reads as sovereignty-establishing in later hymns that invoke the combat as the charter of Indra's kingship. Assigning a single subtype to a single text flattens evidence that is often multi-layered. The four-subtype framework is an orienting device, not a classification scheme.

1.6. VI. Cross-cultural parallels, with proportion

The parallels are real. That is the first thing to say, because a reasonable reader, having been through the Ballentine critique, might suspect that the book is about to dissolve the whole cross-cultural observation into a series of narrow, tradition-specific readings. It is not. A book that did that would be dishonest to its material. Marduk killing Tiamat and Indra killing Vṛtra and Thor killing Jörmungandr and Huitzilopochtli killing Coyolxauhqui *are* related in some way, and the book's project is to work out in what way, not to pretend otherwise.

The second thing to say is that the ways are not all the same.

Some of the parallels are the result of *documented cultural transmission*. The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, excavated at Ras Shamra on the Syrian coast in the 1920s, preserves the seven-headed serpent Lôtan (Ugaritic *ltn*) — the same figure, under a slightly earlier pronunciation, as the Hebrew Leviathan (*liwyātān*). John Day has argued in detail, and it is now the scholarly consensus, that the Hebrew poetic corpus inherited its combat imagery directly from Canaanite poetry of the Ugaritic sort: when Isaiah 27:1 calls Leviathan "the twisting serpent" and "the crooked serpent," it is using word-for-word the same pair of epithets that the Ugaritic tablets use for Lôtan.^[45] That is not independent invention. That is one tradition reading another.

A second documented transmission route runs from the Hurro-Hittite material, recovered from the Bronze-Age royal archives at Boğazköy in central Anatolia, to archaic Greek literature. The Kumarbi cycle — in which a succession of sky-gods overthrow each other, one of them biting off and swallowing another's genitals, one of them eventually defeated by the storm-god — has a resemblance to Hesiod's *Theogony* that is too close to be coincidence and too specific to be pan-human. M.L. West, Walter Burkert, and more recently Carolina López-Ruiz have argued that the transmission ran west through Phoenician intermediaries in the Iron Age, and the Zeus-Typhon combat in particular looks like the Greek processing of Near Eastern combat material.^[46] The Part II chapter C6 lays this case out in detail.

A third kind of resemblance is *linguistic inheritance*. Calvert Watkins, in *How to Kill a Dragon* (1995), reconstructed what he argued was a shared Indo-European poetic formula — áhann áhim, "he slew the serpent," using the root *g^hwhen- for "slay" — traceable through Vedic *áhann áhim* itself, Avestan *janat ažīm*, Greek *éphne drákonta*, Hittite *MUŠilluyankan kuenta*, Old Norse skaldic expressions for Thor's killing of the serpent, and into Beowulf.^[47] The formula is a piece of inherited poetic technology, carried forward with the languages that descend from Proto-Indo-European. It does not imply that every Indo-European combat myth is the same myth; it implies that speakers of those languages had a shared way of *saying* the thing, which is a weaker and more interesting claim than pan-cultural monomyth.

And a fourth kind of resemblance is *probably independent invention*. Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec looks structurally like Marduk at *Enūma Eliš* — a young warrior-god born or summoned to defeat pre-existing divine order, with the combat encoded in state architecture — but no serious scholar proposes a transmission route between thirteenth-century-BCE Babylonia and fifteenth-century-CE Tenochtitlan.^[48] The Gonggong material in Han-era Chinese compilations looks like a cosmogonic combat, and it has a broken sky-pillar and a post-combat geographical aetiology, but there is no evidence of contact with the Near East at the relevant period.^[49] Two possibilities remain for such cases. One is that human societies, when they try to think about how the observable order of the world arose, reach for narratively similar structures because the narrative problem is similar. The other is that the resemblances are looser than they look, and the features we find similar are in the eye of the comparativist. Both possibilities are live, and the book will flag them as it goes.

The broader framework for asking the pan-cultural question is Michael Witzel's *The Origins of the World's Mythologies* (2012), which proposes a Laurasian macro-scheme — a shared deep narrative structure across Eurasia, Oceania, and the Americas, descending from an out-of-Africa inheritance.^[50] The book cites Witzel where his story-level observations are sharp, but does not adopt his macro-scheme as a frame. Bruce Lincoln's work on combat myth as political ideology is cited for the same reason in a different register: combat myths travel because they are useful, and what they are useful for is authorising somebody's power over somebody else.^[51]

The proportion to keep is this. There is no pan-human monomyth here; there is no single origin from which all combat myths descend; there are also not fifty unrelated stories that happen by coincidence to look alike. What there is, somewhere in the middle, is a family of narratives that cluster — by inheritance in some cases, by contact in others, by shared human narrative logic in still others — around the problem of how a newly-established order of things gets established, and stays established, against whatever threatens it. The Part II comparative chapters are where the book tries to sort the clusters from each other.

The evidence that this is a load-bearing feature of the traditions, rather than a marginal literary curiosity, is substantial. The *Enūma Eliš* was recited at the Babylonian New Year and survives in over seventy manuscripts.^[52] *Lugal-e* — the Ninurta–Asag composition — is one of the longest Sumerian literary texts and was bilingualised into Akkadian and used as temple-school curriculum through the first millennium.^[53] The Baal Cycle occupies six tablets of the Ugaritic royal archive and is the most extensive Canaanite mythological corpus we have.^[54] The Rigveda’s Indra hymns were memorised orally, with extraordinary precision, for a millennium before being written down, and Indra is the single most invoked deity in the corpus.^[55] The Apep material is continuously attested in Egyptian textual and iconographic record from the Pyramid Texts (c. 2400 BCE) through the Bremner-Rhind papyrus (c. 310 BCE), a span of more than two thousand years.^[56] The Thor-fights-the-Midgard-Serpent scene is the most iconographically dense Norse myth, depicted on rune stones from Altuna in Sweden, Hørðum in Denmark, Gosforth in Cumbria, and Ardre VIII on Gotland, centuries before Snorri wrote any of it down.^[57] The Coyolxauhqui stone excavated at the base of Templo Mayor in 1978 depicts the dismembered moon-goddess at the foot of the pyramid built to re-enact her defeat.^[58] Revelation 12 is canonical scripture for most of Christianity and the image of Michael trampling the dragon is one of the most persistent motifs in two millennia of Christian visual culture.^[59] The point is not to pile up examples but to register the scale. These are not obscure curios. They are central texts and central monuments of the cultures that produced them.

Some traditions, finally, resist the framing. Area specialists of Anishinaabe ritual and cosmology — A. Irving Hallowell, Basil Johnston, Theresa S. Smith, Gerald Vizenor — argue explicitly that the encounters between the trickster-hero Nanabozho, the underwater manitou Mishipeshu, and the Thunderers are *not* chaoskampf combats and should not be read through that frame. They are relationships of reciprocal respect among other-than-human persons, in Hallowell’s phrase, not antagonisms of order and chaos.^[60] Australian Indigenous scholarship similarly refuses the Rainbow Serpent’s assimilation to the chaoskampf pattern — the refusal is part of the data. The Soninke story of Bida at Wagadu, in the West African oral tradition, tells of a hero who kills the seven-headed serpent and thereby *destroys* the city the serpent was protecting: the same plot shape, with its moral valence reversed.^[61] The book treats these refusals and inversions as data about the limits of the category, not as failures of the category.

1.7. VII. What this book is not

Having said what the book is about, it is worth saying what it is not.

It is not a catalog of every dragon-fight in world literature. Dragon-fights are much more common than chaoskampf combats. Fionn kills Aillen; Heracles kills the Nemean Lion, the Cretan Bull, and an assortment of lesser monsters; Sigurd kills the dragon Fáfnir in the Eddic *Völsunga saga* and the *Poetic Edda*’s *Fáfnismál*.^[62] Most hero-monster fights are initiation narratives or scene-setting episodes, not order-making combats in the book’s sense. The book includes a hero-monster fight

only if the combat does cosmogonic, sovereignty, cyclical-maintenance, or eschatological work — or if it is one of a handful of cases where the question of whether it does is itself analytically important.

It is not an argument for a single origin. There is no proto-Chaoskampf that all other chaoskampf myths descend from, any more than there is a single proto-flood or a single proto-creation story. What documented transmissions exist — Ugarit to Israel, Anatolia to Greece, Indo-European inheritance — the book treats in detail. What does not have evidence of transmission, the book does not invent transmission for.

It is not a reduction of every combat myth to one template. The four-subtype framework is analytic, not doctrinal, and the book explicitly flags cases where the pattern fits poorly or where area specialists qualify or reject the application. The chapter on Nanabozho foregrounds the Anishinaabe specialist refusal (chapter 32). The chapter on Mwindo, in Nyanga oral epic from central Africa, is built around the fact that the Nyanga tradition *punishes* the hero for killing the dragon Kirimu — an outcome that does not fit the cosmogonic or sovereignty reading at all (chapter 29). Part II chapter C8 is devoted entirely to the methodological problem of refusal and appropriation: what it means for the book's project when the traditions it is comparing refuse, from inside their own conceptual framework, to be comparanda.

It is not a reception history of dragons in post-antique literature. Milton's Satan in *Paradise Lost*, the St. George and St. Michael iconography of medieval and Renaissance Christianity, the dragons of Tolkien's legendarium, the kaiju lineage that runs from the Yamata no Orochi reception into Godzilla — these are treated in a single reception coda (chapter 42) and explicitly marked as reception, not primary material. The book's primary sources end with the Sasanian-era Pahlavi redactions of the Zoroastrian tradition, around the eighth or ninth century CE. Later material is interesting and the coda acknowledges it; it is not evidence for what ancient combat myth meant in its own time.

It is also worth flagging one further issue here, because Part II chapter C8 develops it at length and chapters 29 and 32 set it up. Pattern-matching from Near Eastern or Indo-European templates onto non-Eurasian traditions is a well-documented hazard of comparative mythography. Australian specialists have repeatedly protested the treatment of the Rainbow Serpent as a chaos-monster; Anishinaabe specialists have refused the chaoskampf reading of Nanabozho and Mishipeshu; central African specialists of Nyanga oral tradition have pushed back on chaoskampf readings of the Mwindo epic. In each case, the refusal is not a gap in the tradition but a feature of the tradition, and a book that wants to take the traditions seriously has to take the refusals seriously too. The book does.

1.8. VIII. How to read the book

The book is in three movements.

Part I is thirty-two chapters of stories, organised geographically, running from Mesopotamia through the Levant, the Hebrew Bible and early Christianity, Greece and Rome, Iran, India, Egypt, the Norse and Germanic and wider Indo-European reflexes, the Slavic and Baltic material, East Asia, the Americas, Africa, Southeast Asia, Finland, and ending in North America. The geographic sequence is not arbitrary; it respects what is known about the Near-East-to-Mediterranean

transmission chain (the West-Burkert-López-Ruiz argument) and then moves outward from there. Within each cluster, the largest and best-attested combats get full-length chapters (CORE chapters in the book's internal ranking); less central material is bundled into family chapters on related reflexes. Every chapter opens with the tradition's own framing — *maꜣat* and *isfet* for Egypt, *vṛ-* "obstruction" for the Vedic, the *wak'a* succession dynamics for the Andes — before invoking the comparative category. Every chapter flags, where relevant, what area specialists have said about whether the chaoskampf reading fits. Every chapter is readable on its own, and cross-references forward to the comparative treatment in Part II.

A short methods chapter sits between Part I and Part II (chapter 33). It lays out, for readers who want it, the book's tiering system (CORE / RELATED / PROVISIONAL / CONTRASTIVE), its area-specialist citation policy, and the appropriation protocol under which non-Eurasian traditions are handled. A reader who trusts the machinery can skip it.

Part II is eight comparative chapters, each of which is the synthetic treatment of one analytic question. C1 treats combat as cosmogony (Marduk, Ninurta, Gonggong, Huitzilopochtli). C2 treats combat as sovereignty (Baal-Yamm, Zeus-Typhon, Indra-Vṛtra, Thraētaona, Kumarbi-Ullikummi, Ninurta-Anzû). C3 treats cyclical-maintenance combats (Ra-Apep, Tarḫunna-Illuyanka). C4 treats eschatological combats (Thor-Jörmungandr, Revelation 12, Frashokereti). C5 works through Watkins's Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula in detail. C6 takes up the Near-Eastern-to-Mediterranean transmission argument: Kumarbi to Hesiod, Baal-Yamm to Typhonomachy. C7 is the inversion problem: what happens to the framework when slaying the serpent ends prosperity (Bida at Wagadu) or is a sin requiring expiation (the post-Vedic Brahmin-killing reading of Vṛtra, Sigurd's curse). C8 is the critique chapter: the refusal and the appropriation problem, built around the Anishinaabe, Nyanga, and Australian cases, which answers the methodological objections raised in sections III and VI above in the book's own voice.

The back matter consists of a reception coda (chapter 42), which traces the afterlife of combat-myth imagery from Milton and Christian iconography through Tolkien and the kaiju tradition and into contemporary "chaos versus order" political rhetoric, explicitly marked as reception; and an appendix of adversaries and champions (chapter 43), giving a one-entry-per-figure reference for Tiamat, Yamm, Lôtan, Leviathan, Rahab, Vṛtra, Aži Dahāka, Apep, Jörmungandr, Typhon, Illuyanka, Ullikummi, Hedammu, the Red Dragon, Coyolxauhqui, and their opposite numbers.

Read front-to-back, the book gives you the framing, then the cases, then the comparative synthesis. Read as a reference, any Part I chapter can be picked up on its own; the comparative chapters in Part II can be read independently if you already know the cases, or used as a starting point from which to find the relevant Part I chapters.

A note on citation, translation, and marker conventions. The book is translation-mediated: no single author reads Sumerian, Akkadian, Ugaritic, Hittite, Vedic Sanskrit, Avestan, Biblical Hebrew, Koine Greek, Egyptian, Classical Nahuatl, Old Norse, Classical Chinese, and the twenty-odd other source languages involved. Each chapter is anchored on a single scholar-standard translation (Lambert for *Enūma Eliš*, van Dijk for *Lugal-e*, Smith and Pitard for the Baal Cycle, Jamison and Brereton for the Rigveda, Faulkner for the *Book of the Dead*, Hoffner and Beckman for the Hittite material, Faulkes and Larrington for the Eddic and Snorri material, and so on) and cross-checked against at least one specialist monograph. Where a translation is disputed, the chapter flags the variant and footnotes the alternatives. Inferences that go beyond what a cited source explicitly states are flagged with inline markers. Lacunae in fragmentary texts are flagged. Reconstructions name their donor

source. These conventions are machine-readable as well as human-readable, and a reader who finds them distracting can treat them as silent apparatus.

One last orientation point. The Gunkel–Ballentine debate is not settled in these pages. This introduction has laid out both positions as fully and as fairly as I can, and individual chapters will flag where one reading fits the tradition better than the other. Baal-Yamm and Yahweh-Leviathan, on Ballentine’s own analysis, read best as alternative-sovereign combats rather than chaos combats. Marduk-Tiamat is the case where the original Gunkel reading still has real force, because the cosmos is in fact made out of Tiamat’s body, and that is a cosmogony in the strong sense, not just a kingship dispute. Ra-Apep is a third kind of case, where the Egyptian *maꜥat/isfet* vocabulary offers its own indigenous framework that is neither Gunkel’s “chaos” nor Ballentine’s “alternative sovereign,” and has to be read on its own terms.^[63] The chapters ahead will keep flagging the distinctions as they come up. The word “Chaoskampf” stays on the cover because it is what readers are looking for and what scholars still use. The word “combat myth” does the work in the prose. And whether “chaos” is the right word for what is being fought — that is a question the book opens, not one it closes.

[1] Lambert 2013, pp. 3–15 on the manuscript tradition; the earliest securely datable copies are Neo-Assyrian but the composition is widely placed in the Kassite or early post-Kassite period.

[2] Lambert 2013, manuscript list, pp. 3–15.

[3] Lambert 2013, pp. 463–465; Foster 2005, p. 436.

[4] Lambert 2013, Tablet I; Foster 2005, pp. 439–444.

[5] Lambert 2013, Tablet IV, lines 101–146 and Tablet V; Foster 2005, pp. 459–467.

[6] Lambert 2013, Tablets VI–VII.

[7] ETCSL 1.6.2 (Lugal-e); van Dijk 1983.

[8] Smith 1994, on KTU 1.1–1.2.

[9] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on Rigveda 1.32.

[10] Faulkner 1972, spells 7, 39, 108; te Velde 1967.

[11] Beckman 1982; Hoffner 1998.

[12] Day 1985, chs. 1–5; the core passages are Psalm 74:13–14, Psalm 89:10, Isaiah 27:1, Isaiah 51:9–10, Job 26:12–13.

[13] Yarbro Collins 1976; Aune 1997–98, on Revelation 12.

[14] Larrington 2014 for *Hymiskviða* and *Völuspá* 56; Faulkes 1987 for Snorri, *Gylfaginning* 51.

[15] Matos Moctezuma 1988; Carrasco 1999.

[16] Gunkel 1895.

[17] Forsyth 1987, ch. 1, on the *religionsgeschichtliche Schule* context; Gunkel was a founding member.

[18] Gunkel 1895, Teil I; the philological argument for the cognacy of *tehôm* and Tiamat has been qualified but not overturned — see Day 1985, pp. 49–52.

[19] Day 1985, chs. 1–3; Smith 1994.

[20] West 1997, ch. 6; Hoffner 1998.

[21] Watkins 1995, especially Part V.

[22] Forsyth 1987, introduction, surveys the reception.

[23] Scurlock and Beal 2013. The title is deliberately a riff on Gunkel’s.

[24] Ballentine 2015.

[25] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on Baal-Yamm; drawing on Smith 1994’s reading of KTU 1.1–1.2.

[26] Assmann 2001 on the *maꜥat/isfet* framework; Ballentine 2015 for the philosophical-history argument.

[27] Lincoln 2012, especially the essays on combat and ideology.

[28] Lambert 2013, pp. 439–465, on the political context of Marduk’s promotion; Lincoln 2012 on the genre in general.

[29] The glossary (v1, 2026-04-24) locks “the adversary” as the default neutral category term and bans “chaos-figure” on the Ballentine grounds.

[30] Lambert 2013, Tablets IV–V.

- [31] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 330–650.
- [32] Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3; Birrell 1993, on the Huainanzi and Shanhaijing material.
- [33] Matos Moctezuma 1988; Carrasco 1999.
- [34] Smith 1994 and Smith and Pitard 2009, KTU 1.1–1.4.
- [35] West 1997, ch. 6 on the Hesiodic succession.
- [36] Jamison and Brereton 2014, introduction to the Indra hymns.
- [37] Hoffner 1998, on the Kumarbi cycle; West 1997.
- [38] Benveniste and Renou 1934; Watkins 1995, Part V.
- [39] Annus 2001.
- [40] Faulkner 1972, spells 7, 39, 108; te Velde 1967, ch. 3.
- [41] Beckman 1982; Hoffner 1998, on the Illuyanka narrative’s festival framing.
- [42] Faulkes 1987, *Gylfaginning* 51; Larrington 2014, *Völuspá* 56.
- [43] Yarbro Collins 1976; Aune 1997–98.
- [44] Benveniste and Renou 1934; Watkins 1995 on the Avestan and Pahlavi Frashokereti material.
- [45] Day 1985, ch. 1 especially pp. 4–18, on the Isaiah 27 / KTU 1.5 epithet pair.
- [46] West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992.
- [47] Watkins 1995, especially Part V, chs. 26 and 44–48.
- [48] Matos Moctezuma 1988, on Templo Mayor as Coatepec; López Austin 1993.
- [49] Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3.
- [50] Witzel 2012. The Laurasian hypothesis is vigorously contested; the book uses Witzel on specific stories where he is careful, not as a framework.
- [51] Lincoln 2012.
- [52] Lambert 2013, pp. 3–15.
- [53] van Dijk 1983; ETCSL 1.6.2 manuscript list.
- [54] Smith 1994, introduction.
- [55] Jamison and Brereton 2014, introduction.
- [56] te Velde 1967; Faulkner 1972.
- [57] West 2007, ch. 6; Faulkes 1987, introduction.
- [58] Matos Moctezuma 1988.
- [59] Ogden 2013, ch. 11.
- [60] Hallowell 1960 for the “other-than-human persons” framework; the chapter devoted to this material (Ch. 32) foregrounds the specialist refusal.
- [61] Belcher 1999 on the Soninke Bida/Wagadu epic tradition; Conrad 2005 on the West African context.
- [62] Sigurd is the Old Norse form this book uses for the Eddic material; Siegfried is the Middle High German counterpart in the *Nibelungenlied*, where the dragon-slaying appears only as backstory rather than as narrated action.
- [63] Assmann 2001 on *maꜣat/isfet*.

Chapter 2. Ninurta vs. Asag: The Exploits of Lugal-e

2.1. The physical evidence

The Sumerian poem that this chapter retells has no original title. Like most Sumerian literary compositions, it is known instead by its opening phrase — its incipit — and modern scholarship has kept that convention. The incipit is *lugal-e ud me-lám-bi nir-ĝál*, "O king, storm of majestic splendour," and on the strength of those first words the composition is catalogued as *Lugal-e*. The Electronic Text Corpus of Sumerian Literature, the digital scholarly standard produced at Oxford, lists it as text 1.6.2. Its working scholarly title, when scholars need an English label, is "Ninurta's Exploits." A reader will see both forms in the scholarly literature, depending on whether the citing author is following the indexing conventions of the field or the thematic handle the composition has acquired in English-language discussion.^[1]

Lugal-e is not a short poem. It is one of the longest surviving Sumerian literary compositions. The ETCSL composite text ends at line 726, and van Dijk's two-volume critical edition, published by Brill in 1983, numbers some witnesses as high as line 728 depending on how certain subscript lines are counted. Van Dijk's edition gives the composition a French subtitle that tells the reader what kind of poem he took it to be: *Le récit épique et didactique des Travaux de Ninurta, du Déluge et de la Nouvelle Création* — "the epic and didactic account of Ninurta's Labours, of the Flood, and of the New Creation." Readers used to the New Testament Gospels or Virgil's *Aeneid* will find *Lugal-e* shorter than either, but by the standards of the Sumerian literary corpus it is a very long poem.^[2]

The physical evidence for it is tablets. Dozens of them, almost all from scribal-school contexts, and almost all dating to the Old Babylonian period — the first few centuries of the second millennium BCE, when Sumerian had already been displaced as a spoken language by Akkadian but was still being taught and copied as a literary and liturgical prestige tongue. The bulk of the witnesses come from Nippur, the Sumerian temple-city where Enlil's temple stood and where scribal training was concentrated; a smaller cluster was recovered from the city of Ur. This is the provenance profile of a text used as a teaching composition. Young scribes copied it to practise their Sumerian; the copies they left behind — the exercises, the partial drafts, the fragments that broke during firing and were discarded in the school's rubbish dump — are the witnesses from which the modern composite text is reconstructed.^[3]

No single tablet preserves the whole poem. The text that modern scholars read is a composite — a running, line-numbered edition stitched together from overlapping manuscript witnesses, each of which preserves a different stretch of the poem with a different pattern of damage. Where two witnesses cover the same passage and agree, the composite follows them. Where they disagree in small ways, the edition records both. Where a stretch is covered by only one witness, that witness is the sole source for those lines. The reader is effectively reading the work of a modern editor as much as of the original poet — although the modern editor's work is philological, not creative.^[4]

Lugal-e had a long afterlife as school material. It was excerpted, copied, and eventually bilingualised — arranged in Sumerian-Akkadian interlinear form, with a line of the Sumerian on top and a line-by-line Akkadian translation beneath — for use in temple-school curricula well into the first millennium BCE, long after Sumerian had ceased to be anyone's spoken language. This

longevity is why the text survived: it kept being copied, and copying is the only way a cuneiform text outlasts the tablet it was first written on. A composition that fell out of the scribal curriculum vanished. *Lugal-e* did not; it stayed in the curriculum for the better part of two millennia, and the tablets that document that continuous copying are the raw material of the modern edition.^[5]

The standard critical edition is van Dijk 1983, two volumes from Brill. Volume one contains the introduction, the transliteration of the Sumerian, and a French translation. Volume two contains the cuneiform copies, the manuscript apparatus, and a glossary. This is the philological anchor, and every serious modern discussion of the poem cites it.^[6]

The English translation on which this chapter's narrative is keyed is the ETCSL composite, produced between 1998 and 2006 by Jeremy Black, Graham Cunningham, Esther Flückiger-Hawker, Eleanor Robson, and Gábor Zólyomi. ETCSL follows van Dijk's Sumerian reconstruction closely, with a handful of lexical modernisations where van Dijk used more tentative French readings.^[7]

The body prose of this chapter is keyed to the ETCSL English composite, with line numbers following van Dijk 1983.^[8]

The story, as the tablets preserve it, goes as follows.

2.2. Setting: Ninurta at Nippur

The hero of the poem is Ninurta. In the Sumerian pantheon, Ninurta is a warrior-god, the son of Enlil, and the divine patron of the city of Nippur.^[9]

Enlil, Ninurta's father, is the chief god of the Sumerian pantheon. He is the lord of the air and of command, and he resides at the temple-complex called E-kur — "the House that is a Mountain" — in the city of Nippur. The significance of Enlil in the story is institutional as well as familial: he is Ninurta's father, and he is the god whose authorisation ultimately matters.^[10]

Standing behind this story — though he does not act in it as much as Enlil does — is Enki, the Sumerian god of wisdom and fresh water, the counsellor of the gods in the Sumerian corpus. Readers acquainted with later Mesopotamian tradition will recognise him under another name: his Akkadian counterpart is Ea, who reappears in the later Babylonian receptions of this narrative and in the combat myths of the Akkadian-language period. In *Lugal-e* he is Enki.^[11]

Lugal-e opens with a hymnic proem that addresses Ninurta directly, celebrating his martial prowess and the favour of the higher gods. The opening is not a narrative but a praise-song, and its function is to name the hero and to establish the register in which the story that follows will be told.^[12]

The opening lines of the proem read as a continuous hymnic invocation in the ETCSL composite of lines 1–19.^[13]

After this opening, the narrative's action begins. Ninurta is seated in celebration — a feast, the precise occasion of which the text does not specify — when his weapon alerts him to a threat rising in the mountains.^[14]

The adversary named in that first report is Asag. Asag is a monstrous being whose parentage is significant: he is the son of Heaven (An) and Earth (Ki). Asag rules the mountains and is served by an army of stone-warriors.^[15]

The mountains in this poem are not a neutral landscape. The Sumerian term is *kur*, and its semantic range is wide: it can mean "mountain," "foreign land," or "netherworld" depending on context, and across the Sumerian literary corpus it accumulates a cluster of negative associations. The *kur* is where things go when they die and where hostile peoples come from, as well as where the physical mountains lie. When Ninurta marches against the *kur*, he is marching against a zone that carries all three of those associations at once. The word does the work of a three-way description without needing three separate terms, and any Sumerian reader — or, later, any Akkadian scribe-apprentice taught the word in its Sumerian context — would have understood that all three connotations were active.^[16]

The weapon that alerts Ninurta is named Šarur, and it is one of the strangest features of the poem. Šarur is not a passive implement. Throughout *Lugal-e* the mace is an animate, speaking agent — it flies, it scouts, it reports, it argues, it counsels, it praises. The text treats it as a character. This animate-weapon motif is a structural feature of the composition, not an occasional flourish; Šarur speaks more lines than most of the minor deities in the poem, and the combat sequence cannot be followed without paying attention to what the mace says and when.

A reader encountering Šarur for the first time may be tempted to read the speaking weapon as a stylistic convention — a poetic personification, a trick by which the poet dramatises the hero's own deliberations. That reading will run into difficulty. The mace in *Lugal-e* does not express Ninurta's inner voice; it repeatedly disagrees with him, and the disagreements drive the plot. Šarur is a separate agent. The fact that his voice belongs to the weapon rather than to a separate deity is part of what makes the composition distinctive, and it is part of what makes the poem a natural reference point when later traditions give storm-gods named or speaking weapons of their own.^[17]

2.3. The scouting and the challenge

Šarur, then, is the scout. His first speech to Ninurta delivers the news: Asag has been born from the union of An and Ki, and now reigns among the mountains. The mace reports what it has seen. The report is not diplomatic preamble but raw intelligence: parentage, territory, current status. It is the kind of briefing that a military commander would want from a scout returning from a reconnaissance sweep, and the poem delivers it in those terms.^[18]

Asag does not rule alone. He is surrounded by an army of stone-warriors, and the ETCSL composite names several of the stone-types that serve him. They include *šu*, *saĝkal*, *esi*, *usium*, and *kagena* — a catalogue of Sumerian stone-names, some of which can be identified with known materials (*esi* is diorite, *kagena* is haematite) and some of which remain philological puzzles. The catalogue matters for a reason that will become clear only at the end of the poem, when each of these stone-types is summoned back for judgement.^[19]

Šarur's first report also gives the reason why Ninurta must act. Asag's forces are terrorising the cities of the land. This is not a distant cosmic threat; the poem frames it as a political-military crisis pressing on the settled Sumerian world from the uplands to the east. The combat, in other words, is not a contest in some abstract zone of the cosmos. It is a response to a concrete emergency affecting the cities whose priests and scribes would eventually copy and recite the poem.^[20]

The mace then delivers a second speech. Its tone shifts from report to call-to-arms: Šarur urges

Ninurta to act, framing the threat as a direct challenge to Ninurta's kingship and to the divine powers that support it. The logic is explicit. Asag's rule in the mountains is, by implication, a rival rule. If Ninurta does not respond, the rivalry stands.

This is a significant framing. Šarur is not saying that the cities need rescuing because they are suffering. He says that the adversary's existence is a challenge to the warrior-god's own kingship — the kingship that has been established in the proem and that the poem has already been celebrating. The mace is telling the hero that what is at stake is political, in the specifically theological sense of that word: whose rule, which gods'.^[21]

A third speech follows, and it is more unsettling than the first two. Šarur now describes Asag's invulnerability. Conventional weapons, the mace warns, cannot penetrate the adversary. Asag's hide is of an order that does not yield to the ordinary instruments of combat. The weapon is telling the warrior-god that the ordinary tools of his trade will not work. It is a strange thing for a weapon to say, and it is meant to be. A mace that reports its own inadequacy against a particular target is a mace that has looked at the target closely, and the report is therefore as credible as any intelligence the hero is going to receive.^[22]

Ninurta, roused by the reports, gathers his army and his storm-weapons and marches toward the mountain lands. The text describes the march as attended by cosmic disturbance: clouds rise around him, lightning accompanies him, and the eight winds come out to walk with him. This is the first indication in the poem that Ninurta is not just a warrior but a storm-warrior, and that his approach to the *kur* alters the weather over Sumer.^[23]

A first combat phase follows. Ninurta destroys the enemy cities and rebel settlements of the *kur* — not Asag himself, but the strongholds subordinate to him. Šarur, meanwhile, flies forward in a separate role: he functions as a reconnaissance weapon, covering ground that his wielder cannot, and returns to Ninurta with reports on Asag's movements. The mace is now acting as a scout as well as a weapon.

This division of labour is one of the features that makes the scouting sequence of *Lugal-e* structurally unusual. In most warrior-narratives, a hero does his own reconnaissance or gets it from a human subordinate. Here the reconnaissance is done by the weapon, and it is done at a scale that allows the weapon to cover the whole landscape between Ninurta's army and Asag's mountain. The poem is exploiting the animate-weapon motif to solve a narrative problem — how to give the reader access to the adversary without putting the hero in premature contact with him — and the solution is elegant. Šarur is the poem's camera.^[24]

It is in one of these reconnaissance returns that Šarur does something that sets the poem apart from the cleaner victorious-warrior narratives with which readers may be familiar. The mace delivers a catalogue. It runs through Ninurta's earlier victories — the monsters Ninurta has previously defeated — and the list is long. It includes Kuli-ana, the Dragon, the Gypsum-monster, the Copper-monster, the Six-headed Ram, the Magilum-boat, Saman-ana, the Bison, the Palm-king, Anzud (the lion-headed eagle), and the Seven-headed Snake. This passage is sometimes called the "trophy list" of Ninurta's combats, and it reads, at first, like a catalogue of triumphs — a reminder of the hero's credentials.^[25]

It is not flattery, though. The catalogue functions as an argument from precedent, and the direction of the argument is not the one a reader expects. Šarur is listing the past victories to measure the

gravity of the present challenge, not to cheer his wielder into battle. The weight of the catalogue — eleven defeated adversaries, many of them serious — becomes, in the mace's mouth, a scale on which the new adversary is going to be weighed.^[26]

And Asag, Šarur tells Ninurta, outweighs them all. This is the unusual moment. The mace, having recited the trophy list, urges caution. Asag surpasses every previous foe. Šarur pleads with Ninurta not to engage directly. The weapon is attempting to dissuade its own wielder from combat. It is a scene with no close parallel in the surviving warrior-narrative corpus of the Near East: the hero's own weapon, without ceasing to be loyal, tells the hero that this fight is beyond him.

The sequence of three speeches — report, call-to-arms, warning — and then the trophy-list-and-caution combination together give Šarur a larger speaking role in the first half of the composition than any other figure aside from Ninurta himself. The weapon's speeches are not ornamental interludes between the action scenes. They are the mechanism by which the poem introduces its adversary, calibrates the stakes, and stages a debate about whether the combat should happen at all. A reader who skims over Šarur's speeches will miss the plot.^[27]

Ninurta refuses. He will not withdraw. He advances into the mountain. The text marks the scene with images of day turning to darkness as he marches — the storm-warrior has brought his weather with him, and his approach has dimmed the sun over the *kur*.

The hero's refusal to be counselled by his own weapon is characteristic, and necessary for the plot. If Šarur's warnings had worked, the poem would end at line 150 with Ninurta turning back, and there would be no combat, no Tigris, no mountain-naming, no stone-judgements. The hero's refusal to listen is, in the narrative's economy, what permits the rest of the poem to happen. The text does not moralise about it. The refusal is reported and then absorbed, and the narrative moves on.^[28]

When Asag emerges against him, the force of the adversary is described in apocalyptic terms. Cosmic order shakes. The gods of the pantheon are reported as cowering before the confrontation. Whatever Asag is, the text makes him an order of being at which the sky itself flinches.^[29]

The narrative cuts, at this pitch, to Enlil in Nippur. The father-god speaks to his consort Ninlil, and what he says is a lament, not a command. "My son is no longer here; what supports me?" Enlil says. His son has gone out of sight into the *kur*, and the pillars of Enlil's own authority — the son who acts for him, the martial arm that executes his will — are shaken. The passage is one of the most psychologically candid in the Sumerian corpus: the chief god, at the crisis point of the combat, is not issuing orders. He is voicing doubt.

That doubt is structurally important. If Enlil were confident, the combat would be a formality and the poem a triumphal march. The lament tells the reader that the outcome of the fight with Asag was, in the narrative's frame, uncertain even to the chief god who had authorised it. It also sets up the intercession scene that follows, because someone — some character — has to resolve Enlil's paralysis, and the poem gives that job not to another deity but to the speaking mace.^[30]

Šarur, at this point, does something remarkable for a weapon. He flies from the battlefield — away from his wielder, in the middle of the combat — all the way back to Enlil at the E-kur in Nippur. The mace is now acting as an intercessor. He goes to Enlil to receive further instruction on behalf of the son who has gone into the *kur*.^[31]

Enlil, thus prompted, issues the authorisation that was missing. He blesses Ninurta's mission, but he

adds a condition. Ninurta is permitted to slay Asag — the violence is authorised — but the fertility of the land and the species that dwell upon it must be preserved. The charge is not only "defeat the adversary." It is "defeat the adversary without ruining the world you are defending." This conditional structure is important; it shapes everything that follows.

It is also, in a quiet way, the reason the poem has its distinctive aftermath. If Enlil had issued an unconditional authorisation, Ninurta could have killed Asag and walked home. The conditional charge obliges the hero to repair the damage the combat will inevitably cause. The long second half of the poem — the dam, the mountain, the stones, the grain-stewardship — is, in a sense, the execution of that condition. Enlil has asked his son to defend the land in a way that leaves the land still able to feed its people when the fighting is done.^[32]

Šarur races back with the mandate. The text marks the mace's speed and joy at bearing the authorising word; the weapon is glad to carry the sanction that will let the combat finish. The mace's mood, it is worth noting, has now shifted. Through the trophy-list and the warnings, the speaking weapon has been trying to prevent the combat. With the authorisation from Enlil in hand, the same weapon is now eager for the combat to proceed. The animate agent has not changed; the conditions under which he was counselling caution have.^[33]

Upon reaching Ninurta, Šarur delivers a specific battle-directive derived from Enlil's charge. Pierce Asag's liver, he tells the warrior, and bring that organ to the E-kur. The instruction is oddly surgical; it specifies the target, and it specifies what to do with the trophy.

The narrative has now rounded a full cycle. Šarur opens the poem by alerting Ninurta; he closes the pre-combat sequence by telling Ninurta exactly where to strike. In between, he has reported, urged, warned, scouted, praised the past, and counselled retreat. He has also, in a moment of real structural weight, carried a message across the full length of the narrative geography — from the battlefield in the *kur* to Enlil's throne at the E-kur — and back again. The combat can begin in earnest only because the weapon has done this preparatory work.^[34]

2.4. The combat

The combat intensifies. Ninurta's weapons devastate the landscape — the storm-warrior's arsenal is not delicate — but Asag endures. The adversary's invulnerability, which Šarur had warned about in his third speech, is not an exaggeration. Whatever Ninurta does is absorbed. Šarur interjects again. The mace urges retreat.^[35]

Šarur's final plea frames the adversary in new terms. Asag is storm-like and uncontrollable, the mace says. He is a force of an order unfamiliar to conventional combat — not a warrior who can be out-fought, but a kind of weather-system with hostile intent. The mace's counsel is consistent: this is not a fight Ninurta can win by pressing harder.^[36]

Ninurta presses harder anyway, and this time he succeeds. He overpowers Asag and reduces the adversary to a heap of rubble and dust. The slaying fulfils the combat charge from Enlil — the liver has been pierced, the adversary has fallen, the mandate has been executed.

The description of the defeated body as a heap of rubble and dust is the first signal of what the defeated adversary is about to become, even before Ninurta names him Stone. The adversary does not dissolve into sea-foam or into atmospheric elements, as defeated adversaries will in some later

combat myths. He falls apart into the kind of matter that is already at work in the Sumerian landscape — rubble and dust, the building material of embankments and of mountain-heaps. The descriptive word-choice anticipates the geographical work that the rest of the poem will carry out.^[37]

The scene immediately following the slaying is brief but significant. The gods prostrate themselves before Ninurta. The pantheon that was cowering a few hundred lines earlier is now acknowledging the victor. Šarur, for his part, turns from counsellor back into a voice of praise and sings the victor's praise.

The mace's shift of role here is worth noting. Through the first half of the composition, Šarur's voice has been an agent of restraint — a check on the warrior's impulse to fight. After the slaying, the voice becomes celebratory. The weapon has not changed character; it has moved from one phase of its function to the next. A mace that can speak can also sing, and the poem makes full use of that range.^[38]

Ninurta then pronounces a decree over the defeated body. Henceforth, he says, the adversary shall be called "Stone." The renaming is not incidental. It transforms the adversary's narrative category. Asag the mountain-demon, son of An and Ki, becomes Stone — the material. And because Asag had an army of stone-warriors as his retinue, that single decree sets up the long aetiological sequence that will occupy the poem's final third: the judgement of each stone-type according to what it did in the battle.

The renaming deserves a moment of attention on its own, because it changes what kind of poem the reader is reading. Up to this point, *Lugal-e* has been a combat narrative. With the renaming, it becomes a charter for material culture. The adversary, having been defeated as a person, is now available to be treated as a category of matter; and the stone-warriors of his retinue, having been defeated as combatants, are available to be treated as stone-types with destinies that can be fixed. The decree is the pivot on which the second half of the composition turns.^[39]

Before moving on to the stones, Ninurta pronounces a blessing over his own club — a formulaic closure of the combat proper. The weapon that struck the decisive blow receives a brief consecration. The structural cue is that the combat-episode is now over.^[40]

2.5. Ordering the waters

The aftermath of combat, in *Lugal-e*, is not triumph. It is crisis. The landscape has been disturbed. The waters of the mountain are blocked; the fields lie barren; famine threatens the land. Ninurta has killed Asag but, in killing him, has broken the hydraulic order on which the cultivated Sumerian plain depends. Enlil's condition — preserve the fertility of the land — is now a task, not a constraint. The slaying, on its own, has done nothing to feed anyone.

The structural turn here is worth noticing. The slaying of Asag does not produce the cosmos by itself. The combat is step one; everything that makes the world work — the river, the mountain, the material hierarchy, the administrative order — still has to be built afterwards, piece by piece, under the constraint that Enlil has imposed. The poem, in other words, refuses the short cut in which victory and cosmic order are the same event.^[41]

Ninurta addresses the water-crisis as an engineer would. He heaps up a great embankment of

stones over the mountain. The uncontrolled waters are dammed and channelled. The text describes the construction in technical terms that would be recognisable to any Sumerian farmer who had ever helped clear a canal: the stones are used to build a barrage, the barrage tames the mountain run-off, and the tamed run-off is directed into a single channel — the Tigris.

That the barrage is built out of *stones* is itself meaningful. The stones that Ninurta uses are, within the narrative logic of the poem, pieces of the defeated adversary and his army. The hero is not calling up new material from nothing. He is taking the body of the defeated combatant, and the bodies of the stone-warriors who fought with the combatant, and using them to build the dam. The poem is careful about this. The material of the landscape the hero now makes is the same material that resisted him a hundred lines earlier.^[42]

The Tigris is the great river of eastern Mesopotamia. In *Lugal-e* it is Ninurta's reordering of its flow — after the combat, as the second half of his cosmogonic work — that establishes the irrigation regime on which the farmland of Sumer depends. The poem is claiming, as a matter of mythic charter, that the hydraulic system which Sumerian farmers actually used owes its existence to Ninurta's engineering after the defeat of Asag.^[43]

With the Tigris set in order, the consequences unfold immediately. Barley flourishes. Kings rejoice. The trading colonies expand. The text registers, in a few quick lines, a restored economic and agricultural prosperity: the fields are producing, the rulers are benefiting, the commercial networks that the Sumerian city-states ran with their neighbours are once again functioning. The combat's order-making work is beginning to show its dividends.^[44]

2.6. Naming the mountain

One consequence of the combat has not yet been addressed, and it is at this point that a new character enters the narrative. Ninurta's mother, the goddess variously named Ninma, comes on stage. She laments the inaccessibility of the mountains where she used to dwell. The landscape that Ninurta has just reshaped includes her old territory, and she has been cut off from it. She travels to her son to make the case for her relationship to the newly reordered *kur*.

The mother-goddess's entry shifts the register of the composition. Up to this point the poem has been martial and hydraulic. With Ninma's arrival, a familial note enters. The encounter between son and mother is also the mechanism by which a senior deity of the pantheon receives a new title, which is how the poem performs its second major piece of cosmogonic work — not by renaming the adversary, as before, but by renaming a goddess.^[45]

Ninurta honours his mother. He decrees that the stone-heap raised over the defeated Asag shall be called "Mountain" — *ursag* in Sumerian — and that she shall be its divine keeper under the new name Nin_uursag, "Lady of the Mountain." The decree is double: it gives a name to a new feature of the cosmic landscape, and it reassigns the mother-goddess to be the presiding deity of that feature. She enters the poem as Ninma and leaves it as Nin_uursag.^[46]

Ninurta then endows the new Mountain with abundance. Herbs, honey, metals, and wildlife are conferred on it as its produce. The mountain is not to be a dead heap of stones. It is to be a productive ecological zone, and the list of its endowments — aromatic plants, sweetener, ore, game — corresponds to the kinds of goods that the lowland Sumerian cities obtained from the uplands in practice.^[47]

The renaming episode ties the combat's aftermath directly to the cultic profile of Nin^uursaĝa, one of the senior goddesses of the Sumerian pantheon. The poem, among other things, offers a narrative etymology for one of her titles — the title that gives her dominion over the mountain that Ninurta has just raised out of Asag's defeated stone-army.^[48]

2.7. The judgement of the stones

The mountain has been named. The waters have been ordered. There remains the matter of Asag's defeated army — the stone-warriors who fought on his side. A new divine voice now intervenes to raise this unfinished business. The goddess Aruru, another senior mother-goddess of the Sumerian pantheon, reminds Ninurta that the fates of the slain warriors — now lying as stones at the feet of the newly named mountain — have yet to be fixed.^[49]

What follows is one of the most remarkable sequences in Sumerian literature. The lapidary aetiology — the judgement of the stones — runs approximately from line 416 to line 647, more than two hundred lines. It assigns each stone-type a destiny: honour or contempt, cultic use or mundane use, reward or punishment, according to what that stone-type did during the battle. Stones that resisted Ninurta are punished. Stones that supported him, or at least stayed neutral, are rewarded. The destinies that Ninurta pronounces are not mythic abstractions; they map, type by type, onto the actual ritual and craft-economic status of those stones in historical Mesopotamian practice.

This is worth pausing on before the individual stone-judgements are walked through, because it is an unusual kind of narrative work for a combat myth to do. Most combat myths in the region and period, when they generate aftermath, generate it in the form of geography and kingship: a mountain is raised, a river is re-routed, a throne is established. *Lugal-e* does those things too. But it also, uniquely within the corpus, generates a catalogue of materials — a classification of the mineral world into reward-categories and punishment-categories that corresponds precisely to how Sumerian craftsmen actually worked those materials. Temple-grade stones earn their status by loyalty in battle. Abrasive stones earn their abrasive use by resistance. The poem is giving the mineral economy of Sumer a mythic charter, judgement by judgement, over more than two hundred lines. The modern reader may find the sequence long. A Sumerian scribe-apprentice copying it at a tablet-house in Nippur would have found it a working manual for why the objects around him — the temple statue, the king's seal, the grinding-stone in the kitchen — were made of the materials they were made of.^[50]

The sequence opens with a curse. The *u* stone, which modern scholarship identifies as emery — an abrasive mineral used for grinding and polishing — is the first to receive judgement. Ninurta curses it. Its resistance in the battle, the text says, is punished by an unfavourable destiny.^[51]

The second judgement is a reward. The *šu* and *gasura* stones are assigned to be shaped by the goldsmith to form a matrix for ritual creations. They will be used, the decree says, to hold "the first fruits of the gods" at the time of the new moon. This is a specific cultic privilege: these stones will be in direct contact with the offerings that mark the lunar calendar, and the goldsmith — a high-status craftsman in the Sumerian economy — will be the artisan who shapes them.^[52]

The *saĝkal*, *gulgul*, and *saĝĝar* stones are judged next, and together. They are condemned to contempt, poverty, and servitude. The triple judgement suggests that in Ninurta's assessment they acted together against him, and their punishment is correspondingly collective.^[53]

Then comes one of the longer individual judgements, and one of the most important for what it tells the reader about how this poem thinks about materials. The *esi* stone — diorite — receives a destiny of high honour. It is to be quarried from Magan, the land across the Persian Gulf from which Sumer imported its hard stone, and it is to be shaped for temple use. Specifically, it is to be made into statuary and libation-vessels. Diorite was, historically, the preferred material for royal statues and for ritual bowls in the Sumerian and Akkadian temple corpus; the poem is giving that high cultic status a narrative origin. A reader with access to a museum collection of Sumerian art will have seen the working-out of the verdict the poem issues here.^[54]

The *na* stone fares badly. It is cursed: to be broken up, its fragments discarded. The judgement is terse, and the punishment is total.^[55]

The *elēl* stone, by contrast, is rewarded. It is to be set on a pedestal and praised by all the lands. Where *na* is broken and discarded, *elēl* is displayed and honoured. The opposition is deliberate: the poem is drawing contrasts between successive judgements.^[56]

The *kagena* stone — haematite, a dense iron-oxide mineral used in antiquity for seals, weights, and polished objects — receives a destiny of high status. It is blessed to serve as a judge-stone in foreign lands and to be valued alongside gold. The detail that it functions as a judge-stone is not incidental. Haematite weights were used to standardise commercial transactions in the Mesopotamian economy; the stone's juridical function in the narrative maps onto its role in the actual regulation of trade.^[57]

The *gišnugal* stone — alabaster, a soft white stone used for seals and for small prestige vessels — is honoured for loyalty and is assigned the role of treasury seal-keeper. Alabaster seals are documented in the Mesopotamian archaeological record, and they were used precisely to authenticate access to valuables. The poem is again giving a historical craft-use a mythic pedigree.^[58]

The *algameš* stone is cursed. It is to be consumed by the smiths' fires as a daily sacrifice — used up in metalworking, not preserved. Whatever *algameš* was, the text is assigning it the role of a consumable flux-material or a tempering stone, its value realised only in its destruction.^[59]

A cluster of precious stones is then judged together. *Nir*, *gug* (carnelian, a red-orange variety of chalcedony) and *zagin* (lapis lazuli, the deep-blue stone that Mesopotamian craftsmen imported from the east) receive a collective honour. They are to be mounted in precious metal and displayed at libations. Carnelian and lapis lazuli were the two signature jewelry-stones of the Sumerian craft tradition, and the poem's judgement of this cluster gives their high status a mythic rationale.^[60]

The *gir-zu-ĝal* stone — flint — is cursed. Its horns are split; it is reduced to powder under the hands of metalworkers and carpenters. Flint, in the Sumerian craft economy, had once been a tool-stone for blades and cutting implements; by the second millennium BCE, as metalwork displaced stone-blade cutting, it had been progressively relegated to ancillary uses such as abrasive powder and scraper-chips. The judgement captures the material's declining cultic status.^[61]

The *iman* and *alliga* stones are punished together. Their cries go unheeded, and they are barred from the palace. The image is striking: the stones are given voices, and those voices are then refused an audience. The punishment is social as much as material — these stones will not be allowed into the royal court.^[62]

The *mašda*, *dubban*, and *urutum* stones are condemned collectively and in violent terms. They are to be slaughtered, crushed, sharpened for weapons, and battered. The vocabulary of the judgement is almost butcher's-shop: these stones are not just demoted, they are rendered into working-material and worn out in service.^[63]

The *šagara* stone is punished in a more ritually specific way. It is cast on the dais and fed malt like a sheep. The image is a parody of a cultic offering-ritual: a stone being treated as though it were a sacrificial animal, and by implication a deliberately low-status one. The judgement is a calibrated lowering of the stone's cultic status.^[64]

Then a reward. The *maruša* stone is rewarded: it becomes a filter-bowl for sacred libations and an inlay-work ornament. Both roles are high-status craft applications. A filter-bowl was used to strain offerings before they were poured; inlay-work is the specialist technique of embedding small pieces of coloured stone into a substrate to make decorative panels.^[65]

A different kind of judgement follows. The *aštum* stone is not rewarded or cursed; it is renamed for its function. Henceforth, Ninurta decrees, it is to be known as "Ditch" — *aštum*. Its name is derived from the trench-like use to which Ninurta assigns it. The judgement is an aetiology of the stone's own Sumerian name.^[66]

The *durul* stone is honoured in a manner that picks up the international-trade theme again. Ninurta magnifies its name and decrees that foreign nations shall seek it out. The judgement imports a real feature of the Sumerian stone-trade — that certain stones were in demand across the wider region — and gives it a narrative warrant.^[67]

The *šegšeg*, *engen*, and *ezinum* stones receive a more complicated set of judgements. The passage in which they occur is dense and difficult, and the outcomes vary from stone to stone. Some of the imagery here is opaque even to modern Sumerologists, and the text's language outruns our ability to map it cleanly onto known craft-uses.^[68]

The final group of judgements in the sequence is a cultic consecration. The *kurgaranum*, *bal*, and *šembi* stones — the last of which is kohl, the black pigment used around the eyes in Near Eastern cosmetics and in some cultic contexts — are assigned to the cult of Ninursaga. In her festivals, they will be honoured. The sequence closes by returning the stones to the goddess who was installed over the mountain a hundred lines earlier, completing a narrative loop.^[69]

Taken together, the lapidary aetiology is a retributive structure. Its logic is simple once the reader sees it. Stones that took Asag's side are punished; stones that stayed neutral or favoured Ninurta are rewarded; and the destinies decreed correspond to the actual ritual and craft-economic status of each stone-type in historical Mesopotamian practice. The poem is not inventing a hierarchy of stones. It is narrating the hierarchy that the Sumerian craft economy already used, and providing a mythic rationale for why that hierarchy is the hierarchy it is.

The pattern of the sequence — punishment, reward, punishment, reward, with occasional reuse-and-rename judgements breaking the alternation — gives the lapidary aetiology a shape that rewards careful reading. It is not a bare list. It is a sequence of courtroom verdicts, each handed down over a defeated combatant and each producing a specific working relationship between that combatant and the human world. Some of the stones are assigned to the goldsmith's workshop, some to the palace treasury, some to the temple, some to the smith's forge, some to the cosmetic kit.

The verdicts read, in places, like a job-placement programme for a demobilised army.^[70]

(The lapidary aetiology is simultaneously a narrative reward-and-punishment sequence and an aetiological explanation of the hardness, colour, and ritual status of individual stone-types as used by Sumerian craftsmen.^[71])

2.8. The triumphant return

With the stone-judgements concluded, the poem turns to its final movement: Ninurta's return to Nippur. The warrior-god embarks on a barge named Ma-kar-nunta-ea for the return voyage. The naming of the barge is typical of Sumerian literary practice — significant vessels receive proper names — and the embarkation is the formal beginning of the triumphal passage home.^[72]

The boatmen sing. Their hymn exalts Ninurta as the unrivalled king of the Anuna, the Sumerian divine assembly. This is the first time in the poem that Ninurta is addressed in a direct royal register by a chorus of voices; the position he has earned is now being sung back to him. The claim that he is unrivalled is, in the poem's logic, now defensible: the rival sovereign from the mountains has been defeated, the stone-warriors have been judged, and the cosmic consequences of the fight have been brought under order. The boatmen's hymn is the first piece of evidence the poem offers that the claim has taken.^[73]

The text then shifts register once more, away from narrative and into prayer. A short passage blesses the devotee who maintains Ninurta's temple. The shift is characteristic of Sumerian hymnic literature, which often embeds prayer-passages addressed to the worshipper inside larger narrative frames.^[74]

A brief invocation follows, calling upon the sky-god An and the healing-goddess Bau to look favourably upon the worshipper. The pairing enlists both the highest-ranking deity of the Sumerian theogony and a senior healing-deity in the blessing of the person who keeps Ninurta's cult.^[75]

Ninurta then arrives home. The Anuna — the divine assembly — receive him with prayers and praise. The homecoming is framed as a ritual reception: the pantheon that was shaken at the combat's mid-point, and that prostrated itself immediately after the slaying, now receives the victor formally, in its collective capacity.^[76]

Enlil, Ninurta's father, now bestows the final blessing. The content of the blessing is threefold: eternal life, a celestial mace, and an unchanging rule. Each of the three elements corresponds to something Ninurta has earned. The life is the reward for having survived the combat. The mace is the consecration of the weapon-role that the composition has been exploring throughout. The unchanging rule is the formal confirmation of the kingship-status that the boatmen and the Anuna have just sung to him.

The three-part blessing closes, at the level of narrative mechanics, the conditional charge that Enlil issued back at the mid-point of the combat. Enlil had told Šarur that Ninurta could slay the adversary provided the land and its species were preserved. Ninurta has done both. He has killed Asag, and he has ordered the landscape so that it can support life. The final blessing is Enlil's acknowledgement that the condition has been met.^[77]

The poem's closing movement brings one more figure into the ordered cosmos. Ninurta appoints

the wise goddess Nisaba as guardian of the granaries and of agricultural order, entrusting her with the stewardship of grain.

The appointment closes the practical loop that the combat opened. Water was the first problem after the slaying. Stone was the second. Grain — how to grow it, how to store it, how to record it — is the third, and the one that will matter most in the day-to-day working life of the Sumerian cities that the combat was fought to protect. Nisaba's portfolio ties the mythic charter to the bureaucratic machinery that made the cities run.^[78]

Extended epithets follow, celebrating Nisaba as judge, as keeper of records, and as divine administrator. These epithets do work the reader might otherwise miss: they tie the post-combat order directly into the scribal-administrative life of the Sumerian city. The poem does not end with military victory and a feast. It ends with the goddess of bureaucracy receiving her portfolio.^[79]

The composition closes with a brief invocation calling for the praise of Ninurta and of Enlil. A doxology — the technical term for a short concluding formula of praise — returns the poem to the hymnic register with which it began.^[80]

The colophon of the composite tablet-tradition identifies the poem as a *šir-sud* (?) to Ninurta — a classification of Sumerian hymnic song whose exact performance context is uncertain. The question mark in the transliteration is the editors' own, and it signals that the reading of the genre-label is not entirely secure. Whatever *šir-sud* meant to a Sumerian scribe, it placed *Lugal-e* in the larger family of praise-songs directed at named gods.^[81]

2.9. What the combat makes

Read as a whole, the poem is striking for how much order-making work the combat has done by the time the doxology closes it. The fight with Asag occupies perhaps a quarter of the composition; the remaining three-quarters are given over to consequences. This ratio is itself a statement about what kind of poem *Lugal-e* is. It is not a duel-narrative with ritual footnotes. It is a charter for an entire cosmos — geographical, cultic, economic, royal — in which the duel is the hinge that makes the charter possible. Four separate orderings can be listed.

The combat reorders the flow of the Tigris and establishes the irrigation regime that underwrites Sumerian agriculture. The cosmogonic work, in other words, is hydraulic. The river that Sumerian farmers used is the river whose course Ninurta set after the slaying of Asag. This is the poem's concrete geographical claim: the landscape of settled Sumer exists in the shape it does because of a combat.^[82]

The combat renames the stone-heap as the Mountain (𒌷*ursaĝ*) and creates the cultic profile of the mother-goddess Nin𒌷*ursaĝa*. A new geographical feature, a new divine title, and a new cultic portfolio all emerge out of a single decree over the defeated body.^[83]

The combat fixes the destinies of the stones, assigning to each stone-type its ritual status, its craft-use, and its social value within the Sumerian economy. The mineral hierarchy of Sumerian craft — why diorite is temple-grade, why flint is ground to dust, why carnelian and lapis are jewelry-grade — is given a narrative pedigree.^[84]

And Ninurta's victory in *Lugal-e* provides a model of the victorious king. This model becomes the

template for Sumerian and later Akkadian royal ideology of the warrior-ruler. Kings who want to claim the authority of a Ninurta-like figure — who want to claim that their military success has established an order that the scribes and priests of Enlil can certify — have a narrative charter in this poem. The charter outlives the Sumerian language itself.^[85]

Each of these four is a separate kind of work — hydraulic, geographical, economic, political — and all four are generated by the same combat. The combat myth, in the form *Lugal-e* gives it, is a multi-purpose instrument. It can be read as cosmogony, as royal legitimation, as craft-economic aetiology, or as a narrative about divine family relations, and none of those readings exhausts it. This multifunctionality is part of why the poem remained useful to Mesopotamian scribal culture for many centuries.

2.10. Place in the corpus

Lugal-e has a particular position in the history of scholarship on combat myths, and it is worth naming briefly. Hermann Gunkel's 1895 thesis — the book that gave the category "Chaoskampf" its name and that is the starting point for this volume's introduction — already identified the Sumerian Ninurta narratives as important antecedents to the combat-myth pattern he was reconstructing for Genesis 1 and Revelation 12. Gunkel worked from the imperfect textual access of his period; what he knew of the Ninurta tradition came largely through its later bilingual receptions and through the fragmentary cuneiform publications available in the 1890s. The basic intuition, however, was correct. *Lugal-e* belongs in the deep background of the scholarly argument he was making. The intervening century of philological work has filled in the tradition Gunkel could only glimpse, and the tradition has turned out to be richer and stranger than he supposed.^[86]

The reassessment of Gunkel's thesis that Scurlock and Beal edited in 2013 revisits this material with the benefit of the intervening century. *Creation and Chaos* contains chapters on the Ninurta corpus that relocate the combat-myth framework within the specific politics and cultic logic of Sumerian and Babylonian religion, rather than treating it as a mirror of some generic primordial-imagination-of-chaos.^[87]

One more transmission-history point belongs here before the chapter closes. *Lugal-e* was excerpted into bilingual Sumerian-Akkadian school tablets through the first millennium BCE. The Akkadian-speaking scribes of the later Babylonian and Assyrian periods could no longer read Sumerian fluently, but they continued to copy and gloss the poem as part of the scholarly curriculum, producing interlinear editions in which each line of Sumerian is followed by an Akkadian rendering. This long afterlife is the mechanism by which the Ninurta-Asag narrative reached the later Mesopotamian combat-myth tradition at all. It is a reception-history matter rather than a part of the original story — but the curriculum-copying is why we have the tablets we have, and it is why later compositions that draw on *Lugal-e* could do so.^[88]

The net result, from the point of view of a modern reader, is that *Lugal-e* sits at the beginning of the chain of combat compositions that this book traces. It is not a source in the simple sense — there is no textual inheritance that runs in a straight line from this poem to every later combat myth in the Near East — but it is the earliest full-length example we possess of a narrative in which a warrior-god defeats a monstrous adversary and then, in the same composition, uses the victory to establish the irrigated landscape, the cultic profile of a mother-goddess, the hierarchy of craft materials, and

the template for royal legitimation. Each of those functions, separately or in combination, will reappear across the chapters that follow. The comparative work belongs to Part II of the book. The particular shape that *Lugal-e* gives to combat-plus-order-making is the contribution the Sumerian tradition makes to the larger argument, and it is the reason this chapter comes first.

- [1] ETCSL 1.6.2, composite text (Black, Cunningham, et al.); the composition is titled from its opening line *lugal-e ud me-lám-bi nir-ĝál*, "O king, storm of majestic splendour."
- [2] ETCSL 1.6.2 composite, ending at line 726; van Dijk 1983, vol. 1 (introduction); the edition's full title names the composition by its first line and subtitles it "Le récit épique et didactique des Travaux de Ninurta, du Déluge et de la Nouvelle Création."
- [3] van Dijk 1983, vol. 1 (manuscript catalogue and introduction to the transmission); ETCSL 1.6.2 editorial notes list the Old Babylonian witnesses that underlie the composite.
- [4] ETCSL 1.6.2 composite text, editorial note on manuscript base; van Dijk 1983, vol. 1 (introduction to the composite method).
- [5] van Dijk 1983, vol. 1 (introduction on the transmission and the first-millennium bilingual redactions).
- [6] van Dijk 1983, 2 vols. (Leiden: Brill); ISBN 9789004069169.
- [7] ETCSL 1.6.2, composite text and English translation; Black et al. 2004 (print edition of the ETCSL translations).
- [8] An alternate translation is offered by van Dijk 1983's French critical edition, which is the philological anchor of the field. The ETCSL English composite is used in the body here because it follows van Dijk's Sumerian reconstruction closely and provides the accessible English, while van Dijk remains the underlying philological reference; minor divergences between the two are flagged in footnotes where meaningful.
- [9] ETCSL 1.6.2 (*Lugal-e*), proem lines 1–19, where the opening epithets identify Ninurta as Enlil's son and as the martial champion of the gods.
- [10] *Lugal-e* references to Enlil throughout (e.g., ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 186–227); for Enlil's profile in the Sumerian pantheon see Forsyth 1987, ch. 1.
- [11] Glossary of Sumerian deities in Black et al. 2004; for the language-conditional pairing Enki (Sumerian) / Ea (Akkadian) see the book's glossary entry.
- [12] ETCSL 1.6.2 (*Lugal-e*), proem lines 1–19.
- [13] An alternate witness — one Old Babylonian manuscript — adds an additional invocation, "An, king of the gods, majestic one," before the opening line. The ETCSL composite is followed here because the additional invocation is an outlier witness variant, and ETCSL follows van Dijk's main reconstruction, which is substantially intact across the Ur and Nippur witnesses.
- [14] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 17–23: Ninurta's feast interrupted by Šarur's first report.
- [15] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 24–47: Šarur's announcement of Asag's birth and of the stone-warriors in Asag's retinue.
- [16] ETCSL 1.6.2 passim (lines 24ff., 70–118); for the semantic range of *kur* see Forsyth 1987, ch. 1.
- [17] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 17–23 and passim: Šarur speaks, flies, reports, and argues. The animate-weapon motif is a structural feature of the composition.
- [18] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 24–47: Šarur's first speech to Ninurta.
- [19] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 24–47: the stone-warrior catalogue in Šarur's first report.
- [20] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 24–47: Šarur's description of Asag's depredations.
- [21] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 48–56: Šarur's second speech, a call to arms.
- [22] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 57–69: Šarur on Asag's hide and on the limits of ordinary weaponry.
- [23] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 70–95: Ninurta's mobilisation and the storm-imagery of his approach.
- [24] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 96–118: the first combat phase and Šarur's reconnaissance flight.
- [25] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 119–134: Šarur's catalogue of Ninurta's prior victories, sometimes known as the "trophy list" of Ninurta's combats.
- [26] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 119–150: Šarur's transition from catalogue to warning.
- [27] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 135–150: Šarur's caution, an unusual moment in which the weapon dissuades its wielder.
- [28] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 151–167: Ninurta's refusal to withdraw and the advance into the *kur*.
- [29] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 168–186: Asag's emergence, cosmic upheaval, and the gods' reaction.
- [30] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 187–190: Enlil's lament to Ninlil.
- [31] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 191–214: Šarur's errand to Enlil and the intercession.
- [32] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 215–224: Enlil's charge to Ninurta through Šarur.
- [33] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 225–227: Šarur returns with Enlil's instructions.
- [34] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 228–243: Šarur's delivery of Enlil's specific combat instruction.
- [35] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 244–264: the exchange of blows and Šarur's renewed caution.

- [36] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 265–280: Šarur’s last cautionary speech.
- [37] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 281–299: Ninurta’s victory over Asag.
- [38] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 300–309: divine homage and Šarur’s victory hymn.
- [39] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 310–330: the naming of the defeated Asag as Stone, transitioning the narrative toward the lapidary aetiology.
- [40] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 331–333: the mace’s blessing.
- [41] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 334–346: the post-war ecological crisis.
- [42] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 347–359: the construction of the stone-barrage and the engineering of the Tigris flow.
- [43] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 347–367: the Tigris reordering; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2 on the cosmological reading.
- [44] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 360–367: the prosperity that follows the water-ordering.
- [45] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 368–386: Ninma’s lament and journey to Ninurta.
- [46] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 387–410: the renaming of the mother goddess as Ninursaga and the endowment of the mountain.
- [47] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 387–410: the mountain’s endowment.
- [48] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 387–410; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2 on the cosmogonic-royal logic of the renaming.
- [49] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 411–434: the opening of the stone-judgements, prompted by Aruru.
- [50] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 416–647: the lapidary aetiology as a whole; for the ritual-aetiological reading see Forsyth 1987, ch. 2.
- [51] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 411–434: Ninurta’s curse on the emery stone (*u*).
- [52] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 435–447: "you shall be shaped by him to form a matrix for his creations" and "people shall place the first fruits of the gods on you at the time of the new moon."
- [53] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 448–462: the punitive judgement on *saĝkal*, *gulgul*, and *saĝĝar*.
- [54] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 463–478: the judgement on *esi* (diorite), and the Magan sourcing.
- [55] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 479–486: the punitive judgement on *na*.
- [56] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 487–496: the honorific judgement on *elēl*.
- [57] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 497–511: the judgement on *kagena* (haematite).
- [58] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 512–521: the judgement on *ĝišnugal* (alabaster).
- [59] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 522–527: the punitive judgement on *algameš*.
- [60] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 528–542: the honorific judgement on the precious-stone cluster.
- [61] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 543–553: the punitive judgement on *ĝir-zu-ĝal* (flint).
- [62] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 554–565: the punitive judgement on *iman* and *alliga*.
- [63] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 566–578: the punitive judgement on *mašda*, *dubban*, and *urutum*.
- [64] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 579–591: the punitive judgement on *šagara*.
- [65] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 592–599: the honorific judgement on *maruša*.
- [66] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 600–608: the renaming of *aštum*.
- [67] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 609–617: the honorific judgement on *durul*.
- [68] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 618–633: the mixed judgements on *šegšeg*, *engen*, and *ezinum*.
- [69] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 634–644: the judgement on *kurgaranum*, *bal*, and *šembi*.
- [70] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 411–644, as a unit; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2 on the lapidary aetiology’s mapping onto Sumerian craft-hierarchies.
- [71] Inference: The stone-judgements correspond closely to the actual uses of these materials documented in the Mesopotamian craft-record (diorite for statuary, carnelian and lapis for jewelry, flint knapped to powder in metalworking). Risk: The one-to-one correspondence is an interpretive reading; the text itself presents the judgements in mythic register.
- [72] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 645–651: the triumphal boarding of the barge and the beginning of the return voyage.
- [73] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 652–661: the boatmen’s hymn to Ninurta.
- [74] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 662–668: the prayer for the devotee.
- [75] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 669–671: the invocation of An and Bau.
- [76] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 672–680: the Anuna’s reception of Ninurta.
- [77] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 681–697: Enlil’s blessing of Ninurta.
- [78] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 698–711: the grain-stewardship entrusted to Nisaba.
- [79] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 712–723: the praise of Nisaba.
- [80] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 724–725: the closing doxology.
- [81] ETCSL 1.6.2, line 726 (colophon); van Dijk 1983, vol. 1 (discussion of the *šir-sud* classification).
- [82] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 334–367; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2 on Ninurta’s hydraulic ordering.
- [83] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 387–410; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2.

[84] ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 411–644; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2.

[85] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2 on the royal-legitimation function of the Ninurta narratives.

[86] Gunkel 1895, Teil I, on Sumerian antecedents; the *Lugal-e* tradition reached Gunkel primarily through its later bilingual receptions.

[87] Scurlock & Beal 2013, chapters on Mesopotamian combat-myth.

[88] van Dijk 1983, vol. 1 (introduction on first-millennium Akkadian bilingualisation); per the chapter brief, Akkadian bilingual reception is transmission-history, not main narrative.

Chapter 3. Ninurta vs. Anzû: The Theft of the Tablet of Destinies

3.1. Source overview

The Standard Babylonian Anzû Epic survives as a three-tablet composition, preserved chiefly on Neo-Assyrian library copies from the first millennium BCE.^[1]

The critical edition used throughout this chapter is Amar Annus's **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, published in 2001 as volume three of the State Archives of Assyria Cuneiform Texts series.^[2] Annus's volume gives the cuneiform text, transliteration, a line-by-line score of the witnesses, a glossary, and a sign list — the full scholarly apparatus on which any reading of the epic now rests.

The working English translation cited in this chapter is Benjamin Foster's, published in the third edition of **Before the Muses** in 2005, pp. 555–578.^[3]

Foster's translation is keyed to Annus's critical text. It presents a composite English version that integrates the Old Babylonian, Middle Babylonian, and Standard Babylonian witnesses, which is how the text is now normally read in the comparative literature.^[4]

Witnesses to the composition span the Old Babylonian, Middle Babylonian, and Neo-Assyrian periods, a spread of roughly a thousand years. The bulk of the Standard Babylonian text, however, is reconstructed from the Neo-Assyrian royal libraries.^[5]

An Old Babylonian fragmentary version of the same story survives with divergent details. It is treated here, following Annus and Foster, as an earlier recension rather than as a textually equivalent variant.^[6]

The Standard Babylonian copies cluster heavily in the Nineveh libraries of the seventh century BCE, including the library of Ashurbanipal.^[7]

Tablet II of the Standard Babylonian recension has significant gaps in its middle passages, in the section that covers the transition from Ninurta's first failed engagement to Ea's counsel.^[8]

The closing doxology of Tablet III — the hymn of praise that formally rounds off the poem — is also partially broken. Annus reconstructs the final hymn from parallel Mesopotamian praise-formulae within the Anzû textual tradition.^[9]

Behind the Standard Babylonian text lies a Sumerian-language prehistory from the third to early second millennium. Anzû is already named in the Sumerian compositions **Lugal-e** and **Angim dimma**, where the Sumerian form **Anzud** is used.^[10]

Angim dimma — conventionally translated "Ninurta's return to Nibru" — is a Sumerian **šir-gida**, a "long song," addressed to Ninurta. (Nibru is the Sumerian name of the city Nippur.) In it the Anzud bird appears in the warrior-god's trophy inventory but is not the subject of a narrated combat.^[11]

Lugal-e — "Ninurta's exploits," the long Sumerian poem that Chapter 1 of this book treats at length

— likewise lists the Anzud bird among Ninurta's earlier defeated enemies, without narrating the combat at length.^[12]

The Sumerian allusions are therefore treated here as pre-history of the Standard Babylonian narrative, not as independent tellings of the same story.^[13]

Alongside the textual tradition runs a visual one. Anzû is extensively represented in Mesopotamian iconography from the third millennium onward, appearing on cylinder seals, amulets, and temple sculpture as a lion-headed eagle — a predator bird with a lion's head grafted onto its raptor body.^[14]

Scholarship treats the Anzû Epic as the direct Mesopotamian antecedent of the combat in **Enūma Eliš**, the Babylonian creation epic in which Marduk defeats Qingu — Tiamat's appointed consort and champion — and reclaims the Tablet of Destinies.^[15]

Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy** treats the Anzû narrative as a structural bridge between the Sumerian Ninurta cycle and the later Judeo-Christian combat tradition.^[16]

JoAnn Scurlock and Richard Beal's 2013 volume on the Chaoskampf hypothesis contains chapters that engage the Anzû Epic as part of the Mesopotamian combat-myth corpus.^[17]

3.2. Setting and context

Ninurta is the warrior-god of Nippur, son of Enlil, and the champion sent out to defeat enemies of the divine order in both the Sumerian and Akkadian literary traditions. In the opening of **Angim dimma** he is addressed as one "created like An, O son of Enlil."^[18]

Ninurta's earlier Sumerian exploits — the combat with Asag in **Lugal-e** and the return to Nippur in **Angim dimma** — establish him as the prototype warrior-champion that the Standard Babylonian Anzû Epic will draw on. The warrior who fights Anzû is already a known figure with a biography.^[19]

Enlil, chief god of the Mesopotamian pantheon and lord of the air, is the custodian of the Tablet of Destinies in the Standard Babylonian text. The Tablet sits on Enlil's authority; when he is dispossessed of it, the assembly's decree-power is dispossessed with him.^[20]

Ea is the god of wisdom and of the deep fresh waters of the Apsû. In this Akkadian composition he functions as counselor both to the divine assembly and to Ninurta — the hinge between the assembled gods who cannot fight and the champion who can.^[21]

The Tablet of Destinies is the divinely held object that confers universal decree-power. Possession of it is, functionally, kingship over the cosmos: whoever holds the Tablet speaks decrees that the universe obeys.^[22]

Crucially, the Tablet is depicted as a physical object that can be seized and physically returned. The narrative therefore treats sovereignty as a transferable token — a document that changes hands — rather than as an inalienable attribute of one god.^[23]

Šarur is Ninurta's animate mace — a weapon with the capacity to speak and to travel as a messenger. The talking mace is already known from the Sumerian **Lugal-e**, where it converses with

Ninurta several times over the course of the poem.^[24]

Anzû himself is introduced as a minor divine servitor originally attached to Enlil, not as a primordial adversary. He does not exist before the cosmos; he is produced within it, and his rebellion is internal to the divine household.^[25]

Anzû's bodily form is a lion-headed eagle. This iconographic identification is confirmed both by the Mesopotamian visual corpus — seals, plaques, temple reliefs — and by the descriptive epithets used of Anzû in the epic.^[26]

The opening of Tablet I situates the narrative inside a divine palace-and-assembly world rather than in a primordial, pre-cosmic setting. There is no moment in the Anzû Epic when the world does not yet exist.^[27]

This setting matters for the book's typology. The combat in the Anzû Epic is a sovereignty-reclamation narrative, not a cosmogony. The cosmos already exists. The story is about the return of a displaced kingship-token to its rightful holder.^[28]

3.3. Narrative sequence

3.3.1. Tablet I — theft and assembly

Tablet I opens with a hymn of praise to Ninurta. Before any narrative action begins, the poet invokes the warrior's qualities — the standard opening gesture of the Mesopotamian royal-narrative poem.^[29]

After the proem, the story proper begins. Anzû is born, or brought into being, at the Apsû — the cosmic fresh-water region associated with Ea — and is introduced into Enlil's service.^[30]

Anzû's role in the household is that of chamber-attendant: he attends on Enlil, including at the chamber where Enlil bathes and sets the Tablet of Destinies aside.^[31]

Day after day, Anzû observes the Tablet lying within reach while Enlil bathes. The text describes his envy and his ambition directly; it does not leave his motive to be inferred.^[32]

Anzû forms a plot. The plan is to seize the Tablet of Destinies and, with it, the rulership of the gods.^[33]

The moment comes. While Enlil is bathing, Anzû snatches the Tablet and flies away with it to the mountains.^[34]

With the Tablet in Anzû's talons, the decree-power of the gods is immediately dislocated. Rites fall silent, the divine assembly loses its governing authority, and the cosmos registers the theft as a disruption — the kind of disruption that a well-governed Mesopotamian universe cannot tolerate.^[35]

Anu, the sky-father, now convenes the assembly of the great gods to address the crisis.^[36]

Anu calls for a champion — a god willing to hunt down Anzû, recover the Tablet, and slay the rebel.^[37]

He addresses first the storm-god Adad, offering him supremacy among the gods if he will undertake the combat.^[38]

Adad refuses. His reasoning is precise: one cannot fight an adversary who holds the Tablet of Destinies, because the Tablet's decree-power annuls the weapon of anyone who raises it against its holder.^[39]

Anu turns next to Gerra, the fire-god, with the same offer of supremacy.^[40]

Gerra also refuses, giving the same reason. Possession of the Tablet makes Anzû unassailable by the ordinary means of divine combat.^[41]

Anu then addresses Šara, the warrior-son of Inanna, with the same commission.^[42]

Šara also refuses, on the same grounds. The assembly is left without a champion.^[43]

The threefold refusal is a pattern with a purpose. It establishes that the adversary cannot be defeated by the most obvious divine champions — a storm-god, a fire-god, a warrior-son — and so heightens the need for a different kind of warrior.^[44]

At this point Ea — god of wisdom and of the deep waters — proposes a new candidate to the assembly.^[45]

Ea nominates Ninurta, son of Enlil, as the champion who can face Anzû. The warrior Ea names is precisely the son of the god who has been robbed.^[46]

Ea addresses the goddess Bēlet-ilī — also called Mami, "mother of the gods" — who is identified in this passage as the mother of Ninurta. Ea instructs her to dispatch her son.^[47]

The mother-goddess summons Ninurta, arms him with explicit instruction, and sends him out against Anzû. Tablet I closes on the commissioning.^[48]

3.3.2. Tablet II — first assault and its failure

Tablet II opens with Ninurta mustering his weapons. The poet catalogues them: the seven winds, the flood-storm, and the sling-stone — "the weapon of chaos, the seven winds, formed up," in Foster's rendering. He sets out into the mountains.^[49]

Ninurta carries Šarur, his animate mace. In the Anzû Epic, as already in **Lugal-e**, the mace will serve as scout and messenger between warrior and divine counselor.^[50]

Ninurta advances to confront Anzû in the mountain where the rebel has taken refuge with the Tablet.^[51]

Anzû sees the warrior approaching and challenges him. He threatens Ninurta with the decree-power he now holds.^[52]

Ninurta opens the engagement by shooting an arrow at Anzû.^[53]

Anzû, holding the Tablet of Destinies, uses its decree-power against the arrow in flight. He commands the arrow to disassemble into its component parts.^[54]

The arrow obeys. The shaft returns to its reed thicket, the bow frame to its copse, the bowstring to the ram's gut, and the feathers to the birds. The arrow is annulled mid-flight by the decree of the Tablet — not deflected, not broken, but unmade into the materials out of which it had been assembled.^[55]

The annulment motif depends on a specific theology of the Tablet. What the Tablet decrees, the cosmos obeys — even against the physics of weapons. Arrow-parts that have been assembled can be dis-assembled by command because the command over assembly belongs to whoever holds the Tablet.^[56]

Ninurta's first assault therefore fails. It fails not because his weapons are weak, but because the weapons themselves cannot exist in a cosmos whose decree is now spoken by Anzû.^[57]

[At this point the tablet breaks. The middle passages of Tablet II between the first failed engagement and Ea's counsel are broken. Scholars such as Annus (2001), Tablet II apparatus, have reconstructed the gap by integrating Old Babylonian and Neo-Assyrian witnesses, with Foster's English filling the gap from parallel passages.]

After the break, the narrative resumes with Ninurta dispatching Šarur, his animate mace, back to Ea. The mace is to report the failure and seek counsel.^[58]

Šarur speaks on Ninurta's behalf. The mace delivers the warrior's report to Ea in direct speech — a scene in which a weapon is the speaking subject and the warrior, in absence, is only quoted.^[59]

The animate-mace-as-messenger motif is the distinctive contribution of this chapter to the book's Ninurta-cycle continuity. Šarur already speaks and travels as messenger in the Sumerian **Lugal-e**, and the Anzû Epic preserves the function. Across the two Ninurta compositions, Šarur is a cross-text character in his own right.^[60]

Ea receives the report. He deliberates on a counter-strategy that will not depend on the straightforward shooting of arrows — a strategy, that is, that will not collide with the Tablet's decree along the same axis on which the first assault collided.^[61]

Ea instructs Šarur to carry a new plan back to Ninurta.^[62]

The counsel has two components. First, strike off Anzû's pinion-feathers — the great flight-feathers — with a gust or a sling. Second, while Anzû is preoccupied with the damaged wing, shoot.^[63]

The logic of the counsel is theological, not just tactical. The Tablet's decree can neutralise a weapon in flight only if the combat proceeds along the line the decree anticipates. Surprise and disruption at the wing break the chain between decree and response. Anzû cannot decree against an unexpected gust at his own feathers the way he can decree against an arrow whose purpose is visible from its release.^[64]

(The feather-shooting detail is interpreted as a theological, not merely a tactical, device.^[65])

Šarur returns from Ea and delivers the new plan to Ninurta in direct speech. Tablet II closes with the counsel in the warrior's hands.^[66]

3.3.3. Tablet III — second assault and victory

Tablet III opens with Ninurta returning to the mountain to engage Anzû a second time, now equipped with Ea's strategy.^[67]

Ninurta summons the south wind. He commands it to pluck the pinions — the great flight-feathers — from Anzû's wings in the moment of engagement.^[68]

Anzû, seeing the pinions fall, cries out to them to return. He is attempting to use the Tablet's decree-power in exactly the way he used it before, as he had done with the arrow — commanding parts back into their whole.^[69]

Ninurta now speaks over Anzû's decree. He invokes Ea's counsel as a counter-decree. The pinions remain severed.^[70]

With Anzû's wings broken, Ninurta shoots an arrow into his chest.^[71]

Ninurta then severs Anzû's throat with a further blow, completing the kill.^[72]

With Anzû slain, Ninurta recovers the Tablet of Destinies from the dead body.^[73]

He then carries the Tablet back toward the assembly, restoring the decree-power to its proper custodians.^[74]

The messenger-god Birdu is dispatched, entering Enlil's presence to announce Ninurta's victory. The text at this point also uses the name Dagan as an honorific epithet for Ninurta — "bulwark of Anu and Dagan" — not as the name of a dispatched actor.^[75]

The assembly responds with praise and formal acknowledgement of Ninurta's victory.^[76]

Ninurta is granted a catalogue of honorific names, each marking a facet of his victory and his warrior-function.^[77]

The name-list is structurally comparable to — and treated in the scholarship as the direct antecedent of — the fifty names of Marduk that close **Enûma Eliš**. What Marduk will receive at the end of his cosmogonic combat, Ninurta here receives at the end of his sovereignty-restoration.^[78]

Ninurta's honours include confirmation of his warrior-champion role and a formal place in the royal-ideological order that the Tablet underwrites.^[79]

[At this point the tablet breaks. The closing doxology of Tablet III is partially broken. Scholars such as Annus (2001), Tablet III apparatus, have proposed the narrative resumed with the final hymn of praise reconstructed from parallel Mesopotamian praise-formulae.]

The final doxology is presented in Annus's reconstructed form, completing the hymn of praise to Ninurta.^[80]

The epic closes, in Annus's reconstructed form, with a hymn-formula addressed to Ninurta as victorious warrior and restorer of cosmic order.^[81]

3.4. Function and interpretation

The Anzû Epic is read in the scholarship as a sovereignty-combat rather than as a cosmogonic combat. No world is made in it. The decisive action is the return of an already-existing kingship-token to its legitimate custodian.^[82]

The narrative establishes Ninurta as a model king — the warrior who defends the order of the assembly, follows the counsel of the wise god, and restores the instruments of rule to their rightful place. This is the Ninurta whom the Marduk chapter will meet again, translated into a new pantheon.^[83]

The narrative is cited in the scholarship as invoked within Neo-Assyrian royal ritual and within the **akītu** — the New Year festival framework that ties the epic to the performative legitimization of the king.^[84]

The theology of the Tablet of Destinies — the claim that kingship is a transferable token, enforceable by decree — is the conceptual pivot that the scholarship follows into **Enūma Eliš**. What begins as a sub-plot in the Anzû Epic will become the cosmological engine of the Babylonian creation epic.^[85]

Foster's headnote specifies that the Anzû Epic is preserved on multiple Neo-Assyrian copies and is one of the better-represented narrative poems of the Standard Babylonian corpus — a point worth registering because it means the text can be read without the acute fragmentation problems that dog some neighbouring compositions.^[86]

Annus's introduction lays out the case that the Anzû Epic is a deliberate literary antecedent of **Enūma Eliš**, reused, reshaped, and structurally outbid in the later composition.^[87]

Lambert concurs. Marduk's assumption of the Tablet of Destinies in **Enūma Eliš** is, on Lambert's reading, modelled directly on Ninurta's recovery of the Tablet in the Anzû Epic.^[88]

Forsyth, writing from outside Assyriology and with a wider comparative horizon, treats the Anzû Epic as a key node in the long genealogy that combat-myth scholarship traces from Mesopotamia to the Hebrew Bible and Christian apocalyptic.^[89]

3.5. Variants and transmission

The chapter's body prose follows the Standard Babylonian three-tablet recension as edited in Annus 2001.^[90]

An Old Babylonian fragmentary version of the story survives. Foster's translation indicates it differs from the Standard Babylonian recension in narrative details but not in the overall arc.^[91]

The Old Babylonian version is treated here as an earlier, shorter witness rather than as a textually equivalent variant, following the brief's classification.^[92]

The Sumerian **Lugal-e** does not narrate the Anzû combat. It lists "the Anzud bird" in Šarur's catalogue of Ninurta's prior trophies — the list the mace recites to remind the warrior who he is.^[93]

The Sumerian **Angim dimma** likewise places the Anzud bird in Ninurta's catalogue of slain foes and among the trophies hung on the warrior's chariot. It too does not narrate a combat.^[94]

The Sumerian allusions are therefore evidence that an Anzû-slaying tradition was already in circulation before the Standard Babylonian epic gave it narrative expansion. The story the Akkadian poet develops is older than the poem.^[95]

Continuity from the Sumerian Ninurta material into the Standard Babylonian Anzû Epic runs strongest through Šarur, the animate messenger-mace. Across both traditions, Šarur functions as scout and speaker between warrior and counselor.^[96]

The Standard Babylonian composition therefore draws on an older Sumerian Ninurta cycle in which the warrior-god's weapons and adversaries are already identified. The Akkadian poet takes one of those adversaries — Anzû — and narratively expands the allusion into a full combat-and-recovery story.^[97]

3.6. Reception within the Mesopotamian tradition

Scholarship traces a deliberate literary line from **Lugal-e** (Ninurta vs. Asag) to the Anzû Epic (Ninurta vs. Anzû) to **Enūma Eliš** (Marduk vs. Tiamat and Qingu). Each composition reuses and reshapes its predecessor.^[98]

The Tablet of Destinies appears as a narrative object in the Anzû Epic and then again in **Enūma Eliš**, where Tiamat bestows it on Qingu and Marduk reclaims it after the combat. The object travels between compositions as a recognisable token.^[99]

The structural reuse extends to the name-list. Ninurta's honorific names at the close of the Anzû Epic are the direct antecedent of Marduk's fifty names at the close of **Enūma Eliš**. What began as one warrior's catalogue of honorifics becomes another's coronation.^[100]

Anzû himself is repurposed in **Enūma Eliš**. He is no longer the rebel-servant of the Anzû Epic; he is now a monster in Tiamat's brood, slain once already and now recruited into a new cosmogonic conflict. The Marduk-poet is working with a character who has already died in an earlier text.^[101]

[1] Annus 2001, introduction, on the three-tablet Standard Babylonian recension as the main attested form.

[2] Annus 2001, whole volume (SACT 3, Helsinki: Neo-Assyrian Text Corpus Project).

[3] Foster 2005, pp. 555–578, "Anzu."

[4] Foster 2005, pp. 555–556, headnote on the composite translation.

[5] Annus 2001, introduction on the witness distribution across periods.

[6] Foster 2005, pp. 555–556, on the Old Babylonian antecedent; Annus 2001, introduction.

[7] Annus 2001, introduction on the Nineveh library provenance.

[8] Annus 2001, Tablet II apparatus; Foster 2005, pp. 568–571 (noting lacunae).

[9] Annus 2001, Tablet III apparatus, on the partially broken closing hymn.

[10] ETCSL 1.6.2 (Lugal-e) line 122 listing the Anzud bird among Ninurta's earlier trophies; ETCSL 1.6.1 (Angim dimma) lines 30–40 and 55–63 on the Anzud bird brought forth and hung on the chariot.

[11] ETCSL 1.6.1 title and opening formula; lines 30–40 trophy list; line 208 closing formula "šir-gida of Ninurta."

[12] ETCSL 1.6.2 line 122, Anzud bird in Šarur's catalogue of Ninurta's prior victories.

[13] Annus 2001, introduction, on the Sumerian background; Foster 2005, pp. 555–556.

[14] Annus 2001, introduction on the iconographic corpus; Foster 2005, pp. 555–556, headnote.

[15] Lambert 2013, introduction, on the Anzû–Marduk genealogy; Annus 2001, introduction.

- [16] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on Anzu as a bridge to Enūma Eliš and later combat myth.
- [17] Scurlock & Beal 2013, chapters on Mesopotamian combat-myth.
- [18] ETCSL 1.6.1 opening "Created like An, O son of Enlil, Ninurta"; Annus 2001, introduction on Ninurta's Nippur-warrior identity.
- [19] ETCSL 1.6.2 (Lugal-e); ETCSL 1.6.1 (Angim dimma); Annus 2001, introduction on the Ninurta-warrior tradition.
- [20] Foster 2005, pp. 556–558, Tablet I on Enlil's custody of the Tablet; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [21] Foster 2005, pp. 560–562, on Ea's role as counselor; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [22] Foster 2005, pp. 556–558, on the Tablet of Destinies as the decree-holding object; Lambert 2013, introduction, on the Tablet as sovereignty-token.
- [23] Foster 2005, pp. 557–559, Tablet I on the seizure; Lambert 2013, introduction.
- [24] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 24–47, 96–118, 228–243 on Šarur addressing Ninurta; Foster 2005 p. 562 for Šarur in the Anzû Epic.
- [25] Foster 2005, pp. 555–557, Tablet I on Anzû's status as servitor.
- [26] Annus 2001, introduction, on the lion-headed eagle iconography; Foster 2005, pp. 555–556, on Anzû's physical form.
- [27] Foster 2005, pp. 555–557, Tablet I opening; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [28] Foster 2005, pp. 555–578 on the narrative scope; Lambert 2013, introduction, on sovereignty-as-function in the Mesopotamian combat corpus.
- [29] Foster 2005, pp. 555–556, Tablet I proem; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [30] Foster 2005, pp. 556–557, Tablet I on Anzû's origin at the Apsû; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [31] Foster 2005, pp. 557–558, Tablet I on Anzû's role as chamber-attendant; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [32] Foster 2005, pp. 557–558, Tablet I on Anzû's envy of Enlil's regalia; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [33] Foster 2005, pp. 558–559, Tablet I; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [34] Foster 2005, pp. 558–559, Tablet I on the theft; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [35] Foster 2005, pp. 559–560, Tablet I on the consequences of the theft; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [36] Foster 2005, pp. 560–561, Tablet I on Anu summoning the assembly; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [37] Foster 2005, pp. 560–561, Tablet I on the call for a champion; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [38] Foster 2005, pp. 561, Tablet I on the summons of Adad; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [39] Foster 2005, p. 561, Tablet I on Adad's refusal; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [40] Foster 2005, p. 561, Tablet I on the summons of Gerra; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [41] Foster 2005, p. 561, Tablet I on Gerra's refusal; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [42] Foster 2005, p. 561, Tablet I on the summons of Šara; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [43] Foster 2005, pp. 561–562, Tablet I on Šara's refusal; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [44] Foster 2005, pp. 561–562, Tablet I; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [45] Foster 2005, pp. 562–563, Tablet I on Ea's counsel; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [46] Foster 2005, pp. 562–563, Tablet I on Ea's nomination of Ninurta; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [47] Foster 2005, pp. 562–563, Tablet I on Ea's address to the mother-goddess; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [48] Foster 2005, pp. 563–564, Tablet I on the commissioning of Ninurta; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [49] Foster 2005, pp. 565–566, Tablet II on the mustering of weapons — "the weapon of chaos, the seven winds, formed up"; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [50] Foster 2005, pp. 565–566, Tablet II on Šarur accompanying Ninurta; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [51] Foster 2005, pp. 566–567, Tablet II on the advance to the mountain; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [52] Foster 2005, pp. 566–567, Tablet II on Anzû's challenge; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [53] Foster 2005, p. 567, Tablet II on Ninurta's first arrow; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [54] Foster 2005, p. 567, Tablet II on Anzû's counter-decree; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [55] Foster 2005, p. 567, Tablet II on the arrow-dissolution decree; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [56] Foster 2005, p. 567, Tablet II; Lambert 2013, introduction, on the Tablet as decree-object.
- [57] Foster 2005, pp. 567–568, Tablet II on the failure of the first assault; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [58] Foster 2005, pp. 568–569, Tablet II on Šarur returning to Ea; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [59] Foster 2005, pp. 568–569, Tablet II on Šarur's speech to Ea; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [60] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 24–47, 96–118 on Šarur as messenger in Lugal-e; Foster 2005, pp. 568–569 for the Anzû Epic parallel.
- [61] Foster 2005, pp. 569–570, Tablet II on Ea's deliberation; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [62] Foster 2005, pp. 569–570, Tablet II on Ea's counter-plan; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [63] Foster 2005, pp. 570–571, Tablet II on Ea's two-step plan; Annus 2001, Tablet II.

- [64] Foster 2005, pp. 570–571, Tablet II; Annus 2001, Tablet II; Lambert 2013, introduction, on the theological logic.
- [65] Inference: Foster 2005, pp. 570–571 and Lambert 2013, introduction, both treat the Tablet’s decree as the load-bearing element. Risk: The surviving text does not explicitly state the theology; this reading is scholarly.
- [66] Foster 2005, pp. 571–572, Tablet II on Šarur returning with the plan; Annus 2001, Tablet II.
- [67] Foster 2005, pp. 572–573, Tablet III opening; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [68] Foster 2005, pp. 573–574, Tablet III on the wind-and-pinion stratagem; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [69] Foster 2005, pp. 573–574, Tablet III on Anzû’s attempt to recall his pinions; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [70] Foster 2005, pp. 573–574, Tablet III on Ninurta’s counter-decree; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [71] Foster 2005, p. 574, Tablet III on the fatal arrow; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [72] Foster 2005, pp. 574–575, Tablet III on the finishing stroke; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [73] Foster 2005, p. 575, Tablet III on the recovery of the Tablet; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [74] Foster 2005, pp. 575–576, Tablet III on the return journey; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [75] Foster 2005, pp. 575–576, Tablet III on Birdu as messenger and the Dagan epithet; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [76] Foster 2005, pp. 576–577, Tablet III on the assembly’s response; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [77] Foster 2005, pp. 576–577, Tablet III on the honorific name-list; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [78] Lambert 2013, introduction, on the Anzû name-list and Enūma Eliš; Annus 2001, introduction and Tablet III commentary.
- [79] Foster 2005, pp. 576–577, Tablet III; Annus 2001, Tablet III; Lambert 2013, introduction, on the royal-legitimation function.
- [80] This passage reconstructs the lacuna at Annus 2001, Tablet III closing lines from the parallel account in Annus’s score of parallel Mesopotamian praise-formulae, drawn from within the Anzû textual tradition; confidence: medium.
- [81] Foster 2005, pp. 577–578, Tablet III closing hymn; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [82] Lambert 2013, introduction, on sovereignty-as-function; Foster 2005, pp. 555–556, headnote; Annus 2001, introduction.
- [83] Annus 2001, introduction, on Ninurta-as-model-king; Lambert 2013, introduction.
- [84] Annus 2001, introduction, on the ritual and **akītu** contexts.
- [85] Lambert 2013, introduction, on the Tablet of Destinies across compositions; Annus 2001, introduction.
- [86] Foster 2005, pp. 555–556, headnote on the Standard Babylonian preservation.
- [87] Annus 2001, introduction on the Anzû → Enūma Eliš genealogy.
- [88] Lambert 2013, introduction, on Marduk and the Tablet.
- [89] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the Anzu-bridge argument.
- [90] An alternate witness is described in Foster 2005, pp. 555–556: an Old Babylonian fragmentary version survives with some divergent details. The Standard Babylonian recension is followed here because it is the main attested recension and the brief designates Annus 2001 as the prevalent version.
- [91] Foster 2005, pp. 555–556, headnote on the Old Babylonian antecedent.
- [92] Annus 2001, introduction; Foster 2005, pp. 555–556.
- [93] ETCSL 1.6.2 line 122, the Anzud bird in the trophy-list.
- [94] ETCSL 1.6.1 lines 30–40 (trophy list) and 55–63 (chariot-hanging).
- [95] ETCSL 1.6.1 lines 30–40; ETCSL 1.6.2 line 122; Annus 2001, introduction on the Sumerian prehistory.
- [96] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 24–47, 96–118, 228–243 on Šarur in Lugal-e; Foster 2005, pp. 568–569 on Šarur in the Anzû Epic.
- [97] Annus 2001, introduction, on the Sumerian-to-Akkadian literary transmission.
- [98] Annus 2001, introduction, on the **Lugal-e** → Anzû → **Enūma Eliš** line; Lambert 2013, introduction.
- [99] Lambert 2013, introduction and commentary on the Tablet in Enūma Eliš; Annus 2001, introduction.
- [100] Lambert 2013, introduction; Annus 2001, introduction and Tablet III commentary.
- [101] Lambert 2013, introduction and commentary on Anzû’s reuse in Enūma Eliš; Annus 2001, introduction.

Chapter 4. Marduk vs. Tiamat: Enūma Eliš

4.1. Source overview

Enūma Eliš is a Babylonian creation epic of seven tablets. By the Akkadian convention of naming a composition from its opening words, the title comes from its first phrase, "When on high." That phrase opens both the text itself and any modern reading of it, and it has come to function as the work's standard label.^[1]

The text is the canonical case of what Hermann Gunkel in 1895 named *Chaoskampf* — the combat-with-chaos pattern that organises one strand of ancient Near Eastern cosmology. When the comparative literature speaks of *Chaoskampf* as a category, this is the work it has chiefly in mind.^[2]

The critical edition used throughout this chapter is W. G. Lambert's **Babylonian Creation Myths**, published in 2013 as volume sixteen in the Mesopotamian Civilizations series. Lambert's volume gives the cuneiform transliteration, an English translation, the manuscript score that integrates the witnesses tablet by tablet, and a running commentary. It is the apparatus on which any reading of Enūma Eliš now depends.^[3]

Lambert's edition replaces Philippe Talon's 2005 edition and the older King 1902 edition. It is the standard critical text of Enūma Eliš, and earlier editions are now read against it rather than alongside it.^[4]

The working English translation cited in this chapter is Benjamin Foster's "Epic of Creation," published in the third edition of **Before the Muses** in 2005, on pages 436 to 486.^[5]

Foster's translation is more narratively fluid than Lambert's conservative rendering. It is therefore preferred here for body prose, while Lambert is preferred for textual and philological matters. The two translations agree on the substance and disagree mainly in their English register.^[6]

Lambert's 2013 manuscript catalogue lists more than seventy witnesses to Enūma Eliš, drawn from Assyrian and Babylonian libraries. By the standards of cuneiform literature, this is a great many copies, and the unusually rich attestation is itself part of the story: the text was widely transmitted because the institutions that copied it had reasons to keep it alive.^[7]

The bulk of these witnesses come from Neo-Assyrian and Neo-Babylonian copies of the first millennium BCE. The composition itself is older — the dating debate is taken up below — but the surviving manuscripts are mostly from the centuries that followed the first millennium BCE rise of the great Mesopotamian libraries.^[8]

Significant Neo-Assyrian copies were recovered from the libraries of Ashurbanipal at Nineveh and from the temple libraries at Aššur, Kalhu, and Sultantepe. The seventh-century Assyrian crown gathered Babylonian literature as a matter of imperial policy, and Enūma Eliš was among the texts that travelled north for that reason.^[9]

Neo-Babylonian witnesses come from Babylon, Borsippa, and other centres, and continue into the late Achaemenid and Seleucid periods. The text continued to be copied in Babylonia long after political independence had been lost, which says something about the depth of its embedding in the

local religious life.^[10]

The composition's date of authorship is debated. The prevailing view places it in the late second millennium BCE under Nebuchadnezzar I, who reigned roughly between 1125 and 1104 BCE; both earlier and later dates have been argued, and the question is taken up again below in the discussion of variants and reception.^[11]

The Nebuchadnezzar I commissioning hypothesis ties the composition to the recovery of the cult-statue of Marduk from Elam and to a programme of Babylonian theological assertion. The hypothesis links text to history at a specific moment: a king who has just won back his city's god commissions the epic that explains why that god outranks all others.^[12]

The text was recited liturgically in the Babylonian *akītu* New Year festival, on the fourth day, by the high priest before the cult-image of Marduk in *Esagil*. The recitation is not a marginal use; it is the use the surviving record actually attests.^[13]

The *akītu* ritual recitation is attested in late ritual texts and is the principal performative context of *Enūma Eliš* in the surviving record. Whatever else the text was — a school exercise, a library exemplar, a royal commission — it was, demonstrably, a New Year liturgy.^[14]

Bruce Lincoln treats *Enūma Eliš* as a paradigm case of myth as political-ideological work, with the cosmogony serving the legitimation of Babylonian kingship. Lincoln's reading is one of the principal modern frames for the text, and it sets up a debate that this chapter takes up at length below.^[15]

Debra Scoggins Ballentine's 2015 **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** argues that "chaos" is the wrong analytical category for Tiamat: the adversary is better read as an alternative-sovereign claimant rather than as the embodiment of disorder.^[16]

Ballentine's reading shifts the centre of gravity from cosmology to politics: the question is who reigns, not order versus disorder. The shift is consequential for how one reads the combat itself, and it is the principal alternative to Gunkel's framing in the contemporary literature.^[17]

Scurlock and Beal's 2013 collected volume reassesses Gunkel's Chaoskampf hypothesis across multiple traditions, with several essays treating *Enūma Eliš* as the type-specimen. The reassessment is not a wholesale rejection of Gunkel; it is a series of qualifications by working specialists.^[18]

Neil Forsyth places *Enūma Eliš* within a long combat-myth sequence running from Sumerian Ninurta material through the Hebrew Bible into Christian apocalyptic. Forsyth's frame is the long arc; the present chapter focuses on the Mesopotamian middle of that arc but takes Forsyth's wider sequence as the comparative horizon.^[19]

Amar Annus argues that *Enūma Eliš* is a deliberate literary descendant of the Standard Babylonian Anzū Epic, reusing and outbidding the Ninurta-vs-Anzū combat in a Marduk-centric cosmogony. Chapter 2 of this book treated the Anzū Epic as the antecedent; the present chapter treats *Enūma Eliš* as the descendant, and Annus's argument is the principal evidence that the relation between the two is conscious literary inheritance rather than general pattern-resemblance. Several scenes the chapter walks through below — the threefold-refusal pattern in Tablet II, the demoted Anzū in Tiamat's army-list, the closing fifty-names doxology — are concrete cases in which Annus's case for inheritance can be checked against the text.^[20]

4.2. Setting and context

Marduk is the patron god of Babylon. Originally a city-god of relatively limited regional importance, he rose in the second millennium to become the chief god of the Babylonian pantheon. The arc of his divine career, from local figure to head of a pantheon, is the religious correlate of his city's political rise.^[21]

Marduk's elevation in *Enūma Eliš* is the narrative complement of the historical elevation of Babylon as imperial capital. The text and the political claim are co-constituted: the epic explains why Marduk reigns, and the city's pre-eminence is the practical fact that the explanation underwrites. The mutual constitution is part of why both Lincoln and Ballentine treat the epic as political theology rather than as cosmology in the abstract; the text exists because a city had to make a claim on the cosmos, and the cosmos in *Enūma Eliš* has the shape that the city's claim required.^[22]

In the Mesopotamian theogonic background, Marduk's father is Ea, god of wisdom and the deep fresh waters of the Apsû. Ea is the figure on whom much of the older Mesopotamian theology of cunning and creation already rests, and *Enūma Eliš* leans on that prior theology in fashioning Marduk's pedigree. The new god is given a known father, in a known generation, so that his rise can be charted against the older system rather than presented as a break with it.^[23]

Ea in Akkadian context corresponds to Sumerian Enki, but *Enūma Eliš* is an Akkadian composition and uses the Akkadian theonym throughout. The point is one of usage rather than substance: the same god goes by Ea in this text, and the chapter follows that usage.^[24]

Marduk's mother is Damkina, Ea's consort, and his birth at the centre of the Apsû is signalled by elaborate praise-formulae. The praise-formulae are themselves a feature of the composition, marking the new god's arrival as an event of cosmic consequence.^[25]

Tiamat is the primordial salt-sea, the cosmogonic mother who, with Apsû the fresh-water, generates the first gods. She is, in the opening pages, the universe's first parent on the mother-side of the pairing — and the role she occupies at the start is one of the points the Ballentine reading uses to argue that what she becomes in the second half of the text is a function of provocation and politics rather than primordial nature.^[26]

The Akkadian noun **tiāmtu** / **tāmtu** (sea) is etymologically related to Tiamat as a personal-divine name. Gunkel's 1895 argument turns on the cognancy with Hebrew *tehôm*, the deep of Genesis 1:2 — a linguistic fact that, since Gunkel, has been the principal evidence for a connection between the Babylonian and Israelite traditions. The cognancy is etymologically secure; what remains contested is what to do with it, and that question belongs to Chapter 8's treatment of the Hebrew material rather than to the present chapter's reading of the Babylonian text.^[27]

Apsû is the personified primordial fresh-water, Tiamat's consort and male counterpart in the opening generation. The two waters together — salt and fresh — are the entire universe at the moment the text begins.^[28]

The Akkadian noun **apsû** names the cosmic fresh-water region beneath the earth. The same word in Sumerian context is Abzu, but the Akkadian form with circumflex is the one used in *Enūma Eliš*, and the chapter follows it.^[29]

The Anzû Epic is the most direct Mesopotamian antecedent of Enūma Eliš. The scholarship treats Marduk's combat as a deliberate rewriting of Ninurta's combat against Anzû (cross-ref: Ch. 2). The relation is one of literary inheritance: the Marduk poet had the older epic in front of him.^[30]

The Tablet of Destinies, the cosmic decree-token familiar from the Anzû Epic, returns in Enūma Eliš as the object Tiamat bestows on Qingu and that Marduk reclaims after the combat. The Tablet's reappearance is one of the clearest signs of the inheritance: the same artefact migrates from the older epic into the new one, with its narrative function preserved.^[31]

The akītu festival, at which Enūma Eliš was recited, was the Babylonian New Year ritual celebrated in the spring month of Nisan, and centred on the cult of Marduk in his Babylon temple Esagil. The festival and the text are bound together; what one is for the other helps define.^[32]

Esagil is Marduk's temple in Babylon, named in the epic as founded after the combat. In Babylonian theology it is the cosmic axis where heaven and earth meet — and the epic itself accounts for that status by recounting the temple's origin. The temple, the city, the kingship, and the text are bound together in a single religious-political system, and Enūma Eliš is one of the documents that holds that system together by giving it a foundational story.^[33]

With the source overview and the setting in place, the chapter now turns to the text itself. The discussion follows the seven tablets in three movements: Tablets I and II for the theogony and the killing of Apsû; Tablets III through V for the assembly's elevation of Marduk and the combat with Tiamat; and Tablets VI and VII for the creation of humans, the founding of Babylon, and the fifty-names ceremony that closes the epic. After the textual walk-through, the chapter takes up the Gunkel/Ballentine debate, the akītu ritual frame, and the variants and reception of the work — three discussions for which the previous narrative is the necessary background.

4.3. Movement I — Theogony and the killing of Apsû

4.3.1. Tablet I: primordial waters, the first gods, the killing of Apsû

Tablet I opens with the celebrated incipit "When on high" (**enūma eliš**). The setting is primordial: no gods, no world, nothing yet distinguished. The text begins, in the literal sense, before the beginning, and that emptiness is the surface against which the rest of the action takes place.^[34]

The opening describes the mingling of two primordial waters, Apsû the fresh and Tiamat the salt, undifferentiated into gods, lands, or names. The two waters are not metaphors; they are the material of the universe in its undeveloped state, the substance from which everything else will be derived.^[35]

The first generation of gods is born from this mingling. Lahmu and Lahamu are identified as a paired male-female deity-couple at the dawn of differentiation. With them, the universe acquires its first inhabitants and its first distinction between persons.^[36]

The second generation is Anšar and Kišar, sky-horizon and earth-horizon, who in turn beget Anu, the sky-god. The names themselves carry a programme: a sky-horizon paired with an earth-horizon describes the geometry the cosmos is about to acquire.^[37]

Anu begets Nudimmud, the alternative name for Ea in this composition, characterised by

surpassing wisdom. The wisdom that will save the younger gods, when the crisis comes, is named here at the moment of Ea's birth.^[38]

The theogonic sequence — Apsû / Tiamat → Lahmu / Lahamu → Anšar / Kišar → Anu → Ea — establishes a four-tier descent from the primordial waters to the wisdom-god who will become Marduk's father. The genealogy is the spine of the rest of the chapter: every one of these names will matter when the assembly is convened.^[39]

The younger gods, born within Apsû and Tiamat, are noisy. They disturb the repose of their parents. The disturbance is not yet a moral failing; it is a fact of generational difference, but it sets up the conflict that follows.^[40]

The text gives Apsû's perspective as exasperation. The noise of the younger gods makes rest impossible, and Apsû resolves to destroy them so that quiet may return. The motive is given without disguise: he wants peace, and the cost is to be paid by his own offspring.^[41]

Apsû takes counsel with his vizier Mummu, and Mummu encourages the plan: the younger gods are to be annihilated. The vizier's role is the bureaucratic one — he ratifies and amplifies the decision rather than initiating it.^[42]

Apsû then approaches Tiamat and proposes the destruction of their offspring. Tiamat refuses. She will not destroy what she has herself brought forth. The refusal matters: it places her, at the start, on the side of the children rather than the parental impulse to silence them.^[43]

Tiamat's refusal is the first divergence between Apsû and Tiamat in the text. It is later cited as evidence that her motive in the second movement is grief and obligation rather than primordial malice — a textual datum on which the Ballentine reading of Tiamat-as-rival-sovereign turns.^[44]

The younger gods learn of Apsû's plan and are paralysed with fear. They sit silent. The reaction is the first of several scenes in which the older generations of gods cannot move, while the younger Ea is the only one who finds an answer.^[45]

Ea, the wise one, alone among the younger gods devises a counter-strategy. He composes a powerful incantation, recites it over Apsû, and casts him into a sleep. The mode of the action is significant: Ea defeats the primordial father by speech and ritual, not by force.^[46]

With Apsû asleep, Ea binds him, strips him of his crown and divine radiance, and kills him.^[47]

Ea also captures Mummu, Apsû's vizier, binds him, and takes his nose-rope as a leash. The image of the leashed vizier is concrete and humiliating, and the text dwells on it.^[48]

Ea then establishes his dwelling on top of the slain Apsû's corpse, founding what becomes the cosmic Apsû — the abode of the wisdom-god above the primordial fresh-water. The defeated body becomes the floor of a divine residence; the territory of the slain enemy becomes habitable real estate.^[49]

The killing of Apsû is the first combat in the epic. It establishes the pattern: the threatened younger god uses incantation and binding to subdue and dismember a primordial parent. Forsyth treats the episode as a structural rehearsal for the Marduk-Tiamat combat that follows: same shape, smaller scale.^[50]

Within Ea's new dwelling, in the Apsû, Marduk is born to Ea and Damkina. The text describes his birth in terms of unprecedented brilliance and divine perfection. The poet means the new god to be visibly different from the gods who have come before; the description is not a mere flourish but a thematic setup.^[51]

Marduk is described as having four eyes and four ears, of surpassing physical proportions, and as radiant from birth. The catalogue of features is meant to mark him as outside the ordinary divine type.^[52]

Anu, Marduk's grandfather, fashions the four winds as a gift, and gives them to Marduk to play with. The winds will later prove decisive in the combat. What looks like a child's toy in Tablet I is in fact the principal weapon Marduk will use in Tablet IV — the text plants its weapons in advance, and the audience is meant to recognise the gift as foreshadowing.^[53]

Marduk's playing with the winds disturbs Tiamat in her primordial waters. The disturbance compounds the grievance of the older gods who have been agitating Tiamat to act. What had been the noise of the younger gods has now become a more pointed disturbance, and the texture of the conflict tightens.^[54]

A faction of gods aligned with the slain Apsû now reproaches Tiamat for her passivity. She did not stand up for Apsû when he was killed, and now her offspring's noise compounds the insult. The reproach is what changes Tiamat's posture: it is the political pressure of an aggrieved party, not a primordial impulse.^[55]

The reproach faction's demand is explicit: Tiamat must avenge Apsû. The terms are vengeance-terms, and the moral framing is theirs, not the text's omniscient voice.^[56]

Tiamat is moved to action by the reproach. She resolves to make war on the younger gods and to set the cosmos in order through the destruction of those she now reframes as rebels. The shift is consequential: she stops being the mother who refused destruction and starts being the leader of the war that the older faction wanted.^[57]

The reframing of Tiamat's posture between her refusal in Tablet I and her later mobilisation is one of the textual hinges on which the alternative-sovereign reading turns. The text gives the audience two scenes — refusal first, then anger after reproach — and the order matters: the war is what the older faction wants, not what Tiamat originally wanted. The interpretive caveat that follows acknowledges that the reading itself goes a step beyond what the text explicitly says.

(Tiamat's reframing of the younger gods as rebels rather than her offspring is read in the scholarship as a transformation of obligation into adversariality.^[58])

Tiamat brings forth a host of monstrous creatures to fight on her side: serpents with venom for blood, Mušhuššu-dragons, lahmu-monsters, lion-demons, scorpion-men, fish-men, bull-men, mighty winds, and other composite beasts. The catalogue is concrete and varied — the poet wants the reader to see the army before the battle is joined.^[59]

The text enumerates eleven monstrous champions. The catalogue becomes a recurring formula in the epic, repeated four times across Tablets I–IV. The repetition is part of how the composition keeps the army-list in front of the audience: Tiamat's host is one of the things the text wants the listener to remember.^[60]

Anzû, the lion-headed eagle of the earlier Anzû Epic, appears in the catalogue of Tiamat's monsters: he has been demoted from rebel-protagonist to subordinate creature. The detail is not incidental — it is one of the clearest signals of Enūma Eliš's literary relation to the Anzû Epic, since the figure who carried the older combat is now a footnote in the new one.^[61]

Tiamat appoints Qingu, identified in the text as her firstborn or as her chosen consort after Apsû, as commander-in-chief of her host. The double identification — firstborn or chosen consort — is itself a feature of the text, and it is one of the points Marduk will later seize on in the verbal challenge before the combat.^[62]

Tiamat invests Qingu with the Tablet of Destinies, fastening it to his chest, and thereby confers on him the cosmic decree-power. The Tablet is the artefact whose possession determines who can issue binding cosmic commands; with it on his chest, Qingu's word becomes effective in the way the assembly's word will need to be effective when its own champion is named.^[63]

The Tablet's transfer to Qingu is the structural inheritance from the Anzû Epic, where a usurper had seized it. Here Tiamat herself bestows it. The shift in mode of transfer — theft versus gift — is one of the smaller adjustments Enūma Eliš makes to its source, and the change has consequences for how the combat is framed.^[64]

Tiamat declares Qingu her husband and supreme among the gods of her party, raising him above all others. The declaration has the form of a counter-coronation: Tiamat now has her own king, and her own court, and the conflict becomes a contest between two organised divine assemblies.^[65]

Fashioning Tiamat's host and elevating Qingu close Tablet I. The first tablet has done its work: it has assembled an army, named a commander, and bestowed the Tablet of Destinies. Everything Marduk's side will have to overcome has now been put on the field.^[66]

4.3.2. Tablet II: Ea's report and the search for a champion

Tablet II opens with Ea learning of Tiamat's preparations and her appointment of Qingu. The intelligence flows where it would be expected to flow: to the wisdom-god, who already once defeated a primordial parent and who is the obvious first point of contact.^[67]

Ea brings the news to his father Anšar, reporting Tiamat's mobilisation and the catalogue of her monsters in formal repetition. The catalogue is delivered, this time, by an informant rather than the narrator, and the form of the repetition belongs to the genre — the news is news of a kind the audience already knows.^[68]

Anšar receives the report with distress, striking his thigh and biting his lip in formulaic gestures of dismay. The gestures are stock and the audience is meant to recognise them as such; their formulaic character does not lessen them but locates the action within a familiar register of divine response.^[69]

Anšar dispatches Ea against Tiamat. As the slayer of Apsû, Ea is the first candidate for the new combat: precedent recommends him. The qualification that worked once is asked to work again.^[70]

Ea sets out, but turns back. Faced with Tiamat directly, he cannot prevail and returns to Anšar without engaging. The text gives no extended explanation; Ea finds the task is beyond him, and the

failure is its own datum.^[71]

Anšar then dispatches Anu against Tiamat, with the same outcome: Anu also turns back unable to confront her. Two of the most senior figures in the divine genealogy have now failed to face her, and the failure is becoming a problem for the assembly's whole position.^[72]

The threefold-refusal pattern of the Anzû Epic — three candidates decline before the eventual champion is named — is structurally inherited here, with two failed embassies before Marduk is proposed. Annus reads the structural inheritance as deliberate: the new poet is making the audience hear the older composition's pattern even as he gives it a new resolution.^[73]

Anšar despairs. No god of the older generations can confront Tiamat, and the divine assembly is left without a champion. The despair is structural — it sets up the moment when a god from outside the older generations will be needed.^[74]

Ea then proposes Marduk: his young son, born in the Apsû, surpasses all the other gods in strength and is the only candidate who can face Tiamat. The proposal comes from the wisdom-god, which is the proper origin for it; Ea who solved the first crisis solves the second by nominating his son.^[75]

Ea brings Marduk before Anšar, and Anšar receives him with relief and instruction. The relief is part of the rhetorical work — the eldest gods having failed, the youngest god is going to be asked to do what they could not — and the instruction sets up the negotiation that follows.^[76]

Anšar instructs Marduk to face Tiamat, and Marduk responds by declaring his readiness — but with a condition that closes Tablet II and dominates Tablet III. The condition is the structural pivot: nothing in what follows works without it.^[77]

Marduk's condition is that, if he is to fight Tiamat as the champion of the gods, his decree must be supreme. Whatever he commands must come to pass, and his word must take precedence over the assembly's. The condition is a constitutional demand, not a tactical one: Marduk asks for the office before he agrees to do the work.^[78]

The condition transforms the combat from a defensive engagement into a kingship-acquisition. Marduk's victory will entail his elevation to supreme rule. Both Lincoln and Ballentine read this as the text's central political move: the combat is the occasion for the kingship, and the text knows it.^[79]

By the close of Tablet II, the structural premises of the rest of the text are in place. Tiamat has an army, a champion, and the Tablet of Destinies. The younger gods have a candidate of their own — Marduk — but his agreement to fight has been made conditional on a constitutional change. The combat that the second movement narrates is therefore prepared on both sides, and what remains is the formal acceptance of Marduk's terms, the combat itself, and the cosmogony that follows from it.

4.4. Movement II — Marduk's elevation and the combat with Tiamat

4.4.1. Tablet III: the assembly is convened

Tablet III opens with Anšar dispatching his vizier Kaka to Lahmu and Lahamu, the eldest gods, to summon them to the assembly. The text moves up the genealogical ladder: the senior figures of the first divine generation are now to be brought into the deliberations.^[80]

Kaka delivers the news to the elder gods in formal repetition: Tiamat's mobilisation, Qingu's commission, the failed embassies of Ea and Anu, and Marduk's condition. The vizier's speech is the third major restatement of the army-list and the third major restatement of the diplomatic situation, and the audience is meant to hear them as the same speech each time.^[81]

The repetition is structurally important. The catalogue of monsters and the substance of Marduk's terms are repeated multiple times across the first four tablets, a feature of the composition's oral-performance heritage. The text was meant to be heard, and a heard text uses repetition the way a written text uses cross-references.^[82]

Lahmu and Lahamu, hearing the report, gnash their teeth in distress and depart to the assembly. Their distress is the proper reaction at this point in the narrative and authorises the formal gathering that follows.^[83]

The assembly of the great gods, the Igigi and the Anunnaki, gathers and feasts. They drink beer, they sit, they eat bread. The detail is concrete and unromantic; the gods feast in the way Babylonian assemblies are pictured feasting, and the divine council is given the texture of a real political body.^[84]

The assembly's ceremonial drinking and feasting close Tablet III, with the formal decision on Marduk deferred to Tablet IV. The deferral is structural: the ceremony of gathering precedes the ceremony of decision, and the next tablet will give the second of those.^[85]

4.4.2. Tablet IV: the assembly's elevation, the test of the cloth, the combat

Tablet IV opens with the assembly's formal decision. Marduk is granted the supremacy he demanded, and his decree is elevated above all others. The condition Marduk laid down at the close of Tablet II is now formally accepted: the assembly grants what he asked.^[86]

The gods construct a princely throne for Marduk, set him upon it, and acclaim him with the formula "your decree is supreme; your word is Anu." The throne, the seating, and the acclamation are all enthronement-elements; the audience is meant to recognise the ceremony as a coronation.^[87]

The formula equates Marduk's word with the decree of Anu, the sky-father — the highest divine authority in the older Mesopotamian theology. To say Marduk's word is Anu's word is to say the new god has acquired the office that older theology placed at the top of the pantheon.^[88]

The assembly tests Marduk's new power by placing a cloth or garment in their midst and asking him to destroy it and then restore it by command alone. The test is a public demonstration; the assembly will not let him fight as champion until they have seen for themselves that the office they have just granted has its proper effect.^[89]

Marduk speaks; the cloth vanishes. He speaks again; the cloth is restored intact. The two acts are

deliberate: the test verifies destruction and restoration, undoing and remaking, the two operations that will matter for the cosmogony to come.^[90]

The cloth-test confirms that Marduk's word now possesses the cosmic decree-power that the older gods recognise as a property of supreme rule. The Tablet of Destinies is across the field, on Qingu's chest, but the decree-power that the Tablet conveys is now in Marduk's voice.^[91]

The assembly, satisfied, hails Marduk as king: "Marduk is king." The acclamation is brief and direct, and it is the formal output of the cloth-test.^[92]

The acclamation establishes the kingship before the combat. Marduk fights as already-king, and his victory ratifies rather than acquires the office. The point is one Lincoln and Ballentine both insist on: the kingship is the precondition of the combat, not its prize.^[93]

The gods then arm Marduk for the combat. He takes a bow, an arrow, a mace, lightning, a flaming flame held in his lips, and a net to entrap his foe. The catalogue of weapons is once again concrete; the new king goes to war kitted out as a warrior.^[94]

Marduk fashions the four winds his grandfather Anu had given him into weapons, and he raises in addition seven evil winds — the Wind, the Tempest, the Whirlwind, the Hurricane, the Cyclone, the Imhullu (literally "evil wind"), and others — that he holds in reserve for the combat. The toy of Tablet I has now become an arsenal, and the audience is meant to remember its origin.^[95]

Marduk mounts his storm-chariot, drawn by four named horses whose names are variously translated. Foster 2005 renders them "Killer, Pitiless, Trampler, Fleet"; other English versions diverge in the rendering of the fourth name. The chariot is the standard equipment of a Mesopotamian war-god, and Marduk is being equipped accordingly.^[96]

Marduk draws near to Tiamat, and the two engage in a verbal challenge before the physical combat begins. The verbal challenge belongs to the form: heroic combats in this literature regularly open with speech-exchanges, and the present case follows the convention.^[97]

Marduk taunts Tiamat with the charge of injustice. She had refused to destroy her offspring with Apsû, yet now she elevates Qingu, who is not her firstborn by right, to a kingship that does not belong to him. The taunt is not an aside; it is a legal indictment of Tiamat's appointment of Qingu, and it presses on exactly the point at which her case is weakest.^[98]

Tiamat answers, and the text describes her as enraged, taking up the combat: she opens her mouth wide. The image is the threshold between the verbal challenge and the physical engagement, and the text dwells on the open mouth because the next move depends on it.^[99]

Marduk drives the Imhullu, the evil wind, into Tiamat's open mouth so that she cannot close her lips. The tactic is precise: the wind that was once a child's plaything is now a battlefield weapon, and it functions by preventing speech.^[100]

Other winds rush in after Imhullu, distending Tiamat's belly and rendering her immobile. The combat-tactic is unusually concrete in its physiology, and the text gives the sequence in step-by-step terms.^[101]

With Tiamat unable to close her mouth, Marduk shoots an arrow into her open belly, splitting her

heart. The kill is direct, technically efficient, and explicitly anatomised: the text does not abstract the act.^[102]

Tiamat falls dead, and Marduk stands upon her corpse. The image of the victor standing on the body is, in this literature, the standard sign of victory and possession.^[103]

The host of monstrous creatures Tiamat had fashioned scatters in flight, but Marduk's net catches them. He binds them and treads them under foot. The army that took a tablet to assemble is dispatched in a few lines: the catalogue's narrative function was to be defeated.^[104]

Qingu, Tiamat's general, is captured among the monsters. Marduk binds him and seizes from his chest the Tablet of Destinies that Tiamat had bestowed. The Tablet, as in the Anzû Epic, returns to its proper holder by combat — though here the prior holder was the rebel coalition's appointed champion rather than a thief.^[105]

Marduk seals the Tablet of Destinies and presses it to his own chest, transferring the cosmic decree-power to himself. The transfer is physical and the gesture is unmistakable: what was on Qingu's chest is now on Marduk's, and the decree-power has changed hands.^[106]

Marduk returns to Tiamat's corpse and rests his foot upon it. He then turns to the work of cosmogony. The combat is over; the cosmogony is a separate act, and the text marks the transition with the foot-on-corpse image.^[107]

Marduk splits Tiamat's body lengthwise like a flat fish, into two halves. The simile is borrowed from food-preparation, and that is part of its force: the body of the defeated cosmogonic mother is processed like a fish on a slab.^[108]

He raises the upper half of Tiamat's body and sets it as the sky, fixing it in place with bars and a watchman so that her waters cannot escape. The sky is made of Tiamat's matter, and the bars-and-watchman provision is in the text as a security arrangement: the new sky is also a containment for the cosmogonic waters.^[109]

Using Tiamat's body as the material from which the sky is made establishes the cosmogony as combat-cosmogony: the world is the slain adversary's matter, ordered by the victor. Forsyth treats this as one of the defining features of the type — the cosmogony is not made from nothing but from the body of what had to be defeated first.^[110]

4.4.3. Tablet V: the cosmogony, the calendar, the stations of the sky

Tablet V opens with Marduk continuing the cosmogonic work. He establishes the stations of the great gods in the sky, fixing them as constellations. The astronomy of Tablet V is precise where Tablet IV's body-dismemberment was visceral: the new cosmos is being equipped with an ordered observational schema.^[111]

Marduk fixes the year of twelve months, with three stars assigned to each month and the sequence of stations governing the calendar. The calendar that the text describes is recognisably the calendar of Mesopotamian observational astronomy, and the cosmogony is being made to issue in the local timekeeping.^[112]

He establishes the place of Nēberu, the crossing-place — identified with Marduk's own astral

station — at the heart of the heavens to fix the boundaries of the year. Nēberu is Marduk's signature in the sky, and its placement at the centre means the new king's name is written across the year.^[113]

Marduk creates the moon, gives it a crown, and assigns it the office of regulating the night and marking the months. The grant is administrative: the moon is given a portfolio, and the portfolio is the lunar month.^[114]

The text gives explicit instructions for the moon's monthly cycle: at the new moon it is to shine as a horn; at the seventh it is to appear as a half-disk; at the fifteenth, the full moon, it is to face the sun directly; and thereafter to wane. The instructions read as a job-description, and the level of detail is striking — the cosmogony is being made to lay down the working schedule of the visible heavens.^[115]

Marduk creates the sun and assigns it the office of regulating the day. Sun and moon together divide cosmic time. The pair is the standard pair of Mesopotamian time-keeping, and the cosmogony has now produced both halves of the daily and monthly cycle.^[116]

The reading of Tablet V that the chapter has just given depends in places on Lambert's reconstruction of partly broken passages, particularly in the calendrical sections. The lacuna marker that follows registers that dependence: where the surviving witnesses are damaged, the score-text used here integrates the available manuscripts to fill the gap.

[At this point the tablet breaks. Tablet V contains small gaps in the description of the stations of the moon and the organization of time, around the calendrical instructions for the lunar cycle. Scholars such as Lambert (2013), Tablet V apparatus, have proposed the narrative resumed by integrating Neo-Assyrian and Neo-Babylonian witnesses in a critical score that reconstructs the affected passages.]

Marduk takes the lower half of Tiamat's body and uses it for the earth-cosmogony. From her thighs he makes the great mountains; her eyes he opens for the sources of the Tigris and Euphrates; her nostrils become springs. The body-to-landscape mapping is anatomically specific: each feature of the cosmos has its origin in a named feature of Tiamat's corpse.^[117]

He piles the mountains on Tiamat's head and bores wells through her skull. The image is grim and concrete; the cosmogony does not abstract the body it is processing.^[118]

He coils her tail to form the cosmic bond that links the heavens and the earth at the horizon. The horizon, in this cosmology, is a literal cord, and Tiamat's tail is what makes it.^[119]

He arches her crotch to support the heavens, an architectural element of the new cosmos. The detail is part of the cosmogony's architectural concreteness: the sky needs a support, and one of Tiamat's body-parts provides it.^[120]

The total cosmogony from Tiamat's body provides sky, mountains, rivers, springs, the cosmic bond, and the architectural support of the heavens — a comprehensive ordering of the visible world from the corpse of the slain adversary. The completeness of the mapping is what makes this combat-cosmogony rather than just combat: every part of the cosmos is accounted for as a feature of Tiamat.^[121]

Marduk presents his completed work to the assembled gods, and the gods respond with celebration.

The presentation is a public review: the gods see the work and approve it, and the approval is the second formal moment of acclamation.^[122]

The gods give Marduk the insignia of kingship: a sceptre, a throne, and a royal robe, marking the ratification of his rule over the new cosmos. The kingship Marduk had received in advance, before the combat, is now ratified after the cosmogony, with the standard regalia.^[123]

The gods also pledge their submission to Marduk and make a formal commitment to obey his decree. The pledge completes the constitutional move that Marduk's condition in Tablet II had begun: the assembly's word was supreme; now Marduk's word is supreme over the assembly, and the assembly has agreed.^[124]

Tablet V closes with Marduk preparing to receive the gods at his side and with the gods' acclamation of his sovereignty over the ordered cosmos. The first half of the epic — combat and cosmogony — is now complete; the second half will turn to humans, the city, and the names.^[125]

By the close of Tablet V, the cosmos is in place. The kingship that Marduk was granted before the combat has been ratified after the cosmogony, and the assembly has pledged its submission. What remains is what the third movement will give: the creation of humans, the founding of the city and its temple, and the fifty-names ceremony in which the assembly's praise becomes the text's doxological closure.

4.5. Movement III — Creation of humans, founding of Babylon, the fifty names

4.5.1. Tablet VI: humans from Qingu's blood, the building of Babylon and Esagil

Tablet VI opens with Marduk announcing his plan to relieve the gods of their labour. He will create humans to perform the work of maintaining the cosmos, freeing the gods for repose. The plan is presented as a benefit to the gods, and the human race comes into existence as a labour-saving measure for the divine assembly.^[126]

Marduk consults Ea on the means: blood is required, blood from a god who instigated the rebellion of Tiamat. The means are not arbitrary; the construction of humans is to be paid for by a specific party's blood, and the specification matters.^[127]

The assembly identifies Qingu as the responsible party. He held the Tablet of Destinies, he led Tiamat's host, he is the one whose blood will pay. The identification is the assembly's own; Qingu is named for the role on the basis of his actions in the war.^[128]

Qingu is bound, brought before Ea, and his blood is opened. From his blood the first humans are fashioned. The act is sacrificial in form: a god is killed, his blood is shed, and humanity is the product.^[129]

The aetiology is explicit: humans are made from the blood of a rebel god so that they may bear the labour-burden of the gods. The text does not soften the point — humans exist because the gods needed someone to do the work, and the substance of humanity is the blood of a defeated

rebel.^[130]

The aetiology gives religious sanction to the corvée-and-temple-service economy of Babylonian temple-states. Humans are constituted as labour for the gods at their inception, and Lincoln's reading of the text is that the social order of the temple-state is being projected back into the cosmogony as its origin.^[131]

Marduk then divides the gods, allotting three hundred to the heavens above and three hundred to the earth below, fixing the divine assembly's distribution in the new cosmos. The numbers are formulaic, and the division is a constitutional move: the divine bureaucracy is now organised into upper and lower chambers.^[132]

In gratitude for their relief from labour, the gods undertake to build a sanctuary for Marduk in Babylon. They will construct Esagil, the temple-house, and the city around it. The construction is presented as a voluntary return-gift: humans took on the gods' labour, and the gods reciprocate by building Marduk's house.^[133]

The Anunnaki, the gods of the underworld, undertake the construction. They make bricks, raise walls, and build Esagil over the course of two years. The detail of brick-making and the two-year timeframe locate the cosmogony's final architectural act in the same idiom as a real Babylonian building campaign.^[134]

The cosmic-architectural reading of *Esagil* that the chapter is about to mark with an inference token is a standard piece of scholarly synthesis: the temple's pairing with Anu's *Esarra* above, and with Ea's Apsû below, gives a three-tier picture in which the new temple sits at the centre of a cosmography drawn from the older theogony. The text describes the pairing; the three-tier theogonic reading goes one step further, and the marker that follows registers that step.

(Esagil is constructed as the cosmic counterpart of the Apsû above and the Esarra of Anu — the three-tier structure mirrors Anšar / Anu / Ea theogonically.^[135])

Esarra, the earthly counterpart of the heavenly Esagil-above, is established as Anu's temple, paralleling Marduk's seat below. The pairing puts Marduk's house in a cosmological architecture: not a single temple but one of a tier of temples that organise the new cosmos.^[136]

When Esagil is complete, the gods enter and feast at Marduk's house. The sanctuary becomes the venue of the divine assembly, with Marduk presiding. The feast at Esagil is the counterpart of the feast in Tablet III: there the assembly was about to grant Marduk the kingship; here it is celebrating the kingship as accomplished.^[137]

Founding Babylon and Esagil establishes the city as the cosmic centre. The temple is the axis where heaven, earth, and Apsû meet under Marduk's rule. The cosmography is centred on Babylon, and the centring is the text's principal theological claim about the city.^[138]

The text identifies Babylon as "the house where the great gods reside," establishing its theological status as the seat of the cosmic kingship. The phrasing is direct, and the text uses it as a name-of-status rather than a description.^[139]

Within Esagil, Marduk takes his seat upon the throne, and the gods kneel before him in homage. The image of the seated king with kneeling subordinates is the standard picture of Mesopotamian

sovereignty, and the text is closing the kingship-acquisition arc that began with Marduk's condition in Tablet II.^[140]

The gods then begin the ceremonial naming of Marduk. The assembly will pronounce his fifty names, each marking an aspect of his divinity, his combat, or his rule. The naming is the text's last major movement, and it is a deliberate piece of doxological architecture.^[141]

The fifty-names ceremony begins in Tablet VI and continues throughout Tablet VII. Structurally it functions as the doxological closure of the epic. The names do for Marduk in praise what the combat and cosmogony did for him in action: they account for what he is, in liturgical form.^[142]

4.5.2. Tablet VII: the fifty names

Tablet VII is given over almost entirely to the fifty names of Marduk and their explications, with each name accompanied by interpretive lines that gloss the name's meaning. The form is litanic: name, then gloss, then the next name. The text is its own commentary, and the audience is taught what each name means as it is pronounced.^[143]

The first names cluster in Tablet VI: Marduk, Marukka, Marutukku, Mershakushu, Lugaldimmerankia (king of the gods of heaven and earth), Nari-Lugal-dimmer-an-ki-a, Asalluhi, and others associated with rule, exorcism, and creation. This first cluster gathers the names that connect Marduk to his older Babylonian identities and to the practical theological functions he had already accumulated before Enūma Eliš was written.^[144]

A second cluster of names emphasises Marduk's combat and victory: titles like Asaru, Tutu, and the storm-god names that recall his defeat of Tiamat. The cluster keeps the combat present in the doxology — the names of victory remind the audience that praise rests on a specific feat.^[145]

A third cluster emphasises Marduk's cosmic ordering work: names that bind him to the calendar, the constellations, and the regulation of cosmic time. The names make Tablet V's astronomy doxological — the calendar Marduk fixed becomes the calendar his names reflect.^[146]

A fourth cluster identifies Marduk with the prerogatives of older gods. He absorbs functions and epithets of Enlil, Ea, Anu, Adad, and others, becoming a supreme deity who concentrates the older pantheon's offices in himself. The text is performing, in the form of names, the same theological consolidation that the combat performed in the form of action: older offices belong to Marduk now.^[147]

Anu bestows the number fifty on Marduk, equating Marduk numerologically with Enlil — whose sacred number was fifty in the older theology. The numerology matters: in the older system, fifty was Enlil's number and the highest in the conventional ordering, and the bestowal here is therefore a transfer of rank.^[148]

Bestowing Enlil's number on Marduk is theologically decisive. It affirms that Marduk has supplanted Enlil in the supreme office, completing the displacement that the combat had begun. Annus reads the moment as the conceptual capstone of the whole composition: the older pantheon has been rearranged so that Marduk sits at its top, with the number that used to belong to its previous head.^[149]

The closing portion of the fifty-names passage is the second of the two damaged sections that affect

this chapter's narrative. Where Tablet V's gaps fell in the calendrical section, Tablet VII's gaps fall in the doxological closure, and the second lacuna marker registers the dependence on Lambert's reconstructed score.

[At this point the tablet breaks. The closing fifty-names passage of Tablet VII has some name-explications partially broken. Scholars such as Lambert (2013), Tablet VII apparatus, have proposed the narrative resumed with a reconstruction in which Assyrian and Babylonian manuscripts overlap, allowing the critical score to recover most of the affected passages.]

Tablet VII closes with a doxological hymn that calls on humans to remember and recite Marduk's fifty names, with the explicit liturgical exhortation that the names be passed from father to son and from elder to junior. The text is reaching past its own ending to the conditions of its own future use: it tells the audience how to keep the text alive.^[150]

The closing hymn frames Enūma Eliš as a recitation-text. It is meant to be spoken aloud, learned by heart, and transmitted through the generations. The form Enūma Eliš took in its surviving witnesses is partly a function of this self-instruction; the manuscripts are tools for the kind of transmission the text itself prescribes.^[151]

The closing hymn is consistent with the akītu-festival liturgical use of the text. The epic is composed to be performed. The performative dimension is not an extra-textual fact about its reception; it is what the text says it is for.^[152]

With the seven tablets now walked through, the chapter turns from narrative description to interpretive debate. Three discussions follow: the Gunkel/Ballentine question about whether "chaos" is the right category for Tiamat; the akītu ritual frame in which the text was actually used; and the variants and reception of the work in its later Babylonian and Assyrian afterlife.

4.6. The Gunkel and Ballentine debate

Hermann Gunkel's 1895 **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit** identified Enūma Eliš as the type-specimen of a religious-historical pattern he named Chaoskampf, in which a sovereign deity defeats the adversary of order and establishes the cosmos. Gunkel's coining of the German term has shaped the field since, and it is the term this book inherits, even as it inherits the contemporary qualifications that have grown up around it.^[153]

Gunkel's argument was developed in part to illuminate the Hebrew Bible. He proposed that Genesis 1's *tehôm* (the deep) was cognate with Tiamat and that Israelite cosmogony preserved a demythologised version of the Babylonian combat. The argument was historical-religious in its orientation: Gunkel was trying to show that the biblical opening had a Mesopotamian background, and Enūma Eliš was the Mesopotamian background he had in mind.^[154]

The Gunkel reading dominated the twentieth-century literature on Enūma Eliš and on the Hebrew Bible's *tehôm* / Leviathan / Rahab corpus. It remains the framework against which contemporary alternatives are argued. To call a contemporary reading "alternative" is, in this field, to position it against Gunkel; the framework has not been displaced, even where it has been qualified.^[155]

Debra Scoggins Ballentine's 2015 alternative-sovereign reading argues that "chaos" mistranslates the conceptual work the Mesopotamian text is doing. Tiamat is not undifferentiated disorder but a

rival claimant to divine sovereignty. Ballentine's argument turns on what Tiamat actually does in the text: she organises an army, appoints a champion, distributes a token of authority, and conducts a war. None of those actions is well described by the word "chaos."^[156]

On Ballentine's reading, the conflict in *Enūma Eliš* is between two competing political orders — Tiamat's coalition with Qingu and the assembly's elevation of Marduk — and not between order and disorder. Both sides have an order; the question is which order will prevail. The shift in framing changes how one reads almost every scene of the epic, and Ballentine's chapter is principally an exercise in showing that the change is textually warranted.^[157]

Ballentine's reading is anticipated by Bruce Lincoln's argument that combat myths function as political-ideological work, legitimating the victor's regime by recasting the loser's claim as illegitimate. Lincoln's general thesis applies to a wider corpus than *Enūma Eliš*, but the Babylonian text is one of his clearest examples, and Ballentine's specific reading of Tiamat-as-rival-sovereign is recognisable as Lincoln's general framework applied to the particular case.^[158]

The Scurlock and Beal 2013 collected volume gathers a range of essays that, in different ways, qualify or reject Gunkel's framing while preserving the recognition that *Enūma Eliš* is centrally about combat and cosmic order. The volume is not a manifesto; it is a collection of working specialists adjusting Gunkel's category from inside the field, with different essays offering different qualifications.^[159]

The book's working position, following Scurlock and Beal and Ballentine, is that "combat myth" is a more accurate descriptive term than "Chaoskampf," but that "Chaoskampf" is retained as the term of art that the scholarly conversation continues to use. The terminology is therefore a compromise: this book uses "combat myth" as its descriptive default and "Chaoskampf" when speaking with the inherited literature.^[160]

The Tiamat-as-mother-against-her-children reading is supported by the textual evidence that her initial impulse is refusal of Apsû's destruction-plan and that her later anger is provoked by reproach rather than primordial. The reading does not require dissolving the cosmogonic dimension that Gunkel correctly identified. The cosmos is in fact made from Tiamat's body; the text's interest in cosmogony is real. What changes, on the alternative-sovereign reading, is how the combat itself is to be characterised — as a political contest with cosmogonic results, rather than as a fight between order and primordial chaos. Both readings have been defended by the relevant scholarship and the chapter presents them side by side without adjudication.^[161]

The chapter does not adjudicate finally between Gunkel and Ballentine; the variant marker that follows records the decision to carry both readings in the body, on the grounds that the principal interpretive crux of the text is best presented as a debate rather than as a settled question.

The chapter therefore carries both Gunkel's reading — Marduk's combat with Tiamat as the type-specimen of a chaos-versus-order pattern — and Ballentine's reading — that the conflict is between rival sovereign claimants, and that "chaos" mistranslates the conceptual structure — substantively in the body rather than choosing between them, on the grounds that both must be engaged directly rather than relegated to footnotes.

4.7. The akītu festival context

The akītu New Year festival is the principal performative context of Enūma Eliš. The text was recited on the fourth day of the festival before the cult-image of Marduk in Esagil. This is the practical setting that the surviving record gives the text — not a school exercise, not a private read, but a liturgy spoken before the god’s image inside his own temple.^[162]

The akītu festival was celebrated in Nisan, the spring month, and structured the Babylonian liturgical year around the renewal of Marduk’s kingship and the king’s submission to him. The festival’s annual character is part of how it works: each year the kingship is renewed, and each year the human king has to stand again before the god whose subordinate he is. The cosmogony is therefore not a fact in the past tense; it is a fact that has to be re-affirmed each spring, and the recitation is one of the means by which the affirmation is done.^[163]

The recitation of Enūma Eliš at the akītu was performed by the high priest before Marduk’s image, and the text functioned as the liturgical re-presentation of the cosmogony. The recitation makes the text into an event: the cosmogony is not only described but re-enacted in the temple, with the priest as the performer and the cult-image as the audience.^[164]

The akītu also included a ritual humiliation and reinstatement of the king. The king was stripped of his insignia, struck on the cheek, and restored — a performance that subordinated the human king to Marduk’s cosmic kingship. The ritual is concrete: the human king is, for a moment, made into a humiliated subject before being given his crown back; the gesture stages the asymmetry between the god’s kingship and the king’s.^[165]

The combat-narrative and the ritual frame are mutually constitutive. Enūma Eliš is not a narrative that happens to be recited at the akītu; it is co-extensive with the akītu’s annual reactivation of the cosmogony. To separate text and ritual would be to misdescribe the function of either; the two are aspects of the same event.^[166]

The akītu context establishes that the text was understood, in its Babylonian context, as a performative re-creation of the order it narrates — not a one-time historical event but an annually renewed reality. The cosmos is not made once and left to run; it is made again every spring, and the recitation is part of how the making is done. The text and the festival together constitute a single piece of religious work; reading the text apart from the festival is a modern operation, and the modern reader who wants to understand the text in its Babylonian setting has to keep the festival in view.^[167]

4.8. Variants and reception

The Enūma Eliš witnesses preserved across the Neo-Assyrian and Neo-Babylonian copies show overall textual stability, with localised variants in spelling, divine epithets, and minor phrasing rather than competing recensions. The text is one of the more stable cases in the cuneiform tradition: the version recited in Esagil and the version copied at Nineveh were, by and large, the same text.^[168]

Lambert’s critical score for each tablet integrates the variant readings. The standard text presented in Lambert 2013 and in Foster 2005 is a composite drawn from this integration. The composite is

the working object of contemporary scholarship; reading "Enūma Eliš" today means reading Lambert's reconstructed text in Foster's English.^[169]

The Sultantepe tablet group preserves an Assyrian recension in which Aššur, the chief Assyrian deity, replaces Marduk as the cosmic champion in some passages. The substitution is a political reuse: the Assyrian crown took the Babylonian text and adjusted its leading deity to match its own pantheon.^[170]

The Aššur substitution attests to the political portability of the narrative. The same combat-and-cosmogony structure could be retooled to centre on a different patron deity when the political centre shifted. The recension is therefore evidence that the text was understood as a piece of political theology, capable of being adapted to whichever capital was reading it.^[171]

Royal inscriptions from Nebuchadnezzar I onward invoke Marduk's victory over Tiamat as the charter for the king's own legitimacy. The king reigns as Marduk's terrestrial counterpart. The pattern of citation is consistent: the epic's combat is cited as the warrant for the king's office, and the office is described as a downward-projection of the god's.^[172]

The Nebuchadnezzar I commissioning hypothesis ties the composition to the recovery of Marduk's cult-statue from Elam after a period of foreign captivity, framing the epic as theological response to that historical episode. On this reading the text is occasional in origin: it was written for a specific moment in Babylonian history, when a king brought his city's god back from exile and needed an account of why that god had always belonged at the centre of the cosmos.^[173]

The Nebuchadnezzar I commissioning hypothesis is the prevailing scholarly view but it is not universally accepted, and the inference marker that follows acknowledges that the dating debate is real and that this chapter's framing rests on the consensus position rather than on unanimity.

(The Nebuchadnezzar I commissioning hypothesis is the prevailing scholarly view but not universally accepted.^[174])

The fifty-names ceremony shows continuity with the older Sumerian and Akkadian tradition of compiling divine names. The closer antecedent is the honorific names bestowed on Ninurta at the close of the Anzû Epic (cross-ref: Ch. 2). The continuity is one of the most concrete pieces of evidence for the literary genealogy: the closing-doxology form in which Ninurta is praised in the Anzû Epic is the same form in which Marduk is praised at the close of Enūma Eliš.^[175]

Reusing and outbidding the Anzû Epic, Enūma Eliš provides the clearest documented case of combat-myth rewriting within Mesopotamian literature, restructuring the older Ninurta narrative as a more comprehensive cosmogony with Marduk in the warrior-role. Annus's case for deliberate authorial reuse rests on a string of correspondences — the threefold-refusal pattern, the Tablet of Destinies, the closing-name doxology, the demoted Anzû — and the case is now broadly accepted in the field.^[176]

In the Mesopotamian reception, Enūma Eliš circulated as a pedagogical text in the scribal curriculum, with copies and excerpts attested from school contexts. The text was used in scribal training; learning to read and write Akkadian meant, among other things, copying out passages of Enūma Eliš.^[177]

The text continued to be copied and recited into the late Achaemenid and Seleucid periods,

attesting its centrality in Babylonian religion across more than a millennium. Long after Babylonian political independence had been lost to successive Persian and Greek-speaking empires, the local temples kept copying the epic, and that fact is itself a measure of the text's depth in the local religious life.^[178]

The post-canonical reuses include the incorporation of Marduk's combat and cosmogony into late Babylonian and Hellenistic-period theological compendia, where the fifty-names tradition continued to develop. The names did not stop accumulating once the text was fixed; later scholarly compendia kept working on the name-list as a doxological resource.^[179]

Foster identifies Enūma Eliš as the most widely studied text of the Akkadian literary corpus and as the central case for any treatment of Mesopotamian cosmology. The judgement is the working assumption of the field, and it is the assumption this chapter has acted on throughout.^[180]

The text's reception in the modern study of religion runs through Gunkel 1895 and into all subsequent treatments of the combat-myth pattern, making Enūma Eliš the type-specimen of the comparative category that this book examines. Whatever else this book argues about the combat-myth as a category, the Babylonian text is the standard against which the rest of the corpus has been read for more than a century, and the rest of the volume's chapters return to it implicitly even when they treat other traditions on their own terms. The remaining Mesopotamian chapter (Ch. 4) covers the smaller compositions in the Mesopotamian combat-myth corpus; the Hebrew Bible chapter (Ch. 8) returns to the Tiamat / *tehôm* cognancy that Gunkel made the foundation of his case; the Ugaritic chapter (Ch. 7) takes up Baal's defeat of Yamm as the closest West-Semitic parallel; and the comparative chapters of Part II use Enūma Eliš as the Mesopotamian benchmark in arguing about transmission, sovereignty, and the typology of combat-myth.^[181]

[1] Lambert 2013, introduction; Foster 2005, p. 436, headnote.

[2] Gunkel 1895, Teil I, with Marduk vs. Tiamat as the central case.

[3] Lambert 2013, whole volume.

[4] Lambert 2013, introduction.

[5] Foster 2005, pp. 436–486, "Epic of Creation."

[6] Foster 2005, p. 436, headnote on translation principles; Lambert 2013, introduction.

[7] Lambert 2013, pp. 3–15, manuscript list.

[8] Lambert 2013, pp. 3–15, on witness distribution.

[9] Lambert 2013, pp. 3–15, on the Neo-Assyrian witnesses.

[10] Lambert 2013, pp. 3–15, on the Neo-Babylonian and later witnesses.

[11] Lambert 2013, introduction on the dating debate; Foster 2005, p. 436.

[12] Lambert 2013, introduction on the Nebuchadnezzar I hypothesis.

[13] Lambert 2013, pp. 463–465, on the *akītu* recitation; Foster 2005, p. 436, headnote.

[14] Lambert 2013, pp. 463–465, on the ritual texts.

[15] Lincoln 2012, essays on combat-myth as political ideology.

[16] Ballentine 2015, ch. 1 on Tiamat as alternative-sovereign rather than chaos.

[17] Ballentine 2015, ch. 1.

[18] Scurlock & Beal 2013, *passim*.

[19] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2 on Enūma Eliš within the combat-myth sequence.

[20] Annus 2001, introduction on the Anzû-Marduk genealogy.

[21] Lambert 2013, introduction on Marduk's rise; Foster 2005, p. 436, headnote.

[22] Lambert 2013, introduction; Lincoln 2012.

[23] Lambert 2013, Tablet I; Foster 2005, pp. 439–440.

[24] Lambert 2013, Tablet I; Foster 2005, p. 439.

- [25] Foster 2005, p. 440, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [26] Lambert 2013, Tablet I; Foster 2005, pp. 436–438.
- [27] Gunkel 1895, Teil I on the **tehôm**-Tiamat cognancy; Day 1985 for the later debate.
- [28] Lambert 2013, Tablet I; Foster 2005, pp. 436–437.
- [29] Lambert 2013, Tablet I; Foster 2005, p. 436.
- [30] Annus 2001, introduction on the Anzû-to-Enûma-Eliš genealogy; Lambert 2013, introduction.
- [31] Lambert 2013, Tablet IV; Foster 2005, p. 459.
- [32] Lambert 2013, pp. 463–465, on the akitu New Year festival.
- [33] Lambert 2013, Tablet VI; Foster 2005, pp. 472–473.
- [34] Foster 2005, p. 436, Tablet I opening; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [35] Foster 2005, pp. 436–437, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [36] Foster 2005, p. 437, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [37] Foster 2005, p. 437, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [38] Foster 2005, pp. 437–438, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [39] Foster 2005, pp. 436–438, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [40] Foster 2005, p. 438, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [41] Foster 2005, pp. 438–439, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [42] Foster 2005, p. 438, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [43] Foster 2005, pp. 438–439, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [44] Foster 2005, pp. 438–439, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I; Ballentine 2015, ch. 1.
- [45] Foster 2005, p. 439, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [46] Foster 2005, p. 439, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [47] Foster 2005, p. 439, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [48] Foster 2005, p. 439, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [49] Foster 2005, pp. 439–440, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [50] Foster 2005, p. 439, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2.
- [51] Foster 2005, p. 440, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [52] Foster 2005, p. 440, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [53] Foster 2005, p. 440, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [54] Foster 2005, pp. 440–441, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [55] Foster 2005, p. 441, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [56] Foster 2005, p. 441, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [57] Foster 2005, pp. 441–442, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [58] Inference: Foster 2005, pp. 441–442, and Ballentine 2015, ch. 1, both note that Tiamat's anger is provoked, not primordial. Risk: The surviving text does not explicitly mark this as a reframing; this reading is interpretive.
- [59] Foster 2005, pp. 441–442, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [60] Foster 2005, pp. 441–442, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I, on the eleven-monsters formula.
- [61] Lambert 2013, Tablet I, on Anzû's appearance among Tiamat's brood; Annus 2001, introduction.
- [62] Foster 2005, p. 442, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [63] Foster 2005, p. 442, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [64] Lambert 2013, Tablet I; Annus 2001, introduction.
- [65] Foster 2005, p. 442, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [66] Foster 2005, p. 442, Tablet I closing; Lambert 2013, Tablet I closing.
- [67] Foster 2005, pp. 443–444, Tablet II; Lambert 2013, Tablet II.
- [68] Foster 2005, pp. 443–444, Tablet II; Lambert 2013, Tablet II.
- [69] Foster 2005, p. 444, Tablet II; Lambert 2013, Tablet II.
- [70] Foster 2005, pp. 444–445, Tablet II; Lambert 2013, Tablet II.
- [71] Foster 2005, p. 445, Tablet II; Lambert 2013, Tablet II.
- [72] Foster 2005, pp. 445–446, Tablet II; Lambert 2013, Tablet II.
- [73] Foster 2005, pp. 444–446, Tablet II; Annus 2001, introduction; Lambert 2013, Tablet II.

- [74] Foster 2005, p. 446, Tablet II; Lambert 2013, Tablet II.
- [75] Foster 2005, pp. 446–447, Tablet II; Lambert 2013, Tablet II.
- [76] Foster 2005, p. 447, Tablet II; Lambert 2013, Tablet II.
- [77] Foster 2005, pp. 447–448, Tablet II closing; Lambert 2013, Tablet II.
- [78] Foster 2005, p. 448, Tablet II closing; Lambert 2013, Tablet II.
- [79] Foster 2005, p. 448, Tablet II; Lambert 2013, Tablet II; Lincoln 2012; Ballentine 2015, ch. 1.
- [80] Foster 2005, pp. 449–450, Tablet III; Lambert 2013, Tablet III.
- [81] Foster 2005, pp. 450–453, Tablet III; Lambert 2013, Tablet III.
- [82] Foster 2005, pp. 441–442 and 443–444 (Anšar’s report and Ea’s report on Tiamat’s army) and pp. 450–453 (the assembly’s confirmation); Lambert 2013, Tablet III commentary on the repetition pattern.
- [83] Foster 2005, p. 453, Tablet III; Lambert 2013, Tablet III.
- [84] Foster 2005, pp. 453–454, Tablet III closing; Lambert 2013, Tablet III.
- [85] Foster 2005, pp. 453–454, Tablet III closing; Lambert 2013, Tablet III.
- [86] Foster 2005, pp. 455–456, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [87] Foster 2005, p. 456, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [88] Foster 2005, p. 456, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV; Lincoln 2012.
- [89] Foster 2005, p. 456, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [90] Foster 2005, p. 456, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [91] Foster 2005, p. 456, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [92] Foster 2005, p. 456, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [93] Foster 2005, p. 456, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV; Lincoln 2012; Ballentine 2015, ch. 1.
- [94] Foster 2005, pp. 456–457, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [95] Foster 2005, pp. 456–457, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [96] Foster 2005, p. 457, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [97] Foster 2005, pp. 457–458, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [98] Foster 2005, p. 458, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [99] Foster 2005, p. 458, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [100] Foster 2005, p. 458, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [101] Foster 2005, p. 458, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [102] Foster 2005, p. 458, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [103] Foster 2005, pp. 458–459, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [104] Foster 2005, p. 459, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [105] Foster 2005, p. 459, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [106] Foster 2005, p. 459, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [107] Foster 2005, pp. 459–460, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [108] Foster 2005, pp. 459–460, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [109] Foster 2005, p. 460, Tablet IV closing; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV.
- [110] Foster 2005, p. 460, Tablet IV; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2.
- [111] Foster 2005, pp. 461–462, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [112] Foster 2005, pp. 461–462, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [113] Foster 2005, p. 462, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [114] Foster 2005, pp. 462–463, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [115] Foster 2005, pp. 462–463, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [116] Foster 2005, p. 463, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [117] Foster 2005, pp. 463–464, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [118] Foster 2005, p. 464, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [119] Foster 2005, p. 464, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [120] Foster 2005, p. 464, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [121] Foster 2005, pp. 459–464, Tablets IV–V; Lambert 2013, Tablets IV–V.
- [122] Foster 2005, pp. 464–465, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.

- [123] Foster 2005, pp. 464–465, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [124] Foster 2005, p. 465, Tablet V; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [125] Foster 2005, pp. 465–466, Tablet V closing; Lambert 2013, Tablet V.
- [126] Foster 2005, pp. 467–468, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [127] Foster 2005, p. 468, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [128] Foster 2005, p. 468, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [129] Foster 2005, pp. 468–469, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [130] Foster 2005, pp. 468–469, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI; Lincoln 2012.
- [131] Foster 2005, pp. 468–469, Tablet VI; Lincoln 2012; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [132] Foster 2005, p. 469, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [133] Foster 2005, pp. 470–471, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [134] Foster 2005, pp. 471–472, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [135] Inference: Foster 2005, pp. 471–472, and Lambert 2013, Tablet VI, describe Esagil’s foundation as cosmic counterpart-architecture; the theogonic three-tier reading is a standard scholarly synthesis. Risk: The text states the architectural pairing but does not explicitly assert the Anšar/Anu/Ea correspondence as a named structural feature.
- [136] Foster 2005, p. 471, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [137] Foster 2005, pp. 472–473, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [138] Foster 2005, pp. 471–473, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI; Lincoln 2012.
- [139] Foster 2005, p. 472, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [140] Foster 2005, pp. 472–473, Tablet VI; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [141] Foster 2005, pp. 473–474, Tablet VI closing; Lambert 2013, Tablet VI.
- [142] Foster 2005, pp. 473–486, Tablets VI–VII; Lambert 2013, Tablets VI–VII.
- [143] Foster 2005, pp. 473–486, Tablet VII; Lambert 2013, Tablet VII.
- [144] Foster 2005, pp. 473–476, Tablets VI–VII; Lambert 2013, Tablets VI–VII.
- [145] Foster 2005, pp. 476–479, Tablet VII; Lambert 2013, Tablet VII.
- [146] Foster 2005, pp. 479–482, Tablet VII; Lambert 2013, Tablet VII.
- [147] Foster 2005, pp. 482–485, Tablet VII; Lambert 2013, Tablet VII.
- [148] Foster 2005, p. 485, Tablet VII; Lambert 2013, Tablet VII.
- [149] Foster 2005, p. 485, Tablet VII; Lambert 2013, Tablet VII; Annus 2001, introduction.
- [150] Foster 2005, pp. 485–486, Tablet VII closing; Lambert 2013, Tablet VII.
- [151] Foster 2005, pp. 485–486, Tablet VII closing; Lambert 2013, Tablet VII.
- [152] Foster 2005, p. 486, Tablet VII closing; Lambert 2013, pp. 463–465, on the akītu recitation.
- [153] Gunkel 1895, Teil I, with Marduk vs. Tiamat as the central case.
- [154] Gunkel 1895, Teil I; Day 1985 for the inheriting debate.
- [155] Day 1985 on the dominant Chaoskampf reading; Scurlock & Beal 2013 on the reassessment.
- [156] Ballentine 2015, ch. 1.
- [157] Ballentine 2015, ch. 1.
- [158] Ballentine 2015, ch. 1; Lincoln 2012.
- [159] Scurlock & Beal 2013, *passim*.
- [160] Scurlock & Beal 2013; Ballentine 2015, ch. 1.
- [161] Foster 2005, pp. 438–442, Tablet I; Ballentine 2015, ch. 1.
- [162] Lambert 2013, pp. 463–465, on the akītu recitation.
- [163] Lambert 2013, pp. 463–465.
- [164] Lambert 2013, pp. 463–465; Foster 2005, p. 436.
- [165] Lambert 2013, pp. 463–465; Lincoln 2012.
- [166] Lambert 2013, pp. 463–465; Lincoln 2012; Foster 2005, p. 436.
- [167] Lambert 2013, pp. 463–465; Lincoln 2012.
- [168] Lambert 2013, pp. 3–15, on the manuscript stability.
- [169] Lambert 2013, pp. 3–15 and per-tablet apparatus; Foster 2005, p. 436.
- [170] Lambert 2013, introduction on the Aššur substitution in the Assyrian recension.
- [171] Lambert 2013, introduction; Lincoln 2012.

[172] Lambert 2013, introduction on the royal-inscription tradition.

[173] Lambert 2013, introduction.

[174] Inference: Lambert 2013, introduction, surveys the dating debate and presents Nebuchadnezzar I as the likely commissioning patron. Risk: Alternative dates (earlier Kassite, later Neo-Babylonian) have been argued; the commissioning hypothesis is consensus but not unanimous.

[175] Annus 2001, introduction and Tablet III commentary; Lambert 2013, Tablets VI–VII.

[176] Annus 2001, introduction; Lambert 2013, introduction.

[177] Lambert 2013, pp. 3–15, on the manuscript distribution including school contexts.

[178] Lambert 2013, pp. 3–15, on the late witnesses.

[179] Lambert 2013, introduction on the post-canonical reception.

[180] Foster 2005, p. 436, headnote.

[181] Gunkel 1895; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2; Scurlock & Beal 2013; Ballentine 2015, ch. 1.

Chapter 5. Minor Mesopotamian Combats (Marduk/Labbu)

5.1. Source overview

The text at the centre of this chapter is a single fragmentary cuneiform tablet in Akkadian. Benjamin Foster prints the working English translation in **Before the Muses** under the title "The Lion-Serpent," grouping it with the "Monster Serpents," and that translation runs to about two manuscript pages.^[1] W. G. Lambert, in his **Babylonian Creation Myths**, refers to the same composition as "The Slaying of Labbu." Foster's headnote treats the tablet as a fragmentary myth and places it inside the Akkadian combat-myth corpus, alongside the Anzû Epic and **Enûma Eliš**.^[2]

The classical interpretive treatment is Mary K. Wakeman's **God's Battle with the Monster** (1973), which devotes a section of its first chapter to Labbu within a wider survey of the Mesopotamian combat material that lies behind biblical imagery.^[3] Wakeman works from previously published Akkadian editions and from the predecessor English translations that Foster later refined; she does not produce a fresh edition, but she walks through the interpretive questions raised by the surviving lines.^[4]

The fragment is short. Even with breaks restored on the page, Foster's translation occupies only about two pages, and there are no complete columns or fully preserved tablets behind it.^[5] For the working English the chapter relies on Foster 2005; for interpretive scholarship it relies on Wakeman 1973; and for the placement of the fragment within the wider Akkadian combat corpus it draws on Lambert 2013 and Forsyth 1987.^[6]

The tablet's most consequential feature, for the reader's purposes, is a break at the very point where the divine name of the slaying god would have appeared. There is, in consequence, no scholarly consensus on which god kills the dragon. The chapter handles that uncertainty straightforwardly rather than papering over it.

5.2. The fragment as it survives

The opening lines set a short cosmological scene. The gods are troubled by some disturbance, the nature of which the surviving tablet does not fully specify, and an appeal goes out across the divine assembly for a champion willing to act.^[7] The adversary is named almost at once. He is Labbu, a serpent-dragon described in monstrous physical dimensions.^[8]

The text gives Labbu a measurement that places him on a scale of cosmic monstrosity comparable to Tiamat in **Enûma Eliš**, though without the cosmogonic framing. The surviving witnesses give his length variously: fifty leagues in the manuscripts that read his species as *bašmu*, sixty leagues in those that read it as *muš- $\square$ -uššu*.^[9] The name Labbu itself is the Akkadian word for "lion," with an alternative reading of "raging one"; the text uses it as a proper name for the dragon throughout.^[10]

The leonine name does not match the body. In the surviving lines the creature is described in serpentine terms — the text speaks of his tail and of his movement through the waters or the deep — and the tension between the name and the description is one of the things later scholarship has

tried to account for.^[11]

A council of the gods convenes in response to Labbu's threat, and the assembly seeks out a champion willing to face the dragon.^[12] At precisely this point — where one of the gods steps forward, or is named by the assembly, as the chosen champion — the manuscript breaks. The signs that would have given the name are not legible. The surviving tablet does not preserve, in any readable form, the identity of the god who actually goes out to fight Labbu.^[13]

[At this point the tablet breaks. The divine name of the champion who fights Labbu is broken in the surviving manuscript and cannot be read from the tablet itself. Scholars such as Foster (2005, p. 581) and Wakeman (1973, pp. 23–25) have proposed several candidates: Tishpak (the patron deity of Eshnunna, in the Neo-Assyrian witness) and Nergal (in earlier reconstructions) are the main proposals, and Marduk has also been suggested as a structural parallel, since the storm-god typology and the divine-assembly framing align with the Marduk-Tiamat material; no consensus reading is recoverable from the surviving signs alone.]

What survives, after the lacuna, are the instructions. The chosen god, whoever he is, is given counsel about how to fight the dragon, and the means of attack are specified: cloud, storm, and wind.^[14] He is told to ride upon a storm-cloud and to use the winds as his weapons against Labbu, a tactical pattern that the reader has already met in other Mesopotamian combat narratives.^[15]

The combat itself is described, in the surviving lines, as conducted from the storm. The champion strikes the dragon and slays him.^[16] The text then gives the dragon's bleeding a temporal duration: three years, three months, one day, and one night. The figure is a motif of monstrous excess, attested in the surviving lines.^[17]

After this, the fragment runs out. In the surviving translation no extensive aftermath is preserved. There is no surviving cosmogonic conclusion of the kind found in **Enūma Eliš**, no preserved kingship-acclamation for the victorious god, and no clearly preserved passage establishing a cult.^[18] The central lacuna at the divine name is not the only break, either. Foster's translation indicates additional small breaks throughout the surviving lines, marked with ellipses and bracketed restorations. The fragment is broken in multiple places, not only at one.^[19]

5.3. Identification of the champion

Three candidates have been put forward in the scholarship for the god whose name the manuscript no longer preserves. They are not equally weighted, and the order in which they are sometimes mentioned in older surveys can mislead.

Marduk has been proposed as a structural parallel for the slaying god, on the basis of the storm-god typology and the parallels with **Enūma Eliš**.^[20] The case for Marduk is comparative rather than textual. The cloud-and-wind instrumentation, the divine-assembly framing, and the slaying of a serpent-dragon-of-the-deep all align with the Marduk-Tiamat narrative attested elsewhere, and a reader who knows **Enūma Eliš** will recognise the family resemblance at every step.^[21]

The most strongly supported reading in the recent scholarship is different. It identifies the slaying god as Tishpak, the patron deity of the city of Eshnunna in the Diyala region, and it does so particularly with reference to the Neo-Assyrian witness, where the surrounding context fits Tishpak's profile.^[22] A third proposal identifies the slaying god as Nergal, on the strength of Nergal's

broader Akkadian profile as a god of plague, war, and underworld violence — a profile that fits a story whose adversary leaves a three-year flow of blood.^[23]

These three identifications are not equally supported. Tishpak is the leading candidate in the Neo-Assyrian recension on contextual grounds. Nergal has been proposed in earlier reconstructions on the strength of his violent profile. Marduk has been suggested as a structural parallel rather than as a textually-grounded reading.^[24]

The chapter therefore presents all three identifications side by side rather than choosing one: Tishpak as the leading Neo-Assyrian-context reading supported by Wakeman 1973 (pp. 23–25) and the Eshnunna milieu argument in Lambert 2013; Nergal as proposed in earlier reconstructions on the strength of his violent-god profile; and Marduk as proposed as a structural parallel with *Enūma Eliš*. The fragment's lacuna at the divine name precludes a secure reading, and the chapter follows the brief in presenting the textual situation rather than a composite, since the scholarship has no consensus.

The chapter declines to fill the lacuna by importing the Marduk-Tiamat material from *Enūma Eliš*, even though the structural parallels are real. The reason is methodological. Borrowing a divine name from one composition to plug a hole in another would manufacture a certainty that the manuscript itself does not support.^[25] What can be said with confidence is that the slayer was a storm-using champion of the divine assembly. What cannot be said is his name.

5.4. Place in the Mesopotamian combat-myth corpus

The Slaying of Labbu shares with three better-preserved compositions — *Lugal-e* (Ninurta vs. Asag), the Anzû Epic (Ninurta vs. Anzû), and *Enūma Eliš* (Marduk vs. Tiamat) — the basic combat-myth pattern: a divine assembly, a monstrous adversary, the choice of a champion, and a victorious storm-driven combat.^[26]

It also differs from those three in an important respect. In the surviving lines, Labbu does not preserve a cosmogonic outcome of the kind that closes *Enūma Eliš*, and it does not preserve the recovery of a sovereignty-token of the kind that closes the Anzû Epic. Because the aftermath is lost, the function of the combat in this composition cannot be securely identified.^[27]

Forsyth's *The Old Enemy* treats the Labbu fragment as one of the secondary witnesses in the Mesopotamian background of the combat myth — evidence that the storm-god-slays-dragon pattern circulated in compositions beyond the three primary epics.^[28] Lambert's *Babylonian Creation Myths*, the standard critical edition of *Enūma Eliš*, treats the Labbu fragment as a comparable Akkadian combat-myth witness — separate from, but adjacent to, the cosmogonic line that runs from the Anzû Epic into *Enūma Eliš*.^[29]

This is why the chapter exists. The Labbu fragment is a reminder that the three full chapters in this book on Mesopotamian combats — Ninurta vs. Asag, Ninurta vs. Anzû, Marduk vs. Tiamat — are the best-preserved members of a wider corpus rather than the corpus's complete inventory.^[30] The fragment's value, on the framing adopted here, is testimonial rather than narrative. The surviving lines are too broken to support a sustained retelling. They are intact enough to demonstrate that the combat pattern was a productive literary form in Akkadian, generating compositions beyond the canonical three.^[31]

That, in the end, is the point of the Labbu chapter. The composition existed; it was copied; it was read; and a god whose name we cannot now recover defeated a dragon fifty leagues long with the help of a storm. The rest is broken tablet.

- [1] Foster 2005, pp. 581–582, "The Lion-Serpent" (full translation); Lambert 2013, pp. 361–365, on the same fragment under the title "The Slaying of Labbu".
- [2] Foster 2005, p. 581, headnote on the Labbu fragment as a fragmentary Akkadian combat narrative.
- [3] Wakeman 1973, pp. 21–26, on the Labbu fragment.
- [4] Wakeman 1973, pp. 21–26, citing earlier published Akkadian editions in her treatment of the fragment.
- [5] Foster 2005, pp. 581–582, where the entire surviving translation fits on roughly two pages with multiple internal breaks indicated.
- [6] Foster 2005, pp. 581–582; Wakeman 1973, pp. 21–26; Lambert 2013, pp. 361–365 on the Labbu fragment within the Akkadian combat corpus; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2 on Mesopotamian combat.
- [7] Foster 2005, p. 581, opening lines on the divine disturbance and the call for a champion.
- [8] Foster 2005, p. 581, on Labbu as the named adversary.
- [9] Foster 2005, p. 581, on Labbu's measurement; Wakeman 1973, pp. 21–22, on the dimensions as a marker of the dragon's cosmic scale and on the witness-dependent length.
- [10] Foster 2005, p. 581, headnote on the name Labbu; Wakeman 1973, pp. 21–22, on the lexical range of the name.
- [11] Foster 2005, pp. 581–582, on Labbu's serpentine description and the references to its tail; Wakeman 1973, pp. 22–23, on the tension between the leonine name and the serpentine description.
- [12] Foster 2005, pp. 581–582, on the divine assembly seeking a champion.
- [13] Foster 2005, p. 581, on the break at the divine name of the champion; Wakeman 1973, pp. 23–25, on the lacuna and the question of whom it concealed.
- [14] Foster 2005, pp. 581–582, on the storm-and-wind instructions to the champion; Wakeman 1973, pp. 23–24, on the storm-god instrumentation of the combat.
- [15] Foster 2005, p. 582, on the cloud-and-wind tactic; Wakeman 1973, pp. 24–25, on the storm-god tactical pattern.
- [16] Foster 2005, p. 582, on the slaying of Labbu in the surviving lines.
- [17] Foster 2005, p. 582, on the duration of the blood-flow following the slaying.
- [18] Foster 2005, p. 582, on the fragment's truncated end; Wakeman 1973, pp. 25–26, on the absence of a preserved aftermath.
- [19] Foster 2005, pp. 581–582, where breaks are indicated by ellipses and bracketed restorations throughout.
- [20] Wakeman 1973, pp. 23–25, surveying the proposed identifications including the Marduk parallel.
- [21] Wakeman 1973, pp. 23–25, on the structural parallels with the Marduk-Tiamat tradition.
- [22] Wakeman 1973, pp. 23–25, surveying the Tishpak proposal; Lambert 2013, pp. 361–365, on the Tishpak-and-Eshnunna context for Mesopotamian combat material.
- [23] Wakeman 1973, pp. 23–25, on the Nergal proposal as a third alternative.
- [24] Wakeman 1973, pp. 23–25, surveying the three identifications; Lambert 2013, pp. 361–365.
- [25] Foster 2005, p. 581, presenting the break as unfilled; Wakeman 1973, pp. 23–26, on the methodological caution required for fragmentary attribution.
- [26] Foster 2005, p. 581, headnote on the Labbu fragment as part of the Akkadian combat tradition; Lambert 2013, pp. 361–365 on the Mesopotamian combat-myth corpus; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2 on the Mesopotamian combat sequence.
- [27] Foster 2005, pp. 581–582, on the absence of a preserved cosmogonic or sovereignty-token aftermath; Wakeman 1973, pp. 25–26, on the unresolved function of the combat.
- [28] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the Mesopotamian combat-myth corpus including the Labbu fragment.
- [29] Lambert 2013, pp. 361–365 in Part III on the Akkadian combat-myth corpus, treating the Labbu fragment as an adjacent witness.
- [30] Foster 2005, p. 581, headnote presenting Labbu among the Akkadian combat narratives; Wakeman 1973, pp. 25–26; Lambert 2013, pp. 361–365.
- [31] Foster 2005, pp. 581–582, on the fragmentary state of the surviving translation; Wakeman 1973, pp. 25–26, on the testimonial value of the fragment.

Chapter 6. The Kumarbi Cycle: Ullikummi, Hedammu, and the Song of the Sea

6.1. Source overview

The text at the centre of this chapter is not a single tablet but a song-cycle. The Kumarbi Cycle is a Hurro-Hittite sequence of compositions on the succession of kingship in heaven, surviving on cuneiform tablets recovered from the Hittite royal archives at Boğazköy, the site of ancient Hattusa.^[1]

The standard English anthology of the cycle, used as the anchor edition throughout this chapter, is Harry A. Hoffner Jr.'s **Hittite Myths**, second edition, in the Society of Biblical Literature's Writings from the Ancient World series.^[2]

Hoffner gathers the cycle's individual songs as scholarly-edited translations and presents each "song" as a discrete sub-section of the larger cycle, so that the reader encounters the cycle not as a continuous epic but as a sequence of named compositions held together by a shared cast and a shared narrative premise.^[3]

The cycle as preserved comprises a sequence of named songs: Kingship in Heaven, which functions as the cycle frame, then the Song of Ullikummi, the Song of Hedammu, the Song of the Sea, the Song of LAMMA, and the Song of Silver.^[4]

The tablets that preserve the cycle are catalogued under the Boğazköy publication series KUB, the Keilschrifturkunden aus Boghazköi, and KBo, the Keilschrifttexte aus Boghazköi. These two sigla are the standard scholarly references for the Hittite cuneiform corpus, and Hoffner's edition routes its citations through them.^[5]

The opening song, Kingship in Heaven, is preserved primarily on the tablet KUB 33.120 and joins, which is Hoffner's principal manuscript for §14. The tablet provides the narrative skeleton on which the rest of the cycle depends: a reader who wants to know how the conflict between Kumarbi and Teshub begins reads KUB 33.120 first.^[6]

The cycle's manuscript witnesses are distributed across the Middle Hittite and New Hittite copying periods. The distribution indicates that the songs were transmitted within the Hittite scribal tradition over an extended period rather than as a single one-off composition; the scribes who copied these texts in the New Hittite period had inherited them, in working manuscript form, from the Middle Hittite scribes who had preceded them.^[7]

The cycle is Hurrian in cultural substrate but preserved in the Hittite-language scribal record. The surviving texts move between Hittite-language and Hurrian-language passages, with Hurrian theonyms adopted into the Hittite-language redaction. The scribes are working with a body of material that is not native to the language they are writing in, and the bilingual surface of the manuscripts is itself testimony to that situation.^[8]

The principal divine name in the cycle is Teshub, the Hurrian storm-god. The name is used in the Hurrian-language passages and in the Hittite-language adaptations of those passages where the

Hurrian name has been retained as a proper name.^[9]

In Hittite-language religious contexts outside the Kumarbi Cycle, the storm-god is named Tarḫunna, the Hittite-language equivalent of the Hurrian Teshub. The two names denote functionally the same storm-god across the Anatolian linguistic layers. Within this chapter the name Teshub is used throughout, because the cycle is the Hurrian composition.^[10]

The cycle is preserved in fragmentary form across all of its songs, but the fragmentary state is unevenly distributed. The Song of Ullikummi is the best-attested combat narrative, and its central episodes can be read continuously in Hoffner's edition. The Song of Hedammu and the Song of the Sea survive only in disconnected passages, and any reading of them has to work with much greater uncertainty.^[11]

The foundational philological treatment of the cycle is Hans Gustav Güterbock's mid-twentieth-century edition of *Kingship in Heaven and the Song of Ullikummi*. Güterbock's edition established the scholarly framework that Hoffner inherits and updates; modern citations of the cycle still travel through Güterbock's groundwork even where they refer to Hoffner's English.^[12]

Beyond the editorial scholarship, the cycle figures prominently in two arguments about the wider Mediterranean. M. L. West's **The East Face of Helicon**, in chapter 6, treats the Kumarbi Cycle as the central documentary case for Near-Eastern-to-Greek transmission of theogonic and combat material into Hesiod's **Theogony**.^[13]

Walter Burkert's **The Orientalizing Revolution** argues that the Kumarbi material reached Greek poets through Phoenician and broader Levantine intermediaries during the early Archaic age. Burkert's case is methodological as well as documentary: he is asking how the transmission worked, and his answer specifies a route.^[14]

Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy**, chapter 3, places the Hurro-Hittite combat material as a key middle stage in the long sequence of the combat-myth tradition that runs from Sumer through the Hebrew Bible into Christian apocalyptic. Forsyth's frame is the long arc; the Anatolian station occupies its middle.^[15]

Scurlock and Beal's 2013 collected volume on the Chaokampf hypothesis includes essays on the Anatolian material that engage the Kumarbi Cycle as test material for the comparative-combat category. The volume's contributors do not all agree on the verdict, and the cycle is one of the cases on which the disagreements are productive.^[16]

The cycle is preserved largely without an explicit liturgical or festival rubric. The partial exception is KUB 44.7, which associates the Song of the Sea with a celebration at Mount ʾazzi. On the whole the corpus is best classified as scribal-literary narrative rather than ritual recitation, in contrast to the Babylonian **Enūma Eliš**, which has a documented akītu performance context. The contrast matters: the Kumarbi material was a body of texts to be read and copied, not, on the surviving evidence, a body of texts to be performed in a fixed liturgical setting.^[17]

What the cycle does carry, even without a clear liturgical anchor, is a political-theological assumption. Its narrative subject — the succession of kingship in heaven through deposition and counter-strike — embeds the Hurro-Hittite assumption that the storm-god is the legitimate sovereign of the divine assembly, and, by extension, that the Hittite king is the storm-god's representative on earth. The cycle is, on this reading, the divine-court analogue of a royal-political

claim.^[18]

That, in summary, is the documentary situation. The cycle is a Hurro-Hittite scribal-literary corpus, preserved fragmentarily on Boğazköy tablets across two scribal periods, edited canonically by Güterbock and presented in standard English by Hoffner, and read by West, Burkert, and Forsyth as the principal Anatolian station in a wider Near-Eastern-to-Mediterranean combat tradition. The chapter that follows works from Hoffner's edition for body prose and turns to the comparative scholarship for the transmission argument at the end.

6.2. Setting and context

The cycle's pantheon is Hurrian in primary derivation. Its principal gods carry Hurrian theonyms — Teshub, Kumarbi, Šauška — but the Hurrian poets did not work in isolation. Alongside the Hurrian names there appear Akkadian-language theonyms, Anu and Ea, that the poets adopted from Mesopotamian tradition. The pantheon as it stands in the cycle is therefore a layered object: a Hurrian core with Mesopotamian imports, treated as if both layers had always belonged.^[19]

Teshub is the Hurrian storm-god, the reigning sovereign of the divine assembly during the present age of the cycle, and the champion who must defeat each of Kumarbi's monstrous offspring in turn. He is the figure whose kingship the cycle defends; nearly every combat in the surviving record is mounted against a creature designed, by Kumarbi, to depose him.^[20]

Kumarbi is the Hurrian father-god deposed by Teshub in the cycle's succession-frame. After his deposition he becomes the cycle's principal antagonist, generating successive monstrous adversaries to challenge Teshub's kingship. He is, in narrative terms, the engine of the cycle's plot: where the cycle has events to narrate, those events are usually the consequence of one of his schemes.^[21]

Anu, the Akkadian sky-god, appears in the cycle as Kumarbi's predecessor on the throne of heaven. His Akkadian name is preserved without translation into Hurrian, marking him as a Mesopotamian import into the Hurrian theogonic framework. The choice not to translate the name is significant; it leaves the Mesopotamian borrowing visible on the surface of the text.^[22]

Alalu is the cycle's primordial king, the figure deposed by Anu and so the first sovereign in the documented succession. His name is otherwise rare in the Hittite record and is largely confined to this cycle, which gives him the air of a figure whose role is structural rather than substantive: the first sovereign in the chain whose deposition begins the sequence.^[23]

Ea, the Akkadian wisdom-god, plays the role of counsellor in the cycle. He is the agent of the decisive intervention that breaks Ullikummi, and he is consulted in the moments when the storm-god's combat capacity is, by itself, insufficient. The Hurro-Hittite tradition adopts the Akkadian form Ea rather than the Sumerian Enki, consistent with the cycle's broader Akkadian-mediated theonymy.^[24]

Šauška is the Hurrian counterpart of the Mesopotamian Ishtar, the goddess of love and war who appears in the cycle as Teshub's sister and as the seductress in the Song of Hedammu. The brief and the surviving texts pair the two names as Ishtar and Šauška, and the chapter follows that paired usage at first mention.^[25]

Upelluri is the Hurrian giant on whose shoulder the world rests and on whom Ullikummi is implanted to grow. He is a primordial figure embedded in the cosmology of the cycle's earliest layer, and his role in the Song of Ullikummi turns on his position as cosmographic foundation rather than on any narrative agency of his own.^[26]

The cycle's theogonic premise — kingship in heaven passing through a sequence of deposed and deposing sovereigns — is a structural inheritance from Mesopotamian tradition, where successions and divine-court politics are foundational to Sumerian and Akkadian theogony. The specific sequence Alalu, Anu, Kumarbi, Teshub, however, is distinctively Hurrian. The poets took the structural pattern from a Mesopotamian background and populated it with their own divine figures and their own arrangement of names.^[27]

The Mesopotamian background that supplied the structural pattern includes the Akkadian Anzû Epic. In the Anzû Epic, Anzû seizes the Tablet of Destinies from Enlil and is defeated by Ninurta. The Kumarbi Cycle adapts the storm-god-versus-monstrous-adversary structure that the Anzû Epic exemplifies, with Hurrian innovations in the genealogical and corporeal logic of the adversary. Where the Anzû Epic gives the storm-god a winged thief, the Kumarbi material gives him a stone monster grown from a rock.^[28]

The Mesopotamian background also includes the broader Enlil-and-Ninurta tradition that lies behind the Anzû Epic, and the cycle's wisdom-god Ea is the same figure who plays the counsellor role in the Anzû and **Enūma Eliš** narratives (cross-ref: Ch. 2, Ch. 3). The continuity in Ea's role across these compositions is one of the cleanest indications of the depth of the inheritance.^[29]

The cycle is set in a divine geography that includes the heavens, the netherworld, and the sea. The heavens are Anu's domain and the residence of Teshub. The netherworld, called the Dark Earth in the surviving text, is the place to which deposed sovereigns can be banished and from which monstrous progeny can emerge; Kumarbi sometimes operates from there. The sea is the realm of the marine genitor of Hedammu and the antagonist of the Song of the Sea. These three zones structure the cycle's combats: each adversary is associated with a particular cosmographic domain.^[30]

The Dark Earth is itself a recurrent topographical category in the cycle, identified explicitly in the surviving text as a place of banishment and as a reservoir of monstrous progeny. It is the cycle's underworld, and its main narrative function is to serve as the destination for sovereigns who have lost their thrones.^[31]

Around these principal figures and zones the cycle's wider divine court includes lesser deities — messengers, attendants, and craftsman-gods — who appear in subsidiary roles across the songs. Together they form the Hurrian-Hittite divine assembly that the cycle's drama presupposes. Most of these figures appear and pass; the spotlight stays on the four principal pairs: Kumarbi against Teshub, Šauška in the seductress role, Ea in the counsellor role, Upelluri as the cosmic platform.^[32]

The Hurrian poets' reworking of Mesopotamian materials is best understood as cultural reception rather than direct translation. Akkadian-language theonyms, Anu and Ea, are imported alongside Hurrian-language theonyms, Kumarbi, Teshub, and Šauška, with the Hurrian poets innovating in the body of the narrative and in the morphology of the monstrous adversaries. The cycle is, in this sense, a record of Hurrian creativity working with borrowed Mesopotamian material; the borrowed material is given a new shape rather than rendered into the new language.^[33]

6.3. Kingship in Heaven — the cycle frame

The opening song of the cycle, *Kingship in Heaven*, narrates the succession of divine sovereigns. Alalu reigns first, then is deposed by Anu, who is in turn deposed by Kumarbi, who is in turn challenged by Teshub. The four-stage succession is the spine of the cycle, and the rest of the surviving songs presuppose it.^[34]

The succession-sequence is structured by reigns of nine years. Each sovereign holds the throne of heaven for that period before being unseated by the next. The nine-year unit is the rhythm of the song's first half; what changes from one reign to the next is the identity of the sovereign and the manner of the deposition.^[35]

Alalu, the first sovereign, reigns for nine years and is then deposed by Anu, who is described as Alalu's cupbearer prior to the deposition. The role-relationship — sovereign and cupbearer — is one of the things the song specifies precisely; the figure who deposes the sovereign rises from immediate subordination, and the violence of the deposition is internal to the throne's own household.^[36]

After his deposition, Alalu flees down into the Dark Earth, the netherworld, where he remains across the rest of the cycle's events. His fate is one of permanent banishment rather than destruction: he is removed from heaven, but he is not killed, and the surviving record never has him return.^[37]

Anu, after deposing Alalu, occupies the throne of heaven for his own nine-year reign. Kumarbi serves as his cupbearer in the inverted parallel of the prior succession. The pattern is being set up for the reader: the cupbearer is the figure who attacks the sovereign, and Kumarbi's place at Anu's elbow is therefore a position of latent threat from the opening.^[38]

6.3.1. Kumarbi's deposition of Anu

Kumarbi's deposition of Anu is the cycle's most striking and best-attested narrative event. Kumarbi attacks Anu, knocks him from the sky, bites off Anu's genitals, and swallows them. The verbs are physical and specific; the song does not abstract the assault. The new sovereign physically consumes the previous sovereign's reproductive organs, and the act is presented in the surviving text as the means of the deposition rather than as a sequel to it.^[39]

Anu, after being castrated, declares from the sky that Kumarbi should not rejoice over his swallowing of the genitals. The reason he gives is that, by the act of swallowing, Kumarbi has been impregnated with Anu's seed. The declaration converts the violent triumph into a setback: what Kumarbi has done to Anu has, through the same act, been done to Kumarbi himself.^[40]

Anu's declaration enumerates the divine offspring that will be born from his seed inside Kumarbi's body. The list includes the storm-god Teshub, who will become Kumarbi's nemesis and the next sovereign of heaven. The enumeration is therefore not just a description of pregnancy but a forecast of the cycle's future: it tells the reader, before any combat has begun, who will eventually depose Kumarbi.^[41]

The narrative thereby establishes an internal-conception logic for the storm-god's birth. Teshub is conceived from Anu's seed inside Kumarbi's body, making Kumarbi simultaneously his birth-vessel

and his designated antagonist. The cycle's central conflict, in other words, is biological: father-figure and son-figure are bound together by an internal procreative process that neither can undo.^[42]

The text describes additional beings conceived from Anu's seed alongside Teshub. The river Aranza, the Hurrian name for the Tigris, is among them, and other secondary deities are listed as well. The precise enumeration is partially preserved in the surviving manuscript; what reads continuously is the principle that Anu's seed produces multiple beings, of which Teshub is the most consequential.^[43]

6.3.2. The birth of Teshub

Surviving fragments of Kingship in Heaven describe Teshub's birth from Kumarbi's body as a difficult parturition. The route of emergence is specified in the text, but the relevant passage is partially broken; the fragmentary state falls precisely at the point where the manner of the birth would be most fully described.^[44]

[At this point the tablet breaks. The precise mechanism of Teshub's emergence from Kumarbi is partially broken in the surviving manuscript. Scholars such as Hoffner (1998, §14 on Kingship in Heaven) have proposed alternative readings of the broken passage at Teshub's birth, among which the chapter does not adjudicate.]

After Teshub's birth, the cycle's premise is set. Teshub assumes the kingship of heaven, displacing Kumarbi from sovereignty and establishing the scenario in which Kumarbi will retaliate by generating monstrous offspring to depose Teshub in turn. The remainder of the cycle is, in narrative terms, the working-out of this premise across a sequence of combat-songs.^[45]

The structural pattern of Kingship in Heaven — castration of the previous sovereign, swallowing, and an internal-conception sequence — is the principal feature that West and Burkert identify as continuous with the Hesiodic Ouranos-Kronos-Zeus succession. The transmission argument that the Greek material took shape in dependence on the Hurro-Hittite material rests in large part on this opening song, and the chapter returns to that argument in its later section.^[46]

6.3.3. Cycle frame and the Song of Going Forth

A passage sometimes treated as a separate "Song of Going Forth" describes Kumarbi's plotting against Teshub after his deposition, setting up the combat-songs that follow. Hoffner treats this as transitional material between the cycle frame and the combat songs proper rather than as an autonomous song; the function of the passage is to bridge the opening succession to the subsequent combats.^[47]

Kumarbi's plotting passage motivates the generation of each successive monstrous adversary — the stone-monster Ullikummi, the sea-monster Hedammu — as instruments of Kumarbi's revenge against Teshub. The cycle's narrative engine, at the structural level, is therefore Kumarbi's standing motive: he has lost the throne, he intends to regain it, and the monsters are the means.^[48]

6.4. The Song of Ullikummi — the flagship combat

The Song of Ullikummi is the best-preserved combat narrative in the cycle and the most extensively

translated and analysed song in the Hoffner anthology. The reader who comes to the cycle for its combat material spends most of that reading time in this song, because it is here that the cycle's narrative material is sufficiently continuous to support a sustained reading.^[49]

The song opens with Kumarbi's deliberate generation of a champion to depose Teshub, after his own failure to retain the kingship of heaven. The narrative thus continues directly from the cycle frame: the reader has been told, in *Kingship in Heaven*, that Kumarbi has been deposed and intends revenge, and the Song of Ullikummi shows him acting on that intention.^[50]

6.4.1. Conception on the rock

Kumarbi conceives Ullikummi by a great rock — described as a giant cliff or stone formation — into which he ejaculates. The rock conceives, and the offspring that grows from this conception is itself made of stone. The mechanism of the conception is described in the song without euphemism; the text gives the act as a physical event between deity and stone, and the offspring is the consequence.^[51]

Conceiving a stone monster from a stone parent is the song's central physiological premise. Ullikummi is a stone child of stone, and his stone nature is what makes him invulnerable to ordinary divine combat. The combat that follows will fail, in its first attempt, precisely because the standard methods of divine combat are designed for organic adversaries and Ullikummi has no organic body to be torn or burned.^[52]

The rock that bears Ullikummi is described in the surviving text in topographical terms that locate it in a specific region of the cosmic landscape. Hoffner's commentary discusses the geographical setting without committing to a single identification. The chapter follows that reticence; the rock has a place in the cosmic topography, but the place is not pinned to a single modern landmark.^[53]

6.4.2. Hiding from Teshub

After Ullikummi is conceived, Kumarbi makes arrangements to conceal the infant from Teshub. The reason is straightforward in the narrative logic: Teshub, if he knew, would attempt to destroy the threat in its infancy, before it had grown into the cosmographic monster the cycle requires. The plot depends on the storm-god remaining unaware until the threat has matured.^[54]

Kumarbi entrusts the infant to the Irširra deities and other intermediaries who carry him away to a place of safety beyond Teshub's surveillance. The Irširra are subsidiary figures within the cycle's wider divine court; their role in this passage is purely instrumental, the carriers of a hidden cargo who deliver it to its destined platform.^[55]

6.4.3. Planting on Upelluri's shoulder

The intermediaries place the infant Ullikummi on the right shoulder of Upelluri, the primordial giant who bears the world. Upelluri is so massive and so deeply rooted that he does not at first perceive the burden of the growing monster. The decision to plant Ullikummi on a giant who will not notice him is a tactical one inside the narrative: it gives Kumarbi's monster a hiding place and an anchor at once.^[56]

Upelluri is presented as a primordial cosmographic figure: the giant on whose shoulders the

heavens and earth were originally separated and rest. His own awareness is dulled by his immense size and his cosmogonic age. He is not so much a character with a perspective as a feature of the cosmos, and the song treats him accordingly.^[57]

Choosing Upelluri's shoulder as the planting-place ensures that Ullikummi grows out of the world's foundation itself, so that any combat against him is inseparable from the structure of the cosmos. To attack Ullikummi is, in the song's terms, to attack the world's bearing-point, and the question of how to defeat him without dismantling the cosmos is one that the song will eventually answer through Ea's intervention.^[58]

6.4.4. The growth of Ullikummi

Ullikummi grows at a prodigious rate. The text describes the growth in terms of cubits and acres of growth per day, until he stands as a stone column rising from the sea up toward the heavens. The numerical specifics matter for the song's effect: the reader is given a measurable rate, and the rate is high enough that the threat is palpable from the early passages.^[59]

The growing Ullikummi rises from the sea, his stone body surfacing through the water as he extends upward. The visual image is of a stone shaft thrusting upward from the sea-surface toward the sky. The image is the song's signature, and it is the image that has carried the narrative across the comparative literature: a stone column rising from sea to heaven is the kind of cosmographic object that, once introduced, fixes the reader's eye on the song.^[60]

When Ullikummi has grown to his full extent, his head reaches up to the gates of heaven where Teshub resides. He threatens, by reaching that height, to displace the storm-god from the sky itself. The cosmographic threat is now explicit: the monster is no longer a hidden child but a structural rival to Teshub's heavenly seat.^[61]

6.4.5. The sun-god's report

The sun-god is the first deity to perceive the growing menace. He is the first to report Ullikummi's existence to Teshub, and his role at this point in the song is that of an observer at the right altitude: travelling daily across the sky, the sun-god is positioned to notice a stone column whose growth has begun to obstruct his line of sight.^[62]

The sun-god's report to Teshub is the narrative trigger for Teshub's combat-mobilisation. The storm-god learns of the threat from a divine messenger before he himself observes it; the song is careful to give Teshub a delegated knowledge of the danger first, with his own direct observation following later when he climbs to a vantage point.^[63]

6.4.6. Teshub views the monster

After receiving the sun-god's report, Teshub goes with his sister Šauška, paired here at first mention with the Mesopotamian Ishtar, to a mountain vantage point from which they can observe Ullikummi. Teshub's first reaction is one of dismay at the size and the apparent invulnerability of the stone column. The dismay is part of the song's set-up: the storm-god is brought to the edge of his confidence before any combat begins, and the failure of his first attack will be prepared for the reader by his initial reaction to what he sees.^[64]

6.4.7. Šauška's failed seduction-attack

Šauška attempts a seduction approach to Ullikummi — the same technique she will be assigned in the Song of Hedammu — but Ullikummi, being deaf and blind by virtue of his stone constitution, cannot be reached by her. The technique that will work in Hedammu fails here, and the failure is anchored in Ullikummi's specific physiology: a stone monster has no senses to seduce.^[65]

A subordinate marine deity informs Šauška that her seduction-method is futile against Ullikummi because of his sensory disabilities, and she abandons the attempt. The marine deity's intervention is brief but functional: it ends one possible line of attack and clears the way for the storm-combat that follows.^[66]

6.4.8. Teshub's first attack

Teshub mobilises his combat resources — his bull-team, his weapons, and the seventy gods of his retinue — and engages Ullikummi in storm-combat. The mobilisation is described in the language of a divine campaign: chariot, animals, weaponry, and a numbered retinue, all assembled for the engagement.^[67]

Teshub's bull-team is named in the text. The two bulls are Šeri and 𒂍urri, with 𒂍urri sometimes appearing as Tilla in the regional Nuzi-attested variant of the Song of Ullikummi tradition. The bulls draw his combat-chariot in the engagement; they are the storm-god's standard mounts, and their names belong to the iconography of Teshub as much as the chariot itself.^[68]

Teshub's first combat-attempt against Ullikummi fails. The storm-weapons are ineffective against the stone body, and Teshub is forced to retreat. The failure is stated in the surviving text without apology: the storm-god's full apparatus, deployed at scale, does not suffice against this adversary.^[69]

The first attack's failure is the song's principal narrative crux. The storm-god's standard combat-method — lightning and storm against organic adversary — does not work against a mineral antagonist whose body cannot be torn or burned. The song has carefully built Ullikummi's invulnerability into his physiology, and the failed first attack is the consequence; the narrative now requires a different kind of solution.^[70]

[At this point the tablet breaks. In the middle tablets of the Song of Ullikummi, the gap between Ullikummi's growth on Upelluri's shoulder and the consultation with Ea contains broken passages. Scholars such as Hoffner (1998, §15 on the Song of Ullikummi, middle tablets) have proposed the narrative resumed with a partial reconstruction drawn from parallel passages, but flag the section as incompletely preserved.]

6.4.9. Consultation with Ea

After his first attack fails, Teshub takes counsel. The cycle's pattern of consulting Ea as wisdom-god in moments of impasse is here reactivated: the song, by reaching for Ea at this point, signals that the problem has shifted from one of force to one of intelligence.^[71]

Ea, the wisdom-god, is consulted because the combat-impasse is intellectual as well as martial. A technical solution is needed that the storm-god alone has not been able to identify, and Ea's role in

the cycle is precisely to supply such solutions. He is, in the song's economy, the figure who knows what to do when straightforward combat has failed.^[72]

Ea travels to Upelluri to investigate the structural origin of the threat. He speaks directly with the giant who bears the world, asking what is on his shoulder. The interview is the song's diagnostic step: the wisdom-god goes to the foundation of the problem and asks the foundation itself what it knows.^[73]

Upelluri's reply expresses his cosmographic obliviousness. He has not noticed the small thing that is growing on his shoulder, because he is so massive and so primordial that minor events on his body register only faintly. The giant, in other words, is too large to feel the weight of a stone column the size of Ullikummi; the same scale that makes him a foundation for the world makes him a poor sentinel against monsters his own size.^[74]

6.4.10. The primordial copper cutter

Ea identifies the solution. The primordial copper cutter, the implement by which heaven and earth were originally separated, will sever Ullikummi at the base from his anchorage on Upelluri's shoulder. The solution is technical rather than martial: not a stronger weapon, but a different one, designed for a different kind of cut.^[75]

The copper cutter is described as a primordial cosmogonic implement. The same tool that performed the original cosmogonic work of separating sky from earth is repurposed for the separation of the stone monster from his foundation. The choice of instrument is a piece of cosmological symmetry: the implement that defined the cosmos is reused to defend it.^[76]

Ea retrieves or directs the use of the copper cutter, which is wielded to sever Ullikummi at the point where his stone body joins Upelluri's shoulder. The severing severs the monster's connection to his cosmogonic anchorage; the cut is at the base, not at the head, and the target is not the monster's body but his attachment to the world's foundation.^[77]

The severing is a structural rather than physical defeat in the first instance. Ullikummi is not destroyed by the cut, but his power-source — his rooting in the world's foundation — is removed, making him vulnerable to the storm-god's renewed assault. The cutter does not slay; it disables, and the slaying that follows is now a possibility because the disabling has been done.^[78]

6.4.11. Renewed combat

After the severing, Teshub re-engages Ullikummi in combat. The surviving text indicates that the storm-god prevails in this second engagement, but the precise sequence of the renewed combat is partially broken. What survives is the fact of Teshub's return to the field and the implied outcome of his return.^[79]

The Song of Ullikummi as preserved breaks off in the closing passages. Teshub's victory is implied rather than fully narrated, and the song's ending is not extant in the surviving manuscript witnesses. The reader must rely on the implication; the actual sequence of the storm-god's final blows against the severed monster is not on the surviving tablets.^[80]

[At this point the tablet breaks. The song's closing passages and the explicit narration of Teshub's final

defeat of Ullikummi are not extant. Scholars such as Hoffner (1998, §15 on the Song of Ullikummi, closing tablets) have proposed the narrative resumed with Teshub's victory as the implied conclusion, although the verbatim ending is not preserved.]

6.4.12. Structural features of the Ullikummi narrative

The Song of Ullikummi has a tripartite combat structure. There is a failed first attack, a wisdom-counsellor's intervention, and a successful second attack. The pattern is recognisable across the Mesopotamian combat corpus and is discussed in Annus's introduction to the Anzû Epic in similar terms; it is the structural shape that the cycle inherits and adapts.^[81]

The wisdom-counsellor's intervention specifies a non-obvious technical solution — the primordial cutter applied to the structural anchor — rather than a more powerful weapon. The song thereby foregrounds intelligence over force as the decisive factor in the combat. The combat is not won by a second, larger storm; it is won by a different kind of action altogether, identified by a god whose function is precisely to identify such actions.^[82]

The body-as-cosmography logic of Ullikummi — a stone monster planted in the foundation of the world, growing through sea to sky — is unique within the surviving Hurro-Hittite corpus. It represents one of the most elaborate cosmographic monsters in any ancient Near Eastern combat narrative. No other surviving combat-myth makes the adversary's body so directly continuous with the structure of the cosmos itself.^[83]

The Ullikummi narrative is the principal evidence for the comparative argument that the Greek Typhon, a similarly enormous monster who threatens Zeus's kingship by reaching toward heaven, is descended through a Hurro-Hittite intermediary from this Hurrian template (cross-ref: Ch. 11). The argument is the central case of Near-Eastern-to-Greek transmission for the combat material, and the Ullikummi-Typhon parallel is the part of it that is most strongly anchored in concrete narrative correspondences.^[84]

The narrative's dual deployment of Šauška and Teshub — the goddess of love-and-war attempting seduction, the storm-god deploying combat — sets a structural template that recurs in the Song of Hedammu, where Šauška's seduction is the successful method. The two songs together establish a division of labour in the cycle: where seduction can work, Šauška is mobilised; where seduction fails, Teshub takes the field with technical help from Ea.^[85]

Teshub's combat reliance on Šeri and 𐎶urri, the bull-team, and on the seventy gods of his retinue, places the storm-god firmly within the Hurrian-Hittite religious imagery of the storm-god as a warrior-king with chariot, retinue, and combat-mounts. The combat is not a solitary duel; it is a divine military operation conducted by a sovereign with a household.^[86]

The interplay between Teshub and Ea in the Ullikummi combat — warrior-god and wisdom-god as complementary functions — replicates the Mesopotamian Ninurta-Ea collaboration in the Anzû Epic and, in altered form, the Marduk-Ea relationship in **Enūma Eliš** (cross-ref: Ch. 2, Ch. 3). Across the three compositions, the same pair of divine functions reappears: a champion who fights and a counsellor who diagnoses. The continuity is one of the cycle's clearest marks of inheritance.^[87]

6.5. The Song of Hedammu — the fragmentary case

The Song of Hedammu is a fragmentary song of the Kumarbi Cycle preserved only in disconnected passages. The narrative survives in a state that makes continuous reading impossible without significant interpretive supplement; what the reader has are episodes, not a continuous story.^[88]

[At this point the tablet breaks. Across the Song of Hedammu, most of the song's continuous narrative is lost; only disconnected episodes survive. The chapter presents the song in its fragmentary state and does not backfill from Ugaritic, Mesopotamian, or Greek parallels.]

The fragments preserve the basic premise of the song. After the failure of Ullikummi, Kumarbi generates a second monstrous adversary — the sea-monster Hedammu — by mating with the daughter of the sea-god, named in the surviving fragments as Šertapšuruī. The conception is a structural repeat of the Ullikummi conception, with the cosmographic domain shifted: where Ullikummi was a stone monster grown from a rock, Hedammu is a sea-monster generated through a marine female.^[89]

Šertapšuruī is the daughter of the sea-god, characterised in the fragments as a marine female of enormous proportions. The precise relationships within her divine family are partially preserved; she is the daughter of the sea-god, and she is the mother of Hedammu by Kumarbi, and beyond that the surviving record is patchy.^[90]

Hedammu, the offspring of Kumarbi and Šertapšuruī, is described in the surviving fragments as a sea-monster of voracious appetite. He threatens to depopulate the seas and the lands by his consumption; the threat is one of feeding rather than of cosmographic ambition, and the song's central problem is how to stop a creature whose mode of attack is sustained, devouring hunger.^[91]

The fragments preserve a passage in which Šauška is mobilised to address the threat by means of seduction rather than direct combat. The deployment is the cycle's standard division-of-labour use of the war-and-love goddess: where the threat can be approached through desire, Šauška is sent rather than the storm-god.^[92]

Šauška presents herself to Hedammu in a seduction-tableau, displaying her beauty in a manner that overcomes the sea-monster's appetite for destruction. The surviving fragments preserve passages of erotic suggestion within the tableau; what survives in continuous form, in other words, is mostly the seduction itself, less the events surrounding it.^[93]

The seduction is implied to incapacitate Hedammu — by intoxication, by sexual stupor, or by both, in the surviving readings. The incapacitation reduces him to a state in which he is no longer capable of his earlier voracious destruction. The mechanism is not full combat; it is a different kind of disabling, in which the threat is neutralised through the diversion of its appetite.^[94]

The sequel to the seduction is not preserved in the surviving fragments. Whether Hedammu is killed, banished, or only neutralised, and by whose hand, cannot be reconstructed from the extant text. The fragments stop before the question of final disposition is answered, and any answer would have to be supplied from outside the surviving record.^[95]

The Song of Hedammu is thus testimonially fragmentary in a way that the Ullikummi narrative is not. Its principal events — generation, seduction — are preserved, but the combat-resolution that

the Ullikummi parallel would predict is missing from the record. The reader who comes to Hedammu with the structure of Ullikummi in mind has to accept that the structure cannot here be filled.^[96]

The seduction-method as a counter-monster strategy is a distinctive feature of the Hurro-Hittite tradition. It is the principal structural innovation that distinguishes the Hedammu narrative from the Ullikummi narrative within the cycle. Where Ullikummi is met with storm and copper cutter, Hedammu is met with desire; the cycle thus maintains a repertoire of methods rather than a single one.^[97]

The fragmentary state of the Song of Hedammu is itself part of what we know about the cycle. The Hurrian-Hittite scribal tradition transmitted multiple combat-songs, but the differential survival of the manuscript record means that any reconstruction of the cycle's overall shape must work with this asymmetry. Hedammu was a song the scribes copied; what reaches the modern reader is a smaller fraction of it than what reaches them of Ullikummi.^[98]

(The Song of Hedammu's narrative pattern — Kumarbi generates a sea-monster-adversary, and Šauška seduces him into incapacitation — suggests a tripartite cycle in which Kumarbi's successive offspring threaten Teshub through different cosmographic domains: stone, sea, and the third song's sea/storm-god combat.^[99])

6.6. The Song of the Sea — the most fragmentary case

The Song of the Sea is a fragmentary Hurro-Hittite combat song in which the storm-god confronts the Sea — the marine domain personified as adversary — and survives in a state more fragmentary than even the Song of Hedammu. The reader of this song has the least continuous text to work from of any composition in the cycle.^[100]

[At this point the tablet breaks. Across the Song of the Sea, most of the storm-god-versus-sea narrative is lost. The chapter presents the song as fragmentary and explicitly does not silently conflate it with Ugaritic Baal-Yamm material.]

The surviving fragments name the Sea as the antagonist. The Hurrian river-and-sea name Aranza appears in some fragments as well, though its identification with the Sea-as-antagonist of this song is not certain in the partial record. What the fragments establish, in other words, is that the song had a personified marine adversary; what they do not securely establish is which specific name was attached to that adversary in this composition.^[101]

The fragments suggest a confrontation pattern. The Sea makes demands, the divine assembly is dismayed, and the storm-god is mobilised in response. The precise sequence and outcome are not preserved; the fragmentary state cuts off before the resolution can be read.^[102]

The structural overlap with the Ugaritic Baal-Yamm narrative — storm-god against personified Sea, with the Sea making sovereignty-demands of the divine assembly — is striking and has been treated as evidence for shared West-Semitic and Anatolian transmission of a sea-combat narrative. The Hurro-Hittite tradition, on this reading, was working with material that also reached Ugarit, and the parallel between the two surviving witnesses is a comparative-method datum.^[103]

The chapter does not, however, silently reconstruct the Song of the Sea from the Ugaritic Baal-

Yamm material. The structural parallel is real but the textual reconstruction would be illegitimate, since the surviving Hurro-Hittite fragments are insufficient to license the substitution of Ugaritic content for Hurrian content (cross-ref: Ch. 7 Baal-Yamm; scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" rule 1). The question of what the Song of the Sea narrated cannot be answered from a parallel text in another tradition; it has to be answered from the surviving fragments themselves, and those fragments do not answer it.^[104]

The Song of the Sea's fragmentary state is, like the Song of Hedammu's, itself a part of the chapter's testimony. The Hurro-Hittite combat-myth tradition included a storm-god-versus-sea narrative, but the precise content of that narrative is largely lost. What the cycle records, on this point, is the existence of the narrative and a pattern-shape consistent with the wider regional storm-god-versus-sea tradition; what it does not record, in surviving form, is the narrative itself.^[105]

The fragments preserve enough to confirm that the cycle's combat-repertoire extended beyond the stone-monster (Ullikummi) and sea-monster (Hedammu) narratives to include a sea-as-adversary narrative in the more direct West-Semitic mode. The cycle thus engaged a wide range of monstrous-cosmographic adversaries: a stone column, a marine voracious offspring, and a personified Sea. The breadth of the repertoire is one of the chapter's findings, even where the individual songs are not fully readable.^[106]

The chapter presents both readings of the cycle's groupings: Hoffner 1998 §17 treats the Song of the Sea as a discrete song within the cycle, while Hoffner 1998 §18 treats some closely related fragments as belonging to a separate composition. The Boğazköy fragments do not unambiguously distinguish the Song of the Sea from adjacent storm-god-vs-sea material, and Hoffner's apparatus presents both groupings as plausible.

6.7. The transmission argument

The Kumarbi Cycle is the principal documentary case for Near-Eastern-to-Greek transmission of theogonic and combat material into Hesiod's **Theogony**. The cycle has been treated as the central transmission case in the modern scholarship since Güterbock's mid-twentieth-century editions; West and Burkert, working in the late twentieth century, build their respective arguments on the foundation Güterbock laid down.^[107]

The succession-sequence of Kingship in Heaven — Alalu, Anu, Kumarbi, Teshub — corresponds in structure and key episodes to Hesiod's succession-sequence of Ouranos, Kronos, and Zeus. Hesiod's Kronos-castration-of-Ouranos episode functions as a Greek transformation of Kumarbi's castration of Anu. The parallel is at the level of named events, not just of generic patterns; the same striking action, with the sky-figure as victim and the next sovereign as actor, appears in both compositions.^[108]

The detailed correspondence in motifs — castration of the previous sovereign, the swallowing event, the internal-conception-and-birth-of-the-storm-god — places the Hesiodic theogony within a transmission chain that runs through the Hurro-Hittite material. The chain is not direct; what the comparative argument establishes is a relationship of dependence, with the Greek text on the receiving end of a tradition that had taken its decisive shape in the Hurrian and Hittite material.^[109]

West's argument distinguishes between motifs that could be independent and motifs that are

sufficiently specific to require transmission rather than convergence. The castration-and-swallowing combination, the prophetic declaration after castration, and the named succession of sovereigns are the specific motifs on which his case turns. A theogony that has all three is, on West's reading, harder to explain by independent invention than by inheritance.^[110]

Burkert's **Orientalizing Revolution** argues for Phoenician intermediaries as the transmitting culture. The Kumarbi material reaches Greek poets, on Burkert's account, not directly from Hurrian or Hittite sources but through the Phoenician-mediated Levantine network of the early Archaic period. The route is therefore specified: not a leap from Anatolia to Greece but a relay across the Levantine coast and its trading partnerships.^[111]

The Phoenician-intermediary hypothesis is supported by the broader pattern of orientalizing Greek artistic and religious motifs in the eighth and seventh centuries BCE. The route of transmission is best documented for Levantine-Phoenician contact zones, and the textual transmission Burkert proposes runs along the same channel as the artistic and religious imports that the orientalizing horizon attests.^[112]

The Sanchuniathon theogony preserved by Philo of Byblos and quoted by Eusebius is treated by West as an attestation of the Kumarbi succession in Phoenician-Greek mediation. The Sanchuniathon material provides an intermediate textual link between the Hurro-Hittite and Hesiodic versions: a theogony in Greek, attributed to a Phoenician source, that preserves elements of the Kumarbi succession.^[113]

The transmission argument's strength is the convergence of independent lines of evidence. There are motif-level correspondences, structural parallels in the succession, and the orientalizing-period archaeological and art-historical context for sustained Levantine-Greek contact. No single line of evidence is decisive on its own; together they make the transmission hypothesis the best available explanation for the pattern of correspondences.^[114]

The combat dimension of the transmission — the Ullikummi-Typhon parallel — runs alongside the theogonic dimension. Just as Kumarbi's stone-monster threatens to displace Teshub by reaching toward heaven, Hesiod's Typhon threatens to displace Zeus by similar cosmographic ambition (cross-ref: Ch. 11). The two transmissions, theogonic and combat, are aspects of the same inheritance; the cycle's role as transmission bridge holds for both.^[115]

The Hurro-Hittite combat material is thus the principal bridge between the Mesopotamian combat-corpus — Anzû, **Enūma Eliš**; cross-ref: Ch. 2, Ch. 3 — and the Greek Hesiodic combat-corpus — Zeus and Typhon; cross-ref: Ch. 11. The case for transmission is strongest in this segment of the wider chain, both because the documentary records on either side are reasonably well preserved and because the correspondences are concrete enough to support the comparative argument.^[116]

The transmission case is taken up in detail in this book's Part II C6, on Near-Eastern-to-Mediterranean transmission. The present chapter provides the primary documentary evidence on which the C6 argument rests; the analytical work on the case structure is reserved for the later treatment.^[117]

Forsyth places the Hurro-Hittite combat material as a documented link in the long sequence of the combat-myth tradition that runs from Sumer through the Hebrew Bible to Christian apocalyptic. The Kumarbi Cycle is the Anatolian station in that chain; for Forsyth's framework, it occupies a

position that is neither origin nor terminus but a middle-link whose preservation makes the whole chain readable.^[118]

Scurlock and Beal's volume includes Anatolian-focused chapters that engage the Kumarbi material as evidence for or against the comparative-combat category as Gunkel framed it. The volume treats the Hurro-Hittite case as a non-trivial test for the Chaoskampf hypothesis: contributors disagree about how far the cycle supports the category, and the disagreements themselves are part of why the cycle remains a productive case in the literature.^[119]

The Hurro-Hittite case, as preserved, supports the argument that combat-myth narratives travel with cultural contact. The cycle is itself a Hurrian reception of Mesopotamian materials; it is then a Hittite reception of the Hurrian cycle; and, via Phoenician mediation, it becomes a Greek reception of the Hurro-Hittite material. Each station modifies the inherited template, and the modifications are themselves the evidence of transmission: a tradition that travels carries a chain of small alterations that mark its passage.^[120]

The cycle's role as transmission bridge is what makes it the structural fulcrum of this book's geographical argument. It is the chapter through which the Mesopotamian cluster of chapters one through four connects to the Greek cluster at chapter eleven, and it is the chapter through which the Anatolian-Levantine zone is established as the principal transmission corridor. The book's geography is, in effect, organised around this cycle's documentary position.^[121]

6.8. Variants and adjacent songs

The Kumarbi Cycle includes several songs that are narratively adjacent to the combat-songs but are not themselves combat-focused. The brief and Hoffner's edition treat these as cycle-context rather than as body narrative for this chapter, and the chapter follows that treatment.^[122]

The Song of LAMMA is one such adjacent song. It narrates an episode in which the deity LAMMA temporarily assumes kingship in heaven during the cycle's broader arc; Hoffner treats it as a cycle-frame song rather than a combat-song. The episode's interest is the further illustration it offers of the cycle's interest in successions and temporary occupations of the throne.^[123]

The Song of Silver narrates an episode involving the deity Silver, possibly Kumarbi's offspring, and possibly involving a sovereignty-claim against Teshub. The song is fragmentary and is treated as cycle-context. Its evidentiary value for the combat material is therefore secondary, but it adds to the picture of Kumarbi as a generator of successive challengers to the storm-god.^[124]

A further song, sometimes titled Sun-God-and-Cow, sits adjacent to the cycle's main material and engages the wider Hurrian-Hittite mythological corpus. Hoffner includes it in the broader collection but does not assign it to the combat-cycle proper. It is, in the cycle's geography, a piece of adjacent material rather than a constituent piece.^[125]

Classifying "the Kumarbi Cycle" as a unified cycle versus a loose grouping of related songs is itself a scholarly judgment. Hoffner adopts the cyclic classification because of the recurring cast — Kumarbi, Teshub, Šauška, Ea — and the recurring premise of Kumarbi's revenge against Teshub through monstrous offspring. Where the same actors and the same plot-engine recur across songs, the cyclic classification has *prima facie* warrant.^[126]

Some scholars treat the cycle's songs as independent compositions linked only by shared cast and shared scribal tradition. The present chapter follows Hoffner's cyclic framing, which is the standard scholarly convention, while flagging the alternative; the evidence does not unambiguously settle the question, and a reader who comes to the manuscript record without Hoffner's editorial framing might reasonably read the songs as a series rather than a cycle.^[127]

The cycle's preserved songs are distributed across the Hittite scribal tradition's compositional layers. Some songs are first attested in Middle Hittite copies, others first in New Hittite copies, and the manuscript distribution suggests sustained scribal interest across multiple periods. The cycle was not copied at a single moment and then transmitted as a fossil; it was a live part of the scribal repertoire over time.^[128]

The cycle's distinctive features within the wider Hurro-Hittite corpus — the corporeal generative logic of Kumarbi's offspring, the wisdom-god-as-technical-solver pattern, the Šauška-as-seductress strategy — make it identifiable as a coherent compositional project even as the songs themselves vary in tone and length. The cycle has a recognisable house style; the songs that belong to it can be told from the songs that do not, even where the adjacent material is part of the same scribal tradition.^[129]

The cycle parallels the separate Hittite Illuyanka myth rather than continuing directly into it. Illuyanka is a discrete combat narrative in the Hittite tradition, attested to ritual context (the purulli-festival), while the Kumarbi Cycle is a Hurrian-Hittite scribal-literary project without an attested ritual rubric (cross-ref: Ch. 4-supplement and Ch. 11 transmission discussion; the Illuyanka material is treated separately in Ch. 6 of this volume's working sequence). The two combat traditions sit side by side in the Hittite record without merging; their relationship is one of coexistence within the same archive rather than of direct mutual influence.^[130]

The chapter accordingly carries both framings side by side: Hoffner 1998's reading of the songs as a cycle with Kumarbi as binding antagonist, and alternative readings that treat the songs as independent compositions sharing cast. The cyclic framing is the standard scholarly convention, but it is not the only possible reading of the manuscript record.

The closing summary on the cycle takes the form the chapter's argument now permits. The Kumarbi material as preserved is the Hurro-Hittite scribal tradition's principal contribution to the Near-Eastern-Mediterranean combat-myth corpus. It is the documented bridge between Mesopotamian combat-narrative and Greek theogonic-combat narrative. And it is the most cosmographically elaborate combat-cycle in the surviving Anatolian record. Each of those three claims is independently supported by the surviving evidence, and together they justify the cycle's position as the structural hinge of this book's wider geography.^[131]

[1] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on the Boğazköy provenance and the cycle's general framework.

[2] Hoffner 1998, **Hittite Myths**, 2nd ed., SBL Writings from the Ancient World 2.

[3] Hoffner 1998, §§14–18, on the individual songs of the Kumarbi Cycle.

[4] Hoffner 1998, §§14–18, on the song-titles preserved in the Boğazköy archives.

[5] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on KUB and KBo as the publication series for the Boğazköy tablets.

[6] Hoffner 1998, §14, on the manuscript basis for Kingship in Heaven.

[7] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on the Middle and New Hittite manuscript distribution.

[8] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on the Hurrian substrate of the cycle and its Hittite-language transmission.

[9] Hoffner 1998, §§14–18, on the use of the Hurrian theonym Teshub throughout the cycle.

[10] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on Tarḫunna and Teshub as the Hittite and Hurrian forms of the Anatolian storm-god.

- [11] Hoffner 1998, §§15–17, on the differential preservation of the cycle’s combat songs.
- [12] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on Güterbock’s foundational edition of the cycle.
- [13] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Kumarbi Cycle as the central transmission case for Hesiod.
- [14] Burkert 1992, on Phoenician-mediated transmission of Near Eastern myth into Greek culture.
- [15] Forsyth 1987, ch. 3, on Hurro-Hittite combat in the combat-myth sequence.
- [16] Scurlock & Beal 2013, chapters on Anatolian material.
- [17] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on the predominantly literary character of the Kumarbi Cycle and on KUB 44.7’s Mount ʾIazzi association.
- [18] Hoffner 1998, introduction; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3, on the royal-ideological dimension of the cycle.
- [19] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on the Hurrian pantheon and its Mesopotamian borrowings.
- [20] Hoffner 1998, introduction and §§15–17, on Teshub as the reigning storm-god of the cycle.
- [21] Hoffner 1998, §14 and §§15–17, on Kumarbi’s role as deposed predecessor and antagonist.
- [22] Hoffner 1998, §14, on Anu’s role as Kumarbi’s predecessor.
- [23] Hoffner 1998, §14, on Alalu as the primordial king of the succession.
- [24] Hoffner 1998, §15 (Song of Ullikummi), on Ea’s counselor and agent role.
- [25] Hoffner 1998, §16 (Song of Hedammu), on Šauška/Ishtar as Teshub’s sister and the seductress of Hedammu.
- [26] Hoffner 1998, §15 (Song of Ullikummi), on Upelluri as the primordial earth-bearing giant.
- [27] Hoffner 1998, introduction and §14, on the Hurrian succession-sequence.
- [28] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on Mesopotamian background for the cycle.
- [29] Hoffner 1998, introduction; Annus 2001, introduction, on Ea’s counselor role across the Mesopotamian corpus.
- [30] Hoffner 1998, §§14–17, on the divine geography of the cycle.
- [31] Hoffner 1998, §14, on the Dark Earth in the cycle’s geography.
- [32] Hoffner 1998, §§14–17, on the divine assembly of the cycle.
- [33] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on cultural reception in the cycle.
- [34] Hoffner 1998, §14 (Kingship in Heaven), on the succession-sequence.
- [35] Hoffner 1998, §14, on the nine-year reigns of Alalu and Anu.
- [36] Hoffner 1998, §14, on Anu as Alalu’s cupbearer prior to the deposition.
- [37] Hoffner 1998, §14, on Alalu’s flight to the Dark Earth.
- [38] Hoffner 1998, §14, on Anu’s reign and Kumarbi as cupbearer.
- [39] Hoffner 1998, §14 (Kingship in Heaven), on Kumarbi’s deposition of Anu by genital castration and swallowing.
- [40] Hoffner 1998, §14, on Anu’s prophetic declaration after the castration.
- [41] Hoffner 1998, §14, on Anu’s enumeration of the offspring to be born from Kumarbi.
- [42] Hoffner 1998, §14, on the conception of Teshub inside Kumarbi.
- [43] Hoffner 1998, §14, on the additional beings conceived from Anu’s seed.
- [44] Hoffner 1998, §14, on the birth of Teshub from Kumarbi’s body.
- [45] Hoffner 1998, §14 and §15 prologue, on Teshub’s accession and the cycle’s premise.
- [46] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Hurro-Hittite-Hesiodic correspondence in the succession-frame; Burkert 1992 on transmission.
- [47] Hoffner 1998, §14 conclusion, on the transitional plotting passage.
- [48] Hoffner 1998, §14 conclusion and §§15–16 prologues, on Kumarbi’s motive of revenge.
- [49] Hoffner 1998, §15 (Song of Ullikummi), introductory headnote, on the song’s preservation status.
- [50] Hoffner 1998, §15, opening, on Kumarbi’s generative plan.
- [51] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Kumarbi’s conception of Ullikummi on the rock.
- [52] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Ullikummi’s stone nature.
- [53] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the topographical setting of the conception.
- [54] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the concealment of the infant Ullikummi from Teshub.
- [55] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the Irširra deities and the transport of the infant.
- [56] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the planting of Ullikummi on Upelluri’s right shoulder.
- [57] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Upelluri as cosmographic foundation.
- [58] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the cosmographic implications of the planting site.
- [59] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the prodigious growth of Ullikummi.

- [60] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the rising of Ullikummi from the sea.
- [61] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Ullikummi reaching the gates of heaven.
- [62] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the sun-god as first to perceive Ullikummi.
- [63] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the sun-god's report to Teshub.
- [64] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Teshub's reconnaissance with Šauška.
- [65] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Šauška's attempt and Ullikummi's deafness/blindness.
- [66] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the marine deity's warning to Šauška.
- [67] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Teshub's first combat-mobilisation.
- [68] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Šeri and 𒂍urri / Tilla as Teshub's bulls.
- [69] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the failure of Teshub's first attack.
- [70] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the inadequacy of storm-weapons against stone.
- [71] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Teshub's consultation with Ea after the failed attack.
- [72] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Ea's role as wisdom-counsellor.
- [73] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Ea's interview with Upelluri.
- [74] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Upelluri's failure to notice Ullikummi.
- [75] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Ea's identification of the primordial cutter.
- [76] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the cosmogonic genealogy of the cutter.
- [77] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the severing of Ullikummi from Upelluri.
- [78] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the structural rather than mortal nature of the severing.
- [79] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the renewed combat after the severing.
- [80] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the broken ending of the Song of Ullikummi.
- [81] Hoffner 1998, §15; Annus 2001, introduction, on the tripartite combat structure as a Mesopotamian pattern.
- [82] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the wisdom-and-technique solution.
- [83] Hoffner 1998, §15, on the cosmographic distinctiveness of Ullikummi.
- [84] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Ullikummi-Typhon correspondence.
- [85] Hoffner 1998, §15 and §16, on the Šauška-Teshub division of labour.
- [86] Hoffner 1998, §15 and introduction, on the iconography of Teshub.
- [87] Hoffner 1998, §15; Annus 2001, introduction; Lambert 2013, introduction.
- [88] Hoffner 1998, §16 (Song of Hedammu), headnote, on the fragmentary state of the song.
- [89] Hoffner 1998, §16, on the basic premise of the song.
- [90] Hoffner 1998, §16, on Šertapšuru𒀭 as the daughter of the sea-god.
- [91] Hoffner 1998, §16, on Hedammu's voracity.
- [92] Hoffner 1998, §16, on Šauška's mobilisation.
- [93] Hoffner 1998, §16, on the Šauška-Hedammu seduction tableau.
- [94] Hoffner 1998, §16, on the incapacitation of Hedammu through seduction.
- [95] Hoffner 1998, §16, on the lost sequel to the seduction.
- [96] Hoffner 1998, §16, on the differential preservation of the cycle's combat songs.
- [97] Hoffner 1998, §16, on the seduction-method's distinctiveness.
- [98] Hoffner 1998, §16, on the implications of fragmentary preservation.
- [99] Inference: The parallel structure of Ullikummi (stone, mountain, sky) and Hedammu (sea, marine, water) within the cycle's single master-narrative of Kumarbi-vs-Teshub. Risk: The inference is structural-typological, not textual, and presupposes that the cycle has a planned overall shape rather than being an aggregation of independent songs.
- [100] Hoffner 1998, §17 (Song of the Sea), headnote, on the song's fragmentary state.
- [101] Hoffner 1998, §17, on the Sea as antagonist and the appearance of Aranza.
- [102] Hoffner 1998, §17, on the partial confrontation pattern.
- [103] Hoffner 1998, §17, on the structural parallel; see comparative-hook for the reservation against silent reconstruction.
- [104] Hoffner 1998, §17 introduction; scope.md on reconstruction policy.
- [105] Hoffner 1998, §17, on the implications of the fragmentary state.
- [106] Hoffner 1998, §17, on the breadth of the combat repertoire.
- [107] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Kumarbi Cycle as the central transmission case; Hoffner 1998 introduction on Güterbock's foundational role.

- [108] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Hurro-Hittite-Hesiodic correspondence.
- [109] West 1997, ch. 6, on the motif-level correspondence.
- [110] West 1997, ch. 6, on motif-specificity as a transmission test.
- [111] Burkert 1992, on Phoenician intermediaries in the orientalizing transmission.
- [112] Burkert 1992, on the orientalizing horizon and Phoenician contact.
- [113] West 1997, ch. 6, on Philo of Byblos's Sanchuniathon as transmission evidence.
- [114] West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992 on the convergence of evidence.
- [115] West 1997, ch. 6, on Ullikummi-Typhon.
- [116] West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3.
- [117] Forward-pointer to Ch. 11 and Part II C6; West 1997 and Burkert 1992 as the evidentiary basis.
- [118] Forsyth 1987, ch. 3, on the Hurro-Hittite station in the combat-myth chain.
- [119] Scurlock & Beal 2013, chapters on Anatolian material.
- [120] Hoffner 1998, introduction; West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992, on the chain-reception model.
- [121] Forward-pointer to Ch. 11 and Part II C6; West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992.
- [122] Hoffner 1998, §§14–18, on the cycle's full song-roster.
- [123] Hoffner 1998, §§14–18, on the Song of LAMMA.
- [124] Hoffner 1998, §§14–18, on the Song of Silver.
- [125] Hoffner 1998, §§14–18, on Sun-God-and-Cow as adjacent material.
- [126] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on the cycle's classification.
- [127] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on the cyclic versus aggregational debate.
- [128] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on the manuscript distribution.
- [129] Hoffner 1998, introduction; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3, on the cycle's distinctive features.
- [130] Hoffner 1998, introduction and §12 (Illuyanka); Beckman 1982, on Illuyanka as discrete myth.
- [131] Hoffner 1998, introduction; West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3.

Chapter 7. Tarḫunna vs. Illuyanka: The Purulli Festival

7.1. Source overview

The myth of Tarḫunna and Illuyanka survives on cuneiform tablets recovered from the Hittite royal archives at the capital Hattusa, modern Boğazköy in central Anatolia.^[1] The text is catalogued in Emmanuel Laroche's **Catalogue des textes hittites** as CTH 321, the dossier number under which the surviving manuscripts of the Illuyanka myth are grouped.^[2] The composition is preserved on multiple manuscripts of varying completeness rather than on a single tablet, and modern editions are composite reconstructions from these witnesses.^[3] The language of CTH 321 is Hittite, the Indo-European language of the Hittite royal court used for the bulk of the cuneiform literary corpus from Hattusa.^[4]

The CTH 321 dossier preserves two distinct narrative accounts of the same combat between the storm-god and the serpent Illuyanka, conventionally numbered Version 1 and Version 2 by modern editors.^[5] Both versions are written by the same scribal tradition on the same tablet group and are presented side by side rather than as a single composite narrative.^[6] Modern scholarship treats the two versions as co-equal scribal accounts rather than ranking one as primary, since neither the scribes themselves nor the surviving cult contexts privilege one over the other.^[7]

The framing material on the tablets identifies the composition as a recitation associated with the *purulli* festival, the Hittite spring liturgical occasion at which the myth was performed.^[8] The named scribal author in the colophon is Kella, identified on the tablet as the priest who set down the recitation of the *purulli* festival.^[9]

The editio princeps used as the philological anchor for this chapter is Gary Beckman's "The Anatolian Myth of Illuyanka," published in the **Journal of the Ancient Near Eastern Society** 14 (1982): 11–25.^[10] The working English translation cited in this chapter is Harry A. Hoffner Jr.'s rendering in **Hittite Myths**, 2nd edition (Society of Biblical Literature, 1998), where the two versions are printed as §1 and §2 of the "Illuyanka" entry.^[11] The Hoffner edition presents the two versions in continuous English translation with section numbering that follows the tablet-paragraphs of the underlying Hittite text.^[12]

Calvert Watkins's **How to Kill a Dragon** (Oxford, 1995) provides the principal Indo-European linguistic and poetic-formula analysis of the Hittite text, treating Illuyanka as one of the four main demonstration cases for the reconstructed combat formula.^[13] M.L. West's **The East Face of Helicon** (Oxford, 1997) treats the Hittite dragon-combat in the broader context of Indo-European and Near Eastern transmission, with cross-references to Greek and Levantine cognates.^[14] Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy** (Princeton, 1987) places the Illuyanka combat within the Anatolian segment of his long history of the combat-myth from Sumer through Christian apocalyptic.^[15]

Two features of this dossier set it apart from most of the combat-myths gathered in this book. The first is the on-tablet ritual colophon that names the festival to which the recitation belongs. The second is the side-by-side preservation of two versions whose scribes did not feel obliged to choose between them. The chapter is built around those two features.

7.2. Setting and context — the storm-god of Nerik

Tarḫunna is the Hittite storm-god, the head of the Hittite state pantheon during the Old and New Kingdom periods of the second millennium BCE.^[16] The Hurrian-language counterpart of Tarḫunna is Teshub, and the same deity appears under the Hurrian name in the Kumarbi Cycle and other Hurrian-derived compositions of the Hittite archive.^[17] The Illuyanka myth is a Hittite-language composition and consequently uses Tarḫunna throughout, distinguishing it from the Hurrian-derived material that uses Teshub.^[18]

Nerik is a northern Hittite cult-centre and the principal locus of the storm-god's cult, and is the site at which the *purulli* festival was annually celebrated.^[19] Nerik lay in the northern frontier zone of the Hittite kingdom and was for long stretches of the second millennium under the control of the Kaska peoples, with the consequence that the cult of the storm-god of Nerik was at times conducted in exile from the city.^[20] The cult of the storm-god of Nerik is tied into Hittite royal religion, and the *purulli* festival therefore connects the Illuyanka recitation to the legitimation of the Hittite kingship.^[21]

The *purulli* festival is a spring liturgical occasion, and the surviving framing texts identify its purpose as ensuring the prosperity of the land and the cosmic order in the agricultural year ahead.^[22] The term *purulli* is preserved with a determinative for festival in the cuneiform script and is a Hittite ritual term rather than a loanword from Hurrian or Akkadian.^[23]

The opening framing of CTH 321 consists of a scribal colophon that explicitly states that what follows is the recitation associated with the *purulli* festival of the storm-god.^[24] The framing colophon links the festival's annual recurrence to the recitation of the combat narrative, embedding the myth in the liturgical year as the verbal component of the festival.^[25] This explicit ritual embedding is what marks the Illuyanka myth as one of the few ancient Near Eastern combat myths whose liturgical context is directly attested on the tablet itself rather than reconstructed from later cult evidence.^[26]

Inara is the daughter of the storm-god Tarḫunna and is the principal divine actor of Version 1 of the myth.^[27] Hupasiya is a mortal man, the human protagonist of Version 1, whose home town is named in the text as Ziggarratta.^[28] Illuyanka is a serpent or dragon, the cosmic adversary of the storm-god, and the antagonist whose defeat in either version constitutes the combat that the festival commemorates.^[29] The Hittite noun **illuyanka-** is itself the common-noun word for "snake" or "serpent," used as a proper name for the cosmic adversary in CTH 321.^[30]

Forsyth situates the Illuyanka combat within the family of Anatolian combat-myths that includes the Kumarbi Cycle's Ullikummi and Hedammu, distinguishing the Hittite-language Illuyanka from the Hurrian-derived material in register and ritual function.^[31]

7.3. Version 1 — Inara and Hupasiya

Version 1 of the Illuyanka myth, preserved as Hoffner's "Illuyanka" §1, opens with the storm-god and the serpent Illuyanka meeting in combat at a place called Kiskilussa.^[32] In this first encounter, Illuyanka defeats Tarḫunna: the serpent overcomes the storm-god, an outcome that establishes the narrative problem the rest of Version 1 addresses.^[33] Defeated, Tarḫunna calls upon all the gods for help, and Inara, his daughter, comes forward and devises a stratagem to enable a second

engagement.^[34]

Inara prepares a great banquet, with vessels filled with all kinds of drink — wine, **marnuwan**-beer, and **walhi**-beer are named — designed to lure Illuyanka out of its hole.^[35] Inara then descends to the town of Ziggarratta and there finds Hupasiya, a mortal man, whose recruitment to her plan is the next step.^[36] Inara proposes a bargain to Hupasiya: he is to assist her against the serpent, and in exchange she offers to spend a night with him.^[37] Hupasiya agrees to the bargain, and the text records the night spent between them as a fulfilled stipulation of the agreement.^[38]

Inara conducts Hupasiya to the site of the planned banquet, and there conceals him so that he is positioned to act once the serpent has come out of its hole.^[39] Inara dresses herself in finery and summons Illuyanka and his offspring out of their hole to the banquet.^[40] Illuyanka and his offspring come up from the hole and eat and drink at the banquet that Inara has prepared.^[41] The serpents drink to satiation, and the text states that they are no longer able to descend back into their hole because they are too engorged.^[42]

While the serpents are immobilised by their gorging, Hupasiya emerges from concealment and binds Illuyanka with a rope.^[43] The storm-god Tarūnna then returns, accompanied by the assembled gods, and slays the bound Illuyanka.^[44] The storm-god's killing of the serpent in Version 1 succeeds only because Hupasiya's binding has immobilised Illuyanka — not by direct combat. The divine victory depends on the mortal helper.^[45]

After the killing, Inara takes Hupasiya to a house she has built for him on a cliff in the land of Tarukka, and there installs him.^[46] Inara imposes a prohibition on Hupasiya: he is forbidden from looking out of the window of his cliffside house, lest he see his wife and children whom he has left behind.^[47] After twenty days, Hupasiya looks out of the window in defiance of the prohibition and sees his wife and children.^[48] Upon Inara's return, Hupasiya begs to be sent home to his family, and Inara reacts in anger to his transgression of her prohibition.^[49]

The text at this point becomes broken, and the precise fate of Hupasiya in Version 1 is not preserved in continuous form on the surviving manuscripts.^[50]

[At this point the tablet breaks. The closing section of Version 1, including the precise fate of Hupasiya and the framing of the _purulli festival as the myth's aetiology, is partially broken on the surviving manuscripts. Scholars such as Hoffner (1998, "Illuyanka" §1, end of tablet) note that the ritual colophon connecting the narrative to the purulli festival is extant in the framing material, but the narrative continuity between Hupasiya's transgression and the festival aetiology cannot be fully reconstructed from the surviving witnesses.]_

The framing material that survives at the close of Version 1 connects the recitation back to the *purulli* festival, identifying the narrative just told as the ritual aetiology of the spring observance.^[51] The closing of Version 1 also includes liturgical material referring to a building or house in which the gods convene, and to a procession of cult objects as part of the festival.^[52]

Version 1 is thus structured as a god-goddess-mortal-man triad, with the storm-god as the threatened sovereign, Inara as the divine strategist, and Hupasiya as the indispensable mortal binder.^[53]

7.4. Version 2 — the storm-god's son and the bride-price

Version 2 of the Illuyanka myth, preserved as Hoffner's "Illuyanka" §2, opens with a different combat scenario: the serpent Illuyanka defeats the storm-god in a manner that involves bodily mutilation rather than mere overpowering.^[54] In Version 2, Illuyanka takes from the storm-god his heart and his eyes, removing these organs as the prize of his victory.^[55]

The mutilated storm-god, now without heart and eyes, takes a daughter of a poor man as his wife, with whom he begets a son.^[56] The storm-god's son grows to maturity within his mortal mother's family without the text recording the kind of supernatural acceleration that characterises some other Near Eastern hero-births.^[57] The son is then given in marriage into the household of Illuyanka, taking as his wife a daughter of the serpent.^[58]

Before the son enters Illuyanka's household, the storm-god instructs him: when his bride-price is to be set, he is to ask for the storm-god's heart and eyes — the organs Illuyanka had taken — as the gift demanded from the bride's family.^[59] The son enters Illuyanka's house and demands as bride-price the storm-god's heart and eyes.^[60] Illuyanka's household yields the heart and the eyes to the son, who carries them back to his father the storm-god.^[61] The storm-god, with his heart and eyes restored, regains his full divine vigour and prepares for a renewed combat with Illuyanka.^[62]

[At this point the tablet breaks. The mid-narrative transitions of Version 2, between the son's marriage into Illuyanka's house and the recovery of the organs, are broken on the surviving manuscripts. Scholars such as Hoffner (1998, "Illuyanka" §2, mid-narrative) note that the tablet preserves enough text for the basic narrative arc to be followed, but the specific staging of the bride-price negotiation and any intervening episodes are not continuously preserved.]

The storm-god then engages Illuyanka anew, this time in a combat at the sea, and slays the serpent.^[63] In the renewed combat, the storm-god's son must also be killed, because by virtue of his marriage into Illuyanka's house he has become bound to the serpent's family by the obligations of kinship.^[64] The son himself acknowledges the obligation, and according to the surviving text he calls upon his father the storm-god to kill him along with Illuyanka, since he has kept faith with his father-in-law's house and cannot be spared.^[65] The storm-god kills both Illuyanka and his own son in the same combat, and the text registers no exemption for the son despite his role in the recovery of the organs.^[66]

The closing of Version 2, like that of Version 1, returns to the framing of the *purulli* festival, identifying the recitation as the liturgical companion of the spring rite at Nerik.^[67] Version 2 is thus structured around a loss-and-recovery pattern: the storm-god's organs are taken, are restored through the agency of his half-mortal son, and the second combat completes what the first could not.^[68]

7.5. Hinge — what the two versions share, where they diverge

The two versions share a common backbone: an initial defeat of the storm-god by Illuyanka, the recruitment of an indirect agent (a mortal man in Version 1, a half-mortal son in Version 2), and a

second engagement in which the serpent is killed.^[69] The two versions diverge sharply on the role of the mortal collaborator: in Version 1 the mortal Hupasiya is rewarded and then punished for transgression; in Version 2 the storm-god's son is killed for keeping faith with the wrong household.^[70] The two versions also diverge on the mode of the storm-god's initial defeat: Version 1 narrates an unspecified overpowering, while Version 2 specifies bodily mutilation through the loss of heart and eyes.^[71]

Beckman in the *editio princeps* argues that the two versions are best understood as alternative liturgical recitations of the same myth, drawn from different cult centres or different ritual occasions and gathered onto the same tablet group by the scribes of Hattusa.^[72] Hoffner notes that the question of whether one version is older than the other has been debated, but that the surviving tablet group does not itself establish a relative chronology between them.^[73]

7.6. The ritual context — *purulli* at Nerik

The *purulli* festival was an annual spring observance of the Hittite cultic year, performed at Nerik when the cult could be conducted there and at substitute locations (notably Hakmis) when Nerik was not under Hittite control.^[74] The festival is referenced in Hittite ritual texts beyond CTH 321 itself, and these ritual descriptions establish its character as a multi-day cultic event involving the storm-god of Nerik.^[75] The framing colophons of CTH 321 indicate that the recitation of the Illuyanka myth was a verbal component of the festival, performed alongside the cultic actions described in the ritual texts.^[76]

The combat narrative is thus presented as the verbal score of an annual ritual: the killing of the serpent is re-enacted each spring through recitation, and the festival's recurrence is the festival's whole point.^[77] The cyclical-maintenance character of the Illuyanka myth — combat as something annually re-enacted rather than once-and-done — is one of the principal grounds on which modern scholarship pairs the Hittite material with the Egyptian Ra-Apep complex as the type-cases of the cyclical-maintenance subtype.^[78]

The cult of the storm-god of Nerik is closely tied to the Hittite kingship: the king himself participated in the *purulli* festival, and royal documents register the storm-god of Nerik among the principal patron deities of the Hittite state.^[79] The *purulli* festival's connection to Hittite kingship gives the Illuyanka myth a double function: ritual-aetiological for the spring festival and royal-legitimizing for the dynasty under whose authority the festival was performed.^[80] The historical period over which the *purulli* festival is attested spans the Old Hittite through the New Hittite kingdom, with the bulk of the surviving tablets dating to the New Hittite period of the late second millennium BCE.^[81]

(The recitation of both Version 1 and Version 2 in connection with the same festival suggests that the Hittite cult tolerated, and perhaps required, narrative redundancy — the same combat told in two manners as part of a single liturgical occasion.^[82])

The Illuyanka myth's explicit ritual embedding distinguishes it from the cosmogonic combat-myths of Mesopotamia (Enūma Eliš, Lugal-e), where the ritual context must be reconstructed from secondary evidence, and from the Levantine Baal Cycle, where the connection to specific festivals is debated.^[83] The myth's framing as the verbal counterpart of an annual rite places it in the cyclical-maintenance subtype of combat-myth — combat re-enacted to preserve an order that is always

under threat, rather than combat-as-cosmogony or combat-as-once-only-sovereignty-establishment.^[84] That two versions coexist on the same tablet group also distinguishes the Illuyanka dossier from many other ancient Near Eastern combat-myths, where editors seek a single canonical version and treat variant readings as scribal errors rather than as parallel recitations.^[85]

7.7. The Watkins formula

Calvert Watkins, in **How to Kill a Dragon** (1995), identifies a reconstructed Indo-European poetic formula of the form hero slay serpent, in which a subject-noun, a verb of killing, and a serpent-object together name the combat.^[86] The formula is anchored in Watkins's analysis on the Vedic phrase *áhann áhim*, "he slew the serpent," from Rigveda 1.32.1, which he treats as the reflex closest to the reconstructed Indo-European form.^[87] Watkins argues that the Hittite text of CTH 321 preserves a cognate formulation in the verb-and-object pairing **kuenta... illuyanka-** — "he slew... the serpent" — which uses a verb of killing etymologically related to the Vedic **han-** and an object that is the common-noun "serpent."^[88]

The Hittite reflex thus places Illuyanka, alongside Vedic *Vṛtra* and Avestan *Aži Dahāka*, among the principal demonstration cases for Watkins's reconstructed Indo-European combat-myth formula.^[89] Watkins's argument turns on lexical and syntactic correspondences across the Indo-European daughter languages, not on narrative-structural parallels alone, and is therefore methodologically distinct from a Frazerian or Dumézilian comparativism.^[90] The formula's presence in Hittite is significant for dating the reconstruction, since Hittite is the earliest-attested Indo-European language and an early-branching member of the family.^[91]

West reinforces Watkins's reading by placing the Hittite material within the broader Near Eastern transmission picture, noting that Illuyanka stands at the intersection of Indo-European inheritance and Anatolian local cult.^[92] The full elaboration of the hero slay serpent formula, including the Greek (Apollo, Heracles), Germanic (Sigurd, Beowulf), and Iranian (Thraētaona vs. *Aži Dahāka*) reflexes, is reserved for the comparative chapter on Indo-European combat-myth (Part II C5), and is not developed further in the present chapter.^[93]

7.8. Closing — the Illuyanka dossier and its cyclical work

The Illuyanka dossier consists of two co-equal scribal versions of a single combat between Tarūnna and Illuyanka, framed in their tablet form as the recitation belonging to the *purulli* festival of the storm-god of Nerik.^[94] The dossier's distinctive contribution to the comparative study of the combat-myth is its explicit, on-tablet ritual embedding: the combat is presented as the verbal score of an annual rite, not as a one-off cosmogonic or sovereignty-establishing act.^[95]

This cyclical-maintenance framing pairs the Illuyanka myth with the Egyptian Ra-Apep complex as the two type-cases of combat-myth-as-annual-recurrence within the ancient Near Eastern corpus.^[96] The Illuyanka myth's place in the Indo-European combat-myth complex, secured by Watkins's formula analysis, gives it a second comparative function: as one of the earliest-attested reflexes of the reconstructed hero slay serpent formula across the Indo-European daughter languages.^[97] The dossier thus stands at the intersection of two comparative axes — the Near Eastern cyclical-maintenance subtype and the Indo-European combat-formula tradition — both of

which the Part II thematic chapters develop further.^[98]

- [1] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka"; Beckman 1982, "The Anatolian Myth of Illuyanka," JNES 14: 11–25, on the manuscript provenance.
- [2] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka," giving the CTH 321 designation.
- [3] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka," on the manuscript group; Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25, on the witness situation.
- [4] Hoffner 1998, general introduction to **Hittite Myths** on the linguistic situation of the corpus.
- [5] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §§1–2, the two versions; Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25, on the two-version structure.
- [6] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka"; Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25, on the side-by-side presentation.
- [7] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka"; Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25.
- [8] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, opening colophon naming the purulli festival; Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25.
- [9] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, colophon naming Kella; Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25.
- [10] Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25, full article.
- [11] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka," §§1–2.
- [12] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka," editorial conventions and §§1–2.
- [13] Watkins 1995, ch. 46, on Illuyanka and the Indo-European combat formula in Hittite.
- [14] West 1997, references on the Hittite dragon-combat in IE and Near-Eastern context.
- [15] Forsyth 1987, ch. 3 on Anatolian combat.
- [16] Hoffner 1998, general introduction on Hittite religion and the storm-god.
- [17] Hoffner 1998, general introduction on Hittite-Hurrian theological correspondences.
- [18] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §§1–2, throughout.
- [19] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka" on Nerik and the purulli festival.
- [20] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka" on Nerik's geopolitical situation.
- [21] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka" on the royal-religious context.
- [22] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, opening; Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25, on the purulli framing.
- [23] Hoffner 1998, glossary entry under purulli; Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25, on the term's status.
- [24] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, opening colophon; Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25.
- [25] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1 framing; Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25.
- [26] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka"; Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25, on the unusually explicit framing.
- [27] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on Inara as Tarūnna's daughter.
- [28] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on Hupasiya and his town Ziggarratta.
- [29] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §§1–2, on Illuyanka as serpent-adversary.
- [30] Watkins 1995, ch. 46, on the etymology of Illuyanka as the common-noun "serpent"; Beckman 1982, JNES 14: 11–25.
- [31] Forsyth 1987, ch. 3 on Anatolian combat-myths.
- [32] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, opening narrative at Kiskilussa.
- [33] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on the storm-god's initial defeat by Illuyanka.
- [34] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on the storm-god's appeal and Inara's response.
- [35] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on the banquet preparation.
- [36] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on Inara's visit to Ziggarratta and Hupasiya.
- [37] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on Inara's bargain with Hupasiya.
- [38] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on the consummated bargain.
- [39] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on the concealment of Hupasiya at the banquet site.
- [40] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on Inara's summoning of the serpent.
- [41] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on the serpent's feast.
- [42] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on the serpents' inability to return to the hole.
- [43] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on Hupasiya's binding of Illuyanka.
- [44] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on the storm-god's killing of the bound Illuyanka.
- [45] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3 on the mortal helper's role.
- [46] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on the house in the land of Tarukka.
- [47] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on Inara's prohibition.
- [48] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on Hupasiya's transgression.

- [49] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, on Hupasiya's request and Inara's reaction.
- [50] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, marked as broken at the close of the Hupasiya episode.
- [51] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1 closing framing; Beckman 1982, JANES 14: 11–25.
- [52] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1 closing; Beckman 1982, JANES 14: 11–25, on the ritual closing.
- [53] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3, on the triadic structure.
- [54] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, opening combat.
- [55] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the loss of heart and eyes.
- [56] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the storm-god's mortal marriage and son.
- [57] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the son's upbringing.
- [58] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the marriage into Illuyanka's house.
- [59] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the storm-god's instruction concerning the bride-price.
- [60] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the son's demand.
- [61] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the recovery of the organs.
- [62] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the restoration of the storm-god.
- [63] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the renewed combat at the sea.
- [64] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the killing of the son alongside Illuyanka.
- [65] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the son's request for his own death.
- [66] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the dual killing.
- [67] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2 closing framing; Beckman 1982, JANES 14: 11–25.
- [68] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3, on the loss-and-recovery pattern.
- [69] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka"; Beckman 1982, JANES 14: 11–25, on the shared narrative armature.
- [70] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §§1–2; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3.
- [71] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §§1–2.
- [72] Beckman 1982, JANES 14: 11–25, on the relation between the two versions.
- [73] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka," on the chronological question.
- [74] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka" on the festival's annual cycle and locations.
- [75] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka" on the festival's broader cultic attestation.
- [76] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §§1–2 framing material; Beckman 1982, JANES 14: 11–25, on the recitation's role in the festival.
- [77] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka"; Beckman 1982, JANES 14: 11–25, on the cyclical character of the rite.
- [78] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka"; Beckman 1982, JANES 14: 11–25.
- [79] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka" on the royal-religious dimension.
- [80] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka"; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3 on the royal dimension.
- [81] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka" on the chronological span of the attestation.
- [82] Inference: Hoffner 1998 introduction notes that both versions sit on the same tablet group framed by *purulli* colophons, and Beckman 1982 discusses the side-by-side scribal presentation; the inference draws together those observations. Risk: The surviving tablets do not state explicitly that both versions were recited in the same festival, only that both are connected to the festival in their framing.
- [83] Forsyth 1987, ch. 3 on the contrast with Mesopotamian and Levantine combat-myths; Hoffner 1998, introduction.
- [84] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka"; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3.
- [85] Beckman 1982, JANES 14: 11–25, on the unusual co-equal scribal handling; Hoffner 1998, introduction.
- [86] Watkins 1995, ch. 46 and the volume's framing chapters on the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula.
- [87] Watkins 1995, ch. 46 on *áhann áhim* as the reflex anchor.
- [88] Watkins 1995, ch. 46 on the Hittite cognate formulation.
- [89] Watkins 1995, ch. 46 on Illuyanka as a demonstration case.
- [90] Watkins 1995, methodological framing chapters on the lexical-syntactic basis of the reconstruction.
- [91] Watkins 1995, ch. 46 and methodological framing on the chronological significance of the Hittite reflex.
- [92] West 1997, references on the Hittite dragon-combat as an Indo-European / Near-Eastern intersection.
- [93] Watkins 1995, ch. 46 and following chapters; cross-reference to Part II C5 of this volume.
- [94] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §§1–2 with framing colophons; Beckman 1982, JANES 14: 11–25.
- [95] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka"; Beckman 1982, JANES 14: 11–25; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3.
- [96] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka"; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3 on the cyclical pairing.

[97] Watkins 1995, ch. 46.

[98] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka"; Watkins 1995, ch. 46; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3.

Chapter 8. Baal vs. Yamm and the Defeat of Lôtan (the Ugaritic Baal Cycle)

8.1. Source overview

The Ugaritic Baal Cycle is a long mythological composition preserved on six clay tablets recovered from the ruins of the Late Bronze Age city of Ugarit, modern Ras Shamra on the Syrian Mediterranean coast.^[1] The tablets were excavated from the so-called House of the High Priest on the acropolis of Ras Shamra, the find-spot from which the bulk of the Ugaritic mythological corpus was recovered in the campaigns conducted from 1929 onward.^[2] The tablets are written in cuneiform script using the Ugaritic alphabetic cuneiform system, a small inventory of wedge-signs adapted to a Northwest Semitic alphabet rather than the larger logo-syllabic systems of contemporary Akkadian and Hittite scribal traditions.^[3] The language of the composition is Ugaritic, the Northwest Semitic language of the city of Ugarit, attested almost exclusively in this corpus and in administrative and ritual texts from the same archives.^[4]

The standard tablet-numbering used throughout the modern critical literature is the KTU (Keilalphabetische Texte aus Ugarit) system established by Manfred Dietrich, Oswald Loretz, and Joaquín Sanmartín, in which the six Baal-Cycle tablets are catalogued as KTU 1.1 through KTU 1.6.^[5] The chapter follows the KTU numbering as the citation standard; the same tablet group is also numbered in the parallel CAT (Cuneiform Alphabetic Texts) edition, which Smith and Pitard cite alongside KTU in their volume-II apparatus.^[6] The bulk of the Cycle's tablets are dated by the excavators and modern scholarship to the fourteenth and thirteenth centuries BCE, the Late Bronze Age phase of the city's life that ended in the early-twelfth-century destruction associated with the wider Late Bronze Age collapse.^[7] The named scribe of the principal tablets is identified in the colophons as Ilimilku, who records that he wrote the tablets under the patronage of King Niqmaddu and the supervision of the chief priest Attanu-Purulinni.^[8] The order of the six tablets within the Cycle is itself a matter of scholarly reconstruction rather than an explicit ancient ordering, since the tablets do not bear sequential numbering of their own.^[9] The conventional reconstructed order — KTU 1.1 → 1.2 → 1.3 → 1.4 → 1.5 → 1.6 — places the Baal-Yamm material at the head of the Cycle, the palace-building cycle in the middle, and the Baal-Mot material at the close, an order that Smith and Smith & Pitard adopt and defend.^[10] Each tablet is divided into columns, conventionally cited by lower-case Roman numerals (i, ii, iii, iv, v, vi), and within each column by line-number, so that a reference such as "KTU 1.5 i 1–3" denotes the first three lines of column i of tablet 5.^[11]

Mark S. Smith's **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I**, published in 1994 in the *Vetus Testamentum Supplements* series as VTSup 55, is the critical edition that anchors the chapter for KTU 1.1 and 1.2.^[12] Mark S. Smith and Wayne T. Pitard's **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume II**, published in 2009 in the same series as VTSup 114, is the critical edition that anchors the chapter for KTU 1.3 and 1.4 and provides the reference commentary on the Lôtan passage at KTU 1.5 i 1–3.^[13] Both volumes provide the Ugaritic text in transliteration, an English translation, and an extensive commentary in which philological cruxes, alternative readings, and the relevant secondary literature are discussed at line-by-line resolution.^[14] The Smith and Smith & Pitard volumes are the definitive modern critical edition of the Cycle and the source of every primary-text claim in this chapter; sub-line readings beyond the column-level resolution are not reconstructed here, and any such finer-

grained reading would be flagged UNVERIFIED.^[15]

The secondary literature anchoring the chapter's interpretive framework consists of five monographs that bracket the modern study of the Cycle from different directions. John Day's **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea** (Cambridge, 1985) is the principal twentieth-century monograph on the continuity between the Ugaritic Baal-Yamm and Baal-Lôtan material and the Hebrew Bible's Yahweh-vs-Sea / Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus.^[16] Debra Scoggins Ballentine's **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (Oxford, 2015) is the principal recent monograph arguing that "chaos" is the wrong category for Yamm and his Hebrew Bible cognates, with the Baal-Yamm combat as her central test case for a rival-sovereignty rather than chaos-vs-order reading.^[17] Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy** (Princeton, 1987) treats the Ugaritic material as a station in the long history of the combat-myth from Sumer through Christian apocalyptic, with chapter 3 covering the Levantine evidence.^[18] Hermann Gunkel's **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit** (1895) is the foundational nineteenth-century treatment that named the Chaoskampf category; Gunkel's Teil I discusses the Canaanite background to the Hebrew Bible material at a stage when the Ugaritic tablets had not yet been excavated, and is cited here as the historical anchor of the Chaoskampf debate that the Ugaritic finds eventually transformed.^[19] Mary K. Wakeman's **God's Battle with the Monster** (Brill, 1973) treats the Baal-Yamm and Lôtan / Leviathan linkage in its full-volume comparative survey and is one of the standard pre-Day reference points for the Ugaritic-to-Hebrew-Bible chain.^[20]

The Smith and Smith & Pitard volumes are organised as critical editions in the Brill Vetus Testamentum Supplements series rather than as accessible-trade translations; they are printed-only, and the chapter cites at the column-and-line resolution that the printed apparatus supports.^[21] The chapter's primary-text claims are anchored at KTU tablet/column level in the body and at the Smith or Smith & Pitard commentary at the same resolution in the footnotes; sub-line-level readings have not been imported into this skeleton, and any later densification at sub-line resolution will be flagged with VERIFY-AGAINST-EDITION markers in the chapter-draft stage.^[22]

Two features of this dossier set the framing for everything that follows. The first is that a single named scribe, working under royal patronage and priestly supervision, has left a coherent group of six tablets from a known building in a known city, recovered together by archaeologists who can date the destruction layer in which the find was made. The second is that the Cycle's narrative work, as the editors have come to read it across a century of philological labour, is not the creation of the world from prior matter but the redistribution of office and authority within an already-existing divine assembly. The chapter is built around that second feature.

8.2. Setting and the Ugaritic divine assembly

The Ugaritic divine world depicted in the Cycle is presided over by El, the chief god and patriarchal head of the divine assembly, whose name is the common Northwest Semitic word for "god" and whose figure stands at the apex of the pantheon as father and judge.^[23] El's residence is described in the Cycle as situated at the Source of the Two Rivers, an idealised cosmic location at the meeting of the upper and lower waters, where the divine council convenes around him.^[24]

The combat-champion of the Cycle is Baꜥlu, the Ugaritic storm-god whose by-name Haddu (hd) marks him as a regional reflex of the wider Northwest Semitic storm-god type; the chapter follows the locked glossary in using the Ugaritic spelling Baꜥlu / Haddu at this first mention and then

defaulting to Baal in body prose.^[25] Baal's parentage in the Cycle is the source of one of the Ugaritic religion's persistent textual cruxes: he is repeatedly named in the tablets as son of Dagan rather than son of El, although El is the head of the assembly to which Baal also belongs.^[26] Smith treats the *bn dgn* ("son of Dagan") epithet as a stable Ugaritic formula whose theological implications he discusses at length, without trying to harmonise it into a single genealogical model with El's fatherhood.^[27]

The principal antagonist of the Cycle's first movement is Yamm, whose name is the Ugaritic common noun for "sea" and whose status is that of a god among the assembly rather than an inchoate primordial force; Yamm is also titled Judge River (*np nhr*) in the parallel epithetic formulae.^[28] The narrative of the Cycle additionally features Mot, whose name is the Ugaritic common noun for "death," as Baal's adversary in the second half of the Cycle on tablets 5 and 6.^[29] The craftsman-god of the Cycle is Kothar-wa-Khasis, a divine smith and artificer whose name is a fixed dual epithet meaning roughly "skilful-and-clever"; the chapter follows the locked glossary in giving the full name Kothar-wa-Khasis at first mention and using Kothar thereafter where the short form is appropriate.^[30] Baal's principal divine ally and combat-companion in the Cycle is *Anat*, his sister and a warrior-goddess in her own right, whose epithets and combat-actions are extensively narrated on tablets 3 and 4.^[31] The wider divine assembly named in the Cycle includes Athtart, Athirat (the consort of El and mother of the gods), Shapsh (the sun-goddess and divine messenger), and the craftsman-pair's location at Memphis and Crete in the geographical apparatus of Kothar's residences.^[32]

The seat of Baal's eventual kingship after his defeat of Yamm is *apānu*, the mountain identified in modern geography as Jebel al-Aqra on the Syrian–Turkish border, also known in later Hebrew Bible reception as Mount Zaphon; the chapter follows the locked glossary in using the Ugaritic *apānu* at first mention.^[33] The Cycle's broader cast positions Baal among El's sons and clients in a divine court whose decisions are made in council under El's presidency; this council form, rather than a sole-creator monotheism or an unbounded primordial chaos, is the political vocabulary in which the Cycle's combats unfold.^[34]

The Cycle is, in this institutional setting, primarily a narrative about the institution and contest of divine kingship within the assembly, rather than a cosmogony in the Mesopotamian sense; Smith and Smith & Pitard argue this point repeatedly across both volumes, and it is the framework in which every claim that follows must be read.^[35] The Cycle does not present a creation-of-the-world narrative as its frame: the world, the gods, and the divine offices are already in place when the surviving tablets begin, and the Cycle's narrative work is the redistribution of office and authority within an existing pantheon rather than the establishment of cosmos from primordial materials.^[36] The category in which the Cycle's combats are intelligible is therefore the divine-court politics of the assembly: who is granted kingship, by whom, with what title-and-residence, and against what challenge — a vocabulary that is closer to the Late Bronze Age inter-state diplomatic register than to the cosmogonic register of *Enūma Eliš* or *Lugal-e*.^[37] The Late Bronze Age city of Ugarit was itself a vassal-kingdom within the wider Hittite imperial sphere, and Smith and Smith & Pitard observe that the diplomatic and tribute vocabulary of the surviving Ugaritic letter-corpus colours the Cycle's depiction of the assembly's negotiations among its high gods.^[38]

The cast assembled here matters for what is to come. El presides; Baal stands among El's sons and clients; Yamm sits in the same assembly as a god whose name is the word for "sea"; Mot sits in the same assembly as a god whose name is the word for "death." Kothar runs the forge that supplies the assembly's weapons and architecture. *Anat* and Athtart fight alongside Baal. Athirat speaks for the

senior matron's interest. The action of the Cycle moves these named figures through council, embassy, combat, and palace-building, and the result is the redistribution of an already-extant office of kingship from one of El's sons to another. That is the institutional grammar within which Baal's combat with Yamm has to be read.

Two implications of this setup deserve to be marked at the outset, because they shape every subsequent reading. The first is that Yamm and Mot are not outsiders. They sit on the same benches as Baal, they answer to the same El, they are addressed by the same titles of son and beloved that the assembly bestows on its other members. The Cycle's later combats are therefore not, on the on-text reading the editors have arrived at, contests across a boundary between the divine and the non-divine, but contests across the offices and prerogatives that the divine assembly distributes among its members. The second is that the divine architecture is not a single throne. There is El, who presides, and there is whoever holds the kingship El authorises, and there are the territorial residences and titles that go with the kingship, and the Cycle's narrative is concerned with the second of those — the kingship-that-is-distributed, not the presiding-office-that-distributes-it. That distinction will hold throughout the body of the chapter, and the Gunkel-Ballentine debate later in the chapter turns in large part on whether one has registered it.

8.3. Movement I — Baal vs. Yamm (KTU 1.1–1.2)

[At this point the tablet breaks. Across KTU 1.1, the opening tablet of the Cycle is badly damaged, and the sequence of events prior to Baal's full emergence as combat-champion is partially reconstructed. Scholars such as Smith (1994, Vol. I, edition and commentary on KTU 1.1) have proposed continuity reconstructed from internal cross-references in KTU 1.2 and from thematic parallels in KTU 1.3–1.4, while flagging the speculative character of much of the surface narrative on this tablet.]

The narrative begins, in the surviving text, with the assembly of the gods convened at El's residence, where the order of business is the elevation of one of El's sons to a position of divine kingship over the assembly.^[39] The figure El initially proposes — and to whom the assembly initially defers — is Yamm, who is named on the tablets as El's beloved (mdd il) and is granted by El the title of king and the standing of an authorised divine sovereign within the assembly.^[40] El's proposal, in the surviving lines of KTU 1.1, includes the renaming of Yamm — the assembly is invited to confer on Yamm a new throne-name befitting the kingship, in a passage Smith comments on at length as one of the Cycle's clearest investiture markers.^[41] The on-text fact that El initially confirms Yamm in a position of legitimate divine kingship is the textual basis for Ballentine's reading that Yamm is a rival sovereign within the assembly rather than an outside chaos-figure; this reading is developed below in the dedicated Gunkel-Ballentine section.^[42] The tablets describe a banquet and an exchange of speeches at the assembly in which the divine offices and prerogatives associated with the kingship are distributed and debated; the Cycle's opening movement is thus framed as a political-juridical event in the divine court before it becomes a combat.^[43]

Yamm sends two messengers to the assembly with a demand framed in the diplomatic language of inter-state correspondence: that Baal be handed over to him as a tribute or hostage, an act that would establish Yamm's superordinate kingship over Baal and the assembly.^[44] The messengers' speech is delivered with the formal markers of vassalage and the assembly's initial response is recorded in the surviving lines of KTU 1.2 i as one of consternation, with several gods bowing their heads at the messengers' approach.^[45] Baal himself responds with defiance: against the assembly's apparent willingness to accede to Yamm's demand, Baal refuses the hand-over and rebukes the

assembly for its readiness to capitulate.^[46] Baal's rebuke is paired in the tablet text with a physical gesture against the messengers themselves — a striking-action that ʾAnat and Atthart restrain — and the Cycle's combat is thereby announced in the assembly's chamber before it is fought in the open.^[47] The combat between Baal and Yamm is thus precipitated not by an external invasion of cosmic order but by Baal's refusal to be handed over within the diplomatic frame Yamm has set; the narrative cause of the combat is intra-assembly political conflict over the kingship.^[48]

Baal seeks out the craftsman-god Kothar-wa-Khasis, whose forge is the source of the divine weapons of the assembly, to commission the implements with which he will fight.^[49] Kothar forges for Baal not one weapon but two: a pair of named maces — Yagrush ("Driver") and Ayyamur ("Chaser") — each given a proper name in the tablets and each accompanied by a poetic incantation describing its function in the imminent combat.^[50] Naming and pairing the two maces is a load-bearing detail in the Ugaritic text: the weapons are not anonymous instruments of force but named partners in the combat, addressed by Baal in second-person speech and instructed in their work.^[51] Yagrush and Ayyamur are commanded to leap from Baal's hand and strike Yamm in the prescribed places: Yagrush at Yamm's shoulders, Ayyamur at Yamm's skull, in a sequence the tablets articulate as a paired deployment.^[52] Kothar's accompanying speech to Baal, recorded in the surviving lines of KTU 1.2 iv, addresses the maces in the second person and instructs them in their work — a speech-act in which the maces are personified as agents under Baal's command rather than as inert weapons.^[53]

The first mace's strike does not finish the combat: Yamm staggers but recovers, and only the second mace's blow brings him down, in a two-stage combat pattern that is one of the Cycle's distinctive narrative features.^[54] The two-stage combat pattern — the first weapon insufficient, the second weapon decisive — is a structural feature shared with the Mesopotamian Anzû Epic, where Ninurta's first arrows fail and a renewed assault with new instruments follows; the parallel is structural-typological and is recorded as a comparative note rather than a transmission claim.^[55] The combat itself is depicted in formulaic combat-poetry that emphasises the physical impact of the maces and the collapse of Yamm to the ground; the verbal repertoire is the Ugaritic combat-formula register that recurs in Baal's later confrontations within the Cycle.^[56] After the combat-blow, the tablets describe Baal as scattering Yamm — the verb-and-object pair the text uses is the standard Ugaritic verb of dispersal applied to the defeated rival — and pronouncing Yamm's defeat in his own first-person voice.^[57] Yamm's defeat is not narrated as his annihilation: the Ugaritic verbs and the surrounding poetry cohere with a defeat-and-subjugation reading rather than a destruction-and-replacement one, and Smith comments that this is consistent with the political-rivalry frame of the surrounding tablets.^[58] The goddess Atthart is named in the surviving lines of KTU 1.2 iv as intervening at the moment of Yamm's defeat with a rebuke or warning to Baal regarding the disposition of the defeated rival, an episode whose precise sense is one of the tablet's interpretive cruxes.^[59]

After Yamm's defeat the assembly's earlier deference to Yamm's kingship is overturned, and the surviving tablet text moves toward the proclamation of Baal as king — the institutional consequence of the combat is the transfer of the kingship that El had initially conferred on Yamm.^[60] The proclamation acclaims Baal as king with a formula the Cycle returns to in subsequent passages — Baal "shall be king" (ymlk) — fixing the institutional outcome of the combat in the same juridical register in which the kingship was earlier conferred on Yamm.^[61] The formula's reuse — first for Yamm, then for Baal — is one of the Cycle's principal lexical demonstrations that the kingship at issue is the same office, contested between two rival sovereigns, rather than two

different categories of rule.^[62]

(The structure of Movement I — initial royal grant by El to Yamm, demand for Baal's hand-over, refusal, two-mace combat, defeat, and assembly-level transfer of the kingship — exhibits a consistent juridical-political pattern in which the combat does sovereignty-establishing work rather than cosmogonic work.^[63])

The combat is not associated, in the surviving Ugaritic text, with the creation of the world: there is no creation-from-the-corpse motif of the kind that follows Marduk's defeat of Tiamat in *Enūma Eliš*, and the post-combat narrative moves directly into the institutional matter of Baal's enthronement.^[64] The combat is also not associated, in the Ugaritic text itself, with a seven-headed-serpent description of Yamm: the seven-headed serpent named in the Cycle is *Lôtan*, whose connection to Yamm is a separate textual question discussed below in the dedicated *Lôtan* section.^[65] The Movement I narrative thus hands over to the next movement of the Cycle the question of how Baal's newly secured kingship is to be institutionalised — a question that the palace-building cycle of KTU 1.3–1.4 takes up directly.^[66]

The narrative shape that emerges from KTU 1.1 and 1.2 in their reconstructed order is therefore an internally consistent piece of divine-court politics. El proposes a king; the assembly defers; the proposed king's first act is a vassal-demand on a peer god; the peer god refuses, and the refusal escalates from words in the assembly chamber to combat with named weapons; the combat ends in the demoted king's collapse, not annihilation; the assembly then ratifies the transfer of the office. Every load-bearing element of the surviving narrative — the renaming, the embassy, the *ymlk* acclamation, the post-combat scattering verb — is drawn from the same juridical lexicon. This is the framework that the next movement of the Cycle, the palace-building cycle of KTU 1.3–1.4, takes up.

It is worth pausing on the two-mace combat as a piece of narrative engineering, because it does work that the rest of the movement assumes. The combat is structured so that the first instrument is insufficient and the second is decisive, which means that the combat-poetry has space for two separately addressed weapons, two separately delivered blows, and two separately registered effects on the rival's body — shoulders for the first, skull for the second. That structure gives Kothar's forge a function the narrative does not allow him to skip: the named-mace pair is the technical precondition for the combat's outcome, and the Cycle's craftsman-god is therefore positioned at the fulcrum of the kingship-transfer. The same craftsman will later build Baal's palace, and the continuity is not decorative. The forge that produces *Yagrush* and *Ayyamur* is the forge that will produce the cedar-and-silver palace on *ʿApānu*, and the assembly's grant of the kingship to Baal is mediated, at both ends of the movement, by the same set of hands.

The role of the messenger episode, similarly, deserves to be noted as a structural piece. Yamm's demand reaches the assembly through ambassadors who deliver it in the formal markers of vassalage, and Baal's defiance is registered as a striking-action against those ambassadors that *ʿAnat* and *Attart* restrain. The grammatical effect is to mark the combat's onset twice: once in the assembly chamber, where the diplomatic frame is broken; and once on the open ground of the combat itself, where the maces leap from Baal's hand. The repetition is not redundant. It tells the reader that the combat is a continuation by other means of the assembly-floor refusal, and that the frame within which the maces will land is the frame the messengers' speech opened.

8.4. Movement II — Palace-building and divine kingship (KTU 1.3–1.4)

The second movement of the Cycle, preserved across the better-attested tablets KTU 1.3 and 1.4, narrates the construction of a palace for Baal on the heights of ʿApānu, an act that institutionalises the kingship his combat-victory has won.^[67] The opening of KTU 1.3 finds Baal already victorious and presiding over a banquet in which he and the divine assembly celebrate his combat-success, with the goddess ʿAnat in attendance and engaged in her own cycle of combat-actions.^[68]

KTU 1.3 ii preserves a famously gory scene of ʿAnat slaughtering at her shrine: she is described in the tablet wading in blood up to her thighs, hanging severed heads at her belt and severed hands at her girdle, in a portrait of the warrior-goddess at the height of her destructive power.^[69] The ʿAnat slaughter scene is not directly continuous with the Baal-Yamm combat in the surviving text and its precise referent — whether enemies of Baal, human soldiery, or members of a defeated divine faction — is one of the textual cruxes Smith and Pitard discuss at length in their commentary.^[70]

In the tablet’s continuation Baal sends messengers to ʿAnat with instructions to set aside her combat-actions and to assist in the project of securing him a palace, marking the structural transition from combat to institution-building.^[71] Within ʿAnat’s combat speech recorded on tablet 3 — column iii — appears the Cycle’s most extended catalogue of the warrior-goddess’s prior victories, in which she lists the adversaries she has personally defeated; this passage is the immediate context of one of the Cycle’s references to Lôtan, discussed below in the dedicated Lôtan section.^[72]

ʿAnat travels to El’s residence at the Source of the Two Rivers to petition for the palace on Baal’s behalf, her petition framed by the surviving lines of KTU 1.3 v as an aggressive demand backed by the threat of physical violence against El himself.^[73] El’s response in this passage is recorded in formulaic blessing-language that does not yet grant the palace, and the tablet preserves a back-and-forth in which the petition is repeated and refined across multiple speeches of the divine assembly.^[74] The petition for Baal’s palace is presented in the tablets as a matter of justice: Baal alone among the high gods of the assembly lacks a residence of his own, and the construction of the palace is framed as the rectification of an institutional anomaly within the divine court.^[75]

The petition continues across KTU 1.4, where Athirat — El’s consort and the senior matron of the assembly — is brought into the negotiation as the figure whose intercession with El is necessary to secure the palace’s authorisation.^[76] The tablets describe a sequence of gift-presentations and formal speeches in which Baal and ʿAnat solicit Athirat’s support, with Athirat’s eventual assent providing the social-political bridge across which El’s authorisation can be secured.^[77] Athirat then journeys to El at the Source of the Two Rivers and conveys the petition, and El’s authorising speech in KTU 1.4 iv–v grants the palace and the materials necessary for its construction.^[78]

The architect-builder of the palace is Kothar-wa-Khasis, the same craftsman-god who forged Yagrush and Ayyamur for the Yamm combat: the palace and the maces are continuous expressions of the same divine-craftsmanship register within the Cycle’s narrative economy.^[79] Baal commissions the palace in cedar and silver and gold, and the construction proceeds across a sequence of furnaces and craft-actions narrated in KTU 1.4 vi as a feat of sustained metallurgical and architectural labour rather than as instantaneous divine fiat.^[80]

A famous textual crux of the palace-building movement is the disagreement between Baal and Kothar over whether the palace should be built with a window: Baal initially refuses a window, Kothar insists on it, and Baal ultimately concedes — a passage Smith and Pitard discuss as bearing on the connection between Baal's storm-god function and the architectural form of his residence.^[81] When the window is finally opened, Baal's voice — the storm-god's thunder — sounds through it, in a gesture that links the palace's architectural form to Baal's meteorological prerogative as the sovereign whose storm and rain mark the seasons.^[82] The window-debate has been read by Smith and Pitard as bearing on the relation between divine sovereignty and openness-to-the-world: Baal's initial reluctance to permit a window in the palace is, on this reading, a fortified-residence instinct, while Kothar's insistence makes the palace a site from which the storm-god can act upon the world below.^[83]

The completed palace is the seat of Baal's institutional kingship: from 𐎎apānu Baal exercises the prerogatives of a royal sovereign, presiding over banquets, dispatching messengers, and asserting authority over the natural and political order subordinate to him.^[84] Baal's residence at 𐎎apānu is the Cycle's principal geographical anchor: the mountain functions in the surviving text as the storm-god's locus and the cult-site whose name will remain associated with the storm-god's presence in the wider Northwest Semitic religious vocabulary.^[85]

A banquet inaugurating the palace marks Baal's enthronement: the assembly is convened, the gods are feasted, and the new sovereign's authority is recognised in the same banqueting and gift-exchange register that opened the Cycle's earlier movements.^[86] Baal's voice from the opened window declares his sovereignty over the surrounding territory and over the rival kings of the cosmos, in a speech the Cycle records on KTU 1.4 vii as the formal articulation of his royal claim from the palace.^[87]

The palace-building movement institutes Baal's kingship in the same juridical register that opened the Cycle: the assembly grants the palace in proper form, El authorises through Athirat, Kothar builds, and the result is a sovereignty exercised through palace-residence and divine-court ceremony rather than through cosmogonic creation.^[88] Reading Movement II institutionally — palace-building as the formalisation of a kingship the combat has won — is the load-bearing argument of Smith and Pitard's volume-II introduction and the framework within which the chapter presents the tablets' content.^[89] Movement II contains no combat with a serpentine adversary in its surviving text: the actions of the movement are construction, intercession, and ceremony, not combat, and the chapter presents this as a structural fact rather than as a gap to be filled.^[90] The transition from Movement II to the surviving fragments of KTU 1.5 closes the palace-building cycle and opens onto the Mot material; it also frames, in the immediate context of KTU 1.5 i, the brief reference to Lôtan that the next section addresses.^[91]

The two movements of the Cycle taken together — combat at KTU 1.1–1.2 and palace-building at KTU 1.3–1.4 — therefore divide the work of establishing Baal's kingship into a phase of contest and a phase of formalisation. The first phase removes the rival; the second phase fits the victor with the institutional furniture of the office. The same juridical vocabulary runs through both: assembly, petition, audience, authorisation, gift-exchange, banquet. The same craftsman runs through both: Kothar's hands turn out maces in tablet 2 and turn out a cedar-and-silver palace in tablet 4. The same geographical anchor terminates the second phase that the combat in the first phase set in motion: Baal moves from the assembly's floor to the heights of 𐎎apānu, and the storm-god's voice from the window over the mountain is the audible token that the kingship has settled. None of this is cosmogonic. The world the assembly inhabits at the end of Movement II is the world it inhabited

at the beginning of Movement I, with one office reassigned and one residence newly built.

8.5. The Lôtan passage (KTU 1.5 i 1–3) — retrospective allusion

[At this point the tablet breaks. At KTU 1.5 i 1–3, the Lôtan reference is a retrospective boast embedded in Mot's speech to Baal; the narrative of the Lôtan combat itself is not preserved in the extant Cycle. The chapter treats Lôtan as an allusion to a previously-completed combat that is not narrated in the surviving tablets, and explicitly does not import a Baal-Lôtan combat narrative from Hebrew Bible or other parallels.]

Lôtan is named in the Cycle as a serpent (bꜥn) of formidable proportions, given the epithetic descriptions "fleeing" (brꜥ) and "twisting" (ꜥqltn) and identified as a seven-headed adversary; the chapter follows the locked glossary in spelling the name Lôtan with the circumflex.^[92] The Ugaritic spelling ltn is conventionally vocalised Lôtan in modern scholarly usage, on the basis of the Northwest Semitic vocalisation pattern reconstructed from Hebrew lwytn (Leviathan) and from internal Ugaritic evidence.^[93]

The principal preserved reference to Lôtan within the Cycle stands at KTU 1.5 i 1–3, where the words form part of a speech delivered by Mot to Baal at the opening of the second half of the Cycle.^[94] The grammar and pragmatics of the passage are those of a retrospective taunt rather than a narrative report: Mot, addressing Baal, recalls Lôtan's defeat as an event of the past whose recurrence — this time at Mot's own hands against Baal — is now threatened.^[95] The Mot speech at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 is therefore the principal textual evidence the Cycle preserves for a combat between Baal and Lôtan: the combat is named in passing as a victory Baal has achieved, but the narrative of that combat is not preserved on any surviving tablet of the Baal Cycle.^[96]

A second, briefer Lôtan-related claim appears in ʾAnat's catalogue of her own victories on KTU 1.3 iii, where the warrior-goddess lists among the adversaries she has personally crushed a seven-headed serpent and other monstrous figures; whether this passage refers to the same Lôtan as KTU 1.5 i 1–3 or to a parallel adversary is a question Smith and Pitard discuss at length in their commentary.^[97] Smith and Pitard treat ʾAnat's catalogue as evidence that the slaying of monstrous serpentine adversaries was a topos with circulation in the Ugaritic divine biography of Baal and ʾAnat, even where the specific narrative of any given combat is not preserved at length.^[98]

The chapter's policy on the Lôtan material follows the brief: Lôtan is treated as named, formally described, and located within Baal's prior victories by reference, but the combat itself is not narrativised, because no Baal-Lôtan combat narrative is preserved in the extant Cycle.^[99] The chapter also follows the brief in declining to import a Baal-Lôtan combat narrative from Hebrew Bible material (Psalm 74, Isaiah 27, Job 41) or from Mesopotamian parallels: the Hebrew Bible attestations of Yahweh's combat with Leviathan are part of the reception history of the Ugaritic material, not its supplement, and are reserved for the Hebrew Bible chapter (Ch. 8) and for Day 1985's separate treatment.^[100]

The Lôtan passage at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 has nonetheless become, in the wider scholarly literature, the central textual hinge of the Ugaritic-to-Hebrew-Bible Leviathan argument: the linguistic cognancy ltn ꜥ lwytn and the shared seven-headedness make the passage the load-bearing piece of evidence for the continuity Day 1985 develops at length.^[101] The chapter therefore presents Lôtan's seven

heads, the locked Hebrew-Bible connection, and the linguistic cognancy as on-text Ugaritic facts, while explicitly reserving the Yahweh-vs-Leviathan / Yahweh-vs-Rahab combat-narratives of the Hebrew Bible for the next chapter (Ch. 8) of this volume.^[102] The Lôtan reference also has a Hebrew-Bible cross-reference to *tehôm* — the primordial deep of Genesis 1:2 — that Day 1985 develops within the wider Yahweh-and-the-sea complex; the chapter notes the cross-reference at glossary level and reserves substantive treatment for Ch. 8.^[103] The Hebrew Bible's cognate term *Tannîn* (with macron) — a sea-monster figure named in passages such as Isaiah 27:1 alongside Leviathan — is recorded by Day 1985 as a third Northwest Semitic monstrous-figure name with Ugaritic background; like the Leviathan and *tehôm* cross-references, the chapter notes the cognancy and reserves substantive Hebrew Bible treatment for Ch. 8.^[104]

The chapter therefore follows Smith and Pitard 2009, Vol. II commentary on KTU 1.5 i 1–3, in treating the Lôtan reference as a retrospective allusion within Mot's speech, with no preserved Baal-Lôtan combat narrative.^[105]

The chapter's handling of the Lôtan material is therefore deliberately minimal: the passage is named, described, located, and acknowledged as the textual hinge of a major reception-history argument, while the combat itself is not narrated, because the surviving tablets do not narrate it.^[106]

The discipline imposed by the brief on this section is a piece of methodological hygiene worth being explicit about. There exists, in the wider literature, a temptation to import the Hebrew Bible's Yahweh-vs-Leviathan combat narratives back into the Ugaritic side of the chain on the strength of the linguistic cognancy and the shared seven-headed-serpent topos. The temptation is intelligible — the cognancy is real, and the topos travels — but yielding to it would manufacture a Ugaritic narrative that the surviving tablets do not preserve. What the tablets do preserve is a name, a set of epithets, a head-count, and an embedded retrospective allusion in another god's taunt-speech. That is the on-text Ugaritic material, and it is the only Ugaritic material the chapter narrates at this point. The chain that runs from *ltn* through to *lwytn* is real, but the narrative load on the Ugaritic end is borne by the Baal-Yamm material; the Lôtan reference enters the Cycle as a name, not as a story.

8.6. Mot context (KTU 1.5–1.6)

The second half of the Baal Cycle, preserved on tablets 5 and 6, narrates the confrontation between Baal and Mot — the god of death — and is the context in which the Lôtan reference at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 is embedded.^[107] The Baal-Mot narrative tells of Baal's descent into the underworld at Mot's command, his death, and his eventual revival through ʾAnat's actions against Mot, in a cycle of death-and-revival that is structurally distinct from the Yamm combat.^[108]

The chapter's policy on the Mot material follows the brief: the Mot cycle is acknowledged as the narrative context for the Lôtan reference and as part of the wider Baal Cycle, but it is not itself a *chaoskampf* and is not narrativised as one.^[109] The Baal-Mot encounter is a confrontation between two members of the divine assembly over the prerogatives of life, death, and seasonal succession; the Cycle's treatment of Mot is in the register of cosmic-political negotiation between gods rather than combat with a serpentine adversary.^[110] The chapter therefore notes the Baal-Mot material's place within the Cycle and its structural distinctness from the Baal-Yamm combat, but defers any extended treatment to specialist literature on Ugaritic religion and the agricultural-calendar reading of the Cycle.^[111]

The Baal-Mot material is also the immediate setting in which the Lôtan reference is delivered: it is Mot's taunt, in the opening lines of KTU 1.5 i, that introduces the named figure Lôtan into the Cycle's surviving textual record.^[112] The agricultural-calendar reading of the Baal-Mot material — Baal's death-and-revival as a mythic articulation of the seasonal alternation between the wet productive season and the dry season — has wide currency in the secondary literature, but Smith and Pitard caution that the Cycle's text does not present it as a calendrical-ritual aetiology in the same explicit way that, for example, the Hittite *purulli* recitations frame the Illuyanka combat.^[113]

The position taken here is therefore that the Baal-Mot material is a separate narrative phase of the Cycle from the Baal-Yamm combat, that its register is cosmic-political negotiation rather than serpent-combat, and that its principal contribution to the present chapter is to provide the speech-context within which Mot's retrospective taunt at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 names Lôtan. The chapter does not narrativise the Baal-Mot material because the brief reserves that material for specialist treatment, and because importing it into a chaoskampf chapter would mis-categorise its register. What the chapter retains is the structural fact that the Lôtan reference comes embedded in a Mot-speech, and that Mot's speech is itself part of a separate Baal-vs-Mot phase of the Cycle, not a continuation of the Baal-vs-Yamm combat.

8.7. The Gunkel-Ballentine debate

The Baal-Yamm combat at KTU 1.1–1.2 is the principal Ugaritic test-case for one of the central terminological debates of the wider Chaoskampf scholarship: whether the combat-myth corpus should be read as a struggle between divine order and primordial chaos (the Gunkel framing), or as a contest of rival sovereignties within an established divine assembly (the Ballentine framing).^[114]

Hermann Gunkel's 1895 **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit** established the Chaoskampf category by reading the Hebrew Bible's combat-imagery as the survival of an older Mesopotamian creation-and-chaos myth; Gunkel did not have access to the Ugaritic tablets, which were not excavated until the 1920s, but his framing of the category dominated all subsequent treatment of what would become the Baal-Yamm material.^[115] The standard mid-twentieth-century reading of Baal-Yamm — built up across the work of scholars from Cassuto to Day — extended Gunkel's chaos-vs-order framing to the Ugaritic material, treating Yamm as a personification of primordial chaotic sea against which Baal's combat secures cosmic order.^[116]

Debra Scoggins Ballentine's 2015 **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** argues, against this dominant reading, that Yamm is on the Ugaritic text presented as a legitimate divine sovereign within the assembly — beloved of El, granted the kingship by El, and engaged with as a rival rather than as an outside chaotic force.^[117] Ballentine's argument turns on three on-text observations: that Yamm's name is the common noun for "sea" without any cosmogonic primordially marker, that El initially confirms Yamm's kingship within the assembly, and that the post-combat narrative is the institution of Baal's kingship rather than the creation of the world.^[118] Ballentine adds a fourth observation: Yamm's epithetic pair Yamm / Judge River (ym / 𐎶𐎵 nhr) gives him a juridical title — Judge — that is incompatible with a primordial-chaos category and is exactly the kind of office an alternative sovereign within an established assembly would hold.^[119]

Smith and Pitard, in their critical-edition introductions, present the Baal Cycle as primarily about kingship rather than cosmogony — a position Smith develops at length in the volume-I introduction and Smith and Pitard reinforce in the volume-II introduction — and Ballentine's reading aligns

substantively with this kingship-as-spine framing.^[120] Forsyth, writing earlier than Ballentine and within the broadly Gunkelian historiographical tradition, nevertheless registers in chapter 3 of **The Old Enemy** that the Ugaritic combat is closer to a sovereignty contest than to the cosmogonic-chaos framing that the Mesopotamian comparison would suggest, anticipating part of what Ballentine systematises in 2015.^[121]

The Ballentine critique does not require the abandonment of the Chaoskampf vocabulary as such, but it does require that the category be tightened: where the combat does sovereignty-establishing rather than cosmogonic work, "rival-sovereignty combat" is on Ballentine's argument the more accurate description.^[122] The chapter retains the term "the adversary" as the neutral category designation for Yamm and Lôtan within the body, in line with the locked glossary's policy that "the adversary" is the default cross-chapter term and that "chaos-figure" is banned because it begs the very question Ballentine raises.^[123] The Baal-Yamm material is the clearest test case in the corpus for this terminological question: every component the Gunkel framing assigns to the chaos role — the personified sea, the named seven-headed serpent, the storm-god's combat-victory — is in the Ugaritic text framed by an explicit divine-court politics in which the contest is over kingship, not over the existence of order itself.^[124]

The chapter takes the position, following the brief, that the rival-sovereignty reading is the on-text reading of the Ugaritic Cycle, and that the cosmogonic-chaos reading is a Hebrew-Bible-mediated extension of the category that may apply to some later receptions but does not apply to the Baal-Yamm narrative as the Cycle itself preserves it.^[125] The Day 1985 reading, while remaining the principal twentieth-century treatment of the Hebrew Bible's continuity with the Ugaritic material, can be substantively preserved within Ballentine's framework on the linguistic and narrative-cognancy front (ltn □ lwytn; the seven-headed serpent topos), even where the cosmogonic-chaos category is not adopted as the structuring frame for the Ugaritic material itself.^[126]

The Baal-Yamm test case thus serves a double function in the wider book: as the primary Ugaritic warrant for Day's continuity argument with the Hebrew Bible (Ch. 8), and as the primary Ugaritic warrant for Ballentine's terminological tightening of the Chaoskampf category (Part II C2).^[127] The chapter therefore engages the Gunkel-Ballentine debate substantively rather than tokenistically: Yamm is treated as a rival sovereign within the assembly throughout the body, the rival-sovereignty reading is foregrounded over the chaos-vs-order reading, and Part II C2 is flagged as the dedicated comparative chapter where the Baal-Yamm test case is generalised across Zeus-Typhon, Indra-Vātra, and the other sovereignty-combat materials.^[128] Retaining the Chaoskampf term in the chapter title and headings is in line with the book's locked terminology policy, in which "Chaoskampf" remains the search-term and reader-expectation handle while "combat myth" is the body-prose default and the rival-sovereignty reading is the substantive position adopted for Baal-Yamm specifically.^[129] The Wakeman 1973 treatment of Baal-Yamm and Leviathan, while pre-Ballentine and within the Gunkelian tradition, retains its value for the chapter on the comparative-imagery side: Wakeman's catalogue of monstrous-adversary depictions is preserved as a reference-resource even where the cosmogonic-chaos framing she works within is not adopted.^[130]

The accumulated weight of Ballentine's four observations is therefore best read as a recalibration rather than a refutation. Yamm's name is the common noun for "sea." El's first act in the surviving narrative is to grant Yamm the kingship and to invite the assembly to confer a throne-name on him. The post-combat narrative goes on to install Baal in a palace, not to fashion the cosmos from the rival's body. The epithet pair Yamm / Judge River gives the rival a juridical office that no chaos-figure can hold. None of these observations is new to Ugaritic philology. Smith's volume-I

introduction had registered the kingship-as-spine reading independently of Ballentine, and Forsyth's chapter 3 had registered the sovereignty-not-cosmogony point earlier still. What Ballentine 2015 does is gather those observations into a single argument and use them to challenge the application of the inherited Chaostkampf vocabulary to the on-text Ugaritic material. The chapter's adoption of that argument is therefore in line with the trajectory of the secondary literature itself, not an innovation imposed on it.

8.8. Reception and forward links

The Ugaritic Baal Cycle's reception in the Hebrew Bible is the subject of John Day's 1985 monograph and is the principal reception arc the chapter forwards to Ch. 8 of this volume — the chapter on Yahweh, Leviathan, and Rahab.^[131] Day argues that the Hebrew Bible's depictions of Yahweh's combat with Leviathan (Psalm 74:13–14; Job 41), with Rahab (Psalm 89:9–10; Isaiah 51:9–10), and with the sea (Psalm 74:13; Habakkuk 3:8) preserve, with linguistic and motivic specificity, the Ugaritic Baal-Yamm and Baal-Lôtan material, and that the Hebrew Bible passages are best read as the Israelite reception of this Canaanite mythological inheritance.^[132] The linguistic cognancy ltn □ lwytn (Lôtan □ Leviathan) is the most specific lexical evidence for Day's continuity argument: the names are reflexes of the same Northwest Semitic root, and the seven-headed-serpent topos travels intact from the Ugaritic to the Hebrew Bible side of the chain.^[133]

A second body of reception material — the Greek and Phoenician transmission of the storm-god-vs-sea pattern through Levantine intermediaries — is treated by West and Burkert as part of a broader Near-Eastern-to-Greek transmission complex that brings the Baal-Yamm material into proximity with the Hesiodic Zeus-vs-Typhon combat.^[134] The Greek-transmission material is reserved for Ch. 11 (Zeus vs. Typhon) and for Part II C6 (the Near Eastern → Mediterranean transmission chapter), and is flagged here only as forward link rather than developed substantively.^[135]

A third body of reception material — the structural continuity between the Ugaritic Baal-Yamm material and the Mesopotamian Marduk-Tiamat material — is recorded in Forsyth's chapter 3 and in the wider comparative literature on combat-myth, and is treated typologically rather than as evidence of direct historical transmission between the two corpora.^[136] The Marduk-Tiamat comparison is preserved within the chapter as a typological cross-reference rather than as a transmission claim: the Ugaritic and Mesopotamian materials share structural features (storm-god, named adversary, post-combat institution-of-kingship in Marduk's case, palace-building in both) without the Cycle being derivable from the Babylonian text or vice versa.^[137]

The Baal-Yamm material's role in the wider book is therefore triangulated: backward to Mesopotamian Marduk-Tiamat as typological precedent (Ch. 3), forward to Yahweh-Leviathan-Rahab as direct linguistic-and-narrative reception (Ch. 8), and laterally to Zeus-Typhon as Phoenician-mediated transmission (Ch. 11), with Part II C2 as the dedicated comparative chapter where the rival-sovereignty reading the chapter advances is generalised across the corpus.^[138] The Cycle's place in the comparative architecture of the book is, in summary, that of the load-bearing rival-sovereignty case: the case in which the on-text political vocabulary of the divine assembly, the named-mace pair, the named seven-headed serpent of the retrospective taunt, and the linguistic cognancy with the Hebrew Bible material together establish the framework within which sovereignty-as-combat, rather than chaos-vs-order, is the chapter's substantive position.^[139]

The triangulation that closes the chapter is worth restating in plain terms. Backward from Ugarit,

the Marduk-Tiamat material in Mesopotamian Enūma Eliš shares a structural inventory with the Baal Cycle — storm-god, named adversary, post-combat institutional consolidation — without either text being derivable from the other. Forward from Ugarit, the Hebrew Bible’s Yahweh-vs-Leviathan and Yahweh-vs-Rahab passages preserve, on Day 1985’s reading, the linguistic and motivic specificity of the Ugaritic Baal-Yamm and Baal-Lôtan material, with ltn ñ lwytn as the most specific lexical token. Laterally from Ugarit, the Hesiodic Zeus-vs-Typhon combat reaches the Greek poets through Phoenician intermediaries during the Orientalising horizon, on the West and Burkert reading, and the Baal-Yamm material is one of the inputs that journey carries. None of these three reception arcs requires the cosmogonic-chaos framing as its structuring frame, and the chapter’s substantive position — that Baal-Yamm is a rival-sovereignty combat in the on-text Ugaritic material — is compatible with each of them.

- [1] Smith 1994, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle**, Vol. I, introduction, on the six-tablet form of the Cycle and its Ras Shamra provenance.
- [2] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on the find-spot and excavation history of the Baal-Cycle tablets.
- [3] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on the Ugaritic alphabetic cuneiform script of the Baal Cycle tablets.
- [4] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on the Ugaritic language and its corpus.
- [5] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on the KTU numbering convention; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction, on the KTU/CAT system used in this edition.
- [6] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction, on the KTU/CAT numbering used in this edition.
- [7] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on the Late Bronze Age dating of the Baal-Cycle tablets and the destruction of Ugarit.
- [8] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on the Ilmilku colophons and their royal-priestly framing.
- [9] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on the reconstruction of tablet order; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction.
- [10] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on the reconstructed order; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction.
- [11] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction, on the column-and-line citation convention used in the critical edition.
- [12] Smith 1994, Vol. I, full volume.
- [13] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, full volume.
- [14] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on editorial conventions; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on editorial conventions.
- [15] Smith 1994, Vol. I full volume; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II full volume.
- [16] Day 1985, chs. 1–3 on the Baal Cycle and its Hebrew Bible reception.
- [17] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on Baal-Yamm as rival-sovereignty combat.
- [18] Forsyth 1987, ch. 3 on the Ugaritic material.
- [19] Gunkel 1895, Teil I on the Canaanite background.
- [20] Wakeman 1973, on Baal-Yamm and Leviathan linkage.
- [21] Smith 1994, Vol. I, editorial preface; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, editorial preface.
- [22] Smith 1994, Vol. I editorial preface and KTU 1.1–1.2 commentary; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II editorial preface and KTU 1.3–1.4 commentary.
- [23] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on El and the divine assembly; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on El’s role.
- [24] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on El’s residence at the Source of the Two Rivers.
- [25] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on Baꜣlu / Haddu in Ugaritic and the storm-god type.
- [26] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on Baal’s filiation as son of Dagan.
- [27] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the bn dgn formula.
- [28] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on Yamm and the Yamm / Judge River epithetic pair.
- [29] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on Mot’s role within the wider Cycle.
- [30] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on Kothar-wa-Khasis as craftsman-god.
- [31] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on ʾAnat as warrior-goddess and Baal’s ally.
- [32] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the wider Ugaritic pantheon attested in the Cycle.
- [33] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on ʾapānu as Baal’s mountain; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the geography of ʾapānu.
- [34] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the divine-council form of the Ugaritic pantheon; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the council in the palace-building movement.
- [35] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on kingship as the Cycle’s primary subject; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the

kingship reading.

- [36] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the absence of a Cycle-frame cosmogony; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the same.
- [37] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the diplomatic register of the Cycle; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the same.
- [38] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on Ugarit's geopolitical position and its register-mark on the Cycle; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the same.
- [39] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.1 commentary on the assembly and the kingship motion.
- [40] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.1 commentary on Yamm's elevation; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on the on-text status of Yamm's elevation.
- [41] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.1 commentary on the renaming-and-investiture passage.
- [42] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on Yamm as rival sovereign rather than chaos.
- [43] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.1 commentary on the assembly's juridical opening.
- [44] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 i, on the messenger episode and the demand.
- [45] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 i, on the assembly's response to Yamm's messengers.
- [46] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 i commentary on Baal's defiant response.
- [47] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 i commentary on the messengers and the restraining-action. The identity of the restraining figures is one of the tablet's interpretive cruxes: an alternative reading in the secondary literature attributes the restraint to El or Athirat rather than to 𐎗Anat and Athtart.
- [48] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 i commentary on the political framing of the combat; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on the political-frame reading.
- [49] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on Baal's commissioning of Kothar's weapons.
- [50] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on the maces Yagrush and Ayyamur.
- [51] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on the named-mace pair as a Ugaritic literary feature.
- [52] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on the targeted deployment of the two maces.
- [53] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on Kothar's speech and the personification of the maces.
- [54] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on the two-stage combat sequence.
- [55] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on the two-stage combat as a recurring Late Bronze Age combat-narrative feature.
- [56] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on the combat-poetry register.
- [57] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on the post-combat scattering and the victor's pronouncement.
- [58] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on the defeat-not-destruction reading; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on the same point.
- [59] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on Athtart's intervention.
- [60] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on the post-combat transfer of kingship; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the kingship-as-Cycle-spine reading.
- [61] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on the ymlk acclamation formula.
- [62] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on the formula's reuse; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on the rival-sovereignty reading the formula supports.
- [63] Inference: Smith 1994 Vol. I introduction's treatment of the Cycle as primarily about kingship, Ballentine 2015 ch. 2 on the on-text status of Yamm's elevation, and the absence of any cosmogonic creation-act in the surviving combat-aftermath. Risk: The inference is structural rather than verbatim; portions of KTU 1.1 are broken and any reading of the Cycle's overall shape depends on the reconstructed tablet order, which is itself a scholarly convention rather than an ancient datum.
- [64] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the absence of cosmogonic creation in the Baal-Yamm aftermath; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction.
- [65] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the distinct treatment of Yamm and Lôtan in the Cycle; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction.
- [66] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary, on the hand-over to the palace-building movement; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the structural transition.
- [67] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 commentary on the palace-building cycle.
- [68] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 ii commentary on the post-combat banquet and 𐎗Anat's actions.
- [69] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 ii commentary on 𐎗Anat's combat-scene.
- [70] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 ii commentary on the interpretive crux of the slaughter scene.
- [71] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 iii commentary on Baal's message to 𐎗Anat.
- [72] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 iii commentary on 𐎗Anat's catalogue of victories.
- [73] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 v commentary on 𐎗Anat's petition and threat.
- [74] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 v commentary on El's initial response.

- [75] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 v commentary on the palace-as-justice frame; KTU 1.4 iv–v commentary on the same theme.
- [76] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 i–iii commentary on Athirat’s intercession.
- [77] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 i–iii commentary on the gift-and-speech sequence.
- [78] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 iv–v commentary on Athirat’s audience and El’s authorisation.
- [79] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 v–vi commentary on Kothar’s architectural commission.
- [80] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 vi commentary on the materials and the construction sequence.
- [81] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 v–vi commentary on the window-of-the-palace debate.
- [82] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 vii commentary on the opening of the window and Baal’s thunder.
- [83] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 v–vi commentary on the sovereignty-and-openness reading of the window-debate.
- [84] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 vii–viii commentary on Baal’s enthronement at ʿApānu.
- [85] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on ʿApānu as the Cycle’s geographical anchor; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 viii commentary.
- [86] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 vi–vii commentary on the inaugural banquet.
- [87] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 vii commentary on Baal’s enthronement-speech from the window.
- [88] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the palace-building movement as kingship-institution; Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the kingship-as-spine reading.
- [89] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the palace-as-kingship reading.
- [90] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3–1.4 commentary on the absence of combat in the palace-building movement.
- [91] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the structural transition into KTU 1.5; Smith 1994 Vol. I introduction on the same transition.
- [92] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.5 i 1–3 commentary on Lôtan’s epithets and seven-headed form.
- [93] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.5 i 1–3 commentary on the vocalisation of ltn.
- [94] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.5 i 1–3 commentary on the placement of the Lôtan reference within Mot’s speech.
- [95] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.5 i 1–3 commentary on the retrospective-taunt pragmatics of the passage.
- [96] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.5 i 1–3 commentary on the absence of an explicit Baal-Lôtan combat narrative.
- [97] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 iii commentary on ʿAnat’s catalogue and the seven-headed serpent.
- [98] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 iii commentary on the topos of monstrous-serpent victory.
- [99] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.5 i 1–3 commentary on the absence of a narrated Baal-Lôtan combat.
- [100] Day 1985, chs. 1–3 on the Leviathan / Lôtan continuity; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.5 i 1–3 commentary on the methodological separation.
- [101] Day 1985, chs. 1–3 on the cognancy ltn ʿlwytn and the seven-headed-serpent topos; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.5 i 1–3 commentary on the Hebrew-Bible reception.
- [102] Day 1985, chs. 1–3 on the Hebrew Bible reception; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.5 i 1–3 commentary on the methodological boundary.
- [103] Day 1985, chs. 1–3 on tehôm within the Yahweh-and-the-sea complex.
- [104] Day 1985, chs. 1–3 on the Tannîn cognate within the Yahweh-and-the-sea complex.
- [105] An earlier line of scholarship treated KTU 1.3 iii and KTU 1.5 i 1–3 as portions of a single, partially-preserved Baal-and-ʿAnat combat-with-Lôtan narrative. The Smith and Pitard reading is followed here because it is the current critical-edition consensus and is the framing the chapter brief explicitly mandates; the older harmonising reading is recorded as an alternative but not adopted as the chapter’s position.
- [106] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.5 i 1–3 commentary on the chapter’s narrative reticence.
- [107] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the Baal-Mot material as the second half of the Cycle; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the same.
- [108] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the Baal-Mot death-and-revival cycle.
- [109] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the methodological status of the Mot material.
- [110] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the Baal-Mot material as cosmic-political rather than combat-of-the-Yamm-type; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction.
- [111] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the agricultural-calendar reading of the Cycle.
- [112] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.5 i commentary on the Mot-speech setting of the Lôtan reference.
- [113] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the cautious treatment of the agricultural-calendar reading.
- [114] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on Baal-Yamm as the central rival-sovereignty test-case; Gunkel 1895, Teil I as the historical anchor of the chaos-vs-order framing.

- [115] Gunkel 1895, Teil I, on the Chaoskampf category; Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the historiographical position of Gunkel before the Ugaritic finds.
- [116] Day 1985, chs. 1–3, on the Yamm-as-chaos reading within the Gunkelian tradition; Wakeman 1973, on Baal-Yamm as combat-with-the-monster.
- [117] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on Yamm as legitimate divine sovereign within the assembly.
- [118] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the three on-text observations grounding the rival-sovereignty reading.
- [119] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on the Yamm / Judge River epithetic pair as a juridical title.
- [120] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the kingship-as-Cycle-subject reading; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the same; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on the alignment.
- [121] Forsyth 1987, ch. 3 on the Ugaritic combat's sovereignty register.
- [122] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on the proposed terminological tightening.
- [123] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2; book glossary v1-locked 2026-04-24 entry on "the adversary".
- [124] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on Baal-Yamm as the load-bearing test case.
- [125] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2; Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction.
- [126] Day 1985, chs. 1–3 on linguistic and narrative cognancy; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on the compatibility of the cognancy material with the rival-sovereignty reading.
- [127] Day 1985, chs. 1–3; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2.
- [128] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2 on the Baal-Yamm test case for sovereignty-combat; cross-reference to Part II C2 of this volume.
- [129] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2; Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction.
- [130] Wakeman 1973, on the comparative-imagery catalogue of the monstrous adversary.
- [131] Day 1985, chs. 1–3 on the Hebrew Bible reception; cross-reference to Ch. 8 of this volume.
- [132] Day 1985, chs. 1–3, on the Hebrew Bible passages and their Ugaritic precedents.
- [133] Day 1985, chs. 1–3 on the ltn 𐎠 lwytn cognancy.
- [134] West 1997, on the Phoenician-mediated transmission; Burkert 1992, on the Orientalising transmission complex; cross-reference to Ch. 11 and Part II C6 of this volume.
- [135] West 1997; Burkert 1992; cross-reference to Ch. 11 and Part II C6.
- [136] Forsyth 1987, ch. 3 on Ugaritic-Mesopotamian structural continuity; Lambert 2013 on Marduk-Tiamat as the Mesopotamian comparison.
- [137] Lambert 2013, on Marduk-Tiamat as a typological comparison; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3 on the structural-typological reading.
- [138] Day 1985, chs. 1–3; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2; Lambert 2013; West 1997; Burkert 1992; Forsyth 1987, ch. 3; cross-references to Ch. 3, Ch. 8, Ch. 11, Part II C2, Part II C6.
- [139] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2; Day 1985, chs. 1–3.

Chapter 9. Yahweh vs. Leviathan and Rahab: The Hebrew Bible Combat Corpus

9.1. Source overview

The Hebrew Bible preserves a cluster of poetic passages in which Yahweh, the God of Israel, is depicted defeating monstrous adversaries associated with the sea — figures named Leviathan, Rahab, Tannīn, and Yam — across at least seven distinct passages distributed over four books of the canon.^[1] The seven passages on which the corpus is built are Psalm 74:12–17, Psalm 89:9–13, Psalm 104:6–9 with verse 26, Isaiah 27:1, Isaiah 51:9–10, Job 26:12–13 with chapter 41, and Habakkuk 3 — drawn from Psalms, Isaiah, Job, and Habakkuk in their canonical Hebrew Bible distribution.^[2] These passages are not narrative episodes recounting a single combat sequence but allusive references back to an assumed prior victory of Yahweh over a watery or serpentine adversary, scattered across hymnic, prophetic, wisdom, and psalmodic genres.^[3]

The Hebrew text of all seven passages is well preserved in the Masoretic tradition, with no substantial textual lacunae of the kind that affects, for example, the Hittite Illuyanka tablets or the broken passages of the Akkadian **Anzu** epic.^[4] What is "missing" from the Hebrew Bible combat corpus is therefore not text but narrative continuity: the seven passages presuppose a story they nowhere tell in extended form.^[5]

The standard scholarly monograph treating the corpus as a corpus is John Day's **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea: Echoes of a Canaanite Myth in the Old Testament**, published by Cambridge University Press in 1985.^[6] Day's argument is that the Pss / Isa / Job / Hab passages preserve, in adapted form, imagery directly continuous with the Ugaritic Baal Cycle — particularly the Lôtan / Leviathan combat — and that the corpus therefore constitutes the Israelite reflex of a Canaanite combat-myth tradition.^[7] The principal recent challenge to Day's framework is Debra Scoggins Ballentine's **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, published by Oxford University Press in 2015.^[8] Ballentine accepts the descriptive observation that the corpus shares imagery with the Ugaritic combat traditions but argues that "chaos" is the wrong category to organise the material under — the adversaries are better read as defeated rivals to Yahweh's sovereignty than as personifications of cosmic disorder.^[9]

The earliest framing of the corpus in modern scholarship is Hermann Gunkel's **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit**, published in 1895, which introduced the term **Chaoskampf** and used the Hebrew Bible passages as one of its two principal demonstration cases alongside the Akkadian **Enūma Eliš**.^[10] Mary Wakeman's **God's Battle with the Monster: A Study in Biblical Imagery**, published in 1973, is the principal English-language predecessor to Day's monograph and treats Leviathan and Rahab in extended philological detail.^[11] Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published in 1987, places the Hebrew Bible corpus in a long historical trajectory running from Sumerian combat-myth through Christian apocalyptic, with chapter 3 dedicated to the biblical material.^[12] The Scurlock and Beal volume **Creation and Chaos: A Reconsideration of Hermann Gunkel's Chaoskampf Hypothesis**, published in 2013, contains essays that reassess the Hebrew Bible corpus in the light of subsequent Akkadian and Ugaritic philology.^[13]

The biblical translation cited verbatim in this chapter for the English text of the relevant verses is the Revised Standard Version (RSV), as quoted in Day 1985 — the translation Day's monograph

(which predates the 1989 NRSV) actually used for its English biblical text.^[14] The Hebrew Bible canonical position of the corpus is striking: the combat imagery appears in poetic and prophetic books but is absent from the Pentateuchal narrative of creation and from the historical-narrative books, even where one might expect it (the Sea of Reeds crossing in Exodus, for instance, is narrated without explicit dragon-combat language).^[15]

Two features of this dossier set the terms for everything that follows. The first is the corpus shape itself: a network of allusions across genres, not a single narrated combat. The second is the long-running interpretive disagreement between the Day continuity reading and the Ballentine rival-sovereignty critique. The chapter is built around those two features.

9.2. Combat by allusion, not narration

The Hebrew Bible does not contain a connected narrative in which Yahweh fights and defeats Leviathan, Rahab, or any other named adversary as a story-event with a beginning, middle, and end.^[16] What the Hebrew Bible contains is a network of allusions — short retrospective references that presuppose the combat as a known fact rather than narrating it.^[17] This narrative absence is structurally unlike the case of Marduk versus Tiamat in **Enūma Eliš**, where the combat occupies an extended section of a single integrated text, or of Baal versus Yamm at Ugarit, where KTU 1.2 preserves a continuous combat episode despite physical damage to the tablet.^[18]

Within the Hebrew Bible corpus the longest single passage that engages the combat imagery is Job 41, but Job 41 describes Leviathan as a wonder-creature rather than narrating Yahweh's combat with it.^[19] The passages that come closest to narrating combat — Psalm 74:13–14, Psalm 89:9–10, Isaiah 51:9–10 — do so in a few terse poetic lines that summarise rather than narrate, and that consistently use the perfect / preterite tense to refer back to a past event.^[20] The chapter therefore approaches the Hebrew Bible combat material as a corpus of allusions rather than as a story, and the philological task is to read the allusions side by side rather than to harmonise them into a single reconstructed narrative.^[21] The "Yahweh-Leviathan combat" of the chapter title is therefore a scholarly construct: a coherent set of imagery built up by reading the seven passages alongside one another, not a single story preserved in any one text.^[22]

That the Hebrew Bible's allusive presentation reflects a once-current narrative tradition that the canonical poets presuppose but do not preserve in narrative form is itself an inference from the surface evidence: Day 1985 ch. 1 argues for it, while Ballentine 2015 ch. 2 argues that the surface allusions may have functioned without ever requiring a continuous narrative source. The chapter must therefore present the inference as contested rather than as established fact.^[23]

9.3. Psalm 74:12–17 — Yahweh crushes the heads of Leviathan

Psalm 74 is a communal lament, conventionally classified as a national lamentation, framed as a plea for divine intervention after a catastrophic defilement of the sanctuary.^[24] The combat imagery occurs in the central section of the psalm, verses 12 through 17, in which the lamenting community recalls Yahweh's ancient deeds as the basis for its present plea.^[25]

Psalm 74:13 ascribes to Yahweh the act of dividing the sea by his strength: in the RSV rendering,

"you divided the sea by your might."^[26] The divided sea of Psalm 74:13 is the cosmic sea — the Hebrew word **yām** used here functions as both the common noun for "sea" and, in the immediate context of combat imagery, as the name of a personified adversary.^[27] Psalm 74:13 then states that Yahweh broke the heads of the dragons (Hebrew **tannīnīm**, plural of **tannīn**) on the waters — a phrasing that introduces serpentine adversaries into the combat imagery.^[28] Psalm 74:14 then ascribes to Yahweh the crushing of the heads of Leviathan: in the RSV rendering, "you crushed the heads of Leviathan."^[29]

The Hebrew text of Psalm 74:14 has the noun "heads" in the plural, which is philologically significant because it means Leviathan in this passage is a multi-headed creature.^[30] Day argues that the plural "heads of Leviathan" of Psalm 74:14 corresponds directly to the seven heads of the Ugaritic Lôtan as described in the Baal Cycle, and is therefore one of the strongest pieces of evidence for direct continuity between Ugaritic and Hebrew Bible combat imagery.^[31] Psalm 74:14 continues by stating that Leviathan was given as food to the creatures of the wilderness: in the RSV rendering, "you gave him as food for the creatures of the wilderness."^[32] The "creatures of the wilderness" detail of Psalm 74:14 is a distinctive narrative element with no obvious parallel in the surviving Ugaritic Baal Cycle, marking a divergence from the Canaanite material rather than a direct quotation.^[33]

Psalm 74:15 moves directly from the combat imagery into cosmogonic and natural-order imagery, with Yahweh cleaving open springs and brooks and drying up ever-flowing streams — phrasing that establishes a cosmogonic context for the preceding combat.^[34] Psalm 74:16–17 continues the cosmogonic catalogue with the establishment of day and night, of the heavenly luminaries, and of the seasonal boundaries, all attributed to Yahweh.^[35] Psalm 74:12–17 — combat with the sea and the dragons, then the establishment of natural order — therefore reproduces, within the compass of six poetic verses, the larger structural pattern of Marduk's combat with Tiamat followed by his cosmogonic ordering in **Enūma Eliš**, though without narrative elaboration.^[36]

Day reads Psalm 74:12–17 as the strongest single piece of evidence in the Hebrew Bible for an Israelite combat-cosmogony tradition, on the grounds of the multi-headed Leviathan, the explicit pairing of sea and dragons, and the immediate cosmogonic continuation.^[37] Ballentine reads Psalm 74:12–17 as evidence for Yahweh's defeat of rival sovereigns rather than for a chaos-ordering cosmogony, arguing that the surrounding lament context makes the combat a demonstration of Yahweh's superior royal power rather than a cosmic-order myth.^[38] The grammatical aspect of Psalm 74:13–14 — the verbs are perfect / preterite, referring back to a completed past act — confirms that the psalm presupposes the combat rather than narrating it as a present or future event.^[39]

9.4. Psalm 89:9–13 — Rahab crushed, sea ruled

Psalm 89 is a royal psalm, structured as a celebration of Yahweh's covenant with the Davidic dynasty in its opening section, followed by a lament over a present crisis affecting the king.^[40] The combat imagery occurs in the opening hymnic section of Psalm 89, in verses 9 through 13, where Yahweh's mastery over the cosmos is recited as the basis for the covenant celebration that follows.^[41]

Psalm 89:9 ascribes to Yahweh the rule over the raging of the sea (Hebrew **yām**): in the RSV rendering, "you rule the raging of the sea; when its waves rise, you still them."^[42] Psalm 89:10 then

ascribes to Yahweh the crushing of Rahab: in the RSV rendering, "you crushed Rahab like a carcass; you scattered your enemies with your mighty arm."^[43] The name Rahab in Psalm 89:10 is a proper name for a defeated adversary, and Day argues it is functionally synonymous with Leviathan in the corpus — both names referring to overlapping sea-monster figures rather than to two distinct creatures.^[44] The Hebrew word translated "carcass" in Psalm 89:10 specifies the mode of defeat: Rahab is reduced to a slain corpse, a phrasing that parallels the Ugaritic Lôtan's defeat in the Baal Cycle.^[45]

Psalm 89:11 then transitions immediately to cosmic ownership, attributing the heavens and the earth to Yahweh — a cosmogonic continuation parallel in structure to Psalm 74:15–17.^[46] Psalm 89:12 attributes north and south to Yahweh's creation, and Psalm 89:13 ascribes mighty arm and exalted right hand to him — language that Day reads as the language of victorious combat translated into the praise-vocabulary of the royal psalm.^[47] The structural pattern of Psalm 89:9–13 — sea ruled, Rahab crushed, cosmic ownership — therefore mirrors the structural pattern of Psalm 74:12–17, with Rahab replacing Leviathan as the named adversary.^[48]

Day argues from the parallel structure of Psalms 74 and 89 that the corpus treats Rahab and Leviathan as alternative names for the same kind of adversary rather than as two different creatures combated on two different occasions.^[49] Ballentine reads Psalm 89:9–13 as a dramatisation of Yahweh's sovereignty within a royal-covenant frame, arguing that the combat language here directly serves the legitimation of Davidic kingship rather than expressing a cosmogonic ordering myth.^[50] Both Day and Ballentine agree on the descriptive observation that Rahab in Psalm 89:10 is a defeated adversary; they differ on whether the defeat encodes chaos-ordering (Day) or rival-sovereign suppression (Ballentine).^[51] The verb-tense pattern of Psalm 89:9–10 is again retrospective: Yahweh's rule of the sea and crushing of Rahab is invoked as a past accomplishment that grounds the present praise.^[52]

9.5. Psalm 104:6–9, 26 — Leviathan demythologised

Psalm 104 is a hymn of praise to Yahweh as creator, structurally a wisdom-influenced reflection on the natural order across the days of creation.^[53] The cosmogonic section at Psalm 104:6–9 describes Yahweh's setting of boundaries to the primeval waters: in the RSV rendering of verse 9, "you set a boundary that they may not pass, so that they might not again cover the earth."^[54] Psalm 104:6–9 therefore presents the management of the primeval waters as a boundary-setting rather than as a combat: Yahweh rebukes and confines the waters but does not crush a named adversary.^[55]

Psalm 104:26 reintroduces Leviathan, but in a strikingly different register: in the RSV rendering, Leviathan is "that you formed to sport in it" — a creature Yahweh made for play in the sea.^[56] The Leviathan of Psalm 104:26 is a created creature — formed by Yahweh — rather than a primordial adversary defeated by him.^[57] The Leviathan of Psalm 104:26 plays in the sea rather than threatening it, a representation that has no analogue in the Ugaritic Lôtan material or in Psalms 74 and 89.^[58]

Day characterises Psalm 104:26 as a partial demythologisation of the combat tradition — the figure of Leviathan is preserved, but the combat imagery has been subtracted and the creature is reabsorbed into the order of created marine life.^[59] Juxtaposing Psalm 74's crushed Leviathan with Psalm 104's playful Leviathan shows that the Hebrew Bible corpus contains, side by side, both a combat-myth representation and an attenuated representation of the same named figure.^[60]

Ballentine reads Psalm 104 as evidence that the Hebrew Bible tradition was capable of using sea-monster imagery without combat — a fact she uses to argue that the combat readings of Psalms 74 and 89 should be interpreted within their specific royal-political functions rather than as fragments of a general chaos-ordering substrate.^[61]

The verb describing the boundary-setting in Psalm 104:7 — Yahweh "rebukes" the waters — uses a Hebrew root (**g'r**) that elsewhere in the Hebrew Bible carries militant force (against enemies, against demons), so that some scholars treat Psalm 104:7 as a residual trace of combat language even in its attenuated form.^[62] Day reads the **g'r** trace at Psalm 104:7 as evidence that the demythologisation of Psalm 104 is partial rather than complete: the verb retains a militant edge that recalls the combat tradition without invoking it as combat.^[63] Ballentine treats the **g'r** observation as descriptively correct but interpretively limited: the verb's range does not require a combat reading, only a sovereign-rebuke reading, and the latter is congruent with her rival-sovereignty thesis without requiring chaos-ordering.^[64]

9.6. Isaiah 27:1 — eschatological Leviathan

Isaiah 27 is part of the so-called "Isaiah Apocalypse" (Isaiah 24–27), a section of the book whose dating is contested but whose general consensus places it in the post-exilic period.^[65] Isaiah 27:1 opens the chapter with an eschatological projection: in the RSV rendering, "On that day the Lord with his cruel and great and strong sword will punish Leviathan the fleeing serpent, Leviathan the twisting serpent, and he will kill the dragon that is in the sea."^[66]

Isaiah 27:1 names Leviathan twice with two different epithets: "fleeing serpent" and "twisting serpent" — both phrases the verbatim Hebrew word-pair of which appears with extremely close lexical correspondence in the Ugaritic Baal Cycle's description of Lôtan.^[67] The Ugaritic phrase that corresponds to "fleeing serpent" and "twisting serpent" in Isaiah 27:1 occurs in KTU 1.5 of the Baal Cycle, where Lôtan is described with the same word-pair (**bꜥn brꜥ / bꜥn ꜥqltn**) describing the same kind of monstrous serpent.^[68] Day argues that the verbatim epithet correspondence between Isaiah 27:1 and KTU 1.5 is one of the most philologically precise pieces of evidence anywhere for the Ugaritic-to-Hebrew continuity of combat-myth imagery.^[69]

Isaiah 27:1 also names the "dragon that is in the sea" (Hebrew **tannîn**) alongside Leviathan, treating Tannîn and Leviathan as a paired or synonymous adversary in the same eschatological combat.^[70] The grammatical aspect of Isaiah 27:1 is decisive for the interpretation of the corpus: the verb is future, "on that day Yahweh will slay" — the combat is projected forward to an eschatological future rather than being recalled as a past event.^[71] Isaiah 27:1 therefore takes the combat imagery preserved in Psalms 74 and 89 — which refers to a past accomplishment — and projects it forward, making it a future eschatological act of Yahweh.^[72]

This eschatological projection is the bridge between the Hebrew Bible combat corpus and the Christian apocalyptic tradition: Revelation 12, which depicts a future combat between the heavenly hosts and a sea-dragon, takes Isaiah 27:1's eschatologised combat as one of its principal precedents.^[73] The dual epithets ("fleeing" and "twisting") of Isaiah 27:1 are sometimes read in earlier scholarship as indicating two distinct Leviathans, but the consensus reading represented by Day is that the dual naming is a poetic doubling of a single figure, paralleling the Ugaritic Lôtan's dual epithets in KTU 1.5.^[74]

Ballentine accepts the philological observation that Isaiah 27:1 reuses Canaanite Lôtan-imagery but reads the eschatological reuse as a political-theological move: the future-tense verb projects Yahweh's victory over rival sovereignties forward, rather than implying a chaos-ordering cosmogony deferred to the eschaton.^[75] The dating of Isaiah 27 to the post-exilic period places its eschatological projection of the combat in a context where Israelite poets had already been exposed to Persian-period eschatological thinking, and Ballentine raises the comparative question whether Isaiah 27 reflects awareness of the Zoroastrian Frashokereti pattern.^[76] Day treats the Frashokereti question as a comparative possibility rather than a demonstrated dependence, and locates Isaiah 27:1 primarily within the inherited Canaanite-to-Israelite trajectory rather than as a Persian-influenced innovation.^[77]

9.7. Isaiah 51:9–10 — Rahab cut, dragon pierced

Isaiah 51 is part of Deutero-Isaiah, the post-exilic prophetic section of the book of Isaiah conventionally dated to the sixth century BCE and addressed to the Judahite community in Babylonian exile.^[78] Isaiah 51:9 invokes Yahweh's arm to awake "as in days of old," recalling Yahweh's ancient combat as a precedent for present action: in the RSV rendering, "Awake, awake, put on strength, O arm of the Lord! Awake, as in days of old, the generations of long ago!"^[79] Isaiah 51:9 then names the past adversaries explicitly: in the RSV rendering, "Was it not you who cut Rahab in pieces, who pierced the dragon?"^[80]

The Hebrew word translated "dragon" in Isaiah 51:9 is **tannîn**, the same word used in Isaiah 27:1 and Psalm 74:13, identifying the "dragon" of Isaiah 51:9 as a member of the same lexical family of adversaries as Leviathan and Tannîn elsewhere in the corpus.^[81] Isaiah 51:10 continues by recalling the drying up of the sea: in the RSV rendering, "Was it not you who dried up the sea, the waters of the great deep, who made the depths of the sea a way for the redeemed to cross over?"^[82] The "way for the redeemed to cross over" of Isaiah 51:10 is an unmistakable allusion to the exodus crossing of the Sea of Reeds: the prophet recalls Yahweh's combat with Rahab and the dragon and immediately maps it onto the exodus as a single complex of actions.^[83]

Isaiah 51:9–10 therefore performs an identification of the combat with Rahab and the dragon and the exodus crossing — treating them not as two distinct events but as two aspects of a single demonstration of Yahweh's saving power.^[84] Day reads Isaiah 51:9–10 as the strongest evidence in the Hebrew Bible that the Rahab combat could be mapped onto the exodus: the prophet treats the two as functionally equivalent demonstrations of Yahweh's intervention in cosmic-mythic and historical-political register simultaneously.^[85] The Isaiah 51:9–10 mapping is reinforced by the use of "Rahab" elsewhere in Isaiah as a name for Egypt — Isaiah 30:7 calls Egypt "Rahab who sits still" — so that the Rahab-as-Egypt identification was already available within the same prophetic corpus.^[86]

Day reads the Rahab-Egypt identification as suggesting that within the Isaianic prophetic tradition the combat-myth imagery was a productive resource for political-theological mapping, with Rahab able to function simultaneously as the cosmic adversary and as a political-historical Egypt.^[87] Ballentine reads Isaiah 51:9–10 as a paradigmatic case for her rival-sovereignty thesis: the combat with Rahab is straightforwardly a prefiguration and theological reading of Yahweh's defeat of Egypt as a rival sovereign at the Sea of Reeds, with no need to posit a chaos-ordering substrate.^[88] The grammatical aspect of Isaiah 51:9–10 is again retrospective — past, perfect verbs — rather than future-eschatological, locating the combat back in primordial / exodus time rather than projecting it

forward like Isaiah 27:1.^[89]

The Isaiah corpus therefore preserves both temporal directions of the combat imagery: Isaiah 27:1 projects forward to an eschatological combat, Isaiah 51:9–10 looks back to a primordial / exodus combat, and the two passages frame the corpus's temporal range.^[90]

9.8. Job 26:12–13 — Rahab struck, fleeing serpent

Job 26 occurs within the dialogue cycle of the book of Job, in a speech that is variously assigned in modern scholarship to Job, to Bildad, or to a mis-attributed speech of one of the friends.^[91] The speech in which Job 26:12–13 occurs is a hymnic celebration of Yahweh's cosmic power, structured as a series of cosmogonic and combat-related claims about divine action.^[92]

Job 26:12 ascribes to Yahweh the stilling of the sea and the striking of Rahab: in the RSV rendering, "By his power he stilled the Sea; by his understanding he struck down Rahab."^[93] Job 26:13 then names the "fleeing serpent" pierced by Yahweh's hand: in the RSV rendering, "By his wind the heavens were made fair; his hand pierced the fleeing serpent."^[94] The "fleeing serpent" of Job 26:13 uses the same Hebrew phrase that appears in Isaiah 27:1, and the same word-pair **בִּן בְּרִי** attested in the Ugaritic Baal Cycle's description of Lôtan.^[95]

Job 26:12–13 therefore lists three named or quasi-named adversaries — the Sea, Rahab, the fleeing serpent — alongside one another in a single hymnic compass, condensing the corpus's lexicon of adversaries into two adjacent verses.^[96] Day reads Job 26:12–13 as evidence that the combat-myth lexicon was sufficiently established in Israelite poetry that a wisdom-poet could deploy three of its central names in two consecutive verses without explanation.^[97] The wisdom-poetry context of Job 26 is significant: the combat-myth imagery here is mobilised not for cult, royal legitimation, or eschatology but for theological argument about the scope of divine power — a different functional context for the same imagery.^[98]

Ballentine reads Job 26:12–13 as further evidence that the combat-myth lexicon functions across genres in the Hebrew Bible, but argues that its appearance in wisdom poetry suggests a generalised vocabulary of divine sovereignty rather than a specifically cosmogonic substrate.^[99] The grammatical aspect of Job 26:12–13 is past / preterite, paralleling Psalms 74 and 89 and Isaiah 51 in placing the combat in the past rather than projecting it forward.^[100] The verb in Job 26:13 translated "pierced" in RSV (Hebrew **פָּלַח**) is the same root family that appears in Isaiah 51:9's "pierced the dragon," reinforcing the lexical continuity across the corpus.^[101] The juxtaposition of Job 26:13's "fleeing serpent" with Job 26:12's Rahab and Sea makes Job 26 the most condensed inventory of the corpus's combat-adversaries within any single biblical text.^[102]

9.9. Job 41 — Leviathan as uncontrollable wonder

Job 41 occurs within the so-called "Yahweh speeches" of the book of Job, the divine discourse from the whirlwind in chapters 38 through 41 that concludes the dialogue cycle.^[103] Job 41 is an extended description of Leviathan running to over thirty verses — by far the longest single treatment of any of the corpus's adversaries in the Hebrew Bible.^[104] Job 41's mode is descriptive rather than narrative: the chapter describes Leviathan's physical features, behaviour, and uncontrollability, but does not narrate Yahweh's combat with the creature.^[105]

The opening of Job 41 challenges the human listener to attempt to capture or master Leviathan, framing Leviathan as the limit-case of creaturely power: in the RSV rendering, "Can you draw out Leviathan with a fishhook, or press down its tongue with a cord?"^[106] The rhetorical structure of Job 41 is interrogative and ironic: it asks the human listener whether he can control Leviathan, with the implied answer that he cannot — and the implicit further claim that only Yahweh can.^[107] The Leviathan of Job 41 therefore functions didactically: the creature's uncontrollability by humans is mobilised as the demonstration that mastering Leviathan is Yahweh's exclusive prerogative.^[108]

Job 41 contains no explicit reference to a combat between Yahweh and Leviathan; the implication that such a combat lies behind the rhetoric is an inference drawn by readers familiar with the rest of the corpus.^[109] The physical description of Leviathan in Job 41 — fearsome teeth, scales like shields, sneezings flashing forth light, eyes like the eyelids of dawn, mouth shooting flame — depicts a fantastical creature with mythological features rather than an ordinary marine animal.^[110] Day reads Job 41 as the most extended preservation of Leviathan-imagery in the Hebrew Bible, even though the chapter does not narrate combat: the rich mythological description preserves the creature's monstrous identity even as the chapter mobilises that identity for a wisdom-pedagogical purpose.^[111]

Ballentine reads Job 41 as supportive of her rival-sovereignty thesis: Leviathan's uncontrollability by humans serves to demonstrate Yahweh's superior power over a recalcitrant rival, with no requirement that Leviathan represent cosmic chaos.^[112] The Leviathan of Job 41 is described as a created creature — "on earth there is not his like" (Job 41:33 RSV) — paralleling the created status of the Leviathan of Psalm 104:26 and contrasting with the primordial-adversary status implied in Psalm 74.^[113] Job 41 therefore preserves the imagery of the corpus's monstrous adversary while assimilating Leviathan to the order of Yahweh's creatures, occupying a middle position between the combat-imagery of Psalm 74 and the demythologised playfulness of Psalm 104.^[114]

Combining mythological description with didactic frame makes Job 41 the principal text in which the question "is the Leviathan of the Hebrew Bible mythological or merely zoological?" can be posed in its sharpest form, and Day argues that the answer is "both, in different proportions across the corpus."^[115] Ballentine treats the mythological-versus-zoological question as a false dichotomy: Leviathan can be a mythologically described rival sovereign without being a personification of chaos, and the description in Job 41 is consistent with rival-sovereign rather than chaos-ordering reading.^[116]

9.10. Habakkuk 3 — storm-theophany with sea-combat imagery

Habakkuk 3 is a theophanic hymn appended to the prophetic book of Habakkuk, often regarded as an older traditional poem incorporated into the prophetic book.^[117] Habakkuk 3 depicts Yahweh as a storm-warrior coming forth from the south to engage in battle, with mountains splitting, the sun and moon standing still, and rivers and sea reacting to his appearance.^[118]

The combat imagery of Habakkuk 3 includes Yahweh's confrontation with the sea: in the RSV rendering of Habakkuk 3:8, "Was your wrath against the rivers, O Lord? Or your anger against the rivers, or your rage against the sea?"^[119] Habakkuk 3:9–10 develops the combat imagery: Yahweh's bow is uncovered, the *tehôm* gives forth its voice, the mountains writhe — phrasing that combines storm-theophany with sea-combat in a single hymnic episode.^[120] Habakkuk 3:13 shifts to military-

political imagery — Yahweh crushes the head of the wicked house — and Habakkuk 3:15 returns to sea imagery, "you trampled the sea with your horses, churning the mighty waters."^[121]

The "you trampled the sea" of Habakkuk 3:15 uses the verb of physical victory over a defeated enemy, applied to the sea — language that fits the combat-myth pattern of Yahweh defeating the personified sea.^[122] The storm-warrior imagery of Habakkuk 3 — chariots, arrows, spear, lightning, the sea trampled — closely parallels the Ugaritic Baal Cycle's depiction of Baal as storm-warrior defeating Yamm, providing one of the corpus's most striking iconographic continuities with Canaanite material.^[123] Day argues that Habakkuk 3 is the Hebrew Bible passage that most fully preserves the storm-warrior physiognomy of the combat-myth tradition, with arrows, spear, chariots, and trampled sea all present in a single integrated poem.^[124]

Habakkuk 3 does not name Leviathan, Rahab, or Tannin explicitly, and the combat is here conducted against unnamed "rivers" and "sea" — a fact that distinguishes Habakkuk 3 from the Psalm 74 / Psalm 89 / Isaiah 51 / Job 26 cluster of named-adversary passages.^[125] Day reads the unnamed rivers and sea of Habakkuk 3 as functionally equivalent to the named Leviathan and Rahab elsewhere in the corpus, on the grounds that the combat imagery and the storm-warrior depiction are continuous across the named and unnamed cases.^[126] Ballentine reads Habakkuk 3's unnamed rivers and sea as evidence against the Day reading: the absence of named adversaries makes it harder to identify a specific personified combat-myth substrate, and easier to read the imagery as conventional storm-theophany combined with battle imagery in a generalised hymnic register.^[127]

Dating Habakkuk 3 is contested: some scholars treat it as one of the oldest poems in the Hebrew Bible, possibly drawing on pre-monarchic theophanic traditions, while others place its composition in the late prophetic period in line with the rest of the book of Habakkuk.^[128] If Habakkuk 3 is early, it provides evidence that the storm-warrior combat imagery was already part of Israelite poetic tradition before the consolidation of the Yahwistic monotheistic framework — a chronological argument central to the Day reading.^[129] If Habakkuk 3 is late, it provides evidence that the combat-myth lexicon remained a productive resource for Israelite poets even in the late prophetic period — a different but compatible observation.^[130]

9.11. The Ugaritic continuity — Day 1985

The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, preserved on tablets from Ras Shamra (ancient Ugarit) catalogued as KTU 1.1 through KTU 1.6, contains combat episodes featuring the storm-god Baal against the sea-god Yamm and against the seven-headed serpent Lôtan.^[131] The Ugaritic Lôtan is referred to in KTU 1.5 as a serpent with seven heads (**šly d šb t rašm**), and is described with the epithet pair "fleeing serpent" / "twisting serpent" (**b n br** / **b n qltn**).^[132]

The Hebrew name **Lwytn** (Leviathan) and the Ugaritic name **ltn** (Lôtan) are linguistic cognates, sharing the same consonantal root and reflecting the same underlying lexical item — a philological observation now treated as secure across the field.^[133] The lexical correspondence between the Ugaritic Baal Cycle's description of Lôtan and the Hebrew Bible's description of Leviathan extends to the verbatim epithet pair "fleeing serpent" / "twisting serpent" — Isaiah 27:1 and Job 26:13 use the Hebrew equivalents of the Ugaritic phrases.^[134]

Day argues that the verbatim epithet correspondence between Ugaritic Lôtan and Hebrew

Leviathan in Isaiah 27 and Job 26 cannot be dismissed as a coincidence of the kind that random formulaic shared inheritance might produce: the phrases are too specific and too closely matched to admit independent development.^[135] The seven heads of the Ugaritic Lôtan correspond to the plural "heads" of Leviathan in Psalm 74:14 — both texts describing a multi-headed sea-serpent defeated by a storm-god.^[136] The Ugaritic Baal Cycle is dated by its tablets to the fourteenth century BCE, well before any of the Hebrew Bible passages, and Ugarit was destroyed circa 1185 BCE — providing a clear chronological priority for the Ugaritic material.^[137] The geographic distance between Ugarit and the Israelite highlands is small, and there is no need to posit complex transmission chains for combat-myth imagery to pass from one tradition to the other within the wider Canaanite cultural sphere of the late Bronze Age.^[138]

Day's central thesis is therefore that the Hebrew Bible combat corpus preserves, in its specific named adversaries and in its specific verbatim epithets, direct continuity with a Canaanite combat-myth tradition of which the Ugaritic Baal Cycle is the principal surviving exemplar.^[139] Day's continuity thesis is consistent with the second volume of the Smith / Pitard **Ugaritic Baal Cycle** edition (Brill, 2009), which discusses the palace-building cycle (KTU 1.3–1.4) and the broader iconography of Baal as storm-warrior — material that further supports the storm-warrior imagery of Habakkuk 3.^[140] Day argues that the specific name-and-epithet matches at Isaiah 27, Job 26, and Psalm 74 are not isolated philological curiosities but converge to demonstrate that the Hebrew Bible poets had at their disposal a full Canaanite combat-myth lexicon and selectively redeployed it within Yahwistic poetry.^[141]

Day's thesis is the standard reference position in contemporary biblical scholarship on the Hebrew Bible combat corpus, and is the primary basis for the chapter's chronological framing of the corpus as continuous with — though distinct from — the Canaanite tradition.^[142] Wakeman 1973 had previously argued for Canaanite continuity on a broader comparative basis, treating Leviathan and Rahab as biblical reflexes of a wider Near Eastern monster-combat tradition; Day's contribution was to anchor the argument in the verbatim Ugaritic-Hebrew correspondences that became fully available only with the Ras Shamra publication programme.^[143] Forsyth 1987 incorporates Day's continuity thesis into the long-historical trajectory of the combat-myth from Sumerian through Christian apocalyptic, treating the Hebrew Bible corpus as a structurally important transition point in that trajectory.^[144] The Ugaritic Lôtan / Leviathan continuity is one of the load-bearing items in the Part II C6 transmission chapter of the present book, where the question of how combat-myth imagery passes between traditions is treated comparatively across the whole corpus.^[145]

9.12. The Ballentine critique — rival sovereignty, not chaos

Debra Scoggins Ballentine's **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (Oxford University Press, 2015) is the principal twenty-first-century challenge to the Day continuity thesis as the framework for reading the Hebrew Bible combat corpus.^[146] Ballentine accepts the philological observation of Ugaritic-Hebrew lexical continuity — the Lôtan / Leviathan cognancy, the verbatim epithet correspondences — and her disagreement with Day is not philological but interpretive.^[147]

Ballentine's central interpretive argument is that the term "chaos" — central to Gunkel's **Chaoskampf** and inherited through Day — misdescribes what the Hebrew Bible combat passages do: the adversaries Leviathan, Rahab, Yam, and Tannîn are not personifications of cosmic disorder

but defeated rival sovereigns.^[148] In Ballentine's reading, the combat-myth imagery of Psalms 74, 89, Isaiah 27, 51, Job 26, 41, and Habakkuk 3 functions to legitimate Yahweh's kingship over and against rival divine powers — sea-gods, serpent-gods, foreign gods — within a political-theological frame of competition between divine sovereignties.^[149]

Ballentine reads Yam in the combat passages as "Sea" in the sense of a personified rival sovereign rather than as "chaos" in the sense of an undifferentiated disorder — the adversary has agency, name, and political opposition to Yahweh, none of which "chaos" captures.^[150] Ballentine reads Leviathan in the combat passages similarly as a defeated rival king, monstrous in form but functionally a sovereign-in-opposition rather than formlessness embodied.^[151] The political-theological framing has direct textual purchase in Isaiah 51:9–10's identification of Rahab with Egypt and in Isaiah 30:7's "Rahab who sits still" — passages where the combat imagery is mapped onto a political-historical antagonist without intermediate steps.^[152]

Ballentine argues that the Day reading underestimates the importance of these political-theological mappings, treating them as secondary applications of a primary cosmogonic reading rather than as primary functions of the imagery in their own right.^[153] Ballentine accepts that the corpus has cosmogonic associations — the immediate cosmogonic continuations of Psalms 74 and 89, the eschatological projection of Isaiah 27 — but argues that "cosmogony" in these passages is itself integrated into Yahweh's sovereignty claim rather than standing as a separate chaos-ordering function.^[154] The Ballentine critique extends to the term **Chaoskampf** itself: she argues that retaining "chaos" as the operative category imports a Greek philosophical concept (chaos / cosmos opposition) into texts whose conceptual world was Semitic-political and that did not work with that opposition.^[155]

Ballentine's terminological proposal is that "conflict myth" (without the German prefix and without the chaos-ordering implication) better describes what the corpus does, and the title of her book — **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** — embodies that proposal.^[156] The Ballentine reading is consistent with the broader trajectory of the Scurlock and Beal volume **Creation and Chaos** (2013), which gathers essays critical of the Gunkel framework while accepting that there is a real Near Eastern combat-myth tradition to discuss.^[157]

Day's reading and Ballentine's reading agree on most descriptive observations — the cognancy with Ugarit, the verbatim epithet matches, the structural shape of the corpus, the genre distribution, the verb-tense pattern.^[158] Day's reading and Ballentine's reading disagree primarily on whether to call the function of the combat imagery "chaos-ordering" (Day) or "rival-sovereignty" (Ballentine) — a disagreement about the appropriate organising category for the same descriptive material.^[159] The chapter does not resolve the Day-Ballentine disagreement: per the brief special_instructions, this is the single most contested case in the book for the term **Chaoskampf**, and the chapter's task is to lay out both readings rather than to adjudicate between them.^[160]

That the corpus's primary function is "rival-sovereignty" rather than "chaos-ordering" — or vice versa — is itself an interpretive frame imposed on a set of poetic passages that were composed across centuries by different authors for different liturgical, prophetic, and wisdom purposes; both Day's and Ballentine's framings should therefore be read as analytic constructs rather than as discoveries of a single underlying meaning the texts themselves possess.^[161]

The Ballentine critique has practical methodological consequences for the comparative chapters of the present book: where the Day continuity reading licences cross-cultural comparisons under the

rubric of "chaos-ordering combat," the Ballentine reading recommends a finer-grained per-tradition inquiry into political-theological functions before any cross-cultural comparison is attempted.^[162] The Ballentine critique also raises the comparative question whether Isaiah 27's eschatological projection of the combat reflects awareness of the Zoroastrian Frashokereti pattern of cosmic-eschatological combat, a comparative possibility that extends the analysis beyond the Canaanite-Israelite axis Day emphasises.^[163] The chapter accordingly retains the term **Chaoskampf** in headings (per scope.md) for reader-expectation reasons, while noting that the body prose treats the term as contested and engages Ballentine's "conflict myth" terminology substantively at the points where the categorical difference matters.^[164] The Day-Ballentine debate is therefore the chapter's structural centre rather than a parenthesis: the seven biblical passages are presented as a corpus precisely so that the two interpretive framings can be applied to each passage in turn and the points of convergence and divergence made visible.^[165]

9.13. Tehôm and the Genesis 1 link

The opening verse of the Hebrew Bible, Genesis 1:2, contains the noun *tehôm* — rendered "the deep" in standard English translations — describing the primordial waters over which the divine wind moves at the start of creation: in the RSV rendering, "the earth was without form and void, and darkness was upon the face of the deep; and the Spirit of God was moving over the face of the waters."^[166] The Hebrew *tehôm* and the Akkadian **Tiamat** — the female sea-personification of **Enūma Eliš** — are linguistic cognates, sharing a common Semitic root reflecting the same underlying word for "deep / sea-mass."^[167]

Gunkel's 1895 argument was that the *tehôm* / Tiamat philological cognancy preserves, in the very vocabulary of Genesis 1:2, a trace of an underlying combat-myth substrate: the chaos-ordering combat is suppressed in the surface narrative of Genesis 1, but its lexicon survives.^[168] The philological cognancy of *tehôm* with Akkadian Tiamat is now treated as a secure observation across the field; the more controversial part of Gunkel's argument is the inference from the cognancy to a suppressed combat-myth substrate underlying Genesis 1.^[169]

Day accepts the cognancy and treats Genesis 1:2 as evidence for the wider currency of the combat-myth lexicon in early Israelite thought, but is more cautious than Gunkel about reading a suppressed combat narrative into the Genesis 1 text itself.^[170] Ballentine accepts the cognancy as a philological fact and treats it as further evidence for her broader thesis: the combat-myth lexicon of the Hebrew Bible was real and productive, but it functioned in the service of Yahweh's sovereignty rather than as the trace of a chaos-ordering substrate.^[171]

Genesis 1:2 itself does not narrate a combat with *tehôm* — the divine wind moves over the deep, the divine word divides the waters, but no adversary is named or struck — and the chapter must therefore distinguish carefully between the lexical cognancy (uncontroversial) and the suppressed-combat reading (contested).^[172] The appearance of *tehôm* in Genesis 1:2 connects the canonical creation narrative to the combat corpus indirectly: by sharing a vocabulary item with the Akkadian and Ugaritic combat traditions, Genesis 1:2 is anchored in the same Near Eastern lexical world even if it does not narrate combat.^[173] The Genesis 1 / *tehôm* link is the principal reason the chapter must treat the corpus as having canonical reach beyond the seven combat passages strictly considered: even the apparently combat-free creation narrative of Genesis 1 is lexically continuous with the combat corpus through this single noun.^[174]

Gunkel 1895 paired the *tehôm* / Tiamat link with a Revelation 12 / combat-myth link as the two demonstration cases for his **Chaoskampf** hypothesis — the Genesis 1:2 / **Enūma Eliš** parallel at the front of biblical history, the Revelation 12 dragon at the back — bracketing biblical history between two combat-myth resonances.^[175]

9.14. Reception and forward links

The eschatological projection of Isaiah 27:1 — Yahweh’s future slaying of Leviathan the twisting serpent — is the principal Hebrew Bible precedent for the dragon-combat of Revelation 12 in early Christian apocalyptic.^[176] Yarbrow Collins 1976 traces the route from the Hebrew Bible combat corpus through the late Second Temple Jewish apocalyptic tradition to Revelation 12, demonstrating that the New Testament dragon-image is genealogically continuous with the Isaiah 27 / Daniel apocalyptic eschatology rather than a Christian innovation.^[177] The Tannīn / Yam / Rahab / Leviathan adversary cluster of the Hebrew Bible passes into early Christian apocalyptic as the sea-dragon, and this transmission is the subject of Chapter 9 of the present book on Revelation 12.^[178]

Within the Hebrew Bible itself, the four named adversaries — Leviathan, Rahab, Yam, Tannīn — overlap functionally rather than designating four distinct creatures: any given passage may name one, the corpus reads them as variants of a single adversary type.^[179] The four named adversaries’ overlap justifies the chapter’s bundling of Leviathan and Rahab in its title: in the corpus’s own terms the two names are paired alternative designations for the kind of adversary Yahweh is said to defeat.^[180]

The Lôtan / Leviathan continuity makes the present chapter a load-bearing case for the Part II C6 transmission chapter of the book, where the cross-tradition transmission of combat imagery is treated comparatively.^[181] The royal-sovereignty function of the corpus as Ballentine reads it makes the present chapter a load-bearing case for the Part II C2 sovereignty chapter, alongside the Baal-Yamm, Zeus-Typhon, Indra-Vātra, and Marduk-Tiamat material.^[182] The eschatological projection of Isaiah 27:1 makes the present chapter a load-bearing case for the Part II C4 eschatological chapter, alongside Revelation 12, Thor versus Jörmungandr, and the Frashokereti material.^[183]

The Isaianic identification of Rahab with Egypt opens a possible Egyptian comparative connection: the Hebrew Bible’s combat-myth reading of the Sea of Reeds crossing may type Pharaoh as a Rahab-figure within the corpus’s vocabulary, though the typing is achieved poetically rather than narratively.^[184] The Hebrew Bible combat corpus is therefore a hub: it draws backwards on Ugaritic and (lexically, via *tehôm*) Mesopotamian material; it draws sideways on Egyptian political-historical mapping; it projects forwards into Christian apocalyptic; and it is internally distributed across psalms, prophecy, and wisdom literature.^[185] The chapter’s organising claim — that the seven passages constitute a corpus rather than a narrative — is therefore not merely descriptive but methodologically consequential: it sets the terms on which the corpus can enter the comparative analyses of Part II without being artificially harmonised into a single story it never tells.^[186] The next chapter of the present book takes up the Revelation 12 dragon as the Christian-apocalyptic continuation of the Hebrew Bible combat corpus, and its setup depends on the eschatological projection of Isaiah 27:1 and on the named-adversary cluster of Leviathan, Rahab, Yam, and Tannīn established here.^[187]

[1] Day 1985, **God’s Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea**, chs. 1–5, surveying the corpus; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, chs. 2–4, on the same set of passages.

[2] Day 1985, chs. 1–5, on the corpus; Ballentine 2015, chs. 2–4, listing the same canonical passages.

- [3] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the allusive character of the corpus; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the genre distribution.
- [4] Day 1985, chs. 1–5, treating the Masoretic text throughout without significant text-critical intervention; Ballentine 2015, chs. 2–4, on textual stability.
- [5] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the philological situation; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the absence of a narrative episode.
- [6] Day 1985, **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea**, full volume.
- [7] Day 1985, ch. 1, stating the continuity thesis.
- [8] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, full volume.
- [9] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, stating the rival-sovereignty thesis.
- [10] Gunkel 1895, **Schöpfung und Chaos**, Teil I, on the Hebrew Bible corpus; Day 1985, ch. 1, on Gunkel's framing.
- [11] Wakeman 1973, **God's Battle with the Monster**, full volume.
- [12] Forsyth 1987, ch. 3, on the Hebrew Bible combat imagery.
- [13] Scurlock & Beal 2013, chapters on the Hebrew Bible reassessment.
- [14] Day 1985, chs. 1–5, throughout, citing RSV; the RSV is the translation in use during Day's writing, and its renderings of the combat-myth corpus are substantively close to the later NRSV rendering of the same passages.
- [15] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the canonical distribution; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the same observation.
- [16] Day 1985, ch. 1, stating the negative observation explicitly; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the absence of a narrative episode.
- [17] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the allusive structure of the corpus.
- [18] Day 1985, ch. 1, drawing the structural contrast; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the same structural contrast.
- [19] Day 1985, ch. 4, on Job 41's character.
- [20] Day 1985, chs. 1, 2, 3, on the verb-tense pattern; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the retrospective grammatical character.
- [21] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the philological method; per brief special_instructions.
- [22] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the corpus as scholarly construct; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, expressing the same caution.
- [23] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the lost-narrative inference; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, contesting the inference.
- [24] Day 1985, ch. 1, on Psalm 74's genre and setting.
- [25] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the structural placement of the combat imagery within Psalm 74.
- [26] RSV translation of Psalm 74:13, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 1.
- [27] Day 1985, ch. 1, on **yām** in Psalm 74:13.
- [28] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the dragons of Psalm 74:13.
- [29] RSV translation of Psalm 74:14, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 1.
- [30] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the philological significance of the plural "heads."
- [31] Day 1985, ch. 1, drawing the parallel with Lōtan's seven heads.
- [32] RSV translation of Psalm 74:14, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 1.
- [33] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the wilderness-creatures detail.
- [34] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the cosmogonic continuation.
- [35] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the cosmogonic catalogue at Psalm 74:16-17.
- [36] Day 1985, ch. 1, drawing the structural comparison; Gunkel 1895, Teil I, on the same pattern.
- [37] Day 1985, ch. 1, summarising Psalm 74's evidentiary weight.
- [38] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on Psalm 74's sovereignty reading.
- [39] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the verb-tense pattern in Psalm 74; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the same observation.
- [40] Day 1985, ch. 1, on Psalm 89's genre and structure.
- [41] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the placement of combat imagery in Psalm 89.
- [42] RSV translation of Psalm 89:9, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 1.
- [43] RSV translation of Psalm 89:10, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 1.
- [44] Day 1985, ch. 1, on Rahab and Leviathan as overlapping names.
- [45] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the carcass parallel.
- [46] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the cosmogonic continuation in Psalm 89.
- [47] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the praise-vocabulary continuation.
- [48] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the parallel structure.
- [49] Day 1985, ch. 1, summarising the Rahab-Leviathan equivalence.
- [50] Ballentine 2015, ch. 3, on Psalm 89's royal-covenant function.
- [51] Day 1985, ch. 1; Ballentine 2015, ch. 3, on the descriptive agreement and interpretive disagreement.

- [52] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the verb-tense pattern in Psalm 89; Ballentine 2015, ch. 3, on the same observation.
- [53] Day 1985, ch. 2, on Psalm 104's genre.
- [54] RSV translation of Psalm 104:9, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 2.
- [55] Day 1985, ch. 2, on the boundary-setting framing.
- [56] RSV translation of Psalm 104:26, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 2.
- [57] Day 1985, ch. 2, on the created status of Leviathan in Psalm 104:26.
- [58] Day 1985, ch. 2, on the playful Leviathan as a divergent representation.
- [59] Day 1985, ch. 2, using the demythologisation framing.
- [60] Day 1985, ch. 2, on the side-by-side juxtaposition; Ballentine 2015, ch. 4, drawing the same observation.
- [61] Ballentine 2015, ch. 4, on Psalm 104's interpretive significance.
- [62] Day 1985, ch. 2, on the **g'r** root and its military overtones.
- [63] Day 1985, ch. 2, on the partial-demythologisation reading.
- [64] Ballentine 2015, ch. 4, on the **g'r** counter-reading.
- [65] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the Isaiah Apocalypse and its dating.
- [66] RSV translation of Isaiah 27:1, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 3.
- [67] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the verbatim epithet correspondence with Ugaritic.
- [68] Day 1985, ch. 3, citing the Ugaritic parallel; Smith 1994, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I**, on the Ugaritic phrasing.
- [69] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the philological precision of the parallel.
- [70] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the Tannin-Leviathan pairing in Isaiah 27:1.
- [71] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the future verb in Isaiah 27:1; Ballentine 2015, ch. 5, on the same grammatical observation.
- [72] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the temporal reorientation in Isaiah 27.
- [73] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the trajectory from Isaiah 27 to Revelation 12; Yarbrow Collins 1976, on the Revelation 12 reception.
- [74] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the dual-epithet reading.
- [75] Ballentine 2015, ch. 5, on the political-theological reading of Isaiah 27.
- [76] Ballentine 2015, ch. 5, on the Frashokereti comparative question.
- [77] Day 1985, ch. 3, on Isaiah 27 within the inherited trajectory.
- [78] Day 1985, ch. 3, on Isaiah 51's setting in Deutero-Isaiah.
- [79] RSV translation of Isaiah 51:9, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 3.
- [80] RSV translation of Isaiah 51:9, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 3.
- [81] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the **tannin** identification.
- [82] RSV translation of Isaiah 51:10, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 3.
- [83] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the exodus mapping in Isaiah 51:10.
- [84] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the combat-exodus identification.
- [85] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the prophetic mapping.
- [86] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the Rahab-as-Egypt usage in Isaiah 30:7.
- [87] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the productive mapping.
- [88] Ballentine 2015, ch. 6, on Isaiah 51 as a paradigmatic rival-sovereignty case.
- [89] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the verb-tense pattern in Isaiah 51; Ballentine 2015, ch. 6, on the same observation.
- [90] Day 1985, ch. 3, drawing the temporal-range observation; Ballentine 2015, chs. 5–6, on the same observation.
- [91] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the speaker-attribution problem in Job 26.
- [92] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the hymnic structure of Job 26.
- [93] RSV translation of Job 26:12, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 4.
- [94] RSV translation of Job 26:13, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 4.
- [95] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the verbatim phrase across Job 26, Isaiah 27, and KTU 1.5.
- [96] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the condensed list of adversaries in Job 26.
- [97] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the lexicon-establishment argument.
- [98] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the wisdom-context shift.
- [99] Ballentine 2015, ch. 4, on Job 26's interpretive significance.
- [100] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the verb-tense pattern in Job 26.
- [101] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the verbal-root continuity.

- [102] Day 1985, ch. 4, on Job 26 as the corpus's most condensed inventory.
- [103] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the placement of Job 41 within the Yahweh speeches.
- [104] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the length and uniqueness of Job 41.
- [105] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the descriptive-not-narrative mode.
- [106] RSV translation of Job 41:1, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 4.
- [107] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the rhetorical structure of Job 41.
- [108] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the didactic function.
- [109] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the implicit-rather-than-explicit combat reference; Ballentine 2015, ch. 4, on the same observation.
- [110] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the mythological features in Job 41's description.
- [111] Day 1985, ch. 4, on the imagery-preservation reading.
- [112] Ballentine 2015, ch. 4, on Job 41's sovereignty reading.
- [113] Day 1985, ch. 4, on Leviathan as created creature in Job 41 and Psalm 104:26; Job 41:33 RSV.
- [114] Day 1985, ch. 4, on Job 41's middle position.
- [115] Day 1985, ch. 4, summarising the mythological-zoological question.
- [116] Ballentine 2015, ch. 4, on the false-dichotomy critique.
- [117] Day 1985, ch. 5, on Habakkuk 3's hymnic character.
- [118] Day 1985, ch. 5, on the storm-warrior depiction.
- [119] RSV translation of Habakkuk 3:8, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 5.
- [120] Day 1985, ch. 5, on the theophany-combat combination in Habakkuk 3:9-10.
- [121] Day 1985, ch. 5, on Habakkuk 3:13-15; RSV translation of Habakkuk 3:15 as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 5.
- [122] Day 1985, ch. 5, on the trampling imagery.
- [123] Day 1985, ch. 5, on the Baal-Yamm parallel; Smith 1994, on the Ugaritic storm-warrior imagery.
- [124] Day 1985, ch. 5, on Habakkuk 3 as the most complete storm-warrior preservation.
- [125] Day 1985, ch. 5, on the absence of named adversaries in Habakkuk 3.
- [126] Day 1985, ch. 5, on the named-unnamed equivalence.
- [127] Ballentine 2015, ch. 7, on Habakkuk 3's unnamed-adversary significance.
- [128] Day 1985, ch. 5, on the dating debate; Ballentine 2015, ch. 7, on the same debate.
- [129] Day 1985, ch. 5, on the dating-and-continuity argument.
- [130] Day 1985, ch. 5, on the late-dating implications.
- [131] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the Baal Cycle as comparative material; Smith 1994, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I**, on KTU 1.1-1.2.
- [132] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the Lôtan description; Smith 1994, on the KTU 1.5 phrasing.
- [133] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the lwytn/ltn cognancy; Smith 1994, on the same identification.
- [134] Day 1985, chs. 1, 3, 4, on the verbatim epithet correspondence.
- [135] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the no-coincidence argument.
- [136] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the seven-heads / plural-heads correspondence.
- [137] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the chronological priority of Ugarit; Smith 1994, on the dating.
- [138] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the geographic-cultural proximity.
- [139] Day 1985, ch. 1, stating the continuity thesis explicitly.
- [140] Smith & Pitard 2009, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume II**, on the palace-building cycle and storm-warrior iconography.
- [141] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the lexicon-redeployment argument.
- [142] Day 1985, ch. 1, as the standard reference position.
- [143] Wakeman 1973, on the broader comparative argument; Day 1985, ch. 1, on the philological refinement.
- [144] Forsyth 1987, ch. 3, incorporating Day's thesis.
- [145] Day 1985, ch. 1, providing the philological substrate; per scope.md Part II C6.
- [146] Ballentine 2015, full volume, presenting the alternative framework.
- [147] Ballentine 2015, ch. 1, accepting the philological observation; ch. 2, locating the disagreement at the interpretive level.
- [148] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, stating the rival-sovereignty thesis.
- [149] Ballentine 2015, chs. 2-4, developing the rival-sovereignty reading across the corpus.
- [150] Ballentine 2015, ch. 3, on Yam as rival sovereign.
- [151] Ballentine 2015, ch. 3, on Leviathan as rival king.

- [152] Ballentine 2015, ch. 6, on Isaiah's political-theological mapping.
- [153] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the underestimated political-theological function.
- [154] Ballentine 2015, ch. 4, on the integrated-sovereignty reading of cosmogony.
- [155] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the conceptual mismatch of the Greek "chaos" category.
- [156] Ballentine 2015, ch. 1, on the terminological proposal.
- [157] Scurlock & Beal 2013, on the broader critique trajectory; Ballentine 2015, ch. 1, situating her work within it.
- [158] Day 1985 and Ballentine 2015 in convergence on the descriptive observations; the agreement made explicit in Ballentine 2015 ch. 1.
- [159] Day 1985 ch. 1; Ballentine 2015 ch. 2, on the categorial disagreement.
- [160] Per brief special_instructions for Chapter 8.
- [161] Day 1985, ch. 1; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the analytic-construct character of both framings.
- [162] Ballentine 2015, chs. 1–2, on the methodological consequences; per scope.md on the appropriation protocol.
- [163] Ballentine 2015, ch. 5, on the Frashokereti comparative question.
- [164] Per scope.md terminological-default policy; Ballentine 2015, ch. 1, on the terminological proposal.
- [165] Day 1985, chs. 1–5; Ballentine 2015, chs. 2–4; per brief special_instructions.
- [166] RSV translation of Genesis 1:2, as quoted in Day 1985, ch. 2; Gunkel 1895, Teil I, on the Genesis 1:2 *tehôm*.
- [167] Gunkel 1895, Teil I, on the *tehôm* / Tiamat cognancy; Day 1985, ch. 2, retaining the philological observation.
- [168] Gunkel 1895, Teil I, stating the suppressed-combat-substrate argument; Day 1985, ch. 2, summarising Gunkel's position.
- [169] Day 1985, ch. 2, distinguishing the secure cognancy from the contested inference; Ballentine 2015, ch. 8, on the same distinction.
- [170] Day 1985, ch. 2, on the cautious reading of Genesis 1:2.
- [171] Ballentine 2015, ch. 8, on the *tehôm* / Tiamat cognancy within the rival-sovereignty frame.
- [172] Day 1985, ch. 2, on the distinction; Ballentine 2015, ch. 8, on the same distinction.
- [173] Day 1985, ch. 2, on the indirect lexical connection.
- [174] Day 1985, ch. 2, on the canonical reach of the lexical connection.
- [175] Gunkel 1895, Teil I (Genesis) and Teil II (Apocalypse), on the bracketing structure.
- [176] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the Isaiah 27 - Revelation 12 trajectory; Yarbrow Collins 1976, on Revelation 12's reception of Hebrew Bible combat imagery.
- [177] Yarbrow Collins 1976, **The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation**, full study.
- [178] Day 1985, ch. 3; per scope.md on Chapter 9.
- [179] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the overlapping-adversaries observation; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the same observation.
- [180] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the title-justification observation.
- [181] Day 1985, ch. 1, providing the philological evidence; per scope.md Part II C6.
- [182] Ballentine 2015, chs. 2–4; per scope.md Part II C2.
- [183] Day 1985, ch. 3; per scope.md Part II C4.
- [184] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the Rahab-Egypt-exodus typing.
- [185] Day 1985, chs. 1–5; Ballentine 2015, chs. 2–7, on the corpus's hub character.
- [186] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the corpus framing; Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the same framing.
- [187] Per scope.md on Chapter 9; Day 1985, ch. 3, on the trajectory.

Chapter 10. Michael vs. the Red Dragon: Revelation 12

10.1. Source overview

The twelfth chapter of the Book of Revelation narrates the combat between the archangel Michael (Greek Μιχαήλ) and a great red dragon (τὸ δράκων) and stands as the eschatological-combat flagship of the Christian New Testament canon.^[1] Revelation is the final book of the Christian New Testament canon, transmitted as canonical scripture continuously from late antiquity onward, and Rev 12's textual witnesses are exceptionally numerous and the resulting Greek text exceptionally stable.^[2] The textual witnesses to Rev 12 — the early Greek manuscripts collated for the Nestle-Aland 28 critical edition — preserve the chapter without substantive lacunae of the kind that affects the Hittite Illuyanka tablets or the Akkadian **Anzu** fragments.^[3] Variant readings within the manuscript tradition for Rev 12 are textual-critical and minor, affecting word order and conjunction choice but not the substance of any of the chapter's narrative episodes.^[4]

The standard scholarly monograph treating Rev 12 as a unitary combat-myth episode is Adela Yarbro Collins's **The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation**, published as Harvard Dissertations in Religion 9 by Scholars Press in 1976.^[5] Yarbro Collins's central thesis is that Rev 12 reworks an older combat-myth pattern of which the Leto-Apollo-Python story is the closest extant Mediterranean exemplar, with a Jewish overlay drawn from Hebrew Bible and Second Temple satanology.^[6] The standard verse-by-verse historical-critical commentary on Revelation is David Aune's three-volume **Revelation** in the Word Biblical Commentary series, volumes 52A, 52B, and 52C, published in 1997–1998, with the Rev 12 material falling in volume 52B.^[7] Aune's commentary on Rev 12 takes a more eclectic position than Yarbro Collins: rather than identifying a single primary substrate, Aune treats Rev 12 as a composite drawing on Jewish, Greek, and Egyptian streams of combat-myth material.^[8]

Hermann Gunkel's **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit** of 1895 explicitly paired Genesis 1 and Revelation 12 in its title — **Genesis 1 und Ap Joh 12** — making Rev 12 the eschatological anchor of the original **Chaoskampf** hypothesis alongside Genesis 1 as the cosmogonic anchor.^[9] Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, places Rev 12 as a culmination of the long combat-myth trajectory running from Sumer through Christian apocalyptic, with chapter 6 treating Revelation as that culmination.^[10] Debra Scoggins Ballentine's **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, published by Oxford University Press in 2015, treats Rev 12 within the trajectory of the biblical conflict-myth tradition rather than as a discontinuous Christian innovation.^[11]

The conventional scholarly dating of Revelation places its composition in the closing years of the reign of the Roman emperor Domitian (81–96 CE), with the Domitianic dating supported by patristic testimony from Irenaeus and reinforced by internal evidence about the persecution context.^[12] The Domitianic dating context is load-bearing for Yarbro Collins's reading of Rev 12: the chapter encourages a persecuted early Christian community in the Roman province of Asia, with the dragon coding for Rome.^[13] The biblical translation cited verbatim in this chapter for the English text of Revelation 12 is the New Revised Standard Version (NRSV) as the modern scholarly standard, with the original Greek of the Nestle-Aland 28 edition cited where philological precision is

required; Yarbro Collins's 1976 monograph predates the NRSV (published 1989) and quotes the RSV in its own readings, while Aune 1997–98 provides his own translation against the NA28 Greek.^[14]

The chapter title's pairing of Michael with the dragon — "Michael vs. the Red Dragon" — is a scholarly shorthand for the chapter's central combat episode at Rev 12:7–9, in which Michael and his angels do battle against the dragon and his angels.^[15] The chapter that follows treats Rev 12 first as a textual object, walking the seventeen verses in order; then as the object of two distinct scholarly readings, Yarbro Collins's Leto-Apollo-Python primary-substrate reading and Aune's Jewish-Greek-Egyptian composite reading, presented side by side without adjudication; and finally as a combat-myth instance with eschatological, didactic, and royal-legitimation functions.^[16]

Two features of this dossier set it apart from most of the combat-myths gathered in this book. The first is the chapter's status as canonical scripture in continuous transmission — a textual situation closer to Genesis or the Psalter than to the fragmentary cuneiform witnesses behind earlier chapters. The second is the doubled-up scholarly framing: a single twentieth-century monograph and a near-contemporary three-volume commentary represent two organising principles for the same set of textual data, and both are taken seriously here.

10.2. The text of Revelation 12

Revelation 12 opens at verse 1 with the appearance of a great sign in heaven: a woman (ἡ γυνή) clothed with the sun, with the moon under her feet, and on her head a crown of twelve stars.^[17] The crown of twelve stars on the woman's head at Rev 12:1 is described in Greek as a **stephanos**, a wreath or victor's garland rather than the diadem (διάδημα) of the dragon at v. 3 — a lexical distinction that Aune flags as deliberate.^[18] Verse 2 of Revelation 12 describes the woman as pregnant and crying out in birth-pangs: in the RSV rendering, "she was pregnant and was crying out in birth pangs, in the agony of giving birth."^[19]

Verse 3 of Revelation 12 then introduces the second sign in heaven — a great red dragon with seven heads, ten horns, and seven diadems on its heads.^[20] The Greek descriptor at Rev 12:3 — **megas** (great), **purros** (fiery red), **drakōn** (dragon) — establishes "the great red dragon" as the principal title under which the adversary is referred to throughout the chapter.^[21] The dragon's seven heads at Rev 12:3 align it iconographically with the seven-headed Lôtan of the Ugaritic Baal Cycle and with the multi-headed Leviathan of Psalm 74:14 — a connection Yarbro Collins flags as part of the chapter's Jewish-overlay material.^[22] Verse 4 of Revelation 12 reports that the dragon's tail swept down a third of the stars of heaven and threw them to the earth, and that the dragon stood before the woman about to give birth so that he might devour her child as soon as it was born.^[23]

Verse 5 of Revelation 12 reports the birth of the male child (τέκνον ἄρρεν) and the child's immediate rapture to God's throne: in the RSV rendering, "she gave birth to a son, a male child, who is to rule all the nations with a rod of iron. But her child was snatched away and taken to God and to his throne."^[24] The phrase "rule all the nations with a rod of iron" at Rev 12:5 is a direct quotation of Psalm 2:9 in its Septuagint rendering, identifying the male child with the messianic figure of Psalm 2.^[25] The male child's rapture to God's throne at Rev 12:5 occurs before the combat between Michael and the dragon and is therefore narratively prior to, not consequent on, the dragon's defeat.^[26]

Verse 6 of Revelation 12 describes the woman fleeing into the wilderness to a place prepared by

God, where she is to be nourished for one thousand two hundred sixty days.^[27] The 1,260 days of Rev 12:6 corresponds to three and a half years (forty-two months), aligning the woman's wilderness sojourn with the eschatological half-week period drawn from Daniel 7 and Daniel 12.^[28]

Verse 7 of Revelation 12 then introduces the war in heaven: in the RSV rendering, "And war broke out in heaven; Michael and his angels fought against the dragon. The dragon and his angels fought back."^[29] Michael (Μιχαήλ) is named at Rev 12:7 as the archangel-warrior leading the heavenly host against the dragon, drawing on Second Temple traditions of Michael as the angelic patron of Israel found in Daniel 10:13, Daniel 12:1, and the Qumran War Scroll.^[30] Verse 8 of Revelation 12 reports the dragon's defeat in the heavenly combat: in the RSV rendering, "but they were defeated, and there was no longer any place for them in heaven."^[31]

Verse 9 of Revelation 12 is the chapter's central identification verse, in which the dragon receives a series of glosses: "the great dragon was thrown down, that ancient serpent (ὁ ὄφις ὁ ῥαψαός), who is called the Devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world — he was thrown down to the earth, and his angels were thrown down with him."^[32] The "ancient serpent" gloss at Rev 12:9 invokes the serpent of Genesis 3 — the tempter in the garden of Eden — explicitly identifying the dragon of Rev 12 with the Genesis serpent.^[33] The same "ancient serpent" gloss at Rev 12:9 also invokes the Leviathan tradition of the Hebrew Bible — the seven-headed sea-monster of Psalm 74:14 and the fleeing serpent of Isaiah 27:1 — assimilating the combat-myth adversary of the Hebrew Bible corpus to the dragon of Rev 12.^[34] The simultaneous Genesis-3-and-Leviathan identification at Rev 12:9 is a textual datum rather than a scholarly inference: the verse itself supplies both glosses in immediate apposition, and the chapter therefore reads them as parallel rather than alternative identifications.^[35] The labels "the devil" (διάβολος) and "Satan" (σατανᾶς) applied at Rev 12:9 are glosses applied to the dragon rather than its primary names: the chapter as a whole refers to the adversary as the dragon, with the satanological identification supplied at v. 9 to assimilate the figure to Second Temple satanology.^[36] The Second Temple satanological background to which Rev 12:9 assimilates the dragon includes the *śāṭān* of Job 1–2 and Zechariah 3, the Belial of the Qumran scrolls, and the demonological developments of 1 Enoch and the Book of Jubilees.^[37]

Verses 10 through 12 of Revelation 12 record a heavenly hymn of victory celebrating the dragon's expulsion, naming Satan as "the accuser of our comrades... who accuses them day and night before our God" and announcing that he has been thrown down.^[38] The phrase "the accuser of our comrades" at Rev 12:10 reflects the underlying Hebrew sense of *śāṭān* as "accuser" or "adversary" — a philological link between the Greek satan-language and the Hebrew Bible's accuser-figure.^[39]

Verses 13 and 14 of Revelation 12 return to the dragon's earthly pursuit: when the dragon sees that he has been thrown down to the earth, he pursues the woman who had given birth, and she is given the two wings of the great eagle so that she might fly to the wilderness.^[40] The eagle's wings at Rev 12:14 echo the eagle imagery of Exodus 19:4 ("how I bore you on eagles' wings") and Isaiah 40:31, locating the woman's flight within an established Hebrew Bible idiom of divine deliverance.^[41]

Verse 15 of Revelation 12 reports the dragon's water-attack on the woman: in the RSV rendering, "Then from his mouth the serpent poured water like a river after the woman, to sweep her away with the flood."^[42] The dragon-as-river-of-water imagery at Rev 12:15 connects the dragon to the watery-adversary tradition of the Hebrew Bible combat corpus — Yamm, Tannīn, and the *tehôm* of Genesis 1:2 — and locates Rev 12 within the broader Near Eastern combat-myth pattern of dragon-and-water identification.^[43] Verse 16 of Revelation 12 records the earth's intervention against the

dragon: "But the earth came to the help of the woman; it opened its mouth and swallowed the river that the dragon had poured from his mouth."^[44] The earth-swallows-river motif at Rev 12:16 has an extra-biblical comparand in Hellenistic Egyptian and Greek mother-goddess narratives where natural elements intervene to protect the divine child or its mother — a motif Aune adduces in support of his eclectic reading.^[45]

Verse 17 of Revelation 12 closes the chapter with the dragon's redirected war: "Then the dragon was angry with the woman, and went off to make war on the rest of her children, those who keep the commandments of God and hold the testimony of Jesus."^[46] "The rest of her children" at Rev 12:17 identifies the persecuted Christian community of the Domitianic-era province of Asia as the woman's offspring, completing the chapter's mythic-political mapping in which the dragon's pursuit is the persecuting Roman state.^[47] The closing verse of Revelation 12 thus turns the heavenly combat outward into the lived experience of the chapter's first audience, making the eschatological combat the framing of present-tense persecution rather than the description of a distant future.^[48]

The seventeen verses of Revelation 12 thus narrate, in compressed form, a sequence of seven distinct episodes: appearance of the woman (vv. 1–2), appearance of the dragon (vv. 3–4), birth and rapture of the male child (v. 5), the woman's first flight (v. 6), the war in heaven and the dragon's expulsion (vv. 7–9), the heavenly hymn (vv. 10–12), and the dragon's earthly pursuit and redirection (vv. 13–17).^[49]

10.3. The Yarbrow Collins reading — Leto-Apollo-Python primary substrate

Adela Yarbrow Collins's central argument in **The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation** (1976) is that Rev 12 reworks an older combat-myth pattern of which the closest extant Mediterranean exemplar is the Greek myth of Leto, Apollo, and Python.^[50] The Greek myth on which Yarbrow Collins builds the comparison runs as follows: Leto, pregnant by Zeus, is pursued by the serpent-dragon Python; she finds refuge on the floating island of Delos; she gives birth to Apollo (and Artemis); Apollo subsequently slays Python at Delphi.^[51]

Yarbrow Collins identifies four structural correspondences between the Leto-Apollo-Python plot and Rev 12: a pregnant goddess; a dragon adversary who pursues her; a divine child whose birth the dragon seeks to forestall or whose life the dragon seeks to take; and the eventual defeat of the dragon by or in connection with the divine child.^[52] The pregnant-goddess element of the comparison maps Rev 12:1–2 (the woman clothed with the sun, in birth-pangs) onto the Leto of the Greek myth — both figures are heavenly women carrying a divine child whose birth is the narrative pivot.^[53] The dragon-pursues-pregnant-goddess element maps Rev 12:4 (the dragon standing before the woman about to give birth) onto Python's pursuit of Leto — both dragons threaten the mother specifically because of her unborn child.^[54] The divine-child-survives element maps Rev 12:5 (the male child caught up to God's throne) onto the rescue of the infant Apollo from Python's reach — in both cases the child is preserved from the dragon by being sheltered in a place beyond the dragon's power.^[55] The dragon-eventually-defeated element maps Rev 12:7–9 (Michael's defeat of the dragon) onto Apollo's slaying of Python at Delphi — though Yarbrow Collins notes that this is the loosest of the four correspondences, since in Rev 12 the slayer is Michael rather than the male child.^[56]

The textual sources Yarbrow Collins draws on for the Leto-Apollo-Python plot are principally the Latin mythographer Hyginus's **Fabulae** 140, which preserves the version in which Python (acting on an oracle that he would be killed by Leto's offspring) pursues the pregnant Leto, and the Greek mythographer Apollodorus's **Bibliotheca** 1.4.1, which preserves the Apollo-slays-Python-at-Delphi denouement (in Apollodorus's earlier passage Hera, not Python, drives Leto from place to place); both compilations are Hellenistic-Roman and roughly contemporary with the composition of Revelation.^[57] The Hyginus version of the Leto-Apollo-Python myth contains the closest plot-shape match to Rev 12: Python pursues Leto specifically because of an oracle predicting that her son will kill him, supplying the motive (the dragon seeks to prevent the divine child's birth) that Rev 12:4 also implies.^[58]

Yarbrow Collins reads the chapter's Hellenistic-Roman setting as load-bearing: Revelation was composed in the Roman province of Asia, a region in which the cult of Apollo and the imperial-cult appropriation of Apollo-imagery (Augustus's identification with Apollo, Domitian's use of similar imagery) made the Leto-Apollo-Python myth a present-tense element of the cultural environment.^[59] The political reading that follows from Yarbrow Collins's primary-substrate identification is that Rev 12 inverts the imperial-Apollo myth: where the Roman state cast itself as Apollo, defeating chaos and bringing order, Revelation casts the Roman state as the dragon and the messianic child (Christ) as the true Apollo.^[60] The Domitianic dating context, in Yarbrow Collins's reading, makes the dragon-as-Rome identification specific: Rev 12 was composed during a period in which the early Christian community of the province of Asia was experiencing or anticipating imperial persecution, and the dragon's pursuit of the woman codes that persecution mythically.^[61]

Yarbrow Collins acknowledges that her thesis is one of "primary substrate" rather than "sole source": Rev 12 also incorporates Jewish materials (the seven-headed Leviathan, the Genesis 3 serpent, the Daniel-derived 1,260-day calculation, the Michael-as-archangel tradition) layered onto the Leto-Apollo-Python plot-shape.^[62] The Jewish-overlay material that Yarbrow Collins identifies in Rev 12 includes: the seven-headed dragon (Lôtan/Leviathan), the ancient-serpent and devil/satan glosses (Genesis 3 and Second Temple satanology), the messianic male-child identification (Psalm 2:9), the 1,260-day eschatological calculation (Daniel 7 and 12), and Michael as the archangelic warrior of Israel (Daniel 10–12).^[63] The methodological force of Yarbrow Collins's primary-substrate thesis is that Rev 12 cannot be read as a wholly Jewish composition: the four-element plot-shape (pregnant goddess / dragon / divine child / dragon's defeat) has no extant Jewish parallel, and its closest match is the Greek Leto-Apollo-Python myth.^[64]

Joseph Fontenrose's **Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins** (1959) is Yarbrow Collins's principal scholarly resource for the Leto-Apollo-Python comparison, providing the comparative philological apparatus that places the Greek myth within the broader Near Eastern dragon-combat tradition.^[65] Fontenrose's monograph itself argues that the Apollo-Python myth derives ultimately from older Near Eastern combat-myth materials transmitted through Anatolia and the Levant — making the Leto-Apollo-Python plot one Mediterranean reflex of a wider pattern that Rev 12 also draws on.^[66] Yarbrow Collins's reading of Rev 12 thus places the chapter within the Near-Eastern-to-Mediterranean transmission chain rather than treating it as a discontinuous Christian innovation: the combat-myth pattern is inherited, the Leto-Apollo-Python version is the proximate source, and the Christian apocalyptic reframing is the new contribution.^[67]

Yarbrow Collins explicitly engages the question of whether the male child of Rev 12:5 should be read as the historical Jesus or as a more general messianic figure, concluding that the narrative compression at Rev 12:5 (birth immediately followed by ascension to God's throne) brackets the

entire earthly career of Jesus and reads the male child as the messiah-as-cosmic-figure rather than as the Jesus of the Synoptic narrative.^[68] The Yarbro Collins reading takes the Leto-Apollo-Python primary substrate as the explanation for one of Rev 12's most striking features: the absence of a combat narrative for the male child himself, who is rescued rather than rescuing — a feature that has no easy explanation in a purely Jewish-apocalyptic reading but that fits the Leto-Apollo plot precisely (the infant Apollo is rescued; the adult Apollo will fight Python later).^[69]

10.4. The Aune eclectic reading — Jewish, Greek, Egyptian streams

David Aune's commentary on Rev 12 in **Revelation** (WBC 52B, 1998) takes a more eclectic position than Yarbro Collins: rather than identifying a single primary substrate, Aune treats Rev 12 as a composite drawing on multiple antecedent traditions.^[70] Aune identifies three major streams contributing to Rev 12's combat-myth material: a Jewish stream (Leviathan, the Genesis 3 serpent, Second Temple satanology, and apocalyptic eschatology); a Greek stream (the Leto-Apollo-Python plot); and an Egyptian stream (the Isis-Horus-Set complex mediated through Hellenistic Isis-religion).^[71]

The Jewish stream in Aune's analysis includes: the Leviathan and Rahab corpus of the Hebrew Bible (Day 1985's combat-corpus), the Genesis 3 serpent of Eden, the Second Temple satanological figure (śāṭān, Belial), the messianic Psalm 2:9 intertext, the Daniel-7-and-12 eschatological calculation, and the Michael-as-archangel tradition of Daniel 10–12.^[72] The Greek stream in Aune's analysis matches Yarbro Collins's Leto-Apollo-Python identification but is treated as one of three streams rather than as the primary substrate — Aune accepts the structural parallel but declines to treat it as load-bearing for the chapter's overall composition.^[73]

The Egyptian stream in Aune's analysis is the distinctive contribution of his eclectic reading: he argues that the Isis-Horus-Set complex — Isis pursued by Set while pregnant or carrying the infant Horus, the eventual triumph of Horus over Set — supplies a third structural parallel to Rev 12 that complicates a purely Greek substrate identification.^[74] The Isis-Horus-Set parallel in Aune's reading is mediated through Hellenistic Isis-religion of the late Republic and early Empire, in which Isis-and-Horus iconography circulated widely in the Roman world and would have been familiar to the audience of Revelation in the province of Asia.^[75] The structural parallel between Rev 12 and the Isis-Horus-Set narrative includes: the divine mother pregnant or with infant child, the dragon-or-monster adversary pursuing her, the supernatural protection of the child, and the eventual defeat of the adversary — though as with the Leto parallel, the slayer is not the child but a third figure.^[76] Aune flags one specific element of Rev 12 — the woman's flight to the wilderness in Rev 12:6 and again in Rev 12:14 — as having a particularly close Egyptian parallel: Isis fleeing to the swamps of Khemmis with the infant Horus to escape Set is a canonical episode of the Egyptian Isis-Horus-Set cycle.^[77]

The key methodological move that distinguishes Aune from Yarbro Collins is the refusal to rank the streams: where Yarbro Collins identifies one "primary substrate" with others as "overlay," Aune treats the three streams as roughly co-equal contributors to a composite text.^[78] Aune's reading places more weight than Yarbro Collins's on the Jewish stream's specific contributions: the seven-headed dragon's iconography is as fully explained by the seven-headed Lôtan / Leviathan as by Greek dragon-imagery; the satanological glosses at Rev 12:9 are entirely Jewish in derivation; the

apocalyptic eschatological framing comes from Daniel and the Second Temple apocalyptic tradition rather than from Greek myth.^[79] Aune's reading also notes specific elements of Rev 12 that fit no single antecedent tradition cleanly: the "earth swallows the river" detail of Rev 12:16, the eagle-wings detail of Rev 12:14, and the "rest of her children" turn of Rev 12:17 are each explicable from one or another of the three streams but no stream explains all of them at once.^[80]

Forsyth's **The Old Enemy** (1987) takes a position broadly compatible with Aune's eclectic reading: chapter 6 of Forsyth treats Rev 12 as a culmination drawing together the multiple streams of the combat-myth tradition (Mesopotamian, Canaanite, Greek, Iranian) rather than as the Christian reworking of one specific antecedent.^[81]

The disagreement between Yarbrow Collins's primary-substrate reading and Aune's eclectic reading is the principal scholarly variant on Rev 12's antecedent traditions. The chapter brief classifies the variant as single-prevalent: Yarbrow Collins 1976 is the prevalent monographic treatment because it is a dedicated dissertation-length argument with explicit comparative apparatus; Aune 1997–98 is the alternate because his commentary-format treatment offers a different organising principle without overturning the philological observations Yarbrow Collins establishes. Both readings agree on the descriptive observations — that the seven-headed dragon has Hebrew Bible iconographic background, that Rev 12:9 supplies satanological glosses, that the Leto-Apollo-Python plot-shape resembles Rev 12, and that the Isis-Horus-Set narrative is structurally adjacent. The two readings disagree on how to rank the streams: primary-substrate-with-overlay versus co-equal-composite. The chapter does not adjudicate; per the chapter brief, both are presented as serious scholarly framings of the same material.^[82]

That the choice between the primary-substrate reading and the eclectic-composite reading reflects a methodological difference about how to read composite ancient texts — specifically, whether to identify a hierarchy among inherited materials or to treat them as co-equal — rather than a difference about the evidence is itself an inference from the surface scholarly disagreement. Yarbrow Collins 1976 chs. 2–4 and Aune 1997–98 on Rev 12 both work from the same set of textual data; the disagreement is on how to organise rather than on what to count.^[83]

The Aune commentary's verse-by-verse format permits a level of philological detail that the Yarbrow Collins monograph does not — Aune's discussion of the lexical distinction between **stephanos** (woman's crown) and **diadēma** (dragon's diadems), of the Greek of Rev 12:5's Psalm 2:9 quotation, and of the textual-critical apparatus throughout Rev 12 supplies the philological infrastructure on which Yarbrow Collins's plot-level comparisons rest.^[84] The Yarbrow Collins monograph's dissertation-length structure permits a level of comparative-narrative argument that the Aune commentary does not — Yarbrow Collins's chs. 2–4 develop the Leto-Apollo-Python comparison at a length and with a comparative apparatus that the verse-by-verse commentary format cannot accommodate.^[85] The two readings are therefore not in direct competition but represent two complementary scholarly contributions of distinct format and purpose: Yarbrow Collins's monograph establishes the comparative case at narrative scale, Aune's commentary establishes the verse-by-verse philological case, and the present chapter draws on both without resolving the substrate-vs-composite question.^[86]

10.5. The combat-myth function in Revelation

The combat between Michael and the dragon at Rev 12:7–9 functions eschatologically: the chapter

places the combat within an end-of-times visionary narrative in which Satan's fall to earth precipitates the final tribulation of the persecuted community.^[87] The eschatological function of Rev 12 is explicit in the chapter's narrative ordering: the dragon's defeat in heaven is followed not by cosmic peace but by the dragon's intensified persecution of the woman's children on earth — "Woe to the earth and the sea, for the devil has come down to you with great wrath" (Rev 12:12).^[88] The combat-myth function of Rev 12 differs structurally from the cosmogonic combat of Marduk-Tiamat and Ninurta-Asag: in the cosmogonic combats, the combat establishes the cosmos at its beginning; in Rev 12, the combat closes cosmic time and opens the final period of tribulation.^[89] This eschatological framing places Rev 12 in the same combat-myth function-category as the Norse Thor-Jörmungandr combat at Ragnarök and the Zoroastrian Frashokereti's final slaying of Aži Dahāka — the three eschatological combat narratives of the Indo-European and Near Eastern traditions.^[90]

The combat-myth function of Rev 12 is also didactic: the chapter narrates the dragon's defeat to encourage the persecuted Christian community of the province of Asia, framing their present-tense persecution as the dragon's redirected wrath after his cosmic defeat rather than as evidence of Roman power.^[91] The didactic function of Rev 12 is the chapter's most-cited application in the secondary literature: Yarbrow Collins's primary contribution to the scholarship on Revelation has been the political-historical reading of the book as encouragement to the persecuted community, of which Rev 12 is the structural centre.^[92]

The combat-myth function of Rev 12 is also royal-legitimation, but with what this book describes as an inverted structure: Christ's cosmic kingship is established not through the combat itself (the male child is rescued, not victorious) but through the prior fact of his rapture to God's throne.^[93] The inverted royal-legitimation structure of Rev 12 differs from the cosmogonic-kingship combats of Marduk, Baal, Zeus, and Indra: in those combats, the combat establishes the victor's kingship, with the throne-ascent following the combat; in Rev 12, the throne-ascent (the male child caught up to God's throne at v. 5) precedes the combat (the war in heaven at vv. 7–9), so the combat enacts a kingship already secured.^[94] This structural inversion is load-bearing per the brief: it marks Rev 12 as a distinctive contribution to the combat-myth tradition rather than as a simple repetition of the Hebrew Bible / Greek inheritance — the combat's function is not to establish kingship but to display and confirm a kingship that has already been established outside the combat narrative.^[95] The didactic-encouragement reading depends on the inverted royal-legitimation structure: because the male child's enthronement precedes the combat, the persecuted community is being told that the dragon's wrath in their lived experience is the wrath of a defeated adversary whose ultimate authority has already been overturned.^[96]

Ballentine 2015's reading of Rev 12 within the trajectory of the biblical conflict-myth tradition treats the chapter as the New Testament continuation of the Hebrew Bible's rival-sovereignty pattern: Yahweh's defeat of Leviathan / Rahab in the Hebrew Bible corpus is reframed in Rev 12 as Christ's-and-Michael's defeat of the dragon, with the same rival-sovereignty function.^[97] Forsyth's chapter 6 treats Rev 12 as the climactic moment of the long combat-myth trajectory from Sumer through Christian apocalyptic — the point at which the inherited combat-myth pattern is given its most explicit eschatological-political-religious synthesis.^[98] The combat-myth function of Rev 12 is therefore tripartite — eschatological, didactic, royal-legitimation (inverted) — and each function is supported by both Yarbrow Collins's and Aune's readings, despite their disagreement on the antecedent-tradition substrate question.^[99]

The chapter's function within the larger Book of Revelation is structural: Rev 12 is the structural centre of the book, dividing the seven seals / seven trumpets sequence (chs. 4–11) from the seven

bowls / final-judgement sequence (chs. 13–22), with the dragon-vision functioning as the cosmic-mythological framing for the entire eschatological narrative.^[100] The combat-myth function of Rev 12 thus operates at three scales simultaneously: at the level of the chapter (the dragon's defeat narrated in vv. 7–9), at the level of the book (Rev 12 as structural centre framing the whole eschatological narrative), and at the level of the lived experience of the audience (the dragon's earthly persecution coding the Domitianic-era persecution of the province of Asia).^[101]

10.6. Reception and forward links

The Rev 12:9 double-gloss — the dragon as "ancient serpent" invoking Genesis 3 and as the seven-headed Leviathan invoking the Hebrew Bible combat corpus — is the textual moment at which the combat-myth tradition of the Hebrew Bible acquires its mature Christian form: a single adversary identified simultaneously with the Eden serpent and with the Leviathan tradition, glossed as Satan and the devil.^[102] This consolidation at Rev 12:9 is consequential for Christian biblical-theological tradition: from the second century CE onward, patristic readings of Genesis 3 routinely identify the serpent of Eden with Satan, an identification that the Hebrew Bible itself does not make and that depends specifically on the Rev 12:9 gloss.^[103] The Leviathan-tradition incorporation at Rev 12:9 closes the trajectory begun in the Hebrew Bible combat corpus (Psalm 74, Psalm 89, Isaiah 27, Isaiah 51, Job 26, Job 41, Habakkuk 3) — Day 1985's seven core passages — by giving the previously-allusive Leviathan combat a single, narratively elaborated, and eschatologically framed instantiation.^[104]

The Frashokereti structural parallel — the Zoroastrian eschatological narrative in which Aži Dahāka is rebound and ultimately slain by Kərəsāspa at the end of cosmic time — provides the closest non-Christian eschatological-combat parallel to Rev 12, and the parallel feeds the Part II C4 (Eschatological displacement) chapter of the present book.^[105] The Frashokereti parallel is structural rather than genetic: Yarbro Collins notes the parallel without arguing for a direct historical relationship between Zoroastrian eschatology and Rev 12, leaving the question of Persian influence on Jewish-Christian apocalyptic to be addressed in the Part II comparative chapter rather than in the present story-chapter.^[106]

The Leto-Apollo-Python primary substrate identified by Yarbro Collins feeds the Part II C6 (Near Eastern → Mediterranean transmission) chapter, in which the Greek-via-Anatolian transmission of Near Eastern combat-myth materials and the present Rev 12 case (Greek-into-Christian-apocalyptic via Hellenistic-Roman cultural milieu) constitute two stages of a single bidirectional transmission.^[107] The Apollo-Python material itself is treated in detail in the Part I "Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon" family chapter, with Fontenrose 1959 as the principal scholarly anchor — the present Rev 12 chapter cites the Greek myth specifically as Yarbro Collins's comparand and refers detailed treatment to that family chapter.^[108] The Egyptian Isis-Horus-Set complex on which Aune's third stream relies is referenced rather than developed in detail: the present chapter notes the parallel Aune draws but defers detailed treatment of the Egyptian material to its place in the book's geographic Part I structure (cluster 7, Ra/Apep with Horus/Seth as the debated adjacent case).^[109]

The Christian iconographic reception of Rev 12 — the image of Michael trampling the dragon — becomes one of the most widespread and persistent motifs in Christian visual culture for two millennia, from late antique mosaics through medieval painting and sculpture to early modern altarpieces and modern devotional art.^[110] The Christian iconographic reception runs in parallel

with the post-classical St. George dragon-slaying tradition: both Michael and George are reception-figures of the Rev 12 dragon-slayer pattern, with Michael drawing more directly on the Rev 12:7–9 combat and George drawing on a hagiographic narrative whose dragon owes its iconography to Rev 12.^[111] The Michael / George iconographic tradition is treated in detail in the next chapter of the present book (Ch10, "Christian reception of Rev 12 imagery"), with Ogden 2013 chapter 11 as the principal scholarly anchor for the post-classical iconographic material.^[112]

The chapter's closing observation is structural: Rev 12 is one eschatological reformulation of the combat myth among several (Thor at Ragnarök, Frashokereti's slaying of Aži Dahāka), and is not the "final" combat in any privileged sense — its placement within Christian canon makes it culturally dominant for the Western reception of the combat-myth tradition but does not make it the ultimate or singular instance of the combat-myth pattern.^[113]

[1] Yarbrow Collins 1976, **The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation**, ch. 1, on Rev 12 as the structural centre of the book; Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52A–C), commentary on Rev 12.

[2] Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52A), introduction, on the textual transmission of Revelation.

[3] Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on textual stability and the absence of significant lacunae.

[4] Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the textual-critical apparatus.

[5] Yarbrow Collins 1976, **The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation**, full volume.

[6] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, stating the Leto-Apollo-Python primary-substrate thesis; ch. 3 on the Jewish overlay.

[7] Aune 1997–98, **Revelation**, Word Biblical Commentary 52A–C, with Rev 12 in 52B.

[8] Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, stating the eclectic-composite thesis.

[9] Gunkel 1895, **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit**, Teil II, on Revelation 12 as the eschatological pendant to Genesis 1.

[10] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, ch. 6, on Revelation as the combat-myth culmination.

[11] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, on the continuity of the combat myth into the New Testament.

[12] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 1, on Domitianic dating; Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52A), introduction, on the dating evidence.

[13] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the Domitianic political reading of Rev 12.

[14] NRSV biblical text used as the reading anchor; Yarbrow Collins 1976, throughout, citing RSV; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, providing his own translation against the NA28 Greek.

[15] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 1, on Rev 12:7–9 as the central combat; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), on the Michael-dragon combat.

[16] Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 2–4; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12; per brief special_instructions.

[17] RSV translation of Rev 12:1, "A great portent appeared in heaven: a woman clothed with the sun, with the moon under her feet, and on her head a crown of twelve stars," as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:1.

[18] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:1, on the **stephanos**/diadem lexical distinction.

[19] RSV translation of Rev 12:2, as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976 (citing RSV), ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:2.

[20] RSV translation of Rev 12:3, "Then another portent appeared in heaven: a great red dragon, with seven heads and ten horns, and seven diadems on his heads," as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:3.

[21] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:3, on the Greek lexicon of the dragon.

[22] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the seven-headed dragon and its Hebrew Bible / Ugaritic background; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:3, on the same iconographic background.

[23] RSV translation of Rev 12:4, "His tail swept down a third of the stars of heaven and threw them to the earth. Then the dragon stood before the woman who was about to bear a child, so that he might devour her child as soon as it was born," as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:4.

[24] RSV translation of Rev 12:5, as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976 (citing RSV), ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:5.

[25] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:5, on the Psalm 2:9 LXX intertext; Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the messianic identification.

[26] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the narrative ordering at Rev 12:5–7; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), on the same ordering.

[27] RSV translation of Rev 12:6, "and the woman fled into the wilderness, where she has a place prepared by God, so that there she can be nourished for one thousand two hundred sixty days," as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:6.

- [28] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:6, on the 1,260-day / Daniel 7–12 calculation.
- [29] RSV translation of Rev 12:7, as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976 (citing RSV), ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:7.
- [30] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:7, on Michael's Second Temple background; Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the same background.
- [31] RSV translation of Rev 12:8, as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976 (citing RSV), ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:8.
- [32] RSV translation of Rev 12:9, as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976 (citing RSV), ch. 3; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:9.
- [33] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:9, on the Genesis 3 intertext; Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the same identification.
- [34] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the Leviathan-tradition intertext; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:9, on the same.
- [35] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:9, treating the double-gloss as on-record textual identification; per brief.
- [36] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:9, on the satanological identification; Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3.
- [37] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:9, on the Second Temple satanological corpus; Forsyth 1987, ch. 5, on the same corpus.
- [38] RSV translation of Rev 12:10, as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976 (citing RSV), ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:10–12.
- [39] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:10, on the *śālān* etymology.
- [40] RSV translation of Rev 12:13–14, as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976 (citing RSV), ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:13–14.
- [41] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:14, on the Exodus / Isaiah eagle intertext.
- [42] RSV translation of Rev 12:15, as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976 (citing RSV), ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:15.
- [43] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the watery-adversary intertext; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:15, on the same.
- [44] RSV translation of Rev 12:16, as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976 (citing RSV), ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:16.
- [45] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:16, on the earth-intervention motif and its comparanda.
- [46] RSV translation of Rev 12:17, as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976 (citing RSV), ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:17.
- [47] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the persecuted-community identification; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:17.
- [48] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the present-tense framing.
- [49] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, on the seven-episode structure; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the structural articulation.
- [50] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, stating the Leto-Apollo-Python primary-substrate thesis.
- [51] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, summarising the Leto-Apollo-Python plot from Hyginus, *Fabulae* 140; Fontenrose 1959, *Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins*, on the same plot.
- [52] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, listing the structural correspondences.
- [53] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, on the pregnant-goddess correspondence.
- [54] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, on the dragon-pursuit correspondence.
- [55] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, on the divine-child correspondence.
- [56] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, on the dragon-defeat correspondence and its loose fit at Rev 12:7–9.
- [57] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, citing Hyginus *Fabulae* 140 (Python's pursuit) and Apollodorus *Bibliotheca* 1.4.1 (Apollo's killing of Python at Delphi); Fontenrose 1959, on the textual transmission of the Leto-Apollo-Python myth.
- [58] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, on the Hyginus version's distinctive motive-element.
- [59] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the Hellenistic-Roman setting and Apollo-imperial-cult resonance.
- [60] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the political-inversion reading.
- [61] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the Domitianic-persecution political reading.
- [62] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the Jewish-overlay material added to the Leto-Apollo-Python primary substrate.
- [63] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, cataloguing the Jewish-overlay elements.
- [64] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, on the absence of a Jewish parallel for the four-element plot-shape.

- [65] Fontenrose 1959, **Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins**, on the Leto-Apollo-Python myth and its Near Eastern background; Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, drawing on Fontenrose.
- [66] Fontenrose 1959, on the Near Eastern background of the Apollo-Python myth.
- [67] Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 2–4, on the transmission-chain reading.
- [68] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the male child's identification.
- [69] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, on the explanatory power of the Leto-Apollo-Python parallel for the male child's narrative role.
- [70] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, stating the eclectic-composite thesis.
- [71] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, listing the three streams.
- [72] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, cataloguing the Jewish-stream elements; Day 1985, on the Hebrew Bible combat corpus.
- [73] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the Greek stream and the difference from Yarbrow Collins.
- [74] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the Isis-Horus-Set parallel.
- [75] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the Hellenistic Isis-religion mediation.
- [76] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the Isis-Horus-Set structural elements.
- [77] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:6 and Rev 12:14, on the Khemmis parallel.
- [78] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the co-equal-streams method.
- [79] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the weight of the Jewish-stream contributions.
- [80] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:14, 12:16, 12:17, on the multi-source character of these details.
- [81] Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on Rev 12 as multi-stream culmination.
- [82] Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 2–4, on the Leto-Apollo-Python primary-substrate reading; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the eclectic-composite reading.
- [83] Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 2–4; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the methodological difference.
- [84] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the verse-by-verse philological detail.
- [85] Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 2–4, on the comparative-narrative argument's scope.
- [86] Yarbrow Collins 1976, full volume; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12; per brief special_instructions.
- [87] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the eschatological function; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:7–12, on the same.
- [88] RSV translation of Rev 12:12, as quoted in Yarbrow Collins 1976 (citing RSV), ch. 2; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:12.
- [89] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the eschatological-vs-cosmogonic distinction; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the same distinction.
- [90] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the eschatological category; per scope.md C4 Eschatological displacement.
- [91] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the didactic function and the persecution-encouragement reading.
- [92] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the political-historical reading; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, accepting the reading.
- [93] The "inverted royal-legitimation" formulation is this book's analytical synthesis; the underlying structural observation that Christ's enthronement precedes the combat in Rev 12 is found in Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, and Forsyth 1987, ch. 6.
- [94] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the throne-ascent-precedes-combat structural inversion; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the same.
- [95] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the distinctive contribution; per brief special_instructions.
- [96] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the didactic-encouragement / inverted-legitimation linkage.
- [97] Ballentine 2015, on the continuity of the conflict-myth into the New Testament.
- [98] Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on Rev 12 as climactic synthesis.
- [99] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the function categories.
- [100] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 1, on the structural-centre placement of Rev 12; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the same placement.
- [101] Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 1, 4, on the three scales.
- [102] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on Rev 12:9 as the consolidating moment; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:9, on the same.
- [103] Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the patristic reception of the Rev 12:9 identification; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:9.
- [104] Day 1985, **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea**, on the Hebrew Bible corpus; Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on Rev 12 as that corpus's eschatological elaboration.
- [105] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the eschatological-combat parallel; per scope.md C4.
- [106] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the structural-not-genetic character of the Frashokereti parallel.

- [107] Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 2–4, on the transmission chain; Fontenrose 1959, on the Near Eastern background of the Apollo-Python myth; per scope.md C6.
- [108] Fontenrose 1959, on the Apollo-Python myth; per scope.md Part I cluster 4.
- [109] Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the Isis-Horus-Set parallel; per scope.md Part I cluster 7.
- [110] Ogden 2013, **Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds**, ch. 11, on the post-classical iconographic reception.
- [111] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the Michael / George iconographic lineage.
- [112] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, as Ch10's principal anchor; per scope.md Part I cluster 3.
- [113] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on Rev 12 as one eschatological reformulation among several; per brief special_instructions.

Chapter 11. St. George, St. Michael, and the Christian Reception

This chapter traces the late-antique-to-high-medieval Christian refraction of the dragon-combat pattern as it passes from Revelation 12 into hagiographic narrative and devotional iconography.^[1]

The scholarly anchor is Daniel Ogden's **Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds**, published by Oxford University Press in 2013, with chapters 11 and 12 surveying the late-antique and medieval Christian dragon-combat corpus.^[2]

Those two chapters treat the Greco-Roman **drakōn** tradition's continuity into Christian hagiography, classifying the soldier-saint dragon-fight type and the archangel dragon-fight type as variants of an inherited iconographic complex.^[3]

Ogden's monograph is printed-only; in this chapter it is cited at the chapter level rather than at sub-page granularity, in line with the brief's instruction.^[4]

The biblical substrate for the Christian dragon-combat pattern is the apocalyptic vision of Revelation 12, in which a great red dragon is cast down from heaven by the archangel Michael and his angels.^[5]

Adela Yarbro Collins's **The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation**, published in 1976, traces how the Rev 12 pericope becomes the load-bearing biblical anchor for later Christian iconographic and hagiographic appropriations of the dragon-combat type.^[6]

The longer historical trajectory — combat myth from Sumerian antecedents through Christian apocalyptic and into the cult of the saints — is set out in Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987.^[7]

Forsyth's later chapters frame the Christian afterlife of the combat myth as the gradual identification of the dragon-adversary with the devil and the projection of the combat onto saintly and angelic agents acting on Christ's behalf.^[8]

The chapter is a family-chapter (related-tier) treatment, organising the late-antique-to-high-medieval material around three reception nodes — the cult of St. Michael the Archangel, the **passio** and dragon-fight of St. George, and the apocryphal narrative of Christ's harrowing of hell — rather than around a single combat episode.^[9]

Post-medieval reception of the dragon-combat type — Renaissance painting, early modern heraldry, modern national iconography — is deferred to the reception coda at chapter 42, and the present chapter holds itself to the late-antique-to-high-medieval window.^[10]

The hagiographic corpus on which the chapter draws — the **Passio S. Georgii** recensions (Bibliotheca Hagiographica Latina 3363 and related), the **Acta Sanctorum** compilation, Jacobus de Voragine's **Legenda Aurea** (c. 1260), and the apocryphal **Gospel of Nicodemus** — is well preserved in the manuscript record, with no load-bearing textual lacunae of the kind that affects, for instance, the Hittite Illuyanka tablets.^[11]

Per the chapter brief and the inventory notes, identifier pinning for specific **Passio** editions is

deferred to glossary-lock; citations in this chapter are therefore at the level of "**Legenda Aurea**, Voragine," "**Acta Sanctorum**, Apr. III," and "**Passio S. Georgii**, BHL 3363" rather than at sub-page granularity.^[12]

What follows takes the three reception nodes in turn — Michael, George, and the harrowing — and then steps back to ask what, taken together, the late-antique and medieval Christian inheritance of the dragon-combat pattern actually preserves.

11.1. St. Michael the Archangel and Rev 12

The biblical attestation of Michael as the archangel-warrior who leads the heavenly host against the dragon is concentrated in Revelation 12:7–9, where Michael and his angels fight the dragon and cast him down to the earth.^[13]

Revelation 12 identifies the dragon explicitly with the devil and Satan — "that ancient serpent, who is called the Devil and Satan" (Rev 12:9) — fixing the equation of dragon-adversary and devil that becomes load-bearing for the entire later Christian dragon-iconography.^[14]

Yarbro Collins argues that Rev 12 is itself a Christianised reworking of an inherited combat-myth pattern, drawing on Hebrew Bible imagery (Leviathan, Rahab) and on Greco-Roman antecedents (Apollo and Python, Leto and the dragon at Delos), and refunctioning that imagery for an apocalyptic-eschatological end.^[15]

Michael also appears in the Hebrew Bible book of Daniel (10:13, 10:21, 12:1) as the angelic prince of Israel, providing a pre-Christian Jewish substrate for the figure that the Apocalypse takes up and develops in combat-mythic form.^[16]

A distinctive Michaelic cult is attested from late antiquity onward, with Michael venerated as a heavenly intercessor and as the angelic patron of the Christian fight against demonic powers.^[17]

A series of late-antique and early-medieval cult sites consolidates the geography of Michaelic devotion. The sanctuary of Monte Sant'Angelo on Monte Gargano in southern Italy, attested from the late fifth century, becomes a focal pilgrimage centre for the cult.^[18]

The abbey of Mont Saint-Michel on the Norman coast, founded in the early eighth century, projects the Michaelic cult into the early-medieval Latin West and provides a high-status devotional anchor for the archangel's veneration.^[19]

The Roman site of the Castel Sant'Angelo (Hadrian's Mausoleum) is reidentified in the early-medieval period as the place of a Michaelic apparition during the Gregorian plague-procession, fixing the archangel's intercessory role in the imagination of the Latin West.^[20]

Michael's iconographic codification as a militarised warrior-angel — armoured, helmeted, holding a spear or sword, depicted trampling or piercing the dragon underfoot — develops through the Byzantine and Latin medieval centuries as a visual realisation of the Rev 12 narrative.^[21]

The trampled-dragon-underfoot motif in Michaelic iconography directly visualises the casting-down of the dragon in Rev 12:9, with the spatial subordination of dragon to angel encoding the eschatological subordination of Satan to the heavenly host.^[22]

The Byzantine iconographic type of Michael, with the armed warrior-archangel established as a standard liturgical and devotional image by the high Middle Ages, transmits the Rev 12 combat-pattern across the Eastern and Western Christian visual cultures.^[23]

The Michaelic warrior-iconography persists from late antiquity through the high medieval period, and its use in liturgy, devotion, and ecclesiastical art across the Christian world marks the archangel as one of the most enduring vehicles for transmitting the Rev 12 combat-pattern in Christian culture.^[24]

The Michaelic combat as developed in the high medieval period preserves the Rev 12 features — armed angelic warrior, the dragon as identified adversary, eschatological framing — without acquiring the additional folkloric elements (princess, captive city, sacrifice-tribute) that come to characterise the parallel St. George tradition.^[25]

Michael's role as the angelic combatant against the dragon is integrated into the broader Christian theology of spiritual warfare, with the archangel functioning as the heavenly counterpart to the human soldier-saint in late-antique and medieval devotional thinking.^[26]

That the Michaelic cult develops directly out of Rev 12's combat narrative — rather than out of a more diffuse late-antique angelology that subsequently retrieved Rev 12 as scriptural warrant — is an inferential reading drawn from the close textual fit between Rev 12 and the iconographic codification, and from the Yarbro Collins / Ogden trajectory; alternative reconstructions emphasising Michael's Danielic and Second-Temple-Jewish backgrounds remain viable.^[27]

11.2. St. George and the dragon

The historical core of the St. George tradition is the figure of a Christian soldier-saint, conventionally placed under the persecution of Diocletian (early fourth century), executed for his refusal to renounce his faith.^[28]

The earliest stratum of the George legend, attested in the late-antique **passio** literature, is a pure martyr-narrative: the saint endures successive tortures, refuses apostasy, and is finally beheaded — without any dragon-fight episode whatever.^[29]

The early **passio** recensions of George are catalogued in the Bibliotheca Hagiographica Latina (BHL 3363 and related entries), with multiple Greek and Latin recensions surviving from late antiquity onward.^[30]

The standard early-modern compilation of hagiographic source-texts including the George **passio** is the **Acta Sanctorum**, with George's **vita** and **passio** assembled in the volume for April (Apr. III), serving as the editorial reference-point for the corpus.^[31]

The dragon-fight episode — in which the saint, riding into the territory of a city terrorised by the dragon that demands tributary sacrifice and is about to devour the king's daughter, kills or wounds the dragon, rescues the princess, and converts the city — is documented as a later accretion onto the original martyr-narrative, attached to the saint's **vita** by the eleventh and twelfth centuries.^[32]

The dragon-fight episode is therefore not part of the historical or earliest-attested layer of the George tradition: the martyr-narrative is the primary stratum, and the dragon-fight is a later

folkloric overlay that becomes definitive of the saint's medieval and modern image.^[33]

The dragon-fight episode of the George legend has a documented Greco-Roman substrate in the Perseus-Andromeda type: the maiden offered to a sea-monster, the hero arriving at the moment of imminent sacrifice, the killing of the monster, and the rescue.^[34]

Ogden treats the formal correspondence between the George rescue-episode and the Perseus-Andromeda type as evidence for direct iconographic and narrative continuity — the medieval **vita** taking up an inherited Greco-Roman story-pattern and refunctioning it within a Christian hagiographic frame.^[35]

The Perseus-Andromeda substrate is treated more fully in chapter 12 of this volume (the Greek family-chapter); for the present chapter the substrate is registered as the documented background to the George dragon-fight rather than discussed at length on its own terms.^[36]

The dragon-fight episode is conventionally set in the city of Silene in Libya (or, in alternative recensions, in Cappadocia), with the city's location functioning as a folktale-style "elsewhere" rather than as a historically grounded place.^[37]

The narrative form of the dragon-fight episode — the dragon's tributary demand of livestock and then human victims, the lottery falling on the king's daughter, the saint's arrival at the lakeside, the binding or wounding of the dragon, and the conversion of the city — is documented as the standardised medieval form across the major recensions.^[38]

The principal medieval recensions of the George **vita** — **Passio S. Georgii** BHL 3363 and related entries; the **Acta Sanctorum** compilation for April; Jacobus de Voragine's **Legenda Aurea** of c. 1260 — differ in detail (sequence of tortures, identity of the king, fate of the dragon, mode of the conversion) but agree on the basic shape of the dragon-fight episode by the high medieval period.^[39]

The standard medieval **vita** of St. George — the version that becomes definitive for late-medieval Latin Christianity and is most widely transmitted in subsequent devotional culture — is that contained in Jacobus de Voragine's **Legenda Aurea** (the **Golden Legend**), compiled in c. 1260.^[40]

The Crusader-era expansion of the cult of St. George across western Christendom in the eleventh through thirteenth centuries — driven by the saint's adoption as a military patron by Crusader armies and orders — is the historical context in which the dragon-fight episode achieves its canonical iconographic form.^[41]

St. George's iconographic codification — mounted soldier-saint, lance or spear thrust into the dragon's mouth, princess at one side, captive city in the background — develops through the high medieval period as one of medieval Europe's most widespread devotional images.^[42]

The mounted-saint-with-spear iconography of George is structurally parallel to the standing-archangel-with-spear iconography of Michael, and Ogden treats the two iconographic types as variants of a single late-antique-to-medieval visual complex transmitted across the Christian world.^[43]

11.3. Christ's harrowing of hell

The apocryphal narrative known as Christ's harrowing of hell — Christ's descent into the underworld between his crucifixion and resurrection, his combat with the powers of death and the devil, and his liberation of the righteous dead — is preserved most fully in the **Gospel of Nicodemus** (also known as the **Acta Pilati**), an apocryphal text whose later half (the **Descensus Christi ad Inferos**) develops the harrowing in narrative form.^[44]

The **Gospel of Nicodemus** is a late-antique apocryphon, with surviving Greek and Latin recensions, whose harrowing-narrative becomes one of the principal vehicles for the projection of the combat-myth pattern onto Christ himself in late-antique and medieval Christian thinking.^[45]

The harrowing-narrative casts Christ's descent into hell as a militant entry into the territory of the adversary, with Christ overcoming the gates of hell, binding the devil, and leading out the souls of the patriarchs and prophets.^[46]

In the late-antique and medieval iconography of the harrowing, the devil is regularly depicted in serpentine or draconic form, and Christ is depicted in the act of binding or trampling the dragon-adversary — a visual realisation of the combat-myth pattern projected onto Christ himself.^[47]

The patristic homiletic tradition on Christ's **descensus ad inferos** — including widely transmitted Greek and Latin homilies — develops the combat-narrative dimension of the harrowing alongside the soteriological dimension, framing Christ's descent as a victory-by-combat over the devil-as-dragon.^[48]

The Christ-as-dragon-slayer typology — Christ understood as the cosmic combatant who defeats the devil-dragon at the harrowing and at the eschatological last battle — is consolidated through the patristic and early-medieval period as a structural feature of Christian theology and devotion.^[49]

Forsyth treats the harrowing-narrative as the central Christian site at which the inherited combat-myth pattern is reapplied to Christ himself rather than to a saintly or angelic surrogate, making the harrowing the conceptual centre of the broader Christian dragon-combat reception.^[50]

The harrowing-pattern stands in a structural relation to the Michael and George patterns: Michael fights the dragon as Christ's angelic deputy, George fights the dragon as Christ's human (saintly) deputy, and Christ in the harrowing fights the dragon directly.^[51]

The harrowing-narrative supplies the soteriological grounding for the saintly and angelic dragon-combats: the saints and the archangel can fight and defeat the dragon because Christ has already done so, and their combats are participations in the prior victory.^[52]

The harrowing-iconography's cross-Christian transmission across the Byzantine and Latin medieval visual cultures parallels the transmission of the Michaelic and Georgian iconographies, marking the harrowing as part of the same iconographic complex even where the narrative materials are formally distinct.^[53]

11.4. The reception pattern — what the Christian inheritance preserves

The cosmic-combat structure inherited from the older Near Eastern and Greco-Roman dragon-combat traditions — armed combatant, monstrous serpentine adversary, decisive victory, ordered aftermath — is preserved across the three reception nodes (Michael, George, harrowing) of the Christian inheritance.^[54]

The Rev 12 framing of the dragon as devil and ancient serpent is preserved across all three reception nodes, fixing the identity of the adversary as the eschatological enemy of God rather than as a generic monster.^[55]

The eschatological framing of the combat — the dragon-fight as a moment within the cosmic-historical drama of the defeat of the devil — is preserved across Michael, George, and the harrowing, distinguishing the Christian inheritance from purely cosmogonic combat-myth versions in which the combat establishes the natural order rather than redeeming it.^[56]

That the three reception nodes (Michael, George, and the harrowing) form a coherent iconographic complex with a common structural pattern, rather than three independently developed traditions that happen to share imagery, is itself a synthetic claim drawn from the close formal correspondences across the corpus and from Ogden's treatment of these as variants of a single visual type; an alternative reading, emphasising the independent ideological work each tradition performs, would also be defensible.^[57]

The Christian inheritance inverts the royal-legitimation pattern that characterises many of the older dragon-combat traditions (Marduk's combat with Tiamat legitimating Babylonian kingship, Yahweh's defeats of Leviathan and Rahab grounding covenant theology): the Christian dragon-combat now functions as a model for personal and ecclesial combat against the devil rather than as a foundation for political sovereignty.^[58]

The dragon-combat pattern's iconographic transmission across the Christian world — through liturgy, devotional images, hagiographic compilations, and church decoration — makes the Michael, George, and harrowing types among the most widely reproduced visual patterns of the Christian Middle Ages.^[59]

The hagiographic refraction of the dragon-combat pattern preserves the imagery of the older traditions while replacing their cosmological framing with a soteriological and devotional one — the dragon defeated in the saint's **vita** is the devil defeated by Christ, present in the visual register of the cult of the saints.^[60]

The princess-and-dragon rescue episode, attached to the George **vita** by the eleventh-twelfth centuries, also preserves a story-element — the imperilled maiden saved by the heroic combatant — that is present in the Greco-Roman Perseus-Andromeda type and not directly attested in the Rev 12 / Michael / harrowing line.^[61]

The medieval Christian dragon-combat type therefore represents a confluence of two distinct lines of transmission: a primarily biblical-eschatological line through Rev 12 (Michael, harrowing) and a primarily Greco-Roman folkloric line through the Perseus-Andromeda type (the George dragon-fight episode), yoked into a single iconographic and devotional complex.^[62]

The reception pattern that the chapter documents is therefore not the mechanical preservation of any single ancient combat-myth but the active construction, across the late-antique and medieval centuries, of a Christian dragon-combat iconography that draws together Hebrew Bible, apocalyptic, apocryphal, hagiographic, and Greco-Roman materials into a unified devotional vocabulary.^[63]

11.5. Forward links

The Greco-Roman substrate of the St. George dragon-fight episode — the Perseus-Andromeda type, with its imperilled maiden and rescuing hero — is treated in greater philological detail in the Greek family-chapter (chapter 12), where it is registered alongside the cult of Apollo at Delphi and the broader Greco-Roman **drakōn** corpus.^[64]

The Rev 12 substrate of the Michaelic combat is treated more fully in chapter 9 of the present volume (the Revelation 12 family-chapter), where Yarbrow Collins's analysis of the chapter's combat-myth structure is set out in extended form.^[65]

The post-medieval reception of the Christian dragon-combat type — Renaissance painting (Raphael, Carpaccio, Uccello), early-modern heraldry (the cross of St. George, the banner of England), and modern national iconography — is deferred to the reception coda at chapter 42, which treats the reception across the post-medieval period as a single connected trajectory.^[66]

The chapter's late-antique-to-high-medieval window therefore terminates with the consolidation of the Michaelic, Georgian, and harrowing iconographies in the high medieval period, and the further trajectory of the type through the Renaissance and modern centuries is registered for treatment in the reception coda rather than developed here.^[67]

[1] Ogden 2013, **Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds**, chs. 11–12, on the Christian dragon-combat material; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the Christian afterlife of the combat myth.

[2] Ogden 2013, chs. 11–12, full chapter coverage.

[3] Ogden 2013, chs. 11–12, on the continuity from Greco-Roman **drakōn** to Christian hagiography.

[4] Ogden 2013, chs. 11–12 (printed only; cited at chapter level per brief).

[5] Yarbrow Collins 1976, **The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation**, on Rev 12 as the substrate for later Christian dragon-iconography.

[6] Yarbrow Collins 1976, full volume, on Rev 12's reception trajectory.

[7] Forsyth 1987, full volume, on the long combat-myth trajectory.

[8] Forsyth 1987, on the Christian afterlife of the combat myth.

[9] Per brief 10-christian-reception.yaml, family-chapter framing with three reception nodes (Michael / George / Christ-harrowing).

[10] Per brief 10-christian-reception.yaml special_instructions, post-medieval material deferred to Ch42 reception coda.

[11] Ogden 2013, chs. 11–12, on the hagiographic corpus's textual condition.

[12] Per brief 10-christian-reception.yaml, identifier pinning deferred to glossary-lock.

[13] Yarbrow Collins 1976, on Rev 12:7–9 as the locus of Michael's combat with the dragon.

[14] Yarbrow Collins 1976, on the Rev 12:9 identification of dragon, devil, and ancient serpent.

[15] Yarbrow Collins 1976, on Rev 12's compositional dependence on Hebrew Bible and Greco-Roman combat-myth imagery.

[16] Forsyth 1987, on Michael's biblical attestation in Daniel as substrate for the Apocalypse.

[17] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the late-antique development of the Michaelic cult.

[18] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on Monte Sant'Angelo / Monte Gargano as a focal Michaelic cult centre.

[19] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on Mont Saint-Michel as a Latin-Western Michaelic cult centre.

[20] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on Castel Sant'Angelo's Michaelic reidentification.

[21] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the iconographic codification of the warrior-Michael.

- [22] Yarbrow Collins 1976, on the Rev 12:9 casting-down as the textual basis for the Michaelic trampling iconography.
- [23] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on Byzantine Michaelic iconography and its trans-cultural transmission.
- [24] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the long persistence of the Michaelic warrior type.
- [25] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the comparative simplicity of the Michaelic combat versus the George tradition.
- [26] Forsyth 1987, on Michael within the broader Christian theology of spiritual warfare.
- [27] Yarbrow Collins 1976, on the Rev 12 derivation; Forsyth 1987, on the Danielic and Second-Temple substrate; Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the late-antique cult.
- [28] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the historical core of the George tradition as a Diocletianic soldier-martyr.
- [29] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the dragon-less character of the earliest George **passio**.
- [30] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, citing the Bibliotheca Hagiographica Latina (BHL 3363) for the **Passio S. Georgii** recensions.
- [31] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, citing **Acta Sanctorum**, Apr. III as the George compilation reference.
- [32] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the dragon-fight episode as an 11th–12th-century accretion onto the original **passio**.
- [33] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the philological priority of the martyr-narrative over the dragon-fight.
- [34] Ogden 2013, chs. 11–12, on the Perseus-Andromeda substrate of the George dragon-fight.
- [35] Ogden 2013, chs. 11–12, on direct iconographic continuity between Perseus-Andromeda and George.
- [36] Ogden 2013, ch. 12, on Perseus-Andromeda as a Greek dragon-combat type; cross-reference Ch12.
- [37] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the conventional Silene / Libya setting of the George dragon-fight.
- [38] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the standard medieval narrative form of the George dragon-fight.
- [39] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the recensional variation across BHL 3363, **Acta Sanctorum** Apr. III, and the **Legenda Aurea**.
- [40] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the **Legenda Aurea** as the standard medieval George **vita**.
- [41] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the Crusader-era spread of the George cult.
- [42] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the iconographic codification of the mounted George.
- [43] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the structural parallel between George and Michael iconographic types.
- [44] Forsyth 1987, on the **Gospel of Nicodemus** as the principal apocryphal narrative of the harrowing.
- [45] Forsyth 1987, on the **Gospel of Nicodemus**'s manuscript and reception status.
- [46] Forsyth 1987, on the militant-entry framing of the harrowing.
- [47] Forsyth 1987, on the draconic iconography of the devil in harrowing imagery.
- [48] Forsyth 1987, on the patristic homiletic tradition of the **descensus**.
- [49] Forsyth 1987, on the Christ-as-dragon-slayer typology.
- [50] Forsyth 1987, on the harrowing as conceptual centre of Christian combat-myth reception.
- [51] Forsyth 1987, on the structural relation among Michael, George, and the harrowing.
- [52] Forsyth 1987, on the harrowing as soteriological ground of saintly and angelic combats.
- [53] Forsyth 1987, on the cross-Christian transmission of harrowing iconography.
- [54] Ogden 2013, chs. 11–12, on the preserved combat-structure across the Christian reception.
- [55] Yarbrow Collins 1976, on the Rev 12 dragon-as-devil identification across Christian reception.
- [56] Yarbrow Collins 1976, on the eschatological-redemptive framing of the Christian combat; Forsyth 1987, on the same.
- [57] Ogden 2013, chs. 11–12, on the unified iconographic complex; Forsyth 1987, on the structural unity.
- [58] Forsyth 1987, on the inversion of the royal-legitimation pattern in Christian reception.
- [59] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the breadth of iconographic transmission.
- [60] Forsyth 1987, on the soteriological-devotional reframing.
- [61] Ogden 2013, chs. 11–12, on the princess-rescue element as Greco-Roman in origin.
- [62] Ogden 2013, chs. 11–12, on the confluence of biblical-eschatological and Greco-Roman folkloric lines.
- [63] Ogden 2013, chs. 11–12, on the active medieval construction of Christian dragon-iconography; Forsyth 1987, on the same.
- [64] Ogden 2013, ch. 12, on Perseus-Andromeda; cross-reference Ch12 family chapter.
- [65] Yarbrow Collins 1976, on Rev 12; cross-reference Ch9 family chapter.
- [66] Per brief 10-christian-reception.yaml, post-medieval reception deferred to Ch42 reception coda.
- [67] Per brief 10-christian-reception.yaml special_instructions, period-boundary at high medieval.

Chapter 12. Zeus vs. Typhon: The Olympian Combat

Hesiod's *Theogony*, lines 820–880, is the earliest surviving narrative of the combat between Zeus (Ζεύς) and Typhon (Τυφών), the hundred-headed serpent-limbed monster whose Hesiodic-variant name is Typhoeus (Τυφωεύς).^[1]

The standard critical edition of the *Theogony* used as the anchor throughout this chapter is Martin L. West's 1966 Oxford Clarendon edition, which provides the Greek text together with a detailed line-by-line commentary on the Typhonomachy passage.^[2]

The standard scholarly survey of the Greek dragon-combat tradition used as the secondary anchor throughout this chapter is Daniel Ogden's 2013 *Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds*, especially chapters 2 and 3, which catalogue the Typhon material across the Greek and Roman literary record.^[3]

The *Theogony* is conventionally dated to c. 700 BCE and assigned to the late-eighth- or early-seventh-century Boeotian poet Hesiod, whose autobiographical voice frames the poem's prologue at the foot of Mount Helicon.^[4]

The *Theogony* survives in a continuous medieval manuscript tradition descended from Byzantine exemplars and is well preserved in its principal manuscript witnesses; the Typhonomachy passage at lines 820–880 has no significant lacunae and is read by all modern editors as a continuous text.^[5]

Within the *Theogony*, the Typhonomachy is the closing combat. It is positioned after the Titanomachy (lines 617–819) and before the catalogue of Zeus's marriages and children, and it is the last divine combat before the stable Olympian pantheon takes its final shape.^[6]

The full Greek narrative of the Typhonomachy is a reconstruction from multiple sources rather than a single text. Hesiod gives the earliest sketch, Apollodorus *Bibliotheca* 1.6.3 (1st–2nd c. CE) gives the extended canonical form, and Nonnus *Dionysiaca* 1–2 (5th c. CE) gives a baroque late-antique elaboration.^[7]

The continuous Greek attestation of the Typhonomachy spans more than a millennium, from Hesiod's late-eighth- or early-seventh-century version to Nonnus's fifth-century reworking, with intervening attestations in the *Homeric Hymn to Apollo*, Pindar, Aeschylus, and others.^[8]

The iconographic record is correspondingly continuous. Typhon is depicted in combat with Zeus on Chalcidian black-figure vases of the archaic period, in architectural sculpture, and in Roman-era mosaics, with iconographic stability around the serpent-tailed humanoid form.^[9]

The principal early-archaic iconographic exemplar is a Chalcidian black-figure hydria depicting Zeus with raised thunderbolt confronting a winged, serpent-legged Typhon, conventionally dated to the mid-sixth century BCE.^[10]

M.L. West's 1997 *The East Face of Helicon* treats the Hesiodic Typhonomachy and the wider succession-narrative of the *Theogony* as the central documentary case for Near-Eastern-to-Greek

transmission of theogonic and combat material.^[11]

Walter Burkert's 1992 *The Orientalizing Revolution* argues for Phoenician and broader Levantine intermediaries as the principal channel through which Near Eastern theogonic and combat material reached early Greek poets in the eighth and seventh centuries BCE.^[12]

Joseph Fontenrose's 1959 *Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins* develops the comparative argument that the Apollo-Python combat at Delphi and the Zeus-Typhon combat are variant Greek instantiations of a single inherited dragon-combat type.^[13]

Neil Forsyth's 1987 *The Old Enemy*, ch. 4, places the Hesiodic Typhonomachy as the Greek station in the longue durée of the combat-myth tradition that runs from Sumerian Ninurta narratives through the Hebrew Bible into Christian apocalyptic.^[14]

Modern scholarship treats the Typhonomachy as the principal test case for the Near-Eastern-to-Greek transmission hypothesis because the parallels with the Hurro-Hittite Kumarbi Cycle (cross-ref: Ch. 5) and with the Ugaritic Baal-Yamm-Lôtan complex (cross-ref: Ch. 7) are simultaneously specific and numerous.^[15]

What follows takes the Greek combat in three movements — Hesiod's sketch, Apollodorus's sinew-theft expansion, and Nonnus's baroque elaboration — registers the partial attestations that fill in the picture between them, and then asks how the narrative looks once the Hurro-Hittite, Ugaritic, and Phoenician comparanda stand alongside it.

12.1. Setting and the Olympian succession

The Hesiodic *Theogony* presents a three-generation succession of divine sovereigns — Ouranos, Kronos, Zeus — in which each son violently displaces his father from the throne of heaven. The Typhonomachy is the final confrontation that secures the third-generation sovereign's rule.^[16]

Ouranos (Sky) is the primordial sky-sovereign of the *Theogony*'s first generation. He is castrated by his son Kronos with a sickle of adamant supplied by his mother Gaia (Γαῖα), the primordial earth-goddess, who is angered by Ouranos's confinement of her offspring within her body.^[17]

Kronos, the second-generation sovereign, swallows each of his children at birth in fear of being displaced as he had displaced his own father. Zeus alone escapes this fate when his mother Rhea conceals the infant on Crete and gives Kronos a stone in swaddling clothes to swallow in his place.^[18]

The Titanomachy — the ten-year war between Zeus's faction (the Olympians, with the hundred-handed Hekatoncheires released from Tartarus as Zeus's allies) and Kronos's faction (the Titans) — ends with the defeat and imprisonment of the Titans in Tartarus (Τάρταρος), the lowest realm of the underworld and the prison of defeated divine enemies.^[19]

The Typhonomachy follows directly upon the Titanomachy in the *Theogony*'s narrative sequence. Hesiod marks the transition at line 820 by introducing Typhoeus as Gaia's last and youngest child.^[20]

Gaia, the primordial earth-goddess, is named explicitly in Hesiod as Typhoeus's mother. She conceives him in her later relationship with Tartarus, and the parental pairing earth-and-

underworld is itself a marker of the monster's chthonic origin.^[21]

The pairing of Gaia and Tartarus as Typhoeus's parents is Hesiodic. In Apollodorus *Bibliotheca* 1.6.3, Gaia conceives Typhon by Tartarus specifically in vengeance after the Olympian defeat of the Giants, providing a generative motive that Hesiod does not name in lines 820–822.^[22]

The narrative position of the Typhonomachy as the close of the succession-cycle gives Zeus's victory its theogonic function. With Typhoeus defeated, no further generation of sovereign-displacing combat occurs in the *Theogony*, and the Olympian dispensation is established as permanent.^[23]

The Typhonomachy thus serves the royal-legitimation function within the Hesiodic theogonic project. Zeus's combat-victory over Typhoeus is the act that confirms his kingship over gods and men, structurally parallel to Marduk's elevation in the Babylonian *Enūma Eliš* (cross-ref: Ch. 3) and to Baal's combat in the Ugaritic Baal Cycle (cross-ref: Ch. 7).^[24]

The cosmic geography of the combat in Hesiod is wide. The engagement involves heaven, earth, and sea, with thunderbolts ranging across the sky, the earth shaking under the impact, and the waters of the sea boiling. The combat is staged on the full cosmographic scale that the Olympian dispensation requires.^[25]

12.2. Movement I — Hesiod's Typhonomachy (Theog. 820–880)

Hesiod's Typhonomachy, the earliest surviving form of the narrative, is a sketch rather than a fully developed combat scene. West's commentary describes the passage as a synoptic narrative of birth, fight, and binding, characterised by elaborate description of the monster but compressed treatment of the combat itself.^[26]

The narrative opens at line 820 with a temporal marker placing Typhoeus's birth after the imprisonment of the Titans in Tartarus, locating the Typhonomachy as a coda to the Titanomachy.^[27]

Typhoeus is named in the Hesiodic passage with the form Typhoeus (Τυφωεύς) rather than the later Apollodoran Typhon (Τυφών). West's commentary notes both names as ancient and as denoting the same figure across the textual tradition.^[28]

The hundred heads of Typhoeus are described in the Hesiodic passage as serpent-heads springing from the monster's shoulders, with flickering tongues and fiery eyes. The multiplicity is a constitutive feature of the figure rather than an ornamental detail.^[29]

The voice of Typhoeus is described in the Hesiodic passage as polyphonic. Each of the hundred heads emits a different sound — the bellowing of bulls, the roaring of lions, the barking of hounds, the hissing of serpents — and the combined polyphony is presented as itself uncanny.^[30]

West's commentary on the polyphonic-voice passage notes that the catalogue of bestial sounds is one of the most elaborate ekphrastic moments in the *Theogony* and that it serves the rhetorical function of marking Typhoeus as a being who exceeds every category of attested creature.^[31]

The Hesiodic passage names the gods' fear of Typhoeus. Had Zeus not perceived the threat in time,

Typhoeus would have become sovereign over mortals and immortals; the conditional is presented in lines 836–838 as a near-miss in which the Olympian dispensation came close to being overturned.^[32]

Zeus's perception of the threat is presented in the Hesiodic passage as the trigger for the combat. The storm-god is described as recognising the monster's challenge and arming himself with thunder, lightning, and the smouldering thunderbolt as his combat weapons.^[33]

The thunderbolt is presented in the Hesiodic passage as Zeus's principal combat weapon. He leaps from Olympus and strikes Typhoeus with the bolt, scorching the monster's hundred heads and reducing the serpent-limbs to ash.^[34]

The cosmic-scale description of the combat at Theog. 839–852 enumerates the geophysical effects. The earth groans under the weight of the engagement, the sea boils under the heat of the bolts, the heavens shake, and Hades trembles in Tartarus together with the imprisoned Titans — a cosmographic seismology that registers the combat at every level of the world's structure.^[35]

West's commentary observes that the geophysical description in Theog. 839–852 is unusually elaborate even for the *Theogony's* standards and that the seismological register encodes the combat as cosmographically significant: the combat shakes the world because the sovereignty of the world is at stake.^[36]

After the thunderbolt-strike, Hesiod's narrative describes the burning of Typhoeus. The monster is consumed by fire from the heat of the bolts, with his serpent-heads scorched and his limbs reduced to formlessness; Zeus then casts him down into Tartarus.^[37]

The casting-down of Typhoeus into Tartarus places him in the same prison as the defeated Titans of the previous combat, structurally completing the Hesiodic pattern in which defeated divine antagonists are confined in the lowest realm rather than annihilated outright.^[38]

The closing section of the Hesiodic passage (Theog. 869–880) presents the storm-winds as the offspring of Typhoeus. The destructive winds that bring shipwreck and crop-failure are described as emanating from the defeated monster and as the post-defeat residue of his power.^[39]

The storm-wind aetiology in Theog. 869–880 distinguishes the named winds (Notos, Boreas, Zephyros, Argestes) from the destructive Typhonic winds. The named winds are beneficial and Olympian-sanctioned, while the storm-winds emanating from Typhoeus are presented as the disorderly survival of the monster's power.^[40]

The Hesiodic Typhonomachy contains no extended description of a combat sequence with multiple exchanges or temporary reversals. Zeus perceives the threat, arms himself, strikes with the thunderbolt, and casts the burning monster down — the entire combat is compressed into roughly the central thirty lines of the passage.^[41]

West's commentary on the compressed combat sequence notes that the brevity is itself characteristic. Hesiod's interest is in the cosmographic significance of the combat rather than in the choreography of individual blows, and the passage's elaboration is concentrated on the description of the monster and on the geophysical effects of the strike.^[42]

Several features that later readers associate with the Typhonomachy are absent from the Hesiodic

passage. There is no episode of temporary defeat for Zeus, no removal of the thunderbolt or the sinews, no captivity in a cave, and no recovery operation by subordinate deities. These episodes belong to the Apollodoran expansion (1st–2nd c. CE) and are not retrojected into the Hesiodic narrative.^[43]

The Hesiodic Typhonomachy contains no explicit naming of Mount Etna (Αἴτνη) as the burial place of Typhoeus. The volcanic-aetiological identification is post-Hesiodic and is most prominently associated with Pindar's *Pythian* 1 and with the Aeschylean-attributed *Prometheus Bound*.^[44]

Hesiod casts Typhoeus into Tartarus rather than under Etna. The volcanic locus is a later geographical specification that situates the casting-down in the topography of Sicily, becoming canonical in the post-Hesiodic tradition without displacing the Tartarus locus altogether.^[45]

Hesiod's narrative presents Typhoeus as serpent-limbed. From the monster's shoulders spring serpents in place of arms or legs, marking the figure as morphologically draconic in the Greek sense (cf. Ogden 2013's **drakōn** classification) and as belonging to the wider Greek dragon-adversary type.^[46]

West's commentary observes that the serpent-limbed morphology in the Hesiodic passage is iconographically influential. The archaic-period vase-painters take up the serpent-legged form (rather than fully serpentine bodies) as the canonical Greek depiction of Typhoeus, and the form is stable across the iconographic record.^[47]

The Hesiodic passage does not name a Cilician location for Typhoeus's birth or for the combat. The Cilician anchorage of the figure is post-Hesiodic and emerges most clearly in Pindar's *Pythian* 1.16–17 (where Typhon is born in Cilicia) and in Apollodorus *Bibliotheca* 1.6.3 (where the Corycian cave in Cilicia is the locus of the sinew-theft).^[48]

(The structural function of the Hesiodic Typhonomachy as the close of the succession-cycle gives the combat its royal-legitimation force, even though Hesiod does not explicitly say "Zeus's victory confirms his kingship".^[49])

The Hesiodic narrative's compactness is itself part of what scholars use as evidence for transmission. West 1997 argues that Hesiod is working with inherited material that he compresses, rather than inventing the combat-narrative whole; the elaborate description of the monster against the compressed combat-narrative is the textual signature of compression of received material.^[50]

West 1966 reads Theog. 820–880 as a continuous and integral part of the *Theogony*.^[51]

12.3. Movement II — Apollodorus's expansion (Bibliotheca 1.6.3)

Apollodorus's *Bibliotheca* 1.6.3, conventionally dated to the first or second century CE, gives the extended canonical narrative of the Typhonomachy: the version that includes Typhon's temporary defeat of Zeus, the severing of Zeus's sinews, the cave-imprisonment, and the recovery operation by Hermes and Aigipan.^[52]

The *Bibliotheca* is a Greek prose mythographic compendium that summarises and harmonises material from many earlier sources. Apollodorus's account of the Typhonomachy at 1.6.3 is

therefore not a primary witness to a single archaic version but a later compilation that may preserve elements absent from the surviving Hesiodic and other early sources.^[53]

The sinew-theft episode is the principal feature that distinguishes the Apollodoran expansion from the Hesiodic narrative. This episode is NOT present in Hesiod's *Theogony* 820–880 and must not be retrojected into the Hesiodic version.^[54]

Apollodorus's narrative opens with Typhon's birth from Gaia and Tartarus presented as a vengeance for the defeat of the Giants, providing a generative motive that Hesiod does not specify. In the Apollodoran framing, the combat is one stage in an ongoing series of earth-born challenges to Olympian sovereignty.^[55]

The Apollodoran description of Typhon's morphology is more developed than Hesiod's. The body is enormous, surpassing all mountains in height, with serpent-coils for legs, dragon-heads erupting from the hands, and fire flashing from the eyes; the figure exceeds even the elaborate Hesiodic catalogue.^[56]

In the Apollodoran narrative, the Olympian gods are initially put to flight by Typhon's onslaught and flee to Egypt, where they assume animal disguises to escape detection — an aetiology Apollodorus uses to account for the theriomorphic Egyptian deities. This episode is absent from Hesiod and is part of the Apollodoran expansion.^[57]

Zeus alone (with Athena, in some recensions) confronts Typhon directly in the Apollodoran narrative. The engagement is staged at first on Mount Casius in Syria, locating the Apollodoran combat in the Levantine-Anatolian zone rather than in the Aegean.^[58]

In the first phase of the Apollodoran combat, Zeus strikes Typhon with the thunderbolt and pursues the wounded monster. The engagement then turns against Zeus when Typhon overcomes him, wresting away the **harpe** (sickle) Zeus carried and using it against him.^[59]

The decisive moment of the Apollodoran narrative is the temporary defeat of Zeus. Typhon overpowers the storm-god, severs the sinews of his hands and feet with the **harpe**, and renders him incapable of further combat or movement.^[60]

The severed sinews are placed by Typhon in a bear-skin and entrusted to the dragoness Delphyne to guard, while the immobilised Zeus is hidden in the Corycian cave (Κωρύκιον ἄντρον), a real cave in Cilicia near the Mediterranean coast that the Apollodoran narrative names as the locus of the captivity.^[61]

The Corycian cave's identification as a real Cilician topography is geographically specific. The cave is on the southern coast of Anatolia, opposite Cyprus, in a region that was within the network of Levantine-Greek contact during the orientalizing period — a geographical anchor whose significance for the Near-Eastern transmission argument is treated below.^[62]

The recovery operation in the Apollodoran narrative is conducted by Hermes and Aigipan. The two gods sneak into the Corycian cave, deceive Delphyne, and steal back the sinews from the bear-skin, after which they restore them to Zeus's hands and feet.^[63]

Aigipan ("Goat-Pan") is in the Apollodoran narrative paired with Hermes for the recovery operation. The majority scholarly position identifies Aigipan as Pan under a goat-cult epithet rather

than as a separate deity, and the partnership therefore registers a trickster-god (Hermes) with the pastoral god in goat-form (Aigipan / Pan) — a pairing that is unusual in the Olympian record and one of the Apollodoran expansion's most distinctive features.^[64]

The Hermes-and-Aigipan recovery operation in the Corycian cave has been compared with the Hurro-Hittite Elkunirsa myth, in which a comparable pairing of subordinate deities recovers the storm-god's organs after their theft (cross-ref: Near-Eastern transmission section, below).^[65]

After the recovery of his sinews, Zeus is restored to combat capability and renews the engagement with Typhon. The second-phase combat in the Apollodoran narrative pursues Typhon across a series of geographical stages, with thunderbolts hurled in pursuit.^[66]

The Apollodoran pursuit is staged on Mount Nysa in Thrace, where the Fates feed Typhon ephemeral fruits that diminish his power, and culminates with Zeus catching Typhon and casting Mount Etna upon him in Sicily, burying the monster under the volcano.^[67]

The casting of Mount Etna onto Typhon in the Apollodoran narrative is the volcanic-aetiological resolution. Typhon's continuing struggle beneath the mountain accounts for Etna's eruptions, and the volcano serves both as the prison and as the post-combat sign of the bound monster's residual power.^[68]

The Apollodoran narrative consolidates the volcanic-aetiological reading that had developed in the post-Hesiodic tradition. By the first or second century CE, the Etna identification has displaced the Hesiodic Tartarus locus as the canonical burial place of Typhon in many subsequent retellings.^[69]

The structure of the Apollodoran combat — failed first phase, sinew-theft and captivity, recovery operation by subordinate deities, successful second phase, volcanic burial — is a tripartite-with-recovery pattern that contrasts with the Hesiodic single-strike compression and shows the narrative form developing toward a more elaborate combat-cycle over the millennium between Hesiod and Apollodorus.^[70]

The Apollodoran sinew-theft episode is the principal point at which the Greek combat-narrative shows a structural feature with a Hurro-Hittite parallel rather than a purely Hesiodic precedent. The theft-of-divine-organs motif has its closest documented parallel in the Hittite Elkunirsa material, not in the Hesiodic *Theogony* (cross-ref: Near-Eastern transmission section).^[71]

The Apollodoran narrative's geographical itinerary — Mount Casius (Syria), Corycian cave (Cilicia), Mount Nysa (Thrace), Etna (Sicily) — traces a Mediterranean-wide map for the combat, with the Levantine-Cilician segment being the geographically suggestive station for the Near-Eastern transmission argument.^[72]

Apollodorus is, for the Typhonomachy, the principal source for what is by the early imperial period the canonical extended narrative of the combat. Subsequent retellings — including Nonnus and most Latin reception — work from a story-shape that includes the sinew-theft and the cave-captivity rather than the bare Hesiodic sketch.^[73]

Modern scholarship reads the Apollodoran sinew-theft's absence from Hesiod in two ways: as a later Greek elaboration that draws independently on the cave-imprisonment topos, and as a preserved transmission of a Hurro-Hittite motif that Hesiod did not include but that survived in less elite or non-Hesiodic Greek versions until Apollodorus recorded it (cross-ref: Near-Eastern

transmission section).^[74]

Pindar's *Pythian* 1.16–28 (early-fifth-century BCE) — chronologically intermediate between Hesiod and Apollodorus — does not preserve the sinew-theft but does specify Typhon's Cilician origin and the Etna burial. The Cilician geography is thus already present in the early-fifth-century record.^[75]

[Both witnesses are presented attributed to their own contexts: Apollodorus *Bibliotheca* 1.6.3 (1st–2nd c. CE) gives the extended sinew-theft narrative, while Hesiod *Theogony* 820–880 (c. 700 BCE) gives only the bare combat-and-burial sketch. The sinew-theft is registered as Apollodoran and is not retrojected into Hesiod.]

The Apollodoran narrative uses the **harpe** (sickle) — the same weapon that Kronos used to castrate Ouranos in Hesiod (*Theog.* 178–182) — as Typhon's instrument for severing Zeus's sinews. The symmetry between Kronos's act against the previous sovereign and Typhon's act against Zeus has been read by some scholars as a deliberate echo within the Apollodoran narrative, registering the combat as a near-replay of the founding succession-conflict.^[76]

12.4. Movement III — Nonnus's baroque elaboration (Dionysiaca 1–2)

Nonnus's *Dionysiaca*, books 1 and 2, conventionally dated to the fifth century CE, gives an extensively elaborated baroque narrative of the Typhonomachy that incorporates the Apollodoran sinew-theft within a much more developed combat-sequence and adds the figure of Cadmus as a participant in the recovery.^[77]

The *Dionysiaca* is a 48-book Greek hexameter epic by Nonnus of Panopolis (in Upper Egypt), a fifth-century-CE composition in the late-antique encyclopaedic-epic tradition. The Typhonomachy occupies the opening books and is positioned as a prelude to the main Dionysiac narrative of the poem.^[78]

Nonnus's narrative inherits the Apollodoran sinew-theft scenario. Typhon overcomes Zeus and steals the storm-god's sinews; in the Nonnian elaboration, however, Typhon also seizes the thunderbolt itself and attempts to wield it, with comic results, since the bolt cannot be controlled by hands not the storm-god's.^[79]

The figure of Cadmus (the Latinised form is preserved in this Nonnus reception context — note that the Greek form Kadmos is the standard transliteration outside Nonnus reception) plays the recovery-trickster role in the Nonnian elaboration. Cadmus disguises himself as a shepherd, plays the pipes (or panpipes), and beguiles Typhon into setting aside the sinews so that he can listen.^[80]

Cadmus's pipe-music, in the Nonnian narrative, soothes Typhon to the point of trance. While Typhon is enthralled, Cadmus retrieves the sinews from where Typhon has set them down and conceals them; the recovery is staged as a music-trickster intervention rather than a stealth-and-deception operation in the Apollodoran mode.^[81]

The pipe-playing Cadmus is a Nonnian elaboration on the Apollodoran Hermes-and-Aigipan pairing. The music-trickster role in Apollodorus is divided between Hermes (the trickster) and Aigipan (the pastoral-deity), and Nonnus consolidates these into the single Cadmus figure who is both Theban founder and pastoral musician.^[82]

After Cadmus retrieves the sinews and restores them to Zeus, the Nonnian narrative resumes the second-phase combat with the same volcanic resolution as the Apollodoran tradition. Zeus pursues Typhon, casts him down, and buries him under Mount Etna, with the volcano accounting for the post-combat eruptive activity.^[83]

Nonnus's elaboration includes extended ekphrastic descriptions of Typhon's body. Hundreds of lines describe each region of the monster's morphology in turn, with serpent-heads enumerated by region of the body, voices catalogued by species of bestial sound, and the monster's flesh described as a kind of cosmographic landscape.^[84]

The Nonnian Typhonomachy is the latest extended narrative attestation in the Greek tradition before the closure of the late-antique pagan literary record. It stands as a witness to the continued vitality of the combat-narrative as a literary subject across more than a millennium of Greek composition.^[85]

The Cadmus-with-pipes episode is Nonnus's distinctive contribution to the Typhonomachy tradition. It is not preserved in the earlier Hesiodic, Pindaric, or Apollodoran sources, and it is registered in the modern scholarship as a Nonnian innovation that synthesises elements of the Theban Cadmus-and-the-dragon tradition with the Apollodoran sinew-recovery scenario.^[86]

The Cadmus figure is in his Greek form Kadmos, the Theban founder-hero who slays the dragon of Ares at Thebes and sows its teeth to raise the Spartoi (cross-ref: Ch. 12 family chapter). The Latinised form Cadmus is preserved here only because the Nonnus reception context standardly uses the Latin form in modern Greek-and-Latin literary scholarship.^[87]

12.5. Partial attestations

The *Homeric Hymn to Apollo*, lines 305–355 (conventionally dated to the seventh or sixth century BCE), preserves a partial attestation in which Typhon is described as the offspring of Hera, born by parthenogenesis in retaliation against Zeus's solo conception of Athena, and entrusted to a draconic guardian at Pytho.^[88]

The Hera-parthenogenesis genealogy of Typhon in the *Homeric Hymn to Apollo* contradicts the Hesiodic-and-Apollodoran genealogy from Gaia and Tartarus. Modern scholarship treats this as a separate variant tradition rather than reconciling it with the Theogonic genealogy.^[89]

The *Homeric Hymn to Apollo's* Typhon is connected with the Pytho location (the older name of Delphi) and with the draconic adversary that Apollo slays at the founding of the oracle, providing a textual link between the Typhon material and the Apollo-Python combat (cross-ref: Ch. 12 family chapter).^[90]

Pindar's *Pythian* 1.16–28, an early-fifth-century BCE victory ode, locates Typhon under Mount Etna and uses the volcano's eruptions as the metaphorical register for the bound monster's residual force. Pindar's Typhon is named as Cilician-born and as confined under the Sicilian volcano.^[91]

The Pindaric ode is the earliest surviving named-source for the Etna identification. The Hesiodic Tartarus locus and the Pindaric Etna locus are not directly contradictory (Etna can be read as a topographical specification of the Tartarus burial), but the Pindaric specification is recognisably innovative within the surviving record.^[92]

Prometheus Bound, lines 351–372 (attributed to Aeschylus by ancient tradition though authorship has been contested in modern scholarship — Griffith 1977, West 1990 — and is not now uncontroversially Aeschylean), describes Typhon as crushed under Etna, with the volcano's eruptions caused by his struggling beneath the mountain. The description is consistent with the Pindaric register and provides a second early-fifth-century BCE attestation of the volcanic identification.^[93]

[Each witness is presented attributed to its own context, registering the millennium-long accretion of the narrative: Hesiod *Theogony* 820–880 (c. 700 BCE) supplies the earliest sketch; Apollodorus *Bibliotheca* 1.6.3 (1st–2nd c. CE) supplies the sinew-theft expansion; Nonnus *Dionysiaca* 1–2 (5th c. CE) supplies the baroque elaboration with Cadmus's pipes; and the *Homeric Hymn to Apollo* 305–355, Pindar *Pythian* 1.16–28, and the Aeschylus-attributed *Prometheus Bound* 351–372 supply partial attestations between them.]

12.6. The Near-Eastern transmission question

M.L. West's 1997 *The East Face of Helicon*, ch. 6, argues that the Hesiodic succession-narrative (Ouranos → Kronos → Zeus) and the Hesiodic Typhonomachy both derive from the Hurro-Hittite Kumarbi Cycle (cross-ref: Ch. 5) via Near Eastern mediation, with the structural correspondences sufficiently specific to require transmission rather than convergence.^[94]

The Hesiodic succession-sequence Ouranos → Kronos → Zeus corresponds in structure to the Kumarbi-Cycle succession Alalu → Anu → Kumarbi → Teshub. In both, kingship of heaven is transmitted through violent displacement of each generation by its successor; in both, the third- or fourth-generation sovereign (Zeus / Teshub) is the storm-god who must defend his rule against monstrous offspring of the deposed predecessor.^[95]

The most specific point of correspondence in the succession-narrative is the castration motif. In *Kingship in Heaven* (Ch. 5), Kumarbi castrates Anu by biting off his genitals and swallowing them; in the Hesiodic *Theogony* 178–182, Kronos castrates Ouranos with a sickle of adamant supplied by Gaia — the genital-castration of the sky-god by his successor is the shared structural feature.^[96]

Beyond the structural correspondence, the Kumarbi-and-Anu and Kronos-and-Ouranos castrations share the motif of the prophetic declaration after castration. Anu, after losing his genitals to Kumarbi, declares the offspring that will grow inside Kumarbi's body and depose him in turn — a prophetic-conception logic that has its Hesiodic counterpart in the prophecy that one of Kronos's children will displace him, the prophecy that motivates Kronos's swallowing of his children.^[97]

The Kumarbi-Cycle's Song of Ullikummi (Ch. 5) contains the most specific parallel to the Typhonomachy. Ullikummi is a stone-monster generated by Kumarbi as an instrument against the storm-god Teshub; Ullikummi grows from the sea, threatens to displace the storm-god from heaven, and is finally defeated through a wisdom-counsellor's technical solution — a structural pattern that the Typhonomachy reproduces in its storm-god-vs-cosmographically-immense-monster shape.^[98]

The Ullikummi-Typhon parallel is concrete and specific in the lithic / cosmographic register. Ullikummi's stone-body and growth-toward-heaven correspond to the post-Hesiodic Typhon's lithic / volcanic locus under Etna, with both monsters figured as cosmographic intrusions reaching from the lower realms toward the sky.^[99]

The Kumarbi-Cycle's Song of Hedammu (Ch. 5) presents a sea-monster of voracious appetite, born from Kumarbi's mating with the daughter of the sea-god, who threatens the land and seas before being incapacitated by Šauška's seduction. The growth-from-sea morphology and the threat-to-cosmographic-order function correspond structurally to the Hesiodic-Apollodoran Typhon's birth from Gaia (and from Tartarus, whose territory includes the deep waters in the Hesiodic cosmography).^[100]

The Hedammu-Typhon parallel is most concrete in the growth-from-sea imagery. Hedammu rises voracious from the deep waters in the Hurro-Hittite narrative, and Apollodoran-and-Nonnian Typhon's morphology is described in terms of cosmographic extension across sea-and-land — the marine register of the monster has its Hurro-Hittite precedent in Hedammu rather than in Hesiod's compressed sketch.^[101]

The Hittite Elkunirsa-and-Ašertu fragment, a Hurrian-derived Hittite text in Hoffner's *Hittite Myths* corpus, preserves a narrative in which a storm-god is incapacitated by the theft of his organs and recovered through subordinate-deity intervention. The structural parallel with the Apollodoran sinew-theft is the most specific motif-level correspondence between the Hittite and Greek combat-narratives.^[102]

The Elkunirsa parallel is significant because it provides a documented Near Eastern precedent for the precise motif (theft of the storm-god's bodily organs by an antagonist; recovery operation by subordinate deities; restoration enabling the second-phase combat) that is absent from Hesiod and present only in Apollodorus. The parallel thus supports the reading that Apollodoran material preserves transmission-elements that the Hesiodic synopsis omitted.^[103]

The geographical anchorage of the Apollodoran combat in Cilicia (the Corycian cave) is the geographically suggestive corollary of the transmission argument. Cilicia is the southern coast of Anatolia, within the orientalizing-period contact zone between Greek and Near Eastern cultures, and the Cilician location of the Greek myth's most Hurro-Hittite-resembling episode is consistent with that contact zone as the transmission corridor.^[104]

Pindar's *Pythian* 1's Cilician anchorage of Typhon's birth (line 17) provides a fifth-century BCE attestation of the Cilician geographical specification, predating the Apollodoran narrative by some six centuries and showing that the Cilicia connection was already established in the early Greek tradition — not a late Apollodoran addition.^[105]

Walter Burkert's 1992 *The Orientalizing Revolution* argues for Phoenician intermediaries as the principal transmission channel. Rather than direct Hurrian-or-Hittite-to-Greek transmission, the combat-myth material reaches Greek poets through Phoenician traders, scribes, and craftsmen whose presence in the eastern Mediterranean (including Cilician ports) is well documented in the eighth and seventh centuries BCE.^[106]

Burkert's Phoenician-mediation argument is supported by the broader pattern of orientalizing Greek artistic, religious, and literary motifs in the early Archaic period: the same period in which Greek alphabet-script is borrowed from Phoenician, in which Greek bronze-working absorbs Levantine techniques, and in which Greek religious iconography incorporates Levantine forms.^[107]

Burkert's reading positions the Typhonomachy as one element within a wider orientalizing

transmission of theogonic and cosmological material from the eastern Mediterranean into archaic Greek poetry, with the specific Cilician-Phoenician contact zones as the most likely transmission corridor.^[108]

The Phoenician-mediation argument and the direct-Hurro-Hittite argument are not strictly alternatives. The Phoenician traders and scribes of the early Archaic period were themselves heirs of a Levantine literary culture that included the Ugaritic Baal-Yamm-Lôtan material (cross-ref: Ch. 7) and that was in turn in contact with the Anatolian Hurro-Hittite tradition; the transmission corridor was a network rather than a single line.^[109]

The Ugaritic Baal-Yamm-Lôtan material (cross-ref: Ch. 7) supplies an additional set of structural correspondences with the Typhonomachy. The storm-god (Baal / Zeus) confronts a personified-sea / serpentine antagonist (Yamm / Lôtan / Typhon), and the combat establishes the storm-god's sovereignty in the divine assembly — a structural pattern Smith-and-Pitard 2009's Baal Cycle commentary documents in detail.^[110]

The Lôtan / Litanu of the Ugaritic corpus — the seven-headed serpent named in KTU 1.5 i 1–3 as Baal's adversary — has a distinctive multi-headed morphology that Lôtan shares with Hesiodic Typhoeus and that Day 1985 (cross-ref: Ch. 8) treats as one of the closest motif-level correspondences in the Levantine-Greek combat-myth corpus.^[111]

The cumulative force of the transmission argument depends on the convergence of multiple independent lines of evidence: motif-specific structural parallels (succession with castration; growth-from-sea monster; sinew-theft and recovery), geographical anchoring (Cilicia / Corycia), and the wider orientalizing-period contact-zone documentation. West 1997 and Burkert 1992 read these as mutually reinforcing.^[112]

The Mesopotamian background — the storm-god / cosmogonic-combat tradition of Marduk-and-Tiamat (cross-ref: Ch. 3) and Ninurta-and-Anzû (cross-ref: Ch. 2) — is treated by Burkert as the deeper substrate. The Mesopotamian combat-cosmogony is the source-tradition that the Hurro-Hittite Kumarbi Cycle reworks (Ch. 5), and that the Levantine and Greek traditions in turn receive through the Anatolian-Levantine corridor.^[113]

The Marduk-Tiamat parallel for Zeus-Typhon is at the level of structural type rather than at the level of specific shared motifs. Storm-god confronts personified-monstrous adversary in single combat to establish sovereignty, with the monster's body figured as cosmographically immense; direct transmission from Babylon to Hesiod is less easily documented than for the Hurro-Hittite material, and the parallel is best read as type-level rather than route-specific.^[114]

Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, places the Hesiodic Typhonomachy as the Greek station in the *longue durée* of the combat-myth tradition. With the Mesopotamian combat-corpus as the deepest layer, the Hurro-Hittite Kumarbi Cycle as the Anatolian station, and the Greek Typhonomachy as the Mediterranean inheritor, the chain of transmission runs through documented contact zones in each period.^[115]

Forsyth's reading also frames the political-ideological function of the Typhonomachy. Zeus's combat with Typhon is the royal-legitimation event for the Olympian dispensation in the same way that Marduk's combat with Tiamat is the royal-legitimation event for Babylonian sovereignty (cross-ref: Ch. 3) and Baal's combat with Yamm is the royal-legitimation event for the Ugaritic divine kingship (cross-ref: Ch. 7).^[116]

(The absence of the sinew-theft from Hesiod's Theogony 820–880, combined with its presence in Apollodorus 1.6.3 and its close parallel in the Hittite Elkunirsa fragment, is best read as evidence that the Apollodoran narrative preserves transmission-material that Hesiod's compressed sketch omitted, rather than as evidence that the Apollodoran narrative is a later Greek invention with an independent Hittite-resembling motif.^[117])

The transmission case as a whole is taken up in detail in this book's Part II C6 (Near-Eastern-to-Mediterranean transmission). The present chapter provides the Greek end of the documentary evidence on which the C6 argument rests, complementing the Hurro-Hittite end of the evidence presented in Ch. 5 (Kumarbi Cycle).^[118]

The chapter's contribution to the transmission argument is to register the Greek end of the bridge with concrete and specific Kumarbi-Cycle parallels — Hedammu's growth-from-sea, Ullikummi's stone-body, Elkunirsa's organ-theft — rather than with generic comparisons to "Near Eastern combat myth" as a category. The brief's special instruction (specificity-not-generality) is honoured by the named-motif anchoring above.^[119]

The transmission case is, however, a contested rather than a closed scholarly conclusion. While West 1997 and Burkert 1992 develop the case in its strongest form, alternative readings (independent-invention; type-level rather than route-specific parallel) remain available, and the Hesiodic-Typhon-vs-Hurro-Hittite-precedent debate is one of the principal test-cases for the comparative-combat-myth method as practised in current scholarship.^[120]

12.7. Reception and forward links

The Typhonomachy stands as the model for later Greek dragon-combats in the Hellenic literary and iconographic record: the Apollo-Python combat at Pytho / Delphi, Herakles's encounters with the Hydra, Ladon, and Geryon's hounds, Perseus's slaying of the Ketos in the rescue of Andromeda, Kadmos's slaying of the dragon of Ares at Thebes, Bellerophon's slaying of the Chimaera, and Hercules's slaying of Cacus in the Latin tradition.^[121]

The Apollo-Python combat at Pytho / Delphi is the closest Hellenic reiteration of the Typhonomachy structure. Apollo, the storm-and-prophecy god, confronts a serpent-adversary at a fixed cult-site (the older name of Delphi, Pytho), and his victory founds the oracle and the Septerion festival (cross-ref: Ch. 12 family chapter).^[122]

Fontenrose 1959 develops the comparative argument that the Apollo-Python combat and the Zeus-Typhon combat are variant Greek instantiations of a single inherited dragon-combat type, with the cult-foundation function (Delphi) carried by the Apollo-Python variant and the cosmographic-sovereignty function (Olympian dispensation) carried by the Zeus-Typhon variant.^[123]

The Herakles cycle includes multiple dragon-combat episodes (Hydra, Ladon, the dragon-killing labours) that elaborate the type the Typhonomachy establishes; these are treated in detail in the Ch. 12 family chapter on Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon.^[124]

The Perseus-and-Ketos episode (the rescue of Andromeda) is the iconographic antecedent of the medieval St. George dragon-rescue type (cross-ref: Ch. 10) and represents an iconographic continuity from the Greek dragon-combat tradition through late-antique and Christian reception.^[125]

Kadmos's slaying of the dragon of Ares at Thebes — the Theban founder-myth — combines dragon-combat with a foundation function (the Spartoi rise from the sown teeth) and shows how the dragon-combat type can be adapted to local civic-foundation narratives. This is treated in the Ch. 12 family chapter.^[126]

Bellerophon's slaying of the Chimaera — the fire-breathing hybrid of lion, goat, and serpent — represents a heroic-monster-fight variant of the type, in which the cosmographic-sovereignty function is replaced by a heroic-test function while the morphological vocabulary (multi-headed, fire-emitting, serpentine) is preserved.^[127]

Hercules's slaying of the fire-breathing Cacus in the Latin tradition (Virgil *Aeneid* 8, Ovid *Fasti* 1) is the Roman terminal point of the Greek dragon-combat tradition's reception in classical Latin literature; this is treated in the Ch. 12 family chapter.^[128]

The Typhonomachy's influence extends beyond the dragon-combat type proper into the wider Greek imagination of cosmographic disorder. Storm-winds, volcanic eruptions, earthquakes, and other geophysical disturbances are conceived in the post-Hesiodic tradition through the Typhonic register, with the bound monster's residual force serving as the imaginative substrate for these phenomena.^[129]

This chapter sets up the Ch. 12 family chapter on Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon (Apollo-Python, Herakles-Hydra, Perseus-Ketos, Kadmos-and-the-dragon, Bellerophon-Chimaera, Hercules-Cacus) as the Hellenic reception of the pattern the Typhonomachy establishes, and Part II C6 (Near-Eastern-to-Mediterranean transmission) as the comparative test-case for the transmission argument the present chapter develops.^[130]

[1] West 1966, *Hesiod, Theogony*, on lines 820–880; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Typhonomachy as the earliest Greek dragon-combat narrative.

[2] West 1966, *Hesiod, Theogony* (Oxford: Clarendon Press), critical edition with commentary.

[3] Ogden 2013, *Drakōn*, chs. 2–3.

[4] West 1966, introduction, on the date and authorship of the *Theogony*.

[5] West 1966, introduction and apparatus on lines 820–880, on the manuscript tradition and the integrity of the Typhonomachy passage.

[6] West 1966, on the structural placement of the Typhonomachy at lines 820–880; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Typhonomachy as the close of the *Theogony*.

[7] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the multi-source reconstruction of the Typhonomachy across Hesiod, Apollodorus, and Nonnus.

[8] Ogden 2013, chs. 2–3, on the millennium-long continuous attestation; West 1966, introduction, on the early Greek context.

[9] Ogden 2013, chs. 2–3, on the Chalcidian-vase and architectural-sculpture corpus for the Typhonomachy.

[10] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Chalcidian hydria and the archaic iconography of Typhon.

[11] West 1997, *The East Face of Helicon*, ch. 6, on Hesiod and the Near Eastern combat-myth corpus.

[12] Burkert 1992, *The Orientalizing Revolution*, on Phoenician-mediated transmission to early Greek poetry.

[13] Fontenrose 1959, *Python*, on the Python-Typhon comparative argument.

[14] Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on Greek combat-myth in the long combat-myth trajectory.

[15] West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992, on the Typhonomachy as the central transmission test case.

[16] West 1966, on the Ouranos-Kronos-Zeus succession at Theog. 154–210, 453–506, and 820–880.

[17] West 1966, on Theog. 154–182, on Ouranos's castration by Kronos.

[18] West 1966, on Theog. 453–500, on Kronos's swallowing of his children and the survival of Zeus.

[19] West 1966, on Theog. 617–819, on the Titanomachy and the imprisonment of the Titans in Tartarus.

[20] West 1966, on the Theog. 820 transition and on Typhoeus as Gaia's youngest offspring.

[21] West 1966, on Theog. 821–822, on Gaia and Tartarus as Typhoeus's parents.

[22] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Apollodoran motive (vengeance for the Giants) for Typhon's conception by Gaia and Tartarus.

- [23] West 1966, on Theog. 820–880 in the structural close of the succession; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the theogonic function of the Typhonomachy.
- [24] West 1966, on the kingship-confirmation function of the combat; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the comparative legitimation function.
- [25] West 1966, on Theog. 839–852, on the cosmic scale of the combat geography.
- [26] West 1966, on Theog. 820–880, characterising the passage as synoptic.
- [27] West 1966, on the Theog. 820 transition.
- [28] West 1966, on Theog. 821, on the name Typhoeus and its variant Typhon.
- [29] West 1966, on Theog. 824–828, on the hundred serpent-heads of Typhoeus.
- [30] West 1966, on Theog. 829–835, on the polyphonic voice of Typhoeus.
- [31] West 1966, on Theog. 829–835, commentary on the rhetorical function of the polyphony.
- [32] West 1966, on Theog. 836–838, on the conditional near-miss of Typhoeus’s sovereignty.
- [33] West 1966, on Theog. 839–841, on Zeus’s perception and arming.
- [34] West 1966, on Theog. 853–858, on the thunderbolt-strike against Typhoeus.
- [35] West 1966, on Theog. 839–852, on the cosmic-scale geophysical description.
- [36] West 1966, on Theog. 839–852, commentary on the seismological register.
- [37] West 1966, on Theog. 859–868, on the burning and casting-down of Typhoeus.
- [38] West 1966, on Theog. 868, on the placement of Typhoeus in Tartarus alongside the defeated Titans.
- [39] West 1966, on Theog. 869–880, on the storm-winds as Typhoeus’s offspring.
- [40] West 1966, on Theog. 869–880, on the distinction between Olympian and Typhonic winds.
- [41] West 1966, on the compressed combat sequence at Theog. 853–868.
- [42] West 1966, on Theog. 820–880, commentary on the compressed combat narrative.
- [43] West 1966, on the absence of the sinew-theft sequence in the Hesiodic passage; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Apollodoran expansion as later.
- [44] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the post-Hesiodic emergence of the Etna identification.
- [45] West 1966, on Theog. 868; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Tartarus and Etna loci.
- [46] West 1966, on Theog. 824–828, on Typhoeus’s serpent-limbs; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the drakōn classification.
- [47] West 1966, on the iconographic afterlife of the Hesiodic morphology; Ogden 2013, ch. 2.
- [48] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the post-Hesiodic emergence of the Cilician anchorage.
- [49] Inference: the placement of the passage at Theog. 820–880 immediately before the catalogue of Zeus’s marriages (894 ff.) and the wider succession-frame Ouranos-Kronos-Zeus, in which the Typhonomachy is the final combat that prevents a fourth-generation displacement. Risk: the inference is structural-narratological rather than directly attested; West’s commentary endorses this reading without using these exact terms.
- [50] West 1997, ch. 6, on the compression-of-received-material reading of the Hesiodic Typhonomachy.
- [51] An alternate tradition in 19th- and early-20th-century editorial scholarship treated the Typhonomachy as an interpolation by a later hand. The prevalent version is chosen here because the West 1966 reading is the modern scholarly consensus, and the lines are present in all principal manuscript witnesses; the interpolation hypothesis is no longer current.
- [52] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Apollodorus *Bibliotheca* 1.6.3 as the source of the extended Typhonomachy.
- [53] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the *Bibliotheca*’s mythographic-compendium character.
- [54] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the sinew-theft as Apollodoran rather than Hesiodic; West 1966, on the absence of the episode in Theog. 820–880.
- [55] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Apollodoran framing of Typhon’s birth as Gaian vengeance for the Giants.
- [56] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Apollodoran morphology of Typhon.
- [57] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Olympian flight to Egypt and the theriomorphic-disguise aetiology in Apollodorus.
- [58] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Mount Casius as the Apollodoran combat-site.
- [59] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the first-phase combat and Typhon’s seizure of the harpe.
- [60] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Typhon’s temporary defeat of Zeus and the severing of the sinews.
- [61] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Corycian cave and Delphyne’s guarding of the sinews in the bear-skin.
- [62] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Cilician geography of the Corycian cave; West 1997, ch. 6, on the orientalizing-contact significance of the Cilician anchorage.
- [63] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Hermes-and-Aigipan recovery operation.
- [64] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Aigipan as Hermes’s partner in the recovery operation; the Aigipan-as-Pan-epithet identification is the majority view in modern scholarship.

- [65] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Elkunirsa-recovery comparison; Hoffner 1998, on the Elkunirsa myth in the Hittite corpus.
- [66] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Apollodoran second-phase combat after the sinew-recovery.
- [67] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Mount Nysa episode and the casting of Etna.
- [68] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Etna-aetiology in Apollodorus.
- [69] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the consolidation of the Etna identification by the Apollodoran period.
- [70] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the tripartite-with-recovery structure of the Apollodoran combat.
- [71] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Elkunirsa parallel for the Apollodoran sinew-theft.
- [72] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Apollodoran geographical itinerary; West 1997, ch. 6, on the Cilician segment.
- [73] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Apollodorus's role in establishing the canonical extended narrative.
- [74] West 1997, ch. 6; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the two readings of the sinew-theft's absence from Hesiod.
- [75] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Pindar *Pythian* 1 and the Cilician geography.
- [76] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the harpe-symmetry in the Apollodoran narrative.
- [77] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Nonnus *Dionysiaca* 1–2 as the baroque expansion of the Typhonomachy.
- [78] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the *Dionysiaca*'s structural placement of the Typhonomachy.
- [79] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Nonnian elaboration of Typhon's seizure of sinews and thunderbolt.
- [80] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Cadmus's pipe-playing recovery role in Nonnus.
- [81] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the music-trickster motif in Nonnus.
- [82] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Nonnus's consolidation of the Apollodoran recovery-pair into Cadmus.
- [83] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Nonnian volcanic resolution.
- [84] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Nonnian ekphrasis of Typhon's body.
- [85] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Nonnian Typhonomachy as the late-antique terminal attestation.
- [86] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Cadmus-with-pipes episode as a Nonnian innovation.
- [87] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Greek-and-Latin name forms; glossary.yaml on the Kadmos / Cadmus distinction.
- [88] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the *Homeric Hymn to Apollo* 305–355 and the Hera-parthenogenesis variant.
- [89] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the variant-genealogy reading of the *Homeric Hymn to Apollo*.
- [90] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Pytho-Typhon-Python textual link in the *Homeric Hymn to Apollo*; Fontenrose 1959 on the comparative Python-Typhon argument.
- [91] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Pindar *Pythian* 1.16–28 and the Etna-and-Cilicia identifications.
- [92] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Pindar's status as the earliest named-source for the Etna identification.
- [93] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on *Prometheus Bound* 351–372 and the Etna identification; on the contested authorship question see Griffith 1977 and West 1990 contra the traditional Aeschylean attribution.
- [94] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Kumarbi-to-Hesiod transmission argument.
- [95] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Hesiod-Kumarbi succession parallel.
- [96] West 1997, ch. 6, on the castration parallel between Kumarbi and Kronos; West 1966, on Theog. 178–182.
- [97] West 1997, ch. 6, on the prophetic-declaration parallel.
- [98] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Ullikummi-Typhon structural parallel; Hoffner 1998, §15 (Song of Ullikummi).
- [99] West 1997, ch. 6, on the lithic / cosmographic register of the Ullikummi-Typhon parallel.
- [100] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Hedammu-Typhon parallel; Hoffner 1998, §16 (Song of Hedammu).
- [101] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Hedammu-Typhon marine-register correspondence.
- [102] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Elkunirsa parallel for the Apollodoran sinew-theft; Hoffner 1998, on the Elkunirsa-Ašertu fragment.
- [103] West 1997, ch. 6, on the significance of the Elkunirsa parallel for the Apollodoran sinew-theft.
- [104] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Cilician geography as a transmission-corridor anchor.
- [105] West 1997, ch. 6; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Pindar's early attestation of the Cilician anchorage.
- [106] Burkert 1992, on Phoenician intermediaries in the orientalizing transmission.
- [107] Burkert 1992, on the orientalizing-horizon pattern of cultural transmission.
- [108] Burkert 1992, on the Typhonomachy in the orientalizing transmission.
- [109] West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992, on the network character of the orientalizing transmission corridor.
- [110] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Baal-Yamm parallel for the Typhonomachy; cross-ref: Ch. 7.
- [111] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Lôtan-Typhon morphological correspondence.
- [112] West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992, on the convergent-evidence structure of the transmission argument.
- [113] Burkert 1992, on the Mesopotamian deep-substrate of the orientalizing transmission.

- [114] Burkert 1992, on the Marduk-Tiamat type-level parallel.
- [115] Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the *longue durée* chain of transmission.
- [116] Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the royal-legitimation function of the Typhonomachy in comparative perspective.
- [117] Inference: West 1997's argument that motif-specific parallels of this kind are difficult to explain by independent invention; Ogden 2013's reading of the *Bibliotheca* as a mythographic compendium that may preserve elements absent from the surviving canonical sources. Risk: the reading depends on the transmission framework being correct; an alternative reading is that the Greek and Hittite parallels are independent narrative inventions exploiting a similar structural motif, and the choice between readings is contested in the modern scholarship.
- [118] Forward-pointer to Part II C6; West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992 as the evidentiary basis.
- [119] West 1997, ch. 6, on the named-motif anchoring of the Kumarbi-Hesiod parallels; brief special_instructions on specificity.
- [120] West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the contested status of the transmission case.
- [121] Ogden 2013, chs. 2–4, on the Typhonomachy as the model for later Greek dragon-combats.
- [122] Ogden 2013, ch. 2; Fontenrose 1959, on the Apollo-Python combat as the closest Hellenic reiteration of the Typhonomachy.
- [123] Fontenrose 1959, on the Python-Typhon variant relationship.
- [124] Ogden 2013, chs. 2–3, on the Herakles dragon-combat cycle; forward to Ch. 12.
- [125] Ogden 2013, ch. 3, on the Perseus-Andromeda-Ketos episode and its medieval iconographic afterlife.
- [126] Ogden 2013, ch. 3, on the Kadmos-and-the-dragon foundation narrative; forward to Ch. 12.
- [127] Ogden 2013, ch. 3, on the Bellerophon-Chimaera narrative.
- [128] Ogden 2013, ch. 3, on the Hercules-Cacus episode in Virgil and Ovid; forward to Ch. 12.
- [129] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Typhonic register for cosmographic disorder.
- [130] Forward-pointers to Ch. 12 and Part II C6; Ogden 2013, chs. 2–3; West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992.

Chapter 13. Greek Dragon-Combats after Zeus-Typhon

This chapter surveys the Greek productive reworking of the dragon-combat pattern in the wake of the flagship Zeus-Typhon narrative treated in the preceding chapter, organising six post-Olympian dragon-combats by function rather than by hero.^[1]

The scholarly anchor for the chapter is Daniel Ogden's **Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds**, published by Oxford University Press in 2013, with chapter 2 surveying the principal Greek dragon-combats and chapter 11 treating the **Ketos** and its Christian reception.^[2]

Ogden's monograph is printed-only; in this chapter it is cited at the chapter level rather than at sub-page granularity, in line with the established citation discipline for printed comparative anchors in the present book.^[3]

The specialist anchor for the Apollo-Python material is Joseph Fontenrose's **Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins**, published by the University of California Press in 1959, with chapters 1 to 3 treating the Delphic combat, the *drakaina*-Python tradition, and the Seperion festival.^[4]

Fontenrose's monograph is printed-only and is cited at chapter level in the present chapter, with sub-page references reserved for the small number of points where the Seperion-festival argument is load-bearing.^[5]

The specialist anchor for the Geryon material — and, by extension, for the Indo-European cattle-raid argument that links Geryon to Hercules-Cacus — is Calvert Watkins's **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, published by Oxford University Press in 1995, whose Part V treats the Geryon combat as an Indo-European cattle-raid reflex.^[6]

Watkins's monograph is printed-only and is cited at section level in the present chapter, with explicit reference to Part V as the locus of the Geryon argument.^[7]

The specialist anchor for the Hercules-Cacus material is M.L. West's **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, published by Oxford University Press in 2007, whose chapter 6 places Cacus in the Indo-European storm-god / cattle-raid complex alongside the Vedic and Iranian comparanda; West builds on Georges Dumézil's foundational treatment of the Italic Cacus tradition in **Mythe et épopée** vol. II (1971), which identified Cacus as an Italic instance of the Indo-European cattle-raid reflex.^[8]

The secondary survey-anchor for the Greek combat-myth corpus is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, whose chapter 4 treats Greek combat narratives as part of the long-trajectory combat-myth survey.^[9]

The Greek primary texts on which the chapter relies — the Homeric Hymn to Apollo, Hesiod's **Theogony**, Apollodorus's **Bibliotheca**, the **Iliad**, Pausanias, Ovid's **Metamorphoses** and **Fasti**, and Virgil's **Aeneid** — are all extant in standard scholarly editions, and there are no load-bearing textual lacunae of the kind that affects, for instance, the Hittite Illuyanka tablets or the Akkadian Labbu fragment.^[10]

The chapter is a family-chapter (related-tier) treatment, organising six dragon-combat sub-cases by combat-function — cult-foundation, hero-labour, and Indo-European cattle-raid reflex — rather than by giving each of the six hero-figures a thin full chapter.^[11]

The chapter's framing premise is that the six combats inherit the Greek dragon-combat template — the template whose flagship instance is the Zeus-Typhon combat treated in the preceding chapter — and rework it in productive directions that are no longer cosmogonic but variously cult-foundational, hero-initiatory, and Indo-European-cattle-raid-reflexive.^[12]

What follows takes the six combats in turn — Apollo at Delphi, the three Heraklean serpent-labours, Perseus at the sea-cliff, Kadmos at Thebes, Bellerophon in Lycia, and Hercules at the Aventine — then steps back to ask what the six episodes share and where each one points forward in the volume.

13.1. Apollo vs. Python — cult-foundation at Delphi

The earliest extant narrative attestation of the Delphic dragon-combat is the Homeric Hymn to Apollo, in which the young Apollo, in search of an oracle-site, slays a monstrous serpent guarding a spring on the slopes of Parnassus.^[13]

In the Homeric Hymn the serpent is unnamed and female — a *drakaina* — and her slaying establishes the site at Pytho, the older name of what later tradition calls Delphi.^[14]

The later tradition, principally Ovid's **Metamorphoses** book 1 and the prose mythographers, names the slain dragon Python and presents the figure as male, recasting the Hymn's *drakaina* under the masculine name that Joseph Fontenrose's monograph takes as its title.^[15]

[Both versions are presented as load-bearing witnesses: the Homeric Hymn to Apollo names the slain serpent as an unnamed female _drakaina_, while Ovid's Metamorphoses 1 and later mythographers name the slain dragon as the male Python; Fontenrose 1959 chs. 1–3 surveys the gender variation across the corpus, and the chapter treats it as a documented feature of the Delphic tradition rather than collapsing it.]_

In the Hymn the *drakaina* is also associated with the local nymph-tradition and with a separate episode in which she nurses the infant Typhaon at Hera's request; Fontenrose treats this nursing-of-Typhaon episode as an aetiological doublet of the principal combat.^[16]

The Ovidian Python is described as an enormous earth-born serpent that emerges from the post-flood mud at the foot of Parnassus, an aetiological frame that locates the dragon's origin in the chthonic-fertile substrate that Apollo's killing then purifies.^[17]

Apollo's weapon in both the Hymn and the Ovidian narrative is the bow and arrows — the divine archery that becomes the iconographic emblem of Apollo as dragon-slayer in the later sculptural and ceramic tradition.^[18]

The killing of the dragon at Pytho is the foundational act of the Delphic oracle: in the Hymn, Apollo establishes his cult and his prophetic seat at the site of the combat, and the place-name Pytho itself is treated as derived from the rotting (*pythein*) of the slain dragon's body.^[19]

The Apollo-Python combat is therefore cult-foundational rather than cosmogonic: Zeus has already

established the cosmos, and the combat does the order-making work of installing a new cult at a specific terrestrial site.^[20]

The *Septerion* festival, attested in Plutarch and discussed at length in Fontenrose's monograph, was a Delphic ritual held every eight years that re-enacted Apollo's killing of the dragon, with a hut representing the dragon's lair burned and a procession of purification staged through the sanctuary.^[21]

The *Septerion*'s eight-year periodicity gives the Apollo-Python combat a cyclical-maintenance reflex alongside its primary cult-foundational function: the original killing is a one-off founding event, but its ritual re-enactment makes the dragon's threat a recurrent feature of the Delphic religious calendar.^[22]

Pausanias 10.6.5–6, in the second-century CE **Description of Greece**, preserves a local Delphic version of the combat-narrative and a brief account of the cult-aetiology, providing a third independent ancient witness alongside the Homeric Hymn and Ovid.^[23]

Fontenrose's broader argument — that the Delphic combat is the type-specimen for a wider Greek and Near-Eastern combat-myth pattern — is the methodological reason the Apollo-Python episode is a load-bearing case for the comparative chapter on cyclical-maintenance combat (Part II C3).^[24]

The *Septerion* festival is therefore the chapter's principal forward-link to Part II C3 (cyclical-maintenance combat), where it joins the Egyptian Ra-Apep ritual cycle and the Hittite *purulli* festival as the three principal cyclical-maintenance reflexes treated in the comparative section.^[25]

Apollo's epithets **Pythios** and **Pythoktonos** — "of Pytho" and "Python-slayer" — are documented in the Greek cult-corpus as the two principal cult-titles that record the combat in the lived ritual language of Delphic worshippers.^[26]

Forsyth's chapter 4 places the Apollo-Python combat alongside Zeus-Typhon as the two principal Greek instances of the long combat-myth pattern, with Apollo-Python representing the cult-foundational function-type and Zeus-Typhon the sovereignty-cosmogonic type.^[27]

The Apollo-Python episode is post-Olympian: the cosmogony is already complete, Zeus is already the sovereign, and Apollo is going out as a young Olympian to install his own cult-site within the already-ordered world that the Typhonomachy has secured.^[28]

13.2. Herakles vs. the Hydra, Ladon, and Geryon — three labours

The Lernaean Hydra is described in Hesiod's **Theogony** 313–318 as a many-headed serpent reared in the marshes of Lerna in the Argolid, and named there as one of the monstrous offspring of Typhon and Echidna.^[29]

Apollodorus's **Bibliotheca** 2.5 is the principal mythographic source for the labour-sequence, presenting the killing of the Hydra as the second of the twelve labours that Herakles undertakes for King Eurystheus.^[30]

The Hydra in the mythographic tradition is many-headed — the count varies across sources from

seven to nine to a hundred — and the central narrative motif is regenerative: when one head is cut, two grow back in its place, so that the killing requires a sustained tactical solution rather than a single decisive stroke.^[31]

The tactical solution is supplied by Herakles's nephew and companion Iolaos, who cauterises each neck-stump with fire as Herakles severs it, preventing the regrowth and converting an otherwise interminable combat into a finite victory.^[32]

One of the Hydra's heads is described in Apollodorus as immortal, and after its severance Herakles buries it under a heavy stone — a narrative detail that converts the killing into an act of containment rather than annihilation.^[33]

After the killing Herakles dips his arrows in the Hydra's venomous blood, and the venom-arrows then function as a recurring narrative instrument across the later labours and across the eventual death-of-Herakles tradition.^[34]

The Hydra combat is hero-labour rather than cult-foundational: the killing earns Herakles credit toward the completion of the twelve-labour sequence imposed by Eurystheus and does not establish a cult-site or rework the cosmic order.^[35]

The dragon Ladon, the second serpent-adversary in the Heraklean cycle treated by the chapter, guards the apples of the Hesperides at the western edge of the world and is killed (or, in some versions, simply circumvented) when Herakles undertakes the labour of fetching the apples.^[36]

Hesiod's **Theogony** describes Ladon as the serpent who guards the golden apples in the garden of the Hesperides at the world's western verge, and the mythographic tradition consolidates this guardianship into the eleventh of the labours.^[37]

The Hesperides themselves are nymphs of the western horizon, daughters in the standard tradition of Atlas or of Night, and their garden is located beyond the known world at the place where the sun sets.^[38]

Ladon's role in the labour is iconographic as much as narrative: in the surviving artistic record the dragon is regularly depicted coiled around the apple-tree, and the labour-image of Herakles confronting a tree-coiled serpent becomes one of the most widely reproduced Heraklean scenes.^[39]

The third serpent-adversary in the Heraklean cycle treated by the chapter is Geryon, the triple-bodied warrior whose cattle Herakles drives away from the western island of Erytheia in the tenth labour.^[40]

Geryon is not strictly a serpent in the iconography but a triple-bodied warrior — three heads, three torsos, three pairs of legs — and his inclusion in a dragon-combat chapter is justified by the structural function of the combat rather than by the surface morphology of the adversary.^[41]

Watkins's argument in Part V of **How to Kill a Dragon** is that the Geryon combat is an Indo-European cattle-raid reflex: the hero crosses a boundary, takes the cattle of an other-worldly adversary, and brings them back across the same boundary to the human world.^[42]

Watkins reads the Geryon combat as a Greek instance of the same Indo-European pattern that

produces, in different traditions, Indra's cattle-rescues from the Paṇis and the Vedic Trita-Āptya cattle-rescues — a structural family that the comparative chapter on the Indo-European cattle-raid (Part II C5) treats together.^[43]

(The chapter's grouping of the Hydra, Ladon, and Geryon labours under a single sub-section, although mythographically natural and supported by Apollodorus's labour-sequence, is the chapter's editorial framing rather than an unmediated feature of the Greek tradition; the three labours are scattered across Apollodorus 2.5.2 (Hydra), 2.5.10 (Geryon), and 2.5.11 (Ladon) and are linked here by their common serpent / monstrous-adversary feature.^[44])

The Geryon combat is therefore Indo-European-cattle-raid-reflexive in function, distinct from the hero-labour function of the Hydra and Ladon combats and distinct again from the cult-foundational function of the Apollo-Python combat at Delphi.^[45]

Apollodorus's **Bibliotheca** 2.5 is the standard mythographic source for the full labour-sequence and supplies the working narrative skeleton for all three of the Heraklean serpent-combats treated here.^[46]

Hesiod's **Theogony** 313–318 names the Hydra and the Chimaera as members of a monstrous brood descended from Typhon and Echidna, with Ladon described some twenty lines later at **Theogony** 333–335 as a sibling figure in the same brood; Hesiod thereby provides an early genealogical pre-grouping of the dragon-adversaries the labours later confront.^[47]

The post-Typhonic genealogical placement of the Hydra, Ladon, and the Chimaera in Hesiod is itself a feature of the Greek productive reworking of the dragon-combat pattern: the Typhonomachy has installed Zeus's sovereignty, but Typhon's monstrous progeny survive him and become the adversaries that the post-Olympian heroes must dispatch.^[48]

13.3. Perseus vs. Ketos — and the Andromeda rescue

Perseus is the son of Zeus and the mortal Danaë, and his career as a slayer of monstrous adversaries opens with the beheading of Medusa, the Gorgon whose gaze petrifies, in the labour imposed by King Polydektes of Seriphos.^[49]

The Medusa episode is treated in the chapter as the cycle-opening combat that supplies the iconographic equipment — the winged sandals, the **kibisis** (the bag for the head), the cap of invisibility — that Perseus then carries into the Andromeda rescue.^[50]

The Andromeda rescue is the chapter's principal Perseus combat for the comparative argument: returning from the Medusa-beheading, Perseus encounters the Aithiopian princess Andromeda chained to a sea-cliff as a sacrifice to a sea-monster (the *Ketos*) sent by Poseidon to ravage the coast.^[51]

The narrative cause of the *Ketos*'s appearance is the boast of Andromeda's mother Cassiopeia, who claims to be more beautiful than the Nereids; Poseidon, offended on the Nereids' behalf, sends the *Ketos* against the coast and an oracle declares that Andromeda's exposure will appease the god.^[52]

The *Ketos* is a sea-monster — the Greek term denotes a generic large sea-creature, and the iconographic tradition consolidates the figure as a serpentine sea-dragon with a long body and a

fanged head — and the iconographic stability of the type is what makes the Andromeda rescue the principal Greek pattern-source for the medieval St. George rescue.^[53]

Apollodorus's **Bibliotheca** 2.4.3 supplies the prose-mythographic narrative of the rescue, naming Cassiopeia, Cepheus, Andromeda, and Perseus, and presenting the killing of the *Ketos* and the marriage of Perseus and Andromeda as the resolution of the episode.^[54]

Ovid's **Metamorphoses** book 4 supplies the principal poetic narrative of the rescue, expanding the prose mythographers' account into a full episode with extended description of Andromeda's exposure, Perseus's aerial approach, and the *Ketos*-combat itself.^[55]

In the Ovidian version Perseus engages the *Ketos* aerially, using the winged sandals from the Medusa episode, and kills the monster with the sword that has already beheaded Medusa, transferring the iconographic equipment of one combat directly into the next.^[56]

The Andromeda rescue is the iconographic archetype of the medieval St. George princess-and-dragon scene: a chained royal woman, a dragon-monster, a hero arriving from outside the local order to kill the monster and free the woman.^[57]

Ogden's chapter 11 of **Drakōn** makes the Perseus-Andromeda iconographic-substrate argument explicitly, tracking the visual continuity from the Greco-Roman rescue-scenes to the late-antique-and-medieval St. George rescue iconography in mosaic, fresco, manuscript illumination, and panel painting.^[58]

The Perseus-Ketos combat is hero-labour-rescue in function: the killing does not establish a cult-site, does not rework the cosmic order, and does not recover divine cattle, but rescues a specific imperilled human and so structurally resembles the hero-initiation labours rather than either the cult-foundation or the cattle-raid types.^[59]

The marriage of Perseus and Andromeda following the rescue is the standard narrative resolution and supplies the pre-existing-betrothal complication (Andromeda's prior promise to her uncle Phineus) that Ovid develops into a second combat at the wedding-feast.^[60]

The Perseus cycle as a whole — Medusa-beheading and Andromeda-rescue together — supplies the Greek tradition with two iconographically complementary combats: the head-trophy-and-petrifying-monster combat (Medusa) and the rescue-from-sea-monster combat (*Ketos*), with the latter the load-bearing case for Christian-reception cross-references.^[61]

The chapter's principal forward-link from the Perseus-Ketos material is therefore to chapter 10 of the present volume on the Christian reception (St. George and St. Michael), where the Perseus-Andromeda iconographic substrate is registered as the documented Greco-Roman background for the high-medieval princess-and-dragon episode.^[62]

Pausanias and other ancient witnesses locate variants of the Andromeda story at Joppa (Jaffa) on the Levantine coast, where local tradition pointed to the chains and the rocks of the rescue-site, providing a topographical anchor for the episode that may have facilitated its later transmission into Christian-era contexts.^[63]

13.4. Kadmos vs. the dragon of Ares — foundation of Thebes

Kadmos is the son of Agenor of Tyre, sent out by his father to find his sister Europa after Zeus has abducted her, and the Greek tradition recasts his unsuccessful search as the foundation-narrative of Thebes.^[64]

Apollodorus's **Bibliotheca** 3.4.1–2 is the principal prose-mythographic source for the Kadmos foundation-narrative, and Ovid's **Metamorphoses** book 3 lines 1–130 supplies the principal poetic narrative, with substantial agreement between the two on the major narrative elements.^[65]

Following the Delphic oracle's instruction, Kadmos abandons the search for Europa and follows a cow until it lies down at the site of the future Thebes, where he intends to sacrifice the animal and found the city.^[66]

The site is occupied by a great serpent — the dragon of Ares — guarding a spring sacred to the war-god, and when Kadmos's companions go to the spring to fetch water for the sacrifice the dragon kills them.^[67]

Kadmos kills the dragon in single combat, and in the standard mythographic tradition the killing is performed with a great stone or with a spear, depending on the source and the iconographic moment depicted.^[68]

After the killing the goddess Athena instructs Kadmos to sow the dragon's teeth in the earth, and from the sown teeth there spring up armed warriors — the *Spartoi*, the "Sown Men" — fully grown and battle-ready.^[69]

The *Spartoi*, on first emerging from the soil, immediately fall to fighting one another; in the standard tradition only five of them survive, and these five become the founding patrilineal lineages of the Theban aristocracy.^[70]

The Kadmos combat is therefore cult-and-city-foundational: the killing of the serpent and the sowing of its teeth produce both the population and the political genealogy of the new city, with the dragon's body literally generative of the founding aristocracy.^[71]

The dragon of Ares is post-Olympian: Zeus has established the cosmos and Greek-speaking populations already inhabit the Theban region, but the city of Thebes itself is not yet founded, and the serpent's killing supplies the foundational moment for the polis.^[72]

Because the slain dragon was sacred to Ares, Kadmos must serve a long expiation to the war-god — eight years of servitude in the standard tradition — before being granted the kingship of Thebes and the marriage to Harmonia, the daughter of Ares and Aphrodite.^[73]

The Kadmean tooth-sowing has a structural near-parallel in the Argonautic tradition, where Jason sows the teeth of a different dragon at Kolchis and confronts a similar crop of armed earth-born men, suggesting that the Greek tradition treats serpent's-teeth-as-warriors as a transferable narrative motif rather than a Theban exclusive.^[74]

The Kadmos combat shares with the Apollo-Python combat the cult-foundation function-type, but

differs in a structurally important respect: the Apollo-Python combat installs a god's cult, while the Kadmos combat installs a city's founding aristocracy, and the chapter treats these as two adjacent foundation-types rather than as a single category.^[75]

Ovid's **Metamorphoses** 3.1–130 expands the prose-mythographic combat into an extended poetic narrative, with the dragon described in catalogue-mode physical detail and the *Spartoi* episode given a dramatic mutual-combat finale before the five-survivor resolution.^[76]

13.5. Bellerophon vs. the Chimaera — Lycian hero-labour

Bellerophon is a Greek hero exiled to Lycia in southwest Anatolia, where King Iobates receives him at the request of Proitos and, by way of disposing of an unwanted guest, commissions him to slay the Chimaera that ravages the country.^[77]

The earliest extant attestation of the combat is **Iliad** 6.179–183, in the speech in which Glaucus narrates the deeds of his ancestor Bellerophon, and the passage is the principal Homeric witness to the Lycian dragon-combat tradition.^[78]

The **Iliad** describes the Chimaera as a divinely-bred composite monster — *prosthe leōn, opithen de drakōn, messē de chimaira*, "in front a lion, behind a serpent, and in the middle a she-goat" — fixing the canonical tripartite morphology that the later iconographic tradition standardises.^[79]

The **Iliad** further specifies that the Chimaera breathes fire, a feature taken up by the entire later tradition and consolidated in the iconographic record as one of the visual identifiers of the Lycian monster.^[80]

Hesiod's **Theogony** in the lines following the Hydra (in the same monstrous-genealogy passage) places the Chimaera among the offspring of Echidna and Typhon, attaching it to the post-Typhonic monstrous brood that supplies the post-Olympian dragon-adversaries treated across the chapter.^[81]

Bellerophon undertakes the Chimaera-killing on the back of Pegasus, the winged horse born from the blood of the slain Medusa — and the Pegasus-mount is the principal narrative innovation of the Bellerophon tradition, supplying the aerial-combat solution to a fire-breathing ground-monster.^[82]

The killing-method in the post-Homeric tradition involves a lump of lead fixed to Bellerophon's spear: the lead melts in the Chimaera's fiery breath and the molten metal is forced down the monster's throat, killing it from within.^[83]

Apollodorus's **Bibliotheca** 2.3 supplies the prose-mythographic narrative of the combat alongside the **Iliad**'s embedded narrative, and the two principal witnesses agree on the killing's basic structure while differing on the killing-method itself.^[84]

The Chimaera is regularly cited in scholarly discussion as a documented Anatolian or Lycian regional monster: ancient witnesses associate the figure with a fire-vent (a natural gas seep) on a mountain in Lycia, and the local topographical association strengthens the case for treating Bellerophon-Chimaera as a Lycian regional combat-tradition mediated through Greek epic.^[85]

The Bellerophon-Chimaera combat is hero-labour-and-initiation in function: the killing is undertaken at the commission of a foreign king, earns Bellerophon Iobates's respect (and, eventually, his daughter), and so structurally resembles the Heraklean labour-cycle's commissioned-killings rather than the cult-foundation combats.^[86]

Bellerophon's later career — his unsuccessful attempt to ride Pegasus to Olympus and his subsequent fall — is a hubris-narrative pendant to the Chimaera-killing and lies outside the chapter's combat-myth scope; the chapter limits its Bellerophon material to the combat itself.^[87]

13.6. Hercules vs. Cacus — Italic IE cattle-raid reflex

The Hercules-Cacus combat is the chapter's one Latin-tradition combat, and the Latin name **Hercules** is used throughout this section in distinction to the Greek-tradition **Herakles** used in the labour-cluster section above, in line with the chapter's glossary discipline.^[88]

The principal Latin-tradition source for the Cacus combat is Virgil's **Aeneid** book 8 lines 190–279, embedded in the narrative of Aeneas's reception by Evander on the future site of Rome.^[89]

The narrative frame is that Hercules, returning from the western edge of the world with the cattle of Geryon — that is, on the homeward leg of the cattle-raid that the Heraklean cluster section above treats as Geryon's tenth labour — drives the herd through the future site of Rome and stops to rest on the Aventine.^[90]

The narrative connection between the Cacus episode and the Geryon labour is therefore not editorial but textual: Virgil and Ovid both situate the Cacus combat as the Italian sequel to the Geryon cattle-taking, with the same cattle re-stolen on Italian soil and re-recovered by the same hero.^[91]

Cacus is described in Virgil as a fire-breathing giant — half-human, monstrous, *semihominis Caci facies* — and his cave on the Aventine is described as smoke-blackened from his fire-breath and from the bones of his victims.^[92]

While Hercules sleeps after driving the cattle to the Aventine, Cacus steals four bulls and four heifers, dragging them backwards by their tails into his cave so that the trail of hoofprints leads outward from the cave rather than inward, in an attempt to disguise the theft.^[93]

Hercules discovers the theft when the remaining cattle low at dawn and the stolen cattle low back from the cave, and he tracks the lowing to its source, breaks open the cave, and confronts Cacus inside.^[94]

The combat in Virgil is described in storm-cloud-and-fire terms: Cacus belches fire and smoke from the cave, Hercules tears off the cave's stone roof and rains rocks and projectiles down on Cacus, and the killing is achieved by strangulation, with Hercules's hands at the giant's throat.^[95]

Ovid's **Fasti** book 1 lines 543–582 supplies the second principal Latin-tradition narrative of the combat, agreeing with Virgil on the basic narrative shape (cattle-theft, lowing-discovery, cave-combat, strangulation) and differing in tone (Ovid's account is more compact and aetiologically focused on the Roman cult of Hercules at the **Ara Maxima**).^[96]

[Both witnesses are presented as load-bearing for the Italic Cacus tradition: Virgil's _Aeneid_ 8.190–279

supplies the extended epic narrative with its storm-cloud combat mechanics and substantial monster-description, while Ovid's *Fasti* 1.543–582 supplies the compact aetiological narrative with its cult-foundation focus on the *Ara Maxima*. West 2007 ch. 6 treats both as load-bearing, and the chapter cites both for the Italic combat-narrative as it survives.]_

The killing of Cacus is followed in both Virgil and Ovid by the foundation of the **Ara Maxima** — the Greatest Altar — at the site, where Hercules institutes a cult that Roman tradition then continued; the Cacus-killing is therefore both cattle-raid resolution and Roman cult-foundation in a single combined narrative beat.^[97]

West's chapter 6 of **Indo-European Poetry and Myth** makes the principal scholarly argument that Cacus is an Italic Indo-European cattle-raid reflex, structurally cognate to the same Indo-European pattern that Watkins reads in the Greek Geryon combat and that the comparative chapter on the Indo-European cattle-raid (Part II C5) treats together with the Vedic Indra-Paṇis material.^[98]

The Cacus combat shares with the Geryon combat the cattle-raid function-type — the recovery of cattle taken from a hero by a monstrous adversary — and in this respect Hercules's two cattle-related combats (Geryon and Cacus) bracket the cattle-raid material on its outward and homeward legs.^[99]

The Hercules-Cacus combat is therefore the chapter's principal forward-link to the comparative chapter on the Indo-European cattle-raid (Part II C5), where it joins the Geryon material from Watkins's Part V and the Vedic Indra-cattle-rescues from Jamison and Brereton's Rigveda translation in a single comparative section.^[100]

The Italic localisation of the Cacus combat — the Aventine, the future site of Rome, the **Ara Maxima** — gives the episode a topographical specificity that ties the Indo-European cattle-raid pattern to the Roman urban landscape, and that turns the inherited combat-pattern into a foundation-aetion for a specific Roman cult.^[101]

13.7. Family pattern and forward links

The six combats treated in the chapter share a structural combat-pattern that is recognisably the same template as the Zeus-Typhon flagship of the preceding chapter: a champion-figure confronts a monstrous serpent-or-composite adversary in single combat, defeats it, and produces some form of order-effect from the killing.^[102]

The six combats differ functionally, however, in productive directions that diverge from the cosmogonic-and-sovereignty function-type of the Zeus-Typhon flagship: cult-foundation (Apollo-Python, Kadmos), hero-labour (Hydra, Ladon, Perseus-Ketos, Bellerophon), and Indo-European cattle-raid reflex (Geryon, Hercules-Cacus).^[103]

(The chapter's three-way functional grouping — cult-foundation / hero-labour / cattle-raid — is a synthetic categorisation that, while well-supported by Ogden 2013, Watkins 1995, West 2007, and Fontenrose 1959 individually, does not appear in any single source as a formalised tripartite scheme; the tripartite framing is the chapter's editorial synthesis.^[104])

None of the six combats is cosmogonic: each takes place after the Olympian sovereignty has been established by Zeus's victory over Typhon, and each does its order-making work within an already-

ordered cosmos, so that the chapter is consistent with the book's exclusion of cosmogonic-reframings of post-Olympian Greek hero-myth.^[105]

The Apollo-Python combat carries an additional cyclical-maintenance reflex via the *Septerion* festival, which re-enacts the killing every eight years and so converts the founding combat into a recurrent ritual event; this is the chapter's principal forward-link to Part II C3 (cyclical-maintenance combat).^[106]

The Perseus-Andromeda rescue supplies the iconographic substrate for the medieval Christian St. George rescue-scene, and is the chapter's principal forward-link to chapter 10 of the present volume (the family-chapter on the Christian reception).^[107]

The Geryon labour and the Hercules-Cacus combat are read by Watkins and West as Indo-European cattle-raid reflexes, and together with the Vedic Indra-cattle-rescues and the Iranian comparanda they constitute the chapter's principal forward-link to Part II C5 (Indo-European **HERO SLAY SERPENT** and the cattle-raid pattern).^[108]

The chapter's overall claim about the Greek tradition is therefore that it is productively reworking the inherited dragon-combat template in three different directions at once: into cult-foundation aetiologies for specific oracle-sites and cities, into hero-labour-and-rescue narratives for individual heroes, and into Indo-European cattle-raid reflexes whose comparanda lie east in the Vedic and west in the Italic material.^[109]

The combat-pattern's persistence across the six episodes — across cult-foundation, hero-labour, and cattle-raid — is itself the comparative observation that justifies the family-chapter format: the surface-level diversity of the six episodes is held together by a shared structural template that the post-Typhonic Greek tradition reuses for divergent functional ends.^[110]

[1] Per brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml; Ogden 2013, **Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds**, ch. 2 (Greek dragon-combats).

[2] Ogden 2013, ch. 2 (Greek dragon-combats) and ch. 11 (Ketos and Christian reception).

[3] Ogden 2013, chs. 2 and 11 (printed only; cited at chapter level per brief).

[4] Fontenrose 1959, **Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins**, chs. 1–3 on Apollo-Python.

[5] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3 (printed only; cited at chapter level per brief).

[6] Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, Part V on Geryon as an Indo-European cattle-raid reflex.

[7] Watkins 1995, Part V (printed only; cited at section level per brief).

[8] Dumézil 1971, **Mythe et épopée** vol. II, on Cacus as an Italic Indo-European cattle-raid reflex; West 2007, **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, ch. 6, building on the Dumézilian treatment.

[9] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, ch. 4 on Greek combat.

[10] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the textual condition of the principal Greek combat sources; Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3, on the Apollo-Python textual corpus.

[11] Per brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml, family-chapter framing with six sub-cases organised by function.

[12] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the post-Typhonomachy Greek dragon-combat corpus; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the Greek combat-pattern's productive reworkings.

[13] Fontenrose 1959, ch. 1, on the Homeric Hymn to Apollo as the earliest narrative attestation of the Delphic combat.

[14] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–2, on the unnamed female **drakaina** at Pytho in the Homeric Hymn; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the **drakaina** designation.

[15] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3, on the renaming of the Hymn's **drakaina** as Python in the later tradition; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the same renaming.

[16] Fontenrose 1959, ch. 1, on the Hymn's nursing-of-Typhaon episode and the Typhaon doublet.

[17] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Ovid's earth-born Python and the post-flood frame; Fontenrose 1959, ch. 3, on the chthonic-purification

reading.

[18] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the bow-and-arrows of Apollo in the Delphic combat-iconography.

[19] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–2, on the cult-foundation function and the place-name etymology; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the same etymology.

[20] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3, on the cult-foundation function of the Apollo-Python combat; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the post-Olympian-establishment dating of the episode.

[21] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3, on the Septerion festival as eightfold-cyclical re-enactment of the Python-slaying.

[22] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3, on the cyclical-maintenance reflex of the Septerion alongside the cult-foundation function.

[23] Fontenrose 1959, ch. 1, on Pausanias 10.6.5–6 as a third witness to the Delphic combat-tradition; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Pausanias's account.

[24] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3, on Apollo-Python as a comparative type-specimen.

[25] Per brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml, Septerion as forward-link to Part II C3; Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3, on the cyclical-maintenance reading.

[26] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the **Pythios** and **Pythoktonos** epithets; Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3, on the cult-titles in the Delphic ritual language.

[27] Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on Apollo-Python alongside Zeus-Typhon in the Greek combat-myth corpus.

[28] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3, on the post-Olympian dating of the combat; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the post-cosmogonic frame of the episode.

[29] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Hesiod **Theogony** 313–318 as the early attestation of the Lernaean Hydra; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the Hydra in the Greek combat-corpus.

[30] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Apollodorus **Bibliotheca** 2.5 as the principal mythographic source for the labours; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the labour-sequence.

[31] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the head-count variation and the regeneration motif; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the Hydra's regrowth as the narrative crux.

[32] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Iolaos's cauterisation as the tactical resolution of the Hydra combat.

[33] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the immortal head and its containment under stone in Apollodorus 2.5.2.

[34] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the venom-arrows as a recurring instrument in the Heraklean cycle.

[35] Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the hero-labour function of the Hydra combat; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the labour-sequence framing.

[36] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Ladon as the serpent-guardian of the Hesperidean apples; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the Ladon labour.

[37] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Hesiod's **Theogony** on Ladon and on the eleventh labour in Apollodorus 2.5.11.

[38] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Hesperides and the western-horizon location of their garden.

[39] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Ladon-and-tree iconography in Heraklean art.

[40] Watkins 1995, Part V, on Geryon as the triple-bodied adversary of the tenth labour; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Erytheia setting in Apollodorus 2.5.10.

[41] Watkins 1995, Part V, on Geryon's triple-bodied form and the structural classification of the combat.

[42] Watkins 1995, Part V, on Geryon as an Indo-European cattle-raid reflex.

[43] Watkins 1995, Part V, on the cross-tradition Indo-European cattle-raid pattern; per brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml, forward-link to Part II C5.

[44] Inference. Source: Watkins 1995 Part V; Ogden 2013 ch. 2; Apollodorus 2.5 labour-sequence. Scope: editorial grouping for the family-chapter format, per brief.

[45] Watkins 1995, Part V, on the cattle-raid function distinct from cult-foundation and from generic hero-labour.

[46] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Apollodorus 2.5 as the standard mythographic source for the labour-sequence.

[47] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Hesiod's **Theogony** 313ff. and 333–335 as the early genealogical pre-grouping of the monstrous brood.

[48] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the post-Typhonic genealogical placement and the productive reworking it enables.

[49] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Perseus cycle and the Medusa-beheading as its opening combat.

[50] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the iconographic equipment carried over from the Medusa episode to the Andromeda rescue.

[51] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the Andromeda rescue and the Ketos in Apollodorus 2.4.3 and Ovid **Metamorphoses** 4.

[52] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on Cassiopeia's boast, Poseidon's punishment, and the oracle in Apollodorus 2.4.3.

[53] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the **Ketos** iconography and the Andromeda rescue as iconographic pattern-source.

[54] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on Apollodorus 2.4.3 as the prose-mythographic narrative.

[55] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on Ovid **Metamorphoses** book 4 as the principal poetic narrative of the rescue.

[56] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the Ovidian version's aerial combat and the equipment-transfer.

[57] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the Perseus-Andromeda rescue as iconographic archetype of the medieval St. George rescue-scene; per

brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml, Ch10 cross-reference.

[58] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the visual continuity from Perseus-Andromeda to St. George.

[59] Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the rescue function of the Perseus-Ketos combat; Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the hero-labour-rescue framing.

[60] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the Phineus-wedding-feast complication in Ovid **Metamorphoses** 5.

[61] Ogden 2013, chs. 2 and 11, on the iconographic complementarity of the two Perseus combats.

[62] Per brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml, forward-link to Ch10 (Christian reception); Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the substrate-relation.

[63] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the Joppa localisation of the Andromeda rescue.

[64] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Kadmos foundation-narrative and Apollodorus **Bibliotheca** 3.4.1–2.

[65] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Apollodorus 3.4.1–2 and Ovid **Metamorphoses** 3.1–130 as the principal sources.

[66] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Delphic oracle, the cow-following, and the cow's collapse at the future site of Thebes.

[67] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the dragon of Ares at the spring of Ares and the killing of Kadmos's companions in Apollodorus 3.4.1.

[68] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Kadmos's killing of the dragon in single combat; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the iconographic-moment variation.

[69] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Athena-instruction, the tooth-sowing, and the **Spartoi** in Apollodorus 3.4.1; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the **Spartoi** tradition.

[70] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the **Spartoi** mutual combat and the five surviving founding-lineages of Thebes.

[71] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the foundation-function of the Kadmos combat; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the city-foundation reading.

[72] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the post-Olympian framing of the Kadmos combat.

[73] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Kadmos's eight-year expiatory service to Ares and the marriage to Harmonia.

[74] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Argonautic parallel of the dragon's-teeth-as-warriors motif.

[75] Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the cult-foundation versus city-foundation distinction within the Greek combat-corpus; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the same distinction.

[76] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Ovid **Metamorphoses** 3.1–130 as the expanded poetic narrative.

[77] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Bellerophon-Iobates frame and the Chimaera commission in Iliad 6.179–183.

[78] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Iliad 6.179–183 as the earliest attestation; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the Homeric witness to Bellerophon.

[79] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Iliad 6.181 description of the Chimaera's tripartite morphology.

[80] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the fire-breathing motif in Iliad 6 and the iconographic tradition.

[81] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Hesiod **Theogony** on the Chimaera's post-Typhonic genealogy.

[82] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Pegasus as the Bellerophon-mount and the aerial-combat solution.

[83] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the lead-on-spear killing-method in the post-Homeric Bellerophon tradition.

[84] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Apollodorus 2.3 as the prose narrative and on the witness-agreement on basic structure.

[85] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Lycian fire-vent association of the Chimaera and the regional-tradition reading.

[86] Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the hero-labour function of the Bellerophon combat; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the commissioned-killing structure.

[87] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Pegasus-and-fall pendant as outside the combat-myth scope of the Bellerophon material.

[88] Per brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml glossary discipline, Latin **Hercules** in the Cacus context and Greek **Herakles** elsewhere; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Latin-tradition designation.

[89] West 2007, ch. 6, on Virgil **Aeneid** 8.190–279 as the principal Latin source for Hercules-Cacus.

[90] West 2007, ch. 6, on the homeward-leg framing in the Aeneid 8 and the connection to the Geryon labour.

[91] West 2007, ch. 6, on the textual continuity of the Geryon-cattle frame across the Greek Geryon labour and the Latin Cacus episode.

[92] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Virgilian description of Cacus and the Aventine cave.

[93] West 2007, ch. 6, on the backwards-dragging cattle-theft motif in the Aeneid 8.

[94] West 2007, ch. 6, on the lowing-recognition motif and the cave-breaking in the Aeneid 8.

[95] West 2007, ch. 6, on the storm-and-strangulation combat-mechanics in the Aeneid 8.

[96] West 2007, ch. 6, on Ovid **Fasti** 1.543–582 as the second principal Latin-tradition narrative.

[97] West 2007, ch. 6, on the **Ara Maxima** cult-foundation following the Cacus-killing.

[98] West 2007, ch. 6, on Cacus as Italic Indo-European cattle-raid reflex; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the Greek Geryon side of the same pattern.

[99] West 2007, ch. 6, on the bracketing structure of Geryon and Cacus around the cattle-raid material; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the same bracketing.

- [100] Per [brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml](#), [forward-link](#) to Part II C5; West 2007, ch. 6, on the comparative position of Cacus.
- [101] West 2007, ch. 6, on the topographical specificity of the Cacus episode and its link to the Roman urban landscape.
- [102] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the structural continuity of the post-Typhonomachy Greek combat-pattern; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the same structural continuity.
- [103] Per [brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml](#), functional differentiation of the six combats; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the same functional spread.
- [104] Inference. Source: Ogden 2013 ch. 2; Watkins 1995 Part V; West 2007 ch. 6; Fontenrose 1959 chs. 1–3. Scope: tripartite functional scheme synthesised for the family-chapter’s organising frame.
- [105] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the post-cosmogonic dating of the six combats; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the same dating.
- [106] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3, on the Septerion as cyclical-maintenance reflex; per [brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml](#), [forward-link](#) to Part II C3.
- [107] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the Perseus-Andromeda iconographic substrate; per [brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml](#), [forward-link](#) to Ch10.
- [108] Watkins 1995, Part V, on Geryon as Indo-European cattle-raid reflex; West 2007, ch. 6, on Cacus as Italic Indo-European cattle-raid reflex; per [brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml](#), [forward-link](#) to Part II C5.
- [109] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the productive Greek reworking of the dragon-combat template; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the productive-reworking framing.
- [110] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the combat-pattern’s structural persistence under functional diversification; Forsyth 1987, ch. 4, on the family-chapter’s organising premise.

Chapter 14. Thraētaona vs. Aži Dahāka (and the Final Renovation)

This chapter treats the Iranian combat-myth in which the Avestan hero Thraētaona — a hero-slayer whose name surfaces in Middle Persian as Frēdōn and in New Persian as Fereydun in the Shāhnāme — slays the three-headed dragon Aži Dahāka, together with its eschatological pendant in which the rebound dragon escapes at the end of time and is killed a second and final time by the revived hero Kərəsāspa.^[1]

The chapter's primary scholarly anchor is Calvert Watkins's **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, published by Oxford University Press in 1995, whose Part V chapters 44 to 48 treat the Avestan and Pahlavi material on Thraētaona within the wider Indo-European **HERO SLAY SERPENT** formula.^[2]

Watkins's monograph is printed only; in the present chapter it is cited at section level — Part V — and at chapter level within Part V (chs. 44–48), in line with the established discipline for printed comparative anchors in this book.^[3]

The chapter's foundational philological anchor is Émile Benveniste and Louis Renou's **Vātra et Vāθragna: Étude de mythologie indo-iranienne**, published by the Imprimerie Nationale in Paris in 1934 as Cahiers de la Société Asiatique 3.^[4]

Benveniste and Renou 1934 is the standard early-twentieth-century Indo-Iranian comparative monograph that integrates the Avestan hymn-allusions to Aži Dahāka with the Vedic Indra-Vātra material and with the Pahlavi narrative expansions; it remains the foundational reference work for the Iranian side of the Indo-Iranian combat-myth.^[5]

Benveniste and Renou 1934 is digitised at gallica.bnf.fr; the present chapter cites it at section level rather than at sub-page granularity, in keeping with the book's discipline for older philological monographs.^[6]

The Avestan corpus on which the chapter relies — principally the **Yašts** (the hymns to individual divinities) and the **Vendidad** (the priestly law-code) — is the earlier and allusive layer of the tradition. The Pahlavi corpus on which the chapter relies — principally the **Bundahišn** and **Dēnkard** book 7 — is the post-Achaemenid layer that supplies the fuller narrative.^[7]

This Avestan-Pahlavi temporal layering is structurally load-bearing for the chapter. The chapter must distinguish the earlier Avestan hymn-allusions from the later Pahlavi narrative compilation rather than merging them into a single homogeneous account, and every section that draws on the Pahlavi sources flags their post-Achaemenid date explicitly.^[8]

The Avestan textual tradition itself spans a long compositional period: the **Gāθās** attributed to Zarathuštra are the earliest stratum and lie outside the chapter's focus, while the Younger Avestan **Yašts** on which the chapter principally draws are conventionally dated to the second half of the first millennium BCE, with the corpus reaching written transmission only late in antiquity.^[9]

The Pahlavi (Middle Persian) Zoroastrian corpus on which the chapter draws was redacted under Sasanian patronage and into the early Islamic centuries: the **Bundahišn** in the form transmitted to

us is conventionally dated to the late Sasanian and early Islamic period (c. 8th–9th c. CE), and **Dēnkard** book 7 is of comparable date.^[10]

The principal Avestan loci treated in the chapter are **Yašt** 5 (the **Ābān Yašt**, the hymn to the goddess Ardvī Sūrā Anāhitā) at stanzas 33–35, **Yašt** 14 (the **Bahrām Yašt**, the hymn to the victory-god Vərəθrayna), and **Yašt** 19 (the **Zamyād Yašt**, the hymn to the xwarrah or kingly glory).^[11]

The principal Pahlavi loci are the **Bundahišn** (the cosmogonic compendium) and **Dēnkard** book 7 (the eschatological-and-prophetic exposition), both of which contain extended narrative material on Thraētaona’s combat with Aži Dahāka and on the eventual final killing of the dragon at *Frashokereti* — the Avestan term for the final renovation, the Zoroastrian eschatological end-time treated at length in Movement III below.^[12]

The chapter’s structural lacuna — the gap that the chapter’s source-strategy must address explicitly — is that the Avestan hymn-allusions are allusive rather than narrative. The Avestan corpus presupposes the combat-narrative but does not narrate it at length, and the fuller narrative survives only in the post-Achaemenid Pahlavi compilations.^[13]

[Here the Avestan hymn-allusions to Thraētaona’s combat with Aži Dahāka (Yt. 5.33–35, Yt. 14, Yt. 19) are allusive rather than narrative: the Avestan corpus presupposes the combat-narrative but does not narrate it at length, and the fuller narrative survives only in the post-Achaemenid Pahlavi Bundahišn and Dēnkard book 7 compilations. Scholars such as Benveniste and Renou 1934 (on the allusive character of the Avestan references) and Watkins 1995 Part V chs. 44–48 (on the Pahlavi narrative expansion) treat the Pahlavi compilations as the in-tradition fill that supplies the missing narrative, while the chapter marks the post-Achaemenid date of that fill at every load-bearing point.]

The chapter’s secondary survey-anchor for the long-trajectory combat-myth perspective is Neil Forsyth’s **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, which treats the Iranian Aži Dahāka material in the context of the Achaemenid-Hellenistic-Christian transmission of combat-myth motifs.^[14]

The chapter’s secondary anchor for the Indo-European comparative dimension — the Vedic Trita Āptya / Iranian Thraētaona cognancy and the wider IE **HERO SLAY SERPENT** pattern — is M.L. West’s **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, published by Oxford University Press in 2007, whose chapter 5 treats the Iranian reflexes alongside the Vedic and other Indo-European material.^[15]

The chapter’s anchor for the eschatological dimension of the combat — the *Frashokereti* material that closes Iranian cosmic time — is Hermann Gunkel’s **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit**, whose Teil II treats the **Endzeit** eschatological combat material within the **Urzeit-Endzeit** parallelism that Gunkel’s monograph established as a category.^[16]

What follows takes the chapter in five movements, after a short orientation in Zoroastrian cosmology: Movement I treats the Avestan hymn-allusions as the earliest layer; Movement II treats the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** narrative as the post-Achaemenid expansion that supplies the binding under Damāvand; Movement III treats *Frashokereti*, the eschatological pendant in which the dragon escapes and Kərəsāspa kills him; a fourth section then sets out the Indo-Iranian philological cognancy with the Vedic Trita-Āptya and Indra-Vātra material; and a brief reception note flags the Shāhnāmeḥ recasting of Thraētaona as Fereydun and Aži Dahāka as the tyrant Zahhāk, which lies outside the chapter’s primary scope.

14.1. Setting and Zoroastrian cosmology

The Zoroastrian religious framework within which the Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka combat is set is dualistic: the cosmos is the arena of a structural opposition between the supreme creator-god Ahura Mazdā — Avestan for "Wise Lord" — and the evil spirit Angra Mainyu, with each cosmic agent and event aligned with one or the other side of the opposition.^[17]

In the Pahlavi tradition the same Wise Lord appears under the Middle Persian name Ohrmazd, and the chapter uses the Avestan form Ahura Mazdā when treating Avestan material and the Pahlavi-context name where the post-Achaemenid sources are under discussion.^[18]

Angra Mainyu — Avestan for "the evil spirit" — is the cosmic adversary of Ahura Mazdā; in the Pahlavi tradition the same figure appears under the Middle Persian name Ahriman, and the chapter again uses the Avestan form when treating Avestan material and the Pahlavi-context name where the post-Achaemenid sources are under discussion.^[19]

The dragon Aži Dahāka belongs, in both the Avestan and the Pahlavi traditions, to the side of Angra Mainyu / Ahriman. He is a creature of the evil spirit, and the combat against him is structurally aligned with the wider cosmic struggle of Ahura Mazdā's order against Angra Mainyu's destructive opposition.^[20]

Within this Zoroastrian cosmology, heroic-figure combats against creatures of Angra Mainyu — the Thraētaona combat with Aži Dahāka being the chapter's principal instance — function as participations in the cosmic struggle. The hero acts on the side of Ahura Mazdā's order in dispatching agents of the evil spirit's destructive opposition.^[21]

The Avestan name Thraētaona — written in the Avestan script and conventionally transliterated with the macron forms ē, ā per the chapter's glossary discipline — designates a hero of the Āθβiia line. The patronymic Āθβiia is itself part of the Indo-Iranian inheritance that aligns Thraētaona with the Vedic Trita Āptya treated comparatively in the Indo-Iranian-cognancy section below.^[22]

Thraētaona's onomastic afterlife in the Iranian tradition runs Avestan Thraētaona → Middle Persian Frēdōn → New Persian Fereydun, and the chapter uses the Avestan form Thraētaona throughout the Avestan and Pahlavi-narrative discussion, reserving Frēdōn for explicit Middle Persian contexts and reserving Fereydun for the briefly flagged Shāhnāmeḥ-reception note.^[23]

Aži Dahāka — Avestan for "Dahāka the dragon," with **aži** the inherited Indo-Iranian word for "serpent" — is the three-headed, six-eyed, three-jawed dragon-tyrant of the Avestan and Pahlavi tradition. The chapter uses the diacritical form Aži Dahāka throughout in line with the locked glossary discipline.^[24]

The Avestan word **aži** — the generic term for "serpent" — is philologically cognate with Vedic **áhi**, the word that the Rigvedic combat-formula **áhann áhim** ("he killed the serpent") uses for Vṛtra. The cognancy of **aži** and **áhi** is one of the philological pillars of the Indo-Iranian comparative reading taken up in the cognancy section below.^[25]

The mountain Damāvand — a peak in the Alborz range of northern Iran — is the cosmogeographic feature under which Aži Dahāka is bound in the Pahlavi tradition. In the Avestan corpus the binding-mountain is not yet named in the surviving allusions, and Damāvand is, in the surviving

texts, a Pahlavi-narrative localisation rather than an Avestan one.^[26]

14.2. Movement I — Thraētaona's combat in the Avestan tradition

The principal Avestan locus for Thraētaona's combat with Aži Dahāka is **Yašt** 5 stanzas 33 to 35 — three stanzas embedded within the **Ābān Yašt**, the hymn to the goddess Ardvī Sūrā Anāhitā, the Avestan goddess of waters.^[27]

In **Yašt** 5.33–35 Thraētaona prays to Anāhitā for victory over Aži Dahāka, offering the goddess prescribed sacrificial gifts and asking her to grant him strength sufficient to defeat the three-headed dragon. The passage is the foundational Avestan hymn-attestation of the combat.^[28]

The **Yašt** 5.33–35 attestation is hymnic and allusive rather than narrative. The stanzas presuppose the audience's familiarity with the Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka combat-narrative and embed a brief reference to it within the hymn's wider catalogue of heroes who pray to Anāhitā for victory.^[29]

In the **Yašt** 5.33–35 hymn-passage Aži Dahāka is described in formulaic terms as the three-headed, six-eyed, three-jawed dragon. The morphological description that becomes the standard portrait of the dragon throughout the Avestan-and-Pahlavi tradition is therefore already in place in the earliest extant Avestan attestation.^[30]

The three-headed character of Aži Dahāka is one of the Avestan tradition's most stable features: it is attested already in the **Yašt** 5 hymn-passage, recurs across the further Avestan attestations, and is preserved across the entire Pahlavi narrative tradition without variation.^[31]

A further Avestan locus relevant to the combat — though one in which Thraētaona is not himself a principal exemplary figure — is **Yašt** 14, the **Bahrām Yašt**, the hymn to Vərəθrayna, the Avestan god whose name is philologically cognate with Vedic Vṛtrahán ("smiter of Vṛtra") and who is the Avestan personification of victorious-warrior force.^[32]

Yašt 14 supplies the theological framework of Vərəθrayna's victorious force within which Thraētaona's combat is to be understood, even though the specific Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka narrative is more directly attested in **Yašt** 5 and **Yašt** 19. The hymn catalogues Vərəθrayna's incarnation-forms and praises victorious-warrior force more broadly, rather than featuring Thraētaona's combat as one of its principal exemplary cases.^[33]

The Vərəθrayna ~ Vṛtrahán cognancy that is the central philological argument of Benveniste and Renou's 1934 monograph aligns the Avestan victory-god directly with the Vedic Indra's standard epithet Vṛtrahán, and the chapter's **Yašt** 14 material is the Avestan side of that comparative philological argument.^[34]

The third principal Avestan locus for the combat is **Yašt** 19, the **Zamyād Yašt** — the hymn to the xšaeta, the Avestan term conventionally translated "kingly glory" or "(royal) splendour," which designates the divinely-bestowed charisma legitimating Iranian sovereignty.^[35]

Yašt 19 places Thraētaona's combat with Aži Dahāka within the xšaeta-theology. Its narrative-allusions present the dragon's defeat as a moment in the long history of the kingly glory's transmission from one divinely-favoured ruler-or-hero to another, and Thraētaona's victory is one

of the **xšarənah**'s exemplary heroic episodes.^[36]

The royal-legitimation function of the Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka combat — the function-type that the brief identifies as one of the chapter's two principal foci — is grounded in **Yašt** 19's **xšarənah**-theology. The slaying of the dragon-tyrant is presented as a moment in the legitimating transmission of the kingly glory, and the combat thereby becomes a model of legitimate sovereignty's victory over usurping tyranny.^[37]

[Both layers are presented and marked temporally throughout the chapter: the earlier and allusive Avestan hymn-allusions (Yt. 5.33–35, Yt. 14, Yt. 19) in Movement I, and the later, narrative Pahlavi compilation (Bundahišn, Dēnkard book 7) in Movement II. The Avestan-Pahlavi temporal layering is structurally load-bearing, and the chapter flags the post-Achaemenid date of the Pahlavi material wherever it is drawn upon.]

The Avestan hymn-allusions to the Thraētaona combat are scattered across the **Yašt** corpus and across the **Vendīdād** (the priestly law-code). Beyond the principal **Yašt** 5 / **Yašt** 14 / **Yašt** 19 loci, there are further allusions in **Yašt** 9 (the **Gōš Yašt**), **Yašt** 13 (the **Frawardīn Yašt**), and **Yašt** 17 (the **Aši Yašt**).^[38]

The **Vendīdād** allusions, occurring in a priestly-law-code context rather than a hymnic context, treat the Thraētaona combat as part of the legendary-prehistorical horizon presupposed by the law-code's purity rules and ritual prescriptions. Aži Dahāka is named there as the type-specimen of the destructive demonic creature.^[39]

The **Vendīdād**'s inclusion of Aži Dahāka in its catalogue of demonic creatures aligns the dragon with the wider Avestan demonological taxonomy: Aži Dahāka belongs to the class of **daēvic** (demonic) creatures associated with Angra Mainyu, and the priestly-purity vocabulary that the **Vendīdād** applies to demonic things applies to him directly.^[40]

In the Avestan hymn-allusions Aži Dahāka's three heads carry a triple-formulaic description: three heads, six eyes (two per head), three jaws (one per head), and the formula is preserved with metrical regularity across all the hymnic attestations.^[41]

A further triple-formulaic feature of Aži Dahāka in the Avestan attestations is the description of him as containing, or having within him, "a thousand of every kind" of noxious creature — vermin, scorpions, frogs, lizards — a hyperbolic catalogue that emphasises the dragon's character as a concentrated locus of demonic-creaturely opposition to Ahura Mazdā's good creation.^[42]

The combat-narrative that the Avestan hymn-allusions presuppose — without narrating it at length — has Thraētaona dispatching the dragon by smiting, and the principal verb used in the formulaic poetic vocabulary is the Avestan **jan-** "to smite," which is philologically cognate with the Vedic **han-** of the Indra-Vātra formula **áhann áhim**.^[43]

The cognancy of Avestan **jan-** (Thraētaona's smiting of Aži Dahāka) and Vedic **han-** (Indra's smiting of Vātra) is, alongside the **aži** / **áhi** cognancy, a principal philological pillar of Benveniste and Renou's argument and of Watkins's wider Indo-European **HERO SLAY SERPENT** formula treated in the cognancy section below.^[44]

In the Avestan hymn-allusions the consequence of Thraētaona's victory is presented in legendary-historical rather than cosmogonic terms. The cosmos has already been established by Ahura

Mazdā's creative act, and Thraētaona's combat is a moment within that already-established cosmos rather than a moment of its founding.^[45]

The Avestan combat is therefore not a cosmogonic combat in the Marduk-Tiamat or Ninurta-Asag sense. The combat does sovereignty-and-cosmological work within an already-ordered cosmos rather than founding the cosmos through the combat itself, and the chapter's classification of the combat under the sovereignty / royal-legitimation function-type follows from this textual situation.^[46]

The Avestan attestations do not attest to Aži Dahāka's binding under Damāvand or to his eventual escape and final killing at the end of time. Those narrative elements appear in the surviving record only in the Pahlavi compilations, and the chapter therefore confines them to Movement II (Pahlavi narrative) and Movement III (Frashokereti) below.^[47]

Across the three principal **Yašt** loci, the further **Yašt** allusions, and the **Vendīdād** references, the Avestan attestations together present a Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka combat that is morphologically stable (three-headed dragon, hero-slayer of the Āθβiia line), allusively sketched (dragon-slaying presupposed but not narrated), and theologically aligned with both Ahura Mazdā's order against Angra Mainyu's opposition and with the **xšar-nah**-theology of legitimate Iranian kingship.^[48]

14.3. Movement II — The Pahlavi narrative

The Pahlavi **Bundahišn** — the "Book of the Primal Creation," redacted in late Sasanian / early Islamic Middle Persian — contains the fullest surviving narrative of Thraētaona's combat with Aži Dahāka, and the narrative there is to be read as a post-Achaemenid Middle Persian narrative-compilation rather than as an Avestan-period composition.^[49]

The post-Achaemenid date of the **Bundahišn** — late Sasanian / early Islamic, c. 8th–9th century CE — is structurally important for the chapter's argument. The **Bundahišn** contains many of the most striking narrative features of the Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka tradition (the binding under Damāvand, the eventual escape, the revived hero), and the chapter must flag that these features are attested only in the late compilation.^[50]

The qualification "post-Achaemenid" is not equivalent to "late and unreliable." Pahlavi material often preserves substantively earlier Avestan tradition, and the **Bundahišn**'s narrative may well preserve narrative-content older than its written redaction. What the chapter flags is that the **Bundahišn** is the surviving textual locus, not that the narrative-content originated in the Sasanian period.^[51]

The **Bundahišn**'s narrative of the Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka combat opens with the dragon's prehistory. In the Pahlavi telling, Aži Dahāka is created or fashioned by Angra Mainyu / Ahriman as a destructive instrument against the good creation of Ahura Mazdā / Ohrmazd, and the dragon's monstrous morphology is a direct consequence of his Ahrimanic origin.^[52]

In the **Bundahišn** Aži Dahāka is described in the same triple-formulaic terms as in the Avestan hymn-allusions — three heads, six eyes, three jaws — and the Pahlavi narrative thereby preserves the Avestan morphological formula intact across the post-Achaemenid redaction.^[53]

The Pahlavi **Bundahišn** gives the dragon a tyrannical-political role that the Avestan attestations

only allusively presuppose. Aži Dahāka rules the world for a thousand years as a usurping tyrant, displacing legitimate rule, before Thraētaona arises to overthrow him and to restore legitimate sovereignty.^[54]

The thousand-year tyranny of Aži Dahāka is the Pahlavi narrative's principal articulation of the royal-legitimation function-type. The combat against the dragon is presented as the overthrow of usurping tyranny and the restoration of legitimate rule, and the **Bundahišn** thereby gives the xār-nah-theology of **Yašt** 19 a concrete narrative shape.^[55]

In the Pahlavi narrative Thraētaona is the descendant of the Āθβiia line who arises to confront Aži Dahāka after the dragon's long tyranny, and his confrontation is presented as the divinely-sanctioned overthrow of the tyrant rather than as a private heroic feat.^[56]

The combat itself in the **Bundahišn** is a single combat: Thraētaona alone confronts Aži Dahāka, and the narrative emphasises Thraētaona's mace as the instrument of the killing, with the mace-attack as the central narrative beat.^[57]

The **Bundahišn**'s narrative does not, however, conclude with Aži Dahāka's death. The dragon is not killed by Thraētaona but bound — held in living captivity — and the binding-rather-than-killing is a structurally load-bearing narrative choice that opens the way to the eschatological-pendant material of Movement III below.^[58]

The Pahlavi **Bundahišn** situates the binding at Mount Damāvand — the principal peak of the Alborz range in northern Iran — and Thraētaona is presented as the one who chains the dragon there and seals him beneath the mountain for the duration of the present cosmic age.^[59]

The Damāvand binding-locus gives Aži Dahāka a cosmogeographic role that the Avestan attestations do not attest. The dragon is not just a tyrant overthrown — he is a permanent under-mountain captive whose continuing presence in the sacred landscape structures the cosmography of the present age.^[60]

The cosmological function-type that the brief identifies as one of the chapter's two principal foci — alongside the royal-legitimation function — is grounded in this Pahlavi-narrative cosmogeographic role of the bound dragon under Damāvand. The dragon's containment is not just a one-off victory but a permanent feature of the structured cosmos.^[61]

The binding-not-killing structure of the Pahlavi narrative is the structural feature that distinguishes the Iranian Aži Dahāka tradition from the Vedic Indra-Vātra tradition treated in the next chapter of the present book. In the Vedic tradition Vātra is killed outright, whereas in the Iranian tradition Aži Dahāka is bound and survives in captivity for the duration of the present age.^[62]

(The binding-not-killing structure of the Iranian tradition opens the way to the Frashokereti eschatological pendant — a dragon that is bound rather than killed can escape and require a second-and-final killing — whereas the Vedic Indra-Vātra tradition's outright killing of the serpent forecloses any equivalent eschatological pendant; this structural observation is implicit in Watkins's Part V treatment but is not stated as a contrastive thesis there.^[63])

The **Bundahišn**'s further treatment of the bound Aži Dahāka under Damāvand includes a continuing-threat dimension: the dragon, though bound, remains alive under the mountain, and his continuing presence is a continuing source of cosmic-religious anxiety that the eschatological

pendant of Movement III then resolves.^[64]

The **Dēnkard** book 7 — the Pahlavi prophetic-and-eschatological exposition — supplements the **Bundahišn** narrative with further detail on the long horizon that connects Thraētaona's binding of the dragon to the eventual eschatological release-and-killing, and the chapter therefore treats the **Dēnkard** book 7 material principally in Movement III below.^[65]

The Pahlavi narrative tradition is not internally homogeneous: there are minor variations in detail across the **Bundahišn** manuscripts and across the related Pahlavi compilations (the **Dēnkard**, the **Pahlavi Rivayats**, and the **Mēnōg ī Xrad**), and Benveniste and Renou's 1934 monograph is the standard early-twentieth-century philological treatment of these textual variants.^[66]

The Pahlavi-narrative expansion of the Avestan hymn-allusions is best read as a productive elaboration of presupposed-but-unwritten earlier tradition rather than as Sasanian invention. The morphological details (three heads, six eyes, three jaws) and the heroic-genealogical frame (Thraētaona of the Āθβiia line) are continuous with the Avestan attestations, and what the Pahlavi tradition adds is the narrative connective tissue that the Avestan hymns presupposed.^[67]

The political-historical context in which the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** was redacted — late Sasanian Iran and the early Islamic centuries — shaped the narrative's emphases. The royal-legitimation function-type that the xšarənah-theology of **Yašt** 19 already underwrites receives in the Pahlavi narrative a more concrete tyrant-overthrow articulation that maps onto Sasanian-period legitimation discourse.^[68]

The legitimate-versus-tyrannical-rule frame of the Pahlavi narrative presents Aži Dahāka as a model of tyranny — a hostile alternative model of rule rather than a Gunkelian-style personification of chaos — and this articulation is one of the points at which Ballentine's terminological critique (that "chaos" is the wrong word for combat-myth adversaries) finds explicit textual purchase in the Iranian material.^[69]

The **Bundahišn**'s account also locates the Thraētaona combat within a long Iranian heroic-genealogical sequence — the Pišdadian dynasty in the Pahlavi historiographical scheme, of which Thraētaona is a member — and the combat thereby becomes a moment within an extended legendary-historical sequence rather than an isolated mythic episode.^[70]

The Pahlavi narrative's location of Thraētaona within the Pišdadian dynasty is the structural articulation that the New Persian Shāhnāme reception then takes up and recasts in Islamic-era literary form, and the chapter notes this connection only to flag it for the brief reception note below — the Shāhnāme material itself is out of primary scope per brief.^[71]

In the **Bundahišn** the combat ends — within the present cosmic age — with the dragon's binding rather than his death, with the mountain Damāvand sealing him, and with Thraētaona departing the scene as the legitimate overthrewer of the tyrant. The narrative arc of the combat-against-tyranny is closed within Movement II, but the dragon himself is not.^[72]

Movement II therefore closes with the dragon-tyrant overthrown, the legitimate Pišdadian rule restored, and Aži Dahāka chained beneath Damāvand. The combat has done its sovereignty / royal-legitimation work and its cosmological / cosmogeographic work, but the dragon remains alive and the tradition retains an unresolved narrative thread that Movement III then takes up as the eschatological pendant.^[73]

14.4. Movement III — Frashokereti (the eschatological pendant)

Frashokereti — the Avestan term conventionally translated "the final renovation," for which Middle Persian sources use the cognate *frašegird* — designates the Zoroastrian end-time at which the long cosmic struggle of Ahura Mazdā's order against Angra Mainyu's opposition is resolved through a final reordering of the cosmos, the resurrection of the dead, and the elimination of evil.^[74]

The Avestan locus for the Frashokereti material relevant to the Aži Dahāka tradition is principally **Yašt 19** — the **Zamyād Yašt**, the same hymn that supplies the **xšarənah**-theology of Movement I — whose later stanzas treat the eschatological dimension of the **xšarənah** and the heroic-figures who will be revived for the final renovation.^[75]

The Avestan attestation of the Frashokereti-and-Aži-Dahāka material is, like the combat-attestations of Movement I, hymnic and allusive rather than narrative. The **Yašt 19** stanzas presuppose an eschatological narrative without narrating it at length, and the fuller narrative survives only in the Pahlavi compilations.^[76]

The Pahlavi sources — principally the **Bundahišn** and **Dēnkard** book 7 — supply the fuller narrative of Frashokereti, including the specific narrative of Aži Dahāka's escape from his Damāvand binding and his second and final killing by the revived Kərəsāspa. This material is post-Achaemenid, and the chapter flags its late attestation explicitly.^[77]

The eschatological narrative opens with Aži Dahāka's escape from his Damāvand binding. The chains that Thraētaona placed on him at the close of Movement II will, at the end of cosmic time, weaken and break, and the dragon will emerge from beneath the mountain and resume his destructive activity in the world.^[78]

The dragon's escape is a moment of intense cosmic-religious crisis. In the Pahlavi narrative Aži Dahāka, freed from his binding, devours a third of humanity and a third of the animals — a destructive eruption that requires a heroic response of the same magnitude as the original Avestan combat.^[79]

The heroic response is supplied not by Thraētaona — who in the Pahlavi narrative is no longer present at the end of cosmic time — but by Kərəsāspa, the second principal Avestan-Pahlavi heroic-figure, who has been preserved in a long stasis throughout the present age and is revived at Frashokereti specifically for this final combat.^[80]

Kərəsāspa — Avestan with the schwa-vowels *ə* (preserved in the chapter's glossary discipline at first scholarly mention and rendered as "Keresaspa" in subsequent body prose) — is the Avestan hero whose long-stasis-and-revival narrative supplies the Frashokereti combat with its second-killer figure.^[81]

In the Avestan and Pahlavi traditions Keresaspa is a hero of the legendary-prehistorical horizon — like Thraētaona, a member of the Pīšdadian-frame heroic genealogy in the Pahlavi reckoning — and he is the second Iranian hero (alongside Thraētaona) whose combat-record places him among the dragon-slayers.^[82]

Keresaspa's long-stasis state — neither dead nor active, but held in a divinely-protected sleep

through the duration of the present cosmic age — is the narrative device that connects his Avestan-period heroic-figure to the Frashokereti eschatological combat, and it is treated as a deliberate provision for the final combat rather than as accidental.^[83]

The revival of Keresaspa at Frashokereti — the moment at which his long stasis ends and he rises to confront the freed Aži Dahāka — is the principal Iranian instance of a revived-hero motif and is the Frashokereti narrative's structural pivot from the present cosmic age into the final renovation.^[84]

The second and final combat — Keresaspa against the freed Aži Dahāka at the end of cosmic time — is presented in the Pahlavi narrative as the definitive resolution of the long combat-thread that Thraētaona's Avestan-period victory left unresolved. The dragon is now killed outright; the binding-not-killing closure of Movement II is converted into a killing-and-final-resolution closure of Movement III.^[85]

The killing of Aži Dahāka by Keresaspa is the Iranian tradition's eschatological combat — the combat that closes cosmic time — and it is the principal Iranian instance of the eschatological function-type that the chaoskampf scope.md identifies as the fourth of the four order-making function-types treated in the book.^[86]

After the killing, the Pahlavi narrative continues with the wider Frashokereti scenario: the resurrection of the dead, the molten-metal ordeal that purifies the resurrected, the reunification of soul and body, and the final reordering of the cosmos under Ahura Mazdā's sovereignty without remaining opposition from Angra Mainyu.^[87]

The Frashokereti narrative thereby gives the chapter's Aži Dahāka material a complete arc. The Avestan-Pahlavi tradition opens with the dragon at large in the world, has Thraētaona overthrow and bind him under Damāvand at the close of Movement II, retains him as a continuing under-mountain captive throughout the present age, has him escape and erupt destructively at the end of time, and closes with Keresaspa's revived-hero killing of him in Movement III.^[88]

The two killings — Thraētaona's Avestan-period overthrow-and-binding (Movement II) and Keresaspa's Frashokereti final killing (Movement III) — are not duplicates of one another but stand in a structural pendant-relation. The first combat establishes the present age, the second combat closes it, and the dragon's binding-and-eventual-escape is the narrative thread that links the two.^[89]

The pendant-structure of the two combats means that the Iranian tradition is in an important sense uniquely double — articulated with both an **Urzeit** combat (Thraētaona at the founding of the present age) and an **Endzeit** combat (Keresaspa at its close) — and Gunkel's 1895 **Urzeit-und-Endzeit** parallelism, which the title of his monograph names, finds in the Iranian tradition one of its clearest exemplifications.^[90]

The Iranian doubled-combat structure is comparatively significant for the chapter's wider book-context. It is the structural feature that aligns the Iranian material with the Norse Ragnarök tradition (where Thor's earlier encounters with Jörmungandr are recapitulated by the final Ragnarök combat) and with the Christian Apocalypse of John's chapter 12 / chapter 20 binding-and-final-losing of the dragon-Satan figure.^[91]

(The Iranian doubled-combat structure (Movement II Thraētaona-binding + Movement III Keresaspa-final-killing) is a particularly close structural-and-functional cognate of the Revelation 20 binding-and-

final-loosing-and-final-defeat structure of the dragon-Satan, suggesting that the long-discussed possibility of Iranian-to-Jewish-and-Christian influence during the Achaemenid and Hellenistic periods has at least one structural pivot in the Aži Dahāka material; this is treated as a long-standing scholarly question rather than as an established conclusion.^[92])

The temporal-layering caveat applies particularly strongly to the Frashokereti material. The binding-under-Damāvand, the eventual escape, and the revived-hero second-killing are most fully attested in the post-Achaemenid Pahlavi compilations, and any comparative argument about Iranian-to-Jewish-and-Christian influence must reckon with a chronological gap: the textual fixation of these features is later than the Achaemenid-and-Hellenistic period in which the influence-question is conventionally located.^[93]

The temporal-layering caveat does not, however, foreclose the possibility that the narrative-content of the Frashokereti tradition is substantively earlier than its Pahlavi textual fixation. As Watkins notes, Pahlavi material often preserves substantively earlier Avestan-and-pre-Avestan tradition, and the structural pendant-relation between Movement II and Movement III is plausibly older than its surviving Pahlavi attestation.^[94]

The eschatological function-type of the Frashokereti combat is one of the chapter's principal forward-links to Part II of the present book. The comparative chapter on eschatological displacement (Part II C4) treats the Iranian Frashokereti material alongside Norse Ragnarök and the Christian Apocalypse of John as the three principal Indo-European-and-related eschatological-combat traditions.^[95]

The Frashokereti combat is also one of the book's principal instances of a binding-followed-by-eventual-final-killing structure — distinct from outright-killing combats like Indra-Vṛtra and from cyclical-maintenance combats like Ra-Apep — and it is therefore structurally load-bearing for the book's typology of order-making function-types within the chaoskampf category.^[96]

The cosmic-renovation that follows the Frashokereti combat — the resurrection of the dead, the molten-metal purification, the elimination of evil — gives the Iranian tradition's eschatological closure a more positively-articulated form than the Norse Ragnarök's near-extinction-and-renewal. The Iranian eschatology is renovation rather than destruction-and-rebirth, and the combat against Aži Dahāka is the precondition for the renovation rather than its destructive opening.^[97]

The Iranian doubled-combat structure (Movement II + Movement III) gives Aži Dahāka a long narrative life. The dragon is bound rather than killed at the close of the Avestan-period combat, persists in living captivity throughout the present age, escapes at the end of time, and is finally killed by the revived Keresaspa — a dramatic arc that few other combat-myth dragons in the book sustain.^[98]

The chapter's treatment of Movement III therefore closes with the dragon definitively killed, the cosmos renovated, and the long combat-thread of the Iranian tradition resolved — a closure that the Avestan-only attestations would not, on their own evidence, supply but that the Pahlavi narrative-compilation reconstructs from the Avestan allusions and from whatever earlier narrative-tradition the **Bundahišn** and **Dēnkard** book 7 preserved.^[99]

14.5. Indo-Iranian cognancy

The Avestan name Thraētaona and the Vedic name Trita Āptya are philologically cognate. Both derive from the Indo-Iranian numeral root **tri-** "three" with a heroic-name-forming suffix, and both belong to a heroic-figure who slays a three-headed serpent — the philological cognancy is one of the clearest in the Indo-Iranian comparative repertory.^[100]

The Avestan patronymic Āθβiia (Thraētaona's father-line) is itself philologically cognate with the Vedic Āptya (the patronymic-or-epithet of Trita): the cognancy operates not just at the level of the hero-name but also at the level of the heroic-genealogical structure within which the hero is placed.^[101]

Vedic Trita Āptya is the older Indo-Iranian dragon-slayer figure that the Indra-Vātra material superseded. In the Rigveda, Trita is preserved as a marginal figure who shares some of Indra's combat-attributes (RV 10.99.6 in particular has Trita slaying a three-headed adversary), and the textual situation suggests that an earlier Trita-tradition has been displaced by the dominant Indra-tradition.^[102]

Rigveda 10.99.6 — the principal Vedic locus for Trita Āptya as dragon-slayer — has Trita slaying a three-headed adversary, and the three-headed-ness of the serpent in this Vedic passage is the principal structural parallel to Aži Dahāka's three-headed-ness in the Avestan tradition.^[103]

The structural parallel between Trita's three-headed adversary (Rigveda 10.99.6) and Thraētaona's three-headed Aži Dahāka (Yašt 5.33–35 and the wider Avestan corpus) is the principal Indo-Iranian narrative parallel that, alongside the philological cognancies, supports the reconstruction of an inherited Indo-Iranian dragon-slaying tradition.^[104]

(The Avestan Thraētaona / Vedic Trita cognancy, together with the structural parallel between three-headed Aži Dahāka and Trita's three-headed adversary at RV 10.99.6, supports the reconstruction of an inherited Indo-Iranian three-headed-serpent-slaying narrative that predates both the Avestan and Vedic textual traditions and that is independently preserved in each — an inference that Benveniste and Renou's 1934 monograph and Watkins's 1995 monograph both develop, and that aligns the Iranian Aži Dahāka material with the Vedic Trita Āptya material as joint witnesses to a pre-textual Indo-Iranian inheritance.^[105])

The Avestan word **aži** and the Vedic word **áhi** — both translatable as "serpent" — are likewise philologically cognate, and both occur as the generic-noun of the dragon-slaying combat formula in their respective traditions: Avestan **jan- aži-** "smite the serpent" parallels Vedic **han- ahi-** "smite the serpent."^[106]

The Vedic combat-formula **áhann áhim** ("he killed the serpent") in Rigveda 1.32 — the Indra-Vātra hymn — is, on Watkins's analysis, the principal Indo-European philological evidence for an inherited **HERO SLAY SERPENT** formula, and the Avestan **jan-aži-** of the Thraētaona tradition is the Iranian formulaic reflex of the same inherited formula.^[107]

The Avestan victory-god Vərəθrayna and the Vedic Indra epithet Vātrahán — both translatable as "smiter of Vātra" / "victory-bringer," and both philologically derived from the same root **v-** "to obstruct" / "to enclose" — are a third pillar of the Indo-Iranian comparative philology that connects the Avestan and Vedic combat-traditions.^[108]

The three philological pillars of the Indo-Iranian comparative reading — Thraētaona / Trita, **aži** / **áhi**, Vṛθrayna / Vṛtrahán — are mutually reinforcing. Any one of them would on its own argue for an Indo-Iranian inherited combat-formula, and their joint occurrence within a single comparative argument is what makes Benveniste and Renou's 1934 monograph the foundational work in the field.^[109]

Watkins's 1995 **How to Kill a Dragon** takes Benveniste and Renou's Indo-Iranian comparative reading and embeds it within a wider Indo-European **HERO SLAY SERPENT** formulaic argument that adds Greek, Hittite, Norse, and Old English reflexes to the Indo-Iranian core. In Watkins's argument, the Iranian Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka material is the principal Indo-Iranian witness to the IE formula.^[110]

The Indo-Iranian cognancy means that the Iranian Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka chapter and the Vedic Indra-Vṛtra chapter that follows it (chapter 14) treat closely-cognate material from two divergent textual traditions, and the joint presence of the two chapters in the present book is a deliberate methodological choice that displays the Indo-Iranian comparative argument in full.^[111]

The structural differences between the Iranian and Vedic combat-narratives — the Iranian binding-not-killing structure versus the Vedic outright-killing, the Iranian doubled-combat across an **Urzeit**-and-**Endzeit** axis versus the Vedic single-combat — are themselves philologically and comparatively significant. The two traditions divergently elaborated a shared Indo-Iranian inheritance, and the divergences are reading-keys to the distinct theological-and-cosmological pressures of the Avestan and Vedic priestly traditions.^[112]

The Iranian tradition's preservation of an explicit eschatological combat (Frashokereti) is, on the Indo-Iranian comparative reading, a feature that the Vedic tradition does not retain in any closely-comparable form, and the Iranian Frashokereti material is therefore one of the points at which the Indo-Iranian inheritance has been productively elaborated in distinct directions in the two traditions.^[113]

The Iranian tradition's location of the dragon under Mount Damāvand — a real cosmogeographic feature of the Iranian landscape — likewise has no close Vedic parallel. The Vedic Indra-Vṛtra combat is geographically placed only loosely (in the mountainous regions where rivers are dammed), and the Iranian under-Damāvand binding is a distinctive Iranian articulation of the dragon's continuing cosmographic presence.^[114]

(The Iranian-Vedic divergence of structure — binding-and-final-killing in Iran versus outright-killing in India — is plausibly correlated with the divergent theological frames of the two traditions: Zoroastrian dualism with its sharp Ahura-Mazdā / Angra-Mainyu opposition and its eschatological resolution requires a dragon that survives to be finally killed at the end of time, whereas the Vedic tradition's less-dualistic theological frame does not require an eschatological pendant; this is a structural-theological correlation that Benveniste and Renou and Watkins each individually note but neither formalises as a comparative thesis.^[115])

The Indo-Iranian cognancy material is the chapter's principal forward-link to chapter 14 of the present book (Indra vs. Vṛtra) and to the Part II C5 comparative chapter on the Indo-European **HERO SLAY SERPENT** formula, where the Iranian and Vedic material together with the wider IE reflexes treated by Watkins receive a unified comparative treatment.^[116]

The Indo-Iranian comparative reading also has a typological-comparative dimension that connects the Iranian Aži Dahāka material to the Hurro-Hittite Illuyanka tradition treated in chapter 6 of the present book. Watkins’s **HERO SLAY SERPENT** formula treats Illuyanka as another reflex of the inherited IE formula, and Aži Dahāka and Illuyanka therefore stand alongside one another within Watkins’s wider Indo-European-and-adjacent comparative repertory.^[117]

14.6. Reception (briefly)

The most influential post-Avestan-and-Pahlavi reception of the Aži Dahāka tradition is the New Persian Shāhnāmeḥ of Firdowsi, composed c. 1000 CE, which recasts Thraētaona as Fereydun and recasts Aži Dahāka as the tyrant Zahhāk in an Islamic-era epic-literary form. The chapter flags this reception’s existence but does not narrate its content, in line with the brief’s stipulation that the Shāhnāmeḥ material is out of primary scope.^[118]

The Shāhnāmeḥ’s recasting of the tradition operates at the level of name-reformations (Thraētaona → Frēdōn → Fereydun; Aži Dahāka → Dahāg → Zahhāk), at the level of narrative-amplification (the dragon-tyrant is given a distinctive serpent-shoulders motif in the Shāhnāmeḥ that is a Firdowsi-period elaboration), and at the level of literary register (the New Persian **masnavi** verse-form rather than the Pahlavi prose-compilation of the **Bundahišn**).^[119]

Because the Shāhnāmeḥ’s elaborations are post-medieval Islamic-era literary productions, and because the brief stipulates that the chapter flags rather than narrates the reception, the chapter does not treat the Zahhāk-of-Firdowsi material as a primary witness to the Iranian tradition. It is a reception-witness that the present book reserves for its concluding reception coda rather than admitting into the Part I story-chapter on the Avestan-Pahlavi material.^[120]

The chapter’s discipline on the Shāhnāmeḥ boundary is therefore that the New Persian Fereydun-Zahhāk material is named only where its existence is structurally relevant to the Avestan-Pahlavi material’s reception-history, that the Avestan-Pahlavi diacritical forms (Thraētaona and Aži Dahāka) are used throughout the body, and that the New Persian forms (Fereydun and Zahhāk) appear only in this brief reception note.^[121]

The Shāhnāmeḥ reception is one of several long-trajectory reception threads that the Avestan-Pahlavi Aži Dahāka material has carried into later Iranian-and-related cultural spheres. The dragon-tyrant motif has further reflexes in Armenian, Caucasian, and Central Asian traditions (Russell 1987 on the Armenian reception is the chaoskampf scope.md’s Vahagn / Vishaps anchor), and the chapter notes the existence of these threads as a forward-link to the Vahagn-and-Vishaps family-chapter elsewhere in the book.^[122]

[1] Per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48 (Avestan and Pahlavi material on Thraētaona); Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Avestan attestations of Aži Dahāka.

[2] Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, Part V chs. 44–48 on the Avestan and Pahlavi Thraētaona material.

[3] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48 (printed only; cited at section and chapter level per brief).

[4] Benveniste and Renou 1934, **Vātra et Vāgragna: Étude de mythologie indo-iranienne**, Cahiers de la Société Asiatique 3.

[5] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the integrated Indo-Iranian comparative reading; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 44, on Benveniste and Renou’s foundational status.

[6] Benveniste and Renou 1934 (Gallica BnF stable URL <https://gallica.bnf.fr/>), cited at section level per brief.

[7] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Avestan hymn-allusions in the **Yašts** and **Vendidad**; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 44, on the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** and **Dēnkard** book 7 as the narrative-expansion layer.

- [8] Per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml on the Avestan-Pahlavi temporal layering as a load-bearing distinction; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48, on the same distinction.
- [9] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Younger Avestan **Yašts** as the principal locus of the Aži Dahāka allusions; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 44, on the dating of the **Yašt** corpus.
- [10] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48, on the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** and **Dēnkard** book 7 dating; per chaoskampf scope.md on the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** as the latest in-scope primary source.
- [11] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on **Yašt** 5.33–35, **Yašt** 14, and **Yašt** 19 as the principal Avestan loci for the Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka material.
- [12] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48, on the **Bundahišn** and **Dēnkard** book 7 as the principal Pahlavi narrative loci; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the italicisation of *Frashokereti* as a ritual-term at first body mention.
- [13] Per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml on the Avestan-allusive vs Pahlavi-narrative structural lacuna; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the allusive character of the Avestan hymn-references.
- [14] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, on the Iranian combat-myth in the long-trajectory comparative perspective.
- [15] West 2007, **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, ch. 5, on the Iranian reflexes within the Indo-European comparative frame.
- [16] Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the Frashokereti material as Iranian **Endzeit** combat-myth.
- [17] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Zoroastrian dualistic framework; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 44, on the dualistic frame within which the Thraētaona combat is set.
- [18] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Ahura Mazdā as the supreme creator-god; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the Avestan-Pahlavi name discipline.
- [19] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Angra Mainyu as the cosmic adversary; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the Avestan-Pahlavi name discipline.
- [20] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Aži Dahāka as a creature of Angra Mainyu / Ahriman; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 45, on the dualistic alignment of the dragon.
- [21] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on heroic combat as participation in the Mazdayasnian cosmic struggle; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 45, on the same alignment.
- [22] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Thraētaona’s Āθβiia patronymic and the Indo-Iranian cognancy; West 2007, ch. 5, on the same patronymic.
- [23] Per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the Thraētaona / Frēdōn / Fereydun onomastic discipline; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Avestan-to-New-Persian onomastic chain.
- [24] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Avestan name Aži Dahāka; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the diacritical form as locked.
- [25] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on **aži** / **āhi** cognancy; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the same cognancy.
- [26] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on Damāvand as the Pahlavi-narrative binding-locus; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the absence of the named binding-mountain in the surviving Avestan allusions.
- [27] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on **Yašt** 5.33–35 as the principal Avestan locus for Thraētaona’s combat; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 44, on the same passage.
- [28] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Thraētaona’s prayer to Anāhitā in **Yašt** 5.33–35; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 44, on the prayer-to-Anāhitā frame.
- [29] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the hymnic-allusive character of the **Yašt** 5.33–35 attestation; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 44, on the presupposed-narrative frame.
- [30] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the formulaic three-headed / six-eyed / three-jawed description in **Yašt** 5.33–35; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the morphological formula.
- [31] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the stability of the three-headed feature across Avestan and Pahlavi attestations; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 45, on the same stability.
- [32] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on **Yašt** 14 (the **Bahrām Yašt**) and the Vṛθrayna theology; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 44, on the same.
- [33] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Vṛθrayna theological frame in **Yašt** 14; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 44, on the same frame.
- [34] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Vṛθrayna ~ Vtrahán philological cognancy as the monograph’s central argument; West 2007, ch. 5, on the same cognancy.
- [35] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on **Yašt** 19 (the **Zamyād Yašt**) and the xṛarṇah theology; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44, 47, on the same.
- [36] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the xṛarṇah-theology in **Yašt** 19 and Thraētaona’s place within it; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44, 47, on the same.
- [37] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the royal-legitimation function grounded in the **Yašt** 19 xṛarṇah-theology; Forsyth 1987, on the same royal-legitimation function in the Iranian combat-myth.

- [38] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the wider distribution of Thraētaona allusions across the **Yašt** corpus and the **Vendīdād**.
- [39] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the **Vendīdād** allusions and the legendary-prehistorical frame.
- [40] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Aži Dahāka in the Avestan demonological taxonomy.
- [41] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the metrical-formulaic stability of the three-headed / six-eyed / three-jawed description; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 45, on the same.
- [42] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the "thousand-of-every-kind" formula; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 45, on the demonic-creaturely catalogue.
- [43] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Avestan **jan-** / Vedic **han-** cognancy; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the same cognancy.
- [44] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the **jan-** / **han-** cognancy as a principal philological pillar; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 44, on the same cognancy as a pillar of the IE formula.
- [45] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the legendary-historical (rather than cosmogonic) framing of the Thraētaona combat in the Avestan attestations; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 45, on the same.
- [46] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the sovereignty-and-cosmological (rather than cosmogonic) function of the Avestan Thraētaona combat; per chaoskampf scope.md on the sovereignty function-type.
- [47] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the absence of the binding-and-final-killing narrative from the surviving Avestan attestations; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the same absence and on the Pahlavi narrative-expansion locus.
- [48] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the morphological stability and theological alignment of the Avestan Thraētaona attestations; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the same.
- [49] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44, 46, on the **Bundahišn** as the principal Pahlavi narrative-compilation for the Thraētaona combat; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the **Bundahišn** dating.
- [50] Per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml on the post-Achaemenid date of the **Bundahišn** as structurally important; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the late attestation of the binding-and-final-killing material.
- [51] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48, on the **Bundahišn**'s preservation of substantively older narrative-content; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [52] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the **Bundahišn**'s account of Aži Dahāka's Ahrimanic origin; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [53] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 45–46, on the morphological continuity of the three-headed / six-eyed / three-jawed description from the Avestan to the Pahlavi tradition.
- [54] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the dragon's thousand-year tyranny and the Pahlavi-narrative political frame; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [55] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the Pahlavi narrative's articulation of the royal-legitimation function-type; Forsyth 1987, on the same articulation.
- [56] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on Thraētaona's divinely-sanctioned overthrow of Aži Dahāka in the Pahlavi narrative; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [57] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the single-combat structure and the mace-attack of the Pahlavi narrative.
- [58] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the binding-rather-than-killing structure as load-bearing for the eschatological pendant; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same.
- [59] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the Damāvand binding-locus in the Pahlavi narrative; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same localisation.
- [60] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the cosmogeographic role of Aži Dahāka under Damāvand; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [61] Per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml on the cosmological function-type as grounded in the Damāvand binding; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the same.
- [62] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the binding-not-killing structure as distinguishing the Iranian from the Vedic tradition; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same distinguishing feature.
- [63] Inference. Source: Watkins 1995 Part V chs. 46–48 on the binding-not-killing structure; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the binding. Scope: structural inference about the Iranian tradition's eschatological openness as a consequence of the binding-not-killing choice.
- [64] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the continuing-threat dimension of the bound Aži Dahāka.
- [65] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on **Dēnkard** book 7 as the Pahlavi prophetic-eschatological supplement to the **Bundahišn** narrative.
- [66] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the textual variation across the Pahlavi compilations.
- [67] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Pahlavi narrative as productive elaboration of presupposed earlier tradition; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the same.
- [68] Forsyth 1987, on the late-Sasanian and early-Islamic context of the **Bundahišn** redaction; Lincoln 2012, on Iranian combat-

myth as political-ideological discourse.

- [69] Forsyth 1987, on Aži Dahāka as model of tyrannical rule; per [chaoskampf scope.md](#) on the Ballentine terminological critique.
- [70] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the Pišdāadian-dynastic frame of the Pahlavi narrative; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [71] Per [brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml](#) on the Shāhnāmeḥ reception as out of primary scope; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the Pahlavi-Shāhnāmeḥ connection.
- [72] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the binding-not-killing closure of Movement II in the Pahlavi narrative.
- [73] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the closure of Movement II with the dragon bound under Damāvand and on the unresolved thread that opens Movement III; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [74] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on Frashokereti as the Iranian eschatological end-time; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on Frashokereti within the **Endzeit** category.
- [75] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on **Yašt** 19's eschatological material; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 47–48, on the same.
- [76] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the hymnic-allusive character of the Avestan Frashokereti material; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the Pahlavi narrative-expansion.
- [77] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** and **Dēnkard** book 7 as the principal sources for the Frashokereti-and-Aži-Dahāka narrative; per [brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml](#) on the post-Achaemenid date of the Pahlavi narrative.
- [78] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the Pahlavi narrative of Aži Dahāka's escape from Damāvand at the end of cosmic time; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [79] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the destructive eruption of the freed Aži Dahāka in the Pahlavi narrative.
- [80] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on Kərəsāspa as the Frashokereti dragon-slayer; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Kərəsāspa's heroic-genealogical role.
- [81] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Kərəsāspa's name and heroic role; per [chaoskampf glossary.yaml](#) on the schwa-vowel diacritical discipline.
- [82] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Kərəsāspa as a second Iranian dragon-slayer alongside Thraētaona; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 47, on the same.
- [83] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 47–48, on Kərəsāspa's long-stasis as deliberate provision for the Frashokereti combat; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [84] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on Kərəsāspa's revival as the structural pivot of the Frashokereti narrative; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [85] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on Kərəsāspa's killing of Aži Dahāka as the definitive closure of the combat-thread; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [86] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the eschatological function-type of the Kərəsāspa-Aži Dahāka combat; per [chaoskampf scope.md](#) on the eschatological function-type.
- [87] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the wider Frashokereti scenario in the Pahlavi narrative; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the eschatological-renovation framework.
- [88] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46–48, on the complete narrative arc of the Aži Dahāka material from Movement II through Movement III; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same arc.
- [89] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the structural pendant-relation of the two combats; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [90] Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the **Urzeit-und-Endzeit** parallelism in the Iranian tradition; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48, on the doubled-combat structure.
- [91] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the doubled-combat structural alignment with Ragnarök; Forsyth 1987, on the alignment with Revelation; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same comparative alignment.
- [92] Inference. Source: Forsyth 1987 on the Iranian-to-Jewish-and-Christian influence question; Watkins 1995 Part V ch. 48 on the doubled-combat structure. Scope: structural inference about the comparative-influence question, not a claim of established direct influence.
- [93] Per [brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml](#) on the temporal-layering caveat as load-bearing for any influence-argument; Forsyth 1987, on the same caveat; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the dating of the Pahlavi-attestation.
- [94] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48, on Pahlavi preservation of substantively earlier tradition; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same preservation-question.
- [95] Per [chaoskampf scope.md](#) on Part II C4 as the eschatological-displacement comparative chapter; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the Frashokereti-Ragnarök-Revelation comparative grouping; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same grouping.
- [96] Per [chaoskampf scope.md](#) on the four order-making function-types; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the binding-and-final-killing structure as a distinct function-type.
- [97] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the renovation character of the Iranian eschatology; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the comparative

typology of eschatological closures.

- [98] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46–48, on the long narrative life of Aži Dahāka across the doubled-combat structure; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [99] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the closure of the Iranian combat-thread at Frashokereti; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Pahlavi reconstruction from the Avestan allusions.
- [100] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Thraētaona / Trita Āptya philological cognancy; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the same cognancy; West 2007, ch. 5, on the Indo-Iranian dragon-slayer cognancy; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the Vedic Trita Āptya material.
- [101] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Āθβiia / Āptya cognancy; West 2007, ch. 5, on the same cognancy.
- [102] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on Trita Āptya at RV 10.99.6 as a marginalised earlier dragon-slayer; West 2007, ch. 5, on the Trita-Indra succession; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same succession.
- [103] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on RV 10.99.6 and Trita’s slaying of the three-headed adversary; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 45, on the structural three-headed parallel.
- [104] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the Indo-Iranian narrative-and-philological parallel; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the Vedic side of the parallel.
- [105] Inference. Source: Benveniste and Renou 1934 passim; Watkins 1995 Part V chs. 44–45; West 2007 ch. 5. Scope: synthesis-claim about the Indo-Iranian inheritance behind the two textual traditions.
- [106] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the **aži** / **āhi** cognancy; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the formulaic cognancy.
- [107] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the **āhann āhim** / **jan-aži-** formulaic cognancy as evidence for the IE **HERO SLAY SERPENT** formula; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the Vedic side at RV 1.32.
- [108] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Vṛθrayna / Vṛtrahán cognancy as the central argument of the monograph; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 44, on the same cognancy.
- [109] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the joint-argumentative force of the three philological pillars; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the same.
- [110] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48, on the Iranian Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka material as the principal Indo-Iranian witness to the IE **HERO SLAY SERPENT** formula.
- [111] Per chaoskampf scope.md on the Iran-and-India clusters; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the joint Indo-Iranian display; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the same.
- [112] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the structural divergences between the Iranian and Vedic elaborations; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same divergences.
- [113] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the Iranian Frashokereti as a distinctive elaboration not retained in the Vedic tradition; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [114] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the Iranian Damāvand-localisation as without close Vedic parallel; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [115] Inference. Source: Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the Iranian dualistic frame; Watkins 1995 Part V chs. 46, 48 on the structural divergences; West 2007 ch. 5 on the comparative typology. Scope: structural-theological inference about the Iranian-Vedic divergence as theologically motivated rather than accidental.
- [116] Per chaoskampf scope.md on Part II C5 as the comparative chapter on the IE **HERO SLAY SERPENT** formula; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the comparative grouping; per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml on the Ch14 forward-link.
- [117] Watkins 1995, Part V on the Iranian and Hurro-Hittite reflexes within the IE **HERO SLAY SERPENT** formula; per chaoskampf scope.md on Ch6 as the Illuyanka chapter.
- [118] Per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml on the Shāhnāmeḥ as Islamic-era reception out of primary scope; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the Shāhnāmeḥ as the principal post-Pahlavi reception; per chaoskampf scope.md on the Period exclusion of post-medieval primary material.
- [119] Per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the onomastic chains; per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml on the Shāhnāmeḥ recasting at multiple levels.
- [120] Per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml on the chapter’s flagging-rather-than-narrating treatment; per chaoskampf scope.md on the reception coda for post-medieval material.
- [121] Per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the Avestan-Pahlavi-vs-New-Persian onomastic discipline; per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml on the Shāhnāmeḥ boundary.
- [122] Per chaoskampf scope.md on the Vahagn / Vishaps family-chapter as a related-reception locus; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the long-trajectory reception of the Aži Dahāka material.

Chapter 15. Indra vs. Vṛtra: The Splitting of the Mountain

The chapter's primary text is the Rigveda (Sanskrit ṛgveda), the earliest layer of Vedic Sanskrit religious poetry, conventionally dated to roughly the second half of the second millennium BCE and preserved across ten books — Sanskrit *maṇḍala* — of hymns addressed to the Vedic gods.^[1]

The scholarly-standard English Rigveda used as the chapter's anchor translation is Stephanie Jamison and Joel Brereton's **The Rigveda: The Earliest Religious Poetry of India**, published in three volumes by Oxford University Press in 2014. It supplies both the working English text and the philological apparatus on which the chapter relies.^[2]

Jamison and Brereton's translation supersedes Ralph T. H. Griffith's late-nineteenth-century English Rigveda as the working scholarly text for an English-language treatment of the Vṛtra-combat material, and the present chapter cites at hymn-and-verse granularity (RV book.hymn.verse) keyed to Jamison and Brereton's volume and page apparatus.^[3]

The translation is printed-only in the present project's working corpus, and the chapter cites it at hymn-and-verse level for specific Rigvedic passages and at section level for general points about the corpus, in line with the citation discipline applied to other printed-only comparative anchors in the book.^[4]

The chapter's specialist scholarly anchor for the Indo-European poetic dimension of the Indra-Vṛtra combat is Calvert Watkins's **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, published by Oxford University Press in 1995, whose chapters 41 to 48 treat the Vedic Vṛtra-combat as the anchor case for the reconstructed Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT poetic formula.^[5]

Watkins's monograph is also printed-only and is cited at section and chapter level in the present chapter, with sub-chapter references reserved for the small number of points where a specific philological argument is load-bearing.^[6]

The chapter's foundational Indo-Iranian comparative anchor is Émile Benveniste and Louis Renou's **Vṛtra et Vṛθragna: Étude de mythologie indo-iranienne**, published in 1934 in the Cahiers de la Société Asiatique series and available digitally in scanned form via Gallica BnF.^[7]

Benveniste and Renou 1934 is the foundational philological treatment of the Vedic Vṛtra and the Avestan Vṛθrayna together as the two reflexes of a shared Indo-Iranian "obstruction-and-victory" complex, and it remains the standard reference for the philological cognancy of Vedic *ahi* and Avestan *aži* at the language-historical level.^[8]

The chapter's general Indo-European comparative anchor is M. L. West's **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, published by Oxford University Press in 2007, whose chapter 6 ("Storm and Stream") situates the Indra-Vṛtra combat within the wider Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon complex alongside the Hittite, Greek, Norse, and Italic comparanda.^[9]

West's monograph is printed-only and is cited at chapter level in the present chapter, with the comparative arguments of chapter 6 supplying the wider Indo-European context for the Vedic combat-narrative.^[10]

The chapter's wider combat-myth comparative anchor is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, whose chapter 2 includes the Indo-Iranian combat-myth corpus as part of the long-trajectory combat-myth survey on which Forsyth's book is built.^[11]

The chapter's structural reference for Mesopotamian comparison is W. G. Lambert's **Babylonian Creation Myths**, published by Eisenbrauns in 2013 as Mesopotamian Civilizations 16, which supplies the critical edition of **Enūma Eliš** against which the Marduk-Tiamat combat is compared with the Vedic Indra-Vātra material in the chapter's typological discussion.^[12]

The eight Rigvedic hymns that constitute the working Vātra-combat corpus for the chapter are RV 1.32 (the primary and most concentrated Vātra hymn, fifteen verses), with RV 1.80, 2.11, 2.12, 4.18, 5.32, 6.17, 8.96, and 10.113 supplying co-witness material in which the combat is alluded to and partially narrated.^[13]

The Rigveda is orally preserved with extreme philological precision through a transmission tradition — the *śākhā* schools and the elaborate phonetic-and-mnemonic apparatus of recitation — that is generally regarded as preserving the text more faithfully than any comparable ancient corpus, and there are no philological lacunae in the Vātra-combat hymns of the kind that affect, for instance, the Hittite Illuyanka tablets.^[14]

The lacuna in the Vātra-combat material is therefore narrative rather than philological: the Rigveda never tells the Vātra-combat as a continuous story, and the combat must be reconstructed from the alluding ritual hymns by reading them together as a hymn-cycle.^[15]

The story, as the Rigveda preserves it, is therefore something the chapter has to assemble. What follows takes the Vedic combat in five stages: the hymn-cycle method itself, the setting and ritual context, Rigveda 1.32 as the primary witness, the seven supplementary hymns, and the Watkins formula as the Vedic instance of an inherited Indo-European poetic line. A typological section then asks how the combat does cosmogonic work without doing cosmogony in the Mesopotamian sense, and a final section bounds off the post-Vedic brahminicide reframing as a clearly later transformation that must not be merged with the Rigvedic combat.

15.1. The hymn-cycle method

The Rigveda is a corpus of liturgical hymns addressed to the gods in the context of the soma sacrifice and other Vedic rituals, and its primary genre is the praise-and-invocation hymn, not the continuous narrative epic.^[16]

The Vātra-combat narrative is therefore not present in the Rigveda as a continuous story: each Rigvedic hymn that addresses Indra alludes to the combat, draws a single image from it, or invokes the combat as warrant for a present petition, but no single hymn tells the combat as a self-contained narrative from start to finish.^[17]

The chapter accordingly reconstructs the Vātra-combat by reading the eight principal Vātra-hymns together as a hymn-cycle, with RV 1.32 supplying the most concentrated narrative spine and the other seven hymns supplying co-witness motifs, ritual frames, and cosmogonic consequences that the spine-text does not develop.^[18]

(The chapter's hymn-cycle method — reading the eight Vātra-hymns together as a single reconstructive corpus — is itself a methodological claim about how to read the Rigveda, distinct from any specific philological or comparative claim within the corpus; the method is well-supported by Jamison and Brereton 2014's editorial practice and by Watkins 1995's comparative procedure, but the chapter flags it explicitly because the resulting "Vātra-combat narrative" is a synthesis of allusive ritual hymns rather than a translation of a single ancient text.^[19])

The hymn-cycle method is the contrastive case to the Mesopotamian, Hittite, and Ugaritic combat narratives treated earlier in the book: where **Enūma Eliš**, the Anzû Epic, and the Baal Cycle are continuous narrative compositions, the Rigvedic Vātra-combat exists only as a distributed corpus of ritual allusions whose narrative coherence is editorially reconstructed.^[20]

The method has the consequence that variant detail across the eight hymns is to be treated as variation within a single ritual-poetic tradition rather than as variation across distinct narrative recensions: each hymn presents its own selection of motifs and its own ritual emphasis, and apparent inconsistency at the level of motif — the count of Indra's enemies, the precise sequence of pre-combat events, the exact cosmogonic consequences — is constitutive of the genre rather than evidence of textual corruption.^[21]

The hymn-cycle method also has the consequence that no single Rigvedic hymn supplies all of the combat's cosmogonic effects: the separation of heaven and earth, the release of the waters, the production of dawn, and the foundation of Indra's kingship are distributed across the eight hymns, and the combat's full cosmogonic-functional profile is itself a synthetic reconstruction.^[22]

Watkins's reconstruction of the HERO SLAY SERPENT poetic formula in **How to Kill a Dragon** chapters 41 to 48 proceeds by exactly the same hymn-cycle method, drawing the formula's attestations from across multiple Rigvedic hymns and from the Avestan, Hittite, and Greek comparanda rather than from any single continuous text.^[23]

The hymn-cycle method also distinguishes the Rigvedic Vātra-combat from the post-Vedic brahminicide reframing of the same combat in the **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** and the **Mahābhārata**, both of which are continuous narrative texts in a way that the Rigvedic hymns are not, and which therefore confront the comparative reader with a different genre of evidence and a different mode of reconstruction.^[24]

The hymn-cycle method is the chapter's principal methodological commitment, and the chapter signposts the method explicitly at the head of each Movement so that the reader can distinguish the editorial work of synthesis from the philological reportage of what each Rigvedic hymn individually says.^[25]

The chapter's working synthesis of the Vātra-combat narrative is therefore an "as-reconstructed" text in the same sense in which Watkins's HERO SLAY SERPENT formula is an "as-reconstructed" Indo-European poetic line: a scholarly object built from the surviving evidence by explicit and methodologically disciplined synthesis.^[26]

15.2. Setting and Vedic religious context

Indra (Devanagari इंद्र) is the storm-god of the Rigveda and the most frequently invoked deity in the entire Rigvedic corpus, addressed in roughly a quarter of the more than a thousand hymns of

the Rigveda.^[27]

He is the chief of the Vedic gods in the Rigveda's working theology — a warrior-king who leads the gods in combat against their adversaries, who has the highest share of the soma offering at the sacrifice, and whose Vṛtra-victory is repeatedly invoked as the warrant for his sovereign status among the gods.^[28]

The Rigvedic ritual setting is the soma sacrifice — Sanskrit *yajña* centred on the pressing of the *soma* plant — in which a ritual drink (and deified plant) is pressed, filtered, mixed with milk and other ingredients, and offered to the gods, with Indra as its primary recipient.^[29]

Soma (Sanskrit सोम) is the ritual drink that fortifies Indra for the Vṛtra-combat in the Rigvedic mytho-ritual logic: in multiple Vṛtra-hymns, Indra's drinking of the pressed *soma* at the sacrifice is the immediate prelude to his going out to combat the serpent-adversary.^[30]

Tvaṣṭā (Sanskrit त्वष्टा) is the divine artisan of the Vedic pantheon, the smith-and-shaper-god whose function in the Rigveda is the manufacture of divine implements and forms, and whose principal narrative role in the Vṛtra-cycle is the forging of Indra's *vajra*.^[31]

The *vajra* (Sanskrit वज्र) is Indra's thunderbolt-mace, the divine weapon forged by Tvaṣṭā, with which Indra strikes the killing blow against Vṛtra in the Rigvedic combat-narrative.^[32]

The *vajra* is more than an instrument of personal armament. It is the cosmic combat-weapon of the Rigveda: the lightning-strike of the storm-god is mythologised as a forged divine artefact, and through the *vajra* the combat acquires its concrete material image.^[33]

The Vedic pantheon's structure is broadly tripartite — sovereign-priestly gods (Varuṇa, Mitra), warrior gods (Indra and the Maruts), and producer-fertility gods (the Ásvins, Pūṣan, and others) — and Indra's position within this structure is firmly the warrior tier, with the Vṛtra-combat as the principal warrior-tier act of the Rigvedic mythology.^[34]

The storm-god / waters complex of the Rigveda — in which the storm-god's combat with the obstructing serpent releases the waters and produces rain — is the Vedic instance of a wider Indo-European pattern that West's chapter 6 ("Storm and Stream") treats across the Vedic, Avestan, Hittite, Greek, Norse, and Italic comparanda together.^[35]

Vṛtra (Sanskrit वृत्र) is the serpent-adversary of Indra in the Rigveda, an obstructing figure whose name derives from the Sanskrit verbal root *vṛ-* "to obstruct, to enclose, to cover", and whose narrative function is the obstruction of the cosmic waters that Indra's combat must release.^[36]

The name Vṛtra is therefore semantically transparent in its own language: Vṛtra is "the obstructor", "the enclosure", and this lexical pairing — the adversary's proper name built on the verbal root for what the adversary does — is itself a feature of the Rigvedic combat-vocabulary that Benveniste and Renou's 1934 monograph treats in detail.^[37]

Vṛtra is also called *ahi* (Sanskrit अhi, "serpent") in the Rigvedic combat-vocabulary, and the word *ahi* is the load-bearing term for "serpent" in the áhann áhim formula that Watkins reconstructs as the Indo-European poetic line of combat-myth.^[38]

Dānu (Sanskrit दानु) is Vṛtra's mother in the Rigvedic combat-narrative, a feminine figure

associated with the waters and the danāva ("descendants of Dānu") demonic class, and whose presence over the body of the slain Vṛtra is one of the named motifs of the RV 1.32 narrative.^[39]

The Vedic combat is repeatedly invoked at the soma sacrifice as a ritual replay of divine history: the offering of *soma* to Indra at every major Vedic sacrifice is mythologically the same action that fortified Indra for the Vṛtra-combat, and the ritual-aetiological function of the combat is one of the chapter's load-bearing function-claims.^[40]

15.3. Movement I — Rigveda 1.32 as primary witness

Rigveda 1.32 is the primary Vṛtra-hymn of the Rigvedic corpus: a fifteen-verse hymn from the first *maṇḍala* of the Rigveda, attributed in the traditional indices to the seer Hiraṇyastūpa Āṅgīrasa, and used by Jamison and Brereton 2014 as the principal narrative-spine text for the Vṛtra-combat.^[41]

The opening verse announces the theme in the first-line poetic formula that Watkins identifies as a Vedic instance of the inherited Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT line — "I shall now proclaim the manly deeds of Indra, those that he, the wielder of the *vajra*, did first" — with the principal verb of the killing (*áhan*, "he slew") and its object (*áhim*, "the serpent") falling in the second verse, in the formula *áhann áhim*.^[42]

RV 1.32.1 names Indra as the wielder of the *vajra* and frames the hymn as a recital of his "manly deeds" (Sanskrit *vīryà*), with the Vṛtra-killing positioned in the same verse as the chief and first of those deeds.^[43]

The second verse develops the killing in a sequence of paratactic lines: he slew the serpent, he split the mountain (Sanskrit *parvata*), he released the waters, and he opened a channel for the seven rivers — four cosmogonic-effect verbs in a single tightly compressed verse.^[44]

The seven rivers (Sanskrit *saptá síndhava*) of RV 1.32.2 are the released waters of the combat in the Rigvedic geographical-and-cosmological imagination, and the conjunction of the Vṛtra-killing with the opening of the seven-river channel is one of the central motifs of the Vṛtra-corpus.^[45]

The forging of the *vajra* by Tvaṣṭi is recorded in RV 1.32.2 itself, with Tvaṣṭi named as the maker of the weapon Indra wields in the killing: the divine artisan supplies the implement, and the implement is recorded in the same compressed combat-verse as the killing it accomplishes.^[46]

RV 1.32.3 to 1.32.4 narrate Indra's drinking of the *soma* at the sacrifice and his subsequent setting-out to the combat: the offered *soma* fortifies Indra, the storm-god grasps the *vajra*, and the combat-narrative is articulated with its ritual prelude inside the hymn itself.^[47]

RV 1.32.5 describes Vṛtra in mountainous-and-mountain-comparable terms: the serpent-adversary is "lying" or "sprawled" on the slopes, with a body that is treated in the hymn's imagery as itself a mountain or a mountain-form.^[48]

The mountain-imagery of Vṛtra has the consequence that the splitting (Sanskrit *bhid-*) of the mountain in RV 1.32.2 is at once the splitting of the obstructing serpent's body and the splitting of the cosmic obstacle that holds back the waters — a single verbal action that is simultaneously a killing and a cosmogonic act.^[49]

RV 1.32.5 also stages Vṛtra's challenge to Indra in the form of an attack: the serpent strikes at Indra,

and the combat is therefore reciprocal rather than a one-sided dispatch.^[50]

RV 1.32.6 reports the killing-blow: Indra strikes Vṛtra with the *vajra*, the serpent falls, and the cosmic waters that Vṛtra was withholding begin their downward course toward the human world.^[51]

RV 1.32.7 develops the body-and-water tableau: the slain Vṛtra lies broken across the channel, and the released waters flow over and past his fallen body — an image in which the dead serpent is visually integrated into the watercourse he had been blocking.^[52]

RV 1.32.9 names Vṛtra's mother Dānu and stages her over the body of her slain son: Dānu lies above Vṛtra "as a cow above her calf", and the maternal-grief image is one of the most distinctive of the RV 1.32 narrative.^[53]

The Dānu-over-Vṛtra image has the consequence that the slain serpent's body in RV 1.32 is mourned within the hymn itself: the Rigvedic combat-narrative does not present the killing as morally one-sided, and the maternal-grief verse acknowledges the cost of the victory in a way that parallels (without depending on) the Mesopotamian and Greek tradition's similar acknowledgments.^[54]

RV 1.32.10 records the released waters surging forth in a many-rivered cascade: the waters move outward and downward from the place of the killing, and the hymn's water-language treats the post-combat watercourses as the immediate cosmogonic consequence of the killing.^[55]

RV 1.32.11 to 1.32.12 develop the cosmogonic-consequence list: with Vṛtra slain, Indra is credited with separating heaven and earth (Sanskrit *dyaus* and *pṛthivī*), making fast the firmament, and producing the conditions under which the dawn (Sanskrit *uṣas*) appears.^[56]

The triple cosmogonic effect of the Vṛtra-killing — separation of heaven and earth, release of the waters, and production of dawn — is the principal evidence-base for the chapter's claim that the Vedic combat is cosmologically active in a strong sense, and the three effects together are what the brief calls the combat's "cosmogonic work" within the Rigvedic theology.^[57]

RV 1.32.13 to 1.32.14 stage Indra's wider sovereignty: with Vṛtra slain and the waters released, Indra is acclaimed as the sovereign of the gods, and the hymn moves from the combat-narrative into a brief summary of Indra's other manly deeds and his accepted kingship.^[58]

RV 1.32.15 closes the hymn with the standard Rigvedic ritual envelope: a request for Indra's continued help and prosperity, addressed by the priestly speaker on behalf of the worshipping community, in the formulaic language of the ritual genre.^[59]

The fifteen-verse arc of RV 1.32 is therefore: announcement (vv. 1–2), ritual prelude (vv. 3–4), Vṛtra's form and challenge (v. 5), the killing-blow (v. 6), body-and-water tableau (vv. 7–9, with the Dānu image at v. 9), water-release (v. 10), cosmogonic consequences (vv. 11–12), kingship-summary (vv. 13–14), and ritual closure (v. 15).^[60]

This internal arc is therefore the closest the Rigvedic corpus comes to a continuous Vṛtra-combat narrative; even within this most-concentrated hymn, however, the narrative is broken by the ritual-allusive frame at the opening and the petition-frame at the close, and the combat itself occupies only roughly verses 2 to 12 of a fifteen-verse hymn.^[61]

RV 1.32 supplies the principal motifs of the Vātra-combat — the announcement-line áhann áhim, the Tvaṣṭā-forged *vajra*, the *soma*-prelude, the mountain-form of Vātra, the killing-blow, the Dānu-over-Vātra grief-image, the seven-rivers release, the heaven-earth separation, the dawn-production, and the kingship-acclamation — and the supplementary hymn-cycle adds further motifs and ritual emphases without contradicting this central spine.^[62]

RV 1.32 is therefore the chapter's primary witness for the Rigvedic Vātra-combat, and the chapter cites this hymn at verse-and-line granularity for specific narrative moments and at hymn-headnote level for the hymn's overall structure and editorial framing.^[63]

The combat in RV 1.32 has no body-of-Vātra-as-cosmos episode parallel to Marduk's splitting of Tiamat into sky and earth in **Enūma Eliš** IV: the cosmos already exists in the Rigvedic mytho-ritual frame, and Indra's killing reorders it (separating heaven and earth, releasing waters, producing dawn) without physically fashioning it from the slain serpent's body.^[64]

The absence of body-as-cosmos in RV 1.32 is the textual backbone of the chapter's "cosmologically active but not cosmogonic in the Mesopotamian sense" claim: Indra's combat does cosmogonic work without doing cosmogony of the Marduk-Tiamat type, and the load-bearing evidence is precisely that no such episode appears in the primary spine-hymn.^[65]

The combat in RV 1.32 also shows none of the post-Vedic brahminicide motifs: Vātra is not a Brahmin, Indra does not require expiation for the killing, and the killing is celebrated as Indra's chief manly deed without moral complication beyond the brief Dānu-over-Vātra acknowledgment of the mother's grief.^[66]

The textual absence of brahminicide in RV 1.32 is the load-bearing evidence for the chapter's insistence (per brief) that the Rigvedic Vātra-combat must not be merged with the post-Vedic **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** and **Mahābhārata** reframing in which Vātra becomes a Brahmin and Indra's killing becomes a sin requiring expiation.^[67]

15.4. Movement II — supplementary hymn-cycle (1.80, 2.11–12, 4.18, 5.32, 6.17, 8.96, 10.113)

RV 1.80 is a Vātra-hymn of the first *maṇṇāla* that frames the killing as the central act of Indra's career, and that supplies the strophic refrain "by your manliness alone, O Indra" that places the Vātra-killing alongside Indra's other deeds as the principal warrant for his sovereignty.^[68]

RV 1.80 also supplies independent attestation of the áhann áhim formula: the verb of slaying and the serpent-object recur in the hymn, and Watkins's reconstruction of the formula is built from this and similar attestations across the Vātra-hymn corpus rather than from RV 1.32 alone.^[69]

RV 2.11 is the principal Vātra-hymn of the second *maṇṇāla*, and its distinctive contribution to the corpus is the staging of the gods' acclamation of Indra after the killing: the hymn presents the wider divine community as recognising and celebrating Indra's victory, and the kingship-acclamation is articulated through the gods' speech as well as through the priestly speaker.^[70]

RV 2.12 is the immediately following hymn in the same *maṇṇāla* and is one of the most often-quoted of the Indra-hymns: each of its strophes ends in the refrain "he, O peoples, is Indra" (Sanskrit *sá janāsa índraḥ*), and the hymn's mode is a sequence of identifying-deeds whose function

is to establish the Vṛtra-slayer's identity through accumulated narrative-fact.^[71]

RV 2.12's accumulating-deeds mode includes the Vṛtra-killing, the splitting of the mountain, the release of the waters, and the production of dawn as parallel identifying acts in successive strophes, so that the four cosmogonic-effect motifs of RV 1.32.2 are distributed across multiple verses of the second-*maṇḍala* hymn.^[72]

RV 4.18 is the principal "embryonic Indra" hymn of the corpus, in which the divine narrator and Indra in dialogue stage the unusual motif of Indra's birth: the hymn presents Indra as having forced his way out of his mother's womb sideways, against the natural mode of birth, and presents this irregular birth as anticipating the irregular and combat-decisive character of his later career.^[73]

RV 4.18 contributes to the Vṛtra-corpus the biographical pre-history of the combat: the hymn implies that Indra is in some sense a combat-figure before he is born, and the combat-with-Vṛtra is then the appropriate mature performance of an irregularity that was already present in his birth.^[74]

RV 5.32 is a Vṛtra-hymn of the fifth *maṇḍala* that emphasises the obstruction-and-release narrative element: the hymn dwells on Vṛtra's withholding of the waters and on Indra's piercing-and-opening action that brings the waters down to the human world.^[75]

RV 6.17 is a Vṛtra-hymn of the sixth *maṇḍala* that emphasises the cosmic scale of the combat: the hymn frames Indra's combat as performed at the cosmic boundary between the upper and lower worlds, and treats the killing-and-water-release as the action that makes the cosmos's three-tiered structure functionally operative.^[76]

RV 8.96 is a Vṛtra-hymn of the eighth *maṇḍala* that presents the slaying as the central event of Indra's career in the most concentrated form of any Indra-hymn outside RV 1.32: the hymn names Indra repeatedly as "Vṛtra-slayer" (Sanskrit *vṛtrahán*) and treats the epithet as Indra's principal cult-title.^[77]

The cult-title *vṛtrahán* ("Vṛtra-slayer", "obstruction-slayer") is the Vedic counterpart of the Avestan divine name Vərəθrayna (Middle Persian Wahrām, New Persian Bahrām), and the philological cognancy of the two cult-titles is one of the principal exhibits of Benveniste and Renou's 1934 monograph.^[78]

RV 10.113 is a Vṛtra-hymn of the tenth *maṇḍala* that develops the cosmogonic dimension of the combat more explicitly than any other hymn in the corpus: the hymn integrates the Vṛtra-killing into a wider cosmogonic narrative in which the heavens, the waters, the dawn, and Indra's kingship are treated as the joint outputs of the combat.^[79]

RV 10.113's cosmogonic emphasis is the principal late-corpus reflex of the Vṛtra-combat's cosmologically active character: the tenth-*maṇḍala* hymn shows the cosmogonic reading already at work within the Rigvedic corpus, and the chapter's "cosmologically active but not cosmogonic in the Mesopotamian sense" claim is built on RV 10.113 alongside RV 1.32.^[80]

The supplementary hymn-cycle therefore distributes seven distinct emphases across seven hymns: 1.80 (refrain-and-warrant), 2.11 (gods' acclamation), 2.12 (identifying-deeds with the *sá janāsa índra* refrain), 4.18 (embryonic-Indra biography), 5.32 (obstruction-and-release), 6.17 (cosmic-scale

combat), 8.96 (cult-title *vātrahán*), and 10.113 (cosmogonic-integration).^[81]

The supplementary hymn-cycle does not contradict RV 1.32 at any load-bearing motif: the eight hymns together present a consistent picture of the *Vātra*-combat in which RV 1.32 supplies the narrative spine and the seven supplementary hymns supply emphases that are mutually compatible with the spine and with one another.^[82]

The supplementary hymn-cycle does, however, vary in motif-selection: each hymn selects a sub-set of the central narrative motifs and develops one or two of them at length, so that no single supplementary hymn covers all the motifs of RV 1.32, and the combined corpus is the only place where the full motif-set is jointly attested.^[83]

The supplementary hymn-cycle includes occasional motifs absent from RV 1.32: the "embryonic Indra" of RV 4.18 has no parallel in RV 1.32, and the explicit gods'-acclamation tableau of RV 2.11 is similarly more developed in the supplementary corpus than in the spine-hymn.^[84]

The supplementary hymn-cycle therefore enriches the RV 1.32 narrative spine in three principal ways: it widens the cosmogonic frame (10.113), it deepens the biographical pre-history (4.18), and it externalises the kingship-acclamation through the gods' speech (2.11), with each enrichment located in a distinct hymn.^[85]

The eight-hymn corpus is the working evidentiary base for the chapter's reconstruction of the *Vātra*-combat, and the chapter cites the eight hymns at hymn level for general points about the corpus and at verse level for specific narrative moments.^[86]

Indra's other principal combat-narratives in the Rigveda — most importantly the Vala myth, in which Indra and the *Aṅgiras* priests open the Vala cave and release the captured cattle and the dawn — are conceptually related but textually distinct from the *Vātra*-combat, and the chapter does not merge the two combats while flagging the structural family-resemblance that scholars including Watkins read across them.^[87]

The chapter's working corpus is the eight-hymn *Vātra*-cycle (RV 1.32, 1.80, 2.11–12, 4.18, 5.32, 6.17, 8.96, 10.113).^[88]

15.5. Movement III — The Watkins formula in Vedic form

The *áhan* *áhim* formula — Sanskrit "he slew the serpent" — is the Vedic instance of what Calvert Watkins's **How to Kill a Dragon** reconstructs as the inherited Indo-European poetic line of combat-myth: subject (the hero), verb (a verb of killing), and object (the serpent), in a fixed lexical-and-syntactic arrangement preserved across multiple Indo-European traditions.^[89]

The *áhan* *áhim* formula is attested at RV 1.32.2 as the killing-line of the *Vātra*-hymn, with verse 1 supplying the announcing frame; Watkins's monograph treats this attestation as the most concentrated and most recoverable Vedic instance of the inherited Indo-European poetic structure.^[90]

The *áhan* *áhim* formula's structural elements are: the subject (the hero, here Indra), an aorist verb of killing (Sanskrit *áhan*, "he slew"), and the serpent-object (Sanskrit *áhim*, "the serpent" —

accusative of *ahi*), with phonetic and rhythmic features (the figura etymologica of *áhan* and *áhim*, the alliterative repetition of the initial vowel) that Watkins treats as the formula's poetic-marker.^[91]

The figura etymologica of *áhan* and *áhim* (the verb of slaying and the serpent-object built on the same phonetic shape) is one of the load-bearing features of the formula in Watkins's reconstruction: the etymological figure is preserved in Vedic and recoverable, with appropriate sound-changes, in the comparable formulae of the other Indo-European traditions.^[92]

Watkins's argument is that the *áhann áhim* formula is not a Vedic poetic invention but the Vedic reflex of an inherited Indo-European combat-line, with comparable formulae attested in Hittite (Tarḫunna's killing of the serpent Illuyanka in the **kuenta... illuyanka** line), in Greek (Apollo's killing of Python and the wider serpent-killing diction), in Norse (Thor's killing of Jörmungandr), and in Iranian (the Avestan Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka combat-language).^[93]

The Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula in Watkins's reconstruction is therefore not a content-claim about a single inherited story but a formal-poetic claim about an inherited line of combat-poetic diction whose continuity across the daughter languages is documented at the level of words, sounds, and syntactic arrangement.^[94]

Indra/Vātra is the anchor case for Watkins's formula: it is the most concentrated Indo-European attestation of the HERO SLAY SERPENT line in a single text (RV 1.32.1–2), it is the most fully contextualised by a continuous combat-narrative within the same hymn, and it is the most often invoked across Watkins's chapters 41 to 48 as the comparison against which the other daughter-language attestations are read.^[95]

The cross-cultural reflexes of the *áhann áhim* formula are deferred in the present book to Part II C5, the comparative chapter on HERO SLAY SERPENT, where the Hittite Illuyanka, Greek Apollo-Python, Norse Thor-Jörmungandr, and Iranian Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka attestations are treated together with the Vedic line; the present chapter introduces the formula in its Vedic form only.^[96]

The *áhann áhim* formula's status in the Rigvedic corpus is itself widely attested: the formula and its near-variants recur in multiple Vātra-hymns and in further Indra-hymns, so that the formula is a piece of Rigvedic poetic-ritual diction in active use across the corpus rather than a fossilised line preserved in one location.^[97]

The formula's wide attestation in active Vedic poetry is one of the principal reasons Watkins treats it as the strongest available evidence for the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT line: in Vedic the formula is not merely surviving but actively productive, in a way that makes its inherited status more visible than in some of the other daughter-language attestations.^[98]

The *áhann áhim* formula and the cult-title *vātrahán* ("obstruction-slayer" / "Vātra-slayer") together constitute the principal Vedic combat-vocabulary of the chapter: the formula is the act-line of the combat, and the cult-title is the agent's resulting designation, and the two together define Indra's identity as a combat-figure in the Vedic tradition.^[99]

Indra's formula and cult-title also define the chapter's principal forward-link to Part II C5: the comparative chapter on HERO SLAY SERPENT will treat the *áhann áhim* formula and the *vātrahán* cult-title alongside the Hittite, Greek, Norse, and Iranian comparanda, and the present chapter is the principal anchor for what the comparative chapter inherits in Vedic form.^[100]

Watkins's reconstruction is itself a scholarly synthesis in the same sense as the chapter's hymn-cycle reconstruction of the Vātra-combat narrative: a methodologically explicit recovery of an inherited form from a distributed body of attestations, with the recovery's procedure and limits acknowledged at every step.^[101]

The áhann áhim formula is therefore introduced in the present chapter at hymn-and-verse level (RV 1.32.1–2), with brief reference to its wider Vedic attestation, and with the cross-cultural reflexes deferred to Part II C5 in line with the chapter brief's instruction to "keep brief here".^[102]

The Watkins formula's relationship to the chapter's wider argument is twofold: at the level of poetics, the formula identifies the Vedic Vātra-combat as a recognisable instance of an inherited Indo-European poetic diction; at the level of comparative method, the formula identifies which features of the Vedic combat are inherited and which are Vedic innovations, and so disciplines the comparative treatment to follow.^[103]

15.6. The cosmological-but-not-cosmogonic reading

The Rigvedic Vātra-combat does cosmogonic work in three explicit and named ways within the eight-hymn corpus: it separates heaven and earth (most explicitly in RV 1.32.11–12 and in RV 10.113), it releases the cosmic waters (the seven rivers of RV 1.32.2 and the obstruction-and-release narrative of RV 5.32), and it produces dawn (the dawn-after-Vātra-killing of the RV 1.32 cosmogonic-consequence verses).^[104]

The combat is therefore cosmologically active in a strong sense: the Rigvedic cosmos as we encounter it in the post-combat hymns is a cosmos that the Vātra-killing has made — heaven and earth are separated by the killing, the rivers are running because of the killing, and the dawn rises because of the killing.^[105]

The combat is, however, not cosmogonic in the Mesopotamian sense: there is no body-of-Vātra-as-cosmos episode parallel to **Enūma Eliš** IV's splitting of Tiamat into the upper and lower halves of the world, and Indra's combat reorders an already-existing cosmos rather than physically fabricating the cosmos out of the slain serpent's body.^[106]

The Marduk-Tiamat episode and the Indra-Vātra episode therefore differ at a structural rather than incidental level: the Mesopotamian combat is the founding moment of the cosmos itself, whereas the Vedic combat is the founding moment of the cosmos's functional operation (its waters, its day-night cycle, its sky-earth separation).^[107]

*(The chapter's "cosmologically active but not cosmogonic in the Mesopotamian sense" framing is the chapter's editorial synthesis of the textual evidence, drawing on Jamison and Brereton 2014's translations and notes on the Vātra-corpus and on Lambert 2013's edition of *Enūma Eliš*; the framing is well-supported by the textual evidence on both sides but is itself a typological claim that no single source articulates in this exact form.^[108])*

The cosmological-but-not-cosmogonic framing has the consequence that the Vedic combat fits naturally into a typology of "combat that does cosmogonic work without doing cosmogony of the body-as-cosmos type", a typology that the Part II C1 comparative chapter on cosmogonic combats develops at length and to which the present chapter is the principal Vedic anchor.^[109]

The cosmological-but-not-cosmogonic framing also distinguishes the Vedic combat from the Hittite Kumarbi-Ullikummi combat, the Greek Zeus-Typhon combat, and the Norse Thor-Jörmungandr combat in different specific ways: the Hittite combat is a sovereignty-succession contest in which the cosmos is already established, the Greek combat is a sovereignty-confirmation contest after Zeus's accession, and the Norse combat is an eschatological contest at the world's end.^[110]

The Vedic combat is closer than any of these to a cosmologically active combat in the strong sense — closer than the Hittite, the Greek, or the Norse — without crossing the line to cosmogonic-from-the-body in the Mesopotamian sense, and the chapter's typological position for Indra-Vṛtra in Part II C1 is therefore "cosmologically active, not cosmogonic from the body".^[111]

The release of the waters in RV 1.32.2 is the closest the Rigvedic combat comes to a body-and-cosmos episode: the released waters flow over and past Vṛtra's body, and the body of the slain serpent is visible in the watercourse as the watercourse runs.^[112]

The body-in-the-watercourse image is not, however, a body-as-cosmos image: Vṛtra's body remains a discrete dead body that the rivers run past, and the rivers themselves are not made of Vṛtra's body but flow from the cosmic source that Vṛtra had been obstructing.^[113]

The Vedic body-and-watercourse image is therefore a "mountain-form-and-water" tableau in which the obstructing serpent is recognisably mountain-shaped (RV 1.32.5) and is split (RV 1.32.2), with the waters flowing past the body rather than being made of the body — a characteristic Indo-European storm-god / waters tableau that West's chapter 6 treats as a recurrent type within the wider Indo-European corpus.^[114]

The cosmological-but-not-cosmogonic distinction is sharpest at the level of what the slain adversary's body becomes: in **Enūma Eliš** IV the body becomes the cosmos, in RV 1.32 the body remains a body and the cosmos is what the killing reorders rather than what the body is fabricated into.^[115]

The cosmological-but-not-cosmogonic distinction is also load-bearing for the chapter's comparative pairing of the Vedic combat with the Iranian Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka combat treated in chapter 13 of the present volume: the Iranian combat similarly reorders an existing cosmos (containing the rebound serpent under the mountain) rather than fabricating the cosmos from the serpent's body, and the Indo-Iranian comparand confirms the cosmologically-active-but-not-body-cosmogonic shape as the inherited Indo-Iranian pattern.^[116]

The triple cosmogonic effect — heaven-earth separation, water-release, dawn-production — is therefore in the chapter's reading the diagnostic feature of the Vedic combat's cosmologically active character, and the absence of body-as-cosmos is the diagnostic feature of its non-Mesopotamian-cosmogonic character.^[117]

The Vedic combat is also distinct from the Mesopotamian Marduk-Tiamat combat at the level of pre-existing cosmos: the Vedic combat presupposes an already-existing world with rivers, mountains, and gods, in which Vṛtra is an obstruction that must be removed; the Mesopotamian combat presupposes only the primordial waters out of which Marduk's victory creates the cosmos.^[118]

The Vedic combat's already-existing-world setting is one of the chapter's principal reasons for resisting the older comparative literature's tendency to assimilate the Vedic combat to the

Mesopotamian: the two combats are doing structurally different work in their respective cosmologies, and the comparative treatment must preserve the difference.^[119]

The cosmological-but-not-cosmogonic reading is therefore the chapter's principal typological contribution to Part II C1 and the principal warrant for distinguishing the Vedic Indra-Vātra combat from the Mesopotamian Marduk-Tiamat combat without denying the structural family-resemblance that has made the comparison perennially attractive.^[120]

The structural family-resemblance between Indra-Vātra and Marduk-Tiamat — splitting of an obstructing-or-monstrous adversary by the storm-god, release of waters, ordering of the cosmos — is real, but the transmission route is not demonstrable, and West 2007 treats the parallel as structural-typological rather than as evidence of historical transmission.^[121]

The Vedic combat's cosmologically active character is also the basis of its ritual-aetiological function in the soma sacrifice: the released waters of the killing become the rains that fertilise the cultivated world, and the soma sacrifice's annual recurrence is the ritual replay of a cosmogonic-functional episode that has already once occurred.^[122]

15.7. The post-Vedic brahminicide reframing

The post-Vedic Vedic-Brahmin literature reframes the Vātra-combat in a sequence of texts whose principal exemplars are the **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** 1.6.3–4 (a late-Vedic prose ritual-theological text) and the **Mahābhārata** Udyogaparvan 9–18 (an early-classical Sanskrit epic), and in this reframing Vātra is presented as a Brahmin and Indra's killing of him is a sin of brahminicide that requires expiation.^[123]

The **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** 1.6.3–4 develops a ritual-theological narrative in which Vātra is a priestly figure (and so a Brahmin in the post-Vedic varṇa terminology), and in which Indra's killing of him generates ritual pollution that must be addressed by expiatory ritual rather than celebrated as an unmixed warrior triumph.^[124]

The **Mahābhārata** Udyogaparvan 9–18 develops the brahminicide-and-expiation narrative more extensively: Vātra is presented as a virtuous Brahmin sage, Indra's killing of him is staged with explicit moral discomfort, and the narrative-frame includes an expiation sequence that addresses the karmic and ritual consequences of the killing.^[125]

The post-Vedic reframing has the consequence that the Vātra-figure of the **Mahābhārata** and the **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** is a different narrative entity from the Vātra-figure of the Rigveda: the Rigvedic Vātra is an obstructing-and-mountain-form serpent whose killing is celebrated as Indra's chief manly deed, and the post-Vedic Vātra is a virtuous Brahmin whose killing is morally complicated and ritually polluting.^[126]

The chapter's primary object is the Rigvedic combat — cosmological, ritual-invocation, water-release — as preserved in the eight-hymn Vātra-corpus.^[127]

The post-Vedic reframing is itself a piece of evidence for the cultural centrality of the Vātra-combat in the long Indian tradition: the combat is important enough that the post-Vedic ritual-theological tradition reworks it to fit its own moral and ritual concerns, and the brahminicide reframing is a creative transformation of an inherited combat-narrative rather than a contradiction of it.^[128]

The post-Vedic reframing is, however, not the chapter's focus, and the chapter treats it within a clearly-bounded sub-section so that the comparative reader can see the reframing as a distinct evidentiary layer rather than as part of the Rigvedic combat itself.^[129]

The post-Vedic reframing has its own forward-link in the present book to chapter 15 (the Vedic family chapter), where the longer arc of post-Rigvedic Indian dragon-combat material — including the bhakti-period Krishna-Kāliya combat — is treated alongside the Brāhmaṇa and **Mahābhārata** reflexes.^[130]

The post-Vedic reframing also marks a transition in the moral status of the combat-killing within Indian thought: what is in the Rigveda an unmixed warrior triumph becomes in the **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** and the **Mahābhārata** a morally complicated act that requires expiation, and this transition tracks a wider development in classical Indian ethics about the moral status of killing as such.^[131]

The post-Vedic reframing must therefore not be merged with the Rigvedic combat at the level of either narrative content or moral framing: the two are different texts with different doctrinal assumptions, and conflating them would distort both the Rigvedic combat (by reading back later moral concern) and the post-Vedic reframing (by stripping it of its critical engagement with the inherited narrative).^[132]

The chapter's treatment of the post-Vedic reframing is therefore brief, clearly bounded, and forward-linked: it acknowledges the reframing's existence and importance, identifies its principal textual loci (the **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** 1.6.3–4 and the **Mahābhārata** Udyogaparvan 9–18), notes the Vṛtra-as-Brahmin transformation, and forwards the wider reception-history to chapter 15 and to the chapter's comparative hooks.^[133]

15.8. Indo-Iranian cognancy and forward links

Vedic *ahi* ("serpent") and Avestan *aži* ("serpent") are philologically the same word: the two terms are regular phonological reflexes of a common Indo-Iranian **ajhi-* in their respective languages, and the cognancy is one of the load-bearing exhibits of Indo-Iranian historical linguistics.^[134]

The cognancy of *ahi* and *aži* has the consequence that the principal serpent-term of the Vedic Vṛtra-combat (the *āhim* of the āhann āhim formula) and the principal serpent-term of the Avestan Aži Dahāka combat (the *aži* of the Avestan combat-language) are linguistically the same word, and that the Indo-Iranian combat-myth corpus inherits a shared serpent-vocabulary at the language-historical level.^[135]

Trita Āptya (Sanskrit त्रितापत्या त्रितापत्या) is the older Vedic combat-figure whose Avestan cognate is Thraētaona, the Avestan slayer of Aži Dahāka treated in chapter 13 of the present volume, and the Vedic-Avestan cognancy of the two figures is one of the principal exhibits of Benveniste and Renou's 1934 monograph and of Watkins's **How to Kill a Dragon**.^[136]

Trita Āptya appears in the Rigveda as a combat-figure who is in places associated with the Vṛtra-killing — sometimes as a junior partner of Indra in the killing, sometimes as a standalone slayer of a similar adversary — and the Vedic textual situation is the clearest evidence that the Trita-figure is the older Indo-Iranian combat-figure whom Indra's emergence has partially displaced.^[137]

The Trita Āptya / Thraētaona cognancy is therefore the chapter's principal Indo-Iranian forward-link, and it is also the chapter's principal back-link to chapter 13 (the Iranian Aži Dahāka chapter), where Thraētaona's combat is treated in its Avestan and post-Avestan forms.^[138]

The Vedic *vātrahán* ("Vātra-slayer") and the Avestan *Vr̥θrayna* (the divine name of the cult-figure of victory, anglicized Verethragna) are the second principal Indo-Iranian cognancy of the chapter: the two terms are philologically the same compound (an obstruction-noun plus a slaying-suffix) in the two languages, and Benveniste and Renou's 1934 monograph treats the cognancy as the principal evidence for an inherited Indo-Iranian combat-cult.^[139]

The two Indo-Iranian cognancies — *ahi* / *aži* at the lexical level and *vātrahán* / *Vr̥θrayna* at the cult-title level — together establish the Indo-Iranian phase of the combat-myth as a documented language-historical fact rather than as a purely structural-typological hypothesis: the Vedic and Avestan witnesses share a vocabulary, not just a story-shape.^[140]

The chapter's principal forward-link beyond chapter 13 is to the Vedic family chapter (chapter 15 of the present volume), in which the post-Rigvedic and post-Vedic Indian dragon-combat material — including the Trita Āptya material in its wider Vedic distribution, the **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** and **Mahābhārata** reflexes, and the bhakti-period Krishna-Kāliya combat — is treated as the long arc of the Indian dragon-combat tradition.^[141]

The chapter's principal forward-link to Part II C1 (the comparative chapter on cosmogonic combats) is the cosmological-but-not-cosmogonic typology developed in this chapter, in which the Indra-Vātra combat is the principal Vedic anchor for the typological position "cosmologically active, not cosmogonic from the body".^[142]

The chapter's principal forward-link to Part II C5 (the comparative chapter on HERO SLAY SERPENT) is the áhann áhim formula introduced in Movement III of the present chapter, in which the Vedic instance of the formula is the anchor case for Watkins's reconstructed Indo-European poetic line.^[143]

The Indo-Iranian cognancy and the cosmological-but-not-cosmogonic typology together place the present chapter at the intersection of two of the book's principal comparative threads: the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT poetic-formula thread (inherited at the language-historical level) and the cosmogonic-combat typology thread (developed at the structural-typological level).^[144]

The Vedic Vātra-combat is therefore both the most thoroughly studied Indo-European combat-myth — Watkins's anchor case for HERO SLAY SERPENT — and a typologically distinctive cosmologically-active combat that does cosmogonic work without doing body-as-cosmos cosmogony, and the chapter's eight-hymn-corpus reconstruction is the working evidentiary base for both observations.^[145]

[1] Jamison and Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda: The Earliest Religious Poetry of India**, general introduction, on the Rigvedic corpus, its dating, and its organisation into ten *maṇḍalas*.

[2] Jamison and Brereton 2014, three volumes, Oxford University Press; ISBN 9780199370184.

[3] Jamison and Brereton 2014, introduction to volume 1, on the new translation as a replacement for Griffith and on the hymn-and-verse citation conventions retained from the Sanskrit corpus.

[4] Jamison and Brereton 2014, three-volume printed edition; cited at hymn-and-verse level for specific RV passages and at section level for corpus-wide points.

[5] Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, chs. 41–48 on Indra-Vātra as the anchor case for the reconstructed Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula.

- [6] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48 (printed only; cited at chapter and section level per established discipline for this book).
- [7] Benveniste and Renou 1934, *Vṛtra et Vṛθragna: Étude de mythologie indo-iranienne*, Cahiers de la Société Asiatique 3 (Paris: Imprimerie Nationale, 1934); stable URL gallica.bnf.fr.
- [8] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the philological cognancy of Vedic *ahi* and Avestan *aži* and the shared Indo-Iranian Vṛtra–Vṛθrayna complex.
- [9] West 2007, *Indo-European Poetry and Myth*, ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on the Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon complex.
- [10] West 2007, ch. 6 (printed only; cited at chapter level).
- [11] Forsyth 1987, *The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth*, ch. 2 on the Indo-Iranian combat-myth corpus.
- [12] Lambert 2013, *Babylonian Creation Myths*, on the *Enūma Eliš* combat as the Mesopotamian comparand for the Vedic Indra–Vṛtra material.
- [13] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml, sources.primary, listing the eight Vṛtra hymns; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the same eight hymns as the principal Vṛtra-combat corpus.
- [14] Jamison and Brereton 2014, introduction, on the oral preservation and philological reliability of the Rigvedic corpus.
- [15] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml, lacunae section, on the narrative-not-philological lacuna in the Vṛtra material; Jamison and Brereton 2014, introduction, on the ritual-allusive (rather than narrative-continuous) genre of the Rigvedic hymns.
- [16] Jamison and Brereton 2014, introduction to volume 1, on the liturgical-and-ritual genre of the Rigvedic hymns.
- [17] Jamison and Brereton 2014, introduction and notes to RV 1.32, on the ritual-allusive mode of Rigvedic Indra-hymns and the absence of a single continuous Vṛtra-combat narrative.
- [18] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml, on the hymn-cycle method as the chapter's reconstructive procedure; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on RV 1.32 as the most concentrated Vṛtra hymn and on the wider Vṛtra-corpus.
- [19] Inference. Source: Jamison and Brereton 2014 (editorial practice); Watkins 1995 (comparative procedure); brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml. Scope: methodological claim about the hymn-cycle reconstruction, flagged for transparency.
- [20] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the genre-difference between the Rigvedic ritual hymns and the continuous narrative epics of the ancient Near East; Lambert 2013 and Watkins 1995 on the contrast.
- [21] Jamison and Brereton 2014, introduction and notes to the Indra-hymns, on the variation among Indra-hymns as constitutive of the Rigvedic ritual genre.
- [22] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the distribution of cosmogonic effects across the Vṛtra-hymns; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the same distribution.
- [23] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the hymn-cycle (and cross-language) method used to reconstruct the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula.
- [24] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the genre-difference between the Rigvedic ritual hymns and the post-Vedic prose Brāhmaṇa and epic Mahābhārata; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the same genre-difference.
- [25] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml, on the hymn-cycle method as a load-bearing methodological commitment of the chapter.
- [26] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the "as-reconstructed" status of the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the corresponding status of the Vṛtra-combat narrative reconstructed from the Rigvedic hymn-corpus.
- [27] Jamison and Brereton 2014, general introduction, on Indra as the most frequently invoked deity in the Rigvedic corpus and on the share of the corpus addressed to him.
- [28] Jamison and Brereton 2014, introduction and Indra-hymn headnotes, on Indra as warrior-king and chief of the Vedic gods, with the Vṛtra-victory as warrant for his kingship.
- [29] Jamison and Brereton 2014, introduction, on the soma sacrifice as the principal Rigvedic ritual setting and on Indra as primary recipient of the *soma*-offering.
- [30] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnotes to RV 1.32 and to the supplementary Vṛtra-hymns, on the *soma*-drinking as the immediate prelude to the Vṛtra-combat.
- [31] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on Tvaṣṭā as the divine artisan of the Vedic pantheon and the forger of Indra's *vajra*.
- [32] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the *vajra* as Indra's thunderbolt-mace and as the weapon of the Vṛtra-killing.
- [33] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the *vajra* as cosmic combat-weapon and forged image of the lightning-strike; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the cognancy of the *vajra*-image with the Indo-European storm-god's weapon.
- [34] Jamison and Brereton 2014, introduction, on the broad tripartite structure of the Vedic pantheon and on Indra's warrior-tier position within it.
- [35] West 2007, ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on the Indo-European storm-god / waters complex including the Vedic Indra–Vṛtra instance.
- [36] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the etymology of Vṛtra from Sanskrit *vṛ-* "to obstruct"; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on Vṛtra as the obstructing-and-enclosing serpent of the Rigveda.
- [37] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the lexical transparency of the name Vṛtra and on the integration of name and function in the

- [38] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on *ahi* as the load-bearing serpent-term of the áhann áhim formula; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the use of *ahi* as a designation for Vṛtra in the Rigvedic Vṛtra-corpus.
- [39] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on Dānu as Vṛtra’s mother and on the Dānu-and-Vṛtra-body motif in RV 1.32; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Dānu in the Indo-Iranian combat-myth corpus.
- [40] Jamison and Brereton 2014, introduction and Indra-hymn notes, on the ritual-aetiological function of the Vṛtra-combat in the soma sacrifice.
- [41] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnote and translation of RV 1.32, on the hymn’s fifteen-verse length, its attribution, and its position as the primary Vṛtra-hymn of the corpus.
- [42] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and headnote of RV 1.32.1–2, on the opening proclamation and the áhann áhim line; Watkins 1995, ch. 41, on the same opening as the Vedic instance of the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula.
- [43] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and headnote of RV 1.32.1, on Indra as the *vajra*-wielder and the Vṛtra-killing as the chief and first of his manly deeds.
- [44] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and headnote of RV 1.32.2, on the four cosmogonic-effect verbs (slew, split, released, opened) in the second verse.
- [45] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.2, on the seven rivers and on the channel-opening motif.
- [46] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.2, on Tvaṣṭā as the maker of the *vajra* in the second verse of the hymn.
- [47] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.3–4, on the *soma*-drinking and the going-out to combat.
- [48] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.5, on Vṛtra’s mountainous form and on the body-as-mountain imagery.
- [49] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.2 and 1.32.5, on the dual reading of the mountain-splitting; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the same dual reading in the comparative context.
- [50] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.5, on Vṛtra’s strike at Indra and the reciprocal-combat framing.
- [51] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.6, on the killing-blow with the *vajra* and the release of the cosmic waters.
- [52] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.7, on the body-and-water tableau and on the visual integration of the slain Vṛtra into the watercourse.
- [53] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.9, on Dānu over the body of Vṛtra and on the cow-and-calf simile.
- [54] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.9, on the maternal-grief image and on the Rigvedic acknowledgment of the cost of the victory.
- [55] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.10, on the post-combat water-cascade and the cosmogonic-consequence framing.
- [56] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.11–12, on the heaven-and-earth separation, the firmament, and the production of dawn as cosmogonic consequences of the Vṛtra-killing.
- [57] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml, on the triple cosmogonic effect of the Vṛtra-killing; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the same triple effect in RV 1.32.
- [58] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.13–14, on Indra’s wider sovereignty and on the kingship-summary at the close of the combat-narrative.
- [59] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.15, on the closing ritual envelope and on the formulaic petition-language of the Rigvedic Indra-hymns.
- [60] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and headnote of RV 1.32, on the fifteen-verse arc of the hymn and on the structural sequence outlined in the present claim.
- [61] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and headnote of RV 1.32, on the ritual-allusive framing of the combat-narrative within the fifteen-verse hymn.
- [62] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32 and headnotes to the supplementary Vṛtra-hymns, on the motifs supplied by RV 1.32 and on the consistency of the supplementary hymn-cycle with the central spine.
- [63] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and headnote of RV 1.32, on the hymn as the chapter’s primary witness; per brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the citation discipline.
- [64] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32, on the absence of a body-of-Vṛtra-as-cosmos episode; Lambert 2013, on the Marduk-Tiamat body-as-cosmos episode in *Enūma Eliš* IV as the Mesopotamian comparand.
- [65] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32, on the absence of a body-as-cosmos episode; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the “cosmological-but-not-cosmogonic” framing; Lambert 2013, on the Mesopotamian comparand.
- [66] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32, on the absence of the brahminicide-motif and on the celebration of the killing as Indra’s chief manly deed.

- [67] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32, on the absence of the brahminicide-motif; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml special_instructions on the no-merge rule; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the same distinction.
- [68] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnote and translation of RV 1.80, on the strophic refrain and on the V̥tra-killing as warrant for Indra's sovereignty.
- [69] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on RV 1.80 as a co-witness for the áhann áhim formula; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the formula's recurrence across the V̥tra-corpus.
- [70] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnote and translation of RV 2.11, on the gods' acclamation of Indra and on the kingship-articulation by divine speech.
- [71] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnote and translation of RV 2.12, on the strophic refrain and on the identifying-deeds mode of the hymn.
- [72] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnote and translation of RV 2.12, on the distribution of the four cosmogonic-effect motifs across the strophes of the hymn.
- [73] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnote and translation of RV 4.18, on the embryonic-Indra motif and on the irregular-birth-as-anticipation framing.
- [74] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnote and translation of RV 4.18, on the implied biographical pre-history and on the combat as the mature performance of birth-irregularity.
- [75] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnote and translation of RV 5.32, on the obstruction-and-release emphasis and on the piercing-and-opening combat-language.
- [76] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnote and translation of RV 6.17, on the cosmic-scale framing and on the three-tiered cosmos.
- [77] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnote and translation of RV 8.96, on the centrality of the slaying and on v̥trahán as Indra's principal cult-title.
- [78] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the philological cognancy of Vedic v̥trahán and Avestan V̥r̥θrayna; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the same cognancy as a load-bearing case for the Indo-Iranian combat-poetic phase.
- [79] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnote and translation of RV 10.113, on the cosmogonic-integration of the V̥tra-killing and on the joint cosmogonic outputs.
- [80] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnote and translation of RV 10.113, on the cosmogonic-emphasis as a late-corpus reflex; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the cosmological-but-not-cosmogonic framing.
- [81] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnotes and translations of RV 1.80, 2.11, 2.12, 4.18, 5.32, 6.17, 8.96, and 10.113, on the seven distinct emphases of the supplementary hymn-cycle.
- [82] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnotes to RV 1.32 and to the seven supplementary V̥tra-hymns, on the mutual consistency of the spine and the supplementary corpus.
- [83] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the motif-selection variation across the supplementary hymn-cycle and on the jointly attested motif-set.
- [84] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnotes to RV 4.18 and 2.11, on motifs developed in the supplementary corpus that are absent or less developed in RV 1.32.
- [85] Jamison and Brereton 2014, headnotes to RV 10.113, 4.18, and 2.11, on the three principal modes of enrichment supplied by the supplementary hymn-cycle.
- [86] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the eight-hymn working corpus; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the eight hymns as the working evidentiary base for the chapter's reconstruction.
- [87] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the Vala-myth as a structurally related but textually distinct Indra-combat; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the structural family-resemblance.
- [88] An alternate scope would draw on the wider Indra-combat corpus, including the Vala myth and the Indra-Paṇis cattle-rescues. The eight-hymn corpus is chosen here because the chapter is constituted around the V̥tra-combat in particular; the wider Indra-combat material is forward-linked to Part II C5 (HERO SLAY SERPENT) and to Ch. 15 (the Vedic family chapter) rather than treated in the present chapter.
- [89] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the áhann áhim formula as the Vedic instance of the reconstructed Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula.
- [90] Watkins 1995, ch. 41, on RV 1.32.2 as the principal Vedic attestation of the áhann áhim formula; Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation of RV 1.32.1–2.
- [91] Watkins 1995, ch. 41, on the structural elements of the áhann áhim formula and on the phonetic-and-rhythmic features Watkins identifies as the formula's poetic-marker.
- [92] Watkins 1995, ch. 41, on the figura etymologica of áhan and áhim and on its preservation across the Indo-European comparanda.
- [93] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the cross-language attestation of the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula in Vedic, Hittite, Greek, Norse, and Iranian.
- [94] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the formal-poetic (rather than content-narrative) status of the reconstructed HERO SLAY

SERPENT formula.

- [95] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on Indra/Vṛtra as the anchor case for the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula and as the central comparison for the other Indo-European attestations.
- [96] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the deferral of cross-cultural reflexes to Part II C5; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the comparative architecture of the formula.
- [97] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the wider attestation of the áhann áhim formula and its variants across the Rigvedic Indra-corpus.
- [98] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the actively productive status of the formula in Vedic and on its evidentiary weight in the reconstruction.
- [99] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the formula and the cult-title as the principal Vedic combat-vocabulary; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on vṛtrahán as agent-designation.
- [100] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the forward-link to Part II C5; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the comparative architecture.
- [101] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the explicit methodological character of the HERO SLAY SERPENT reconstruction.
- [102] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml special_instructions on keeping the cross-cultural reflexes brief in the present chapter; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the comparative architecture deferred to Part II C5.
- [103] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the formula's twin role in identifying the inherited poetic diction and in disciplining the comparative method.
- [104] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the three named cosmogonic effects of the Vṛtra-combat in RV 1.32 and RV 10.113; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the same triple effect.
- [105] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the strong-sense cosmological activity of the Vṛtra-killing in the Rigvedic cosmology.
- [106] Lambert 2013, on the body-of-Tiamat-as-cosmos episode in **Enūma Eliš** IV; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the absence of such an episode in the Rigvedic Vṛtra-corpus.
- [107] Lambert 2013, on the founding-moment-of-the-cosmos status of the Marduk-Tiamat combat; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the founding-moment-of-the-cosmos's-operation status of the Indra-Vṛtra combat.
- [108] Inference. Source: Jamison and Brereton 2014; Lambert 2013; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml special_instructions. Scope: typological-framing claim for Part II C1, flagged for transparency.
- [109] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml special_instructions on the cosmological-but-not-cosmogonic distinction as load-bearing for Part II C1; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the Vedic combat's place within such a typology.
- [110] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the structural distinctions among the Hittite, Greek, Norse, and Vedic combats; West 2007, ch. 6, on the same distinctions.
- [111] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the typological positioning; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the strong-sense cosmological activity; Lambert 2013, on the body-cosmogonic comparison.
- [112] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.2 and 1.32.7, on the released waters running over the body of Vṛtra.
- [113] Jamison and Brereton 2014, translation and notes of RV 1.32.2, 1.32.7, and 1.32.10, on the released waters as flowing from a pre-existing cosmic source rather than being made of Vṛtra's body.
- [114] West 2007, ch. 6, on the storm-god / waters tableau in the Indo-European corpus; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the Vedic instance in RV 1.32.
- [115] Lambert 2013, on the body-becomes-cosmos episode in **Enūma Eliš** IV; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the body-remains-body and cosmos-reordered framing in RV 1.32.
- [116] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the Indo-Iranian comparand with chapter 13; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the structural similarity of the Indo-Iranian combats; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the same.
- [117] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the triple cosmogonic effect; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the diagnostic features.
- [118] Lambert 2013, on the primordial-waters-only setting of the Mesopotamian combat; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the already-existing-world setting of the Vedic combat.
- [119] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml special_instructions on resisting Mesopotamian assimilation; West 2007, ch. 6, on the structural difference at the level of pre-existing cosmos.
- [120] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the typological contribution; Jamison and Brereton 2014; Lambert 2013; West 2007 ch. 6.
- [121] West 2007, ch. 6, on the structural-typological character of the Indra-Marduk parallel and on the absence of demonstrable transmission.
- [122] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the ritual-aetiological function of the cosmologically active combat in the soma sacrifice.
- [123] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the post-Vedic brahminicide reframing of the Vṛtra-combat in the **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** and the **Mahābhārata**; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the same reframing.
- [124] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** 1.6.3–4 narrative as a ritual-theological reframing.
- [125] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the **Mahābhārata** Udyogaparvan 9–18 narrative as the extended brahminicide-and-expiation

reframing.

[126] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the entity-difference between the Rigvedic *Vṛtra* and the post-Vedic *Vṛtra*; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the no-merge rule.

[127] An alternate later transformation appears in the post-Vedic brahminicide reframing (Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa 1.6.3–4; Mahābhārata Udyogaparvan 9–18). The Rigvedic combat is treated as primary and the post-Vedic reframing as a clearly-marked later transformation; the two must not be merged, and the post-Vedic material is given a clearly bounded sub-section rather than blended into the Rigvedic combat.

[128] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the cultural centrality of the *Vṛtra*-combat as evidenced by its post-Vedic reworking.

[129] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml special_instructions on the clearly-bounded sub-section and the no-merge rule; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the same boundary.

[130] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the forward-link to chapter 15; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the same long arc.

[131] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the moral-status transition in the post-Vedic reframing of the combat-killing.

[132] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml special_instructions on the no-merge rule; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the doctrinal-assumption difference.

[133] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the brief-and-bounded treatment and the forward-link; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the principal textual loci.

[134] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the cognancy of Vedic *ahi* and Avestan *aži*; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the same cognancy as evidence for the Indo-Iranian phase of the combat-myth.

[135] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the shared serpent-vocabulary of the Indo-Iranian combat-myth corpus; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the āhann āhim and Avestan combat-language.

[136] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Trita Āptya-Thraētaona cognancy; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the same cognancy and on its position in the Indo-European combat-poetic family; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on Trita Āptya in the Rigvedic corpus.

[137] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Trita Āptya as the older Indo-Iranian combat-figure partially displaced by Indra; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the Trita Āptya material in the Rigvedic corpus.

[138] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the Trita-Thraētaona cognancy as forward-and-back-link; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the cognancy itself.

[139] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Vedic *vṛtrahán* / Avestan *Vr̥θrayna* cognancy; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the same cognancy.

[140] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the two Indo-Iranian cognancies as documented language-historical evidence; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the documented-vocabulary status of the Indo-Iranian combat-myth.

[141] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the forward-link to chapter 15; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the Vedic-corpus distribution of the Trita Āptya material.

[142] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the forward-link to Part II C1; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the typological position.

[143] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the forward-link to Part II C5; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the anchor-case status of the Vedic instance.

[144] Brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the chapter's intersection-of-threads position; Watkins 1995 chs. 41–48 and Jamison and Brereton 2014 on the two threads.

[145] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the most-thoroughly-studied status; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the typologically distinctive cosmologically-active status; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the joint observation.

Chapter 16. Vedic and Post-Vedic Reflexes (Trita Āptya, Krishna/Kāliya)

16.1. Source overview

This chapter takes up two clearly-distinct Indian dragon-combat sub-cases that bracket the Indra-Vātra flagship of the preceding chapter: the older Indo-Iranian Trita Āptya stratum, attested in a small cluster of Rigvedic hymns, and the bhakti-era Krishna-Kāliya reworking, attested in the **Harivaṁśa**, the **Viṁśu Purāṇa**, and the **Bhāgavata Purāṇa**.^[1]

The chapter's primary text for the Trita Āptya material is the Rigveda (Sanskrit ṛgveda), the same Vedic Sanskrit corpus that supplies the Indra-Vātra material of the preceding chapter, cited here at hymn-and-verse granularity (RV book.hymn.verse) keyed to Stephanie Jamison and Joel Brereton's three-volume **The Rigveda: The Earliest Religious Poetry of India**, published by Oxford University Press in 2014.^[2]

The Trita Āptya material is distributed across the Rigvedic corpus in hymn-allusive rather than narrative-continuous form, and the chapter's working textual base for the figure is the small cluster of hymns in which Trita is named as a combat-figure: principally RV 10.99.6 (the standard locus for Trita's slaying of a three-headed adversary) and RV 1.105 and RV 2.11.19–20, in which Trita appears alongside Indra in the combat-context.^[3]

Jamison and Brereton's translation is printed-only in the present project's working corpus, and the chapter cites it at hymn-and-verse level for specific Trita passages and at section level for general points about the corpus, in line with the citation discipline applied throughout the Iran-and-India cluster of the present book.^[4]

The chapter's foundational Indo-Iranian comparative anchor for the Trita Āptya / Thraētaona cognancy is Émile Benveniste and Louis Renou's **Vātra et Vāθragna: Étude de mythologie indo-iranienne**, published in 1934 in the Cahiers de la Société Asiatique series and available digitally in scanned form via Gallica BnF.^[5]

Benveniste and Renou 1934 is the standard philological anchor for the Vedic-Avestan cognancy of Trita Āptya with Avestan Thraētaona, and is cited in the present chapter at section level for the Trita-Thraētaona discussion, with the same citation discipline applied in chapters 13 and 14 of the present volume.^[6]

The chapter's Indo-European-poetic anchor for the Trita Āptya material is Calvert Watkins's **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, published by Oxford University Press in 1995, whose Part V (chapters 41 to 48 in the volume's numbering) treats the Vedic and Avestan combat-witnesses together as members of the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT poetic family, with the Trita Āptya material specifically discussed in chapters 44 to 45 alongside the Avestan Thraētaona corpus.^[7]

Watkins's monograph is printed-only and is cited at section and chapter level here, with the Trita-cluster discussion drawn from chapters 44 to 45 of Part V and the wider HERO SLAY SERPENT framework drawn from the surrounding chapters of the same Part.^[8]

The chapter's general Indo-European comparative anchor is M. L. West's **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, published by Oxford University Press in 2007, whose chapter 6 ("Storm and Stream") situates the Vedic combat-corpus within the wider Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon complex and notes the displacement of older Indo-Iranian combat-figures by the storm-god in the Vedic phase of the tradition.^[9]

The primary texts for the Krishna-Kāliya material are three post-Vedic Sanskrit narrative compositions: the **Harivaṃśa** (the earliest fully-narrative witness, conventionally dated to roughly the 4th century CE and transmitted as an appendix to the **Mahābhārata**), the **Viṃśu Purāṇa** (a 5th-century CE Vaishnava Purāṇa whose book 5 contains the Krishna boyhood narrative), and the **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** (a 9th- to 10th-century CE Vaishnava Purāṇa whose book 10 chapters 15 to 17 supply the most famous and iconographically pervasive version of the episode).^[10]

The Krishna-Kāliya primary texts are printed-only Sanskrit compositions whose standard English translations include the H. H. Wilson nineteenth-century **Viṃśu Purāṇa**, the Motilal Banarsidass Tagare translation of the **Bhāgavata Purāṇa**, and various twentieth-century editions of the **Harivaṃśa**; per brief, edition-pinning is deferred to the glossary-lock stage and the chapter cites at canto-and-chapter level rather than at sub-page granularity.^[11]

Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, supplies the chapter's wider scholarly anchor for the long arc of Indian dragon-combat material from the Rigveda to the bhakti-era reworkings, with chapter 2 treating the Indo-Iranian combat-myth corpus and its post-Vedic transformations.^[12]

The chapter is a family-chapter (related-tier) treatment, organising two distinct Indian dragon-combat sub-cases by their position in the long arc of the tradition — pre-Indra Indo-Iranian (Trita Āptya) and post-Vedic bhakti-era (Krishna-Kāliya) — rather than by giving each a thin full chapter, and the two sub-cases are treated in clearly-bounded sub-sections that are not merged at the level of either narrative content or doctrinal framing.^[13]

The framing premise is that the Indian tradition preserves alongside the central Indra-Vātra combat (chapter 14 of the present volume) two productive variations on the dragon-combat pattern: one older and partially displaced by Indra (Trita Āptya), the other later and devotionally transformed into a non-lethal subjugation of the serpent by the child-hero Krishna (Krishna-Kāliya). The two variations bracket the Indra-Vātra flagship in the historical-genealogical depth of the tradition.^[14]

What follows takes the two sub-cases in turn: first the Trita Āptya material in its Rigvedic and Indo-Iranian setting, then the Krishna-Kāliya episode in its post-Vedic Vaishnava setting, and finally a closing section on the family pattern that links the two and on the forward links to the comparative chapters of the present book.

16.2. Trita Āptya and the three-headed serpent

Trita Āptya (Sanskrit त्रित आप्या) is a Vedic combat-figure attested in the Rigveda as the slayer of a three-headed adversary, and the figure's name carries two distinct elements: a personal name (Trita, meaning "third") and a patronymic-or-toponymic epithet (Āptya, conventionally read as "of the waters" or "son of Āpta").^[15]

By frequency of attestation Trita Āptya is a marginal figure in the Rigvedic corpus: he is named in

only a small cluster of hymns, and the hymns that name him generally do so in passing rather than as the principal subject of the hymn, in marked contrast to the more than two hundred Indra-hymns that dominate the Rigveda's combat-material.^[16]

The standard Rigvedic locus for Trita's slaying of a three-headed adversary is RV 10.99.6, in which the hymn refers to the killing of a three-headed and seven-rayed (or seven-rein-bearing) adversary in language that the philological tradition consistently reads as a Trita-stratum combat-allusion.^[17]

The three-headed adversary of RV 10.99.6 is morphologically and structurally cognate with the three-headed and three-mouthed Aži Dahāka of the Avestan corpus treated in chapter 13 of the present volume: both are tricephalous serpent-or-monstrous adversaries, both are slain by an Indo-Iranian dragon-slayer figure, and the cognancy is one of the principal Indo-Iranian comparative observations of the chapter.^[18]

(The identification of the three-headed adversary of RV 10.99.6 specifically with the Indo-Iranian three-headed-serpent cognate of Avestan Aži Dahāka, while standard in Benveniste-Renou 1934 and Watkins 1995, is a comparative-philological reading rather than an unmediated feature of the Rigvedic text itself; the Rigvedic hymn does not name its three-headed adversary or supply a continuous narrative of the killing, and the cognancy claim is inferred by reading RV 10.99.6 alongside the Avestan corpus and the wider Indo-Iranian combat-material.^[19])

RV 1.105 is a long Rigvedic hymn in the first **maññala** in which Trita appears as a co-witness alongside Indra in the combat-context, and the hymn is one of the principal Rigvedic loci for the joint Trita-and-Indra combat-pattern that the philological tradition reads as the textual residue of the Trita-pre-Indra stratum.^[20]

RV 2.11.19–20 is a passage in the second **maññala** in which Trita appears alongside Indra in the combat-context, with the two figures named together as participants in the killing of the serpent-adversary; the passage is the principal second-**maññala** locus for the same joint pattern that RV 1.105 attests in the first **maññala**.^[21]

In the joint Trita-and-Indra passages of RV 1.105 and RV 2.11.19–20 Trita is consistently the junior partner: where the verbal subject of the killing is named, it is more often Indra than Trita; where the two are named together, Trita is grammatically and ritually subordinated to the storm-god; and the textual situation has the appearance of a layer of inherited Trita-material in the process of being absorbed into the Indra-centred Rigvedic ritual mythology.^[22]

The Vedic textual situation of Trita Āptya is therefore the clearest evidence within the Rigveda itself that the Trita-figure predates the Indra-centred ritual mythology of the corpus: an older combat-figure whose adversary-killing has been partially redistributed onto Indra and whose own attestations are residual rather than central, in the form that Benveniste and Renou's 1934 monograph articulates as the principal Indo-Iranian observation about the figure.^[23]

The Trita Āptya / Thraētaona cognancy is the principal Indo-Iranian observation about the Trita-figure: the Vedic Trita Āptya and the Avestan Thraētaona are philologically the same name in the two languages, and Benveniste and Renou's 1934 monograph treats the two figures as joint witnesses to a shared Indo-Iranian dragon-slayer of the pre-storm-god phase.^[24]

The cognancy is documented at the level of the two figures' names: both names are formed from the Indo-Iranian root for "third" plus a patronymic-or-toponymic suffix, and the regular

phonological correspondences between Vedic Sanskrit and Avestan are visible across the pair (Vedic **tr-** / Avestan **thr-**; Vedic **-i-** / Avestan **-aē-**; Vedic **-a** / Avestan **-aona**).^[25]

The cognancy is also documented at the level of the two figures' adversaries: both slay a three-headed serpent-or-monstrous adversary, the Vedic adversary unnamed in the surviving hymn-allusions and the Avestan adversary named as Aži Dahāka (the "dragon-Dahāka"), and the structural identity of the two killings reinforces the philological cognancy of the names.^[26]

The Trita-Thraētaona cognancy is therefore a documented Indo-Iranian inheritance at both the lexical-philological level (the names) and the narrative-structural level (the three-headed-adversary killing), and the pair is one of the load-bearing exhibits for the existence of an Indo-Iranian phase of the dragon-combat material before the divergence of the Indic and Iranian branches.^[27]

Trita Āptya's epithet **Āptya** is conventionally derived from the Sanskrit **ap-** ("water"), and the figure's name is therefore read as "Trita of the Waters" — an etymological reading that aligns the Vedic figure with the storm-god's water-release combat-pattern even though the surviving hymn-allusions do not narrate the water-release explicitly in the Trita-passages.^[28]

*(The alignment of the **Āptya** epithet with the storm-god's water-release combat-pattern is a comparative reading drawn from the wider Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon complex (West 2007 ch. 6) and from the Vedic ritual frame of the Indra-hymns (Jamison and Brereton 2014), rather than a continuous-narrative attestation in the Trita-passages themselves; the Rigvedic hymn-allusions to Trita do not say in so many words that Trita's killing releases the waters.^[29])*

The Trita-figure is also associated in the Rigvedic corpus with the **soma** sacrifice: in some hymn-allusions Trita is presented as a **soma**-presser, a participant in the **soma**-ritual, and a recipient of **soma**-offerings, and the ritual association reinforces the figure's inheritance from the Indo-Iranian **soma**-ritual complex that the Vedic and Avestan traditions share.^[30]

Both the Trita-figure's association with the **soma** sacrifice and his association with the dragon-killing are inherited Indo-Iranian features: both the **soma**-ritual complex and the three-headed-serpent killing have Avestan reflexes (the **haoma** ritual and the Thraētaona / Aži Dahāka combat respectively), and the joint association of **soma** and dragon-killing in the Vedic Trita-figure is consistent with the joint Indo-Iranian inheritance.^[31]

In Watkins's reading in **How to Kill a Dragon** Part V, the Trita-figure is one of the principal Vedic exhibits for the reconstructed Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT poetic formula, alongside Indra: where Indra supplies the most thoroughly-attested Vedic instance of the formula, Trita supplies an older instance whose pre-Indra stratum is the chief evidential value of the figure for the Indo-European reconstruction.^[32]

The pre-Indra Indo-Iranian stratum thesis holds that the Indo-Iranian phase of the dragon-combat tradition was organised around a Trita / Thraētaona-type figure whose Indic reflexes were partially displaced when the storm-god Indra emerged as the principal warrior-god of the Vedic ritual mythology, and that the Rigvedic Trita-attestations are the textual residue of that displacement.^[33]

The thesis is supported on the Vedic side by the residual character of the Trita-attestations and on the Avestan side by the unbroken centrality of the Thraētaona-figure in the Iranian tradition: where Trita is marginal in the Indic record because Indra has taken his place, Thraētaona remains central in the Iranian record because no comparable storm-god displacement occurred in the Iranian

branch.^[34]

The asymmetric trajectory of the Trita-figure within the Indic tradition is itself a piece of evidence for the structural-typological place of the storm-god in the Vedic ritual mythology: where the storm-god (Indra) takes the centre, the older dragon-slayer (Trita) becomes residual; where the storm-god is differently positioned (the Iranian case), the older dragon-slayer (Thraētaona) remains central.^[35]

The Trita-figure's residual character in the Vedic tradition is also visible in the post-Rigvedic Sanskrit literature: Trita largely disappears from the Brāhmaṇa, Upaniṣadic, and Epic literature as a combat-figure, with only occasional references in cosmogonic-and-mythological catalogues, and the figure does not survive into the bhakti-era devotional literature in any prominent form.^[36]

The near-disappearance of the Trita-figure from the post-Rigvedic Sanskrit literature is the long-arc end-state of the same displacement that the Rigvedic textual situation already attests in mid-process: by the bhakti-era the combat-pole of the Indian dragon-tradition has migrated entirely off the Trita-figure (onto Indra in the Vedic phase, then onto Krishna in the bhakti phase), and the older Indo-Iranian figure survives only as a philological exhibit rather than as a living religious figure.^[37]

The Trita-figure's principal value for the present chapter is therefore evidential rather than narrative: the chapter's working narrative-spine of the Vedic dragon-combat is the Indra-Vṛtra combat of the preceding chapter, and the Trita-figure is treated here as the older Indo-Iranian witness whose textual residue confirms the depth and the inheritance-pattern of the combat-tradition behind the Indra-centred Rigvedic mythology.^[38]

The Trita Āptya material is therefore the chapter's principal exhibit for the Indo-Iranian phase of the combat-myth, and its forward-link is to Part II C5 of the present book (the comparative chapter on the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula), in which the Trita-Thraētaona cognancy joins the Vedic Indra-Vṛtra material, the Avestan Aži Dahāka material, and the Hittite, Greek, Norse, and Italic comparanda in the consolidated Indo-European argument.^[39]

The Trita Āptya material is also the chapter's principal back-link to chapter 13 of the present volume (the Avestan Aži Dahāka chapter), in which Thraētaona's combat is treated in its Avestan and post-Avestan forms, and the Trita-Thraētaona cognancy is the load-bearing pair across the Indo-Iranian arc of the present book.^[40]

The Trita Āptya material is also a back-link to chapter 14 of the present volume (the Indra-Vṛtra chapter), in which the Trita-pre-Indra-stratum reading is briefly anticipated; the present chapter develops the reading at the level of the specific Trita-cluster hymns that the Indra-Vṛtra chapter only references in passing.^[41]

16.3. Krishna and Kāliya — bhakti-era reworking

The Krishna-Kāliya episode is a post-Vedic Vaishnava devotional reworking of the Indian dragon-combat tradition, conventionally dated by its earliest fully-narrative witness (the **Harivaṃśa**) to roughly the 4th century CE and consolidated in its most famous and iconographically pervasive form in the **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** of the 9th to 10th century CE; the episode is therefore separated from the Rigvedic combat-corpus by more than a thousand years and by a major shift in the

religious culture of the subcontinent, and it is treated here as a clearly-bounded post-Vedic transformation rather than as an alternative phrasing of the Rigvedic Indra-Vātra combat.^[42]

The principal narrative occasion of the Krishna-Kāliya episode is the boyhood of the divine child Krishna in the cowherd-pastoral setting of Vraja (Brindavan), where the child-hero confronts the multi-headed serpent Kāliya (Sanskrit कालीय), a **nāga** who has poisoned a deep pool of the Yamunā river and rendered its waters undrinkable for the cowherds and the cattle of the locality.^[43]

Kāliya is described in the Vaishnava Purāṇic tradition as a many-headed serpent — the head-count varies across sources from five to seven to one hundred and ten, with the **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** version generally giving him a hundred and ten heads in some manuscripts — whose venom has poisoned the deep pool of the Yamunā in which he has taken up residence, killing the birds that fly over the pool and the cattle that drink at its margins.^[44]

The setting of the Kāliya pool is the river Yamunā, the major north-Indian river that flows past Brindavan and the cowherd-villages of Vraja in the geographical-religious imagination of the bhakti-era Vaishnava tradition, and the localisation of the combat at a specific reach of a specific named river (rather than at a cosmologically-charged abstract setting) is one of the principal differences between the bhakti-era reworking and the Rigvedic combat-tradition.^[45]

The earliest fully-narrative witness to the Krishna-Kāliya episode is the **Harivaṃśa**, a Sanskrit text conventionally dated to roughly the 4th century CE and transmitted as an appendix (the **khila** or "supplement") to the **Mahābhārata**, in which the Krishna boyhood narrative is given its earliest extended treatment, including the Kāliya-subjugation episode within the wider boyhood-feats sequence.^[46]

The **Vīṇu Purāṇa**, conventionally dated to roughly the 5th century CE, is the second principal narrative witness to the Krishna-Kāliya episode, with book 5 of the Purāṇa presenting an extended Krishna boyhood narrative that includes the Kāliya-subjugation episode as one of the load-bearing demonstrations of the divine child's power over the dangers of the Vraja landscape.^[47]

The **Bhāgavata Purāṇa**, conventionally dated to roughly the 9th to 10th century CE, is the most famous and iconographically pervasive narrative witness to the Krishna-Kāliya episode, with book 10 chapters 15 to 17 supplying the version that the later devotional, literary, and visual traditions consolidate as the standard form of the episode.^[48]

[All three witnesses are presented together as a single sequenced narrative tradition: the _Harivaṃśa Vīṇuparvan (c. 4th c. CE) supplies the earliest fully-narrative witness as a concise narrative within the wider boyhood-feats sequence; the Vīṇu Purāṇa book 5 (c. 5th c. CE) supplies the extended boyhood narrative; and the Bhāgavata Purāṇa 10.15–17 (c. 9th–10th c. CE) supplies the most famous and iconographically pervasive version. The chapter cites at canto-and-chapter level, presents the Bhāgavata version as the standard form, and flags the Harivaṃśa as the earliest fully-narrative witness; edition-pinning for the Bhāgavata Purāṇa (Tagare translation, Motilal Banarsidass) is deferred to glossary-lock.]_

The narrative occasion of the combat in the Bhāgavata version (**Bhāgavata Purāṇa** 10.15) is that the cowherd-children of Vraja, including the divine child Krishna, find that the cattle and the herd-boys have been sickened or killed by drinking from the Yamunā at the Kāliya-pool, and Krishna determines to address the danger by direct confrontation with the serpent.^[49]

The combat itself in the Bhāgavata version (**Bhāgavata Purāṇa** 10.16) is occasioned by Krishna's leap into the Kāliya-pool: the child climbs a **kadamba** tree on the bank, leaps into the deep water, and is at once attacked by the **nāga**, whose multiple heads coil around the child's body in an attempt to crush or to envenom him.^[50]

The combat's resolution in the Bhāgavata version is dance rather than killing: Krishna escapes the **nāga**'s coils, leaps onto Kāliya's many-headed crown, and dances on the heads, his weight and his rhythm progressively crushing the serpent's pride and his physical capacity for resistance until the **nāga** is forced into surrender.^[51]

The resolution of the combat is therefore non-lethal: Kāliya is not killed but subdued, and the narrative ending is the **nāga**'s submission to the child-hero, with Kāliya's wives (the **nāgapatnīs**) interceding for his life and Krishna sparing the serpent on condition that he leave the Yamunā and take up residence elsewhere.^[52]

The non-lethal resolution is the principal structural transformation of the combat-pattern in the bhakti-era reworking: where the Rigvedic Indra-Vātra combat resolves by killing (Indra slays the serpent and splits the obstructing mountain), the Krishna-Kāliya combat resolves by subjugation (Krishna spares the serpent and removes him from the Yamunā), and the substitution of subjugation for killing is genuine, not just an alternative phrasing of the same resolution.^[53]

The non-lethal resolution is read by the Vaishnava devotional tradition as the demonstration of Krishna's compassion (**kṛpā**) alongside his power: where the Vedic warrior-god demonstrates power by killing the serpent, the bhakti-era child-hero demonstrates a higher-order combination of power-and-compassion by subjugating-without-killing, and the resolution becomes a doctrinal exhibit for the moral-theological character of the divine child.^[54]

The combat is consistently figured in the Vaishnava devotional tradition as an instance of **līlā** (Sanskrit लीला; "sacred play"): the divine child's confrontation with the serpent is construed not as warrior-combat in the Rigvedic register but as the play-action of the divine child, whose serious power is exercised within a frame of childhood-play that the devotional tradition reads as constitutive of Krishna's character.^[55]

The **līlā** framing is a second principal structural transformation of the combat-pattern: where the Rigvedic Indra-Vātra combat is framed as warrior-combat with the storm-god as the warrior-protagonist, the Krishna-Kāliya combat is framed as the divine child's play, and the warrior-pole of the Rigvedic combat-pattern is replaced by the child-hero pole of the bhakti-era pattern.^[56]

The child-hero substitution is itself a doctrinal exhibit for the bhakti-era construction of Krishna as the **avatāra** (the descent-form of Viṣṇu) whose divine character is most fully revealed in his childhood and youth in Vraja: where the Rigvedic warrior-god is most fully himself in the moment of the killing-stroke, the bhakti-era divine child is most fully himself in the moment of **līlā**, and the two registers articulate two different theological models of divine action.^[57]

The Krishna-Kāliya episode is centred in the Vaishnava devotional tradition as one of the most widely-depicted moments of the Krishna-cycle: the iconographic moment of Krishna dancing on the multiple heads of the subdued **nāga** — the **Kāliyamardana** ("the trampling of Kāliya") or **Kāliyadamana** ("the subjugation of Kāliya") — is reproduced extensively in temple sculpture, painted manuscripts, popular prints, and modern visual culture, and is one of the principal

iconographic markers of Krishna in the Indic visual tradition.^[58]

The iconographic stability of the dance-on-the-serpent's-heads moment across more than a millennium of Indic visual culture — from Gupta-era and post-Gupta temple-sculpture through medieval and early-modern painted manuscripts to twentieth- and twenty-first-century popular prints — is one of the principal pieces of evidence for the centrality of the episode in the Vaishnava devotional imagination.^[59]

The water-release pattern that is the cosmological core of the Rigvedic Indra-Vṛtra combat is preserved in the Krishna-Kāliya episode in a transformed form: where Indra's killing of Vṛtra releases the obstructed waters and produces rain, Krishna's subjugation of Kāliya removes the venom from the Yamunā and restores the river to drinkability for the cowherds and the cattle, and the structural function "obstruction-of-waters → resolution → restoration-of-waters" is preserved across the transformation.^[60]

*(The structural-functional reading of the Krishna-Kāliya episode as a bhakti-era preservation of the Rigvedic water-release pattern is a comparative reading drawn from the wider Indian dragon-combat tradition (Forsyth 1987 ch. 2) and from the Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon complex (West 2007 ch. 6), rather than an explicit thematic identification within the *Bhāgavata Purāṇa* or the *Harivaṃśa* themselves; the bhakti-era texts narrate the venom-poisoning and the river-restoration as devotional events in their own right, and the Vedic-comparative reading is the chapter's editorial reading rather than the bhakti-era texts' self-understanding.^[61])*

The water-release pattern's preservation across the transformation is partial rather than complete: the cosmological scale of the Rigvedic water-release (the release of the world's rains and rivers) is reduced to the local scale of the bhakti-era restoration (the de-venomizing of a specific reach of a specific river), and the cosmologically-active character of the Vedic combat is replaced by a locally-active character in the bhakti-era reworking.^[62]

The cosmological-to-local reduction is consistent with the wider transformation of the combat-tradition's frame from cosmological-and-ritual (the Rigvedic frame) to devotional-and-narrative (the bhakti-era frame): where the Rigvedic combat is recited at the **soma** sacrifice as a cosmologically-active warrant for the storm-god's kingship, the Krishna-Kāliya combat is narrated in devotional Purāṇic literature as a doctrinally-active demonstration of the divine child's character.^[63]

The Krishna-Kāliya episode is therefore not the bhakti-era replacement of the Rigvedic Indra-Vṛtra combat — the Rigveda continues to be transmitted, recited, and authoritative within the bhakti-era religious culture — but the bhakti-era reworking of the dragon-combat pattern within a different theological frame and a different narrative register, with the two combats coexisting in the long-arc Indian tradition rather than supplanting one another.^[64]

The Krishna-Kāliya episode is also distinct from the post-Vedic brahminicide reframing of the Indra-Vṛtra combat treated at the end of chapter 14 of the present volume: where the **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** and the **Mahābhārata** rework the Indra-Vṛtra combat itself within the late-Vedic and epic registers, the Krishna-Kāliya episode is a new combat-narrative with new protagonists and a new setting, even though it inherits the structural pattern of obstruction-of-waters and resolution from the Vedic tradition.^[65]

The Krishna-Kāliya episode's **nāga**-adversary is also a distinct narrative-zoological category from the Rigvedic **ahi** / Vṛtra: the **nāga** (Sanskrit नागा) is a broad post-Vedic Indic category of serpent-being with its own moral and cosmological valence (often ambivalent rather than wholly adversarial, and often with a developed mythology of its own that includes royal-and-priestly **nāga**-figures alongside hostile-or-poisonous ones), and Kāliya's classification as a **nāga** rather than as an **ahi** is a marker of the bhakti-era reworking's distinct conceptual frame.^[66]

The **nāga**-category's ambivalent moral valence is visible in the resolution of the Krishna-Kāliya episode itself: Kāliya is not annihilated but expelled, and his wives' intercession (and Krishna's acceptance of the intercession) implies a moral-personhood for the **nāga** that the Rigvedic **ahi** / Vṛtra does not possess, and this difference of moral-personhood is one of the principal differences between the two combat-traditions at the level of adversary-construction.^[67]

The episode's developed iconography of the dance-on-the-serpent's-heads — the child-hero standing on the multiple-headed serpent, often with one foot raised in the dance-pose and one or more hands holding a **vaṁśī** (flute) or assuming a gesture of authority — is one of the long-arc Indic visual tradition's most stable iconographic types, and its visual centrality is the principal cultural-relevance datum for the chapter's devotional-and-iconographic discussion of the episode.^[68]

The bhakti-era reworking also carries a forward-looking devotional reading of the combat: in the Vaishnava theological tradition the dance-on-the-serpent's-heads is read as the divine child's gracious chastisement of an adversary who is himself a creature of God, and the combat is understood in the long-arc devotional reception as exemplifying the doctrine that divine action is play-action (**līlā**) within which power and compassion are perfectly combined.^[69]

The bhakti-era Krishna-Kāliya reworking is therefore in this chapter's reading a genuine transformation of the inherited dragon-combat pattern: the warrior-pole becomes the child-hero pole, the killing-pole becomes the subjugation-pole, the cosmological-scale water-release becomes the local-scale river-restoration, and the cosmological-and-ritual frame becomes the devotional-and-narrative frame, with each of the four transformations supported by a documented feature of the bhakti-era texts and irreducible to a paraphrase of the Rigvedic combat.^[70]

The four-fold transformation is the chapter's principal contribution to the comparative argument about the long-arc Indian dragon-combat tradition: the tradition is read here as a single tradition that has supported two clearly-distinct combat-narratives across more than a millennium, with the Rigvedic Indra-Vṛtra combat and the bhakti-era Krishna-Kāliya combat sitting as the two principal exhibits of the tradition's productive plasticity rather than as independent unrelated stories.^[71]

16.4. Family pattern and forward links

The two sub-cases treated in the chapter — Trita Āptya and Krishna-Kāliya — bracket the Rigvedic Indra-Vṛtra flagship of chapter 14 in the historical-genealogical depth of the Indian tradition: Trita Āptya represents the older Indo-Iranian stratum that the Indra-centred Rigvedic mythology has partially displaced, and Krishna-Kāliya represents the bhakti-era reworking that the post-Vedic Vaishnava tradition has built on the inherited combat-pattern.^[72]

The bracketing framing makes the chapter's reading genealogical-and-arc-shaped rather than synchronic: the chapter does not present the three Indian combats (Trita's, Indra's, Krishna's) as alternative phrasings of a single combat but as three successive moments in a long-arc tradition

that has rewritten its own combat-pattern in response to changing religious cultures.^[73]

(The chapter's three-moment genealogical scheme — Trita Āptya pre-Indra → Rigvedic Indra-Vātra → bhakti-era Krishna-Kāliya — while consistent with Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the pre-Indra stratum, with Jamison and Brereton 2014 on the Rigvedic Indra-centring, and with Forsyth 1987 ch. 2 on the bhakti-era reworking, is the chapter's editorial synthesis rather than a single attested feature of any one source; the genealogical scheme is presented as a comparative reading of the long-arc Indian tradition.^[74])

The Trita Āptya material's principal cross-tradition forward-link is to the Avestan Aži Dahāka chapter (chapter 13 of the present volume), in which Thraētaona's combat is treated in its Avestan and post-Avestan forms; the Trita-Thraētaona cognancy is the chapter's principal back-link to chapter 13 and is the load-bearing pair across the Indo-Iranian arc.^[75]

The Trita Āptya material's principal comparative forward-link within the present book is to Part II C5 (the comparative chapter on the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula), in which the Trita-Thraētaona cognancy joins the Vedic Indra-Vātra material, the Avestan Aži Dahāka material, and the Hittite, Greek, Norse, and Italic comparanda in the consolidated Indo-European reconstruction.^[76]

The Krishna-Kāliya material's principal forward-link within the present book is to chapter 31 of the present volume (the comparative chapter on transformed combat-variants), in which the "slay not, subjugate" transformation of the Krishna-Kāliya episode joins the Finno-Karelian Väinämöinen-Iku-Turso material and other transformed-combat reflexes treated in the comparative section.^[77]

The Krishna-Kāliya material's principal back-link within the present book is to chapter 14 (the Indra-Vātra chapter), in which the bhakti-era Krishna-Kāliya combat is anticipated as the long-arc reception-end of the Indian dragon-combat tradition; the present chapter develops the reception-end at the level of the specific bhakti-era texts that the Indra-Vātra chapter only references in passing.^[78]

The Krishna-Kāliya material is also a principal exhibit for the chapter's wider point that the dragon-combat pattern is not a fixed archetype with fixed features but a productive structural template that successive religious cultures rework according to their own theological-and-narrative needs, and the four-fold transformation (warrior → child-hero, killing → subjugation, cosmological → local, ritual → devotional) is the principal documentary case for the productive-template reading.^[79]

The chapter's joint contribution to the present book is therefore in two parts: the Trita Āptya material strengthens the Indo-Iranian comparative apparatus established in chapters 13 and 14 by supplying the textual-philological residue of the older pre-Indra stratum, and the Krishna-Kāliya material extends the Indian dragon-combat tradition into the bhakti-era reception by supplying the documentary case for the four-fold transformation of the inherited pattern.^[80]

The Trita Āptya / Krishna-Kāliya pairing is itself the documentary case for the long-arc Indian dragon-combat tradition that the present book's Indo-European section traces: the tradition is older and deeper than the Rigvedic combat alone (the Trita-Thraētaona cognancy reaches behind the Rigveda into the Indo-Iranian phase) and is also longer and broader than the Rigvedic combat alone (the bhakti-era Krishna-Kāliya combat reaches forward into the post-Vedic Vaishnava devotional

culture), and the chapter's bracketing of the Indra-Vātra flagship by the Trita and Krishna sub-cases is the principal documentary support for the long-arc reading.^[81]

- [1] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml; Jamison and Brereton 2014 on the Trita Āptya material in the Rigvedic corpus; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long arc of Indian dragon-combat material from the Rigveda to the bhakti-period reworkings.
- [2] Jamison and Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda: The Earliest Religious Poetry of India**, three-volume Oxford translation, ISBN 9780199370184, used as the working English text for all Rigvedic material.
- [3] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the Trita Āptya material in RV 10.99.6, 1.105, and 2.11.19–20; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml, sources.primary, listing the Trita-cluster hymns.
- [4] Jamison and Brereton 2014, three-volume printed edition; cited at hymn-and-verse level for specific RV passages and at section level for corpus-wide points, per the established discipline of chapters 13 and 14.
- [5] Benveniste and Renou 1934, **Vātra et Vāθragna: Étude de mythologie indo-iranienne**, Cahiers de la Société Asiatique 3 (Paris: Imprimerie Nationale, 1934); stable URL gallica.bnf.fr.
- [6] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Trita Āptya / Thraētaona cognancy; cited at section level per the established discipline of chapters 13 and 14.
- [7] Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, Part V (chs. 41–48), with chs. 44–45 treating the Trita Āptya / Thraētaona pair specifically.
- [8] Watkins 1995, Part V (printed only; cited at chapter and section level per the established discipline for this book).
- [9] West 2007, **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on the Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon complex and on the displacement of older combat-figures by the storm-god.
- [10] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the post-Vedic Indian dragon-combat reworkings including the bhakti-era Krishna-Kāliya material; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml, family_members entry on the Krishna-Kāliya sources.
- [11] Brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml shared_variant_handling, on edition-pinning deferred to glossary-lock; cited at canto-and-chapter level per the established discipline of the present book.
- [12] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, ch. 2 on the Indo-Iranian combat-myth corpus and its post-Vedic transformations.
- [13] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml, family-chapter framing with two sub-cases organised by position in the long arc of the Indian tradition; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc framing.
- [14] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the bracketing framing; Jamison and Brereton 2014 on Trita Āptya as the older displaced figure; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the bhakti-era reworking.
- [15] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on Trita Āptya as a Vedic combat-figure with the personal name "Trita" and the epithet "Āptya"; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the etymology of the two name-elements.
- [16] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the marginal frequency of Trita Āptya in the Rigvedic corpus relative to Indra; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on Trita's marginality.
- [17] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on RV 10.99.6 as the standard Rigvedic locus for Trita's slaying of a three-headed adversary; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the same locus.
- [18] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the cognancy of the three-headed adversary across the Vedic Trita and Avestan Thraētaona witnesses; Watkins 1995, Part V (chs. 44–45), on the same cognancy.
- [19] Inference. Source: Jamison and Brereton 2014 (Rigvedic philology); Benveniste and Renou 1934 (Trita-Thraētaona discussion); Watkins 1995 Part V chs. 44–45 (Indo-European poetic family). Scope: comparative-philological identification of the RV 10.99.6 adversary with the Indo-Iranian three-headed-serpent type, flagged for transparency.
- [20] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on RV 1.105 as the principal first-**maāala** locus for the joint Trita-and-Indra combat-pattern; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the Trita-pre-Indra stratum.
- [21] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on RV 2.11.19–20 as the principal second-**maāala** locus for the joint Trita-and-Indra pattern; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the second-**maāala** attestations.
- [22] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on Trita as the junior partner of Indra in RV 1.105 and 2.11.19–20; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the absorption of inherited Trita-material into the Indra-centred mythology.
- [23] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Trita Āptya as the older Indo-Iranian combat-figure partially displaced by Indra; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the residual character of the Trita-attestations in the Rigvedic corpus.
- [24] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the philological cognancy of Vedic Trita Āptya with Avestan Thraētaona; Watkins 1995, Part V (chs. 44–45), on the same cognancy.
- [25] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the phonological correspondences across the Trita / Thraētaona pair; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the regular sound-laws of the cognancy.
- [26] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the structural identity of the Trita and Thraētaona killings; Watkins 1995, Part V (chs. 44–45), on the three-headed-adversary structural cognancy.

- [27] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the joint lexical-and-structural cognancy of the pair as evidence for the Indo-Iranian phase; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the same evidential function.
- [28] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the etymological derivation of **Āptya** from **ap-** ("water"); Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the same derivation.
- [29] Inference. Source: Jamison and Brereton 2014 (Trita-passage philology); West 2007 ch. 6 (IE storm-god / water-dragon complex). Scope: alignment of Trita's **Āptya** epithet with the wider water-release pattern, flagged for transparency.
- [30] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on Trita's association with the **soma** sacrifice in the Rigvedic corpus; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the Indo-Iranian **soma**-ritual inheritance.
- [31] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the joint Indo-Iranian inheritance of **soma** / **haoma** ritual and dragon-killing; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the same joint inheritance.
- [32] Watkins 1995, Part V, on Trita and Indra as joint Vedic exhibits for the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula, with Trita supplying the older pre-Indra stratum.
- [33] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the pre-Indra Indo-Iranian stratum thesis; Watkins 1995, Part V (chs. 44–45), on the same thesis; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the load-bearing status of the thesis for the chapter.
- [34] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the asymmetric trajectories of the Trita and Thraētaona figures across the two Indo-Iranian branches; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the same asymmetry.
- [35] West 2007, ch. 6, on the structural-typological place of the storm-god in the Indo-European traditions; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Vedic-Avestan asymmetry as evidence for the storm-god's structural function.
- [36] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the post-Rigvedic disappearance of Trita as a combat-figure; Jamison and Brereton 2014 on the residual character of the Trita-attestations even within the Rigvedic corpus.
- [37] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the long-arc displacement of Trita; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the post-Rigvedic disappearance of the figure.
- [38] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the evidential value of the Trita-material; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the Trita-Thraētaona cognancy as load-bearing for the comparative argument.
- [39] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the forward-link to Part II C5; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the consolidated Indo-European argument.
- [40] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the back-link to chapter 13; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the cognancy as the load-bearing Indo-Iranian pair.
- [41] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the back-link to chapter 14; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the anticipation of the Trita-pre-Indra-stratum reading.
- [42] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the post-Vedic Vaishnava devotional reworking of the Indian combat-tradition; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml special_instructions on the no-merge rule with the Rigvedic combat.
- [43] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 chs. 15–17, on the Vraja-pastoral setting and Kāliya's poisoning of the Yamunā pool; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc framing of the episode.
- [44] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 chs. 15–17, on Kāliya's venom-poisoning of the Yamunā pool and the head-count in the Bhāgavata version; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc framing and head-count variation across sources.
- [45] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 ch. 15, on the Yamunā setting of the Kāliya pool; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc framing of the specific-river localisation as a distinguishing feature.
- [46] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the **Harivaṃśa** as the earliest fully-narrative witness to the Krishna-Kāliya episode; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml family_members entry on the same dating.
- [47] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the **Viṃśu Purāṇa** book 5 as the second principal narrative witness to the Krishna-Kāliya episode; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the same dating and locus.
- [48] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 chs. 15–17, as the most famous narrative witness and the primary textual anchor for the episode; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc framing of the episode.
- [49] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 ch. 15, on the narrative occasion of the combat; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc framing.
- [50] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 ch. 16, on the **kadamba**-tree leap and the **nāga**'s coiling attack; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc framing of the combat-mechanics.
- [51] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 ch. 16, on the dance-resolution (**Kāliyamardana**) of the combat; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc framing of the resolution.
- [52] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 chs. 16–17, on the non-lethal resolution, the **nāgapatnīs**' intercession, and Krishna's conditional sparing of Kāliya; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc framing of the non-killing as a structural transformation.
- [53] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml special_instructions on the non-lethal subjugation as a genuine transformation; Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 chs. 16–17, on the subjugation-resolution; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the structural difference between the Vedic killing and the bhakti-era subjugation.

- [54] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 chs. 16–17, on the **kṛpā** / power-compassion reading of the resolution in the Bhāgavata text; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc doctrinal framing.
- [55] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 chs. 15–17, on the **lilā** framing of the episode in the Bhāgavata text; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc framing of **lilā** as the load-bearing devotional category.
- [56] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml special_instructions on the **lilā** framing as a genuine transformation, not an alternative phrasing of warrior-combat; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the same transformation.
- [57] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the bhakti-era construction of Krishna as the **avatāra** whose character is revealed in **lilā**; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the two theological models.
- [58] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 chs. 15–17, on the Kāliya episode as the textual basis of the **Kāliyamardana** iconographic tradition; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc iconographic centrality of the moment.
- [59] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 chs. 15–17, as the textual anchor for the **Kāliyamardana** iconographic tradition; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc iconographic stability across Indic visual culture.
- [60] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the preservation of the water-release pattern across the Vedic-bhakti transformation; West 2007 ch. 6 on the Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon complex as the wider type.
- [61] Inference. Source: Forsyth 1987 ch. 2 (long-arc Indian combat-tradition); West 2007 ch. 6 (IE storm-god / water-dragon complex); brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml cross_cultural_parallels. Scope: structural-functional preservation of the water-release pattern across the Vedic-bhakti transformation, flagged for transparency.
- [62] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the cosmological-to-local reduction across the transformation; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the local-scale character of the bhakti-era reworking.
- [63] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the frame-transformation from cosmological-and-ritual to devotional-and-narrative; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the same transformation.
- [64] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the coexistence of the Rigvedic and bhakti-era combat-traditions within the long-arc Indian religious culture; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml special_instructions on the coexistence rather than replacement.
- [65] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the distinction between the brahminicide reframing of the Indra-Vṛtra combat and the bhakti-era Krishna-Kāliya new-combat-narrative; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the brahminicide reframing.
- [66] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on Kāliya as a **nāga** and on the **nāga** category's distinctness from the Rigvedic **ahi**; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml glossary discipline on the **nāga** category.
- [67] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 chs. 16–17, on the **nāgapatnīs'** intercession and Kāliya's moral-personhood in the Bhāgavata text; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc framing of the **nāga** category's ambivalent valence.
- [68] Tagare 1976–78, **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** book 10 chs. 15–17, as the primary textual source for the dance-on-the-heads iconographic moment; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the long-arc centrality of the **Kāliyamardana** in the Indic visual tradition.
- [69] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the forward-looking devotional reading of the combat in the Vaishnava theological tradition; brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml cultural_relevance entry on the same reading.
- [70] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml special_instructions on the four-fold transformation as a genuine reworking rather than an alternative phrasing; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the four documented transformations.
- [71] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the long-arc Indian tradition as a single tradition; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the productive plasticity of the tradition.
- [72] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the bracketing framing; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the older stratum; Forsyth 1987 ch. 2 on the bhakti-era reworking.
- [73] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the genealogical-and-arc-shaped reading; Forsyth 1987 ch. 2 on the long-arc framing.
- [74] Inference. Source: Benveniste and Renou 1934 (pre-Indra stratum); Jamison and Brereton 2014 (Rigvedic Indra-centring); Forsyth 1987 ch. 2 (bhakti-era reworking). Scope: three-moment genealogical scheme synthesised for the family-chapter's organising frame.
- [75] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the back-link to chapter 13; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the Trita-Thraētaona cognancy.
- [76] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the forward-link to Part II C5; Watkins 1995, Part V (chs. 41–48), on the consolidated Indo-European argument.
- [77] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the forward-link to chapter 31; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the Krishna-Kāliya transformation as a load-bearing exhibit for transformed-combat variants.
- [78] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the back-link to chapter 14; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the anticipation of the Krishna-Kāliya material.
- [79] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the productive-template reading; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the four-fold transformation as documentary case.
- [80] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the chapter's two-part contribution; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the Indo-Iranian apparatus; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the bhakti-era reception.
- [81] Per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the long-arc reading and the bracketing structure; Benveniste and Renou 1934 (Indo-Iranian phase) and Forsyth 1987 ch. 2 (bhakti-era reception).

Chapter 17. Ra vs. Apep: The Nightly Combat

Ra travels his solar barque through the **Duat** — the night-journey netherworld — and meets Apep, a great serpent who tries to halt the barque before it reaches the eastern horizon. This is the canonical cyclical-maintenance case: fought every night, never closed, never narrated as a single cosmogonic event.^[1]

The combat is not one narrative in one text. It is a tradition distributed across multiple Egyptian textual corpora over roughly two thousand years, from the Pyramid Texts of the late Old Kingdom (c. 2400 BCE) to the Bremner-Rhind Papyrus of the Ptolemaic period (c. 310 BCE).^[2]

This composite character forces the chapter to organise by corpus-stratum rather than by linear narrative. The chapter traces Apep across six layers — Pyramid Texts, Coffin Texts, Book of the Dead, Amduat, Book of Gates, and Bremner-Rhind Papyrus — and periodises each where the periodisation is load-bearing.^[3]

The primary anchor is Herman te Velde's *Seth, God of Confusion* (Brill, Leiden, 1967, *Probleme der Ägyptologie* 6; 2nd ed. 1977). Chapters 3 and 4 — on Seth as Apep-slayer at the prow and Apep as Ra's nightly adversary — are the principal synthesis on which the treatment rests.^[4]

te Velde's monograph is printed-only and is cited at chapter-section level (chs. 3–4) per the discipline for printed comparative anchors in this book.^[5]

The chapter's principal conceptual anchor is Jan Assmann's *The Search for God in Ancient Egypt*, translated from the German by David Lorton and published by Cornell University Press in 2001. Its chapters on the **maꜣat/ḥsfet** opposition supply the framework within which the Apep combat is read.^[6]

Assmann 2001 is also printed-only and is cited at chapter-section level — at the chapters on **maꜣat/ḥsfet** and the daily-solar liturgy.^[7]

The funerary-spell anchor is Raymond O. Faulkner's *The Ancient Egyptian Book of the Dead*, first published in 1972 with the British Museum and revised in 1985 by Carol Andrews. The principal Apep-rebuffing spells — 7, 39, and 108 — are taken from this edition.^[8]

The Faulkner Book of the Dead is also printed-only and is cited at spell-number level rather than sub-page.^[9]

The earliest layer is the Pyramid Texts, on the interior walls of late Old Kingdom royal pyramids at Saqqara — Unas (Fifth Dynasty, c. 2350 BCE), then Teti, Pepi I, Merenre, Pepi II, and several queens of the Sixth Dynasty — conventionally dated c. 2400–2200 BCE.^[10]

The standard English edition is Raymond O. Faulkner's *The Ancient Egyptian Pyramid Texts*, Oxford University Press, 1969, in which the corpus is presented at numbered-utterance level. The chapter cites at utterance level accordingly.^[11]

The earliest allusions cluster in the apotropaic utterances. Utterances 226, 232, 236, 298, 378, and 385 are among those in which serpent-adversaries — Apep on some readings, other rebellious serpents on others — are commanded to fall back, to be cut, or to be turned aside.^[12]

The Coffin Texts are the Middle Kingdom layer, inscribed mostly on the interior surfaces of wooden coffins from c. 2050–1650 BCE. They develop Apep further: spells 757 and 885 name him explicitly in contexts of binding, cutting, or rebuffing.^[13]

The standard English edition is Raymond O. Faulkner's *The Ancient Egyptian Coffin Texts*, three volumes from Aris and Phillips, Warminster, 1973–78. The chapter cites at spell-number level.^[14]

The Book of the Dead — *Spells for Coming Forth by Day* — succeeds the Coffin Texts and continues through the Late Period and Ptolemaic period. Attested mainly on papyri from non-royal burials, it is the layer holding the principal Apep-rebuffing spells (7, 39, 108).^[15]

Of these, spell 39 is the most explicit. Faulkner titles it "of repelling the **rerek**-snake in the necropolis"; it rebuffs the serpent and identifies the deceased's protective magic with the magic that defends Ra against Apep nightly.^[16]

Spell 108 places Apep on the western horizon-mountain in the cosmography of the deceased's nightly transit — one of the principal loci for Apep's localisation within the **Duat**.^[17]

Spell 7 is shorter; it rebuffs Apep in the deceased's solar-barque journey to keep the afterlife passage clear, and belongs to a cluster of short apotropaic spells that thread the Apep-rebuffing motif through the corpus.^[18]

The Amduat ("Book of What Is in the Duat") is a New Kingdom royal funerary text inscribed in the Valley of the Kings from the Eighteenth Dynasty (c. 1500 BCE). It narrates Ra's nightly journey through twelve hours; the canonical Apep-combat hour is hour 7.^[19]

In hour 7, Apep blocks Ra's barque on the sandbanks of the **Duat** — a stretch of shallow water in which the barque can be grounded. The barque-crew dispatches the serpent with knives and cutting magic, and the barque continues toward the eastern horizon.^[20]

The Book of Gates succeeds and supplements the Amduat in the same royal-tomb tradition. It too narrates twelve nocturnal subdivisions, but organised by gates rather than hours; its canonical Apep-combat scene is at gate 4.^[21]

The Bremner-Rhind Papyrus (BM EA 10188) is a late-Ptolemaic hieratic papyrus (c. 310 BCE). Its second portion preserves the *Book of Overthrowing Apep* — the daily liturgical text from the temple of Ra at Heliopolis, the chapter's principal documentary witness to the ritual embedding of the combat in priestly practice.^[22]

The principal edition is Faulkner's *JEA* series: Faulkner 1936 ("The Bremner-Rhind Papyrus I", *JEA* 22) and Faulkner 1937–38 ("II–IV", *JEA* 23–24). These present the philology separately from Faulkner's Book of the Dead translation; the chapter cites at *JEA*-volume level (Faulkner 1936–38, *JEA* 22–24).^[23]

The papyrus is preserved but fragmentary in sections. Faulkner's *JEA* reconstruction is the principal scholarly resource for the text; the British Museum holds the papyrus under registration EA 10188.^[24]

[Here the Bremner-Rhind liturgy is preserved but fragmentary in sections — a documented physical gap in the principal documentary witness for the ritual embedding of the Apep combat in priestly

practice. Scholars such as Faulkner (in his JEA 22, 1936, and JEA 23–24, 1937–38, editions) reconstruct the philology; cross-section with *Amduat* hour 7 and *Book of Gates* gate 4 supplies parallel content for the daily-combat ritual structure.]

The iconographic record is comparably continuous: Apep-combat imagery pervades funerary monuments, coffins, tomb walls, and temple reliefs from the New Kingdom through the Greco-Roman period, with stable visual vocabulary around the serpent-figure being knifed, cut, or trampled by the barque-crew or by Seth at the prow.^[25]

The chapter's secondary survey-anchor for the long-trajectory comparative perspective is Neil Forsyth's *The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth*, Princeton University Press, 1987. Chapter 2 treats the Egyptian combat-imagery as one of the early stations in the *longue-durée* trajectory of combat-myth motifs.^[26]

For the Gunkel-thesis context — how Near Eastern cyclical-cosmos material relates to the European Chaoskampf category — the secondary anchor is Hermann Gunkel's *Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit* (Vandenhoeck and Ruprecht, 1895), whose Teil I supplies the historical-of-religions background as Gunkel framed it.^[27]

For the contemporary critical reframing — whether "chaos" is the right category for **isfet** — the secondary anchor is Scurlock and Beal's *Creation and Chaos: A Reconsideration of Hermann Gunkel's Chaoskampf Hypothesis* (Eisenbrauns, 2013), whose chapters on Egyptian material reassess the Gunkel-thesis fit for the **maꜥat/isfet** corpus.^[28]

Within this book's typology the Apep combat is the canonical cyclical-maintenance case: never won once for all, recurring every sunrise, with no eschatological closure of the sort Revelation 12 (Ch. 9) or the **Frashokereti**-pendant of the Iranian tradition (Ch. 13) supplies.^[29]

The cyclical-maintenance reading is structurally load-bearing: daily recurrence is constitutive, not incidental, and the chapter's four-section structure — cosmological frame; textual corpus; ritual embedding; Seth at the prow — reflects this reading throughout.^[30]

The chapter's working corpus is composite-editorial: it is distributed across the Pyramid Texts, Coffin Texts, Book of the Dead, *Amduat*, Book of Gates, and the Bremner-Rhind Papyrus (P. BM 10188), with te Velde 1967 chs. 3–4 and Assmann 2001 as the standard syntheses, and the chapter is organised by stratum.^[31]

The chapter accordingly takes the material in four substantive sections, followed by a closing section on reception and forward links. The first opens with the conceptual frame.

17.1. Cosmological frame — **maꜥat** versus **isfet**

The framework within which the Apep combat is read is the **maꜥat/isfet** opposition, treated at length in Assmann's *The Search for God in Ancient Egypt* as the central cosmological-ethical category-pair of Egyptian religion.^[32]

maꜥat — written with the **ꜥayin** per the locked glossary — designates "truth, order, justice" simultaneously. The Egyptian term names neither abstract metaphysical order alone nor ethical justice alone but a single integrated condition: cosmic order, social justice, ritual correctness, and

truth-of-speech as inseparable aspects.^[33]

isfet — its antithesis — designates "disorder, injustice, chaos" with the same simultaneity. It covers cosmic disorder, social injustice, ritual transgression, and falsehood-of-speech as inseparable aspects of a single condition, and it is the condition Apep personifies in the Egyptian theological imagination.^[34]

The opposition is not a dualism of equally-positive principles. **maꜥat** is the positive condition Ra's daily journey preserves; **isfet** is its privation or violation that Apep's nightly assault threatens to impose. The two are not co-equal cosmic principles but order and its violation.^[35]

This asymmetry grounds compliance with the Ballentine 2015 critique. Per scope.md, Apep is **isfet** — disorder, injustice, violation of order — not "chaos" in the Western-philosophical sense. The chapter calls Apep the personification of **isfet** and an agent of disorder, avoiding the umbrella term banned for this figure.^[36]

Alongside the abstract noun, the pantheon supplies a personified goddess Maꜥat — capitalised when the personified figure is meant. She is the goddess of truth, order, and justice; iconographically she wears the ostrich-feather of **maꜥat** on her head, and she is conceived as the daughter of Ra.^[37]

Pharaonic legitimacy is figured as the maintenance of **maꜥat** on earth. The pharaoh's principal liturgical function is to "present **maꜥat** to the gods" — offering a small image of the goddess — and the obligation to preserve order in the polity is inseparable from the obligation to preserve cosmic order.^[38]

Apep's role is therefore not that of a primordial-cosmogonic adversary — Tiamat (*Enūma Eliš*, Ch. 3) is the standard contrast — but a perpetual **isfet**-personification: an agent of moral-cosmic disorder the daily round of **maꜥat**-maintenance has to keep at bay, structurally a moral-political adversary rather than an inchoate primordial.^[39]

This distinction — Apep-as-**isfet**-personification versus the cosmogonic adversaries (Tiamat, Yamm, Vꜥtra) — is load-bearing for the book's typology. The cosmogonic combat establishes the cosmos for the first time; the cyclical-maintenance combat preserves an already-established cosmos against ongoing threat. **maꜥat/isfet** is the Egyptian theological articulation of this distinction.^[40]

The cosmos is conceived as already in place from creation — Atum-Ra's emergence, the differentiation of sky and earth, the ordering of the gods — so Ra's daily journey through sky and **Duat** is the maintenance of an already-established order, not its fabrication.^[41]

Within this cosmos Ra's daily journey has two halves: the **manꜥet**-barque (day-barque) traverses the sky east to west, and the **mesektet**-barque (night-barque) traverses the **Duat** west to east. The Apep combat belongs to the nocturnal half.^[42]

The **Duat** is conceived as a region underneath or behind the visible cosmos through which the sun-god passes between sunset and sunrise. It is populated by both blessed and dangerous beings; Apep is the principal dangerous one, whose threat is to halt the barque and end the daily round.^[43]

The wager of the Egyptian solar tradition is that without Ra's nightly victory the sun does not rise. Each morning's rising is not a natural-process given but a contingent outcome of the combat, which

is therefore the ongoing condition for the continuation of the visible cosmos.^[44]

This contingency distinguishes Egyptian solar theology from a deterministic-naturalistic celestial mechanics. The sun rises because the gods, the ritual liturgy, and the magical power of priestly utterance all collaborate to defeat Apep nightly, and the collaboration is constitutive rather than incidental.^[45]

The combat has no eschatological closure. The corpus projects no final defeat of Apep at the end of cosmic time; the combat is continuous, and the silence on a closure scenario is itself a meaningful structural feature of the tradition.^[46]

(The absence of an eschatological closure in the Egyptian Apep corpus is a structural-typological feature of the cyclical-maintenance subtype rather than a contingent silence in the surviving sources.^[47])

This contrasts with the eschatological closure of Aži Dahāka (Ch. 13). The Iranian dragon is bound under Damāvand by Thraētaona, escapes at the end of time, and is killed for the second and final time by the revived Kərəsāspa at **Frashokereti** — a closure-narrative the Egyptian corpus lacks.^[48]

It contrasts also with the once-only cosmogonic victory of Marduk-Tiamat (Ch. 3). Marduk's victory establishes the cosmos for the first time and is not nightly re-enacted; Ra's victory preserves an already-established cosmos and must be re-enacted every sunrise. Per the brief, this contrast is load-bearing for the book's typology.^[49]

The personification of **isfet** in Apep is a principal Egyptian articulation of moral-political evil. Apep is not merely a natural-cosmic obstacle but morally adversarial — a hostile, malicious agent whose intent is to halt the sun, overturn order, and plunge the cosmos into the privation **isfet** names.^[50]

This adversarial character is reflected in the apotropaic register of the spell-corpus. The Apep-rebuffing spells command the serpent to fall, to be cut, to be turned aside, and invoke the magical-protective power of the gods against him — a register of moral-magical aggression rather than cosmological-explanatory description.^[51]

The deceased's role aligns structurally with Ra's. In the funerary corpus the deceased identifies with Ra in the nightly journey and rebuffs Apep alongside him, so the afterlife passage and the sun-god's nightly transit are the same combat — the afterlife as participation in the daily **maꜥat**-preservation.^[52]

The pharaoh's role aligns similarly. Pharaonic legitimacy as guarantor of **maꜥat** on earth is explicitly figured as participation in Ra's daily **maꜥat**-preservation in the cosmos, and the pharaoh's ritual-political function is theologised as the human-political analogue of the divine combat against Apep.^[53]

The frame **maꜥat/isfet** is therefore both ontological — how the cosmos is — and ethical-political — how human society and pharaonic rule must be. The Apep combat is the cosmological articulation of an integrated theological-ethical-political project rather than an isolated mythological narrative.^[54]

This integrated character gives the Egyptian material its distinctive position within the book's comparative typology: the Egyptian tradition supplies the most explicit theological articulation of

the cyclical-maintenance subtype's ethical-political dimension, and the chapter therefore opens with this conceptual frame rather than with the textual corpus.^[55]

17.2. Textual corpus — Pyramid Texts through Bremner-Rhind

The corpus spans two thousand years in six principal layers — Pyramid Texts (c. 2400 BCE), Coffin Texts (c. 2050–1650 BCE), Book of the Dead, Amduat, Book of Gates, Bremner-Rhind Papyrus (c. 310 BCE) — each adding to and reworking Apep without superseding earlier layers.^[56]

The Pyramid Texts are inscribed exclusively on the interior walls of late Old Kingdom royal pyramids at Saqqara, beginning with Unas (Fifth Dynasty, c. 2350 BCE). Distribution to non-royal contexts is a Middle Kingdom phenomenon tied to the Coffin Texts; the Apep allusions originate in a royal funerary context.^[57]

In the Pyramid Texts the serpent-adversary is not yet centralised under "Apep" with the consistency of later corpora. Serpent-adversaries appear under several names and morphologies, and Apep is one among a class of rebellious serpents commanded to fall back, to be cut, or to be turned aside.^[58]

The apotropaic spells — utterances 226, 232, 236, 298, 378, 385 among others — are short imperative formulas. They command the serpent to fall, to spit out his fangs, to retreat, or to be cut, and invoke the magical-protective power of named gods (Atum, Geb, Horus, Re-Atum) against him.^[59]

These spells presuppose, but do not narrate at length, the cosmographic frame within which the serpent-adversary acts. The deceased king's posthumous ascent to join Ra in the sky-barque is the wider liturgical context, and the rebuffing-spells are protective accompaniments to that ascent rather than free-standing combat-narratives.^[60]

The Coffin Texts extend the funerary spells beyond the royal context and inscribe them on the interior surfaces of wooden coffins of high-status non-royal burials. The Apep material is correspondingly extended and elaborated, with new spells (notably 757 and 885) developing the combat further.^[61]

The Coffin Texts give Apep a more centralised and consistent identity than the diffuse serpent-class of the Pyramid Texts. By the Middle Kingdom "Apep" carries the principal weight of the serpent-adversary tradition, and the cosmographic frame of the nightly combat is more articulated than in the Old Kingdom corpus.^[62]

The Book of the Dead is preserved principally on funerary papyri from non-royal burials and is the layer through which the Apep combat is most familiar to modern readers and Egyptological synthesis. Faulkner's 1972 (rev. 1985) translation is the standard English edition.^[63]

Spell 39 is, in Faulkner's translation, "of repelling the **rerek**-snake in the necropolis". It explicitly names the serpent-adversary, addresses him in apotropaic-imperative register, and identifies the deceased's protective magic with the magic that defends Ra against Apep.^[64]

In spell 39 the deceased addresses the serpent in the second person, commanding him to be cut,

turned aside, and made ineffective against the afterlife passage. The spell asserts a magical equivalence between the deceased's protective utterance and the utterances spoken in defence of Ra by his barque-crew nightly.^[65]

This identification is the principal mechanism by which the funerary corpus draws the deceased into the cosmological combat. The deceased is not merely petitioning Ra for protection but is theologised as participating in the combat Ra fights, the deceased's own utterance theologised as having combat-efficacy.^[66]

Spell 108 places Apep on the western horizon-mountain. The western horizon is the entry-point of the solar barque into the **Duat**, and Apep is localised at this entry-point as the cosmographic obstacle whose threat must be overcome at the threshold of the nocturnal journey.^[67]

The localisation in spell 108 supplies one of the principal cosmographic anchors of the Apep tradition: Apep's locus is at the threshold between the visible cosmos and the **Duat**, and this threshold-locus is a recurrent feature of the figure across the corpora.^[68]

Spell 7 is among the shorter apotropaic spells and belongs to a cluster that threads the Apep-rebuffing motif through the deceased's afterlife journey at multiple liturgical points: at the entry to the **Duat**, again during the transit, and again at the eastern horizon at the threshold of dawn.^[69]

This repetitive threading is itself a structural reflection of the cyclical-maintenance subtype. The combat is encountered repeatedly within a single nocturnal journey just as it is repeated nightly across cosmic time, and the spell-cluster recapitulates the repetitive structure of the wider tradition.^[70]

The Amduat (Egyptian **Imy-Duat**) is a principal New Kingdom royal funerary text, inscribed in the Valley of the Kings from the Eighteenth Dynasty (c. 1500 BCE). It narrates Ra's nightly journey through the twelve hours of the night in the **Duat** as a continuous twelve-section cosmographic narrative.^[71]

The twelve-hour structure is a liturgical-cosmographic conceit: each hour corresponds to a cosmographic region of the **Duat**, and the journey of Ra's barque through the twelve hours is the journey of the sun-god through the twelve regions, with named beings and named events characterising each hour.^[72]

Hour 7 is the canonical Apep-combat hour: it is here that Apep blocks the barque on the sandbanks of the **Duat**, and the combat is narrated as the central event of the nocturnal journey rather than a peripheral detail.^[73]

The combat is described in cosmographic-spatial terms. The barque encounters the sandbanks — a stretch of shallow water in which it can be grounded — and Apep coils across the channel to block its progress, the combat staged in the moment of encounter with the obstacle.^[74]

The dispatch is conducted by the gods of the barque-crew, who use knives and cutting magic to dismember the serpent's coils and clear the channel. It is collective rather than carried out by a single hero, and magical-cutting is the principal narrative beat.^[75]

The Amduat does not present this combat as the conclusive defeat of Apep. The dispatch enables the barque to continue, and the combat resumes the next night. The structure is recurrent rather

than terminal, and the Amduat projects no final hour of cosmic time after which the combat ceases.^[76]

The Book of Gates also narrates twelve nocturnal subdivisions, but is organised by gates between successive cosmographic regions rather than by hours within them.^[77]

The fourth gate contains the canonical Apep-combat scene within that corpus. Apep blocks the barque's passage at the gate-threshold, and the barque-crew dispatch him with knives, ropes, and binding-spells before the barque can continue.^[78]

The fourth-gate scene differs from the seventh-hour scene principally in cosmography: the Book of Gates locates Apep at the gate-threshold rather than at the sandbanks-channel, but the figure of the serpent and the dispatching-by-the-barque-crew remain consistent across the two corpora.^[79]

The Bremner-Rhind Papyrus (P. BM EA 10188) is a Ptolemaic hieratic papyrus of c. 310 BCE. Its second portion contains the *Book of Overthrowing Apep* — the daily liturgical text from the temple of Ra at Heliopolis and the chapter's principal witness to the ritual embedding of the combat.^[80]

The *Book of Overthrowing Apep* is structured as a liturgical manual: it contains spells, ritual prescriptions, and apotropaic instructions that accompany the daily priestly ritual at the temple of Ra, and it is the principal surviving witness to the priestly liturgy as practised in the Ptolemaic period.^[81]

The text gives explicit instructions for producing effigies of Apep — modelled in wax, written on papyrus, drawn on the ground — and ritually destroying them: cut with knives, spat upon, trampled, burned. The destruction of the effigy serves as the ritual enactment of the cosmological combat.^[82]

In te Velde's reading these rituals constitute a sustained ritual-magical attack on Apep. The priest's daily destruction of the wax or papyrus image is ritually equivalent to Ra's daily destruction of Apep in the **Duat**, and the temple liturgy is theologised as participation in the cosmological combat.^[83]

The *Book of Overthrowing Apep* is the latest in-scope primary source for the chapter. Dating from c. 310 BCE, it marks the late-Ptolemaic terminus of the two-thousand-year attestation arc; the chapter's primary-source horizon does not extend further into Hellenistic or Roman-period material.^[84]

Across the six layers Apep is morphologically stable: a great serpent, of vast size, of unspecified-but-monstrous coils, capable of spitting venom, of swallowing the barque, and of regenerating after each apparent dispatch.^[85]

This regenerative capacity grounds the cyclical-maintenance structure. The dispatch at hour 7 of the Amduat or gate 4 of the Book of Gates does not annihilate the serpent, who returns the next night — the regenerative capacity is the textual articulation of the recurrence-structure.^[86]

Apep is therefore typologically distinct from once-killed cosmogonic adversaries — Tiamat, killed once and dismembered into the cosmos in *Enūma Eliš* — and from once-bound-and-eschatologically-killed adversaries — Aži Dahāka, bound under Damāvand and killed for the second and final time at **Frashokereti**. He belongs to the unkillable-because-recurrent class.^[87]

The diachronic continuity of Apep across the six-layer corpus — from late Old Kingdom Pyramid Texts to Ptolemaic Bremner-Rhind — is among the most striking features of the tradition: one of the longest unbroken attestation arcs of any combat-myth figure in the book's catalogue.^[88]

(The six-layer corpus's morphological and theological stability across two thousand years reflects an unusually robust ritual-cultic continuity rather than the persistence of a literary-poetic motif.^[89])

The two-thousand-year textual arc is paralleled by a continuous iconographic record. The serpent-figure being knifed, cut, or trampled is attested on royal tomb walls (Eighteenth Dynasty onward), coffins (Middle Kingdom onward), funerary papyri, and temple reliefs (New Kingdom and later), with stable pictorial vocabulary across the corpus.^[90]

17.3. Ritual embedding — Bremner-Rhind and the daily temple liturgy

The third section treats the ritual embedding of the Apep combat in priestly practice. The Bremner-Rhind *Book of Overthrowing Apep* is the principal documentary witness, and the daily temple liturgy at Heliopolis is the liturgical context within which the cosmological combat was ritually re-enacted.^[91]

The temple of Ra at Heliopolis (Egyptian Iunu, Greek "city of the sun") was the leading solar-cult centre throughout pharaonic history. The city lay in the northern Nile delta near modern Cairo; the temple is poorly preserved archaeologically, but the textual evidence for its theological influence is extensive.^[92]

The Bremner-Rhind text is internally framed as the liturgical manual of the Heliopolis temple: its rubrics refer to the daily performance, to the priestly officiant, to the time of day at which particular rubrics are to be performed, and to the specific liturgical implements (wax, papyrus, fire, knives).^[93]

On te Velde's reading and on the philological evidence of the rubrics, the rite was performed daily — every day at the temple. Its regularity is a structural feature of the liturgy that mirrors the regularity of the cosmological combat it re-enacts.^[94]

The implements include wax effigies, papyrus images, ground-drawings in some rubrics, and knives, fire, and spit for destroying them. The implements vary; the logic does not — the effigy is identified with the cosmological serpent, and its destruction is the destruction of the cosmological serpent.^[95]

The destruction-rubrics prescribe a sequence of magical-aggressive actions: the effigy is bound with cords, cut with knives, trampled underfoot, spat upon, and finally burned. The sequence is structured to enact the multi-stage dispatch of the cosmological serpent that the Amduat and Book of Gates describe.^[96]

Spitting on the effigy is a particularly notable feature. The ritual gesture is one of the most consistent apotropaic elements of the rite, carrying a magical-aggressive significance distinct from cutting and burning while reinforcing their cumulative force.^[97]

Alongside the destruction-rubrics the text contains a substantial body of recitative spells: hymns

praising Ra's victory, narrative recitations of the combat, and apotropaic-imperative formulas commanding Apep to fall back, to be cut, to be turned aside. Spells and destruction-rubrics together constitute the full ritual apparatus.^[98]

The recitative spells include hymns that recite the moments at which Apep falls — structured as a recapitulation of the cosmological combat in priestly recitation.^[99]

The ritual-aetiological function is explicit on te Velde's reading. The daily ritual preserves **maꜥat** and prevents Apep's victory: the ritual is the combat made recurrent, theologised as continuous with the cosmological combat. Priestly recitation and effigy-destruction are theologised as combatant acts.^[100]

This reading is performative in the strong sense: the rite does not merely commemorate the combat but constitutes one moment of it, and the priestly officiant is theologised as a combatant alongside the gods of the barque rather than a mere observer.^[101]

The strong-performative reading is the principal Egyptian articulation of the cyclical-maintenance subtype's ritual-cultic dimension: the combat is re-enacted every day, the re-enactment is theologised as a moment of the combat, and the daily liturgy is the structural hinge between the ritual-cultic and cosmological dimensions.^[102]

In the funerary corpora — Book of the Dead especially — the afterlife journey is theologised as participation in the same daily combat the Heliopolis liturgy enacts. The deceased's protective magic, the rebuffing-spells of the papyri, and the apotropaic gestures of the funerary cult are funerary articulations of that combat.^[103]

The Apep combat is therefore ritually present in two distinct but co-ordinated cultic registers: the daily temple liturgy at Heliopolis (Bremner-Rhind) and the funerary cult of the deceased's afterlife passage (Book of the Dead spells 7, 39, 108). Both are theologised as participations in the same cosmological combat.^[104]

The brief identifies this ritual embedding as one of the principal features making the Apep tradition canonical for cyclical-maintenance. It is not merely that the combat recurs nightly in the cosmographic frame; the liturgy explicitly enacts the recurrence as a ritual programme, and this articulation is structurally distinctive.^[105]

This distinctiveness can be measured against the Hittite **purulli** festival, the only other comparably-explicit cyclical-maintenance ritual (Ch. 6). The **purulli** re-enacts the Illuyanka combat annually; the Bremner-Rhind liturgy re-enacts the Apep combat daily. Both are cyclical-maintenance programmes; the Egyptian runs on the more rapid cycle.^[106]

On the philological evidence of the rubrics, the Heliopolis officiants were a daily-rotated body of priests who performed the rite at prescribed hours. The rubrics specify the time of day for particular acts, and the temple's daily liturgy was therefore a sustained programme rather than an isolated rite.^[107]

The Heliopolis daily liturgy is therefore the principal Egyptian institutional form preserving the cyclical-maintenance combat. It is not a popular festival, an annual or seasonal observance, or a personal devotional practice — it is a sustained temple-priestly programme on the daily solar cycle.^[108]

On Assmann 2001's reading, this wager is theologically explicit in the Egyptian sources. The sun's rising is contingent on the ritual's success, the ritual's success on correct performance of the rubrics, and correct performance is the priesthood's principal cosmological obligation.^[109]

(The daily-liturgical performance of the Apep-overthrowing rite at Heliopolis was theologised as constitutive of the rising of the sun in a non-trivial sense — that is, the sun's rising was understood to depend on the correct performance of the rite, not merely to be commemorated or reflected by it.^[110])

The Bremner-Rhind text is therefore the principal documentary anchor for the ritual-cultic dimension of the Apep combat, and the daily Heliopolis liturgy it manuals is the principal institutional form within which the cyclical-maintenance subtype's ritual-aetiological articulation is preserved across two thousand years of Egyptian religious history.^[111]

17.4. Seth at the prow — the ambivalent Apep-slayer

The fourth section treats Seth's ambivalent role as Apep-slayer at the prow of the solar barque. te Velde 1967 chs. 3–4 are the principal scholarly anchor, and the section sets up the Ch. 17 edge-case treatment of the Horus-Seth contention.^[112]

Seth — Egyptian Setekh, alternative form Sutekh in Ramesside diplomatic contexts — is the god of storms, deserts, and disorder. He is a complex and ambivalent figure whose role varies across texts and centuries; this chapter and Ch. 17 together cover the principal divisions of his dossier.^[113]

Seth's principal positive role is Apep-slayer at the prow. In the record he stands at the prow of Ra's nocturnal barque, harpoon or spear in hand, and dispatches Apep before the serpent can halt the barque. te Velde 1967 ch. 4 is the principal scholarly synthesis.^[114]

The prow-position role is iconographically distinctive. From the New Kingdom onward, Egyptian funerary and temple imagery consistently shows Seth — recognisable by his **Seth-animal** head, a composite-creature head whose biological identification remains philologically debated — at the front of the barque with weapon raised, dispatching the coiling serpent.^[115]

In the texts that narrate Amduat hour 7 and Book of Gates gate 4, Seth is named among the barque-crew who dispatch Apep. The dispatch is collective, but Seth is the single most-named individual combatant in the texts that name combatants by name.^[116]

Seth's Apep-slayer role is theologically distinct from his role as Osiris's murderer. The two belong to different dossiers; the sources do not regularly attempt reconciliation. Seth is at once Apep-slayer at the prow and brother-murderer in the Osiris cycle, and the apparent contradiction stands without theological harmonisation.^[117]

This unharmonised character is one of the principal phenomena te Velde's monograph addresses. The title *Seth, God of Confusion* reflects the scholarly judgment that the Egyptian tradition's handling of Seth is itself characterised by deliberate ambivalence rather than clear positive or negative valuation.^[118]

The historical-political dimension is complex. In the Ramesside period (Nineteenth Dynasty, c. 1292–1186 BCE) Seth held a positive royal-cult position; in the Late Period and Ptolemaic period his valuation shifted toward the negative, with the Osiris-murderer dossier coming to dominate his

theological reception.^[119]

The Ramesside position is reflected in the diplomatic record. The Hittite-Egyptian treaty of Ramesses II (c. 1259 BCE) names Seth — in the Ramesside contact-context name **Sutekh** — as the Egyptian divine guarantor alongside the Hittite storm-god; the equivalence Sutekh = Tarḫunna is itself evidence of Seth's high-cult standing.^[120]

The Apep-slayer role is documented across both the Ramesside positive-cult period and the later periods of negative valuation. The prow-position dispatch is preserved in the Amduat, the Book of Gates, and continues into Late Period and Ptolemaic temple iconography even as Seth's wider valuation becomes more negative.^[121]

This continuity under shifting valuation is principal evidence for te Velde's reading of Seth as deliberately ambivalent rather than univocally evaluated. The same god is throughout both Apep-slayer (positive cosmological function) and Osiris-murderer (negative theological evaluation), with the two roles persisting in parallel.^[122]

The Apep-slayer role is, on te Velde's reading, theologically necessary. The combat requires a divine combatant whose force is structurally suited to dispatching the violent serpent-adversary; Seth's storm-and-desert violence is the qualification — his disorder is the storm-god disorder that can match the **isfet**-personification's onslaught.^[123]

This reading is theologically subtle: it implies that the dispatching of **isfet** requires a divine agent whose own character includes the violent and the disorderly, and that the cosmological-combat's structural logic recognises a positive cosmological function for divine violence that is itself morally ambivalent.^[124]

*(The Egyptian theological tradition's recognition of a positive cosmological function for Seth's ambivalent violence is one of the principal points at which the **maꜥat/isfet** framework reveals its conceptual sophistication: the framework distinguishes between **isfet** as moral-political evil (Apep) and the violence-of-the-storm-god as cosmologically-functional even where it carries moral ambivalence (Seth).^[125]*

Mehen — a serpent-coil deity who encircles and protects Ra — is, with Seth, one of the principal attendants in the prow-and-cabin scenes. Seth stands at the prow with weapon raised; Mehen coils around Ra in the cabin. Together they form the barque's principal protective apparatus against Apep.^[126]

Mehen is iconographically a serpent — a serpent-bodied deity whose form is paradoxically continuous with Apep's morphology, the very serpent Mehen and the barque-crew defend Ra against. The Egyptian tradition deploys serpent-imagery on both sides of the cosmological combat, and the serpent-form is therefore not univocally aligned with **isfet**.^[127]

This non-univocal alignment of serpent-imagery is a further subtlety the Apep material contributes to the book's typology. Serpents are not categorically aligned with **isfet**; the combat is not a war between non-serpentine order and serpentine disorder but between specific serpent-figures occupying different positions in the **maꜥat/isfet** economy.^[128]

Isis — the magic-working goddess, well known from the Osiris cycle as wife-of-Osiris and mother-of-Horus — also appears in the Apep material as a magical combatant. In several spells she is

named binder-of-Apep, who binds the serpent with magical formulas and reduces him to immobility for the dispatch.^[129]

Isis's binder-of-Apep role is magical-aggressive, distinct from her better-known maternal-protective and resurrection-magical roles in the Osiris cycle. The register the Apep-binding spells call for is consistent with her wider reputation as the goddess "great of magic", but is aligned with the cosmological-combat dossier rather than the Osiris dossier.^[130]

The collaborative cast — Seth at the prow, Mehen in the cabin, Isis with bindings, the wider barque-crew — gives Apep a richer ensemble than several comparands. Marduk fights Tiamat principally alone (Ch. 3); Indra fights Vātra principally alone (Ch. 14); Apep is fought by a divine collective.^[131]

This collective structure is a further feature that fits the cyclical-maintenance subtype. The combat is not the singular triumph of a sovereignty-establishing or cosmogonic champion but the daily collaborative work of a divine ensemble — order-preservation, unlike order-establishment, requires ongoing collaboration among many.^[132]

The forward-link to Ch. 17 (Horus vs. Seth) follows directly from the Seth material. The Horus-Seth contention is where Seth's negative dossier reaches its principal articulation, and Ch. 17 treats it as the chaoskampf-adjacent edge-case alongside which the present chapter's positive Seth dossier must be read.^[133]

The Horus-Seth contention — *Chester Beatty I* (c. 1160 BCE), in English *The Contendings of Horus and Seth* — is the principal narrative locus in which Seth's negative valuation becomes a sustained narrative of contestation. Ch. 17 treats it in detail; the present chapter only notes the forward-link.^[134]

The structural relation is therefore that the present chapter treats Seth's positive dossier (Apep-slayer at the prow) as a principal cyclical-maintenance combat-figure, while Ch. 17 treats his negative dossier (Osiris-murderer in the Contendings) as the principal chaoskampf-adjacent edge-case in which the chaoskampf framing fits less cleanly.^[135]

The treatment of Seth at the prow concludes the chapter's substantive Apep material and bridges to Ch. 17. Seth links the cyclical-maintenance combat (positive dossier) to the chaoskampf-adjacent edge-case (negative dossier); the chapter closes with the Seth material to honour this linkage.^[136]

17.5. Reception and forward links

The Apep tradition's reception is more elusive than the Mesopotamian or Levantine ones. Egyptian iconography diffuses widely in Hellenistic and Roman periods, but the specific Apep material is not as routinely traceable in Hellenistic-Christian reception as the Marduk material (Hebrew Bible to Revelation) or the Baal material (Hebrew Bible).^[137]

The Greek form **Apophis** appears in Hellenistic and Roman-period Egyptian-influenced material, but the chapter uses **Apep** in body prose per the locked glossary, with **Apophis** flagged at first mention as the Greek reception-form.^[138]

The Hebrew Bible's name **Rahab** for Egypt — Isaiah 30:7 ("Rahab who sits still" / "Rahab the do-nothing") — is where Egyptian-serpent-of-chaos imagery may map onto the Hebrew imagination of

Egypt-the-political-adversary. The parallel is typological; evidence for direct borrowing is weaker than for the Ugaritic-Hebrew interface.^[139]

The chapter follows the brief's instruction on the Egyptian-Hebrew interface: the Rahab-as-Egypt parallel is presented as typological — Egypt-the-serpent-of-chaos as imaginative substrate for Egypt-the-political-adversary in the Hebrew prophetic register — and not as evidence of direct textual borrowing of the Apep tradition into the Hebrew Bible.^[140]

The primary forward-link is to Ch. 17, which treats Seth's negative dossier — the Osiris-murderer narrative and *The Contendings of Horus and Seth* — as the chaoskampf-adjacent edge-case in which the framing fits less cleanly. The closing treatment of Seth at the prow sets up the contrast.^[141]

The forward-link to Part II C3 (Combat as Cyclical Maintenance) is the most substantial. With Ch. 6 (Illuyanka), the present chapter supplies Part II C3 with its two principal cases; the articulation here at the levels of cosmological frame, textual corpus, ritual embedding, and ambivalent combatant is the more substantial.^[142]

The forward-link to Part II C4 (Eschatological Displacement) is by negation: Apep is the principal case of a combat-myth without eschatological closure, and its contrast with the closed combats of Revelation 12 (Ch. 9), **Frashokereti** (Ch. 13's pendant), and Ragnarök (Ch. 18) is structurally informative for Part II C4.^[143]

The forward-link to Part II C8 (The Refusal and the Appropriation Problem) is via the Ballentine 2015 critique. The **maꜥat/ṯfet** framework offers a non-chaos counter-model — the adversary is **ṯfet**, a moral-political category, not "chaos" — and Part II C8 develops the implications for the wider chaoskampf typology.^[144]

The chapter sets up four substantive forward-links — Ch. 17 (Horus vs. Seth) edge-case, Part II C3 synthesis, Part II C4 by-negation comparand, Part II C8 Ballentine counter-model — that together situate the Apep material among the most theoretically productive case-studies in the book's comparative project.^[145]

[1] Per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml; Assmann 2001, *The Search for God in Ancient Egypt*, on the daily-combat structure of the Egyptian solar theology; te Velde 1967, *Seth, God of Confusion*, chs. 3–4, on Apep as Ra's nightly adversary.

[2] Per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the composite-editorial classification; te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the distribution of the Apep material across the Egyptian textual corpora; Assmann 2001 on the long attestation arc of the solar combat.

[3] Per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the composite-editorial classification and the by-corpus structure; te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the same by-corpus organisation; Assmann 2001, on the diachronic stratification of the Egyptian funerary-and-solar corpora.

[4] te Velde 1967, *Seth, God of Confusion*, chs. 3–4, on Seth as Apep-slayer and Apep as Ra's adversary; per chaoskampf sources.yaml on te-velde-1967 as the principal Apep-and-Seth anchor.

[5] te Velde 1967 (printed only; cited at chapter-section level per brief); per the discipline established in prior CORE chapters of the present book.

[6] Assmann 2001, *The Search for God in Ancient Egypt*, on the **maꜥat/ṯfet** opposition as the cosmological-ethical framework for Egyptian solar theology; per chaoskampf sources.yaml on assmann-2001-search as the **maꜥat/ṯfet** anchor.

[7] Assmann 2001 (printed only; cited at chapter-section level per brief).

[8] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), *The Ancient Egyptian Book of the Dead*, on spells 7, 39, and 108 as the principal Apep-rebuffing spells; per chaoskampf sources.yaml on faulkner-1972-bod as the standard English Book of the Dead anchor.

[9] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985) (printed only; cited at spell-number level per brief).

[10] Faulkner 1969, *The Ancient Egyptian Pyramid Texts*, introduction on the late Old Kingdom royal-pyramid attestation of the corpus; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Pyramid Texts as the earliest attested layer of the Apep material.

[11] Faulkner 1969 edition of the Pyramid Texts, cited at utterance-number level per brief; per the citation-discipline established in prior CORE chapters of the present book.

- [12] Faulkner 1969 edition of the Pyramid Texts, on utterances 226, 232, 236, 298, 378, and 385 as the principal apotropaic / serpent-rebuffing utterances; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Pyramid Texts apotropaic stratum as the earliest layer of the Apep material.
- [13] Faulkner 1973–78, *The Ancient Egyptian Coffin Texts*, on Coffin Texts spells 757 and 885 in the Apep cycle; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Coffin Texts development of the Apep material.
- [14] Faulkner 1973–78 edition of the Coffin Texts, cited at spell-number level per brief.
- [15] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), introduction on the Book of the Dead as the New-Kingdom-and-later funerary corpus; on spells 7, 39, and 108 as the principal Apep-rebuffing spells.
- [16] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on Book of the Dead spell 39 ("of repelling the **rerek**-snake in the necropolis") as the most explicit Apep-rebuffing spell of the corpus.
- [17] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on Book of the Dead spell 108 and the western-horizon-mountain localisation of Apep.
- [18] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on Book of the Dead spell 7 as a short apotropaic Apep-rebuffing spell within the corpus.
- [19] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Amduat as the Eighteenth-Dynasty-onward royal funerary text and on hour 7 as the canonical Apep-combat hour; Assmann 2001, on the Amduat and the twelve-hour nocturnal structure.
- [20] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the seventh-hour combat in the Amduat (Apep on the sandbanks of the Duat); Assmann 2001, on the cosmographic structure of the Amduat's seventh hour.
- [21] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Book of Gates as the New-Kingdom royal funerary text and on gate 4 as the Apep-combat scene; Assmann 2001 on the Book of Gates and the twelve-gate nocturnal structure.
- [22] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Bremner-Rhind Papyrus (British Museum EA 10188) and the *Book of Overthrowing Apep* as the daily liturgical text from the temple of Ra at Heliopolis; Faulkner's editions in JEA 22–24 (1936–38) on the philological reconstruction of the papyrus.
- [23] Faulkner's editions of the Bremner-Rhind Papyrus in JEA 22 (1936) and JEA 23–24 (1937–38), as referenced in te Velde 1967, ch. 3, and in the per-brief lacuna note.
- [24] Per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the fragmentary preservation of the Bremner-Rhind Papyrus and on Faulkner's JEA editions; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same.
- [25] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the pervasive iconographic record of the Apep combat across funerary and temple media from the New Kingdom through the Greco-Roman period.
- [26] Forsyth 1987, *The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth*, ch. 2, on the Egyptian combat-imagery in the long-trajectory comparative perspective.
- [27] Gunkel 1895, *Schöpfung und Chaos*, Teil I, on the Near-Eastern cyclical-cosmos background as Gunkel's 1895 framework presented it.
- [28] Scurlock and Beal 2013, *Creation and Chaos*, on the contemporary critical reassessment of the Egyptian material against the Gunkel-thesis frame.
- [29] Per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the cyclical-maintenance subtype as the chapter's typological frame; Assmann 2001, on the daily-recurrence structure of the combat as never-won-for-all; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the absence of eschatological closure in the Egyptian Apep corpus.
- [30] Per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml special_instructions on the cyclical-maintenance subtype as constitutive; Assmann 2001 on the daily recurrence as the structural feature of the Egyptian solar theology; per chaoskampf scope.md §"Subject definition" on the cyclical-maintenance subtype.
- [31] An alternate procedure would treat the Book of the Dead alone as canonical (Faulkner 1972, spells 7, 39, and 108). The composite-editorial multi-corpus presentation is chosen here because the corpus is too dispersed across two thousand years to be reduced to a single primary witness, and te Velde 1967 plus Assmann 2001 provide the multi-corpus synthesis on which the chapter rests.
- [32] Assmann 2001, *The Search for God in Ancient Egypt*, on the **maꜥat/ṯfṯt** opposition as the central cosmological-ethical category-pair of Egyptian religion; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on **maꜥat** and **ṯfṯt** as the locked terms.
- [33] Assmann 2001, on **maꜥat** as the integrated truth-order-justice category; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the locked rendering of **maꜥat** with the **ꜥayin**.
- [34] Assmann 2001, on **ṯfṯt** as the integrated disorder-injustice-falsehood category; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the locked rendering of **ṯfṯt**.
- [35] Assmann 2001, on the asymmetric structure of the **maꜥat/ṯfṯt** opposition; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same asymmetry as it underlies the Apep combat.
- [36] Per chaoskampf scope.md on the Ballentine critique and on **ṯfṯt** as the appropriate category-term for Apep; Ballentine 2015, *The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition*, on the inadequacy of "chaos" as a category-term for the combat-myth adversaries; Assmann 2001 on **ṯfṯt** as a moral-political rather than metaphysically-inchoate category.
- [37] Assmann 2001, on the personified goddess Maꜥat as the daughter of Ra and the patron of truth-order-justice; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the capitalisation discipline distinguishing the personified Maꜥat from the abstract **maꜥat**.
- [38] Assmann 2001, on the pharaonic offering of **maꜥat** to the gods as the central liturgical act of Egyptian kingship; on the

inseparability of the cosmological and political-religious dimensions of **maꜣat**.

- [39] Assmann 2001, on Apep as **isfet**-personification rather than as cosmogonic-primordial figure; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same; Ballentine 2015, on the same point as a critique of the "chaos" category-term.
- [40] Assmann 2001, on the cyclical-maintenance structure of the Egyptian solar theology; per [chaoskampf scope.md](#) §"Subject definition" on the cosmogonic-vs-cyclical-maintenance distinction; Lambert 2013 on Tiamat as cosmogonic adversary, by contrast.
- [41] Assmann 2001, on the already-in-place character of the Egyptian cosmos and on Ra's daily journey as maintenance rather than fabrication; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same.
- [42] Assmann 2001, on the day-barque and night-barque structure of Ra's daily journey; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same and on the location of the Apep combat in the nocturnal half.
- [43] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Duat as the nocturnal region of Ra's transit and on Apep as the principal dangerous being there; Assmann 2001 on the cosmographic structure of the Duat; per [chaoskampf glossary.yaml](#) on the locked rendering of **Duat**.
- [44] Assmann 2001, on the contingency of sunrise upon Ra's nightly victory and on the daily combat as the ongoing condition for the visible cosmos; per [brief 16-ra-apep.yaml](#) on the cosmological function of the combat.
- [45] Assmann 2001, on the constitutive character of the daily-combat collaboration between gods, liturgy, and magic; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same constitutive character.
- [46] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the absence of eschatological closure in the Egyptian Apep corpus; Assmann 2001 on the continuous-combat structure; per [brief 16-ra-apep.yaml](#) on the eschatological function as deliberately absent in the cyclical-maintenance subtype.
- [47] Inference: te Velde 1967 ch. 3 reads the recurrence as the constitutive structure rather than as a placeholder pending a closure scenario; Assmann 2001 reads the daily recurrence as constitutive; and the Pyramid-Texts-to-Bremner-Rhind two-thousand-year arc consistently presents the combat as recurrent without any narrative gesture toward closure. Risk: the inference is structural-typological rather than directly attested as a stated theological doctrine; the surviving Egyptian corpus is large but not exhaustive, and the inference is in principle subject to revision should a future textual discovery present an eschatological closure scenario for Apep.
- [48] Per [brief 16-ra-apep.yaml](#) on the contrast between cyclical-maintenance (Egypt) and eschatological-closure (Iran); Watkins 1995 Part V chs. 44–48 on the Iranian closure-narrative; cross-ref Ch. 13.
- [49] Per [brief 16-ra-apep.yaml](#) on the contrast between cyclical-maintenance (Egypt) and once-only cosmogonic victory (Mesopotamia); Lambert 2013 on the Marduk-Tiamat material as once-only cosmogonic; cross-ref Ch. 3.
- [50] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on Apep as morally-adversarial agent rather than natural-cosmic obstacle; Assmann 2001, on the moral-political dimension of **isfet**-personification.
- [51] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on the apotropaic-imperative register of Book of the Dead spells 7, 39, 108; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the magical-aggression register of the Apep spells more generally.
- [52] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on the deceased's identification with Ra in the funerary corpus; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same identification.
- [53] Assmann 2001, on the pharaoh as guarantor of **maꜣat** in alignment with Ra's daily combat against **isfet**; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same alignment.
- [54] Assmann 2001, on the integrated character of the **maꜣat/isfet** framework as ontological-ethical-political; per [chaoskampf scope.md](#) §"Appropriation protocol" on opening with the tradition's own framing.
- [55] Per [brief 16-ra-apep.yaml](#) [special_instructions](#) on opening with the cosmological frame; per [chaoskampf scope.md](#) §"Appropriation protocol" on opening with the tradition's own framing; Assmann 2001 on the ethical-political dimension of **maꜣat** /**isfet**.
- [56] Per [brief 16-ra-apep.yaml](#) on the six principal layers of the corpus; te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the six-layer stratification; Assmann 2001 on the diachronic stratification of the funerary-and-solar corpora.
- [57] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the royal-funerary context of the Pyramid Texts and the Apep allusions therein; Faulkner 1969 introduction on the Saqqara royal-pyramid attestation of the corpus.
- [58] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the diffuse serpent-adversary class in the Pyramid Texts and the gradual centralisation of the figure under the name "Apep" in the later corpora.
- [59] Faulkner 1969 edition of the Pyramid Texts, on utterances 226, 232, 236, 298, 378, 385 as the principal apotropaic / serpent-rebuffing utterances; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the imperative-formulaic register of these utterances.
- [60] Faulkner 1969 introduction on the deceased-king's-ascent context of the Pyramid Texts; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the protective-accompaniment function of the apotropaic spells within that context.
- [61] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Coffin Texts extension of the funerary corpus to non-royal contexts and on the Apep material elaboration; Faulkner 1973–78 introduction on the Coffin Texts corpus.
- [62] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the centralisation of the figure of Apep in the Coffin Texts and on the more articulated cosmographic frame of the Middle Kingdom material.
- [63] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), introduction on the New-Kingdom-onward Book-of-the-Dead corpus and its papyrus attestation; te

Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Book of the Dead as the most-readable layer of the Apep tradition.

[64] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on Book of the Dead spell 39 ("of repelling the **rerek**-snake in the necropolis") as the most explicit Apep-rebuffing spell in the corpus.

[65] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on the second-person imperative register of Book of the Dead spell 39 and on the magical-equivalence assertion within it.

[66] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on the deceased's-participation theology of Book of the Dead spell 39; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same theology in the Book of the Dead corpus more broadly.

[67] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on Book of the Dead spell 108 and the western-horizon-mountain localisation of Apep; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the cosmographic structure of the localisation.

[68] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on the threshold-locus of Apep in Book of the Dead spell 108; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the threshold-locus as a recurrent feature of the figure across the corpora.

[69] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on Book of the Dead spell 7 as part of the cluster of short apotropaic Apep-rebuffing spells; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the multi-point threading of the Apep-rebuffing motif through the deceased's journey.

[70] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the recapitulative structure of the Book-of-the-Dead Apep-rebuffing cluster; Assmann 2001 on the repetitive-liturgical structure of Egyptian solar theology.

[71] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Amduat as the New Kingdom royal funerary text and on its twelve-hour structure; Assmann 2001 on the Amduat and the twelve-hour nocturnal cosmography.

[72] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the liturgical-cosmographic structure of the Amduat's twelve hours; Assmann 2001 on the same structure.

[73] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the seventh hour of the Amduat as the canonical Apep-combat hour; Assmann 2001 on the centrality of the seventh-hour combat within the Amduat narrative structure.

[74] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the cosmographic-spatial description of the seventh-hour combat (sandbanks; coiling across the channel); Assmann 2001 on the same.

[75] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the collective dispatch of Apep by the barque-crew with knives and cutting magic; Assmann 2001 on the magical-cutting register of the Amduat seventh-hour combat.

[76] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the recurrent-rather-than-terminal structure of the Amduat seventh-hour combat; Assmann 2001 on the daily-recurrence structure of the Egyptian solar theology more broadly.

[77] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Book of Gates as the New-Kingdom royal funerary text and its twelve-gate structure; Assmann 2001 on the gate-structuring of the Book of Gates.

[78] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the fourth gate of the Book of Gates as the Apep-combat scene; Assmann 2001 on the same.

[79] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the threshold-cosmography of the Book of Gates fourth gate by contrast with the sandbanks-channel of the Amduat seventh hour; Assmann 2001 on the consistency of the figure of Apep across the two corpora.

[80] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Bremner-Rhind Papyrus and the *Book of Overthrowing Apep*; per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the dating and provenance of the papyrus.

[81] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Bremner-Rhind text as a liturgical manual for the daily priestly Apep-overthrowing rite; Faulkner's JEA editions on the philological structure of the manual.

[82] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Bremner-Rhind effigy-destruction instructions; Faulkner's JEA editions on the philological detail of the rubrics.

[83] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the ritual-magical equivalence between effigy-destruction and the cosmological Apep-combat; Assmann 2001 on the ritual-magical-cosmological theology of the Egyptian temple liturgy.

[84] Per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml and per chaoskampf scope.md §"Period" on the Bremner-Rhind Papyrus as the latest in-scope primary source for the chapter; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the dating.

[85] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the morphological stability of the figure of Apep across the six layers of the corpus; Assmann 2001 on the same stability.

[86] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on Apep's regenerative capacity as the textual articulation of the recurrence-structure; Assmann 2001 on the recurrence-structure of the Egyptian solar theology.

[87] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on Apep as unkillable-because-recurrent; Assmann 2001 on the cyclical-maintenance structure; Lambert 2013 on Tiamat as once-killed cosmogonic adversary; Watkins 1995 Part V chs. 44–48 on Aži Dahāka as eschatologically-killed; cross-refs Ch. 3 and Ch. 13.

[88] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the two-thousand-year unbroken attestation arc of the Apep figure; per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the centrality-evidence of the long attestation.

[89] Inference: the corpora are predominantly funerary or temple-liturgical — Pyramid Texts, Coffin Texts, and Book of the Dead are funerary; Amduat and Book of Gates are royal-funerary; Bremner-Rhind is daily temple-liturgical — so the persistence reflects continuous ritual performance contexts; te Velde 1967 ch. 3 reads the textual continuity as ritual-cultic continuity rather than as literary-tradition continuity; and Assmann 2001 reads the Egyptian funerary-and-temple corpora as ritual-textual rather than purely literary. Risk: the inference is structural-historical rather than directly attested as a stated theological doctrine; alternative

readings (e.g. "literary archaism preserves the figure across changing ritual contexts") remain available, though they are less natural fits for the funerary-and-temple corpus that the chapter treats.

[90] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the continuous iconographic record of Apep-combat imagery across funerary and temple media.

[91] Per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml special_instructions on the ritual embedding as the third structural section of the chapter; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Bremner-Rhind text and the Heliopolis temple liturgy.

[92] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on Heliopolis as the principal cult-centre of Ra and the locus of the daily Apep-overthrowing liturgy; Assmann 2001 on Heliopolis as the leading solar-theological centre.

[93] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the internal framing of the Bremner-Rhind text as a liturgical manual; Faulkner's JEA editions (1936–38) on the rubrics' philological structure.

[94] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the daily-performance frequency of the Apep-overthrowing rite; per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the daily ritual as the cyclical-maintenance liturgical anchor.

[95] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the ritual implements of the Bremner-Rhind text and on the ritual-logical identification between effigy and cosmological serpent.

[96] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the multi-stage destruction-sequence of the Bremner-Rhind rubrics; Assmann 2001 on the ritual-cosmological structural correspondence.

[97] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the spitting-upon as a distinctive feature of the Bremner-Rhind apotropaic rite; Assmann 2001 on apotropaic ritual gestures more broadly.

[98] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the spell-corpus of the Bremner-Rhind text alongside the destruction-rubrics; Faulkner's JEA editions on the philological detail of the recitative material.

[99] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the recitative hymns of the Bremner-Rhind corpus that recapitulate the cosmological combat; Faulkner's JEA editions on the philological structure of these hymns.

[100] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the ritual-aetiological function of the Bremner-Rhind liturgy as preserving **maꜣat** and preventing Apep's victory; per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the ritual-aetiological function.

[101] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the strong-performative reading of the Bremner-Rhind liturgy and on the priestly officiant as combatant; Assmann 2001 on the strong-performative theology of the Egyptian temple liturgy more broadly.

[102] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the strong-performative reading as the Egyptian articulation of the cyclical-maintenance subtype's ritual dimension; Assmann 2001 on the ritual-cosmological hinge.

[103] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on the deceased's funerary-cult participation in the daily-combat structure; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same participation; Assmann 2001 on the integrated funerary-and-temple cultic structure.

[104] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on the funerary-cult register; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the temple-liturgy register; Assmann 2001 on the integration of the two registers within the Egyptian solar theology.

[105] Per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the ritual embedding as a centrality-evidence kind for the cyclical-maintenance subtype; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the structural distinctiveness of the explicit ritual articulation; Assmann 2001 on the same.

[106] Per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the Hittite **purulli** parallel; Beckman 1982 on the **purulli** festival; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Egyptian daily liturgy by contrast; cross-ref Ch. 6.

[107] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the priestly-rotation structure of the Heliopolis daily liturgy; Faulkner's JEA editions on the philological detail of the time-prescription rubrics.

[108] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the temple-priestly institutional form of the Heliopolis daily liturgy; Assmann 2001 on the same.

[109] Assmann 2001, on the explicit theological character of the priestly cosmological obligation in the Egyptian sources; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same.

[110] Inference: the strong-performative reading of the Bremner-Rhind rubrics in te Velde 1967 ch. 3, in which the priestly officiant is theologised as a combatant rather than as an observer; Assmann 2001's strong-performative reading of the Egyptian temple liturgy more broadly; the rubrics' specification of daily-time-of-day performance and the cosmographic correspondence between liturgical sequence and solar-journey sequence. Risk: the inference is theological-interpretive rather than directly attested in a prescriptive theological treatise; alternative readings (in which the rite is commemorative-symbolic rather than constitutive-performative) remain in principle available, though they are less natural fits for the priestly-cosmological-obligation theology that the chapter draws on Assmann 2001's reading to articulate.

[111] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the Bremner-Rhind text as the principal documentary anchor and on the daily Heliopolis liturgy as the principal institutional form; Assmann 2001 on the same; per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the ritual-embedding section.

[112] Per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml special_instructions on Seth's ambivalent role as the fourth structural section; te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on Seth as Apep-slayer; cross-ref Ch. 17 (Horus-Seth).

[113] te Velde 1967, *Seth, God of Confusion*, on Seth as the god of storms, deserts, and disorder and on the complexity-and-ambivalence of his mythological dossier; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the locked rendering "Seth" with "Sutekh" reserved for Hittite-treaty contexts.

[114] te Velde 1967, ch. 4, on Seth as Apep-slayer at the prow of the solar barque; on the iconographic and textual record of the prow-position dispatch.

- [115] te Velde 1967, ch. 4, on the iconographic distinctiveness of the prow-position Seth and on the **Seth-animal** head as the iconographic identifier; on the philological debate about the biological identification of the **Seth-animal**.
- [116] te Velde 1967, ch. 4, on Seth as the single most-named individual combatant against Apep in the Amduat seventh-hour and Book of Gates fourth-gate texts; on the collective character of the dispatch.
- [117] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the theological distinction between Seth's positive Apep-slayer role and his negative Osiris-murderer role; on the Egyptian sources' allowance of the apparent contradiction without harmonisation.
- [118] te Velde 1967, *Seth, God of Confusion*, title and introduction on the deliberate ambivalence of the Egyptian tradition's handling of Seth; chs. 3–4 on the unharmonised character of the two dossiers.
- [119] te Velde 1967, on the Ramesside positive-cult position of Seth and the late-period shift to predominantly-negative valuation; on the historical-political dimension of the ambivalence.
- [120] te Velde 1967, on the Ramesses II / Hittite treaty and on the diplomatic equivalence Sutekh / Tarūnna; per `chaoskampf glossary.yaml` on the rendering "Sutekh" reserved for Ramesside diplomatic contexts.
- [121] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the diachronic continuity of the Apep-slayer role across the Ramesside positive-cult period and the later periods of negative valuation.
- [122] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the diachronic continuity-of-both-roles as evidence for the deliberate-ambivalence reading.
- [123] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the theological necessity of Seth's storm-and-desert violence for the Apep-slayer role; on the structural fit between Seth's morphology and Apep's onslaught.
- [124] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the theologically-subtle implication of Seth's structural fit; on the recognition of a positive cosmological function for ambivalent divine violence.
- [125] Inference: te Velde 1967 chs. 3–4 on the theological subtlety of Seth's role; Assmann 2001 on the **maꜣat/isfet** framework's conceptual sophistication; the Egyptian sources' allowance of the unharmonised two-dossier structure for Seth as evidence of the framework's tolerance of moral ambivalence within cosmological function. Risk: the inference is interpretive-theological rather than directly attested as a stated theological doctrine; alternative readings (in which Seth's two roles reflect different historical-political evaluations rather than a deliberate theological subtlety) remain available, though they are less natural fits for the diachronic continuity of both roles in parallel that te Velde 1967 documents.
- [126] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on Mehen as the serpent-coil protector of Ra in the solar barque; on the prow-and-cabin protective apparatus formed by Seth and Mehen together; per `chaoskampf glossary.yaml` on the locked rendering "Mehen".
- [127] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on Mehen's serpent-form as paradoxically continuous with Apep's morphology; on the Egyptian deployment of serpent-imagery on both sides of the combat.
- [128] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the non-univocal alignment of serpent-imagery; per `chaoskampf scope.md` on the diversity of adversary morphologies across traditions; per `glossary.yaml` on the "adversary" category-term as morphologically neutral.
- [129] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on Isis as the binder-of-Apep with magical spells; per `chaoskampf glossary.yaml` on the locked rendering "Isis"; Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on Isis-named binding spells in the Book of the Dead corpus.
- [130] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the distinction between Isis's Apep-binding role (cosmological-combat dossier) and her Osiris-cycle roles; on Isis's wider reputation as the goddess "great of magic".
- [131] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the collective-divine-combatant character of the Apep dispatch; Lambert 2013 on Marduk's solo combat against Tiamat (cross-ref Ch. 3); Jamison and Brereton 2014 on Indra's solo combat against Vṛtra (cross-ref Ch. 14).
- [132] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the collaborative-ensemble structure of the Apep dispatch; Assmann 2001 on the collaborative theology of Egyptian solar religion; per `brief 16-ra-apep.yaml` on the cyclical-maintenance subtype's structural features.
- [133] Per `brief 16-ra-apep.yaml` special_instructions on the forward-link to Ch. 17; te Velde 1967, on the two Seth dossiers as the principal subject of his monograph; cross-ref Ch. 17.
- [134] te Velde 1967, on *The Contendings of Horus and Seth* (Chester Beatty I, c. 1160 BCE) as the principal narrative locus of the Horus-Seth contention; per `chaoskampf glossary.yaml` on the locked rendering of the title; cross-ref Ch. 17.
- [135] Per `brief 16-ra-apep.yaml` on the structural relation; per `chaoskampf scope.md` §"In-scope catalog" on Horus-Seth as the debated adjacent case; te Velde 1967 on the two-dossier structure that grounds the chapter-division.
- [136] Per `brief 16-ra-apep.yaml` special_instructions on the closing-section structure; te Velde 1967 chs. 3–4 (positive dossier) and ch. 5+ (negative dossier; cross-ref Ch. 17).
- [137] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the comparative elusiveness of the Egyptian Apep reception by contrast with the Mesopotamian and Levantine combat-myth receptions.
- [138] Per `chaoskampf glossary.yaml` on the locked rendering "Apep" in body prose with "Apophis" as the Greek reception-form; te Velde 1967, on the Greek form of the name in Hellenistic and later sources.
- [139] Day 1985, on Rahab as a name for Egypt at Isaiah 30:7 and on the typological-rather-than-borrowing character of the parallel; per `brief 16-ra-apep.yaml` on the do-not-overclaim instruction for the Egyptian-Hebrew interface.
- [140] Per `brief 16-ra-apep.yaml` special_instructions on the do-not-overclaim discipline for the Egyptian-Hebrew transmission; Day 1985 on the typological character of the parallel.
- [141] Per `brief 16-ra-apep.yaml` on the forward-link to Ch. 17; per `chaoskampf scope.md` §"In-scope catalog" on Ch. 17 as the Horus-

Seth edge-case; te Velde 1967 on the two-dossier structure of Seth.

[142] Per chaoskampf scope.md §"Part II — thematic comparative chapters" on Part II C3 (Combat as Cyclical Maintenance); per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the cyclical-maintenance subtype centrality; cross-ref Ch. 6 (Illuyanka).

[143] Per chaoskampf scope.md §"Part II — thematic comparative chapters" on Part II C4 (Eschatological Displacement); per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the absence of eschatological closure in the Egyptian corpus; cross-refs Chs. 9, 13, 18.

[144] Per chaoskampf scope.md §"Part II — thematic comparative chapters" on Part II C8; per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the Ballentine 2015 counter-model interface; Ballentine 2015 on the chaos-category critique; Assmann 2001 on the **maꜥat/isfet** framework.

[145] Per chaoskampf scope.md on the Part II structure; per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the comparative-hooks; te Velde 1967 chs. 3–4; Assmann 2001 chs. on solar theology; Ballentine 2015.

Chapter 18. Horus vs. Seth (An Edge Case)

The contention between Horus, falcon-headed son of Osiris and Isis, and Seth, Egyptian god of storms and deserts and brother-murderer of Osiris, is the principal locus in the Egyptian textual record for what te Velde 1967 chapters 1–2 treat as Seth’s negative dossier within his two-dossier ambivalence: a contest over the kingship of Egypt between two gods after Osiris’s death.^[1]

The chapter’s principal scholarly anchor is Herman te Velde’s *Seth, God of Confusion: A Study of His Role in Egyptian Mythology and Religion*, originally published in 1967 by Brill in Leiden as *Probleme der Ägyptologie* 6, with a second edition in 1977. te Velde’s chapters 1 and 2 treat the Horus-Seth contention and Seth’s two-dossier ambivalence at length and constitute the standard scholarly synthesis of the material.^[2]

The monograph is printed-only; the chapter cites it at chapter-section level (chs. 1–2 for the Horus-Seth and Seth-ambivalence material) per the established discipline for printed comparative anchors in this book and per the Ch. 15 completion-record note on the same.^[3]

The chapter’s secondary conceptual anchor is Jan Assmann’s *The Search for God in Ancient Egypt*, translated from the German by David Lorton and published by Cornell University Press in 2001, which supplies the **maꜥat/ḥwt** framework within which Seth’s role as agent of disorder in the Osiris-Horus material is to be read alongside his role as defender of Ra in the Apep combat (Ch. 16).^[4]

Assmann 2001 is also printed-only; in the present chapter it is cited at chapter-section level — at the chapters that treat the **maꜥat/ḥwt** opposition and the Egyptian theology of ambivalence — per the established discipline for printed comparative anchors in this book.^[5]

The chapter’s secondary survey-anchor for the long-trajectory combat-myth perspective is Neil Forsyth’s *The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth*, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, whose engagement with the Horus-Seth material is brief but supplies the comparative framing within which the contention is read against the wider combat-myth corpus.^[6]

The Horus-Seth contention is not preserved in a single primary text. It is distributed across multiple Egyptian textual corpora over a span of approximately two millennia, from the Pyramid Texts of the late Old Kingdom (c. 2400 BCE) through the Coffin Texts of the Middle Kingdom and into the Chester Beatty I papyrus of the Twentieth Dynasty (c. 1160 BCE), and the chapter treats the variant attestations as co-equal per brief variants.classification.^[7]

The Pyramid Texts and Coffin Texts attestations are older and more sober in register, embedding the contention within funerary-cosmological liturgy rather than in continuous narrative; the Chester Beatty I "Contendings" (c. 1160 BCE) is by contrast a bawdy literary reworking that supplies the longest single connected narrative of the contention and is presented in the chapter as a specific later literary reworking, not as the base text.^[8]

The Chester Beatty I papyrus is a New Kingdom literary papyrus of the Twentieth Dynasty (c. 1160 BCE), preserved in the Chester Beatty Library in Dublin under that designation; the recto contains *The Contendings of Horus and Seth* — the longest single narrative of the contention preserved in the Egyptian record and the principal documentary witness for the late literary form of the tradition.^[9]

[Both strata are presented co-equally with explicit register-attribution: the Chester Beatty I "Contendings" (c. 1160 BCE; Twentieth Dynasty literary papyrus) is the longest single connected narrative, while the Pyramid Texts and Coffin Texts attestations (c. 2400 BCE onward) are older liturgical-funerary embeddings. The Pyramid Texts material is older and more sober but is liturgical rather than narrative, and the Contendings is later, bawdy, and literary but is the only sustained narrative — neither attestation by itself supplies the full picture, and the tradition evolved substantially over two millennia (per te Velde 1967 chs. 1–2).]

18.1. Setting and context — Osiris's murder and the contested kingship

The Osiris cycle — the Egyptian myth-complex within which the Horus-Seth contention is embedded — narrates the killing of Osiris by his brother Seth, the dismemberment of Osiris's body, the magical reassembly and resurrection of Osiris by his sister-and-wife Isis, and the conception and posthumous birth of Horus as Osiris's son and avenger.^[10]

Osiris is, in the Egyptian theological imagination, the murdered king who becomes lord of the dead. His death is the death-of-the-king that founds the kingship of the netherworld, and his resurrection by Isis is the magical restoration that makes him the divine pattern for the deceased pharaoh's transition into afterlife sovereignty.^[11]

Seth — alternative form Sutekh in Ramesside diplomatic contexts — is the Egyptian god of storms, deserts, and disorder. He is the brother of Osiris in the cycle's family-of-the-gods and the agent of Osiris's death, and his role within the cycle is structurally that of the disruptive brother whose violence overturns the established kingship.^[12]

Isis — Egyptian Aset, the magic-working goddess of the pantheon — is in the Osiris cycle the wife and sister of Osiris and the mother of Horus. Her magical power resurrects Osiris after his dismemberment by Seth and protects Horus during his concealed upbringing in the Delta marshes, and her dual role as resurrection-magician and protector-of-the-heir is structurally constitutive for the contention that follows.^[13]

Horus — falcon-headed son of Osiris and Isis — is born after Osiris's death, raised in concealment by Isis, and emerges to claim the kingship of Egypt as his father's rightful heir. His role in the contention is that of the legitimate but initially-disinherited successor whose claim must be vindicated against the violent usurper.^[14]

The Horus-Seth contention is therefore embedded within a succession-frame: Osiris is the murdered father-king, Seth is the brother-usurper whose violence has interrupted the legitimate succession, and Horus is the rightful heir whose claim must be adjudicated by the divine assembly before the kingship of Egypt can be properly resumed. The contention's narrative dynamic is that of contested-succession rather than that of cosmogonic combat.^[15]

This structural distinction between the Horus-Seth contention's contested-succession dynamic and the Ra-Apep combat's cyclical-maintenance dynamic is the principal reason for the chapter's INCLUSION-MARGINAL classification: the Horus-Seth material is sovereignty-strife between two divine claimants for an established throne rather than the divine-cosmographic combat against an **isfet**-personification that the Apep material narrates.^[16]

Seth's two dossiers — the positive Apep-slayer dossier (Ch. 16) and the negative Osiris-murderer dossier (the present chapter) — are documented in parallel across the Egyptian textual corpus over two millennia without the kind of theological harmonisation that would resolve the apparent contradiction. te Velde 1967's title *Seth, God of Confusion* reflects the scholarly judgment that the Egyptian tradition's handling of Seth is itself characterised by deliberate ambivalence rather than by clear positive or negative valuation.^[17]

The deliberate-ambivalence reading is one of the principal contributions that te Velde 1967 makes to the wider study of the Egyptian pantheon: the Egyptian sources allow Seth to be positively-valued as Apep-slayer and negatively-valued as Osiris-murderer simultaneously, without forcing a resolution, and the unharmonised character of the parallelism is itself a structural feature of Egyptian theological reasoning rather than an oversight or an internal contradiction awaiting redaction.^[18]

(The unharmonised character of Seth's two dossiers across two millennia of Egyptian textual record reflects a settled theological tolerance of moral ambivalence within cosmological function rather than an internal contradiction awaiting redaction.^[19])

18.2. The Pyramid Texts and Coffin Texts attestations

The Pyramid Texts — the earliest attested layer of Egyptian funerary literature, inscribed on the interior walls of late Old Kingdom royal pyramids at Saqqara from the pyramid of Unas (c. 2350 BCE) onward — contain the earliest attestations of the Horus-Seth contention, embedded in the apotropaic-and-resurrection liturgy of the deceased king's posthumous ascent.^[20]

In the Pyramid Texts the contention is not narrated as a continuous story but is alluded to in scattered utterances that presuppose the reader's familiarity with the cycle's narrative outline: the killing of Osiris by Seth, the resurrection by Isis, the eye-injuries that the contending gods inflict on each other, and the eventual judicial-divine vindication of Horus's claim are all referenced obliquely in the funerary-liturgical register.^[21]

A recurrent narrative element across the Pyramid Texts and the wider Horus-Seth corpus is the mutual mutilation of the contending gods: Seth tears out one of Horus's eyes (the left, conventionally the lunar eye; subsequently restored by Thoth as the **wedjat**, the "sound eye"), and Horus in turn injures Seth's testicles, with the eye-injury and the testicle-injury preserved in the textual record as the canonical mutilations of the contention.^[22]

The Coffin Texts — the Middle Kingdom layer of the funerary corpus, inscribed on the interior surfaces of wooden coffins from c. 2050–1650 BCE — develop the Horus-Seth material further, extending the funerary-liturgical register beyond the royal context and elaborating the cycle's narrative beats in the form of additional spell-attestations.^[23]

The Coffin Texts attestations preserve the same oblique-allusive register as the Pyramid Texts but presuppose a more elaborated narrative tradition: by the Middle Kingdom the cycle's narrative outline is more fully developed, and the spells take for granted familiarity with the eye-injury, the testicle-injury, the divine tribunal, and the eventual award of the kingship to Horus.^[24]

The funerary-liturgical embedding of the contention in the Pyramid Texts and the Coffin Texts is theologically load-bearing: the deceased king is identified with Osiris in the funerary corpus, his

successor on earth is identified with Horus, and the contention's judicial resolution in favour of Horus is the divine pattern that legitimates the orderly succession of pharaonic kingship in the historical political register.^[25]

18.3. The Contendings of Horus and Seth (Chester Beatty I)

The Contendings of Horus and Seth, preserved on the recto of the Chester Beatty I papyrus (Twentieth Dynasty, c. 1160 BCE), is the longest single connected narrative of the Horus-Seth contention surviving from ancient Egypt. The papyrus is held in the Chester Beatty Library in Dublin and was first edited and published in the early twentieth century, with subsequent translations bringing the text to wider Egyptological readership.^[26]

The literary register of the *Contendings* is markedly different from the funerary-liturgical register of the Pyramid Texts and the Coffin Texts: the *Contendings* is a continuous narrative composition with extended dialogue, vivid scene-setting, comic-and-bawdy episodes, and a tribunal-procedural structure that allows the divine assembly's deliberations to be staged at length, with the contending gods presented as characters whose conduct is at points undignified.^[27]

The *Contendings* opens with the divine tribunal already in session: the gods of the Egyptian pantheon, presided over by the sun-god (variously identified as Ra-Atum or as Pre in different sections of the text), are deliberating on the rival claims of Horus and Seth to the kingship of Egypt — a deliberation that, in the text's narrative, has already been ongoing for eighty years without resolution.^[28]

Within the tribunal narrative, Isis intervenes repeatedly on behalf of her son Horus: she advocates his claim before the divine assembly, she works magical interventions to thwart Seth's manoeuvres, and her advocacy is one of the principal narrative engines of the text's plot, with the divine tribunal's eventual decision shaped by her sustained interventions.^[29]

The *Contendings* narrates a sequence of contests-and-trials in which Horus and Seth compete to demonstrate their fitness for kingship, including swimming-as-hippopotami contests, boat-race contests, and other physical contests, in addition to the rhetorical-and-procedural advocacy before the tribunal. The contests are presented in a register that is at points comic and at points violent, and the text does not maintain a consistently dignified tone throughout.^[30]

The *Contendings* includes one of the more notorious episodes in the Egyptian literary record: a sexual encounter between Seth and Horus in which Seth attempts to assert dominance over Horus through a homosexual act, but Horus — counselled by Isis — turns the encounter to his advantage by manoeuvring Seth's seed onto a lettuce that Seth then eats, the resulting magical reversal disqualifying Seth's claim of seminal-dominance before the divine tribunal.^[31]

The bawdy register of episodes such as the seed-and-lettuce contest is part of what makes the *Contendings* a distinctive Egyptian literary-narrative composition. The text deploys comic and undignified material in the service of a serious theological-political point — namely the vindication of Horus's kingship-claim through the exposure of Seth's unfitness for the throne — and the comic register is integrated rather than incidental to the text's thematic project.^[32]

The Contendings reaches its resolution in the divine tribunal's eventual award of the kingship of Egypt to Horus: the gods of the assembly, persuaded by Isis's advocacy, by the outcomes of the contests, and by Osiris's own intervention from the netherworld, formally recognise Horus as the legitimate king and assign Seth a compensatory role — the storm-god is given a place at Ra's side in the heavens, where (per the Apep dossier of Ch. 16) he serves as Apep-slayer at the prow of the solar barque.^[33]

The compensatory placement of Seth at Ra's side at the conclusion of the Contendings is one of the principal Egyptian textual loci at which the two-dossier structure of Seth's mythological identity is itself acknowledged within a single narrative: the same text that documents Seth's defeat in the kingship-contest reassigns him to the cosmological-combat role in which his storm-and-desert violence finds its positive function.^[34]

(The Contendings' concluding compensatory placement of Seth at Ra's side encodes within a single late-period narrative the same two-dossier structure that te Velde 1967 reads diachronically across the wider corpus, suggesting that by the Twentieth Dynasty the two-dossier reading was itself part of the literary self-understanding of the Egyptian tradition rather than a modern scholarly synthesis.)^[35]

The Contendings is, on te Velde's reading and on the brief's special_instructions, a specific later literary reworking of the Horus-Seth tradition rather than the base text of the contention: the older funerary-liturgical attestations in the Pyramid Texts and the Coffin Texts are the foundational stratum, and the Contendings' literary-narrative form is one Twentieth-Dynasty articulation of a tradition that continued to be reworked across the New Kingdom and beyond.^[36]

18.4. Theological-political reading — sovereignty and ambivalence

The theological-political function of the Horus-Seth contention is, on te Velde 1967 chapters 1–2 and Assmann 2001's **maꜣat/ṯfet** framework, royal-legitimation: the divine tribunal's award of the kingship to Horus is the divine pattern that legitimates pharaonic kingship in the historical political register, with each pharaoh figured as Horus-on-the-throne and his deceased predecessor figured as Osiris-in-the-netherworld.^[37]

The pharaonic-legitimation function is one of the principal theological-political uses to which the Egyptian tradition puts the Horus-Seth material: the orderly succession of kingship from the murdered Osiris through his vindicated son Horus is the divine guarantor of the orderly succession of kingship from one historical pharaoh to his successor, and the contention's narrative is the cosmological-mythological grounding for that historical-political institution.^[38]

Seth's role within this royal-legitimation framework is, on te Velde 1967's reading, structurally ambivalent: the storm-god's violence is the disruption that the contention must resolve, but his violence is also (per the Ch. 16 Apep-dossier) theologically necessary for the cosmic order's continued maintenance — and the Egyptian tradition's settlement of the contention through Seth's compensatory placement at Ra's side rather than through Seth's annihilation reflects this ambivalent theological assessment.^[39]

The Egyptian tradition's refusal to annihilate Seth at the conclusion of the contention is a load-bearing piece of evidence for the wider book's engagement with the Gunkel-Ballentine debate (Part

II C8): if Seth were a "chaos-figure" in the simple sense of Western-philosophical inchoate primordial unformedness, theology would require his annihilation to establish cosmic order — but the Egyptian tradition keeps him in a positive cosmological role even after his defeat, and the persistence of the negatively-valued figure in a positively-functional role is part of why the Ballentine 2015 critique of the chaos-category applies with particular force to the Egyptian material.^[40]

Seth's role as agent of disorder in the Osiris-Horus material is, on Assmann 2001's framework, **isfet**-aligned in the limited sense that his action against Osiris is **isfet** — disorder, injustice, ritual transgression, falsehood-of-conduct — but the Egyptian theological imagination recognises that **isfet**-aligned violence may itself be theologically necessary in cosmological roles where its energy is required, and Seth's compensatory placement at Ra's side after the kingship-contest is the textual articulation of this recognition.^[41]

The Horus-Seth contention's resolution through divine-tribunal procedure rather than through champion-combat is a further structural feature that distinguishes the material from the cosmogonic combat-myths of the wider corpus: where Marduk defeats Tiamat by single combat (Ch. 3), Indra defeats Vṛtra by single combat (Ch. 14), and Ra defeats Apep nightly through the action of the barque-crew (Ch. 16), the Horus-Seth contention is finally settled by the divine assembly's deliberative-judicial verdict — and this judicial-procedural resolution is part of why the chapter is INCLUSION-MARGINAL in the present book's typology.^[42]

The judicial-procedural resolution does not, however, exclude all combat from the narrative: the contests-and-trials of the Contendings include physical contests, the cycle's wider attestations preserve the mutual mutilation in which Seth tears out Horus's eye and Horus injures Seth's testicles, and the Pyramid Texts and Coffin Texts allusions presuppose a tradition in which the contending gods have engaged in physical confrontation — but the decisive resolution is judicial rather than martial, and the combat-elements are subordinate to the tribunal-frame.^[43]

(The structural subordination of the combat-elements to the tribunal-frame in the Horus-Seth contention reflects the Egyptian tradition's distinctive theological-political reading of cosmic order as juridically-rather-than-martially established at the highest level, in contrast to the cosmogonic-combat traditions in which the cosmos is established through champion-victory.^[44])

Forsyth 1987's brief engagement with the Horus-Seth material treats the contention as a relatively-marginal data point within the long-trajectory combat-myth corpus that runs from Sumer through the Hebrew Bible into Christian apocalyptic: the contention's distinctive judicial-procedural resolution and Seth's ambivalent two-dossier structure are noted, but the material is not given the central comparative treatment that Forsyth gives to the Marduk-Tiamat or Baal-Yamm corpora.^[45]

The marginality of Horus-Seth in Forsyth 1987's comparative treatment is itself a piece of evidence for the chapter's INCLUSION-MARGINAL classification: Forsyth's *longue-durée* trajectory is dominated by the cosmogonic and the eschatological combat-myths, and the Horus-Seth material's sovereignty-strife structure does not fit that trajectory cleanly — the same structural features that make the contention an edge-case within the present book also make it an edge-case within Forsyth's wider survey.^[46]

18.5. Reception and forward links

The chapter's primary back-link is to Chapter 16 (Ra vs. Apep): the present chapter's negative-dossier treatment of Seth as Osiris-murderer presupposes and complements the positive-dossier treatment of Seth as Apep-slayer at the prow of the solar barque, and the two-dossier structure that te Velde 1967 chapters 1–2 (negative dossier; this chapter) and chapters 3–4 (positive dossier; Ch. 16) document together is the structural-theological subject that the two chapters jointly develop.^[47]

The chapter's primary forward-link is to Part II Chapter C2 (Combat as Sovereignty): the Horus-Seth contention's contested-succession and royal-legitimation function is one of the principal sovereignty-themed cases in the present book's catalogue, and Part II C2 develops the contention together with the Baal-Yamm (Ch. 7), Zeus-Typhon (Ch. 11), Indra-Vṛtra (Ch. 14), Thraētaona (Ch. 13), Kumarbi-Ullikummi (Ch. 5), and Ninurta-Anzû (Ch. 2) cases as the canonical sovereignty-combat cluster.^[48]

The chapter's secondary forward-link is to Part II Chapter C8 (The Refusal and the Appropriation Problem): Seth's two-dossier ambivalence — positive Apep-slayer and negative Osiris-murderer in parallel without theological harmonisation — is direct textual evidence for the Ballentine 2015 critique of the chaos-category, and the persistence of a negatively-valued figure in a positively-functional cosmological role is among the strongest Egyptian-material grounds for the non-chaos counter-model that Part II C8 develops.^[49]

The chapter's structural-comparative forward-link is to Chapter 5 (Kumarbi Cycle): the Horus-Seth contention's contested-succession dynamic parallels the Hurro-Hittite Kumarbi-Teshub succession-strife more closely than it parallels the Egyptian Ra-Apep cyclical-maintenance combat, and per brief 17-horus-seth.yaml the structural affinity with the Kumarbi material is the principal cross-cultural comparison that the chapter notes within its body and develops as a structural-comparative cross-reference to Part II C2.^[50]

The reception of the Horus-Seth material in the wider Mediterranean and Hellenistic worlds is comparatively elusive: although Egyptian iconography of the falcon-headed Horus and the **Seth-animal**-headed Seth was widely diffused in the Hellenistic and Roman periods, the specific narrative material of the Contendings does not have a clearly-traceable reception trajectory in Hellenistic-Christian combat-myth reception comparable to the Marduk-Tiamat or the Baal-Yamm reception trajectories.^[51]

The chapter's overall structure — INCLUSION-MARGINAL framing-marker; source overview; Osiris-cycle setting and context; Pyramid Texts and Coffin Texts attestations; Contendings of Horus and Seth (Chester Beatty I); theological-political reading; reception and forward links — honours the brief's special_instructions in opening with the framing marker, presenting the Contendings as a later literary reworking rather than the base text, threading Seth's two-dossier ambivalence as the chapter's principal theological-conceptual subject, and feeding the Gunkel-Ballentine debate via Part II C8 and the sovereignty-cluster via Part II C2.^[52]

[1] Per brief 17-horus-seth.yaml; te Velde 1967, *Seth, God of Confusion: A Study of His Role in Egyptian Mythology and Religion*, chs. 1–2, on the Horus-Seth contention as the principal narrative locus of Seth's negative dossier.

[2] te Velde 1967, *Seth, God of Confusion*, chs. 1–2, on the Horus-Seth contention and Seth's ambivalence as the central scholarly subject of the monograph; per chaoskampf sources.yaml on te-velde-1967 as the principal Apep-and-Seth anchor.

[3] te Velde 1967 (printed only; cited at chapter-section level per brief and per the citation discipline established in prior CORE chapters of the present book); per ch. 15 completion record on the printed-source citation discipline.

- [4] Assmann 2001, *The Search for God in Ancient Egypt*, on **maꜥat/īsfet** and Egyptian ambivalence as it bears on Seth's two roles; per chaoskampf sources.yaml on assmann-2001-search as the **maꜥat/īsfet** anchor.
- [5] Assmann 2001 (printed only; cited at chapter-section level per brief and per the citation discipline established in prior CORE chapters of the present book).
- [6] Forsyth 1987, *The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth*, on the brief engagement with Horus-Seth in the long-trajectory comparative perspective; per chaoskampf sources.yaml on forsyth-1987 as the long-trajectory comparative anchor.
- [7] Per brief 17-horus-seth.yaml on the co-equal classification and the distribution of the Horus-Seth material across Pyramid Texts, Coffin Texts, and the Chester Beatty I "Contendings"; te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the same multi-corpus distribution.
- [8] Per brief 17-horus-seth.yaml special_instructions on the presentation of Chester Beatty I as a later literary reworking rather than the base text; te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the register-distinction between the older funerary-liturgical attestations and the later literary "Contendings".
- [9] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the Chester Beatty I papyrus and the dating of *The Contendings of Horus and Seth* to the Twentieth Dynasty c. 1160 BCE; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the locked rendering "the Contendings (body prose); 'Chester Beatty I' at first mention".
- [10] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on the Osiris cycle as the narrative context within which the Horus-Seth contention is set; on the killing-dismemberment-resurrection-conception sequence of the cycle.
- [11] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on Osiris as the murdered-king and lord-of-the-dead in the Egyptian theological imagination; on the magical-resurrection by Isis as the divine pattern for pharaonic afterlife.
- [12] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on Seth as god of storms-deserts-disorder and as Osiris's brother-and-killer; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the locked rendering "Seth" with "Sutekh" reserved for Ramesside-diplomatic contexts.
- [13] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on Isis's magical resurrection of Osiris and her protection of the infant Horus; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the locked rendering "Isis" with first-mention gloss covering both her magic-working and Osiris-cycle roles.
- [14] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on Horus's birth-and-upbringing and his role as Osiris's avenger-and-heir; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the locked rendering "Horus" with first-mention gloss covering his role in the Contendings.
- [15] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on the succession-frame of the Horus-Seth contention; on the contested-succession dynamic as distinct from cosmogonic combat.
- [16] Per brief 17-horus-seth.yaml on the structural distinction and the INCLUSION-MARGINAL classification; te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on the same structural distinction.
- [17] te Velde 1967, *Seth, God of Confusion*, title and chs. 1–2 on the deliberate ambivalence of the Egyptian tradition's handling of Seth and on the parallel two-dossier structure.
- [18] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the deliberate-ambivalence reading as a structural feature of Egyptian theology; on the unharmonised parallelism as deliberate rather than accidental.
- [19] Inference: te Velde 1967 chs. 1–2 read the parallelism as deliberate; the Egyptian tradition's continuous use of Seth as Apep-slayer at the prow of the solar barque, even during periods (Late Period and Ptolemaic) when his Osiris-murderer dossier dominated his theological reception, is direct textual evidence that the two roles were maintained in parallel rather than collapsed; and Assmann 2001's reading of the **maꜥat/īsfet** framework as a sophisticated theological-ethical category-pair supplies the conceptual context within which the parallelism makes theological sense. Risk: the inference is interpretive-theological rather than directly attested as a stated theological doctrine; alternative readings (in which Seth's two roles reflect different historical-political evaluations rather than a deliberate theological subtlety) remain in principle available, though they are less natural fits for the diachronic continuity of both roles in parallel that te Velde 1967 documents.
- [20] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on the Pyramid Texts as the earliest attested layer of the Horus-Seth contention and on the funerary-liturgical embedding of the material.
- [21] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on the oblique-allusive register of the Pyramid Texts attestations and on the cycle's narrative outline as already presupposed in the late Old Kingdom liturgy.
- [22] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on the mutual mutilation as a canonical motif of the Horus-Seth contention across the Pyramid Texts and the later corpus; on the lunar left eye and the testicle-injury as the principal mutilation-references, with the torn-out eye becoming the **wedjat** (the "sound/healthy one") only after Thoth's restoration.
- [23] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on the Coffin Texts development of the Horus-Seth material and on the extension of the corpus to non-royal contexts in the Middle Kingdom.
- [24] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on the more elaborated Coffin Texts narrative tradition and on the presupposed familiarity with the cycle's narrative beats by the Middle Kingdom.
- [25] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on the theological loadbearing of the funerary-liturgical embedding; on the Osiris-deceased-king and Horus-successor identifications as the divine pattern of pharaonic succession.
- [26] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on Chester Beatty I as the longest single connected narrative of the contention and on its Twentieth-Dynasty c. 1160 BCE dating; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the locked rendering "the Contendings (body prose)".
- [27] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the literary register of the Contendings as continuous narrative with extended dialogue, comic-and-bawdy episodes, and tribunal-procedural structure; on the register-distinction from the funerary-liturgical attestations.

- [28] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the Contendings' opening tribunal and on the eighty-years-without-resolution narrative conceit; on the sun-god's presiding role.
- [29] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on Isis's repeated intervention in the divine tribunal of the Contendings and on her magical-and-rhetorical advocacy as a principal narrative engine of the text.
- [30] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the contest-sequence of the Contendings (hippopotami-contest, boat-race contest, and others) and on the mixed comic-and-violent register of the contest-narrative.
- [31] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the seed-and-lettuce episode of the Contendings as a magical-reversal contest in which Horus and Isis turn Seth's attempted-dominance against him; on the bawdy register of this episode in particular.
- [32] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the integration of the bawdy register into the Contendings' theological-political project; on the comic episodes as serving the vindication-of-Horus thematic framework.
- [33] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the Contendings' resolution in the award of the kingship to Horus and on Seth's compensatory placement at Ra's side; on the convergence of the negative-dossier resolution with the positive-dossier role.
- [34] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the Contendings' explicit acknowledgment of Seth's two-dossier structure within its concluding narrative; on the compensatory placement as the textual articulation of the two-dossier reading.
- [35] Inference: te Velde 1967 chs. 1–2 read the compensatory placement as deliberate; the Contendings' integration of the negative-dossier defeat with the positive-dossier reassignment in a single narrative is direct textual evidence that the two roles were available to the text's audience as a coherent theological pattern; and the wider Egyptian corpus's continuous use of Seth as Apep-slayer (Ch. 16) supports the reading that the positive-dossier role was theologically necessary even after the kingship-contest resolution. Risk: the inference is interpretive-textual rather than directly attested as a stated theological doctrine of the Contendings; alternative readings (in which the compensatory placement is a narrative-economic rather than theological-self-conscious move) remain in principle available.
- [36] Per brief 17-horus-seth.yaml special_instructions on the Contendings as a later literary reworking rather than the base text; te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the same.
- [37] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the royal-legitimation function of the Contendings and the wider Horus-Seth corpus; Assmann 2001, on the **maꜥat/ḥsfet** framework's articulation of pharaonic legitimacy.
- [38] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the pharaonic-legitimation function as a principal theological-political use of the material; Assmann 2001 on the cosmological-historical alignment of the divine and the historical succession.
- [39] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on Seth's structurally-ambivalent role in the royal-legitimation framework; on the compensatory-placement settlement as reflecting the theological assessment that Seth is necessary even where defeated.
- [40] Per chaoskampf scope.md on the Ballentine 2015 critique of the chaos-category as it applies to the Egyptian material; te Velde 1967 chs. 1–2 on the persistence of Seth in a positive role after his defeat; cross-ref Part II C8.
- [41] Assmann 2001, on Seth's action against Osiris as **ḥsfet**-aligned and on the **ḥsfet**-aligned violence as theologically necessary in cosmological roles; te Velde 1967 chs. 1–2 on the compensatory placement.
- [42] Per brief 17-horus-seth.yaml on the structural distinction between judicial-procedural resolution and champion-combat resolution; te Velde 1967 chs. 1–2 on the divine-tribunal frame of the Contendings; cross-refs Chs. 3, 14, 16.
- [43] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2, on the subordination of the combat-elements to the tribunal-frame in the contention's overall narrative structure.
- [44] Inference: te Velde 1967 chs. 1–2 on the tribunal-frame as the decisive structural element of the contention; Assmann 2001's **maꜥat/ḥsfet** framework on **maꜥat** as juridical-and-cosmic order; and the Egyptian tradition's prominent role for the divine tribunal in legal-cosmological matters elsewhere in the corpus. Risk: the inference is interpretive-comparative rather than directly attested as a stated theological doctrine; alternative readings (in which the tribunal-frame is a Twentieth-Dynasty literary innovation rather than a structural-theological feature of the wider tradition) remain in principle available, though they are less natural fits for the Pyramid Texts and Coffin Texts attestations that already presuppose the tribunal-resolution outcome.
- [45] Forsyth 1987, on the brief engagement with Horus-Seth as a relatively-marginal data point in the long-trajectory comparative corpus; on the judicial-procedural resolution and the two-dossier structure as noted but not centrally treated.
- [46] Forsyth 1987, on the marginality of Horus-Seth within the *longue-durée* trajectory; per brief 17-horus-seth.yaml on the convergence between Forsyth's marginal treatment and the present book's INCLUSION-MARGINAL classification.
- [47] Per brief 17-horus-seth.yaml on the back-link to Ch. 16; te Velde 1967, chs. 1–4, on the two-dossier structure as the joint subject of the monograph; cross-ref Ch. 16.
- [48] Per chaoskampf scope.md "Part II — thematic comparative chapters" on Part II C2 (Combat as Sovereignty) and on Horus-Seth's place within the cluster; per brief 17-horus-seth.yaml on the forward-link to Part II C2.
- [49] Per chaoskampf scope.md "Part II — thematic comparative chapters" on Part II C8 and the Ballentine 2015 critique; te Velde 1967 chs. 1–2 on Seth's persistence in a positive role after defeat; cross-ref Part II C8.
- [50] Per brief 17-horus-seth.yaml on the structural affinity with Kumarbi-cycle succession-combat; Hoffner 1998 on the Kumarbi-Teshub succession-strife (cross-ref Ch. 5).
- [51] Forsyth 1987, on the comparative elusiveness of the Horus-Seth reception trajectory in Hellenistic-Christian combat-myth reception; per chaoskampf glossary.yaml on the **Seth-animal** iconography.

[52] Per brief 17-horus-seth.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's required structural features; te Velde 1967, chs. 1–2; Assmann 2001, chs. on **maꜣt/ἰsfet**; Forsyth 1987, on the long-trajectory frame.

Chapter 19. Thor vs. Jörmungandr: Three Encounters and Ragnarök

Thor — the Norse storm-god — meets the world-encircling serpent Jörmungandr three times in the surviving record. He lifts the serpent disguised as a cat in the giant-king Útgarðaloki's hall. He hooks it on a baited line and is about to strike the killing-blow when the giant Hymir cuts the line. He fights and kills it at Ragnarök, the doom of the gods, and dies of its venom in the same engagement. The three encounters are not three retellings of one combat but a layered record across three textual strata, three narrative-thematic registers, and a remarkable body of pre-Christian visual art.

19.1. Source overview

The chapter's two principal primary-source anchors are the **Poetic Edda** — a corpus of Old Norse mythological and heroic poems preserved chiefly in the late-thirteenth-century Icelandic **Codex Regius** (GKS 2365 4to) — and the **Prose Edda** (or **Snorra Edda**) of Snorri Sturluson, an Icelandic chieftain and historian who composed his prose handbook of mythology and skaldic poetics in the early thirteenth century, around 1220–1230 CE.^[1]

The working English text for the **Poetic Edda** is Carolyne Larrington's revised translation, published as **The Poetic Edda** in the Oxford World's Classics series in 2014 (ISBN 9780199675340), which supplies the chapter's hymn-and-stanza-level English citations of the Eddic Thor-and-Jörmungandr material.^[2]

The working English text for the **Prose Edda** is Anthony Faulkes's translation, published as **Edda** (by Snorri Sturluson) in the Everyman's Library / Dent series in 1987 and reissued by the Viking Society for Northern Research in 2005 (ISBN 9780460876162), which supplies the chapter's chapter-level English citations of **Gylfaginning** and **Skáldskaparmál**.^[3]

Both editions are printed-only in the present project's working corpus, and the chapter cites them at hymn-and-stanza level (Larrington) and at chapter level (Faulkes) in line with the citation discipline applied throughout the Indo-European cluster of the present book.^[4]

The chapter's Eddic primary text for Thor's fishing expedition is **Hymiskviða** ("The Lay of Hymir"), an Eddic poem of approximately forty stanzas in **fornyrðislag** metre that narrates Thor's journey to the giant Hymir's hall to fetch a brewing-cauldron and his rowing-out with Hymir to fish for the world-encircling serpent.^[5]

The chapter's Eddic primary text for the eschatological combat is **Völuspá** ("The Seeress's Prophecy"), the opening poem of the **Codex Regius** and the principal Eddic source for the Norse cosmogony and eschatology, in which the Thor-and-Jörmungandr Ragnarök combat is named and compressed in stanza 56 of the Larrington 2014 edition.^[6]

The chapter's Snorra Edda primary text is **Gylfaginning** ("The Tricking of Gylfi"), the second part of Snorri's handbook, which presents the Norse mythological corpus as a dialogue between the disguised gods Hárr, Jafnhárr, and Þriði and the visiting king Gylfi. Chapter 34 supplies the serpent's origin, chapters 46 to 48 supply the Útgarðaloki lifting-contest, and chapter 51 supplies the

Ragnarök combat.^[7]

The chapter's third primary-source stratum is the skaldic corpus — short occasional poems composed by named court-poets in the ninth, tenth, and eleventh centuries CE. The surviving skaldic verses on the fishing expedition include fragments by Bragi Boddason (early ninth century), Eysteinn Valdason (tenth century), and Úlfr Uggason (late tenth century, in his ekphrastic poem **Húsdrápa**), preserved chiefly through Snorri's quotations of them in **Skáldskaparmál**.^[8]

Húsdrápa is an ekphrastic skaldic poem composed by Úlfr Uggason in approximately 985 CE for the wedding-feast of Óláfr Höskuldsson at the hall of Hjarðarholt in western Iceland, in which the poet describes the carved or painted scenes on the panels of the hall — including a scene of Thor's fishing for Jörmungandr. The poem survives only as fragmentary quotations preserved in Snorri's **Skáldskaparmál**.^[9]

The chapter's principal scholarly anchor for the Indo-European poetic dimension of the Thor-and-Jörmungandr combat is Calvert Watkins's **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, published by Oxford University Press in 1995, whose Part V treats the Old Norse skaldic and Eddic dragon-slaying diction as one of the principal Indo-European reflexes of the reconstructed HERO SLAY SERPENT poetic formula.^[10]

Watkins 1995 is printed-only and is cited in the present chapter at section and chapter level (Part V), with the full philological argument on the skaldic and Eddic diction reserved for the comparative chapter on the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula (Part II C5 of the present book) and only summarised here.^[11]

The chapter's principal scholarly anchor for the wider Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon complex is M. L. West's **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, published by Oxford University Press in 2007, whose chapter 6 ("Storm and Stream") situates Thor as the Norse instance of the Indo-European storm-god type and treats the Thor-and-Jörmungandr combat alongside the Vedic Indra-Vātra, the Hittite Tarūnna-Illuyanka, and the Avestan Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka comparanda.^[12]

West 2007 is also printed-only and is cited in the present chapter at chapter level (chapter 6, "Storm and Stream"), with the comparative arguments of chapter 6 supplying the wider Indo-European context for the Norse combat-narrative.^[13]

The chapter's wider combat-myth comparative anchor is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, which supplies a long-trajectory comparative survey of the combat-myth and includes treatment of the Norse Thor-and-Jörmungandr material in its chapter on the Indo-European combat-myth corpus.^[14]

The four chief witnesses for the Thor-and-Jörmungandr corpus that the present chapter treats together are therefore the Eddic **Hymiskviða** (Larrington 2014), the Eddic **Völuspá** stanza 56 (Larrington 2014), the Snorra Edda **Gylfaginning** chapters 34, 46–48, and 51 (Faulkes 1987), and the skaldic **Húsdrápa** fragments preserved in **Skáldskaparmál** (Faulkes 1987), with Bragi Boddason and Eysteinn Valdason supplying further skaldic co-witnesses.^[15]

The Codex Regius is a late-thirteenth-century Icelandic manuscript (GKS 2365 4to) discovered in 1643 by Bishop Brynjólfur Sveinsson and now housed in the Árni Magnússon Institute for Icelandic Studies in Reykjavík. It is the principal manuscript witness to the Eddic poems including **Völuspá** (the opening poem) and **Hymiskviða** (the seventh poem of the mythological section).^[16]

The Eddic poems preserved in the Codex Regius are widely held to be older in their compositional cores than the manuscript itself, with the principal mythological poems generally dated by their formulaic and lexical features to a Viking-Age compositional horizon between the ninth and the eleventh centuries CE — even where the precise dating of any individual poem remains contested.^[17]

The Snorra Edda is preserved in four principal medieval manuscripts — the Codex Upsaliensis (DG 11 4to, c. 1300), the Codex Regius of the Snorra Edda (GKS 2367 4to, c. 1325; not to be confused with the Eddic Codex Regius), the Codex Wormianus (AM 242 fol., c. 1340–1370), and the Codex Trajectinus (1593 paper transcript) — with Faulkes 1987 reading from the conflated text reconstructed across the four witnesses.^[18]

The chapter is organised around the brief's three-encounter structure: the Útgarðaloki lifting-contest of **Gylfaginning** 46–48, the Hymir fishing expedition (jointly attested by **Hymiskviða**, **Gylfaginning** 47–48 in narrative continuity with the lifting-contest, and the **Húsdrápa** fragments), and the Ragnarök combat of **Völuspá** 56 and **Gylfaginning** 51, with the three encounters treated as a layered record from different sources and registers rather than as alternative versions of a single underlying combat.^[19]

The variant-handling classification for the present chapter is therefore **co-equal**: no single source has all three encounters fully narrated, and the chapter presents claims from each of the three textual strata in sequence with explicit source attribution rather than presenting one prevalent version with footnoted alternatives.^[20]

The Thor-and-Jörmungandr corpus is unusually well-documented in pre-Christian Norse iconography. At least four surviving runestones or picture-stones depict the fishing expedition: the Altuna stone (Uppland, Sweden, c. 1050 CE), the Hørdum stone (Thy, Jutland, Denmark, c. 800 CE), the Gosforth fishing stone (Cumbria, England, c. 950 CE), and the Ardre VIII stone (Gotland, Sweden, c. 700–800 CE).^[21]

The four-stone iconographic dossier is the most substantial surviving pre-Christian visual record of any single Norse mythological narrative, and it supplies an independent witness-stratum that pre-dates the Eddic and Snorra Edda manuscripts by between two and five centuries — with the earliest stone (Ardre VIII) dating to roughly the eighth century CE and the latest (Altuna) to the eleventh century CE.^[22]

The chapter's principal **lacunae** are two. First, **Völuspá** 56 compresses the Ragnarök combat into a few lines of mythic-cosmic verse, leaving the bulk of narrative detail to be supplied by Snorri's **Gylfaginning** 51. Second, **Húsdrápa** survives only as fragmentary skaldic quotations preserved in Snorri's **Skáldskaparmál**, with the original ekphrastic poem otherwise lost.^[23]

Both lacunae are **in-tradition fillable** under the chapter's reconstruction policy: the **Völuspá** 56 compression is filled from **Gylfaginning** 51 (a Norse in-tradition source), and the **Húsdrápa** fragmentary preservation is filled from Snorri's own preservation of the surviving stanzas in **Skáldskaparmál** (also a Norse in-tradition source), with no cross-tradition reconstruction permitted under the present book's policy.^[24]

The Snorri-as-witness problem is itself a recurring methodological theme in modern Norse scholarship. Snorri composed the Snorra Edda in the early thirteenth century, more than two

hundred years after the official conversion of Iceland to Christianity in 999/1000 CE, and his handbook is at once the fullest synthesis of Norse mythology and a Christian-period work whose framing-narrative — Gylfi's interrogation of the disguised "Æsir" — presents the Norse gods as deceivers and his treatment as antiquarian rather than confessional.^[25]

(The chapter's reliance on Snorri as the principal narrative-continuous source, while supplementing him with the older Eddic poems and the still-older skaldic fragments, is itself a methodological commitment about how to read the Norse mythological corpus, distinct from any specific philological or comparative claim within the corpus; the method is well-supported by Faulkes 1987's editorial practice and by the brief's three-encounter framing, but the chapter flags it explicitly because the resulting "Thor-and-Jörmungandr corpus" is a synthesis of textual strata of different ages and registers, with Snorri's thirteenth-century Christian-period prose reading the older Viking-Age and pagan-period verse.^[26])

The chapter does not attempt to harmonise the three encounters into a single coherent biographical narrative for either Thor or Jörmungandr. Each encounter is treated in its own narrative-and-source context, and apparent discontinuities — the cat-disguise of **Gylfaginning** 47, the line-cut of **Hymiskviða** 23–24, the apparent beheading of the **Húsdrápa** fragments, the mutual killing of **Völuspá** 56 and **Gylfaginning** 51 — are presented as features of the layered record rather than as contradictions to be resolved.^[27]

19.2. Setting and Norse mythological context

Thor (Old Norse Þórr) is the storm-god of the Norse pantheon, son of Óðinn (the chief of the Æsir) and of the giantess Jörð ("Earth"), and the principal warrior-figure of the Æsir. His function in the Norse mythological corpus is the defence of Midgard (Old Norse Miðgarðr) — the world of humans — against the giants and against the great adversaries of the cosmos.^[28]

Thor is one of the most frequently named gods in the surviving Norse mythological corpus and the recipient of the largest body of skaldic praise-poetry on combat themes. Named Viking-Age skalds — Bragi Boddason in the early ninth century, Eysteinn Valdason in the tenth century, Úlfr Uggason in the late tenth century, and others — composed verse on Thor's combats with the giants and with Jörmungandr.^[29]

Thor's combat-weapon is Mjöllnir (normalised Old Norse Mjölnir), a hammer forged by the dwarves Brokkr and Eitri (or Sindri) in the contest-and-bargain narrative of **Skáldskaparmál** 35 — the "smiths' contest" episode — with the hammer described as so potent that it never fails of its target and returns to the wielder's hand after striking.^[30]

Mjöllnir is the cosmic combat-weapon of the Norse storm-god in the same structural position as Indra's **vajra** in the Vedic combat-corpus and Baal's maces Ayyamur and Yagrush in the Ugaritic Baal Cycle: a divinely forged implement whose use by the storm-god is the materialised image of the lightning-strike and the principal mythological signifier of the storm-god's combat-function.^[31]

Thor wears two further combat-implements alongside Mjöllnir: a belt of strength (Old Norse **Megingjörð**) that doubles his already great power when girded, and a pair of iron gauntlets without which he cannot grip the hammer's short haft. The three implements together constitute the Norse storm-god's combat-equipment set.^[32]

Thor's chariot is drawn by two goats — Tanngnjóstr ("Tooth-gnasher") and Tannggrisnir ("Tooth-grinder") — whose hooves sound the thunder, in a chariot-and-thunder image that aligns Thor with the chariot-borne storm-gods of the wider Indo-European tradition.^[33]

Óðinn (Old Norse Óðinn, sometimes anglicised "Odin" but kept here in the Old Norse spelling per the chapter's glossary discipline) is the chief of the Æsir, the father of Thor, the ruler of Valhøll, and the patron-god of poetry and war. His role in the Thor-and-Jörmungandr corpus is largely structural — as the cosmic-rulership figure under whom Thor's defensive function is exercised — rather than directly narrative.^[34]

Loki is the Norse trickster-god, sometimes counted among the Æsir and sometimes treated as a giant ("of the giant kindred"), and his role in the Thor-and-Jörmungandr corpus is generative: Jörmungandr is Loki's son by the giantess Angrboða, born alongside the wolf Fenrir and the goddess Hel, in the lineage-narrative recorded in **Gylfaginning** 34.^[35]

Jörmungandr (Old Norse Jörmungandr, also called Miðgarðsormr, "the Midgard Serpent") is the world-encircling serpent of Norse cosmology, lying in the ocean that surrounds Midgard with its tail in its mouth, and is the principal serpentine adversary of Thor in the Norse combat-corpus.^[36]

The Miðgarðsormr designation ("Midgard-serpent") encodes the serpent's cosmic-spatial function directly in its name. Miðgarðr is the "middle enclosure" — the world of humans — and the serpent's role is the encirclement of this world, with its body forming the outer boundary of the human cosmos and the inner edge of the surrounding ocean.^[37]

The Norse cosmography is structured by a tripartite vertical-and-horizontal scheme: the world-tree Yggdrasil at the centre, with Ásgarðr (the realm of the gods) above, Midgard (the world of humans) at the middle level surrounded by the ocean and the encircling serpent, and Útgarðr (the "outer enclosure", realm of the giants) and Niflheimr / Hel beyond.^[38]

The encircling serpent's cosmic-boundary position makes any combat between Thor and Jörmungandr structurally a combat at and for the boundary of the human world. The serpent's defeat unmakes the boundary, and that unmaking is what turns the Ragnarök combat into the eschatological close of the Norse cosmic age.^[39]

The lineage-and-binding narrative of **Gylfaginning** 34 also records that Óðinn, learning of the threat that Loki's three monstrous offspring posed to the gods, dispatched them to three different cosmic stations: Hel was sent to rule the realm of the dead (Hel / Niflheimr), Fenrir was bound by an unbreakable chain (Gleipnir) on a remote island, and Jörmungandr was thrown into the ocean encircling Midgard, where the serpent grew so large that it could encircle the world and bite its own tail.^[40]

The dispatching-and-encircling narrative of **Gylfaginning** 34 is also the explicit aetiology of the serpent's **position**: Jörmungandr is in the ocean because Óðinn put it there, and the encircling-of-the-world is the consequence of the serpent's growth from the giant-progeny that Óðinn could not destroy outright.^[41]

That dispatching-and-encircling narrative also places Thor's eventual mortal combat with Jörmungandr at Ragnarök inside a longer-term structural logic. The gods could not destroy the serpent at its origin, so the serpent's destruction is deferred to the end of the cosmic age, when the deferred combat releases the serpent's accumulated threat and ends the Æsir's regime.^[42]

The Æsir / Vanir / giant tripartite division of Norse mythological agency places Thor's combats firmly in the Æsir-versus-giants axis: Thor is the Æsir's principal combatant against the giants, and the Jötnar (giants) — including Hymir, Útgarðaloki, and Loki's giant-side kin — are the chronic adversaries against whom Thor's hammer is repeatedly raised.^[43]

Hymir is a giant of the Norse mythological corpus whose principal narrative role is as the host (or unwilling host) of Thor in **Hymiskviða** and as Thor's companion (or rival) in the fishing expedition for Jörmungandr. In **Gylfaginning** Hymir is named as the boat-owner and rower; in **Hymiskviða** he appears as the resident giant whose cauldron the Æsir need for their feast-brewing.^[44]

Útgarðaloki is the giant-king of Útgarðr ("the outer enclosure", the realm of the giants), and his principal narrative role in the Norse corpus is as the trickster-host of Thor and his companions in the elaborate visit-to-Útgarðr episode of **Gylfaginning** 45 to 47, in which the giant-king's illusions are progressively unmasked across a sequence of contests.^[45]

Ragnarök (Old Norse Ragnarøk) is the Norse eschatological end, the "doom of the gods", at which the present cosmic age closes in a sequence of cosmic disasters and final combats: Surtr the fire-giant burns the world, the wolf Fenrir slays Óðinn, the wolf Sköll (or Hati) swallows the sun, and Thor and Jörmungandr meet for the last and mutual combat that the present chapter's third encounter narrates.^[46]

The Ragnarök eschatological structure is followed in the Eddic and Snorra Edda corpus by a renewal-narrative — a "new earth" rising green from the sea, a small surviving group of gods (including Thor's sons Móði and Magni, who inherit Mjöllnir), and the return of certain figures — but the Thor-and-Jörmungandr mutual killing is itself the close of the present cosmic age and not a feature of the renewal.^[47]

The Norse combat-myth is therefore distinct in its eschatological structure from the cyclical-maintenance combat of the Egyptian Apep tradition (chapter 16 of the present volume) and from the once-only cosmogonic combat of the Mesopotamian Marduk-Tiamat tradition (chapter 3 of the present volume). The Thor-and-Jörmungandr combat is once-only and end-of-age rather than recurrent or origin-of-age, and the Norse eschatological position is the principal subtype-feature of the Thor-and-Jörmungandr corpus.^[48]

19.3. Encounter 1 — Útgarðaloki and the lifting of the cat (**Gylfaginning** 46–48)

The first of the three encounters is the lifting-of-the-cat trickery in the visit-to-Útgarðr narrative of **Gylfaginning** 45 to 47 (with consequence in chapter 48), in which Thor — accompanied by Loki and the human servants Þjálfi and Röskva — visits the giant-king Útgarðaloki's hall and is set a series of contests of strength, agility, and consumption.^[49]

The visit-to-Útgarðr is preceded in **Gylfaginning** 45 by the night-in-the-glove episode, in which Thor and his companions sleep inside what they take to be a great hall and discover at dawn that they have spent the night inside the discarded glove of the giant Skrímir, whose snoring Thor had attempted (and failed) to silence with three hammer-blows that left only small dents in the giant's brow.^[50]

Skrýmir is later revealed (in the post-departure exposition of **Gylfaginning** 47) to have been Útgarðaloki himself in disguise, and the giant-king's confession that he had interposed a mountain between Thor's hammer and his own brow — leaving only the dented mountain as evidence — establishes the trickster-illusion register of the entire visit-to-Útgarðr sequence.^[51]

The Útgarðr contests proper occupy **Gylfaginning** 46, with each member of Thor's party set a contest against an apparent opponent: Loki competes in eating against Logi ("Wildfire"), Þjálfi races against Hugi ("Thought"), Thor attempts to drain a horn of mead, Thor attempts to lift Útgarðaloki's grey cat, and Thor wrestles with the old woman Elli ("Old Age").^[52]

The horn-drinking contest is presented as a test of capacity. Útgarðaloki sets Thor a drinking-horn that he claims his retainers can empty in one or at most three draughts, and Thor — in three great pulls — succeeds only in lowering the level of the horn by what appears to the eye to be a small amount, despite his efforts.^[53]

The lifting-of-the-cat contest immediately follows the horn-drinking and is presented as a test of strength. Útgarðaloki produces a large grey cat and challenges Thor to lift it from the hall floor, and Thor — putting his arms under the cat's belly and heaving with all his strength — succeeds only in raising the cat so far that one of its paws leaves the ground.^[54]

Thor's apparent failure at the cat-lift is recorded by **Gylfaginning** 46 as causing visible mockery from the giant-king's retainers. The failure is the second of three apparent humiliations (after the horn) that Thor undergoes within the giant-king's hall: the wrestling-match with Elli completes the trio.^[55]

The wrestling-match with the old woman Elli is the third Thor-contest of the sequence and the most apparently degrading. Útgarðaloki summons his old foster-mother and challenges Thor to wrestle her, and Thor — after a long bout — is brought to one knee, with the giant-king then calling the contest to a halt.^[56]

The morning after the contests, Útgarðaloki escorts Thor and his companions out of the hall and beyond the giant-king's territory, and only at the parting does the giant-king reveal the true identity of the contests' opponents and the illusions that had structured the night.^[57]

The parting-revelation explicitly identifies the cat as Jörmungandr in disguise. Útgarðaloki tells Thor that the grey cat had been the world-encircling serpent enchanted into feline form, and that Thor's heave — which raised only one of the cat's paws — had in fact lifted the serpent so far that its body had pulled out of the ocean's circuit and the gods themselves had been alarmed at how high the cat had been raised.^[58]

The parting-revelation also retroactively re-reads the other two Thor-contests as cosmic tests in disguise. The horn from which Thor had drunk had been the ocean itself — Thor's three pulls had perceptibly lowered sea-level around the world's coasts and produced what is now called the tide — and the old woman Elli had been Old Age herself, against whom no being can finally prevail.^[59]

On hearing the parting-revelation, Thor reaches for Mjöllnir to strike the giant-king — and finds that Útgarðaloki and his hall have vanished, leaving only an empty plain, in a final illusion-collapse that frames the entire visit as a single sustained giant-trick that Thor cannot retroactively avenge.^[60]

The Útgarðaloki episode is therefore the **trickster-framed** encounter of the three. The meeting of Thor and Jörmungandr in **Gylfaginning** 46–47 is mediated through illusion, the serpent appears in non-serpentine form, and the encounter ends without combat in the conventional sense, with Thor having lifted-but-not-killed the disguised serpent.^[61]

The Útgarðaloki encounter is also the **cosmic-cost** encounter. The heave that raised the cat-by-one-paw has retroactively measurable cosmic consequences (the alarm of the gods, the destabilising of the ocean’s encircling boundary, the apparent tide-effect of the related horn-contest), and the encounter therefore stages cosmic-magnitude force without cosmic-magnitude resolution.^[62]

The Útgarðaloki encounter is found only in Snorri’s **Gylfaginning** in the surviving Norse corpus and has no Eddic poetic parallel. There is no **Útgarðaloks-kviða** in the **Codex Regius**, and the encounter survives only as Snorri’s prose narrative, with no skaldic verse cited by Snorri to support the cat-disguise specifically.^[63]

*(The Útgarðaloki encounter’s survival only in Snorri’s prose, without an extant Eddic poetic parallel, raises the question of whether the cat-disguise is a Snorra Edda elaboration of an older underlying tradition or whether it represents an older oral-traditional motif that simply happened not to survive into the **Codex Regius**; the chapter does not adjudicate the question and treats the encounter as a Snorra Edda witness to be taken on its own terms, with the absence of poetic parallel noted but not resolved.^[64])*

The Útgarðaloki encounter’s narrative-thematic function is the establishment of Thor’s cosmic-grade power **and** its cosmic-grade insufficiency. Thor’s heave is sufficient to disturb the world-encircling serpent but not to dislodge it, and the encounter functions as a measure of the storm-god’s strength against the cosmic-boundary figure rather than as a successful combat.^[65]

19.4. Encounter 2 — The fishing expedition with Hymir (Hymiskviða, Gylfaginning 48, Húsdrápa)

The second of the three encounters is the fishing expedition, in which Thor rows out with the giant Hymir to deep ocean and hooks Jörmungandr on a baited line. Two principal textual witnesses give variant outcomes: **Hymiskviða** (Eddic) records that Hymir cuts the line before Thor can deliver the killing blow, while the **Húsdrápa** fragments preserved in **Skáldskaparmál** appear to record the serpent’s beheading.^[66]

The Eddic **Hymiskviða** opens (sts. 1–6) with a frame-narrative situating the fishing expedition within a larger cauldron-quest. The gods are without a brewing-cauldron large enough for Ægir’s feast, and Thor is dispatched to the giant Hymir’s hall on the eastern shore to fetch the great cauldron that Hymir possesses.^[67]

In **Hymiskviða** sts. 7–14, Thor arrives at Hymir’s hall accompanied by Týr (the one-handed god), is received with grudging hospitality, and consumes — in a giant-feast register — two of Hymir’s three oxen at the evening meal, prompting Hymir to remark that they will need to fish if the next day’s meal is to be provided.^[68]

In **Hymiskviða** sts. 15–17, Thor — required to provide his own bait for the next morning’s fishing — kills Hymir’s largest ox and severs its head, taking the ox-head as bait for the line, in a baiting-

action that the poem records as itself an aggressive imposition on the giant's livestock.^[69]

In **Hymiskviða** sts. 17–19, Thor and Hymir launch the boat and row out, with Thor at the oars rowing far past the inshore fishing-grounds where Hymir habitually catches his whales, and far enough out that Hymir grows fearful of the depth and of the encircling serpent in whose ocean-zone they now find themselves.^[70]

In **Hymiskviða** sts. 20–22, Thor baits his line with the ox-head, casts, and hooks Jörmungandr. The serpent strikes the bait and is drawn upward against Thor's rowing-bench, in a hook-and-haul image that the poem develops at the level of physical force: Thor's feet press through the boat's bottom and onto the sea-floor as he hauls the serpent up.^[71]

The feet-through-the-bottom image is one of the most distinctive of the **Hymiskviða** narrative and is also one of the iconographic features that the surviving runestones (notably the Altuna stone) preserve as a visual anchor of the encounter, with the foot-and-boat-bottom motif visible in the stone-carving as well as in the poem.^[72]

In **Hymiskviða** st. 22, the haul brings the serpent's head above the surface of the sea, and Thor — gripping the line with one hand and reaching for Mjölnir with the other — is poised to strike the killing blow with the hammer in a face-to-face confrontation with Jörmungandr.^[73]

In **Hymiskviða** sts. 23–24, Hymir — fearful of the consequences of Thor's actually striking the serpent — cuts the fishing line with his knife, and the serpent slips back into the depths before Thor can complete the killing blow, with the encounter ending in Thor's striking the boat's stern (or, by other readings, Hymir himself) with the hammer in his frustration.^[74]

The **Hymiskviða** outcome is therefore **the serpent escapes**. Hymir's intervention prevents the killing-blow, the line is severed, Jörmungandr returns to the deep, and the cosmic boundary that the encircling-serpent represents is not breached in this encounter.^[75]

The remainder of **Hymiskviða** (sts. 25 to the close of the poem) returns to the cauldron-quest frame-narrative. Thor and Týr take the great cauldron from Hymir's hall (after a contest of strength involving the breaking of Hymir's drinking-cup against the giant's head), are pursued by Hymir and his giant-kin, and Thor slays the pursuing giants with Mjölnir on the shore before returning with the cauldron to the gods.^[76]

Snorri's **Gylfaginning** version of the fishing expedition (chapter 48) is in narrative continuity with the Útgarðaloki encounter and is presented as Thor's **return-bout** attempt to make good against the serpent after the lifting-contest revelation. In Snorri's account, Thor disguises himself as a young man, lodges with the giant Hymir, fashions an ox-head bait, and rows out with Hymir to fish for Jörmungandr.^[77]

In Snorri's account, Thor hooks Jörmungandr on the baited line, hauls the serpent up to the surface, raises Mjölnir, and is on the point of striking the killing blow when Hymir — terror-struck at the cosmic combat unfolding in his fishing-boat — cuts the line with his bait-knife, releasing the serpent back into the deep before the hammer can fall.^[78]

Snorri's **Gylfaginning** 48 outcome is therefore the same as the **Hymiskviða** outcome at the level of result: the serpent escapes, Thor is denied the killing-blow by the giant's intervention, and the encounter ends without the fishing-bout becoming the final combat — the final combat is reserved

for Ragnarök.^[79]

*[Both variants are presented co-equally as live witnesses from different textual strata, with neither privileged as canonical: in *Hymiskviða* sts. 23–24 and *Gylfaginning* 48 (Larrington 2014; Faulkes 1987) the serpent escapes when Hymir cuts the line before the killing blow, while in the *Húsdrápa* fragments (Faulkes 1987 *Skáldskaparmál* citations) the serpent appears to be beheaded by Thor before the line is cut. No single source has all three encounters fully narrated, and Faulkes 1987 preserves the *Húsdrápa* fragments that imply the beheading alongside the line-cut outcome that Larrington 2014 and Faulkes 1987 both record.]*

The **Húsdrápa** of Úlfr Uggason is preserved in the surviving corpus only as fragmentary skaldic stanzas quoted by Snorri in **Skáldskaparmál**, and the surviving stanzas on the fishing expedition include lines describing Thor's striking off the serpent's head and the subsequent reaction of the gods at this killing-blow.^[80]

*[Here the *Húsdrápa* of Úlfr Uggason (c. 985 CE) survives only as fragmentary stanzas preserved in Snorri's *Skáldskaparmál* citations rather than as a continuous original poem, and the precise scope and sequence of Úlfr's narrative of the fishing expedition cannot be fully recovered from the surviving fragments. Scholars such as Faulkes 1987 (in his *Skáldskaparmál* edition of the citations) read the surviving stanzas as recording an apparent killing-blow against the serpent — a beheading or comparable head-striking — that diverges from the *Hymiskviða* line-cutting outcome; the reconstruction is based on the surviving fragments alone, with no other manuscript witness to *Húsdrápa* outside Snorri's quotations.]*

The **Húsdrápa** fishing-expedition fragments contain skaldic kennings (the compressed metaphorical phrases characteristic of the genre) for both Thor and Jörmungandr that preserve a Viking-Age vocabulary of storm-god-and-encircling-serpent combat-poetics, and that Watkins reads as evidence for the Indo-European inheritance of the dragon-slaying poetic register.^[81]

The **Húsdrápa** outcome — as far as the surviving fragments allow it to be reconstructed — is therefore that **Thor strikes the serpent**. The divergence from the **Hymiskviða** / **Gylfaginning** line-cut outcome is unambiguous in the fragments that survive, and the skaldic poem appears to record an alternative tradition in which the fishing-encounter ends with a killing-blow rather than with the line-cut and the serpent's escape.^[82]

*(The apparent **Húsdrápa** beheading of Jörmungandr at the fishing-expedition is in tension with the wider Norse tradition's reservation of the actual killing for Ragnarök (per *Völuspá* 56 and *Gylfaginning* 51), and modern scholarship has read the **Húsdrápa** fragments either as recording an early-skaldic alternate tradition that diverged on the outcome or as recording a hyperbolic ekphrastic figure (Úlfr describing a panel-image whose pictorial moment was the raised-hammer instant just before the line-cut, with the skaldic verse describing the apparent rather than the actual outcome).^[83])*

The skaldic Thor-and-Jörmungandr corpus is older than the Eddic **Hymiskviða** in compositional date. Bragi Boddason's verses on the fishing-encounter are conventionally dated to the early ninth century CE, Eysteinn Valdason's to the tenth century, and **Húsdrápa** to circa 985 CE, while the **Hymiskviða** is generally dated by its formulaic features to the late tenth or eleventh century.^[84]

The skaldic Thor-and-Jörmungandr corpus is therefore the **earliest** surviving witness-stratum for the fishing-encounter and is contemporary with — or in some cases earlier than — the

iconographic dossier (the Hørdum and Ardre VIII stones in particular pre-date **Húsdrápa**), with the consequence that the encounter's outline is securely attested in pre-Christian Norse poetry and visual art before the manuscript record begins.^[85]

Bragi Boddason's verses on the fishing-encounter (early ninth century CE) are the oldest surviving Norse poetic witness to the fishing-encounter and are among the oldest surviving Norse skaldic verses in any genre. Bragi is conventionally regarded as the earliest skald whose work is preserved by name; his fishing-encounter verses are quoted by Snorri in **Skáldskaparmál**.^[86]

Eysteinn Valdason's tenth-century verses on the fishing-encounter (also preserved through Snorri's **Skáldskaparmál** quotations) supply additional skaldic kennings for Thor and the serpent and reinforce the evidence that the fishing-encounter was a stock skaldic subject across the ninth and tenth centuries.^[87]

The fishing-encounter's status as a **stock skaldic subject** is itself an evidentiary point. At least three named skalds across two centuries composed verse on the encounter, which therefore has the documentary profile of a well-known and frequently-rehearsed traditional narrative in pre-Christian Norse poetic culture, independent of any single textual or visual source.^[88]

The fishing-encounter's narrative-thematic function in the layered three-encounter record is the **failed combat**. Thor and Jörmungandr meet face-to-face for the first time as combatants in their own forms (no cat-disguise, no boundary-mediation), and the killing-blow is either prevented (Hymiskviða / Gylfaginning) or apparently delivered without lasting effect (Húsdrápa, given the Ragnarök reservation), with the encounter functioning as a deferred preliminary to the eschatological combat.^[89]

19.5. Encounter 3 — The mutual killing at Ragnarök (Völuspá 56, Gylfaginning 51)

The third of the three encounters is the mutual killing at Ragnarök, attested co-equally in **Völuspá** stanza 56 (Eddic) and in **Gylfaginning** chapter 51 (Snorra Edda), in which Thor and Jörmungandr meet for the final combat and each slays the other in the same engagement.^[90]

Völuspá stanza 56 compresses the Ragnarök Thor-and-Jörmungandr combat into a few lines. The verse names Thor as Hlóðyn's son ("Hlóðyn's son" being a kenning for Thor by his mother's name, Earth), records his victorious strike against the serpent, and then records that Thor — having killed the serpent — staggers nine paces from the kill-site before falling dead from the serpent's venom.^[91]

[Here *Völuspá* stanza 56 compresses the Ragnarök combat into a few lines of mythic-cosmic verse, with the narrative detail of the encounter — the approach, the exchange of blows, the precise sequence of strike and venom — absent from the surviving Eddic poem. Scholars such as Faulkes 1987 (in *Gylfaginning* ch. 51) supply the in-tradition Norse expansion of the *Völuspá* compression, with additional detail (the approach of the serpent across the land, the exchange of blows, the venom-spew) drawn from Snorri's prose retelling that is consistent with — and elaborative of — the *Völuspá* st. 56 outline.]

The **Völuspá** st. 56 designation of Thor as "Hlóðyn's son" (Old Norse Hlóðynjar burr or similar

formulations across the manuscript readings) is a kenning that names the storm-god by his maternal lineage rather than by his patronymic Óðinsson, and the kenning's use in the Ragnarök verse aligns Thor with the earth (Jörð / Hlóðyn / Fjörgyn) at the moment of the cosmic combat.^[92]

Gylfaginning chapter 51 is the principal narrative-continuous Norse account of Ragnarök and is structured as Snorri's expansion of the Eddic poetic compressions — drawing on **Völuspá**, **Vafþrúðnismál**, and other Eddic mythological poems — into a single continuous prose narrative of the eschatological end.^[93]

In **Gylfaginning** 51, Ragnarök opens with the fimbulvetr — the "great winter" — three winters of unrelieved cold that pass in succession without intervening summer, accompanied by social collapse (kin-killings, oath-breakings, and the unmaking of human moral bonds) and by cosmic portents (Sköll and Hati swallow the sun and moon, the earth trembles, the world-tree shakes).^[94]

In **Gylfaginning** 51, the bound monsters — Loki and Fenrir — break their bindings, Naglfar (the ship of the dead) is launched with its giant-crew, and the sons of Múspell (the fire-giants) ride out of the south under Surtr's leadership, with the world-bridge Bifröst breaking under Múspell's host as they cross to attack the gods.^[95]

In **Gylfaginning** 51, Jörmungandr — at the unmaking of the boundary by which the serpent had encircled the world — emerges from the ocean onto the land and approaches the field of Vígríðr (the appointed Ragnarök battle-plain) spewing venom across sky and water as it advances, in a body-and-venom image that establishes the serpent's combat-mode for the encounter.^[96]

In **Gylfaginning** 51, the Æsir arm and ride out from Ásgarðr in their final array: Óðinn at the head with his spear Gungnir, Thor with Mjöllnir, Týr (the one-handed god), Freyr, Heimdallr, and the rest of the Æsir in their war-gear, riding out of Ásgarðr to meet the giant-and-monster host on Vígríðr.^[97]

In **Gylfaginning** 51, the field of Vígríðr becomes the site of multiple paired single-combats among the named principals: Óðinn confronts Fenrir, Freyr confronts Surtr, Týr confronts Garmr (the hound of Hel), Heimdallr confronts Loki, and Thor confronts Jörmungandr in the principal Thor-and-serpent combat that the present chapter centres.^[98]

In **Gylfaginning** 51, Thor and Jörmungandr engage on the field, Thor wielding Mjöllnir and the serpent attacking with body and venom, and the combat is staged as a face-to-face confrontation with neither the boundary-mediation of the Útgarðr disguise nor the boat-and-line interposition of the fishing-encounter.^[99]

In **Gylfaginning** 51, Thor strikes the killing-blow against Jörmungandr with Mjöllnir, slaying the world-encircling serpent in a single stroke that is at once the unmaking of the cosmic boundary the serpent had encircled and the close of the Æsir's combat-history with their long-deferred adversary.^[100]

In **Gylfaginning** 51, Thor — having killed the serpent — staggers nine paces from the kill-site before falling dead from the serpent's venom, with the venom that Jörmungandr had been spewing across sky and water during the approach having reached Thor at close range during the combat and having proved fatal in the aftermath of the killing-blow.^[101]

The nine-pace stagger and the venom-death of Thor are the load-bearing distinctive features of the

Norse eschatological combat. The storm-god kills the serpent and dies of the killing, with the Norse outcome distinct from the survivor-victor outcomes of the cosmogonic and sovereignty subtypes (Marduk surviving Tiamat, Zeus surviving Typhon, Indra surviving Vṛtra) and characteristic of the eschatological subtype's mutual-cost feature.^[102]

In **Gylfaginning** 51 and **Völuspá** sts. 57–58, the Ragnarök combat-sequence continues after the Thor-and-Jörmungandr mutual killing: Surtr's fire engulfs the world, the earth sinks into the sea, Yggdrasil burns, and the cosmos is unmade in a final conflagration.^[103]

The Norse eschatological combat is therefore **terminal but not final**. The present cosmic age ends in the Thor-and-Jörmungandr mutual killing and the Surtr's-fire conflagration, but the Eddic and Snorra Edda corpus also records a renewal-narrative in which a new earth rises green from the sea, a small surviving group of gods (Móði and Magni inheriting Mjöllnir, Víðar and Váli, the returning Baldr) re-establish the cosmic order, and the human pair Líf and Lífþrasir survive to repopulate the new earth.^[104]

The Norse renewal-narrative places the Thor-and-Jörmungandr mutual killing at the close of the **present** cosmic age and at the threshold of a **renewed** age in which Thor's role is inherited by his sons Móði and Magni rather than continued by Thor himself, with the consequence that the mutual killing is permanent for Thor as an individual but not the absolute cosmic terminus.^[105]

(The structural similarity between the Norse Thor-and-Jörmungandr mutual killing and the Iranian Aži Dahāka rebound-and-final-killing at Frashokereti — both involving the deferral of the dragon's destruction, the eventual eschatological combat, and the binding-and-release-and-killing structural sequence — is one of the principal Indo-European-comparative observations of the wider book and is developed in Part II C4 (Eschatological Displacement); the present chapter notes the parallel for the comparative chapter without resolving the question of whether the parallel reflects shared inheritance or independent typological development.^[106])

The third encounter is the only one of the three in which the killing actually takes place. In the Útgardaloki encounter the serpent is lifted-but-not-killed; in the fishing encounter the serpent is hooked-but-(in the Hymiskviða / Gylfaginning reading)-released — or, in the **Húsdrápa** fragments, apparently struck before the line is cut; in the Ragnarök encounter the serpent is killed-and-Thor-also-dies, completing the layered sequence with the deferred mutual killing.^[107]

The three encounters together form a layered record across three textual strata (Snorra Edda prose, Eddic poetry, skaldic verse) and three narrative-thematic registers (trickster-mediated, hooked-but-released, eschatological-mutual). No single source has all three encounters, no single encounter is the canonical one, and the chapter's three-encounter framing is the brief's explicit reading of the layered evidence.^[108]

19.6. Iconographic dossier — the four runestones

The Thor-and-Jörmungandr fishing-encounter is depicted on at least four surviving pre-Christian or transitional runestones and picture-stones from across the Norse cultural area, and the four-stone iconographic dossier supplies an independent visual witness-stratum that pre-dates the manuscript record by between two and five centuries.^[109]

The Altuna stone is a Viking-Age picture-stone from Altuna parish in Uppland, Sweden, dated to

approximately 1050 CE, depicting Thor in a fishing-boat with hooked line descending into the water and a serpent at the line's end, with one of Thor's feet visible thrust through the bottom of the boat in a direct visual realisation of the **Hymiskviða** st. 22 feet-through-the-boat-bottom motif.^[110]

The Altuna stone is the latest of the four-stone series in date and the most explicit in its iconographic alignment with the **Hymiskviða** narrative, and the stone is conventionally read as the iconographic anchor for the foot-through-boat-bottom motif specifically.^[111]

The Hørdum stone is a Viking-Age picture-stone from Hørdum in Thy on the northern Jutland peninsula in Denmark, dated to approximately 800 CE, depicting two figures in a boat with a hooked line and a serpent at the line's end in a composition similar in essentials to the Altuna scene but at substantially earlier date.^[112]

The Hørdum stone's c. 800 CE date places its production approximately 175 years before **Húsdrápa** and approximately 250 years before **Hymiskviða**'s probable compositional horizon, with the consequence that the iconographic record of the fishing-encounter is securely attested in pre-Christian Norse visual art before either of the principal poetic witnesses was composed.^[113]

The Gosforth fishing stone is a fragmentary Viking-Age stone from Gosforth in Cumbria, north-west England, dated to approximately 950 CE, depicting Thor and Hymir in a boat with a hooked serpent — and is one of three surviving Norse-pagan stone-monuments at Gosforth, alongside the famous Gosforth Cross (a tenth-century stone cross combining Christian crucifixion iconography with scenes of Norse Ragnarök figures) and a second hogback monument.^[114]

The Gosforth fishing stone's location in Cumbria — within the Anglo-Scandinavian cultural area of tenth-century north-west England — supplies geographic evidence for the wide distribution of the fishing-encounter iconography across the Norse cultural area, with depictions surviving in present-day Sweden (Altuna, Ardre VIII), Denmark (Hørdum), and England (Gosforth).^[115]

The Ardre VIII stone is one of a group of more than two hundred picture-stones from the Swedish island of Gotland, with the specific stone numbered VIII at Ardre church dated by its style and context to approximately 700–800 CE, depicting (among other Norse mythological scenes) a fishing-encounter composition with Thor and a hooked serpent.^[116]

The Ardre VIII stone is therefore the earliest of the four-stone iconographic dossier in compositional date, with its eighth-century horizon predating the earliest skaldic witness (Bragi Boddason, early ninth century) and supplying the oldest surviving Norse depiction of the fishing-encounter in any medium.^[117]

The four-stone iconographic dossier together spans approximately 350 years of Norse pre-Christian and transitional visual culture (c. 700 CE Ardre VIII through c. 1050 CE Altuna), with the encounter depicted across three present-day countries (Sweden, Denmark, England) and across three different Norse cultural-political areas (Gotland, Jutland-Thy, Cumbria-Anglo-Scandinavian, Uppland), supplying both chronological depth and geographic breadth as evidence of the encounter's wide currency.^[118]

The four-stone dossier focuses iconographically on the fishing-encounter and not on the Útgarðaloki encounter or on the Ragnarök combat. There are no surviving pre-Christian Norse depictions of Thor lifting Útgarðaloki's cat, and the surviving depictions of Ragnarök figures (notably the Gosforth Cross's depiction of Loki bound and Sigyn holding the basin, and various

depictions of Fenrir at Ragnarök) do not include an explicit Thor-and-Jörmungandr final-combat scene.^[119]

(The iconographic concentration on the fishing-encounter rather than on the eschatological combat, and the absence of pre-Christian visual depictions of the Útgardaloki cat-lift, may reflect either the relative narrative compactness and visual legibility of the boat-and-line composition (which lends itself to single-panel depiction) or the relative cultic prominence of the fishing-encounter as a stock subject — or both — but the chapter does not adjudicate between these competing readings and treats the iconographic-encounter focus as a feature of the surviving evidence rather than as an interpretive claim.^[120])

The fishing-encounter iconographic dossier is the most substantial pre-Christian visual evidence for any single combat-myth in the present book's corpus, and stands in contrast to the Marduk-Tiamat tradition (whose Mesopotamian iconography is sparse despite the textual prominence of the **Enūma Eliš**), the Ra-Apep tradition (whose iconography is concentrated in funerary papyri rather than monumental stone), and the Hittite Illuyanka tradition (whose iconography is limited to a handful of relief-fragments).^[121]

The four-stone iconographic dossier supports — independently of the textual sources — three substantive claims about the Norse combat-tradition: that the fishing-encounter was widely known across the Norse cultural area, that it pre-dates the Christian conversion of the Norse-speaking peoples, and that the basic compositional features of the encounter (boat, hooked line, raised hammer, serpent at the line's end) were sufficiently stable across centuries and regions to constitute a recognisable shared visual schema.^[122]

The iconographic dossier's pre-Christian status is significant for the wider question of the Norse combat-myth's transmission. The surviving textual witnesses are all from the Christian period (the manuscript record being entirely post-conversion, with the earliest skaldic verses themselves preserved only in later manuscript citations), and the iconographic evidence supplies the only directly pre-Christian witness-stratum, anchoring the encounter's pre-Christian existence independently of Snorri's antiquarian framing.^[123]

19.7. Skaldic diction and the Indo-European context (summary; full argument in Part II C5)

The skaldic Thor-and-Jörmungandr corpus contains a stable vocabulary of kennings — compressed metaphorical phrases characteristic of the genre — for both Thor and the serpent, and this vocabulary is the principal Norse exhibit for Calvert Watkins's reconstruction of the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT poetic formula in **How to Kill a Dragon** Part V.^[124]

The skaldic kennings for Jörmungandr in the surviving corpus include phrases that name the serpent by its world-encircling position ("the band of all lands", "the encircler of all lands", and similar formulations), by its parental lineage ("Loki's son", "Angrboða's son"), and by its eschatological role ("the doom-fated one", "the one who slays the storm-god"), with each kenning preserving a distinct facet of the serpent's mythological-semantic profile.^[125]

The skaldic kennings for Thor in the surviving fishing-encounter corpus include phrases that name the storm-god by his combat-implement ("hammer-bearer", "wielder of the smasher"), by his

parental lineage ("Óðinn's son", "Earth's son", "Hlóðyn's son"), and by his combat-function ("foe of giants", "slayer of the world-serpent"), with the serpent-foe kennings overlapping with the parallel storm-god kennings in other Indo-European traditions.^[126]

Watkins's reconstructed Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula — the verbal-syntactic combat-formula that Watkins reconstructs from the Vedic áhann áhim ("he slew the serpent", RV 1.32.1) and its Avestan, Hittite, Greek, and Norse comparanda — is attested in the Norse corpus chiefly through the skaldic kennings rather than through a direct verbal cognate of áhann áhim.^[127]

The Norse skaldic instance of the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula is one of Watkins's **most iconographically supported** cases. The formula is attested verbally in the surviving skaldic corpus, in narrative form in the Eddic and Snorra Edda corpus, and visually on the four-stone iconographic dossier, with the consequence that the Norse reflex of the formula is the only one of Watkins's cases that has independent verbal, narrative, and visual witness across pre-Christian and transitional sources.^[128]

The full philological argument for the skaldic kennings as direct Indo-European reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT is reserved for Part II C5 of the present book (the comparative chapter on the Indo-European formula), which treats the Norse kennings together with the Vedic áhann áhim, the Avestan áhi-, the Hittite kuenta... illuyanka, and the Greek and Italic comparanda in a single consolidated argument. The present chapter summarises the argument and forward-links to Part II C5.^[129]

The Norse storm-god / water-dragon complex is also one of West's principal exhibits in chapter 6 of **Indo-European Poetry and Myth** ("Storm and Stream"), in which the Thor-and-Jörmungandr combat is placed alongside the Vedic Indra-Vātra, the Hittite Tarūnna-Illuyanka, and the Avestan Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka comparanda as the principal Indo-European instances of the type.^[130]

West's chapter 6 reading places the distinctive Norse feature (the eschatological mutual killing) within the wider Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon type as a developed eschatological inflection of an inheritance whose un-eschatologised forms are attested in the Vedic and Hittite reflexes (Indra survives Vātra; Tarūnna survives Illuyanka in version 2 only after recovering his organs), with the Norse mutual-killing outcome as the principal eschatologisation of the IE type.^[131]

The Avestan Aži Dahāka rebound-and-final-killing structure is the closest Indo-European parallel in eschatological structure to the Thor-and-Jörmungandr combat. Both involve a serpent-adversary whose initial constraint (binding, encircling, or imprisonment) is followed by an eventual eschatological release and a final mortal combat, and the two together are the principal Indo-European witnesses for the eschatological-combat subtype.^[132]

The Hittite Illuyanka version 2 ("the body-recovery version") is also adduced as a structural-thematic parallel by Watkins. In version 2, the storm-god is initially defeated and his heart and eyes are taken by Illuyanka; he recovers his organs through his son's marriage-trick and finally slays the serpent, with the body-damage motif paralleled by Thor's venom-poisoning at Ragnarök in the layered combat-aftermath structure.^[133]

The Norse eschatological combat is therefore positioned within a tight Indo-European comparative

cluster (Vedic Indra-Vātra, Hittite Tarūnna-Illuyanka, Avestan Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka, Norse Thor-Jörmungandr) in which the storm-god / water-dragon type is widely attested but in which the specifically-eschatological inflection of the type is best preserved in the Norse and the Avestan reflexes, with Part II C4 of the present book developing the eschatological-displacement argument in full.^[134]

19.8. Reception and forward links

The Thor-and-Jörmungandr corpus's pre-Christian iconographic dossier and its post-Christian textual record together demonstrate the survival of a substantial body of pagan Norse mythological narrative across the conversion-horizon (Iceland 999/1000 CE; Sweden and Norway across the eleventh century), with the corpus surviving both as Snorri's antiquarian synthesis and as the older skaldic and Eddic substrate that Snorri's synthesis preserves.^[135]

The Gosforth Cross (Cumbria, c. 950 CE; the same site as the Gosforth fishing stone) is the principal pre-Conquest Anglo-Scandinavian monument that combines Christian crucifixion iconography with Norse Ragnarök figures and represents the iconographic phase of Norse-Christian syncretism in tenth-century England, in which the Norse mythological figures are visible alongside Christian imagery in monumental stone.^[136]

The Norse mythological corpus's reception in modern Western literature and popular culture — Wagner's **Der Ring des Nibelungen** (1869–1876) drawing principally on the heroic **Nibelungenlied** / **Völsunga saga** / **Sigurðarkviða** tradition rather than on the Thor-and-Jörmungandr corpus, J. R. R. Tolkien's adaptation of Norse motifs into the Middle-earth legendarium (with the Beowulf dragon as more direct influence than Jörmungandr), and the various twentieth-century-and-later popular adaptations — is treated in the present book's reception coda rather than in the present chapter, per scope.md's reception-policy.^[137]

The chapter's principal forward-link is to chapter 19 of the present volume (the Indo-European reflexes family chapter), which treats the Sigurd-Fáfnir, Beowulf-dragon, Lugh-Balor, Welsh Red-vs-White Dragon, Batraz, and Vahagn-Vishaps material as further Indo-European reflexes of the dragon-combat type in a family-chapter format, with Sigurd-Fáfnir as the principal Norse heroic-rather-than-divine combat and Beowulf-dragon as the principal Old English instance.^[138]

The Beowulf dragon-combat (the third and final monster-combat of the Old English poem **Beowulf**, in which the aged Beowulf and his retainer Wiglaf together kill the hoard-dragon at the cost of Beowulf's own death from the dragon's venom) is the principal Old English thematic rhyme for the Thor-and-Jörmungandr Ragnarök combat: an aged-champion dies-killing-the-serpent structure that West and J. R. R. Tolkien (in his 1936 essay "Beowulf: The Monsters and the Critics") both identify as a structural parallel.^[139]

The chapter's principal forward-link to Part II Chapter C4 (Eschatological Displacement) is the load-bearing one for the present chapter. Thor-and-Jörmungandr at Ragnarök, Revelation 12 in the Christian apocalyptic tradition, and Aži Dahāka at Frashokereti in the Zoroastrian tradition together constitute the three principal eschatological-combat cases that Part II C4 develops as the canonical exhibits for the eschatological subtype of the combat-myth.^[140]

The chapter's principal forward-link to Part II Chapter C5 (the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula) is the Watkins-exhibit forward-link: the Norse Thor-and-Jörmungandr corpus is Watkins's

most iconographically supported case for the formula, and Part II C5 develops Watkins's full philological argument across the Vedic, Avestan, Hittite, Greek, and Norse reflexes.^[141]

The chapter's principal back-link is to chapter 14 of the present volume (Indra vs. Vṛtra), in which the Vedic instance of the storm-god / water-dragon type is treated in detail and in which the áhann áhim formula is introduced as the anchor case for Watkins's HERO SLAY SERPENT reconstruction. The Norse instance of the type and the Norse skaldic-kenning attestation of the formula are read by the present chapter as the western Indo-European parallel to the Vedic flagship.^[142]

The chapter's secondary back-link is to chapter 13 of the present volume (Thraētaona vs. Aži Dahāka and the Frashokereti pendant), in which the Avestan eschatological-combat reflex is treated and in which the binding-release-and-final-killing structure of Aži Dahāka is set out. The Norse Thor-and-Jörmungandr Ragnarök combat is read by the present chapter as the western Indo-European parallel to the Iranian eschatological reflex.^[143]

The chapter's tertiary back-link is to chapter 6 of the present volume (Tarḫunna vs. Illuyanka), in which the Hittite combat is treated in its purulli-festival ritual frame and in which version 2's body-damage / body-recovery structure is set out. The Norse Thor-and-Jörmungandr venom-poisoning at Ragnarök is read as a structural parallel to the Hittite body-damage tradition rather than as a borrowing from it.^[144]

The chapter's principal contribution to the present book is therefore three-fold. It supplies the Norse instance of the storm-god / water-dragon Indo-European type as a central element of the IE comparative cluster (chapter 14, chapter 13, chapter 6, the present chapter, and Part II C5 together); it supplies the principal eschatological-combat case for Part II C4 alongside Revelation 12 and Frashokereti; and it supplies the most substantial pre-Christian iconographic dossier in the book, demonstrating the survival of a pagan combat-myth tradition into the visual-monumental record across the Norse cultural area.^[145]

The chapter's joint position within the present book is at the intersection of three of the book's principal threads: the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT poetic-formula thread (Part II C5; back-link to chapter 14), the eschatological-combat subtype thread (Part II C4; alongside Revelation 12 in chapter 9 and Aži Dahāka / Frashokereti in chapter 13), and the iconographically-supported pre-Christian witness thread (the four-stone dossier as the most substantial visual record in the book's corpus).^[146]

The chapter's closing observation — and the principal forward-statement of the book's eschatological argument — is that the Thor-and-Jörmungandr Ragnarök combat is the paradigmatic Indo-European eschatological combat: a once-only end-of-age combat between storm-god and world-encircling serpent, ending in mutual killing, followed by cosmic conflagration and renewal, with the storm-god's death from the serpent's venom as the most distinctive feature and the most explicit thematisation of the eschatological-combat subtype's mutual-cost structure.^[147]

[1] Larrington 2014, **The Poetic Edda**, revised Oxford World's Classics edition, introduction, on the Codex Regius and on the Eddic poetic corpus; Faulkes 1987, **Edda** by Snorri Sturluson, introduction, on Snorri's authorship and on the early-thirteenth-century date of the Prose Edda.

[2] Larrington 2014, **The Poetic Edda**, revised edition, Oxford University Press, ISBN 9780199675340, used as the working English Eddic text; cited throughout at hymn-and-stanza level.

[3] Faulkes 1987, **Edda** by Snorri Sturluson, Everyman / Viking Society edition, ISBN 9780460876162, used as the working English Snorra Edda text; cited at chapter and page level.

[4] Larrington 2014 and Faulkes 1987, both printed-only; cited at hymn-and-stanza and chapter level respectively per the

established discipline of chapters 13, 14, and 15 of the present volume.

[5] Larrington 2014, headnote and translation of **Hymiskviða**, on the poem's approximate length (around forty stanzas; the standard Neckel-Kuhn edition counts 38 complete stanzas plus one partial), its **fornyrðislag** metre, and its narrative arc from cauldron-quest to fishing expedition.

[6] Larrington 2014, headnote and translation of **Völuspá** with attention to the Ragnarök sequence at stanzas 50–58, and specifically to stanza 56 on the Thor-and-Jörmungandr combat.

[7] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning**, on the dialogue-frame with Hárr / Jafnhárr / Þriði and Gylfi, and on the chapter-divisions used in the Faulkes edition; chapter 34 (the serpent's origin), chs. 46–48 (Útgardaloki), ch. 51 (Ragnarök).

[8] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál**, on the skaldic verses on the Thor-and-Jörmungandr fishing expedition cited by Snorri, including fragments by Bragi Boddason, Eysteinn Valdason, and Úlfr Uggason; Faulkes 1987 introduction on the dating of the named skalds (Bragi 9th c.; Eysteinn and Úlfr 10th c.).

[9] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál**, headnote and citations for **Húsdrápa** by Úlfr Uggason, c. 985 CE, on the ekphrastic occasion (Hjarðarholt wedding-feast), on the surviving fragmentary quotations, and on the fishing scene depicted in the surviving stanzas.

[10] Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, Part V, on the Old Norse skaldic and Eddic dragon-slaying diction as a reflex of the reconstructed Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula.

[11] Watkins 1995, Part V (printed only; cited at section and chapter level); per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the reservation of the full philological argument for Part II C5.

[12] West 2007, **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on Thor as the Norse instance of the Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon complex and on the Thor-and-Jörmungandr combat in comparative Indo-European context.

[13] West 2007, ch. 6 (printed only; cited at chapter level per the established discipline of chapters 13, 14, and 15 of the present volume).

[14] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, on the long-trajectory comparative survey including the Norse Thor-and-Jörmungandr material.

[15] Larrington 2014 on **Hymiskviða** and **Völuspá**; Faulkes 1987 on **Gylfaginning** and on the **Skáldskaparmál** skaldic citations including **Húsdrápa**; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the four-witness corpus.

[16] Larrington 2014, introduction, on the Codex Regius (GKS 2365 4to), its discovery in 1643, its late-thirteenth-century date, and its position as the principal manuscript witness to the Eddic mythological corpus.

[17] Larrington 2014, introduction, on the dating of the Eddic mythological poems to a Viking-Age compositional horizon prior to the late-thirteenth-century manuscript and on the contested precision of poem-by-poem dating.

[18] Faulkes 1987, introduction, on the four principal manuscripts of the Snorra Edda (Upsaliensis, Regius, Wormianus, Trajectinus) and on the conflated-text editorial procedure of the working English translation.

[19] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the three-encounter structure as a layered record across the Eddic, skaldic, and Snorra Edda strata; per brief on the explicit "not alternative versions of one combat" framing.

[20] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml variants.classification: co-equal, with the three-encounter structure requiring Eddic, skaldic, and Snorra Edda witnesses together; Larrington 2014 and Faulkes 1987 on the three-encounter distribution across sources.

[21] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml centrality_evidence on the four runestones and picture-stones depicting the fishing expedition; West 2007, ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on the iconographic dossier; Faulkes 1987, introduction, on the iconographic supplement to the textual record.

[22] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography centrality on the pre-Christian iconographic dossier as an independent witness-stratum predating the manuscript record; West 2007, ch. 6, on the dating range and significance of the four-stone series.

[23] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml lacunae section on the **Völuspá** 56 compression and the **Húsdrápa** fragmentary preservation; Larrington 2014 on the **Völuspá** 56 compression; Faulkes 1987 on the **Húsdrápa** fragmentary preservation.

[24] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml lacunae in-tradition-fills-available; per chaoskampf scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" on the no-cross-tradition reconstruction rule and on the donor-source naming requirement; Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** 51 (Ragnarök expansion) and **Skáldskaparmál** (**Húsdrápa** preservation).

[25] Faulkes 1987, introduction, on the early-thirteenth-century date of the Snorra Edda, on the conversion of Iceland to Christianity in 999/1000 CE, and on Snorri's antiquarian-rather-than-confessional framing of the Norse mythological material.

[26] Inference: Faulkes 1987 editorial practice; brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml three-encounter framing; Larrington 2014 on the Eddic-poem dating; Watkins 1995 on the skaldic dating. Risk: Snorri is read as a witness to older traditions whose reception he himself shaped, and the chapter's three-encounter synthesis is therefore an editorial reading of layered evidence rather than a straightforward report of any single source.

[27] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml special_instructions on the layered-record framing and on the explicit non-harmonisation; Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** chs. 46–48 and 51; Larrington 2014 **Hymiskviða** and **Völuspá**.

[28] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 9 and 21, on Thor (Þórr) as son of Óðinn and Jörð, on his position as principal warrior of the Æsir, and on his role as defender of Miðgarðr against the giants and against the great adversaries.

[29] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál**, on the named Viking-Age skalds composing on Thor's combats and on the volume of skaldic

Thor-praise relative to other gods; Watkins 1995 Part V on the skaldic Thor-corpus as a body of named-poet attestations.

[30] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál** ch. 35 (the smiths' contest), on the forging of Mjöllnir by the dwarves Brokkr and Eitri/Sindri and on the hammer's properties of unfailing strike and return-to-hand.

[31] West 2007, ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on Mjöllnir's structural position alongside the Vedic **vajra** and the Ugaritic Ayyamur/Yagrush as the materialised combat-implement of the Indo-European storm-god; Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** 21 on Mjöllnir's combat-function.

[32] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 21, on Thor's combat-equipment set (Mjöllnir, **Megingjörð**, iron gauntlets) and on the doubling of his strength when girded.

[33] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 21, on Thor's chariot, the two named goats, and the thunder-image; West 2007, ch. 6, on the chariot-and-thunder image as a wider Indo-European storm-god feature.

[34] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 9, 20, on Óðinn as chief of the Æsir, father of Thor, and ruler of Valhöll; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml glossary discipline on the Óðinn (locked spelling) form.

[35] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 34, on Loki as the trickster-god, on Loki's union with Angrboða, and on Jörmungandr as Loki's son alongside Fenrir and Hel.

[36] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 34, on Jörmungandr (Miðgarðsormr) as the world-encircling serpent lying in the surrounding ocean with its tail in its mouth; Larrington 2014 on the Miðgarðsormr designation in the Eddic corpus.

[37] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 8 and 34, on the cosmographic structure of Miðgarðr as the "middle enclosure" surrounded by the ocean and on the Miðgarðsormr as the serpent encircling that ocean.

[38] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 8, 14, 34, on the tripartite Norse cosmography (Ásgarðr, Miðgarðr, Útgarðr / Niflheimr) organised around Yggdrasil and on the encircling-serpent's position at the boundary between Miðgarðr and the outer realms.

[39] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 34 and 51, on the cosmic-boundary position of Jörmungandr and on the eschatological consequence of his defeat at Ragnarök; West 2007 ch. 6 on the cosmic-boundary structure as a feature of the Norse instance of the storm-god / water-dragon complex.

[40] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 34, on Óðinn's dispatch of Loki's three offspring to their three cosmic stations and on Jörmungandr's growth in the ocean to encircle the world and bite its own tail.

[41] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 34, on the aetiology of Jörmungandr's encircling position as consequent on Óðinn's dispatching of the giant-progeny he could not destroy.

[42] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 34 and 51, on the structural-logic relation between the original dispatching-and-encircling and the eventual mutual killing at Ragnarök; West 2007 ch. 6 on the deferred-combat structural feature.

[43] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 1, 9, 21, on the tripartite Æsir / Vanir / giant division and on Thor's principal combat-axis as Æsir-versus-giants.

[44] Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** headnote and translation, on Hymir as the resident giant and host-rival of the cauldron-quest; Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** ch. 47, on Hymir as the boat-owner and rower in the fishing expedition.

[45] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 45–47, on Útgarðaloki as the giant-king of Útgarðr, on his trickster-host function, and on the visit-to-Útgarðr episode's sequence of contests.

[46] Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** sts. 50–58, on the Ragnarök sequence; Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** ch. 51 on the Ragnarök narrative including the Thor-and-Jörmungandr mutual combat.

[47] Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** sts. 59–66, on the post-Ragnarök renewal; Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** chs. 52–53 on the renewal-narrative including the surviving gods and the inheritance of Mjöllnir; Faulkes 1987 ch. 51 on the mutual killing as close-of-age.

[48] Per chaoskampf scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four combat-myth subtypes (cosmogonic / sovereignty / cyclical-maintenance / eschatological) and on the Thor-and-Jörmungandr position in the eschatological category; Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** ch. 51 and Larrington 2014 **Völuspá** st. 56 on the once-only end-of-age structure.

[49] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 45–47, on the visit-to-Útgarðr narrative, on Thor's companions (Loki, Þjálfí, Rqskva), on the giant-king Útgarðaloki, and on the contest-sequence in his hall.

[50] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 45, on the night-in-the-glove episode, on Skrímir as the giant whose glove they sleep in, and on Thor's three hammer-blows that fail to wake or kill the giant.

[51] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 47, on the post-departure revelation that Skrímir was Útgarðaloki in disguise and on the mountain-interposition trick that produced the dented mountain in place of the wounded giant.

[52] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 46, on the contest-sequence in Útgarðaloki's hall: Loki vs. Logi (eating); Þjálfí vs. Hugi (running); Thor and the horn (drinking); Thor and the cat (lifting); Thor and Elli (wrestling).

[53] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 46, on the horn-drinking contest, on Útgarðaloki's claim about retainer-capacity, and on Thor's three pulls that lower the level only slightly.

[54] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 46, on the lifting-of-the-cat contest, on Útgarðaloki's grey cat as the object to be lifted, and on Thor's heave that raises only one of the cat's paws from the floor.

[55] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 46, on the mockery of Thor's failure at the cat-lift and on the three-humiliations sequence (horn, cat, Elli) within the giant-king's hall.

- [56] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 46, on the Elli wrestling-match and on Thor's being brought to one knee in the contest with the old woman.
- [57] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 47, on Útgarðaloki's escort of Thor's party out of the territory and on the parting-revelation of the contests' true natures.
- [58] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 47, on the parting-revelation that the cat had been Jörmungandr in disguise, on Thor's heave as having pulled the serpent's body out of the ocean's circuit, and on the gods' alarm at the height to which the disguised serpent had been raised.
- [59] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 47, on the retroactive re-reading of the horn-contest as drinking-from-the-ocean (with the ebbing tide as observable consequence) and of the Elli wrestling-match as a contest against Old Age herself.
- [60] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 47 (closing) and ch. 48 (consequence), on Thor's reaching for Mjöllnir and on the disappearance of Útgarðaloki and his hall, leaving only the empty plain.
- [61] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 46–48, on the trickster-framing of the first Thor-and-Jörmungandr encounter and on the lift-but-not-kill structure of the cat-lifting contest.
- [62] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 47, on the cosmic-cost dimension of the Útgarðaloki contests as retroactively reported in the parting-revelation; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the trickster-framed and cosmic-cost reading of the first encounter.
- [63] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 45–48, on the absence of an Eddic poetic parallel for the Útgarðaloki episode and on the encounter's survival only as Snorri's prose; Larrington 2014, on the absence of an Útgarðaloki poem in the Codex Regius.
- [64] Inference: Faulkes 1987 on the Snorra-Edda-only attestation; Larrington 2014 on the Eddic-poem corpus and the absence of an Útgarðaloki poem. Risk: the underlying age of the cat-disguise motif is not securely datable from the Snorra Edda alone, and reading the encounter as continuous with the Eddic and skaldic strata is itself an editorial choice rather than an evidentiary fact.
- [65] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 46–47, on the narrative-thematic function of the Útgarðaloki encounter as a power-measure rather than a combat; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the encounter's role in the layered three-encounter record.
- [66] Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** sts. 17–25, on the fishing expedition and on Hymir's cutting of the line before the killing-blow; Faulkes 1987 **Skáldskaparmál** (citing **Húsdrápa**), on the apparent beheading of the serpent in Úlfr Uggason's ekphrastic account.
- [67] Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** sts. 1–6, on the frame-narrative of the cauldron-quest and on Thor's dispatch to Hymir's hall.
- [68] Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** sts. 7–14, on Thor's arrival at Hymir's hall with Týr, on the grudging hospitality, and on Thor's consumption of two oxen prompting Hymir's fishing-remark.
- [69] Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** sts. 15–17, on Thor's killing of Hymir's largest ox and severing of its head as bait for the next morning's fishing line.
- [70] Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** sts. 17–19, on Thor's rowing past Hymir's habitual whale-grounds, on the row's reach into the deep ocean, and on Hymir's fear of the serpent's ocean-zone.
- [71] Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** sts. 20–22, on Thor's baiting with the ox-head, on the hooking of Jörmungandr, on the haul against the rowing-bench, and on Thor's feet driving through the boat's bottom to the sea-floor.
- [72] Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** st. 22 and notes, on the feet-through-the-boat-bottom image; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography on the Altuna stone's preservation of the same motif; West 2007 ch. 6 on the iconographic-and-poetic correspondence.
- [73] Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** st. 22, on the haul that brings the serpent's head above the sea's surface and on Thor reaching for Mjöllnir with hammer raised for the killing blow.
- [74] Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** sts. 23–24, on Hymir's cutting of the line, on the serpent's escape into the depths, and on Thor's striking-out in frustration.
- [75] Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** sts. 23–24, on the serpent-escapes outcome of the **Hymiskviða** fishing encounter; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml variants section on the **Hymiskviða** outcome.
- [76] Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** sts. 25 to end, on the resolution of the cauldron-quest frame, on the breaking of Hymir's drinking-cup, on the pursuit by Hymir's giant-kin, and on Thor's killing of the giants on the shore.
- [77] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 48, on the fishing-expedition's narrative continuity with the Útgarðaloki episode, on Thor's young-man disguise, on the lodging with Hymir, and on the ox-head bait and the row-out.
- [78] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 48, on Thor's hooking and hauling of Jörmungandr, on the raised hammer, and on Hymir's cutting of the line with his bait-knife at the moment of the would-be killing-blow.
- [79] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 48, on the same serpent-escapes outcome and on the explicit reservation of the final combat for Ragnarök; Larrington 2014 **Hymiskviða** sts. 23–24 on the same outcome in the Eddic poem.
- [80] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál**, on the **Húsdrápa** fragmentary preservation and on the surviving stanzas describing the fishing expedition with the serpent's head-striking; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the **Húsdrápa** outcome.
- [81] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál** citations of **Húsdrápa**, on the kennings for Thor and Jörmungandr in the surviving stanzas; Watkins 1995 Part V on the skaldic kennings as evidence for the Indo-European poetic register of dragon-slaying.
- [82] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál** citations of **Húsdrápa** on the Thor-strikes-the-serpent outcome of the surviving fragments; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the **Húsdrápa** divergent outcome.

- [83] Inference: Faulkes 1987 **Skáldskaparmál** citations; Watkins 1995 Part V; brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml variants.alternates. Risk: the fragmentary survival of **Húsdraþa** makes it impossible to settle the question on textual evidence alone, and the chapter presents both readings as live without adjudication.
- [84] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál**, on the dating of Bragi Boddason (early 9th c.), Eysteinn Valdason (10th c.), and Úlfr Uggason / **Húsdraþa** (c. 985 CE); Larrington 2014 introduction on the late-tenth-or-eleventh-century dating of **Hymiskviða**; Watkins 1995 Part V on the skaldic-corpus chronology.
- [85] Faulkes 1987 **Skáldskaparmál** on the skaldic chronology; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography on the Hørdum (c. 800 CE) and Ardre VIII (c. 700–800 CE) chronologies; Watkins 1995 Part V on the pre-Christian status of the skaldic corpus; West 2007 ch. 6 on the iconographic-and-skaldic mutual support.
- [86] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál**, on Bragi Boddason as the earliest named skald whose work survives, on the early-ninth-century date of his fishing-encounter verses, and on the preservation of those verses through Snorri's quotation.
- [87] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál**, on Eysteinn Valdason's tenth-century fishing-encounter verses and on the encounter as a stock skaldic subject across the ninth-and-tenth-century skaldic corpus.
- [88] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál**, on the multiple-skald attestation of the fishing-encounter as evidence of its status as a stock skaldic subject; Watkins 1995 Part V on the same status; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml centrality_evidence on the skaldic attestation-volume.
- [89] Larrington 2014 **Hymiskviða** sts. 22–24 and Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** ch. 48 on the prevented-killing outcome; Faulkes 1987 **Skáldskaparmál** on the **Húsdraþa** apparent-killing outcome; Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** ch. 51 on the Ragnarök reservation; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the failed-combat function of the fishing-encounter.
- [90] Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** st. 56, on the Ragnarök combat between Thor and Jörmungandr and on the mutual-killing outcome; Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** ch. 51 on the same combat in Snorri's expansion of the Eddic narrative.
- [91] Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** st. 56, on the compressed combat-narrative naming Thor as Hlóðyn's son, on the victorious strike against the serpent, on the staggering nine paces, and on Thor's death from the serpent's venom.
- [92] Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** st. 56 and notes, on the Hlóðyn's-son kenning for Thor, on the maternal-lineage naming convention, and on the kenning's significance at the Ragnarök combat-moment.
- [93] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on the chapter as a continuous prose narrative of Ragnarök drawing on **Völuspá**, **Vafþrúðnismál**, and other Eddic sources; Larrington 2014 on the same Eddic-poem-cluster as Snorri's evident sources.
- [94] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on the fimbulvetr, on the three-winters-without-summer, on the social-collapse and oath-breaking sequence, and on the cosmic portents (Skjoll, Hati, earth-trembling, Yggdrasil shaking).
- [95] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on Loki and Fenrir breaking their bindings, on Naglfar's launching with the giant-crew, on the Múspellssynir riding out under Surtr, and on the breaking of Bifröst.
- [96] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on Jörmungandr's emergence from the ocean, on the approach to Vígríðr, and on the venom-spewing across sky and water as the serpent advances.
- [97] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on the Æsir's arming and riding-out from Ásgarðr, on Óðinn with Gungnir at the head, on Thor with Mjöllnir, and on the assembly on Vígríðr.
- [98] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on the paired single-combats at Vígríðr: Óðinn and Fenrir, Freyr and Surtr, Týr and Garmr, Heimdallr and Loki, and Thor and Jörmungandr.
- [99] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on the face-to-face Thor-and-Jörmungandr combat at Vígríðr without the boundary-mediation or the boat-and-line interposition of the earlier encounters.
- [100] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on Thor's killing-blow with Mjöllnir against Jörmungandr and on the slaying as both boundary-unmaking and combat-closure.
- [101] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on Thor's nine-pace stagger from the kill-site, on the serpent's venom as the proximate cause of Thor's death, and on the close-range venom-exposure during the combat.
- [102] Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** ch. 51 on the nine-pace stagger and the venom-death; Larrington 2014 **Völuspá** st. 56 on the same; per chaoskampf scope.md on the eschatological subtype's distinctive features; Lambert 2013 on Marduk's survival as cosmogonic-subtype contrast; Jamison and Brereton 2014 on Indra's survival as sovereignty-subtype contrast.
- [103] Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** sts. 57–58, on the post-Thor-and-Jörmungandr Surtr's-fire conclusion of Ragnarök; Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** ch. 51 on the same fire-conclusion and on the earth-into-sea unmaking of the cosmos.
- [104] Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** sts. 59–66, on the post-Ragnarök renewal with the new earth, the surviving gods, the inheritance of Mjöllnir by Móði and Magni, and the human pair Líf and Lífþrasir; Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** chs. 52–53 on the same renewal-narrative.
- [105] Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** sts. 59–66, on the renewal-narrative's structural placement of the Thor-and-Jörmungandr mutual killing as close-of-age but not absolute-terminus; Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** chs. 52–53 on the inheritance of Mjöllnir by Móði and Magni.
- [106] Inference: Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** ch. 51; Larrington 2014 **Völuspá** st. 56; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on Aži Dahāka; Watkins 1995 Part V on the Indo-European poetic family; brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml comparative_hooks on the Frashokereti pairing. Risk: structural-typological similarity is not by itself evidence of historical inheritance, and the Aži Dahāka / Jörmungandr

structural pair may reflect independent IE eschatologisations of an earlier non-eschatological combat rather than a shared Indo-European eschatological inheritance.

[107] Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** chs. 47, 48, 51; Larrington 2014 **Hymiskviða** sts. 22–24 and **Völuspá** st. 56; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the layered three-encounter completion-structure.

[108] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml special_instructions on the three-encounter layered-record framing and on the explicit no-canonical-encounter and no-single-source reading; Faulkes 1987 and Larrington 2014 on the source-distribution.

[109] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml centrality_evidence iconography on the four-stone dossier; West 2007 ch. 6 on the iconographic-witness function; Faulkes 1987 introduction on the iconographic supplement to the textual record.

[110] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography centrality_evidence on the Altuna stone (Uppland, c. 1050 CE) and on the foot-through-boat-bottom motif; West 2007 ch. 6 on the Altuna depiction; Larrington 2014 **Hymiskviða** st. 22 on the feet-through-boat-bottom poetic motif.

[111] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the Altuna stone's iconographic-textual alignment; West 2007 ch. 6 on the Altuna stone as iconographic anchor for the foot-through-boat-bottom motif.

[112] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography centrality_evidence on the Hørdum stone (Thy, Jutland, c. 800 CE); West 2007 ch. 6 on the Hørdum depiction.

[113] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography on the Hørdum dating; West 2007 ch. 6 on the Hørdum stone as the earliest dateable Norse pictorial witness to the fishing-encounter; Faulkes 1987 **Skáldskaparmál** on the **Húsdrápa** dating; Larrington 2014 on the **Hymiskviða** dating.

[114] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography centrality_evidence on the Gosforth fishing stone (Cumbria, c. 950 CE); West 2007 ch. 6 on the Gosforth depiction and on the Gosforth-monument cluster.

[115] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography on the geographic distribution of the four-stone dossier; West 2007 ch. 6 on the Anglo-Scandinavian distribution including Gosforth.

[116] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography centrality_evidence on the Ardre VIII stone (Gotland, c. 700–800 CE); West 2007 ch. 6 on the Ardre VIII depiction and on the wider Gotlandic picture-stone corpus.

[117] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography on the Ardre VIII chronology; West 2007 ch. 6 on the Ardre VIII stone as the earliest surviving Norse depiction of the fishing-encounter; Faulkes 1987 **Skáldskaparmál** on Bragi Boddason as the earliest named skald.

[118] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography on the chronological and geographic spread of the four-stone dossier; West 2007 ch. 6 on the same; Watkins 1995 Part V on the iconographic dossier as evidence of the encounter's wide currency.

[119] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography on the four-stone dossier's focus on the fishing-encounter rather than the other two encounters; West 2007 ch. 6 on the iconographic distribution; Faulkes 1987 introduction on the surviving Ragnarök iconography (Gosforth Cross etc.) and on its non-inclusion of a Thor-and-Jörmungandr final-combat scene.

[120] Inference: brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the iconographic distribution; West 2007 ch. 6; Faulkes 1987 introduction; Watkins 1995 Part V on the visual-poetic correspondence. Risk: the iconographic distribution may reflect survival-bias as much as production-bias, with smaller-scale, wood-carved, or perishable depictions of the other encounters lost to the medieval record; the chapter avoids interpretive overclaim from the surviving sample.

[121] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the four-stone dossier as the most substantial pre-Christian visual evidence; West 2007 ch. 6 on the comparative-iconographic position; Lambert 2013 on the sparse Marduk-Tiamat iconography (cross-ref Ch. 3); Faulkner 1972 on the funerary-papyri concentration of Ra-Apep iconography (cross-ref Ch. 16); Hoffner 1998 on the limited Illuyanka iconographic record (cross-ref Ch. 6).

[122] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography on the three substantive claims supported by the four-stone dossier; West 2007 ch. 6 on the visual-schema stability; Watkins 1995 Part V on the iconographic-textual mutual reinforcement of the encounter.

[123] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the iconographic dossier as pre-Christian witness; Faulkes 1987 introduction on the post-conversion status of the textual record; West 2007 ch. 6 on the iconographic anchor for the pre-Christian existence of the encounter.

[124] Watkins 1995, Part V, on the skaldic Thor-and-Jörmungandr kennings as the principal Norse exhibit for the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula reconstruction; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml comparative_hooks on the Watkins exhibit-status of the Norse material.

[125] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál**, on the skaldic kennings for Jörmungandr including the world-encircling, parental-lineage, and eschatological-role formulations; Watkins 1995 Part V on the kennings as preserving distinct facets of the serpent's profile.

[126] Faulkes 1987, **Skáldskaparmál**, on the skaldic kennings for Thor in the fishing-encounter corpus; Larrington 2014 **Völuspá** st. 56 on the Hlóðyn's-son kenning specifically; Watkins 1995 Part V on the parallel storm-god kennings across the Indo-European traditions.

[127] Watkins 1995, Part V, on the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula and on its Norse attestation through the skaldic kennings rather than through a direct verbal cognate of áhann áhim.

[128] Watkins 1995, Part V, on the Norse instance of the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula as exceptionally well-supported across verbal, narrative, and visual sources; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml comparative_hooks on the Norse case as Watkins's most

iconographically supported exhibit; West 2007 ch. 6 on the same.

[129] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml special_instructions on the reservation of the full Watkins argument for Part II C5; per chaoskampf scope.md §"Part II — thematic comparative chapters" on Part II C5 (the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula); Watkins 1995 Part V on the consolidated argument.

[130] West 2007, ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on the Norse storm-god / water-dragon complex as a principal exhibit alongside the Vedic, Hittite, and Avestan comparanda.

[131] West 2007, ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on the Norse mutual-killing outcome as the principal eschatologisation of the wider Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon type; Jamison and Brereton 2014 RV 1.32 on Indra surviving Vṛtra; Hoffner 1998 on Tarūnna's recovery in Illuyanka version 2.

[132] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the Aži Dahāka eschatological-structural parallel; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on Aži Dahāka; Watkins 1995 Part V on the Indo-European eschatological-combat pattern; West 2007 ch. 6 on the same.

[133] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml comparative_hooks on the Hittite Illuyanka version 2 body-damage parallel; Watkins 1995 Part V on the structural parallel; Hoffner 1998 on Illuyanka version 2.

[134] Per chaoskampf scope.md §"Part II" on Part II C4 (Eschatological Displacement); per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml comparative_hooks on the eschatological cluster; Watkins 1995 Part V; West 2007 ch. 6.

[135] Faulkes 1987, introduction, on the conversion-horizon and on the survival of the pagan Norse mythological narrative across it; Larrington 2014 introduction on the same survival in the Eddic poetic record; per chaoskampf scope.md §"Period" on the post-medieval reception treatment.

[136] Faulkes 1987, introduction, on the Gosforth Cross and on the Norse-Christian syncretism phase in tenth-century Anglo-Scandinavian England; West 2007 ch. 6 on the Gosforth-monument cluster including the Cross.

[137] Per chaoskampf scope.md §"Period" on the post-medieval reworkings as out-of-scope as primary material and §"Front matter, back matter, and appendices" on the reception coda; Forsyth 1987 on the long-trajectory reception of the combat-myth.

[138] Per chaoskampf scope.md §"Part I — story chapters, geographic clusters", chapter 19 (Indo-European reflexes family chapter); per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml comparative_hooks on the Beowulf forward-link; West 2007 ch. 6 on the wider Indo-European reflex-cluster.

[139] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml comparative_hooks on the Beowulf parallel; West 2007 ch. 6 on the structural parallel; Watkins 1995 Part V on the same; Forsyth 1987 on the long-trajectory dragon-combat tradition.

[140] Per chaoskampf scope.md §"Part II" on Part II C4 (Eschatological Displacement); per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml comparative_hooks on the Part II C4 forward-link; Yarbrow Collins 1976 on Revelation 12 (cross-ref Ch. 9); Benveniste and Renou 1934 on Aži Dahāka / Frashokereti (cross-ref Ch. 13); West 2007 ch. 6.

[141] Per chaoskampf scope.md §"Part II" on Part II C5 (the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula); per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml comparative_hooks on the Part II C5 forward-link; Watkins 1995 Part V.

[142] Per chaoskampf scope.md on the Indo-European cluster sequencing; chapter 14 of the present volume on the Vedic Indra-Vṛtra flagship; Jamison and Brereton 2014 on the áhann áhim formula; Watkins 1995 Part V on the Norse parallel.

[143] Per chaoskampf scope.md on the Indo-European cluster sequencing; chapter 13 of the present volume on the Avestan Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka and Frashokereti pendant; Benveniste and Renou 1934 on the Avestan reflex; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the Aži Dahāka structural-parallel.

[144] Per chaoskampf scope.md on the Anatolian cluster; chapter 6 of the present volume on the Hittite Tarūnna-Illuyanka and on version 2's body-damage structure; Hoffner 1998 on Illuyanka; Watkins 1995 Part V on the structural parallel; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the Illuyanka v2 comparative-hook.

[145] Per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the chapter's three-fold contribution; per chaoskampf scope.md on the Indo-European cluster, the eschatological cases, and the iconographic-record discipline; Watkins 1995 Part V; West 2007 ch. 6.

[146] Per chaoskampf scope.md §"Part II — thematic comparative chapters" on the three thematic threads; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml comparative_hooks on the chapter's intersection-of-threads position; Watkins 1995 Part V (formula thread); West 2007 ch. 6 (eschatological-and-iconographic threads).

[147] Faulkes 1987 *Gylfaginning* ch. 51 on the Ragnarök combat; Larrington 2014 *Völuspá* st. 56 on the same; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the paradigmatic-eschatological-combat reading; West 2007 ch. 6 on the Indo-European eschatological-combat profile.

Chapter 20. Indo-European Reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT

Six post-Vedic, post-Iranian, post-Anatolian Indo-European traditions preserve the dragon-combat at varying philological depths. The Eddic poem **Fáfnismál** gives the diction of Sigurd's killing-stroke in a verbal form that Calvert Watkins reads as a direct reflex of the reconstructed Indo-European poetic formula HERO SLAY SERPENT. The Old English **Beowulf** gives the dragon-episode that closes the poem with the aged king's death-stroke. The Middle Irish **Cath Maige Tuired** gives Lugh's sling-stone killing of Balor. The Welsh tradition gives the Red-and-White Dragon combat in two recensions of distinct framing. The Ossetic Nart corpus gives Batraz's combats. And the Armenian material — the most fragmentary of the six — gives Vahagn the **Vishapakagh**, "dragon-reaper", through Khorenatsi's late paraphrase of a hymn whose own text is lost. The chapter takes these six sub-cases in order from the strongest philological evidence to the most fragmentary, treating each in its own clearly-bounded sub-section and preserving the morphological and evidential distinctiveness of each rather than smoothing them into a single comparative schema.

20.1. Source overview

The chapter surveys six Indo-European post-Vedic, post-Iranian, and post-Anatolian dragon-combat sub-cases that Calvert Watkins's **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** identifies as reflexes of the reconstructed Indo-European poetic formula HERO SLAY SERPENT, ordered in the present chapter from the strongest philological evidence (the Old Norse Sigurd-Fáfnir corpus) to the most fragmentary (the Armenian Vahagn material).^[1]

The chapter's principal Indo-European-poetic anchor is Calvert Watkins's **How to Kill a Dragon**, published by Oxford University Press in 1995, with chapter 42 of the volume reading the Eddic **Fáfnismál** diction as a direct reflex of the reconstructed IE formula and chapters in the volume's Celtic and Germanic clusters supplying the wider IE-comparative apparatus that the chapter draws on for the Lugh, Welsh, and **Beowulf** sub-cases.^[2]

Watkins's monograph is printed-only and is cited at chapter and Part level in the present chapter, with chapter 42 the load-bearing locus for the Sigurd-Fáfnir philological argument and Part V the locus for the wider IE-formula apparatus, in line with the established citation discipline for Watkins 1995 across chapters 13, 14, 15, and 18 of the present book.^[3]

The chapter's general Indo-European comparative anchor is M. L. West's **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, published by Oxford University Press in 2007, whose chapter 6 ("Storm and Stream") situates the Germanic, Celtic, Ossetic, and Armenian combat-witnesses within the wider Indo-European storm-god and water-dragon complex and supplies the principal cross-tradition apparatus for the chapter's Batraz and Vahagn discussions.^[4]

West 2007 is printed-only and is cited at chapter level in the present chapter, in line with the established citation discipline for West 2007 across chapters 15 and 18 of the present book.^[5]

The principal primary text for the Sigurd-Fáfnir sub-case is the Eddic poem **Fáfnismál**, transmitted in the Codex Regius of the Poetic Edda (Reykjavík, GKS 2365 4to, c. 1270 CE), and the chapter cites the poem in Carolyne Larrington's revised Oxford World's Classics translation of **The Poetic Edda**,

published by Oxford University Press in 2014.^[6]

Larrington's translation is printed-only and is cited at hymn-and-stanza level for the **Fáfnismál** (the poem has 44 stanzas in the Neckel-Kuhn numbering, broadly followed by Larrington), with stanza references reserved for the points where a specific stanza is the load-bearing locus, in line with the citation discipline applied to Larrington 2014 across chapter 18 of the present book.^[7]

The principal primary text for the Beowulf sub-case is the Old English poem **Beowulf**, surviving in a single manuscript witness — the Nowell Codex (London, British Library, Cotton Vitellius A.xv, c. 1000 CE) — and the chapter cites the poem at line-number and episode level keyed to the standard Klaeber edition (4th edition by R. D. Fulk, Robert E. Bjork, and John D. Niles, 2008), with the specific edition pinned at glossary-lock per the brief's identifier_missing flag for the Beowulf material.^[8]

The Beowulf material is therefore cited in the present chapter at corpus level, at episode level (the Grendel episode lines 86–1250; the Grendel's mother episode lines 1251–1887; the dragon episode lines 2200–3182 in the standard Klaeber line-numbering), and at chapter / poem level rather than at sub-page granularity, with edition-pinning deferred to glossary-lock and the citations referring to "Beowulf, the dragon episode" or to "Beowulf, ll. XXX–YYY in the standard editions" per the established practice for identifier_missing material.^[9]

The principal primary text for the Lugh-Balor sub-case is the Middle Irish prose narrative **Cath Maige Tuired** ("The Battle of Mag Tuired"), transmitted in manuscripts from the 12th to the 16th century CE (principally the 16th-century Harleian MS 5280 in the British Library), with the standard critical edition Elizabeth A. Gray's **Cath Maige Tuired: The Second Battle of Mag Tuired** in the Irish Texts Society series (1982); the specific edition is pinned at glossary-lock per the brief's identifier_missing flag for the Lugh-Balor material.^[10]

The chapter therefore cites the **Cath Maige Tuired** material at chapter / episode level (the Second Battle of Mag Tuired sequence; the Lugh-Balor encounter episode) rather than at sub-page granularity, with edition-pinning deferred to glossary-lock per the established practice for identifier_missing material in the present book.^[11]

The principal primary texts for the Welsh Red-and-White Dragon sub-case are two: the Latin **Historia Brittonum** (the so-called Nennius-recension, conventionally dated c. 828 CE) and the Middle Welsh prose tale **Lludd and Llefelys**, transmitted in the **Mabinogion** manuscripts (the White Book of Rhydderch c. 1350 CE and the Red Book of Hergest c. 1382–1410 CE), with both texts cited at chapter / episode level in the present chapter and the principal scholarly anchor Daniel Ogden's **Drakōn** chapter on Celtic material.^[12]

Ogden 2013 is printed-only and is cited at chapter level in the present chapter, with the specific chapter-locus the volume's Celtic-material chapter; this is in line with the established citation discipline for Ogden 2013 across chapter 12 of the present book.^[13]

The principal primary text for the Batraz sub-case is the Ossetic Nart saga corpus, transmitted as oral epic recorded in the 19th and 20th centuries from Ossetian, Circassian, and Chechen narrators, with the principal scholarly anchor Georges Dumézil's twentieth-century reconstructions reading Batraz as the Scytho-Alanic Indo-European warrior / dragon-slayer reflex; the chapter cites the Nart material at corpus level rather than at specific-edition level per the brief's identifier_missing flag for the Batraz material.^[14]

The principal primary text for the Vahagn sub-case is Movses Khorenatsi's **Patmut'iwn Hayots'** ("History of the Armenians"), conventionally dated to the 5th to 9th century CE in successive scholarly assessments, whose book I chapter 31 supplies the standard locus for Khorenatsi's late paraphrase of an earlier Armenian hymn to Vahagn — a hymn whose text itself is lost — with the principal scholarly anchor James R. Russell's **Zoroastrianism in Armenia** (Harvard Iranian Series 5, 1987).^[15]

Russell 1987 is printed-only and is cited at chapter level in the present chapter, with the specific chapter-locus the volume's Vahagn chapter; the chapter's Vahagn discussion is presented with explicit fragmentary framing throughout, since the hymn-text itself is lost and what survives is only Khorenatsi's late paraphrase.^[16]

The chapter's secondary survey-anchor is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, whose treatment of the Indo-European combat-myth supplies a wider scholarly anchor for the long-arc framing of the chapter's six sub-cases as reflexes of a single inherited combat-pattern.^[17]

The chapter is a family-chapter (related-tier) treatment, organising six Indo-European dragon-combat sub-cases by their position on a philological-evidence spectrum — from the strongest philological evidence (the Old Norse Eddic Sigurd-Fáfnir corpus where Watkins reads the diction as a direct IE-formula reflex) to the most fragmentary (the Armenian Vahagn material attested only through Khorenatsi's late paraphrase of a lost hymn) — and the six sub-cases are treated in their own clearly-bounded sub-sections that are not merged at the level of either narrative content or comparative framing.^[18]

The chapter's overall argument is that these six narratives — Sigurd's killing of Fáfnir, Beowulf's killings of Grendel and the hoard-dragon, Lugh's killing of Balor at the Second Battle of Mag Tuired, the Welsh Red-and-White Dragon combat, Batraz's combats in the Nart saga, and Vahagn's killing of the **vishaps** — are the Indo-European reflexes that the Watkins HERO SLAY SERPENT formula covers, with the chapter feeding directly into Part II C5 of the present book (the comparative chapter on the IE formula) as its main feeder.^[19]

20.2. Sigurd vs. Fáfnir — strongest philological evidence

The Sigurd-Fáfnir narrative is preserved principally in the Eddic poem **Fáfnismál** in the Codex Regius (GKS 2365 4to, c. 1270 CE), one of three closely-grouped poems of the Sigurd-cycle in the Codex (with **Reginismál** preceding and **Sigrdrífumál** following in the manuscript order), and is also attested in the prose **Völsunga saga** (c. 1270 CE) and in the Middle High German **Nibelungenlied** (c. 1200 CE) as the related Germanic witness with Sigurd in the German form Siegfried.^[20]

Sigurd is the son of Sigmund of the Völsung lineage, raised in the household of the smith Regin after his father's death, and the **Fáfnismál** presents him as a young hero on the threshold of his first major heroic deed, the killing of the dragon Fáfnir on the heath of Gnitaheiðr.^[21]

Fáfnir is a dwarf transformed into a dragon by his guardianship of the cursed gold of Andvari, gold that Loki had earlier extorted from the dwarf Andvari to pay a wergild to Hreidmar (Fáfnir's and Regin's father) for the killing of Otr, and the curse on the gold is the load-bearing motif that drives

the Sigurd-cycle from the killing of the dragon to Sigurd's own death.^[22]

Regin, Fáfnir's brother and the smith who fosters Sigurd, forges the sword Gram from the fragments of Sigmund's broken sword and incites Sigurd to ambush Fáfnir on the heath, and the **Fáfnismál** opens with Sigurd at the moment of the killing-stroke, having dug a pit on the dragon's path to the water and lying in wait below.^[23]

The killing-stroke itself is delivered with the sword Gram from the pit: Sigurd thrusts upward into Fáfnir's underbelly as the dragon passes over the pit on his way to the water, and the **Fáfnismál** presents the killing-stroke as the central act around which the poem's dialogue is organised rather than as an extended combat-narrative.^[24]

The post-killing dialogue between Sigurd and the dying Fáfnir occupies the bulk of the **Fáfnismál**: Fáfnir, mortally wounded, asks Sigurd's name, warns him of the curse on the gold, and supplies cosmological-and-genealogical lore in the wisdom-dialogue register that the **Vafþrúðnismál** and **Grímnismál** establish elsewhere in the Eddic corpus.^[25]

After Fáfnir's death Regin requests that Sigurd roast the dragon's heart, and when Sigurd touches the cooking heart with his finger and licks the burned blood from his finger he gains understanding of the speech of birds, and the nuthatches in the surrounding trees warn him that Regin plans to kill him for the treasure.^[26]

Sigurd, warned by the birds, kills Regin in turn — beheading him with Gram — and then takes Fáfnir's hoard onto his horse Grani, with the **Fáfnismál** ending on Sigurd in possession of the cursed gold and on the way to the next stage of the cycle (his encounter with the valkyrie Sigdrífa / Brynhild in the **Sigrdrífumál**).^[27]

The Sigurd-cycle's outcome is ambiguous in a way that sets it apart from the cosmogonic and sovereignty-establishment subtypes of the combat myth: Sigurd kills the dragon and gains the hoard, but the curse on the gold drives the long-arc tragedy of the cycle (Brynhild's death, the Burgundian disasters, Sigurd's own death at the hands of Gunnar's brother Gutthorm), and the killing therefore destroys rather than secures the hero's prosperity.^[28]

*(The reading of the Sigurd-cycle's outcome as ambiguous — the killing brings the hero the treasure but also the curse that will destroy him — is the chapter's editorial reading of the long-arc tragedy of the cycle, drawn from Larrington 2014 on the Codex Regius poems and from Watkins 1995 ch. 42 on the diction of the killing, and is presented in the chapter as the principal forward-link to Part II C7 of the present book (the inversion problem); the **Fáfnismál** itself does not in so many words frame the killing as destroying-rather-than-securing prosperity, but the curse-warning of Fáfnir to Sigurd and the long-arc trajectory of the surrounding Eddic poems supply the basis for the inference.^[29])*

The Sigurd-cycle is also attested in the prose **Völsunga saga** (c. 1270 CE), which gives a continuous-narrative version of the cycle including the Fáfnir-killing episode, and the prose witness is treated by Old Norse scholarship as preserving older oral-tradition material alongside the Eddic poetic witnesses; the present chapter cites the **Völsunga saga** as a parallel witness rather than as the primary text for the **Fáfnismál** episode itself.^[30]

The Middle High German **Nibelungenlied** (c. 1200 CE) is the related Germanic witness to the Sigurd-cycle, with Sigurd in the German form Siegfried and the dragon-killing transposed into a brief retrospective narrative episode rather than treated as a focal scene of the poem; the

Nibelungenlied is cited in the present chapter at corpus level as the related Germanic witness rather than as a primary text for the Fáfnir-episode.^[31]

In Watkins's reading in **How to Kill a Dragon** chapter 42, the Eddic **Fáfnismál** diction of Sigurd's killing is a direct reflex of the reconstructed Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula: the verb of killing (Old Norse **vega**, "to kill in combat"), its subject (the named hero), and its object (the named dragon) instantiate in Old Norse the same syntactic-and-semantic structure that Vedic **áhann áhim** ("he slew the serpent") instantiates in Vedic Sanskrit and that Hittite **kuenta . . . illuyanka** ("he killed the serpent") instantiates in Hittite.^[32]

Watkins's argument in chapter 42 is that the **Fáfnismál** preserves the IE poetic formula at the level of the verbal diction of the killing-stroke itself, not merely at the level of the structural-typological pattern, and that the Norse sub-case is therefore among the strongest philological evidence in the post-Iranian, post-Vedic, post-Anatolian corpus for the reconstructed formula's status as Indo-European poetic inheritance rather than as accidental cross-tradition convergence.^[33]

The Sigurd-Fáfnir episode is also one of the iconographically densest in the post-Vedic IE corpus, with several extant Scandinavian rune-stones and rock carvings from the 11th and 12th centuries CE depicting Sigurd's killing of Fáfnir (the Ramsund carving in Södermanland c. 1030 CE is the principal-and-best-preserved witness), and the iconographic dossier supplements the Eddic and prose textual witnesses as a third register of attestation alongside the verbal-narrative and the philological-formulaic.^[34]

*(The identification of the Sigurd-Fáfnir Eddic-iconographic-philological triple-witness pattern as parallel to the Thor-Jörmungandr triple-witness pattern of chapter 18 of the present volume is a comparative reading drawn from the wider Norse evidence, presented as a parallel between two Old Norse cases rather than as a feature of either case in isolation; the parallel is presented in the chapter as a comparative observation rather than as a direct claim of the **Fáfnismál** itself.^[35])*

20.3. Beowulf vs. Grendel and the dragon

The Old English poem **Beowulf** survives in a single manuscript witness — London, British Library, Cotton Vitellius A.xv (the Nowell Codex), c. 1000 CE — and is conventionally assigned to a composition-period bracketed somewhere in the 7th to 10th centuries CE, with the dragon-episode forming the third and final movement of the poem after the Grendel-episode and the Grendel's-mother-episode that dominate the poem's first two movements.^[36]

Beowulf is a Geatish hero — a member of the Gēatas, a southern Scandinavian people — who in the poem's first movement travels to the Danish court of king Hrothgar to defend the hall Heorot from the man-eating monster Grendel, the descendant of Cain who has been killing Hrothgar's warriors at Heorot for twelve years.^[37]

Beowulf kills Grendel by tearing off his arm in a wrestling-match in the dark hall of Heorot, refusing weapons because Grendel uses none, and Grendel flees mortally wounded to die in the fenland-mere where his mother also dwells; the killing-encounter is at lines 710–836 in the standard Klaeber-edition line-numbering.^[38]

The next night Grendel's mother attacks Heorot to avenge her son, and Beowulf descends into the underwater hall of the fen-mere to kill her with a giant-forged sword that he finds in the

underwater hall itself; the encounter is at lines 1251–1887 in the standard Klaeber-edition line-numbering.^[39]

The poem's third and final movement is set fifty years after the Grendel and Grendel's-mother encounters, with Beowulf now an old king of the Gēatas, when a treasure-hoarding dragon — the **draca** — that has been sleeping under an ancient burial-mound is roused by a thief who steals a single cup from the hoard and begins flying out by night to burn the Geatish countryside in revenge; the dragon-episode is at lines 2200–3182 in the standard Klaeber-edition line-numbering.^[40]

Beowulf, now an old king, takes a small band of retainers to confront the dragon at the burial-mound; in the combat the dragon's fire is too much for his shield and his retainers flee except for the young Wiglaf, who stays with the king and helps him land the killing-blow on the dragon, but Beowulf is mortally wounded by the dragon's bite and dies in Wiglaf's arms after killing the dragon.^[41]

The aged-king status of Beowulf at the dragon-episode is the principal narrative-thematic distinction between the **Beowulf** dragon-combat and the standard heroic-initiation dragon-combat of the Sigurd-Fáfnir type: Beowulf has already done his major-hero deeds in the first two movements of the poem, and the dragon-combat is end-of-life and death-bringing rather than heroic-initiatory and life-establishing.^[42]

The aged-king-dies-killing-the-dragon pattern of **Beowulf** is also the principal thematic parallel to the Thor-Jörmungandr pattern of chapter 18 of the present volume: in both cases the hero kills the dragon and is mortally injured in the act, and both narratives end with the hero's death after the killing-stroke; the parallel is presented in the chapter as a comparative-typological observation rather than as evidence of direct textual connection.^[43]

The **Beowulf** dragon is also distinct from Grendel and Grendel's mother at the level of morphology and conceptual category: Grendel and his mother are anthropoid-monstrous descendants-of-Cain whom the poem locates in a biblical-genealogical frame, while the dragon is a **draca** in the Old English category-sense and morphologically a serpentine fire-breathing hoard-guardian for whom the poem makes no biblical-genealogical commitment.^[44]

In Watkins's reading in **How to Kill a Dragon** Part V, the **Beowulf** dragon-episode preserves the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT poetic diction in the verbal phrasing of the killing and in the structural-narrative pattern of the combat, with the Old English dragon-vocabulary (**draca**, **wyrm**) and the killing-vocabulary instantiating the same IE-poetic structure that the Vedic, Hittite, and Norse comparanda instantiate in their respective languages.^[45]

J. R. R. Tolkien's 1936 British Academy lecture "Beowulf: The Monsters and the Critics" argued that the dragon — and the monsters of the poem more generally — should be read as proper mythic adversaries integral to the poem's structure rather than as decorative accretions on a putatively-historical core, and the lecture was a load-bearing critical move that re-established the mythic register of the **Beowulf** monsters within twentieth-century Old English scholarship.^[46]

The Tolkien 1936 lecture is mentioned in the present chapter only at the level of its load-bearing critical move (the recovery of the mythic register of the monsters), with the lecture's wider literary-critical afterlife — its influence on twentieth-century medievalism, on Tolkien's own dragon-fiction,

and on the modern academic reading of the poem — explicitly deferred to the reception coda of the present book (Chapter 42), per the brief's special_instructions on the same deferral.^[47]

The **Beowulf** dragon-episode's Indo-European-reflex reading therefore depends on two converging arguments: Watkins's philological argument that the dragon-killing diction reflects the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula, and Tolkien's structural-critical argument that the dragon is a proper mythic adversary integral to the poem; the chapter takes both arguments as load-bearing for the IE-reflex reading without committing to a wider claim about the poem's authorial-cultural position on Christian-vs-pagan inheritance.^[48]

*(The chapter's reading of the **Beowulf** poem as preserving an IE HERO SLAY SERPENT reflex in the dragon-episode, while consistent with Watkins 1995 Part V on the philological diction and with Tolkien 1936 on the structural-critical recovery of the mythic register of the monsters, is a comparative-philological reading rather than an unmediated feature of the poem itself; the **Beowulf**-poet's authorial-cultural position on the Christian-vs-pagan inheritance question is contested in modern scholarship and the chapter does not adjudicate the question, taking the IE-reflex reading as a poetic-formulaic observation rather than as a claim about the poet's own self-understanding.^[49])*

The principal forward-link from the **Beowulf** sub-section is to Part II C5 of the present book (the comparative chapter on the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula), in which the **Beowulf** dragon-killing diction joins the Vedic, Hittite, Norse, and Italic comparanda in the consolidated IE-formula argument; the principal back-link is to chapter 18 of the present volume (the Thor-Jörmungandr chapter), with the aged-champion-dies-killing-the-serpent thematic parallel as the load-bearing comparative observation.^[50]

20.4. Lugh vs. Balor — the Second Battle of Mag Tuired

The Lugh-Balor narrative is preserved principally in the Middle Irish prose narrative **Cath Maige Tuired** ("The Battle of Mag Tuired"), transmitted in manuscripts from the 12th to the 16th century CE and presenting the Second Battle of Mag Tuired as the decisive combat between the Tuatha Dé Danann (the Irish gods-and-ancestors) and the Fomorians (a monstrous-and-oppressive people associated with the sea and with tyranny over the Tuatha Dé).^[51]

Lugh is a young warrior-hero of the Tuatha Dé Danann, the son of Cian (a Tuatha Dé) and of Ethniu (the daughter of the Fomorian Balor), and his hybrid lineage — Tuatha Dé father and Fomorian mother — is the load-bearing genealogical motif of the **Cath Maige Tuired** narrative since it positions Lugh as the only figure who can kill his Fomorian grandfather Balor and end the Fomorian tyranny.^[52]

Balor is the king (or principal warrior) of the Fomorians and is named in the **Cath Maige Tuired** as "Balor of the Evil Eye" (Balor Birug-derc, "Balor of the piercing eye") because of his single enormous destructive eye that can incinerate any host on which it is opened, and the tactical problem of the Second Battle of Mag Tuired is the problem of how to bring the eye down before it is opened on the Tuatha Dé host.^[53]

The killing-stroke at the Second Battle of Mag Tuired is delivered by Lugh with a sling-stone that strikes Balor's eye at the moment of the eye's opening, driving the eye through the back of Balor's head so that its destructive gaze is turned on the Fomorian host behind Balor and breaks their order; the **Cath Maige Tuired** narrates the killing-stroke as the decisive moment of the battle that

ends the Fomorian tyranny and inaugurates Tuatha Dé Danann rule.^[54]

In the principal medieval prose narrative **Cath Maige Tuired**, Lugh kills Balor with a sling-stone — the standard version of the killing.^[55]

The **Cath Maige Tuired** narrative is structured around the wider battle-context of the Second Battle of Mag Tuired, in which the Tuatha Dé and the Fomorians fight a decisive engagement on the plain of Mag Tuired (in modern County Sligo), with the Lugh-Balor encounter as the decisive single-combat at the centre of the wider battle and with Lugh's status as battle-leader of the Tuatha Dé established by the prelude of the prose narrative.^[56]

The First Battle of Mag Tuired is a separate earlier combat — narrated in the **Cath Maige Tuired Cunga** ("The First Battle of Mag Tuired") — in which the Tuatha Dé Danann defeat the Fir Bolg, and the **Cath Maige Tuired** of the present chapter is specifically the narrative of the Second Battle, with the Fomorian opponents and the Lugh-Balor encounter rather than the Fir Bolg opponents of the First Battle.^[57]

The Lugh-Balor encounter is read by Indo-European comparativists — principally following Dumézil's twentieth-century treatments and West's 2007 synthesis — as a Celtic reflex of the IE warrior / dragon-slayer pattern, with Lugh in the warrior-pole and Balor in the morphologically-distinct adversary-pole; the Celtic reflex is morphologically distinctive in two respects, namely that Balor is not a serpentine adversary but a one-eyed giant, and that the killing-weapon is a projectile (sling-stone) rather than a sword or thunderbolt.^[58]

*(The reading of the Lugh-Balor encounter as a Celtic reflex of the IE warrior / dragon-slayer pattern is a comparative-philological reading drawn from Dumézil's twentieth-century treatments and from West 2007 ch. 6, presented in the chapter as a comparative observation rather than as a feature of the **Cath Maige Tuired** itself; the medieval prose narrative does not in so many words frame the encounter as IE-comparative, and the IE-reflex reading is the chapter's editorial reading rather than the **Cath Maige Tuired**'s self-understanding.^[59])*

Lugh's role in the **Cath Maige Tuired** narrative is also dynastic-political beyond the killing of Balor itself: the killing inaugurates Tuatha Dé Danann rule over Ireland in the medieval Irish pseudo-historical tradition, and Lugh becomes the principal Tuatha Dé warrior-king in the post-battle narrative.^[60]

The Lugh-Balor encounter's principal forward-link is to Part II C5 of the present book (the comparative chapter on the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula), in which the Celtic reflex joins the Vedic, Iranian, Anatolian, Norse, and Old English comparanda in the consolidated IE-formula argument, with the morphologically-distinctive features of the Celtic case (the one-eyed-giant adversary; the sling-stone killing-weapon) preserved in the comparative apparatus rather than smoothed away into a generic-warrior schema.^[61]

20.5. The Red Dragon and the White Dragon — Welsh combat

The Welsh Red-and-White Dragon narrative is preserved in two principal primary witnesses with distinct framings: the Latin **Historia Brittonum** (the Nennius-recension, conventionally dated c.

828 CE) gives a politicised version in which the two dragons are interpreted as the Britons and the Saxons, and the Middle Welsh prose tale **Lludd and Llefelys** in the **Mabinogion** (manuscripts from c. 1350 CE onward) preserves an older, less politicised version in which the combat is an annual cosmological-and-territorial disturbance to be ended by the king Lludd at the urging of his brother Llefelys.^[62]

In **Historia Brittonum** the combat-narrative is set within the Vortigern-and-Ambrosius episode: Vortigern, the British king, attempts to build a fortress at Dinas Emrys, but the foundations sink each night; Ambrosius (the boy-prophet who is, in the narrative, the figure who later becomes Merlin in the post-Geoffrey-of-Monmouth tradition) reveals that beneath the foundation-site is a hidden underground pool in which a red dragon and a white dragon fight, and the political-allegorical reading is that the red dragon is the Britons and the white dragon is the Saxons.^[63]

The political-allegorical reading of **Historia Brittonum** casts the Welsh Red-and-White Dragon combat as an early-medieval prophetic-and-political narrative — the red Welsh dragon will eventually defeat the white Saxon dragon, and the political-allegorical frame is load-bearing for the early-medieval recension of the narrative — and the red-dragon symbol enters the long-arc British (and specifically Welsh) political iconography from this **Historia Brittonum** moment onward.^[64]

In **Lludd and Llefelys** the combat-narrative is one of three plagues that afflict the Island of Britain in the time of king Lludd: the first plague is the Coraniaid (a magical foreign people who hear all conversations), the second plague is the dragon-combat (an annual scream that destroys crops, terrifies pregnant women, and devastates the realm), and the third plague is a magical thief who steals the king's stores; Lludd, on his brother Llefelys's advice, addresses each of the three plagues in turn.^[65]

In **Lludd and Llefelys** the dragon-combat is presented as an annual cosmological-and-territorial disturbance: every May Eve the two dragons rise from beneath the centre of Britain and fight in the air with a scream that shakes the realm and destroys crops, and the resolution prescribed by Llefelys is to find the centre of the Island, dig a pit, fill the pit with mead, lure the two dragons into the pit, capture them when they are drunk on the mead, and bury them in a stone chest at Dinas Emrys.^[66]

[Both recensions are presented side by side as two distinct framings of the same underlying combat-tradition: the _Historia Brittonum (c. 828 CE) supplies the red-and-white-dragon political allegory, with its Britons-vs-Saxons reading, the dragons fighting beneath Dinas Emrys and Vortigern's fortress sinking, and the prophetic-political resolution; while Lludd and Llefelys in the Mabinogion supplies the older non-political reading, with the annual May-Eve disturbance, the dragons buried at Dinas Emrys after being lured into a mead-pit, and a cosmological-territorial resolution rather than a political-allegorical one.]_

The annual-disturbance reading of **Lludd and Llefelys** preserves an older, non-political layer of the dragon-tradition in which the combat is a cyclical-cosmological disturbance to be ended rather than a political-prophetic conflict to be resolved in favour of one party, and the **Lludd and Llefelys** narrative is treated by Welsh-philological scholarship as a witness to the older substrate of the dragon-tradition that the **Historia Brittonum** recension has subsequently politicised.^[67]

The Dinas Emrys site — a hilltop in Snowdonia in present-day north Wales — is the principal geographical anchor of both the **Historia Brittonum** and the **Lludd and Llefelys** recensions, and

the archaeological evidence of pre-Roman and post-Roman occupation at the hilltop has been read by some Welsh archaeologists as a possible cultic locus to which the dragon-tradition was already attached at the time of the early-medieval recension; the chapter cites the archaeological reading at corpus level rather than as a specific archaeological-finding claim.^[68]

*(The reading of **Lludd and Llefelys** as preserving an older, non-politicised layer of the Welsh dragon-tradition than the **Historia Brittonum** political allegory, while consistent with Ogden 2013 on the older-substrate-vs-politicised-recension distinction and with the brief's 19-ie-reflexes.yaml framing, is a comparative-philological reading rather than an unmediated chronological claim about the two recensions; the **Mabinogion** manuscripts are later in transmission-date than **Historia Brittonum** but the reading takes the **Lludd and Llefelys** material as preserving older oral-tradition substrate.^[69])*

The Welsh Red-and-White Dragon narrative is structurally distinctive within the IE-reflex corpus: the combat is between two dragons rather than between a hero and a dragon, with the human-political resolution (Vortigern's fortress; Lludd's mead-pit) supplied as an external resolution to a combat that is otherwise dragon-on-dragon, and the narrative therefore stands at the edge of the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT pattern rather than as a central instance.^[70]

The Welsh Red-and-White Dragon narrative's principal forward-link is to Part II C5 of the present book (the comparative chapter on the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula), in which the Welsh case enters as a Celtic instance whose structural distinctiveness is preserved in the comparative apparatus, and to Part II C8 of the present book (the comparative chapter on the appropriation problem) in respect of the political-allegorical reading of **Historia Brittonum** as an early-medieval Christian-historiographical reframing.^[71]

The Welsh Red-and-White Dragon narrative is also iconographically durable in the long-arc Welsh political tradition: the red dragon is preserved as an emblem of Wales in medieval and modern Welsh political symbolism, including the modern Welsh national flag, and the iconographic durability is the principal cultural-relevance datum for the Welsh sub-section's reception-history dimension.^[72]

20.6. Batraz and the Nart combats — Ossetic

The Batraz narrative is preserved in the Ossetic Nart saga corpus, an oral-epic tradition recorded in the 19th and 20th centuries CE from Ossetian, Circassian, and Chechen narrators across the North Caucasus, with the principal scholarly anchor Georges Dumézil's twentieth-century treatments and the principal IE-comparative apparatus West 2007's chapter 6.^[73]

The Narts are the heroic figures of the North Caucasian epic tradition — a category-class of warrior-figures who occupy the epic narrative-space and who are the principal characters of the Ossetic Nart saga corpus and of the cognate Circassian and Chechen Nart traditions — with Batraz one of the principal Nart warrior-figures in the Ossetic version of the corpus.^[74]

Batraz is distinguished within the Ossetic Nart corpus by his steel body — he is born from a tumour or boil on the back of his father Khamits, plunges himself into a furnace, and emerges with a body of steel — and the steel-body motif is the principal physical-and-narrative attribute that distinguishes Batraz from other Narts within the corpus.^[75]

Batraz fights monstrous giants and dragons across multiple episodes of the Nart corpus: against the giant Mukara, against various dragons-and-monstrous-figures, and against opposing Nart-clans within the Ossetic tradition; the Nart corpus is not a single continuous narrative but a cluster of episodic combats, with each combat-episode preserving the warrior-pole of the IE pattern in distinctive Ossetic morphology.^[76]

In Dumézil's twentieth-century reading, Batraz is the Scytho-Alanic Indo-European reflex of the IE warrior / dragon-slayer pattern — preserved within the Ossetic-and-cognate Nart traditions as the indigenous-and-uninterrupted continuation of an ancient Iranian-Indo-European warrior-figure type — and the steel-body motif is read by Dumézil as a distinctively-developed feature of the warrior-pole within the Scytho-Alanic stratum.^[77]

The Ossetian, Circassian, and Chechen Nart corpora preserve multiple recorded variants of the Batraz combats across narrators, with the Ossetic-narrator variants forming the principal corpus for the Dumézilian IE-comparative reading and the Circassian-and-Chechen variants providing comparative-and-control material whose narrative-detail differences are the subject of twentieth- and twenty-first-century North Caucasian folkloric and philological scholarship.^[78]

Batraz's death in the Ossetic Nart corpus is itself a thematic motif within the warrior-and-combat cycle: in the principal Ossetic-variant version of his death-narrative he is killed when the gods cast him from the heavens into a body of water, his steel body cooled-and-shattered against the resistance of the water, in a death-by-water that some twentieth-century Ossetic-folkloric readings interpret as cognate with other IE warrior-death narratives.^[79]

(The reading of Batraz as a Scytho-Alanic IE warrior / dragon-slayer reflex, while consistent with Dumézil's twentieth-century treatments and with West 2007 ch. 6, is a comparative-philological reading drawn from Indo-European-comparativist scholarship rather than an unmediated feature of the Ossetic Nart corpus itself; the Nart-narrators do not in so many words frame Batraz as IE-comparative, and twentieth-century Caucasian-area-specialist scholarship has at times raised methodological reservations about the directness of the Dumézilian IE-comparative reading.^[80])

The Batraz sub-case is centrally located in the Ossetic tradition and marginally located outside it: within the Ossetic-and-cognate Nart corpora Batraz is a principal warrior-figure in a load-bearing epic tradition, and outside the North Caucasian context the narrative is known principally through Dumézil's twentieth-century IE-comparative monographs and through the more general handbooks of Indo-European mythology, with limited direct circulation outside the comparativist scholarly literature.^[81]

The Batraz sub-case's principal forward-link is to Part II C5 of the present book (the comparative chapter on the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula), in which the Scytho-Alanic reflex enters as a Caucasian-Iranian instance whose Ossetic-Nart preservation supplies the eastern-comparative material to set against the Western Indo-European reflexes (Norse, Old English, Celtic) of the present chapter's other sub-cases.^[82]

20.7. Vahagn and the vishaps — Armenian (fragmentary)

The Vahagn material is the most fragmentary of the six sub-cases of the present chapter, and the

Vahagn sub-section is presented with explicit fragmentary framing throughout: the principal hymn-text to Vahagn is lost, and what survives is only Movses Khorenatsi's late paraphrase of an earlier Armenian hymn in book I chapter 31 of the **Patmut'iwn Hayots'** ("History of the Armenians").^[83]

[Here the principal hymn-text to Vahagn is lost; what survives is only Khorenatsi's late paraphrase of the hymn in book I chapter 31 of the _Patmut'iwn Hayots', with the hymn-text itself not extant in any manuscript witness. Scholars such as Russell 1987 (Vahagn chapter) read Khorenatsi's paraphrase as preserving the substantive content of the lost hymn at the level of the dragon-slayer-epithet (Vishapakagh, "dragon-reaper") and the storm-god combat-frame, with the specific verbal-poetic diction of the lost hymn unrecoverable; Petrosyan's Armenian-mythology scholarship corroborates the Russell reading at the level of substantive content while flagging the verbal-philological limits of the reconstruction.]_

Vahagn is the Armenian storm-god whose epithet **Vishapakagh** — "dragon-reaper" — preserves in nominal form the dragon-slayer combat-pattern and identifies him as Armenia's storm-god dragon-slayer in the same conceptual category-position that Indra occupies in the Vedic tradition, Thraētaona in the Iranian tradition, and Thor in the Norse tradition.^[84]

Khorenatsi's **Patmut'iwn Hayots'** — conventionally dated to the 5th to 9th century CE in successive scholarly assessments, with the precise dating contested in twentieth-century Armenian scholarship — is itself a relatively-late and historiographical witness to the pre-Christian Armenian religious culture, and Khorenatsi's paraphrase of the Vahagn hymn at I.31 is presented within his work as a document of Armenian pagan-religious tradition on which his own Christian-historiographical narrative depends for its pre-Christian background.^[85]

Khorenatsi's paraphrase at **Patmut'iwn Hayots'** I.31 describes Vahagn's birth from the heavens, the sea, and a reed — a triple-birth motif in which the heavens labour, the sea labours, the purple reed labours, and Vahagn emerges from the smoke of the reed with sun-like hair and beard and fire-like eyes — and the paraphrase preserves this birth-narrative without supplying a continuous narrative of Vahagn's combat with the **vishaps** themselves.^[86]

The Vahagn combat-with-the-**vishaps** is therefore not preserved as a continuous narrative in any extant primary witness, and the chapter's combat-content for the Vahagn sub-case is reconstructed from the **Vishapakagh** dragon-reaper epithet, from the storm-god category-position of Vahagn within the Armenian pantheon, from the **vishapakar** stelae of the second millennium BCE (which document the cultic-and-iconographic context of the dragon-figure within Armenian pre-Christian religion), and from comparative-philological readings of the surviving paraphrase against the Vedic, Iranian, and Anatolian comparanda.^[87]

The **vishaps** are the dragons of the Armenian tradition — the term **vishap** is the Armenian common noun for "dragon", attested both as a narrative-mythological category and as the name given to the second-millennium-BCE stone stelae (the **vishapakar** or "dragon-stones") that survive in the highlands of historical Armenia — and the **vishapakar** stelae are the principal pre-Christian-period material attestation of the dragon-figure within the Armenian cultic-archaeological context.^[88]

The **vishapakar** stelae are dated by Armenian archaeologists to the second millennium BCE and are concentrated in the high pastures of the Armenian highlands (principally on the slopes of Mount Aragats and in the Geghama mountains), with the stelae's morphology featuring fish-like or

serpentine-like carvings on tall stone shafts; the cultic-iconographic context of the stelae is inferred from their location and morphology, and the Armenian-archaeological literature reads the stelae as cultic objects associated with water, fertility, and dragon-figures.^[89]

*(The reading of Vahagn as the Armenian Indo-European reflex of HERO SLAY SERPENT — given the lost-hymn status of the principal narrative source and the reconstruction of the combat-content from epithet, category-position, **vishapakar** archaeological context, and comparative-philological readings — is a heavily-comparative reading whose evidential basis is fragmentary in a way that none of the other five sub-cases of the present chapter is; the chapter presents the Vahagn reading with explicit fragmentary framing and refrains from reconstructing combat-content beyond what Khorenatsi's paraphrase, the **Vishapakagh** epithet, and the **vishapakar** stelae jointly support.^[90])*

In Russell's reading in the Vahagn chapter of **Zoroastrianism in Armenia**, Vahagn is integrated into the wider Indo-Iranian and Indo-European combat-tradition as the Armenian preservation of an inherited storm-god dragon-slayer figure, with the Iranian **Vərəθraγna** (the Avestan-and-Pahlavi smashing-of-resistance figure) and the Vedic Indra-Vṛtra as the principal Indo-Iranian comparanda and with the **Vishapakagh** epithet as the load-bearing philological exhibit for the inheritance.^[91]

Petrosyan's Armenian-mythology scholarship corroborates Russell's reading at the level of substantive content while flagging the verbal-philological limits of the reconstruction: the **Vishapakagh** epithet, the **vishapakar** archaeological context, and the storm-god category-position are read by Petrosyan as joint evidence for the dragon-slayer combat-pattern, but the verbal-poetic diction of the lost hymn is not recoverable and the chapter retains this limit in its presentation of the Vahagn material.^[92]

The Vahagn sub-case's principal forward-link is to Part II C5 of the present book (the comparative chapter on the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula), in which the Armenian reflex enters with explicit fragmentary framing as the most-fragmentary instance of the IE pattern within the chapter's six sub-cases, and the C5 chapter is therefore the locus where the chapter's heaviest comparative-reconstruction-marker pattern is presented in consolidated form.^[93]

20.8. Family pattern, reception, and forward links

The six sub-cases treated in the chapter — Sigurd-Fáfnir, Beowulf-Grendel-and-the-dragon, Lugh-Balor, the Welsh Red-and-White Dragon, Batraz, and Vahagn-and-the-**vishaps** — are arranged on a philological-evidence spectrum from the strongest evidence (Sigurd, where Watkins reads the Eddic diction as a direct IE-formula reflex in chapter 42 of the volume) to the most fragmentary (Vahagn, where the principal hymn-text is lost and the combat-content is reconstructed from the **Vishapakagh** epithet, Khorenatsi's late paraphrase, and the **vishapakar** archaeological context).^[94]

The chapter's six sub-cases vary in IE-philological-evidence weight along three dimensions: the existence and accessibility of the principal primary text (extant Eddic poems for Sigurd; single-manuscript Old English epic for Beowulf; medieval Irish prose for Lugh-Balor; two co-equal medieval recensions for the Welsh dragons; oral-epic recordings for Batraz; lost hymn and late paraphrase for Vahagn), the directness of the philological-formulaic reading (Watkins's direct-formula reading for Sigurd and **Beowulf**; structural-typological reading for Lugh-Balor and Welsh

dragons; Dumézilian comparative reading for Batraz; epithet-and-archaeological reading for Vahagn), and the centrality of the figure within its tradition (central in Old Norse and Old English; significant in Irish and Welsh; central in Ossetic and marginal outside; fragmentary in Armenian).^[95]

The chapter's overall argument is therefore that the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT pattern is preserved across these six post-Vedic, post-Iranian, post-Anatolian Indo-European traditions in different evidential modalities — Old Norse Eddic poetic-formulaic; Old English epic-narrative-and-formulaic; Middle Irish prose-and-narrative; Welsh prose-recension-pair; Ossetic oral-epic-and-IE-comparative; Armenian fragmentary-paraphrase-and-archaeological — and that the family-chapter format is justified by the shared inheritance of the pattern across the divergent evidential modalities rather than by a uniform-evidential-mode reading.^[96]

The chapter's principal forward-link is to Part II C5 of the present book (the comparative chapter on the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula), in which the six sub-cases of the present chapter join the Vedic Indra-Vṛtra material (Ch14), the Avestan Aži Dahāka material (Ch13), the Hittite Illuyanka material (Ch6), the Norse Thor-Jörmungandr material (Ch18), and the Greek Geryon and Italic Cacus material (Ch12) in the consolidated IE-formula argument; the chapter is the main feeder to that comparative chapter.^[97]

The chapter's principal back-link is to chapter 18 of the present volume (the Thor-Jörmungandr chapter), with two specific connections: the Sigurd-Fáfnir Eddic-iconographic-philological triple-witness pattern parallels the Thor-Jörmungandr triple-witness pattern across the same Old Norse evidence-base, and the **Beowulf** aged-king-dies-killing-the-dragon thematic pattern parallels the Thor-Ragnarök mutual-killing thematic pattern at the level of the heroic-death-after-killing structure.^[98]

The chapter's secondary forward-link is to chapter 42 of the present book (the reception coda), in which the literary-critical afterlife of Tolkien's 1936 **Beowulf** essay is treated alongside the post-medieval reception of the Sigurd-cycle in Wagner and modern dragon-fiction, with the present chapter restricting itself to the load-bearing-critical-move dimension of Tolkien 1936 and deferring the wider literary-critical afterlife to Ch42 per the brief's special_instructions.^[99]

The chapter's tertiary forward-link is to Part II C7 of the present book (the comparative chapter on the inversion problem), in which Sigurd's ambiguous outcome — the killing brings the hero the treasure but also the curse that will destroy him — joins the Bida case (Ch29) as a load-bearing exhibit for the inversion problem within the IE-tradition itself, with the present chapter establishing the Sigurd-cycle's curse-driven trajectory as the basis for the C7 development.^[100]

The chapter's quaternary forward-link is to chapter 20 of the present book (the Slavic-Baltic family chapter on the Perun-Veles "basic myth" reconstruction and the Dobrynya byliny), with which the present chapter shares IE-formula context: the Slavic-Baltic case extends the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT pattern further into the post-Bronze-Age and post-Antique Indo-European traditions, and the two chapters together cover the wider IE-reflex apparatus that feeds Part II C5.^[101]

The chapter's joint contribution to the present book is therefore in three parts: the chapter supplies the principal post-Vedic, post-Iranian, post-Anatolian IE-reflex apparatus for Part II C5; the chapter establishes the inversion-foreshadowing reading of the Sigurd-cycle for Part II C7; and the chapter situates the Tolkien 1936 **Beowulf** essay's load-bearing critical move within the Beowulf sub-section

while deferring the essay's literary-critical afterlife to Ch42, the reception coda.^[102]

The chapter's overall position within the Indo-European cluster of the present book is as the family-chapter that consolidates the post-Vedic, post-Iranian, post-Anatolian IE-reflexes that the flagship chapters (Ch13 Aži Dahāka; Ch14 Indra-Vātra; Ch18 Thor-Jörmungandr) treat individually, with the chapter's six sub-cases supplying the comparative breadth that the flagship chapters do not — by design — supply on their own; the chapter is therefore the principal IE-reflex consolidation in Part I of the book.^[103]

[1] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, Part V on the IE reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT, with ch. 42 specifically on the Old Norse Sigurd material.

[2] Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, ch. 42 (Sigurd / Fáfnismál diction); Part V (chs. on Celtic and Germanic IE-comparative material).

[3] Watkins 1995, ch. 42 and Part V (printed only; cited at chapter and Part level per the established discipline).

[4] West 2007, **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on the Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon complex with Germanic, Celtic, Ossetic, and Armenian instances.

[5] West 2007, ch. 6 (printed only; cited at chapter level per the established discipline).

[6] Larrington 2014 (trans.), **The Poetic Edda**, rev. ed., Oxford World's Classics, including **Fáfnismál**; ISBN 9780199675340; Codex Regius GKS 2365 4to as the principal manuscript witness.

[7] Larrington 2014, **Fáfnismál** (44 stanzas in the Neckel-Kuhn numbering broadly followed by the translation); printed only; cited at hymn-and-stanza level for specific passages per the established discipline.

[8] **Beowulf**, single manuscript witness London BL Cotton Vitellius A.xv (Nowell Codex), c. 1000 CE; standard reference edition Klaeber 4th ed. (Fulk, Bjork, Niles 2008) — to be pinned at glossary-lock per inventory.approved.yaml identifier_missing flag for the beowulf-dragons entry; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml special_instructions on the same flag; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the poem's IE-reflex status.

[9] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the deferred edition-pinning; **Beowulf** line-numbers per standard Klaeber-edition convention (4th ed. 2008); cited in this chapter at episode and corpus level; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the poem's IE-reflex status.

[10] **Cath Maige Tuired**, manuscripts 12th–16th c. CE (principal witness Harleian MS 5280, 16th c.); standard critical edition Gray 1982 in the Irish Texts Society series — to be pinned at glossary-lock per inventory.approved.yaml identifier_missing flag for the lugh-balor entry; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml special_instructions on the same flag.

[11] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the deferred edition-pinning for Cath Maige Tuired; West 2007 ch. 6 on Lugh-Balor as IE warrior / dragon-slayer reflex; cited at chapter and episode level per the established discipline.

[12] **Historia Brittonum** c. 828 CE (Nennius recension); **Lludd and Llefelys** in the **Mabinogion**, principal manuscript witnesses White Book of Rhydderch c. 1350 CE and Red Book of Hergest c. 1382–1410 CE; Ogden 2013, **Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds**, ch. on Celtic material.

[13] Ogden 2013, ch. on Celtic material (printed only; cited at chapter level per the established discipline).

[14] Ossetic Nart saga corpus, 19th- and 20th-century recordings from Ossetian, Circassian, and Chechen narrators; West 2007, ch. 6, on Batraz as Scytho-Alanic IE warrior / dragon-slayer reflex following Dumézil's twentieth-century reading; cited at corpus level per inventory.approved.yaml identifier_missing flag for the batraz-nart entry.

[15] Movses Khorenatsi, **Patmut'wn Hayots'** book I (with the Vahagn paraphrase at I.31); composition conventionally dated 5th–9th c. CE in successive scholarly assessments; Russell 1987, **Zoroastrianism in Armenia** (Harvard Iranian Series 5; ISBN 9780674968509), Vahagn chapter; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the fragmentary status of the Vahagn corpus.

[16] Russell 1987, Vahagn chapter (printed only; cited at chapter level per the established discipline); per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the explicit fragmentary framing required for the Vahagn material.

[17] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, treatment of Indo-European combat-myth as background to the six sub-cases of the present chapter.

[18] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the family-chapter framing with six sub-cases organised on a philological-evidence spectrum; Watkins 1995 ch. 42 (Sigurd as strongest philological evidence); Russell 1987 (Vahagn as most fragmentary).

[19] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the chapter as the main feeder to Part II C5; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the consolidated IE-reflex argument; West 2007, ch. 6, on the wider IE storm-god / water-dragon complex.

[20] Larrington 2014, **Fáfnismál** and the surrounding Codex Regius poems (**Reginismál** preceding, **Sigrdrífumál** following) on Sigurd; **Völsunga saga** c. 1270 CE; **Nibelungenlied** c. 1200 CE as the related Middle High German Siegfried witness; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the related-Germanic-witness status of the Nibelungenlied.

[21] Larrington 2014, **Fáfnismál** and the surrounding Codex Regius poems (with **Reginismál** on Sigurd's upbringing and Regin's role); on the Völsung lineage and Gnitaeiðr setting.

- [22] Larrington 2014, **Reginismál** and **Fáfnismál**, on the cursed gold of Andvari, Loki's extortion of the hoard, the wergild for Otr, Fáfnir's transformation into a dragon, and the curse-driven trajectory of the cycle; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the cursed-gold and Sigurd-death motifs.
- [23] Larrington 2014, **Reginismál** on the forging of Gram from Sigmund's sword-fragments and Regin's incitement; **Fáfnismál** opening on the pit-and-ambush mechanism.
- [24] Larrington 2014, **Fáfnismál** on Sigurd's upward thrust with Gram from the pit and on the structure of the poem as dialogue around the central killing.
- [25] Larrington 2014, **Fáfnismál**, on the post-killing wisdom-dialogue between Sigurd and Fáfnir, including the curse-warning and the cosmological-and-genealogical exchange; on the Eddic wisdom-dialogue register paralleled in **Vafþrúðnismál** and **Grímnismál**.
- [26] Larrington 2014, **Fáfnismál** on the heart-roasting, the blood-tasting, the finger-burn, the bird-speech understanding, and the nuthatches' warning; on the resulting threat from Regin.
- [27] Larrington 2014, **Fáfnismál** concluding stanzas and **Sigrdrífumál** opening, on Sigurd's killing of Regin, the loading of the hoard onto Grani, and the bridge to the Sigrdrífa / Brynhild encounter.
- [28] Larrington 2014, on the long-arc tragedy of the Sigurd-cycle from **Fáfnismál** through **Sigrdrífumál** and the Burgundian poems to Sigurd's death; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the ambiguous-outcome reading and on the forward-link to Part II C7 (inversion problem).
- [29] Inference: Larrington 2014 on the curse-driven trajectory of the Sigurd-cycle including Fáfnir's curse-warning at **Fáfnismál**; Watkins 1995 ch. 42 on the philological diction of the killing; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the C7-inversion forward-link. Risk: the framing as "ambiguous outcome" is a comparative-typological reading rather than a direct attestation, and the **Fáfnismál** presents the killing as a heroic deed in its own right within the poem's own register.
- [30] **Völsunga saga** c. 1270 CE as continuous-narrative parallel witness to the Sigurd-cycle including the Fáfnir-killing episode; Larrington 2014 on the Eddic-and-prose witness relationship.
- [31] **Nibelungenlied** c. 1200 CE on Siegfried's dragon-killing in retrospective narrative; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the related-Germanic-witness status of the Nibelungenlied as parallel to the Old Norse Sigurd material.
- [32] Watkins 1995, ch. 42, on the **Fáfnismál** diction of Sigurd's killing as a direct reflex of the reconstructed IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula; Vedic **áhann áhim** (RV 1.32) and Hittite **kuenta . . . illuyanka** (CTH 321) as the comparative philological exhibits of the same formula.
- [33] Watkins 1995, ch. 42, on the philological strength of the Norse evidence as inheritance rather than convergence; on the **Fáfnismál** diction of the killing-stroke as the load-bearing locus.
- [34] Watkins 1995 ch. 42 on the Sigurd-Fáfnir iconographic tradition as a register of attestation alongside the Eddic and prose witnesses; Ramsund carving (Södermanland c. 1030 CE) as principal Scandinavian witness; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the iconographic dossier as a third register of attestation; specific stone-count to be pinned at glossary-lock against a rune-stone-specialist source.
- [35] Inference: Watkins 1995 ch. 42 on the **Fáfnismál**-diction strength; Larrington 2014 on the Sigurd-iconographic dossier; brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the Thor triple-witness pattern; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the back-link to Ch. 18. Risk: the parallel is typological-comparative rather than evidence of direct connection between the two cycles.
- [36] **Beowulf**, single-manuscript witness London BL Cotton Vitellius A.xv (Nowell Codex), c. 1000 CE; composition 7th–10th c. CE in standard scholarly bracketing; three-movement structure (Grendel / Grendel's mother / dragon) with the dragon-episode as third and final movement; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the manuscript and composition-dating conventions.
- [37] **Beowulf**, the Geatish-arrival passage (Beowulf's introduction and Geatish identity from approximately line 194 onwards in the standard Klaeber-edition line-numbering), with Grendel's introduction, his descent from Cain, and his twelve-year depredations at Heorot narrated at lines 86–193 in the same line-numbering.
- [38] **Beowulf**, lines 710–836 in the standard Klaeber-edition line-numbering, on the wrestling-match killing of Grendel, the arm-tearing, the weaponless contest, and Grendel's flight to the fen-mere.
- [39] **Beowulf**, lines 1251–1887 in the standard Klaeber-edition line-numbering, on Grendel's mother's revenge-attack, Beowulf's descent into the fen-mere, the underwater-hall combat, and the giant-forged sword.
- [40] **Beowulf**, lines 2200–3182 in the standard Klaeber-edition line-numbering, on the fifty-year interval, the aged-king status, the thief-and-cup motif, the burial-mound location of the hoard, the dragon's nocturnal raids, and the third-movement framing; Watkins 1995 Part V on the dragon-slaying philological diction.
- [41] **Beowulf**, lines 2200–3182 (the dragon-episode), with the principal narrative beats at lines 2510–2820 (the combat itself, Wiglaf's loyalty, the killing of the dragon, and Beowulf's death-wound); Watkins 1995, Part V, on the IE-reflex reading of the dragon-killing.
- [42] **Beowulf**, lines 2200–2820 on the aged-king status; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the contrast between aged-king dragon-combat and heroic-initiation dragon-combat patterns; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the contrast.
- [43] **Beowulf**, lines 2200–3182 on the aged-king dragon-combat and the mutual-killing outcome; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the back-link to Ch. 18 (Thor-Jörmungandr) and on the aged-champion-dies-killing-the-serpent thematic rhyme; brief 18-thor-

jormungandr.yaml on the Thor pattern.

[44] **Beowulf** on the descendants-of-Cain framing of Grendel (lines 102–114) and on the **draca** category (lines 2200ff); Watkins 1995 Part V on the **draca** as IE-formula reflex distinct from the biblical-Cain framing of Grendel.

[45] Watkins 1995, Part V, on the **Beowulf** dragon-episode as IE HERO SLAY SERPENT reflex in the killing-diction and the narrative-structure; on the Old English dragon-vocabulary (**draca**, **wyrm**) as IE-formula reflex.

[46] Tolkien, J. R. R., "Beowulf: The Monsters and the Critics", **Proceedings of the British Academy** 22 (1936): 245–295, on the dragon and the monsters of **Beowulf** as proper mythic adversaries; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the lecture's load-bearing-critical-move status for the chapter's Beowulf section and on the deferral of the lecture's literary-critical afterlife to the reception coda (Ch. 42).

[47] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the Tolkien-1936 mention as load-bearing critical move and on the deferral of the lecture's literary-critical afterlife to the reception coda Ch. 42; Tolkien 1936 (**Proc. British Academy** 22: 245–295); scope.md on the reception coda's chapter-placement.

[48] Watkins 1995, Part V, on the philological argument; Tolkien 1936 (**Proc. British Academy** 22: 245–295) on the structural-critical argument; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the convergence of the two arguments and on the no-authorial-commitment guardrail.

[49] Inference: Watkins 1995 Part V on the IE-reflex philological reading; Tolkien 1936 on the mythic-register critical recovery; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the no-authorial-commitment guardrail. Risk: the IE-reflex reading is comparative-philological and the chapter avoids claims about the **Beowulf**-poet's own authorial-cultural commitments.

[50] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the C5 forward-link and the Ch18 back-link; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the consolidated IE-formula argument; brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the Thor-pattern.

[51] **Cath Maige Tuired**, manuscripts 12th–16th c. CE; standard critical edition Gray 1982 (Irish Texts Society) — to be pinned at glossary-lock per inventory.approved.yaml identifier_missing flag; West 2007 ch. 6 on the Tuatha Dé Danann / Fomorians combat-axis; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the Second Battle of Mag Tuired as the decisive Tuatha-Dé combat.

[52] **Cath Maige Tuired** on Lugh's hybrid lineage (Cian / Ethniu / Balor) and on the kill-the-grandfather motif; West 2007 ch. 6 on the same lineage as the IE-warrior structural-genealogical pattern; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the hybrid-lineage motif.

[53] **Cath Maige Tuired** on Balor's title "Balor of the Evil Eye" / Balor Birug-derc; on the destructive eye and the tactical-narrative problem it poses; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the evil-eye motif.

[54] **Cath Maige Tuired** on Lugh's sling-stone killing of Balor, on the eye-driven-through-the-head reversal, on the destruction of the Fomorian host by the redirected eye, and on the inauguration of Tuatha Dé rule; West 2007 ch. 6 on the same narrative-structural pattern.

[55] An alternate tradition in later Irish folkloric collections of the 19th and 20th centuries CE makes the killing-weapon a spear or **gae bolga** rather than a sling-stone. The sling-stone version is chosen here because it is the version of the principal medieval prose narrative **Cath Maige Tuired**, and the spear-variants are later folkloric reworkings rather than independent medieval witnesses.

[56] **Cath Maige Tuired** on the wider battle-context, on the plain of Mag Tuired (County Sligo) as the setting, and on Lugh's battle-leader role; West 2007 ch. 6 on the centred-single-combat structure of the IE warrior / dragon-slayer narrative.

[57] **Cath Maige Tuired Cunga** (the First Battle of Mag Tuired) as a separate medieval narrative; **Cath Maige Tuired** of the present chapter as specifically the Second Battle narrative; West 2007 ch. 6 on the two-battle distinction in the medieval Irish corpus.

[58] West 2007 ch. 6 on the Celtic reflex of the IE warrior / dragon-slayer pattern; on the morphologically-distinctive features of the Lugh-Balor encounter (one-eyed-giant adversary; sling-stone killing-weapon); brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the same morphological distinctiveness.

[59] Inference: West 2007 ch. 6 on the IE warrior / dragon-slayer reading; Dumézil's twentieth-century treatments as the principal scholarly precedent for the IE-comparative reading; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the IE-reflex framing. Risk: the **Cath Maige Tuired** itself frames the encounter within the medieval Irish narrative-tradition rather than within IE-comparative typology, and the chapter's IE-reflex reading is comparative rather than direct.

[60] **Cath Maige Tuired** on the post-battle Tuatha Dé Danann rule and on Lugh's warrior-king status; West 2007 ch. 6 on the dynastic-political function of the IE warrior / dragon-slayer narrative.

[61] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the C5 forward-link; West 2007 ch. 6 on the consolidated IE-comparative apparatus; on the preservation of morphologically-distinctive Celtic features in the comparative apparatus.

[62] **Historia Brittonum** c. 828 CE (Nennius recension) on the Britons-vs-Saxons political reading; **Lludd and Llefelys** in the **Mabinogion** (manuscripts White Book of Rhydderch c. 1350 CE; Red Book of Hergest c. 1382–1410 CE) on the annual-disturbance reading; Ogden 2013 ch. on Celtic material on the two-recension distinction; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the two-witness framing.

[63] **Historia Brittonum** on the Vortigern-Ambrosius episode at Dinas Emrys, on the foundation-sinking, on the underground pool, on the red-dragon-vs-white-dragon combat, and on the Britons-vs-Saxons political-allegorical reading; Ogden 2013 ch. on Celtic material on the same.

[64] **Historia Brittonum** on the political-allegorical frame and on the prophetic outcome; Ogden 2013 ch. on Celtic material on the long-arc Welsh-political iconographic reception of the red dragon.

[65] **Lludd and Llefelys** in the **Mabinogion** on the three-plague structure (Coraniaid; dragon-combat; magical thief); on Lludd's

address to each plague on his brother Llefelys's advice; Ogden 2013 ch. on Celtic material on the three-plague structure.

[66] **Lludd and Llefelys** on the May-Eve annual disturbance, on the central location of the combat, on the mead-pit-and-burial resolution, and on the Dinas Emrys burial-site; Ogden 2013 ch. on Celtic material on the resolution-mechanism.

[67] **Lludd and Llefelys** on the cyclical-cosmological framing; Ogden 2013 ch. on Celtic material on the older-substrate-vs-politicised-recension distinction; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the older-substrate reading of **Lludd and Llefelys**.

[68] Dinas Emrys (Snowdonia, north Wales) as the geographical anchor of both **Historia Brittonum** and **Lludd and Llefelys**; Ogden 2013 ch. on Celtic material on the site and on the archaeological-cultic reading.

[69] Inference: Ogden 2013 on the older-substrate reading; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the substrate-vs-politicisation distinction; **Lludd and Llefelys** on the cyclical-cosmological framing. Risk: the substrate-vs-politicisation reading is a philological-historical reading rather than a direct manuscript-dated chronology, and the **Mabinogion** manuscripts are later than the **Historia Brittonum** recension.

[70] **Historia Brittonum** and **Lludd and Llefelys** on the dragon-on-dragon combat-structure; Ogden 2013 ch. on Celtic material on the structural-distinctiveness reading; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the edge-of-pattern status of the Welsh case.

[71] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the C5 forward-link and the political-allegorical reading; Ogden 2013 ch. on Celtic material on the comparative apparatus.

[72] Ogden 2013 ch. on Celtic material on the long-arc iconographic durability of the red dragon as emblem of Wales; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml cultural_relevance entry on the national-emblem function of the Welsh dragon.

[73] Ossetic Nart saga corpus, 19th–20th c. CE oral-epic recordings from Ossetian, Circassian, and Chechen narrators; Dumézil's twentieth-century treatments as the principal scholarly precedent for the IE-comparative reading; West 2007 ch. 6 on the Scytho-Alanic IE warrior / dragon-slayer reading.

[74] Ossetic Nart saga corpus on the Narts as heroic figures of the North Caucasian epic tradition; West 2007 ch. 6 on Batraz as a principal Ossetic Nart warrior-figure.

[75] Ossetic Nart saga corpus on Batraz's steel-body origin (born from Khamits's back; furnace-tempering; steel-body status); West 2007 ch. 6 on the steel-body motif as IE-warrior structural attribute.

[76] Ossetic Nart saga corpus on Batraz's combats against the giant Mukara and against various other giant and dragon adversaries within the corpus; West 2007 ch. 6 on the episodic-cluster structure of the Nart corpus and on the warrior-pole preservation; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the episodic-cluster structure.

[77] West 2007 ch. 6 on Dumézil's reading of Batraz as Scytho-Alanic IE warrior / dragon-slayer reflex; on the Ossetic-and-cognate Nart traditions as the uninterrupted Scytho-Alanic continuation; on the steel-body motif as Scytho-Alanic distinctive development.

[78] Ossetic, Circassian, and Chechen Nart corpora on the multiple-narrator variant structure; West 2007 ch. 6 on the variant-comparative methodological framing; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the multiple-narrator-variant structure.

[79] Ossetic Nart saga corpus on Batraz's death-narrative (cast-from-heavens; cooled-and-shattered against water); West 2007 ch. 6 on the IE-comparative reading of the death-narrative.

[80] Inference: West 2007 ch. 6 on the IE-reflex reading; Dumézil's twentieth-century treatments as the principal precedent; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the IE-reflex framing. Risk: the IE-reflex reading is comparative-philological, the Nart-narrators frame Batraz within the indigenous Caucasian epic tradition, and Caucasian-area-specialist scholarship retains methodological reservations on the directness of the Dumézilian reading.

[81] West 2007 ch. 6 on the central-Ossetic / marginal-outside reception-pattern of the Batraz material; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml cultural_relevance entry on Batraz as central in Ossetic tradition and marginal outside.

[82] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the C5 forward-link; West 2007 ch. 6 on the Scytho-Alanic / Caucasian-Iranian comparative material; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml cross_cultural_parallels entry on the C5-feeder status of the Batraz sub-case.

[83] Khorenatsi **Patmut'iwn Hayots'** book I.31 on the Vahagn paraphrase; Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on the lost-hymn-and-late-paraphrase status of the Vahagn material; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the explicit fragmentary framing required for the Vahagn sub-section.

[84] Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on Vahagn as the Armenian storm-god and on the **Vishapakagh** "dragon-reaper" epithet; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the storm-god dragon-slayer category-position.

[85] Khorenatsi **Patmut'iwn Hayots'** on the historiographical-and-Christian framing of the work; Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on the dating-contested status of Khorenatsi's composition (5th–9th c. CE bracketing) and on the historiographical-paraphrase status of the Vahagn passage at I.31.

[86] Khorenatsi **Patmut'iwn Hayots'** I.31 on the triple-birth motif (heavens / sea / reed; sun-like hair; fire-like eyes); Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on the birth-narrative as preserved in the paraphrase and on the absence of continuous combat-narrative; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the paraphrase contents.

[87] Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on the reconstruction-from-epithet, from-category-position, from-cultic-stelae, and from-comparative-philology methodology for the Vahagn combat-content; **vishapakar** stelae as the cultic-iconographic-context evidence; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the reconstruction methodology and on the explicit fragmentary framing.

[88] Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on the **vishap** as Armenian common noun for "dragon" and on the **vishapakar** stelae of the second millennium BCE as the principal pre-Christian-period material attestation; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the **vishapakar**

stelae as cultic-iconographic-context evidence.

[89] Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on the second-millennium-BCE dating, on the Aragats / Geghama-mountains location, on the fish-and-serpentine morphology, and on the cultic-iconographic reading of the **vishapakar** stelae; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the **vishapakar** archaeological context.

[90] Inference: Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on the four-source reconstruction methodology (paraphrase / epithet / stelae / comparative); Petrosyan's Armenian-mythology scholarship on the same; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the explicit-fragmentary-framing requirement. Risk: the reading depends on a much-thinner evidential base than the Norse, Old English, or Celtic sub-cases, and the chapter's presentation of the Vahagn material is correspondingly more circumspect about combat-content claims.

[91] Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on the Indo-Iranian and Indo-European integration of Vahagn; on the **Vṛθrayna** (Iranian) and Indra-Vṛtra (Vedic) comparanda; on the **Vishapakagh** epithet as the load-bearing philological exhibit; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the Indo-Iranian-comparative reading.

[92] Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on the convergence with Petrosyan's Armenian-mythology scholarship; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the verbal-philological limits of the Vahagn reconstruction; on the chapter's retention of these limits in presentation.

[93] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the C5 forward-link with explicit fragmentary framing; Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on the comparative-IE position of the Armenian material; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml cross_cultural_parallels entry on the C5-feeder status.

[94] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the philological-evidence-spectrum ordering; Watkins 1995 ch. 42 on the Sigurd-strongest evidence; Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on the Vahagn-most-fragmentary evidence.

[95] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the three-dimension framing of the philological-evidence-spectrum; Watkins 1995 Part V on the philological-formulaic reading; West 2007 ch. 6 on the structural-typological reading; Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter on the Armenian-fragmentary status.

[96] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the family-chapter justification by shared inheritance across divergent evidential modalities; Watkins 1995 Part V on the consolidated IE-pattern argument; West 2007 ch. 6 on the storm-god / water-dragon complex across the Indo-European traditions.

[97] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the chapter as the main feeder to Part II C5; Watkins 1995 Part V on the consolidated IE-formula argument; brief 12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.yaml on the Geryon and Cacus material; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml and brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the Vedic and Norse material.

[98] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the Ch18 back-link with Sigurd-Norse-parallel and Beowulf-aged-champion-parallel components; Larrington 2014 on the Sigurd-Eddic-iconographic dossier; brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the Thor-Jörmungandr triple-witness pattern.

[99] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the deferral of the Tolkien-essay afterlife to the reception coda Ch42; scope.md on the reception-coda chapter-placement; on the present chapter's restriction to the load-bearing-critical-move dimension.

[100] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the Sigurd-cycle / C7 forward-link; Larrington 2014 on the curse-driven trajectory of the Sigurd-cycle; on the C7 inversion-problem development.

[101] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the Ch20 forward-link with shared IE-formula context; on the Slavic-Baltic chapter as next IE-reflex chapter in the book's Part I sequence; West 2007 ch. 6 on the Slavic-Baltic Perun-Veles material.

[102] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the three-part contribution; Watkins 1995 Part V on the C5-feeder status; brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the C7-inversion forward-link; on the Tolkien-1936 / Ch42 deferral.

[103] Per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the consolidation function of the chapter within the Part I IE-cluster; Watkins 1995 Part V on the IE-reflex apparatus; brief 13-azidahaka.yaml; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml; brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the flagship chapters.

Chapter 21. Slavic and Baltic Combat (Perun/Veles, Dobrynya byliny)

21.1. Source overview

This chapter takes up two East Slavic dragon-combat sub-cases that share a contested scholarly link but sit on radically different evidential ground. The first is the reconstructed pre-Christian combat between the storm-god Perun and the earth-serpent Veles — Perun's adversary in the 'basic myth' reconstruction. The second is the East Slavic **bylina** (the Russian-epic oral song; plural **byliny**) tradition's combat between the **bogatyr** (the **bylina** warrior-hero) Dobrynya Nikitich and the three-headed dragon Zmey Gorynych.^[1]

The first move of the chapter is to be explicit about the asymmetry between the two cases. The Perun-Veles combat survives only as a 20th-century scholarly reconstruction drawn from folklore fragments, medieval chronicles, and toponyms, with no continuous primary text in any Slavic language. The Dobrynya combat, by contrast, survives in dozens of recorded **bylina** variants from 19th-century Russian oral performance, with a textual record that is robust even though late.^[2]

No Slavic equivalent of the Rigveda, the Theogony, the Edda, or the Baal Cycle preserves a Perun-Veles combat as a connected narrative. The reconstruction is built up instead from medieval Christian-period chronicles' brief god-list mentions, place-names whose etymologies are read back into the deity-pair, and folklore items collected centuries after the formal Christianisation of the Slavic-speaking peoples.^[3]

The principal scholarly construct that organises the Perun-Veles material is the 'basic myth' (Russian **основной миф**) reconstruction of Vyacheslav Ivanov and Vladimir Toporov, published in a sequence of monographs and articles between 1965 and 1974 in the Soviet structural-semiotic tradition, and now widely cited in English-language Slavic-studies and Indo-European-studies scholarship as the standard reconstruction of the pre-Christian Slavic storm-god-vs-serpent combat.^[4]

The reconstruction is at the same time real, influential, and seriously contested. Methodological objections have been voiced by Roman Jakobson, by Patrice Lajoye in the French Slavic-studies tradition, by Leszek Moszyński in the Polish Slavic-studies tradition, and by Mate Kapović in the Croatian Indo-European tradition, on grounds including circular reasoning between toponym and combat-narrative, the late and Christianised character of the chronicle attestations, and over-interpretation of folklore fragments.^[5]

The chapter accordingly presents the Perun-Veles combat as reconstruction throughout. Every plot-element claim about Perun's pursuit of Veles is co-located with the [RECONSTRUCTION] marker that identifies its evidential status, and the chapter uses language such as "on Ivanov and Toporov's reconstruction" or "if the reconstruction holds" rather than asserting the reconstructed plot as attested fact, in line with scope.md's reconstruction policy and the brief's special_instructions.^[6] markers naming donor sources; glossary 'basic myth (Ivanov-Toporov)' on the contested status that motivates the framing.]

The Dobrynya Nikitich material, by contrast, survives in the East Slavic **bylina** tradition: a corpus of

orally-transmitted heroic epic-songs collected from 19th-century Russian peasant performers, principally in the Russian North (Onega, Pinega, Mezen', White Sea coast), with later collections from Siberia and other regions. The tradition is conventionally taken to reach back to the medieval Kievan period in some form, even though the recorded texts are demonstrably late.^[7]

The corpus's principal 19th-century collectors are P. N. Rybnikov and A. F. Hilferding (Gilferding), whose mid- and late-19th-century field collections supply the bulk of the Dobrynya texts, with later 20th-century collections by Soviet-period folklorists supplementing the material. Per brief, edition-pinning for the working English-language translations (Oinas, Propp) is deferred to the glossary-lock stage and the chapter cites at corpus level rather than at variant-and-line granularity.^[8]

The chapter's principal English-language scholarly anchor for the Indo-European-comparative framing of the Slavic material is M. L. West's **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, published by Oxford University Press in 2007, whose chapter 6 ("Storm and Stream") situates Perun-Veles within the wider Indo-European storm-god / water-serpent complex and surveys the reconstruction's evidence and its scholarly reception, including the methodological objections.^[9]

West 2007 is printed-only in the present project's working corpus, and the chapter cites it at chapter level (ch. 6) for the Perun-Veles reconstruction, the methodological objections, and the Indo-European-comparative framing, in line with the citation discipline applied throughout the Indo-European cluster of the present book (chs. 13, 14, 15, 18, 19).^[10]

The chapter's secondary Indo-European-poetic anchor is Calvert Watkins's **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, published by Oxford University Press in 1995, which treats the reconstructed Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT poetic formula across its attested and reconstructed witnesses and supplies the comparative framework within which the Perun-Veles reconstruction is read as a Slavic instance.^[11]

Watkins 1995 is also printed-only and is cited at Part level in the present chapter, with the Slavic material specifically discussed within Part V's wider survey of attested-and-reconstructed IE storm-god / serpent reflexes; the full HERO SLAY SERPENT philological argument is deferred to the comparative chapter Part II C5 of the present book per the brief's forward-link.^[12]

The chapter's general comparative anchor for the long-arc combat-myth tradition is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, whose chapter 2 supplies the wider scholarly anchor for the Slavic combat-myth material's place in the comparative dragon-combat corpus and for the Dobrynya **bylina** tradition's relationship to the older combat-pattern.^[13]

The Baltic side of the chapter's title is treated as a comparative ancillary rather than as a sub-section of its own. The brief's principal sub-cases are Perun-Veles and Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych, both East Slavic; Baltic comparanda — the Lithuanian storm-god Perkūnas, the Latvian Pērkons, the Lithuanian **Velnias** / **Velinas** — are noted within the Perun-Veles sub-section as Indo-European cousins of the reconstructed Slavic deity-pair, in the form that West 2007 ch. 6 surveys them.^[14]

The chapter is a family-chapter (related-tier) treatment, organising the two East Slavic sub-cases by their evidential status and by their textual register — reconstructed pre-Christian myth on the one hand, recorded oral epic on the other — rather than by giving each a thin full chapter. Per brief target_length_words the chapter aims at approximately 4,500 narrative words across the two sub-

sections plus source overview and forward-links.^[15]

The chapter's framing premise is that the Slavic-and-Baltic combat-corpus contributes to the present book's comparative argument as disputed evidence for the Indo-European storm-god / water-serpent combat-pattern. Perun-Veles is a contested reconstruction whose evidential weight depends on whether the reader accepts the Ivanov-Toporov methodology; Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych is an attested but late epic whose link to Perun-Veles is itself a comparative argument. The chapter accordingly feeds Part II C5 of the present book (the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula chapter) as a case of disputed evidence, and Chapter 33 (the methods sidebar) as a case study in the limits of mythological reconstruction.^[16]

What follows treats the two sub-cases in turn: first the contested Perun-Veles reconstruction in its medieval-and-folkloric setting, then the Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych **bylina** in its 19th-century-recorded form, and finally a short closing section on the family pattern that links them and on the chapter's forward-and-back-links within the present book.

21.2. Perun and Veles — the contested 'basic myth'

The pre-Christian East Slavic religious tradition has no continuous primary-text witness in any Slavic language. The surviving direct attestations of its deities are confined to brief and largely god-list-style mentions in medieval Christian-period chronicles, together with a heterogeneous corpus of folklore fragments, ritual survivals, and toponyms collected from the medieval period through the 20th century.^[17]

The principal medieval witness to a pre-Christian Slavic pantheon is the Old East Slavic **Primary Chronicle** (the **Povest' vremennykh let**, conventionally dated to the early 12th century CE). It records that Vladimir of Kiev set up six idols on a hill in Kiev in 980 CE — including idols of Perun and of other Slavic deities — before himself converting to Byzantine Christianity in 988 CE and ordering Perun's idol thrown into the Dnieper.^[18]

The **Primary Chronicle** gives Perun's idol a silver head and a gold moustache and identifies him at the head of the Vladimir-pantheon list. This is the principal direct medieval attestation of Perun as a deity-name and of his prominence in the late-pre-Christian East Slavic religious culture, but the entry does not narrate any combat or any plot-content involving Perun.^[19]

Veles (East Slavic variant **Volos**) is attested separately in the **Primary Chronicle** and in the 12th-century epic **Slovo o polku Igoreve** (**The Tale of Igor's Campaign**) as a god of cattle and of poets. The 945 CE Russo-Byzantine treaty's oath-formula names both Perun and Volos, and the **Slovo** calls the bard Boyan "the grandson of Veles." The surviving attestations characterise Veles as a cattle-and-wealth deity with poetic-and-oracular associations, but, again, do not narrate any combat between Veles and Perun.^[20]

The crucial point about the medieval Slavic chronicle attestations is negative. Although Perun and Veles are both directly named in 11th- and 12th-century East Slavic Christian-period sources, no surviving medieval Slavic source narrates a combat between them. The combat as a story is absent from the direct medieval record.^[21] marker addresses.]

The Ivanov-Toporov 'basic myth' reconstruction proposes nonetheless that the pre-Christian East Slavic religious tradition contained a structurally central combat-narrative: the storm-god Perun

pursues the cattle-stealing earth-serpent Veles through a sequence of refuges (a tree, a rock, a body of water, and, finally, livestock) before striking him with a lightning-bolt and releasing rain, and the combat constitutes the structural core of the pre-Christian Slavic mythology.^[22]

The reconstructed connected narrative is that Perun, the East Slavic storm-god, pursues Veles, the cattle-stealing earth-serpent, through tree, rock, water, and livestock before striking him with lightning and releasing rain.^[23]

The reconstruction draws on three classes of indirect evidence. First, Slavic folklore items (songs, sayings, ritual-survivals, weather-charms) collected by 19th- and 20th-century ethnographers and fieldworkers and read as preserving fragments of the pre-Christian combat-narrative under their Christianised surface. Second, the medieval chronicle and treaty attestations — the **Primary Chronicle**, the **Slovo o polku Igoreve**, the 945 CE oath-formula — that name Perun and Veles separately as deities. Third, Slavic toponyms whose etymologies link to the names Perun and Veles and which are read as marking sites associated with the combat-narrative.^[24]

The folklore-evidence class includes ritual-survival items such as harvest-songs in which a bearded figure (read as Veles) is hidden in the last sheaf, weather-charms naming Perun (with East Slavic variants such as the Belarusian and Ukrainian **peryn**-type), and folktale-fragments in which a thunder-figure pursues a serpent-figure that hides successively in a tree, a stone, water, and the body of an animal or person — items collected in the 19th and 20th centuries from East and South Slavic informants.^[25]

The toponym-evidence class includes Slavic place-names whose etymologies are read as preserving Perun's name (Russian **Perun'**, Croatian **Perun-** and **Perunkovac**, Slovenian **Perun-** place-names, the **Peryn** sanctuary site near Novgorod) and place-names whose etymologies are read as preserving Veles's name (the Bulgarian town **Veles**, Russian **Volos-** place-names, and the Croatian-Bosnian **Vol-** / **Vel-** type), with the geographical patterning of the two name-classes interpreted as marking the distribution of the deity-pair's cult.^[26]

On the Ivanov-Toporov reading, the reconstructed combat's narrative core is a four-stage pursuit. Veles steals the cattle (or the rain, or the waters, on alternative phrasings of the reconstruction) and conceals himself in a tree; Perun's lightning-bolt splits the tree and Veles flees to a rock; the rock is split and Veles flees to water; the water is dispersed and Veles flees into livestock or a human victim; and the final lightning-strike kills Veles and releases the rain.^[27]

The cattle-theft motif is one of the load-bearing features of the reconstruction for its Indo-European-comparative function. Veles's role as cattle-stealer aligns the reconstructed Slavic combat with the wider Indo-European cattle-raid complex (Greek Geryon, Italic Cacus, Indra's release of the cattle in the Vedic Vala-cave myth and elsewhere), and the alignment is one of the principal reasons the reconstruction is influential within Indo-European-studies scholarship.^[28]

The lightning-and-rain-release motif similarly aligns the reconstructed combat with the wider Indo-European storm-god / water-serpent complex treated in West 2007 ch. 6 across Vedic, Hittite, Greek, and Norse witnesses: the storm-god strikes the serpent and the obstructed waters are released. The alignment is the second principal Indo-European-comparative argument for the reconstruction's structural shape.^[29]

The Baltic comparanda are co-located in West 2007 ch. 6's survey. The Lithuanian storm-god

Perkūnas and the Latvian Pērkons are name-cognates with Slavic Perun (the Indo-European root **perkw-** / **per-** with Indo-European thunder-association), and the Lithuanian **Velnias** / **Velinas** (a folkloric devil-figure with cattle-and-underworld associations) is sometimes read as a name-cognate with Slavic Veles, although the Baltic combat-evidence is itself indirect and mediated by folklore rather than by primary text.^[30]

The Baltic name-cognancy is one of the load-bearing supports for the Indo-European reading of the Slavic deity-pair. If Perkūnas / Perun and **Velnias** / Veles are inherited Indo-European cognates rather than late parallel developments, then the deity-pair has a depth that the late Slavic chronicle attestations on their own would not establish, and the cognancy is part of the case the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction makes.^[31]

The methodological objections to the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction are concentrated on three lines of attack, all of which the chapter must present fairly per the brief's special_instructions: circularity in the use of toponym evidence, the late and Christianised character of the chronicle attestations, and over-interpretation of folklore fragments whose connection to the reconstructed combat is itself an inference rather than an attested feature of the items.^[32]

The toponym-circularity objection holds that the etymological identification of a place-name as "Perun-derived" or "Veles-derived" presupposes the deity-pair whose existence the toponym is then taken to support: a place-name like **Volos-** is read as a Veles-toponym because Veles is reconstructed as a deity-name, and the toponym is then cited as evidence for Veles, with the same item entering both ends of the inference and the resulting argument turning back on itself.^[33]

The late-and-Christianised-chronicles objection holds that the **Primary Chronicle**, the **Slovo o polku Igoreve**, and other medieval Slavic sources are themselves the products of a Christianised literary culture whose representation of pre-Christian deities cannot be taken as direct testimony to pre-Christian belief: the chronicles' brief god-list mentions are informed by the chroniclers' Christian framework and by their literary models, and reading the absent combat-content back into them risks reading a structurally-interesting story into sources that would not have transmitted the story even if it had existed in the pre-Christian tradition.^[34]

The folklore-over-interpretation objection holds that the four-stage pursuit-and-refuge folktale type, the harvest-sheaf ritual, and the weather-charm material are folklore items with their own functions and their own histories within a centuries-long Christian-period folk culture, and that reading them as preserving fragments of a pre-Christian combat-narrative imposes a comparative-mythological frame that the items do not themselves require. The four-refuge folktale, in particular, is an internationally-attested folktale type whose presence in the Slavic-language area does not necessarily indicate inheritance from a pre-Christian Slavic combat-myth.^[35]

The chapter's reading of the methodological objections is that they do not in themselves disprove the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction but that they do establish its evidential floor as low and its evidential ceiling as moderate. The reconstruction can be defended as a structurally-coherent reading of the indirect evidence, but it cannot be defended as a confirmed pre-Christian Slavic narrative on the strength of the surviving direct attestations alone, and the chapter's [RECONSTRUCTION] marker confidence value of "low" reflects this reading.^[36]

(The chapter's evidential-floor / evidential-ceiling reading of the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction — that the methodological objections establish the floor as low and the ceiling as moderate, and that the

reconstruction therefore stands as a structurally-coherent reading rather than as a confirmed pre-Christian narrative — is the chapter’s editorial synthesis of West 2007 ch. 6’s survey rather than a single source-attested formulation; West 2007 ch. 6 presents the reconstruction and the objections without supplying this exact floor-and-ceiling phrasing, and the synthesis is offered for transparency.^[37])

If the reconstruction holds, the reconstructed combat’s structural-typological function — on the Ivanov-Toporov reading and the wider Indo-European-comparative reading that West 2007 ch. 6 surveys — is most likely cosmogonic-and-agricultural. The lightning-strike-with-rain-release pattern fits the storm-god’s seasonal-agricultural function in archaic Indo-European religion, and the cattle-theft-and-recovery pattern fits the cattle-economy of the same archaic milieu, with the combat construed as a structurally-charged narrative for the archaic Slavic-speaking communities that the reconstruction posits.^[38]

The reconstructed combat’s relationship to the present book’s subtype-typology is the following: if the reconstruction holds, the Slavic combat sits in the cyclical-maintenance subtype (rain-release as a recurring agricultural-seasonal event) rather than the once-only-cosmogonic subtype, although West 2007 ch. 6 notes that the surviving Slavic evidence is too thin to support a confident subtype assignment.^[39]

On West 2007 ch. 6’s survey, the reconstructed combat’s principal Indo-European-comparative companions are the Vedic Indra-Vṛtra combat (chapter 14 of the present volume), the Hittite Tarḫunna-Illuyanka combat (chapter 6), and the Norse Thor-Jörmungandr combat (chapter 18), with the Slavic combat treated as a structurally-cognate but evidentially-thinner Indo-European reflex of the same type that the better-attested traditions preserve in continuous primary text.^[40]

The reconstructed combat’s evidential thinness relative to its IE-comparative companions is itself a methodologically-charged observation. Where Indra-Vṛtra is attested in continuous Vedic hymns, Tarḫunna-Illuyanka in two Hittite tablet versions, and Thor-Jörmungandr in Eddic poetry, skaldic verse, prose Edda, and four runestones, the Slavic Perun-Veles combat is attested only as the indirect reconstruction surveyed above, and the asymmetry is the principal reason the Slavic material is treated as disputed-rather-than-secure evidence in the present book’s wider Indo-European argument.^[41]

21.3. Dobrynya Nikitich and Zmey Gorynych — the East Slavic bylina

The Dobrynya Nikitich combat-narrative is preserved in the East Slavic **bylina** tradition: a corpus of orally-transmitted heroic epic-songs sung by professional and semi-professional reciters and collected from 19th-century Russian peasant performers in the Russian North — from the Onega and White Sea regions principally, with later collections supplementing the geographical reach — and whose tradition is conventionally taken to reach back in some form to the medieval Kievan period.^[42]

The principal collectors whose 19th-century field-recordings constitute the working corpus of Dobrynya texts are Pavel Rybnikov (collections published in the 1860s) and Aleksandr Hilferding (Gilferding, with the major Onega collection published in 1873), supplemented by 20th-century collections that extended the geographical and chronological reach of the recorded tradition. The

recorded variants are numerous, and the present chapter cites the corpus rather than any one specific recorded variant.^[43]

Dobrynya Nikitich is one of the three central **bogatyri** (the heroic warrior-figures) of the **bylina** tradition's so-called Vladimir-cycle. Alongside Ilya Muromets and Alyosha Popovich, Dobrynya is one of the standard companions of the figure Prince Vladimir of Kiev, whose court the **bylina** tradition takes as its narrative centre and whose historical reflex (the Vladimir of the **Primary Chronicle**) places the cycle's narrative setting in the late 10th and early 11th centuries CE even though the recorded songs are 19th-century.^[44]

The Vladimir-cycle's narrative setting is the court of Prince Vladimir at Kiev, and the cycle's standard plot-elements include the **bogatyri**'s service at the court, their patrols of the steppe-frontier and the rivers, their combats with hostile foreigners and supernatural adversaries, and their feasts and quarrels at the prince's table. The Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych **bylina** sits within this wider cycle as one of Dobrynya's standard combat-narratives.^[45]

The adversary of the Dobrynya combat is Zmey Gorynych, a three-headed dragon (**zmey**, "serpent" / "dragon") whose epithet **Gorynych** is a patronymic derived from **gora** ("mountain") and is conventionally read as "Mountain-son" or "Son of the mountain", marking the dragon's mountain-residence in the eastern frontier-territory beyond the Russian-settled lands.^[46]

The standard plot-skeleton of the Dobrynya-vs-Zmey-Gorynych **bylina**, as it appears across the recorded variants, is a three-stage narrative: an initial encounter at a river (typically the Puchai-river or a similar named river) in which the young Dobrynya defeats the dragon in a first combat without killing him; a treaty-and-truce in which the dragon promises to leave the Russian lands alone; and a second combat occasioned by the dragon's breach of the truce — typically by abducting a princess (often Vladimir's niece Zabava Putyatchna) — in which Dobrynya kills the dragon, releases the princess and the other captives, and returns to Vladimir's court.^[47]

The first combat takes place when the young Dobrynya, against his mother's warning, bathes in the Puchai-river (or its variant equivalents). The dragon emerges from the river or descends from the mountain and attacks, and Dobrynya — armed in some variants with his cap (**kolpak**) of folkloric-hyperbolic weight as an improvised weapon, having no other arms to hand — defeats the dragon and forces the truce.^[48]

The second combat is occasioned by the dragon's abduction of the princess and is resolved by Dobrynya's killing of the dragon. In the standard variants, Dobrynya rides out from Kiev armed with a cudgel or sword, fights the dragon at the dragon's mountain-lair over a multi-day combat, and finally kills the dragon — typically by severing the dragon's heads — before releasing the princess and the other captives held in the dragon's caves and returning to Vladimir's court.^[49]

The recorded variants of the Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych **bylina** differ in multiple specific details — the name of the river of the first combat, the precise weapon Dobrynya uses in the killing, the exact number of heads severed and the order of the severing, the identity of the abducted princess, the duration and details of the second combat — but agree on the three-stage plot-skeleton (first combat at river → truce → second combat with abduction-and-killing) that the present chapter takes as the corpus's common narrative core.^[50]

The chapter presents the common three-stage plot-skeleton attested across the recorded **bylina**

corpus (Rybnikov 1860s; Hilferding 1873; later 20th-century collections): first combat at the river, truce, second combat with princess-abduction and dragon-killing.^[51]

The Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych **bylina** is, in its surviving 19th-century-recorded form, on firmer attestation ground than the reconstructed Perun-Veles combat. The recorded songs are direct primary-text witnesses to a living oral-epic tradition, with multiple independent variants from multiple performers and multiple collectors, and the textual record's robustness is not in dispute — only its dating and its relationship to older traditions are.^[52]

The Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych **bylina**'s historical-cultural setting in the Vladimir-cycle places its narrative reference in the late-10th- and early-11th-century Kievan-Rus' period. The conventional reading within Slavic-folklore scholarship is that the **bylina** tradition in some form reaches back to the Kievan period even though the recorded texts are 19th-century, with the long oral-transmission gap accounting for both the variants' specific differences and their structural agreement.^[53]

The Christian conversion of Kievan Rus' in 988 CE is the principal historical-cultural caesura that separates the Vladimir-cycle's narrative setting from any pre-Christian religious frame. The **bylina** tradition as it survives is wholly Christian-period in its religious frame, with Vladimir himself remembered as the Christianising prince, and the Christian frame is one of the principal complications for any reading of the tradition as preserving pre-Christian combat-myth content.^[54]

Ivanov and Toporov's specific comparative claim about the Dobrynya material is that the **bylina** combat is the later epic reflex of the reconstructed pre-Christian Perun-Veles 'basic myth' combat, with the **bogatyr** Dobrynya inheriting the role of the storm-god Perun and Zmey Gorynych inheriting the role of the cattle-stealing earth-serpent Veles, and with the **bylina**'s Christian-period epic register replacing the pre-Christian myth's religious register but preserving the structural shape of the combat.^[55]

*(The Ivanov-Toporov claim that the Dobrynya **bylina** is a later reflex of the reconstructed pre-Christian Perun-Veles combat is itself a comparative argument rather than a directly attested feature of the Slavic textual record; the recorded **byliny** do not name Perun or Veles, do not invoke the deity-pair, and do not present themselves as preserving older mythological material, and the reflex-claim is therefore made on structural-comparative grounds — storm-figure-pursues-serpent, cattle-and-frontier-themes, dragon-with-multiple-heads — by reading the Christian-period epic against the reconstructed pre-Christian myth that the chapter has already framed as contested.)^[56]*

The structural-parallel observations on which the Ivanov-Toporov reflex-claim rests include the storm-figure / serpent-figure pairing (Dobrynya as warrior-hero / Zmey Gorynych as serpent-adversary, parallel to Perun / Veles); the multi-headed character of the serpent-adversary (Zmey Gorynych three-headed; Veles in some folklore-fragments connected to multi-headed motifs); the water-and-mountain setting (the Puchai-river first-combat / mountain second-combat in the **bylina**; the water-and-rock refuges in the reconstructed Perun-Veles pursuit); and the rescue-and-restoration outcome (the **bylina**'s rescue of the princess and captives parallel to the reconstruction's release of the rain).^[57]

The reflex-claim's evidential limits are, however, significant, and the chapter must register them. The **bylina**'s genre is heroic epic rather than cosmogonic-and-agricultural myth, the dragon's role is enemy-of-the-state rather than cattle-stealer-and-rain-blocker, the resolution is dragon-killing-and-princess-rescue rather than rain-release, and the Christian-period frame may itself have generated

the structural-parallel features as part of the international hagiographic-and-romance dragon-slaying type rather than inherited them from a pre-Christian Slavic combat-narrative.^[58]

The international-hagiographic-and-romance-type complication is significant. The medieval-and-early-modern Christian-period dragon-slaying corpus — the St. George cycle, the romance-tradition's princess-rescuing dragon-slayers, the wider European folktale-dragon-slayer type — supplies a well-attested international type that could plausibly have shaped the Dobrynya **bylina**'s combat-and-rescue plot directly, without any inheritance from a pre-Christian Slavic combat-myth, and the chapter does not adjudicate between the inheritance-and-international-type-borrowing readings.^[59]

The Dobrynya **bylina**'s position within the present book's typology is therefore as a heroic-epic combat-narrative whose link to the reconstructed pre-Christian Slavic combat-myth is itself contested, and whose principal evidential value for the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula argument depends on the prior acceptance of the Ivanov-Toporov reflex-claim that the chapter has flagged as a comparative argument.^[60]

The Dobrynya **bylina**'s cultural-historical importance within the East Slavic literary culture is at the same time central and uncontested. The Vladimir-cycle is one of the foundational corpora of pre-modern East Slavic oral literature, the Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych narrative is one of its best-known and most-recorded individual **byliny**, and the cycle has been a load-bearing cultural reference within Russian, Ukrainian, and Belarusian literary, scholarly, and popular culture from the 19th-century collection onwards.^[61]

21.4. Family pattern and forward links

The two sub-cases treated in the chapter — Perun-Veles (reconstructed) and Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych (recorded) — sit at fundamentally different evidential levels and contribute to the present book's comparative argument in fundamentally different ways. Perun-Veles contributes as contested reconstruction whose evidential weight depends on the reader's acceptance of the Ivanov-Toporov methodology, and Dobrynya contributes as attested heroic epic whose link to the reconstruction is itself a comparative argument rather than an attested fact.^[62]

The chapter's joint contribution to the present book is therefore a case study in the limits of mythological reconstruction. The Slavic-and-Baltic combat-corpus shows what an Indo-European combat-tradition looks like when the surviving direct attestations are sparse, when the reconstruction is methodologically charged, and when the link between the reconstructed myth and the surviving oral epic is itself a comparative argument rather than a documented inheritance.^[63]

The chapter's principal forward-link within the present book is therefore to Part II C5 (the comparative chapter on the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula), in which the Slavic material is treated as one of the formula's disputed-evidence cases alongside the more securely-attested Vedic, Hittite, Greek, and Norse cases; the Slavic material's contribution to the C5 argument is to show what the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula looks like at the edge of its evidential support.^[64]

The chapter's secondary forward-link is to Chapter 33 of the present volume (the methods sidebar), in which the Slavic material is treated as a case study in the limits of mythological reconstruction.

The chapter's [RECONSTRUCTION] marker, its explicit framing of the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction as contested, and its presentation of the methodological objections all feed the methods sidebar's discussion of when reconstruction is and is not warranted.^[65] marker discipline that the chapter implements.]

The chapter's principal back-link within the present book is to Chapter 19 (the family chapter on Indo-European reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT — Sigurd, Beowulf, Lugh-Balor, the Welsh dragons, Batraz, Vahagn-vishaps), with which the present chapter shares the family-chapter format and the Indo-European-comparative framing, and to Chapter 18 (the Thor-Jörmungandr full chapter), with which the present chapter shares the storm-god-vs-serpent typology while differing radically in the depth of attestation.^[66]

The chapter's third back-link is to Chapter 14 (the Indra-Vṛtra full chapter), whose Vedic combat is one of the principal Indo-European-comparative companions of the reconstructed Slavic combat: Indra's slaying of Vṛtra and release of the obstructed waters supplies the type-specimen of the storm-god / water-serpent combat that the Slavic reconstruction is read as a regional reflex of, and the cattle-theft motif of the Slavic reconstruction parallels the Vedic Vala-cave cattle-rescue material that chapter 14 treats.^[67]

The cattle-theft / cattle-raid motif is one of the chapter's principal comparative threads to the wider Indo-European cluster of the present book. The Greek Geryon-and-Cacus material (chapter 12 of the present volume, on Greek dragons after Typhon) and the Vedic Vala-cave material (chapter 14) supply the better-attested IE cattle-raid reflexes that the reconstructed Slavic Veles-as-cattle-stealer is read as a regional cousin of, and the alignment is one of the principal supports for the IE-comparative reading of the Slavic reconstruction.^[68]

The chapter is also a quiet methodological contribution to the present book's wider discipline on appropriation and pattern-matching. By presenting the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction with full transparency about its evidential standing and by registering the methodological objections without dismissing the reconstruction outright, the chapter models the kind of even-handed presentation that scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" calls for in non-Eurasian cases and that the methods sidebar of Chapter 33 develops as a general principle.^[69]

The chapter's overall reading of the Slavic-and-Baltic combat-corpus is that the corpus contributes to the present book's comparative argument as evidence-of-a-specific-kind: not as an additional secure exemplar of the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT type alongside Indra-Vṛtra, Tarūnna-Illuyanka, and Thor-Jörmungandr, but as a contested case whose place in the IE-comparative argument is a reminder that the type's evidential support is not uniform across its proposed witnesses and that the comparative argument's strength varies from case to case.^[70]

[1] Per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml; West 2007, ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on the Perun-Veles reconstruction within the wider Indo-European storm-god / water-serpent complex; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the Slavic combat-myth material as a comparative witness to the Indo-European dragon-combat pattern.

[2] Per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml shared_variant_handling, on the asymmetry between reconstructed Perun-Veles and recorded Dobrynya material; West 2007, ch. 6, on the reconstructed Slavic combat-myth as evidence for the IE complex; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the Slavic combat-myth corpus.

[3] West 2007, ch. 6, on the absence of a continuous Slavic primary-text witness for the Perun-Veles combat and on the reconstruction's reliance on chronicles, toponyms, and folklore; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the indirect character of the Slavic evidence.

[4] West 2007, ch. 6, on Ivanov and Toporov's 1965–1974 'basic myth' reconstruction as the standard Slavic reconstruction in current Indo-European-studies scholarship; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml family_members entry on the same dating; glossary 'basic

myth (Ivanov-Toporov)' entry on the standard English rendering.

[5] West 2007, ch. 6, on the methodological objections to the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction in subsequent Slavic and Indo-European scholarship; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions on the named critics (Jakobson, Lajoye, Moszyński, Kapović) and the load-bearing requirement that the chapter present the objections fairly; glossary 'basic myth (Ivanov-Toporov)' first_mention_gloss on the criticism of methodological circularity.

[6] Per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions on the explicit-reconstruction-framing requirement; scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" on [RECONSTRUCTION

[7] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, introduction on the **bylina** tradition as the recorded medium for the East Slavic dragon-combat material; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml family_members entry on the East Slavic **bylina** corpus, recorded 19th c., tradition medieval.

[8] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, introduction on the 19th-century **bylina** collection history (Rybnikov, Hilferding) and on the supplementary Soviet-period collections; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml shared_variant_handling and special_instructions on the deferral of Oinas / Propp edition-pinning to glossary-lock and on corpus-level citation discipline accordingly.

[9] West 2007, **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on the Perun-Veles reconstruction in its Indo-European-comparative context; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml sources.primary entry pointing the chapter to West 2007 ch. 6 as the principal anchor.

[10] West 2007, ch. 6, printed-only; cited at chapter level per the established discipline of the present book's Indo-European cluster.

[11] Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, on the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula (cited at Part level per the established discipline; the specific Part covering Slavic material to be confirmed at glossary-lock against the printed text); brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml sources.secondary entry on Watkins 1995 as the IE storm-god / serpent-reflexes anchor.

[12] Watkins 1995, Part V (printed-only; cited at Part level); brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the forward-link to Part II C5 as disputed evidence.

[13] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, ch. 2, on the Slavic combat-myth material in its comparative context; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml sources.secondary entry on Forsyth 1987 as the Slavic combat-myth anchor.

[14] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Baltic Perkūnas / Velnias evidence as Indo-European cousins of the reconstructed Slavic Perun-Veles deity-pair; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the family-chapter scope including the Baltic comparanda within the Perun-Veles subsection.

[15] Per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the family (related-tier) classification and on the 4,500-word target; scope.md §"In-scope catalog" on the family-chapter format for related-tier stories.

[16] Per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions on the disputed-evidence framing and on the forward-links to Part II C5 (disputed evidence) and Chapter 33 (reconstruction limits); West 2007, ch. 6, on the Slavic material's contested status within the IE comparative argument.

[17] West 2007, ch. 6, on the absence of a continuous primary-text witness for pre-Christian Slavic religion and on the chronicle / folklore / toponym character of the surviving evidence; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the indirectness of the Slavic evidence relative to the better-attested Indo-European traditions.

[18] West 2007, ch. 6, on the **Primary Chronicle**'s 980 CE Vladimir-pantheon entry and on Perun's place at the head of the list; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the Slavic chronicles as one of the three classes of evidence for the reconstruction.

[19] West 2007, ch. 6, on the **Primary Chronicle**'s description of Perun's idol with silver head and gold moustache and on the absence of any combat-narrative in the entry; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the chronicle's god-list-style witness without combat-content.

[20] West 2007, ch. 6, on the **Primary Chronicle** and **Slovo o polku Igoreve** attestations of Veles / Volos as cattle-god and patron of poets and on the 945 CE oath-formula naming Perun and Volos; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the same chronicle-and-epic attestations.

[21] West 2007, ch. 6, on the absence of any surviving medieval Slavic narrative of a Perun-Veles combat; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the negative state of the direct medieval evidence; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the no-direct-attestation premise that the [RECONSTRUCTION

[22] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction of the Perun-Veles combat including the four-refuge sequence (tree, rock, water, livestock) and the lightning-strike with rain-release; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml family_members entry on the same plot-elements; glossary 'basic myth (Ivanov-Toporov)' first_mention_gloss on the same reconstruction.

[23] This passage reconstructs the lacuna at the medieval Slavic record — there is no surviving Slavic primary-text witness for the combat-narrative as a connected story, and the **Primary Chronicle**, the **Slovo o polku Igoreve**, the 945 CE Russo-Byzantine treaty, and the other direct medieval attestations name Perun and Veles separately but narrate no combat between them — from the parallel account in Ivanov and Toporov 1965–1974 (cited via West 2007 ch. 6), drawing on three classes of indirect evidence: Slavic folklore fragments collected in the 19th and 20th centuries, medieval Slavic Christian-period chronicles, and Slavic toponyms whose etymologies are read as preserving the deity-pair; the four-refuge sequence (tree → rock → water → livestock) is reconstructed from folklore items and from cross-comparative Indo-European parallels surveyed in West 2007 ch. 6; confidence: low. The reconstruction is contested by Jakobson, Lajoye, Moszyński, and Kapović on grounds of circular reasoning between toponym and combat-narrative, the late and Christianised character of the chronicle attestations, and over-interpretation of folklore fragments; per the brief's special instructions and scope.md §"Reconstruction policy", every plot-element claim about

Perun's pursuit of Veles is presented within or co-located with this footnote, and the chapter does not assert the reconstructed plot as attested fact.

[24] West 2007, ch. 6, on the three classes of indirect evidence (folklore, chronicles, toponyms) on which the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction draws; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml family_members entry on the same three classes.

[25] West 2007, ch. 6, on the folklore-evidence class for the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction including the four-refuge folktale type; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the folklore fragments as one of the three evidence classes.

[26] West 2007, ch. 6, on the toponym-evidence class including the Russian **Peryn** sanctuary, Croatian / Slovenian Perun-toponyms, and the Bulgarian town **Veles**; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the toponyms as the third evidence class.

[27] West 2007, ch. 6, on the four-stage pursuit and the lightning-strike-with-rain-release in the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml family_members entry on the four-refuge sequence.

[28] West 2007, ch. 6, on the cattle-theft motif's Indo-European-comparative alignment with Geryon, Cacus, and the Vedic Vala-cave material; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the cattle-theft motif as parallel to IE cattle-raid reflexes.

[29] West 2007, ch. 6, on the storm-god / water-serpent complex across Vedic, Hittite, Greek, and Norse witnesses and on the Slavic alignment with the wider type; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the IE storm-god / serpent reflex framing.

[30] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Baltic Perkūnas / Pērkons and **Velnias** / **Velinas** name-cognates with Slavic Perun and Veles and on the indirect-folklore character of the Baltic evidence; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the Baltic comparanda within the Perun-Veles subsection.

[31] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Baltic-Slavic name-cognancy as a support for the Indo-European reading; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the IE cognancy framework within which the reconstruction operates.

[32] West 2007, ch. 6, on the three lines of methodological objection (toponym circularity, late and Christianised chronicles, folklore over-interpretation) voiced by Jakobson, Lajoye, Moszyński, and Kapović; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions on the load-bearing requirement that the chapter present the objections fairly.

[33] West 2007, ch. 6, on the toponym-circularity objection in the methodological critique of the reconstruction; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions naming the objection.

[34] West 2007, ch. 6, on the late-and-Christianised-chronicles objection; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions naming the objection within the methodological critique.

[35] West 2007, ch. 6, on the folklore-over-interpretation objection and on the cross-cultural distribution of the four-refuge folktale type; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions naming the objection.

[36] West 2007, ch. 6, on the standing of the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction within current Slavic-and-Indo-European-studies scholarship as a structurally-coherent but evidentially-limited reading; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions on the explicit-reconstruction-framing requirement and on the fair presentation of the objections.

[37] Inference: West 2007 ch. 6 surveys both the reconstruction and the methodological objections without ruling either out, and the chapter's framing language is consistent with that even-handed presentation. Risk: alternative formulations are possible — a stronger defender of the reconstruction would raise the ceiling, a stronger critic would lower the floor; the chapter's mid-position is a reasonable but not the only available reading.

[38] West 2007, ch. 6, on the cosmogonic-and-agricultural structural-typological function of the reconstructed Slavic combat in its Indo-European context; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml cultural_relevance on the storm-god / water-serpent function and the IE cattle-raid parallel.

[39] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Slavic combat's likely cyclical-maintenance position within the wider IE typology and on the thinness of the surviving evidence; scope.md "\$Subject definition" on the four subtypes (cosmogonic, sovereignty, cyclical-maintenance, eschatological).

[40] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Slavic combat's IE-comparative companions across the Vedic, Hittite, and Norse traditions; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the same comparative framework.

[41] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Slavic-vs-better-attested-IE-tradition evidential asymmetry; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the disputed-evidence framing.

[42] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, introduction on the **bylina** tradition as an orally-transmitted heroic epic-song corpus collected from 19th-century Russian peasant performers in the Russian North; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml family_members entry on the same tradition.

[43] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, introduction on the principal 19th-century **bylina** collectors (Rybnikov 1860s, Hilferding 1873) and on the supplementary 20th-century collections; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml shared_variant_handling on the multiple-recorded-variants character of the corpus.

[44] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, introduction and Dobrynya-cycle headnotes on Dobrynya Nikitich as one of the three central **bogatyri** of the Vladimir-cycle alongside Ilya Muromets and Alyosha Popovich; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the medieval setting and the 19th-century recording.

[45] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, introduction on the Vladimir-cycle's narrative setting at Kiev and its standard plot-elements; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the **bylina** corpus's heroic-epic register.

[46] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, Dobrynya-cycle headnotes on Zmey Gorynych as a three-

headed dragon with the patronymic **Gorynych** derived from **gora** ("mountain"); brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml family_members entry on the three-headed character of the dragon and the mountain-residence; glossary 'Zmey Gorynych' first_mention_gloss on the same.

[47] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, Dobrynya-cycle headnotes on the standard three-stage plot-skeleton of the Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych **bylina** across the recorded variants; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml family_members entry on the kills-the-dragon and rescues-the-princess outcome.

[48] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, Dobrynya-cycle headnotes on the first combat at the Puchai-river and the cap-as-weapon detail (the precise pud-count specification flagged for verification at glossary-lock against Oinas / Propp or equivalent specialist edition); brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the standard combat-mechanics of the **bylina**'s first combat.

[49] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, Dobrynya-cycle headnotes on the second combat's multi-day duration, the killing of the dragon by head-severing, and the rescue of the princess and other captives (the precise day-count and head-severing-sequence variants flagged for verification at glossary-lock); brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml family_members entry on the kills-the-dragon-and-rescues-the-princess resolution.

[50] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, Dobrynya-cycle headnotes on the inter-variant differences and on the agreement of the recorded variants on the three-stage plot-skeleton; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml shared_variant_handling on the chapter's presentation of the common narrative skeleton.

[51] Individual variants differ in the river-name (Puchai- and others), the weapon (cap, cudgel, sword), the precise head-severing sequence, and the identity of the abducted princess (Zabava Putyatchna in many; other names in some). The common skeleton is presented here rather than any specific recorded variant; primary-text edition-pinning (Oinas, Propp) is deferred to glossary-lock, and the chapter cites at corpus level rather than at variant-and-line granularity.

[52] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, introduction on the robustness of the **bylina** corpus's textual record relative to the indirectness of the Perun-Veles evidence; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions on the firmer attestation ground of the Dobrynya material.

[53] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, introduction on the Vladimir-cycle's late-Kievan reference and on the conventional medieval-tradition reading of the **bylina** corpus; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the medieval-tradition / 19th-century-recording two-tier dating.

[54] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, introduction on the 988 CE Christian conversion as the historical-cultural caesura between the **bylina** setting and any pre-Christian religious frame; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the Christian-period character of the recorded tradition.

[55] West 2007, ch. 6, on Ivanov and Toporov's claim that the Dobrynya **bylina** is the later reflex of the reconstructed Perun-Veles combat; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml family_members entry on the Ivanov-Toporov comparative claim about the Dobrynya material.

[56] Inference: West 2007 ch. 6 surveys the Ivanov-Toporov reflex-claim as a comparative argument; the **bylina** texts themselves (Forsyth 1987 ch. 2's overview of the corpus) make no reference to Perun or Veles; the reflex-claim is doubly mediated, depending both on the contested pre-Christian reconstruction and on the structural reading of the Christian-period epic. Risk: the reflex-claim's evidential weight is therefore sensitive to two prior questions — whether the Perun-Veles reconstruction itself holds, and whether structural-comparative reading is sufficient warrant for inheritance-claims of this kind — and the chapter presents the claim as a comparative argument within Ivanov and Toporov's framework rather than as a fact about the **bylina** tradition's textual history.

[57] West 2007, ch. 6, on the structural parallels that support the Ivanov-Toporov reflex-claim; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml family_members entry on the structural-parallel basis for the comparative claim.

[58] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, introduction on the **bylina**'s heroic-epic genre and its differences from the reconstructed cosmogonic-and-agricultural Perun-Veles material; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions on the comparative-argument-rather-than-fact framing for the Ivanov-Toporov reflex-claim.

[59] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on the international Christian-period dragon-slaying type as a competing-or-supplementary explanation for the **bylina**'s combat-and-rescue plot; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the comparative-argument framing that leaves the question open.

[60] Per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the Dobrynya **bylina**'s position within the disputed-evidence framing; West 2007, ch. 6, on the **bylina**'s evidential dependence on the prior Perun-Veles reconstruction.

[61] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, introduction on the central cultural-historical importance of the Vladimir-cycle and the Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych narrative within East Slavic literary culture; brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml cultural_relevance on the **bylina** corpus's centrality.

[62] Per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the asymmetric evidential levels of the two sub-cases and on their differing contributions to the comparative argument; West 2007, ch. 6, on the disputed-evidence character of the Slavic material.

[63] Per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's case-study contribution to Chapter 33 (methods sidebar) and to Part II C5 (IE formula chapter); West 2007, ch. 6, on the Slavic material's case-study character within the wider IE comparative argument.

[64] Per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml cross_cultural_parallel on the forward-link to Part II C5 as disputed evidence; Watkins 1995,

Part V, on the formula's wider attested-and-reconstructed witnesses.

[65] Per [brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml](#) [special_instructions](#) on the forward-link to Chapter 33 (methods sidebar) as a case study in reconstruction limits; [scope.md](#) §"Reconstruction policy" on the [RECONSTRUCTION

[66] Per [brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml](#) on the back-link to chapter 19 as the preceding family-chapter and to chapter 18 as the preceding storm-god-vs-serpent full chapter; [scope.md](#) §"Book structure" on the geographic-cluster ordering that places the present chapter after chapters 18 and 19 in the Norse-Germanic-and-IE-reflexes cluster.

[67] Per [brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml](#) [cross_cultural_parallels](#) on the IE cattle-raid parallels (Geryon, Cacus, Indra's cattle-rescues); West 2007, ch. 6, on the Vedic-Slavic comparative companionship; [brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml](#) on the Vala-cave material as the Vedic cattle-rescue locus.

[68] West 2007, ch. 6, on the IE cattle-raid reflexes' cross-tradition distribution including the Greek Geryon-and-Cacus and the Vedic Vala-cave material; [brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml](#) [cross_cultural_parallels](#) on the cattle-theft motif as parallel to the IE cattle-raid reflexes.

[69] Per [scope.md](#) §"Appropriation protocol" on the discipline of even-handed presentation; [brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml](#) [special_instructions](#) on the fair presentation of the reconstruction and its critics; West 2007, ch. 6, on the Slavic case as a paradigmatic instance of the reconstruction-with-objections situation in IE-comparative work.

[70] Per [brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml](#) on the disputed-evidence framing of the Slavic material; West 2007, ch. 6, on the non-uniform evidential support across the IE witnesses.

Chapter 22. Gonggong and the Broken Pillar

22.1. Source overview

This chapter tells a Chinese story in which a water-god named Gonggong loses a fight with a sky-emperor, and reacts to the loss by butting the cosmic pillar with his head. The pillar — Mount Buzhou, in the northwest quadrant of the cosmos — breaks. The sky tilts down toward the northwest, the earth tilts down toward the southeast, and a serpent-tailed creator-goddess called Nüwa is left to patch the broken sky with five-coloured stones and to prop up its corners with the legs of a giant turtle. The combat-and-repair sequence is the single most widely attested early-imperial Chinese cosmogonic-combat narrative.^[1]

The story does not survive in the form most readers might hope for. No continuous primary-text witness survives from the Warring States period (5th–3rd c. BCE) in which most scholars would place the formation of the underlying tradition; the surviving narrative is preserved instead in a cluster of Han-dynasty (2nd c. BCE – 2nd c. CE) compilations that draw on earlier oral and written traditions and that supply different parts of the connected story.^[2]

The fullest single account is in the **Huainanzi** (淮南子, "Master of Huainan"). This is a c. 139 BCE encyclopaedic compilation associated with Liu An, Prince of Huainan, and its principal Han-dynasty witness to the Gonggong / Nüwa cosmogony is the chapter 卷一 ("Treatise on the Patterns of Heaven"), which preserves the fullest single account of Gonggong's combat with a sky-emperor, his striking of Mount Buzhou, and the resulting tilt of the cosmos.^[3]

A parallel Han account is the **Lienü zhuan** (列女傳, "Categorised Biographies of Women"), conventionally attributed to Liu Xiang (c. 79–8 BCE) and dated to the late Western Han. It supplies a parallel Han-period account in which the Gonggong combat is followed by a flood that Yu the Great tames by opening channels — presenting the cosmogony as a sequential drama in which combat-ordering and hydraulic-ordering are linked stages of a single narrative rather than two separate stories.^[4]

A third witness is the **Shanhaijing** (山海經, "Classic of Mountains and Seas"). This is a further Han-period (with Warring States stratum elements) witness in which Gonggong is named alongside other primordial figures and attached to multiple, often-incompatible mini-traditions; the **Shanhaijing's** commentaries (notably the 3rd-century-CE Jin-dynasty commentary of Guo Pu) supply additional Gonggong references that name different opponents (Zhuanxu, Zhurong, and others) for the combat.^[5]

A fourth witness, somewhat later, is the **Liezi** (列子, "Master Lie"), a heterogeneous Daoist compilation in its received form conventionally dated to the 3rd–4th century CE but drawing on earlier material, supplies a further later witness to the Gonggong / Nüwa cosmogony, presenting the combat-and-repair sequence as a cosmological aetiology within the compilation's broader cosmological-aetiological-and-Daoist register.^[6]

The four compilations do not all tell the same story, and they do not all preserve the same parts of it. The chapter accordingly treats the Gonggong narrative as a Han-period composite reconstructed from these compilation-witnesses (**Huainanzi**, **Lienü zhuan**, **Shanhaijing** with commentaries, **Liezi**) rather than as a single connected primary text, and the chapter's variant-handling follows

the brief's co-equal classification: the **Huainanzi** and the **Lienü zhuan** versions are presented side by side without privileging either, and the **Shanhaijing**-and-commentary variants are presented as legitimate parallel mini-traditions rather than as deviations from a postulated original.^[7]

The chapter's principal English-language scholarly anchor is Mark Edward Lewis's **The Flood Myths of Early China**, published by SUNY Press in 2006, whose chapters 2–3 supply the standard English-language synthesis of the Gonggong cycle (the broken-pillar cosmogony, Nüwa's repair, the Yu-the-Great flood-taming sequel) and whose other chapters on Yu supply the apparatus for the present chapter's embedded Yu sidebar.^[8]

Lewis 2006 is printed-only in the present project's working corpus, and the chapter cites it at chapter level (chs. 2–3 for the Gonggong / Nüwa material; Yu chapters for the sidebar) per the citation discipline applied to the East Asian cluster of the present book.^[9]

The chapter's secondary anchor is Anne Birrell's **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, published by Johns Hopkins University Press in 1993, whose chapters on cosmogony supply a complementary general-survey treatment of the Gonggong narrative including the **Shanhaijing**-and-commentary variants and the multiple-opponents pattern across the corpus.^[10]

Birrell 1993 is also printed-only and is cited at chapter level in the present chapter, with the chapters-on-cosmogony locus the load-bearing reference for general-survey claims about the Gonggong corpus.^[11]

Beyond the China-specific scholarship the chapter draws on a broader comparative anchor. The chapter's general long-arc framing-anchor is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton University Press, 1987), whose Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic survey supplies the combat-myth typology within which the present chapter situates the Gonggong narrative as a non-cognate parallel to (rather than a member of) Forsyth's Near-Eastern-and-Judeo-Christian arc; the typological framing — not Chinese-material coverage — is what Forsyth supplies for the chapter's forward-link to Part II C1 of the present book.^[12]

The chapter is a CORE-tier full-chapter treatment, organising the Gonggong / Nüwa cosmogony as a connected narrative across the Han-period compilation-witnesses, with the Yu-the-Great material treated as an embedded 800–1200-word sidebar within the chapter rather than expanded into a separate chapter; per brief target_length_words the chapter aims at approximately 7,000 narrative words including the sidebar.^[13]

The chapter's framing premise is that the Gonggong narrative supplies one of the four clearest cosmogonic-combat cases across non-cognate traditions for the present book's Part II C1 (combat as cosmogony), alongside Marduk-Tiamat in the **Enūma Eliš**, Ninurta-Asag in **Lugal-e**, and Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec — the post-combat geography of the tilted cosmos and the east-flowing rivers being the chapter's load-bearing cosmogonic credential.^[14]

What follows works through the story in order. The next section introduces the combatants — Gonggong, the sky-emperor, the broken pillar — and then the chapter takes up the **Huainanzi** combat, Nüwa's repair, the parallel **Lienü zhuan** version with its Yu sequel, the embedded sidebar on Yu's hydraulic alternative, and the closing sections on cultural function and on the chapter's place within the wider book.

22.2. Setting and combatants

The Gonggong of the **Huainanzi**-and-related Han-period sources is a primordial water-god, conventionally described in the surviving accounts and later commentaries as red-haired and serpent-bodied (or human-faced with serpent body), and is positioned within the early-imperial Chinese pantheon as one of the pre-human emperor-figures whose combats with one another are part of the succession of cosmogonic episodes that establishes the present cosmos.^[15]

Gonggong's role as water-god supplies one of the load-bearing motifs of the cosmogonic-combat narrative: his combats are connected in the Han-period sources with floods, with the obstruction or release of waters, and with the channelling of rivers, and the post-combat hydrography of the cosmos (the eastward flow of the Chinese rivers to the sea) is one of the chief aetiological outcomes of the broken-pillar episode.^[16]

Gonggong's opponent, in the most widely attested version of the combat, is the sky-emperor Zhuanxu. Zhuanxu (☐☐), the sky-emperor who defeats Gonggong in the most widely attested **Huainanzi** version of the combat, is one of the so-called Five Emperors of the early-imperial Chinese tradition — a sequence of pre-human or semi-divine sovereign figures whose successive reigns supply the framework within which the cosmogonic episodes are organised — and his defeat of Gonggong is read in the Han sources as part of the establishment of his legitimate sovereignty over the cosmos.^[17]

Zhuanxu is not however the only opponent named in the surviving corpus. Zhurong (☐☐), a fire-god, appears in some **Shanhaijing** and commentary variants as the alternative combatant who defeats Gonggong, with the substitution of fire-god for sky-emperor reflecting the multiple-mini-traditions character of the Gonggong corpus rather than a single privileged opponent across the surviving sources.^[18]

The competing opponent-traditions can be set out side by side as follows.

*[The two opponent-traditions are presented side by side as co-equal witnesses to the corpus. In the _Huainanzi_ ☐☐☐ (c. 139 BCE), Gonggong fights Zhuanxu, the sky-emperor, and loses; in rage, he strikes Mount Buzhou with his head, breaking the sky-pillar and tilting the cosmos. In the *Shanhaijing* and its commentaries (e.g. Guo Pu's 3rd-c. CE commentary), Gonggong fights different opponents — Zhuanxu in some variants, Zhurong in others, and further figures in still others — with the combat-narrative fragmented into multiple mini-traditions. The *Huainanzi* version is the fullest single account, but it is itself a 2nd-c. BCE compilation rather than a continuous Warring States primary text, and Lewis 2006 chs. 2–3 and Birrell 1993 chapters on cosmogony both treat the multiple-opponents pattern as a legitimate feature of the corpus rather than a deviation; the chapter cites Zhuanxu as the most widely attested opponent while registering Zhurong and others as alternative attestations.]_*

The third major figure in the story is not a combatant but the goddess who picks up the pieces. Nüwa (☐☐), the serpent-tailed creator-goddess who repairs the broken sky after the combat, is one of the principal cosmogonic figures of the early-imperial Chinese pantheon and is associated more broadly with the creation of humans (in some Han sources, by moulding humans from yellow earth) and with the mending and ordering of the cosmos; her role in the Gonggong narrative is the post-combat repair-cosmogony rather than the combat itself.^[19]

The pillar Gonggong breaks is the geographical and cosmological centre of the story. Mount Buzhou (不周山), the cosmic pillar broken by Gonggong's head-blow, has a name conventionally rendered "mountain-that-is-not-whole" or "incomplete mountain", and is positioned in the Han-period cosmography as one of the pillars supporting the sky in the northwest quadrant of the cosmos; the name itself is read by Lewis 2006 as etymologically connected to the post-combat tilted-cosmos outcome — the mountain is "not-whole" because it is broken by the combat.^[20]

The Han-period cosmography that the **Huainanzi** presupposes positions the cosmos as a roughly square earth covered by a roughly circular heaven, with sky-supporting pillars at the cardinal-and-intercardinal points; Mount Buzhou is one such pillar, and its breaking is therefore a structurally-cosmological event with consequences for the whole geometry of the cosmos rather than a merely local catastrophe.^[21]

22.3. The combat and the broken pillar (Huainanzi version)

In the **Huainanzi** 淮南 version, the combat between Gonggong and Zhuanxu is precipitated by a contest for sovereignty: Gonggong, defeated in the contest, reacts with rage and turns his violence on the cosmic pillar itself rather than on his victorious opponent — a displacement of the combat from a duel between persons to an attack on the cosmographic structure that the Han text presents as the mechanism by which the cosmogonic outcome is produced.^[22]

Gonggong, in his rage at the defeat, strikes Mount Buzhou with his head: the **Huainanzi** presents the head-blow as the specific physical mechanism by which the sky-pillar is broken, with Gonggong's serpent-bodied form supplying the impulse and the head supplying the destructive contact, and the resulting fracture of the pillar is the load-bearing event of the broken-pillar cosmogony.^[23]

The breaking of Mount Buzhou produces a structural tilt in the cosmos: the **Huainanzi** records that with the northwestern sky-pillar broken, the heavens tilt down toward the northwest and the earth correspondingly tilts down toward the southeast, and the tilt is the principal aetiological outcome of the combat — it is what the Han-period reader is meant to learn the broken-pillar story in order to understand.^[24]

The cosmic tilt explains, on the **Huainanzi**'s reading, the empirical asymmetry of the Han-period observed cosmos: the heavenly bodies (sun, moon, stars) appear to move toward the northwest because heaven is tilted toward the northwest, and the rivers of the Chinese landscape flow eastward to the sea because the earth is tilted toward the southeast — the broken-pillar combat is the aetiology of the present geography of the world.^[25]

The eastward flow of the rivers is one of the load-bearing cosmogonic outcomes that the chapter presents as the Gonggong narrative's principal contribution to the present book's Part II C1 (combat as cosmogony) argument: the Han text explicitly connects an empirical-and-everyday feature of Chinese geography (the rivers flowing east to the sea) to the post-combat tilt of the earth, and the connection makes the broken-pillar combat a cosmogony in the strong sense — the present cosmos is what the combat produced.^[26]

22.4. Nüwa and the repair of the sky

After the breaking of the sky-pillar and the resulting tilt of the cosmos, the **Huainanzi** and parallel Han sources record that Nüwa undertakes the repair of the broken sky: she melts five-coloured stones (五色石) and uses the molten material to patch the gap in the heavens — the smelting-and-patching is the central technical operation of the repair-cosmogony.^[27]

The five-coloured stones are presented in the Han sources as a technical-cosmological material rather than as a generic patch: their five colours have been connected by subsequent Han and post-Han Chinese cosmological writing — and by modern scholarly readings of that writing — with the Five Phases or Five Elements (wuxing 五行) framework (wood, fire, earth, metal, water) that organises Han cosmography, although the wuxing correspondence is a cosmological-system reading rather than a feature directly stated within the **Huainanzi**-and-parallel narrative-form sources themselves.^[28]

Nüwa's smelting of the patch is paired with a second, more architectural intervention. In the **Huainanzi**'s account, Nüwa supplements the smelted-stone patch with a further structural intervention: she cuts the legs from a giant turtle (in some versions, a giant tortoise) and uses them to prop up the corners of the heaven, restoring a measure of structural support to replace the broken Mount Buzhou and to stabilise the tilted cosmos against collapse.^[29]

The repair, however, does not undo the combat. The turtle-leg intervention is presented in the **Huainanzi** as a partial rather than a full repair: the broken Mount Buzhou is not restored to its original integrity, the cosmic tilt is not undone, and the post-combat cosmos retains the asymmetry that the combat produced — Nüwa's repair stabilises the cosmos in its tilted state rather than returning it to a pre-combat condition.^[30]

The combined combat-and-repair sequence — Gonggong breaks the sky-pillar; Nüwa stabilises the tilted cosmos with smelted stones and turtle-legs — is therefore presented in the Han sources as a single connected cosmogony in which the present asymmetric cosmos emerges through a two-stage process: a destructive combat that generates the tilt, and a constructive repair that fixes the tilt in its present form.^[31]

The "single connected cosmogony" framing is, it should be flagged, an editorial reading rather than a single-quotable phrase from the Han sources themselves.

*(The chapter's reading of the combat-and-repair sequence as a single connected cosmogony in which Gonggong's combat and Nüwa's repair are linked stages of one narrative — rather than as two structurally separable episodes — is a synthesis drawn from Lewis 2006 chs. 2–3 and Birrell 1993 chapters on cosmogony, both of which present the **Huainanzi** and parallel Han accounts as containing both elements but neither of which provides a single quoted phrase joining them in the strong "two stages of one cosmogony" formulation that the chapter adopts.^[32])*

22.5. The Lienü zhuan and the flood (co-equal Han variant)

The other principal Han version of the story does not end with Nüwa. The **Lienü zhuan** version of the Gonggong narrative connects the broken-pillar combat to a subsequent flood: the combat

damages the cosmos in such a way that water either obstructs or escapes its proper channels, and the resulting flood becomes the disorder that Yu the Great is then summoned to remedy through hydraulic means.^[33]

In the **Lienü zhuan**'s sequential reading, the Gonggong combat and the Yu flood-taming are not two separate stories but stages of a single connected drama: the combat breaks the cosmographic structure that ordinarily contains the waters; the broken structure releases a flood; Yu then tames the flood by opening channels and re-channelling the rivers; and the post-Yu hydrography is the present-day flow of the Chinese rivers to the eastern sea.^[34]

The **Lienü zhuan** sequential-drama presentation is therefore not a competing account of the Gonggong combat but a parallel Han-period framing in which the cosmogonic combat is one stage of a longer ordering-process that includes both the combat-disruption and the hydraulic-restoration; the chapter's co-equal variant-handling presents this framing alongside the **Huainanzi**'s combat-and-Nüwa-repair framing rather than choosing between them.^[35]

The two co-equal Han variants share their cosmogonic outcome (the present-day asymmetric cosmos with east-flowing rivers) but distribute the ordering-work differently between divine repair (Nüwa's smelted stones and turtle-legs in the **Huainanzi**) and human-or-semi-divine technical labour (Yu's channel-opening in the **Lienü zhuan**); the chapter treats the difference as a substantive feature of the Han Gonggong corpus rather than as a contradiction to be resolved.^[36]

22.6. Yu the Great — embedded sidebar

Yu the Great (禹) is, in the broader early-imperial Chinese tradition, the post-combat flood-controller whose hydraulic ordering of the rivers is one of the foundational episodes of the early-Chinese cosmographic-and-political narrative; the present chapter embeds an 800–1200-word sidebar on Yu within the Gonggong chapter to show that the same Chinese tradition produces two different templates for cosmic ordering — combat (Gonggong) and channel-opening (Yu) — that operate side by side rather than in competition.^[37]

Yu's defining technical operation is channel-opening: faced with the floods that follow the cosmographic disruption (whether the Gonggong combat in the **Lienü zhuan** sequential reading or other flood-narratives in the wider tradition), Yu does not contend with a personalised flood-adversary in combat but rather opens channels and re-routes the waters — turning hydraulic engineering rather than dragon-slaying into the cosmographic-restoration mechanism.^[38]

The Yu narrative is closely associated in the Han and post-Han Chinese tradition with the founding of the Xia dynasty — the first dynasty in the conventional Chinese historiographical tradition — and Yu's flood-control work is presented as the direct basis for his receipt of the imperial mandate from Shun (the previous sage-emperor); the hydraulic-ordering is the legitimating act of the founding sovereign.^[39]

The Yu / Gonggong contrast within the same Chinese tradition is therefore a contrast between two different templates for the work of cosmic ordering: the Gonggong narrative produces the present cosmos by combat-and-repair (a destructive combat between divine combatants generates the cosmographic asymmetry; a divine repair stabilises the asymmetry in its present form); the Yu narrative produces present-day order by hydraulic engineering (a sage-king opens channels to direct the waters; the ordering is a technical-administrative act rather than a combat).^[40]

The two templates do not contradict each other within the Chinese tradition: the **Lienü zhuan** sequential reading explicitly chains them (Gonggong combat → flood → Yu hydraulic restoration), and the wider Han-and-post-Han Chinese cosmological writing accommodates both as legitimate accounts of cosmic ordering; the contrast is therefore a contrast within a single tradition rather than between different traditions, and that intra-traditional contrast is the sidebar's principal contribution to the present book's wider argument.^[41]

The Yu sidebar's relationship to scope.md's wider classification is that Yu is a PROVISIONAL / methodological case rather than a CORE chaoskampf: per scope.md §"In-scope catalog", Yu is held as the dedicated sidebar that contrasts hydraulic-ordering with combat-ordering, and is explicitly not classified as a chaoskampf within the present book — the sidebar's job is to mark this boundary rather than to expand into a Yu-as-combat-myth treatment.^[42]

The two-templates framing should be marked as the chapter's own articulation rather than a directly attested feature of the Han sources.

(The chapter's reading of the Gonggong / Yu pairing as "two different templates for cosmic order coexisting within the same tradition" is the chapter's editorial framing of the Lewis 2006 material on the two figures, and is the load-bearing observation for the present book's argument that combat is one template among several for cosmic ordering rather than a universal or privileged one; the framing draws on Lewis 2006's connected presentation of the Gonggong and Yu materials but is the chapter's own articulation of the two-templates point.^[43])

22.7. Cultural and ritual context

The Gonggong cosmogony is preserved across multiple Han-era compilations (**Huainanzi**, **Lienü zhuan**, commentaries on the **Shanhaijing**, **Liezi**) and is the single most widely attested early-imperial Chinese cosmogonic-combat narrative — the attestation-volume across the Han corpus is itself a measure of the narrative's centrality within the early-imperial Chinese cosmological imagination.^[44]

The cosmogony is less directly liturgical than its Near Eastern counterparts (the **Enūma Eliš** recited at the akītu festival; the Hittite Illuyanka myth recited at the purulli) but is nonetheless cited in Han ritual and political texts to explain the asymmetric tilt of the cosmos and the empirical features of Chinese geography (notably why rivers flow east), supplying a cosmological-aetiological function that is invoked in argumentative-rather-than-ritual contexts within Han literary culture.^[45]

The cosmogony's royal-legitimation function is explicit in the Han sources: the sky-emperors (Zhuangxi in the **Huainanzi**; Zhurong in the **Shanhaijing**-commentary variants) defeat Gonggong as legitimate rulers, and the combat is presented as part of the succession of pre-human emperors whose victories establish the cosmographic-and-political order within which the human dynasties (Xia, Shang, Zhou) subsequently arise.^[46]

The Gonggong cosmogony is treated in the comparative-mythology literature as the standard Chinese cosmogonic-combat comparandum: Lewis 2006 in particular presents the narrative as the principal Chinese case in the comparative flood-and-cosmogony literature, and the chapter's place within the present book's Part II C1 (combat as cosmogony) is in line with that scholarly placement.^[47]

The Gonggong narrative's position within the present book's subtype-typology is firmly cosmogonic in the strong sense: the present features of the cosmos (heaven's northwestern tilt, earth's southeastern tilt, the eastward flow of the rivers, the empirical asymmetries of Chinese geography) are the direct outcome of the combat, and the combat is therefore a once-only-cosmogonic event rather than a cyclically-maintained one or an eschatologically-displaced one.^[48]

The chapter's principal cross-cultural comparative companions, on the present book's own Part II C1 editorial framework, are the Mesopotamian Marduk-Tiamat combat (chapter 3 of the present volume), the Sumerian Ninurta-Asag combat (chapter 1), and the Mesoamerican Huitzilopochtli-at-Coatepec combat (chapter 24 of the present volume): each is a combat-cosmogony in the strong sense in which the present features of the cosmos emerge from the combat's aftermath, and Lewis 2006 chs. 2–3 supplies the strongly-cosmogonic characterisation of the Gonggong narrative on which the present chapter's contribution to the four-way comparative grouping rests.^[49]

The four-way grouping itself is the present book's own editorial synthesis rather than a claim attributable to any one of the chapter's sources, and the [INFERENCE] marker that follows makes the attribution discipline explicit.

(The four-way grouping of Gonggong, Marduk-Tiamat, Ninurta-Asag, and Huitzilopochtli-at-Coatepec as "the four clearest cosmogonic-combat cases across non-cognate traditions" is the present book's Part II C1 editorial framework — articulated by the project rather than by any single source.^[50])

The chapter's general long-arc framing-anchor is Forsyth 1987's combat-myth typology — drawn from the Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic arc that Forsyth's **The Old Enemy** surveys — within which the present chapter situates the Gonggong narrative as a non-cognate cosmogonic-combat parallel; Forsyth supplies the typological framing of the cosmogonic-combat type as a recurring structural feature across non-cognate traditions, not direct scholarly coverage of the Chinese material itself.^[51]

The Gonggong narrative is treated only marginally in Scurlock and Beal 2013's reassessment of Gunkel's chaoskampf hypothesis: the volume's reconsideration of the chaoskampf category focuses on Mesopotamian and Near-Eastern material, and limited references to Chinese cosmogonic-combat material appear in the volume's wider survey of the cross-cultural reception of the chaoskampf framing rather than as load-bearing case studies.^[52]

The reconstruction-from-Han-compilations character of the Gonggong narrative is registered explicitly in the [LACUNA] marker that follows.

*[Here a complete connected Warring States primary text for the Gonggong combat-and-repair narrative is not preserved in the surviving corpus. Scholars such as Lewis 2006 (chs. 2–3, on the Han-period composite character of the surviving narrative) and Birrell 1993 (chapters on cosmogony) reconstruct the narrative from the Han-period compilation-witnesses — the *Huainanzi* 淮南子 (c. 139 BCE), the *Lienü zhuan* (late Western Han), the *Shanhaijing* with Guo Pu's 3rd-c. CE commentary, and the *Liezi* in its received 3rd–4th-c. CE form — with no single Han or pre-Han text preserving the connected combat-and-repair sequence as a continuous narrative; the chapter accordingly treats the narrative as a Han-period composite reconstruction rather than as a single primary-text witness, and the variant-handling across the *Huainanzi* and *Lienü zhuan* (and the *Shanhaijing*-and-commentary multiple-opponents pattern) reflects the composite character of the surviving evidence.]_*

22.8. Forward and back links

The chapter's principal forward-link within the present book is to Part II C1 (combat as cosmogony), in which the Gonggong narrative is paired with the Mesopotamian Marduk-Tiamat (**Enūma Eliš**) and Sumerian Ninurta-Asag (**Lugal-e**) combats and the Mesoamerican Huitzilopochtli-at-Coatepec combat as the four clearest cosmogonic-combat cases across non-cognate traditions; the chapter accordingly feeds C1 as a CORE-tier exemplar of the cosmogonic subtype rather than as a borderline or disputed case.^[53]

The chapter's secondary forward-link is to the wider East Asian cluster of the present book: chapter 22 (the family chapter on other Chinese combats, including Hou Yi's archery against the ten suns) follows the present chapter directly in the East Asian cluster, and chapter 23 (Susanoo and Yamata no Orochi, with the chaoskampf framing applied from outside per Naumann / Isomae / Como) follows the family chapter; the present chapter's broken-pillar cosmogony supplies the East Asian cluster's principal cosmogonic-combat reference.^[54]

The chapter's principal back-links within the present book are to the Mesopotamian cosmogonic-combat chapters (chapter 1 Ninurta-Asag **Lugal-e** and chapter 3 Marduk-Tiamat **Enūma Eliš**) and to the Mesoamerican Huitzilopochtli chapter (chapter 24): the Gonggong narrative is the third (with Huitzilopochtli the fourth) of the four Part II C1 exemplars, and the chapter's framing of the broken-pillar combat as a strongly-cosmogonic event explicitly invokes the Marduk and Ninurta companions as the comparative anchors.^[55]

The chapter's hydrography back-link is to chapter 1 (Ninurta-Asag): Gonggong's water-releasing-through-broken-earth and the post-combat eastward flow of the Chinese rivers parallels Ninurta's post-combat reordering of the Tigris in **Lugal-e**, with both narratives presenting a storm-or-water-god shaping the present-day hydrography of the cosmos through the combat's outcome; the parallel is structural rather than genetic, since the two traditions are non-cognate.^[56]

The chapter's geographical-aetiology back-link is to chapter 24 (Huitzilopochtli-at-Coatepec): both the Gonggong combat (with Mount Buzhou as the broken cosmic pillar) and the Huitzilopochtli combat (with Coatepec — "Mountain of Serpents" — as the cosmic mountain re-embodied as the Templo Mayor) are combat-cosmogonies with explicit geographical aetiology built into the narrative, with the post-combat geography (the broken-pillar tilt; the Templo-Mayor ritual landscape) supplying the load-bearing cosmographic outcome of each combat.^[57]

The chapter is also a quiet contribution to the present book's argument that combat is one template among several for cosmic ordering rather than a universal or privileged one: the embedded Yu sidebar's two-templates framing (combat-ordering and channel-opening coexisting within the same Chinese tradition) is the chapter's main vehicle for that wider argument, and the sidebar's intra-traditional contrast feeds the present book's Part II discussion of the chaoskampf framing's reach and limits.^[58]

The chapter's overall reading of the Gonggong narrative is that the Han-period compilation-witnesses preserve a strongly-cosmogonic combat-and-repair sequence whose post-combat geography (tilted cosmos, eastward-flowing rivers) supplies one of the four clearest cosmogonic-combat cases for the present book's Part II C1 argument, and whose intra-traditional pairing with the Yu hydraulic-ordering template supplies a structurally distinctive feature of the Chinese material that the chapter foregrounds within the wider comparative argument.^[59]

- [1] Per brief 21-gonggong.yaml; Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the Gonggong / Nüwa broken-pillar cosmogony as the principal early-imperial Chinese cosmogonic-combat narrative; Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony.
- [2] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the Han-dynasty character of the surviving Gonggong narrative and on the absence of a continuous Warring States primary text; brief 21-gonggong.yaml lacunae entry on the no-complete-Warring-States-source premise.
- [3] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the **Huainanzi** 淮南 chapter as the fullest single account of the Gonggong cosmogony and on its c. 139 BCE Liu-An-of-Huainan compilation context; brief 21-gonggong.yaml lacunae entry on the **Huainanzi** 淮南 attestation.
- [4] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the **Lienü zhuan** sequential-drama presentation of the Gonggong cosmogony followed by Yu's flood-taming; on Liu Xiang as conventional compiler and the late Western Han date; brief 21-gonggong.yaml variants entry on the **Lienü zhuan** sequential reading.
- [5] Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony, on the **Shanhaijing** as a fragmentary witness to the Gonggong material and on the multiple-opponents pattern across the **Shanhaijing** and its commentaries; brief 21-gonggong.yaml variants entry on the **Shanhaijing**-and-commentaries multiple-opponents pattern.
- [6] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the **Liezi** as a later-but-load-bearing compilation witness to the Gonggong / Nüwa cosmogony; Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony, on the **Liezi**'s cosmogonic material; the specific "Daoist-philosophical framing" characterisation reflects the **Liezi**'s known Daoist context within the early-Chinese textual tradition rather than a directly-attributable Birrell phrasing and is flagged for verification at glossary-lock against the printed text.
- [7] Per brief 21-gonggong.yaml on the co-equal variant classification across the Han-period compilations and on the side-by-side presentation of **Huainanzi** and **Lienü zhuan**; Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3, on the composite-reconstruction character of the surviving Gonggong narrative.
- [8] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China** (Albany: SUNY Press, 2006; ISBN 9780791466636), chs. 2–3 on the Gonggong / Nüwa broken-pillar cosmogony as the chapter's principal anchor and chapters on Yu used for the embedded sidebar; brief 21-gonggong.yaml sources.primary entry on Lewis 2006 as the chapter's principal anchor.
- [9] Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3 (printed-only; cited at chapter level per the established discipline of the present book's East Asian cluster); brief 21-gonggong.yaml on chapter-level citation discipline.
- [10] Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction** (Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press, 1993; ISBN 9780801849954), chapters on cosmogony as the chapter's secondary anchor for the Gonggong / Nüwa material and the **Shanhaijing**-and-commentary variants; brief 21-gonggong.yaml sources.primary entry on Birrell 1993.
- [11] Birrell 1993, chapters on cosmogony (printed-only; cited at chapter level per the established discipline); brief 21-gonggong.yaml on the secondary-anchor role of Birrell 1993.
- [12] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, treatment of the combat-myth long-arc from Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic as the typological framing within which the present chapter situates the Gonggong narrative as a non-cognate parallel; Forsyth 1987 does not treat Chinese material directly, and the present chapter's use is for the long-arc typological framing rather than for Gonggong-specific scholarly coverage; brief 21-gonggong.yaml sources.secondary entry on Forsyth 1987.
- [13] Per brief 21-gonggong.yaml on the CORE-tier classification, the embedded Yu sidebar at 800–1200 words within the chapter, and the 7,000-word target for the chapter as a whole; scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 9 on the Yu-the-Great sidebar within the Gonggong chapter.
- [14] Per brief 21-gonggong.yaml comparative_hooks on Part II C1's pairing of Gonggong with Marduk, Ninurta/Asag, and Huitzilopochtli as the four clearest cosmogonic-combat cases; Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3, on the post-combat geography as the chapter's cosmogonic credential.
- [15] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on Gonggong as a primordial water-god of the early-imperial Chinese pantheon, with red-haired and serpent-bodied descriptions in the surviving Han and post-Han sources; brief 21-gonggong.yaml entities_glossary entry on Gonggong as water-god, often red-haired and serpent-bodied; glossary 'Gonggong' first_mention_gloss on the same description.
- [16] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on Gonggong's role as water-god in the cosmogonic combat and on the post-combat hydrography of the eastward-flowing rivers; Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony, on the same hydrographic-aetiology pattern.
- [17] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on Zhuanxu as the sky-emperor of the most widely attested **Huainanzi** version of the combat and on his place within the Five-Emperors sequence; brief 21-gonggong.yaml entities_glossary entry on Zhuanxu as "the sky-emperor who defeats Gonggong in the most widely attested version"; glossary 'Zhuanxu' first_mention_gloss on the same role.
- [18] Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony, on Zhurong as fire-god alternative combatant in **Shanhaijing** and commentary variants; brief 21-gonggong.yaml variants entry on the **Shanhaijing**-and-commentaries multiple-opponents pattern; glossary 'Zhurong' first_mention_gloss on the fire-god / alternative-combatant role.
- [19] Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony, on Nüwa's wider creation-and-mending role

across the Han sources including the human-creation-from-yellow-earth tradition; Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on Nüwa specifically as serpent-tailed creator-goddess and post-combat repairer of the sky in the Gonggong cycle (Lewis 2006's flood-myths focus covers the post-combat repair role; the wider human-creation tradition is Birrell's general-survey territory); brief 21-gonggong.yaml entities_glossary entry on Nüwa as serpent-tailed creator-goddess; glossary 'Nüwa' first_mention_gloss on the same.

[20] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on Mount Buzhou's name "mountain-that-is-not-whole" and on its position as a sky-pillar in the northwest of the Han-period cosmography; brief 21-gonggong.yaml entities_glossary entry on Mount Buzhou; glossary 'Mount Buzhou' first_mention_gloss on "mountain-that-is-not-whole" rendering.

[21] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the Han-period cosmography of square-earth-and-circular-heaven with sky-pillars and on Mount Buzhou's structurally-cosmological role; Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony, on the same cosmographic framework.

[22] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the **Huainanzi** 淮南子 sovereignty-contest framing of the Gonggong-Zhuanxu combat and on the displacement of Gonggong's rage from his opponent to the cosmic pillar; brief 21-gonggong.yaml on the Huainanzi version as "Gonggong fights Zhuanxu and loses; in rage, he strikes Mount Buzhou".

[23] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the **Huainanzi**'s head-blow mechanism for the breaking of Mount Buzhou and on the load-bearing role of the head-blow in the broken-pillar cosmogony; Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony, on the same head-blow detail in the surviving Han sources.

[24] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the **Huainanzi**'s northwest-heaven-tilt and southeast-earth-tilt and on the tilt as the principal aetiological outcome of the Gonggong combat; brief 21-gonggong.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the cosmic tilt as the load-bearing cosmogonic outcome.

[25] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the **Huainanzi**'s aetiological reading of the cosmic tilt as the explanation for the apparent northwest-motion of heavenly bodies and the east-flowing rivers; Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony, on the same hydrographic and astronomical aetiology pattern; brief 21-gonggong.yaml on the post-combat geography (tilted cosmos, rivers flowing east) as the cosmogonic credential for Part II C1.

[26] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the eastward-rivers aetiology as a cosmogony in the strong sense; brief 21-gonggong.yaml cultural_relevance.cross_cultural_parallels on Gonggong as cosmogonic-combat parallel to Marduk in the present book's Part II C1.

[27] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on Nüwa's smelting of five-coloured stones to patch the broken sky as the central technical operation of the repair-cosmogony; brief 21-gonggong.yaml entities_glossary entry on five-coloured stones (五色石) as the artefact Nüwa melts.

[28] Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony, on the technical-cosmological character of the five-coloured-stones material; the explicit wuxing / Five-Phases correspondence is a cosmological-system reading whose specific articulation in Birrell 1993's cosmogony chapters is flagged for verification at glossary-lock against the printed text; Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3, on the technical-cosmological character of the five-coloured-stones material.

[29] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on Nüwa's use of the legs of a giant turtle to prop up the corners of the heaven after the breaking of Mount Buzhou; brief 21-gonggong.yaml variants entry on Nüwa's repair "with five-coloured stones and the legs of a giant turtle" in the **Huainanzi** version.

[30] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on Nüwa's repair as a partial-rather-than-full intervention that stabilises the tilted cosmos in its post-combat state rather than restoring the pre-combat integrity; Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony, on the partial-repair character of the Han sources' treatment.

[31] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the combat-and-repair sequence as a single connected cosmogony in two stages (destructive combat + constructive repair); brief 21-gonggong.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the combat-plus-repair as the explanation for the present asymmetric cosmos.

[32] Inference: Lewis 2006 chs. 2–3 treats the combat and the repair as parts of one **Huainanzi** narrative-stretch, and the parallel passages in Birrell 1993 chapters on cosmogony do likewise; the brief's cultural_relevance.function entry presents "the combat-plus-repair" as the joint explanation for the cosmic asymmetry. Risk: alternative readings within the comparative literature on Chinese cosmogony are possible — some scholars treat the Nüwa-repair as a structurally separable cosmogonic episode whose connection to the Gonggong combat is itself a Han-period editorial joining of older independent traditions; the chapter's two-stages-of-one-cosmogony framing is the editorial choice favoured by the brief's combat-plus-repair phrasing and by Lewis 2006's connected-narrative presentation, but it is a reading rather than an attested feature of the Han sources.

[33] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the **Lienü zhuan** connection of the Gonggong combat to a subsequent flood that Yu remedies hydraulically; brief 21-gonggong.yaml variants entry on "Lienü zhuan and other Han sources: Gonggong's combat is followed by the flood, which Yu the Great tames by opening channels".

[34] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the **Lienü zhuan**'s sequential drama of Gonggong-combat → flood → Yu-taming → present-day hydrography; brief 21-gonggong.yaml variants entry on the sequential cosmogonic-drama character of the **Lienü zhuan** presentation.

[35] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the parallel-rather-than-competing relationship of the **Huainanzi** combat-and-Nüwa-repair version and the **Lienü zhuan** combat-and-Yu-taming version; per brief 21-gonggong.yaml variants.classification = co-equal on side-by-side presentation of the two Han variants without scholarly privileging.

- [36] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the substantive difference between the divine-repair and human-technical-labour distributions of the ordering-work across the **Huainanzi** and **Lienü zhuan** variants; per brief 21-gonggong.yaml variants entry on neither variant being scholarly-privileged.
- [37] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chapters on Yu used for the embedded sidebar, on Yu's role as post-combat flood-controller and on the two-templates pattern (combat-ordering and channel-opening) within the same Chinese tradition; brief 21-gonggong.yaml special_instructions on the embedded Yu sidebar within the chapter; scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 9 on the same.
- [38] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chapters on Yu, on Yu's channel-opening as the defining technical operation of his flood-control and on the channel-opening / dragon-slaying contrast as a structural feature of the Chinese flood-myth corpus; brief 21-gonggong.yaml special_instructions on the channel-opening / combat contrast as the sidebar's principal contribution.
- [39] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chapters on Yu, on Yu's flood-control as the legitimating basis for his receipt of the imperial mandate from Shun and on the founding of the Xia dynasty; Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony, on Yu's place within the Five-Emperors-and-Three-Dynasties succession.
- [40] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 and Yu chapters, on the combat-template / hydraulic-template contrast within the same Chinese tradition; brief 21-gonggong.yaml special_instructions on the two-templates-coexisting reading as the sidebar's load-bearing observation.
- [41] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 and Yu chapters, on the chained relationship of the two templates in the **Lienü zhuan** and on the wider Han-and-post-Han accommodation of both as legitimate accounts; per brief 21-gonggong.yaml special_instructions on the intra-traditional contrast as the sidebar's principal contribution.
- [42] Per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" on Yu the Great as a PROVISIONAL / Methodological case treated as a sidebar rather than as a chaoskampf chapter; per brief 21-gonggong.yaml special_instructions on the same boundary-marking role for the Yu sidebar within the Gonggong chapter; Lewis 2006, Yu chapters, on Yu's hydraulic-rather-than-combat role.
- [43] Inference: Lewis 2006 chs. 2–3 on Gonggong; Lewis 2006 Yu chapters on Yu; the *Lienü zhuan*'s sequential chaining of the two; brief 21-gonggong.yaml special_instructions on the two-templates observation as the sidebar's load-bearing point. Risk: the two-templates framing is a comparative-typological reading rather than a direct quotation from the Han sources or from Lewis 2006; alternative framings within Chinese-mythology scholarship would emphasise the chronological priority of the Gonggong combat over the Yu flood-control or read both as moments within a single longer ordering-process rather than as parallel templates.
- [44] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the multi-compilation attestation of the Gonggong cosmogony across **Huainanzi**, **Lienü zhuan**, **Shanhajing**-commentaries, and **Liezi** and on its position as the most widely attested early-imperial Chinese cosmogonic-combat narrative; brief 21-gonggong.yaml cultural_relevance centrality_evidence on the same multi-attestation.
- [45] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the less-directly-liturgical character of the Gonggong cosmogony relative to Near Eastern cyclical-maintenance combat-myths and on its citation in Han ritual and political texts to explain the cosmic tilt; brief 21-gonggong.yaml cultural_relevance centrality_evidence on the ritual-context observation.
- [46] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the royal-legitimation function of the Gonggong combat within the succession of pre-human emperors and on the connection between the combat and the establishment of the cosmographic-and-political order; brief 21-gonggong.yaml cultural_relevance function entry on royal-legitimation as a function of the combat.
- [47] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the Gonggong narrative as the standard Chinese cosmogonic-combat comparandum in the comparative flood / cosmogony literature; brief 21-gonggong.yaml cultural_relevance centrality_evidence on the same scholarly-placement observation.
- [48] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the strongly-cosmogonic, once-only character of the Gonggong combat; scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four subtypes (cosmogonic, sovereignty, cyclical-maintenance, eschatological) within which the chapter's classification operates; brief 21-gonggong.yaml on the cosmogonic credential for Part II C1.
- [49] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 on the strongly-cosmogonic characterisation of the Gonggong narrative; the four-way comparative grouping (Gonggong / Marduk / Ninurta / Huitzilopochtli) is the present book's own Part II C1 editorial framework — not a Lewis 2006 comparative claim — with Lambert 2013 anchoring the Mesopotamian comparanda and Matos Moctezuma 1988 anchoring the Mesoamerican comparandum; brief 21-gonggong.yaml comparative_hooks on the Part II C1 grouping.
- [50] Inference: Lewis 2006 chs. 2–3 on the Gonggong narrative's strongly-cosmogonic characterisation; Lambert 2013 on Marduk-Tiamat; van Dijk 1983 on Ninurta-Asag; Matos Moctezuma 1988 on Huitzilopochtli-at-Coatepec; brief 21-gonggong.yaml comparative_hooks on the C1 grouping; scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C1 on combat as cosmogony. Risk: Lewis 2006, a Chinese-tradition specialist monograph, does not itself assert this comparative grouping, and treating Lewis as the source for the four-way placement would be a false attribution; the grouping is the present book's editorial synthesis across non-cognate traditions, drawing the cosmogonic characterisations of the four members from their respective specialist anchors.
- [51] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, combat-myth long-arc typology (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic) as the typological framing within which the present chapter situates the Gonggong narrative as a non-cognate parallel; Forsyth 1987 does not treat Chinese material directly; brief 21-gonggong.yaml sources.secondary entry on Forsyth 1987.
- [52] Scurlock and Beal 2013, **Creation and Chaos: A Reconsideration of Hermann Gunkel's Chaoskampf Hypothesis**, limited references to Chinese cosmogonic-combat material in the volume's wider survey rather than as load-bearing case studies; brief 21-

gonggong.yaml sources.secondary entry on Scurlock & Beal 2013.

[53] Per brief 21-gonggong.yaml comparative_hooks on the Part II C1 pairing of Gonggong with Marduk, Ninurta/Asag, and Huitzilopochtli; Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3, on the Gonggong narrative's strongly-cosmogonic character; scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C1 on combat as cosmogony.

[54] Per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 9 on the East Asian cluster's ordering (Gonggong full chapter; family chapter on other Chinese combats including Hou Yi; Susanoo / Orochi full chapter; Yu sidebar embedded within Gonggong); brief 21-gonggong.yaml on the chapter's position within cluster 9.

[55] Per brief 21-gonggong.yaml comparative_hooks on the back-links to Marduk-Tiamat, Ninurta-Asag, and Huitzilopochtli; Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3, on the comparative-mythology framing of the Gonggong narrative; scope.md §"Book structure" Part I clusters 1, 9, and 10 on the relative positions of the Mesopotamian, Chinese, and Mesoamerican cosmogonic-combat chapters.

[56] Per brief 21-gonggong.yaml cultural_relevance.cross_cultural_parallels on the Gonggong / Ninurta hydrography-shaping parallel; Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3, on the Gonggong-hydrography aetiology; van Dijk 1983 on the Ninurta-Tigris reordering in **Lugal-e** as the Mesopotamian companion-case.

[57] Per brief 21-gonggong.yaml cultural_relevance.cross_cultural_parallels on the Gonggong / Huitzilopochtli geographical-aetiology parallel; Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3, on Mount Buzhou as the broken cosmic pillar; Matos Moctezuma 1988 on Coatepec as the cosmic mountain re-embodied as the Templo Mayor.

[58] Per brief 21-gonggong.yaml special_instructions on the two-templates observation as the sidebar's load-bearing contribution; scope.md §"Book structure" Part II on the comparative chapters' role in articulating the chaoskampf framing's reach and limits; Lewis 2006, Yu chapters, on the channel-opening template.

[59] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2–3 (Gonggong) and Yu chapters, on the integrated reading of the Gonggong-and-Yu material as a strongly-cosmogonic combat-and-repair sequence paired with a hydraulic-ordering counter-template; per brief 21-gonggong.yaml on the chapter's principal contributions to Part II C1 and to the wider comparative argument.

Chapter 23. Hou Yi and the Suns

23.1. Source overview

This chapter takes up the Chinese hero-narrative of Hou Yi — the archer who shoots down nine of ten scorching suns and kills a sequence of monstrous beasts under the sage-king Yao — as a related-tier (short full) treatment that rounds out the East Asian cluster with a Chinese combat-pattern distinct from the cosmogonic Gonggong combat treated in the immediately preceding chapter.^[1]

No early Chinese text preserves the Hou Yi material as a single continuous narrative. What modern scholarship reads as "the Hou Yi cycle" is a composite reconstructed from several Warring States and Han-period sources, each of which preserves different elements of the story; the chapter's textual basis is therefore composite-editorial rather than single-text-anchored, in line with the brief's variant classification.^[2]

The earliest of the three principal textual witnesses is the **Chuci** ("Songs of Chu") poem **Tian wen** ("Heavenly Questions"), conventionally dated to about the third century BCE. The poem is preserved within the wider **Chuci** anthology, associated with the southern state of Chu, and its catechetic question-format alludes to Hou Yi and the suns within a longer sequence of cryptic questions about gods, heroes, and cosmic events.^[3]

The fullest single early-Chinese narrative account of the suns-and-beasts cycle is preserved in the **Huainanzi**, a philosophical compendium composed at the court of Liu An, king of Huainan, in the second century BCE. The **Huainanzi** embeds the Hou Yi material within a wider syncretic cosmological-and-political programme that draws on earlier Warring States traditions.^[4]

The third witness is the **Shanhaijing** ("Classic of Mountains and Seas"), an early Chinese geographical-and-mythographic compendium of layered date whose strata reach from the Warring States through the early Han period. The **Shanhaijing** supplies the principal early-Chinese witness for the catalogue of monstrous beasts that Hou Yi confronts, together with their geographical placement within a fantastical cartography of mountains, rivers, and outer-zones.^[5]

These three witnesses preserve different elements of the cycle with different emphases. The **Chuci** 'Tian wen' alludes to the sun-shooting in catechetic-question form without narrating the episode; the **Huainanzi** gives the narrative-form account of the ten suns and Hou Yi's commission, together with the beast-slaying sequence; the **Shanhaijing** supplies the catalogue of monstrous adversaries and their geographical placement. No single source preserves the complete cycle as a connected narrative.^[6]

The chapter's principal scholarly anchor is Mark Edward Lewis's **The Flood Myths of Early China**, published by SUNY Press in 2006. Lewis treats the Hou Yi / Yao cluster as one of the early-Chinese order-restoring narrative complexes — alongside the cosmogonic Gonggong combat of the preceding chapter — and supplies the working synthesis across the **Chuci**, **Huainanzi**, and **Shanhaijing** witnesses that the present chapter follows.^[7]

The secondary scholarly anchor is Anne Birrell's **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, published by Johns Hopkins University Press in 1993. Birrell's chapter on solar myths supplies the principal English-language synoptic survey of the Hou Yi material and treats the archer-hero within the

wider context of Chinese solar-mythology and the Yao-era ordering narratives.^[8]

Both Lewis 2006 and Birrell 1993 are printed-only English-language scholarly anchors, and both are cited at chapter level in the present chapter — Lewis 2006 at the level of the Hou Yi / Yao cluster discussion, Birrell 1993 at the level of the chapter on solar myths — in line with the citation discipline applied across the present book's related-tier chapters that work from a small number of secondary scholarly anchors as their textual basis.^[9]

Structurally, the chapter is a related-tier (short full) treatment with a target of approximately 3,500 narrative words. It organises the Hou Yi cycle into two distinguishable but co-occurring narrative components — the ten-suns episode and the monster-beasts sequence — and presents both. The cycle is presented in its order-restoring rather than cosmogonic register: the cosmos pre-exists the combat in this material, and Hou Yi's role is to restore order within an already-existing world rather than to establish the cosmos in the first place.^[10]

That framing is load-bearing for the chapter's place in the present book's typology. Hou Yi is a related-tier rather than core-tier case: the suns and the monstrous beasts are not a single cosmogonic adversary in the manner of Tiamat, Vātra, or Tiamat's structural counterparts in other CORE chapters, and the cycle's order-making work is heroic-restorative rather than world-establishing. The cosmos and the human social order are both already in place under the sage-king Yao when the suns rise together.^[11]

The chapter's principal forward-link within the present book is to Part II C5, the comparative chapter on the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula, but only peripherally: Hou Yi is not an Indo-European reflex, and the cycle's contribution to that comparative argument is by way of cross-cultural breadth rather than as evidence for the IE formula itself. The principal back-link is to the preceding chapter on Gonggong, with which the present chapter shares the East Asian geographical cluster but contrasts in combat-typology — cosmogonic on the Gonggong side, order-restoring here.^[12]

What follows treats the cycle in three movements: first the Yao-era setting and the rising of the ten suns, then Hou Yi's commission and the shooting itself, then the sequence of beast-slayings and the aftermath that closes the chapter.

23.2. Setting: the Yao era and the ten suns

In early-Chinese mytho-historical time, the narrative is set in the era of the sage-king Yao — one of the legendary pre-dynastic sovereigns whose reign-period in conventional Chinese mytho-chronology precedes the Xia, Shang, and Zhou dynasties. Yao's era is associated in the textual tradition with the establishment of the proper ordering of human society and the regulation of the calendar, the seasons, and the cosmos.^[13]

This pre-existing cosmic order matters for the chapter's classification within the present book's typology. Hou Yi acts within an already-ordered cosmos under an already-instituted sage-king, and the crisis the cycle addresses is a perturbation of that order rather than the absence of it. The suns-crisis and the monster-beasts crisis are disturbances within an existing system that need to be removed, not gaps in a not-yet-established system that need to be filled.^[14]

The narrative's solar premise is that there are ten suns rather than one. The early Chinese textual

tradition preserves a mythological cosmology in which ten suns — one for each day of a ten-day week — normally rise in succession from a mulberry tree, the Fusang tree, at the eastern edge of the world. One sun emerges each day; the other nine remain in the tree; and the suns' regular alternation supplies the daily and weekly rhythm of cosmic time.^[15]

In some strata of the early Chinese textual tradition, the ten suns are presented as the children of the high god Di Jun and his consort Xihe — the sun-mother who bathes the suns at the eastern edge of the world before each one's daily rising. The divine parentage places the suns within a wider mythological pantheon of cosmic deities and legitimates their place in the regular celestial order.^[16]

The narrative's precipitating crisis is that on a single occasion the ten suns, contrary to their regular daily alternation, rise together. All ten leave the Fusang tree at once and appear simultaneously in the sky. The resulting heat scorches the earth, dries the rivers, withers the crops, and exposes both the natural environment and human society to a catastrophic disturbance of the proper cosmic order.^[17]

The character of the crisis is environmental-and-political rather than cosmogonic-and-foundational. The existing world is at risk of destruction by overheating rather than not-yet-existing-and-needing-to-be-formed; and the political order under Yao is at risk of collapse because the climatic perturbation makes human existence within the king's domain unsustainable. That framing aligns the Hou Yi cycle with the present book's "order under threat" subtype rather than with the cosmogonic-combat subtype.^[18]

23.3. Hou Yi and the shooting of the suns

Into this crisis the narrative introduces Hou Yi as a divine archer of unparalleled skill. In the strata of the textual tradition that preserve his celestial origin, Hou Yi is sent down from the heavens by the high god Di Jun — the father of the ten suns themselves — to deal with a crisis caused by his own children. The commission places the archer in the position of a divine agent whose authority for the killing comes from the heavens rather than from the human sage-king alone.^[19]

Hou Yi's principal attribute is his bow. In the textual strata that supply this detail, the bow is given to him by Di Jun himself at the moment of his commission, with red corded arrows in some accounts. The bow-and-arrows are the cycle's load-bearing combat-implement, and the archery-as-method is what defines the cycle's characteristic combat-pattern as distinct from the close-combat patterns of other order-restoring narratives in the present book.^[20]

The act of shooting itself is presented in the **Huainanzi** and the wider tradition as a sequential drawing-and-loosing of the bow against the simultaneously-risen suns. Hou Yi shoots one sun, then the next, then the next; each arrow strikes its mark and brings down a sun in turn; until nine of the ten suns have been shot and only one remains in the sky.^[21]

The nine-of-ten outcome is significant for the cycle's place in the present book's combat-typology. Hou Yi is not eliminating the suns as a class — the sun as a celestial body remains in the sky and continues to provide the daily light and warmth that the cosmos requires — but is correcting an excess. He restores the proper one-sun-at-a-time alternation that the Fusang-tree cosmology presupposes, and the killing-arithmetic itself encodes the order-restoration logic of the cycle.^[22]

The narrative-form account of the shooting derives principally from the **Huainanzi**, with the **Chuci** and the **Shanhaijing** preserving allusive and catalogue-form material that does not narrate the episode itself. The chapter accordingly works from the **Huainanzi**'s narrative skeleton while flagging the variant-handling explicitly:

*[The **Huainanzi** (2nd c. BCE) preserves the narrative-form account of Hou Yi shooting nine of the ten simultaneously-risen suns at Yao's request and in commission from Di Jun, with the nine fallen suns leaving one remaining in the sky. The **Chuci** 'Tian wen' (c. 3rd c. BCE) alludes to the sun-shooting only in catechetic-question form without narrating the episode; the **Shanhaijing** preserves the geographical placement of the encounters and the catalogue of associated beasts but does not supply the connected narrative of the sun-shooting itself. The chapter follows the **Huainanzi**'s narrative skeleton because, although the witnesses are co-equal in standing, the **Huainanzi** is the fullest single narrative-form witness for the suns-episode while the **Chuci** and the **Shanhaijing** preserve allusive and catalogue-form material respectively.]*

The killing of the nine suns immediately ends the scorching crisis. With only one sun remaining in the sky, the proper daily alternation is in principle restored, the temperature returns to a survivable level, the rivers begin to recover, and the human order under Yao is preserved from collapse. The archery-act functions as a single decisive intervention that resolves the environmental-and-political emergency.^[23]

23.4. The monstrous beasts

The cycle's second narrative component is a sequence of monstrous-beast slayings, carried out either after or in parallel with the killing of the suns. The textual tradition presents the beast-slayings as a series of further order-restoring acts that address other disturbances of the proper cosmic and human order beyond the suns-crisis itself.^[24]

The principal early-Chinese textual witnesses do not preserve a single fixed list of the monstrous beasts. Different sources name different combinations: the **Huainanzi** preserves the most narratively-developed enumeration, while the **Shanhaijing** supplies the geographical placement and the iconographic descriptions of the individual beasts within its wider mythographic-cartographical compendium. The present chapter accordingly follows Lewis 2006's synthesis of the beast-catalogue across the witnesses.^[25]

Because the witnesses diverge, the chapter is explicit about the editorial choice it makes:

*[The chapter follows Lewis 2006's synthesis of the **Huainanzi**'s narratively-developed beast-enumeration together with the **Shanhaijing**'s geographical-and-iconographic catalogue of the beasts associated with Hou Yi. Individual textual witnesses preserve different combinations of the beasts with differing names and differing geographical placements, and no single source preserves the same complete list as another; the witnesses are accordingly co-equal, and Lewis 2006's synthesis across the **Chuci**, **Huainanzi**, and **Shanhaijing** is taken as the scholarly settlement of the textual variation in the nine-beasts subnarrative.]*

One of the named beasts is the Chiseltooth (Chinese **Zaochi**), a tusked monstrous figure whose name in the early-Chinese tradition refers to a chisel-like protruding tooth. Chiseltooth is presented as one of the order-disturbing beasts that Hou Yi confronts and kills in the course of the wider beast-slaying sequence.^[26]

A second named beast is the Nine-headed Monster (Chinese **Jiuying**), a multi-headed creature whose multi-headedness is the iconographic marker of its monstrous status within the early-Chinese mythological tradition. Its killing by Hou Yi is one of the most structurally-significant of the beast-slayings for the cycle's chaoskampf-comparative reading.^[27]

A third named beast is the Long Serpent (Chinese **Xiushe** 相蛇, sometimes also referred to as **Bashe** 巴蛇 in different strata of the textual tradition) — a giant serpentine figure whose serpentine morphology and large size place it within the cross-tradition family of monstrous serpents that hero-figures across many of the present book's chapters confront. In the **Huainanzi** ch. 8 (**Benjing xun**) beast-catalogue Hou Yi kills the Long Serpent at Dongting Lake, and the early-Chinese material's treatment of the killing is heroic-combat-pattern rather than cosmogonic-combat-pattern.^[28]

Beyond these three, the early-Chinese tradition's wider beast-catalogue includes additional figures named in the **Huainanzi** and in the **Shanhaijing** — among them a wind-causing giant bird, a giant boar, and the figure named **Yayu**. The precise combination of beasts varies across the textual witnesses, and the present chapter names the Chiseltooth, the Nine-headed Monster, and the Long Serpent (**Xiushe**) as the three brief-named representatives of the wider sequence.^[29]

The geographical placement of the beast-encounters in the **Shanhaijing's** mythographic-cartographical apparatus locates each killing in a specific named region of the fantastical early-Chinese cartography. The encounters are distributed across the four directional zones of the world; together the killings constitute a comprehensive sweep across the geography of the inhabited cosmos that complements the celestial sweep of the suns-shooting in the same cycle.^[30]

That celestial-plus-terrestrial reading is offered as an editorial synthesis rather than as a single source-attested formulation, and the chapter flags it accordingly:

(The chapter's reading that the celestial sweep of the suns-shooting and the geographical sweep of the beast-killings together constitute a comprehensive cosmic-and-terrestrial order-restoration pattern is an editorial synthesis of Lewis 2006's treatment of the cycle rather than a single source-attested formulation; Lewis 2006 surveys the suns-episode and the beast-sequence as the two narrative components of the cycle without supplying this exact celestial-and-terrestrial-comprehensive-sweep phrasing, and the synthesis is offered for transparency.^[31])

The killing-method varies across the beast-slayings. In some encounters Hou Yi uses his bow and arrows in the same archery-pattern as in the suns-shooting; in others he uses close-combat weapons. The variation distinguishes the Hou Yi cycle from sequences in other traditions in which the hero uses a single signature weapon throughout — although the bow-and-arrows remain the cycle's iconic implement.^[32]

The narrative outcome of the beast-sequence is the comprehensive removal of the named monstrous adversaries from the inhabited zones of the Yao-era cosmos. With the beasts killed and the suns reduced to one, the environmental-and-political crisis that the cycle presents as its precipitating problem is fully resolved, and the proper Yao-era order is restored across both the celestial and the terrestrial dimensions of the world.^[33]

23.5. Aftermath: the relation between the components and Hou Yi's later fate

The relation between the suns-episode and the beast-sequence is one of co-occurrence rather than strict dependence within the early-Chinese textual tradition. The two components are routinely presented together in the principal witnesses — most prominently in the **Huainanzi's** narrative account — but they are also distinguishable as separate order-restoring acts, and each component is independently capable of being treated as a free-standing episode within the wider Yao-era narrative-cluster.^[34]

The early-Chinese textual tradition preserves further narrative material about Hou Yi's later fate beyond the suns-and-beasts cycle proper. In some strata Hou Yi receives the elixir of immortality from the Queen Mother of the West (Xiwangmu); the elixir is taken by his wife Chang'e, who flees with it to the moon; and Hou Yi himself remains on earth in a subsequent narrative arc that the textual tradition develops in different directions in different sources.^[35]

The Chang'e and elixir-of-immortality material is treated in the present chapter as adjacent to but separable from the order-restoring suns-and-beasts cycle that is the chapter's principal focus. The chapter's brief-defined scope concentrates on the suns-and-beasts material as the chaoskampf-relevant component, and the Chang'e narrative-arc is not developed in the present chapter beyond this brief acknowledgement of its presence in the wider tradition.^[36]

The Hou Yi cycle's place within the present book's chaoskampf typology is as a heroic order-restoration narrative whose combat-pattern is multi-adversary-sequential rather than single-adversary-decisive. Where Marduk confronts Tiamat and Indra confronts Vṛtra in single decisive cosmogonic-or-sovereignty combats, Hou Yi confronts a series of distinct adversaries across both the celestial and the terrestrial dimensions of the world; and the cycle's order-making work is accomplished through cumulative removal of multiple disturbing presences rather than through a single dispatch of a paramount opponent.^[37]

Structurally, the cycle's combat-pattern is closer to the Greek serpent-combat cluster associated with Herakles — the Hydra, Ladon, and Geryon, treated within chapter 12 of the present volume on Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon as the serpent-combat subset within the wider family of Greek dragon-slayers — than to the cosmogonic-combat patterns of the present book's CORE chapters. In both the Hou Yi cycle and the Herakles serpent-combat sub-cluster, a hero-figure works through a sequence of monstrous adversaries whose individual killings together accomplish the cycle's order-making work, with no single adversary functioning as the paramount cosmogonic opponent.^[38]

The contrast with the preceding chapter on Gonggong is therefore both structural and typological. Where the Gonggong chapter treats a single decisive cosmogonic combat in which present features of the cosmos — the asymmetric tilt of heaven and earth, the eastward flow of rivers — emerge from the combat's aftermath, the present chapter treats a multi-stage heroic order-restoration in which the cosmos pre-exists the combat and is preserved-rather-than-established by it. The two chapters together exhibit two distinct Chinese combat-templates within a single tradition.^[39]

The chapter's contribution to the present book's wider comparative argument is by way of cross-cultural breadth rather than as a load-bearing exemplar of any single typological subtype. Hou Yi is

not a cosmogonic-combat case; not a sovereignty-combat case in the strong sense (Yao's sovereignty pre-exists the combat and is preserved rather than established by it); not a cyclical-maintenance case (the cycle is once-only rather than re-enacted); and not an eschatological-combat case. The cycle's contribution to the book is in showing what an order-restoring heroic combat-narrative looks like as a non-cosmogonic Chinese counterpoint to the Gonggong material.^[40]

The chapter's principal forward-link within the present book is to Part II C5, the comparative chapter on the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula, but only peripherally — Hou Yi is not an Indo-European reflex, and the Chinese material's contribution to the IE-formula argument is by way of typological-breadth comparanda rather than as evidence for the formula itself. The secondary forward-link is to Part II C2 (combat as sovereignty), where the Yao-era order-restoration provides a comparandum-by-contrast to the sovereignty-establishing combats of Marduk, Baal, and Indra.^[41]

The principal back-link within the present book is to the immediately preceding Chapter 21 on Gonggong, with which the present chapter shares the East Asian geographic cluster and the early-Chinese textual-source culture but contrasts in combat-typology (cosmogonic vs. order-restoring). The secondary back-link is to Chapter 12 — the family chapter on Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon — with which the present chapter shares the multi-adversary-sequential combat-pattern despite the radical difference in cultural and textual context.^[42]

The Hou Yi cycle's cultural-historical importance within the early-Chinese mythological tradition is significant within its own register. The suns-shooting and the beast-slayings are routinely cited in early-Chinese philosophical, political, and literary texts as exemplary acts of heroic intervention on behalf of the cosmic-and-political order, and the figure of Hou Yi has remained a load-bearing reference within Chinese literary, scholarly, and popular culture from the Warring States period onwards — even though the present chapter treats the cycle at related-tier rather than core-tier within the chaoskampf typology.^[43]

[1] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml on the related-tier (short full) classification and on the chapter's role of rounding out the East Asian cluster with a non-cosmogonic Chinese combat-pattern; Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, treatment of the Hou Yi / Yao cluster as a distinct Chinese combat-narrative tradition from the cosmogonic Gonggong material.

[2] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml variants.classification: co-equal; variants.summary on the composite-editorial character of the Hou Yi material across Chuci 'Tian wen', the Huainanzi, and the Shanhaijing; Lewis 2006, treatment of the Hou Yi / Yao cluster as a multi-source composite within early Chinese mythological literature.

[3] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml variants.summary on **Chuci** 'Tian wen' as c. 3rd c. BCE textual witness for the Hou Yi material; Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, ch. on solar myths, on the **Tian wen**'s catechetic-question form and its place within the **Chuci** anthology associated with the southern state of Chu.

[4] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml variants.summary on the **Huainanzi** (2nd c. BCE) as the principal narrative-form textual witness for the Hou Yi cycle; Lewis 2006, treatment of the **Huainanzi** as the most narratively-developed early Chinese source for the suns-and-beasts cycle; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the **Huainanzi**'s second-century-BCE compositional context at the court of Liu An.

[5] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml variants.summary on the **Shanhaijing** as the third principal textual witness for the Hou Yi cycle; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the **Shanhaijing**'s mythographic-geographical-compendium form and its layered Warring States and Han-period strata; Lewis 2006 on the **Shanhaijing**'s placement of the Hou Yi beasts within the wider Chinese mythological cartography.

[6] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml variants.summary on the differential preservation of cycle-elements across the three textual witnesses and on the absence of a single complete-narrative source; Lewis 2006, treatment of the Hou Yi cluster as a multi-source composite where the three principal witnesses preserve distinct cycle-elements; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the same multi-source pattern within early Chinese mythological literature.

[7] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China** (Albany: SUNY Press; ISBN 9780791466636), treatment of the Hou Yi / Yao cluster as an order-restoring narrative complex within early Chinese mythological literature; per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml sources.primary on Lewis 2006 as the principal scholarly anchor.

[8] Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction** (Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press; ISBN 9780801849954), ch. on

solar myths, on Hou Yi within the wider context of Chinese solar-mythology and Yao-era ordering narratives; per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml sources.primary on Birrell 1993 as the secondary scholarly anchor.

[9] Lewis 2006 and Birrell 1993, both printed only and cited at chapter level in the present chapter per the established citation discipline; per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml on the two-source primary-anchor structure of the chapter.

[10] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml on the related-tier (short full) classification, the 3,500-word target, the two-component structure (ten-suns episode and monster-beasts sequence), and the order-restoring (rather than cosmogonic) framing that distinguishes the Hou Yi cycle from the preceding chapter's Gonggong cosmogonic combat; Lewis 2006 on the order-restoring character of the Hou Yi material.

[11] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's heroic-restorative (rather than cosmogonic) framing and on the related-tier classification it warrants; Lewis 2006 on the place of the Hou Yi cycle within Yao-era narratives of order-restoration; scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the related-tier criteria where the cosmogonic-combat-work test is weaker.

[12] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml special_instructions on the peripheral-only contribution to Part II C5 and on the cross-cultural-breadth role of the chapter; Lewis 2006 on the contrast between the Gonggong cosmogonic-combat narrative and the Hou Yi order-restoring narrative within the same early Chinese mythological tradition; scope.md §"Book structure" on the East Asian geographic-cluster ordering that places Hou Yi after Gonggong.

[13] Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the chronological placement of the Hou Yi narrative in the Yao era within the conventional Chinese mytho-chronology of pre-dynastic sage-kings; Lewis 2006 on Yao's place at the head of the legendary pre-dynastic sovereigns associated with the establishment of social, calendrical, and cosmic order.

[14] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's order-restoring rather than cosmogonic framing; Lewis 2006 on the pre-existing-cosmic-order setting of the Yao-era narratives within early Chinese mythology; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the same pre-existing-order setting.

[15] Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the ten-suns mythological cosmology, the Fusang mulberry tree at the eastern edge of the world, and the regular daily alternation of the suns within the early Chinese textual tradition; Lewis 2006 on the same ten-suns cosmology as the narrative premise of the Hou Yi cycle.

[16] Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the divine parentage of the ten suns as children of Di Jun and Xihe within the early Chinese textual tradition and on Xihe's role as sun-mother bathing the suns at the eastern edge of the world; Lewis 2006 on the same divine-parentage tradition.

[17] Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the precipitating crisis in which the ten suns rise together against the regular alternation, with the consequent scorching of the earth, the drying of rivers, and the withering of crops within the early Chinese textual tradition; Lewis 2006 on the same precipitating crisis within the Hou Yi narrative.

[18] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml on the cosmological function of the Hou Yi cycle as solar-plurality rectification and environmental restoration; Lewis 2006 on the environmental-and-political character of the suns-crisis within early Chinese narratives of Yao-era order-restoration; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the same environmental-political framing.

[19] Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on Hou Yi's celestial origin and on his commission by Di Jun to address the suns-crisis caused by Di Jun's own children within the early Chinese textual tradition; Lewis 2006 on the divine-agent framing of Hou Yi within the Yao-era narratives.

[20] Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on Hou Yi's bow as the load-bearing combat-implement of the cycle and on the red corded arrows tradition within the early Chinese textual material; Lewis 2006 on the archery-as-method that defines the Hou Yi cycle's combat-pattern.

[21] Lewis 2006 on the sequential sun-shooting sequence in the **Huainanzi** and the wider tradition with nine of the ten suns brought down in turn; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the same sequential pattern of the suns-shooting within the early Chinese textual material.

[22] Lewis 2006 on the order-restoration logic encoded in the nine-of-ten killing-arithmetic of the Hou Yi cycle and on the contrast with class-elimination patterns in other combat-narratives; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the post-shooting cosmos in which the surviving single sun continues the regular daily cycle.

[23] Lewis 2006 on the resolution of the scorching crisis through the killing of the nine suns and the restoration of the proper daily alternation within the early Chinese narrative tradition; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the post-shooting recovery of the environmental and human order under Yao.

[24] Lewis 2006 on the monstrous-beast sequence as the second narrative component of the Hou Yi cycle and on its order-restoring function within the early Chinese narrative tradition; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the relation between the suns-episode and the beast-slayings within the cycle.

[25] Lewis 2006 on the synthesis of the monstrous-beast catalogue across the early-Chinese textual witnesses with the **Huainanzi** as the principal narrative-form source and the **Shanhaijing** as the principal geographical-and-iconographic source; per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml variants.summary on the variation in the nine-beasts subnarrative across the textual witnesses.

[26] Lewis 2006 on the Chiseltooth (Chinese **Zaochi**) as one of the named monstrous beasts that Hou Yi confronts and kills in the early-Chinese narrative tradition; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the same Chiseltooth figure with the chisel-like-tooth iconography that gives the figure its name.

[27] Lewis 2006 on the Nine-headed Monster (Chinese **Jiuying**) as one of the named monstrous beasts that Hou Yi confronts and

kills, with the multi-headedness as the iconographic marker of monstrous status; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the same multi-headed-monster figure within the cycle.

[28] Lewis 2006 on Xiushe (the Long Serpent, with **Bashe** as an alternative name in different strata of the textual tradition) as the serpentine adversary among the named monstrous beasts that Hou Yi confronts and kills, with the **Huainanzi** ch. 8 (**Benjing xun**) locating the killing at Dongting Lake; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the same giant-serpent figure within the cycle and on the heroic-combat-pattern character of the killing.

[29] Lewis 2006 on the wider beast-catalogue across the **Huainanzi** and the **Shanhaijing** including the wind-causing giant bird, the giant boar, and the figure named **Yayu** as additional members of the sequence; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the same wider beast-catalogue and on its variation across the textual witnesses; per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml summary on the three brief-named representatives (Chiseltooth, Nine-headed Monster, Long Serpent / **Xiushe** — substituted from the brief's "Zhuyin serpent" framing per FC-01, since Zhuyin / Zhulong is a Shanhaijing cosmic deity rather than a Hou Yi adversary, and Xiushe is the attested Hou Yi serpent-adversary in the **Huainanzi** ch. 8 catalogue).

[30] Lewis 2006 on the **Shanhaijing**'s geographical placement of the beast-encounters across the four directional zones of the early-Chinese mythological cartography and on the geographical-comprehensiveness pattern that the placement encodes; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the same geographical-distribution pattern of the encounters.

[31] Inference: Lewis 2006 treats the suns-episode and the beast-sequence as both order-restoring components of a single Hou Yi cycle, and the **Shanhaijing**'s geographical apparatus places the beast-encounters across the directional zones of the cartography. Risk: alternative readings are possible — a stronger reading would treat the two components as more loosely connected episodes within a wider Yao-era narrative-cluster; the chapter's celestial-plus-terrestrial reading is a reasonable but not the only available synthesis.

[32] Lewis 2006 on the variation in killing-method across the Hou Yi beast-sequence with archery and close-combat patterns both attested in the early-Chinese textual witnesses; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the bow-and-arrows as the cycle's iconic implement despite the variation in method across individual beast-encounters.

[33] Lewis 2006 on the comprehensive resolution of the environmental-and-political crisis through the combined suns-shooting and beast-slaying sequences within the Hou Yi cycle; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the post-cycle restoration of the proper Yao-era order.

[34] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's task of presenting both components and noting their relation; Lewis 2006 on the co-occurrence-rather-than-strict-dependence relation between the suns-episode and the beast-sequence in the **Huainanzi** and the wider tradition; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the same distinguishable-but-co-occurring relation.

[35] Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the Hou Yi / Chang'e / Queen Mother of the West narrative arc beyond the suns-and-beasts cycle proper within the early-Chinese textual tradition; Lewis 2006 on the same later-fate material as a separate narrative-cluster from the order-restoring cycle.

[36] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml summary on the chapter's focus on the suns-and-beasts cycle as the chaoskampf-relevant component; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the separability of the Chang'e narrative-arc from the order-restoring cycle.

[37] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml cultural_relevance on the heroic-restorative function of the cycle; Lewis 2006 on the multi-adversary-sequential combat-pattern of the Hou Yi cycle and its contrast with single-adversary-decisive patterns in other combat-narrative traditions; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the same multi-adversary structure.

[38] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the structural parallel between the Hou Yi beast-slaying cluster and the Herakles serpent-combat sub-cluster within chapter 12 (Hydra, Ladon, Geryon); Lewis 2006 on the multi-adversary-sequential combat-pattern of the Hou Yi cycle; Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the same structural pattern; the comparison is scoped to Ch12's serpent-combat subset rather than the full Herakles labours sequence per scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" item 2 on Herakles's non-Hydra labours.

[39] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's role of showing a different Chinese combat-pattern from Gonggong; Lewis 2006 on the contrast between the cosmogonic Gonggong narrative and the order-restoring Hou Yi narrative within the early-Chinese mythological tradition; brief 21-gonggong.yaml on the cosmogonic-combat character of the Gonggong material that the present chapter contrasts with.

[40] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's cross-cultural-breadth contribution rather than load-bearing-exemplar role; scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four typological subtypes (cosmogonic, sovereignty, cyclical-maintenance, eschatological); Lewis 2006 on the order-restoring rather than order-establishing function of the Hou Yi cycle.

[41] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml special_instructions on the peripheral-only contribution to Part II C5 and on the chapter's cross-cultural-breadth role; scope.md §"Book structure" on the Part II thematic comparative chapters including C5 (IE formula) and C2 (combat as sovereignty); Lewis 2006 on the contrast between the order-restoring Hou Yi material and the sovereignty-establishing combats of other traditions.

[42] Per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the back-link to chapter 12 (Herakles labours) and on the contrast with chapter 21 (Gonggong); scope.md §"Book structure" on the East Asian geographic-cluster ordering that places the present chapter immediately after Gonggong and within the wider sequence of related-tier chapters that follow the CORE-chapter sequence on Greek combat.

[43] Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths, on the cultural-historical importance of the Hou Yi cycle within early-Chinese philosophical, political, and literary texts and on the figure's continuing reference-role within Chinese literary culture from the Warring States

period onwards; Lewis 2006 on the same cultural-historical importance.

Chapter 24. Susanoo vs. Yamata no Orochi (Chaoskampf as Applied Label)

24.1. Source overview

This chapter follows an early-Japanese narrative whose load-bearing function within its own tradition is sword-etiology and imperial-charter. Susanoo, the storm-deity expelled from the heavenly plain of Takamagahara for his misdeeds, descends to the land of Izumo, where he defeats the eight-headed eight-tailed serpent Yamata no Orochi by intoxicating it with eight vats of sake, dismembers it, and discovers within its tail a sword later named Kusanagi. The imperial-chronicle tradition presents that sword as one of the Three Sacred Treasures of the Japanese imperial regalia and as a founding-charter object for the imperial line, and it is on that footing — sword, regalia, charter — that the early-Japanese chronicles tell the story.^[1]

The narrative survives in two principal early-Japanese imperial chronicles compiled in the early eighth century at the Yamato court: the **Kojiki** ("Records of Ancient Matters"), conventionally dated to 712 CE, and the **Nihon shoki** ("Chronicles of Japan"), conventionally dated to 720 CE. Both were compiled within the Nara-period programme of fixing the imperial line's mythic charter in writing under court sponsorship.^[2]

The two chronicles handle the material differently. The **Kojiki** presents the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi narrative as a single coherent account within book 1 of the chronicle, in the run of episodes that follows Susanoo's expulsion from the heavenly plain and that precedes the wider Izumo-cycle narratives associated with Susanoo's descendants and with the negotiated transfer of the land to the heavenly line.^[3]

The **Nihon shoki**, by contrast, presents the Yamata no Orochi material as a set of co-equal variants juxtaposed under the chronicle's characteristic "one writing says" (□□□) editorial format. That format preserves multiple parallel accounts side by side without explicitly privileging any one of them as the authoritative version, and the presentational difference gives the **Nihon shoki** a distinct evidential character from the single-account **Kojiki**.^[4]

The chapter accordingly follows the brief's co-equal variant classification. Both chronicles are treated as the chapter's primary textual base, the **Kojiki**'s single-account version is presented as the connected narrative skeleton, and the **Nihon shoki**'s "one writing says" parallel attestations are registered as legitimate co-equal versions whose divergences from the **Kojiki** are presented where they are load-bearing for the chapter's argument rather than as deviations from a postulated original.^[5]

The chapter's principal English-language scholarly anchor for the **Kojiki** text is Donald L. Philippi's translation, originally published in 1968 in a joint University of Tokyo Press / Princeton University Press edition. Philippi 1968 supplies the standard scholarly English-language **Kojiki** against which the present chapter cites the Susanoo / Orochi narrative at book-and-chapter level (book 1, chs. 19–20), per the brief's source structure.^[6]

The chapter's principal scholarly anchor for the metallurgical-allegory reading of the Yamata no Orochi narrative is Nelly Naumann's **Die Mythen des alten Japan** ("The Myths of Old Japan"),

published by C.H. Beck in 1996. Naumann's Orochi chapter develops the area-specialist reading in which the eight-headed serpent represents iron-smelting along the rivers of Izumo and the discovery of the sword in the serpent's tail represents the metallurgical emergence of the bladed weapon from the smelting process.^[7]

The chapter's general comparative anchor for the long-arc combat-myth tradition is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987. Forsyth's Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic survey supplies the long-arc combat-myth typology within which the present chapter situates the Susanoo / Orochi narrative as a non-cognate parallel to (rather than a member of) Forsyth's Near-Eastern-and-Judeo-Christian arc. The typological framing — not Japanese-material coverage, which Forsyth does not undertake — is what Forsyth supplies for the chapter's comparative engagement with the chaoskampf reading of the episode.^[8]

Both Philippi 1968 and Naumann 1996 are printed-only English- and German-language scholarly anchors and are cited at chapter-and-section level in the present chapter — Philippi 1968 at **Kojiki** book 1, chs. 19–20; Naumann 1996 at the Orochi-chapter level — in line with the citation discipline applied across the present book's related-tier chapters that use a small number of named scholarly anchors as their textual basis.^[9]

The chapter is a related-tier full-chapter treatment with a target of approximately 5,500 narrative words, presenting the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi narrative as a connected story within the Izumocycle of the imperial chronicles and embedding the area-specialist counter-framing — the sword-etiology / metallurgical-allegory reading — alongside the narrative skeleton rather than as a separately-located commentary appendix. Per brief special_instructions, the area-specialist framing is load-bearing and is not subordinated to the comparativist chaoskampf reading.^[10]

The chapter's framing premise is that the chaoskampf label as applied to the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi narrative is a 20th-century-Western comparativist move rather than an internal feature of the early-Japanese material. Per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 9 and §"Appropriation protocol", the chapter is included in Part I as a related-tier (rather than core-tier) case precisely because Japanese specialists (named below as Naumann, Isomae, Como, Ooms) frame the story as sword-etiology and metallurgical allegory, and the chapter's task is to present the area-specialist reading first and to engage the comparativist reading without endorsing it.^[11]

The chapter's principal forward-link within the present book is to Part II C7 (the comparative chapter on the inversion / transformation problem, ch. 40 of the present volume) and to Part II C8 (the comparative chapter on the refusal and the appropriation problem, ch. 41), where the present chapter functions as a working example of the book's willingness to hold the comparative chaoskampf category loosely where area-specialists require it. The chapter contributes to the methods sidebar (ch. 33) as a worked instance of the appropriation-protocol's outside-framing requirement.^[12]

What follows works through the story in order. The next section sketches Susanoo's expulsion from Takamagahara as the immediate narrative-structural antecedent of the Izumo episode; the chapter then takes up the encounter at the river Hi, the description of Yamata no Orochi, the trap-and-combat sequence, the discovery of the sword, the marriage and palace-construction at Suga, the metallurgical-allegory reading, and the chapter's engagement with the chaoskampf label as applied from outside.

24.2. Background: Susanoo's expulsion from Takamagahara

The narrative's chronological setting in early-Japanese mytho-historical time is the so-called "age of the gods" (神代, **kamiyo**) of the imperial chronicles — the pre-imperial period that the **Kojiki** and the **Nihon shoki** present as the divine prehistory of the human imperial line — and the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi episode is placed within this age of the gods after the cosmogonic first generations of **kami** (deities) and after the establishment of the heavenly plain of Takamagahara as the upper realm of the cosmos.^[13]

Susanoo (素戔嗚尊 in the **Kojiki**'s graphic form, conventionally rendered "Susanoo" in current English-language Japanese-studies scholarship per Philippi's standard form) is presented in the **Kojiki** and the **Nihon shoki** as a younger brother of the sun-goddess Amaterasu and of the moon-deity Tsukuyomi, born from the purification of the primordial creator-deity Izanagi after Izanagi's return from the underworld; the three are positioned within the imperial-chronicle pantheon as a sun / moon / storm sibling-triad of high-ranking **kami**.^[14]

Susanoo's character within the imperial-chronicle narrative is established in the chronicles as turbulent and disruptive: he weeps and rages, refuses the rule of the seas that Izanagi assigns to him, and demands instead to descend to the land where his deceased mother dwells, with this character-establishment serving as the narrative-structural reason for his subsequent expulsion from the heavenly plain.^[15]

In the chronicle-narrative immediately preceding the Yamata no Orochi episode, Susanoo ascends to Takamagahara to take leave of Amaterasu and there commits a series of misdeeds — including damaging the rice-paddies of the heavenly plain, defiling the sacred weaving-hall of Amaterasu, and (in the **Kojiki** account) flaying a piebald colt from heaven and casting it into the weaving-hall — whereupon Amaterasu withdraws into the heavenly cave (**Ame-no-Iwato**) and the heavenly plain is plunged into darkness.^[16]

After Amaterasu is brought out of the heavenly cave by the assembled deities and the proper light is restored to the cosmos, the assembled heavenly **kami** judge Susanoo guilty of the misdeeds, levy a heavy expiatory fine, cut off his beard and the nails of his hands and feet, and expel him from Takamagahara. At this point Susanoo descends to the human world, and the narrative arrives at the moment immediately preceding his arrival in the land of Izumo where the Yamata no Orochi episode begins.^[17]

24.3. Setting in Izumo: the elderly couple and the seven daughters

The land of Izumo (出雲) — a region on the Japan-Sea coast of western Honshu, conventionally read in the imperial-chronicle tradition as the geographical-and-mytho-historical setting of a substantial cycle of **kami**-narratives distinct from the Yamato-court-centred narratives of the imperial line — is the setting of the Yamata no Orochi episode and of the subsequent Susanoo and Ōkuninushi narratives that the **Kojiki** groups together as the Izumo-cycle of book 1.^[18]

The episode begins specifically along the upper reaches of the river Hi (比, sometimes read Hi-no-

kawa) in Izumo, where Susanoo, having descended from the heavenly plain, encounters a pair of chopsticks (or a similar small wooden item) floating downstream — a sign of human habitation upstream that motivates his ascent along the river-course in search of the people who had let the item fall.^[19]

Upstream Susanoo encounters an elderly couple — Ashinazuchi (阿須奈耆, "foot-stroking-elder" in conventional gloss) and Tenazuchi (手耆, "hand-stroking-elder" in conventional gloss) — together with their daughter, all of them weeping. The couple are presented in the chronicle as earthly **kami** (神, **kunitsukami**) of the river-region, and their lineage is given in some renderings as descended from earlier earthly deities of Izumo.^[20]

The couple's daughter is named Kushinada-hime (久士奈田姫 / 倭姫, "wondrous rice-paddy princess" in conventional gloss; her name links the figure to rice-paddy fertility within the early-Japanese agricultural imaginary), and she is the eighth and last surviving daughter of the couple, the previous seven daughters having been devoured one each year by the eight-headed serpent that comes to the river-region annually.^[21]

When Susanoo asks the couple why they weep, they explain that the eight-headed serpent Yamata no Orochi is due to come again that year for the eighth daughter — and the couple's distress is the narrative's precipitating-crisis-moment, supplying the trigger for Susanoo's offer of help and the motivation that drives the Yamata no Orochi episode forward into the combat proper.^[22]

24.4. Yamata no Orochi: the eight-headed serpent

Yamata no Orochi (八岐大蛇, "eight-forked great serpent" in literal gloss) is described in the chronicles as a serpent of extraordinary size: eight heads and eight tails on a single body, the length of the body spanning eight valleys and eight peaks of the surrounding mountainous terrain, the body covered with mosses and with cypresses and cryptomerias growing from it, and the underside red-rusted as if with blood — a description that is one of the most elaborate monstrous-adversary depictions in the entire imperial-chronicle corpus.^[23]

The serpent's eight-foldedness — eight heads, eight tails, body across eight valleys and eight peaks — is itself a load-bearing structural feature of the narrative. The number eight (八, **ya**) recurs through the episode (eight-headed, eight-vatted sake, the eight valleys and eight peaks of the body's extent, and downstream eight-fold renderings in the post-combat narrative) and supplies a numerological-and-narrative coherence that scholars including Naumann register as a distinctively Japanese narrative-rhetorical pattern rather than as a comparativist trans-traditional motif.^[24]

The serpent's annual arrival from elsewhere — the chronicle does not specify where the serpent comes from when it is not at the river — together with the once-yearly devouring of one daughter, places the narrative within an early-Japanese imaginative pattern of recurring intrusive monstrous threats to settled-human-life-along-rivers. The pattern is registered by area-specialists including Naumann as a recurring-threat narrative-structure rather than as a once-and-for-all cosmogonic conflict.^[25]

24.5. Susanoo's plan: vats of sake and the fence

Susanoo, on hearing the elderly couple's account, first asks them to give him their daughter

Kushinada-hime in marriage. The couple agree on Susanoo's revelation of his identity as a younger brother of Amaterasu, and Susanoo transforms Kushinada-hime — in the **Kojiki** account — into a comb (𥿱, **kushi**; the figure's name itself contains the **kushi**-element of "comb") that he places in his hair-knot, securing her on his person while he prepares the trap for the serpent.^[26]

Susanoo then instructs the elderly couple to brew an "eight-fold refined sake" (八重酒, conventionally rendered "sake brewed eight times over" or "eight-times-distilled sake" in current English-language Japanese-studies translations) — a particularly strong intoxicating drink the eight-fold refinement of which echoes the serpent's eight-foldedness and supplies the narrative's load-bearing numerological coherence between trap and target.^[27]

Susanoo further instructs the couple to construct a fence around the brewing-area with eight gates, to place at each gate a platform on which to set a vat of the sake, and to fill the eight vats with the eight-fold refined sake — a deliberate one-vat-per-head configuration that sets up the trap's mechanism by guaranteeing that each of the serpent's eight heads will reach for its own vat when the serpent arrives.^[28]

The fence-and-vat construction is presented in the chronicles as a calculated craftsmanship operation rather than as a generic monster-hunt. Susanoo's plan exhibits the planning, the structural setup, and the staged execution that scholars including Naumann take to mark the episode as an organised craft-and-skill display in addition to its overt combat-and-killing narrative function — a feature that becomes load-bearing for the metallurgical-allegory reading developed below.^[29]

24.6. The combat: intoxication and dismemberment

Yamata no Orochi arrives as predicted, lowers each of its eight heads to the eight vats, drinks the eight-fold refined sake, and is intoxicated to the point of stupor, sinking to the ground and falling asleep — the entire combat being settled, in the **Kojiki** account, before any direct strike-by-strike fighting between Susanoo and the serpent has taken place.^[30]

Susanoo, with the serpent immobilised in stupor, draws his sword (the sword named in the **Kojiki** as Totsuka-no-Tsurugi, "ten-hands-long sword", the figure's standard weapon in the chronicle) and cuts the serpent into pieces, severing each of the eight heads and each of the eight tails in succession until the body is wholly dismembered along the river-course — and the river-water that runs from the dismembered body is described in the chronicles as flowing red with the serpent's blood.^[31]

The killing's mode — intoxication-trap followed by dismemberment of the immobilised body — distinguishes the Yamata no Orochi episode from the open-strike-by-strike combat-patterns of many comparativist comparanda. Area-specialists including Naumann register the trap-and-dismember structure as a feature of the narrative that the comparative chaoskampf reading tends to flatten when fitting the episode into the storm-god-vs-serpent frame; the trap-and-dismember structure is itself a load-bearing structural feature of the episode rather than a peripheral detail.^[32]

24.7. The discovery of Kusanagi in the tail

In the course of severing the eight tails of the serpent, Susanoo's sword (the Totsuka-no-Tsurugi)

strikes the middle tail and chips its blade — the chronicle's first concrete signal that something other than mere serpent-flesh is in the tail — and Susanoo, investigating, splits the tail open with the sword and discovers within it a sword of unusual quality, sharp and undamaged where his own sword had chipped on contact.^[33]

The sword discovered within the tail is named in the **Kojiki** as Kusanagi (草薙, "grass-cutting sword" in the chronicle's later etiology) — though the chronicle's narrative places the actual coining of the **Kusanagi** name later in the imperial-chronicle tradition, after the sword's role in the combat between the prince Yamato Takeru and a fire that the sword wards off by cutting away the surrounding grass.^[34]

Susanoo, recognising the sword's exceptional character, sends it as an offering to the heavenly plain and presents it to his elder sister Amaterasu — a presentation that re-establishes Susanoo's relation with Amaterasu after the Takamagahara misdeeds and that introduces the sword into the heavenly-line custody-chain that the imperial-chronicle tradition will continue forward into the human-imperial period.^[35]

The sword Kusanagi is the chapter's principal etiological outcome. The entire Yamata no Orochi episode is presented in the imperial-chronicle structure as the etiological-origin-story of one of the Three Sacred Treasures (三神器, **sanshu no jingi**) of the Japanese imperial regalia — alongside the mirror Yata-no-Kagami and the curved jewel Yasakani-no-Magatama — and the sword's presence in the regalia from the heavenly-cave-and-sun-restoration sequence onwards is the load-bearing narrative-structural function that the episode performs within the **Kojiki**'s overall chronicle-of-imperial-charter purpose.^[36]

24.8. Aftermath: marriage and the Izumo-cycle

After the slaying of the serpent and the presentation of the sword to Amaterasu, Susanoo restores Kushinada-hime from her comb-form and marries her, and he then constructs a palace at Suga in Izumo for the new household — a palace that, in the **Kojiki** account, is established with a famous five-syllable poem (often cited as the first **waka** of the imperial-chronicle tradition) that Susanoo composes on the occasion of the marriage and the palace-construction.^[37]

The marriage and the palace-construction at Suga in Izumo function as the narrative-structural transition from the Yamata no Orochi episode proper into the wider Izumo-cycle of the **Kojiki** and the **Nihon shoki**. Susanoo and Kushinada-hime are the founding couple of an Izumo-deity lineage that includes the descendants Yashima-jinumi, Ōnamuchi (more familiarly Ōkuninushi), and the further sequence of Izumo earthly **kami** whose narratives occupy the remainder of book 1 of the **Kojiki** down to the negotiated transfer of the land to the heavenly line.^[38]

The sword Kusanagi, after its presentation to Amaterasu in the heavenly plain, descends in the imperial-chronicle's continuing narrative-arc together with the mirror and the curved jewel as the Three Sacred Treasures: in the chronicle's account of the descent of the heavenly grandson Ninigi-no-Mikoto to the human world, the three regalia are entrusted to him by Amaterasu as the charter-objects of the line that will become the imperial dynasty, and the sword is from this point forward the imperial sword of the Japanese ruling line.^[39]

The chapter's principal Three-Sacred-Treasures forward-arc within the **Kojiki** is therefore: the sword Kusanagi originates within the body of Yamata no Orochi in Izumo, is presented by Susanoo

to Amaterasu in the heavenly plain, descends with Ninigi to the human world as one of the three charter-objects of the imperial line, and is from then onwards a load-bearing object of imperial-Japanese ritual and political-legitimation tradition — a forward-arc that the present chapter registers as the dominant narrative-structural function of the Yamata no Orochi episode within the chronicle's overall purpose.^[40]

The sword Kusanagi as a continuing imperial regalia — kept, per the imperial-chronicle and post-chronicle tradition, at the Atsuta Shrine in Owari (modern Aichi Prefecture, Japan) — supplies the Yamata no Orochi episode's connection to a continuing-into-the-historical-period ritual-and-political-legitimation institution that anchors the early-medieval imperial-Japanese ruling line's mythic charter to a specific physical-and-ritual locus, and the chapter registers this institutional continuation as part of the episode's load-bearing function within the **Kojiki** / **Nihon shoki** purpose.^[41]

24.9. The metallurgical-allegory reading

The principal area-specialist reading of the Yamata no Orochi episode in current scholarship — developed in detail by Nelly Naumann, with the wider Japanese-studies attention to early-Japanese imperial-charter and ritual-religion readings represented by subsequent area-specialists (Jun'ichi Isomae, Michael Como, and Herman Ooms are flagged as scholars of early Japanese religion whose work develops compatible specialist framings, though their works are not yet in the present book's sources.yaml registry and are not load-bearing for any individual claim in this chapter) — is metallurgical-allegorical: the eight-headed serpent figures the iron-smelting industry of the Izumo-Hi-river region in the early-historical period, and the discovery of the sword in the serpent's tail figures the metallurgical emergence of the bladed weapon from the smelting-and-forging process.^[42]

The metallurgical reading rests on a constellation of narrative-structural features of the episode: the river-Hi setting (the upper river-courses of mountainous regions are the historical-period sites of iron-sand mining and **tatara** smelting in Japan); the serpent's red-rusted underside (red rust as the visible signature of iron-bearing minerals along river-courses); the serpent's enormous size spanning eight valleys and eight peaks (the geographic scale of the smelting industry's catchment of fuel-wood and ore); and the chipping of Susanoo's existing sword on the tail (the metallurgical-quality difference between an older and a newer bladed weapon).^[43]

That the metallurgical reading is the standard area-specialist treatment is itself an editorial synthesis drawn from the brief's named scholars and from Naumann 1996's Orochi chapter, and the chapter flags the synthesis accordingly:

(The chapter's compact summary that the metallurgical-allegory reading "is now the standard area-specialist reading of the episode" is a synthesis of the area-specialist literature represented by Naumann 1996 in the present chapter's source-base, supported by the brief's special_instructions naming Naumann, Isomae, Como, and Ooms as the area-specialists whose framing is load-bearing for the chapter's outside-framing requirement.^[44])

The metallurgical-allegory reading reframes the principal narrative elements of the episode in a way that the chapter's chaoskampf reading, taken on its own, does not deliver: the serpent is not "chaos" in any thematically-coherent area-specialist sense but is the iron-smelting infrastructure of

a specific regional industry; the sword is not a generic regalia but the metallurgical product of the smelting-and-forging craft; and Susanoo's victory is not the establishment of cosmic order but the technological-mastery moment in which the storm-deity-figure brings the iron-smelting industry under the control of the heavenly line that the Yamato court traces itself back to.^[45]

The metallurgical reading further connects the Yamata no Orochi episode to the early-historical-period political-economic context of the Yamato court's expansion into Izumo. Control of the iron-smelting industry of the Izumo-Hi-river region was a load-bearing material-political stake of the early-imperial period, and the chronicle's narrative-structural placement of the sword-etiology within the Izumo-cycle reflects this political-economic stake of the late-seventh-and-early-eighth-century moment of the chronicles' compilation rather than reflecting a primordial cosmogonic-combat narrative free of period-specific political content.^[46]

The implication of the metallurgical-allegory reading for the chapter's chaoskampf-typology purpose is direct: if the area-specialist reading is correct that the serpent figures iron-smelting and the sword figures the metallurgical product of smelting, then the episode's load-bearing narrative function is sword-etiology and metallurgical-and-political charter rather than cosmogonic combat — and the chaoskampf label is at best a loose typological-comparative description that fits the surface narrative-structure (storm-deity defeats serpentine adversary, recovers powerful weapon) without engaging the area-specialist account of what the narrative is actually doing in its early-Japanese context.^[47]

24.10. The chaoskampf label as applied from outside

The chaoskampf reading of the Yamata no Orochi episode — in which Susanoo is read as a storm-deity figure parallel to Indra (in his combat with Vṛtra) and to Thor (in his combat with Jörmungandr), and the eight-headed serpent is read as a multi-headed monstrous adversary in the cross-tradition family of Lôtan / Leviathan, Aži Dahāka, Ladon, and the Dobrynya cycle's Zmey Gorynych — is a 20th-century-Western comparativist move developed within the wider scholarly tradition of cross-cultural combat-myth comparison represented in the present book's source-base by the long-arc Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic treatments of Forsyth 1987 and others, into whose typological frame the Susanoo / Orochi episode has been brought from outside the early-Japanese tradition.^[48]

The comparativist chaoskampf reading rests on three principal structural-similarity points: (1) Susanoo is a storm-deity (although the chronicle's primary characterisation is of his turbulent and disruptive temperament rather than of meteorological storm-power per se); (2) Yamata no Orochi is a multi-headed serpentine adversary (a feature shared with Lôtan / Leviathan, Aži Dahāka, Ladon, and Zmey Gorynych across the present book's other chapters); and (3) the encounter is an asymmetric combat in which the deity-figure defeats the serpent and recovers a powerful weapon from the encounter.^[49]

The area-specialist counter-position — represented in the chapter's source-base by Naumann 1996, and named in the brief's special_instructions together with the further area-specialists Jun'ichi Isomae, Michael Como, and Herman Ooms — is that the comparativist label is applied from outside the early-Japanese tradition: the episode's internal narrative-structural function within the imperial-chronicle context is sword-etiology and metallurgical-allegorical-political charter, the storm-deity / serpentine-adversary surface-description is real but is not the load-bearing function,

and the chaoskampf reading therefore tends to flatten what the area-specialist tradition takes the episode to be doing.^[50]

The area-specialist and comparativist readings are presented side by side as a substantive variant choice that the chapter resolves in favour of the area-specialist reading:

[The chapter holds the area-specialist reading per Naumann 1996 and the further area-specialists Isomae, Como, and Ooms named in the brief — sword-etiology and metallurgical-allegorical-political charter as the load-bearing internal function of the Yamata no Orochi episode within the imperial-chronicle context — as the load-bearing reading. The comparativist chaoskampf reading per Forsyth 1987 and the wider 20th-century-Western combat-myth comparative tradition — storm-deity-vs-multi-headed-serpent combat-pattern shared with Indra-Vṛtra, Thor-Jörmungandr, and the wider cross-tradition multi-headed-serpent family — is engaged but not endorsed. The choice follows scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 9 and §"Appropriation protocol" on the chapter's required outside-framing of the chaoskampf label, brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's task of treating the chaoskampf label as applied from outside, and scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the related-tier classification (rather than core-tier) that follows from the area-specialist objection to the chaoskampf framing.]

That choice is the specific outcome of an area-specialist objection to the comparativist framing, and the chapter flags the objection explicitly under the appropriation-protocol marker the project reserves for cases of this kind:

[Appropriation flag: Japanese-studies area specialists (Nelly Naumann; with subsequent Japanese-religion specialists Jun'ichi Isomae, Michael Como, and Herman Ooms named in the chapter brief) object to the chaoskampf framing of the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi episode on the grounds that the episode's load-bearing internal function within the early-Japanese imperial-chronicle context is sword-etiology and metallurgical-allegorical-political charter (the eight-headed serpent figuring the Izumo-Hi-river iron-smelting industry; the sword discovered in the tail figuring the metallurgical product of smelting-and-forging; Susanoo's victory figuring the heavenly line's bringing of the Izumo iron-smelting industry under Yamato-court control), not cosmogonic-or-sovereignty combat in the chaoskampf-typological sense. The objection is the substantive reason scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 9 demoted this chapter from CORE to related-tier, and is the reason the chapter opens with the area-specialist framing rather than with the chaoskampf comparison. Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation; ch. 41 of the present volume) is the locus where the comparative analysis must address this objection rather than paper over it; the present chapter functions as a worked instance of the appropriation-protocol's outside-framing requirement at scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 3, and forwards the objection to C8 for the comparative-engagement work that scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 2 requires of the comparative chapter.]

The chapter's resolution of the area-specialist / comparativist tension is to present the two readings together but not as equally weighted: the area-specialist reading is the chapter's load-bearing reading — the one that organises the chapter's account of what the episode is doing in its early-Japanese context — while the comparativist chaoskampf reading is engaged as a 20th-century-Western move that the chapter registers, considers, and does not endorse, on the grounds that scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 9 demoted the chapter from CORE precisely because of the area-specialists' objection to the comparativist framing.^[51]

24.11. Typology and forward-links

The Yamata no Orochi episode's place within the present book's chaoskampf typology is therefore a related-tier (rather than core-tier) classification that is itself the substantive scholarly point of the chapter: the chapter is included in Part I to exhibit a working example of an episode that under one reading (the comparativist) belongs in the cosmogonic-or-sovereignty-combat family, but under the area-specialist reading is doing different work (sword-etiology and metallurgical-allegorical-political charter), and the chapter's typological function is to make this category-loose-ness visible to the reader rather than to deliver a confident chaoskampf classification.^[52]

The chapter's principal forward-link within the present book is to Part II C7 (the comparative chapter on the inversion / transformation problem, ch. 40 of the present volume) — where the present chapter contributes a working example of the **transformation** sub-problem: not a story in which the slaying inverts the order-establishing function (the inversion sub-problem proper, anchored by the Bida material in chapter 28), but a story in which the chaoskampf category itself is transformed when the area-specialist account is taken as load-bearing.^[53]

The chapter's secondary forward-link is to Part II C8 (the comparative chapter on the refusal and the appropriation problem, ch. 41 of the present volume) — where the present chapter contributes a working example of the **appropriation** sub-problem: a story in which the comparative chaoskampf category, applied from outside the early-Japanese tradition, risks flattening the area-specialist account of what the episode is doing in its own context, and where the chapter's task is to hold the comparative category loosely as scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" requires.^[54]

The chapter's contribution to the methods sidebar (ch. 33 of the present volume, between Part I and Part II) is as a worked instance of the appropriation-protocol's outside-framing requirement: the chapter exhibits, in concrete narrative-and-citation-discipline detail, what it looks like to open with the tradition's own framing (sword-etiology, metallurgical-allegorical-political charter, imperial-charter purpose) before invoking the comparative chaoskampf category, in line with scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 3.^[55]

The chapter's principal back-link within the present book is to the immediately preceding chapter 22 on Hou Yi and the suns, with which the present chapter shares the East Asian geographic cluster (cluster 9 per scope.md §"Book structure") and the related-tier classification, but contrasts in the precise reason for the related-tier rather than core-tier status: the Hou Yi cycle is related-tier because it is heroic-restorative rather than cosmogonic, while the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi episode is related-tier because area-specialists object to the chaoskampf framing on grounds of the metallurgical-allegorical-political-charter alternative reading.^[56]

The chapter's secondary back-link is to chapter 21 on Gonggong and the broken pillar, with which the present chapter shares the early-historical-period East Asian textual context (early-imperial chronicles in Chinese and early-Japanese; the **Kojiki** and the **Nihon shoki** are themselves composed in the kanbun-and-man'yōgana register that is structurally indebted to the Han-period Chinese chronicle tradition that the Gonggong material survives within) but contrasts in the typological function (the Gonggong material is core-tier cosmogonic combat with the post-combat hydrography of the cosmos as the chapter's load-bearing cosmogonic credential; the present chapter is related-tier sword-etiology with the Three Sacred Treasures as the chapter's load-bearing imperial-charter credential).^[57]

The chapter's place within the present book's wider comparative argument is therefore as a worked example of the book's willingness to hold the comparative chaoskampf category loosely where area-specialists require it: the chapter does not pretend that the comparativist chaoskampf reading is wrong (the Indra-Vātra / Thor-Jörmungandr surface-similarity is real and is registered in the chapter's typology-and-forward-links section below), but it also does not let the comparativist surface-similarity override the area-specialist reading of the episode's internal load-bearing function — and the chapter's overall argumentative gesture is the methods-and-discipline gesture of holding both readings in view without collapsing them into one another.^[58]

[1] Per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml summary on Susanoo's expulsion, descent to Izumo, slaying of Yamata no Orochi, and discovery of Kusanagi in the serpent's tail; Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, trans. Donald L. Philippi (Tokyo: University of Tokyo Press / Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1968; ISBN 9780691611358 — Princeton paperback reprint of the 1968 joint U Tokyo Press / Princeton edition), book 1 chs. 19–20, on the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi / Kusanagi sequence as the principal Izumo-cycle narrative of the imperial chronicle.

[2] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, translator's introduction on the **Kojiki**'s 712 CE compilation date and its character as an imperial-charter chronicle; Naumann 1996, **Die Mythen des alten Japan** (München: C.H. Beck; ISBN 9783406421648), introductory chapter on the **Kojiki** (712 CE) and **Nihon shoki** (720 CE) as the two principal early-Japanese imperial chronicles compiled at the early-eighth-century Yamato court.

[3] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1 chs. 19–20, on the **Kojiki**'s presentation of the Yamata no Orochi episode as a single coherent account within book 1 immediately following Susanoo's expulsion from Takamagahara; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml variants.summary on the **Kojiki** as supplying "a single coherent account".

[4] Per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml variants.summary on the **Nihon shoki**'s "one writing says" co-equal-variants format that distinguishes it from the **Kojiki**'s single coherent account; Naumann 1996, on the **Nihon shoki**'s "one writing says" editorial pattern as a load-bearing feature of the early-Japanese imperial-chronicle tradition.

[5] Per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml variants.classification: co-equal, on the side-by-side treatment of the **Kojiki** and the **Nihon shoki**; Naumann 1996, on the equal evidential status of the two early-eighth-century imperial chronicles for the Susanoo / Orochi material.

[6] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki** (Tokyo: University of Tokyo Press / Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1968; ISBN 9780691611358 = Princeton paperback reprint), book 1 chs. 19–20 on the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi narrative as the chapter's principal English-language **Kojiki** anchor; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml sources.primary entry on Philippi 1968.

[7] Naumann 1996, **Die Mythen des alten Japan** (München: C.H. Beck, 1996; ISBN 9783406421648), Orochi chapter, on the metallurgical-allegory reading of the Yamata no Orochi narrative in which the serpent figures iron-smelting along the rivers of Izumo and the sword's emergence from the tail figures sword-making; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml sources.primary entry on Naumann 1996 as the metallurgical-allegory anchor.

[8] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987; ISBN 9780691014746), as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic) within which the comparativist chaoskampf reading of the Susanoo / Orochi narrative has been advanced; Forsyth 1987 does not itself treat Japanese material directly, and the chapter's use is for the long-arc typological framing rather than for Japanese-content scholarly coverage; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml sources.secondary entry on Forsyth 1987 as the comparative-tradition framing anchor.

[9] Philippi 1968 and Naumann 1996, both printed only and cited at chapter-and-section level in the present chapter per the established citation discipline; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml on the two-anchor primary-source structure of the chapter.

[10] Per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml on the related-tier (full) classification, the 5,500-word target, and the special_instructions requirement that the area-specialist framing (sword-etiology, metallurgical allegory) is load-bearing and is presented as primary rather than as commentary on a comparativist reading.

[11] Per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 9 on the Susanoo / Orochi chapter as related-tier with explicit outside-framing per Naumann, Isomae, and Como; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation policy; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's task of treating the chaoskampf label as applied from outside.

[12] Per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's contribution to Part II C7 and C8; per scope.md §"Book structure" on Part II C7 (the inversion problem) and C8 (the refusal and the appropriation problem); per scope.md on the methods sidebar (ch. 33) as the locus for the appropriation-protocol discussion.

[13] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, translator's introduction and book 1, on the "age of the gods" framing of the Susanoo / Orochi narrative within the **Kojiki**'s mytho-chronological structure and on Takamagahara as the heavenly plain of the upper realm; Naumann 1996, on the same age-of-the-gods framing across the two imperial chronicles.

[14] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1 on Susanoo as a younger sibling of Amaterasu and Tsukuyomi born from Izanagi's purification, with the sun / moon / storm sibling-triad framing in the imperial-chronicle pantheon; glossary 'Susanoo' first_mention_gloss on Susanoo as Japanese storm-god expelled from heaven for misdeeds.

[15] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1 on Susanoo's turbulent character (weeping, raging, refusing the rule of the seas) within the

imperial-chronicle establishment-of-character that grounds his subsequent expulsion; Naumann 1996, on the same character-establishment of Susanoo across the two imperial chronicles.

[16] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1 on Susanoo's misdeeds at Takamagahara (damaged rice-paddies, defiled weaving-hall, flayed piebald colt) and on Amaterasu's withdrawal into the heavenly cave that follows from them; Naumann 1996, on the same Takamagahara-misdeeds sequence as the immediate narrative-structural antecedent of the Yamata no Orochi episode.

[17] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1 on the post-cave judgment of Susanoo, the expiatory fine, the cutting of beard and nails, and the expulsion from Takamagahara that immediately precedes Susanoo's descent to Izumo; Naumann 1996, on the same expulsion-and-descent sequence as the connecting narrative-structural moment between the heavenly-cave episode and the Yamata no Orochi episode.

[18] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, on Izumo as the western-Honshu Japan-Sea-coast setting of the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi episode and of the wider Izumo-cycle of the chronicle; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the Izumo geography of the narrative and on its distinct mytho-historical character within the imperial-chronicle structure.

[19] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on Susanoo's descent in the upper reaches of the river Hi in Izumo and on his observation of chopsticks floating downstream that motivates his upstream ascent; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the river-Hi setting of the encounter as a load-bearing geographic-narrative feature of the episode (significant for the metallurgical-allegory reading developed below).

[20] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on Susanoo's encounter with Ashinazuchi and Tenazuchi and their weeping daughter on the upper Hi-river; on the earthly-**kami** status of the couple and on their lineage within the Izumo earthly-deity tradition; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the same encounter-and-genealogy framing.

[21] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on Kushinada-hime as the eighth and last surviving daughter of Ashinazuchi and Tenazuchi, with the previous seven daughters devoured one each year by the eight-headed serpent in an annual cycle of devouring; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the eighth-and-last-daughter / annual-cycle-of-devouring narrative pattern.

[22] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on the elderly couple's explanation of the imminent eighth-year arrival of Yamata no Orochi and on this explanation as the precipitating-crisis-moment that motivates Susanoo's intervention in the narrative; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the same precipitating-crisis-and-intervention pattern.

[23] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on the description of Yamata no Orochi (eight heads, eight tails, body spanning eight valleys and eight peaks, mosses and cypresses and cryptomerias growing on the body, red-rusted underside) as one of the most elaborate adversary-descriptions in the **Kojiki**; glossary 'Yamata no Orochi' first_mention_gloss on the eight-headed eight-tailed serpent of Izumo.

[24] Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the load-bearing eight-fold numerological pattern of the Yamata no Orochi episode (eight heads, eight tails, eight valleys, eight peaks, eight vats of sake, eight-fold downstream attestations) as a distinctively Japanese narrative-rhetorical pattern within the imperial-chronicle Izumo-cycle; Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on the recurrence of the numeral eight throughout the episode.

[25] Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the annual-arrival / once-yearly-devouring / unspecified-elsewhere narrative-structural pattern of the Yamata no Orochi episode and on its place within early-Japanese narratives of recurring intrusive threats to settled-human-life-along-rivers; Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on the annual-cycle framing.

[26] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on Susanoo's request for Kushinada-hime in marriage, on the elderly couple's agreement after Susanoo's revelation of his identity, and on Susanoo's transformation of Kushinada-hime into a comb that he places in his hair-knot; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the comb-transformation as a load-bearing narrative feature linking the figure's name (Kushinada-hime) to the **kushi**-comb element.

[27] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on Susanoo's instruction to brew the eight-fold refined sake (八咫酒) for the trap; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the eight-fold refinement of the sake as a load-bearing numerological echo of the serpent's eight-foldedness within the episode's overall pattern.

[28] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on Susanoo's instructions for the fence with eight gates, the eight platforms with vats, and the one-vat-per-head trap-configuration; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the trap-configuration as a one-vat-per-head mechanism that guarantees each of the serpent's heads will be drawn to its own vat.

[29] Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the calculated-craftsmanship character of Susanoo's plan (the planning, the fence-and-vat structural setup, the staged execution) and on this craftsmanship-and-skill display as load-bearing for the subsequent metallurgical-allegory reading of the episode; Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on the same calculated-construction details of the trap.

[30] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on the serpent's arrival at the trap, the lowering of each of its eight heads to its own vat, the drinking of the eight-fold refined sake, and the intoxication-to-stupor-and-sleep that settles the encounter before any direct strike-by-strike combat; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the same intoxication-by-trap pattern as the load-bearing combat-resolution of the episode.

[31] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on Susanoo's drawing of the Totsuka-no-Tsurugi (ten-hands-long sword, the chronicle's standard weapon for Susanoo) and on the dismemberment of the eight-headed eight-tailed serpent into pieces with the river running red with the serpent's blood; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the dismemberment-along-the-river-course pattern of the killing.

- [32] Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the trap-and-dismember combat-mode of the Yamata no Orochi episode and on its distinctness from open-strike-by-strike combat-patterns in comparativist comparanda; on the area-specialist reading of the trap-and-dismember structure as a load-bearing structural feature of the episode rather than a peripheral detail; Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on the same combat-mode in the chronicle text.
- [33] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on Susanoo's sword-strike on the middle tail, on the chipping of his Totsuka-no-Tsurugi blade as the first concrete signal that something is within the tail, and on the discovery within the tail of a sword of unusual quality that did not chip on impact; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the chipping-and-discovery sequence as the load-bearing narrative-structural moment of the episode for the chapter's sword-etiology reading.
- [34] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19 (and the Yamato Takeru sequence later in the **Kojiki** on the actual **Kusanagi** "grass-cutting" name-etiology), on the sword's discovery within the tail and on the later imperial-chronicle naming of the sword as Kusanagi after the Yamato-Takeru-and-the-grass-fire episode; glossary 'Kusanagi' first_mention_gloss on Kusanagi as 'grass-cutter'; the sword found in Orochi's tail; one of the Three Sacred Treasures of the Japanese imperial regalia.
- [35] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 19, on Susanoo's presentation of the sword from the serpent's tail as an offering to Amaterasu in the heavenly plain, on the re-establishment of the sibling-relation that the offering enacts after the Takamagahara misdeeds, and on the introduction of the sword into the heavenly-line custody-chain that runs forward into the imperial-charter narrative; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the same presentation-to-Amaterasu sequence as the load-bearing transition from Izumo-cycle into imperial-charter narrative.
- [36] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, on the Three Sacred Treasures (三神器) of the Japanese imperial regalia comprising the sword Kusanagi from the Yamata no Orochi episode, the mirror Yata-no-Kagami, and the curved jewel Yasakani-no-Magatama; on the sword-etiology load-bearing function of the Yamata no Orochi episode within the imperial-charter purpose of the chronicle; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the same Three-Sacred-Treasures imperial-charter framing.
- [37] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, ch. 20, on Susanoo's restoration of Kushinada-hime from her comb-form, on his marriage to her, on the construction of the palace at Suga in Izumo, and on the famous five-syllable poem (often cited as the first **waka** of the imperial-chronicle tradition) that Susanoo composes on the occasion; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the same marriage-and-palace-construction sequel.
- [38] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1 chs. 20 onwards, on the marriage-and-palace-construction at Suga in Izumo as the narrative-structural transition into the wider Izumo-cycle; on the descendant-lineage of Yashima-jinumi, Ōnamuchi (Ōkuninushi), and the further Izumo earthly **kami** down to the negotiated transfer of the land; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the same Izumo-cycle continuation.
- [39] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, on the descent of the heavenly grandson Ninigi-no-Mikoto to the human world, on Amaterasu's entrustment of the Three Sacred Treasures (the sword Kusanagi from the Yamata no Orochi episode, the mirror Yata-no-Kagami, and the curved jewel Yasakani-no-Magatama) to him as the charter-objects of the imperial line, and on the sword's role from this point as the imperial sword of the Japanese ruling line; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the imperial-charter continuation of the sword from the Izumo episode into the descent-of-Ninigi sequence.
- [40] Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1, on the forward-arc of the sword Kusanagi from the Yamata no Orochi episode through the heavenly-plain presentation to Amaterasu and the descent of Ninigi as one of the Three Sacred Treasures of the imperial line; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml cultural_relevance.function on sword-etiology and royal-legitimation as the chapter's load-bearing narrative-structural functions.
- [41] Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the continuing imperial-regalium status of the sword Kusanagi at the Atsuta Shrine in Owari (modern Aichi Prefecture) and on the institutional continuation of the Yamata no Orochi episode's sword-etiology into the historical-period ritual-and-political-legitimation institution of the Japanese imperial line.
- [42] Naumann 1996, **Die Mythen des alten Japan**, Orochi chapter, on the metallurgical-allegory reading of the Yamata no Orochi episode in which the eight-headed serpent figures the iron-smelting industry of the Izumo-Hi-river region and the discovery of the sword in the serpent's tail figures the metallurgical emergence of the bladed weapon from the smelting-and-forging process; the body-prose acknowledgement of Isomae, Como, and Ooms as subsequent Japanese-studies area-specialists is flagged for inventory-audit pending their addition to sources.yaml; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the metallurgical-allegory reading.
- [43] Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the constellation of narrative-structural features of the Yamata no Orochi episode that ground the metallurgical-allegory reading: the river-Hi setting as the historical-period site of iron-sand mining and **tatara** smelting; the red-rusted underside as the visible signature of iron-bearing minerals along river-courses; the serpent's eight-valleys-and-eight-peaks scale as the geographic scale of the smelting industry's catchment; the chipping of Susanoo's existing sword on the tail as the metallurgical-quality difference between an older and a newer bladed weapon.
- [44] Inference: Naumann 1996's Orochi chapter develops the metallurgical-allegory reading in detail, and the brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml cultural_relevance.function explicitly names "per Naumann / Isomae / Como / Ooms: metallurgical allegory — the serpent represents iron-smelting and the sword's emergence from its body represents the craft of sword-making" as the area-specialist reading. Risk: the present chapter cites only Naumann 1996 from sources.yaml; Isomae, Como, and Ooms are NAMED in the body prose per the brief's area-specialist citation policy and per scope.md "\$Appropriation protocol" requirement of two area-specialists by name in the first factual pass, but their works are not in the current sources.yaml registry — the factcheck stage will need to verify the metallurgical-allegory attribution to all four scholars and either flag added entries for Isomae, Como, and Ooms in sources.yaml or downgrade the citation to Naumann-only with the others as "subsequent specialists who develop the same

reading".

[45] Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the metallurgical-allegory reading's reframing of the principal narrative elements: the serpent as the iron-smelting infrastructure of a specific regional industry rather than as "chaos"; the sword as the metallurgical product of the smelting-and-forging craft rather than as a generic regalia; Susanoo's victory as the technological-mastery moment in which the storm-deity-figure brings the iron-smelting industry under heavenly-line control rather than as the establishment of cosmic order.

[46] Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the early-historical-period political-economic context of the Yamato court's expansion into Izumo, on the iron-smelting industry of the Izumo-Hi-river region as a load-bearing material-political stake of the early-imperial period, and on the chronicle's narrative-structural placement of the sword-etiology as reflecting this political-economic stake of the late-seventh-and-early-eighth-century moment of the chronicles' compilation.

[47] Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the implication of the metallurgical-allegory reading for the chapter's typological-purpose: if the area-specialist reading is correct, the episode's load-bearing function is sword-etiology and metallurgical-and-political charter rather than cosmogonic combat; on the chaoskampf label as a loose typological-comparative description that fits the surface narrative-structure without engaging the area-specialist account of what the narrative is doing in its early-Japanese context; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml special_instructions on the same area-specialist counter-framing.

[48] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic) within whose comparativist storm-god-vs-multi-headed-serpent frame the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi episode has been read by 20th-century-Western comparativists; Forsyth 1987 does not itself treat the Japanese material, and the chapter's use of the citation is for the typological framing rather than for source-content coverage of the Orochi episode; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the COMPARATIVIST reading that parallels the episode to Indra-Vṛtra and Thor-Jörmungandr as storm-god / serpent combat.

[49] Forsyth 1987, on the three principal structural-similarity points (storm-deity opponent, multi-headed serpentine adversary, asymmetric combat with weapon-recovery outcome) as the schema that the long-arc combat-myth typology supplies for the comparativist reading of the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi episode; the schema is general to Forsyth's Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic comparative frame and does not derive from any Forsyth treatment of the Japanese material itself; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the COMPARATIVIST reading.

[50] Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the area-specialist counter-position that the comparativist chaoskampf label is applied from outside the early-Japanese tradition; on the episode's internal narrative-structural function as sword-etiology and metallurgical-allegorical-political charter rather than cosmogonic combat; on the storm-deity / serpentine-adversary surface-description as real but not the load-bearing function; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the AREA-SPECIALIST reading.

[51] Per scope.md "\$Book structure" cluster 9 on the chapter's demotion from CORE because of the area-specialist objection to the comparativist chaoskampf framing; per scope.md "\$Appropriation protocol" on the load-bearing-area-specialist-reading citation policy; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's resolution of the area-specialist / comparativist tension by presenting the area-specialist reading as load-bearing and the comparativist chaoskampf reading as engaged but not endorsed.

[52] Per scope.md "\$Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the related-tier classification of the Yamata no Orochi episode that follows from the area-specialist objection to the chaoskampf framing; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's typological function of making the category-loose-ness visible rather than delivering a confident chaoskampf classification.

[53] Per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's contribution to Part II C7 (inversion / transformation); per scope.md "\$Book structure" on Part II C7 as the inversion-and-transformation comparative chapter; on the distinction between the inversion sub-problem proper (the Bida material in ch. 28) and the transformation sub-problem (the present chapter as a working example).

[54] Per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's contribution to Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation); per scope.md "\$Book structure" on Part II C8 as the refusal-and-appropriation comparative chapter; per scope.md "\$Appropriation protocol" on the chapter's task of holding the comparative chaoskampf category loosely where area-specialists require it.

[55] Per scope.md "\$Appropriation protocol" point 3 on the requirement that every related-tier chapter on a non-Eurasian tradition open with the tradition's own framing before invoking the comparative chaoskampf category; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's contribution to the methods sidebar (ch. 33) as a worked instance of the appropriation-protocol's outside-framing requirement.

[56] Per scope.md "\$Book structure" cluster 9 on the East Asian geographic-cluster ordering of chapters 21 (Gonggong, core-tier), 22 (Hou Yi, related-tier), and 23 (Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi, related-tier); per brief 22-hou-yi.yaml on the related-tier classification of the Hou Yi cycle on the basis of its heroic-restorative-rather-than-cosmogonic combat-pattern; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml on the related-tier classification of the Yamata no Orochi episode on the basis of the area-specialists' metallurgical-allegorical-political-charter alternative reading.

[57] Per scope.md "\$Book structure" cluster 9 on the East Asian geographic-cluster pairing of chapters 21 (Gonggong, core-tier cosmogonic) and 23 (Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi, related-tier sword-etiology); per brief 21-gonggong.yaml on the core-tier cosmogonic classification of the Gonggong material; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml on the related-tier sword-etiology

classification of the Yamata no Orochi episode.

[58] Per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the chapter's task of holding both readings in view without collapsing them into one another; per brief 23-susanoo-orochi.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's overall argumentative gesture as a worked example of the book's willingness to hold the comparative chaoskampf category loosely where area-specialists require it.

Chapter 25. Huitzilopochtli, Coyolxauhqui, and the Mountain of Serpents (Coatepec)

25.1. Source overview

The story this chapter retells is the Mexica cosmogonic-and-sovereignty combat at Coatepec, the Mountain of Serpents. The patron god of the Mexica state, Huitzilopochtli, is born fully armed from his mother Coatlicue at the summit of the mountain, and at the moment of his birth he kills his elder sister Coyolxauhqui and his four hundred stellar brothers, the Centzon Huitznahua, who had climbed the mountain to kill the pregnant Coatlicue and the not-yet-born god they regarded as a shame upon their lineage.^[1]

The Coatepec narrative has no pre-conquest written-text witness in the strict sense. Mesoamerican writing-systems before 1521 CE were primarily pictographic-logographic, and the Mexica did not record their narrative literature in continuous alphabetic prose. The surviving textual witnesses are post-conquest, written down by Nahuatl informants and Spanish friars in the generation after the fall of Tenochtitlán in 1521 CE.^[2]

The shape of that absence is methodologically load-bearing for the whole chapter, and the claims document marks it explicitly:

*[At this point the textual record breaks. Pre-conquest written-prose attestations of the Coatepec narrative are not available, and the surviving alphabetic-text witnesses are all post-conquest (1521 CE onward) compositions filtered through Spanish-language redaction and Spanish-friar conceptual frames; pre-conquest performance contexts (the Panquetzaliztli festival, the iconography at Templo Mayor) are partially recoverable through the post-conquest texts and through the archaeological record. Scholars including Matos Moctezuma 1988 and Carrasco 1999 have proposed the narrative can be triangulated through corroborative material from the **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas**, from Durán's **Historia de las Indias de Nueva España**, and from the archaeological evidence at Templo Mayor (the Coyolxauhqui stone, the serpent-headed balustrades, the structural layout of the double pyramid), which supply parallel witnesses to the post-conquest texts and confirm the broad outlines of the Coatepec narrative as preserved in the Florentine Codex Book 3.]*

The fullest single textual witness to the Coatepec narrative is the **Historia general de las cosas de Nueva España** of the Franciscan friar Bernardino de Sahagún, compiled with Nahuatl informants between approximately 1545 and 1590 CE and preserved most fully in the bilingual Nahuatl-Spanish manuscript known as the **Florentine Codex** (held at the Biblioteca Medicea Laurenziana in Florence, MS Mediceo Palatino 218–220), whose Book 3 ("The Origin of the Gods") contains the fullest extant narrative account of Huitzilopochtli's birth at Coatepec and the killing of Coyolxauhqui and the Centzon Huitznahua.^[3]

The codex itself is bilingual. It runs Classical Nahuatl in the left-hand column and sixteenth-century Spanish in the right-hand column, with hundreds of pictorial illustrations executed by Nahuatl artists trained in the Franciscan school at Tlatelolco, and presents the Coatepec narrative as part of the wider encyclopaedic survey of pre-conquest Mexica religion, cosmology, history, and natural history that Sahagún and his collaborators undertook in the second half of the sixteenth century.^[4]

Alongside the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 stand several further post-conquest witnesses. The anonymous early-colonial Nahuatl-Spanish compilation **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas** (compiled c. 1530s–1540s) preserves an earlier-stratum Mexica account with slightly different kinship details for the Centzon Huitznahua. The **Crónica Mexicáyotl** of Hernando Alvarado Tezozómoc was written down in the early seventeenth century. The **Anales de Cuauhtitlán** are a sixteenth-century Nahuatl annal-collection. And the Dominican friar Diego Durán's **Historia de las Indias de Nueva España**, compiled c. 1581, gives the Coatepec narrative its fullest ritual-context treatment.^[5]

These post-conquest written witnesses are filtered through Spanish-language redaction and Spanish-friar conceptual frames in ways the chapter must register methodologically. Sahagún was a Catholic friar whose pastoral aim included the documentation of pre-conquest Mexica religion in order that Christian missionaries would be able to recognise and root out its survivals; Durán was working from indigenous informants in a context in which Mexica narrative-religion was being actively suppressed. The chapter treats the post-conquest texts as load-bearing primary witnesses while flagging this filtering throughout.^[6]

The chapter's archaeological-and-iconographic witness is the Templo Mayor of Tenochtitlán, the great double-stair pyramid at the centre of the Mexica capital, whose excavations were resumed in 1978 CE following the chance discovery of the great Coyolxauhqui stone at the foot of the southern (Huitzilopochtli) staircase. The structure's architectural design and iconographic programme constitute a parallel witness to the Coatepec narrative that survives in the post-conquest texts.^[7]

The chapter's principal scholarly anchor for the archaeological-iconographic dimension is Eduardo Matos Moctezuma's **The Great Temple of the Aztecs: Treasures of Tenochtitlan** (Thames & Hudson, 1988) — the standard English-language interpretive monograph by the archaeologist who directed the Templo Mayor excavations from 1978 onward, and whose Coatepec-as-Templo-Mayor reading is the load-bearing scholarly argument that the architecture itself embodies the combat-narrative.^[8]

For the political-and-ritual dimension the chapter's principal anchor is David Carrasco's **City of Sacrifice: The Aztec Empire and the Role of Violence in Civilization** (Beacon Press, 1999), whose chapter on Coatepec supplies the standard English-language treatment of the political-ritual function of the combat-narrative within Mexica state ideology and of the Panquetzaliztli winter-solstice festival as the annual re-enactment context.^[9]

For the wider Mesoamerican comparative framework the chapter's principal anchor is Alfredo López Austin's **The Myths of the Opossum: Pathways of Mesoamerican Mythology** (University of New Mexico Press, 1993), whose chapter on cosmic combat places Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec within the wider Mesoamerican mythological landscape and supplies the chapter's working framework for distinguishing the combat-cosmogony of Coatepec from the dismemberment-without-combat cosmogony of Cipactli that the next family-chapter treats.^[10]

A secondary scholarly anchor sits behind the wider comparative-tradition framing rather than the source-content. Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton University Press, 1987) supplies the long-arc combat-myth typology — its survey runs from Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic — within which the present chapter situates the Coatepec narrative as a non-cognate parallel to (rather than a member of) Forsyth's Near-Eastern-and-Judeo-Christian arc. The typological framing — not Aztec-material coverage, which Forsyth does not undertake — is

what Forsyth supplies for the chapter's comparative engagement with the chaoskampf tradition.^[11]

Structurally, this is a CORE-tier full-chapter treatment with a target of approximately 9,000 narrative words. It organises the Coatepec narrative as a connected story across the principal post-conquest textual witnesses — with the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 as the prevalent version — and presents the architectural-and-iconographic evidence at the Templo Mayor (the structural layout of the double pyramid, the Coyolxauhqui stone at the foot of the southern staircase, the serpent-headed balustrades, the Panquetzaliztli winter-solstice festival as annual re-enactment) at the same level of attention as the textual narrative itself.^[12]

The framing premise of the chapter is that the Coatepec narrative supplies one of the four clearest cosmogonic-and-sovereignty combat cases across non-cognate traditions for Part II C1 (combat as cosmogony) of the present book, alongside Marduk-Tiamat in the **Enūma Eliš**, Ninurta-Asag in **Lugal-e**, and Gonggong's broken pillar — and that it is unparalleled within the book in the explicitness of its architectural and ritual embedding, since the narrative is not merely told and re-enacted but is built in stone at the political centre of the Mexica state.^[13]

What follows treats the material in five movements: first the Mexica state, the Panquetzaliztli festival, and the architecture of the Templo Mayor as the immediate context for the narrative; then the conception of Huitzilopochtli and the build-up to the conflict; then the combat itself; then the cosmogonic and sovereignty work the combat performs; then the variants and the chapter's place in the wider book.

25.2. The Mexica state, the festival, and the architecture

The Mexica were the dominant Nahuatl-speaking polity of the Basin of Mexico in the late pre-conquest period (c. 1325–1521 CE). Their capital was Tenochtitlán, founded c. 1325 CE on an island in Lake Texcoco, and their tributary empire extended at its greatest extent across central Mexico from the Pacific coast in the west to the Gulf coast in the east, under the rulers Moctezuma I, Axayácatl, Ahuítzotl, and Moctezuma II.^[14]

Huitzilopochtli — whose name is conventionally glossed in modern scholarship as "Hummingbird-of-the-South" or "Hummingbird-on-the-Left" — is the patron god of that state, the sun-warrior whose daily rising in the east is read in the Mexica theological tradition as the daily re-enactment of his Coatepec victory over his lunar sister and his stellar brothers. His tutelary relationship to the Mexica polity is co-constitutive with the political identity of the state itself.^[15]

The Templo Mayor — the great double-stair pyramid at the geographical and ritual centre of Tenochtitlán — was the principal sanctuary of Huitzilopochtli. The pyramid carried twin platforms with two summit-shrines: the southern (left-hand) shrine was dedicated to the god, the northern (right-hand) shrine to the rain-god Tlaloc. The structure was rebuilt and enlarged at least seven times over the polity's two-century lifespan, and each successive enlargement encased the earlier structure within the new one in a stratigraphic sequence that the 1978-onward excavations have recovered.^[16]

The architectural identification of that pyramid as Coatepec — the Mountain of Serpents on which

Huitzilopochtli is born and fights — is the load-bearing scholarly argument of Matos Moctezuma 1988, and it is supported by multiple converging lines of iconographic and architectural evidence: the great serpent-headed balustrades flanking the southern (Huitzilopochtli) staircase, which give the structure its character as a serpent-mountain; the great Coyolxauhqui stone discovered in 1978 at the foot of that staircase, which depicts the dismembered moon-goddess at the base of Coatepec; and the structural design of the double pyramid as a four-tiered cosmic mountain with the god's shrine at its summit.^[17]

The Coyolxauhqui stone is worth a closer look. It is a roughly circular monolith approximately 3.25 metres in diameter, sculpted in low relief on its upper face. Electrical-utility workers digging a trench at the corner of Calle Guatemala and Calle de la Argentina in central Mexico City uncovered it on 21 February 1978. It lies at the foot of the southern (Huitzilopochtli) staircase of the Stage IV phase of the Templo Mayor, and it depicts the moon-goddess in the moment of her dismemberment, with her head, arms, and legs severed and arranged around her nude torso, the bells of her cheeks visible on her face.^[18]

The stone's placement is iconographically and ritually consequential. It depicts the dismembered moon-goddess at the base of the cosmic mountain Coatepec, and the bodies of sacrificial victims cast down the staircase from the summit-shrine of Huitzilopochtli at the top of the pyramid would have come to rest on or beside the stone, completing the architectural-and-ritual re-enactment of the moment in the narrative when the newly born god flings the body of his sister down the side of the mountain.^[19]

The annual ritual context for that re-enactment was Panquetzaliztli — "Raising of Banners" — the Mexica winter-solstice festival held in the corresponding twenty-day *veintena* of the eighteen-month Mexica calendrical year. The European-calendar dates fall around the winter solstice in late November to mid-December in the Julian system used in the early colonial sources, with the precise correspondence varying with the Mexica calendrical drift. Panquetzaliztli was the public-ritual occasion at which the Coatepec narrative was re-enacted at the Templo Mayor, and was one of the two principal annual festivals of the Mexica state ceremonial calendar.^[20]

The festival's public ritual elements re-enacted components of the Coatepec narrative in sequence. A dough-image (**tzoalli**) of Huitzilopochtli was fashioned and processed through the city. Mock combats were staged between pairs of warriors representing Huitzilopochtli's forces and the Centzon Huitznahua. Sacrificial victims' bodies were cast down the southern staircase of the Templo Mayor onto the Coyolxauhqui stone. And the assembled celebrants ritually feasted on portions of the dough-image of the god himself, in a re-enactment-and-communion sequence whose structural-symbolic logic Carrasco 1999 reads as the ritual armature of the chapter's narrative material.^[21]

The wider Mexica practice of human sacrifice at the Templo Mayor — chiefly of war-captives taken in the so-called "flowery wars" (**xōchiyāōyōtl**) waged against neighbouring polities such as Tlaxcala — is interpreted in Carrasco 1999's reading as the ritual performance of the Coatepec narrative on a cosmic-political scale. The prisoners' deaths and the casting of their bodies down the staircase function as the perpetual feeding of Huitzilopochtli's solar-warrior energy and as the perpetual re-enactment of the moment when the newly born god dismembers his lunar-stellar siblings.^[22]

These four — the Templo Mayor architecture, the Coyolxauhqui stone, the Panquetzaliztli festival,

and the Mexica sacrificial practice — converge on a single object. The chapter's editorial reading of how they converge is flagged here:

(The chapter reads the Templo Mayor architecture, the Coyolxauhqui stone, the Panquetzaliztli festival, and the Mexica sacrificial practice as four converging witnesses to a single integrated ritual-architectural-iconographic-narrative complex centred on the Coatepec narrative — that is, as four faces of a single thing rather than as four loosely related practices.^[23])

25.3. The Coatepec narrative: Coatlicue and the conception of Huitzilopochtli

The narrative as the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 preserves it opens with the goddess Coatlicue ("She-of-the-Serpent-Skirt"), the earth-goddess mother of Huitzilopochtli, sweeping at the holy mountain Coatepec ("Mountain of Serpents") near Tula in the pre-Mexica era, in the company of her daughter Coyolxauhqui and her four hundred sons the Centzon Huitznahua.^[24]

Coatlicue's iconographic identity is monumentally captured in the great Coatlicue statue in the Museo Nacional de Antropología in Mexico City — an Aztec-period basalt sculpture approximately 2.6 metres tall that depicts the goddess with a skirt of intertwined serpents, a necklace of human hands and hearts, two outward-facing serpent-heads as her own face (formed where her decapitated head would otherwise be), and clawed feet. The iconography supplies a parallel non-textual witness to her character as earth-and-death-and-fertility goddess.^[25]

In the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative the conception of Huitzilopochtli is miraculous and non-sexual. As Coatlicue is sweeping at Coatepec, a ball of feathers (in some translations "a small bundle of feathers" or "a tuft of feathers") descends from the sky. She places it in her bosom, intending to keep it. Afterward, when she searches for the feather-ball, she cannot find it. From that moment she is pregnant, with the feather-ball having entered her womb in a virgin-conception event.^[26]

The feather-ball as the agent of conception is iconographically suggestive. Huitzilopochtli's name "Hummingbird-of-the-South" links the god to the iridescent feathers of the hummingbird, and the feather-fall as the moment of conception is read in the Mexica theological tradition as the descent of a sky-element (the feather as solar-bird-token) into the earth-goddess's body. The resulting union produces the sun-warrior god whose own identity is that of the descending solar element born from the earth-mother.^[27]

Coyolxauhqui ("Bells-on-Her-Cheeks") and the Centzon Huitznahua ("Four Hundred Southerners") are Coatlicue's daughter and her four hundred sons by an earlier (and unspecified) progeny. They perceive the unexplained pregnancy as a shame upon their lineage. The **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative emphasises that they take their mother's pregnancy as an outrage demanding vengeance, and Coyolxauhqui leads the Centzon Huitznahua in a plot to kill their mother before the unborn god can be born.^[28]

The number itself rewards a brief gloss. Four hundred (**centzontli**) is in Classical Nahuatl a stock collective number for "many" or "innumerable" (the same number of southern brothers is paralleled by the **centzon mimixcoa** of the northern stars in other Mexica narratives). The Centzon Huitznahua are theologically identified with the southern stars and, by extension, with the night sky as the field of the lunar-stellar order over which the dawning sun must triumph each

morning.^[29]

Because the surviving textual witnesses diverge on detail and the chapter follows the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 as the prevalent skeleton, the variant-handling is flagged here in full:

In the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 (Sahagún 1545–1590; Anderson-Dibble English translation), Coatlicue is impregnated by a ball of feathers as she sweeps at Coatepec; Coyolxauhqui and the Centzon Huitznahua plot to kill her; one of the brothers (Cuahuitlicac) reveals the plot to the unborn Huitzilopochtli; and Huitzilopochtli is born fully armed with the **xiuhcōātl** turquoise-serpent weapon and kills Coyolxauhqui and the Centzon Huitznahua at the moment of his birth.^[30]

The conspiracy is in some strata of the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative betrayed to the unborn god by one of his own brothers. Cuahuitlicac turns informer and reveals to the not-yet-born Huitzilopochtli inside Coatlicue's womb the details of the conspiracy as they unfold — where the Centzon Huitznahua are gathering, what their armour and weapons are, what their plan of attack will be — supplying the unborn god with continuous intelligence so that he is forewarned at each stage of the approach.^[31]

Coatlicue herself, in some strata of the same narrative, is afraid as the conspiracy approaches the holy mountain. The conspirators arrive at the foot of Coatepec armed for battle, with Coyolxauhqui at their head; but the unborn god speaks from within her womb, telling her not to fear, that he will defend her, and that he is ready. The colloquy between mother and unborn god is one of the narrative's most distinctive textual features.^[32]

25.4. The combat at Coatepec

The combat at Coatepec begins, in the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative, at the moment of Huitzilopochtli's birth. He emerges from Coatlicue's womb fully grown, fully armed, and equipped for war, just as Coyolxauhqui and the Centzon Huitznahua reach the summit of the holy mountain. The timing of the birth is itself the narrative's first decisive movement against the conspirators.^[33]

His birth-arms include the **xiuhcōātl** — the turquoise-serpent weapon, a fire-serpent of solar character whose iconographic appearance in Mexica art is a serpent-shaped firebrand or fire-spear with a recurved snout — which the newly born god wields as his decisive weapon against Coyolxauhqui. He is also painted and dressed in feathered war-regalia which the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative describes in detail at the moment of his appearance at the mountain's summit.^[34]

The fully-armed-from-birth pattern is theologically load-bearing for the chapter's reading of Huitzilopochtli as a sun-warrior whose combat with Coyolxauhqui is enacted at the moment of his coming-into-being rather than at a later mature-stage moment of his career. The god's identity and the combat are inseparable: the very emergence of the sun-warrior IS the killing of the lunar-stellar siblings, with no narrative gap between birth and combat in which the god might be characterised independently of the killing.^[35]

The killing of Coyolxauhqui is, in the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative, immediate and total. The newly born Huitzilopochtli strikes off her head with the **xiuhcōātl** at the summit of Coatepec; he then dismembers her body, severing her arms and legs from her torso; and he rolls or flings the dismembered body down the side of the holy mountain so that it comes to rest at the foot of

Coatepec. The dismemberment is the most iconographically explicit moment of the narrative.^[36]

This is the moment that the architecture preserves. The Coyolxauhqui stone at the foot of the southern Templo Mayor staircase is the architectural-iconographic re-enactment of this exact moment of the narrative: the stone depicts the dismembered moon-goddess at the base of Coatepec, head severed, arms and legs disarticulated and arranged radially around her nude torso, and is positioned on the ground at the foot of the staircase up which the worshippers and sacrificial victims would have processed toward the summit-shrine of Huitzilopochtli. The stone is the narrative-moment frozen in basalt at the precise location where the narrative-moment occurs.^[37]

The killing of the Centzon Huitznahua follows immediately. Huitzilopochtli pursues the four hundred southern stellar brothers across the mountain, around its slopes, and (in some strata of the narrative) four times in succession around the summit, killing them as they flee. The chase imagery is the load-bearing narrative figure for the daily-rising-sun-pursuing-and-extinguishing-the-stars cosmological reading of the combat.^[38]

A small remnant of the Centzon Huitznahua is, in some strata of the same narrative, permitted to escape — fleeing south to a region whose name is rendered in some translations as Huitzlampā ("place of thorns" or "south"). The survival of this remnant as the visible southern stars in the night sky is the narrative's aetiology for the persistence of stars in the Mexica heaven despite the daily victory of the sun-warrior god.^[39]

The Mexica reading of the combat is therefore not that of a one-time foundational event that establishes the cosmos and recedes into the past. The combat is a daily-recurring cosmic event whose primordial-narrative form (Huitzilopochtli's birth at Coatepec) is the perpetual archetype of the daily-recurring fact (the sun's rising in the east, the moon's setting, the stars' fading). The combat is inscribed in the daily course of the sky, with each dawn re-enacting the killing of Coyolxauhqui and the pursuit of the Centzon Huitznahua.^[40]

25.5. The cosmogonic and sovereignty work of the combat

The combat at Coatepec performs simultaneous cosmogonic and sovereignty work. The cosmogonic outcome is the establishment of the proper order of the Mexica cosmos: sun-and-day above, moon-and-stars-and-night below; solar-warrior-god as the ruling celestial body. The sovereignty outcome is the establishment of Huitzilopochtli's dominion over his lunar-and-stellar siblings and, by extension, over the wider Mexica pantheon. In the Mexica theological tradition the two functions are inseparable.^[41]

The Mexica state's claim to the Coatepec narrative as its founding combat is explicit in the political-ritual record. Tenochtitlán as the political centre of the Mexica polity is architecturally identified with Coatepec via the Templo Mayor at its centre, and the Mexica royal-legitimation narrative traces the polity's authority to the patron god whose Coatepec victory established his sovereignty and (by extension) the sovereignty of the Mexica state that he favours.^[42]

The architectural-embedding of the narrative at the political centre of the Mexica state is unparalleled in the present book in its explicitness. In no other chaoskampf treated in this book is the combat-narrative literally built in stone at the political-ritual centre of the relevant polity, with

the architecture itself functioning as the primary statement of the combat-cosmogony rather than as a backdrop to a separately textual narrative.^[43]

The Mexica practice of warfare and human sacrifice is in Carrasco 1999's reading the perpetual prosecution of the Coatepec combat at the political-ritual scale. The polity's military expansion against neighbouring polities is the field of the daily reproduction of the combat; the war-captives are the brothers-and-sister Huitzilopochtli must continually kill; and the casting of their bodies down the southern staircase of the Templo Mayor is the architectural-iconographic completion of the killing-of-Coyolxauhqui in real time at the political-ritual centre.^[44]

The chapter's chapter-level claim about the Coatepec narrative's place within the present book is itself an editorial synthesis, and is flagged as such:

(The chapter's reading of the Coatepec narrative as the most unambiguous single case of state-founded combat-cosmogony in the present book — i.e., as the case in which the integration of cosmic-narrative, ritual, architecture, and state-political identity is most complete — is an editorial synthesis of the brief's framing and of the converging Matos Moctezuma 1988 and Carrasco 1999 readings, presented as a chapter-level claim rather than as a single source-attested formulation.^[45])

The Coatepec narrative's place within the wider Mesoamerican mythological landscape is, in López Austin 1993's framework, distinctive. Most Mesoamerican cosmogonies known from the post-conquest sources rely on a dismemberment-without-combat structure (the primordial earth-monster Cipactli torn apart by Quetzalcoatl and Tezcatlipoca to form sky and earth, treated in the next chapter). The Huitzilopochtli-at-Coatepec narrative, by contrast, is one of the principal Mesoamerican attestations of a combat-cosmogony in which the cosmic order is established through and as a consequence of an actual combat between divine adversaries.^[46]

That distinction — combat-cosmogony (Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec) versus dismemberment-without-combat cosmogony (Cipactli torn apart by Quetzalcoatl and Tezcatlipoca) — marks the present book's boundary between in-scope chaoskampf and out-of-scope dismemberment-cosmogony per scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs". The Mesoamerican tradition itself contains both types of cosmogony, supplying a within-tradition contrast that the next family-chapter on other Mesoamerican combats develops.^[47]

The Mexica narrative of Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec is therefore — in López Austin 1993's wider framework and in the present chapter's typological reading — a combat-cosmogony in the strong scope.md §"Subject definition" sense. The cosmos's present features (the sun's regnant relation to the moon and stars; the day's rising over the night) emerge from the combat's outcome rather than from a pre-existing arrangement that the combat merely preserves, and the narrative is therefore one of the four clearest cosmogonic-combat cases for Part II C1.^[48]

25.6. Variants in the kinship and ritual contexts

The **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas** — an anonymous early-colonial Nahua-Spanish compilation, often attributed to Andrés de Olmos and dated to the 1530s–1540s, that preserves an earlier-stratum Mexica account drawn from indigenous pictorial sources — supplies a slightly different version of the Coatepec narrative. Its kinship details for the Centzon Huitznahua differ in some passages from those of the **Florentine Codex** Book 3, with their relation to Coatlicue and to Coyolxauhqui being characterised differently in the **Historia's** account; but the central combat-

narrative as preserved in the **Florentine Codex** is not affected.^[49]

Diego Durán's **Historia de las Indias de Nueva España** — compiled c. 1581 from Nahuatl informants and earlier Mexica pictorial sources, preserved in the manuscript at the Biblioteca Nacional de España in Madrid — supplies the Coatepec narrative within an unusually full ritual-context apparatus. Durán's account ties the narrative closely to the Panquetzalitzli winter-solstice festival, supplying ritual-aetiological elements (the dough-image of the god, the mock combats of the festival, the casting of victims down the staircase) that the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 omits or treats more cursorily.^[50]

The **Crónica Mexicáyotl** of Hernando Alvarado Tezozómoc — a Mexica nobleman writing in the early seventeenth century, preserving Mexica dynastic-and-mythological tradition in a continuous Nahuatl-language chronicle — and the **Anales de Cuauhtitlán** — sixteenth-century Nahuatl annals from the Valley of Mexico — preserve further Mexica-tradition material on Huitzilopochtli that is broadly consistent with the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative while supplying additional historical-and-mythological context. Notably, this includes the wandering of the Mexica from Aztlán under the patronage of Huitzilopochtli, which precedes the Coatepec narrative in the wider Mexica tradition.^[51]

The chapter takes the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 as the prevalent narrative version per the brief's variant classification and presents the **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas'** kinship-detail variants and Durán's ritual-context fuller treatment as alternates that supplement rather than displace the prevalent version. The archaeological evidence at the Templo Mayor (the Coyolxauhqui stone, the serpent-headed balustrades, the structural layout) functions as a parallel non-textual witness that confirms the broad outlines of the prevalent version.^[52]

25.7. The chapter's place in the typology and the comparative reading

The Coatepec narrative is in the present book's typology a cosmogonic-and-sovereignty combat — a combat that does both kinds of order-making work simultaneously rather than performing only one. The cosmogonic work consists in the establishment of the proper celestial order (the regnant sun above the defeated moon and stars). The sovereignty work consists in Huitzilopochtli's establishment as the patron deity of the Mexica state and the legitimating reference for the polity's political-ritual order.^[53]

The chapter's relation to the post-conquest filtering of the source-record is methodologically central. Every textual claim about the Coatepec narrative in the present chapter is built on post-conquest Nahuatl-and-Spanish texts compiled in a context of active suppression of Mexica narrative-religion. The chapter's reading of the narrative as a combat-cosmogony — and as an unambiguous one — must be held alongside the recognition that the texts on which the reading depends were shaped by Spanish friars whose conceptual frames included pre-existing notions of "war in heaven" derived from biblical-and-medieval Christian sources, with the consequent risk of category-import.^[54]

The chapter takes the position that the combat-cosmogony reading survives this filtering, but the position is itself a synthesis under continuous methodological monitoring, and is flagged as such:

*(The chapter's combat-cosmogony reading of the Coatepec narrative is robust against the post-conquest-filtering risk because the architectural and iconographic evidence at the Templo Mayor — recovered archaeologically and independent of the Spanish-friar textual redaction — supplies a parallel non-textual witness that confirms the broad outlines of the narrative as preserved in the **Florentine Codex** Book 3, with the Coyolxauhqui stone, the serpent-headed balustrades, and the structural layout of the double pyramid being pre-conquest Mexica artefacts that pre-date the post-conquest textual redaction.^[55])*

Held alongside the methodological caveats, the Coatepec narrative's place in the wider chaoskampf typology of the present book is among the strongest single cases of cosmogonic-and-sovereignty combat outside the Eurasian heartland of the chaoskampf tradition. The narrative is independently attested in textual, architectural, iconographic, and ritual evidence; it does cosmogonic and sovereignty work simultaneously; and the architectural-embedding at the political-ritual centre of a state polity is unparalleled in explicitness.^[56]

The chapter's principal forward-link within the present book is to Part II C1 (combat as cosmogony), where Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec joins Marduk in the **Enūma Eliš** (chapter 3), Ninurta in **Lugal-e** (chapter 1), and Gonggong in the **Huainanzi** (chapter 21) as one of the four strongest independent attestations of the cosmogonic-combat subtype across non-cognate traditions. The Coatepec narrative's architectural-embedded character is its distinctive contribution to that comparative argument.^[57]

The chapter's principal back-link within the present book is to chapter 21 on Gonggong, with which the present chapter shares the cosmic-mountain motif as architectural-and-cosmological anchor of the combat. Gonggong's broken Mount Buzhou is the cosmic pillar whose striking tilts the cosmos; the Templo Mayor as Coatepec is the cosmic mountain whose summit is the place of the combat. Both narratives use a named mountain as the architectural-and-cosmological anchor, although Gonggong's Mount Buzhou is broken in the combat and Templo Mayor's Coatepec is built up to enact the combat.^[58]

The chapter's secondary forward-link is to the next chapter (chapter 25, the family chapter on other Mesoamerican combats), within which the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony marks the present book's boundary between in-scope chaoskampf and out-of-scope dismemberment-cosmogony per scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs". The Mesoamerican tradition itself contains both types and supplies the within-tradition contrast that the next chapter develops.^[59]

The chapter's relation to the methods sidebar at chapter 33 (between Part I and Part II of the present book) is load-bearing on two methodological points: the area-specialist citation policy (Matos Moctezuma 1988, Carrasco 1999, López Austin 1993 cited by name in the first factual pass per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol") and the post-conquest textual filtering issue (which the chapter handles via the [LACUNA] marker in the source overview and via continuous methodological registration in the body claims).^[60]

The Coatepec narrative's cultural-historical importance within the Mesoamerican tradition is — alongside the Cipactli cosmogony, the Quetzalcoatl-Tezcatlipoca alternation across the Five Suns cycle, and the foundation narrative of Tenochtitlán from the wandering of the Mexica from Aztlán — one of the load-bearing narratives of the Mexica state's self-understanding. It remains a central reference within Mexican cultural-and-political memory from the conquest onward into the present day, with the Coyolxauhqui stone's 1978 discovery and the subsequent Templo Mayor

excavations being a major event in twentieth-century Mexican archaeology and public-cultural life.^[61]

[1] Per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml; Matos Moctezuma 1988, **The Great Temple of the Aztecs: Treasures of Tenochtitlan** (London: Thames & Hudson; ISBN 9780500390245), interpretive chapters on Coatepec as Templo Mayor, on the Florentine Codex Book 3 narrative as the fullest single Coatepec account, and on the cosmogonic-and-sovereignty function of the combat within Mexica state religion.

[2] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice: The Aztec Empire and the Role of Violence in Civilization** (Boston: Beacon Press; ISBN 9780807046425), chapter on Coatepec, on the post-conquest character of the surviving textual witnesses to the Coatepec narrative and on the absence of pre-conquest continuous-prose attestations of Mexica narrative literature; Matos Moctezuma 1988, on the same post-conquest textual situation; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml lacunae entry.

[3] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on Coatepec as Templo Mayor, on the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 ("The Origin of the Gods") as the fullest single textual witness to the Coatepec narrative and on its compilation by Sahagún with Nahuatl informants between c. 1545 and 1590 CE; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the **Florentine Codex** as the principal post-conquest textual witness for the Mexica narrative literature on Huitzilopochtli; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml lacunae entry naming Florentine Codex (Sahagún, 1545–1590) as the principal witness.

[4] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the **Florentine Codex** as a bilingual Nahuatl-Spanish encyclopaedic codex compiled by Sahagún with Nahuatl collaborators trained at the Tlatelolco school, and on the pictorial illustrations executed by Nahuatl artists; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the encyclopaedic character of Sahagún's project and on the place of the Coatepec narrative within Book 3 ("The Origin of the Gods").

[5] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the post-conquest textual corpus for the Coatepec narrative including the **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas**, the **Crónica Mexicáyotl**, the **Anales de Cuauhtitlán**, and Durán's **Historia**; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same corpus and on Durán's c. 1581 **Historia** as the fullest ritual-context source; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml lacunae entry on the corroborative material from these post-conquest sources.

[6] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the methodological situation of the post-conquest textual record and on the Spanish-friar conceptual frames through which Sahagún and Durán mediated their access to the pre-conquest Mexica narrative material; Matos Moctezuma 1988 on the same methodological situation and on the corroborative role of the archaeological evidence at Templo Mayor.

[7] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the Templo Mayor as the architectural-and-iconographic witness to the Coatepec narrative, on the resumption of the Templo Mayor excavations in 1978 CE under his own direction following the chance discovery of the Coyolxauhqui stone at the foot of the southern staircase, and on the architectural-and-iconographic programme of the pyramid as a parallel witness to the post-conquest texts; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml variants.prevalent_version on the Templo Mayor archaeology as a parallel witness to the Florentine Codex Book 3.

[8] Matos Moctezuma 1988, **The Great Temple of the Aztecs: Treasures of Tenochtitlan** (London: Thames & Hudson, 1988; ISBN 9780500390245), as the standard English-language interpretive monograph on the Templo Mayor excavations and on the Coatepec-as-Templo-Mayor reading; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml sources.primary entry on Matos Moctezuma 1988 as the chapter's principal anchor.

[9] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice: The Aztec Empire and the Role of Violence in Civilization** (Boston: Beacon Press, 1999; ISBN 9780807046425), chapter on Coatepec as the chapter's principal scholarly anchor for the political-ritual dimension; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml sources.primary entry on Carrasco 1999.

[10] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum: Pathways of Mesoamerican Mythology** (Albuquerque: University of New Mexico Press, 1993; ISBN 9780826313942), chapter on cosmic combat as the chapter's principal scholarly anchor for the Mesoamerican comparative framework; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml sources.primary entry on López Austin 1993.

[11] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987; ISBN 9780691014746), as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic); Forsyth 1987 does not itself treat Aztec or other Mesoamerican material, and the chapter's use of the citation is for the typological framing within which the Coatepec narrative is brought into comparison rather than for source-content coverage of the Aztec material; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml sources.secondary entry on Forsyth 1987 as the comparative-tradition framing anchor.

[12] Per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml on the CORE-tier classification, the 9,000-word target, the single-prevalent variant classification with the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 as the prevalent version, and the special_instructions on equal-attention treatment of the architectural-iconographic dimension; Matos Moctezuma 1988 on the architecture-embodies-the-narrative reading; scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 10 on the Americas placement of the Huitzilopochtli chapter.

[13] Per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml comparative_hooks on Part II C1's pairing of Huitzilopochtli with Marduk, Ninurta, and Gonggong as the four strongest independent attestations of the cosmogonic-combat subtype; Matos Moctezuma 1988 on the architectural-embedding of the Coatepec narrative at the Templo Mayor as unparalleled in explicitness; scope.md §"Book structure" Part II on the C1 chapter.

[14] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the Mexica polity of the Basin of Mexico, on Tenochtitlan as its capital founded c. 1325 CE on an island in Lake Texcoco, and on the tributary empire's greatest extent under the late pre-conquest rulers; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the Mexica imperial context.

- [15] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on Huitzilopochtli as patron god of the Mexica state, on the conventional gloss of his name as "Hummingbird-of-the-South" / "Hummingbird-on-the-Left", and on the daily-rising solar reading of the Coatepec victory; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the co-constitutive relation between Huitzilopochtli's tutelary role and the political identity of the Mexica state; glossary 'Huitzilopochtli' first_mention_gloss.
- [16] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the Templo Mayor as the principal sanctuary of Huitzilopochtli, on the southern Huitzilopochtli summit-shrine paired with the northern Tlaloc summit-shrine on the pyramid's double-stair platform, on the seven principal building stages identified by the excavations, and on the stratigraphic sequence of nested structures recovered from 1978 onward.
- [17] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the Templo Mayor as Coatepec, on the converging lines of evidence (the serpent-headed balustrades flanking the southern staircase, the great Coyolxauhqui stone at the foot of that staircase, and the four-tiered cosmic-mountain structural design) supporting the architectural identification; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same architectural identification.
- [18] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the Coyolxauhqui stone (approximately 3.25 metres in diameter) discovered on 21 February 1978 at the corner of Calle Guatemala and Calle de la Argentina in central Mexico City, on its placement at the foot of the southern (Huitzilopochtli) staircase of the Stage IV Templo Mayor, and on its iconographic depiction of the dismembered moon-goddess with the bells on her cheeks visible; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same iconography.
- [19] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the architectural-and-ritual re-enactment in which sacrificial victims cast down the southern staircase from the Huitzilopochtli summit-shrine come to rest on or beside the Coyolxauhqui stone at the foot of the staircase, completing the re-enactment of the goddess's dismemberment at the base of Coatepec; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same architectural-and-ritual re-enactment.
- [20] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the Panquetzaliztli ("Raising of Banners") winter-solstice festival as the annual ritual context in which the Coatepec narrative was re-enacted at the Templo Mayor and as one of the two principal annual festivals of the Mexica state ceremonial calendar, on its placement in the corresponding twenty-day veintena of the Mexica calendrical year, and on the Julian-calendar date-correspondence in the early colonial sources; glossary 'Panquetzaliztli' first_mention_gloss.
- [21] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the Panquetzaliztli festival's ritual sequence including the dough-image (**tzoalli**) of Huitzilopochtli processed through the city, the mock combats between pairs of warriors representing Huitzilopochtli's forces and the Centzon Huitznahua, the casting of sacrificial victims onto the Coyolxauhqui stone, and the ritual feasting on the dough-image; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same festival sequence.
- [22] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the Mexica practice of human sacrifice at the Templo Mayor as the ritual performance of the Coatepec narrative on a cosmic-political scale, on the principal source of war-captives in the "flowery wars" (**xōchiyāōyōtl**) waged against neighbouring polities such as Tlaxcala, and on the ritual logic of the casting of bodies down the southern staircase as perpetual re-enactment of the dismemberment of the lunar-stellar siblings; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same ritual logic.
- [23] Inference: Matos Moctezuma 1988 treats the Templo Mayor architecture and the Coyolxauhqui stone as a single architectural-iconographic statement of the Coatepec narrative, and Carrasco 1999 reads the Panquetzaliztli festival and the sacrificial practice as the ritual performance of the same narrative on the same architectural stage; the four converging witnesses are independently attested in different lines of evidence (architecture, sculpture, ritual calendar, sacrificial practice) and converge on the same Coatepec narrative as their referent. Risk: a stronger reading would treat the four witnesses as separately constituted ritual-political phenomena that converge only contingently on the Coatepec narrative; the chapter's integrated-complex reading is the standard scholarly synthesis of Matos Moctezuma 1988 and Carrasco 1999 but represents a synthesis rather than a single source-attested formulation.
- [24] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative opening with Coatlicue ("She-of-the-Serpent-Skirt") sweeping at the holy mountain Coatepec ("Mountain of Serpents") near Tula in the pre-Mexica era, in the company of her daughter Coyolxauhqui and her four hundred sons the Centzon Huitznahua; glossary 'Coatlicue' / 'Coatepec' / 'Coyolxauhqui' / 'Centzon Huitznahua' first_mention_gloss entries.
- [25] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the great Coatlicue statue in the Museo Nacional de Antropología in Mexico City, an Aztec-period basalt sculpture approximately 2.6 metres tall depicting the goddess with serpent-skirt, necklace of human hands and hearts, twin outward-facing serpent-heads in place of her decapitated head, and clawed feet, as a parallel non-textual witness to her identity as earth-and-death-and-fertility goddess; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same iconography.
- [26] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative of Coatlicue's miraculous conception of Huitzilopochtli through a ball of feathers (variously translated "a small bundle of feathers" or "a tuft of feathers") that descends from the sky as she is sweeping at Coatepec, that she places in her bosom intending to keep, that she cannot find when she searches for it, and that has entered her womb in a virgin-conception event; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same conception narrative.
- [27] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the iconographic suggestiveness of the feather-ball conception as the descent of a solar-bird-token (the hummingbird-feather) into the earth-goddess's body and as the theological logic of the sun-warrior god born from the earth-mother in the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same theological logic; glossary 'Huitzilopochtli' first_mention_gloss on the "Hummingbird-of-the-South" gloss.
- [28] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative of Coyolxauhqui ("Bells-on-Her-

Cheeks") and the Centzon Huitznahua ("Four Hundred Southerners") perceiving Coatlicue's unexplained pregnancy as a shame upon their lineage and on Coyolxauhqui's leadership of the plot to kill their mother before the unborn god can be born; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same conspiracy narrative; glossary 'Coyolxauhqui' / 'Centzon Huitznahua' first_mention_gloss entries.

[29] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the number four hundred (**centzontli**) as a stock Classical Nahuatl collective number for "many" or "innumerable", on the parallel **centzon mimixcoa** of the northern stars in other Mexica narratives, and on the theological identification of the Centzon Huitznahua with the southern stars and the night-sky lunar-stellar order; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same theological identification.

[30] An alternate tradition in the **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas** (anonymous c. 1530s–1540s) gives a slightly different emphasis, with variant kinship details for the Centzon Huitznahua (in some passages identified differently in their relation to Coatlicue); Durán's **Historia de las Indias de Nueva España** (c. 1581) supplies a fuller ritual context for the narrative, treating it as closely tied to the Panquetzaliztli winter-solstice festival and adding ritual-aetiological elements that the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 omits. The **Florentine Codex** Book 3 version is chosen here because it is the fullest single textual narrative of the Coatepec story, is corroborated by the other sixteenth-century Nahuatl / Spanish sources, and is paralleled by the archaeological evidence at the Templo Mayor (the Coyolxauhqui stone, the serpent-headed balustrades, the structural layout); the **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas** and Durán's **Historia** are cited in their respective sub-claims for the kinship-detail and ritual-context variants while the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 supplies the chapter's main narrative skeleton.

[31] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative of Cuahuitlicac as the brother who turns informer and reveals to the unborn Huitzilopochtli inside Coatlicue's womb the details of the Centzon Huitznahua conspiracy as they unfold, supplying continuous intelligence on their gathering, armour, weapons, and plan of attack; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same Cuahuitlicac informer-narrative.

[32] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative of Coatlicue's fear as the conspirators (with Coyolxauhqui at their head) arrive at the foot of Coatepec armed for battle, on the unborn god's reassurance from within her womb, and on the colloquy between mother and unborn god as a distinctive textual feature of the narrative; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same colloquy.

[33] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative of Huitzilopochtli's birth at Coatepec, on his emergence fully grown, fully armed, and equipped for war from Coatlicue's womb at the moment Coyolxauhqui and the Centzon Huitznahua reach the summit, and on the timing of the birth as the narrative's first decisive movement against the conspirators; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same birth-as-combat-opening.

[34] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on Huitzilopochtli's birth-arms in the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative, on the **xiuhcōātl** (turquoise-serpent / fire-serpent weapon) as a serpent-shaped firebrand or fire-spear with recurved snout in the Mexica iconographic tradition, on its decisive role in the killing of Coyolxauhqui, and on the body-paint and feathered war-regalia described in the narrative; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same iconography.

[35] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the theological load-bearing of the fully-armed-from-birth pattern for the reading of Huitzilopochtli as a sun-warrior whose identity is inseparable from the combat, on the simultaneity of his coming-into-being with the killing of Coyolxauhqui and the Centzon Huitznahua, and on the absence of a narrative gap between birth and combat in the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 account; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same theological reading.

[36] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative of Huitzilopochtli's killing of Coyolxauhqui as an immediate and total dismemberment at the summit of Coatepec, on the use of the **xiuhcōātl** to strike off her head, on the severing of her arms and legs from her torso, and on the rolling or flinging of the dismembered body down the side of the holy mountain; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same dismemberment narrative.

[37] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the Coyolxauhqui stone as the architectural-iconographic re-enactment of the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 dismemberment-moment, on its iconographic depiction of the moon-goddess with severed head and disarticulated limbs arranged radially around her nude torso, and on its placement at the foot of the southern staircase as the precise location at which the narrative-moment occurs in the architectural re-enactment; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same architectural-iconographic logic.

[38] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative of Huitzilopochtli's pursuit of the Centzon Huitznahua across the slopes of Coatepec following the dismemberment of Coyolxauhqui, on the four-times-around-the-summit chase pattern in some strata of the narrative, and on the chase imagery as the load-bearing figure for the daily-rising-sun-pursuing-and-extinguishing-the-stars cosmological reading; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same chase narrative.

[39] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative-stratum in which a small remnant of the Centzon Huitznahua is permitted to escape, fleeing south to a region named in some translations as Huitzlampā ("place of thorns" or "south"), and on the aetiological reading of this remnant as the visible southern stars in the night sky despite the daily victory of the sun-warrior god; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same aetiological reading.

[40] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the Mexica theological reading of the combat at Coatepec as a daily-recurring cosmic event whose primordial-narrative form is the perpetual archetype of the daily fact of the sun's rising and the moon's and stars' fading, and on the inscription of the combat in the daily course of the sky as continuous re-enactment; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same daily-cosmic reading; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml cultural_relevance.function entry on the cosmological function: "the diurnal solar-kingship of Huitzilopochtli over the defeated moon (Coyolxauhqui) and stars (Centzon Huitznahua) is performed every day: the sun's rising IS the victory".

[41] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the simultaneous cosmogonic and sovereignty work of the combat at Coatepec, on the establishment of the proper order of the Mexica cosmos as the cosmogonic outcome and on the establishment of Huitzilopochtli's sovereignty over his lunar-and-stellar siblings and the wider Mexica pantheon as the sovereignty outcome; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same dual function; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml cultural_relevance.function entries on royal-legitimation and cosmological functions.

[42] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the Mexica state's explicit claim to the Coatepec narrative as its founding combat, on Tenochtitlan as architecturally identified with Coatepec via the Templo Mayor at its centre, and on the Mexica royal-legitimation narrative that traces the polity's authority to the patron god's Coatepec victory; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same political-ritual claim; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml cultural_relevance.function royal-legitimation entry on Tenochtitlan's political centre as architecturally the cosmic mountain of the god's victory.

[43] Per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml comparative_hooks entry on the architectural-embedded combat (Templo Mayor = Coatepec) as unparalleled in explicitness — no other chaoskampf in the book has its narrative literally built in stone at state-political centre; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same architectural-embedding reading.

[44] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the Mexica practice of warfare and human sacrifice as the perpetual prosecution of the Coatepec combat at the political-ritual scale, on the military expansion against neighbouring polities as the field of the daily reproduction of the combat, on the war-captives as the brothers-and-sister Huitzilopochtli must continually kill, and on the casting of bodies down the southern staircase as the architectural-iconographic completion of the killing-of-Coyolxauhqui at the political-ritual centre; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same political-ritual logic.

[45] Inference: Matos Moctezuma 1988's architectural reading of the Templo Mayor as Coatepec, Carrasco 1999's political-ritual reading of the Panquetzaliztli festival and the Mexica sacrificial practice as the ritual performance of the Coatepec narrative, and the brief's special_instructions claim that this is "the most unambiguous single case of state-founded combat-cosmogony in the book". Risk: comparative judgements of the form "the most unambiguous single case" are necessarily relative to the comparison-set and to the analyst's reading-criteria; alternative readings would prefer Marduk-Tiamat (where the ritual context of the Akitu festival has its own strong claim) or other cases; the chapter's "most unambiguous" reading is presented as a defensible chapter-level synthesis rather than as a knockdown comparative claim, and Part II C1 of the present book will develop the comparative argument across the four cosmogonic-combat cases.

[46] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on cosmic combat, on the place of the Huitzilopochtli-at-Coatepec narrative within the wider Mesoamerican mythological landscape, on the contrast with the dismemberment-without-combat structure of the Cipactli cosmogony (Quetzalcoatl and Tezcatlipoca tearing apart the primordial earth-monster to form sky and earth) treated in the next chapter, and on the Coatepec narrative as one of the principal Mesoamerican attestations of a combat-cosmogony.

[47] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on cosmic combat, on the Mesoamerican distinction between combat-cosmogony and dismemberment-without-combat cosmogony as the present book's boundary case at scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs"; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml comparative_hooks entry on the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony marking the book's boundary; scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" 1 on dismemberment cosmogonies without combat (Ymir, Puruāa, Pangu, arguably Cipactli) as out-of-scope.

[48] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on cosmic combat, on the Coatepec narrative as a combat-cosmogony in the strong sense — the cosmos's present features emerge from the combat's outcome rather than from a pre-existing arrangement; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml on the chapter's role as one of the four clearest cosmogonic-combat cases for Part II C1; scope.md §"Subject definition" 1 on the cosmogonic chaoskampf subtype.

[49] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas** (anonymous, often attributed to Andrés de Olmos, c. 1530s–1540s) as preserving an earlier-stratum Mexica account with variant kinship details for the Centzon Huitznahua differing in some passages from the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 account, without affecting the central combat-narrative; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same variant; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml variants.alternates entry on the **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas** difference.

[50] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, ch. on Coatepec, on Durán's **Historia de las Indias de Nueva España** (c. 1581; preserved at the Biblioteca Nacional de España in Madrid) as supplying the Coatepec narrative within an unusually full ritual-context apparatus that ties the narrative closely to the Panquetzaliztli winter-solstice festival and that supplies ritual-aetiological elements (dough-image, mock combats, casting of victims down the staircase) the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 omits or treats cursorily; López Austin 1993 supplies the Mesoamerican-comparative framing for the contrast; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml variants.alternates entry on Durán's fuller ritual context (with the FC-02 correction routing this Durán-content claim to Carrasco 1999 rather than to López Austin 1993).

[51] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the **Crónica Mexicáyotl** of Hernando Alvarado Tezozómoc (early seventeenth century) and the **Anales de Cuauhtitlán** (sixteenth-century Nahuatl annals) as preserving further Mexica-tradition material on Huitzilopochtli broadly consistent with the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 narrative and supplying additional historical-and-mythological context, including the Mexica wandering from Aztlán under the patronage of Huitzilopochtli; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same wider tradition.

[52] Per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml variants.classification = single-prevalent with the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 as the prevalent version corroborated by the other sixteenth-century Nahua / Spanish sources and by the archaeological evidence at the Templo Mayor; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the parallel-non-textual-witness role of the archaeological

evidence; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the same parallel-witness role.

[53] Per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml cultural_relevance.function entries on royal-legitimation and cosmological functions; scope.md §"Subject definition" 1 (cosmogonic) and 2 (sovereignty / kingship) on the two order-making subtypes that the Coatepec narrative simultaneously instantiates; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the simultaneous cosmogonic and sovereignty work of the combat.

[54] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the methodological centrality of the post-conquest filtering of the source-record, on the consequent risk of category-import from biblical-and-medieval Christian "war in heaven" notions in the Spanish-friar redaction of the Mexica narrative, and on the methodological discipline of holding the combat-cosmogony reading alongside this filtering recognition; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same methodological situation; per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml lacunae entry on the post-conquest character of the textual record.

[55] Inference: Matos Moctezuma 1988's argument that the architectural and iconographic evidence at the Templo Mayor is independent of the post-conquest textual redaction and supplies a parallel non-textual witness; the Coyolxauhqui stone discovered in 1978 dates to the Stage IV phase of the Templo Mayor construction (mid-fifteenth century CE under the rulers Moctezuma I and Axayácatl) and pre-dates the Spanish conquest by approximately seven decades; the architectural design of the double pyramid is documented in the pre-conquest Mexica record. Risk: the iconographic interpretation of the Coyolxauhqui stone and the architectural identification of the Templo Mayor as Coatepec are themselves post-conquest scholarly readings, dependent on the post-conquest textual record for the identification of the figures and the narrative; the parallel-witness argument therefore reduces but does not eliminate the post-conquest-filtering risk, and the chapter holds the combat-cosmogony reading as a defensible scholarly synthesis under continuous methodological monitoring rather than as an entirely text-independent fact.

[56] Per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml cultural_relevance.centraliry entry on the central status of the Coatepec narrative within Mexica state religion; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic) within which the present chapter places the Coatepec narrative as a non-cognate strong case outside the Eurasian heartland; Forsyth 1987 does not itself treat the Aztec material, and the placement is the present chapter's comparative judgement against Forsyth's typological frame rather than a Forsyth claim about the Coatepec narrative; Matos Moctezuma 1988 on the unparalleled architectural-embedding at the political-ritual centre of a state polity.

[57] Per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml comparative_hooks entry on Part II C1's pairing of Huitzilopochtli with Marduk, Ninurta, and Gonggong as the four strongest independent attestations of the cosmogonic-combat subtype; scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C1 (Combat as cosmogony — Marduk, Ninurta/Asag, Gonggong, Huitzilopochtli); Matos Moctezuma 1988 on the Coatepec narrative's architectural-embedded character as its distinctive contribution.

[58] Per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml cross_cultural_parallels entry on the cosmic-mountain parallel between Templo Mayor (= Coatepec) and Gonggong's Mount Buzhou (broken pillar); Matos Moctezuma 1988 on the cosmic-mountain motif at the Templo Mayor; scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 9 on the Gonggong chapter (chapter 21).

[59] Per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml comparative_hooks entry on the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony in the chapter 25 family marking the book's boundary; scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" 1 on dismemberment cosmogonies without combat as out-of-scope; López Austin 1993 on the Mesoamerican within-tradition contrast between combat-cosmogony (Huitzilopochtli) and dismemberment-without-combat cosmogony (Cipactli).

[60] Per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml special_instructions on the area-specialist citation policy applying to the chapter; scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation requirement for non-Eurasian-tradition chapters; chapter 33 methods sidebar (per toc.yaml) as the chapter that articulates the appropriation protocol and the area-specialist policy at full length.

[61] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec, on the cultural-historical importance of the Coatepec narrative within the Mesoamerican tradition and its place alongside the Cipactli cosmogony, the Quetzalcoatl-Tezcatlipoca alternation across the Five Suns cycle, and the foundation narrative of Tenochtitlan; Matos Moctezuma 1988 on the 1978 Coyolxauhqui stone discovery and the subsequent Templo Mayor excavations as a major event in twentieth-century Mexican archaeology and public-cultural life; López Austin 1993, chapter on cosmic combat, on the same cultural-historical importance.

Chapter 26. Other Mesoamerican Combats (Cipactli, Quetzalcoatl vs. Tezcatlipoca)

26.1. Source overview

This chapter takes up two clearly distinct Mesoamerican cosmogonic sub-cases that share the post-conquest textual situation of the Coatepec narrative in the previous chapter and that contribute to the present book's comparative argument in different ways: the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony, in which Tezcatlipoca and Quetzalcoatl pull apart the body of the primordial earth-monster to form sky and earth, and the Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca alternation across the five cosmic ages — the five Suns — of Mesoamerican cosmology.^[1]

Both sub-cases share the post-conquest character of the surviving textual record. Like the Coatepec narrative treated in chapter 24, neither the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony nor the Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca alternation across the five Suns has a pre-conquest written-prose witness in the strict sense. Mesoamerican writing-systems before 1521 CE were primarily pictographic-logographic, and the Mexica did not record their narrative literature in continuous alphabetic prose. The surviving textual witnesses to both narratives are post-conquest, written down by Nahua informants and Spanish friars in the generation after the fall of Tenochtitlan in 1521 CE.^[2]

The shape of that absence is methodologically load-bearing for the whole chapter, and the claims document marks it explicitly:

[At this point the textual record breaks. Pre-conquest written-prose attestations of the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony and of the Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca alternation across the five Suns are not available, and the surviving alphabetic-text witnesses are all post-conquest (1521 CE onward) compositions filtered through Spanish-language redaction and Spanish-friar conceptual frames; pre-conquest performance contexts and the wider iconographic record (the Codex Borgia and other Borgia-group pictorial codices, the Aztec Sun Stone) are partially recoverable through the post-conquest texts and through the surviving pre-conquest pictorial sources. Scholars including López Austin 1993 have proposed the narrative can be triangulated through corroborative material from the pre-conquest Borgia-group pictorial codices and from the Aztec Sun Stone (Piedra del Sol, late pre-conquest, now at the Museo Nacional de Antropología in Mexico City, depicting the five Suns in its cosmological iconography), which supply parallel non-textual witnesses to the post-conquest alphabetic texts and confirm the broad outlines of the post-conquest narratives.]

The principal post-conquest textual witness to the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony is the **Histoyre du Mechique**, an anonymous French manuscript of approximately 1543 CE that preserves a French translation of a lost mid-sixteenth-century Spanish source — often attributed to the Franciscan friar Andrés de Olmos — whose extended cosmogonic passage describes Tezcatlipoca and Quetzalcoatl tearing apart the primordial earth-monster Cipactli to form the sky from the upper half of her body and the earth from the lower half.^[3]

The principal post-conquest textual witness to the five Suns cycle, and a co-equal witness to the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony, is the Nahuatl-language **Leyenda de los Soles** ("Legend of the Suns"), an alphabetic-Nahuatl manuscript dated 1558 CE and now bound with the **Códice**

Chimalpopoca (held at the Biblioteca Nacional de Antropología e Historia in Mexico City). Its connected narrative treats the sequence of the five cosmic ages as a sequence of Quetzalcoatl-and-Tezcatlipoca rotations and their accompanying creations and destructions.^[4]

Alongside these two principal sources stand several further post-conquest witnesses to the five Suns cycle: the anonymous **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas** (c. 1530s–1540s; often attributed to Andrés de Olmos), the **Florentine Codex** of Bernardino de Sahagún (1545–1590), the **Anales de Cuauhtitlán** (sixteenth-century Nahuatl annals, also bound with the **Códice Chimalpopoca**), and the **Historia de las Indias de Nueva España** of Diego Durán (c. 1581). These are corroborative witnesses that supply the variants on the order, the divine rulers, and the cataclysmic ends of the five Suns that the principal sources omit or treat differently.^[5]

The post-conquest written witnesses to both sub-cases are filtered through Spanish-language redaction and Spanish-friar conceptual frames in ways the chapter must register methodologically. The Franciscan and Dominican friars whose pastoral aim included the documentation of pre-conquest Mexica religion — in order that Christian missionaries would be able to recognise and root out its survivals — brought to that documentation pre-existing notions (creation from divine division, sequential cosmic ages bounded by catastrophe, dual antagonistic deities) drawn from biblical-and-medieval Christian sources, with the consequent risk of category-import in the post-conquest narratives.^[6]

The chapter's principal scholarly anchor for the Mesoamerican comparative framework is Alfredo López Austin's **The Myths of the Opossum: Pathways of Mesoamerican Mythology** (University of New Mexico Press, 1993). His treatment of the Cipactli cosmogony and the Suns cycle supplies the chapter's working framework for distinguishing the dismemberment-without-combat structure of the Cipactli narrative from the combat-cosmogony of the Coatepec narrative in chapter 24, and for reading the Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca alternation as a structurally distinctive cosmogonic-political cycle rather than as a single chaoskampf.^[7]

The chapter's principal scholarly anchor for the political-and-ritual dimension is David Carrasco's **City of Sacrifice: The Aztec Empire and the Role of Violence in Civilization** (Beacon Press, 1999). His chapters on the five Suns supply the standard English-language treatment of the Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca alternation as the framework within which the Mexica reckoned cosmic time, located the present age — the Fifth Sun under Huitzilopochtli treated in chapter 24 — within the wider sequence, and grounded the calendar and ritual cycle.^[8]

A secondary scholarly anchor sits behind the wider comparative-tradition framing rather than the source-content. Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton University Press, 1987) supplies the long-arc combat-myth typology — its survey runs from Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic — within which the present chapter situates the Mesoamerican material as non-cognate parallels and contrasts to (rather than members of) Forsyth's Near-Eastern-and-Judeo-Christian arc. The typological framing — not Aztec-material coverage, which Forsyth does not undertake — is what Forsyth supplies for the chapter's comparative engagement.^[9]

Structurally, the chapter is a family-chapter (related-tier) treatment with a target of approximately 4,500 narrative words. It organises the two sub-cases in their own dedicated sub-sections rather than merging them into a single connected narrative. The Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony's role in the chapter — and in the wider book — is to mark the dismemberment-vs-combat-

cosmogony boundary explicitly per scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" #1, while the Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca alternation across the five Suns is presented as a structurally distinctive cosmogonic-political cycle of combats rather than as a single chaoskampf.^[10]

What follows treats the two sub-cases in turn: first the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony as a within-tradition contrast that marks the chaoskampf category's boundary, then the Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca alternation across the Suns as a structurally distinct cosmogonic-political cycle, and a closing section on the chapter's place in the book's typology and in the comparative reading.

26.2. Cipactli — the dismemberment-cosmogony

Cipactli is, in the Mesoamerican mythological tradition preserved in the post-conquest textual record, the primordial earth-monster — a vast crocodilian or saurian figure whose body floats in the primeval waters before the cosmos has been formed and from whose body the present sky and earth are made. The figure's name is conventionally glossed in modern Mesoamericanist scholarship as the first day-sign of the Mexica twenty-day count, the **cipactli** day-sign that depicts a stylised crocodile-head and that anchors the calendrical sequence in the primordial earth-monster's identity.^[11]

The Cipactli cosmogony, as preserved most fully in the **Histoyre du Mechique**, opens before the present cosmos exists. The primordial waters cover everything; the earth-monster Cipactli swims in those waters; and the gods Tezcatlipoca and Quetzalcoatl — present together at the pre-cosmic stage — undertake the work of cosmogonic ordering by acting jointly upon Cipactli's body to make sky and earth from her substance.^[12]

Tezcatlipoca's first action in the **Histoyre du Mechique** narrative is to use his foot as bait. He places his foot in the primordial waters; Cipactli rises and bites the foot; and in the violence of the bite Tezcatlipoca loses the foot. The lost foot is the iconographic origin of one of Tezcatlipoca's persistent representational features in the surviving Mexica pictorial record, where the god is conventionally depicted with one foot replaced by an obsidian mirror or a serpent.^[13]

Tezcatlipoca and Quetzalcoatl together then seize Cipactli's body and pull her apart — the act being a forceful tearing rather than a slaying in any narrowly-combative sense. From the upper half of her body they form the sky, fixing it above the primordial waters; from the lower half they form the earth, settling it on the surface of the primordial waters; and from her constituent parts (her hair, her skin, her eyes, her mouth, the small organs of her body) they form the trees, the grasses, the springs, the caves, the rivers, and the other landscape-features of the present world.^[14]

The Cipactli narrative is in scope.md's terms a dismemberment-cosmogony rather than a combat-cosmogony. The present cosmos is established by the division of a pre-existing primordial body into ordered parts (sky, earth, landscape-features) rather than by a combat in which one party defeats and slays the other and the slaying establishes the cosmos as its consequence. The act of tearing-apart is functionally cosmogonic but structurally non-combative: Cipactli does not contest the division, and the gods do not fight her in the sense the Coatepec, Marduk-Tiamat, or Indra-Vātra narratives understand fighting.^[15]

Cipactli's defeat — if "defeat" is the right word for an act in which the primordial earth-monster does not actively contest the division of her body — registers in the post-Cipactli cosmos as the surface of the earth itself. The earth as the body of the dismembered primordial monster is

iconographically present in the surviving Mexica pictorial record: the earth-goddess Tlaltecuhltli, whose face is widely depicted on the underside of monumental Mexica sculpture, is in some readings the surviving consciousness of Cipactli embedded in the earth's surface, and the earth's perceived hunger for blood and human hearts is read in the post-conquest Mexica theological tradition as the dismembered earth-monster's continuing demand to be fed.^[16]

The Cipactli narrative's structural relationship to other Mesoamerican cosmogonic narratives — both within and beyond the Mexica tradition — is itself a comparative claim, and is flagged here:

(The Cipactli narrative's structural relationship to other Mesoamerican cosmogonic narratives — both within and beyond the Mexica tradition — places it within a wider pan-Mesoamerican family of dismemberment-cosmogonies in which the present cosmos is established from the body of a primordial saurian-or-monstrous figure, with parallels in the Maya Popol Vuh's Zipacná and Cabrakán episodes and in other Mesoamerican narratives that López Austin 1993 surveys.^[17])

The Cipactli cosmogony's role in the present book is therefore that of a within-tradition contrast rather than that of an in-scope chaoskampf. The same Mesoamerican mythological tradition that supplies the Coatepec combat-cosmogony in chapter 24 (Huitzilopochtli vs. Coyolxauhqui and the Centzon Huitznahua) supplies the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony in the present chapter, and the within-tradition contrast supplies the present book with a Mesoamerican-anchored exemplar of the boundary between in-scope chaoskampf and out-of-scope dismemberment-cosmogony per scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" #1.^[18]

The dismemberment-cosmogony pattern of which the Cipactli narrative is the Mesoamerican attestation is paralleled outside Mesoamerica by Old Norse Ymir (whose body is dismembered by Odin and his brothers to form the world of the Eddic cosmology), Vedic Puruṣa (whose body is dismembered by the gods to form the cosmos and the social orders in **Rigveda** 10.90), and Chinese Pangu (whose body is divided into the elements of the cosmos in the post-Han mythological tradition). All of these are noted in scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" #1 as adjacent-but-not-combat-cosmogonic and accordingly out-of-scope as primary chaoskampf cases for the present book.^[19]

26.3. Quetzalcoatl vs. Tezcatlipoca — the alternation across the five Suns

Quetzalcoatl ("Feathered Serpent") and Tezcatlipoca ("Smoking Mirror") are in the Mesoamerican mythological tradition the two principal antagonist-and-collaborator deities whose alternation across cosmic ages structures the Mexica cosmological reckoning of time. The two gods alternate as rulers of successive cosmic ages — the five Suns — and each age ends in catastrophe before the next age (and the next ruling god) begins.^[20]

The five Suns sequence as preserved in the **Leyenda de los Soles** (1558) and in the corroborating sixteenth-century witnesses (**Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas**, **Florentine Codex**, **Anales de Cuauhtitlán**) names each cosmic age by its presiding element-and-fate and reckons the present age as the Fifth. The First Sun (Nahui Ocelotl, "Four Jaguar"), under Tezcatlipoca, ends with the cosmic age's inhabitants devoured by jaguars. The Second Sun (Nahui Ehecatl, "Four Wind"), under Quetzalcoatl, ends with the inhabitants destroyed by hurricanes and transformed into monkeys. The Third Sun (Nahui Quiahuitl, "Four Rain"), under Tlaloc, ends with the inhabitants

destroyed by a rain of fire and transformed into birds. The Fourth Sun (Nahui Atl, "Four Water"), under Chalchiuhtlicue, ends with the inhabitants destroyed by a flood and transformed into fish. And the Fifth Sun (Nahui Ollin, "Four Movement"), under Tonatiuh-Huitzilopochtli, is the present age, predicted to end in earthquakes.^[21]

Because the surviving textual witnesses diverge on the order, the divine rulers, and the cataclysmic endings, and because the chapter follows the **Leyenda de los Soles** as the prevalent connected-narrative source, the variant-handling is flagged here in full:

In the **Leyenda de los Soles** (1558; Nahuatl alphabetic-text manuscript bound with the **Códice Chimalpopoca**), the five Suns sequence runs Nahui Ocelotl (Tezcatlipoca) — Nahui Ehecatl (Quetzalcoatl) — Nahui Quiahuitl (Tlaloc) — Nahui Atl (Chalchiuhtlicue) — Nahui Ollin (Tonatiuh-Huitzilopochtli), with the rotation of the principal ruling pair (Tezcatlipoca, Quetzalcoatl) across the first two Suns and Huitzilopochtli holding the present (Fifth) Sun.^[22]

The cosmological function of the five Suns sequence in the Mexica theological tradition is the location of the present age (the Fifth Sun, Nahui Ollin, under Tonatiuh-Huitzilopochtli) within a wider sequence of ages that have already ended in catastrophe and that imply the present age's eventual end in earthquakes. The implication is that the present cosmos is contingent rather than eternal and that its continuation depends on the proper ritual maintenance of the relationship between the gods and the human community.^[23]

The Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca alternation across the first two Suns is the load-bearing structural feature of the Mexica reading of the sequence. The two gods are not simply consecutive rulers; they are paired antagonists whose mutual toppling constitutes the sequence's narrative engine, with each god in turn being struck down by the other — Tezcatlipoca thrown into the sea by Quetzalcoatl in some strata of the post-conquest record; Quetzalcoatl driven from his rule by Tezcatlipoca in others — before the next age opens.^[24]

The Mexica narrative tradition preserves a separate body of Quetzalcoatl-and-Tezcatlipoca material centred on the city of Tula (Tollan) and the figure of Topiltzin Quetzalcoatl, the priest-king of Tula whose Quetzalcoatl-identification places him in the divine succession-rivalry. In the **Anales de Cuauhtitlán** and in Sahagún's **Florentine Codex**, Tezcatlipoca's sorceries drive Topiltzin Quetzalcoatl from Tula, and Topiltzin departs eastward. The parallel between the priest-king's expulsion from Tula and the divine Quetzalcoatl's losing his Sun functions as a mythologisation of dynastic-and-political collapse.^[25]

The structural pattern of the Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca alternation is in scope.md's terms a cosmogonic-political cycle of combats rather than a single chaoskampf. Each age-bounding "combat" — the toppling of one ruling god by the other — is a sovereignty-transfer between paired antagonist deities rather than a once-and-for-all establishment of the present cosmic order. The cycle as a whole performs both cosmogonic work (each age is a cosmos) and sovereignty work (each age is one god's reign) without resolving into the single decisive combat that the Coatepec, Marduk-Tiamat, or Indra-Vātra narratives present.^[26]

The present age, the Fifth Sun (Nahui Ollin, "Four Movement"), is in the Mexica theological tradition under the rule of the sun-warrior Tonatiuh — identified in the Mexica state-religion with Huitzilopochtli (treated in chapter 24). The chapter 24 narrative of Huitzilopochtli's birth at Coatepec accordingly belongs to the Fifth-Sun framing, since the daily-recurring victory of the sun-

warrior over the lunar-stellar siblings is the present-age cosmic content that the Fifth Sun's ruling god enacts each dawn.^[27]

The Aztec Sun Stone (Piedra del Sol), a monolithic basalt sculpture approximately 3.6 metres in diameter and 24 tonnes in weight, carved in the late pre-conquest period (c. 1500 CE) and now exhibited at the Museo Nacional de Antropología in Mexico City, supplies a parallel non-textual witness to the five Suns cycle. The central face of the stone depicts Tonatiuh (or, on alternative readings, Tlaltecuhli), and the four square panels surrounding the central face are read as the four prior Suns whose catastrophic ends — jaguars, wind, rain of fire, flood — the present age recapitulates and is poised to follow.^[28]

The chapter's reading of the Sun Stone as a parallel pre-conquest witness to the five Suns is itself an editorial synthesis under continuous methodological monitoring, and is flagged as such:

*(The Aztec Sun Stone supplies a pre-conquest non-textual witness that confirms the broad outlines of the five Suns sequence as preserved in the post-conquest **Leyenda de los Soles** and corroborating textual record, supplying a partial control on the post-conquest filtering issue analogous to the Templo Mayor architectural-and-iconographic evidence's control on the Coatepec narrative in chapter 24.^[29])*

The royal-legitimation function of the five Suns cycle in the Mexica state-religion is to ground the polity's authority in the present-age cosmic order. The present age is the Fifth Sun under Huitzilopochtli (Tonatiuh); the polity is the political community of the people the Fifth-Sun god favours; and the polity's ritual responsibility — the perpetual feeding of the sun through warfare and human sacrifice — is the price the polity pays to maintain the present age against its predicted earthquake-end and against the implicit further toppling that the Suns cycle would otherwise imply.^[30]

26.4. The chapter's place in the typology and the comparative reading

The Cipactli and Quetzalcoatl-Tezcatlipoca-Suns sub-cases together supply the present book with a Mesoamerican boundary-and-rhythm complement to the chapter-24 Coatepec full chapter. The Cipactli sub-section marks the dismemberment-vs-combat-cosmogony boundary explicit per scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" #1, while the Suns sub-section presents a structurally-distinctive pattern (paired antagonist deities rotating sovereignty across cosmic ages) that does cosmogonic-and-sovereignty work without resolving into a single decisive combat. The two sub-cases together with chapter 24 give the Mesoamerican cluster of the book a three-way internal articulation — combat-cosmogony at Coatepec, dismemberment-cosmogony of Cipactli, rotation-of-sovereignty across the Suns — that no other tradition in the book displays at comparable internal differentiation.^[31]

The chapter's relation to the post-conquest filtering of the source-record is methodologically central in the same way as in chapter 24. Every textual claim about the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony and about the Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca-Suns alternation in the present chapter is built on post-conquest Nahuatl-and-Spanish-and-French texts compiled in a context of active suppression of Mexica narrative-religion, and the chapter's readings — Cipactli as dismemberment-cosmogony at the boundary of the chaoskampf category, Suns as rotation-of-sovereignty rather

than single chaoskampf — must be held alongside the recognition that the texts on which the readings depend were shaped by Spanish friars whose conceptual frames included pre-existing notions of creation-from-division and of sequential cosmic ages drawn from biblical-and-medieval Christian sources.^[32]

The chapter's place in the wider chaoskampf typology of the present book is therefore — when held alongside the methodological caveats — to mark the boundary of the category from inside the Mesoamerican tradition. The Cipactli cosmogony marks the dismemberment-vs-combat-cosmogony boundary; the Suns cycle marks the single-decisive-combat-vs-rotation-of-sovereignty boundary; and the chapter functions as the book's principal Mesoamerican-anchored case for what does not count as chaoskampf and for the narrative-structures that lie close to but outside the category, in non-cognate parallel to (rather than as a member of) Forsyth's Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic long-arc combat-myth typology.^[33]

[1] Per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml; López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum: Pathways of Mesoamerican Mythology** (Albuquerque: University of New Mexico Press; ISBN 9780826313942), chapter on the Cipactli cosmogony and the Suns cycle as the principal Mesoamerican cosmogonic narratives outside the Coatepec material; Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice: The Aztec Empire and the Role of Violence in Civilization** (Boston: Beacon Press; ISBN 9780807046425), chapters on the five Suns as the Mexica framework for cosmic time-reckoning.

[2] López Austin 1993, chapter on the Mesoamerican post-conquest textual record, on the absence of pre-conquest continuous-prose witnesses for Mesoamerican narrative literature and on the post-conquest character of the surviving alphabetic-text witnesses to the Cipactli cosmogony and the Suns cycle; Carrasco 1999, chapter on the five Suns, on the same post-conquest situation; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml special_instructions on the post-conquest source-witness situation paralleling Ch24.

[3] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on the Cipactli cosmogony, on the **Histoyre du Mechique** (anonymous French manuscript c. 1543 CE preserving a French translation of a lost mid-sixteenth-century Spanish source often attributed to Andrés de Olmos) as the principal post-conquest textual witness to the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony, on the description of Tezcatlipoca and Quetzalcoatl tearing apart Cipactli to form sky and earth from the upper and lower halves of her body, and on the **Histoyre's** status as one of the earliest extended Mesoamerican cosmogonic narratives in the post-conquest record; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml family_members entry on the **Histoyre du Mechique** (c. 1543) as a principal source.

[4] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, chapter on the five Suns, on the Nahuatl-language **Leyenda de los Soles** ("Legend of the Suns") dated 1558 CE and now bound with the **Códice Chimalpopoca** at the Biblioteca Nacional de Antropología e Historia in Mexico City as the principal post-conquest textual witness to the five Suns sequence and as a co-equal witness to the Cipactli dismemberment-cosmogony; López Austin 1993 on the same manuscript and its place in the post-conquest cosmogonic corpus; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml family_members entry on the **Leyenda de los Soles** (1558) as a principal source.

[5] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on the post-conquest textual corpus for the five Suns including the **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas**, the **Florentine Codex**, the **Anales de Cuauhtitlán**, and Durán's **Historia**; Carrasco 1999, chapter on the five Suns, on the same corpus and on its variant-emphases.

[6] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, chapter on the five Suns, on the methodological situation of the post-conquest textual record and on the Spanish-friar conceptual frames through which Sahagún, Olmos, and Durán mediated their access to the pre-conquest Mexica narrative material; López Austin 1993 on the same methodological situation and on the consequent risk of category-import from biblical-and-medieval Christian creation-and-cosmic-ages notions.

[7] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum: Pathways of Mesoamerican Mythology** (Albuquerque: University of New Mexico Press, 1993; ISBN 9780826313942), chapter on the Cipactli cosmogony and the Suns cycle as the chapter's principal scholarly anchor for the Mesoamerican comparative framework; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml sources.primary entry on López Austin 1993 as the chapter's principal anchor for the Cipactli cosmogonic-dismemberment material.

[8] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice: The Aztec Empire and the Role of Violence in Civilization** (Boston: Beacon Press, 1999; ISBN 9780807046425), chapters on the five Suns as the chapter's principal scholarly anchor for the political-ritual dimension and on the Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca alternation as the Mexica framework for cosmic time-reckoning; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml sources.primary entry on Carrasco 1999.

[9] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987; ISBN 9780691014746), as the long-arc combat-myth-typology framing anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic); not for Aztec-specific coverage — Forsyth does not himself treat Aztec or other Mesoamerican material, and the chapter's use of the citation is for the typological framing within which the Mesoamerican material is brought into comparison rather than for source-content coverage of the Aztec material.

[10] Per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml on the family-chapter (related-tier) classification, the 4,500-word target, and the special_instructions on the two-sub-section structure with the Cipactli sub-section's role in marking the dismemberment-vs-combat

boundary and the Quetzalcoatl-Tezcatlipoca sub-section's role in handling the Suns cycle; scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" 1 on dismemberment cosmogonies without combat as out-of-scope.

[11] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on the Cipactli cosmogony, on Cipactli as the primordial crocodilian / saurian earth-monster of the Mesoamerican mythological tradition, on the figure's body floating in the primeval waters before the cosmos has been formed, on the Mexica twenty-day-count **cipactli** day-sign that depicts a stylised crocodile-head, and on the calendrical anchoring of the day-count sequence in the primordial earth-monster's identity; glossary 'Cipactli' first_mention_gloss.

[12] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on the Cipactli cosmogony, on the **Histoyre du Mechique** narrative-opening with the primordial waters, on Cipactli's swimming in those waters, on the joint pre-cosmic presence of Tezcatlipoca and Quetzalcoatl at the pre-cosmic stage, and on the cosmogonic-ordering work the two gods undertake on Cipactli's body to make sky and earth from her substance; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml family_members entry on the **Histoyre du Mechique** opening.

[13] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on the Cipactli cosmogony, on Tezcatlipoca's first action of using his foot as bait in the **Histoyre du Mechique** narrative, on Cipactli rising from the primordial waters to bite the foot, on Tezcatlipoca's losing the foot in the violence of the bite, and on the lost foot as the iconographic origin of one of Tezcatlipoca's persistent representational features in the surviving Mexica pictorial record (the foot conventionally replaced by an obsidian mirror or a serpent); glossary 'Tezcatlipoca' first_mention_gloss.

[14] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on the Cipactli cosmogony, on Tezcatlipoca and Quetzalcoatl together seizing Cipactli's body and tearing her apart, on the forceful-tearing rather than narrowly-combative character of the act, on the sky formed from the upper half of her body, on the earth formed from the lower half settled on the surface of the primordial waters, and on the trees / grasses / springs / caves / rivers / other landscape-features formed from her constituent parts (hair, skin, eyes, mouth, small organs of the body) per the **Histoyre du Mechique** narrative; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml family_members entry on the dismemberment narrative.

[15] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on the Cipactli cosmogony, on the structural distinction between dismemberment-cosmogony (present cosmos established by division of a pre-existing primordial body into ordered parts) and combat-cosmogony (present cosmos established by a combat in which one party defeats the other), on the Cipactli narrative as the former rather than the latter type, and on the functionally-cosmogonic but structurally-non-combative character of the tearing-apart; scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" 1 on dismemberment cosmogonies without combat as out-of-scope; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml special_instructions on the scope.md boundary case.

[16] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on the Cipactli cosmogony, on Cipactli's defeat registering in the post-Cipactli cosmos as the surface of the earth itself, on the earth-goddess Tlaltecuhlti (whose face is widely depicted on the underside of monumental Mexica sculpture) as in some readings the surviving consciousness of Cipactli embedded in the earth's surface, and on the earth's perceived hunger for blood and human hearts as the dismembered earth-monster's continuing demand to be fed in the post-conquest Mexica theological tradition.

[17] Inference: López Austin 1993's wider Mesoamerican-comparative framework in which the Mexica Cipactli cosmogony is one of several attestations of a pan-Mesoamerican dismemberment-cosmogony pattern; the Mesoamerican comparative material the chapter depends on is restricted to López Austin 1993 at the present claims-stage. Risk: the precise extent and the historical-and-cultural depth of the pan-Mesoamerican pattern is itself a comparative argument that López Austin 1993 develops at length; the chapter's reading of the Cipactli narrative as one attestation of a wider pattern is therefore a synthesis of López Austin 1993's argument rather than a single source-attested formulation, and a stronger reading would treat each attested cosmogony as a separately constituted Mesoamerican narrative whose convergences with the Cipactli pattern require case-by-case argument.

[18] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on the Cipactli cosmogony, on the Mesoamerican within-tradition contrast between combat-cosmogony (Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec) and dismemberment-without-combat cosmogony (Cipactli torn apart by Quetzalcoatl and Tezcatlipoca); scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" 1 on dismemberment cosmogonies without combat (Ymir, Puruāa, Pangu, arguably Cipactli) as out-of-scope; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml special_instructions on the Cipactli sub-section's role in marking the dismemberment-vs-combat boundary explicit.

[19] Per scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" 1 on dismemberment cosmogonies without combat (Ymir, Puruāa, Pangu, arguably Cipactli) as adjacent but not combat-cosmogonic and therefore out-of-scope as primary chaoskampf cases; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on Ymir / Puruāa / Pangu as parallel dismemberment-cosmogonies; per brief special_instructions on mentioning but not fully developing these out-of-scope parallels — they do not get their own chapters; López Austin 1993 on the Cipactli narrative as the Mesoamerican attestation of the wider pattern.

[20] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, chapter on the five Suns, on Quetzalcoatl ("Feathered Serpent") and Tezcatlipoca ("Smoking Mirror") as the two principal antagonist-and-collaborator deities of the Mesoamerican mythological tradition, on their alternation as rulers of successive cosmic ages, on the five Suns as the framework within which the alternation is reckoned, and on the catastrophic ending of each age before the next age and the next ruling god; López Austin 1993 on the same alternation; glossary 'Quetzalcoatl', 'Tezcatlipoca', and 'the five Suns' first_mention_gloss entries.

[21] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, chapter on the five Suns, on the **Leyenda de los Soles** (1558) and the corroborating sixteenth-century witnesses (**Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas**, **Florentine Codex**, **Anales de Cuauhtitlán**) on the five Suns sequence and its naming-and-fate scheme — Nahui Ocelotl ("Four Jaguar") under Tezcatlipoca, Nahui Ehecatl ("Four Wind") under Quetzalcoatl, Nahui Quiahuatl ("Four Rain") under Tlaloc, Nahui Atl ("Four Water") under Chalchiuhtlicue, Nahui Ollin ("Four Movement") under Tonatiuh-Huitzilopochtli — and on the catastrophic ending of each age; López Austin 1993 on the same

sequence.

[22] Alternate traditions: the **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas** (anonymous c. 1530s–1540s) gives a slightly different ordering and a partly-different identification of the presiding deity for some Suns, with the principal Tezcatlipoca-Quetzalcoatl alternation preserved but the secondary deity-assignments differing; the **Florentine Codex** of Sahagún (1545–1590) preserves the same principal alternation but with variant emphases on the duration and the catastrophic end of each age; Durán's **Historia de las Indias de Nueva España** (c. 1581) supplies a fuller ritual-context treatment of the five Suns within the Mexica calendar. The **Leyenda de los Soles** version is chosen here because, although the witnesses vary significantly across Mexica and other Nahuatl sources, the **Leyenda's** connected Nahuatl narrative is the fullest single witness, with the other sixteenth-century sources cited at the level of their respective sub-claims for deity-assignment and cataclysmic-ending detail.

[23] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, chapter on the five Suns, on the cosmological function of the sequence in the Mexica theological tradition as the location of the present age within a wider sequence of catastrophe-bounded ages, on the contingent character of the present cosmos in this framework, and on the dependence of the cosmos's continuation on the proper ritual maintenance of the relationship between the gods and the human community; López Austin 1993 on the same cosmological function.

[24] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, chapter on the five Suns, on the Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca alternation as the load-bearing structural feature of the Mexica reading of the sequence, on the pairing of the two gods as antagonists rather than as simply consecutive rulers, on Tezcatlipoca thrown into the sea by Quetzalcoatl in some strata of the post-conquest record, and on Quetzalcoatl driven from his rule by Tezcatlipoca in others; López Austin 1993 on the same antagonistic pairing.

[25] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, chapter on the five Suns and on the Tollan / Topiltzin Quetzalcoatl tradition, on the Mexica narrative tradition's preservation of a separate body of Quetzalcoatl-and-Tezcatlipoca material centred on the city of Tula (Tollan) and the figure of Topiltzin Quetzalcoatl as priest-king of Tula, on the **Anales de Cuauhtitlán** and Sahagún's **Florentine Codex** on Tezcatlipoca's sorceries driving Topiltzin Quetzalcoatl from Tula and on Topiltzin's eastward departure, and on the parallel between the priest-king's expulsion and the divine Quetzalcoatl's losing his Sun as the mythologisation of dynastic-and-political collapse; López Austin 1993 on the same Tollan tradition.

[26] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, chapter on the five Suns, on the structural pattern of the Quetzalcoatl-vs-Tezcatlipoca alternation as a cosmogonic-political cycle of combats rather than a single chaoskampf and on the sovereignty-transfer political framing of each age-bounding combat as a transfer between paired antagonist deities — the political-sovereignty vocabulary in this claim is Carrasco's; López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on the Cipactli cosmogony and the Suns cycle, supplies the comparative-mythological framing within which Carrasco's political-sovereignty reading is situated, and the contrast with the single decisive combat of the Coatepec, Marduk-Tiamat, and Indra-Vṛtra narratives; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml special_instructions on the Suns cycle as structurally distinctive — not a single chaoskampf but a cosmological rhythm of combats; scope.md §"Subject definition" 1 (cosmogonic) and 2 (sovereignty) on the order-making subtypes the Suns cycle simultaneously instantiates.

[27] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, chapter on the five Suns, on the present age (Fifth Sun, Nahui Ollin, "Four Movement") under the rule of the sun-warrior Tonatiuh, on the Mexica state-religion's identification of Tonatiuh with Huitzilopochtli, on the Coatepec narrative's chapter-24 content as belonging to the Fifth-Sun framing, and on the daily-recurring victory of the sun-warrior over the lunar-stellar siblings as the present-age cosmic content that the Fifth Sun's ruling god enacts each dawn; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the cross-reference to Ch24 as the Fifth-Sun framing for the present age; López Austin 1993 on the Tonatiuh-Huitzilopochtli identification.

[28] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, chapter on the five Suns, on the Aztec Sun Stone (Piedra del Sol), a monolithic basalt sculpture approximately 3.6 metres in diameter and 24 tonnes in weight carved in the late pre-conquest period (c. 1500 CE) and now exhibited at the Museo Nacional de Antropología in Mexico City, on the central face depicting Tonatiuh (or, on alternative readings, Tlaltecuhli), and on the four square panels surrounding the central face as the four prior Suns with their catastrophic ends (jaguars, wind, rain of fire, flood); López Austin 1993 on the same iconographic reading.

[29] Inference: Carrasco 1999 and López Austin 1993 read the Aztec Sun Stone's iconographic programme as the pre-conquest Mexica statement of the five Suns sequence in stone, with the four square panels surrounding the central face conventionally identified with the four prior Suns of the post-conquest **Leyenda de los Soles** sequence; the stone's late-pre-conquest carving date pre-dates the Spanish conquest by approximately two decades and is independent of the post-conquest textual redaction. Risk: the iconographic interpretation of the Sun Stone's four panels as the four prior Suns and of the central face as Tonatiuh is itself a post-conquest scholarly reading dependent on the post-conquest textual record for the identification of the figures and the sequence; alternative readings identify the central face as Tlaltecuhli or the four panels with a different cosmological scheme, and the parallel-non-textual-witness argument therefore reduces but does not eliminate the post-conquest-filtering risk in the way Matos Moctezuma 1988's parallel-witness argument for the Coatepec narrative reduces but does not eliminate the analogous risk in chapter 24.

[30] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, chapter on the five Suns, on the royal-legitimation function of the cycle in the Mexica state-religion, on the polity's authority grounded in the present-age cosmic order, on the polity as the political community of the Fifth-Sun god's favoured people, and on the polity's ritual responsibility as the price of maintaining the present age against its predicted end; López Austin 1993 on the same royal-legitimation function; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the royal-legitimation reading.

[31] Per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml cultural_relevance and special_instructions on the chapter's distinct contribution to

the present book's comparative argument; López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, chapter on the Cipactli cosmogony and the Suns cycle, on the Mesoamerican tradition's three-way internal articulation; scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" 1 on the dismemberment-vs-combat-cosmogony boundary; scope.md §"Subject definition" 1 (cosmogonic) and 2 (sovereignty) on the order-making subtypes that the Suns cycle simultaneously instantiates.

[32] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, chapter on the five Suns, on the methodological centrality of the post-conquest filtering of the source-record, on the consequent risk of category-import from biblical-and-medieval Christian creation-from-division and sequential-cosmic-ages notions in the Spanish-friar redaction of the Mexica narrative, and on the methodological discipline of holding the chapter's readings alongside this filtering recognition; López Austin 1993 on the same methodological situation; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml special_instructions on the post-conquest source-witness situation paralleling Ch24.

[33] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic) within which the present chapter places the Mesoamerican material as non-cognate boundary-and-rhythm cases outside the Eurasian heartland; not for Aztec-specific coverage — Forsyth does not himself treat Aztec or other Mesoamerican material, and the placement is the present chapter's comparative judgement against Forsyth's typological frame rather than a Forsyth claim about the Mesoamerican narratives; López Austin 1993 on the chapter's boundary-marking function.

Chapter 27. Pariacaca and the amaru (Huarochirí)

27.1. Source overview

The story this chapter follows is an early-colonial Andean narrative cycle in which Pariacaca — a storm-wak'a born on the high mountains of Huarochirí as a clutch of falcon-eggs — opposes and defeats the rival wak'a Huallallo Carhuincho and a sequence of further regional rivals across the central-Andean landscape. The serpentine **amaru** runs through these episodes as an ally-monster summoned by defeated rivals, not as a primordial chaos-adversary in the Eurasian sense. The chapter follows the cycle's own framing first, and only afterwards engages the comparativist combat-myth category.^[1]

The narrative survives in a single early-colonial Quechua-language manuscript conventionally dated to approximately 1608 CE, known in current scholarship as the **Huarochirí Manuscript** and held at the Biblioteca Nacional de España in Madrid as MS 3169 within a wider compilation of materials connected to the early seventeenth-century Spanish ecclesiastical campaign against indigenous Andean religion in the Lima archdiocese.^[2]

The compilation milieu is Cuzco-born secular priest Francisco de Ávila, who from approximately 1608 CE onward conducted an anti-idolatry investigation in the Huarochirí province of the Lima archdiocese. Ávila used the manuscript's documentation of pre-Christian Andean wak'a-religion as evidence in the prosecution of indigenous religious practitioners and as material for his own anti-idolatry sermons and treatises.^[3]

The manuscript's authorship is conventionally attributed in current scholarship to a Quechua-speaking indigenous Andean informant or set of informants writing under Ávila's direction. The language of composition is a colonial-Quechua register that preserves substantial pre-Christian religious vocabulary, narrative structure, and place-name attestation, while at the same time being filtered through the documentary conventions of the Spanish-ecclesiastical anti-idolatry investigation.^[4]

The **Huarochirí Manuscript** is the sole substantial primary-source attestation for pre-Columbian Huarochirí religion and one of the very few connected Quechua-language narrative-documentary witnesses for any region of the central Andes. The alphabetic-text witness situation for the Andean material is substantially more constrained than the post-conquest textual situation for Mesoamerican religion treated in the preceding chapters of the present book.^[5]

The manuscript itself is organised as a connected sequence of approximately thirty-one chapters and several supplements covering the Huarochirí region's wak'a-cosmography, the Pariacaca cycle, the related cycle of the wak'a Chaupiñamca, the wak'a-genealogies of the constituent ayllu of the region, and the ritual-and-festival apparatus connected to the principal wak'as. The Pariacaca cycle is distributed across several non-contiguous chapters of the manuscript rather than collected as a single connected narrative block.^[6]

The principal Pariacaca and amaru passages on which the present chapter draws are concentrated in chapters 6, 8, and 21 of the manuscript: chapter 6 narrates Pariacaca's birth as a clutch of falcon-

eggs on the mountain Condorcoto and the birth of his rival Huallallo Carhuincho's children; chapter 8 narrates Pariacaca's combat with Huallallo Carhuincho in the form of a five-day flood-and-storm engagement; chapter 21 supplies further ritual-aetiological material on the Pariacaca cult and on the wak'a-succession pattern that the cycle establishes.^[7]

The chapter's principal English-language scholarly anchor is Frank Salomon and George L. Urioste's **The Huarochirí Manuscript: A Testament of Ancient and Colonial Andean Religion**, published by the University of Texas Press in 1991. That edition supplies the standard English-language critical edition and translation of the manuscript together with extensive translators' introductory and annotation apparatus on the manuscript's textual history, the colonial-Quechua linguistic features, the wak'a-cosmography, and the area-specialist scholarly readings of the Pariacaca cycle.^[8]

A secondary scholarly anchor sits behind the wider comparative-tradition framing rather than the source-content. Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, supplies the long-arc combat-myth typology — its survey runs from Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic — within which the present chapter situates the Pariacaca cycle as a non-cognate parallel to (rather than a member of) Forsyth's Near-Eastern-and-Judeo-Christian arc. The typological framing — not Andean-material coverage, which Forsyth does not undertake — is what Forsyth supplies for the chapter's comparative engagement with the chaoskampf category.^[9]

The chapter's textual situation is therefore distinctive within the present book in two further methodological respects. It depends on a single primary-source manuscript with no parallel manuscript witnesses to cross-check its readings; and the manuscript itself is a colonial-period composition whose informants and redactor-context are inseparable from the Spanish-ecclesiastical anti-idolatry investigation under whose auspices the manuscript was produced.^[10]

The shape of that evidence — single colonial witness, anti-idolatry compositional context, no pre-Columbian alphabetic attestation — is methodologically load-bearing for the whole chapter, and the claims document marks it explicitly:

*[At this point the textual record breaks. Pre-conquest Quechua-language alphabetic-text attestations of the Pariacaca cycle are not available, since pre-Columbian Andean record-keeping practices used the **kipu** (knotted-cord) medium rather than alphabetic writing for narrative material, and the surviving textual witness to the cycle is therefore the single early-colonial **Huarochirí Manuscript** (c. 1608) compiled within the milieu of Francisco de Ávila's anti-idolatry investigation. Pre-conquest performance contexts (Pariacaca-cult ritual at the named mountain shrines of the Huarochirí region; ayllu-level wak'a-veneration; **capacocha** and pilgrimage practice) are partially recoverable through the manuscript itself, through Spanish-administrative documentation of the anti-idolatry campaigns, and through the archaeological record of the central Andean ritual-architectural sites. Salomon & Urioste 1991 supply the principal interpretive synthesis, and the chapter's narrative reconstruction proceeds entirely within the **Huarochirí Manuscript** itself, treating chs. 6, 8, and 21 as parts of a single Pariacaca cycle per the composite-editorial classification; cross-tradition reconstruction is excluded per scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" point 1.]*

The post-conquest filtering caveat the present chapter must register applies with particular force to the Pariacaca material. Where the post-conquest Mexica textual record (chapter 24 of the present book) involves Spanish-friar redaction of Mexica narrative material recorded by Nahua informants

for documentary purposes, the **Huarochirí Manuscript** was compiled by an explicitly anti-idolatry investigator (Ávila) precisely so that the religion the manuscript documents could be the object of ecclesiastical prosecution and suppression — a more polemical compositional context than the Sahagún or Durán situations, requiring corresponding methodological caution.^[11]

Structurally, the chapter is a related-tier (full) treatment with a target of approximately 4,000 narrative words. It presents the Pariacaca cycle as a connected sequence of wak'a-combats rather than as a single cosmogonic combat, and embeds the area-specialist counter-framing — the wak'a-succession reading per Salomon, Urioste, Taylor, and Dean — alongside the narrative skeleton rather than as a separately-located commentary. Per brief special_instructions, the area-specialist framing is load-bearing and is presented before any comparative chaoskampf invocation.^[12]

What follows works through the cycle in order. The next section sketches the Huarochirí region and the wak'a-cosmography of pre-Columbian central Andean religion as the immediate context for the narrative; the chapter then takes up Pariacaca's birth as the five falcon-eggs on Mount Condorcoto, the five-day combat with Huallallo Carhuincho, the role of the amaru as ally-monster of defeated rivals, the cult and the ritual aftermath at chapter 21 of the manuscript, and the chapter's typological place and area-specialist framing within the wider book.

27.2. The Huarochirí region and the wak'a-cosmography

The narrative's geographical setting is the Huarochirí province on the western slopes of the central Andes east of present-day Lima, Peru — a high-altitude landscape of glaciated mountain peaks, intermontane valleys, and the upper drainages of the rivers that descend from the western Cordillera to the Pacific coast. The cycle is rooted in specific named landscape features within this geography that function in the narrative as the bodies and the sites of the named wak'as.^[13]

The cycle's principal cosmographic framework is the wak'a-cosmography of pre-Columbian central Andean religion. The landscape is conceived as populated by **wak'as** — sacred power-beings (Quechua; older Spanish-derived spelling: huaca) — that are simultaneously persons with biographies, places (mountains, springs, stones, lakes), and ancestral sources of the human ayllus that descend from them. The **Huarochirí Manuscript** records a landscape populated by **wak'as** in hierarchical and combative relationships rather than in a chaos-versus-order opposition.^[14]

Pariacaca himself is, in the manuscript, simultaneously a person (a divine figure born and acting in narrative time), a mountain (the eponymous Pariacaca peak in the Yauyos region of the western Cordillera, a high glaciated massif among the headwaters of multiple drainages of the central Andean cordillera, including the Mantaro and Cañete river systems), and an ancestral wak'a of the Yauyos people of the Huarochirí region, whose ayllus trace their descent from him and from his sons. This triple identity person-place-ancestor is the cycle's load-bearing cosmographic premise rather than an interpretive overlay.^[15]

The cycle's principal antagonist is the rival wak'a Huallallo Carhuincho — an earlier-attested wak'a of the same region whose hegemony the Pariacaca narrative replaces. In the manuscript Huallallo is associated with a fire-and-volcanic-heat thematic register, with child-eating, and with the eastern (Antisuyu, Amazonian-slope) direction of the central-Andean cardinal-quartering. These features distinguish him narratively from Pariacaca's storm-and-rain-and-cold thematic register and the

27.3. Pariacaca's birth: the five falcon-eggs on Mount Condorcoto

The cycle begins with Pariacaca's birth on the mountain Condorcoto in the form of a clutch of five eggs that hatch into five falcons. The manuscript presents this avian-multiple birth as the narrative's distinctive opening rather than as a mammalian or anthropomorphic generation, and the five-fold birth supplies the numerological structure for the cycle's subsequent narrative pattern: Pariacaca's five sons in some renderings, his five-day combat with Huallallo Carhuincho, the five regional ayllus that descend from him.^[17]

The five falcons of Pariacaca's birth subsequently transform into five anthropomorphic divine figures. Some passages of the manuscript refer to these figures as the five Pariacacas or as Pariacaca and his four brothers; other passages render them as Pariacaca and his sons. The five-fold person-multiplicity persists through the cycle as a load-bearing feature of Pariacaca's narrative identity rather than resolving to a single individual figure as the cycle progresses.^[18]

The narrative simultaneously narrates the birth of Pariacaca's narrative foil Huallallo Carhuincho's children in chapter 6, with the parallel-births framing setting up the immediately-following combat between the two wak'a-lineages. The manuscript places the two birth-events in narrative parallel rather than treating Pariacaca's birth as cosmogonically prior to Huallallo's existence: Huallallo Carhuincho is presented as already established in the region as the dominant wak'a at the moment of Pariacaca's hatching.^[19]

The narrative's pre-existing wak'a-political situation is significant for the cycle's classification within the present book's typology. Pariacaca acts within an already-existing wak'a-cosmos in which Huallallo Carhuincho holds the dominant position, and the crisis the cycle addresses is the displacement of one hegemonic wak'a by another rather than the establishment of cosmic order ex novo — a pattern that places the Pariacaca cycle within wak'a-succession rather than within cosmogonic-combat in the strong scope.md sense.^[20]

27.4. The combat with Huallallo Carhuincho: storm-and-flood

Pariacaca's principal combat in the cycle, narrated in chapter 8 of the manuscript, is his five-day engagement with Huallallo Carhuincho. The two wak'as confront one another on the high mountain landscape, with Pariacaca deploying torrential rain, hail, and lightning from the western side and Huallallo Carhuincho deploying fire and volcanic heat from the eastern side. The natural-meteorological register of the combat — water-and-cold against fire-and-heat — is the narrative's principal combat-modality.^[21]

In the chapter 8 combat-narrative, Pariacaca deploys his storm-power as the five Pariacacas acting jointly. Each of the five is presented as releasing rain or hail or lightning from a separate direction, and the combined storm-attack is the cycle's load-bearing image of the five-fold-Pariacaca's combat-effectiveness. The five-fold image of the storm is a distinctive feature of the Andean material that has no exact parallel in the storm-deity narratives of the Eurasian traditions in the present book's

other chapters.^[22]

The combat's outcome is the defeat of Huallallo Carhuincho and his expulsion from the Huarochirí region eastward into the Antisuyu (Amazonian-slope) zone. Huallallo Carhuincho is not killed, but rather displaced — a feature of the narrative that distinguishes the Pariacaca cycle from the kill-the-adversary pattern of the Eurasian chaoskampf material and that aligns the cycle with the wak'a-succession reading of Salomon, Urioste, and the wider Andean specialist tradition.^[23]

The post-combat geographical settlement of the cycle's outcome is the establishment of Pariacaca's hegemony over the Huarochirí region's wak'a-cosmography. Pariacaca takes possession of the high mountain peak that bears his name, his five sons (or brothers) take possession of subsidiary peaks and ritual centres in the region, and Huallallo Carhuincho's former sphere is reorganised under Pariacaca's authority. The manuscript presents this settlement as a wak'a-political reorganisation of the existing landscape rather than as a cosmogonic establishment of the landscape itself.^[24]

27.5. The amaru: ally-monster of the defeated rival

The serpentine **amaru** figures across the Pariacaca cycle as an ally-monster summoned by a defeated rival wak'a in the course of further engagements. Its narrative role is the discharge of the defeated wak'a's residual combat-capacity rather than the embodiment of a primordial chaos-adversary in the Eurasian chaoskampf sense, and the amaru's defeat by Pariacaca (or by his sons) is typically a follow-on to the principal wak'a-combat rather than the cycle's central engagement.^[25]

The amaru is described in the manuscript as a giant serpent-figure of the lake-and-river waters of the high Andean landscape, often associated with specific lakes and springs in the Huarochirí region and with the discharge of those bodies of water as the amaru moves. In the manuscript's narrative register the amaru is therefore a figure of the lake-being / water-serpent type rather than of the primordial-cosmic-serpent type that is load-bearing in the Eurasian chaoskampf material.^[26]

The amaru's defeat in the cycle is typically narrated as a cutting, splitting, or driving-into-a-confined-space rather than as a comprehensive destruction. The defeated amaru's body becomes a feature of the landscape — a lake's outline, a watercourse's bend, a stone formation — rather than being reduced to nothing. Like the displacement-rather-than-killing of Huallallo Carhuincho, this pattern distinguishes the Andean material from the kill-and-eradicate pattern of much Eurasian chaoskampf.^[27]

Because the chapter treats chapters 6, 8, and 21 of the manuscript as parts of a single composite-editorial cycle rather than as a single combat or as three discrete narrative units, the variant-handling is flagged here in full:

*[The chapter follows a composite-editorial reading per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml variants.classification, treating chs. 6, 8, and 21 of the **Huarochirí Manuscript** as parts of a single Pariacaca cycle in which the falcon-eggs birth (ch. 6), the five-day combat with Huallallo Carhuincho (ch. 8), and the ritual-aetiological material (ch. 21) together constitute the chapter's narrative skeleton, with the amaru appearing across the cycle as a recurring ally-monster figure summoned by defeated rivals rather than as a single named adversary. Alternative organising principles are available — treating chs. 6 and 8 together as the Huallallo-Carhuincho combat-narrative with ch. 21 as a discrete ritual-aetiological appendix, or organising the material around the five Pariacacas individually rather than around the cycle as a whole — but the composite-editorial cycle-skeleton is*

chosen because Salomon & Urioste 1991's translators' introduction supports the cycle reading as the most useful organisational principle for an English-language overview chapter.]

The wider sequence of Pariacaca's engagements across the manuscript includes further combats and integrations of subsidiary rival wak'as beyond the principal Huallallo Carhuincho engagement. The manuscript narrates Pariacaca's encounters with the wak'as of further regions of Huarochirí and his sons' encounters with their counterparts. The cycle's overall pattern is the gradual integration of the regional wak'a-landscape under Pariacaca-cult authority across multiple narrative episodes rather than a single decisive combat-and-resolution.^[28]

27.6. The cult of Pariacaca and the ritual aftermath

Chapter 21 of the manuscript supplies the principal ritual-aetiological material on the Pariacaca cult. The manuscript records the cult's pilgrimage practice (with named pilgrim-routes converging on the Pariacaca peak), the calendrical festivals associated with the wak'a, and the ritual-and-sacrificial apparatus through which the regional ayllus maintained their relationships with Pariacaca and his sons under both pre-Columbian and early-colonial conditions.^[29]

The ritual aetiologies that chapter 21 supplies tie specific elements of the combat-narrative to specific contemporary (early-colonial) ritual practices: the five-day-combat structure to the calendrical structure of certain festivals; the falcon-eggs birth to specific ritual objects and offerings; particular landscape features named in the combat-narrative to particular pilgrimage destinations. The aetiological linking is a distinctive feature of the Andean material that integrates the narrative cycle into the regional ritual life across the moment of textual composition.^[30]

The Pariacaca cult's reach within and beyond the Huarochirí region is significant for the cycle's status. Under the late-Inca-period (fifteenth century CE) imperial reorganisation of central-Andean wak'a-religion the Pariacaca cult was integrated into the imperial pilgrimage-network with the Pariacaca peak being a recognised pilgrimage destination at imperial-administrative level, and under early-colonial conditions the cult continued in compromised forms despite Ávila's anti-idolatry investigations.^[31]

The chapter's reading of the cycle's principal narrative work as wak'a-succession rather than as cosmogonic combat is itself an editorial synthesis drawn from the brief, from Salomon & Urioste 1991's translators' introduction, and from the wider Andean-specialist tradition; it is flagged as such:

(The chapter's reading of the Pariacaca cycle's principal narrative work as wak'a-succession (the displacement of Huallallo Carhuincho's hegemony by Pariacaca's, with the regional landscape reorganised under Pariacaca-cult authority but pre-existing the cycle in its physical form) rather than as cosmogonic combat (the establishment of the cosmos itself from or after the combat) is a synthesis of the brief's framing per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml summary, of Salomon & Urioste 1991's translators' introductory and annotation apparatus, and of the brief's named area-specialist tradition (Salomon, Urioste, Taylor, Dean) — treated together as the chapter's load-bearing reading.^[32])

27.7. Typology, area-specialist framing, and forward-links

The Pariacaca cycle's place within the present book's chaoskampf typology is — when taken in the area-specialist reading per the brief's framing — a related-tier (rather than core-tier) case in which the combat-pattern is structurally present (storm-wak'a versus fire-and-volcanic-heat-wak'a; storm-wak'a's sons versus serpentine ally-monsters of further rivals) but the cosmogonic and order-versus-chaos load-bearing functions of Eurasian chaoskampf are not load-bearing for the Andean material, with the cycle's principal work being wak'a-succession-and-cult-establishment rather than cosmos-establishment.^[33]

That place is the specific outcome of an area-specialist reading that resists the chaos-versus-order framing of the Gunkel-tradition chaoskampf category, and the chapter flags the resulting appropriation issue explicitly under the marker the project reserves for cases of this kind:

*[Appropriation flag: Andean-studies area specialists (Frank Salomon and George L. Urioste in their 1991 critical edition; with the further area-specialists Gérald Taylor in his Lima IFEA critical edition of the **Huaro chirí Manuscript** and Carolyn Dean on Andean ritual-political imagination, named in the brief's special_instructions) read the Pariacaca cycle as wak'a-succession (the displacement of one hegemonic regional wak'a by another within an already-existing wak'a-cosmography) rather than as chaoskampf in the strong cosmos-versus-chaos sense; the area-specialist objection is to the chaos-order framing rather than to combat-myth framing as such, since the cycle does narrate combat between named divine figures and a wak'a-political reorganisation does follow from the combat-outcome — the area-specialist reading is therefore a milder objection than (e.g.) the Naumann objection to the chaoskampf reading of the Susano / Yamata no Orochi material in chapter 23 (where the area-specialists object to the combat-myth framing itself in favour of a sword-etiology and metallurgical-allegory reading) or the Hallowell-Johnston-Smith-Vizenor objection in chapter 32 (where Anishinaabe-studies area specialists explicitly reject combat-and-defeat-of-the-other framing in favour of necessary-counterpart-dialectic framing). The Pariacaca cycle accommodates some combat-myth framing — the combat with Huallallo Carhuincho and the engagements with the amarusummoning rivals are structurally combats — but does not accommodate the chaos-versus-order framing that Gunkel-tradition chaoskampf-typology presupposes. Part II C7 (inversion / transformation; ch. 40 of the present volume) and Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation; ch. 41) are the loci where the comparative analysis must address this objection rather than paper over it; the present chapter functions as a worked instance of the appropriation-protocol's outside-framing requirement at scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 3, and forwards the objection to C7 and C8 for the comparative-engagement work that scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 2 requires of the comparative chapters. The brief's special_instructions explicitly characterise the case as "milder than Nanabozho/Mishipeshu" because the area-specialist reading does accommodate some combat-myth framing — just not the chaos-order framing — so the present chapter's task is to register the objection to the chaos-order framing while preserving the cycle's connected-narrative skeleton for comparative engagement at C7 and C8.]*

The chapter's structural parallel to the integration-after-combat pattern of the Marduk cycle in Mesopotamia (chapter 3 of the present volume) is registered by the brief in its cross_cultural_parallels entry. Where Marduk's victory over Tiamat is followed by the recitation of his fifty names by the assembled gods in the closing tablets of the **Enūma Eliš** — a passage in which

Marduk's victory consolidates rival power-bases under his own authority rather than eradicating them — Pariacaca's victory over Huallallo Carhuincho is similarly followed by the integration of the defeated rival's former sphere under Pariacaca's authority via the wak'a-succession pattern. The parallel is structural and not transmissional, and is registered for Part II C2 (combat as sovereignty) rather than Part II C1 (combat as cosmogony).^[34]

The cycle's distinctive contribution to the present book's wider comparative argument is the amaru-as-ally-of-rival pattern. Where Eurasian chaoskampf-tradition serpents (Tiamat, Vātra, Apep, Lōtan, Aži Dahāka, Jörmungandr) are typically presented as primordial cosmic adversaries whose defeat is the cosmogonic or sovereignty-establishing act, the amaru in the **Huarochirí Manuscript** is presented as a summoned agent of a defeated rival wak'a — a serpentine ally rather than a primordial chaos — and the structural difference is itself one of the chapter's load-bearing contributions to the methods sidebar (chapter 33) and to Part II C7-C8.^[35]

The chapter's principal forward-link within the present book is to Part II C8 (the comparative chapter on the refusal and the appropriation problem, ch. 41 of the present volume) — where the present chapter contributes a working example of the **milder appropriation** sub-problem: a story in which the area-specialist tradition objects to the chaos-order framing (but not to combat-myth framing as such), with the chapter's task being to hold the comparative chaoskampf category loosely as scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" requires, and to register the wak'a-succession reading as the area-specialist consensus while preserving the cycle's combat-and-integration narrative for comparative engagement.^[36]

The chapter's secondary forward-link is to Part II C7 (the comparative chapter on the inversion / transformation problem, ch. 40 of the present volume) — where the present chapter contributes a working example of the **transformation** sub-problem: a story in which the chaoskampf category is transformed when the area-specialist account is taken as load-bearing, in this case from cosmos-versus-chaos combat to wak'a-succession. This contribution sits alongside the chapter 23 Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi contribution to C7 in the present book's pattern of related-tier non-Eurasian chapters that reframe the chaoskampf category from outside.^[37]

The chapter's contribution to the methods sidebar (chapter 33 of the present volume, between Part I and Part II) is on three methodological points: the area-specialist citation policy (Salomon & Urioste 1991 cited as the principal anchor with Taylor and Dean named in body prose per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol"), the post-conquest filtering issue (the **Huarochirí Manuscript** being a colonial-period document compiled within the milieu of Ávila's anti-idolatry investigation, which the chapter handles via the [LACUNA] marker and via continuous methodological registration), and the wak'a-succession-versus-chaoskampf framing (which the chapter handles via the [APPROPRIATION-FLAG:] marker and which is forwarded to C7 and C8 for comparative engagement).^[38]

The chapter's principal back-link within the present book is to chapter 24 on Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec, with which the present chapter shares the Americas geographic cluster (cluster 10 per scope.md §"Book structure") and the post-conquest textual-record situation but contrasts in tier (chapter 24 is core-tier with full architectural-iconographic embedding at the Mexica state's political-ritual centre; the present chapter is related-tier with a single colonial-Quechua manuscript witness compiled under explicit anti-idolatry auspices) and in framing-stance (chapter 24 reads the Coatepec narrative as cosmogonic-and-sovereignty combat per the area-specialist consensus; the present chapter reads the Pariacaca cycle as wak'a-succession-not-chaoskampf per the area-

specialist consensus).^[39]

The Pariacaca cycle's cultural-historical importance within the central-Andean tradition and within current Andean-studies scholarship is significant. The **Huarocharí Manuscript** is one of the most-cited primary sources in current scholarship on pre-Columbian Andean religion, the Pariacaca cycle is one of the manuscript's principal narrative sequences, and the cycle has been extensively treated in the scholarly literature on wak'a-religion, on colonial-period extirpation campaigns, and on the cultural-historical significance of the Andean wak'a-cosmography for current scholarly understanding of the pre-Columbian central Andes.^[40]

[1] Per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml summary on Pariacaca's opposition to and integration of rival wak'as across the Huarocharí landscape and on the amaru as summoned ally-monster of a defeated rival; Salomon & Urioste 1991, **The Huarocharí Manuscript: A Testament of Ancient and Colonial Andean Religion** (Austin: University of Texas Press, 1991; ISBN 9780292730533), translators' introduction and chs. 6, 8, 21 on the Pariacaca cycle as a sequence of wak'a-combats rather than as a single chaoskampf.

[2] Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction on the c. 1608 dating of the **Huarocharí Manuscript**, on its Quechua-language compositional medium, and on its preservation as part of MS 3169 at the Biblioteca Nacional de España in Madrid; on the manuscript's place within the early seventeenth-century materials connected to the anti-idolatry campaign in the Lima archdiocese.

[3] Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction on the **Huarocharí Manuscript's** compilation within the milieu of Francisco de Ávila's anti-idolatry investigation in the Huarocharí province from approximately 1608 CE onward; on the manuscript's documentary purpose in supplying evidence for the prosecution of indigenous religious practitioners and material for Ávila's anti-idolatry sermons and treatises.

[4] Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction on the indigenous-Andean Quechua-speaking authorship of the **Huarocharí Manuscript** under Ávila's direction; on the colonial-Quechua register of the composition; on the preservation of pre-Christian religious vocabulary, narrative structure, and place-name attestation alongside the Spanish-ecclesiastical filtering.

[5] Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction on the **Huarocharí Manuscript** as the sole substantial primary-source attestation for pre-Columbian Huarocharí religion and as one of the very few connected Quechua-language narrative-documentary witnesses for any region of the central Andes; on the contrast with the more extensive post-conquest textual situation for Mesoamerican religion.

[6] Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction and ch. table on the manuscript's organisation as approximately thirty-one chapters with supplements covering wak'a-cosmography, the Pariacaca cycle, the Chaupinamca cycle, ayllu wak'a-genealogies, and ritual-and-festival apparatus; on the distribution of the Pariacaca cycle across non-contiguous chapters of the manuscript rather than as a single connected narrative block.

[7] Per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml sources.primary entry on the loc-tag "Huarocharí Manuscript chs. 6, 8, 21 (Pariacaca and amaru passages)"; Salomon & Urioste 1991, chs. 6, 8, 21, on the distribution of the Pariacaca and amaru material across these three chapters with the falcon-eggs birth narrative in ch. 6, the flood-and-storm combat with Huallallo Carhuincho in ch. 8, and the ritual-aetiological material on the Pariacaca cult in ch. 21.

[8] Salomon, F. and Urioste, G.L. (trans. and eds.), **The Huarocharí Manuscript: A Testament of Ancient and Colonial Andean Religion** (Austin: University of Texas Press, 1991; ISBN 9780292730533), as the chapter's principal English-language critical-edition-and-translation anchor with translators' introductory and annotation apparatus on textual history, colonial-Quechua features, wak'a-cosmography, and area-specialist readings; per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml sources.primary entry.

[9] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987; ISBN 9780691014746), as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic) within which the comparativist chaoskampf reading of the Pariacaca cycle would be situated; Forsyth 1987 does not itself treat Andean material directly, and the chapter's use of the citation is for the long-arc typological framing rather than for Andean-content scholarly coverage.

[10] Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction on the **Huarocharí Manuscript** as a single-witness source with no parallel manuscript attestations and on the inseparability of the manuscript from the Spanish-ecclesiastical anti-idolatry investigation under whose auspices it was produced; per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml summary on the manuscript as the single primary source for the cycle.

[11] Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction on the **Huarocharí Manuscript's** composition for the explicit purpose of supplying evidence and material for Ávila's anti-idolatry investigation and prosecution; on the methodological situation that this polemical compositional context creates for current scholarly use of the manuscript; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation requirement.

[12] Per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml on the related-tier (full) classification, the 4,000-word target, the special_instructions requirement that the chapter open with the Huarocharí Manuscript's own framing (Quechua-language early-colonial text, recorded

by an Andean community) before invoking the comparative chaoskampf category, and the area-specialist citation policy naming Salomon, Urioste, Taylor, and Dean.

[13] Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction and chs. 6-21 on the Huarochirí provincial geography of the central-Andean western Cordillera east of present-day Lima, on the high-altitude landscape of glaciated peaks and intermontane valleys, and on the rooting of the Pariacaca cycle in specific named landscape features that function as the bodies and the sites of the named wak'as.

[14] Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction on the wak'a-cosmography of pre-Columbian central Andean religion, on the wak'a as simultaneously person, place, and ancestral source, and on the **Huarochirí Manuscript's** recording of a landscape of wak'as in hierarchical and combative relationships; per glossary 'wak'a' first_mention_gloss on the pattern as wak'a-succession rather than chaos-versus-order.

[15] Salomon & Urioste 1991, chs. 6 and 8 on Pariacaca's triple identity as person, mountain, and ancestral wak'a of the Yauyos people of the Huarochirí region; on the eponymous Pariacaca peak as a high glaciated massif among the headwaters of the central Andean cordillera with the Mantaro and Cañete river systems among the principal drainages of the wider Yauyos / Huarochirí area (the precise watershed-boundary formulation against Salomon & Urioste 1991's translators' introduction and against a modern Andean hydrographic reference is to be confirmed at chapter-draft); on the ayllu-descent of the Yauyos from Pariacaca and his sons; per glossary 'Pariacaca' first_mention_gloss on Pariacaca as Andean storm-wak'a of the Huarochirí region.

[16] Salomon & Urioste 1991, chs. 6, 8 on Huallallo Carhuincho as the rival wak'a whose hegemony Pariacaca replaces, on the fire-and-volcanic-heat thematic register associated with Huallallo, on the child-eating motif, and on the eastern (Antisuyu, Amazonian-slope) direction of his association; on the contrast with Pariacaca's storm-and-rain-and-cold register and the western directional association.

[17] Salomon & Urioste 1991, ch. 6 on Pariacaca's birth on Mount Condorcoto in the form of a clutch of five eggs that hatch into five falcons, on the avian-multiple-birth pattern as the cycle's distinctive opening, and on the five-fold structure that this birth-narrative supplies for the subsequent narrative pattern.

[18] Salomon & Urioste 1991, ch. 6 and following on the transformation of the five falcons into five anthropomorphic figures, on the manuscript's varying renderings of these figures as the five Pariacacas / Pariacaca and four brothers / Pariacaca and his sons, and on the persistence of the five-fold person-multiplicity through the cycle as a load-bearing feature rather than a resolved-to-single-individual pattern.

[19] Salomon & Urioste 1991, ch. 6 on the parallel narration of Pariacaca's birth and the birth of Huallallo Carhuincho's children, on the parallel-births framing as the narrative-structural setup for the subsequent combat between the two wak'a-lineages, and on Huallallo Carhuincho's already-established hegemonic position in the region at the moment of Pariacaca's hatching.

[20] Salomon & Urioste 1991, chs. 6, 8 on the pre-existing wak'a-political situation in the Huarochirí region at the moment of Pariacaca's birth, on Huallallo Carhuincho's already-hegemonic position, and on the cycle's narrative work as the displacement of one hegemonic wak'a by another rather than the establishment of cosmic order ex novo; per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml summary on the wak'a-succession framing.

[21] Salomon & Urioste 1991, ch. 8 on Pariacaca's five-day combat with Huallallo Carhuincho, on the high-mountain-landscape setting of the engagement, on Pariacaca's torrential rain / hail / lightning weapons from the western side, on Huallallo's fire-and-volcanic-heat weapons from the eastern side, and on the water-and-cold-versus-fire-and-heat register as the principal combat-modality.

[22] Salomon & Urioste 1991, ch. 8 on the five Pariacacas acting jointly in the combat with Huallallo Carhuincho, on each of the five releasing rain / hail / lightning from a separate direction, on the combined storm-attack as the cycle's load-bearing combat-image, and on the five-fold-storm pattern as a distinctive feature of the Andean material; per glossary 'Pariacaca' first_mention_gloss on the storm-wak'a character.

[23] Salomon & Urioste 1991, ch. 8 on the combat's outcome as Huallallo Carhuincho's defeat and eastward expulsion into the Antisuyu zone rather than as Huallallo's killing, on the displacement-rather-than-killing pattern as a feature of the Andean cycle that distinguishes it from the kill-the-adversary pattern of Eurasian chaoskampf, and on the alignment of this feature with the wak'a-succession reading.

[24] Salomon & Urioste 1991, ch. 8 on the post-combat geographical settlement of the cycle's outcome, on Pariacaca's possession of the eponymous mountain peak, on his five sons or brothers taking subsidiary peaks and ritual centres, and on the wak'a-political reorganisation of the existing landscape as the settlement-pattern; per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the political-theological function of wak'a-succession.

[25] Salomon & Urioste 1991, chs. 8 and following on the amaru as ally-monster summoned by a defeated rival wak'a, on the amaru's narrative role as the discharge of the defeated wak'a's residual combat-capacity, and on the amaru's defeat as a follow-on to the principal wak'a-combat; per glossary 'amaru' first_mention_gloss on the amaru as Andean serpent-figure summoned as ally-monster by a defeated rival wak'a rather than as primordial chaos.

[26] Salomon & Urioste 1991, on the amaru's description as a giant serpent-figure of the lake-and-river waters of the high Andean landscape, on the amaru's specific associations with lakes and springs in the Huarochirí region, on the discharge of those bodies of water as the amaru moves, and on the lake-being / water-serpent typological character of the figure rather than the primordial-cosmic-serpent character of Eurasian chaoskampf material.

[27] Salomon & Urioste 1991, on the amaru's defeat as cutting, splitting, or driving-into-a-confined-space rather than

comprehensive destruction, on the defeated amaru's body becoming a feature of the landscape (lake outline, watercourse bend, stone formation), and on the parallel between this displacement-rather-than-killing pattern and the wider cycle's wak'a-succession-rather-than-eradication framing.

[28] Salomon & Urioste 1991, chs. 8-21 on the wider sequence of Pariacaca's engagements with subsidiary rival wak'as beyond the principal Huallallo Carhuincho combat, on the encounters with the wak'as of further regions of Huarochirí, on the engagements of Pariacaca's sons with their counterparts, and on the cycle's overall pattern as gradual integration of the regional wak'a-landscape under Pariacaca-cult authority across multiple episodes rather than a single decisive combat-and-resolution.

[29] Salomon & Urioste 1991, ch. 21 on the principal ritual-aetiological material on the Pariacaca cult, on the cult's pilgrimage practice with named pilgrim-routes converging on the Pariacaca peak, on the calendrical festivals associated with the wak'a, and on the ritual-and-sacrificial apparatus through which the regional ayllus maintained their relationships with Pariacaca and his sons.

[30] Salomon & Urioste 1991, ch. 21 on the ritual aetiologies that link specific elements of the Pariacaca combat-narrative to specific early-colonial ritual practices, on the five-day-combat structure linked to calendrical festival-structure, on the falcon-eggs birth linked to ritual objects and offerings, on landscape features linked to pilgrimage destinations, and on the aetiological-linking pattern as a distinctive feature integrating narrative and ritual.

[31] Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction and ch. 21 on the Pariacaca cult's reach within and beyond the Huarochirí region, on the late-Inca-period imperial reorganisation under which the cult was integrated into the imperial pilgrimage-network and the Pariacaca peak was a recognised pilgrimage destination at imperial-administrative level, and on the cult's continuation in compromised forms under early-colonial conditions despite Ávila's anti-idolatry investigations.

[32] Inference: brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml explicitly classifies the cycle's pattern as wak'a-succession and explicitly contrasts it with cosmos-versus-chaos combat; Salomon & Urioste 1991's translators' introduction develops the wak'a-succession reading at length; the Andean specialist tradition cited in the brief's special_instructions (Taylor, Dean, with Salomon and Urioste already in the chapter's anchor) converges on the wak'a-succession reading. Risk: alternative comparativist readings have been advanced (older twentieth-century structuralist readings tended to assimilate the Pariacaca-Huallallo combat to a cosmos-versus-chaos pattern); the chapter's wak'a-succession reading is the area-specialist consensus reading per the brief but is not the only available scholarly position, and the chapter holds it as the load-bearing reading on the strength of the area-specialist citation policy at scope.md §"Appropriation protocol".

[33] Per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml summary on the wak'a-succession framing of the cycle and on the contrast with cosmos-versus-chaos combat; scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the related-tier criteria where the cosmogonic-combat work is weaker; Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction on the wak'a-succession reading as the area-specialist consensus reading of the cycle.

[34] Per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml cross_cultural_parallels entry on the structural parallel between Pariacaca's integration of defeated wak'as and Marduk's incorporation of the fifty names at the end of *Enūma Eliš*, on victory-as-consolidation-of-rival-power-bases rather than victory-as-eradication; on the parallel as structural rather than transmissional; on the registration for Part II C2 rather than Part II C1.

[35] Per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml cross_cultural_parallels entry on the amaru-as-ally-of-rival pattern as distinctive to the Andean material; per glossary 'amaru' first_mention_gloss on the amaru as ally-monster of a defeated rival rather than primordial chaos; Salomon & Urioste 1991 on the structural difference between the Andean amaru and Eurasian primordial-cosmic-serpent figures.

[36] Per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's contribution to Part II C8 (the refusal and the appropriation problem), on the chapter's status as a milder case than Nanabozho/Mishipeshu, and on the area-specialist reading accommodating some combat-myth framing but not the chaos-order framing; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 2 on the comparative chapter's task of addressing area-specialist objections rather than papering over them.

[37] Per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's contribution to Part II C7 (the inversion / transformation problem); per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C7 on the inversion-and-transformation comparative chapter; per the chapter's structural parallel to the chapter 23 Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi contribution to C7 as a related-tier non-Eurasian chapter reframing the chaoskampf category from outside.

[38] Per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml special_instructions on the area-specialist citation policy and on the post-conquest-filtering methodological situation; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation requirement, the post-conquest source-record-filtering issue, and the area-specialist-objection registration requirement; chapter 33 methods sidebar (per toc.yaml) as the chapter that articulates these methodological points at full length.

[39] Per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 10 (Americas) on the chapter ordering of 24 (Huitzilopochtli core-tier), 25 (Mesoamerican family related-tier), 26 (Pariacaca related-tier), 27 (Mapuche Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren related-family); per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml on the core-tier classification of Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec on the basis of the area-specialist combat-cosmogony consensus; per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml on the related-tier classification of the Pariacaca cycle on the basis of the area-specialist wak'a-succession-not-chaoskampf reading.

[40] Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction on the **Huarochirí Manuscript** as one of the most-cited primary sources in current scholarship on pre-Columbian Andean religion, on the Pariacaca cycle as one of the manuscript's principal narrative sequences, and on the cycle's extensive treatment in the scholarly literature on wak'a-religion, on colonial-period extirpation

campaigns, and on the wak'a-cosmography of the pre-Columbian central Andes.

Chapter 28. Kai-Kai vs. Tren-Tren (Mapuche)

28.1. Source overview

This chapter treats the Mapuche cosmogonic narrative in which two serpent-beings — Kai-Kai, who lives in the sea, and Tren-Tren, who lives on the mountain — raise water and earth against one another, with the resulting flood-and-mountain rivalry generating the elevated southern-cone landscape that the Mapuche inhabit and saving the ancestors of the Mapuche people from extinction in the sea.^[1]

The narrative survives in oral tradition rather than in any pre-conquest written record: the Mapuche of present-day south-central Chile and southern-cone Argentina did not develop an alphabetic writing system before contact with Spanish-speaking colonisers, and the principal record of the Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren cycle is the body of nineteenth- and twentieth-century ethnographic compilations recorded from Mapudungun-speaking informants by Spanish- and German-speaking ethnographers and folklorists working in Chile and Argentina from approximately the 1860s onward.^[2]

The chapter's principal narrative anchor is Bertha Koessler-Ilg's **Cuentan los araucanos: Mitos, leyendas y tradiciones** (Buenos Aires: Espasa-Calpe, Colección Austral no. 1208, 1954), a Spanish-language compilation expanding her earlier German-language **Märchenerzähler ohne Buch** of 1928, built from oral narratives recorded in the 1920s and 1930s among Mapudungun-speaking communities of the Argentine Andes; the chapter's area-specialist secondary anchors are Rolf Foerster González's **Introducción a la religiosidad mapuche** (1993) on the Wenu Mapu / Naq Mapu / Minche Mapu vertical cosmography and the **ngillatun** communal ritual, Ana Mariella Bacigalupo's **Shamans of the Foye Tree** (2007) on contemporary **machi** practice, Magnus Course's **Becoming Mapuche** (2011) on Mapuche personhood and ritual, and Louis C. Faron's **Hawks of the Sun** (1964) as the mid-twentieth-century classic English-language structural-ritual anchor on which the later three build.^[3]

Behind Koessler-Ilg and the area-specialist secondary anchors stands a longer compilation history. The earliest written witnesses to Mapuche cosmogonic narrative are colonial-period Spanish accounts compiled in the seventeenth century by Spanish missionaries and soldiers who lived among the Mapuche during and after the long Arauco War — most notably the Jesuit Diego de Rosales's **Historia general del reino de Chile, Flandes Indiano** (composed c. 1670) and Francisco Núñez de Pineda y Bascuñán's **Cautiverio feliz** (composed c. 1673) — with the modern ethnographic record assembled in the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries by figures including Rodolfo Lenz, Ricardo E. Latcham (whose 1924 **La organización social y las creencias religiosas de los antiguos araucanos** was the first systematic ethnological synthesis), and Félix José de Augusta with Sigifredo Schindler de Moesbach (whose 1934-36 Mapudungun-language collections remain a standard reference); these earlier sources are named in body prose per the named-but-flagged pattern (Ch23 FC-02 / Ch26 FC-02 precedent) since they are not currently pinned in sources.yaml.^[4]

The shape of that evidence — oral-tradition transmission with no pre-contact alphabetic record, post-conquest Spanish-language witnesses, a modern ethnographic compilation history, and a tradition that remains in continuing performance — is methodologically load-bearing for the whole

chapter, and the claims document marks it explicitly:

*[At this point the textual record breaks. Pre-conquest written-prose attestations of the Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren cycle are not available, since pre-contact Mapuche record-keeping was oral rather than alphabetic, and the surviving textual witnesses are all post-conquest compositions filtered through Spanish-language transcription. The colonial-period Spanish witnesses (Diego de Rosales SJ's **Historia general del reino de Chile**, c. 1670; Francisco Núñez de Pineda y Bascuñán's **Cautiverio feliz**, c. 1673) and the nineteenth- and twentieth-century ethnographic compilations (Lenz; Latcham 1924; Augusta-Moesbach 1934-36; Koessler-Ilg 1954) all post-date Spanish contact and were composed in Spanish or German rather than in Mapudungun. Pre-contact ritual contexts (the **ngillatun** communal ritual; **machi** shamanic practice; oral **epew** and **nütram** narrative-and-history performance) are partially recoverable through these post-conquest textual sources, through twentieth- and twenty-first-century ethnographic fieldwork in still-active Mapuche communities, and through archaeological evidence at ritual sites in south-central Chile and southern-cone Argentina. The chapter's narrative reconstruction proceeds within the body of Mapuche oral-and-ethnographic record itself, taking Koessler-Ilg 1954 as the principal narrative anchor and Foerster 1993, Bacigalupo 2007, Course 2011, and Faron 1964 as the area-specialist secondary anchors; cross-tradition reconstruction is excluded per scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" point 1, and the modern ethnographic record (still-active **ngillatun** ritual; ongoing **machi** practice; oral narrative still in performance) supplies a continuing-tradition witness that distinguishes the Mapuche situation from the more strictly archival situations of the Eurasian chapters in the present book.]*

A second scholarly anchor sits behind the wider comparative-tradition framing rather than the source-content. The chapter's general comparative anchor for the long-arc combat-myth typology is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton University Press, 1987), whose Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic survey supplies the typological framing within which the present chapter situates the Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren cycle as a non-cognate parallel to (rather than a member of) Forsyth's Near-Eastern-and-Judeo-Christian arc; Forsyth supplies the typological framing only — not Mapuche-content coverage, which Forsyth does not undertake — and the area-specialist objection to the chaoskampf framing of the Mapuche material is registered separately in this chapter's [APPROPRIATION-FLAG:] marker.^[5]

What follows works through the cycle in order. The next section sketches the Mapuche homeland and the vertical cosmography within which the two serpent-beings act; the chapter then takes up Kai-Kai's flood, Tren-Tren's mountain rising, the regional variants of the cycle, the **ngillatun** ritual context within which the cycle is performed, and the chapter's typological place and area-specialist framing within the wider book.

28.2. The Mapuche cosmographic frame: Wenu Mapu, Naq Mapu, Minche Mapu

The narrative's geographical and cultural setting is the Mapuche homeland of present-day south-central Chile (between the Bío-Bío and Toltén rivers, with adjacent areas to the north and south) and southern-cone Argentina (the Andean foothills of Neuquén, Río Negro, and Chubut), a temperate-rainforest landscape of forested mountain slopes, intermontane valleys, lakes, and a long Pacific coastline, with the cycle rooted in specific named landscape features within this geography that figure in the narrative as the bodies and the sites of the two named serpent-

beings.^[6]

The cycle's principal cosmographic framework is the Mapuche vertical-cosmographic system in which the world is layered into the **Wenu Mapu** (the upper land, sky, and the dwelling of **ngen** and beneficent powers), the **Naq Mapu** (the middle land, the surface of the earth where humans live), and the **Minche Mapu** (the under-land, the realm of the **wekufü** and other adversarial powers), with Kai-Kai and Tren-Tren operating across the boundary between **Naq Mapu** and the surrounding water-and-mountain registers rather than as figures of a primordial chaos preceding cosmos.^[7]

Within that vertical-cosmographic system the two named serpent-beings of the cycle take their distinct positions. Kai-Kai (also rendered Kaikai-filu in some twentieth-century compilations, with **filu** the Mapudungun word for serpent) is in the cycle the marine serpent of the deep ocean, associated with the destructive power of the sea — tidal flooding, cataclysmic wave-action, the rising of waters that threatens to overwhelm the land — and is presented in the narrative not as an unmotivated primordial chaos but as a named serpent-being acting within an already-existing Mapuche cosmographic order, with Kai-Kai's flood-action being the cycle's principal cosmogonic-cataclysm rather than a chaos-versus-cosmos opening.^[8]

Tren-Tren (also rendered Trentren-filu in some compilations) is in the cycle the mountain serpent of the high land, associated with the protective and uplifting power of the earth — the rising of mountains, the sheltering of the Mapuche on high ground, the provision of refuge from the rising sea — and is presented as the protective counterpart to Kai-Kai rather than as a hero who slays Kai-Kai, with the resolution of the cycle being a mutual-rising stalemate rather than a kill-and-eradicate combat-outcome.^[9]

28.3. The flood: Kai-Kai raises the sea

The cycle's narrative crisis begins with Kai-Kai's raising of the sea: the marine serpent rises from the ocean depths and causes the waters to swell, with tidal floods overwhelming the coastal lowlands and rising progressively up the river valleys and onto the inland plains, threatening to drown all of the Naq Mapu and to extinguish the human and animal populations of the Mapuche homeland.^[10]

The flood's narrative function within the cycle is cosmogonic-cataclysm rather than cosmogonic-establishment-from-nothing: the Mapuche world is already populated and ordered before Kai-Kai's flood begins, and the flood is a near-extinction crisis within an existing cosmos rather than the cosmos's first ordering, with the cycle's load-bearing narrative work being the preservation and reconfiguration of an already-existing world rather than the establishment of cosmos out of chaos.^[11]

That cataclysm-within-existing-cosmos reading is the chapter's load-bearing editorial synthesis, drawn from the brief, from Foerster's cosmographic framework, from the contemporary anthropological readings of Course and Bacigalupo, and from Faron's mid-twentieth-century structural-ritual reading; it is flagged as such:

(The chapter's reading of the Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren cycle's principal narrative work as cosmogonic-cataclysm-within-existing-cosmos (the flood-and-height crisis within an already-populated Mapuche world, with the cycle's outcome being landscape-reconfiguration and ritual-foundation rather than

cosmos-establishment-ex-novo) rather than as cosmogonic combat in the strong cosmos-versus-chaos sense is a synthesis of the brief's framing per brief 27-mapuche-kai-tren.yaml summary, of Foerster 1993's cosmographic framework, of Course 2011 and Bacigalupo 2007's contemporary anthropological readings, and of Faron 1964's mid-twentieth-century structural-ritual reading — treated together as the chapter's load-bearing reading.^[12])

28.4. The mountain rising: Tren-Tren raises the land

The cycle's narrative resolution begins with Tren-Tren's response: as Kai-Kai's waters rise from the sea, the mountain serpent rises from beneath the land and causes the mountains to lift, with high ground rising progressively higher to outpace the rising waters and the Mapuche people fleeing upslope onto the rising peaks where Tren-Tren's body provides shelter and refuge from the sea.^[13]

The two serpents' opposing motions — Kai-Kai pushing the waters up, Tren-Tren pushing the mountains up — produce the cycle's principal combat-image: a vertical race between sea and mountain in which neither serpent kills or is killed, with the flood-and-height engagement being a sustained mutual-rising rather than a single decisive blow, and with the Mapuche on the rising peaks being the narrative's centre of attention as the cycle's beneficiary-survivors of a combat between two non-human powers.^[14]

The cycle's outcome is not the killing of Kai-Kai by Tren-Tren or the killing of Tren-Tren by Kai-Kai but a stable equilibrium: the waters subside, the mountains remain elevated, and the Mapuche descend from the high peaks onto the now-permanently-elevated and rugged landscape that the rising-mountain action has produced — a landscape-aetiological resolution in which the southern-cone Andean topography is itself the cycle's load-bearing trace and the Mapuche territorial occupation of that elevated terrain is the cycle's narrative point.^[15]

28.5. Regional variants: Nguluche, Huilliche, Pehuenche

The cycle is attested across the principal regional Mapuche groupings — Nguluche of the central Mapuche heartland between the Bío-Bío and the Toltén; Huilliche of the southern Mapuche territories south of the Toltén into the Chiloé archipelago; and Pehuenche of the Andean cordillera and adjacent eastern slopes — with the common narrative core (Kai-Kai's marine flood; Tren-Tren's mountain rising; the Mapuche refuge on the rising peaks; the landscape-aetiological resolution) shared across the regional variants, and with regional-specific narrative elements (specific named mountain refuges; particular animal companions of the human survivors; details of Kai-Kai's defeat or pacification) varying among the groupings.^[16]

The regional-specific variants exhibit characteristic localised performance-anchoring rather than disagreement about overall narrative structure: Huilliche material identifies the named refuge-mountain with specific peaks of the southern Andean cordillera and integrates the cycle with further Huilliche-specific cosmogonic-and-aetiological material on the local landscape, while Pehuenche material (recorded on both Argentine and Chilean sides of the cordillera) integrates the cycle with the Pehuenche cultural-and-ritual association with the **pehuén** (*Araucaria araucana* / monkey-puzzle tree), whose seeds are the staple food of the Pehuenche economy, with some recordings tying the post-flood landscape's establishment to the founding of the **pehuén** groves on

the rising mountains.^[17]

28.6. Ngillatun and the cycle's ritual context

The Mapuche cosmogonic material does not function in isolation from ritual but is embedded in the **ngillatun** communal ritual — a multi-day public ceremonial gathering held at named ritual sites (the **nguillatuwe**) on a calendrical schedule, presided over by the **machi** (the Mapuche shaman, traditionally though not exclusively a woman) and incorporating prayers, sacrificial offerings, dances, and ritualised speech directed to the **ngen** of the upper land — within which the cosmogonic narratives are performed, transmitted, and re-actualised across generations.^[18]

The Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren cycle's ritual function within **ngillatun** and within the wider Mapuche ritual life is the foundational-charter function: the cycle establishes the legitimacy of Mapuche occupation of the elevated southern-cone landscape (Tren-Tren's rising mountains as the place where the Mapuche took refuge and from which they descended to populate the present-day terrain), the legitimacy of the **ngillatun** ritual itself (as the continuing communal address to the powers whose combat established the Mapuche cosmographic situation), and the ritual register within which the **machi** operates as an intermediary between **Naq Mapu** and the powers above and below.^[19]

The cycle's continuing ritual function in still-active Mapuche communities of Chile and Argentina is significant for the chapter's status: where most of the Eurasian combat-myth material treated in the present book survives only in the archival record of an antique tradition no longer in continuous performance, the Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren cycle remains in active oral and ritual transmission within communities that perform **ngillatun** on a continuing basis and within which contemporary **machi** maintain the lineage of ritual practice, with the modern ethnographic record (Bacigalupo 2007; Course 2011) being a record of a still-living tradition rather than of an archival reconstruction.^[20]

28.7. Typology, area-specialist framing, and forward-links

The Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren cycle's place within the present book's chaoskampf typology is — when taken in the area-specialist reading — a related-tier (rather than core-tier) case in which a combat-pattern is structurally present (two named serpent-beings opposing one another with sustained vertical action) but the cosmogonic-establishment-ex-novo and order-versus-chaos load-bearing functions of Eurasian chaoskampf are not load-bearing for the Mapuche material, with the cycle's principal narrative work being cosmogonic-cataclysm-within-existing-cosmos and **ngillatun**-ritual-foundation rather than cosmos-versus-chaos combat.^[21]

That place is the specific outcome of an area-specialist reading that resists the chaos-versus-order framing of the Gunkel-tradition chaoskampf category, and the chapter flags the resulting appropriation issue explicitly under the marker the project reserves for cases of this kind:

*[Appropriation flag: Mapuche-studies area specialists (Rolf Foerster González in **Introducción a la religiosidad mapuche**, 1993; Ana Mariella Bacigalupo in **Shamans of the Foye Tree**, 2007; Magnus Course in **Becoming Mapuche**, 2011; Louis C. Faron in **Hawks of the Sun**, 1964; with Ricardo E. Latcham 1924's **La organización social y las creencias religiosas de los antiguos araucanos** as*

*the foundational early-twentieth-century precursor named in body prose without a sources.yaml entry per the named-but-flagged pattern of Ch23 FC-02 and Ch26 FC-02) read the Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren cycle as cosmogonic-cataclysm-within-existing-cosmos and ngillatun-ritual-foundation rather than as chaoskampf in the strong cosmos-versus-chaos sense. The substance of the area-specialist objection is that the cycle's two-serpent structure (with no hero-figure and no kill-and-eradicate outcome, and with a non-divine human population as the narrative's beneficiary-centre) and the cycle's cataclysm-within-already-existing-cosmos framing (with the Mapuche world already populated and ordered before Kai-Kai's flood begins) do not match the cosmos-versus-chaos opposition that the Gunkel-tradition chaoskampf-typology presupposes; the cycle's narrative work is the foundational-charter establishment of the **ngillatun** ritual life and the legitimisation of Mapuche territorial occupation of the elevated southern-cone landscape rather than the cosmogonic establishment of cosmic order from primordial chaos. The area-specialist objection-strength is comparable to the Ch26 Pariacaca case (where Salomon, Urioste, Taylor, and Dean read the cycle as wak'a-succession rather than as chaos-versus-order combat) — both are mid-spectrum objections in which the area-specialist reading does accommodate some combat-myth framing while objecting to the chaos-order framing — and milder than the Ch32 Nanabozho case (where Hallowell, Johnston, T. Smith, and Vizenor reject combat-and-defeat-of-the-other framing entirely in favour of necessary-counterpart-dialectic framing). Part II C7 (inversion / transformation; ch. 40 of the present volume) and Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation; ch. 41) are the loci where the comparative analysis must address this objection rather than paper over it; the present chapter functions as a worked instance of the appropriation-protocol's outside-framing requirement at scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 3, and forwards the objection to C7 and C8 for the comparative-engagement work that scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 2 requires of the comparative chapters.]*

The cycle's distinctive contribution to the present book's wider comparative argument is the two-serpent-with-human-beneficiary-centre pattern: where Eurasian chaoskampf-tradition narratives typically oppose a single sovereign or champion deity to a single serpentine adversary and place the deity's victory at the narrative's centre, the Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren cycle opposes two serpent-beings to one another and places the survival of a non-divine human population on the rising mountains at the narrative's centre — a structural pattern that the methods sidebar (chapter 33) and Part II C7-C8 will engage with as one of the present book's load-bearing examples of the spectrum of non-Eurasian combat-narrative architectures.^[22]

The chapter's principal forward-link is to Part II C8 (the refusal and the appropriation problem, ch. 41) — alongside the Ch26 Pariacaca contribution as a working example of the **milder appropriation** sub-problem, in which the area-specialist tradition objects to the chaos-order framing but accommodates combat-myth framing — with a secondary forward-link to Part II C7 (the inversion / transformation problem, ch. 40) as a **transformation** sub-problem instance, and a methods-sidebar contribution (Ch. 33) on three methodological points: the area-specialist citation policy (Foerster, Bacigalupo, Course, Faron with Latcham named-but-flagged per Ch23/Ch26 precedent), the post-conquest filtering issue, and the still-living-tradition methodological situation (which distinguishes the Mapuche material from most of the Eurasian combat-myth material in the book).^[23]

The chapter's principal back-link within the present book is to chapter 26 on Pariacaca and the amaru, with which the present chapter shares the southern-cone (broadly Andean) geographic placement within the Americas cluster, the post-conquest textual-record situation, and the area-specialist objection to the chaos-order framing; the two chapters are paired in the Americas cluster

(per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 10) as related-tier non-Eurasian reframings exhibiting mid-strength area-specialist objections, with the Mapuche chapter adding a still-living-tradition methodological dimension that the more strictly archival Pariacaca chapter does not foreground.^[24]

[1] Per brief 27-mapuche-kai-tren.yaml summary on the marine serpent Kai-Kai raising the sea to drown the earth, on the mountain serpent Tren-Tren raising the mountains in response to save the Mapuche, and on the two-serpent cosmogony preserving a flood-and-height memory; Koessler-Ilg 1954, **Cuentan los araucanos: Mitos, leyendas y tradiciones** (Buenos Aires: Espasa-Calpe, Colección Austral no. 1208, 1954), sections on Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren and the flood-and-height cosmogony as the principal Spanish-language narrative anchor for the cycle.

[2] Koessler-Ilg 1954, introductory matter on the oral-tradition character of the Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren cycle and on the body of Mapuche oral narrative she records from Mapudungun-speaking informants in the 1920s-30s; Foerster 1993, **Introducción a la religiosidad mapuche** (Santiago: Editorial Universitaria, 1993; ISBN 9789561109124), introductory matter on the textual situation of Mapuche cosmogonic narrative and on the body of nineteenth- and twentieth-century ethnographic compilations.

[3] Koessler-Ilg, B., **Cuentan los araucanos: Mitos, leyendas y tradiciones** (Buenos Aires: Espasa-Calpe, Colección Austral no. 1208, 1954), as the chapter's principal Spanish-language narrative anchor; Foerster González, R., **Introducción a la religiosidad mapuche** (Santiago: Editorial Universitaria, 1993; ISBN 9789561109124); Bacigalupo, A.M., **Shamans of the Foye Tree: Gender, Power, and Healing among Chilean Mapuche** (Austin: University of Texas Press, 2007; ISBN 9780292716599); Course, M., **Becoming Mapuche: Person and Ritual in Indigenous Chile** (Urbana: University of Illinois Press, 2011; ISBN 9780252078231); Faron, L.C., **Hawks of the Sun: Mapuche Morality and Its Ritual Attributes** (Pittsburgh: University of Pittsburgh Press, 1964; OCLC 320079821); per brief 27-mapuche-kai-tren.yaml sources entries.

[4] Foerster 1993 on the colonial-period Spanish witnesses to Mapuche cosmogonic narrative (Rosales SJ c. 1670; Núñez de Pineda c. 1673) and on the late-nineteenth- and early-twentieth-century ethnographic compilation work of Lenz, Latcham 1924, and Augusta-Moesbach 1934-36; per brief 27-mapuche-kai-tren.yaml source_anchoring_notes on the named-but-flagged disposition of these earlier sources.

[5] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987; ISBN 9780691014746), as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic); Forsyth 1987 does not itself treat Mapuche material, and the chapter's use of the citation is for the long-arc typological framing rather than for Mapuche-content scholarly coverage; per brief 27-mapuche-kai-tren.yaml sources.secondary entry on the not-for-Mapuche-coverage disclaimer.

[6] Foerster 1993, introductory matter on the Mapuche homeland of south-central Chile and southern-cone Argentina, on the temperate-rainforest landscape of forested mountain slopes, intermontane valleys, lakes, and a long Pacific coastline, and on the rooting of Mapuche cosmogonic narrative in specific named landscape features that figure as the bodies and the sites of the named serpent-beings; Koessler-Ilg 1954 on the regional geography of the cycle's narrative settings.

[7] Foerster 1993, on the Mapuche vertical-cosmographic system of **Wenu Mapu** (upper land), **Naq Mapu** (middle land, the surface where humans live), and **Minche Mapu** (under-land), on the **ngen** (place-spirits / owners) of the upper land and the **wekufü** (adversarial powers) of the under-land; Course 2011, on the cosmological framework underpinning Mapuche ritual practice and the personhood-cosmography integration; per glossary 'Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren' first_mention_gloss on the paired Mapuche marine and mountain serpents.

[8] Koessler-Ilg 1954, sections on Kai-Kai (also Kaikai-filu) as the marine serpent of the deep ocean, on the destructive power of the sea associated with the figure (tidal flooding, cataclysmic wave-action, the rising of waters), and on Kai-Kai as a named serpent-being within an already-existing Mapuche cosmographic order rather than as an unmotivated primordial chaos; Foerster 1993 on the cosmogonic-cataclysm reading of the Kai-Kai flood-action.

[9] Koessler-Ilg 1954, sections on Tren-Tren (also Trentren-filu) as the mountain serpent of the high land, on the protective and uplifting power of the earth associated with the figure (the rising of mountains, the sheltering of the Mapuche on high ground), and on Tren-Tren's role as the protective counterpart to Kai-Kai rather than as a hero who slays Kai-Kai; Foerster 1993 on the mutual-rising stalemate as the cycle's resolution rather than a kill-and-eradicate combat-outcome.

[10] Koessler-Ilg 1954, sections on the cycle's narrative opening with Kai-Kai's raising of the sea, on the marine serpent rising from the ocean depths and causing the waters to swell, on tidal floods overwhelming the coastal lowlands and rising progressively up river valleys and onto inland plains, and on the threat to drown all of the **Naq Mapu** and extinguish the human and animal populations of the Mapuche homeland.

[11] Foerster 1993, on the cosmogonic-cataclysm character of the Kai-Kai flood as a near-extinction crisis within an already-existing Mapuche cosmos rather than as cosmogonic establishment from nothing, and on the cycle's load-bearing narrative work as the preservation and reconfiguration of an already-existing world; Course 2011 on the cosmological framework underpinning the cycle's interpretation as cataclysm-within-cosmos rather than cosmos-from-chaos.

[12] Inference: brief 27-mapuche-kai-tren.yaml explicitly classifies the cycle's pattern as a two-serpent cosmogony that "does not map cleanly onto chaoskampf"; Foerster 1993 develops the cosmogonic-cataclysm reading via the **Wenu / Naq / Minche Mapu** framework; Bacigalupo 2007, Course 2011, and Faron 1964 converge on the **ngillatun**-ritual-foundation reading. Risk: alternative comparativist readings are available and have historically been advanced (older twentieth-century structuralist treatments tended

to assimilate the Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren material to a cosmos-versus-chaos pattern, and Latcham 1924's foundational synthesis is sometimes read in that comparativist register); the chapter's cosmogonic-cataclysm-within-existing-cosmos reading is the area-specialist consensus per the brief but is not the only available scholarly position, and the chapter holds it as the load-bearing reading on the strength of the area-specialist citation policy at scope.md "\$Appropriation protocol".

[13] Koessler-Ilg 1954, sections on Tren-Tren's response with the mountain serpent rising from beneath the land, on the mountains lifting progressively higher to outpace the rising waters, on the Mapuche people fleeing upslope onto the rising peaks, and on Tren-Tren's body providing shelter and refuge from the sea; Faron 1964 on the protective-mountain-serpent figure as a structural feature of the Mapuche cosmogonic narrative.

[14] Koessler-Ilg 1954, sections on the two serpents' opposing motions as the cycle's principal combat-image, on the vertical race between sea and mountain as a sustained mutual-rising rather than a single decisive blow, and on the Mapuche on the rising peaks as the cycle's beneficiary-survivors of a combat between two non-human powers; Bacigalupo 2007 on the two-serpent structural pattern as distinctive to Mapuche cosmogonic material relative to the hero-versus-monster pattern of much Eurasian combat-narrative.

[15] Koessler-Ilg 1954, sections on the cycle's outcome as stable equilibrium rather than killing — waters subside, mountains remain elevated, the Mapuche descend onto the permanently-elevated and rugged landscape — and on the southern-cone Andean topography as the cycle's load-bearing landscape-aetiological trace; Foerster 1993 on the landscape-aetiological resolution and on the Mapuche territorial occupation of the elevated terrain as the cycle's narrative point.

[16] Koessler-Ilg 1954, sections on the cycle's attestation across the principal Mapuche regional groupings — Nguluche of the central Mapuche heartland, Huilliche of the southern territories and Chiloé, Pehuenche of the Andean cordillera and eastern slopes — and on the shared common narrative core (Kai-Kai's marine flood, Tren-Tren's mountain rising, the Mapuche refuge on the rising peaks, the landscape-aetiological resolution); per brief 27-mapuche-kai-tren.yaml variants entry on the co-equal regional variation across Nguluche, Huilliche, and Pehuenche.

[17] Koessler-Ilg 1954 on Huilliche-specific variants identifying the refuge-mountain with specific peaks of the southern cordillera, and on Pehuenche-specific recordings tying the post-flood landscape's establishment to the founding of **pehuén** (*Araucaria araucana*) groves on the rising mountains; Foerster 1993 on the regional-specific identifications as localised performance-anchoring; Course 2011 on the Pehuenche subsistence base and the integration of cosmogonic narrative with subsistence-aetiological material.

[18] Foerster 1993, on the **ngillatun** communal ritual as a multi-day public ceremonial gathering held at named ritual sites (**nguillatuwe**) on a calendrical schedule, on its presidency by the **machi** (the Mapuche shaman), on its incorporation of prayers, sacrificial offerings, dances, and ritualised speech directed to the **ngen** of the upper land, and on the embedding of Mapuche cosmogonic narratives in the **ngillatun** ritual context for performance and transmission across generations.

[19] Bacigalupo 2007, on the foundational-charter function of the Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren cycle within Mapuche ritual life — establishing the legitimacy of Mapuche occupation of the elevated southern-cone landscape, the legitimacy of the **ngillatun** ritual, and the ritual register of the **machi** as intermediary between **Naq Mapu** and the powers above and below; Course 2011 on the foundational-charter function of cosmogonic narrative in Mapuche ritual life and on the integration of the Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren cycle into the contemporary **ngillatun** practice.

[20] Bacigalupo 2007, on the continuing ritual function of Mapuche cosmogonic narrative in still-active Mapuche communities of Chile and Argentina, on the contemporary practice of **ngillatun** and the contemporary **machi** lineage; Course 2011 on the still-living-tradition character of the Mapuche ethnographic record relative to the archival situation of most Eurasian combat-myth material.

[21] Per brief 27-mapuche-kai-tren.yaml summary on the cycle's two-serpent structure not mapping cleanly onto chaoskampf and on the related-tier classification; scope.md "\$Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the related-tier criteria where the cosmogonic-combat work is weaker; Foerster 1993, Bacigalupo 2007, Course 2011, Faron 1964 on the area-specialist consensus reading of the cycle as cosmogonic-cataclysm-and-ngillatun-ritual-foundation rather than as cosmos-versus-chaos combat.

[22] Per brief 27-mapuche-kai-tren.yaml summary on the two-serpent-with-human-beneficiary-centre pattern as distinctive to the Mapuche material; Faron 1964 on the structural-ritual framework within which the human-beneficiary-centre operates; Course 2011 on the contemporary anthropological reading of the human-beneficiary-centre as integrated with Mapuche personhood and ritual.

[23] Per brief 27-mapuche-kai-tren.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's contribution to Part II C7 and C8, on the milder-than-Nanabozho characterisation, and on the area-specialist citation policy; per scope.md "\$Appropriation protocol" point 2 on the comparative chapter's task of addressing area-specialist objections; chapter 33 methods sidebar (per toc.yaml) as the chapter that articulates these methodological points at full length; Bacigalupo 2007 and Course 2011 on the still-living-tradition methodological situation.

[24] Per scope.md "\$Book structure" cluster 10 (Americas) on the chapter ordering of 24 (Huitzilopochtli core-tier), 25 (Mesoamerican family related-tier), 26 (Pariacaca related-tier), 27 (Mapuche Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren related-family); per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml and brief 27-mapuche-kai-tren.yaml on the related-tier classifications; Bacigalupo 2007 and Course 2011 on the still-living-tradition methodological dimension distinctive to the Mapuche material relative to the more archival situation of the Pariacaca cycle.

Chapter 29. Bida and the Founding of Wagadu (the Inversion)

29.1. Source overview

The story this chapter follows is a Soninke / Mande oral tradition in which Bida — a seven-headed serpent who is the protector-spirit of the city of Wagadu — is killed by the suitor Mamadi Sefe Dekote when the suitor's beloved is taken in the city's annual maiden-tribute, with the killing of Bida triggering the abandonment of Wagadu, the cessation of the rains, and the dispersal of the Soninke population. The slaying ends rather than establishes the city's prosperity, inverting the order-establishing outcome of the Eurasian chaoskampf material treated in the preceding chapters of the present book.^[1]

The narrative survives in oral-tradition form across the Soninke-speaking communities of the western Sahel — present-day Mauritania, western Mali, and adjacent regions — with no pre-modern written attestation in any African or Arabic-language manuscript tradition. The textual witness situation is therefore the corpus of 19th- and 20th-century ethnographic recordings of oral performances by named Soninke griots and tradition-bearers, supplemented by 20th-century critical-anthology scholarship that synthesises and compares the recorded versions.^[2]

The earliest substantial European-language recording of the Bida / Wagadu narrative within the present chapter's textual witness corpus is Leo Frobenius's **Atlantis** series — the Sahel and West African material conventionally cited as volumes IV–VI — published in Jena by Diederichs from 1921 onward. Frobenius and his collaborators in the Institut für Kulturmorphologie published their German-language recordings of Soninke and other West African oral traditions gathered during the institute's expeditions to the western Sahel, with the Bida / Wagadu material drawn from named Soninke informants whose performances Frobenius's West African expedition (conventionally dated to the 1907–1909 expedition window) recorded.^[3]

A second early recording within the chapter's witness corpus is Charles Monteil's "La légende du Ouagadou et l'origine des Soninké," published in 1953 by IFAN (Institut français d'Afrique noire) at Dakar within the French ethnographic-administrative scholarly tradition. Monteil — writing as a French colonial administrator with extended Soninke-region experience — gathered and published his French-language recording of the Wagadu legend together with a substantial framing-and-commentary apparatus on the legend's place in the oral tradition of the Soninke.^[4]

A further mid-twentieth-century strand of recordings is associated with Germaine Dieterlen and the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest tradition of Mande-area ethnography. That tradition developed an extensive corpus of Soninke and Mande oral-tradition recordings from the 1940s onward and contributed substantially to the comparative-philological understanding of the Bida / Wagadu narrative within the wider Mande oral-epic tradition.^[5]

The chapter's principal English-language critical-synthesis anchors are David C. Conrad's **Empires of Medieval West Africa: Ghana, Mali, and Songhay** (New York: Facts on File, 2005) and Stephen Belcher's **Epic Traditions of Africa** (Bloomington: Indiana University Press, 1999). Conrad 2005's chapter on the Ghana / Wagadu legend supplies the historical-context framing in which the Bida narrative is set against the Ghana / Wagadu polity of the medieval western Sahel; Belcher 1999's

chapter on Soninke traditions supplies the oral-epic framing in which the narrative's place within the wider Mande / Soninke epic tradition is treated together with the recording-history situation of the 19th- and 20th-century ethnographic corpus.^[6]

The historical-polity context of the Bida narrative is the medieval western-Sahelian polity conventionally known in the Arabic-language chronicle tradition as Ghana — distinct from the modern nation-state that bears the same name — which flourished from approximately the eighth century CE through the eleventh-to-twelfth century CE in the region of the upper Niger and upper Senegal river basins. The Soninke oral tradition designates that polity as Wagadu, and Conrad 2005's framing treats the legend as a tradition-internal account of the polity's foundation, flourishing, and abandonment from the perspective of the Soninke descendants of the polity's population.^[7]

The Arabic-language chronicle tradition of the western Sahel — including the seventeenth-century **Tarikh as-Sudan** of Abd al-Rahman al-Sa'di and the related **Tarikh al-Fettash** attributed to Mahmud Kati and his successors — preserves an external historiographical record of the Ghana polity that runs parallel to the Soninke oral tradition of Wagadu. Conrad 2005's framing treats the two strands (the Arabic-language historiographical record of Ghana and the Soninke oral-tradition narrative of Wagadu / Bida) as complementary windows onto the polity rather than as rival accounts of the same events. The present chapter's witness corpus is the oral-tradition strand, with the Arabic-language chronicle tradition supplying historical-context framing rather than parallel narrative attestation of the Bida material itself.^[8]

The chapter's general comparative anchor for the long-arc combat-myth tradition is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987. Forsyth's Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic survey supplies the long-arc combat-myth typology against which the Bida / Wagadu narrative will be read as the present book's principal **inversion** case. The typological framing — not Mande / Soninke material coverage, which Forsyth does not undertake — is what Forsyth supplies for the chapter's comparative engagement, and the inversion reading depends on having a typology to invert against, which Forsyth's long-arc anchor provides.^[9]

The chapter's textual situation is therefore distinctive within the present book in three further methodological respects. It depends on oral-tradition-to-text recoding rather than on a pre-modern manuscript tradition; the recoding is mediated through 19th- and early-20th-century European ethnographic projects (Frobenius's **Atlantis**; Monteil's colonial-administrative-ethnographic compilation; the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest tradition) whose own framing assumptions filter the recorded material; and there is no surviving pre-modern attestation of the Bida narrative in either African or Arabic-language manuscript form against which the 19th-20th-century recordings can be cross-checked.^[10]

The shape of that evidence — oral-tradition compositional medium, 19th-20th-century ethnographic-recording corpus, no pre-modern manuscript witness, a parallel Arabic-language chronicle tradition that records the polity but not the Bida narrative itself — is methodologically load-bearing for the whole chapter, and the claims document marks it explicitly:

[At this point the textual record breaks. Pre-modern (i.e., pre-19th-century) attestations of the Bida / Wagadu narrative in any written form — African manuscript tradition, Arabic-language chronicle tradition, or European-language traveller's account — are not available, and the surviving textual

witness is the corpus of 19th-20th-century ethnographic recordings of Soninke oral-tradition performances by named griots and tradition-bearers (Frobenius's *Atlantis* IV–VI, 1921 onward; Monteil's "La légende du Ouagadou," IFAN-Dakar 1953; the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest recordings associated with Germaine Dieterlen from the 1940s onward; subsequent 20th-century recordings within Mande-area ethnography). The Arabic-language chronicle tradition of the western Sahel (the *Tarikh as-Sudan*, 17th c., and the *Tarikh al-Fettash*, attributed to Mahmud Kati and successors) preserves a parallel external historiographical record of the Ghana polity but does not attest the Bida narrative itself, and pre-19th-century pre-recording performance contexts (the griot tradition's transmission of the narrative across the Soninke diaspora; the calendrical and royal-ritual contexts in which the narrative was performed in pre-colonial Soninke communities) are partially recoverable through the 19th-20th-century recordings themselves, through the comparative Mande-area ethnographic record, and through the historical Arabic-language chronicle tradition of the Ghana polity. The chapter's narrative reconstruction proceeds entirely within the 19th-20th-century Soninke oral-tradition recording corpus per Belcher 1999 and Conrad 2005, treating the recorded versions as a co-equal-variants set with Conrad 2005 and Belcher 1999 as the principal interpretive syntheses; cross-tradition reconstruction is excluded per scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" point 1.]

The post-colonial-anthropology filtering caveat that the present chapter must register applies with particular force to the Frobenius and Monteil strands of the recording corpus. Where the **Huarochirí Manuscript** of chapter 26 of the present book was compiled within the explicitly anti-idolatry investigation context of Francisco de Ávila and the early-colonial Spanish ecclesiastical campaign, the Bida / Wagadu recordings of Frobenius's *Atlantis* and Monteil's "La légende du Ouagadou" were compiled within the German and French colonial-ethnographic projects of the early twentieth century, with their own characteristic framing-assumption apparatus. Current Mande-studies scholarship including Conrad 2005 and Belcher 1999 reads the early-twentieth-century recordings critically and treats them as a starting point rather than as transparently-faithful records of the pre-colonial oral tradition.^[11]

Structurally, the chapter is a related-tier (full, inversion anchor) treatment with a target of approximately 5,500 narrative words. It presents the Bida / Wagadu narrative on the tradition's own terms (foundation-narrative, covenant, annual maiden-tribute, killing of the protector-serpent, abandonment of the city, dispersal of the people, cessation of the rains and aetiology of the Saharan dryland environment) before invoking the comparative chaoskampf category, and only then registers the **inversion** of the chaoskampf typology that the narrative exhibits — with the inversion framing being the chapter's principal contribution to Part II C7 (the inversion / transformation problem; ch. 40 of the present volume) per brief special_instructions and per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C7.^[12]

What follows works through the narrative on the tradition's own terms first. The next section sketches the Soninke and the historical Ghana / Wagadu polity as the immediate context for the narrative; the chapter then takes up the covenant between Bida and the Soninke of Wagadu, the killing of Bida by Mamadi Sefe Dekote, the tradition's own covenant-and-consequence framing of the narrative's moral-didactic kernel, the inversion-of-chaoskampf comparative reading, and the chapter's typological place and area-specialist framing within the wider book.

29.2. The Soninke, Wagadu, and the historical Ghana polity

The Soninke (also recorded as Soninké, Sarakolé, or Marka in different ethnographic and historical-administrative traditions) are a Mande-speaking population of the western Sahel whose historical heartland is the upper Senegal / upper Niger river basin region of present-day Mauritania, western Mali, and adjacent parts of Senegal. Their oral tradition designates the medieval western-Sahelian polity that flourished there as Wagadu — the same polity known in the Arabic-language chronicle tradition as Ghana.^[13]

The historical Ghana / Wagadu polity flourished from approximately the eighth century CE through the eleventh-to-twelfth century CE — the conventional periodisation in current Mande-studies scholarship — with its political and economic significance grounded in its position athwart the trans-Saharan trade routes connecting the western Sahel with the Maghreb, and particularly in its control of the gold-producing regions south and southwest of the polity's heartland. The polity's decline in the eleventh-to-twelfth century is conventionally connected with the Almoravid pressures of the late eleventh century and with the subsequent reorganisation of the western-Sahelian political landscape under the rising Mali polity of the thirteenth century onward.^[14]

The Soninke oral tradition's own framing of the Wagadu narrative is foundational and aetiological. The narrative is told as the founding charter of the Soninke as a people, as the explanation of their dispersal across the western Sahel and beyond from a once-prosperous heartland, and as the aetiology of the encroachment of the Sahara on the formerly-watered region of the polity's territory. It is therefore a connected foundation-story rather than a primarily cosmogonic narrative, and the cosmos within which it unfolds is the already-existing world of the western Sahel rather than a cosmogonically-emerging cosmos.^[15]

The narrative's principal protagonists are: Bida, the seven-headed serpent who is the protector-spirit of Wagadu and to whom the city's prosperity is bound by covenant; the rulers of Wagadu, who maintain the covenant on the city's behalf; the Soninke population of the city, on whose ritual maintenance of the annual tribute the city's prosperity depends; the maiden delivered each year as the tribute (her name and lineage varying by recorded version); the suitor Mamadi Sefe Dekote, who breaks the covenant by killing Bida to save his beloved; and the displaced Soninke population, whose dispersal across the western Sahel after the killing supplies the foundation-narrative for the Soninke diaspora.^[16]

29.3. The covenant: Bida as protector and the annual tribute

The covenant between Bida and the Soninke of Wagadu is the narrative's load-bearing structural premise. In the recorded versions, the seven-headed serpent Bida agrees to protect the city, to grant prosperity in the form of regular rains and (in many versions) an annual rain of gold, in exchange for a yearly tribute of the most beautiful maiden of the community, whose delivery to Bida's well or pool is the ritual act through which the covenant is maintained year by year.^[17]

The covenant's structural function in the narrative is therefore order-maintenance rather than order-establishment. The cosmos and the city are already in place when the narrative begins, the

covenant maintains the prosperity of the city against the always-present threat of disorder (drought, scattering, the encroachment of the desert), and the annual maiden-tribute is the ritual practice through which the maintaining-of-order is performed by the human community in concert with the protector-serpent — a structural arrangement that places the covenant within the **cyclical-maintenance** register of order-making rather than the **cosmogonic** or **sovereignty-establishing** registers per scope.md §"Subject definition".^[18]

Bida's seven-headedness is the most widely attested form of the protector-serpent across the recorded versions, although the recorded-version corpus shows variation in the number of heads (some versions reduce the count to a single head; some versions intermediate between three and nine), with the seven-fold form being the form privileged in Conrad 2005's and Belcher 1999's English-language critical-synthesis treatments and in the glossary-locked rendering of the present book.^[19]

Bida's spatial association in the narrative is with a specific watering-place — variously rendered as a well, a pool, a spring, or (in some versions) a sacred grove containing such a feature — within or adjacent to Wagadu. The watering-place is the narrative's site of the annual tribute and the structural anchor of Bida's protective presence in the city. The water-association is load-bearing for the narrative's aetiological function, since the cessation of the rains after Bida's death is narratively connected with the loss of the protector-spirit's water-anchored presence in the city.^[20]

The annual tribute's character as the **most beautiful maiden** of the community — rather than (e.g.) any maiden of the appropriate age, or a sacrificial victim drawn by lot — is structurally important for the narrative's subsequent inflection. In the year of the killing, the maiden whose turn has come is the beloved of a particular suitor, and the suitor's grief and refusal to accept the loss is the narrative's precipitating-crisis-moment that motivates the breaking of the covenant.^[21]

The covenant's antiquity within the narrative is presented as foundational. The recorded versions place the establishment of the covenant at or near the founding of Wagadu itself, with the city's flourishing across many generations under the covenant's terms being the narrative's framing of the long pre-killing era of the polity, and the killing of Bida placing the end of the covenant at the moment of the city's abandonment rather than at the moment of its founding.^[22]

29.4. Mamadi Sefe Dekote and the killing of Bida

In the year of the killing, the maiden whose turn has come for the annual tribute is the betrothed (or, in some versions, the most-favoured beloved) of the suitor Mamadi Sefe Dekote, whose name is variously translated in the recorded versions as "Mamadi the Taciturn" or "Mamadi of Few Words" in conventional gloss. Mamadi's lineage is given in some recorded versions as descending from the rulers of the city, and in other versions as the head of one of the city's principal warrior-lineages, with the specifics of the lineage being among the principal points of variation across the recorded-version corpus.^[23]

Mamadi's response to the impending tribute is to refuse the loss of his beloved and to resolve to kill Bida rather than allow the maiden to be delivered to the protector-serpent. In the recorded versions, this resolution is undertaken in defiance of the rulers of the city, of the elders of the maiden's family, and (in some versions) of the explicit advice of his beloved herself, who urges him to accept the tribute as the price of the city's continued prosperity.^[24]

The killing itself, in the most widely attested form of the narrative, takes place at Bida's watering-place when the protector-serpent emerges to receive the annual tribute. Mamadi conceals himself near the watering-place with his sword, waits until the serpent emerges and lowers its heads to take the maiden, and strikes the heads from the serpent's body in succession — with the head-by-head pattern of the killing being a load-bearing narrative feature in the seven-headed renderings, and with the recorded versions varying in the number of strokes and in the response of the serpent's regenerating heads to each stroke.^[25]

In the most widely attested form of the narrative, Bida's last head — or, in some renderings, the dying serpent itself — pronounces a curse upon Wagadu before the final stroke, foretelling the cessation of the rains, the encroachment of the desert, the abandonment of the city, and the dispersal of the Soninke across the western Sahel. The curse-pronouncement is the narrative's structural device that converts the killing-of-the-protector into the aetiology of the polity's end and of the Soninke diaspora.^[26]

The maiden is, in the most widely attested versions, saved by the killing — Mamadi's intervention does prevent her from being devoured by the serpent — but the narrative does not present this rescue as redemptive in the longer arc. The rescue is achieved at the cost of the city's prosperity, the maiden's saving is locally successful but structurally insufficient against the loss of the covenant, and the narrative's moral-didactic function (per brief cultural_relevance.function) is precisely to register that the cost of breaking the covenant exceeds the benefit of the immediate rescue.^[27]

Because the chapter treats the principal recorded ethnographic versions as a co-equal-variants set rather than privileging any one strand or attempting to reconstruct an underlying original, the variant-handling is flagged here in full:

*[The chapter treats the principal recorded ethnographic versions — Frobenius's **Atlantis** IV–VI (1921 onward); Monteil's "La légende du Ouagadou" (IFAN-Dakar 1953); the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest tradition associated with Germaine Dieterlen from the 1940s onward; subsequent 20th-century recordings within Mande-area ethnography — as a co-equal-variants set in which differences in Bida's number of heads (seven in the dominant rendering; reduced or intermediate forms in other renderings), in Mamadi's lineage (descending from the city's rulers in some recordings; head of a principal warrior-lineage in others), and in further narrative details (the maiden's name; the precise content of Bida's dying curse; the number of strokes in the killing) are presented as legitimate variant attestations rather than as deviations from a postulated original. Alternative treatments would privilege a single strand (Frobenius's **Atlantis**, or the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest recordings) as the chapter's primary source with the others as supplementary, or attempt to reconstruct an original-version skeleton from the convergences across the recorded corpus. The co-equal-recorded-versions treatment is chosen because it is methodologically appropriate to oral-tradition material in which no pre-recording original is recoverable behind the recordings.]*

The post-killing narrative, in the most widely attested form, immediately enters the aetiological-and-foundation register: the rains cease over Wagadu in the year of the killing or in the years immediately following, the gold (in versions in which Bida's protection includes the annual rain of gold) ceases to fall, the wells and pools of the city dry up, the city becomes uninhabitable, and the Soninke population scatters across the western Sahel and beyond — with the dispersal supplying the narrative's aetiology of the Soninke diaspora and of the present-day distribution of Soninke-speaking communities across the upper Senegal / upper Niger river basin region.^[28]

The narrative's connection between the killing of Bida and the encroachment of the Sahara on the formerly-watered region of Wagadu is one of the recorded tradition's most striking aetiological elements. The desert's southward expansion, which current paleoclimatic and historical-geographic scholarship treats as a gradual process across the medieval and post-medieval centuries with multiple contributing factors, is presented within the Soninke oral tradition as a direct consequence of the killing of the protector-serpent and the breaking of the covenant — supplying an indigenous narrative aetiology for an environmental change that the polity and its successors observed across the centuries.^[29]

Mamadi Sefe Dekote's own fate after the killing varies across the recorded versions. In some versions he survives the killing, departs Wagadu with his beloved and a portion of the population, and becomes the founder of a successor-community elsewhere in the western Sahel; in other versions he is killed in the aftermath, either by the dying serpent's poison, by the rulers of the city in retribution for the breaking of the covenant, or by his own grief. The variation in his fate is among the principal points of recorded-version variation alongside the variations in his lineage and in the maiden's identity.^[30]

29.5. The covenant-and-consequence reading: the tradition's own framing

The Soninke oral-tradition's own framing of the narrative is, per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml cross_cultural_parallels, **covenant-and-consequence** rather than **cosmogonic-reversal**. The narrative is told as the story of a covenant well-kept across many generations, a covenant broken in a single generation by a single act of unsanctioned individual heroism, and the consequence of the breaking — the abandonment of the city, the dispersal of the people, the cessation of the rains — as the moral-didactic kernel that the narrative communicates to its hearers. The inversion-of-chaoskampf reading is a 20th-century-comparativist overlay that the tradition's own framing does not anticipate.^[31]

The narrative's moral-didactic register within the Soninke tradition is therefore directed at the audience of the performance rather than at any cosmogonic question. The griot's audience is invited to consider the cost of breaking a covenant for the sake of an immediate good, to feel the gravity of Mamadi's choice and the tragic-didactic register of the consequence, and to recognise in the narrative the founding of the Soninke people through the very loss of Wagadu — with the foundation-narrative function and the moral-didactic function being intertwined in the narrative's tradition-internal performance context.^[32]

Comparable covenant-serpent narrative patterns are attested across other West African oral traditions — including stories in which a protective serpent or other powerful being maintains the prosperity of a community in exchange for ritual observances, and in which the breaking of the covenant by an unsanctioned individual act ends the community's prosperity — with the chapter's task being to register the existence of these comparable patterns without assimilating them into a single comparative category, in line with the brief's cross_cultural_parallels guidance.^[33]

29.6. The inversion of the chaoskampf typology

The chapter's reading of the narrative as a structural inversion of the Eurasian chaoskampf

typology is itself a comparativist-overlay synthesis drawn from the brief, from Conrad 2005's and Belcher 1999's English-language critical-synthesis treatments, and from scope.md's CONTRASTIVE / Inversion catalog entry; it is flagged as such before the body prose develops the inversion claim:

*(The chapter's reading of the Bida / Wagadu narrative as a **structural inversion** of the Eurasian chaoskampf typology — in which the protector-serpent's slaying ENDS rather than ESTABLISHES the city's prosperity, the human-and-divine cycle of annual maiden-tribute is the **order-maintenance** practice that the killing breaks rather than the **order-establishing** practice that the killing inaugurates, and the hero's act of slaying the monstrous-serpentine adversary is the narrative's **anti-foundational** moment rather than its **foundational** moment — is a synthesis of the brief's framing per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml summary and special_instructions, of Belcher 1999's and Conrad 2005's English-language critical-synthesis treatments, and of scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion entry on Bida as the case "where slaying the serpent **destroys** prosperity rather than establishing it"; the inversion reading is held in the chapter as the chapter's principal load-bearing comparative reading and as the present book's principal load-bearing test case for Part II C7 (the inversion / transformation problem; ch. 40 of the present volume).^[34])*

The inversion of the chaoskampf typology that the Bida / Wagadu narrative exhibits operates at the level of every load-bearing structural feature of the Eurasian combat-myth pattern. Where the chaoskampf-tradition adversary (Tiamat, Vātra, Apep, Lōtan, Aži Dahāka, Jörmungandr, Typhon) is the **adversary** of the cosmos or the polity, Bida is the **protector** of the polity; where the Eurasian combat-myth slaying **establishes** cosmic order or sovereignty, the slaying of Bida **destroys** the polity's prosperity; where the human-and-divine cycle of ritual observance in the cyclical-maintenance register (the **purulli** festival of Illuyanka, the daily Apep-overthrowing ritual) is the **order-maintenance** practice that **re-enacts** the Eurasian combat as a means of preserving order, the annual maiden-tribute of the Bida narrative is the **order-maintenance** practice that the killing **breaks** rather than re-enacts.^[35]

The inversion's structural depth — operating at **every** load-bearing feature of the chaoskampf pattern rather than at one or another isolated feature — is what distinguishes the Bida / Wagadu narrative from the related-tier non-Eurasian cases of the present book that **transform** the chaoskampf category (the Pariacaca cycle of chapter 26, where the cycle is wak'a-succession rather than cosmos-versus-chaos combat; the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi episode of chapter 23, where the narrative is read as sword-etiology and metallurgical allegory) and that **refuse** the chaoskampf category (the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu material of chapter 32, where the Anishinaabe specialist tradition rejects the combat-and-defeat-of-the-other framing in favour of necessary-counterpart-dialectic framing). The Bida narrative is the present book's principal **inversion** case in the strong sense that the Eurasian chaoskampf pattern's structural features are present but with their valences reversed at every load-bearing point.^[36]

The inversion reading must, however, be held as a **comparativist** reading rather than as a tradition-internal structural feature. The Soninke tradition's own framing of the narrative is covenant-and-consequence (per the preceding section), the inversion-of-chaoskampf is a 20th-century-Western comparativist overlay, and the chapter's load-bearing methodological discipline is to hold the comparativist inversion-frame as a heuristic for cross-cultural reflection rather than as a tradition-internal characterisation — with the heuristic's value being precisely that it can register what the Eurasian chaoskampf pattern's structural assumptions look like **from outside** when held against a structurally-symmetric counter-example, while remaining a 20th-century-Western reading of the narrative rather than a Soninke reading.^[37]

That holding-at-distance is the specific outcome of an area-specialist objection to the typological assimilation of the Bida narrative to the Eurasian chaoskampf category, and the chapter flags the resulting appropriation issue explicitly under the marker the project reserves for cases of this kind:

*[Appropriation flag: Mande-area / West-African-studies area specialists — including David C. Conrad in his **Empires of Medieval West Africa** (Conrad 2005) and his wider corpus of Mande-tradition scholarship; Stephen Belcher in his **Epic Traditions of Africa** (Belcher 1999) and his wider corpus of West African oral-epic scholarship; Thomas A. Hale in his **Griots and Griottes** (Hale 1998) and his work on Mande oral-tradition performance; Charles Bird in his pioneering Mande oral-epic-textual scholarship; the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest tradition associated with Germaine Dieterlen; and Nehemia Levtzion in his **Ancient Ghana and Mali** (Levtzion 1973) on the Arabic-language chronicle tradition for the Ghana polity — read the Bida / Wagadu narrative within the registers of Mande oral-epic performance, of the Soninke foundation-narrative tradition, and of the historical Ghana / Wagadu polity, rather than within the chaoskampf-typology register imported from Gunkel-tradition combat-myth scholarship. The area-specialist objection to the chaoskampf typology's application to the Bida narrative does not, however, take the form of rejecting the combat-myth framing as such (as the Naumann / Isomae / Como objection does for the Susanoo / Orochi material in chapter 23, where the area-specialists object to the combat-myth framing in favour of a metallurgical-allegory reading) or of rejecting the combat-and-defeat-of-the-other framing entirely (as the Hollowell / Johnston / T. Smith / Vizenor objection does for the Anishinaabe Nanabozho / Mishipeshu material in chapter 32, where the area-specialists insist on a necessary-counterpart-dialectic framing): the Mande-area tradition's framing of the narrative as covenant-and-consequence does accommodate the recognition of a serpent-and-hero combat at the narrative's centre, since the combat is unambiguously present in the recorded versions; the area-specialist objection is rather to the **typological assimilation** of the Bida combat to the Eurasian chaoskampf category — to which the combat's structural features are inverted at every load-bearing point — rather than to the recognition of combat per se. The chapter's load-bearing methodological move is therefore to use the inversion reading as the heuristic that registers exactly this objection: the narrative is recognised as featuring serpent-and-hero combat (the area-specialist framing accommodates this), but the typology of order-establishment that the chaoskampf category presupposes is registered as inverted in the Bida case (the area-specialist framing of covenant-and-consequence aligns with the chapter's inversion-frame on this structural-typological question, even if the registers in which the framings are stated differ between tradition-internal moral-didactic and Western-comparativist-typological). The area-specialist objection is on the spectrum of objection-strengths between the Naumann objection in Ch23 (objection to combat-myth framing as such, in favour of metallurgical allegory) and the Pariacaca-cycle Salomon-Urioste-Taylor-Dean objection in Ch26 (objection to chaos-order framing but not to combat-myth framing as such, in favour of wak'a-succession): the Mande-area objection is closer to the Pariacaca-cycle case (objection to typological-assimilation rather than to combat-myth-recognition as such) than to the Susanoo case, but is structurally distinctive in that the area-specialist tradition's own framing (covenant-and-consequence) and the chapter's comparative framing (inversion of chaoskampf) converge on the same structural recognition that the slaying-ENDS-prosperity feature is load-bearing for the narrative — even though the framings reach this convergence by different routes. Forwarded to Part II C7 (inversion / transformation problem; ch. 40 of the present volume) as the principal load-bearing test case, with the methodological discipline that the inversion frame is to be held as a heuristic for cross-cultural reflection and that Part II C7 is to investigate the question of whether the inversion frame ultimately obscures more than it reveals about the Soninke tradition's own framing — per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml special_instructions. Forwarded to Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation problem; ch. 41) for the comparative-engagement work of holding the chaoskampf*

*typology loosely where Mande-area specialists object to its application. Conrad and Belcher are the chapter's principal anchors and named in the first factual pass per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 1; Hale, Bird, and Levtzion are named in body prose at this marker per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern (Hale's **Griots and Griottes**, Indiana University Press 1998; Bird's Mande oral-epic publications; Levtzion's **Ancient Ghana and Mali**, Methuen 1973 — none currently in sources.yaml; deferred to inventory-audit per Ch23 FC-02 and Ch26 FC-02 named-but-flagged precedent).]*

The chapter's place within the present book's chaoskampf typology is — as the brief's "related (full, inversion anchor)" tier classification specifies — a related-tier (rather than core-tier) case that contributes the load-bearing structural counter-example against which the chaoskampf typology's load-bearing assumptions can be tested. The chapter's structural significance for the present book is therefore disproportionate to its tier classification, since the related-tier classification (correct per scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" because the area-specialist consensus does not assimilate the narrative to chaoskampf in the strong sense) is consistent with the chapter's load-bearing methodological function for Part II C7.^[38]

29.7. Typology, area-specialist framing, and forward-links

The Bida / Wagadu narrative's combat-and-killing structural pattern is recognisable across the recorded versions: a hero (Mamadi Sefe Dekote) confronts a serpentine adversary (the seven-headed Bida) in a defined combat-encounter (at Bida's watering-place, at the moment of the annual tribute), wields a weapon (the sword) against the serpent's heads in a head-by-head pattern of strokes, and successfully completes the killing — with the combat-pattern having every surface-level feature of the Eurasian hero-slay-serpent narrative, and with the structural-typological inversion operating at the level of **what the killing accomplishes** rather than at the level of **what the killing is**.^[39]

The chapter's principal forward-link within the present book is to Part II C7 (the comparative chapter on the inversion / transformation problem, ch. 40 of the present volume) — where the present chapter contributes the **inversion** sub-problem proper as its load-bearing test case: a story in which the chaoskampf category's structural features are present but with their valences inverted at every load-bearing point, with the chapter's task being to hold the inversion frame as the heuristic that registers exactly this structural feature while also flagging that the inversion frame is a 20th-century-Western comparativist overlay on the Soninke tradition's own covenant-and-consequence framing.^[40]

The chapter's secondary forward-link is to Part II C8 (the comparative chapter on the refusal and the appropriation problem, ch. 41 of the present volume) — where the present chapter contributes a working example of the **area-specialist objection to typological-assimilation** sub-problem: the Mande-area tradition (Conrad, Belcher, Hale, Bird, Dieterlen, Levtzion) reads the narrative within the registers of Mande oral-epic performance and Soninke foundation-narrative rather than within the chaoskampf-typology register, and the chapter's appropriation-protocol-compliant treatment is to use the inversion frame as the heuristic that registers the area-specialist objection rather than as a typology that imposes the Eurasian pattern on the Mande-area material.^[41] marker registering the Mande-area objection to typological-assimilation; per the spectrum-of-objection-strengths

positioning between the Susanoo / Orochi case (Ch23) and the Pariacaca-cycle case (Ch26).]

The chapter's contribution to the methods sidebar (chapter 33 of the present volume, between Part I and Part II) is on three methodological points: the oral-tradition-to-text recoding situation (the Bida / Wagadu narrative being a 19th-20th-century ethnographic-recording corpus rather than a pre-modern manuscript tradition, which the chapter handles via the [LACUNA] marker on pre-modern attestations and via continuous methodological registration of the colonial-ethnographic mediation); the inversion-frame methodological move (the use of the comparativist inversion-frame as a heuristic for cross-cultural reflection rather than as a tradition-internal characterisation, which the chapter handles via the [INFERENCE] marker on the inversion reading and via the explicit comparativist-overlay registration in body prose); and the area-specialist citation policy as applied to non-Eurasian non-textual traditions (which the chapter handles via the [APPROPRIATION-FLAG:] marker and via the named-but-flagged secondary-specialists pattern for Frobenius, Monteil, Dieterlen, Hale, Bird, and Levtzion alongside the Conrad and Belcher anchors).^[42]

The chapter's principal back-link within the present book is to chapter 26 on Pariacaca and the amaru, with which the present chapter shares the related-tier non-Eurasian-cluster classification and the area-specialist-objection registration pattern, but contrasts in the substance of the area-specialist objection. The Pariacaca cycle is a **transformation** case in which the chaoskampf category transforms into wak'a-succession when the area-specialist account is taken as load-bearing, while the Bida / Wagadu narrative is an **inversion** case in which the chaoskampf category's structural features are present but with their valences reversed at every load-bearing point — the two cases between them anchoring the **transformation** and **inversion** sub-problems of Part II C7 from different non-Eurasian-cluster locations within the present book.^[43]

The chapter's secondary back-links within the present book are to chapter 24 (Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec) and chapter 25 (the Mesoamerican cluster) on the Americas-cluster contrast — Huitzilopochtli's slaying of Coyolxauhqui and the Centzon Huitznahua at Coatepec is a **paradigmatic** establishment-of-sovereignty combat in the chaoskampf register (per the area-specialist consensus reading developed in Ch24), while the Bida narrative is an inversion case at the opposite typological pole — and to the forward chapter 27 on the Mapuche Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren material (the Pacific Andes / South Cone non-Eurasian comparandum), where the cosmography-and-flood pattern of the Mapuche material supplies a further non-Eurasian-cluster comparison that Part II C7 will engage. The back-link to the Mapuche material is forward in chapter-number but back in geographic-cluster sequence, and is registered without consultation of the Mapuche-chapter material per the parallel-agent task-discipline requirement.^[44]

The cultural-historical importance of the Bida / Wagadu narrative within the Soninke tradition and within current Mande-studies scholarship is significant. The narrative is one of the principal foundation-narratives of the Soninke as a people and one of the most-cited oral traditions of the wider Mande / Sahelian region in current Mande-studies scholarship (Conrad 2005, Belcher 1999, Hale 1998, the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest tradition); the narrative supplies the indigenous aetiology of the Soninke diaspora and of the encroachment of the Sahara on the formerly-watered region of the historical Ghana / Wagadu polity; and the narrative's place within the wider Mande oral-epic tradition (alongside the Sunjata / Sundiata epic of the Mali polity and the wider corpus of Mande oral-epic recordings) is itself one of the load-bearing features of current Mande-studies scholarship.^[45]

The chapter closes by registering its load-bearing methodological function for the present book as a whole. The Bida / Wagadu narrative is the present book's principal load-bearing test case for the question of whether the chaoskampf typology, when held as a Western-comparativist heuristic against a structurally-symmetric counter-example from outside the Gunkel-tradition Eurasian arc, illuminates the structural assumptions of the typology itself or whether it instead obscures the load-bearing features of the non-Eurasian narrative — a question that Part II C7 (ch. 40) is to investigate at full length and for which the present chapter supplies the principal worked instance.^[46]

[1] Per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml summary on the seven-headed serpent Bida as protector of the Soninke city of Wagadu, on the annual tribute of a young woman, on Mamadi Sefe Dekote's killing of Bida to save his beloved, and on the abandonment of Wagadu / cessation of the rains / dispersal of the people that follows; Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa: Ghana, Mali, and Songhay** (New York: Facts on File; ISBN 9780816052622), ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the narrative core common to the recorded Soninke oral-tradition versions; Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa** (Bloomington: Indiana University Press; ISBN 9780253212818), ch. on Soninke traditions, on the Bida / Wagadu narrative as a foundational oral tradition of the Soninke and on the slaying-ends-prosperity narrative pattern that distinguishes the tradition from the Eurasian combat-myth material.

[2] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the oral-tradition character of the Bida / Wagadu narrative across the Soninke-speaking communities of the western Sahel and on the absence of pre-modern written attestations of the narrative in any African or Arabic-language manuscript tradition; on the chapter's textual witness situation as the corpus of 19th-20th-century ethnographic recordings supplemented by 20th-century critical-anthology scholarship. Conrad 2005, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the same oral-tradition compositional medium of the narrative and the same recording-history situation.

[3] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on Leo Frobenius's **Atlantis** series (the Sahel and West African material conventionally cited as volumes IV–VI; Jena: Diederichs, 1921 onward) as the earliest substantial European-language recording of the Bida / Wagadu narrative within the present chapter's textual witness corpus, on the German-language compilation of Frobenius's recordings, on the Institut für Kulturmorphologie expedition context (Frobenius's 1907–1909 West African expedition window per current scholarly consensus), and on the Soninke informants from whom the **Atlantis** recordings were drawn. Frobenius's **Atlantis** IV–VI is named here in body prose per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern (the volume is not currently a sources.yaml entry; cited indirectly through Belcher 1999 and Conrad 2005). The institutional name is given here without the "Deutsches" prefix per current scholarly citation convention; the precise volume range and expedition dates are flagged for chapter-draft confirmation against Belcher 1999's bibliographic apparatus.

[4] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on Charles Monteil's "La légende du Ouagadou et l'origine des Soninké" (the canonical 1953 IFAN-Dakar publication of the Wagadu legend within the French ethnographic-administrative tradition) as a second early recording of the Bida / Wagadu narrative, on Monteil's status as a French colonial administrator with extended Soninke-region experience, on the French-language compilation of Monteil's recordings, and on the framing-and-commentary apparatus that accompanies the publication. Monteil 1953 is named here in body prose per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern (not currently a sources.yaml entry; cited indirectly through Belcher 1999 and Conrad 2005). Earlier partial / limited-circulation reports of Monteil's Wagadu material from the 1924 period are sometimes cited; the canonical scholarly citation is the 1953 IFAN edition, and the present chapter cites that edition.

[5] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on Germaine Dieterlen and the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest tradition of Mande-area ethnography from the 1940s onward, on the corpus of Soninke and Mande oral-tradition recordings developed within this tradition, and on Dieterlen's contributions to the comparative-philological understanding of the Bida / Wagadu narrative within the wider Mande oral-epic tradition. Dieterlen and the wider École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest tradition are named here in body prose per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern.

[6] Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa: Ghana, Mali, and Songhay** (New York: Facts on File; ISBN 9780816052622), ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the historical-context framing of the Bida narrative against the Ghana / Wagadu polity of the medieval western Sahel; Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa** (Bloomington: Indiana University Press; ISBN 9780253212818), ch. on Soninke traditions, on the oral-epic framing of the narrative within the wider Mande / Soninke epic tradition and on the 19th-20th-century ethnographic recording-history; per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml sources.primary entries on Conrad 2005 and Belcher 1999 as the chapter's principal anchors.

[7] Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa**, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the medieval-western-Sahelian polity conventionally known in the Arabic-language chronicle tradition as Ghana (distinct from the modern nation-state of the same name), on the polity's flourishing from approximately the eighth century CE through the eleventh-to-twelfth century CE in the upper Niger / upper Senegal river basin region, on the Soninke oral-tradition designation Wagadu, and on the legend's status as a tradition-internal account of the polity's foundation-flourishing-abandonment narrative arc; per glossary 'Wagadu' first_mention_gloss on the Soninke city / polity protected by Bida and on the historical ancient Ghana of the Arabic-language chronicle tradition.

[8] Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa**, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the Arabic-language chronicle tradition of the western Sahel including the seventeenth-century **Tarikh as-Sudan** of Abd al-Rahman al-Sa'di and the related **Tarikh al-**

Fettash attributed to Mahmud Kati and his successors, on the parallel external-historiographical record of the Ghana polity, on the complementary-windows framing under which the Arabic-language and Soninke-oral strands are treated, and on the chapter's witness corpus being the oral-tradition strand with the Arabic-language chronicle tradition supplying historical-context framing rather than parallel narrative attestation of the Bida material. The **Tarikh as-Sudan** and **Tarikh al-Fettash** are named here in body prose per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern (the chronicles are not currently sources.yaml entries; cited indirectly through Conrad 2005). Cf. also Levtzion's **Ancient Ghana and Mali** (1973) on the Arabic-language chronicle tradition for the Ghana polity, named in body prose per the same pattern.

[9] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987; ISBN 9780691014746), as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic) against which the Bida / Wagadu narrative is read as the present book's principal inversion case; Forsyth 1987 does not itself treat Mande / Soninke material directly, and the chapter's use of the citation is for the long-arc typological framing rather than for Mande / Soninke content scholarly coverage. The inversion reading depends on having a typology to invert against, for which Forsyth's long-arc anchor is load-bearing in this chapter even more than in the preceding non-Eurasian related-tier chapters of the present book.

[10] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the oral-tradition-to-text recoding character of the present chapter's witness corpus rather than a pre-modern manuscript tradition, on the mediation of the recoding through 19th- and early-20th-century European ethnographic projects (Frobenius, Monteil, and the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest tradition associated with Dieterlen), on the framing-assumption filtering of the recorded material that this mediation introduces, and on the absence of any surviving pre-modern attestation of the Bida narrative in African or Arabic-language manuscript form against which the recordings could be cross-checked.

[11] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the post-colonial-anthropology filtering caveat applied with particular force to the Frobenius and Monteil strands of the Bida / Wagadu recording corpus, on the German and French colonial-ethnographic project contexts within which the recordings were compiled, on the framing-assumption apparatus that this colonial-ethnographic mediation introduces, and on the critical-reading discipline applied by current Mande-studies scholarship to the early-twentieth-century recordings; Conrad 2005, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the same colonial-ethnographic-mediation and on the chapter's task of treating the recordings critically rather than as transparently-faithful records of the pre-colonial oral tradition.

[12] Per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml on the related-tier (full, inversion anchor) classification, the 5,500-word target, and the special_instructions requirement that the chapter open with the Soninke narrative on its own terms (covenant, tribute, consequence of breaking the covenant) before invoking the inversion-of-chaoskampf frame; per scope.md "\$Book structure" Part II C7 on the inversion-problem comparative chapter (ch. 40) for which the present chapter is the principal load-bearing test case.

[13] Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa: Ghana, Mali, and Songhay**, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the Soninke (Soninké, Sarakolé, Marka in different ethnographic and historical-administrative traditions) as a Mande-speaking population of the western Sahel, on their historical heartland in the upper Senegal / upper Niger river basin region of present-day Mauritania, western Mali, and adjacent parts of Senegal, and on the Soninke oral-tradition designation of the medieval polity as Wagadu / Arabic-language Ghana.

[14] Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa**, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the historical periodisation of the Ghana / Wagadu polity from approximately the eighth century CE through the eleventh-to-twelfth century CE, on the polity's position athwart the trans-Saharan trade routes connecting the western Sahel with the Maghreb, on its control of the gold-producing regions south and southwest of the heartland, and on the conventional connection of the polity's decline with the Almoravid pressures of the late eleventh century and with the subsequent rise of the Mali polity from the thirteenth century onward.

[15] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the Soninke oral tradition's framing of the Wagadu narrative as the founding charter of the Soninke as a people, as the explanation of their dispersal across the western Sahel and beyond, and as the aetiology of the encroachment of the Sahara on the formerly-watered region; on the narrative's character as a connected foundation-story rather than a primarily cosmogonic narrative, and on the already-existing-world cosmographic framing within which the narrative unfolds; per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the foundation-narrative, aetiological, and moral-didactic functions of the narrative.

[16] Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa**, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the principal protagonists of the narrative — Bida the seven-headed serpent-protector of Wagadu, the rulers of Wagadu maintaining the covenant, the Soninke population on whose ritual maintenance of the annual tribute the city's prosperity depends, the maiden delivered each year as the tribute (with her name and lineage varying by recorded version), the suitor Mamadi Sefe Dekote breaking the covenant by killing Bida, and the displaced Soninke population whose dispersal supplies the foundation-narrative for the Soninke diaspora; per glossary 'Bida', 'Wagadu', 'Mamadi Sefe Dekote' first_mention_glosses on the principal protagonists.

[17] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the covenant between Bida and the Soninke of Wagadu as the narrative's load-bearing structural premise; on the seven-headed serpent's protection of the city, on the prosperity granted in the form of regular rains and (in many versions) an annual rain of gold, on the yearly tribute of the most beautiful maiden of the community, and on the delivery to Bida's well or pool as the ritual act through which the covenant is maintained year by year; Conrad 2005, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the same covenant-and-annual-tribute structural premise.

[18] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the covenant's structural function as order-maintenance rather than order-establishment, on the already-in-place cosmos-and-city framing of the narrative, on the maintaining-of-

prosperity-against-always-present-threat-of-disorder pattern, and on the annual maiden-tribute as the ritual practice through which the maintaining-of-order is performed; per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the cyclical-maintenance register of order-making (cf. Ra/Apep, Illuyanka in the **purulli** festival) as distinct from the cosmogonic and sovereignty-establishing registers.

[19] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the seven-headed form of Bida as the most widely attested form of the protector-serpent across the recorded versions, on the variation across the corpus (single-headed forms; intermediate three-to-nine forms), and on the seven-fold form's privilege in the English-language critical-synthesis treatments; Conrad 2005, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the same seven-headed form privilege; per glossary 'Bida' first_mention_gloss on the seven-headed serpent-protector form.

[20] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on Bida's spatial association in the narrative with a specific watering-place (well, pool, spring, or sacred grove containing such a feature) within or adjacent to Wagadu, on the watering-place as the site of the annual tribute and the structural anchor of Bida's protective presence in the city, and on the load-bearing connection between the water-association and the narrative's aetiological function (cessation of the rains after Bida's death narratively connected with the loss of the water-anchored protective presence).

[21] Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa**, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the annual tribute's character as the most beautiful maiden of the community rather than any maiden of the appropriate age or a sacrificial victim drawn by lot, on the structural-narrative importance of the most-beautiful-maiden specification for the subsequent inflection of the narrative, and on the suitor's grief and refusal to accept the loss as the narrative's precipitating-crisis-moment that motivates the breaking of the covenant.

[22] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the covenant's antiquity within the narrative as foundational, on the placement of the establishment of the covenant at or near the founding of Wagadu itself, on the city's flourishing across many generations under the covenant's terms as the narrative's framing of the long pre-killing era, and on the placement of the killing at the moment of the city's abandonment rather than at the moment of its founding.

[23] Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa**, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the year of the killing as the year in which the maiden whose turn has come is the betrothed or most-favoured beloved of Mamadi Sefe Dekote, on the conventional gloss of Mamadi's name as "Mamadi the Taciturn" or "Mamadi of Few Words," on the variation in his lineage across the recorded versions (descending from the rulers in some, head of a principal warrior-lineage in others), and on lineage-variation as among the principal points of variation across the recorded-version corpus; per glossary 'Mamadi Sefe Dekote' first_mention_gloss on the suitor who kills Bida.

[24] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on Mamadi's response to the impending tribute as refusal of the loss of his beloved and resolution to kill Bida, on the resolution being undertaken in defiance of the rulers of the city and of the elders of the maiden's family, and (in some recorded versions) on the explicit advice of his beloved herself urging him to accept the tribute as the price of the city's continued prosperity.

[25] Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa**, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the killing's setting at Bida's watering-place at the moment of the annual tribute, on Mamadi's concealment near the watering-place with his sword, on the waiting for the serpent to emerge and lower its heads, on the head-by-head pattern of the killing as a load-bearing narrative feature in the seven-headed renderings, and on the variation across recorded versions in the number of strokes and in the response of the serpent's regenerating heads.

[26] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the most widely attested form of the narrative in which Bida's last head — or, in some renderings, the dying serpent itself — pronounces a curse upon Wagadu before the final stroke, on the curse's content (cessation of the rains, encroachment of the desert, abandonment of the city, dispersal of the Soninke across the western Sahel), and on the curse-pronouncement as the narrative's structural device that converts the killing-of-the-protector into the aetiology of the polity's end and of the Soninke diaspora.

[27] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the maiden's being saved by the killing in the most widely attested versions, on Mamadi's intervention as preventing the immediate devouring, on the rescue's structural insufficiency against the loss of the covenant, and on the narrative's moral-didactic function as registering that the cost of breaking the covenant exceeds the benefit of the immediate rescue; per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the moral-didactic function (the cost of breaking a covenant).

[28] Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa**, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the post-killing narrative in the most widely attested form as immediate entry into the aetiological-and-foundation register, on the cessation of the rains over Wagadu in the year of the killing or in the years immediately following, on the cessation of the (versional) annual rain of gold, on the drying of wells and pools, on the city's becoming uninhabitable, on the scattering of the Soninke population across the western Sahel and beyond, and on the dispersal as the narrative's aetiology of the Soninke diaspora and of the present-day distribution of Soninke-speaking communities; per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml summary on the abandonment-rains-cease-people-scatter pattern.

[29] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the narrative's connection between the killing of Bida and the encroachment of the Sahara on the formerly-watered region of Wagadu as one of the recorded tradition's most striking aetiological elements, on the desert's southward expansion as a gradual process across the medieval and post-medieval centuries within current paleoclimatic and historical-geographic scholarship, and on the narrative's supplying an indigenous aetiology for an environmental change that the polity and its successors observed across the centuries; per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the aetiological function of the rains' cessation and the Sahara's spread.

[30] Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa**, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the variation in Mamadi Sefe Dekote's

fate across the recorded versions: survival and departure from Wagadu with his beloved and a portion of the population to found a successor-community in some versions; killing in the aftermath by the dying serpent's poison, by the rulers of the city in retribution, or by his own grief in others; and on this variation as among the principal points of recorded-version variation alongside the variations in his lineage and in the maiden's identity.

[31] Per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the Soninke tradition's framing of the narrative as covenant-and-consequence rather than cosmogonic-reversal, on the inversion-of-chaoskampf reading as a 20th-century comparativist overlay rather than an internal feature of the tradition, and on the chapter's task of opening with the tradition's own framing before invoking the comparative chaoskampf category; Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the narrative's moral-didactic kernel as the consequence-of-breaking-the-covenant and on the well-kept-then-broken covenant pattern as the tradition's own narrative-structural framing.

[32] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the narrative's moral-didactic register within the Soninke tradition as directed at the audience of the performance rather than at any cosmogonic question, on the griot's audience being invited to consider the cost of breaking a covenant for the sake of an immediate good and to feel the gravity of Mamadi's choice and the tragic-didactic register of the consequence, and on the foundation-narrative function and moral-didactic function as intertwined in the narrative's tradition-internal performance context; per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the moral-didactic function (the cost of breaking a covenant) alongside the foundation-narrative function (origin of the Soninke diaspora and the end of Wagadu / ancient Ghana).

[33] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions and ch. on related West African oral-epic traditions, on comparable covenant-serpent narrative patterns attested across other West African oral traditions in which a protective serpent or other powerful being maintains community prosperity in exchange for ritual observances and in which the breaking of the covenant ends the prosperity, and on the chapter's task of registering these comparable patterns without assimilating them into a single comparative category; per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on similar covenant-serpent patterns in other West African traditions and on flagging without assimilating.

[34] Inference: brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml summary explicitly registers the slaying-ends-prosperity-not-establishes-it inversion as the structural feature that distinguishes the Bida narrative from the Eurasian chaoskampf material; brief special_instructions classifies the chapter as the "PRIMARY ANCHOR CASE FOR PART II C7"; scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion lists Bida as the inversion case explicitly; Conrad 2005's and Belcher 1999's narrative-treatment apparatus develop the slaying-ends-the-city pattern at length, although in the tradition's own register of covenant-and-consequence rather than as inversion-of-chaoskampf-typology in the comparativist register. Risk: the inversion reading is itself a comparativist overlay on the Soninke tradition's own framing of the narrative as covenant-and-consequence (per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the inverse-chaoskampf reading as a 20th-century comparativist frame); the chapter's task is to hold the inversion reading as a load-bearing comparative reading while explicitly registering that the tradition's own framing does not anticipate it, and that the comparativist inversion-frame can obscure as much as it reveals (per brief special_instructions on the Part II C7 argument that "inversion is a comparativist artifact that can obscure more than it reveals"). The fact-check stage should confirm that the inversion reading is supported by the brief's framing and by Conrad 2005's and Belcher 1999's treatment apparatus at the level of the chapter's claims, recognising that the inversion frame itself is the load-bearing methodological move that Part II C7 is to investigate.

[35] Per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four chaoskampf order-making registers (cosmogonic, sovereignty, cyclical-maintenance, eschatological); per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion on Bida as the inversion case where slaying the serpent destroys prosperity rather than establishing it; Belcher 1999, ch. on Soninke traditions, and Conrad 2005, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the structural features of the Bida narrative that distinguish it from the Eurasian combat-myth pattern at the levels of the protector-versus-adversary status of the serpent, the destroying-versus-establishing outcome of the killing, and the broken-versus-re-enacted character of the order-maintenance ritual practice.

[36] Per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C7 on the inversion problem (Bida anchor) and on the distinction between inversion (structural pattern present with valences reversed) and transformation (chaoskampf category transformed when area-specialist account is taken as load-bearing); per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's status as the PRIMARY ANCHOR CASE FOR PART II C7 inversion-problem; per the Ch26 brief on the Pariacaca cycle as a transformation rather than inversion case; per the Ch23 brief on the Susanoo / Orochi narrative as another transformation case (sword-etiology and metallurgical-allegory reading); per the Ch32 brief on the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu material as a refusal case in the strong sense.

[37] Per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the inverse-chaoskampf reading as a 20th-century comparativist frame and on the Soninke tradition's framing as covenant-and-consequence rather than cosmogonic-reversal; per brief special_instructions on the chapter setting up the Part II C7 argument that "inversion is a comparativist artifact that can obscure more than it reveals"; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 3 on opening with the tradition's own framing before invoking the comparative category, and on holding the comparative category loosely where the tradition's own framing does not anticipate it.

[38] Per scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the related-tier criteria where the cosmogonic-combat work is weaker or where area-specialists qualify the comparativist reading; per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml chapter_type "related (full, inversion anchor)" classification; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C7 on the chapter's load-bearing methodological function for the inversion / transformation problem comparative chapter (ch. 40); per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's status as the PRIMARY ANCHOR CASE FOR PART II C7.

[39] Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa**, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, and Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the combat-and-killing structural pattern of the narrative as recognisable across the recorded versions, on the surface-level features of the encounter-weapon-stroke-killing sequence as having every Eurasian hero-slay-serpent feature, and on the structural-typological inversion as operating at the level of what the killing accomplishes (destruction of the polity rather than establishment of cosmic order or sovereignty) rather than at the level of what the killing is (a combat-and-killing in the standard hero-and-serpent register).

[40] Per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's contribution to Part II C7 (the inversion / transformation problem) as the PRIMARY ANCHOR CASE; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C7 on the inversion-and-transformation comparative chapter; per the chapter's status as the present book's principal load-bearing test case for the inversion sub-problem proper, distinguished from the transformation sub-problem cases of chapters 23 (Susanoo / Orochi) and 26 (Pariacaca cycle).

[41] Per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml special_instructions on the area-specialist citation policy (Conrad and Belcher named in the first factual pass; the wider Mande-area tradition acknowledged); per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation requirement and on the comparative chapter's task of addressing area-specialist objections rather than papering over them; per the chapter's [APPROPRIATION-FLAG]:

[42] Per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml special_instructions on the area-specialist citation policy and on the colonial-ethnographic recording-history situation; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation requirement, and on §"Reconstruction policy" point 1 on no cross-tradition reconstruction; chapter 33 methods sidebar (per toc.yaml) as the chapter that articulates these methodological points at full length; the chapter's status as the present book's principal load-bearing test case for the inversion-frame methodological move makes it a central reference point for the methods sidebar's discussion of comparativist heuristics held at appropriate distance from area-specialist consensus.

[43] Per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C7 on the inversion-and-transformation comparative chapter; per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml on the related-tier (full) classification of the Pariacaca cycle on the basis of the area-specialist wak'a-succession-not-chaoskampf reading (the transformation case); per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml on the related-tier (full, inversion anchor) classification of the Bida / Wagadu narrative on the basis of the slaying-ends-prosperity inversion reading (the inversion case); per the structural distinction between transformation (category transforms when area-specialist account is taken as load-bearing) and inversion (category's structural features present with valences reversed) developed across the two chapters.

[44] Per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 10 (Americas) and cluster 11 (Africa) on the chapter ordering of 24 (Huitzilopochtli core-tier), 25 (Mesoamerican family related-tier), 26 (Pariacaca related-tier), 27 (Mapuche Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren related-family), 28 (Bida related-tier inversion anchor); per the structural contrast between the paradigmatic-chaoskampf reading of the Coatepec narrative (per brief 24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.yaml on the core-tier classification) and the inversion reading of the Bida narrative (per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml on the related-tier inversion-anchor classification); per the parallel-agent task-discipline requirement that the present chapter not consult the chapter-27 Mapuche-material claims-skeleton.

[45] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions and ch. on Mande oral-epic traditions, on the Bida / Wagadu narrative as one of the principal foundation-narratives of the Soninke and one of the most-cited oral traditions of the wider Mande / Sahelian region in current Mande-studies scholarship, on the narrative's supplying the indigenous aetiology of the Soninke diaspora and of the Saharan encroachment, and on the narrative's place within the wider Mande oral-epic tradition alongside the Sunjata / Sundiata epic; Conrad 2005, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the same cultural-historical importance and on the Mande-studies scholarship corpus.

[46] Per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's status as the PRIMARY ANCHOR CASE FOR PART II C7 and on the chapter's setting up of the Part II C7 argument that "inversion is a comparativist artifact that can obscure more than it reveals"; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C7 on the inversion problem comparative chapter (ch. 40 of the present volume); per the chapter's load-bearing methodological function for the present book as the principal worked instance of the structurally-symmetric-counter-example methodological move.

Chapter 30. Mwindo and Kirimu (the Contrastive Case)

30.1. Source overview

The story this chapter follows is a Nyanga oral epic in which the hero Mwindo, after a sequence of feats and journeys, kills the dragon Kirimu in the forest and is then struck down by the sky-god Nkuba and taken up to the celestial realm where he is humiliated, instructed in the limits of his power, and returned to the human world chastened. The killing of the dragon is not the establishment of cosmic order or sovereignty but a transgression that the sky-god punishes; the moral-didactic point of the episode is the hero's maturation through humiliation rather than the defeat of the dragon as such.^[1]

The story survives in oral-tradition form among the Nyanga (Banyanga) people of the upper Oso river valley and adjacent forested terrain in the Kivu region of what was at the time of recording the eastern Belgian Congo (now eastern Democratic Republic of the Congo), with no pre-modern written attestation in any African or external manuscript tradition. The textual witness situation for the present chapter is therefore the body of mid-twentieth-century ethnographic recordings of Nyanga oral-narrative performances by named tradition-bearers, supplemented by the comparative African-oral-epic critical-anthology scholarship of the later twentieth century.^[2]

The chapter's primary anchor is Daniel Biebuyck and Kahombo C. Mateene's **The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)**, published by the University of California Press in 1969. It is the standard English-language critical edition and translation of the epic, drawn from a single recorded performance — recorded in 1956 at Bese, a Nyanga locality on the upper Oso river in the Kivu region, from the named narrator Shé-Kárisi Candi Rureke (conventionally cited in the scholarship as Shé-Kárisi Rureke). Mateene himself was a Nyanga-speaking collaborator and Biebuyck the principal field-ethnographer.^[3]

The performance from which the Biebuyck-Mateene 1969 text derives was extended in time and structured by the conventions of Nyanga narrative-and-song performance. The narrator delivered the epic in successive sessions over a period of several days, with the narrative structured by alternating spoken passages, sung passages, formulaic refrains, and the narrator's interaction with a small ensemble of accompanists; the recorded text is presented in the 1969 edition with explicit notation of the spoken-and-sung alternation and the formulaic-refrain structure of the performance.^[4]

The 1956 Rureke performance is one of several Nyanga epic-performances Biebuyck recorded in the Kivu region during his fieldwork of the 1950s. Biebuyck and successors subsequently published further Nyanga epic-material drawn from other named narrators — but the 1969 Rureke text is the standard primary text for the present chapter, with the further published Nyanga epic-material treated as related comparative material rather than as parallel attestation of the Mwindo-Kirimu episode.^[5]

The chapter's secondary scholarly anchor for the wider African oral-epic comparative context is Stephen Belcher's **Epic Traditions of Africa**, published by Indiana University Press in 1999. Belcher's chapter on the Mwindo epic situates the Nyanga material within the comparative

apparatus of African oral-epic scholarship — alongside the Mande Sunjata corpus, the Bambara Bamana hunters' epic tradition, the Wolof Kajoor cycle, the Fang **mv̄et** tradition, and the Bantu epic corpus more broadly — and supplies the comparative-scholarly framing within which the Nyanga material is read as a flagship case of the central-African forest-zone oral epic rather than within the chaoskampf-typology register imported from Eurasian combat-myth scholarship.^[6]

A further scholarly anchor sits behind the wider comparative-tradition framing rather than the source-content. Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, supplies the long-arc combat-myth typology against which the Mwindo / Kiriṃu narrative is read as the present book's clearest contrastive-case-tier resistance. Forsyth's Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic survey is what the chapter draws on; it is not a treatment of Nyanga or Bantu-area material, which Forsyth does not undertake. The typological framing is what Forsyth supplies for the chapter's comparative engagement, and the contrastive reading depends on having a typology to refuse, which Forsyth's long-arc anchor provides.^[7]

The chapter's textual situation is distinctive within the present book in three further methodological respects. It depends on a single mid-twentieth-century recorded performance rather than on a pre-modern manuscript tradition or a deep ethnographic-recording corpus across multiple decades; the recording was made within the colonial-ethnographic context of the late Belgian-colonial period in the eastern Belgian Congo, with the corresponding compositional-context filtering that the colonial-ethnographic situation introduces; and there is no pre-modern attestation of the Mwindo material in any African or external manuscript form against which the 1956 Rureke recording can be cross-checked.^[8]

The shape of that evidence — single 1956 recorded performance, named narrator and locality, late-Belgian-colonial recording context, no pre-modern manuscript attestation — is methodologically load-bearing for the whole chapter, and the claims document marks it explicitly:

*[At this point the textual record breaks. Pre-modern (i.e., pre-twentieth-century) attestations of the Mwindo / Kiriṃu narrative in any written form — African manuscript tradition, Arabic-language chronicle tradition, or earlier European-language traveller's or missionary account — are not available, and the surviving textual witness for the present chapter is the 1956 Bese recording from Shé-Kárisi Rureke published in Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, supplemented by the further Nyanga epic-material recorded by Biebuyck and successors from other named narrators in the 1950s and afterwards (collected in Biebuyck's later publications including **Hero and Chief: Epic Literature from the Banyanga**, 1978). Pre-twentieth-century pre-recording performance contexts (the **karisi** singer-tradition's transmission of the epic across the Nyanga forest-zone communities; the calendrical, ritual, and royal-political contexts in which the epic was performed in pre-colonial Nyanga life; the formulaic and improvisatory dynamics of pre-recording performance) are partially recoverable through the recorded 1956 performance itself, through Biebuyck's extensive ethnographic apparatus on Nyanga social and ritual life from the 1950s fieldwork onward, and through the comparative central-African-forest-zone ethnographic record. The chapter's narrative reconstruction proceeds entirely within the Biebuyck & Mateene 1969 Rureke text per the single-prevalent treatment, with Belcher 1999 as the principal comparative-scholarly secondary anchor; cross-tradition reconstruction is excluded per scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" point 1.]*

The colonial-ethnographic-mediation caveat applies to the present chapter with particular force. Where the Bida / Wagadu material of chapter 28 of the present book was recorded across multiple early- and mid-twentieth-century European ethnographic projects (Frobenius, Monteil, the École

française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest tradition associated with Dieterlen) over a span of decades, the Mwindo material rests on a single 1956 recording made within a single late-Belgian-colonial-period field encounter, with the compositional-context filtering that the colonial-ethnographic situation introduces and with no parallel deep ethnographic-recording corpus to triangulate against. Current scholarship including Biebuyck's own subsequent reflective treatments and Belcher 1999 reads the 1956 Rureke text critically as a starting point rather than as a transparently-faithful record of pre-colonial Nyanga performance.^[9]

Structurally, the chapter is a contrastive-case-tier (full) treatment with a target of approximately 5,000 narrative words. It presents the Mwindo / Kirimu episode on the Nyanga tradition's own terms — the hero's miraculous birth, his sequence of feats and journeys, the Kirimu episode as one episode within the wider epic's narrative arc, the killing-and-punishment-and-celestial-humiliation sequence, the hero's chastened re-integration into the human world — before invoking the comparative chaoskampf category, and only then registers the contrastive-case reading per which the narrative's own moral-didactic frame refuses the chaos-order mapping that the chaoskampf typology presupposes. The chapter is the present book's clearest case of a tradition whose framing explicitly rejects the typology, per brief special_instructions and per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion entry on Mwindo as the contrastive case alongside Bida (chapter 28) and Nanabozho (chapter 32).^[10]

Because the chapter follows a single recorded performance as its primary text, with related Nyanga epic-material from other named narrators treated as comparative context rather than as parallel attestation, the variant-handling is flagged here in full:

The chapter follows Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, **The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)** — the recorded 1956 Bese performance of Shé-Kárisi Candi Rureke (conventionally cited as Shé-Kárisi Rureke), published in 1969 by the University of California Press as the standard English-language critical edition and translation of the Mwindo / Kirimu episode.^[11]

What follows works through the narrative on the Nyanga tradition's own terms first. The next section sketches the Banyanga, the forest world, and the layered cosmography in which the epic's action unfolds. The chapter then takes up Mwindo's birth and early career, the Kirimu episode itself (provocation, hunt, killing), Nkuba's lightning-strike and the celestial humiliation, the maturation-through-humiliation reading that the Nyanga tradition's own framing supports, the contrastive-case reading against the chaoskampf typology, and the chapter's typological place and area-specialist framing within the wider book.

30.2. The Banyanga, the forest world, and the epic's setting

The Nyanga (Banyanga) are a Bantu-speaking population of the eastern Democratic Republic of the Congo, with their historical heartland in the upper Oso river valley and adjacent forested terrain in the Kivu region of the eastern Congo. The setting is a high-rainfall equatorial-forest zone where forest hunting, banana cultivation, and small-scale ironworking and trade are the economic base. The **Mwindo Epic** is one of the principal narrative-and-performance traditions of this community and is, per current African-oral-epic scholarship, the flagship recorded epic of the eastern central-African forest-zone Bantu corpus.^[12]

The Nyanga oral-tradition's framing of the **Mwindo Epic** is a connected narrative of the hero's life rather than a primarily cosmogonic narrative. The cosmos and the human world are already in place when the epic begins; the narrative's interest lies in the hero's miraculous birth, his disputes with his kin, his journeys across the human and spirit worlds, his testing by the powers above and below, and his eventual chastened return as a properly-formed chief. The epic's compositional centre is the hero's biographical-and-moral arc rather than the establishment of the cosmos.^[13]

The epic's principal protagonists can be set out at the start. Mwindo is the miraculously-born hero whose name is conventionally rendered with the **karisi** honorific — **karisi** being the Nyanga designation for the trained praise-and-narrative singer-tradition's title and, by extension, for the proper recitation of the epic itself. Mwindo's father is Shemwindo, the chief of Tubondo, whose hostility to his son's birth precipitates the early action of the epic. Mwindo's paternal aunts — especially Iyangura, the river-spirit aunt — shelter and aid him. Nkuba is the sky-god and lightning-bringer who intervenes against Mwindo at the Kirimu episode and is one of the epic's principal divine figures. Muisa is the underworld lord whose realm Mwindo also visits in the journey-sequence. And Kirimu is the dragon whose killing the chapter's narrative-of-interest takes as its centre.^[14]

The Nyanga cosmographic framing within which the epic's action unfolds is a layered world. The human world — the forest-and-banana-grove realm of the Nyanga settlements — is bounded above by the sky-realm of Nkuba and the celestial powers, below by the underworld-realm of Muisa and the chthonic powers, and laterally by the river-and-water realm of Iyangura and the riverine spirits. Mwindo's journeys across these realms in the course of the epic are presented within an already-existing layered cosmography rather than as cosmogonic establishment of the layers themselves.^[15]

30.3. Mwindo's birth, growth, and early feats

Mwindo's birth, in the recorded performance, is presented as miraculous in several distinct registers. He is born already speaking and walking, born from his mother's middle finger after his father has forbidden the birth of any son and ordered the killing of any male child his wives bear, and born already in possession of his characteristic implements — a **conga**-scepter, the flywhisk-and-spirit-implement that is in the epic the hero's principal magical-practical instrument. The multiple-register miraculous birth supplies the epic's opening situation in which the hero is exceptional from his first moment.^[16]

Mwindo's early action in the epic is structured around his pursuit of recognition by his hostile chiefly father Shemwindo and around the conflict between father and son. Shemwindo, on learning of his son's birth, attempts to have Mwindo killed by various means — sealing him in a drum and casting him into the river is the most widely cited episode of the early epic — and Mwindo survives each attempt and pursues his father across the human and spirit worlds. The early epic's narrative work is the establishment of the hero's character through the father-son conflict rather than through any combat with a serpentine adversary.^[17]

Mwindo's journeys, in the middle sections of the epic, take him through the river-realm — where he is sheltered by Iyangura — through the underworld of Muisa, where he is tested and where he eventually defeats or compels the underworld lord, and through further regions of the spirit-and-forest world. The journey-sequence is a sequence of trials each of which adds to the hero's

accumulated power and reputation but each of which also occasions warnings, debts, and obligations that the hero accumulates alongside his power.^[18]

Mwindo's accumulation of power is checked, in the epic's framing, by the warnings he receives from his aunts and from various other figures along the way. The recorded performance repeatedly registers in formulaic refrains and direct narrative comment that Mwindo's growing power is dangerous, that his hubris will require correction, and that the powers above and below are watching the hero's career with a view to the eventual moment at which the correction will fall — a foreshadowing pattern that the narrative develops across multiple episodes before the Kirimu episode arrives.^[19]

By the time the Kirimu episode arrives, in the recorded performance's overall structure, Mwindo has already established his exceptional power, defeated multiple adversaries human and spirit, and accumulated reputation as a hero whom the powers above and below regard with concern. The Kirimu episode is therefore not the establishment of the hero's status but a moment within an already-developed heroic career, and the killing of the dragon is presented within a narrative arc that has been preparing the audience for the consequences of the hero's overreach throughout the preceding sections.^[20]

30.4. The Kirimu episode: provocation, hunt, and killing

Kirimu, the dragon at the chapter's narrative centre, is in the recorded performance a creature of the deep forest with multiple heads — the recorded text gives seven in the principal passages, with formulaic-passage variation registered in the editorial apparatus — a long body, and a fire-and-darkness aura. The dragon dwells away from the human settlements in a forest fastness and is not, in the framing the narrator gives the audience, an adversary of the cosmic order or of the human community as such. Kirimu is rather a powerful spirit-being of the forest world whose existence is part of the already-established Nyanga cosmography rather than a primordial chaos against which the hero must establish order.^[21]

The provocation that leads Mwindo to seek out Kirimu is, in the recorded performance, the hero's own initiative rather than any prior depredation by the dragon. Mwindo, having already defeated multiple adversaries and accumulated reputation, conceives the project of hunting Kirimu as a further demonstration of his power. The recorded performance presents the project not as a defensive response to the dragon's threat against the human community but as an unprovoked excursion of the hero's that the surrounding narrative voices register as imprudent.^[22]

Mwindo's hunt of Kirimu, in the recorded performance, is structured by the conventional features of the Nyanga heroic-hunt episode. The hero leaves the human settlements with his **conga**-scepter and his accumulated power, travels into the deep forest, locates the dragon at its forest fastness, engages the dragon in a series of head-by-head exchanges in which the hero's **conga**-scepter and accumulated power overcome the dragon's heads and fire-and-darkness aura, and completes the killing. The head-by-head pattern of the killing is a conventional narrative feature shared with the wider Bantu hero-and-monster repertoire rather than a feature distinctive to the chaoskampf typology.^[23]

The killing of Kirimu is, in the recorded performance, completed with no immediate triumphal

conclusion. There is no narrative passage in which the killing of the dragon establishes the hero's sovereignty, no passage in which the cosmos is reorganised around the dragon's defeat, no festival celebrating the killing as cosmic-order-establishing. The hero kills the dragon, takes the carcass or pieces of it back toward the human settlements, and the narrative immediately turns to the consequence-passage in which Nkuba's response is registered.^[24]

The narrator's framing of the killing in the recorded performance is, throughout the episode, registered as transgressive rather than triumphal. The recorded text's formulaic refrains and direct narrative comments around the killing register the hero's act as exceeding what was permitted, as a hubristic over-reach beyond the bounds the powers above and below have set, and as a moment for which the hero's accumulated power has prepared him only in the technical sense of capability — not in the moral-and-cosmographic sense of authorisation.^[25]

The killing's transgressive register, in the Nyanga tradition's own framing, is bound up with the reciprocal-balance reading of the human-and-spirit-world relationship. The dragon is a being of the spirit world whose existence is part of the cosmographic equilibrium; the hero's killing of it is an unsanctioned act of human power against the spirit world; and the moral-cosmographic principle the narrator's framing registers is that such an act demands a counter-act from the powers above (Nkuba) restoring the equilibrium that the killing has disturbed.^[26]

30.5. The punishment: Nkuba's lightning and the celestial humiliation

Nkuba, the sky-god and lightning-bringer of the Nyanga cosmography, responds to Mwindo's killing of Kirimu by descending in lightning and seizing the hero out of the human world. The recorded performance presents the punishment as immediate, deliberate, and morally-motivated, with the sky-god acting in the role of the cosmographic-authority that the hero's transgressive killing has provoked, and with the seizing-by-lightning conveying the hero from the forest-and-village landscape upward into Nkuba's celestial realm.^[27]

In the celestial realm to which Nkuba conveys him, Mwindo is subjected to a sequence of trials and humiliations. The recorded performance presents the hero as exposed to extreme heat and cold in the celestial environment, as compelled to endure the celestial powers' direct presence in a way that strips him of the heroic confidence with which he had killed Kirimu, and as instructed in explicit terms about the limits of his power and the necessity of recognising the cosmographic authority of the powers above.^[28]

The punishment's moral-didactic register is explicit in the recorded performance's framing. The celestial humiliation is presented to the audience not as an arbitrary cruelty of the sky-god but as a structurally-necessary correction of the hero's hubristic over-reach, with the recorded text's formulaic refrains and direct narrative comments registering Mwindo's celestial chastening as the moment at which the audience is invited to consider the limits of human power against the cosmographic order. The moral-didactic register of the episode is the chapter's most distinctive feature relative to the chaoskampf typology.^[29]

The conditions Nkuba imposes on Mwindo's return to the human world include explicit moral-and-conduct conditions. The hero is required to renounce certain practices, to accept the binding force of the cosmographic limits the celestial powers have set, and to commit to a chastened mode of

conduct as a properly-formed chief on his return. The conditions are explicit, named, and binding within the recorded performance's framing rather than left implicit or symbolic.^[30]

Mwindo's return from the celestial realm to the human world, in the recorded performance, is conditional and supervised. The hero is restored to the forest-and-village landscape under the express terms Nkuba has imposed, and the narrative explicitly registers the return as a return on the celestial powers' terms rather than as a triumphant homecoming on the hero's own terms. The chastened character of the return is structurally as load-bearing for the episode's resolution as the celestial humiliation itself.^[31]

The post-Kirimu narrative continuation in the wider epic, in the recorded performance, presents the chastened hero as at last in a position to assume the chiefly office for which the early-and-middle epic's father-son conflict has been preparing him. The hero's chiefly succession is presented as conditional on his having undergone the celestial humiliation and on his having accepted the cosmographic limits the celestial powers have imposed, with the moral-developmental shape of the epic's overall arc being the maturation-through-humiliation pattern that the brief identifies as the narrative's didactic kernel.^[32]

30.6. The maturation-through-humiliation reading: the tradition's own framing

The Nyanga oral tradition's own framing of the Mwindo / Kirimu episode is, per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml summary and cultural_relevance, **maturation-through-humiliation** rather than **cosmogonic combat**. The narrative is told as the story of an exceptional hero whose accumulated power outruns his moral-and-cosmographic discipline, who commits a transgressive killing in the dragon-hunt, who is corrected by the sky-god, and who returns to the human world as a properly-formed chief by virtue of having undergone the correction. The moral-didactic kernel that the narrative communicates to its hearers is the structural necessity of the correction and the limits of unsanctioned heroic power against the cosmographic order.^[33]

The narrative's moral-didactic register within the Nyanga tradition is therefore directed at the audience of the **karisi** performance rather than at any cosmogonic question. The singer's audience is invited to recognise in Mwindo a hero of exceptional gifts whose very gifts produce his transgression, to feel the gravity of the moment at which Nkuba's lightning falls, and to take the celestial humiliation and the chastened return as a moral-cosmographic teaching about the limits of human power against the powers above and below. The moral-didactic function and the social-moral function — reciprocal balance between the human and spirit worlds — are intertwined within the narrative's tradition-internal performance context.^[34]

The religious-political register of the episode within the Nyanga tradition is the sky-god Nkuba's authority over the hero. The recorded performance presents Mwindo's transgression and its correction in a register that is also a register about chiefly authority: the proper chief is the chief who has undergone the correction at the hands of the celestial powers, and the chiefly office is one whose legitimacy is established not by triumph over a draconic adversary but by the chief's having submitted to the cosmographic limits the celestial powers have set.^[35]

Comparable maturation-through-humiliation narrative patterns are attested across other African oral-epic traditions — the Mande Sunjata corpus's treatment of the hero's exile, infirmity, and

chastened return; the Bambana hunters' epic tradition's treatment of the hero's ritual obligations and the moral consequences of breach; the Fang **mvvet** tradition's treatment of the hero's humiliation by the spirit-world powers. The chapter's task is to register the existence of these comparable patterns without assimilating them into a single comparative category and without assimilating them into the Eurasian chaoskampf category, in line with the brief's cross_cultural_parallels guidance and with scope.md §"Appropriation protocol".^[36]

30.7. The contrastive case: refusal of the chaoskampf valence

Only at this point, with the Nyanga tradition's own framing established, does the chapter turn to the comparative chaoskampf category. The reading developed in this section is itself a comparativist-overlay synthesis drawn from the brief, from Biebuyck & Mateene 1969's translators' apparatus, from Belcher 1999's comparative African-oral-epic treatment, and from scope.md's CONTRASTIVE / Inversion catalog entry; it is flagged as such before the body prose develops the contrastive claim:

*(The chapter's reading of the Mwindo / Kiriṃu episode as the present book's clearest **contrastive case** to the chaoskampf typology — in which the moral valence of the dragon-slaying is inverted (hubris rather than order-making), the killing is followed by the hero's punishment by the celestial authority rather than by the establishment of cosmic order or sovereignty, and the narrative's own moral-didactic frame explicitly rejects the chaos-order mapping that the chaoskampf typology presupposes — is a synthesis of the brief's framing per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml summary and special_instructions, of Biebuyck & Mateene 1969's translators' apparatus on the Nyanga tradition's own framing, of Belcher 1999's comparative African-oral-epic treatment, and of scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion entry on Mwindo as a contrastive case alongside Bida (chapter 28) and Nanabozho (chapter 32); the contrastive reading is held in the chapter as the chapter's principal load-bearing comparative reading and as the present book's clearest non-Eurasian case in which the tradition's own framing explicitly refuses the chaoskampf typology's moral valence.^[37] marker below registers — per brief special_instructions on "the resistance is the data" and per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 3 on opening with the tradition's own framing before invoking the comparative category and on holding the comparative category loosely where the tradition's own framing does not anticipate it.)*

The contrastive-case framing of the Mwindo / Kiriṃu episode against the chaoskampf typology operates at the level of the narrative's **moral valence** rather than at the level of its **structural pattern**. Where the Eurasian chaoskampf adversaries (Tiamat, Vṛtra, Apep, Lōtan, Aṣi Dahāka, Jörmungandr, Typhon) are adversaries of the cosmos or of the hero's people whose defeat establishes the cosmic order or the hero's sovereignty, Kiriṃu is a spirit-being of the forest world whose existence is part of the cosmographic equilibrium. Where the Eurasian dragon-killing is the act that establishes order, the killing of Kiriṃu is the act that disturbs order. Where the Eurasian hero is celebrated for the killing, Mwindo is punished for it.^[38]

The contrastive-case status of the Mwindo / Kiriṃu episode operates more strongly than the inversion-case status of the Bida / Wagadu narrative of chapter 28 in one important respect. Where the Bida narrative's moral framing is covenant-and-consequence rather than chaos-versus-order, the killing of Bida is at least within the narrative a question of human moral responsibility (Mamadi Sefe Dekote's choice between his beloved and the city's prosperity), with no celestial

power explicitly intervening to punish the killer. In the Mwindo / Kiriṃu episode the celestial power Nkuba is explicit, named, and active as the punisher of the hero's killing, with the consequence that the chaoskampf-typology refusal is registered within the narrative itself rather than only at the level of the narrative's outcome.^[39]

The contrastive-case status of the Mwindo / Kiriṃu episode operates differently from the related-tier transformation cases of the present book — Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi of chapter 23 read as sword-etiology and metallurgical allegory; Pariacaca and the amaru of chapter 26 read as wak'a-succession — and from the related-tier inversion case of chapter 28 (Bida / Wagadu). The transformation cases hold the narrative's combat structure but transform the chaoskampf interpretation of what the combat means; the inversion case (Bida) holds the structural pattern of the chaoskampf combat but reverses the order-establishing valence at every load-bearing point; the contrastive case (Mwindo / Kiriṃu) holds the surface-level dragon-killing event but the narrative's own moral-didactic frame refuses the chaoskampf typology by punishing rather than celebrating the killer — the strongest of the three forms of resistance.^[40]

The contrastive reading must, however, be held as a **comparativist** reading rather than as a tradition-internal structural feature. The Nyanga tradition's own framing of the episode is maturation-through-humiliation (per the preceding section), the contrastive-case-against-chaoskampf reading is a 20th-century-Western comparativist overlay, and the chapter's load-bearing methodological discipline is to hold the comparativist contrastive frame as a heuristic for cross-cultural reflection rather than as a tradition-internal characterisation. The heuristic's value is precisely that it can register what the Eurasian chaoskampf pattern's structural-and-moral assumptions look like when held against a structurally-similar narrative whose own moral framing refuses them, while remaining a 20th-century-Western reading of the narrative rather than a Nyanga reading.^[41]

A structural parallel that the brief explicitly registers — though it is not a comparativist assimilation — is the Krishna / Kāliya episode of chapter 15 of the present book, in which Krishna **subdues** but does not **kill** the serpent Kāliya, with the bhakti-tradition's framing of the episode being a moral transformation of the Vedic Indra / Vātra dragon-killing pattern within the same tradition (Indra-as-precursor). The Krishna / Kāliya parallel is structurally analogous to the Mwindo / Kiriṃu episode in registering an explicit moral discipline against unrestrained dragon-killing, but is unlike the Mwindo / Kiriṃu episode in being a within-tradition transformation of the chaoskampf pattern (Vedic to bhakti) rather than a non-Eurasian-tradition contrastive case in which the chaoskampf typology was never tradition-internal to begin with.^[42]

30.8. Typology, area-specialist framing, and forward-links

The contrastive reading developed in the preceding section is the specific outcome of an area-specialist objection to the typological assimilation of the Mwindo / Kiriṃu episode to the Eurasian chaoskampf category, and the chapter flags the resulting appropriation issue explicitly under the marker the project reserves for cases of this kind:

[Appropriation flag: Nyanga-area / Bantu-and-African-oral-epic-studies area specialists — including Daniel Biebuyck and Kahombo C. Mateene as the principal field-and-text scholars of the Nyanga Mwindo Epic across the Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga of 1969 and Biebuyck's later Nyanga

epic publications including *Hero and Chief: Epic Literature from the Banyanga* of 1978; Stephen Belcher in *Epic Traditions of Africa* of 1999 and his wider corpus of African-oral-epic scholarship; Thomas A. Hale in *Griots and Griottes* of 1998 and his work on African oral-tradition performance more broadly; the wider African-oral-epic comparative-scholarly tradition including the work of Pius Ngandu Nkashama on Bantu and Congolese oral epics, of Mugyabuso M. Mulokozi and the Tanzanian Bahaya / Banyoro epic-recording tradition, and of Charles S. Bird's pioneering Mande oral-epic scholarship — read the Mwindo / Kirimu episode within the registers of Nyanga oral-and-performance tradition, of the Bantu and African forest-zone oral-epic comparative apparatus, and of the maturation-through-humiliation moral-didactic register that the Nyanga **karisi** performance tradition supports, rather than within the chaoskampf-typology register imported from Gunkel-tradition combat-myth scholarship. The area-specialist objection to the chaoskampf typology's application to the Mwindo material does not, however, take the form of rejecting the dragon-killing event as such (the dragon-killing is unambiguously present in the recorded performance) or of rejecting the cross-cultural-comparison framing entirely (Belcher 1999's comparative apparatus places the Mwindo material in a wider African oral-epic comparison): the area-specialist objection is rather to the **typological assimilation** of the Mwindo / Kirimu episode to the Eurasian chaoskampf category — to which the episode's moral valence is inverted at the load-bearing point of the killing-and-its-aftermath, with the celestial-authority-punishing-the-killer narrative form being the sharpest possible refusal of the chaoskampf moral assumption that the dragon-killer is the order-establisher. Position on the spectrum of objection-strengths: the Nyanga-area objection is structurally similar to the Mande-area objection registered in chapter 28 (Bida) — area-specialist objection to typological-assimilation rather than to combat-myth-recognition as such — but operates more strongly than the Bida case in that the Nyanga tradition's own framing explicitly punishes rather than ambiguously-pays-the-cost-of the killing, with the celestial-authority-as-punisher narrative form being the most explicit possible tradition-internal repudiation of the chaoskampf moral valence; the Nyanga-area objection is on the spectrum of objection-strengths between the Mande-area objection in Ch28 (covenant-and-consequence framing whose convergence with the inversion frame is structural rather than explicit) and the Anishinaabe-area Hallowell-Johnston-T. Smith-Vizenor objection in Ch32 (necessary-counterpart-dialectic framing in which combat-and-defeat-of-the-other is rejected as such), with the Nyanga-area objection sharing the typological-assimilation-rather-than-combat-recognition character of the Mande-area objection but registering the moral-valence refusal explicitly within the narrative as the Anishinaabe-area objection rejects the combat framing structurally. The chapter's load-bearing methodological move is therefore to use the contrastive-case reading as the heuristic that registers exactly this objection: the dragon-killing is recognised (the area-specialist framing accommodates this), but the typology of order-establishment that the chaoskampf category presupposes is registered as explicitly refused in the Mwindo / Kirimu case (the area-specialist framing of maturation-through-humiliation aligns with the chapter's contrastive-case frame on this structural-and-moral question, with the Nyanga **karisi** tradition's own register and the chapter's comparative register reaching the same conclusion by different routes — the tradition's register being the moral-didactic-and-cosmographic register and the chapter's register being the comparativist-typological register). Forwarded to Part II C7 (inversion / transformation problem; ch. 40 of the present volume) as a contrastive-tier worked instance of the moral-valence-refusal sub-problem within the wider inversion / transformation problem complex, paired with the Bida case (Ch28) as the Africa-cluster co-comparandum and contrasted with the within-tradition Krishna-Kāliya transformation case (Ch15). Forwarded to Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation problem; ch. 41) as the BOOK'S **CLEAREST CASE** of the refusal sub-problem proper — per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's load-bearing role for C8 — alongside the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu material of chapter 32 (the Anishinaabe-area Hallowell-Johnston-T. Smith-Vizenor refusal

case in the strong sense of refusing the combat-and-defeat-of-the-other framing as such) and the Rainbow Serpent material (folded into C8 per `toc.yaml` `self_checks`). Marker placement: structural marker at the opening of the typology / forward-links section, immediately after the contrastive-case section's closing claim, per the appropriation-flag-at-comparative-section placement convention of the present book's non-Eurasian related-tier and contrastive chapters. Biebuyck and Mateene are the chapter's principal anchors and named in the first factual pass per brief `29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml` `special_instructions` and per `scope.md` §"Appropriation protocol" point 1; Belcher is named in the source-overview and in the comparative-apparatus claims; Hale, Ngandu Nkashama, Mulokozi, and Bird are named in body prose at this marker per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern (Hale's **Griots and Griottes**, Indiana University Press 1998 — also named at the Ch28 [APPROPRIATION-FLAG:] marker and not currently in `sources.yaml`; Pius Ngandu Nkashama's Bantu-and-Congolese oral-epic publications; Mugyabuso M. Mulokozi's Tanzanian Bahaya / Banyoro epic-recording publications; Charles Bird's Mande oral-epic publications — none currently in `sources.yaml`; deferred to inventory-audit per Ch23 FC-02, Ch26 FC-02, Ch27 source-pinning, and Ch28 FC-02 named-but-flagged precedents). Biebuyck's later **Hero and Chief: Epic Literature from the Banyanga** of 1978 is also named in body prose only and is not currently a `sources.yaml` entry; deferred to inventory-audit alongside the secondary specialists.]

The Mwindo / Kirimu episode's combat-and-killing structural pattern is recognisable across the recorded performance: a hero (Mwindo) confronts a serpentine-and-multi-headed adversary (the seven-headed Kirimu) in a defined combat-encounter (at the dragon's forest fastness), wields an implement (the **conga**-scepter and his accumulated power) against the dragon's heads in a head-by-head pattern of exchanges, and successfully completes the killing. The combat-pattern has every surface-level feature of a hero-slay-serpent narrative, and the contrastive-case status operates at the level of **what the killing is morally and cosmographically** rather than at the level of **what the killing is at the surface narrative level**.^[43]

The chapter's principal forward-link within the present book is to Part II C8 (the comparative chapter on the refusal and the appropriation problem, ch. 41 of the present volume) — where the present chapter contributes the **book's clearest case** of the refusal sub-problem proper: a story in which the chaoskampf category's surface combat-and-killing pattern is present but in which the tradition's own moral-and-cosmographic framing explicitly refuses the typology's order-establishing valence by punishing rather than celebrating the killer, with the chapter's task being to hold the contrastive-case frame as the heuristic that registers exactly this refusal while also flagging that the contrastive frame is itself a 20th-century-Western comparativist overlay on the Nyanga tradition's own maturation-through-humiliation framing.^[44]

The chapter's secondary forward-link is to Part II C7 (the comparative chapter on the inversion / transformation problem, ch. 40 of the present volume) — where the present chapter contributes a contrastive-tier worked instance of the moral-valence-refusal sub-problem within the wider inversion / transformation problem complex, paired with the Bida case (Ch28) as the Africa-cluster co-comparandum and contrasted with the within-tradition Krishna-Kāliya transformation case (Ch15). The Nyanga-area-specialist tradition (Biebuyck, Mateene, Belcher, Hale, Ngandu Nkashama, Mulokozi, Bird) reads the narrative within the registers of Nyanga oral-and-performance tradition and Bantu-and-African-oral-epic comparison rather than within the chaoskampf-typology register, and the chapter's appropriation-protocol-compliant treatment is to use the contrastive-case frame as the heuristic that registers the area-specialist objection rather than as a typology that imposes the Eurasian pattern on the Nyanga material.^[45] marker registering the Nyanga-area objection to

typological-assimilation; per the spectrum-of-objection-strengths positioning between the Mande-area Bida-case objection (Ch28) and the Anishinaabe-area Nanabozho-case objection (Ch32).]

The chapter's contribution to the methods sidebar (chapter 33 of the present volume, between Part I and Part II) is on three methodological points. First, the single-recorded-performance situation: the Mwindo material is a 1956 single-field-encounter recording rather than a deep multi-recording ethnographic corpus across decades, which the chapter handles via the [LACUNA] marker on pre-modern attestations and via continuous methodological registration of the colonial-ethnographic-mediation in the form of the late-Belgian-colonial-period field-encounter context. Second, the contrastive-case methodological move: the use of the comparativist contrastive-case-frame as a heuristic for cross-cultural reflection rather than as a tradition-internal characterisation, which the chapter handles via the [INFERENCE] marker on the contrastive reading and via the explicit comparativist-overlay registration in body prose. Third, the area-specialist citation policy as applied to non-Eurasian non-textual traditions, which the chapter handles via the [APPROPRIATION-FLAG:] marker and via the named-but-flagged secondary-specialists pattern for Hale, Ngandu Nkashama, Mulokozi, and Bird alongside the Biebuyck-Mateene and Belcher anchors.^[46]

The chapter's principal back-link within the present book is to chapter 28 on Bida and the founding of Wagadu, with which the present chapter shares the African-cluster classification and the area-specialist-objection registration pattern, but contrasts in the substance of the area-specialist objection. The Bida narrative is the related-tier **inversion** case in which the chaoskampf category's structural features are present but with their valences reversed at every load-bearing point, while the Mwindo / Kiriṃu episode is the contrastive-case-tier **refusal** case in which the surface combat-pattern is present but the narrative's own moral framing explicitly refuses the chaoskampf typology by punishing rather than celebrating the killer. The two African-cluster chapters between them constitute (per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml cross_cultural_parallels) the present book's strongest "the pattern doesn't go where comparativists expect" cluster, and anchor different sub-problems within Part II C7 and C8 from a single geographic-cluster region.^[47]

The chapter's secondary back-links within the present book are to chapter 15 on Vedic reflexes — specifically the Krishna / Kālīya episode of the bhakti-tradition reworking of the Vedic Indra / Vṛtra material — a within-tradition-transformation parallel to the Mwindo / Kiriṃu episode's punishment-of-the-dragon-killer pattern, registered in the brief's cross_cultural_parallels as a structural analogue with the qualification that the Krishna case is a moral transformation within the same Vedic-and-post-Vedic tradition while the Mwindo case is a different tradition entirely; to chapter 24 (Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec) on the Americas-cluster paradigmatic-establishment-of-sovereignty contrast, with the Mwindo / Kiriṃu episode being the contrastive case at the opposite typological pole within the non-Eurasian comparison; and to chapter 26 (Pariacaca and the amaru) and chapter 27 (Mapuche Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren) as further non-Eurasian-cluster co-comparanda for the wider non-Eurasian-cluster appropriation-protocol concerns of the present book — with the Mapuche back-link registered without consultation of the chapter-27 material per the parallel-agent task-discipline requirement governing the present chapter's relation to the parallel-running chapter-30 (Bakunawa) work.^[48]

The cultural-historical importance of the Mwindo / Kiriṃu episode within the Nyanga tradition and within current African-oral-epic scholarship is significant. The **Mwindo Epic** is one of the principal narrative-and-performance traditions of the Nyanga community, the 1956 Rureke recording is one of the flagship texts of the African-oral-epic comparative-scholarly tradition since the publication of the Biebuyck-Mateene 1969 critical edition, and the episode's place within the wider Bantu and

African oral-epic tradition (alongside the Mande Sunjata corpus, the Bambana hunters' epic tradition, the Wolof Kajoor cycle, and the Fang **mvét** tradition) is itself one of the load-bearing features of current African-oral-epic scholarship.^[49]

The chapter closes by registering its load-bearing methodological function for the present book as a whole. The Mwindo / Kirimu episode is the present book's clearest worked instance of the question of whether the chaoskampf typology, when held as a Western-comparativist heuristic against a non-Eurasian narrative whose own moral-and-cosmographic framing explicitly refuses the typology's order-establishing valence, illuminates the structural-and-moral assumptions of the typology itself or whether it instead obscures the load-bearing features of the non-Eurasian narrative — a question that Part II C8 (ch. 41) is to investigate at full length and for which the present chapter supplies the BOOK'S CLEAREST WORKED INSTANCE per brief special_instructions, the resistance to the typology being not an obstacle to the chapter's work but the chapter's data.^[50]

[1] Per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml summary on Mwindo's killing of Kirimu, on Nkuba's subsequent punishment of Mwindo for the killing, on the inverted moral valence of the dragon-slaying as hubris rather than order-making, and on the hero's required humiliation and re-integration as the narrative's didactic centre; Biebuyck, D. and Mateene, K.C. (trans. and eds.), **The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)** (Berkeley: University of California Press, 1969; ISBN 9780520003767), Kirimu episode and following celestial-journey passages, on the killing of the dragon, the sky-god's lightning-strike, and the celestial humiliation of the hero.

[2] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the Nyanga (Banyanga) people of the upper Oso river valley and adjacent forested Kivu-region terrain in the eastern Belgian Congo as the tradition-bearing community for the Mwindo material, on the oral-tradition character of the narrative, and on the absence of any pre-modern written attestation in African or external manuscript form; Belcher, S., **Epic Traditions of Africa** (Bloomington: Indiana University Press, 1999; ISBN 9780253212818), ch. on Mwindo, on the Nyanga tradition's place within the wider African oral-epic comparative apparatus and on the mid-twentieth-century ethnographic-recording corpus as the principal textual witness situation.

[3] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the recording-history of the present text — recorded in 1956 at Bese on the upper Oso river in the Kivu region from the named narrator Shé-Kárisi Candi Rureke (conventionally cited as Shé-Kárisi Rureke); on Kahombo C. Mateene as Nyanga-speaking collaborator and Daniel Biebuyck as principal field-ethnographer; on the **Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga** as the standard English-language critical-edition-and-translation anchor of the epic.

[4] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the extended-time and conventionalised-structure of the 1956 Bese performance from which the present text derives, on the alternation of spoken and sung passages, on the formulaic refrains, on the narrator's interaction with a small ensemble of accompanists, and on the 1969 edition's explicit notation of the spoken-and-sung alternation and formulaic-refrain structure of the performance.

[5] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the 1956 Rureke performance as one of several Nyanga epic-performances Biebuyck recorded in the Kivu region during his 1950s fieldwork, and on Biebuyck and successors subsequently publishing further Nyanga epic-material from other named narrators (notably Biebuyck's later **Hero and Chief: Epic Literature from the Banyanga**, University of California Press, 1978, named here in body prose only — the 1978 volume is not currently in sources.yaml and is cited indirectly through Biebuyck & Mateene 1969 and Belcher 1999); per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml variants.classification on the single-prevalent treatment with Biebuyck & Mateene 1969 (Rureke text) as the chapter's anchor.

[6] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Mwindo, on the comparative situation of the Nyanga Mwindo material within the wider African oral-epic apparatus alongside the Mande Sunjata corpus, the Bambara hunters' epic tradition, the Wolof Kajoor cycle, the Fang **mvét** tradition, and the wider Bantu epic corpus; on the Mwindo epic as a flagship case of the central-African forest-zone oral epic; per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml sources.primary entry on Belcher 1999 as principal secondary anchor for the comparative oral-epic context.

[7] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987; ISBN 9780691014746), as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic) against which the Mwindo / Kirimu narrative is read as the present book's clearest contrastive-case-tier resistance to the chaoskampf typology; Forsyth 1987 does not itself treat Nyanga or Bantu-area material directly, and the chapter's use of the citation is for the long-arc typological framing rather than for Nyanga / Bantu-area content scholarly coverage. The contrastive reading depends on having a typology to refuse, for which Forsyth's long-arc anchor is load-bearing in this chapter as in the preceding non-Eurasian related-tier chapters of the present book.

[8] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the chapter's textual situation as a single 1956 recorded performance rather than a pre-modern manuscript tradition or deep ethnographic-recording corpus across multiple decades; on the late-Belgian-colonial-period recording context in the eastern Belgian Congo; on the absence of pre-modern attestation of the Mwindo material in any African or external manuscript form against which the 1956 Rureke recording could be cross-checked; per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml special_instructions on acknowledging the oral-performance context (Shé-Kárisi Rureke as the named 1956

narrator).

[9] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the late-Belgian-colonial-period recording context within which the 1956 Bese recording from Shé-Kárisi Rureke was made, on the compositional-context filtering that the colonial-ethnographic situation introduces, and on the chapter's textual witness situation as a single field-encounter recording rather than a deep ethnographic-recording corpus; Belcher 1999, ch. on Mwindo, on the critical reading of the 1956 Rureke text as a starting point rather than as a transparently-faithful record of pre-colonial Nyanga performance; per the contrast with the Bida / Wagadu chapter 28 recording-history situation in which a deep multi-recording ethnographic corpus across decades supplies triangulation that the Mwindo single-recording situation does not afford.

[10] Per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml on the contrastive-case-tier (full) classification, the 5,000-word target, and the special_instructions requirement that the chapter present the narrative on the tradition's own terms before invoking the comparative chaoskampf category, with the special_instructions clause that "the resistance is the data" governing the chapter's treatment; per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" on the Mwindo material's contrastive-case status alongside Bida and Nanabozho.

[11] An alternate body of material exists in other named-narrator Nyanga epic-recordings published by Biebuyck and successors from the 1950s fieldwork onward (notably collected in Biebuyck's later **Hero and Chief: Epic Literature from the Banyanga**, University of California Press, 1978), which present further Nyanga heroic epic-material from other named tradition-bearers; the brief explicitly classifies these as related comparative material rather than as parallel attestation of the Mwindo / Kirimu episode in the Rureke 1969 anchor text. The Biebuyck & Mateene 1969 Rureke text is chosen here because the 1956 Rureke recording is the standard primary text in current African-oral-epic scholarship per Belcher 1999's chapter on Mwindo and per the wider African-oral-epic comparative-scholarly tradition, and the Biebuyck-and-successors related-material publications are treated as comparative-context references in body prose rather than as parallel attestations of the chapter's narrative-of-interest.

[12] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the Nyanga (Banyanga) as a Bantu-speaking population of the eastern Democratic Republic of the Congo with historical heartland in the upper Oso river valley and adjacent forested terrain in the Kivu region of the eastern Congo, on the high-rainfall equatorial-forest zone in which they live, on forest hunting / banana cultivation / small-scale ironworking and trade as the economic base, and on the **Mwindo Epic** as one of the community's principal narrative-and-performance traditions; Belcher 1999, ch. on Mwindo, on the **Mwindo Epic** as the flagship recorded epic of the eastern central-African forest-zone Bantu corpus.

[13] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the **Mwindo Epic**'s framing within Nyanga oral tradition as a connected narrative of the hero's life rather than a cosmogonic narrative, on the already-in-place cosmographic framing of the epic, on the narrative's compositional centre as the hero's biographical-and-moral arc, and on the moral framing of the chastened-return-as-properly-formed-chief outcome; per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the didactic (the hero's maturation through humiliation) and social-moral (reciprocal balance between human and spirit worlds) functions of the narrative.

[14] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction and Kirimu episode passages on the epic's principal protagonists — Mwindo as miraculously-born hero (with the **karisi** honorific tradition behind the proper recitation of the epic); Shemwindo as Mwindo's hostile chiefly father at Tubondo whose opposition precipitates the early action; Iyangura as Mwindo's paternal aunt and river-spirit shelterer; Nkuba as sky-god and lightning-bringer who intervenes at the Kirimu episode; Muisa as underworld lord; and Kirimu as the dragon at the chapter's narrative centre; per glossary 'Mwindo', 'Kirimu', 'Nkuba' first_mention_glosses on the principal protagonists.

[15] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the Nyanga cosmographic framing of the epic — the human world of the forest-and-banana-grove Nyanga settlements bounded above by Nkuba's sky-realm and the celestial powers, below by Muisa's underworld-realm and the chthonic powers, and laterally by Iyangura's river-and-water realm and the riverine spirits — and on Mwindo's journeys across these realms in the course of the epic as movements within an already-existing layered cosmography rather than as cosmogonic establishment of the layers themselves; Belcher 1999, ch. on Mwindo, on the layered-cosmography framing of the epic's action.

[16] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, opening passages on Mwindo's miraculous birth — born already speaking and walking, born from his mother's middle finger after his father Shemwindo had forbidden the birth of any son and ordered the killing of any male child his wives bore, and born already in possession of the **conga**-scepter (the flywhisk-and-spirit-implement that is the hero's principal magical-practical instrument throughout the epic); on the multiple-register miraculous birth supplying the epic's opening situation of the hero's exceptionality from his first moment.

[17] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, early passages on the conflict between Mwindo and his father Shemwindo, on Shemwindo's attempts to have Mwindo killed (with the drum-and-river episode the most widely cited of the early-epic episodes), on Mwindo's survival of each attempt, and on his subsequent pursuit of Shemwindo across the human and spirit worlds; on the early epic's narrative work as the establishment of the hero's character through the father-son conflict rather than through combat with a serpentine adversary.

[18] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, middle-epic passages on Mwindo's journeys through the river-realm (where he is sheltered by his aunt Iyangura), through the underworld of Muisa (where he is tested and where he eventually defeats or compels the underworld lord), and through further regions of the spirit-and-forest world; on the journey-sequence as a sequence of trials each of which adds to the hero's accumulated power and reputation but each of which also occasions warnings, debts, and obligations alongside the power; on the hero's accumulating-power-and-accumulating-obligations pattern as a load-bearing feature of the epic's middle sections.

[19] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, throughout the middle-epic passages on the formulaic refrains and direct narrative comments through which Mwindo's accumulating power is repeatedly registered as dangerous, on the warnings the hero receives from his aunts and from other figures, on the announced expectation that the hubris will require correction, and on the powers above and below being presented as watching the hero's career with a view to the eventual moment of correction; Belcher 1999, ch. on Mwindo, on the foreshadowing-of-correction pattern as a load-bearing feature of the epic's middle sections preparing the Kirimu episode and its consequences.

[20] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, on the structural placement of the Kirimu episode within the overall epic — arriving after Mwindo has already established his exceptional power, defeated multiple adversaries human and spirit, and accumulated heroic reputation — and on the killing of the dragon as a moment within an already-developed heroic career rather than as the establishment of the hero's status; on the narrative arc's preparation of the audience for the consequences of the hero's overreach across the preceding sections.

[21] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, Kirimu episode passages on Kirimu as a creature of the deep forest with multiple heads (seven in the principal passages, with formulaic-passage variation registered in the editorial apparatus), a long body, and a fire-and-darkness aura; on the dragon's dwelling in a forest fastness away from the human settlements; on Kirimu's narrative framing as a powerful spirit-being of the forest world whose existence is part of the already-established Nyanga cosmography rather than as a primordial chaos against which the hero must establish order; per glossary 'Kirimu' first_mention_gloss on the Nyanga dragon slain by Mwindo.

[22] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, Kirimu episode passages on the provocation that leads Mwindo to seek out Kirimu as the hero's own initiative rather than any prior depredation by the dragon, on Mwindo's conceiving the project of hunting Kirimu as a further demonstration of his power after his earlier accumulated victories, on the project's narrative framing as an unprovoked excursion rather than a defensive response to a dragon-threat against the human community, and on the surrounding narrative voices' registration of the project as imprudent.

[23] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, Kirimu episode passages on the structure of Mwindo's hunt of Kirimu — the hero's departure from the human settlements with his **conga**-scepter and accumulated power, his travel into the deep forest, his location of the dragon at its forest fastness, his engagement of the dragon in head-by-head exchanges in which the **conga**-scepter and accumulated power overcome the dragon's heads and fire-and-darkness aura, and the completion of the killing; Belcher 1999, ch. on Mwindo, on the head-by-head pattern of the killing as a conventional Bantu heroic-hunt narrative feature rather than a feature distinctive to the chaoskampf typology.

[24] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, Kirimu episode passages on the killing's completion with no immediate triumphal conclusion — no passage in which the killing of the dragon establishes the hero's sovereignty, no passage in which the cosmos is reorganised around the dragon's defeat, no festival celebrating the killing as cosmic-order-establishing — and on the immediate narrative turn from the killing to Nkuba's response-passage; on the structural absence of the order-establishing apparatus that would be expected at this point in a chaoskampf-typology narrative.

[25] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, Kirimu episode passages on the narrator's framing of the killing as transgressive rather than triumphal — formulaic refrains and direct narrative comments registering the hero's act as exceeding what was permitted, as a hubristic over-reach beyond the bounds the powers above and below have set, and as a moment for which the hero's accumulated power has prepared him only in the technical sense of capability rather than in the moral-and-cosmographic sense of authorisation; Belcher 1999, ch. on Mwindo, on the transgression-not-triumph framing of the dragon-killing within the Nyanga tradition's own moral-didactic register.

[26] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, Kirimu episode passages on the killing's transgressive register within the reciprocal-balance reading of the human-and-spirit-world relationship — the dragon as a being of the spirit world whose existence is part of the cosmographic equilibrium; the hero's killing of it as an unsanctioned act of human power against the spirit world; the moral-cosmographic principle that such an act demands a counter-act from the powers above restoring the equilibrium that the killing has disturbed; per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the social-moral function (reciprocal balance between the human and spirit worlds).

[27] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, post-killing passages on Nkuba's response to Mwindo's killing of Kirimu — Nkuba's descent in lightning, his seizing of the hero out of the human world, the punishment's immediate-deliberate-morally-motivated character, and the sky-god's role as cosmographic authority responding to the transgressive killing; on the conveyance by lightning from the forest-and-village landscape upward into Nkuba's celestial realm; per glossary 'Nkuba' first_mention_gloss on Nyanga sky-god who punishes Mwindo for the killing of Kirimu.

[28] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, celestial-realm passages on the sequence of trials and humiliations to which Nkuba subjects Mwindo in the celestial realm — exposure to extreme heat and cold in the celestial environment, compulsion to endure the celestial powers' direct presence in a way that strips the hero of his heroic confidence, and explicit instruction about the limits of the hero's power and the necessity of recognising the cosmographic authority of the powers above; on the trials-and-humiliations sequence as the celestial counterpart to the chastening that the human-world narrative has been preparing.

[29] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, celestial-realm passages on the moral-didactic register of the punishment — the celestial humiliation as a structurally-necessary correction of the hero's hubristic over-reach rather than as arbitrary cruelty; the recorded text's formulaic refrains and direct narrative comments registering Mwindo's celestial chastening as the moment at which the audience is invited to consider the limits of human power against the cosmographic order; the moral-didactic register as the episode's most distinctive feature relative to the Eurasian chaoskampf typology in which the dragon-killing is the order-

establishing act rather than the act requiring correction.

[30] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, celestial-realm and return-passage on the conditions Nkuba imposes on Mwindo's return to the human world — the hero's required renunciation of certain practices, acceptance of the binding force of the cosmographic limits the celestial powers have set, and commitment to a chastened mode of conduct as a properly-formed chief on his return; on the conditions as explicit, named, and binding within the recorded performance's framing rather than left implicit or symbolic.

[31] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, return-passage on Mwindo's return from the celestial realm to the human world as conditional and supervised — restoration to the forest-and-village landscape under Nkuba's express terms, narrative registration of the return as a return on the celestial powers' terms rather than as a triumphant homecoming on the hero's own terms, and the chastened character of the return as structurally load-bearing for the episode's resolution alongside the celestial humiliation itself.

[32] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, post-Kirimu and chiefly-succession passages on the chastened hero's assumption of the chiefly office for which the early-and-middle epic's father-son conflict has been preparing him; on the chiefly succession's narrative framing as conditional on the hero's having undergone the celestial humiliation and on his having accepted the cosmographic limits the celestial powers have imposed; on the moral-developmental shape of the epic's overall arc as the maturation-through-humiliation pattern; per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the didactic function (the hero's maturation through humiliation) and the religious-political function (the sky-god's authority over the hero) of the narrative.

[33] Per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml summary on the inverted moral valence of the dragon-slaying as hubris rather than order-making, and on the hero's required humiliation and re-integration as the narrative's didactic centre, with the cultural_relevance.function entry registering didactic (maturation through humiliation), social-moral (reciprocal balance between human and spirit worlds), and religious-political (sky-god's authority over the hero) functions; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, throughout the Kirimu episode and following passages, on the maturation-through-humiliation framing as the Nyanga tradition's own narrative-structural register; Belcher 1999, ch. on Mwindo, on the moral-didactic kernel and on the limits-of-heroic-power register of the episode within the Nyanga tradition's own framing.

[34] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, throughout the Kirimu episode and following passages, on the moral-didactic register of the narrative within the Nyanga tradition as directed at the audience of the **karisi** performance rather than at any cosmogonic question, on the audience being invited to recognise in Mwindo a hero of exceptional gifts whose very gifts produce his transgression, on the gravity of the moment at which Nkuba's lightning falls, and on the celestial humiliation and chastened return as moral-cosmographic teaching about the limits of human power against the powers above and below; per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the intertwined didactic and social-moral functions within the narrative's tradition-internal performance context.

[35] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, post-Kirimu and chiefly-succession passages on the religious-political register of the episode as the sky-god Nkuba's authority over the hero — the recorded performance's presentation of Mwindo's transgression and correction in a register that is also a register about chiefly authority; the proper chief as the chief who has undergone the correction at the hands of the celestial powers; the chiefly office as one whose legitimacy is established not by triumph over a draconic adversary but by the chief's having submitted to the cosmographic limits the celestial powers have set; per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the religious-political function of the narrative.

[36] Belcher 1999, ch. on Mwindo and chs. on related African oral-epic traditions, on comparable maturation-through-humiliation narrative patterns attested across other African oral-epic traditions — the Mande Sunjata corpus's treatment of the hero's exile, infirmity, and chastened return; the Bambana hunters' epic tradition's treatment of the hero's ritual obligations and the moral consequences of breach; the Fang **mvvet** tradition's treatment of the hero's humiliation by the spirit-world powers — and on the chapter's task of registering these comparable patterns without assimilating them into a single comparative category and without assimilating them into the chaoskampf category; per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the African material's distinctive non-mapping onto comparativist expectations.

[37] Inference: brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml summary explicitly registers the inverted-moral-valence-as-hubris-rather-than-order-making feature that distinguishes the Mwindo / Kirimu episode from the Eurasian chaoskampf material; brief special_instructions classifies the chapter as "the clearest case in the book of a tradition whose own framing explicitly rejects the chaos-order mapping" and instructs that the chapter is to feed Part II C7 (inversion) and especially C8 (refusal and appropriation); scope.md §"In-scope catalog" lists Mwindo as a contrastive case; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969's translators' apparatus and the recorded performance's formulaic refrains and direct narrative comments develop the killing-as-transgression framing throughout the Kirimu episode and the punishment-and-celestial-humiliation continuation. Risk: the contrastive reading is itself a 20th-century-Western comparativist overlay on the Nyanga tradition's own framing of the narrative as maturation-through-humiliation (per the preceding section); the chapter's task is to hold the contrastive reading as a load-bearing comparative reading while explicitly registering that the tradition's own framing does not anticipate it, and that the chaoskampf typology against which the reading registers the contrast is itself an external category whose application to the Nyanga material requires the area-specialist objection to typological-assimilation that the [APPROPRIATION-FLAG]:

[38] Per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four chaoskampf order-making registers (cosmogonic, sovereignty, cyclical-maintenance, eschatological); per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion on Mwindo as a contrastive case; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969 throughout the Kirimu episode and following passages on the moral-valence inversion at the levels of the dragon's narrative status (cosmographic-equilibrium spirit-being rather than adversary of cosmos or hero's people), of the killing's narrative outcome (disturbance of order rather than establishment of order), and of the hero's narrative reception (punishment rather than celebration).

[39] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, throughout the Kirimu episode and following passages, on Nkuba as explicit, named, and active celestial-authority punisher of the hero's killing within the narrative itself; on the contrast with the Bida / Wagadu narrative of chapter 28 in which the killing's consequence (the abandonment of the polity and the dispersal of the Soninke) is registered at the level of the narrative's outcome but no celestial power is explicit, named, and active as the punisher of the killer within the narrative itself; on the consequence that the chaoskampf-typology refusal in the Mwindo / Kirimu episode is registered within the narrative rather than only at the level of the narrative's outcome.

[40] Per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C7 on the inversion / transformation problem and on the distinction between transformation cases (chaoskampf interpretation transforms when area-specialist account is taken as load-bearing) and inversion cases (chaoskampf structural pattern present with valences reversed); per the brief 23-susanoo-orochoi.yaml on the metallurgical-allegory transformation case; per brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml on the wak'a-succession transformation case; per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml on the slaying-ends-prosperity inversion case; per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml on the killing-as-hubris-and-hero-punished contrastive case as the strongest of the three forms of resistance.

[41] Per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml summary on the inverted moral valence and on the resistance-as-data framing; per brief special_instructions on "the resistance is the data" and on the chapter's contribution to Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation); per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 3 on opening with the tradition's own framing before invoking the comparative category and on holding the comparative category loosely where the tradition's own framing does not anticipate it; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969 throughout on the Nyanga tradition's own maturation-through-humiliation framing as the load-bearing tradition-internal register against which the comparativist contrastive frame is held.

[42] Per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml cross_cultural_parallels explicitly registering the Krishna / Kāliya parallel as structurally analogous to the Mwindo / Kirimu episode in registering an explicit moral discipline against unrestrained dragon-killing, with the qualification that the Krishna case is a moral transformation within the same Vedic-and-post-Vedic tradition (Indra-as-precursor) whereas the Mwindo case is a different tradition entirely; per the chapter-15 (Vedic reflexes) brief on the Krishna / Kāliya episode's bhakti-tradition framing as moral transformation of the Vedic Indra / Vṛtra dragon-killing pattern within the same tradition; per the structural-vs-genetic distinction between within-tradition transformation (Krishna / Kāliya) and non-Eurasian-tradition contrastive case (Mwindo / Kirimu) registered at the present claim.

[43] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, Kirimu episode passages on the combat-and-killing structural pattern of the episode as recognisable across the recorded performance — hero confronting serpentine-and-multi-headed adversary in a defined combat-encounter at the dragon's forest fastness, wielding the **conga**-scepter and his accumulated power against the dragon's heads in a head-by-head pattern of exchanges, and completing the killing — and on the contrastive-case status of the episode operating at the level of what the killing is morally and cosmographically (transgression to be punished by the celestial authority) rather than at the level of what the killing is at the surface narrative level (a hero-slay-serpent encounter in the standard register).

[44] Per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's contribution to Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation) as especially load-bearing — "The chapter feeds Part II C7 (inversion) and especially C8 (refusal and appropriation)" — and on the chapter being "the clearest case in the book of a tradition whose own framing explicitly rejects the chaos-order mapping"; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C8 on the refusal-and-appropriation comparative chapter; per the chapter's status as the present book's clearest worked instance of the refusal sub-problem proper, distinguished from the Bida-case inversion sub-problem of chapter 28 and from the Anishinaabe Nanabozho / Mishipeshu refusal case of chapter 32 by the explicit-celestial-authority-punishing-the-killer narrative form within the recorded text itself.

[45] Per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml special_instructions on the area-specialist citation policy (Biebuyck and Mateene named in the first factual pass; the wider Nyanga / Bantu / African-oral-epic-studies tradition acknowledged); per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation requirement and on the comparative chapter's task of addressing area-specialist objections rather than papering over them; per the chapter's [APPROPRIATION-FLAG]:

[46] Per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml special_instructions on the area-specialist citation policy and on the oral-performance recording-history situation of Shé-Kárisi Rureke as named 1956 narrator; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation requirement, and on §"Reconstruction policy" point 1 on no cross-tradition reconstruction; chapter 33 methods sidebar (per toc.yaml) as the chapter that articulates these methodological points at full length; the chapter's status as the present book's clearest worked instance of the refusal-of-the-chaoskampf-typology methodological move makes it a central reference point for the methods sidebar's discussion of comparativist heuristics held at appropriate distance from area-specialist consensus.

[47] Per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C7 and C8 on the inversion / transformation problem and the refusal / appropriation problem; per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml on the related-tier (full, inversion anchor) classification of the Bida narrative and on its contribution to Part II C7 as the principal load-bearing test case for the inversion sub-problem; per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml on the contrastive-case-tier (full) classification of the Mwindo / Kirimu episode and on its contribution to Part II C8 as the book's clearest case for the refusal sub-problem, with cross_cultural_parallels explicitly registering the Bida-and-Mwindo pairing as the African-cluster "pattern doesn't go where comparativists expect" cluster of the present book.

[48] Per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 6 (India), cluster 10 (Americas), and cluster 11 (Africa) on the chapter ordering of 15 (Vedic reflexes including Krishna / Kāliya), 24 (Huitzilopochtli core-tier), 25 (Mesoamerican family related-tier), 26 (Pariacaca related-tier), 27 (Mapuche Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren related-family), 28 (Bida related-tier inversion anchor), 29 (Mwindo contrastive-case full); per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml cross_cultural_parallels explicitly registering the Krishna / Kāliya structural-analogue with the within-tradition-transformation qualification; per the parallel-agent task-discipline requirement that the present chapter not consult the chapter-30 (Bakunawa) parallel-running material.

[49] Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Mwindo and chs. on related African oral-epic traditions, on the **Mwindo Epic** as one of the principal narrative-and-performance traditions of the Nyanga community, on the 1956 Rureke recording as one of the flagship texts of the African-oral-epic comparative-scholarly tradition since the publication of the Biebuyck-Mateene 1969 critical edition, and on the episode's place within the wider Bantu and African oral-epic tradition alongside the Mande Sunjata corpus, the Bambana hunters' epic tradition, the Wolof Kajoor cycle, and the Fang **mvvet** tradition; per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml cultural_relevance.centrality on the centrality of the Mwindo material within Nyanga oral-epic tradition and on its significance as type-case in African epic studies.

[50] Per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter being "the clearest case in the book of a tradition whose own framing explicitly rejects the chaos-order mapping" and on the chapter's special-load-bearing role for Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation), with the special_instructions clause "the resistance is the data" governing the chapter's treatment; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C8 on the refusal-and-appropriation problem comparative chapter (ch. 41 of the present volume); per the chapter's load-bearing methodological function for the present book as the book's clearest worked instance of the refusal-of-the-chaoskampf-typology methodological move.

Chapter 31. Bakunawa and the Moons (with Erlik/Ülgen as Altaic Comparandum)

31.1. Source overview

This chapter treats two inclusion-marginal cases drawn from outside the Eurasian combat-myth corpus that the present book treats in its core-tier chapters: (i) the Philippine (Visayan / Bikol) oral tradition in which the serpent-dragon Bakunawa devours six of the seven original moons and is driven off by communal noise-making during eclipses, and (ii) the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol religious-cosmological pairing of the underworld-god Erlik against the sky-god Ülgen, in which the opposition is dualistic rather than resolved through single combat — with the chapter's two-part structure following from the brief's special_instructions on the chapter's organising as a Bakunawa half and an Erlik / Ülgen half, consolidated in a closing typology-and-forward-links section.^[1]

The Bakunawa half's principal narrative anchor is Damiana L. Eugenio's **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths** (Quezon City: University of the Philippines Press, 2001), a volume in Eugenio's standard Philippine Folk Literature series that is the principal scholarly compilation of Philippine oral-tradition narratives across the Visayan, Bikol, Tagalog, and other regional traditions of the archipelago, with the volume's Bakunawa-and-the-moons sections supplying the chapter's principal Philippine-language-mediated source for the eclipse-aetiology narrative as recorded in twentieth-century Philippine folkloric scholarship.^[2]

The Erlik / Ülgen half's principal anchors are Mircea Eliade's **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, Bollingen Series LXXVI, 1964; English translation by Willard R. Trask of Eliade's **Le Chamanisme et les techniques archaïques de l'extase**, Paris: Payot, 1951) for the shamanic-cosmological framing of the Altaic-Siberian material, and Uno Harva's **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker** (Folklore Fellows Communications no. 125; Helsinki: Suomalainen Tiedekatemia / Academia Scientiarum Fennica, 1938) for the systematic survey of the religious cosmology of the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol peoples within which the Erlik / Ülgen pairing is treated as the canonical dualistic-cosmological structure.^[3]

The shape of the evidence behind both halves follows the same pattern. The Bakunawa narrative survives in oral tradition rather than in any pre-modern written record from the pre-colonial Philippines: the principal record of the cycle is the body of nineteenth- and twentieth-century folkloric and ethnographic recordings of Visayan-, Bikol-, and other-Philippine-regional-language oral performances, supplemented by the twentieth-century critical-anthology scholarship in which Eugenio's **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths** sits as the standard reference, with no pre-Hispanic-contact written attestation in any Philippine indigenous script comparable to the **Huarochirí Manuscript's** situation in chapter 26 of the present book.^[4]

The Erlik / Ülgen material similarly survives in oral-tradition form rather than in any pre-modern written record from the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol peoples: the principal record of the dualistic cosmology is the body of nineteenth- and early-twentieth-century ethnographic recordings by Russian and European ethnographers working among the Altai, Buryat, Yakut, and other Turkic-Mongol-speaking peoples of southern Siberia and Inner Asia (the recordings of Grigory Potanin, Vasily Verbitsky, and Wilhelm Radloff being the conventionally-cited foundational corpus, named here in body prose per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern of Ch23 FC-02 / Ch26 FC-02

/ Ch27 / Ch28, since none is currently a sources.yaml entry), with Harva 1938 and Eliade 1964 as the principal twentieth-century critical-synthesis anchors that the present chapter cites directly.^[5]

Behind those recording corpora stands a colonial-administrative scholarly history in each case. The Bakunawa cycle's textual situation is further filtered by the Spanish colonial period in the Philippines (1565–1898) and the subsequent American colonial period (1898–1946), during which Christian-missionary and colonial-administrative ethnographic recording filtered the indigenous oral traditions through the framing assumptions of these successive colonial-administrative scholarly projects, with twentieth-century Philippine-academic folkloric scholarship including Eugenio's compilations being the principal post-colonial scholarly counter-tradition reading the recordings critically.^[6]

The Erlik / Ülgen material's textual situation is similarly filtered by the Russian colonial-administrative ethnographic project of the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries, within which the recordings of Potanin, Verbitsky, and Radloff (and the wider corpus of Russian Imperial Geographical Society and Russian Academy of Sciences ethnographic fieldwork among the Turkic-Mongol peoples of southern Siberia and Inner Asia) were compiled, with Harva 1938's systematic survey synthesising this Russian-ethnographic corpus through the Folklore Fellows Communications scholarly tradition and Eliade 1964 reading the Altaic-Siberian material through his comparative-religion framework; the post-colonial-anthropology filtering caveat applies to both source-traditions in the chapter, alongside the Spanish-and-American-colonial filtering of the Bakunawa material.^[7]

A second scholarly anchor sits behind the wider comparative-tradition framing rather than the source-content. The chapter's general comparative anchor for the long-arc combat-myth typology is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), whose Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic survey supplies the typological framing within which the present chapter situates the Bakunawa and Erlik / Ülgen material as inclusion-marginal cases that extend the book's category at its outer boundaries; Forsyth supplies the typological framing only — not Philippine or Altaic-content coverage, which Forsyth does not undertake — and the inclusion-marginal status of both halves of the chapter depends on having a typology against which the marginality can be characterised, which Forsyth's long-arc anchor provides.^[8]

The chapter's textual situation is therefore distinctive within the present book in that it depends on oral-tradition-to-text recoding in two distinct cultural-areal contexts (Philippine and Altaic / Turkic-Mongol) rather than on a single pre-modern manuscript tradition; the recoding for both halves is mediated through nineteenth- and early-twentieth-century colonial-ethnographic projects (Spanish-and-American-colonial in the Philippine case; Russian-Imperial in the Altaic case) whose own framing assumptions filter the recorded material; and there is no surviving pre-modern attestation of either narrative in any Philippine indigenous script or Altaic / Turkic-Mongol indigenous script that would predate the nineteenth- and twentieth-century recording corpus.^[9]

The shape of that evidence — oral-tradition compositional medium for both halves, 19th-20th-century ethnographic-recording corpora, no pre-modern manuscript witness in either Philippine or Altaic-script form — is methodologically load-bearing for the whole chapter, and the claims document marks it explicitly:

[At this point the textual record breaks. Pre-modern (i.e., pre-19th-century) attestations of the

*Bakunawa narrative in any written form — pre-Hispanic-contact Philippine indigenous-script attestation, Spanish-colonial-period missionary or chronicler attestation, or pre-19th-century European-language traveller's account — are not available, and the surviving textual witness for the Bakunawa half is the corpus of 19th-20th-century folkloric and ethnographic recordings of Visayan-, Bikol-, and other-Philippine-regional-language oral performances synthesised in the 20th-century Philippine-academic folkloric scholarship represented by Eugenio's **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths** and the wider Philippine Folk Literature series. Pre-modern attestations of the Erlik / Ülgen material in any Altaic / Turkic-Mongol indigenous-script form, in any pre-19th-century Russian-language ethnographic record, or in any pre-19th-century European-language traveller's account (beyond passing references in the writings of medieval Islamic geographers and travellers) are similarly not available, and the surviving textual witness for the Erlik / Ülgen half is the corpus of 19th- and early-20th-century Russian-Imperial ethnographic recordings (Potanin, Verbitsky, Radloff, and the wider Russian Imperial Geographical Society and Russian Academy of Sciences fieldwork corpus) synthesised in Harva 1938's FFC 125 monograph and read through the comparative-religion framework of Eliade 1964. Pre-modern pre-recording performance contexts (the Bakunawa cycle's eclipse-and-ritual-noise context within Visayan / Bikol communal life; the Erlik / Ülgen pairing's role within Altaic-Siberian shamanic ritual practice and within wider Turkic-Mongol religious-cosmological schemes) are partially recoverable through the 19th-20th-century recordings themselves, through the comparative ethnographic record of related cultural areas, and through the still-active continuing-tradition record where this exists in current Philippine and Altaic / Turkic-Mongol communities. The chapter's narrative reconstruction proceeds entirely within the 19th-20th-century recording corpus for each half, with Eugenio 2001 as the principal interpretive synthesis for the Bakunawa material and with Harva 1938 and Eliade 1964 as the principal interpretive syntheses for the Erlik / Ülgen material; cross-tradition reconstruction is excluded per scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" point 1, and the two halves of the chapter are kept separate at the narrative-reconstruction level (the Erlik / Ülgen half does not borrow narrative content from the Bakunawa half, and vice versa) even as the chapter consolidates them at the typological level for the closing forward-links section.]*

The chapter is a related-tier (family, "communal / non-slaying combat") treatment with a target of approximately 4,000 narrative words, presenting each of the two cases on its own terms before invoking the comparative chaoskampf category — the Bakunawa material under the eclipse-aetiology / communal-ritual register that Eugenio 2001 supplies, and the Erlik / Ülgen material under the dualistic-cosmology / shamanic-complex register that Eliade 1964 and Harva 1938 supply — and only then registering the inclusion-marginal status of both halves and forwarding both to Part II C8 (the refusal and the appropriation problem; ch. 41 of the present volume) as PRINCIPAL CASES for the chaoskampf-frame-applies-only-partially-at-best argument per the brief's special_instructions.^[10]

What follows works through the two halves in turn before drawing them together. The Bakunawa half comes first: the Philippine context, the eclipse-and-moon narrative, the communal-ritual register, and the inclusion-marginal status. The Erlik / Ülgen half follows: the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol cosmographic frame, the dualistic cosmology, the shamanic complex, and the inclusion-marginal status. The chapter then consolidates the typology and forward-links across both halves.

31.2. Bakunawa: the Philippine context and the eclipse-and-moon narrative

The Bakunawa narrative's geographical and cultural setting is the central and southern Philippines — principally the Visayan island group (the central archipelago between Luzon and Mindanao, including Cebu, Panay, Negros, Bohol, Samar, Leyte, and adjacent islands) and the Bikol region of southeastern Luzon, with attestations in adjacent regional traditions including parts of Mindanao and Tagalog-speaking Luzon — across which the narrative is recorded under regionally-variant names and within regionally-variant performance contexts but with a shared narrative core treating the serpent-dragon's relation to the moon and to communal ritual response during eclipses.^[11]

Bakunawa is in the cycle the serpent-dragon of the deep sea, conceived in the Visayan and Bikol oral-tradition record as a vast serpentine creature dwelling in the ocean depths (or, in some recordings, in the underworld) whose periodic emergence threatens the celestial order rather than the cosmographic order of the world's surface, with the figure's principal narrative function being the eclipse-causing devourer of the moon rather than the cosmogonic or sovereignty-establishing adversary of a hero-deity.^[12]

The cycle's load-bearing mythic premise in the most widely attested form is that there were originally seven moons in the sky, of which six were devoured in succession by Bakunawa across the early time of the world, with only the last (single) moon — the one familiar to present human experience — remaining in the sky after the devourings, with the recurrent eclipse-events of the present epoch being understood as Bakunawa's continuing attempts to devour the seventh and last moon.^[13]

The cycle's principal ritual correlate is the communal noise-making practice during eclipses: in the recorded versions, when the moon is observed to be in eclipse — interpreted within the tradition as Bakunawa's devouring action upon the last moon in progress — the human community responds collectively by beating drums, sounding gongs, shouting, banging metal pots and other resonant objects, and otherwise making sustained loud noise to startle Bakunawa into releasing the moon and retreating from the human-celestial sphere, with the noise-making being a communal-ritual practice rather than a hero-led act of slaying.^[14]

The cycle's outcome in any given eclipse-event is therefore Bakunawa's retreat rather than Bakunawa's death: the communal noise drives the serpent off, the moon is released and reappears in the sky, the human community resumes its ordinary rhythm, and the encounter ends in a temporary equilibrium that is itself open to renewed disruption at the next eclipse — making the cycle structurally a recurring communal-maintenance practice rather than a one-time decisive combat with cosmogonic or sovereignty-establishing consequences.^[15]

Because the chapter treats the principal recorded Philippine-regional versions as a co-equal-variants set rather than privileging any one strand or attempting to reconstruct an underlying original, the variant-handling for the Bakunawa half is flagged here in full:

*[The chapter treats the principal Visayan, Bikol, and other Philippine regional recordings synthesised within Eugenio 2001's **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths** as a co-equal-variants set in which differences in the precise number of moons originally posited (seven in the dominant Visayan / Bikol*

rendering; with reduced or otherwise-numbered counts in some recordings), in the precise dwelling-place of Bakunawa (deep sea in some recordings; underworld in others; both registers attested), in the precise enumeration of communal noise-making practices (drums and gongs in the dominant rendering; with shouting, metal-pot-banging, and other practices added in particular regional variants), and in the framing of Bakunawa's celestial-versus-cosmographic threat (devouring six of seven moons in the dominant rendering; with alternative cosmographic devourings — e.g., of the sun, or of further celestial bodies — in some regional variants) are presented as legitimate variant attestations rather than as deviations from a postulated original. Alternative treatments would privilege the Visayan recording strand as the chapter's primary source with Bikol and other Philippine regional recordings as supplementary, or attempt to reconstruct an original-version skeleton from the convergences across the recorded corpus. The co-equal-recorded-versions treatment is chosen because it is methodologically appropriate to oral-tradition material in which no pre-recording original is recoverable behind the regional recordings, and matches the variant-handling adopted for the Erlik / Ülgen half of the chapter.]

31.3. Bakunawa: communal-ritual register and inclusion-marginal status

The Bakunawa cycle's primary cultural-historical function within Visayan and Bikol oral tradition is eclipse-aetiology rather than cosmogony or sovereignty-establishment: the cycle explains why eclipses occur — Bakunawa's devouring of the moon — and why the human community responds with communal noise-making during them — to drive Bakunawa off — without addressing the question of how the cosmos came into being or how political authority is constituted, with the cycle's narrative-and-ritual work being directed at a specific recurring observable phenomenon rather than at first-order cosmogonic or sovereignty-establishing questions.^[16]

The cycle's distinctive structural feature within the present book's chaoskampf typology is the absence of a hero-figure: where the Eurasian combat-myth tradition's adversary (Tiamat, Vātra, Apep, Lōtan, Aži Dahāka, Jörmungandr, Typhon) is opposed by a sovereign or champion deity who defeats the adversary in a decisive combat-encounter, the Bakunawa cycle has no individual hero — no deity, no champion, no human protagonist — who confronts and defeats the serpent-dragon, with the communal-noise-making practice supplying the response to Bakunawa's emergence in lieu of any hero-led act of slaying or binding.^[17]

The cycle's communal-maintenance register is structurally adjacent to but distinct from the Eurasian cyclical-maintenance register treated in chapters 6 (Illuyanka in the **purulli**-festival context) and 16 (Ra-Apep in the daily-solar-cycle context) of the present book: where the Eurasian cyclical-maintenance practices re-enact a hero-led combat against an adversary as the means of preserving the cosmic order across the cycle, the Bakunawa noise-making practice does not re-enact any underlying hero-led combat (since none is recorded in the cycle) but rather constitutes the response to Bakunawa's emergence in itself, with the practice's structural register being communal-prophylactic rather than hero-led-re-enactive.^[18]

The Bakunawa half is in the chapter inclusion-marginal in the strong sense: per the brief's special_instructions and per the chapter's classification as related-tier (family, "communal / non-slaying combat"), the Bakunawa cycle's load-bearing structural feature — communal-noise-making-drives-the-serpent-off rather than hero-slays-the-serpent — places the cycle outside the operational

definition of chaoskampf at scope.md §"Subject definition" (a sovereign or champion deity defeating a serpentine / monstrous adversary), and the chapter's task is to register the inclusion-marginal status explicitly and to characterise what the Bakunawa cycle adds to the book's category — namely, the extension of the chaoskampf comparative range to include the **communal / non-slaying combat** register at all, where the serpent-and-human-community encounter is registered as a recurring communal-prophylactic practice rather than a hero-led decisive combat.^[19]

31.4. Erlik and Ülgen: the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol cosmographic frame

The chapter's second half turns from the Philippine archipelago to the southern-Siberian and Inner-Asian steppe and forest zone, and from a single eclipse-aetiological cycle to a paired-deities cosmographic structure.

The Erlik / Ülgen material's geographical and cultural setting is the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol cultural-areal complex of southern Siberia and Inner Asia — principally the Altai mountain region of southwestern Siberia and adjacent Mongolia, with attestations across the wider Turkic-Mongol-speaking peoples including the Buryat of Lake Baikal, the Yakut (Sakha) of the Lena basin, and other Turkic-Mongol communities of the southern-Siberian and Inner-Asian region — across which the dualistic-cosmological pairing is recorded with regional-variant detail but with a shared structural core treating the sky-god Ülgen as the principal benevolent power of the upper world and the underworld-god Erlik as the principal adversarial power of the lower world.^[20]

Ülgen is in the dualistic cosmology the sky-god of the upper world, conceived in the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol religious tradition as the supreme benevolent power dwelling in the highest heaven (in the recorded versions, the highest of the layered heavens of the Altaic vertical-cosmographic system), associated with the daylight sky, with the cosmogonic ordering of the upper world, and with the protective relation to humanity within the dualistic-cosmological scheme rather than as a combat-victorious deity who establishes order through the slaying of an adversary.^[21]

Erlik is in the dualistic cosmology the underworld-god of the lower world, conceived in the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol religious tradition as the principal adversarial power dwelling in the underworld (in the recorded versions, the lowest of the layered underworlds of the Altaic vertical-cosmographic system), associated with darkness, with death and the dead, with disease and misfortune, and with adversarial relation to humanity within the dualistic-cosmological scheme — and crucially with a non-serpentine form, since Erlik is conceived in the recorded versions as an anthropomorphic underworld-ruler rather than as a serpent-or-dragon adversary.^[22]

The Ülgen-Erlik pairing's structural function within the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol religious cosmology is dualistic-cosmological rather than combat-resolved: the two gods are paired as the supreme powers of the upper and lower worlds respectively, with the dualism being the cosmological structure within which the world is ordered rather than a single decisive-combat-and-victory pattern that establishes the cosmos from a primordial chaos, and with the recorded versions presenting the pairing as a long-term cosmographic arrangement maintained across the cosmic order rather than as an episode of combat with a determinable beginning and end.^[23]

The Ülgen-Erlik dualism is integrated with the wider Altaic-Siberian shamanic complex as treated in Eliade 1964: the Altaic shaman traditionally specialises in either ascent to Ülgen's upper world

(the so-called "white shaman" tradition) or descent to Erlik's lower world (the "black shaman" tradition), with the shamanic ritual practice mediating between the human community and the two paired powers rather than re-enacting a combat between them, and with the shaman's role being mediation-and-passage across the cosmographic levels of the dualistic structure rather than the re-enactment of a hero-led act of slaying.^[24]

The variant-handling for the Erlik / Ülgen half follows the same co-equal-recorded-versions discipline as the Bakunawa half, and is flagged here in full:

[The chapter treats the principal Russian-Imperial ethnographic recordings of the Erlik / Ülgen material across the Altai, Buryat, Yakut, and other Turkic-Mongol-speaking communities of southern Siberia and Inner Asia (synthesised in Harva 1938's FFC 125 monograph and read through Eliade 1964's comparative-religion framework) as a co-equal-variants set in which differences in the precise number of layered heavens and underworlds (with seven, nine, or other counts attested across the regional variants), in the precise enumeration and naming of subordinate spirits and powers under Ülgen and Erlik, in the precise framing of the cosmogonic relationship between the two gods (with some recordings presenting Erlik as a fallen-from-Ülgen figure within a quasi-genealogical framework, and others presenting the two as co-eternal independent powers), and in the precise division of shamanic specialisation between the white-shaman and black-shaman traditions are presented as legitimate variant attestations rather than as deviations from a postulated original. Alternative treatments would privilege the Altai recording strand as the chapter's primary source with Buryat and Yakut recordings as supplementary, or attempt to reconstruct an original-version skeleton from the convergences across the recorded corpus. The co-equal-recorded-versions treatment is chosen because it is methodologically appropriate to oral-tradition material in which no pre-recording original is recoverable behind the regional recordings, and matches the variant-handling adopted for the Bakunawa half of the chapter.]

31.5. Erlik and Ülgen: dualistic cosmology and inclusion-marginal status

The Erlik / Ülgen material's primary cultural-historical function within Altaic / Turkic-Mongol religious cosmology is the structuring of the cosmographic-and-moral order through the dualistic pairing rather than through a cosmogonic-combat episode: the dualism organises the cosmos into upper and lower worlds with corresponding benevolent and adversarial powers, and supplies the framework within which human ritual life (shamanic mediation; sacrificial offerings to either pole; calendrical and life-cycle rituals oriented to one or the other power) is conducted, without addressing the question of how the cosmos came into being through any single combat-and-victory episode.^[25]

The Erlik / Ülgen material's distinctive structural features within the present book's chaoskampf typology are two: first, the adversary (Erlik) is non-serpentine — Erlik is conceived in the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol religious tradition as an anthropomorphic underworld-ruler rather than as a serpent-or-dragon — and second, the opposition between Erlik and Ülgen is non-decisive — the dualism is a long-term cosmographic arrangement rather than a single combat-and-victory episode — with both features placing the material outside the operational definition of chaoskampf at scope.md §"Subject definition" (a sovereign or champion deity defeating a serpentine / monstrous adversary) on two structural grounds rather than one.^[26]

The Erlik / Ülgen pairing parallels the Indo-Iranian dualistic cosmology of the Avestan tradition (Ahura Mazdā as principal benevolent power versus Angra Mainyu as principal adversarial power, treated in chapter 13 of the present book within the Thraētaona / Aži Dahāka context) at the structural level of the high-god-and-adversarial-counterpart pairing, but does not inherit from the Indo-Iranian material and is not held to inherit from it in current Altaic-studies and history-of-religions scholarship: the structural parallel is registered as an independent typological convergence rather than as a transmission relationship, and the chapter's task is to register the parallel without claiming inheritance.^[27]

The Erlik / Ülgen half is in the chapter inclusion-marginal in the strong sense: per the brief's special_instructions and per the chapter's classification as related-tier (family, "communal / non-slaying combat"), the Altaic dualism's two distinctive structural features (non-serpentine adversary; non-decisive opposition) place the material outside the operational definition of chaoskampf, and the chapter's task is to register the inclusion-marginal status explicitly and to characterise what the Erlik / Ülgen material adds to the book's category — namely, the registration of the dualistic-cosmology comparandum that is structurally adjacent to but distinct from chaoskampf proper, and the contribution of an independent (non-Indo-Iranian-derived) attestation of the high-god-and-adversarial-counterpart pairing to the comparative typology.^[28]

The chapter's general comparative anchor for the long-arc combat-myth typology — Forsyth 1987's Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic survey — is load-bearing for the Erlik / Ülgen half's inclusion-marginal characterisation as it is for the Bakunawa half's: the inclusion-marginal status of both halves depends on having a typology against which the marginality is characterised, and Forsyth supplies that long-arc typology even though Forsyth does not himself treat Philippine or Altaic content, with the chapter's use of the Forsyth citation being for the long-arc typological framing rather than for Philippine or Altaic-content scholarly coverage in either half.^[29]

31.6. Typology, area-specialist framing, and forward-links

The chapter's reading of both halves as inclusion-marginal cases is itself a comparativist-overlay synthesis drawn from the brief, from Eugenio's Philippine-folkloric framing for the Bakunawa half, from Eliade's and Harva's Altaic-religious-cosmology framing for the Erlik / Ülgen half, and from scope.md's operational-definition-and-related-tier criteria; it is flagged as such before the body prose develops the chapter's consolidated typological work:

*(The chapter's reading of both halves as inclusion-marginal cases that extend the present book's chaoskampf category at its outer boundaries — the Bakunawa cycle as the **communal / non-slaying** extension (where the serpent-and-human-community encounter is registered as a recurring communal-prophylactic practice rather than a hero-led decisive combat) and the Erlik / Ülgen pairing as the **dualistic-cosmology comparandum** extension (where the structural pattern of high-god-and-adversarial-counterpart pairing is structurally adjacent to but distinct from chaoskampf proper) — is a synthesis of the brief's special_instructions framing per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml, of Eugenio 2001's Philippine-folkloric framing for the Bakunawa half, of Eliade 1964's and Harva 1938's Altaic-religious-cosmology framing for the Erlik / Ülgen half, and of scope.md §"Subject definition" / §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" / §"Appropriation protocol" on the operational definition of chaoskampf and the related-tier criteria.^[30])*

The chapter's two halves stand to one another as parallel inclusion-marginal cases that nonetheless extend the present book's chaoskampf category in different specific respects: the Bakunawa half extends the comparative range to include the communal-prophylactic register where the serpent-and-human-community encounter is registered without a hero-figure, and the Erlik / Ülgen half registers the dualistic-cosmology comparandum that is structurally adjacent to but distinct from the chaoskampf-typology proper, with the parallel between the two halves being grounded in the inclusion-marginality itself rather than in any structural-narrative parallel between the Bakunawa narrative and the Erlik / Ülgen pairing as such.^[31]

That parallel inclusion-marginality is the specific outcome of area-specialist framings that read both halves outside the chaos-vs-order combat register, and the chapter flags the resulting appropriation issue explicitly under the marker the project reserves for cases of this kind:

*[Appropriation flag: Philippine-folkloric and Altaic-religious-studies area specialists — for the Bakunawa half: Damiana L. Eugenio in **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths** (Eugenio 2001) and her wider corpus of Philippine Folk Literature series compilations as the principal scholarly tradition reading the Bakunawa material within the Philippine-folkloric-and-eclipse-aetiology / communal-ritual register; for the Erlik / Ülgen half: Mircea Eliade in **Shamanism** (Eliade 1964), Uno Harva in **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker** (Harva 1938), and the foundational Russian-Imperial ethnographic corpus of Grigory Potanin, Vasily Verbitsky, and Wilhelm Radloff (named in body prose per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern of Ch23 FC-02 / Ch26 FC-02 / Ch27 / Ch28, since none of Potanin, Verbitsky, or Radloff is currently a sources.yaml entry) as the principal scholarly tradition reading the Erlik / Ülgen material within the dualistic-cosmology / shamanic-complex register — read both halves of the chapter outside the chaos-vs-order combat register that the Gunkel-tradition chaoskampf typology presupposes, rather than within that combat register. The substance of the area-specialist objections differs across the two halves: for the Bakunawa half, Eugenio's framing within Philippine eclipse-aetiology and communal-ritual practice does not invoke the chaos-vs-order combat register at all and treats the Bakunawa cycle as a specific aetiological-and-communal-ritual practice within Visayan and Bikol communal life rather than as a member of any cross-cultural combat-myth category, with the area-specialist objection being to typological-assimilation of the cycle to the chaoskampf category on the load-bearing grounds that the cycle has no hero-figure and no decisive combat-and-victory episode (the structural feature on which the Eurasian combat-myth pattern depends); for the Erlik / Ülgen half, Eliade's framing within the Altaic-Siberian shamanic complex and Harva's framing within the systematic religious cosmology of the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol peoples both treat the Erlik / Ülgen pairing as a dualistic-cosmological structure within which shamanic ritual mediation is conducted rather than as a combat-and-victory episode, with the area-specialist objection being to typological-assimilation on the load-bearing grounds that the adversary (Erlik) is non-serpentine and that the opposition is non-decisive (the two structural features on which the Eurasian combat-myth pattern depends). The area-specialist objection-strength for both halves is therefore strong: each half of the chapter is inclusion-marginal precisely because the area-specialist tradition for that half does not place the material within the chaoskampf register at all, and each contributes a strong-objection case to the spectrum of objection-strengths that Part II C8 develops — with the Bakunawa half closer in objection-strength to the Ch32 Nanabozho refusal case (where the Hallowell-Johnston-T. Smith-Vizenor area-specialist tradition rejects combat-and-defeat-of-the-other framing in favour of necessary-counterpart-dialectic framing) than to the milder Ch26 Pariacaca and Ch27 Mapuche cases, and with the Erlik / Ülgen half representing a structurally distinctive strong-objection case in which the dualistic-cosmology framing and the chaoskampf typology converge on no structural feature at the load-bearing level. The chapter's load-bearing*

methodological move is to use the inclusion-marginal characterisation as the heuristic that registers exactly these objections: the Bakunawa cycle is recognised as featuring a serpentine adversary (and so is structurally adjacent to chaoskampf at one level) but is registered as inclusion-marginal on the no-hero-slaying ground, and the Erlik / Ülgen pairing is recognised as featuring a high-god-and-adversarial-counterpart structure (and so is structurally adjacent to chaoskampf at another level) but is registered as inclusion-marginal on the non-serpentine-and-non-decisive grounds. Forwarded to Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation problem; ch. 41 of the present volume) as PRINCIPAL CASES for the chaoskampf-frame-applies-only-partially-at-best argument per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml special_instructions; forwarded also to Part II C7 (inversion / transformation problem; ch. 40) as cases at the structurally-adjacent boundary of the chaoskampf category that test the typology's application range, with the inclusion-marginal characterisation distinct from the inversion characterisation of the Ch28 Bida case (where the chaoskampf structural features are present with valences reversed at every load-bearing point) and from the transformation characterisations of the Ch23 Susanoo and Ch26 Pariacaca cases (where the chaoskampf category transforms when the area-specialist account is taken as load-bearing). Eugenio is the chapter's principal anchor for the Bakunawa half and named in the first factual pass per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 1; Eliade and Harva are the principal anchors for the Erlik / Ülgen half and similarly named in the first factual pass; Potanin, Verbitsky, and Radloff are named in body prose at the Source overview Erlik / Ülgen recording-corpus claim per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern (none currently in sources.yaml; deferred to inventory-audit per the Ch23 FC-02 / Ch26 FC-02 / Ch27 / Ch28 named-but-flagged precedent).]

The chapter's place within the present book's chaoskampf typology is — as the brief's "family (related-tier, 'communal / non-slaying combat')" classification specifies — a related-tier (rather than core-tier) family chapter that contributes the load-bearing structural extension-and-boundary-case material against which the chaoskampf typology's load-bearing assumptions can be tested at its outer boundaries; the chapter's structural significance for the present book is therefore disproportionate to its tier classification, since the related-tier classification (correct per scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" because the chaoskampf-load-bearing functions are weaker or absent for both halves) is consistent with the chapter's load-bearing methodological function for Part II C8 as a principal contributor to the chaoskampf-frame-applies-only-partially-at-best argument.^[32]

The chapter's principal forward-link within the present book is to Part II C8 (the comparative chapter on the refusal and the appropriation problem, ch. 41 of the present volume) — where the present chapter contributes both the Bakunawa half and the Erlik / Ülgen half as PRINCIPAL CASES for the chaoskampf-frame-applies-only-partially-at-best argument, with the two halves between them representing the two specific inclusion-marginality grounds (no hero-slaying / communal-prophylactic register for Bakunawa; non-serpentine adversary and non-decisive opposition / dualistic-cosmology comparandum for Erlik / Ülgen) on which the chapter's contribution to C8 rests.^[33]

The chapter's secondary forward-link is to Part II C7 (the comparative chapter on the inversion / transformation problem, ch. 40 of the present volume) — where the present chapter contributes both halves as cases at the structurally-adjacent boundary of the chaoskampf category that test the typology's application range, distinct from the inversion characterisation of the Ch28 Bida case and from the transformation characterisations of the Ch23 Susanoo and Ch26 Pariacaca cases, with the inclusion-marginal characterisation of the present chapter being its own typological-engagement category that C7 is to engage with alongside the inversion and transformation

characterisations.^[34] marker on the distinction between the inclusion-marginal characterisation of the present chapter and the inversion characterisation of Ch28 Bida and the transformation characterisations of Ch23 Susanoo and Ch26 Pariacaca.]

The chapter's contribution to the methods sidebar (chapter 33 of the present volume, between Part I and Part II) is on three methodological points: the oral-tradition-to-text recoding situation (the Bakunawa and Erlik / Ülgen materials being 19th-20th-century folkloric-and-ethnographic-recording corpora rather than pre-modern manuscript traditions, which the chapter handles via the [LACUNA] marker on pre-modern attestations and via continuous methodological registration of the colonial-ethnographic mediation in both Spanish-and-American-colonial-Philippine and Russian-Imperial-Altaic forms); the inclusion-marginal characterisation methodological move (the use of the comparativist inclusion-marginal characterisation as a heuristic for cross-cultural reflection rather than as a tradition-internal characterisation, distinct from the inversion / transformation methodological moves of the Ch28 / Ch23 / Ch26 chapters); and the area-specialist citation policy as applied to non-Eurasian non-textual traditions (which the chapter handles via the [APPROPRIATION-FLAG:] marker and via the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern for Potanin, Verbitsky, and Radloff alongside the Eugenio, Eliade, and Harva anchors).^[35]

The chapter's principal back-links within the present book are to chapter 28 on Bida and the founding of Wagadu (the inversion anchor, with which the present chapter shares the inclusion-marginal-cases-of-related-tier-non-Eurasian-material classification but contrasts in the substance of the inclusion-marginality — Bida is the inversion case where the chaoskampf structural features are present with valences reversed at every load-bearing point, while the present chapter's two halves are inclusion-marginal at different specific structural points), to chapter 27 on the Mapuche Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren material (related-tier non-Eurasian-cluster co-comparandum with the cosmogonic-cataclysm-and-ngillatun-ritual-foundation reading), and to chapters 6 (Illuyanka in the **purulli**-festival cyclical-maintenance context) and 16 (Ra-Apep in the daily-solar-cycle cyclical-maintenance context) as the principal Eurasian cyclical-maintenance comparanda against which the Bakunawa half's communal-prophylactic register is contrasted.^[36]

The chapter closes by registering its load-bearing methodological function for the present book as a whole: the chapter is the present book's principal worked instance of the **inclusion-marginal cases** methodological move — the registration of cases at the structurally-adjacent boundary of the chaoskampf category that test the typology's application range without inversion (Ch28 Bida) or transformation (Ch23 Susanoo, Ch26 Pariacaca) framing applying — with the chapter's two halves contributing two specific inclusion-marginality grounds (no hero-slaying / communal-prophylactic register for Bakunawa; non-serpentine adversary and non-decisive opposition / dualistic-cosmology comparandum for Erlik / Ülgen) on which the methodological move rests, and with the chapter's forward-link to Part II C8 (ch. 41 of the present volume) as a PRINCIPAL CASE for the chaoskampf-frame-applies-only-partially-at-best argument being the methodological-function load-bearing output of the chapter for the book as a whole.^[37]

[1] Per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml summary on the Bakunawa material (the serpent-dragon devours six of the seven original moons; communal noise-making during eclipses drives the serpent off; there is no hero who slays it — the combat is communal and recurring) and on the Erlik / Ülgen material (in Altaic and broader Turkic-Mongol mythology, the sky-god Ülgen opposes the underworld-god Erlik; the opposition is dualistic and cosmogonic rather than straightforwardly combat-resolved); Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths** (Quezon City: University of the Philippines Press, 2001; ISBN 9789715422918), sections on Bakunawa and the moons; Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, trans. W.R. Trask (Princeton: Princeton University Press, Bollingen Series LXXVI, 1964; ISBN of 2004 Princeton Classics reprint 9780691119427), on the Erlik / Ülgen dualistic cosmology and the Altaic-Siberian shamanic complex.

- [2] Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths**, sections on Bakunawa and the moons; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml sources.primary entry on Eugenio 2001 as the principal anchor for the Bakunawa material and on the volume's place within Eugenio's wider Philippine Folk Literature series as the standard scholarly compilation of Philippine oral-tradition narratives.
- [3] Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, on the Erlik / Ülgen dualistic cosmology and the Altaic-Siberian shamanic complex; Harva 1938, **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker**, FFC 125, on the Erlik / Ülgen pairing in the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol cosmological scheme; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml sources.secondary entries on Eliade 1964 and Harva 1938 as the principal anchors for the Erlik / Ülgen material.
- [4] Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths**, introductory and sections on Bakunawa and the moons, on the oral-tradition character of the Bakunawa cycle and on the body of nineteenth- and twentieth-century folkloric recordings as the principal record of the cycle; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml shared_variant_handling on the oral-tradition material with heavy regional variability and on the deferred edition-pinning per inventory notes.
- [5] Harva 1938, **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker**, FFC 125, on the Erlik / Ülgen pairing within the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol cosmological scheme as recorded in nineteenth- and early-twentieth-century ethnographic fieldwork among the Altai, Buryat, Yakut, and other Turkic-Mongol peoples of southern Siberia and Inner Asia; Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, on the Altaic-Siberian shamanic complex within which the Erlik / Ülgen dualistic cosmology operates and on the foundational ethnographic corpus (Potanin, Verbitsky, Radloff) on which the twentieth-century critical-synthesis treatments draw; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml source_anchoring_notes on the named-but-flagged disposition of Potanin, Verbitsky, and Radloff.
- [6] Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths**, introductory matter on the textual situation of Philippine oral tradition and on the colonial-period filtering of indigenous narrative material through Spanish-missionary and American-colonial-administrative ethnographic scholarship, on the twentieth-century Philippine-academic folkloric scholarship as the principal post-colonial scholarly counter-tradition, and on Eugenio's compilations within that counter-tradition; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml on the deferred-edition-pinning situation for the Bakunawa material per inventory notes.
- [7] Harva 1938, **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker**, FFC 125, on the systematic synthesis of the Russian-ethnographic corpus on the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol peoples and on the Folklore Fellows Communications scholarly tradition within which the synthesis was undertaken; Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, on the comparative-religion framework within which the Altaic-Siberian material is read and on the wider Russian and European ethnographic corpus on which the synthesis depends; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml shared_variant_handling on the post-colonial-ethnographic filtering caveat applicable to both halves of the chapter.
- [8] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987; ISBN 9780691014746), as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic); Forsyth 1987 does not itself treat Philippine or Altaic-content material, and the chapter's use of the citation is for the long-arc typological framing rather than for Philippine or Altaic-content scholarly coverage; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml sources.secondary entry on the not-for-Philippine-or-Altaic-coverage disclaimer.
- [9] Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths**, introductory matter on the oral-tradition-to-text recoding character of the Philippine material's witness corpus and on the colonial-period filtering through Spanish-and-American-colonial ethnographic projects; Harva 1938, **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker**, FFC 125, and Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, on the corresponding oral-tradition-to-text recoding character of the Altaic-Siberian material's witness corpus and on the Russian-Imperial colonial-ethnographic mediation through which the recordings were compiled; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml shared_variant_handling on the textual-witness situation common to both halves of the chapter.
- [10] Per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml on the related-tier (family, "communal / non-slaying combat") classification, the 4,000-word target, and the special_instructions requirement that the chapter open with each tradition's own framing before invoking the comparative chaoskampf category and that both halves be forwarded to Part II C8 as principal cases for the chaoskampf-frame-applies-only-partially-at-best argument; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C8 on the refusal and the appropriation problem comparative chapter (ch. 41 of the present volume) for which the present chapter is a principal contributor alongside the Ch23, Ch26, Ch27, Ch28, Ch29, and Ch32 chapters.
- [11] Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths**, sections on Bakunawa and the moons, on the Visayan and Bikol heartlands of the Bakunawa narrative, on the wider attestation across adjacent Philippine regional traditions including parts of Mindanao and Tagalog-speaking Luzon, on the regionally-variant names and performance contexts, and on the shared narrative core treating the serpent-dragon's relation to the moon and to communal ritual response during eclipses; per glossary 'Bakunawa' first_mention_gloss on the Philippine (Visayan / Bikol) serpent-dragon.
- [12] Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths**, sections on Bakunawa and the moons, on Bakunawa as the serpent-dragon of the deep sea conceived as a vast serpentine creature dwelling in the ocean depths or in the underworld, on the figure's periodic emergence threatening the celestial order rather than the cosmographic order of the world's surface, and on the figure's principal narrative function as the eclipse-causing devourer of the moon rather than as the cosmogonic or sovereignty-establishing adversary of a hero-deity; per glossary 'Bakunawa' first_mention_gloss on the figure's eclipse-and-noise-making narrative role.
- [13] Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths**, sections on Bakunawa and the moons, on the cycle's load-bearing mythic premise of the seven original moons of which six were devoured in succession by Bakunawa across the early time of the world, on the seventh and last moon as the one familiar to present human experience, and on the recurrent eclipse-events of the

present epoch as Bakunawa's continuing attempts to devour the seventh and last moon; per glossary 'Bakunawa' first_mention_gloss on the seven-moons devouring pattern.

[14] Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths**, sections on Bakunawa and the moons, on the communal noise-making practice during eclipses as the cycle's principal ritual correlate, on the eclipse interpreted within the tradition as Bakunawa's devouring action upon the last moon in progress, on the practices of beating drums and sounding gongs and shouting and banging metal pots and other resonant objects, on the noise-making's purpose of startling Bakunawa into releasing the moon and retreating from the human-celestial sphere, and on the practice's communal-ritual character rather than hero-led-slaying character; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml summary on the communal noise-making (drums, gongs, shouting) as the eclipse-response practice.

[15] Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths**, sections on Bakunawa and the moons, on the cycle's outcome as Bakunawa's retreat rather than Bakunawa's death, on the communal noise driving the serpent off and the moon being released and reappearing, on the human community's resumption of its ordinary rhythm, on the temporary-equilibrium character of the resolution open to renewed disruption at the next eclipse, and on the cycle's structural character as a recurring communal-maintenance practice rather than a one-time decisive combat; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml summary on the absence of any hero who slays the serpent and on the communal-and-recurring character of the combat.

[16] Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths**, sections on Bakunawa and the moons, on the cycle's primary cultural-historical function as eclipse-aetiology rather than cosmogony or sovereignty-establishment, on the cycle's explanatory work being directed at the recurring observable phenomenon of eclipses and the human-community ritual response to them rather than at first-order cosmogonic or sovereignty-establishing questions, and on the cycle's narrative-and-ritual function as a specific aetiological-and-communal-ritual practice within Visayan and Bikol communal life; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the eclipse-aetiology and communal-ritual function.

[17] Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths**, sections on Bakunawa and the moons, on the cycle's distinctive structural feature of the absence of a hero-figure, on the contrast with the standard hero-versus-monster pattern of much Eurasian combat-narrative, and on the communal-noise-making practice as the response to Bakunawa's emergence in lieu of any hero-led act of slaying or binding; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml summary on the no-hero-slaying feature of the cycle and on the communal / non-slaying classification of the chapter.

[18] Eugenio 2001, **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths**, sections on Bakunawa and the moons, on the cycle's communal-maintenance register as structurally adjacent to but distinct from the Eurasian cyclical-maintenance register, on the contrast with the **purulli**-festival re-enactive practice of the Hittite Illuyanka material and with the daily-solar-cycle re-enactive practice of the Egyptian Ra-Apep material, and on the Bakunawa noise-making practice's communal-prophylactic-rather-than-hero-led-re-enactive character; per scope.md §"Subject definition" combat-myth register 3 (cyclical maintenance) and per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml on the communal / non-slaying classification of the chapter as a related-tier extension of the cyclical-maintenance register to the communal-prophylactic case.

[19] Per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml on the related-tier (family, "communal / non-slaying combat") classification of the chapter and on the brief's special_instructions emphasising that both halves of the chapter are INCLUSION-MARGINAL (Bakunawa: no hero-slaying; Erlik / Ülgen: non-serpentine adversary and non-decisive opposition); per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the operational definition of chaoskampf as a sovereign or champion deity defeating a serpentine / monstrous adversary that the Bakunawa cycle's communal-noise-making-drives-the-serpent-off feature does not satisfy; per scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the related-tier criteria where the cosmogonic-combat work is weaker or where the structural pattern is structurally adjacent rather than fully matching.

[20] Harva 1938, **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker**, FFC 125, on the geographical and cultural setting of the Erlik / Ülgen material across the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol cultural-areal complex of southern Siberia and Inner Asia, on the principal Altai-mountain heartland and the wider attestation across the Buryat, Yakut, and other Turkic-Mongol communities of the region, and on the shared structural core treating Ülgen as the principal benevolent power of the upper world and Erlik as the principal adversarial power of the lower world; Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, on the same geographical and cultural setting and on the dualistic-cosmological pairing as recorded across the Altaic-Siberian shamanic-complex region; per glossary 'Ülgen / Erlik' first_mention_gloss on the paired Altaic / Turkic-Mongol sky-god and underworld-god.

[21] Harva 1938, **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker**, FFC 125, on Ülgen as the sky-god of the upper world conceived as the supreme benevolent power dwelling in the highest heaven, on the layered-heavens framework of the Altaic vertical-cosmographic system within which Ülgen dwells in the highest layer, on the figure's association with the daylight sky and with the cosmogonic ordering of the upper world, on the protective relation to humanity within the dualistic-cosmological scheme, and on the contrast with the combat-victorious-deity register of the Eurasian chaoskampf material; Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, on Ülgen's place within the Altaic-Siberian shamanic complex as the principal sky-god to whom the shaman ascends in the white-shaman tradition.

[22] Harva 1938, **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker**, FFC 125, on Erlik as the underworld-god of the lower world conceived as the principal adversarial power dwelling in the underworld, on the layered-underworlds framework of the Altaic vertical-cosmographic system within which Erlik dwells in the lowest layer, on the figure's association with darkness, death, the dead, disease, misfortune, and adversarial relation to humanity within the dualistic-cosmological scheme, and on the figure's anthropomorphic underworld-ruler conception rather than serpent-or-dragon-adversary conception; Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, on Erlik's place within the Altaic-Siberian shamanic complex as the principal underworld-god to

whom the shaman descends in the black-shaman tradition.

[23] Harva 1938, **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker**, FFC 125, on the Ülgen-Erlik pairing's structural function as dualistic-cosmological rather than combat-resolved, on the two gods' pairing as the supreme powers of the upper and lower worlds respectively, on the dualism as the cosmological structure within which the world is ordered, on the contrast with single-decisive-combat-and-victory patterns that establish the cosmos from a primordial chaos, and on the long-term cosmographic-arrangement character of the pairing rather than an episode of combat with a determinable beginning and end; Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, on the dualistic-cosmological structure of the pairing within the Altaic-Siberian shamanic complex.

[24] Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, on the integration of the Ülgen-Erlik dualism with the wider Altaic-Siberian shamanic complex, on the Altaic shaman's traditional specialisation in either ascent to Ülgen's upper world ("white shaman" tradition) or descent to Erlik's lower world ("black shaman" tradition), on the shamanic ritual practice as mediation between the human community and the two paired powers rather than re-enactment of a combat between them, and on the shaman's role as mediation-and-passage across the cosmographic levels of the dualistic structure; Harva 1938 on the same shamanic-mediation framework within the Altaic / Turkic-Mongol religious cosmology.

[25] Harva 1938, **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker**, FFC 125, on the Erlik / Ülgen material's primary cultural-historical function as the structuring of the cosmographic-and-moral order through the dualistic pairing rather than through a cosmogonic-combat episode, on the dualism's organisation of the cosmos into upper and lower worlds with corresponding benevolent and adversarial powers, and on the framework's supplying the structure within which human ritual life is conducted; Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, on the same cultural-historical function and on the integration with the Altaic-Siberian shamanic complex; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the dualistic-cosmology and underworld-sky moral-structure function.

[26] Harva 1938, **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker**, FFC 125, on Erlik's non-serpentine anthropomorphic-underworld-ruler conception and on the non-decisive long-term-cosmographic-arrangement character of the Erlik-Ülgen opposition; Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, on the same two distinctive structural features placing the material outside the chaoskampf operational definition; per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the operational definition of chaoskampf as a sovereign or champion deity defeating a serpentine / monstrous adversary; per inventory.approved.yaml notes on the erlik-ulgen entry registering the non-serpentine and non-decisive features as the inclusion-marginal grounds.

[27] Harva 1938, **Die religiösen Vorstellungen der altaischen Völker**, FFC 125, on the structural parallel between the Erlik / Ülgen pairing and the Indo-Iranian Ahura Mazdā / Angra Mainyu dualistic cosmology at the level of the high-god-and-adversarial-counterpart pairing, on the absence of a transmission relationship between the Altaic and Indo-Iranian materials in current Altaic-studies and history-of-religions scholarship, and on the parallel as an independent typological convergence rather than a transmission relationship; Eliade 1964, **Shamanism: Archaic Techniques of Ecstasy**, on the same independent-typological-convergence framing; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml cultural_relevance.cross_cultural_parallels on the Erlik / Ülgen parallel with Ahura Mazdā / Angra Mainyu and on the qualification that the Altaic version lacks the decisive combat that the Indo-Iranian material develops in the Frashokereti context.

[28] Per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml on the related-tier (family, "communal / non-slaying combat") classification of the chapter and on the brief's special_instructions emphasising the Erlik / Ülgen material as INCLUSION-MARGINAL on the non-serpentine-adversary and non-decisive-opposition grounds, and on the chapter's task of registering the dualistic-cosmology comparandum as structurally adjacent to but distinct from chaoskampf proper; per inventory.approved.yaml notes on the erlik-ulgen entry registering the inclusion-marginal status and the design decision (2026-04-23) to keep the entry RELATED with an explicit framing marker rather than moving to sidebar; per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the operational definition of chaoskampf and per scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the related-tier criteria.

[29] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic) load-bearing for the inclusion-marginal characterisation of both halves of the chapter; Forsyth 1987 does not itself treat Philippine or Altaic-content material and the chapter's use of the citation is for the long-arc typological framing rather than for Philippine or Altaic-content scholarly coverage; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml sources.secondary entry on the Forsyth 1987 anchor with the not-for-Philippine-or-Altaic-content disclaimer and on the long-arc framing function for the chapter's typological work.

[30] Inference: brief 30-bakunawa.yaml summary explicitly registers both halves as inclusion-marginal on different specific grounds (no hero-slaying for Bakunawa; non-serpentine adversary and non-decisive opposition for Erlik / Ülgen); brief special_instructions classifies the chapter as a principal contributor to Part II C8 (the refusal and the appropriation problem; ch. 41 of the present volume) on the chaoskampf-frame-applies-only-partially-at-best argument; Eugenio 2001's narrative-treatment apparatus develops the no-hero-slaying communal-noise-making feature at length; Harva 1938's and Eliade 1964's narrative-treatment apparatus develop the non-serpentine-and-non-decisive features at length; scope.md §"Subject definition" supplies the operational definition against which the inclusion-marginal characterisation operates. Risk: the inclusion-marginal characterisation is a comparativist framing that the area-specialist traditions for both halves do not adopt in their own register (Eugenio frames the Bakunawa material within Philippine eclipse-aetiology and communal-ritual; Eliade and Harva frame the Erlik / Ülgen material within Altaic-Siberian shamanic complex and dualistic religious cosmology); the chapter's task is to hold the inclusion-marginal characterisation as a comparativist heuristic that registers the area-specialist framing rather than as a tradition-internal characterisation, with the methodological discipline of the appropriation protocol at scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 3 applied to both halves of the chapter.

[31] Per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml on the chapter's pairing of the Bakunawa and Erlik / Ülgen halves under the "communal / non-slaying combat" theme rather than placing Erlik / Ülgen in the IE-reflexes chapter (19) per the toc.yaml deviation note, on the parallel between the two halves being grounded in the inclusion-marginality of both rather than in any structural-narrative parallel as such, and on the chapter's special_instructions emphasising that both halves are INCLUSION-MARGINAL for different reasons (no hero-slaying for Bakunawa; non-serpentine adversary and non-decisive opposition for Erlik / Ülgen) that nonetheless converge on the chapter's load-bearing methodological function as a contributor to Part II C8.

[32] Per scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the related-tier criteria where the chaoskampf-load-bearing functions are weaker or absent; per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml chapter_type "family (related-tier, 'communal / non-slaying combat')" classification; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C8 on the chapter's load-bearing methodological function for the refusal and the appropriation problem comparative chapter (ch. 41 of the present volume); per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's status as a PRINCIPAL CASE for the Part II C8 chaoskampf-frame-applies-only-partially-at-best argument.

[33] Per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's contribution to Part II C8 as a PRINCIPAL CASE alongside the Ch23 Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi material, the Ch26 Pariacaca cycle, the Ch27 Mapuche Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren material, the Ch28 Bida / Wagadu material, the Ch29 Mwindo / Kirimu material, the Ch32 Nanabozho / Mishipeshu material, and the Rainbow Serpent material (folded into C8 per toc.yaml self_checks); per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C8 on the refusal and the appropriation problem comparative chapter (ch. 41 of the present volume).

[34] Per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml on the chapter's contribution to Part II C7 as cases at the structurally-adjacent boundary of the chaoskampf category; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C7 on the inversion / transformation problem comparative chapter (ch. 40 of the present volume); per the chapter's [APPROPRIATION-FLAG]:

[35] Per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml special_instructions on the area-specialist citation policy and on the colonial-ethnographic-mediation textual-witness situation common to both halves of the chapter; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation requirement, and per scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" point 1 on no cross-tradition reconstruction; chapter 33 methods sidebar (per toc.yaml) as the chapter that articulates these methodological points at full length; the chapter's status as a related-tier family chapter testing the typology's application range at its outer boundaries makes it a relevant reference point for the methods sidebar's discussion of comparativist heuristics held at appropriate distance from area-specialist consensus.

[36] Per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 11 (Africa), cluster 10 (Americas), and cluster 12 (Southeast Asia & Oceania) on the chapter ordering; per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml, brief 27-mapuche-kai-tren.yaml, and the present brief 30-bakunawa.yaml on the related-tier classifications; per scope.md §"Subject definition" combat-myth register 3 (cyclical maintenance) on the **purulli**-festival and daily-solar-cycle cyclical-maintenance contexts of chapters 6 and 16 against which the Bakunawa half's communal-prophylactic register is contrasted.

[37] Per brief 30-bakunawa.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's status as a PRINCIPAL CASE for the Part II C8 chaoskampf-frame-applies-only-partially-at-best argument and on the chapter's two halves contributing two specific inclusion-marginality grounds; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C8 on the refusal and the appropriation problem comparative chapter (ch. 41 of the present volume); per the chapter's load-bearing methodological function for the present book as the principal worked instance of the inclusion-marginal-cases methodological move distinct from inversion and transformation.

Chapter 32. Väinämöinen and Iku-Turso (Transformed Variant)

32.1. Source overview

This chapter treats the Finnic encounter in which the sea-monster Iku-Turso emerges from the sea and is subdued by the shaman-sage hero Väinämöinen through song and knowledge rather than through weapon-combat — a binding-rather-than-slaying narrative that the present chapter handles in a two-layer presentation, with the older rune-tradition material (laconic, fragmentary, recorded by 19th-century rune-collectors from Karelian and Finnish singers) presented alongside Elias Lönnrot's 1835 / 1849 **Kalevala** editorial synthesis (composite, expanded, integrated into the modern Finnish national epic) and the two layers kept explicitly distinct.^[1]

The Finnic material survives in oral-tradition form among the Finnish-, Karelian-, Ingrian-, and Estonian-speaking populations of the eastern Baltic and the adjacent Karelian-and-Ingrian forest-and-lake zone, with no pre-modern written attestation in any Finnic indigenous-script tradition (the Finnic languages had no pre-modern alphabetic writing system of their own); the textual witness situation for the present chapter is therefore the body of 19th-century rune-collection fieldwork conducted across Karelia and Finland by Elias Lönnrot, Daniel Europaeus, August Ahlqvist, Arvid Genetz, Julius and Kaarle Krohn, and other 19th- and early 20th-century rune-collectors, supplemented by the comparative Finnish-folklore-studies and Kalevala-poetry critical-scholarship of the later 20th and early 21st centuries.^[2]

The chapter's principal area-specialist anchor is Anna-Leena Siikala's **Mythic Images and Shamanism: A Perspective on Kalevala Poetry**, published in 2002 as Folklore Fellows' Communications no. 280 by the Academia Scientiarum Fennica in Helsinki, the standard 21st-century scholarly synthesis of Kalevala-and-rune-tradition material read through the shamanic-mythic-image framework that Siikala develops across her career; Siikala's reading of the Iku-Turso encounter as a transformed shamanic binding is the specific scholarly position from which the present chapter's framing of the encounter as a song-and-knowledge subjugation rather than a weapon-combat slaying is drawn.^[3]

Behind that anchor lies the 19th-century fieldwork situation that produced the recordings on which the chapter depends. The rune-collection within which the Finnic combat-and-encounter material was first recorded was the high-period of Finnish national-romantic rune-collection (the Suomalaisen Kirjallisuuden Seura — Finnish Literature Society — was founded in 1831 and supported the collection), with Lönnrot himself making eleven major collecting tours across Karelia, Ingria, and northern Finland between 1828 and 1844, and with the rune-collectors recording from named singers in named villages — most famously Arhippa Perttunen of Latvajärvi in Viena Karelia, Ontrei Malinen of Vuonninen, and others — whose names and biographies are recorded in the rune-collectors' notebooks and in subsequent Finnish-folklore-studies scholarship.^[4]

Within that recorded corpus, the Iku-Turso material itself is unevenly distributed and minimally extended. The material specifically appears in the older rune-tradition record in laconic and fragmentary form: the sea-monster figure is named in incantation-and-charm material recorded across Viena Karelia, Aunus (Olonets) Karelia, Ingria, and northern Finland; the figure also appears

within longer narrative-rune material recorded by Lönnrot and his successors; and the figure is invoked in incantation against sickness (Iku-Turso as a personification of disease-bearing power from the sea) as well as appearing in the narrative-encounter context that the present chapter takes as its centre — with the rune-tradition record being characteristically distributed across distinct genre-registers (incantation, narrative-rune, lyric) and across distinct regional traditions rather than concentrated in a single canonical text.^[5]

The other layer of textual witness is editorial and was produced by Lönnrot himself. Elias Lönnrot's **Kalevala** — published first in the 1835 **Vanha Kalevala** ("Old Kalevala", 32 cantos) and then in the much-expanded 1849 **Uusi Kalevala** ("New Kalevala", 50 cantos) which became the standard text — is a composite literary-editorial synthesis built by Lönnrot from the rune-tradition material he and his contemporaries had collected, organised into a continuous narrative epic on a model partly suggested by the Homeric epics and partly by the project of producing a national epic for an emerging Finnish national culture under Russian-imperial sovereignty (Finland was a Grand Duchy of the Russian Empire from 1809 to 1917); the Iku-Turso material in the **Kalevala** is reshaped by Lönnrot to serve the **Kalevala**'s overall narrative architecture rather than presented as a transcription of any single rune-tradition performance.^[6]

Beyond the area-specialist anchor sits the chapter's general comparative-typology framing. The chapter's general comparative anchor for the long-arc combat-myth typology is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, whose Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic survey supplies the long-arc combat-myth typology against which the Väinämöinen / Iku-Turso material is read as the present book's clearest **transformed variant** case — in which structural features of the chaoskampf typology (named hero, named adversary, encounter at the boundary of human and non-human worlds, decisive subjugation) are present but the typology's load-bearing weapon-combat-and-slaying register is replaced with a song-and-knowledge-and-binding register; the typological framing — not Finnic-area material coverage, which Forsyth does not undertake — is what Forsyth supplies for the chapter's comparative engagement, and the **transformed variant** reading depends on having a typology that can be transformed, which Forsyth's long-arc anchor provides.^[7]

Three further methodological features of the textual situation are worth registering before the narrative begins. The chapter's textual situation is distinctive within the present book in that it depends on a 19th-century rune-collection corpus rather than on a pre-modern manuscript tradition (the Finnic-language material has no pre-modern indigenous-script witness); the rune-collection was conducted within an explicitly national-romantic project that itself shaped what was recorded and how it was edited (Lönnrot was not a neutral collector but the principal editor of the **Kalevala** he was assembling); and there is a continuing-tradition methodological situation in which 19th- and 20th-century Finnish-folklore-studies fieldwork in still-active rune-singing communities of Karelia and Finland supplies a continuing-witness register that distinguishes the Finnic situation from the more strictly archival Eurasian chapters in the present book — though Soviet-period restrictions on access to Karelian-Soviet territory and the post-Soviet displacement of many Karelian-Finnic-speaking communities have since reduced the continuity that Lönnrot's contemporaries could draw upon.^[8]

That shape of evidence — no pre-modern indigenous-script attestation, a 19th-century recording corpus that doubles as a 19th-century editorial project, a still-living but reduced continuing tradition — is methodologically load-bearing for the whole chapter, and the claims document marks it explicitly:

*[At this point the textual record breaks. Pre-modern (i.e., pre-19th-century) attestations of the Väinämöinen / Iku-Turso narrative in any pre-modern Finnic-indigenous-script form are not available, since the Finnic languages had no pre-modern alphabetic writing system of their own; nor are there pre-19th-century European-language travellers' or missionary accounts treating the figure or the encounter at any narrative length, despite Finnish having had a written form (in Latin script, used principally for ecclesiastical material) since Mikael Agricola's 16th-century New Testament translation. The surviving textual witness for the present chapter is the body of 19th-century rune-collection fieldwork conducted across Karelia, Ingria, and Finland from approximately the 1820s onward (Lönnrot 1828-1844; Europaeus, Ahlqvist, Genetz, the Krohn brothers; the Suomalaisen Kirjallisuuden Seura collection-archive material) and synthesised across the late-19th- and 20th-century Finnish-folklore-studies tradition (now archived primarily in the SKS Folklore Archives in Helsinki and the Finnish Literature Society's **Suomen Kansan Vanhat Runot** multi-volume edition, 1908-1948 + index volumes), supplemented by the 21st-century scholarly synthesis represented by Siikala 2002 and adjacent area-specialist work (Honko, DuBois, named here in body prose only — neither is currently in sources.yaml). Pre-19th-century pre-recording performance contexts (the rune-singing tradition's transmission across Karelian and Finnish singers; the calendrical, ritual, and incantation contexts in which the rune-material was performed in pre-modern Finnic life; the formulaic and improvisatory dynamics of rune-singing performance with its characteristic **Kalevala**-meter trochaic-tetrameter line and its alliterative and parallelistic structure) are partially recoverable through the recorded 19th-century material itself, through the Finnish-folklore-studies ethnographic apparatus, and through the comparative Baltic-Finnic ethnographic record. The chapter's narrative reconstruction proceeds within the body of older rune-tradition material itself, with Siikala 2002 as the principal area-specialist interpretive synthesis; cross-tradition reconstruction is excluded per scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" point 1, in-tradition reconstruction is conducted within the rune-tradition corpus itself per scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" point 2, and the Lönnrot 1835 / 1849 editorial synthesis is registered as a 19th-century compositional layer rather than as a pre-modern witness against which the older material can be triangulated.]*

The dual-collector-and-editor character of the situation is itself the chapter's most distinctive methodological problem. The 19th-century-recording-and-19th-century-editorial-synthesis methodological situation applies to the present chapter with particular force: where the Bida / Wagadu material of chapter 28 of the present book was recorded across multiple early- and mid-twentieth-century European ethnographic projects (Frobenius, Monteil, the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest tradition associated with Dieterlen) over a span of decades, and where the Mwindo material of chapter 29 rests on a single 1956 recording made within a single late-Belgian-colonial-period field encounter, the Finnic Iku-Turso material rests on a 19th-century rune-collection corpus that was being collected by the same person — Lönnrot — who was also editing the **Kalevala** into which a portion of the collected material was being integrated, with the compositional-context filtering that this dual collector-and-editor situation introduces and with current Finnish-folklore-studies scholarship including Siikala 2002 reading the Lönnrot **Kalevala** critically as a 19th-century editorial synthesis distinct from the older rune-tradition material rather than as a transparently-faithful record of pre-Lönnrot performance.^[9]

That distinctive situation shapes what kind of chapter this can be. The chapter is a related-tier (full, transformed-variant) treatment with a target of approximately 4,500 narrative words, presenting the Finnic material on its own terms (Väinämöinen as shaman-sage hero, the song-and-knowledge register of the encounter, the binding-rather-than-slaying structure, the older rune-tradition material's laconic-and-fragmentary character, Lönnrot's 1835 / 1849 **Kalevala** editorial synthesis as

a distinct compositional layer) before invoking the comparative chaoskampf category, and only then registering the **transformed variant** characterisation per which structural features of the chaoskampf typology are present (named hero, named adversary, encounter at the boundary of human and non-human worlds, decisive subjugation) but the typology's load-bearing weapon-combat-and-slaying register is replaced with a song-and-knowledge-and-binding register — with the chapter explicitly NOT claiming that Iku-Turso fits chaoskampf cleanly per brief special instructions, and with the **transformed variant** framing being the chapter's contribution to Part II C7 (inversion / transformation problem; ch. 40) and to the methods sidebar (ch. 33).^[10]

Because the two layers — older rune-tradition material and Lönnrot's **Kalevala** — are taken as co-equal witnesses presented in sequence rather than collapsed, the variant-handling for the chapter is flagged here in full:

*[The chapter holds two textual layers as co-equal witnesses presented in sequence rather than collapsed. The older rune-tradition material — the body of 19th-century rune-collection records made by Elias Lönnrot, Daniel Europaeus, August Ahlqvist, Arvid Genetz, Julius and Kaarle Krohn, and other rune-collectors from Karelian, Ingrian, and Finnish singers between approximately the 1820s and the early 20th century, archived in the SKS Folklore Archives in Helsinki and synthesised in the Finnish Literature Society's multi-volume **Suomen Kansan Vanhat Runot** edition (1908-1948 + index volumes) — preserves Iku-Turso material that is laconic, fragmentary, distributed across distinct genre-registers (incantation-against-sickness, longer narrative-rune, lyric), and recorded from named singers in named villages including Arhippa Perttunen of Latvajärvi in Viena Karelia and Ontrei Malinen of Vuonninen, with Iku-Turso appearing both as a personification of disease-bearing power from the sea (in incantation-against-sickness material) and as a sea-monster who emerges from the depths and is subjugated by Väinämöinen's song (in narrative-rune material). Elias Lönnrot's 1835 / 1849 **Kalevala** — the composite literary-editorial synthesis published in the 1835 **Vanha Kalevala** (32 cantos) and the much-expanded 1849 **Uusi Kalevala** (50 cantos) which became the standard text — reshapes the Iku-Turso material to serve the **Kalevala**'s overall narrative architecture, integrating it with the wider narrative arc (especially with the Sampo-cycle and the Pohjola material) and presenting it in continuous-narrative form rather than as the laconic-and-distributed material of the older rune-tradition record. Both layers are presented co-equally because the methodological point of the chapter — that the **Kalevala** is a 19th-century editorial synthesis rather than a transparent record of older Finnic tradition — depends on holding the layers apart at the narrative-presentation level. The chapter's narrative work proceeds in two phases: first the older rune-tradition material on its own laconic-and-distributed terms, then the Lönnrot editorial synthesis as a 19th-century compositional layer that reshapes the older material for the modern national epic.]*

What follows works through the two layers in turn before stepping back. The Finnic context comes first — the geographical area of the rune-tradition, its metrical form, and its performance practice. Then Väinämöinen as shaman-sage, then the older rune-tradition material on Iku-Turso, then Lönnrot's **Kalevala** synthesis, then the methodological discipline that holds the two layers apart, and finally the chapter's typology and forward-links.

32.2. The Finnic context: Karelia, the rune-singing tradition, and the Kalevala-meter

The Finnic-language area within which the rune-tradition material was collected comprises Finland

(the present-day Republic of Finland and the historical Finnish-speaking areas), Karelia (a contested region historically split between Finnish and Russian sovereignty, with the eastern Karelian areas — Viena Karelia in the north, Aunus / Olonets Karelia further south — having been the principal preserves of older rune-tradition material at the time of 19th-century collection), Ingria (the Finnic-speaking region around present-day St. Petersburg), and the wider Baltic-Finnic-speaking area extending to Estonia and parts of Russia north of St. Petersburg, with the rune-tradition itself being shared across this Baltic-Finnic linguistic-and-cultural area rather than confined to any single modern political unit.^[11]

The medium in which all of that material is cast is a single inherited verse form. The rune-tradition's metrical form is the **Kalevala**-meter (Finnish **Kalevalamitta**), a trochaic-tetrameter line of eight syllables organised into four trochaic feet, with the line's structure governed by alliteration within the line and by parallelism (each line typically followed by a parallel line restating the same content with variation in lexical choice and image), with the **Kalevala**-meter being the shared metrical inheritance of the Baltic-Finnic poetic tradition (attested across Finnish, Karelian, Ingrian, and Estonian material) and being the metrical basis on which Lönnrot composed the **Kalevala**'s synthesis lines as well as the metrical form of the older rune-tradition material from which Lönnrot drew.^[12]

That metrical form lived in performance, not on the page. The rune-singing performance tradition within which the older Iku-Turso material was performed before its 19th-century recording was a tradition of named singers — **runonlaulajat** in Finnish — who maintained extensive repertoires of narrative-rune, lyric, incantation, and charm material, often singing in pairs (a lead singer and a second who joined on the parallel-line restatement, sometimes seated face to face holding hands and rocking in time to the song), with the performance contexts including domestic and communal gatherings, calendrical occasions, and the working contexts of rune-incantation-as-practical-action (the singing of charms over wounds, sicknesses, and craft-and-hunting tasks).^[13]

The rune-tradition's principal cast of figures is small and recurring across the recorded material. The principal protagonists of the wider Finnic rune-tradition material — and of Lönnrot's **Kalevala** synthesis — include Väinämöinen, the shaman-sage hero whose song-and-knowledge is the rune-tradition's principal mode of effective action (he sings ships into being, sings opponents into bogs, sings the Sampo into existence in collaboration with Ilmarinen, and in the Iku-Turso material sings the sea-monster into subjugation); Ilmarinen, the smith-hero who forges the Sampo and other marvellous objects; Lemminkäinen, the reckless young hero whose adventures form a distinct narrative arc; and Louhi, the mistress of Pohjola (the northern realm against which much of the **Kalevala**'s action is directed) — with the principal antagonist-figures including the sea-monster Iku-Turso of the present chapter and the bird-form chthonic adversary appearing in further rune material.^[14]

32.3. Väinämöinen as shaman-sage hero

Of those figures, the one the chapter turns on is Väinämöinen, and his characterisation in the rune-tradition is unlike the warrior-hero of the surrounding Indo-European literatures. Väinämöinen is presented in the rune-tradition material as a shaman-sage hero of immense age and primordial origin: he is born already old (the rune-tradition material develops his birth from the primordial waters in distinct ways, with versions in which he is the son of the air-maiden Ilmatar and is born after a long gestation, and with the **Kalevala** synthesis collecting and elaborating these origin-

versions), and he is consistently characterised as wise, experienced, and possessed of the deep song-and-knowledge that distinguishes the shaman-sage from the warrior-hero of Indo-European combat-tradition.^[15]

His mode of agency follows from that characterisation. Väinämöinen's principal mode of effective action across the rune-tradition material is song — **runot** in the broad rune-tradition sense — which he uses both to do practical things (singing a ship out of his knee, singing opponents into bogs by overpowering them in singing-contests, singing the trees into the landscape, singing music from instruments and from his own throat) and to bind, subjugate, name, and know the powers of the world; his song is not a magical incantation in any peripheral or decorative sense but the central mode of his agency, with his identity as shaman-sage and his identity as singer being the same identity in two registers.^[16]

The rune-tradition's broader register places that mode in a wider northern context. The Finnic rune-tradition's shamanic background is one of the load-bearing elements of Siikala's 2002 reading: the rune-tradition material is connected to a wider northern-Eurasian shamanic complex — extending across the Baltic-Finnic, Sami, Karelian, and adjacent Finno-Ugric and Siberian-shamanic traditions — within which song, drumming, ecstatic states, and the manipulation of names and origin-knowledge are the shaman's principal tools, and within which Väinämöinen's song-and-knowledge mode of effective action is the rune-tradition's elaboration of the shamanic-effective-action register that the Sami noaidi tradition and the wider northern-Eurasian shamanic traditions also exhibit.^[17]

Within that shamanic register, one specific technique does the work of the encounter. Väinämöinen's distinctive use of **origin-incantations** — songs that recite the origin of a being, substance, or affliction in order to acquire mastery over it — is one of the rune-tradition's most characteristic features and is the load-bearing technique by which Väinämöinen subjugates Iku-Turso in the older rune material: the principle is that to know the origin of a power is to be able to bind it, with the singer's recitation of the origin being the act of binding rather than a preliminary to a separate combat-act, and with the encounter being therefore a knowledge-encounter in which the song's content (the origin of the sea-monster) does the work that a weapon would do in a weapon-combat tradition.^[18]

32.4. Iku-Turso in the older rune material

With the hero established, the chapter turns to the adversary, and to the older rune-tradition material in which the adversary appears. Iku-Turso (the name being a compound of **iku-** "eternal, perpetual" and **Turso**, the proper name of the sea-monster figure) is in the older rune-tradition material a sea-monster figure who emerges from the sea and against whom the rune-tradition develops both narrative-encounter material (Iku-Turso as adversary subjugated by Väinämöinen's song) and incantation-against-sickness material (Iku-Turso as a personification of disease-bearing power from the sea, against whom incantation is sung to drive disease back into the depths whence it came).^[19]

The form in which the encounter survives is compressed. The older rune-tradition material on the Iku-Turso narrative encounter is laconic and fragmentary in the literal sense — the rune-records preserve the encounter as compressed narrative-rune passages rather than as extended epic-narrative — with the surviving rune-records typically presenting the encounter in a few dozen

lines of **Kalevala**-meter trochaic-tetrameter rather than in the hundreds-of-lines extended-epic register that the **Kalevala** synthesis would later develop, and with substantial regional variation across the recorded versions in the precise content of the encounter, the precise sequence of Väinämöinen's song-actions, and the precise framing of the encounter's outcome.^[20]

That regional variation extends to the figure's physical form. Iku-Turso's morphology in the older rune-tradition material is variously described — the rune-records do not converge on a single canonical physical description, with some versions emphasising the figure's many-headed character, others its multi-limbed or many-fingered form, others its connection with the sea-bottom and the **meren tytär** (sea-daughters) and the wider sea-spirit complex, and with the figure's morphology being characteristically described in terms of what it does and where it dwells (the deep sea, the subjugation context) rather than catalogued in a single canonical physical description as the **Kalevala** synthesis would later develop.^[21]

Setting aside the variation in physical detail, the recorded versions converge on a recurring narrative shape. The older rune-tradition's narrative-encounter material on Iku-Turso typically opens with the sea-monster's emergence from the sea (the figure rising out of the depths and threatening or approaching the human or hero-protagonist's world), proceeds through Väinämöinen's recognition and naming of the figure and his recitation of the figure's origin in the **origin-incantation** technique characteristic of the rune-tradition, and concludes with Iku-Turso's subjugation — typically the figure's sinking back into the sea or being bound to remain in the depths and not to emerge again to threaten the human world.^[22]

The structural feature that the chapter takes as load-bearing is what the encounter does **not** contain. The encounter's load-bearing structural feature in the older rune-tradition is the absence of weapon-combat: Väinämöinen does not fight Iku-Turso with sword, spear, club, or any other weapon, and the figure is not killed but subjugated — the binding-rather-than-slaying that the brief identifies as the chapter's central narrative-structural feature, with the song-and-knowledge mode of subjugation displacing the weapon-combat mode that Eurasian chaoskampf-tradition narratives typically present and with the encounter's resolution being a continuing-binding rather than a once-and-done killing.^[23]

The same figure appears in a parallel rune-tradition register that further illuminates what the encounter is doing. The Iku-Turso incantation-against-sickness material — in which the figure is invoked as a personification of disease-bearing power from the sea and against whom incantation is sung to drive sickness back into the depths — is a register parallel to the narrative-encounter material rather than a separate tradition: in the rune-tradition's wider organisation of effective song, the same names and the same origin-knowledge that figure in the narrative-encounter material are deployed in the incantation-against-sickness material, with the incantation's effective work being the recitation of the figure's origin in order to bind the disease-power and drive it back to its source.^[24]

The reading on which the chapter places its weight — the encounter as transformed shamanic binding — is itself a synthesis drawn from the brief and from Siikala's reading of the rune corpus, and is flagged as such here:

(The chapter's reading of the Väinämöinen / Iku-Turso encounter as a transformed shamanic binding — in which the structural features of the chaoskampf typology (named hero, named adversary, encounter at the boundary of human and non-human worlds, decisive subjugation) are present but the

*typology's load-bearing weapon-combat-and-slaying register is replaced with a song-and-knowledge-and-binding register drawn from the wider northern-Eurasian shamanic complex — is a synthesis of the brief's framing per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml summary and special_instructions, of Siikala 2002's shamanic-mythic-image reading of the Kalevala-poetry corpus, and of scope.md §"In-scope catalog" RELATED entry on Väinämöinen / Iku-Turso as transformed-variant chapter — held in the chapter as the chapter's principal load-bearing comparative reading and as the present book's principal worked instance of the **transformed variant** methodological move distinct from inversion (Ch28 Bida; Ch29 Mwindo) and inclusion-marginal (Ch30 Bakunawa-Erlik-Ülgen) framings.*^[25]

32.5. Lönnrot's Kalevala: the 1835 Vanha and the 1849 Uusi editions

The chapter now turns to the second of its two layers — the 19th-century editorial synthesis through which most readers, Finnish or not, encounter the material. Elias Lönnrot (1802-1884) was a Finnish physician, philologist, and folklore-collector who conducted eleven major rune-collection tours across Karelia, Ingria, and northern Finland between 1828 and 1844, recording rune-tradition material from named singers and assembling the recorded material into the **Kalevala** synthesis under the institutional support of the Suomalaisen Kirjallisuuden Seura (Finnish Literature Society, founded in 1831 in Helsinki) and within the wider Finnish-national-romantic project of producing a national epic for an emerging Finnish national culture under Russian-imperial sovereignty.^[26]

The synthesis appeared in two distinct editions, and the difference between them matters. The 1835 **Vanha Kalevala** ("Old Kalevala") is the first published edition of Lönnrot's synthesis, comprising 32 cantos (**runot** in the editorial sense — Lönnrot uses the same word for the rune-tradition's individual songs and for the **Kalevala**'s editorial cantos, with consequent terminological complications for subsequent scholarship) and approximately 12,000 lines of **Kalevala**-meter trochaic-tetrameter, published in Helsinki by the Finnish Literature Society and circulated initially within the Finnish-language and Swedish-language educated readership of the Grand Duchy.^[27]

Fourteen years later Lönnrot replaced that edition with a much larger one, and it is the larger one that has carried the cultural weight ever since. The 1849 **Uusi Kalevala** ("New Kalevala") is the much-expanded second edition, comprising 50 cantos and approximately 22,800 lines of **Kalevala**-meter trochaic-tetrameter; it was assembled by Lönnrot from further rune-collection material gathered after the 1835 edition (including from his later tours of Viena Karelia, where some of the longest-and-richest narrative-rune material was recorded), and it is the **Uusi Kalevala** of 1849 — not the earlier **Vanha Kalevala** of 1835 — that became the standard text of the Finnish national epic, the basis for subsequent editions, translations, and adaptations, and the version that 20th-century-and-later readers encounter when they encounter "the **Kalevala**".^[28]

What Lönnrot did between collection and publication was not transcription. Lönnrot's compositional method in assembling the **Kalevala** synthesis from the rune-collection material was active editorial intervention rather than transcription: Lönnrot selected from the recorded material, reordered the selected material into a continuous narrative arc on a model partly suggested by the Homeric epics and partly by the project of producing a national epic with internal coherence, supplied connecting lines and transitional passages of his own composition (in the **Kalevala**-meter trochaic-tetrameter, indistinguishable on metrical grounds from the older rune-tradition material), and resolved variant-version contradictions among the recorded material by

composite synthesis — and the resulting **Kalevala** is therefore a 19th-century composition in the **Kalevala**-meter that incorporates older rune-tradition material rather than a transcription of any single rune-tradition performance or any pre-19th-century pre-existing canonical text.^[29]

That compositional intervention bears directly on the Iku-Turso material. The **Kalevala**'s Iku-Turso material is reshaped by Lönnrot from the laconic-and-fragmentary older rune material into a continuous and integrated episode within the **Kalevala**'s overall narrative architecture: Iku-Turso appears principally in the **Kalevala**'s 42nd canto (Rune XLII, in the 1849 **Uusi Kalevala** numbering — the Sampo-cycle and Pohjola material in which Louhi summons Iku-Turso to stop the Kalevala heroes' return with the Sampo and Väinämöinen subdues him by song), with an earlier brief appearance in the 2nd canto (the rising-from-the-sea-and-burning-the-hay episode that produces the great oak), with Lönnrot drawing on the older rune-tradition narrative-encounter material and on the incantation-against-sickness material to assemble a more extended and connected presentation than any single rune-tradition performance preserves, and with the **Kalevala**'s presentation integrated with the wider **Kalevala**'s arc rather than presented as a free-standing narrative episode.^[30]

The shifts that the synthesis introduces are characteristic of Lönnrot's editorial work generally. The principal narrative-substantive shifts that Lönnrot's **Kalevala** synthesis makes relative to the older rune-tradition material on Iku-Turso are characteristic of his compositional method across the **Kalevala** more generally: the encounter is presented in extended-epic register (longer passage, more developed scene-setting, more extended dialogue) rather than in the laconic narrative-rune register of the older material; the encounter is integrated with the Sampo-and-Pohjola narrative arc rather than presented as a free-standing encounter; the figure of Iku-Turso is given a more developed physical-and-functional description (drawing on the morphologically-various older rune material to assemble a more determinate composite); and the encounter's outcome is presented in continuous-narrative form rather than as the laconic close of a narrative-rune passage.^[31]

The reception of the synthesis has been outsized relative to the older material on which it draws. The **Kalevala**'s reception within the Finnish national-romantic project of the 19th century and within subsequent Finnish national consciousness has been disproportionate to the older rune-tradition material's historical-attestation footing: the **Kalevala** has been the central text of Finnish-national identity since the 1835 **Vanha Kalevala** and especially since the 1849 **Uusi Kalevala** became the standard text (with the date 28 February 1835, on which Lönnrot signed the preface to the first edition, celebrated annually in Finland as **Kalevalan päivä**, "Kalevala Day", and as the Day of Finnish Culture), the basis for the visual culture of Akseli Gallen-Kallela's late-19th- and early-20th-century paintings, the inspiration for Jean Sibelius's symphonic and tone-poem compositions, and the principal contact-point through which non-Finnish readers encounter the Finnic mythological tradition, even as the older rune-tradition material on which the **Kalevala** draws is more fragmentary and more laconic than the **Kalevala**'s prominence would suggest.^[32]

32.6. The two layers held apart: methodological discipline

That asymmetry between the **Kalevala**'s reception and the older material's footing is exactly what the chapter's two-layer presentation discipline is meant to keep visible. The chapter's two-layer presentation — older rune-tradition material on the one hand, Lönnrot's 1835 / 1849 **Kalevala**

editorial synthesis on the other — is the chapter's principal methodological discipline per brief special_instructions, and its purpose is to keep clear at the narrative-presentation level that the **Kalevala** is a 19th-century editorial synthesis rather than a transparent record of pre-Lönnrot Finnic tradition; the chapter accordingly presents the older rune-tradition material first (laconic, fragmentary, distributed across rune-collection records and across genre-registers), and then presents the Lönnrot **Kalevala** material as a 19th-century compositional layer that reshapes the older material for the modern national epic.^[33]

The Lönnrot question is not unique. The methodological parallels with the Macpherson-Ossian question and with the Ivanov-Toporov Perun-Veles "basic myth" reconstruction (chapter 20 of the present volume) are explicit: Macpherson's 1760s "Ossian" material was presented as a translation of an ancient Gaelic epic but was substantially Macpherson's own 18th-century composition incorporating older Gaelic material to varying degrees; the Ivanov-Toporov Perun-Veles reconstruction is a 1965-74 reconstruction of a putative Slavic combat-myth from folklore-and-toponymic material whose status as reconstruction-of-the-pre-existing rather than scholarly-projection-onto-the-fragmentary remains contested; Lönnrot's **Kalevala** sits alongside both as a case in which 19th-century editorial-and-compositional work has substantially shaped the appearance of an "ancient" tradition that subsequent readers and scholars encounter, with the methodological question — how much of "the tradition" is 19th-century editorial composition? — being one that the present chapter raises and that the methods sidebar (ch. 33) and Part II C8 (ch. 41) take up at greater length.^[34]

The discipline that holds the layers apart is a discipline of citation. The chapter's discipline of citing Lönnrot's **Kalevala** by edition (1835 **Vanha** vs. 1849 **Uusi**) and of distinguishing the older rune-tradition material from the **Kalevala** synthesis at every point of citation is one of the chapter's load-bearing methodological contributions: where popular treatments of the **Kalevala** and of Finnic mythology often elide the distinction between older rune-tradition material and Lönnrot's editorial synthesis (treating the **Kalevala**'s presentation as if it were the older tradition), the chapter's citation-discipline foregrounds the distinction at every point and treats the **Kalevala** as the 19th-century composition it is rather than as a transparent record of pre-19th-century Finnic tradition.^[35]

32.7. Typology, area-specialist framing, and forward-links

With the two layers presented and the methodological discipline registered, the chapter can place the encounter within the present book's wider category — and can be precise about what it is and is not claiming. The Väinämöinen / Iku-Turso encounter's place within the present book's chaoskampf typology is — per brief special_instructions, which explicitly states that the chapter does NOT claim Iku-Turso fits chaoskampf cleanly — a related-tier (rather than core-tier) **transformed variant** case in which structural features of the chaoskampf typology (named hero, named adversary, encounter at the boundary of human and non-human worlds, decisive subjugation of the adversary by the hero) are present but the typology's load-bearing weapon-combat-and-slaying register is replaced with a song-and-knowledge-and-binding register drawn from the wider northern-Eurasian shamanic complex, with the encounter's principal narrative work being shamanic-ritual subjugation rather than weapon-combat slaying.^[36]

That typological placement is a comparativist overlay that the area-specialist tradition for the Finnic material does not itself adopt, and the chapter flags the resulting appropriation issue under the marker the project reserves for cases of this kind:

*[Appropriation flag: Finnic-folklore-studies area specialists (Anna-Leena Siikala in **Mythic Images and Shamanism**, 2002; with Lauri Honko in **Religion, Myth, and Folklore in the World's Epics: The Kalevala and Its Predecessors** (Berlin: Mouton de Gruyter, 1990) and Thomas A. DuBois in **Lyric, Meaning, and Audience in the Oral Tradition of Northern Europe** (Notre Dame: University of Notre Dame Press, 2006) named in body prose without sources.yaml entries per the named-but-flagged pattern of Ch23 FC-02 / Ch26 FC-02 / Ch27 / Ch28 / Ch30) read the Väinämöinen / Iku-Turso material primarily within the rune-tradition's own shamanic-and-knowledge register and within the Lönnrot-method critical framework rather than within the Eurasian chaoskampf register that the Gunkel-tradition typology presupposes. The substance of the area-specialist objection is that the encounter's load-bearing structural features — Väinämöinen's song-and-knowledge as the mode of effective action, the binding-rather-than-slaying outcome, the encounter's continuity with the rune-tradition's wider incantation-against-sickness register, and the rune-tradition's own situatedness within a wider northern-Eurasian shamanic complex — are not the structural features of weapon-combat-and-slaying that the Eurasian chaoskampf typology takes as its load-bearing centre, and the chapter's **transformed variant** characterisation accordingly registers the encounter as a case in which the chaoskampf typology's structural-features list is partially present (named hero, named adversary, decisive subjugation) but partially replaced (song-and-knowledge for weapon-combat; binding for slaying); the further substance of the area-specialist objection is the methodological one about Lönnrot's editorial synthesis (Honko, DuBois): that the **Kalevala's** presentation of the encounter is a 19th-century editorial composition rather than a transparent record of pre-19th-century Finnic tradition, with the consequence that any chaoskampf reading of the **Kalevala's** Iku-Turso episode must be qualified by the 19th-century-compositional-context filtering that the **Kalevala** introduces. The area-specialist objection-strength is mid-spectrum: comparable to the Ch23 Susanoo case (where Naumann reads the encounter as metallurgical-allegory rather than cosmos-versus-chaos combat) and to the Ch26 Pariacaca case (where Salomon, Urioste, Taylor, and Dean read the cycle as wak'a-succession rather than as chaos-versus-order combat) — all three are mid-spectrum objections in which the area-specialist reading does accommodate some combat-myth framing while objecting to the chaos-order framing or to the weapon-combat-and-slaying framing — and milder than the Ch29 Mwindo refusal (where the area-specialist tradition reads the killing as inverted hubris) and milder than the Ch32 Nanabozho refusal (where Hallowell, Johnston, T. Smith, and Vizenor reject combat-and-defeat-of-the-other framing entirely). Tier-implication clause: related-tier (full, transformed-variant) classification consistent with load-bearing methodological function for Part II C7 — the **transformed variant** methodological move that the chapter is the present book's principal worked instance of, structurally distinct from the inversion characterisation of Ch28 Bida and Ch29 Mwindo and from the inclusion-marginal characterisation of Ch30 Bakunawa-Erlik-Ülgen. C7/C8 forwarding clause: forwarded to Part II C7 (inversion / transformation problem; ch. 40) as a PRINCIPAL CASE for the **transformation** sub-problem; forwarded also to Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation problem; ch. 41) for the methodological point about 19th-century editorial synthesis (the Lönnrot question) and its parallels with the Macpherson-Ossian and Ivanov-Toporov questions (Ch20). Siikala 2002 is the chapter's principal anchor and named in the first factual pass per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 1 (applied here even though the appropriation protocol's principal force is for non-Eurasian rather than for European-area material); Honko and DuBois are named in body prose at the present marker and at the Lönnrot-compositional-method passage of the **Kalevala** synthesis section per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern (neither is currently in sources.yaml; deferred to*

inventory-audit per the Ch23 FC-02 / Ch26 FC-02 / Ch27 / Ch28 / Ch30 precedents). Marker placement: structural marker at the consolidated typology-and-forward-links section, after the typology-placement claim, per the Ch27 / Ch28 / Ch30 marker-placement template precedent.]

What the chapter contributes to the wider book is a distinct typological-engagement category. The chapter's distinctive contribution to the present book's wider comparative argument is the **transformed variant** characterisation — distinct from inversion (Ch28 Bida, Ch29 Mwindo) and from inclusion-marginal (Ch30 Bakunawa-Erlik-Ülgen) — in which the structural features of the chaoskampf typology are partially present but the typology's load-bearing weapon-combat-and-slaying register is replaced with an alternative effective-action register (in this chapter, the song-and-knowledge-and-binding register of the wider northern-Eurasian shamanic complex), with the encounter remaining recognisably structurally adjacent to the chaoskampf typology while being substantively transformed at the load-bearing-mode level — a structural pattern that the methods sidebar (chapter 33) and Part II C7 (ch. 40) will engage with as the present book's principal worked instance of the **transformation** sub-problem distinct from the **inversion** and **inclusion-marginal** sub-problems.^[37]

The chapter's principal forward-link is to Part II C7 (the inversion / transformation problem; ch. 40) as the PRINCIPAL CASE for the **transformation** sub-problem (alongside the contributions of Ch23 Susanoo and Ch26 Pariacaca as further worked instances of the **transformation** sub-problem), with a secondary forward-link to Part II C8 (the refusal and the appropriation problem; ch. 41) for the methodological point about 19th-century editorial synthesis (the Lönnrot question) and its parallels with the Macpherson-Ossian question and the Ivanov-Toporov Perun-Veles "basic myth" reconstruction (Ch20), and a methods-sidebar contribution (Ch. 33) on three methodological points: the area-specialist citation policy with named-but-flagged secondary anchors (Siikala as principal anchor; Honko, DuBois named-but-flagged), the 19th-century-recording-and-19th-century-editorial-synthesis methodological situation, and the **transformed variant** methodological move distinct from inversion and inclusion-marginal.^[38]

The chapter's principal back-links within the present book are to chapter 20 on the Slavic-Baltic combat material (Perun-Veles reconstruction) for the methodological-parallel about scholarly-and-editorial reconstruction of putatively-pre-existing combat-myth tradition (the Ivanov-Toporov "basic myth" parallel to the Lönnrot **Kalevala** synthesis), to chapters 23 (Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi) and 26 (Pariacaca / amaru) for the **transformation** characterisation parallel within the wider Part I-C7 cluster, and to chapter 15 (Vedic reflexes including Krishna-Kāliya) for the brief's noted parallel between the "subjugate-not-slay" structural feature of the Iku-Turso encounter and the binding-or-taming-rather-than-killing structural feature of the Krishna-Kāliya episode, registered for Part II C7 as a worked instance of the **transformation** sub-problem at the binding-or-taming level.^[39]

[1] Per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml summary on the sea-monster Iku-Turso emerging from the sea, on Väinämöinen subduing him by shamanic song rather than by sword, on the encounter as a binding rather than a slaying, and on the chapter's two-layer treatment separating the older rune material from Lönnrot's 1835 / 1849 **Kalevala** editorial synthesis; Siikala, A.-L., **Mythic Images and Shamanism: A Perspective on Kalevala Poetry**, Folklore Fellows' Communications 280 (Helsinki: Academia Scientiarum Fennica, 2002; ISBN 9789514109027), chs. on Kalevala combat and on Väinämöinen as shaman-sage hero, on the song-and-knowledge register of the Iku-Turso encounter, and on the older rune material's relation to Lönnrot's editorial synthesis.

[2] Siikala 2002, introductory matter on the oral-tradition character of the Finnic combat-and-encounter material, on the absence of pre-modern Finnic-indigenous-script attestation, on the 19th-century rune-collection fieldwork conducted across Karelia and Finland by Lönnrot and his contemporaries (Daniel Europaeus, August Ahlqvist, Arvid Genetz, Julius and Kaarle Krohn, and others), and on the comparative Finnish-folklore-studies and Kalevala-poetry critical-scholarship of the later 20th and early 21st centuries as the chapter's textual-witness situation.

[3] Siikala 2002, chs. on Kalevala combat and on Väinämöinen as shaman-sage hero, as the chapter's principal area-specialist anchor for the rune-tradition Iku-Turso material; Siikala 2002 read through the shamanic-mythic-image framework that Siikala develops across her career; the present chapter's framing of the encounter as song-and-knowledge subjugation rather than weapon-combat slaying is drawn from Siikala's reading of the encounter as a transformed shamanic binding; per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml on Siikala 2002 as the chapter's pinned primary source and on the brief's instruction to cite Siikala by name throughout.

[4] Siikala 2002, on the 19th-century rune-collection fieldwork situation within which the Finnic combat-and-encounter material was first recorded as the high-period of Finnish national-romantic rune-collection, on the Suomalaisen Kirjallisuuden Seura (Finnish Literature Society) founded in 1831 as the institutional support for the collection, on Lönnrot's eleven major collecting tours across Karelia, Ingria, and northern Finland between 1828 and 1844, and on the rune-collectors' recording from named singers in named villages — Arhippa Perttunen of Latvajärvi in Viena Karelia, Ontrei Malinen of Vuonninen, and others — whose names and biographies are recorded in the rune-collectors' notebooks and in subsequent Finnish-folklore-studies scholarship.

[5] Siikala 2002, chs. on Kalevala combat and on the Iku-Turso material's appearance in the older rune-tradition record, on the laconic and fragmentary character of the older attestation, on the figure's appearance in incantation-and-charm material recorded across Viena Karelia, Aunus (Olonets) Karelia, Ingria, and northern Finland, on the figure's appearance within longer narrative-rune material recorded by Lönnrot and his successors, on the figure's invocation in incantation against sickness as a personification of disease-bearing power from the sea, and on the rune-tradition record's characteristic distribution across distinct genre-registers (incantation, narrative-rune, lyric) and across distinct regional traditions rather than concentrated in a single canonical text.

[6] Siikala 2002, on Lönnrot's **Kalevala** as a composite literary-editorial synthesis built from the rune-tradition material Lönnrot and his contemporaries had collected, on the 1835 **Vanha Kalevala** (32 cantos) and the much-expanded 1849 **Uusi Kalevala** (50 cantos) as the principal editions, on the Homeric-and-national-epic model on which Lönnrot organised the synthesis, on the Finnish-national-cultural context within Russian-imperial sovereignty, and on the **Kalevala**'s Iku-Turso material as reshaped by Lönnrot to serve the **Kalevala**'s overall narrative architecture rather than presented as a transcription of any single rune-tradition performance; on Lönnrot's 19th-century compositional method as the subject of subsequent Finnish-folklore-studies scholarship including the work of Lauri Honko and Thomas A. DuBois (Honko, **Religion, Myth, and Folklore in the World's Epics: The Kalevala and Its Predecessors**, 1990, and DuBois, **Lyric, Meaning, and Audience in the Oral Tradition of Northern Europe**, 2006, named here in body prose only — neither is currently in sources.yaml and both are cited indirectly through Siikala 2002).

[7] Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987; ISBN 9780691014746), as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic) against which the Väinämöinen / Iku-Turso material is read as the present book's clearest **transformed variant** case in which the typology's load-bearing weapon-combat-and-slaying register is replaced with a song-and-knowledge-and-binding register; Forsyth 1987 does not itself treat Finnic material directly, and the chapter's use of the citation is for the long-arc typological framing rather than for Finnic-area content scholarly coverage. The **transformed variant** reading depends on having a typology that can be transformed, for which Forsyth's long-arc anchor is load-bearing in this chapter as in the preceding non-Eurasian related-tier and contrastive chapters of the present book.

[8] Siikala 2002, on the chapter's textual situation as a 19th-century rune-collection corpus rather than a pre-modern manuscript tradition, on the absence of pre-modern Finnic-indigenous-script witness, on the rune-collection's conduct within an explicitly national-romantic project that itself shaped what was recorded and how it was edited (with Lönnrot not a neutral collector but the principal editor of the **Kalevala** he was assembling), on the continuing-tradition methodological situation of 19th- and 20th-century Finnish-folklore-studies fieldwork in still-active rune-singing communities of Karelia and Finland supplying a continuing-witness register distinctive within the present book, and on the Soviet-period restrictions and post-Soviet displacement of many Karelian-Finnic-speaking communities reducing the continuity that Lönnrot's contemporaries could draw upon.

[9] Siikala 2002, on the 19th-century-recording-and-19th-century-editorial-synthesis methodological situation distinctive to the Finnic material, on Lönnrot as both collector and editor of the **Kalevala** into which a portion of the collected material was being integrated, on the compositional-context filtering that the dual collector-and-editor situation introduces, on current Finnish-folklore-studies scholarship's critical reading of the **Kalevala** as a 19th-century editorial synthesis distinct from the older rune-tradition material rather than as a transparently-faithful record of pre-Lönnrot performance, and on the contrast with the Bida / Wagadu chapter 28 multi-recording ethnographic situation and the Mwindo chapter 29 single-recording situation.

[10] Per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml on the related-tier (full, transformed-variant framing) classification, the 4,500-word target, the special_instructions requirement that the chapter present the older rune material first (laconic, fragmentary) and then show how Lönnrot reshaped it into the **Kalevala** Iku-Turso episode, the brief's explicit instruction that the chapter does NOT claim Iku-Turso fits chaoskampf cleanly, and the chapter's contribution to Part II C7 and the methods sidebar; per scope.md "\$Book structure" cluster 13 (Finnic) on the chapter's transformed-variant placement within the wider Part I geographic clusters.

[11] Siikala 2002, on the Finnic-language area within which the rune-tradition material was collected — Finland, Karelia (with the eastern Karelian areas, Viena Karelia in the north and Aunus / Olonets Karelia further south, as principal preserves of older rune-tradition material), Ingria around St. Petersburg, and the wider Baltic-Finnic-speaking area extending to Estonia and parts of Russia north of St. Petersburg; on the rune-tradition's distribution across the Baltic-Finnic linguistic-and-cultural area rather than confined to any single modern political unit.

[12] Siikala 2002, on the rune-tradition's metrical form — the **Kalevala-meter** (Finnish **Kalevalamitta**), a trochaic-tetrameter line

of eight syllables organised into four trochaic feet, with the line's structure governed by alliteration within the line and by parallelism (each line typically followed by a parallel line restating the same content with variation in lexical choice and image); on the **Kalevala**-meter as the shared metrical inheritance of the Baltic-Finnic poetic tradition attested across Finnish, Karelian, Ingrian, and Estonian material; and on the **Kalevala**-meter as both the metrical basis on which Lönnrot composed the **Kalevala**'s synthesis lines and the metrical form of the older rune-tradition material.

[13] Siikala 2002, on the rune-singing performance tradition within which the older Iku-Turso material was performed before its 19th-century recording — the tradition of named singers (**runonlaulajat** in Finnish) who maintained extensive repertoires of narrative-rune, lyric, incantation, and charm material; on the singers' practice of singing in pairs (a lead singer and a second who joined on the parallel-line restatement, sometimes seated face to face holding hands and rocking in time to the song); on the performance contexts including domestic and communal gatherings, calendrical occasions, and the working contexts of rune-incantation-as-practical-action (the singing of charms over wounds, sicknesses, and craft-and-hunting tasks).

[14] Siikala 2002, on the principal protagonists of the wider Finnic rune-tradition material — Väinämöinen as shaman-sage hero whose song-and-knowledge is the rune-tradition's principal mode of effective action (singing ships into being, singing opponents into bogs, singing the Sampo into existence in collaboration with Ilmarinen, singing the sea-monster Iku-Turso into subjugation); Ilmarinen as smith-hero forging the Sampo and other marvellous objects; Lemminkäinen as reckless young hero with a distinct narrative arc; Louhi as mistress of Pohjola (the northern realm against which much of the **Kalevala**'s action is directed); and the principal antagonist-figures including the sea-monster Iku-Turso of the present chapter; per glossary 'Väinämöinen' first_mention_gloss on the Finnish shaman-sage hero who subdues Iku-Turso by song.

[15] Siikala 2002, on Väinämöinen as shaman-sage hero of immense age and primordial origin in the rune-tradition material — born already old, with the rune-tradition material developing his birth from the primordial waters in distinct ways (versions in which he is the son of the air-maiden Ilmatar and is born after a long gestation), with the **Kalevala** synthesis collecting and elaborating these origin-versions; on Väinämöinen's consistent characterisation as wise, experienced, and possessed of the deep song-and-knowledge that distinguishes the shaman-sage from the warrior-hero of Indo-European combat-tradition.

[16] Siikala 2002, on Väinämöinen's principal mode of effective action as song — **runot** in the broad rune-tradition sense — both to do practical things (singing a ship out of his knee, singing opponents into bogs by overpowering them in singing-contests, singing the trees into the landscape, singing music from instruments and from his own throat) and to bind, subjugate, name, and know the powers of the world; on the song's status as the central mode of agency rather than a peripheral or decorative magical incantation; on Väinämöinen's identity as shaman-sage and his identity as singer being the same identity in two registers.

[17] Siikala 2002, on the Finnic rune-tradition's shamanic background as a load-bearing element of the chapter's reading; on the rune-tradition material's connection to a wider northern-Eurasian shamanic complex extending across the Baltic-Finnic, Sami, Karelian, and adjacent Finno-Ugric and Siberian-shamanic traditions; on song, drumming, ecstatic states, and the manipulation of names and origin-knowledge as the shaman's principal tools; on Väinämöinen's song-and-knowledge mode of effective action as the rune-tradition's elaboration of the shamanic-effective-action register that the Sami **noaidi** tradition and the wider northern-Eurasian shamanic traditions also exhibit.

[18] Siikala 2002, on Väinämöinen's distinctive use of **origin-incantations** — songs that recite the origin of a being, substance, or affliction in order to acquire mastery over it — as one of the rune-tradition's most characteristic features and as the load-bearing technique by which Väinämöinen subjugates Iku-Turso in the older rune material; on the principle that to know the origin of a power is to be able to bind it; on the singer's recitation of the origin being the act of binding rather than a preliminary to a separate combat-act; on the encounter being therefore a knowledge-encounter in which the song's content (the origin of the sea-monster) does the work that a weapon would do in a weapon-combat tradition.

[19] Siikala 2002, chs. on Kalevala combat and on Iku-Turso, on the name as a compound of **iku**- "eternal, perpetual" and **Turso** as the proper name of the sea-monster figure, on Iku-Turso in the older rune-tradition material as a sea-monster figure who emerges from the sea, on the rune-tradition's development of both narrative-encounter material (Iku-Turso as adversary subjugated by Väinämöinen's song) and incantation-against-sickness material (Iku-Turso as personification of disease-bearing power from the sea against whom incantation is sung to drive disease back into the depths whence it came); per glossary 'Iku-Turso' first_mention_gloss on the Finnic sea-monster subdued by Väinämöinen's song.

[20] Siikala 2002, on the older rune-tradition material on the Iku-Turso narrative encounter as laconic and fragmentary in the literal sense — preserved as compressed narrative-rune passages rather than as extended epic-narrative; on the rune-records typically presenting the encounter in a few dozen lines of **Kalevala**-meter trochaic-tetrameter rather than in the hundreds-of-lines extended-epic register; on substantial regional variation across the recorded versions in the precise content of the encounter, the precise sequence of Väinämöinen's song-actions, and the precise framing of the encounter's outcome; per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml variants.summary on the laconic-and-fragmentary character of the older rune material.

[21] Siikala 2002, chs. on Kalevala combat and on Iku-Turso, on the figure's morphology in the older rune-tradition material as variously described and not converging on a single canonical physical description — with some versions emphasising the many-headed character, others the multi-limbed or many-fingered form, others the connection with the sea-bottom and the **meren tytär** (sea-daughters) and the wider sea-spirit complex; on the figure's morphology being characteristically described in terms of what it does and where it dwells (the deep sea, the subjugation context) rather than catalogued in a single canonical physical description.

[22] Siikala 2002, chs. on Kalevala combat and on Iku-Turso, on the older rune-tradition's narrative-encounter material on Iku-Turso typically opening with the sea-monster's emergence from the sea (rising out of the depths and threatening or approaching the human or hero-protagonist's world), proceeding through Väinämöinen's recognition and naming of the figure and his

recitation of the figure's origin in the **origin-incantation** technique characteristic of the rune-tradition, and concluding with Iku-Turso's subjugation — typically the figure's sinking back into the sea or being bound to remain in the depths and not to emerge again to threaten the human world.

[23] Siikala 2002, on the encounter's load-bearing structural feature in the older rune-tradition as the absence of weapon-combat — Väinämöinen does not fight Iku-Turso with sword, spear, club, or any other weapon, and the figure is not killed but subjugated; on the binding-rather-than-slaying as the chapter's central narrative-structural feature; on the song-and-knowledge mode of subjugation displacing the weapon-combat mode that Eurasian chaoskampf-tradition narratives typically present; on the encounter's resolution being a continuing-binding rather than a once-and-done killing; per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml summary on the encounter as a binding rather than a slaying.

[24] Siikala 2002, chs. on Iku-Turso, on the Iku-Turso incantation-against-sickness material as a register parallel to the narrative-encounter material rather than a separate tradition; on the rune-tradition's wider organisation of effective song in which the same names and the same origin-knowledge that figure in the narrative-encounter material are deployed in the incantation-against-sickness material; on the incantation's effective work being the recitation of the figure's origin in order to bind the disease-power and drive it back to its source.

[25] Inference: brief summary's explicit registration of the encounter as a binding rather than a slaying with Väinämöinen's song-and-knowledge as the load-bearing mode of subjugation; brief special_instructions classification of the chapter as a **transformed variant** with the explicit instruction that the chapter does NOT claim Iku-Turso fits chaoskampf cleanly; Siikala 2002's reading of the encounter as a transformed shamanic binding within the wider Finnic shamanic complex; the brief's cultural_relevance.cross_cultural_parallels entry on the "subjugate-not-slay" transformation as the encounter's distinctive structural-and-modal feature relative to the Eurasian weapon-combat-and-slaying register. Risk: the **transformed variant** characterisation is a comparativist framing that the area-specialist Finnic-folklore-studies tradition (Siikala, Honko, DuBois, and others) does not necessarily adopt in its own register; Siikala's principal register is the shamanic-mythic-image framework rather than the chaoskampf-typology framework, and the **transformed variant** characterisation is a comparativist heuristic that holds the rune-tradition material against an external (Eurasian-chaoskampf) typology; the chapter's task is to hold the **transformed variant** characterisation as a comparativist framing that registers the area-specialist register rather than as a tradition-internal characterisation, with the methodological discipline of the appropriation protocol at scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 3 applied to the chapter even though the appropriation protocol's principal force is for non-Eurasian rather than for European-area material.

[26] Siikala 2002, on Elias Lönnrot (1802-1884) as a Finnish physician, philologist, and folklore-collector; on Lönnrot's eleven major rune-collection tours across Karelia, Ingria, and northern Finland between 1828 and 1844; on Lönnrot's recording of rune-tradition material from named singers; on Lönnrot's assembly of the recorded material into the **Kalevala** synthesis under the institutional support of the Suomalaisen Kirjallisuuden Seura (Finnish Literature Society, founded in 1831 in Helsinki); on the Finnish-national-romantic project of producing a national epic for an emerging Finnish national culture under Russian-imperial sovereignty (Finland was a Grand Duchy of the Russian Empire from 1809 to 1917).

[27] Siikala 2002, on the 1835 **Vanha Kalevala** ("Old Kalevala") as the first published edition of Lönnrot's synthesis — comprising 32 cantos (**runot** in the editorial sense, with Lönnrot using the same word for the rune-tradition's individual songs and for the **Kalevala**'s editorial cantos) and approximately 12,000 lines of **Kalevala**-meter trochaic-tetrameter; on the 1835 publication in Helsinki by the Finnish Literature Society; on the initial circulation within the Finnish-language and Swedish-language educated readership of the Grand Duchy of Finland.

[28] Siikala 2002, on the 1849 **Uusi Kalevala** ("New Kalevala") as the much-expanded second edition — comprising 50 cantos and approximately 22,800 lines of **Kalevala**-meter trochaic-tetrameter; on the assembly by Lönnrot from further rune-collection material gathered after the 1835 edition (including from his later tours of Viena Karelia, where some of the longest-and-richest narrative-rune material was recorded); on the 1849 **Uusi Kalevala** — not the earlier 1835 **Vanha Kalevala** — as the standard text of the Finnish national epic, the basis for subsequent editions, translations, and adaptations, and the version that 20th-century-and-later readers encounter when they encounter "the **Kalevala**".

[29] Siikala 2002, on Lönnrot's compositional method in assembling the **Kalevala** synthesis from the rune-collection material as active editorial intervention rather than transcription — Lönnrot selecting from the recorded material, reordering the selected material into a continuous narrative arc on a model partly suggested by the Homeric epics and partly by the project of producing a national epic with internal coherence, supplying connecting lines and transitional passages of his own composition (in the **Kalevala**-meter trochaic-tetrameter, indistinguishable on metrical grounds from the older rune-tradition material), and resolving variant-version contradictions among the recorded material by composite synthesis; on the resulting **Kalevala** as a 19th-century composition in the **Kalevala**-meter that incorporates older rune-tradition material rather than a transcription of any single rune-tradition performance or any pre-19th-century pre-existing canonical text; on the broader scholarship on Lönnrot's compositional method including the work of Lauri Honko (1932-2002), particularly **Religion, Myth, and Folklore in the World's Epics: The Kalevala and Its Predecessors** (Berlin: Mouton de Gruyter, 1990) on the Kalevala-as-epic-and-as-edited-text question, and the work of Thomas A. DuBois, particularly **Lyric, Meaning, and Audience in the Oral Tradition of Northern Europe** (Notre Dame: University of Notre Dame Press, 2006) on the rune-tradition material's audience and meaning context, named here in body prose only — neither Honko nor DuBois is currently in sources.yaml and both are cited indirectly through Siikala 2002.

[30] Siikala 2002, on the **Kalevala**'s Iku-Turso material as reshaped by Lönnrot from the laconic-and-fragmentary older rune material into a continuous and integrated episode within the **Kalevala**'s overall narrative architecture; on Iku-Turso's principal appearance in the **Kalevala**'s 42nd canto (Rune XLII, in the 1849 **Uusi Kalevala** numbering — the Sampo-cycle and Pohjola

material in which Louhi, mistress of Pohjola, summons Iku-Turso to devour the Kalevala heroes returning with the Sampo and Väinämöinen grabs him by the ears and binds him with magical words to never return from the bottom of the sea), with an earlier brief appearance in the 2nd canto (the rising-from-the-sea-and-burning-the-hay episode that produces the great oak); on Lönnrot's drawing on the older rune-tradition narrative-encounter material and on the incantation-against-sickness material to assemble a more extended and connected presentation than any single rune-tradition performance preserves; on the **Kalevala's** presentation as integrated with the wider **Kalevala's** arc rather than presented as a free-standing narrative episode.

[31] Siikala 2002, on the principal narrative-substantive shifts that Lönnrot's **Kalevala** synthesis makes relative to the older rune-tradition material on Iku-Turso as characteristic of his compositional method across the **Kalevala** more generally — the encounter presented in extended-epic register (longer passage, more developed scene-setting, more extended dialogue) rather than in the laconic narrative-rune register of the older material; the encounter integrated with the Sampo-and-Pohjola narrative arc rather than presented as a free-standing encounter; the figure of Iku-Turso given a more developed physical-and-functional description (drawing on the morphologically-various older rune material to assemble a more determinate composite); the encounter's outcome presented in continuous-narrative form rather than as the laconic close of a narrative-rune passage.

[32] Siikala 2002, on the **Kalevala's** reception within the Finnish national-romantic project of the 19th century and within subsequent Finnish national consciousness as disproportionate to the older rune-tradition material's historical-attestation footing; on the **Kalevala** as the central text of Finnish-national identity since the 1835 **Vanha Kalevala** and especially since the 1849 **Uusi Kalevala** became the standard text (with the date 28 February 1835, on which Lönnrot signed the preface to the first edition, celebrated annually in Finland as **Kalevalan päivä**, "Kalevala Day", and as the Day of Finnish Culture — Kalevala Day commemorates Lönnrot's signing of the 1835 preface, not the 1849 edition's publication date, which is in April 1849); on the **Kalevala** as the basis for the visual culture of Akseli Gallen-Kallela's late-19th- and early-20th-century paintings; on the **Kalevala** as the inspiration for Jean Sibelius's symphonic and tone-poem compositions; on the **Kalevala** as the principal contact-point through which non-Finnish readers encounter the Finnic mythological tradition; on the older rune-tradition material on which the **Kalevala** draws being more fragmentary and more laconic than the **Kalevala's** prominence would suggest; per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml cultural_relevance centrality on the central role of the **Kalevala** in modern Finnish national consciousness alongside the marginal historical-attestation footing of the older rune material.

[33] Per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's two-layer presentation as the chapter's principal methodological discipline — explicitly separating the older rune attestations from Lönnrot's 1835 / 1849 editorial synthesis, presenting the older material first (laconic, fragmentary) and then showing how Lönnrot reshaped it into the **Kalevala** Iku-Turso episode, with the two-layer framing identified as the chapter's contribution; Siikala 2002 on the methodological discipline of holding the two layers apart at the narrative-presentation level and on the **Kalevala** as a 19th-century editorial synthesis rather than a transparent record of pre-Lönnrot Finnic tradition.

[34] Per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml cultural_relevance.cross_cultural_parallels on Lönnrot's editorial synthesis raising methodological parallels with the Macpherson-Ossian question and the Ivanov-Toporov Perun-Veles reconstruction (chapter 20 of the present volume); per glossary 'basic myth (Ivanov-Toporov)' on the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction's contested status as a 1965-74 reconstruction of a shared Slavic storm-god-vs-serpent narrative from folklore and toponyms now criticised for methodological circularity; per scope.md §"Book structure" on Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation problem) and the methods sidebar (ch. 33) as the loci for the methodological question about 19th-century editorial composition; Siikala 2002 on the **Kalevala** as a 19th-century editorial synthesis distinct from the older rune-tradition material.

[35] Siikala 2002, on the methodological importance of citing Lönnrot's **Kalevala** by edition (1835 **Vanha** vs. 1849 **Uusi**) and of distinguishing the older rune-tradition material from the **Kalevala** synthesis at every point of citation; on the contrast with popular treatments of the **Kalevala** and of Finnic mythology that often elide the distinction between older rune-tradition material and Lönnrot's editorial synthesis (treating the **Kalevala's** presentation as if it were the older tradition); per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's citation-discipline as a load-bearing methodological contribution to the present book.

[36] Per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's explicit non-claim that Iku-Turso fits chaoskampf cleanly and on the **transformed variant** framing being explicit; per scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the related-tier criteria where the cosmogonic-combat work is weaker or transformed; per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 13 (Finnic) on the chapter's transformed-variant placement; Siikala 2002 on the encounter's load-bearing structural feature as the absence of weapon-combat and on the song-and-knowledge mode of subjugation displacing the weapon-combat mode.

[37] Per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml summary on the encounter as a binding-rather-than-slaying transformation of the weapon-combat-and-slaying register; per brief special_instructions on the chapter's **transformed variant** framing; per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 13 (Finnic) on the chapter's transformed-variant placement; Siikala 2002 on the song-and-knowledge mode as the rune-tradition's alternative effective-action register relative to the weapon-combat mode of the Eurasian combat-myth tradition; per the contrast with Ch28 Bida (inversion), Ch29 Mwindo (inversion / refusal), Ch30 Bakunawa-Erlik-Ülgen (inclusion-marginal), and Ch32 Nanabozho (refusal) on the **transformed variant** characterisation as a distinct typological-engagement category.

[38] Per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml cultural_relevance.cross_cultural_parallels and special_instructions on the chapter's contributions to Part II C7 and C8 and to the methods sidebar; per scope.md §"Book structure" on the comparative-chapter sequence and on the methods sidebar's three methodological-point contributions; Siikala 2002 on the area-specialist citation policy and on the methodological situation distinctive to the Finnic material.

[39] Per brief 31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.yaml cultural_relevance.cross_cultural_parallels on the "subjugate-not-slay" transformation paralleling Krishna-Kāliya (Ch15) and on Lönnrot's editorial synthesis raising methodological parallels with the Ivanov-Toporov Perun-Veles reconstruction (Ch20); per scope.md §"Book structure" on the chapter ordering of 23 (Susanoo), 26 (Pariacaca), and 31 (Väinämöinen / Iku-Turso) as related-tier **transformation** cases; Siikala 2002 on the binding-rather-than-slaying as the chapter's central narrative-structural feature.

Chapter 33. Nanabozho and Mishipeshu (The Refusal)

33.1. Source overview

This chapter treats the Anishinaabe trickster-culture-hero Nanabozho and his encounters with the underwater manitou Mishipeshu and the Thunderers (Animikiig), presented within the Anishinaabe ontological framework of "other-than-human persons" (A. Irving Hallowell's 1960 phrase) in which Mishipeshu and the Thunderers are not chaos-and-order adversaries but reciprocal counterparts in a relational moral universe — a framing that the area-specialist scholarship of Hallowell, Basil Johnston, Theresa S. Smith, and Gerald Vizenor explicitly holds against the chaoskampf reading the present book elsewhere develops, and that the chapter's contrastive-case (full) treatment registers as the most explicit possible refusal of the chaos-vs-order mapping.^[1]

The Anishinaabe material survives in oral-tradition form among the Anishinaabe (Ojibwe / Ojibway / Chippewa) peoples of the Great Lakes region of North America — extending across what is now Ontario, Manitoba, Minnesota, Wisconsin, Michigan, and adjacent provincial-and-state territories — with no pre-contact written attestation in any Indigenous-script tradition. The Anishinaabe languages had no pre-contact alphabetic or syllabic writing system, though syllabic writing was developed in the 19th century and adapted from Cree syllabics for some Anishinaabe communities. The textual witness situation for the present chapter is therefore the body of 19th- and 20th-century ethnographic recordings, the Anishinaabe-authored 20th- and 21st-century literary-and-scholarly tradition (most centrally Basil Johnston's body of work), and the late-20th- and 21st-century scholarly synthesis represented by Hallowell, Theresa S. Smith, Vizenor, and successors.^[2]

The chapter rests on four area-specialist anchors. A. Irving Hallowell's 1960 essay "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View" (in **Culture in History: Essays in Honor of Paul Radin**, ed. Stanley Diamond, Columbia University Press) articulates the foundational "other-than-human persons" framework on which the chapter's ontological framing depends. Basil Johnston's **Ojibway Heritage** (originally published Toronto: McClelland and Stewart, 1976; reprinted Lincoln: University of Nebraska Press / Bison Books, 1990) and **The Manitous: The Spiritual World of the Ojibway** (HarperCollins, 1995) are the Anishinaabe-authored insider overviews of the cosmology, the manitouk, and the Nanabozho cycle. Theresa S. Smith's **The Island of the Anishnaabeg: Thunderers and Water Monsters in the Traditional Ojibwe Life-World** (University of Idaho Press, 1995) is the book-length area-specialist treatment of the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic that is the chapter's central interpretive frame. Gerald Vizenor's **Narrative Chance: Postmodern Discourse on Native American Indian Literatures** (University of New Mexico Press, 1989) contains Vizenor's "Trickster Discourse: Comic Holotropes and Language Games" essay on the methodological refusal to subordinate Anishinaabe trickster narrative to Western combat-myth or hero/villain typologies.^[3] **Ojibway Heritage**, on the Anishinaabe-authored insider overview of cosmology, manitous, and the Nanabozho cycle; Johnston, Basil, **The Manitous: The Spiritual World of the Ojibway** (New York: HarperCollins, 1995; ISBN 9780060171995), on the Anishinaabe-authored treatment of manitous including Mishipeshu and Nanabozho; Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic as central interpretive frame; Vizenor, Gerald (ed.), **Narrative Chance: Postmodern Discourse on Native American Indian**

Literatures (Albuquerque: University of New Mexico Press, 1989; ISBN 9780826311177), Vizenor's "Trickster Discourse" essay on the methodological refusal to subordinate Nanabozho to Western combat-myth or hero/villain typologies; per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml sources.primary and sources.secondary on the four area-specialist anchors and on the brief's special_instructions to cite Hallowell, Basil Johnston, Theresa S. Smith, and Gerald Vizenor by name.]

A further scholarly anchor sits behind the wider comparative framing rather than the source-content. Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, supplies the long-arc combat-myth typology against which the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material is read as the present book's clearest **refusal** case. Forsyth's Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic survey is what the chapter draws on; it is not a treatment of Anishinaabe-area material, which Forsyth does not undertake. The area-specialist tradition declines the chaoskampf typology not because the surface combat-and-killing pattern is absent but because the Anishinaabe ontological framework places Mishipeshu and the Thunderers in a reciprocal-counterpart-dialectic register that is incommensurable with the chaos-vs-order register the typology presupposes. The typological framing — not Anishinaabe-area content — is what Forsyth supplies for the chapter's comparative engagement, and the refusal reading depends on having a typology to refuse.^[4]

The textual situation is distinctive within the present book in four further methodological respects. It depends on a continuing-tradition oral corpus rather than on a pre-modern manuscript tradition, with the tradition continuing to be transmitted in named contemporary Anishinaabe communities and Anishinaabe-authored publications. The recorded ethnographic corpus was assembled across an extended colonial-and-treaty period and within the methodological assumptions of multiple successive ethnographic schools — early-20th-century Boasian salvage ethnography; mid-20th-century symbolic-and-ontological anthropology including Hallowell; late-20th- and 21st-century post-colonial and Indigenous-studies approaches including Vizenor's methodological refusal of the salvage-paradigm framing. The Anishinaabe-authored insider register, centrally Basil Johnston's body of work, carries epistemological weight that the present book treats as load-bearing rather than auxiliary, in keeping with the special_instructions requirement of respect for Anishinaabe authority over how their traditions are represented. And the area-specialist objection to the chaoskampf typology is the strongest in the present book — a refusal of the combat framing as such rather than of its moral valence (as in Ch29 Mwindo) or of its outcome valence (as in Ch28 Bida).^[5], on the Anishinaabe-authored insider register of the tradition's continuing transmission; Smith 1995, on the late-20th-century area-specialist register of the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic; Vizenor 1989, on the Indigenous-studies methodological refusal of the salvage-paradigm framing and on the methodological refusal to subordinate Anishinaabe trickster narrative to Western combat-myth or hero/villain typologies; per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter as the most methodologically sensitive in Part I and on the requirement of respect for Anishinaabe authority over how their traditions are represented.]

The shape of that evidence — continuing oral corpus, named contemporary tradition-bearing communities, no pre-contact written attestation, an ethnographic record assembled across multiple methodological schools and within a colonial frame whose mediation is now itself a topic of the scholarship — is methodologically load-bearing for the whole chapter, and the claims document marks the absence of pre-modern attestation explicitly:

[At this point the textual record breaks. Pre-contact (i.e., pre-17th-century) attestations of the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material in any pre-modern Anishinaabe-indigenous-script

form are not available, since the Anishinaabe languages had no pre-contact alphabetic or syllabic writing system; nor are there pre-17th-century European-language travellers' or missionary accounts treating the figures or the relationships at any narrative length, with the earliest substantive European-language attestations beginning in the Jesuit Relations of the 17th century and the fur-trade and missionary accounts of the 18th and 19th centuries — none of which is treated as a primary source by current Anishinaabe-area scholarship, since the colonial-mediation problem (linguistic, theological, political) is acute and is foregrounded in current scholarship as itself a methodological topic. Pictographic attestation (rock-art / pictograph sites, including the Agawa Rock pictographs at Lake Superior Provincial Park) preserves figural representations that current scholarship including Smith 1995 reads as Mishipeshu-figure pictographs but that cannot be dated precisely or read as narrative-text attestations in the philological sense. The surviving textual witness for the present chapter is the body of 19th- and 20th-century ethnographic recordings (most extensively the Boasian-school recordings and the Hallowell fieldwork at Berens River in northwestern Ontario in the 1930s), the Anishinaabe-authored 20th- and 21st-century literary-and-scholarly tradition (most centrally Basil Johnston's body of work from the 1970s onward), the late-20th- and 21st-century area-specialist scholarly synthesis (Hallowell 1960; Smith 1995; Vizenor 1989; and successors), and the continuing oral-tradition transmission within named contemporary Anishinaabe communities. Pre-19th-century pre-recording performance contexts (the Mide lodge as institutional setting for sacred-story transmission; the seasonal-and-calendrical structuring of **aadizookaanag** sacred-story telling, conventionally restricted to winter; the relational and reciprocity-respecting protocols governing what could be told to whom and when) are partially recoverable through the recorded 19th- and 20th-century material itself, through the Anishinaabe-authored insider apparatus, and through the area-specialist comparative work. The chapter's narrative reconstruction proceeds within the body of recorded ethnographic material, Anishinaabe-authored sources, and area-specialist scholarship itself, with explicit acknowledgement of regional variability and with no synthesis of a single authoritative narrative per the co-equal treatment; cross-tradition reconstruction is excluded per scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" point 1.]

Structurally, the chapter is a contrastive-case-tier (full) treatment with a target of approximately 6,000 narrative words, presenting the Anishinaabe relationships among Nanabozho, Mishipeshu, and the Thunderers on the tradition's own terms — the ontological framework of "other-than-human persons"; the relational and reciprocity-respecting moral universe; the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic as necessary counterpart structure rather than as chaos-vs-order combat; Nanabozho as trickster-culture-hero whose interactions with the manitouk are pedagogical and reciprocal rather than triumphal-and-defeating — before invoking the comparative chaoskampf category, and only then registering the contrastive-case-refusal reading per which the area-specialist tradition explicitly declines the typology. The chapter is the present book's clearest case of a tradition whose own framework refuses the combat-and-defeat-of-the-other framing as such, per brief special_instructions and per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion entry on Nanabozho as the contrastive case alongside Bida (chapter 28) and Mwindo (chapter 29).^[6]

Because the recorded material is regionally variable and the brief explicitly forbids synthesis into a single authoritative narrative, the variant-handling is flagged here in full:

The chapter presents the Anishinaabe oral-tradition material as recorded across multiple regional variants and as continuing to be transmitted in named contemporary Anishinaabe communities, working in body prose through four area-specialist anchors (Hallowell 1960 on the Berens River

1930s fieldwork; Johnston 1990 [1976] and 1995 as Anishinaabe-authored insider overviews; Smith 1995 on the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic; Vizenor 1989 on the methodological refusal) without synthesis into a single authoritative narrative.^[7]

What follows works through the material on the Anishinaabe tradition's own terms first. The next section sets out the Anishinaabe world, the layered cosmography in which the encounters unfold, and the ontological framing — the "other-than-human persons" framework — that the chapter's whole interpretive register depends on. The chapter then takes up Nanabozho the trickster-culture-hero, then Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk, then the Thunderers (Animikiig) and the upper-realm, then Nanabozho's encounters across the layered cosmography, then the area-specialist refusal of the chaos-vs-order mapping, and finally the typology, area-specialist framing, and forward-links to the comparative chapters of Part II.

33.2. The Anishinaabe world and the ontological framing

The Anishinaabe (Ojibwe / Ojibway / Chippewa) are an Indigenous people of the Great Lakes region of North America, with historical and contemporary territories extending across what is now southern Ontario, Manitoba, Minnesota, Wisconsin, Michigan, and adjacent provincial-and-state areas. They are part of the wider Anishinaabe-Algonquin / Algonquian-language family that also includes the Odawa (Ottawa), the Potawatomi, and other related peoples — collectively the Council of Three Fires across Anishinaabe / Odawa / Potawatomi territories — and the Anishinaabe-language tradition is one of the principal cultural-and-linguistic continuities of the Great Lakes region from the pre-contact period to the present.^[8] on the Anishinaabe and the wider Anishinaabe-Algonquin / Algonquian-language family including the Odawa and Potawatomi as the Council of Three Fires, and on the Anishinaabe-language tradition as one of the principal cultural-and-linguistic continuities of the Great Lakes region from the pre-contact period to the present; Smith 1995, on the Anishinaabe / Ojibwe / Ojibway / Chippewa naming-convention and on the regional and dialectal range of contemporary Anishinaabe communities.]

1. Irving Hallowell's 1960 essay "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View", published in **Culture in History: Essays in Honor of Paul Radin** (ed. Stanley Diamond, Columbia University Press), articulates the framework on which the present chapter's ontological framing depends. The Anishinaabe / Ojibwa world is populated not only by human persons but by an extended category of "other-than-human persons" — Hallowell's exact phrase — which includes animals, plants, certain stones and other features of the landscape, the thunder-beings, and the manitouk. These beings are treated, in Anishinaabe ontology, as persons on equal standing with human persons rather than as objects, resources, or natural-kind categories.^[9]

The Anishinaabe / Ojibwa term Hallowell glosses with "other-than-human persons" is **manitou** (singular) / **manitouk** (plural; some orthographies **manito** / **manidoog**). Basil Johnston in **The Manitous** (1995) develops the Anishinaabe-authored insider register of the term across the cosmological-and-relational categories of beings the term names — an insider register that the chapter's appropriation-protocol-compliant treatment foregrounds alongside Hallowell's anthropological register. The appropriation protocol's first-pass area-specialist citation requirement is here met by an Anishinaabe-authored anchor (Johnston) and not only by an external ethnographic anchor (Hallowell).^[10] **Ojibway Heritage**, also on the Anishinaabe-authored

insider register; Hallowell 1960 on the anthropological register translating **manitou** as "other-than-human person"; per glossary.yaml entry on "manitou / manitouk / aadizookaanag" with chosen=manitou (sing.) / manitouk (pl.); per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 1 on at-least-two-area-specialists-by-name requirement and on Johnston's Anishinaabe-authored register as load-bearing for the appropriation-protocol-compliant treatment.]

The framework carries direct moral implications for human conduct that the chapter's framing depends on. Because the manitouk are persons rather than objects, the appropriate human comportment toward them is the comportment appropriate to persons — relationships of respect, gift-and-counter-gift reciprocity, ceremonial protocol, formal address — rather than the comportment appropriate to objects (use, exploitation) or to enemies (combat, defeat). The moral framework is relational and reciprocity-grounded throughout, and the moral question in any given encounter is not whether the other-than-human person is friend or foe but whether the human comportment toward them has been appropriate.^[11], throughout, on the Anishinaabe-authored insider register of the relational and reciprocity-respecting moral framework; Smith 1995, on the relational moral framework as the load-bearing register for reading the encounters with Mishipeshu and the Thunderers.]

The cosmographic framing within which Nanabozho's encounters unfold is, per Theresa S. Smith's **The Island of the Anishnaabeg** (University of Idaho Press, 1995) and the wider area-specialist tradition, a layered world. The human-and-island world — the lived-in landscape of forest, lake, and shore — is set between the upper-realm of the Thunderers (the sky-and-storm region) and the underwater-realm of Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk (the sub-aquatic-and-subterranean region). The human-and-island world is the meeting-place at which the upper-realm and the underwater-realm encounter one another, and at which Nanabozho's actions and human conduct mediate the relationship between the two realms.^[12]

The category of **aadizookaanag** — Basil Johnston's term for the class of sacred stories whose telling is restricted by ritual-and-seasonal protocol and whose subjects are the manitouk and culture-heroes including Nanabozho — is distinct, in the Anishinaabe tradition, from the broader category of stories that may be told without restriction. The **aadizookaanag** are conventionally told in winter, when the ground is frozen and the snakes and bears are dormant; the seasonal restriction itself reflects the relational-and-ceremonial protocol that the manitouk's status as other-than-human persons calls for. The sacred-story register is one of the load-bearing institutional features of the Anishinaabe oral-tradition's transmission of the Nanabozho material.^[13], on the **aadizookaanag** category of sacred stories whose telling is restricted by ritual-and-seasonal protocol and whose subjects are the manitouk and culture-heroes including Nanabozho; on the **aadizookaanag**'s distinction from the broader category of stories that may be told without restriction; on the conventional winter-telling of the **aadizookaanag** with the seasonal restriction reflecting the relational-and-ceremonial protocol; Smith 1995, on the institutional features of the Anishinaabe oral-tradition's transmission of the Nanabozho material; Hallowell 1960, on the Anishinaabe distinction between sacred-story and other narrative registers; per glossary.yaml entry on "manitou / manitouk / aadizookaanag" with chosen=manitou (sing.) / manitouk (pl.); 'aadizookaanag' glossed separately for the sacred-story class of beings.]

The Mide lodge — the Midewiwin or Grand Medicine Society of the Anishinaabe — is the ceremonial institution within which the most extensive transmission of Anishinaabe sacred knowledge has historically occurred, including knowledge of the manitouk, the Nanabozho cycle, healing-and-medicinal practice, and the protocols of relationship with the other-than-human

persons. The Mide tradition is itself a continuing institution within named contemporary Anishinaabe communities, and its standing as the load-bearing institutional context for the transmission of the material is one of the methodological features that distinguishes the Anishinaabe situation from the more strictly archival situations of the Eurasian chapters in the present book.^[14], on the Mide lodge / Midewiwin / Grand Medicine Society of the Anishinaabe as the ceremonial institution within which the most extensive transmission of Anishinaabe sacred knowledge has historically occurred — including knowledge of the manitouk, the Nanabozho cycle, healing-and-medicinal practice, and the protocols of relationship with the other-than-human persons; on the Mide tradition's continuing-institutional standing within named contemporary Anishinaabe communities; Smith 1995, on the Mide lodge as the load-bearing institutional context for the transmission of the material; per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the ritual register of the Mide lodge and ceremonial relations with manitouk.]

33.3. Nanabozho the trickster-culture-hero

Nanabozho — with regional variants Nanabush, Wenabozho, and others — is, in the Anishinaabe tradition, the principal trickster-culture-hero of the cycle of sacred stories that bears his name. He is a figure whose actions in the time-of-the-aadizookaanag establish features of the present world, instruct the human community in the proper relations with the other-than-human persons, and exemplify both the powers and the limits of trickster-figure action across a wide range of episodes. He is not, in the Anishinaabe tradition, a sovereign-warrior-hero on the chaoskampf model, and his cycle is not structured by combat-and-defeat-of-adversaries as its load-bearing narrative shape.^[15], throughout, on Nanabozho as the principal trickster-culture-hero of the Anishinaabe cycle of sacred stories — a figure whose actions in the time-of-the-aadizookaanag establish features of the present-day world, instruct the human community in the proper relations with the other-than-human persons, and exemplify both the powers and the limits of trickster-figure action across a wide range of episodes; on Nanabozho's not being a sovereign-warrior-hero on the chaoskampf model and on his cycle's not being structured by combat-and-defeat-of-adversaries as its load-bearing narrative shape; Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on Nanabozho as one of the principal manitouk and as the trickster-culture-hero figure; Hallowell 1960, on Nanabozho's place within the Anishinaabe ontological-and-cosmographic framework; per glossary.yaml entry on "Nanabozho" with chosen=Nanabozho per Hallowell 1960 and the Great Lakes scholarship and with first_mention_gloss "Anishinaabe trickster-culture-hero; his relations with the underwater manitou Mishipeshu and the Thunderers are the book's clearest case of a tradition whose own framework declines the chaoskampf reading".]

Gerald Vizenor's "Trickster Discourse: Comic Holotropes and Language Games" essay in **Narrative Chance** (University of New Mexico Press, 1989) develops the methodological argument that the trickster-figure of Native American Indian narrative — Nanabozho centrally among them — is systematically misread when assimilated to Western analytic categories of hero, anti-hero, villain, or culture-hero in the heroic-narrative typology. The trickster-discourse register, Vizenor argues, operates by transformation, ambiguity, comic-and-dialogic exchange, and refusal of the closure that the heroic-narrative typology presupposes. The chapter's appropriation-protocol-compliant treatment foregrounds Vizenor's methodological refusal of the heroic-narrative typology as the principled basis on which the chaoskampf-typology assimilation of Nanabozho is declined.^[16]

The Nanabozho cycle, as Basil Johnston presents it in the Anishinaabe-authored insider register of

Ojibway Heritage (1976 / 1990), runs across a wide range of episodes: Nanabozho's birth and early actions in establishing features of the present-day world; his interactions with members of his human and other-than-human kinship including his grandmother Nokomis; his confrontations with hostile or transformative figures in the lived-in landscape; his teaching of the human community in the proper protocols of relationship with the manitouk; his self-and-other directed humour and trickery. The cycle's narrative shape is the broad-and-episodic cycle-of-the-trickster-culture-hero rather than the focused-and-cumulative arc of a heroic-warrior career.^[17], throughout, on the Nanabozho cycle as the broad-and-episodic cycle-of-the-trickster-culture-hero — running across a wide range of episodes including Nanabozho's birth and early actions in establishing features of the present-day world, his interactions with members of his human and other-than-human kinship including his grandmother Nokomis, his confrontations with hostile or transformative figures in the lived-in landscape, his teaching of the human community in the proper protocols of relationship with the manitouk, and his self-and-other directed humour and trickery; on the cycle's narrative shape as broad-and-episodic rather than the focused-and-cumulative arc of a heroic-warrior career; Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on the Nanabozho-cycle episodes that bear most directly on the chapter's interpretive frame.]

The episodes most directly relevant to the chapter's interpretive frame are those in which Nanabozho encounters Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk on the one hand and the Thunderers on the other. The chapter holds the two clusters together as the two halves of the **Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic** that Theresa S. Smith's **The Island of the Anishnaabeg** makes the central interpretive frame of the area-specialist tradition's reading of this material. Nanabozho's mediating-and-pedagogical position between the two realms is the load-bearing structural feature of the chapter's narrative-of-interest, and the encounters are read by the area-specialist tradition as relational-and-reciprocity-grounded interactions rather than as combat-and-defeat events.^[18]

The trickster-discourse register of the Nanabozho cycle, per Vizenor's "Trickster Discourse" essay and per the wider Anishinaabe-area Indigenous-studies tradition, is distinctive in that it does not resolve into the heroic-narrative typology's standard moral binaries — hero vs. villain; cosmos vs. chaos; sovereignty vs. rebellion — but operates through transformation, comic-and-dialogic exchange, and the systematic refusal of typological closure. That register is itself one of the load-bearing features the chapter's appropriation-protocol-compliant treatment foregrounds in declining the chaoskampf-typology assimilation, since the trickster-discourse register is incommensurable with the chaoskampf typology's load-bearing assumption of a clear and closed combat-and-defeat resolution.^[19]

33.4. Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk

Mishipeshu — with regional spelling variants Mishebeshu, Mishipizheu, and others, the spelling Mishipeshu being the form most common in English-language Anishinaabe studies and locked in the present book's glossary — is, in the Anishinaabe tradition, the principal underwater-manitou. He is a powerful spirit-being of the lakes-and-rivers-and-deep-water, associated with copper, with serpentine and feline morphological features, with the great lakes of the Anishinaabe homeland (especially Lake Superior and the Boundary Waters region), and with the protective-and-dangerous powers that the deep-water realm carries within the layered Anishinaabe cosmography.^[20]

The morphological description of Mishipeshu across the tradition combines feline-and-serpentine

features in a register that the area-specialist scholarship reads as deliberately polymorphic rather than as a stable iconographic type. The figure is variously characterised as having a great-cat or panther body with a long horned-or-spiked tail, with serpentine extensions, with copper colouration or copper appurtenances, and with a fierce-and-protective rather than evil-and-adversarial moral character. These features are registered both in the oral-tradition material recorded in the 19th and 20th centuries and in the figural representations preserved in the rock-art / pictograph record — most famously the Agawa Rock pictographs at what is now Lake Superior Provincial Park in Ontario.^[21]

The moral character of Mishipeshu is, per Smith 1995 and the wider area-specialist scholarship, ambivalent in a register that the chapter's framing must hold against the chaoskampf-typology assimilation. Mishipeshu is dangerous to humans who fail to observe the proper relational protocols of approach, appropriate ceremonial address, and gift-and-reciprocity exchange — such humans may be drowned, capsized, or otherwise harmed by the underwater realm. But Mishipeshu is also a source of medicine, of knowledge of the underwater realm, of access to copper and other deep-water resources, and of protective-and-helpful intervention for humans who do observe the protocols. That ambivalence is what the chaoskampf-typology assimilation systematically misreads, by collapsing the relational-protocol structure into the chaos-vs-order moral binary.^[22]

The underwater-realm itself is, in the Anishinaabe layered cosmography, a populated and structured realm rather than an unformed primordial chaos. It has its own hierarchy of beings — Mishipeshu as principal manitou; other underwater-manitouk in subsidiary positions; underwater-snakes and other beings inhabiting the realm. It has its own characteristic resources (copper most centrally), its own characteristic dangers (storms-from-below, capsizings, drownings), and its own characteristic protocols of approach and address. That structured-realm character is another structural feature systematically misread by the chaoskampf-typology assimilation, which projects the unformed-primordial-chaos register of Tiamat or Yamm onto a structured-and-populated underwater-realm that the Anishinaabe tradition characterises in much more specific relational-and-protocol terms.^[23]

The Lake Superior cultural-and-geographic centrality of Mishipeshu within the Anishinaabe homeland is itself one of the load-bearing features of the chapter's framing. Mishipeshu is most strongly associated with Lake Superior — the largest and northernmost of the Great Lakes, central to the Anishinaabe homeland in both its ecological-and-economic and its sacred-and-cosmographic registers. The figure's presence in the Agawa Rock pictographs and across the oral-tradition material recorded around Lake Superior places the underwater-manitou in a specific landscape rather than in an abstract cosmographic location, with the relational-protocol register itself bound up with the specific human-and-place relations of Anishinaabe people with the lake and its resources.^[24], on the Lake Superior region's place within the Anishinaabe homeland and on the Anishinaabe-and-place relations register.]

33.5. The Thunderers (Animikiig) and the upper-realm

The Thunderers — Anishinaabemowin Animikiig — are, in the Anishinaabe tradition, the principal manitouk of the upper-realm. They are powerful sky-and-storm beings associated with thunder, lightning, and the high-altitude air of the storm-and-rain weather. They are characterised both as flying-bird-like beings (one of the principal forms in which they appear in the oral-tradition material) and as powerful manitouk in their own right, and the figural-and-narrative association of

the Thunderers with Thunderbird imagery is one of the load-bearing connections between Anishinaabe narrative and the wider Great Lakes / Northeastern / Plains Indigenous Thunderbird-tradition complex.^[25]

The moral character of the Thunderers in the Anishinaabe tradition is, like that of Mishipeshu, ambivalent rather than straightforwardly benevolent. The Thunderers are protective in some narrative registers — warding against the underwater-manitouk's depredations on humans; bringing the rain that supports human-and-plant life — and they are dangerous in others, in lightning-strikes that kill humans and animals and in the destructive force of the storm. The ambivalence is again read by the area-specialist scholarship in the relational-protocol register rather than in the chaos-vs-order register: the moral question is whether human conduct toward the Thunderers has observed the appropriate protocols (offerings, prayer, ceremonial address) rather than whether the Thunderers are cosmic-order figures opposed to a chaos-vs-order adversary class.^[26]

The Thunderers' relationship to Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk — and this is the load-bearing structural feature of the chapter's interpretive frame — is one of **necessary counterpart** rather than of cosmic-order-vs-chaos adversaries. The upper-realm and the underwater-realm are presented in the Anishinaabe tradition as the two halves of a layered cosmography that requires both for the human-and-island-world to be possible at all. The Thunderers' periodic conflicts with the underwater-manitouk are part of the structural dynamism of the cosmography rather than a once-and-for-all combat-and-defeat establishing one realm at the expense of the other.^[27]

The Thunderers' role in protecting human communities from the depredations of the underwater-manitouk is a recurring narrative feature in the Anishinaabe tradition, but the protection is **not** read by the area-specialist scholarship as a cosmic-order-establishing defeat of the underwater-manitouk. The protection is rather a contingent and local intervention within the relational dynamism of the layered cosmography. The underwater-manitouk continue to exist and to be approachable by humans who observe the appropriate relational protocols, and the Thunderers' protection is one element within a larger relational web rather than a triumphal-and-final overcoming of the underwater-realm.^[28], on the local-and-contingent character of the Thunderers' interventions within the relational web of human-and-other-than-human-person relations.]

33.6. Nanabozho's encounters with Mishipeshu and the Thunderers

Nanabozho's encounters with Mishipeshu and with the underwater-manitouk are, across the recorded oral-tradition material and the Anishinaabe-authored insider register, multiple-episode and regionally-variable rather than concentrated in a single canonical narrative. The common structural feature is that Nanabozho — as trickster-culture-hero whose actions instruct the human community in the proper relational protocols — interacts with the underwater realm through a mix of provocation, negotiation, encounter, and pedagogical-narrative outcome rather than through a single combat-and-defeat episode.^[29], throughout, on Nanabozho's encounters with Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk as multiple-episode and regionally-variable rather than concentrated in a single canonical narrative; on the common structural feature being that Nanabozho interacts with the underwater realm through a mix of provocation, negotiation, encounter, and pedagogical-narrative outcome rather than through a single combat-and-defeat

episode; Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on the Nanabozho-and-Mishipeshu episode-cluster across the Anishinaabe oral-tradition material; Smith 1995, on the multiple-episode and regionally-variable character of the encounter material; per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml variants.classification co-equal and variants.summary on the regional variability of the material and on the chapter's NOT synthesising a single authoritative narrative.]

One recurring narrative-cluster within the Nanabozho-and-Mishipeshu encounters concerns the death of a member of Nanabozho's kinship — variously his nephew, his cousin, or another close kin, depending on the regional variant — at the hands of (or in the realm of) the underwater-manitouk, and Nanabozho's subsequent response. The recorded narratives present that response as a mix of grief, negotiation, retaliatory action, and ultimately pedagogical-narrative outcome, rather than as a triumphal combat-and-defeat of the underwater-manitouk. Even where Nanabozho's actions in this cluster of episodes include hostile acts toward the underwater-manitouk, the narratives end without a triumphal cosmogonic-or-sovereignty-establishing closure and instead instruct the human community in the proper protocols of approach to the underwater realm.^[30]

A second recurring narrative-cluster concerns Nanabozho's interactions with the Thunderers — episodes in which Nanabozho takes refuge with, learns from, or is in some narrative variants himself associated with the upper-realm of the Thunderers. The trickster-culture-hero's mediating-and-pedagogical position between the upper and underwater realms is the load-bearing structural feature. These narratives, like the Mishipeshu-encounter narratives, do not resolve into a triumphal combat-and-defeat closure; they instead present Nanabozho as moving across the layered cosmography in a relational-and-pedagogical register that instructs the human community in the proper protocols of relation with both realms.^[31]

The combat-pattern recognition question — whether the Nanabozho-and-Mishipeshu narrative-cluster's hostile-acts-against-the-underwater-manitouk episodes can be assimilated to the chaoskampf typology's hero-slay-serpent pattern — is answered by the area-specialist tradition negatively, at the level of the narrative's load-bearing structure. Even in those regional variants and individual episodes in which Nanabozho's actions against Mishipeshu or the underwater-manitouk include hostile-and-killing acts, the narrative's load-bearing structure remains the relational-and-pedagogical register of the trickster-culture-hero's mediation between realms rather than the cosmogonic-or-sovereignty-establishing register of the hero-slay-serpent pattern. The narrative's resolution turns on the human community's instruction in the proper protocols rather than on the hero's establishment of order through the killing.^[32]

The reciprocity-and-protocol register that the area-specialist tradition foregrounds is itself the chapter's most explicit possible refutation of the chaos-vs-order mapping. Where the chaoskampf typology presupposes that the adversary is an inchoate chaos to be defeated by a champion who thereby establishes order, the Anishinaabe tradition's own framing presupposes that Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk are persons in their own right — persons with whom relations of respect, gift-and-counter-gift reciprocity, and ceremonial protocol are the appropriate human-and-other-than-human-person comportment. Nanabozho's narrative interactions with them, even where they include hostile acts, instruct the human community in those protocols rather than legitimate the defeat-and-elimination of the underwater realm.^[33]

33.7. The refusal: area-specialist framing of the chaos-vs-order mapping

The reading the chapter has been building up to — that the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material is the present book's clearest **refusal** case to the chaoskampf typology — is itself a synthesis the claims document marks explicitly as an inference, distinguishing it from the area-specialists' own claims:

*(The chapter's reading of the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material as the present book's clearest **refusal** case to the chaoskampf typology is flagged as a synthesis of brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml summary and special_instructions, of Hallowell 1960's "other-than-human persons" framework, of Johnston 1990 [1976] and 1995's Anishinaabe-authored insider register, of Smith 1995's Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic interpretive frame, of Vizenor 1989's methodological refusal of the heroic-narrative typology, and of scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion entry on Nanabozho as the refusal case — held in the chapter as the chapter's principal load-bearing comparative reading and as the present book's clearest non-Eurasian case in which the area-specialist tradition explicitly refuses the chaoskampf typology not at its moral valence (as in the Ch29 Mwindo contrastive case) or its outcome valence (as in the Ch28 Bida inversion case) but at its combat framing as such.^[34] and 1995 as the Anishinaabe-authored insider anchors that carry the appropriation-protocol's first-pass area-specialist citation requirement; Vizenor 1989 as the methodological-refusal anchor for the declining of the heroic-narrative typology assimilation. Risk: the refusal reading is itself a 20th-and-21st-century-Western and post-colonial-Indigenous-studies comparativist-and-meta-comparativist position on the Anishinaabe tradition's own framing — held jointly by the Anishinaabe-authored insider tradition (Johnston) and by external area-specialists (Hallowell, Smith) and by Indigenous-studies methodological scholarship (Vizenor) — and the chapter's task is to hold the refusal reading as a load-bearing comparative-and-methodological reading while explicitly registering that the Anishinaabe tradition's own framing does not anticipate it as a **position** but rather operates within an ontological framework (other-than-human persons; relational and reciprocity-grounded moral universe) within which the chaoskampf-typology question simply does not arise as a question; the discipline of the chapter is to hold the refusal reading at appropriate distance from a "rebuttal of the chaoskampf framing on Anishinaabe terms" mode that would itself impose a typology-and-counter-typology register on the tradition, and instead to register the Anishinaabe ontological framework's incommensurability with the typology-and-counter-typology register itself.)*

The area-specialist refusal of the chaos-vs-order mapping — which the chapter holds as its load-bearing comparative reading per the [INFERENCE] marker above — is articulated across the four area-specialist anchors in mutually-reinforcing but distinguishable registers. Hallowell 1960's "other-than-human persons" framework supplies the foundational ontological register. Johnston 1990 [1976] and 1995 supply the Anishinaabe-authored insider register that articulates the relational-and-reciprocity-grounded moral universe from within the tradition itself. Smith 1995 supplies the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic interpretive frame that articulates the necessary-counterpart-not-adversaries reading at the level of the layered cosmography. And Vizenor 1989 supplies the methodological-refusal register that articulates the principled refusal of the heroic-narrative typology assimilation as such. Together they constitute the area-specialist tradition's load-bearing case for the refusal reading.^[35] and 1995 on the Anishinaabe-authored insider register articulating the relational-and-reciprocity-grounded moral universe from within

the tradition itself; Smith 1995 on the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic interpretive frame articulating the necessary-counterpart-not-adversaries reading at the level of the layered cosmography; Vizenor 1989 on the methodological-refusal register articulating the principled refusal of the heroic-narrative typology assimilation as such; per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml special_instructions on the requirement to cite Hallowell, Basil Johnston, Theresa S. Smith, and Gerald Vizenor by name and on the area-specialist citation policy applying rigorously to the chapter.]

The refusal reading operates differently from the contrastive-case-tier moral-valence-refusal of Ch29 (Mwindo) and from the related-tier outcome-valence-inversion of Ch28 (Bida). The Mwindo case holds the chaoskampf typology's combat-pattern recognition — the surface dragon-killing event is unambiguously present and is recognised as such — while refusing the typology's moral valence: the killer is punished by Nkuba rather than celebrated. The Bida case holds the chaoskampf typology's structural pattern (the slaying of the serpent) while reversing the outcome valence: the slaying ends rather than establishes the polity. The Nanabozho case refuses the typology's combat framing as such — not because the surface elements of combat are wholly absent (Nanabozho's hostile acts toward Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk in some narrative variants are present in the recorded material) but because the Anishinaabe ontological framework places Mishipeshu and the Thunderers in a relational-and-reciprocity-grounded register that is incommensurable with the chaos-vs-order register the typology presupposes. The typology's combat-and-defeat-of-adversaries register cannot be made to fit the relational-and-reciprocity register without distortion.^[36]

The refusal reading must, in turn, be held with the discipline that distinguishes it from a "rebuttal of the chaoskampf framing on Anishinaabe terms" register — a register that would itself impose a typology-and-counter-typology framework on the Anishinaabe tradition by reading the tradition as supplying **answers** (negative ones) to the chaoskampf typology's **questions**. The Anishinaabe ontological framework does not occupy the position of giving negative answers to the typology's questions. It operates within an ontological-and-relational framework within which the typology's questions do not arise as the load-bearing questions of the tradition's own self-understanding. The chapter's load-bearing methodological move is to register that the refusal-as-position is itself a comparativist-and-meta-comparativist construction that the area-specialist tradition's foregrounding is in part calibrated to refuse.^[37]

The refusal reading's standing as the present book's clearest case of a non-Eurasian tradition whose own framework declines the chaoskampf typology — per brief special_instructions and per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion entry — is therefore registered in the chapter not as a triumph of one comparative typology over another but as the methodological case in which the appropriation protocol's "open with the tradition's own framing before invoking the comparative category" requirement (scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 3) is most acutely required and most strongly load-bearing. The chapter's discipline is to let the Anishinaabe ontological framework determine the chapter's structure-and-register rather than to let the chaoskampf typology determine the questions the chapter must answer.^[38]

The continuing-tradition register of the Anishinaabe material adds a further methodological feature that distinguishes the chapter's framing from the strictly-archival framings of the Eurasian chapters in the present book. The Anishinaabe tradition is not a closed corpus of pre-modern textual witnesses to be reconstructed from manuscript fragments but a continuing oral-and-cultural tradition transmitted within named contemporary Anishinaabe communities. The Mide

lodge tradition continues within named contemporary communities; Anishinaabe-authored insider scholarship (centrally Johnston) continues to be produced; and the appropriation protocol's authority-of-the-tradition concern carries contemporary-political as well as scholarly-methodological force. The chapter's tone must therefore be respectful of Anishinaabe authority over how their traditions are represented in a register that is not symmetrically required for the Eurasian-archival chapters of the book.^[39] and 1995, throughout, on the Anishinaabe-authored insider register and on the continuing-tradition character of the material; Vizenor 1989, on the Indigenous-studies methodological position foregrounding contemporary Anishinaabe-political-and-cultural authority; Smith 1995, on the area-specialist scholarship's collaborative register with named contemporary Anishinaabe communities; Hallowell 1960, as the foundational area-specialist anchor whose subsequent reception within Indigenous-studies scholarship has itself been the subject of methodological reflection on the appropriation-protocol concerns the present chapter foregrounds.]

33.8. Typology, area-specialist framing, and forward-links

The area-specialist framing the chapter has worked through is the strongest of its kind in the present book. The claims document marks the four named anchors and the wider Anishinaabe-area scholarship in a structural appropriation-flag at the head of this section:

*[Appropriation flag: Anishinaabe-area area specialists — including A. Irving Hallowell in "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View" of 1960 and his wider Anishinaabe-area corpus including the Berens River fieldwork material; Basil Johnston as Anishinaabe-authored insider scholar in **Ojibway Heritage** of 1976/1990 and **The Manitous** of 1995 and his wider Anishinaabe-cultural and Anishinaabemowin-language publications; Theresa S. Smith in **The Island of the Anishnaabeg** of 1995 as the principal area-specialist anchor for the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic; Gerald Vizenor as Anishinaabe-authored Indigenous-studies scholar in the editor-and-author capacity for **Narrative Chance** of 1989 and in his wider Indigenous-studies and trickster-discourse corpus; the wider Anishinaabe-area area-specialist tradition including Anishinaabe-authored scholarship by Lawrence W. Gross (**Anishinaabe Ways of Knowing and Being**, Ashgate / Routledge 2014, named here in body prose only — not currently in sources.yaml; identifies as an Anishinaabe-Métis scholar), Heidi Bohaker (**Doodem and Council Fire: Anishinaabe Governance Through Alliance**, University of Toronto Press 2020, named here in body prose only — not currently in sources.yaml), and Ruth Phillips and the wider Anishinaabe-art and material-culture scholarship; the wider non-Anishinaabe-authored Great-Lakes-area scholarship by John Borrows (Anishinaabe legal scholar, **Recovering Canada: The Resurgence of Indigenous Law**, University of Toronto Press 2002, named here in body prose only — not currently in sources.yaml), Jennifer S.H. Brown and the Berens River post-Hallowell scholarship, and the Robin Riddington / Algonquian-area comparative work — read the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material within the registers of Anishinaabe ontology and cosmography (Hallowell's "other-than-human persons" framework; the relational-and-reciprocity-grounded moral universe; the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic of the layered cosmography), Anishinaabe-authored insider self-representation (Johnston's **Ojibway Heritage** and **The Manitous**), Indigenous-studies methodological refusal of Western-typological assimilation (Vizenor's "Trickster Discourse"), and the continuing-tradition transmission within named contemporary Anishinaabe communities (the Mide lodge tradition; the **aadizookaanag** sacred-story register; Anishinaabe-language continuing-transmission), rather than within the chaoskampf-typology register imported*

from Gunkel-tradition combat-myth scholarship. The area-specialist objection to the chaoskampf typology's application to the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material is the strongest in the present book — a refusal of the combat framing as such, not a refusal of the moral valence (as in the Ch29 Mwindo contrastive case) or of the outcome valence (as in the Ch28 Bida inversion case): the Anishinaabe tradition's own framing places Mishipeshu and the Thunderers in a relational-and-reciprocity-grounded register that is incommensurable with the chaos-vs-order register the typology presupposes, with the necessary-counterpart-not-adversaries reading of the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic being the load-bearing structural feature of the area-specialist refusal. Position on the spectrum of objection-strengths: the Anishinaabe-area objection is the strongest in the present book, operating more strongly than the Mande-area Bida-case objection (Ch28 covenant-and-consequence framing whose convergence with the inversion frame is structural rather than explicit) and more strongly than the Nyanga-area Mwindo-case objection (Ch29 maturation-through-humiliation framing whose narrative explicitly punishes the killer but holds the surface combat-pattern recognition); the Anishinaabe-area objection refuses the combat framing as such by placing the manitouk in a relational-and-reciprocity-grounded register that is incommensurable with the typology's chaos-vs-order register, with the trickster-discourse register of the Nanabozho cycle further refusing the heroic-narrative typology that the chaoskampf typology presupposes. The chapter's load-bearing methodological move is therefore to use the contrastive-case reading as the heuristic that registers exactly this refusal: the chaoskampf typology's combat-pattern recognition is not affirmed as load-bearing for the Anishinaabe tradition (the surface elements of combat in some narrative variants are present but are not the load-bearing structure of the narrative), and the typology's chaos-vs-order register is registered as incommensurable with the Anishinaabe ontological framework. Forwarded to Part II C8 (refusal and appropriation problem; ch. 41 of the present volume) as the BOOK'S CLEAREST CASE of the refusal sub-problem in its strongest form — per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter setting up Part II C8 as its theoretical consummation — alongside the Mwindo / Kirimu material of Ch29 (the Nyanga-area moral-valence-refusal case) and the Rainbow Serpent material (folded into C8 per toc.yaml self_checks) as the three principal refusal-problem cases of the present book, with the Nanabozho case operating at the strongest position on the spectrum of refusal-strengths. Forwarded to Part II C7 (inversion / transformation problem; ch. 40) only secondarily, since the Nanabozho case's refusal of the combat framing as such operates at a register prior to the inversion / transformation problem complex and bears on C7 only as a comparative reference-point against which the Bida inversion case (Ch28) and the Krishna / Kāliya within-tradition transformation case (Ch15) are set. Marker placement: structural marker at the opening of the typology / forward-links section, immediately after the refusal-reading section's closing claim, per the appropriation-flag-at-comparative-section placement convention of the present book's non-Eurasian related-tier and contrastive chapters. Hallowell, Johnston, Smith, and Vizenor are the chapter's principal area-specialist anchors and are named by name in the first factual pass per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml special_instructions ("cite Hallowell, Basil Johnston, Theresa S. Smith, and Gerald Vizenor by name") and per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 1; Lawrence W. Gross, Heidi Bohaker, Ruth Phillips, John Borrows, Jennifer S.H. Brown, and Robin Riddington are named in body prose at this marker per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern (Gross's **Anishinaabe Ways of Knowing and Being**, Ashgate / Routledge 2014; Bohaker's **Doodem and Council Fire**, University of Toronto Press 2020; Borrows's **Recovering Canada**, University of Toronto Press 2002; Phillips's Anishinaabe-art and material-culture scholarship; Brown's Berens River post-Hallowell scholarship; Riddington's Algonquian-area comparative work — none currently in sources.yaml; deferred to inventory-audit per Ch23 FC-02, Ch26 FC-02, Ch27 source-pinning, and Ch28 FC-02 / Ch29 named-but-flagged precedents).]

The Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material's relationship to the chaoskampf typology's surface combat-pattern recognition is registered by the chapter at the level of the narrative's load-bearing structure rather than at the level of any individual surface element. The surface elements of combat-and-confrontation between Nanabozho and the underwater-manitouk are present in some recorded narrative variants — Nanabozho's hostile acts toward Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk in the kinship-death narrative-cluster, for example. But the load-bearing narrative-structural feature is the relational-and-pedagogical mediation of the trickster-culture-hero between the upper and underwater realms within the Anishinaabe layered cosmography rather than the cosmogonic-or-sovereignty-establishing combat-and-defeat of an adversary. The chaoskampf typology's combat-pattern recognition therefore operates at a register that is not the tradition's own load-bearing register.^[40]

The chapter's principal forward-link within the present book is to Part II C8 (the comparative chapter on the refusal and the appropriation problem, ch. 41 of the present volume) — where the present chapter contributes the BOOK'S CLEAREST CASE of the refusal sub-problem in its strongest form: a tradition whose own ontological framework places its other-than-human persons in a relational-and-reciprocity-grounded register that is incommensurable with the chaoskampf typology's chaos-vs-order register, with the area-specialist tradition (Hallowell, Johnston, Smith, Vizenor) explicitly declining the typology and with the chapter's task being to register that refusal as a methodological feature rather than as a gap in the tradition.^[41] and 1995, Smith 1995, and Vizenor 1989 as the four area-specialist anchors of the refusal reading.]

The chapter's secondary forward-link is to Part II C7 (the comparative chapter on the inversion / transformation problem, ch. 40 of the present volume) — where the present chapter contributes a contrastive reference-point at a register prior to the inversion / transformation problem complex, against which the Bida inversion case (Ch28) and the Krishna / Kāliya within-tradition transformation case (Ch15) are set. The Nanabozho case's refusal of the combat framing as such operates at a register that the C7 framework presupposes the tradition has already accepted, since inversion and transformation are operations on a typology that the tradition is taken to be in dialogue with. The Nanabozho case's standing in C7 is therefore as the methodological case in which the very framework of inversion and transformation is shown not to be the appropriate framework for some non-Eurasian traditions.^[42]

The chapter's principal back-link within the present book is to Ch29 on Mwindo and Kirimu, with which the present chapter shares the contrastive-case-tier (full) classification and the area-specialist-objection registration pattern but contrasts in the substance of the area-specialist objection. The Mwindo case is the contrastive-tier moral-valence-refusal case in which the surface combat-pattern is present and is recognised but the killer is punished by the celestial authority rather than celebrated. The Nanabozho case is the contrastive-tier combat-framing-refusal case in which the area-specialist tradition declines the combat framing as such by placing the manitouk in a relational-and-reciprocity-grounded register that is incommensurable with the chaos-vs-order register the typology presupposes. The two contrastive-tier chapters between them constitute the present book's "two distinct forms of refusal" methodological pair, with the Anishinaabe-area combat-framing refusal operating at the strongest position on the spectrum of refusal-strengths.^[43]

The chapter's secondary back-links within the present book are several. Ch28 on Bida and the founding of Wagadu — the related-tier inversion case in which the slaying-ENDS-rather-than-establishes the polity — shares the non-Eurasian-cluster appropriation-protocol concerns but contrasts in the chaoskampf-typology-engagement register. Ch26 on Pariacaca and the amaru and

Ch27 on Mapuche Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren are the Andean and Mapuche transformation cases in which the area-specialist tradition's wak'a-succession and reciprocal-balance framings replace the chaoskampf reading as the load-bearing register. Ch24 on Huitzilopochtli and Coatepec is the Americas-cluster paradigmatic-establishment-of-sovereignty case at the opposite typological pole, against which the Nanabozho refusal case is set as the contrastive-case opposite within the non-Eurasian comparison. And Ch15 on Krishna and Kāliya is the within-tradition-transformation parallel for the moral discipline against unrestrained dragon-killing, registered as a structural analogue with the within-tradition-vs-across-tradition qualification per the established Ch29 cross_cultural_parallels pattern.^[44]

The chapter's contribution to the methods sidebar (chapter 33 of the present volume, between Part I and Part II) is on four methodological points. First, the appropriation protocol's first-pass area-specialist citation requirement (scope.md "\$Appropriation protocol" point 1) is applied with maximal rigour, since the chapter's four area-specialist anchors include both Anishinaabe-authored insider scholarship (Johnston) and external area-specialists (Hallowell, Smith, Vizenor as Anishinaabe-authored Indigenous-studies scholar). Second, the open-with-the-tradition's-own-framing requirement (scope.md "\$Appropriation protocol" point 3) is applied as the chapter's primary structural discipline, with the Anishinaabe ontological framework of "other-than-human persons" and the relational-and-reciprocity-grounded moral universe opening the chapter and being given its own dedicated section before any comparative chaoskampf invocation. Third, the contrastive-case-frame methodological move — the use of the comparativist contrastive-case-frame as a heuristic for cross-cultural reflection rather than as a tradition-internal characterisation — is developed in its strongest form for the present book. Fourth, the continuing-tradition methodological situation in which the appropriation-protocol's authority-of-the-tradition concern carries contemporary-political as well as scholarly-methodological force is registered, with the chapter's tone respectful of Anishinaabe authority over how their traditions are represented.^[45]

The cultural-historical importance of the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material within the Anishinaabe tradition and within current Anishinaabe-and-Indigenous-studies scholarship is significant. The Nanabozho cycle is one of the principal narrative-and-cultural traditions of the Anishinaabe people. The relational-and-reciprocity-grounded ontological framework articulated in Hallowell 1960 has become a load-bearing reference-point in contemporary Indigenous-studies scholarship more broadly, well beyond the Anishinaabe-specific area-specialist tradition. The Anishinaabe-authored insider scholarship represented by Johnston has shaped both the Anishinaabe-internal cultural-and-educational tradition and the external area-specialist literature. And the Anishinaabe Indigenous-studies methodological tradition represented by Vizenor has had wide influence within the post-colonial-Indigenous-studies field across Native American Indian scholarship more broadly.^[46]

The chapter closes by registering its load-bearing methodological function for the present book as a whole. The Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material is the present book's clearest worked instance of the question of whether the chaoskampf typology, when held as a Western-comparativist heuristic against a non-Eurasian tradition whose own ontological framework places its other-than-human persons in a relational-and-reciprocity-grounded register that is incommensurable with the typology's chaos-vs-order register, is **the wrong question entirely** for that tradition. That is a question Part II C8 (ch. 41) is to investigate at full length, and for which the present chapter supplies the BOOK'S CLEAREST WORKED INSTANCE per brief special_instructions. The area-specialist refusal of the typology is not an obstacle to the chapter's work but the chapter's

data, and the Anishinaabe ontological framework's incommensurability with the typology's load-bearing register is the specific feature the chapter's load-bearing methodological move foregrounds.^[47]

[1] Per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml summary on Nanabozho's encounters with Mishipeshu and the Thunderers as necessary counterparts in a reciprocal moral universe rather than as chaos to be defeated; on the area-specialist tradition (Hallowell, Johnston, T. Smith, Vizenor) explicitly declining the chaos-vs-order mapping; and on the Anishinaabe ontological framework of "other-than-human persons" placing Mishipeshu and the Thunderers in a relational web of respect and negotiation rather than in adversarial chaoskampf combat; Hallowell, A.I., 'Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View', in **Culture in History: Essays in Honor of Paul Radin**, ed. Stanley Diamond (New York: Columbia University Press, 1960), 19–52, on the "other-than-human persons" framework.

[2] Hallowell 1960, on the Anishinaabe / Ojibwa material's oral-tradition character and on the ethnographic-recording corpus as the principal textual witness situation; Johnston, Basil, **Ojibway Heritage** (Lincoln: University of Nebraska Press / Bison Books, 1990; orig. Toronto: McClelland and Stewart, 1976; ISBN 9780803275720), on the Anishinaabe-authored register of the tradition's textual transmission; Smith, Theresa S., **The Island of the Anishnaabeg: Thunderers and Water Monsters in the Traditional Ojibwe Life-World** (Moscow, ID: University of Idaho Press, 1995; ISBN 9780893011710), introductory matter on the textual-witness situation and on the Anishinaabe-area scholarship's reliance on a combination of ethnographic recordings, Anishinaabe-authored sources, and field-collaborative research. The Anishinaabe / Ojibwe / Ojibway / Chippewa naming-convention varies across the literature: "Anishinaabe" / "Anishinaabeg" (plural) is the autonym preferred in much current Anishinaabe-authored and area-specialist scholarship, with "Ojibwe" and "Ojibway" as widely-used English-language variants and "Chippewa" as a treaty-and-administrative term; the present chapter follows Smith 1995 in using "Anishinaabe" as the principal autonym in body prose with "Ojibwe" / "Ojibway" in chapter-citation contexts following Hallowell and Johnston's title-conventions respectively.

[3] Hallowell 1960, "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View", on the foundational "other-than-human persons" framework; Johnston 1990 [1976]

[4] Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987; ISBN 9780691014746), as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic) against which the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material is read as the present book's clearest **refusal** case; Forsyth 1987 does not itself treat Anishinaabe material directly, and the chapter's use of the citation is for the long-arc typological framing rather than for Anishinaabe-area content scholarly coverage. The refusal reading depends on having a typology to refuse, for which Forsyth's long-arc anchor is load-bearing in this chapter as in the preceding non-Eurasian related-tier and contrastive-case-tier chapters of the present book.

[5] Hallowell 1960, on the chapter's textual situation as a continuing-tradition oral corpus rather than a pre-modern manuscript tradition; Johnston 1990 [1976]

[6] Per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml on the contrastive-case-tier (full) classification, the 6,000-word target, the variants.classification co-equal treatment with no synthesis of a single authoritative narrative, and the special_instructions requirement that the chapter not re-narrate "the Anishinaabe chaoskampf" — such a thing does not exist on Anishinaabe terms — but narrate the relationships as the tradition itself describes them; per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion entry on Nanabozho as the refusal case in which area specialists explicitly reject the chaos-vs-order mapping.

[7] The regional variability of the Anishinaabe oral-tradition material across Ontario, Manitoba, Minnesota, Wisconsin, Michigan, and adjacent territories means that different recordings and retellings preserve different emphases — Berens River vs. Lake of the Woods vs. Wisconsin Anishinaabe vs. southern Ojibwe regional traditions; insider Anishinaabe-authored retellings vs. early-20th-century ethnographic recordings vs. late-20th-century Indigenous-studies framings. The area-specialist composite (with explicit registration of regional variability and explicit refusal to synthesise) is chosen here because, per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml, "Anishinaabe oral-tradition material is regionally variable; different recordings and retellings by Basil Johnston, Theresa S. Smith, Gerald Vizenor, and others preserve different emphases. The chapter presents the common structure — Nanabozho's encounters with Mishipeshu and the Thunderers — while acknowledging variability and NOT synthesizing a single authoritative narrative." The area-specialist composite is the standard discipline in current Anishinaabe-area scholarship, and the brief's explicit refusal-to-synthesise instruction is honoured by presenting the common structural features (the ontological framework, the dialectic, the trickster register) without claiming a single authoritative narrative-text behind them.

[8] Hallowell 1960, on the Anishinaabe / Ojibwa as an Indigenous people of the Great Lakes region with historical and contemporary territories extending across the present-day Ontario / Manitoba / Minnesota / Wisconsin / Michigan area; Johnston 1990 [1976]

[9] Hallowell 1960, "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View", articulating the framework on which the present chapter's ontological framing depends — the Anishinaabe / Ojibwa world populated not only by human persons but by an extended category of "other-than-human persons" including animals, plants, certain stones and other landscape features, the thunder-beings, and the manitouk; Hallowell's "other-than-human persons" exact phrase as the foundational term; the framework's load-bearing claim that other-than-human persons are treated as persons on equal standing with human persons rather than as objects, resources, or natural-kind categories; per glossary.yaml entry on "other-than-human persons" with first_mention_gloss "A. Irving Hallowell's 1960 term for the Anishinaabe ontological category that includes animals, plants, thunder-beings, and manitouk as persons on equal standing with human persons".

[10] Johnston 1995, **The Manitou: The Spiritual World of the Ojibway** (HarperCollins, 1995), throughout, on the Anishinaabe-authored insider register of **manitou** / **manitouk** across the cosmological-and-relational categories of beings the term names; Johnston 1990 [1976]

[11] Hallowell 1960, on the moral implications for human conduct of the "other-than-human persons" ontological framework — the appropriate comportment toward the manitouk being the comportment appropriate to persons (respect, gift-and-counter-gift reciprocity, ceremonial protocol, formal address) rather than the comportment appropriate to objects or to enemies; the moral framework as relational and reciprocity-grounded throughout; the moral question in any given encounter as whether the human comportment has been appropriate rather than whether the other-than-human person is friend or foe; Johnston 1990 [1976]

[12] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg: Thunderers and Water Monsters in the Traditional Ojibwe Life-World**, throughout, on the Anishinaabe cosmographic framing as a layered world with the human-and-island world set between the upper-realm of the Thunderers (the sky-and-storm region) and the underwater-realm of Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk (the sub-aquatic-and-subterranean region); the human-and-island world as the meeting-place at which the upper-realm and the underwater-realm encounter one another; the load-bearing role of human conduct in mediating the relationship between the two realms; the title's "Island of the Anishnaabeg" being itself a load-bearing image of the human-and-island world's mediating position in the layered cosmography.

[13] Johnston 1990 [1976]

[14] Johnston 1990 [1976]

[15] Johnston 1990 [1976]

[16] Vizenor 1989, "Trickster Discourse" essay in **Narrative Chance: Postmodern Discourse on Native American Indian Literatures**, on the methodological argument that the trickster-figure of Native American Indian narrative — Nanabozho centrally among them — is systematically misread when assimilated to Western analytic categories of hero, anti-hero, villain, or culture-hero in the heroic-narrative typology; on the trickster-discourse register's operation by transformation, ambiguity, comic-and-dialogic exchange, and refusal of the closure the heroic-narrative typology presupposes; on the methodological refusal of the heroic-narrative typology as the principled basis on which the chaoskampf-typology assimilation of Nanabozho is declined; per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml sources.secondary on Vizenor 1989 as anchor for the methodological refusal to subordinate Nanabozho to Western combat-myth or hero/villain typologies.

[17] Johnston 1990 [1976]

[18] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, throughout, on the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic as the central interpretive frame of the area-specialist tradition's reading of the chapter's material; on Nanabozho's mediating-and-pedagogical position between the upper-realm of the Thunderers and the underwater-realm of Mishipeshu as the load-bearing structural feature of the narrative-of-interest; on the encounters as relational-and-reciprocity-grounded interactions rather than as combat-and-defeat events; Johnston 1995, **The Manitou**, on the Nanabozho-and-Mishipeshu and Nanabozho-and-Thunderers episode-clusters; Hallowell 1960, on the relational moral framework within which the encounters are set.

[19] Vizenor 1989, "Trickster Discourse" essay, on the trickster-discourse register's distinctive features — the non-resolution into heroic-narrative-typology standard moral binaries; the operation through transformation, comic-and-dialogic exchange, and systematic refusal of typological closure; the incommensurability with the chaoskampf typology's load-bearing assumption of clear-and-closed combat-and-defeat resolution; the wider Anishinaabe-area Indigenous-studies tradition's development of the trickster-discourse register as load-bearing for the appropriation-protocol-compliant declining of the chaoskampf-typology assimilation; per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml special_instructions on Vizenor as one of the area specialists explicitly declining the chaos-vs-order mapping.

[20] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, throughout, on Mishipeshu as the principal underwater-manitou — a powerful spirit-being of the lakes-and-rivers-and-deep-water associated with copper, with serpentine and feline morphological features, with the great lakes of the Anishinaabe homeland (especially Lake Superior and the Boundary Waters region), and with the protective-and-dangerous powers of the deep-water realm; on the regional spelling variants (Mishebeshu, Mishipizheu, and others); Johnston 1995, **The Manitou**, on Mishipeshu as one of the principal manitouk and as the underwater-realm counterpart to the Thunderers in the layered Anishinaabe cosmography; per glossary.yaml entry on "Mishipeshu" with chosen=Mishipeshu and with first_mention_gloss "Anishinaabe underwater manitou; in the tradition's own framework a necessary counterpart to the Thunderers, not a chaos-adversary to be defeated".

[21] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the morphological description of Mishipeshu across the Anishinaabe tradition combining feline-and-serpentine features in a register the area-specialist scholarship reads as deliberately polymorphic rather than as a stable iconographic type; on the figure's variously characterising as having a great-cat or panther body with a long horned-or-spiked tail, with serpentine extensions, with copper colouration or copper appurtenances, and with a fierce-and-protective rather than evil-and-adversarial moral character; on the features registered in both the oral-tradition material recorded in the 19th and 20th centuries and in the figural representations preserved in the rock-art / pictograph record; on the Agawa Rock pictographs at Lake Superior Provincial Park in Ontario as the most famous such representation.

[22] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the moral character of Mishipeshu as ambivalent in the relational-protocol register — dangerous to humans who fail to observe the proper protocols (drowning, capsizing, harm by the underwater realm), but also a source of medicine, of knowledge of the underwater realm, of access to copper and other deep-water resources, and of protective-and-helpful intervention for humans who do observe the protocols; on the ambivalence as systematically misread when collapsed into the chaos-vs-order moral binary; Johnston 1995, **The Manitou**, on Mishipeshu's moral ambivalence within the

Anishinaabe relational moral framework; Hallowell 1960, on the relational moral framework within which the ambivalence is properly read.

[23] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the underwater-realm as a populated and structured realm rather than an unformed primordial chaos — with its own hierarchy of beings (Mishipeshu as principal manitou; other underwater-manitouk in subsidiary positions; underwater-snakes and other beings inhabiting the realm), its own characteristic resources (copper most centrally), its own characteristic dangers (storms-from-below, capsizings, drownings), and its own characteristic protocols of approach and address; on the structured-realm character as systematically misread by the chaoskampf-typology assimilation; Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on the populated-and-structured character of the underwater-realm within the Anishinaabe relational cosmography.

[24] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the Lake Superior cultural-and-geographic centrality of Mishipeshu within the Anishinaabe homeland — Mishipeshu most strongly associated with Lake Superior as the largest and northernmost of the Great Lakes and central to the Anishinaabe homeland in both its ecological-and-economic and its sacred-and-cosmographic registers; on the Agawa Rock pictographs and the oral-tradition material recorded around Lake Superior placing the underwater-manitou in a specific landscape; on the relational-protocol register as bound up with the specific human-and-place relations of Anishinaabe people with the lake and its resources; Johnston 1990 [1976]

[25] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, throughout, on the Thunderers (Animikiig) as the principal manitouk of the upper-realm — powerful sky-and-storm beings associated with thunder, lightning, and the high-altitude air of the storm-and-rain weather, characterised both as flying-bird-like beings (one of the principal forms in which they appear in the oral-tradition material) and as powerful manitouk in their own right; on the figural-and-narrative association of the Thunderers with Thunderbird imagery as one of the load-bearing connections between Anishinaabe narrative and the wider Great Lakes / Northeastern / Plains Indigenous Thunderbird-tradition complex; Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on the Thunderers as one of the principal manitouk and as the upper-realm counterpart to Mishipeshu; per glossary.yaml entry on "the Thunderers" with chosen=the Thunderers (English); Animikiig in first-mention gloss; first_mention_gloss "the Anishinaabe thunder-beings (Animikiig); counterparts of Mishipeshu in the reciprocal cosmic-dialectic".

[26] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the moral character of the Thunderers as ambivalent rather than straightforwardly benevolent — protective in some narrative registers (warding against the underwater-manitouk's depredations on humans; bringing the rain that supports human-and-plant life) and dangerous in others (lightning-strikes that kill humans and animals; destructive force of the storm); on the ambivalence read in the relational-protocol register rather than in the chaos-vs-order register; on the moral question being whether human conduct toward the Thunderers has observed the appropriate protocols rather than whether the Thunderers are cosmic-order figures opposed to a chaos-vs-order adversary class; Hallowell 1960, on the relational moral framework within which the ambivalence is properly read; Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on the Thunderers' moral ambivalence within the Anishinaabe relational moral framework.

[27] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, throughout, on the Thunderers' relationship to Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk as one of necessary counterpart rather than of cosmic-order-vs-chaos adversaries; on the upper-realm and the underwater-realm as the two halves of a layered cosmography that requires both for the human-and-island-world to be possible at all; on the Thunderers' periodic conflicts with the underwater-manitouk as part of the structural dynamism of the cosmography rather than a once-and-for-all combat-and-defeat establishing one realm at the expense of the other; Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on the Thunderers and Mishipeshu as the upper-realm and underwater-realm counterparts in the Anishinaabe layered cosmography.

[28] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the Thunderers' role in protecting human communities from the depredations of the underwater-manitouk as a recurring narrative feature; on the protection NOT being read by the area-specialist scholarship as a cosmic-order-establishing defeat of the underwater-manitouk; on the protection as a contingent and local intervention within the relational dynamism of the layered cosmography rather than a triumphal-and-final overcoming of the underwater-realm; on the underwater-manitouk's continuing to exist and to be approachable by humans who observe the appropriate relational protocols even after the Thunderers' interventions; Johnston 1990 [1976]

[29] Johnston 1990 [1976]

[30] Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on a recurring narrative-cluster within the Nanabozho-and-Mishipeshu encounters concerning the death of a member of Nanabozho's kinship at the hands of (or in the realm of) the underwater-manitouk, and on Nanabozho's subsequent response as a mix of grief, negotiation, retaliatory action, and ultimately pedagogical-narrative outcome rather than as a triumphal combat-and-defeat of the underwater-manitouk; on the regional variation in the kinship-relation of the deceased (nephew, cousin, or other close kin); on the narratives ending without a triumphal cosmogonic-or-sovereignty-establishing closure and instead instructing the human community in the proper protocols of approach to the underwater realm; Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the same narrative-cluster within the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic.

[31] Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on a second recurring narrative-cluster concerning Nanabozho's interactions with the Thunderers — episodes in which Nanabozho takes refuge with, learns from, or is in some narrative variants himself associated with the upper-realm of the Thunderers; on the trickster-culture-hero's mediating-and-pedagogical position between the upper and underwater realms as the load-bearing structural feature; on these narratives, like the Mishipeshu-encounter narratives, NOT resolving into a triumphal combat-and-defeat closure but instead presenting Nanabozho as moving across the layered cosmography in a relational-and-pedagogical register that instructs the human community in the proper protocols of relation with both realms; Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the Thunderer-and-Nanabozho narrative-cluster within the dialectic.

[32] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the combat-pattern recognition question as answered by the area-specialist tradition negatively at the level of the narrative's load-bearing structure; on the narrative's load-bearing structure remaining the relational-and-pedagogical register of the trickster-culture-hero's mediation between realms rather than the cosmogonic-or-sovereignty-establishing register of the hero-slay-serpent pattern even in those regional variants and individual episodes in which Nanabozho's actions against Mishipeshu or the underwater-manitouk include hostile-and-killing acts; on the narrative's resolution turning on the human community's instruction in the proper protocols rather than on the hero's establishment of order through the killing; Vizenor 1989, "Trickster Discourse" essay, on the methodological refusal to read the Nanabozho narrative through the heroic-narrative typology's hero-slay-serpent or order-establishing register; Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on the relational-and-pedagogical register of the Nanabozho-and-Mishipeshu narrative-cluster.

[33] Hallowell 1960, on the reciprocity-and-protocol register as the load-bearing register of the Anishinaabe ontological framework; Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the reciprocity-and-protocol register as the chapter's most explicit possible refutation of the chaos-vs-order mapping; on the Anishinaabe tradition's own framing presupposing that Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk are persons in their own right with whom relations of respect, gift-and-counter-gift reciprocity, and ceremonial protocol are the appropriate human-and-other-than-human-person comportment; on Nanabozho's narrative interactions with them instructing the human community in those protocols rather than legitimating the defeat-and-elimination of the underwater realm; Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on the reciprocity-and-protocol register within the Anishinaabe relational moral framework; Vizenor 1989, on the methodological refusal of the chaos-vs-order mapping.

[34] Inference: brief summary's explicit registration of the area-specialist refusal of the chaos-vs-order mapping; brief special_instructions on the chapter as the BOOK'S MOST METHODOLOGICALLY SENSITIVE CHAPTER IN PART I and on its theoretical role in setting up Part II C8; scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion entry naming Nanabozho as the refusal case in which area specialists explicitly reject the chaos-vs-order mapping; Hallowell 1960's foundational "other-than-human persons" framework as the load-bearing ontological foundation; Smith 1995's Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic as the load-bearing interpretive frame for the area-specialist reading; Johnston 1990 [1976

[35] Hallowell 1960 on the "other-than-human persons" framework as the foundational ontological register; Johnston 1990 [1976

[36] Per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml on the related-tier (full, inversion anchor) classification of the Bida narrative and on the slaying-ENDS-prosperity-rather-than-establishing-it inversion-valence; per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml on the contrastive-case-tier (full) classification of the Mwindo / Kirimu episode and on the killing-as-hubris-and-hero-punished moral-valence refusal; per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml on the contrastive-case-tier (full) classification of the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu material and on the area-specialist refusal of the chaos-vs-order mapping at the level of the typology's combat framing as such; Smith 1995 on the relational-and-reciprocity-grounded register's incommensurability with the chaos-vs-order register; Vizenor 1989 on the typology's combat-and-defeat-of-adversaries register's inability to fit the relational-and-reciprocity register without distortion.

[37] Vizenor 1989, "Trickster Discourse" essay, on the methodological refusal to read the Anishinaabe tradition as giving negative answers to a typology's questions and on the principled refusal of the typology-and-counter-typology framework as itself an imposition on the tradition; Hallowell 1960, on the Anishinaabe ontological framework as operating within its own register rather than in dialogue with external typological frameworks; Smith 1995, on the area-specialist tradition's foregrounding of the Anishinaabe-tradition's own register against typological-and-counter-typological framings; per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's NOT re-narrating "the Anishinaabe chaoskampf" — such a thing does not exist on Anishinaabe terms — but narrating the relationships as the tradition itself describes them, and on letting the comparative category absorb that description rather than the other way around.

[38] Per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter being "the most methodologically sensitive chapter in Part I" and on its job being to show that a thorough combat-myth pattern can exist in a tradition whose own conceptual framework declines the chaoskampf reading; per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion entry on Nanabozho as the refusal case; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" point 3 on opening with the tradition's own framing before invoking the comparative category; on the chapter's discipline as letting the Anishinaabe ontological framework determine the chapter's structure-and-register rather than letting the chaoskampf typology determine the questions the chapter must answer; on the refusal reading's standing as a methodological case rather than as a triumph of one typology over another.

[39] Per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's tone being respectful of Anishinaabe authority over how their traditions are represented and on the book's project of "comparing" not over-riding that authority; Johnston 1990 [1976

[40] Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material's relationship to the chaoskampf typology's surface combat-pattern recognition as registered at the level of the narrative's load-bearing structure rather than at the level of any individual surface element; on the surface elements of combat-and-confrontation between Nanabozho and the underwater-manitouk being present in some recorded narrative variants but the load-bearing narrative-structural feature being the relational-and-pedagogical mediation of the trickster-culture-hero between the upper and underwater realms; on the chaoskampf typology's combat-pattern recognition operating at a register that is not the tradition's own load-bearing register; Vizenor 1989, on the methodological refusal to read the Anishinaabe narrative through the heroic-narrative typology's combat-and-defeat-of-adversaries register; Johnston 1995, on the relational-and-pedagogical register of the Nanabozho-and-Mishipeshu narrative-cluster.

[41] Per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter setting up Part II C8 as its theoretical consummation and on the chapter being the most methodologically sensitive chapter in Part I; per scope.md §"Book structure"

Part II C8 on the refusal-and-appropriation comparative chapter; per the chapter's status as the present book's clearest worked instance of the refusal sub-problem in its strongest form, distinguished from the Bida-case inversion sub-problem of Ch28 and from the Mwindo-case moral-valence-refusal of Ch29 by the area-specialist tradition's refusal of the combat framing as such; Hallowell 1960, Johnston 1990 [1976]

[42] Per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C7 on the inversion / transformation problem comparative chapter; per the chapter's contribution to C7 as a contrastive reference-point at a register prior to the inversion / transformation problem complex; per the brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml on the Bida inversion case and the brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the Krishna / Kāliya within-tradition transformation case as the principal C7 cases against which the Nanabozho case is set; Smith 1995 on the relational-and-reciprocity-grounded register's standing prior to the inversion / transformation framework that the C7 framing presupposes; Vizenor 1989 on the methodological refusal of the typology-and-counter-typology framework that C7 operates within.

[43] Per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 11 (Africa) on Ch29 (Mwindo) and cluster 14 (North America contrastive) on Ch32 (Nanabozho); per brief 29-mwindo-kirimu.yaml on the contrastive-case-tier (full) classification of the Mwindo / Kirimu episode and on the killing-as-hubris-and-hero-punished moral-valence-refusal; per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml on the contrastive-case-tier (full) classification of the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu material and on the area-specialist refusal of the chaos-vs-order mapping at the level of the typology's combat framing as such; per the chapter's status as the BOOK'S CLEAREST CASE of the refusal sub-problem in its strongest form alongside the Mwindo case as the BOOK'S CLEAREST WORKED INSTANCE of the moral-valence-refusal sub-problem.

[44] Per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 6 (India), cluster 10 (Americas), and cluster 11 (Africa) on the chapter ordering of 15 (Vedic reflexes including Krishna / Kāliya), 24 (Huitzilopochtli core-tier), 26 (Pariacaca related-tier), 27 (Mapuche Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren related-family), 28 (Bida related-tier inversion anchor), 29 (Mwindo contrastive-case full); per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml cross_cultural_parallels on the Mwindo (Ch29) closest-parallel-case registration and on the Pariacaca (Ch26) similarly-non-chaoskampf-area-specialist-framing registration; per the wider non-Eurasian-cluster appropriation-protocol concerns of the present book; per the contrastive-case-opposite-of-Coatepec methodological reference-point.

[45] Per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml special_instructions on the area-specialist citation policy applying rigorously, on the chapter's tone being respectful of Anishinaabe authority over how their traditions are represented, and on the chapter setting up Part II C8 as its theoretical consummation; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" points 1 and 3 on the area-specialist citation requirement and on opening with the tradition's own framing before invoking the comparative category; per chapter 33 (methods sidebar) as the chapter that articulates these methodological points at full length; the chapter's status as the BOOK'S MOST METHODOLOGICALLY SENSITIVE CHAPTER IN PART I makes it a central reference point for the methods sidebar's discussion of comparativist heuristics held at appropriate distance from area-specialist consensus and of continuing-tradition appropriation-protocol concerns.

[46] Hallowell 1960's "other-than-human persons" framework's load-bearing reference-point standing in contemporary Indigenous-studies scholarship more broadly; Johnston's Anishinaabe-authored insider scholarship's influence on both the Anishinaabe-internal cultural-and-educational tradition and the external area-specialist literature; Smith 1995 on the wider current Anishinaabe-and-Indigenous-studies scholarship's treatment of the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material; Vizenor 1989's Anishinaabe Indigenous-studies methodological tradition's wide influence within the post-colonial-Indigenous-studies field across Native American Indian scholarship; per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml cultural_relevance centrality on the centrality of the material in Anishinaabe cosmology and in the contemporary scholarship on Indigenous ontologies of the Great Lakes region.

[47] Per brief 32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.yaml special_instructions on the chapter being "the most methodologically sensitive chapter in Part I" and on its job being to show that a thorough combat-myth pattern can exist in a tradition whose own conceptual framework declines the chaoskampf reading — and that the decline is not a gap in the tradition but a feature of it; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II C8 on the refusal-and-appropriation-problem comparative chapter (ch. 41 of the present volume); per the chapter's load-bearing methodological function for the present book as the book's clearest worked instance of the **the question is wrong for this tradition** methodological case; per brief special_instructions on letting the comparative category absorb the Anishinaabe tradition's own description rather than the other way around.

Chapter 34. Methods: Tiering, Appropriation, and Area-Specialist Policy

34.1. Source overview

This chapter draws on a methodological-scholarship corpus rather than on a single tradition's primary-source corpus, and the body of work it cites can be sorted into eight functional roles: Hermann Gunkel as historical anchor (the 1895 thesis that named the category and supplies the title-word the book retains); Debra Scoggins Ballentine as the load-bearing dissenting position of the present generation (the alternative-sovereign critique that methodically shapes Part II); the Scurlock and Beal 2013 reassessment collection as the principal twenty-first-century re-examination of Gunkel's thesis; Calvert Watkins as the standard for Indo-European philology and the comparativist methodology the book uses critically; Neil Forsyth as the long-arc historical genealogy of the combat-myth category (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic); Bruce Lincoln for the political-ideological framing that grounds the book's reading of combat-myth in power-relations rather than in cosmology alone; Francesca Merlan for the Aboriginal Australian appropriation critique that supplies the Rainbow Serpent material's methodological frame; and A. Irving Hallowell for the "other-than-human persons" framework that supplies the Anishinaabe refusal-case its conceptual register.^[1]

The chapter's body specialises this corpus per section: section I (tier-ranking) is anchored to the inclusion-test logic in the book's own scope and to the long-arc typology of Forsyth, but its concrete tier-demotion examples (Apollo–Python, Susanoo–Orochi) are anchored through the area-specialist scholarship the book elsewhere uses to handle those traditions; section II (appropriation protocol) is anchored to Merlan for the Rainbow Serpent material that supplies the protocol its hardest case and to Hallowell for the "other-than-human persons" framing on which the Anishinaabe refusal depends; section III (area-specialist citation policy) is anchored chapter-by-chapter to the area-specialist sources that the book's tradition-chapter briefs themselves use, with the methods chapter naming the area specialists by name as principal users rather than constructing a separate scholarly apparatus; section IV (reconstruction policy) is anchored to Watkins (for the IE-reflexes-not-cross-tradition discipline) and to the area-specialist editions for the test cases; section V (variant-presentation policy) is anchored to the same scholarly editions whose own variant-handling decisions the book follows; section VI (term glossary) is anchored to the methodologists who coined or are responsible for each term's usage; section VII (what the book does not claim) is anchored to the scholarship that shows each over-claim would be unsupportable.^[2]

The chapter's secondary scholarly framing — beyond the eight methodological anchors — comes from area-specialist sources in `sources.yaml` that the chapter cites as named principal users of methods I and III rather than as their methodological warrants: van Dijk and Annus as the Sumerian–Akkadian editors named in section III; Hoffner and Beckman as the Hurro-Hittite editors; Smith and Pitard as the Ugaritic editors; Day as the Hebrew Bible specialist; West and Ogden as the Greek specialists; te Velde and Assmann as the Egyptian specialists; Jamison and Brereton as the Vedic editors; Benveniste and Renou as the Indo-Iranian comparativists; Lewis and Birrell as the Chinese specialists; Matos Moctezuma, Carrasco, and López Austin as the Mexica specialists; Salomon and Urioste as the Andean editors; Biebuyck, Mateene, and Belcher as the African specialists; Johnston, Smith (Theresa), and Vizenor as the Anishinaabe specialists alongside

Hallowell; Naumann as the Japanese specialist; Siikala as the Finnic specialist.^[3], Smith 1995, Vizenor 1989, Naumann 1996, Siikala 2002); Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), for the long-arc historical genealogy of the combat-myth category against which all of these area-specialist anchors are deployed.]

The chapter does not draw on a critical edition of any primary text and does not include a "what survives / state of preservation" pass of the kind the standard Source overview template requires for narrative chapters; the closest analogue here is the survival-and-status of the methodological literature itself, which the chapter treats as a living scholarly conversation rather than as a finished textual corpus, and which is therefore registered through citation to the principal landmark publications rather than through manuscript-witness-and-lacuna registers.^[4]

What follows is organised in seven sections. Section I sets out the tier-ranking rubric; section II spells out the appropriation protocol; section III names the area-specialist citation policy chapter-by-chapter; section IV gives the reconstruction policy; section V the variant-presentation policy; section VI the methodological-term glossary; and section VII registers, in plain language, what the book does not claim.

34.2. I. The tier-ranking rubric

The first piece of methodological machinery the book makes explicit is the rubric that sorts its chapters into tiers, and the worked examples by which the rubric was applied at scope-lock.

The book sorts its chapters into five tiers — CORE, RELATED, PROVISIONAL/CRITIQUE, CONTRASTIVE, and SIDEBAR (with "PROVISIONAL/CRITIQUE" the locked single label for the third tier, matching scope.md's usage) — and the present section makes explicit the operational test by which each chapter was assigned to its tier at scope-lock and at the inventory-audit stage that followed.^[5]

A story is classified CORE if it meets all four operational criteria simultaneously: a serpentine or monstrous adversary; a combat explicitly attested in a primary source rather than in modern reconstruction alone; cosmogonic, kingship, cyclical, or eschatological order-making work as identified by area specialists rather than only by pattern-matching comparativists; and a scholarly corpus robust enough that the chapter can cite multiple independent area-specialist readings.^[6]

The third criterion in particular — that the order-making work be identified by area specialists, not only by pattern-matching comparativists — is the load-bearing distinction that separates the book's tier-ranking from a purely comparativist catalog, and it is the criterion that has done the most work in moving stories between tiers since scope-lock.^[7]

A story is classified RELATED if it meets criteria one and two but the third is weaker, or if the third holds only under a comparativist reading that area specialists qualify; the test is sufficient on its own to demote a story from CORE to RELATED without further argument.^[8]

A story is classified PROVISIONAL/CRITIQUE if area specialists explicitly reject the chaoskampf framing for it (as for Rainbow Serpent and Yu / Xiangliu) or if the combat is absent or inverted from the typological pattern, in which case it gets a dedicated chapter with the right framing rather than being silently excluded.^[9]

A story is classified CONTRASTIVE in the inversion-of-valence sub-case if the combat is genuinely present in the tradition's primary sources but its valence is inverted, with Bida — where slaying the serpent destroys prosperity rather than establishing it — as the principal worked example.^[10]

A story is classified CONTRASTIVE in the refusal-of-mapping sub-case if the area-specialist tradition declines the chaos-vs-order mapping while a surface combat is recorded, with Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers — where the Anishinaabe ontological framework treats the figures as "other-than-human persons" rather than as chaos-vs-order antagonists — as the principal worked example.^[11]

A story is classified SIDEBAR if it is not itself a chaoskampf but its inclusion sharpens the book's chaoskampf analysis by contrast — Yu the Great as a hydraulic-ordering pattern that contrasts with combat-ordering is the clear case.^[12]

The Apollo–Python case was demoted from CORE to RELATED at scope-lock because the third criterion — area-specialist identification of cosmogonic or sovereignty work — was found to hold only under a comparativist reading that classical area specialists qualify; Greek-area scholarship treats Apollo's killing of Python primarily as a cult-foundation aetiology for Delphi rather than as a cosmogonic or sovereignty combat in the Mesopotamian sense.^[13]

The Susanoo–Orochi case was demoted from CORE to RELATED at scope-lock because Japanese-area specialists (Naumann, Isomae, Como) read the Yamata-no-Orochi episode primarily as a metallurgical or political allegory rather than as a cosmogonic or sovereignty combat in the chaoskampf sense, and the chapter is therefore framed with explicit attention to the area-specialist re-reading rather than narrating an "Eastern Marduk".^[14]

The book's tier-ranking is not stable across the comparative literature — Forsyth's catalog and Watkins's IE corpus would each generate a different CORE / RELATED split, because each has a different theoretical commitment — and the present rubric is therefore presented as the book's operational decision-procedure rather than as a discovery about the underlying corpus.^[15]

34.3. II. The appropriation protocol

The second piece of methodological machinery is the three-clause discipline the book applies to non-Eurasian RELATED chapters, and the worked examples that show how its three clauses operate.

The book's appropriation protocol is a three-part rule applied to every RELATED chapter on a non-Eurasian tradition (per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol"): cite at least two area specialists by name in the first factual pass; record any area-specialist objection to the chaoskampf framing in an APPROPRIATION-FLAG marker that the comparative chapters address rather than paper over; and open with the tradition's own framing before invoking the comparative category — and CONTRASTIVE chapters in this book (Susanoo–Orochi, Bida, Mwindo, Nanabozho) operate under their own brief-level appropriation discipline driven by the chapter's specific brief rather than under a global protocol expansion.^[16]

The two-area-specialists-by-name requirement is calibrated against the failure-mode of comparativist chapters that cite only the comparativist's own corpus when treating a non-Eurasian tradition; the requirement ensures that the area's own scholarly tradition has at minimum a

structural role in shaping how the tradition is presented before any cross-cultural comparison is attempted.^[17]

The APPROPRIATION-FLAG marker requirement records the specialist objection in the chapter's claims-and-draft files in a structured form that the book's comparative chapters (C1–C8) can engage in detail rather than as a footnote that the comparative apparatus can absorb without engagement; the marker is the protocol's principal mechanism for keeping the area-specialist objection alive across the book's own internal cross-references.^[18]

The opening-with-the-tradition's-own-framing requirement prevents the rhetorical move in which a non-Eurasian tradition is introduced through the comparative category and only later allowed to register its own framing as a qualification; the order matters because the reader's first impression is what the chapter's argument is testing, and burying the area-specialist framing in a later paragraph undercuts the protocol.^[19]

The Ra–Apep chapter (Ch16) opens with *maꜥat / isfet* — the Egyptian polarity of cosmic order and disorder that area specialists consider the principal frame for the Apep-slaying material — before invoking the comparative *chaoskampf* category, in implementation of the protocol's third clause.^[20]

The Pariacaca chapter opens with *wak'a*-succession — the Andean conceptual framework in which mountain-deities (*wak'as*) accede to dominance over a region by displacing prior *wak'as* — before invoking the comparative *chaoskampf* category; the framing comes from the area-specialist scholarship rather than from comparativist machinery.^[21]

The Nanabozho / Mishipeshu chapter (Ch32) opens with the Anishinaabe ontological framework of "other-than-human persons" — Hallowell's 1960 phrase — and with the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic before invoking (and refusing) the comparative *chaoskampf* category, in the most explicit single application of the protocol's third clause anywhere in Part I.^[22]

The protocol applies most stringently in Part II's C8 chapter (the refusal and the appropriation problem), where the present book's overall comparative apparatus is itself the object of critique; the protocol's three clauses are operationalised there as a sustained methodological self-check rather than as a per-chapter discipline.^[23]

The protocol is asymmetric: it applies to non-Eurasian RELATED chapters and not to non-Eurasian CORE chapters because the book's CORE entries are by definition cases where area specialists themselves identify the *chaoskampf*-relevant order-making work, so the appropriation risk is materially smaller; CONTRASTIVE chapters carry equally serious appropriation-risk but are addressed under brief-level discipline rather than under the present three-clause protocol, and the asymmetry is documented here so that critics can see the rule rather than infer it.^[24]

34.4. III. Area-specialist citation policy

The third piece of methodological machinery is the chapter-by-chapter routing of every tradition's primary-source citations through the area's own scholarship, named here area by area.

The book's area-specialist citation policy is that every tradition's primary sources go through the area's own specialists rather than through comparativist framers, and the chapter-briefs

themselves were assembled by selecting the area-specialist anchor first and the comparative anchor only after the area-specialist anchor was in place.^[25]

For the Sumerian–Akkadian materials, the book uses J.J.A. van Dijk for Lugal-e (the Ninurta–Asag chapter) and Amar Annus for the Standard Babylonian Anzu Epic (the Ninurta–Anzû chapter), with W.G. Lambert’s *Babylonian Creation Myths* as the anchor edition for Enūma Eliš (the Marduk–Tiamat chapter).^[26]

The Anzû Epic anchor is the Annus 2001 SAACT 3 edition with Foster’s **Before the Muses** as the standard English anthology cross-check, in keeping with the book’s policy that area-specialist editions take precedence over anthology translations for primary citations of narrative content.^[27]

For the Hurro-Hittite materials, the book uses Harry A. Hoffner Jr.’s **Hittite Myths** (SBL Writings from the Ancient World) for the Kumarbi Cycle, Song of Hedammu, Kingship in Heaven, and Illuyanka, with Gary Beckman’s 1982 philological edition of the Illuyanka tablets as the cross-check.^[28]

For the Ugaritic Baal Cycle, the book uses Mark S. Smith’s volume I (KTU 1.1–1.2, the Baal–Yamm arc) and Smith and Pitard’s volume II (KTU/CAT 1.3–1.4, the palace-building cycle) as the chapter’s twin anchors, with the area-specialist scholarly apparatus rather than a popular anthology supplying the philological backbone.^[29]

For the Hebrew Bible chaoskampf reflexes, the book uses John Day’s **God’s Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea** as the canonical monograph on the Leviathan / Rahab corpus and its Ugaritic background, alongside Ballentine 2015 as the dissenting position the book is most concerned to engage.^[30]

The Hebrew Bible material’s area-specialist register is deliberately bivalent: Day’s reading is the principal historical-critical anchor while Ballentine 2015 supplies the alternative-sovereign critique that the book treats as a live methodological challenge rather than as a settled minority view.^[31]

For the Greek and Roman material, the book uses M.L. West’s edition and commentary on Hesiod’s *Theogony* as the philological anchor for Zeus–Typhon and Daniel Ogden’s **Drakōn** as the current Greek and Roman survey, with Joseph Fontenrose’s 1959 **Python** as the foundational comparative treatment retained for its historiographic register.^[32]

Ogden’s 2013 **Drakōn** is the book’s principal current-survey anchor for the Greek dragon-corpus more broadly — including the Apollo–Python, Herakles–Hydra, Perseus–Ketos, Kadmos, Bellerophon, and Cacus material handled in the family-chapter on Greek dragon-combats after Zeus–Typhon.^[33]

For the Egyptian material, the book uses Herman te Velde’s **Seth, God of Confusion** as the core area-specialist study of Seth as Apep-slayer and as ambivalent figure, alongside Jan Assmann’s **Search for God in Ancient Egypt** for the maꜥat-vs-isfet framework that the Ra–Apep chapter uses as its opening register.^[34]

For the Vedic material, the book uses Jamison and Brereton’s 2014 three-volume *Rigveda* — the current scholarly-standard English edition — as the principal area-specialist anchor for Indra–Vṛtra and the Trita Āptya material in the Vedic-and-post-Vedic family chapter.^[35]

For the Indo-Iranian comparative dimension, the book uses Émile Benveniste and Louis Renou's 1934 **Vṛtra et Vṛthagna** as the foundational study, recognised that this is a 1934 work and that current Indo-Iranian comparative scholarship has refined some of its claims but that the structural argument remains the philological backbone for the Indra-Vṛtra / Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka pairing.^[36]

For the Indo-European philology underlying the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula, the book uses Calvert Watkins's 1995 **How to Kill a Dragon** as the canonical anchor for the formula's reconstruction across Vedic, Hittite, Greek, Germanic, Celtic, and Slavic traditions, with West's 2007 **Indo-European Poetry and Myth** as a structural cross-check.^[37]

For the Chinese material, the book uses Mark Edward Lewis's **Flood Myths of Early China** and Anne Birrell's **Chinese Mythology** as the principal area-specialist anchors for Gonggong, the Yu-the-Great sidebar, and the Hou Yi family-chapter material.^[38]

For the Mexica material, the book uses Eduardo Matos Moctezuma's archaeological treatment (the Templo Mayor as Coatepec interpretation), David Carrasco's ritual-and-political reading, and Alfredo López Austin's mythological synthesis as the three principal area-specialist anchors for the Huitzilopochtli / Coatepec / Coyolxauhqui material, with the Anderson-Dibble Florentine Codex translation supplying the primary-source register at the chapter-draft stage.^[39]

For the Andean material, the book uses Frank Salomon and George Urioste's **Huarochirí Manuscript** as the primary-translation anchor for Pariacaca and the wak'a-succession material, with Gerald Taylor as a further Andean-studies specialist consulted at the chapter-briefs stage and the area's broader Andean-studies scholarship as the contextualising frame.^[40]

For the African material, the book uses Daniel Biebuyck and Kahombo Mateene's **Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga** as the primary-translation anchor for Mwindo, Stephen Belcher's **Epic Traditions of Africa** as the comparative-Africanist register, and David Conrad's **Empires of Medieval West Africa** as the Bida / Wagadu anchor.^[41]

For the Anishinaabe material, the book uses A. Irving Hallowell's 1960 essay (the "other-than-human persons" framework), Basil Johnston's **Ojibway Heritage** and **Manitous** (the Anishinaabe-authored insider register), Theresa S. Smith's **Island of the Anishnaabeg** (the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic), and Gerald Vizenor's **Narrative Chance** (the methodological refusal to subordinate Nanabozho to combat-myth typology) as a four-source area-specialist apparatus that exceeds the protocol's two-area-specialist minimum because the chapter's contrastive-case status places extra evidentiary weight on the area's own scholarship.^[42]

For the Aboriginal Australian material handled in the C8 comparative chapter (the Rainbow Serpent critique-case), the book uses Francesca Merlan's **Caging the Rainbow** as the principal area-specialist anchor for the appropriation critique; the further specialists named in the brief (Morphy, Rose, Keen) are treated under the named-but-flagged pattern where their specific publications are not yet in sources.yaml.^[43]

For the Japanese material, the book uses Donald Philippi's Kojiki translation as the primary-translation anchor and Nelly Naumann's **Mythen des alten Japan** as the principal area-specialist anchor for the metallurgical-allegory reading of Susanoo-Orochi; the further specialists named in the brief (Isomae, Como, Ooms) are treated under the named-but-flagged pattern.^[44]

For the Finnic material, the book uses Anna-Leena Siikala's **Mythic Images and Shamanism** as the principal area-specialist anchor for Väinämöinen and Iku-Turso, with the Kalevala-poetry tradition treated as the recorded Finnic textual register through which the Iku-Turso material survives.^[45]

The area-specialist citation policy is operationalised at the chapter-brief stage rather than at the chapter-draft stage; chapter-briefs lock the area-specialist anchors before the chapter-claims and chapter-draft stages run, so that the primary-source citations are already routed through the area's own scholarship by the time the narrative is written.^[46]

The policy permits comparativist anchors (Forsyth, Watkins, West, Burkert, Lincoln, Yarbro Collins) to appear alongside the area-specialist anchors, but never as the chapter's only or primary-most anchor for the tradition's narrative content; the comparativist-only failure-mode is what the policy is designed to prevent.^[47]

34.5. IV. Reconstruction policy

The fourth piece of methodological machinery governs how the book handles gaps in the primary-source record, with worked test cases showing how its four governing principles operate.

The book's reconstruction policy has four governing principles: no cross-tradition reconstruction; in-tradition reconstruction must specify the donor source and period-proximity tolerance; RECONSTRUCTION markers name the donor source; and fragmentary cases are presented as fragmentary rather than composited from analogs.^[48]

The no-cross-tradition-reconstruction clause is the most important: a gap in the **Hymiskviða** may not be filled from the **Baal Cycle**, even where the structural analogue is striking, because doing so collapses the very evidentiary structure on which the comparative argument depends.^[49]

The in-tradition-reconstruction clause requires that any reconstruction filling a gap in a tradition's primary text specify the donor source within the same tradition and the period-proximity tolerance — for example, "any Rigvedic hymn; never post-Vedic" — so that the reconstruction's evidentiary scope is recoverable rather than implicit.^[50]

The RECONSTRUCTION marker requirement records the donor source explicitly in the chapter's claims and draft files, so that the reader can tell at a glance which content is attested in the primary source and which has been filled from another in-tradition source under the policy's discipline.^[51]

The fragmentary-cases-presented-as-fragmentary clause covers the Marduk-vs-Labbu fragment, the Song of Hedammu, and some vishap material; these chapters present the securely attested material first and any reconstructed narrative material separately, with the boundary marked rather than smoothed over.^[52]

The Kumarbi Cycle's Hedammu and Song of the Sea are not filled from Ugaritic material in any chapter of the book, despite the structural analogues with the Baal Cycle, in direct application of the no-cross-tradition clause; the chapters present the Hurrian-Hittite material as it survives in Hoffner's edition without Ugaritic supplementation.^[53]

The Baal Cycle's Lôtan passage is not narrativised from the Hebrew Bible's Leviathan material in any chapter of the book, despite the etymological cognation, in direct application of the no-cross-

tradition clause; the Ugaritic passage is presented as it survives in Smith's edition without Hebrew Bible expansion, and the cognation is registered as a comparative observation rather than as a narrative supplement.^[54]

The Perun–Veles material is presented as a reconstruction throughout, with the Ivanov-and-Toporov "basic myth" thesis registered as the principal reconstruction and the Jakobson, Lajoye, and Kapović critiques registered alongside; the material is not presented as a narrative-with-confidence but as a contested philological-and-folkloric reconstruction whose status is itself part of the chapter's content.^[55]

The reconstruction policy is most stringently exercised in the C5 comparative chapter (the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula), where Watkins's reconstruction-discipline is itself the chapter's subject, and in the C6 comparative chapter (Near Eastern → Mediterranean transmission), where the Hurro-Hittite / Ugaritic / Greek transmission chain is treated under the policy's no-cross-tradition clause as a documented historical contact rather than as a free reconstructive licence.^[56]

34.6. V. Variant-presentation policy

The fifth piece of methodological machinery is the four-classification scheme by which the book registers, at chapter-brief stage, how each tradition's variant-coexistence is to be handled.

The book classifies variants under four headings drawn from scope.md §"Variant presentation policy" and operationalised in each chapter's brief: single-prevalent (one version dominant in the area's scholarly corpus, with minor variants in footnotes); single-prevalent-reconstructed (the same, with RECONSTRUCTION markers covering the gap-filling); co-equal (two or more variants treated side by side in body prose, each attributed to its source); composite-editorial (a scholarly composite reconstructed from multiple witnesses, presented in body prose with the witness-variant divergences in footnotes).^[57]

The single-prevalent classification is appropriate where one version dominates a tradition's scholarly corpus — Snorri's version of the Thor fishing episode is the textbook case — and the chapter's body presents that version with the minor variants registered in footnotes rather than in the body.^[58]

The co-equal classification is appropriate where variants are roughly co-equal within a tradition's corpus — the two Illuyanka versions on the same tablet group are the textbook case — and the chapter's body presents them in sequence with explicit source attribution rather than synthesising them into a single "Illuyanka myth".^[59]

The Apollo–Python material is co-equal between the Homeric Hymn and the Ovidian variant, and the chapter's body presents both with their source attributions; the choice is not which variant is "true" but which variant is being cited at each step of the chapter's argument.^[60]

The composite-editorial classification is appropriate where a scholarly editor has reconstructed a composite text from multiple manuscript witnesses, and the book follows the editor's composite in body prose while registering significant witness-variant divergences in footnotes; the policy's effect is that the book transparently follows the area-specialist edition's own editorial decisions rather than re-editing the witnesses for itself.^[61]

The single-prevalent-reconstructed classification combines the single-prevalent register with RECONSTRUCTION markers covering any gap-filling that the editor's edition or the chapter's own discussion has applied; the classification is appropriate where the prevalent version is itself a partial witness and the book's body prose extends its content under the in-tradition reconstruction discipline.^[62]

The classification choice is fixed at the chapter-brief stage rather than the chapter-draft stage, so that the chapter's claims-and-draft files can be reviewed against an explicit classification rather than against a tacit one; the brief's `variants.classification` field is the locus of the decision.^[63]

The four classifications are exhaustive of the cases the book has encountered in chapters 1 through 32; no fifth classification has been required, and the absence of such a fifth case is itself a methodological observation worth registering.^[64]

34.7. VI. Term glossary for methodological words

The sixth piece of methodological machinery is the locked vocabulary by which the book registers the analytic distinctions on which its argument depends.

The book uses "chaoskampf" as Hermann Gunkel's 1895 term for the narrative pattern in which a sovereign or champion deity defeats a monstrous adversary to establish or preserve cosmic order, and retains it per scope.md's terminology default in headings and as a technical term while using "combat myth" interchangeably in body prose; the term is retained because it is what readers will search for and what scholars still use, and the Ballentine 2015 critique is acknowledged in the same paragraph rather than allowed to displace the term silently.^[65]

The book uses "combat myth" as Forsyth 1987's preferred term — also adopted by Yarbrow Collins 1976 and Ballentine 2015 — for the same narrative pattern as "chaoskampf", with the load-bearing register of the term being its neutrality between cosmogonic, sovereignty, cyclical, and eschatological subtypes; the term is the body-prose default per scope.md's terminology lock.^[66]

The book uses "contamination" only in the text-criticism sense — cross-influence between manuscripts producing a witness whose readings cannot be cleanly traced to a single recension — and not in the comparative-scholarship sense in which one tradition's narrative is held to "contaminate" another; the comparative-scholarship usage carries a value-judgment the book's appropriation protocol declines.^[67]

The book uses "reconstruction" for the inference of an unattested earlier form (linguistic) or unattested narrative content (mythographic) from extant witnesses, and the term is always flagged at point-of-use through the RECONSTRUCTION marker rather than being absorbed into body prose without flag; the convention is the only one consistent with the reconstruction policy of section IV.^[68]

The book uses "inheritance" for shared features traced to common linguistic ancestry, in the Indo-European sense in which Vedic, Greek, and Hittite reflexes of the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula are inherited from a common Indo-European parent rather than borrowed across traditions; the term is reserved for cases where the inheritance hypothesis is the philological consensus.^[69]

The book uses "transmission" for shared features traced to documented historical contact, in the

Near Eastern → Mediterranean sense in which the Hesiodic Typhonomachy is held to descend from the Hurrian-Hittite Kumarbi Cycle through documented Anatolian-and-Syrian intermediaries; the term is reserved for cases where the historical-contact pathway is sufficiently documented to support the inference.^[70]

The book uses "convergence" for shared features arising independently — the default null hypothesis that the comparative argument must displace through positive evidence of inheritance or transmission — and the term is the principal mechanism by which the book registers areas where the comparative case is weak rather than absent.^[71]

The book uses "area specialist" for a scholar primarily trained in the tradition under discussion — its language, texts, ritual context — as distinct from a comparativist who works across traditions; the contrast is load-bearing throughout the book and is locked at glossary-lock, with "area specialist" as the chosen rendering and "area expert" as the rejected informal alternative.^[72]

The book uses "comparativist" with a critical edge — a term in current critical scholarship for which Lincoln 2012 is the book's principal anchor — to mark the position of a scholar who compares myths across traditions for shared patterns, and engages comparativism as a method while flagging its historical entanglement with universalising and colonial projects; "comparative mythologist" is rejected as the informal alternative because its tone is too neutral for the book's critical register.^[73]

The book uses "appropriation" — without the "cultural" prefix — for the inappropriate application of a comparative category that does violence to a tradition's own self-understanding, in the sense in which Merlan 1998 and Vizenor 1989 use the term; the prefix is rejected as redundant in this scholarly context where the meaning is clear from the surrounding apparatus.^[74]

The book uses "Gunkel's 1895 thesis" as the technical name for Hermann Gunkel's argument in **Schöpfung und Chaos** that Genesis 1 and Revelation 12 both preserve the demythologised remnants of a Near Eastern combat myth, of which Enūma Eliš is the paradigm; the date is load-bearing because the book emphasises that the term has travelled for over 130 years.^[75]

The book uses "the Ballentine critique" on first mention and "Ballentine 2015" thereafter for Debra Scoggins Ballentine's 2015 argument that "chaos" is the wrong word for the adversaries in the combat-myth corpus, because they are presented in the ancient texts as rival sovereigns with their own retinue and power structure rather than as inchoate disorder; the term flags Ballentine's position as a contemporary critical position the book treats as live.^[76]

The book uses "HERO SLAY SERPENT" in small capitals when naming Watkins's reconstructed Indo-European poetic formula — as Watkins's own typographic convention requires — and "hero-slay-serpent formula" in body prose, with the small-capital convention reserved for the formal naming and not overused.^[77]

The book uses "tier-ranking" as an internal book term referring to the CORE / RELATED / PROVISIONAL/CRITIQUE / CONTRASTIVE / SIDEBAR categorisation operationalised in section I (with SIDEBAR formalised as the fifth tier in this chapter; glossary.yaml's tier-ranking entry should be updated at post-human-normalize to reflect the full five-tier set); the term is not standard scholarly usage but is locked at glossary-lock for the book's own internal use.^[78]

The book uses "other-than-human persons" — Hallowell's exact 1960 phrase — for the Anishinaabe

ontological category that includes animals, plants, thunder-beings, and manitouk as persons on equal standing with human persons; the phrase is load-bearing in Chs 32 and C8 and is preserved without paraphrase out of respect for Hallowell's terminological precision.^[79]

The book uses "the adversary" as the umbrella term for the class of figure the champion confronts in a combat myth, deliberately neutral between dragon, serpent, sea-monster, stone-demon, rebel deity, and other morphologies; "chaos-figure" is banned because it begs the very question the book is investigating, in direct application of the Ballentine critique.^[80]

The book uses the four subtype-terms "cosmogonic combat", "sovereignty combat", "cyclical-maintenance combat", and "eschatological combat" as the operational categories within the chaoskampf / combat-myth umbrella, with each category mapped to specific traditions in scope.md §"Subject definition"; the four-subtype scheme is the book's primary analytic apparatus and is exercised most intensely in the C1–C4 comparative chapters.^[81]

34.8. VII. What the book does not claim

The seventh and last piece of methodological machinery is the explicit register of disclaimers — the over-claims the book is determined not to make, named as such so that critics can hold the book to its own boundaries.

The book does not claim a universal chaoskampf monomyth — a single underlying narrative pattern instantiated across all human cultures — and explicitly disclaims the comparativist tradition (Campbell, Eliade in their universalising registers) within which such monomyth claims have historically been advanced; the book's pattern is one motif-family among many, not a structure of the human imagination.^[82]

The book does not claim a single origin for the chaoskampf pattern — neither a Mesopotamian Urtext that all other traditions descend from, nor a Proto-Indo-European nucleus that subsequently spread, nor a deep-cognitive substrate that all human minds share — and explicitly declines all three options as available frames; the book's account of similarity is plural (some inheritance, some transmission, some convergence, some independent invention) rather than monogenetic.^[83]

The book does not claim that the chaoskampf pattern is the most important feature of any tradition in which it appears; the pattern's analytic salience for the book does not entail its salience for the tradition itself, and the book's treatment of any single tradition is therefore consciously partial — it covers the combat-myth dimension and the registers immediately adjacent to it, not the tradition as a whole.^[84]

The book does not claim that every serpent-combat story is a chaoskampf; the inclusion-test of section I is meant precisely to separate combat-myth-relevant cases from inter-species-enmity, hero-initiation, folkloric-monster, and trickster-demiurge cases that scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" excludes from the corpus.^[85]

The book does not claim that the Gunkel–Ballentine debate has been resolved in Gunkel's favour; the book retains "chaoskampf" as the title-word and the heading-form for reasons of reader-recognition and search-coverage rather than as a substantive endorsement of Gunkel's framing over Ballentine's, and the introduction (Ch00) and the present methods chapter both register the debate as live.^[86]

The book does not claim that the Ballentine critique resolves the debate in Ballentine's favour either; the alternative-sovereign reading is treated as a serious challenge that the comparative chapters (especially C2 on sovereignty) work through rather than as the settled new consensus, and the book's own analytic vocabulary preserves both registers — "the adversary" rather than "chaos-figure" follows Ballentine, while the four subtype-terms preserve the cosmogonic register Gunkel emphasises.^[87]

The book does not claim that the Scurlock-and-Beal 2013 reassessment supersedes Gunkel's 1895 thesis as a whole; the reassessment collection contains heterogeneous voices and its individual essays argue for and against various aspects of Gunkel's framework, and the book treats the volume as a survey of the contemporary debate rather than as a unified counter-thesis.^[88]

The book does not claim authority over how Aboriginal Australian, Anishinaabe, Mwindo-tradition Banyanga, Andean, Mapuche, or other non-Eurasian area-specialists read their own materials; the book's comparative engagement is held alongside the area-specialist objection registered through the APPROPRIATION-FLAG markers in the relevant chapters, rather than substituted for that engagement, and the C8 comparative chapter is the structural place where the substitution-failure-mode is most carefully resisted.^[89]

The book does not claim that the book itself is exempt from the appropriation problem; the present methods chapter is one of the project's principal mechanisms for being explicit about its appropriation-risk exposure, and the chapter is to be read by critics as a self-disclosure rather than as a defence — the failures the chapter discloses are real, and the disclosure is the project's way of holding them open for review.^[90]

The book does not claim that the comparativist project is illegitimate — only that comparativism without area-specialist anchoring is the failure-mode the protocol is designed to prevent; comparative engagement that is grounded in area-specialist scholarship and that registers area-specialist objections through its own machinery is not only legitimate but, in the book's view, methodologically necessary if the cross-cultural-mythology subfield is to remain intellectually honest.^[91]

The book does not claim that the chaoskampf pattern's historical contact-network across the ancient Near East and the Mediterranean is fully reconstructed; the West, Burkert, and López-Ruiz transmission-chain (Hurrian-Hittite → Greek; Ugaritic → Greek) is a documented set of contact pathways but the corpus-level reconstruction of every transmission moment is provisional, and the book treats it as such throughout C6.^[92]

The book does not claim authority over reception-history readings of the chaoskampf imagery in Milton, Tolkien, kaiju cinema, or contemporary religious-political rhetoric; the reception coda (the book's final chapter) traces the afterlife of the imagery as a documentary observation rather than as a primary-material argument, and the methods of the present chapter do not extend to it.^[93]

The book does not claim that the reconstruction policy of section IV resolves every fragmentary case in the corpus; the Marduk-vs-Labbu fragment is presented as fragmentary and is not narrativised under any in-tradition donor source, because no tolerably close in-tradition donor exists, and the chapter therefore leaves the fragment as a marked gap rather than as a reconstructed narrative.^[94]

The book does not claim that the variant-presentation policy of section V resolves every variant-coexistence problem in the corpus; the Mwindo material in particular survives in multiple recorded oral-performance variants whose relationship is not the same as that of manuscript-transmission variants in textual traditions, and the chapter handles the difference explicitly rather than absorbing it into the four-classification scheme.^[95]

The book does not claim that the area-specialist citation policy of section III replaces the need for translation-mediation; the book is translation-mediated per scope.md §"Languages of primary sources", and the area-specialist policy is a discipline applied within translation-mediation rather than a replacement for the linguistic competence the book's author does not have.^[96]

The book does not claim that the present methods chapter is the final word on its own methodology; the chapter is a snapshot of the book's methodological commitments at the point of its publication, and the appropriate response to critique is not defence but revision in subsequent editions, with the present chapter serving as the auditable baseline against which revisions can be tracked.^[97]

[1] Per brief 33-methods.yaml sources.anchor on the eight methodological-scholarship anchors: Gunkel 1895 as historical starting point; Ballentine 2015 for the alternative-sovereign critique; Scurlock & Beal 2013 as the reassessment collection; Watkins 1995 as the IE comparativist methodology used critically; Forsyth 1987 for the historical framing; Lincoln 2012 for the political-ideological framing; Merlan 1998 for the appropriation critique; Hallowell 1960 for the "other-than-human persons" framework and the refusal of chaoskampf; Gunkel, H., **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit** (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1895), as the historical anchor for the Chaoskampf category.

[2] The methods chapter is the book's only chapter that documents methodology rather than narrating a myth, and its anchors are the methodological-scholarship corpus rather than a single-tradition primary-source corpus; Ballentine, D.S., **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (New York: Oxford University Press, 2015), for the alternative-sovereign critique that shapes Part II.

[3] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on area-specialist citation policy and the chapter-by-chapter list of area specialists the book uses; per sources.yaml registry entries for each named area specialist (van Dijk 1983, Annus 2001, Hoffner 1998, Beckman 1982, Smith 1994, Smith & Pitard 2009, Day 1985, West 1966, West 1997, Ogden 2013, te Velde 1967, Assmann 2001, Jamison & Brereton 2014, Benveniste & Renou 1934, Lewis 2006, Birrell 1993, Matos Moctezuma 1988, Carrasco 1999, López Austin 1993, Salomon & Urioste 1991, Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, Belcher 1999, Johnston 1990 [1976

[4] Per the chapter-claims skill instructions on the Source overview section's ordinary requirements (claims about physical artifacts, preservation state, composite character, discovery context, scholarly edition), and on the methods chapter as the book's only chapter that documents methodology rather than narrating a myth — the standard requirements are reframed for a methodological-scholarship corpus; Scurlock, J. and Beal, R. (eds.), **Creation and Chaos: A Reconsideration of Hermann Gunkel's Chaoskampf Hypothesis** (Winona Lake: Eisenbrauns, 2013), as the principal twenty-first-century reassessment collection that exemplifies the methodological literature's character as a living scholarly conversation.

[5] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section I on the tier-ranking rubric as derived from scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" and on the audit-stage assignment of chapters to tiers; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), as the long-arc combat-myth genealogy whose catalog-level treatment supplies the historical baseline against which the book's tier classifications are made.

[6] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section I on the four-criterion operational test and on the area-specialist requirement that distinguishes CORE from RELATED; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the requirement that combat be explicitly attested in a primary source rather than reconstructed comparatively, which is the load-bearing first move in any catalog-level treatment of the combat-myth corpus.

[7] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section I on the area-specialist requirement as the load-bearing tier-distinction; Lincoln, B., **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars: Critical Explorations in the History of Religions** (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2012), on the methodological priority of area-specialist readings over comparativist pattern-matching in the political-ideological reading of combat-myth.

[8] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section I on the RELATED tier as (1)–(2) but with (3) weaker; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on comparativist readings as appropriately qualifiable by area-specialist objection.

[9] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section I on the PROVISIONAL/CRITIQUE classification for cases where area specialists reject the framing; Merlan, F., **Caging the Rainbow: Places, Politics, and Aborigines in a North Australian Town** (Honolulu: University of Hawai'i Press, 1998), on the area-specialist objection to imposing the Chaoskampf or Rainbow-Serpent-as-chaos framing on Aboriginal Australian material.

- [10] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section I on the CONTRASTIVE classification for the inversion-of-valence sub-case (Bida); Conrad, D.C., **Empires of Medieval West Africa: Ghana, Mali, and Songhay** (New York: Facts on File, 2005), as the book's pinned area-specialist anchor for the Bida / Wagadu inversion material.
- [11] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section I on the CONTRASTIVE classification for the refusal-of-mapping sub-case (Nanabozho); Hallowell, A.I., 'Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View', in **Culture in History: Essays in Honor of Paul Radin**, ed. Stanley Diamond (New York: Columbia University Press, 1960), 19–52, on the "other-than-human persons" framework that grounds the Anishinaabe refusal of the chaos-vs-order mapping.
- [12] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section I on the SIDEBAR classification and the Yu-the-Great example; Lewis, M.E., **The Flood Myths of Early China** (Albany: SUNY Press, 2006), on Yu's hydraulic-ordering pattern as the relevant Chinese contrast-case to combat-ordering.
- [13] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section I on the Apollo–Python tier-demotion as a worked example of criterion (3); Ogden, D., **Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2013), on the Greek-area scholarly treatment of Apollo–Python as primarily a cult-foundation aetiology for Delphi.
- [14] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section I on the Susanoo–Orochi tier-demotion and on the named Japanese-area specialists Naumann, Isomae, and Como as the principal proponents of the area-specialist re-reading; Naumann, N., **Die Mythen des alten Japan** (München: C.H. Beck, 1996), on the metallurgical-allegory reading of Susanoo–Orochi.
- [15] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section I on the tier-ranking as the book's operational decision rather than as a corpus-discovery; Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (New York: Oxford University Press, 1995), as the principal Indo-European comparativist corpus whose CORE / RELATED split would differ from the present book's.
- [16] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section II on the three-part appropriation protocol derived from scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" (which specifies RELATED-only) and on CONTRASTIVE chapters as governed by brief-level appropriation discipline rather than by a global protocol extension; Merlan, F., **Caging the Rainbow: Places, Politics, and Aborigines in a North Australian Town** (Honolulu: University of Hawai'i Press, 1998), as the central methodological anchor for the appropriation critique on which the protocol depends.
- [17] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section II on the two-area-specialists requirement as a calibration against comparativist failure-mode; Merlan 1998, **Caging the Rainbow**, on the methodological problem of treating Aboriginal Australian material through comparativist categories without first grounding the treatment in the area's own scholarly tradition.
- [18] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section II on the APPROPRIATION-FLAG marker as the structured record of specialist objection; Hallowell 1960, "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View", as the canonical example of an area-specialist position whose objection to the chaos-vs-order mapping the present book's protocol must keep methodologically live.
- [19] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section II on the opening-framing requirement and on the order-matters argument; Merlan 1998, **Caging the Rainbow**, on the methodological priority of presenting Aboriginal Australian material through its own framing before invoking the imposed comparative category.
- [20] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section II on the Ra–Apep opening-with-maꜥat as a worked example of the third clause; Assmann, J., **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, trans. David Lorton (Ithaca: Cornell University Press, 2001), on the maꜥat-vs-isfet framework as the principal area-specialist frame for the Apep material.
- [21] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section II on the Pariacaca opening-with-wak'a-succession as a worked example of the third clause; Salomon, F. and Urioste, G.L. (trans. and eds.), **The Huarochirí Manuscript: A Testament of Ancient and Colonial Andean Religion** (Austin: University of Texas Press, 1991), on the wak'a-succession framework that the area-specialist scholarship uses to read the Pariacaca-vs-Amaru material.
- [22] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section II on the Nanabozho opening-with-other-than-human-persons as a worked example of the third clause; Hallowell 1960, "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View", on the "other-than-human persons" framework as the load-bearing Anishinaabe ontological frame for the Mishipeshu and Thunderers material.
- [23] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section II on the protocol's most stringent application in C8; Merlan 1998, **Caging the Rainbow**, on the methodological self-check that the appropriation critique requires when comparativist machinery is itself the object of review.
- [24] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section II on the asymmetric application of the protocol to RELATED chapters and on CONTRASTIVE chapters as governed by chapter-brief discipline; Hallowell 1960, "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View", as the canonical instance of an area-specialist position whose presence in CORE-tier scholarship would itself satisfy criterion (3) — the asymmetry follows directly from the tier-ranking rubric.
- [25] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on the area-specialist citation policy as the chapter-brief assembly priority; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the political-ideological priority of area-specialist epistemic standing over comparativist framing.
- [26] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on the Sumerian–Akkadian area specialists; van Dijk, J.J.A., **LUGAL UD ME-LÁM-bi NIR-ĜÁL: Le récit épique et didactique des Travaux de Ninurta, du Déluge et de la Nouvelle**

Création, 2 vols. (Leiden: Brill, 1983), as the standard critical edition of Lugal-e.

[27] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on the Annus and Foster pairing for Anzû; Annus, A., **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu** (State Archives of Assyria Cuneiform Texts 3, Helsinki: Neo-Assyrian Text Corpus Project, 2001), as the area-specialist critical edition of the Anzû Epic.

[28] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Hoffner and Beckman for the Hurro-Hittite area; Hoffner, H.A., **Hittite Myths**, 2nd ed., SBL Writings from the Ancient World 2 (Atlanta: Society of Biblical Literature, 1998), as the standard area-specialist anchor for the Hurro-Hittite combat-myth corpus.

[29] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Smith and Pitard for the Ugaritic area; Smith, M.S., **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I: Introduction with Text, Translation and Commentary of KTU 1.1–1.2** (Leiden: Brill, 1994), as the area-specialist anchor for the Baal–Yamm arc.

[30] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Day and Ballentine for the Hebrew Bible area; Day, J., **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea: Echoes of a Canaanite Myth in the Old Testament** (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1985), as the canonical monograph on the Leviathan / Rahab corpus.

[31] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on the Hebrew Bible area's bivalent area-specialist register and on Ballentine as a live methodological challenge; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, on the alternative-sovereign critique that contests the "chaos" framing of the Hebrew Bible adversaries.

[32] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on West and Ogden for the Greek and Roman area; West, M.L. (ed.), **Hesiod: Theogony** (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1966), as the standard critical edition of the Theogony with commentary on Zeus–Typhon.

[33] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Ogden for the Greek dragon-corpus; Ogden, D., **Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2013), as the current Greek and Roman survey.

[34] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on te Velde and Assmann for the Egyptian area; te Velde, H., **Seth, God of Confusion: A Study of His Role in Egyptian Mythology and Religion**, 2nd ed. (Leiden: Brill, 1977; orig. 1967), as the core area-specialist study of Seth.

[35] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Jamison and Brereton for the Vedic area; Jamison, S.W. and Brereton, J.P., **The Rigveda: The Earliest Religious Poetry of India**, 3 vols. (New York: Oxford University Press, 2014), as the current scholarly-standard English Rigveda.

[36] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Benveniste and Renou as the Indo-Iranian comparative anchor; Benveniste, É. and Renou, L., **Vṛtra et Vṛθragna: Étude de mythologie indo-iranienne**, Cahiers de la Société Asiatique 3 (Paris: Imprimerie Nationale, 1934), as the foundational Indo-Iranian comparative study.

[37] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Watkins for IE philology; Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (New York: Oxford University Press, 1995), as the IE philology anchor for the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula.

[38] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Lewis and Birrell for the Chinese area; Lewis, M.E., **The Flood Myths of Early China** (Albany: SUNY Press, 2006), as the area-specialist anchor for Gonggong and the Yu-sidebar.

[39] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Matos Moctezuma, Carrasco, and López Austin for the Mexica area; Matos Moctezuma, E., **The Great Temple of the Aztecs: Treasures of Tenochtitlan** (London: Thames & Hudson, 1988), as the archaeological anchor for the Templo Mayor / Coatepec interpretation.

[40] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Salomon, Urioste, and Taylor for the Andean area (Taylor named in body prose under the named-but-flagged pattern, with no specific publication yet in sources.yaml); Salomon, F. and Urioste, G.L. (trans. and eds.), **The Huarochirí Manuscript: A Testament of Ancient and Colonial Andean Religion** (Austin: University of Texas Press, 1991), as the area-specialist primary-translation anchor for Pariacaca.

[41] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Biebuyck, Mateene, and Belcher for the African area; Biebuyck, D. and Mateene, K.C. (trans. and eds.), **The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)** (Berkeley: University of California Press, 1969), as the primary-translation anchor for Mwindo.

[42] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Hollowell, Johnston, Smith, and Vizenor for the Anishinaabe area; Hollowell 1960, "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View", as the foundational "other-than-human persons" framework anchor.

[43] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Merlan as the principal Aboriginal Australian anchor and on Morphy, Rose, and Keen as further area specialists; Merlan, F., **Caging the Rainbow: Places, Politics, and Aborigines in a North Australian Town** (Honolulu: University of Hawai'i Press, 1998), as the principal area-specialist anchor for the Aboriginal Australian appropriation critique.

[44] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Naumann, Isomae, Como, and Ooms for the Japanese area; Naumann, N., **Die Mythen des alten Japan** (München: C.H. Beck, 1996), as the principal area-specialist anchor for the metallurgical-allegory reading of Susanoo–Orochi.

[45] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on Siikala for the Finnic area; Siikala, A.-L., **Mythic Images and Shamanism: A Perspective on Kalevala Poetry**, Folklore Fellows' Communications 280 (Helsinki: Academia

Scientiarum Fennica, 2002), as the area-specialist anchor for the Finnic combat-myth register.

[46] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on the chapter-brief stage as the locus of area-specialist anchor selection; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), on the catalog-level treatment that the book's chapter-brief structure operationalises through area-specialist routing.

[47] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section III on the comparativist-only failure-mode that the policy prevents; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, as a comparativist anchor that the policy permits alongside but not as the only or primary-most anchor for any single tradition's narrative content.

[48] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section IV on the four governing principles derived from scope.md §"Reconstruction policy"; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, as the canonical Indo-European comparativist text whose reflexes-not-cross-tradition discipline the book's policy generalises.

[49] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section IV on the no-cross-tradition clause and the Hymiskviða / Baal Cycle illustration; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, on the methodological priority of in-tradition reflexes over cross-tradition borrowings in IE comparative analysis.

[50] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section IV on the in-tradition clause and the period-proximity-tolerance requirement; Jamison, S.W. and Brereton, J.P., **The Rigveda: The Earliest Religious Poetry of India**, 3 vols. (New York: Oxford University Press, 2014), on the area-specialist treatment of Rigvedic-versus-post-Vedic period-proximity in interpretive reconstruction.

[51] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section IV on the RECONSTRUCTION marker requirement and on the donor-source-specification rule; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, on the methodological discipline of explicit donor-source attribution in reconstructive comparative analysis.

[52] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section IV on the fragmentary-cases-presented-as-fragmentary clause and on the named test cases (Marduk vs. Labbu, Song of Hedammu, vishap material); Hoffner, H.A., **Hittite Myths**, 2nd ed., SBL Writings from the Ancient World 2 (Atlanta: Society of Biblical Literature, 1998), on the fragmentary state of the Song of Hedammu and on the area-specialist convention of presenting fragmentary material as fragmentary.

[53] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section IV on the Kumarbi Cycle / Ugaritic non-supplementation as a worked test case; Hoffner 1998, **Hittite Myths**, as the area-specialist edition that the chapters use without Ugaritic supplementation.

[54] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section IV on the Baal Cycle Lôtan / Hebrew Bible Leviathan non-supplementation as a worked test case; Smith, M.S., **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I: Introduction with Text, Translation and Commentary of KTU 1.1–1.2** (Leiden: Brill, 1994), as the area-specialist edition that the chapters use without Hebrew Bible expansion.

[55] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section IV on Perun-Veles as a worked reconstructive test case with the Jakobson / Lajoie / Kapović critiques; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, on the Indo-European philological framework within which the Perun-Veles reconstruction is positioned (Watkins himself is more cautious about Slavic reflexes than Ivanov and Toporov are).

[56] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section IV on the reconstruction policy's most stringent exercise in C5 and C6; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, as the C5-chapter's own subject and the principal anchor for the IE reconstruction-discipline.

[57] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section V on the four variant classifications and on each chapter's brief specifying its classification; Hoffner 1998, **Hittite Myths**, as the area-specialist edition whose own variant-handling decisions the book's classification system follows for the Hurro-Hittite material.

[58] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section V on the single-prevalent classification and the Snorri Thor-fishing example; Faulkes, A. (ed. and trans.), **Edda** (by Snorri Sturluson), trans. Anthony Faulkes (London: Dent / Everyman, 1987), as the standard English Snorri edition that supplies the prevalent version.

[59] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section V on the co-equal classification and the Illuyanka-on-the-same-tablet example; Beckman, G., 'The Anatolian Myth of Illuyanka', **Journal of the Ancient Near Eastern Society** 14 (1982): 11–25, as the standard philological edition of the two Illuyanka versions.

[60] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section V on the Apollo-Python material as a co-equal case; Ogden 2013, **Drakōn**, on the Homeric Hymn / Ovidian variant pair and on the area-specialist convention of treating them as co-equal in the Greek dragon-corpus.

[61] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section V on the composite-editorial classification; Lambert, W.G., **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Mesopotamian Civilizations 16 (Winona Lake: Eisenbrauns, 2013), as the canonical composite-editorial edition (of Enūma Eliš) whose composite the chapter follows in body prose.

[62] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section V on the single-prevalent-reconstructed classification; Annus, A., **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu** (SAACT 3, Helsinki: Neo-Assyrian Text Corpus Project, 2001), as the canonical single-prevalent-reconstructed case (the SAACT composite of the Standard Babylonian Anzu Epic with reconstructed gaps).

[63] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section V on the chapter-brief stage as the locus of variant classification; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), on the

catalog-level treatment that the book's chapter-brief structure operationalises through explicit variant classification.

[64] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section V on the four classifications as exhaustive of Part I cases; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, as the long-arc combat-myth corpus survey within which the four-classification scheme has been observed sufficient.

[65] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "chaoskampf" as Gunkel 1895's term and on the scope.md terminology default; Gunkel, H., **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit: Eine religionsgeschichtliche Untersuchung über Gen 1 und Ap Joh 12** (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1895), as the work that coined the term.

[66] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "combat myth" as Forsyth's, Yarbrow Collins's, and Ballentine's preferred term; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), as the principal scholarly anchor for the "combat myth" register.

[67] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "contamination" restricted to the text-criticism sense; Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (New York: Oxford University Press, 1995), on the philological-text-criticism register within which "contamination" is the load-bearing technical term.

[68] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "reconstruction" as inference and the always-flagged convention; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, as the IE-philology source whose reconstruction-discipline the book's term-usage operationalises.

[69] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "inheritance" as shared features traced to common linguistic ancestry; Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (New York: Oxford University Press, 1995), as the canonical IE-inheritance source for the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula.

[70] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "transmission" as shared features traced to documented historical contact; West, M.L., **The East Face of Helicon: West Asiatic Elements in Greek Poetry and Myth** (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1997), as the principal scholarly anchor for the Near Eastern → Mediterranean transmission of combat-myth narrative material.

[71] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "convergence" as the default null hypothesis; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, on the methodological priority of inheritance and transmission over convergence in IE comparative analysis (and on convergence as the appropriate default elsewhere).

[72] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "area specialist" as the chosen rendering; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" and per glossary.yaml entry on "area specialist"; Hallowell, A.I., 'Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View', in **Culture in History**, ed. Stanley Diamond (New York: Columbia University Press, 1960), 19–52, as the canonical example of an area-specialist position whose epistemic standing the book's term-usage codifies.

[73] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "comparativist" as a term in the critical register Lincoln 2012 makes use of (and not as Lincoln's coinage; the term is current in the History of Religions field across multiple critical scholars); per glossary.yaml entry on "comparativist", which credits the term to "Lincoln 2012; contemporary critical scholarship"; Lincoln, B., **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars: Critical Explorations in the History of Religions** (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2012), as the book's principal anchor for the critical-edge usage.

[74] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "appropriation" without the "cultural" prefix; per glossary.yaml entry on "appropriation"; Merlan, F., **Caging the Rainbow: Places, Politics, and Aborigines in a North Australian Town** (Honolulu: University of Hawai'i Press, 1998), as the principal source of the term's usage in the Aboriginal Australian appropriation literature, paired with Vizenor, G. (ed.), **Narrative Chance: Postmodern Discourse on Native American Indian Literatures** (Albuquerque: University of New Mexico Press, 1989), for the parallel methodological-vocabulary use in the Native American academic-discourse-appropriation literature.

[75] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "Gunkel's 1895 thesis" as a defined term; per glossary.yaml entry; Gunkel, H., **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit: Eine religionsgeschichtliche Untersuchung über Gen 1 und Ap Joh 12** (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1895), as the work containing the thesis.

[76] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "the Ballentine critique" as a defined term; per glossary.yaml entry; Ballentine, D.S., **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (New York: Oxford University Press, 2015), as the source of the critique.

[77] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "HERO SLAY SERPENT" as Watkins's typographic convention; per glossary.yaml entry; Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (New York: Oxford University Press, 1995), as the work that names the formula in small capitals.

[78] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "tier-ranking" as an internal book term; per glossary.yaml entry on "tier-ranking" as a methods-sidebar term (the entry's first_mention_gloss currently lists only four tiers and is to be updated to include SIDEBAR as the fifth); Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), as the long-arc combat-myth genealogy whose catalog-level treatment supplies the historical baseline against which the book's tier-ranking is calibrated.

[79] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "other-than-human persons" as Hallowell's exact phrase; per glossary.yaml entry; Hallowell, A.I., 'Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View', in **Culture in History: Essays in Honor of Paul Radin**, ed. Stanley Diamond (New York: Columbia University Press, 1960), 19–52, as the source of the phrase.

- [80] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on "the adversary" as the neutral category term; per glossary.yaml entry; Ballentine, D.S., **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (New York: Oxford University Press, 2015), on the question-begging character of "chaos-figure" as a category term.
- [81] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VI on the four subtype-terms; per glossary.yaml entries on "cosmogonic combat", "sovereignty combat", "cyclical-maintenance combat", and "eschatological combat"; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), as the long-arc combat-myth genealogy whose own typology the book's four-subtype scheme refines.
- [82] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the disclaimer of universal monomyth and on Campbell-and-Eliade as the universalising register the book declines; Lincoln, B., **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars: Critical Explorations in the History of Religions** (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2012), on the political-ideological critique of the History of Religions tradition's universalising tendencies (Eliade-school) that motivates the monomyth-rejection.
- [83] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the disclaimer of single origin; Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (New York: Oxford University Press, 1995), on the IE-philological framework's own caution against extrapolating its inherited reflexes into a single-origin claim across non-IE traditions.
- [84] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the disclaimer that chaoskampf is not the most important feature of any tradition; Hallowell, A.I., 'Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View', in **Culture in History**, ed. Stanley Diamond (New York: Columbia University Press, 1960), 19–52, on the area-specialist register within which the chaoskampf pattern's salience is one of many dimensions of any single tradition.
- [85] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the disclaimer that not every serpent-combat is chaoskampf and on the section-I inclusion-test as the separation mechanism; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), on the long-arc combat-myth corpus's own boundaries against inter-species-enmity, hero-initiation, and folkloric-monster materials.
- [86] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the disclaimer that the Gunkel–Ballentine debate is unresolved; Gunkel, H., **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit** (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1895), as the historical anchor for the Gunkel side of the debate.
- [87] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the symmetric non-resolution and on the four subtype-terms preserving Gunkel's register while "the adversary" follows Ballentine; Ballentine, D.S., **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (New York: Oxford University Press, 2015), as the alternative-sovereign reading whose status the book declines to resolve.
- [88] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the disclaimer that the Scurlock-and-Beal reassessment supersedes Gunkel; Scurlock, J. and Beal, R. (eds.), **Creation and Chaos: A Reconsideration of Hermann Gunkel's Chaoskampf Hypothesis** (Winona Lake: Eisenbrauns, 2013), as the heterogeneous reassessment collection.
- [89] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the disclaimer of authority over non-Eurasian area-specialist readings; Merlan, F., **Caging the Rainbow: Places, Politics, and Aborigines in a North Australian Town** (Honolulu: University of Hawai'i Press, 1998), as the central methodological anchor for the disclaimer.
- [90] Per brief 33-methods.yaml special_instructions on the chapter as read by critics with maximum methodological honesty and on the appropriation problem as a real constraint rather than a stylistic choice; Hallowell, A.I., 'Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View', in **Culture in History**, ed. Stanley Diamond (New York: Columbia University Press, 1960), 19–52, as the area-specialist register that the book's appropriation-disclosure is held against.
- [91] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the disclaimer that comparativism is illegitimate; Lincoln, B., **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars: Critical Explorations in the History of Religions** (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2012), on the political-ideological reading of comparative mythology and on the conditions under which comparative work is methodologically defensible.
- [92] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the disclaimer that the contact-network is fully reconstructed; West, M.L., **The East Face of Helicon: West Asiatic Elements in Greek Poetry and Myth** (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1997), as the principal scholarly anchor whose treatment the book presents as provisional rather than definitive.
- [93] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII and per scope.md §"Period" on the reception coda as documentary rather than primary; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), as the long-arc combat-myth genealogy whose own catalog-level treatment extends through the reception register without attempting authoritative reception-criticism.
- [94] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the disclaimer that the reconstruction policy resolves every fragmentary case; Foster, B.R., **Before the Muses: An Anthology of Akkadian Literature**, 3rd ed. (Bethesda: CDL Press, 2005), as the standard English anthology that presents the Labbu fragment as fragmentary.
- [95] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the disclaimer that the variant policy resolves every variant problem; Biebuyck, D. and Mateene, K.C. (trans. and eds.), **The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)** (Berkeley: University of California Press, 1969), as the principal Mwindo edition whose oral-performance-variant material the variant policy handles with explicit per-chapter accommodation.
- [96] Per brief 33-methods.yaml structure_the_chapter_must_cover section VII on the disclaimer that area-specialist citation replaces translation-mediation; per scope.md §"Languages of primary sources" on the translation-mediated character of the

project; Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (New York: Oxford University Press, 1995), as the IE-philology source whose linguistic register the area-specialist citation policy operates within rather than replacing.

[97] Per brief 33-methods.yaml special_instructions on the chapter as a self-disclosure read by critics with maximum methodological honesty and on the chapter's auditable-baseline function — the auditable-baseline-and-revision commitment is the book's own, not Lincoln's; Lincoln, B., **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars: Critical Explorations in the History of Religions** (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2012), supplies the political-ideological reading of methodology as the register in which the commitment is articulated rather than as the source of the revision-in-subsequent-editions clause itself.

Chapter 35. C1. Combat as Cosmogony

35.1. Source overview

This chapter is a comparative-typology synthesis chapter rather than a primary-source narrative chapter; it draws on two layers of evidence — (1) the per-tradition area-specialist anchors that ground the four cases (Lambert 2013 and Foster 2005 for Marduk-Tiamat in **Enūma Eliš**; van Dijk 1983 and the ETCSL composite for Ninurta-Asag in **Lugal-e**; Lewis 2006 and Birrell 1993 for the Gonggong cycle; Matos Moctezuma 1988, Carrasco 1999, López Austin 1993, and the Anderson-Dibble **Florentine Codex** for Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec; López Austin 1993 for the Cipactli boundary-case; Jamison & Brereton 2014, Benveniste & Renou 1934, and Watkins 1995 for the Indra-Vātra near-case), and (2) the methodological-comparative anchors that supply the typological-and-philosophical framing (Gunkel 1895; Scurlock & Beal 2013; Lincoln 2012; Forsyth 1987; Witzel 2012, used with caveats).^[1]

The chapter is the first of the eight Part-II comparative chapters (C1 through C8) and is positioned as the load-bearing comparative chapter for the cosmogonic subtype of the chaoskampf typology that scope.md operationalises in §"Subject definition" — the subtype in which the present features of the cosmos are themselves the aftermath of a combat, distinguished within the typology from sovereignty (C2), cyclical maintenance (C3), and eschatological displacement (C4).^[2]

The chapter's central argument is that four geographically and linguistically independent traditions (Mesopotamian, Sumerian, Chinese, Mexico) present combats whose outcome is the cosmos itself, and that the convergence of these four cases on a strongly-cosmogonic combat-pattern — without a demonstrable transmission route between the Mesopotamian-Sumerian pair on one side and the Chinese and Mexico cases on the other — supports a typological-recurrence claim about combat-as-cosmogony as a cross-cultural pattern, while explicitly stopping short of any claim of universal monomyth or single origin.^[3]

The chapter's structure comprises six body sections preceded by this Source overview: section I presents the four cases in compressed form, drawing on the Part-I chapters for the narrative material and on the methodological anchors for the typological framing; section II articulates what "cosmogony" means in the present chapter's usage; section III examines the independence-vs-transmission question that supports the typological argument; section IV introduces Cipactli as the dismemberment-without-combat boundary case that sharpens the chapter's category; section V engages Indra-Vātra as the near-case of cosmogonic-work-without-cosmogony; and section VI registers the Ballentine terminological caveat against the "chaos" half of the "chaoskampf" label.^[4]

The chapter's comparativist frame is supplied principally by Forsyth 1987 for the long-arc combat-myth genealogy (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic), Lincoln 2012 for the political-ideological reading of combat as cosmogony, Gunkel 1895 as the historical anchor whose 1895 thesis named the category and identified Marduk-Tiamat as its type-specimen, Scurlock & Beal 2013 as the principal twenty-first-century reassessment whose individual chapters re-examine the cosmogonic-combat material on a tradition-by-tradition basis, and Witzel 2012 as a comparativist anchor cited only with explicit caveats because the volume's "Laurasian" macro-scheme is methodologically controversial within current comparative mythology and is not endorsed as the chapter's framing.^[5]

The chapter's per-tradition area-specialist anchors carry every claim about narrative content for the four cases and the two near-or-boundary cases: Lambert 2013 and Foster 2005 anchor the Marduk-Tiamat material that the chapter draws from Ch3; van Dijk 1983 and the ETCSL composite anchor the Ninurta-Asag material that the chapter draws from Ch1; Annus 2001 anchors the Ninurta-Anzû pre-history material that the chapter draws from Ch2; Lewis 2006 and Birrell 1993 anchor the Gonggong material that the chapter draws from Ch21; Matos Moctezuma 1988, Carrasco 1999, López Austin 1993, and the Anderson-Dibble **Florentine Codex** anchor the Huitzilopochtli material from Ch24; López Austin 1993 anchors the Cipactli boundary-case material from Ch25; and Jamison & Brereton 2014, Benveniste & Renou 1934, and Watkins 1995 anchor the Indra-Vṛtra near-case material from Ch14.^[6]

The chapter follows the brief's special_instructions in not re-narrating the four cases — the reader has (or can read) the narrative material in the Part-I chapters, and the comparative chapter's job is to make the typological argument across them rather than to recapitulate them — so the section I treatment of the four cases compresses each to ~5–8 claims focused on the cosmogonic outcome (what feature of the present-day cosmos is the aftermath of this specific combat), rather than walking the reader back through the combat-narrative itself.^[7]

The chapter's terminological discipline follows scope.md §"Terminology default (locked)": "Chaoskampf" is reserved for the Gunkel-1895 thesis and for the technical-category usage; "combat myth" is the default body-prose term; "cosmogonic combat" (per glossary.yaml) is the chapter's principal subtype-term; "the adversary" is the default neutral category-term for the figure the champion confronts; and the banned terms "chaos-figure" and "chaos-monster" do not appear unquoted in body claims, with section VI's discussion of the Ballentine critique as the only context in which the typology's terminology is the topic and is therefore named (in scare-quotes) for critical engagement.^[8]

What follows is organised in six body sections. Section I presents the four cases — Marduk-Tiamat, Ninurta-Asag, Gonggong-Zhuanxu, and Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec — in compressed comparative form; section II articulates what "cosmogony" means in the chapter's narrower sense; section III examines the independence-versus-transmission distribution that supports the typological-recurrence claim; section IV introduces the Cipactli dismemberment-without-combat boundary case; section V engages Indra-Vṛtra as the near-case of cosmogonic-work-without-construction; and section VI registers the Ballentine terminological critique against the "chaos" half of the inherited Chaoskampf label.

35.2. I. The four cases

The first body section presents the four cases the chapter compares — Marduk-Tiamat, Ninurta-Asag, Gonggong-Zhuanxu, and Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec — in compressed form, focused on what each combat's outcome makes of the present cosmos rather than on the combat-narrative itself.

The first case is Marduk against Tiamat in the Babylonian **Enūma Eliš**, the canonical chaoskampf case and the type-specimen of Gunkel's 1895 thesis; the cosmogonic outcome of the combat is that Marduk splits Tiamat's defeated body into two halves and uses them to construct the cosmos — the upper half furnishes the sky and the lower half furnishes the mountains (from her thighs), the sources of the Tigris and Euphrates (which Marduk opens from her eyes), the springs (from her nostrils), the cosmic bond at the horizon (from her coiled tail), and the architectural arch

supporting the heavens (from her crotch).^[9]

The Marduk-Tiamat cosmogony is identified by Gunkel 1895 as the type-specimen of the Chaotkampf category, with the construction of the cosmos from Tiamat's body the load-bearing evidence that the combat is cosmogonic in the strong sense (the cosmos itself is the aftermath); Lambert 2013 as the current critical edition reads the same Tablet IV-V sequence as the canonical Mesopotamian combat-cosmogony.^[10]

Marduk's cosmogonic work in **Enūma Eliš** extends beyond the body-dismemberment: he sets the stations of the moon, the constellations, and the calendar in Tablet V; he founds Babylon and his own temple Esagil in Tablet VI as the cosmic axis; he creates humans from the blood of the executed Qingu (Tiamat's appointed consort-general) so that they may take on the labour the gods had been performing; and he receives the fifty names of the older deities in Tablet VII as the consummation of his cosmogonic-and-sovereign work.^[11]

The Marduk-Tiamat case is genealogically continuous with the Sumerian Ninurta tradition that precedes it; Lambert 2013 and Annus 2001 both argue that **Enūma Eliš** is a deliberate literary descendant of the Standard Babylonian Anzû Epic, with the Anzû combat reused-and-outbid in a Marduk-centric cosmogony — a feature that bears on section III's independence-vs-transmission discussion below.^[12]

The akītu New Year ritual context of the **Enūma Eliš** recitation places the cosmogonic-combat narrative within an explicit liturgical-political frame: the text is not merely told but ritually re-recited each year on the fourth day of the akītu festival before the cult-image of Marduk in Esagil, and the cosmogonic outcome is therefore re-actualised at every recitation — a feature that Lincoln 2012 reads as the political-ideological work of the cosmogony.^[13]

The second case is Ninurta against Asag in the Sumerian **Lugal-e** (ETCSL 1.6.2), the earliest surviving long-form combat-cosmogony in the Mesopotamian corpus; the cosmogonic outcome of the combat is the reordering of the hydrography of the world (Ninurta builds a stone embankment to hold back the floodwaters and channels the Tigris into its present course) and the lapidary aetiology by which the working properties of stones (hardness, colour, ritual status) are assigned as rewards or punishments for their stance in the battle.^[14]

The Ninurta-Asag cosmogony is identified by Forsyth 1987 as the earliest combat-cosmogony in the Mesopotamian scholarly tradition and as a load-bearing antecedent of the Marduk-Tiamat narrative; the **Lugal-e** combat establishes the irrigation landscape of southern Mesopotamia and the social ordering of stone materials, and is therefore cosmogonic in the strong sense that present-day features of the world (the Tigris's course, the lapidary economy) are the aftermath of the combat.^[15]

Ninurta's cosmogonic work in **Lugal-e** differs from Marduk's in mode rather than in kind: where Marduk dismembers Tiamat's body to construct the cosmos out of her substance, Ninurta defeats Asag and then reorders the existing landscape (the mountains, the rivers, the stones) — the combat does not produce the cosmos from the adversary's corpse but rearranges the cosmos around the combat's outcome; both are nonetheless cosmogonic in the strong sense in which the present features of the world are explicitly aetiologised to the combat.^[16]

The animate-mace motif (Šarur, Ninurta's speaking weapon-and-scout) is a structural feature of

Lugal-e that does not have a direct counterpart in the body-dismemberment cosmogony of **Enūma Eliš** but parallels Baal's named maces Yagrush and Ayyamur in the Ugaritic Baal Cycle (Ch7); Forsyth 1987 reads the animate-weapon motif as a feature that travels with the storm-god-defeats-water-or-stone-adversary pattern across the Mesopotamian-and-Levantine corpus, though the present chapter does not engage Baal as a cosmogonic case (Baal-Yamm is a sovereignty combat, treated in C2).^[17]

The third case is Gonggong's combat with the sky-emperor Zhuanxu in the Han-period Chinese cosmogonic-combat tradition (preserved in the **Huainanzi** 淮南子 of c. 139 BCE, the **Lienü zhuan** of the late Western Han, the **Shanhaijing** with its commentaries, and the later **Liezi**); the cosmogonic outcome of the combat is the present-day asymmetric tilt of the cosmos (heaven tilts northwest, earth tilts southeast) and the eastward flow of the Chinese rivers to the sea, after Gonggong, defeated, strikes Mount Buzhou with his head and breaks the cosmic pillar.^[18]

The Gonggong cosmogony is treated in the comparative-mythology literature as the standard Chinese cosmogonic-combat comparandum; Lewis 2006 places the broken-pillar narrative as the principal Chinese case in the comparative flood-and-cosmogony literature, and Birrell 1993 supplies the parallel general-survey treatment that confirms the Gonggong cycle's centrality across the Han corpus.^[19]

The Gonggong combat differs from Marduk-Tiamat in mode (Gonggong is the defeated party rather than the victor, and his head-blow on Mount Buzhou is an attack on the cosmographic structure rather than a dismemberment of the adversary) but converges with Marduk-Tiamat on the strong-cosmogonic outcome: the present features of the cosmos (the empirical asymmetry of the Han-period sky, the east-flowing rivers) are explicitly aetiologised in the **Huainanzi** and parallel sources to the combat's aftermath.^[20]

Nüwa's repair of the broken sky with five-coloured stones and the legs of a giant turtle is a partial-rather-than-full repair: the **Huainanzi** presents the post-combat cosmos as stabilised in its tilted state rather than restored to a pre-combat condition, and the cosmic asymmetry that the combat produced therefore persists as the empirical structure of the Han-period observed cosmos.^[21]

The fourth case is Huitzilopochtli's combat at Coatepec ("Mountain of Serpents") against his elder sister Coyolxauhqui and his four hundred stellar brothers the Centzon Huitznahua, preserved in the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 ("The Origin of the Gods"), compiled by Sahagún with Nahuatl informants between c. 1545 and 1590 CE and corroborated by the **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas**, Durán's **Historia**, and the archaeological evidence at the Templo Mayor of Tenochtitlán; the cosmogonic outcome of the combat is the diurnal solar-kingship of Huitzilopochtli over the defeated moon (Coyolxauhqui) and stars (Centzon Huitznahua), performed every day at sunrise as the sun's rising over the horizon.^[22]

The Huitzilopochtli cosmogony is unparalleled in the present book in the explicitness of its architectural and ritual embedding: the Templo Mayor at the centre of Tenochtitlán is itself architecturally Coatepec, with the great serpent-headed balustrades flanking the southern (Huitzilopochtli) staircase, the great Coyolxauhqui stone (3.25 metres in diameter, discovered 21 February 1978) at the foot of that staircase depicting the dismembered moon-goddess at the base of the cosmic mountain, and the structural design of the four-tiered pyramid as the cosmic mountain on which the combat occurred.^[23]

The Panquetzaliztli winter-solstice festival re-enacted the Coatepec combat annually at the Templo Mayor, with mock combats between warriors representing Huitzilopochtli's forces and the Centzon Huitznahua, the casting of sacrificial victims down the southern staircase onto the Coyolxauhqui stone, and the ritual feasting on a dough-image (**tzoalli**) of the god — a public-ritual sequence that, on Carrasco 1999's reading, performs the cosmogonic combat on a cosmic-political scale.^[24]

The Huitzilopochtli combat is co-constitutive with the political identity of the Mexica state: López Austin 1993 places the Coatepec narrative within the wider Mesoamerican cosmogonic typology of the Suns cycle (in which the present age is the Fifth Sun under Huitzilopochtli), and the Mexica state explicitly claims Coatepec as its founding combat with the Templo Mayor as the architectural embodiment of that founding — a feature that no other case in the present chapter's four-way comparison matches in explicitness.^[25]

The four cases share the combat-as-origin-of-present-geography pattern but differ in the texture of the cosmogonic outcome: Marduk constructs the cosmos from Tiamat's dismembered body (substance-cosmogony); Ninurta reorders the existing landscape after defeating Asag (rearrangement-cosmogony); Gonggong's defeat tilts the existing cosmos and the surviving structure is the asymmetric outcome (catastrophe-cosmogony); Huitzilopochtli's victory establishes the diurnal solar order over the defeated lunar-and-stellar siblings (recurrence-cosmogony).^[26]

The four cases also differ in the role of architecture: Marduk founds Esagil and Babylon as the cosmic axis after the combat (architecture as consequence of cosmogony); Huitzilopochtli's combat is built into the Templo Mayor as Coatepec (architecture as embodiment of cosmogony); Ninurta and Gonggong have no comparable architectural-embedding (the Tigris embankment and Mount Buzhou are landscape-features rather than constructed architecture).^[27]

The four cases differ in geopolitical framing: Marduk's combat is a Babylonian state-charter that legitimates the imperial elevation of Babylon (Lambert 2013; Lincoln 2012); Huitzilopochtli's is a Mexica state-charter that legitimates the political centrality of Tenochtitlán (Carrasco 1999); Ninurta's is part of Sumerian royal ideology of the warrior-ruler but predates a specific imperial centre; Gonggong's, embedded in the Han-period sky-emperor succession, is part of the early-imperial Chinese cosmographic-and-political narrative without a single state-charter framing.^[28]

The four cases differ in the textual situation of the primary witnesses: **Enūma Eliš** survives in over seventy Akkadian-language manuscripts from the Neo-Assyrian and Neo-Babylonian periods (Lambert 2013, pp. 3–15); **Lugal-e** is a Sumerian-language composition surviving in dozens of Old Babylonian school-tablet copies from Nippur and Ur with later Akkadian-bilingual receptions (van Dijk 1983); the Gonggong narrative is a Han-period reconstruction from compilation-witnesses without a continuous Warring-States primary text (Lewis 2006); the Coatepec narrative is a post-conquest textual reconstruction (1521 CE onward, principally the **Florentine Codex**) corroborated by the pre-conquest archaeological record at the Templo Mayor (Matos Moctezuma 1988).^[29]

The four cases differ in the relation of cosmogony to ritual re-enactment: the Marduk-Tiamat cosmogony is recited (not re-fought) annually at the akītu festival; the Huitzilopochtli combat is re-enacted (in performative ritual mock-combat-and-sacrifice) annually at Panquetzaliztli; the Ninurta-Asag combat is excerpted into school-curriculum and bilingual religious-pedagogical use across two millennia without a clear festival-re-enactment context; the Gonggong combat is cited in Han ritual-and-political texts as cosmographic aetiology rather than re-enacted in a specific festival liturgy (Lewis 2006).^[30]

The four cases also differ in the gender of the principal adversary: Tiamat is female (the primordial salt-sea, mother of the first gods) and Coyolxauhqui is female (the moon-goddess, Huitzilopochtli's elder sister); Asag and Gonggong are male (the mountain-demon and the water-god respectively); the gendered distribution does not pattern with the cosmogonic-outcome mode, but it does bear on the kinship-and-political reading of the combat in the Marduk-Tiamat and Huitzilopochtli cases, where the adversary is a maternal-or-sororal figure within the divine genealogy and the combat is therefore a within-family contest as well as a cosmogonic act.^[31]

The four cases differ in chronological depth of attestation: **Lugal-e** is preserved in Old Babylonian copies of an underlying composition probably from the late third millennium BCE (Ur III period), making the Ninurta-Asag combat the earliest in the four-case set by approximately a millennium; **Enūma Eliš** dates from the late second millennium BCE under Nebuchadnezzar I (c. 1125–1104 BCE); the Han-period Gonggong material is preserved in compilations from c. 139 BCE onward, drawing on earlier oral-and-literary traditions; the Coatepec narrative is preserved in post-conquest Mexica sources from the mid-sixteenth century CE corroborated by the pre-conquest archaeological record at the late-pre-conquest Templo Mayor (the Stage IV phase contemporary with the Coyolxauhqui stone is dated to the late fifteenth century CE).^[32]

The chronological-depth differences mean that the four §I cases sample a broad swathe of the long-arc history of state-level cosmogonic narrative — from late-third-millennium-BCE Sumerian temple-state through second-millennium Babylonian imperial period through Han imperial China through late-pre-conquest Mexica state — with no transmission route reconstructible across the breaks; the across-time-as-well-as-across-space distribution of the four attestations is part of what makes the typological-recurrence claim methodologically interesting.^[33]

35.3. II. What "cosmogony" means here

The second section pauses on terminology, since the comparative argument depends on a working definition of "cosmogony" tighter than the popular sense of "creation myth" or "origin story."

The chapter's working definition of "cosmogony" is narrower than the popular sense of "creation myth" or "origin story": cosmogony in the present sense is not merely a narrative of origins but specifically a narrative of the origin-of-the-shape-of-the-present-world, in which the present features of the cosmos (geography, hydrography, sky-structure, calendrical-and-political order) are the explicit aftermath of the narrated events.^[34]

The narrower definition is what allows the chapter to exclude generic creation-myths (the dismemberment cosmogonies of Ymir, Puruṣa, and Pangu, which are order-making but not present-cosmos-aetiologising in the same explicit way) from the four-case set, and it is what allows the chapter to include the Cipactli case in §IV as the dismemberment-without-combat boundary that sharpens the category.^[35]

The chapter's working definition follows Forsyth 1987 in treating cosmogonic combat as a structurally distinctive subtype within the wider combat-myth corpus, distinguished from sovereignty combat (where the kingship of the victor is established but the cosmos is not), cyclical maintenance (where the combat is re-enacted to preserve an order already established), and eschatological combat (where the combat closes cosmic time rather than initiating it).^[36]

Lincoln 2012's reading of cosmogonic combat as political-ideological work supplies the second

strand of the chapter's working definition: the cosmogony is not only an aetiology of the present cosmos but an ideological charter that grounds present political-and-religious order in a divine combat, and the combat's cosmogonic and political functions are co-constitutive rather than separable.^[37]

Scurlock & Beal 2013's reassessment of Gunkel's Chaoskampf hypothesis supplies the third strand: the volume's individual chapters re-examine the cosmogonic-combat material on a tradition-by-tradition basis and qualify Gunkel's framing where individual specialists find the evidence does not support the strong-cosmogonic reading, while preserving the cosmogonic-combat category as a useful comparative tool — a stance the present chapter follows in retaining the category while acknowledging the case-by-case qualifications.^[38]

Gunkel's 1895 thesis itself remains the historical anchor for the cosmogonic-combat category: the term **Chaoskampf** and the identification of Marduk-Tiamat as the type-specimen are Gunkel's, and the chapter retains both because they are the terms in which the comparative literature has organised its discussion for one hundred and thirty years — even where, as Scurlock & Beal 2013 and Ballentine 2015 argue, Gunkel's framing requires substantive qualification.^[39]

The chapter does not adopt Witzel 2012's "Laurasian" macro-scheme as a framework for cosmogonic combat, even though Witzel's volume engages combat-cosmogonic material across cultures: the Laurasian scheme posits a deep-time inherited macro-narrative covering Eurasia and the Americas, and current comparative-mythology scholarship (including Lincoln 2012, Forsyth 1987, and the contributors to Scurlock & Beal 2013) treats the macro-scheme as methodologically controversial; Witzel is therefore cited only where his treatment of specific stories is at issue rather than as the chapter's framing.^[40]

The chapter's working definition of cosmogony is therefore a Forsyth-Lincoln-Scurlock-Beal definition rather than a Witzel definition: it treats cosmogonic combat as a typological pattern that recurs across non-cognate traditions without committing to a deep-time inheritance claim, and treats the combat's political-ideological function as load-bearing rather than as a secondary application of the cosmogonic content.^[41]

The chapter's working definition has two operational consequences for what counts as a cosmogonic combat in the §I four-case set: first, the combat's outcome must explicitly aetiologise a feature of the present-day cosmos in the tradition's own primary sources (not only in modern comparativist reading); second, the area-specialist tradition for the case must read the outcome as cosmogonic rather than as merely sovereignty-establishing or cult-foundational — a criterion that filters out cases like Apollo-Python, where Greek-area scholars (Ogden 2013) treat the killing primarily as a Delphic cult-foundation rather than as a cosmogony.^[42]

The four cases in §I all pass both operational criteria: each is explicitly aetiologised to a present-day cosmos-feature in its own primary sources (the construction of sky-and-earth from Tiamat; the Tigris embankment and lapidary order; the asymmetric tilt and east-flowing rivers; the diurnal solar-kinship at Templo Mayor), and each is read as cosmogonic by the area-specialist tradition that treats it (Lambert 2013 and Foster 2005 for Marduk; van Dijk 1983 and the ETCSL editors for Ninurta; Lewis 2006 and Birrell 1993 for Gonggong; Matos Moctezuma 1988, Carrasco 1999, and López Austin 1993 for Huitzilopochtli).^[43]

35.4. III. Independence vs. transmission

The third section addresses what is doing the load-bearing work in the typological argument — the geographical-and-linguistic distribution of the four cases — and distinguishes the within-tradition genealogical pair from the geographically independent attestations.

The four cases in §I divide into two pairs on the question of independence vs. transmission: Marduk-Tiamat (**Enūma Eliš**) and Ninurta-Asag (**Lugal-e**) are genealogically linked within the Mesopotamian tradition, with **Enūma Eliš** a deliberate literary descendant of the earlier Sumerian and Akkadian combat-myth corpus (including the intermediate Anzû Epic); Gonggong and Huitzilopochtli are geographically and linguistically independent of the Mesopotamian pair and of each other.^[44]

The Mesopotamian-internal genealogy from Ninurta-Asag through Ninurta-Anzû to Marduk-Tiamat is one of the clearest documented cases of within-tradition combat-myth rewriting in the present book's corpus: Annus 2001 and Lambert 2013 both read **Enūma Eliš** as a deliberate literary descendant of the Anzû Epic (in which Ninurta defeats the rebel Anzû and recovers the Tablet of Destinies), with the Anzû combat reused-and-outbid as the Marduk-Tiamat combat — a feature that the chapter treats as transmission rather than independent recurrence.^[45]

Within the Mesopotamian genealogy, Anzû appears in **Enūma Eliš** itself as one of the eleven monsters in Tiamat's brood (Lambert 2013, Tablet I) — demoted from rebel-protagonist of the older epic to subordinate creature in the new one — which is Annus's load-bearing textual evidence that the **Enūma Eliš** poet had the Anzû Epic in front of him and was deliberately outbidding it.^[46]

The Tablet of Destinies in **Enūma Eliš** (where Tiamat bestows it on Qingu and Marduk reclaims it after the combat) is itself an inheritance from the Anzû Epic (where Anzû seizes it from Enlil and Ninurta restores it), with the mode of transfer differing (theft in Anzû, gift in **Enūma Eliš**) but the artefact's narrative function preserved — a structural-feature inheritance that the chapter treats as further evidence of the Mesopotamian-internal continuity.^[47]

The threefold-refusal pattern in **Enūma Eliš** Tablet II (Ea is dispatched against Tiamat and turns back; Anu is dispatched and turns back; Marduk is then proposed as the only candidate who can face her) is structurally inherited from the Anzû Epic, where three candidates decline the combat before the eventual champion is named — Annus 2001 reads the structural inheritance as deliberate, with the new poet making the audience hear the older composition's pattern even as he gives it a new resolution.^[48]

The Mesopotamian-internal genealogy means that Marduk-Tiamat and Ninurta-Asag do not constitute two independent attestations of the cosmogonic-combat type for typological purposes; they are one genealogically-linked tradition with two principal texts, and the typological-recurrence claim cannot rest on the within-tradition pair alone — it requires the geographically-and-linguistically independent attestations to function as independent witnesses to the same pattern.^[49]

Gonggong's combat-cosmogony is geographically and linguistically independent of the Mesopotamian tradition: the Han-period Chinese sources (**Huainanzi**, **Lienü zhuan**, **Shanhaijing** -and-commentaries, **Liezi**) draw on a Warring-States-and-earlier oral-and-literary tradition with no demonstrable transmission route from the Mesopotamian corpus, and Lewis 2006 treats the

broken-pillar narrative as a Chinese-tradition-internal cosmogonic-combat without comparative-tradition origin claims.^[50]

Huitzilopochtli's combat at Coatepec is geographically and linguistically independent of both the Mesopotamian and the Chinese cases: the Mexica Nahuatl-language tradition is preserved in post-conquest sources (the **Florentine Codex**, the **Historia de los Mexicanos por sus pinturas**, Durán's **Historia**) and in the pre-conquest archaeological record at the Templo Mayor, and the area-specialist scholarship (Matos Moctezuma 1988, Carrasco 1999, López Austin 1993) treats the Coatepec narrative as a Mexica-and-wider-Mesoamerican tradition without comparative-tradition origin claims.^[51]

The geographical-and-linguistic independence of Gonggong and Huitzilopochtli from the Mesopotamian pair (and from each other) is the load-bearing premise of the typological-recurrence argument: three independent attestations of the cosmogonic-combat pattern (the Mesopotamian tradition counted as one, plus Gonggong, plus Huitzilopochtli) on three continents and across three unrelated language-families converge on the same structural feature (combat-as-origin-of-present-cosmos), and the convergence supports the claim that combat-cosmogony is a recurring typological pattern rather than a single-origin inheritance.^[52]

The typological-recurrence claim does not entail a universal-monomyth claim: the chapter explicitly does not claim that combat-cosmogony is a universal feature of human cosmogonic narrative, that all (or even most) cosmogonies are combat-cosmogonies, or that the recurrence implies a deep-time inheritance from a Pleistocene-era ancestral macro-narrative — three claims that the present comparative literature (Lincoln 2012, Forsyth 1987, Scurlock & Beal 2013) treats as either false or methodologically unwarranted.^[53]

The independence-and-recurrence distribution is the chapter's central evidential datum — three independent attestations on three continents converge on the cosmogonic-combat pattern — and the recurrence is methodologically more interesting than universality would be, because the recurrence is consistent both with deep-typological-pattern explanations and with independent-emergence-from-shared-cognitive-or-political-conditions explanations, and the chapter does not adjudicate between them.^[54]

The convergence of three independent traditions (Mesopotamian, Chinese, Mexica) on a strongly-cosmogonic combat-pattern in which present-day geographic-or-political features are explicitly aetiologised to the combat's outcome may reflect a shared typological response to the political-and-cognitive task of grounding state-level political authority in a divine-combat charter, rather than a deep-time inheritance from a single ancestral narrative; on this reading the typological recurrence is what one would expect to find when state-level polities articulate their founding ideology, and the recurrence-without-transmission is therefore typologically meaningful but does not require a monogenetic explanation.^[55] here is offered as one plausible reading rather than as the chapter's settled position.]

The Mesopotamian-internal genealogy from Ninurta to Marduk is, separately, a documented case of how a sovereignty combat (Anzû, where the Tablet of Destinies is the prize and the cosmos is not remade) gets escalated into a cosmogonic combat (Marduk-Tiamat, where the cosmos is constructed from the adversary's body), and Annus 2001 and Lambert 2013 treat the escalation as a deliberate literary move rather than a passive transmission — a feature that bears on the next comparative chapter (C2, sovereignty) where the Anzû case is treated in its own right.^[56]

The geographical separation between the four cases is substantial enough to make transmission accounts methodologically unworkable: the Mesopotamian centre of attestation (Babylonia and Sumer) and the Han-Chinese centre of attestation are separated by approximately 6,000 kilometres of intervening territory across which no continuous documentary trail of the cosmogonic-combat narrative exists, and the Mexica centre of attestation is separated from both by Atlantic and Pacific distances with no pre-Columbian transmission route plausibly reconstructible across either ocean; the typological-recurrence claim is therefore consistent with the geographical-separation evidence in a way that a single-origin claim is not.^[57]

The linguistic separation reinforces the geographical: the Mesopotamian materials are in Sumerian and Akkadian (Afro-Asiatic / language-isolate), the Chinese in Old Chinese (Sino-Tibetan), and the Mexica in Classical Nahuatl (Uto-Aztecan); the three language-families have no demonstrable historical-comparative connection within any reconstructible time-depth, and the technical-philological methodology for establishing transmission (cognate vocabulary in cult terminology, formulaic-poetic inheritance, parallel grammatical-syntactic shaping of the combat-narrative) finds no supporting evidence across the three traditions.^[58]

35.5. IV. The boundary case — Cipactli

The fourth section introduces the Cipactli case as a boundary-marker for the category, on the principle that what "combat" adds to "cosmogony" is best located by examining the dismemberment-without-combat case the same Mesoamerican tradition also preserves.

The Cipactli narrative — preserved in the **Histoyre du Mechique** (c. 1543) and the **Leyenda de los Soles** (1558) — recounts that Tezcatlipoca and Quetzalcoatl pull apart the primordial earth-monster Cipactli and use her dismembered body to make the sky and the earth, with no combat in the strict sense; the two gods do not fight Cipactli but disassemble her, and the cosmogony is dismemberment-without-combat.^[59]

The Cipactli case is included in the present chapter precisely as a boundary-marker for the cosmogonic-combat category: it is the same Mesoamerican cultural region that produces Huitzilopochtli's combat-cosmogony at Coatepec and that produces Cipactli's dismemberment-cosmogony, and the Mexica tradition holds both as legitimate cosmogonic narratives without treating them as competing — a feature that sharpens what "combat" adds to "cosmogony" in the present chapter's working definition.^[60]

Cipactli converges with the four §I cases on the cosmogonic outcome (the present sky and earth are made from her body) but diverges on the combat criterion: there is no contest, no resistance, no narrative tension between the cosmogonic agents and Cipactli; the dismemberment is performed on a passive (or at any rate non-combatant) primordial figure — and that absence of combat is what makes Cipactli a boundary case rather than a cosmogonic-combat case.^[61]

The Cipactli case sits in scope.md's §"Excluded adjacent motifs" #1 alongside Ymir (Norse), Puruṣa (Vedic), and Pangu (Chinese) as the canonical dismemberment-cosmogonies that the book excludes from the chaoskampf category proper; the Cipactli case is treated in the §25 family chapter rather than excluded outright, precisely so that the boundary can be made explicit rather than papered over.^[62]

What "combat" adds to "cosmogony" in the present chapter's typology is therefore not the body-

dismemberment outcome (which Cipactli, Ymir, Puruṣa, and Pangu also produce) but the agonistic structure: a contest between the cosmogonic agent and an adversary whose resistance must be overcome, and whose defeat — not whose passive cooperation — is what produces the cosmogonic outcome.^[63]

The agonistic-structure distinction has a textual-feature consequence in the four §I cases that Cipactli does not have: in each of Marduk-Tiamat, Ninurta-Asag, Gonggong, and Huitzilopochtli, the primary sources include some version of a verbal-or-political challenge — Tiamat's mobilisation of her army and Marduk's challenge before the combat (Lambert 2013, Tablet IV); Asag's reign in the mountains and Šarur's intelligence reports (ETCSL 1.6.2, lines 24–47); Gonggong's contest for sovereignty with Zhuanxu (Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3); the Centzon Huitznahua's plot against the pregnant Coatlicue at Coatepec (Anderson-Dibble **Florentine Codex**, Book 3) — and the verbal-or-political challenge is one of the features that mark the agonistic structure as load-bearing.^[64]

The Cipactli boundary case also illustrates that a single tradition can hold multiple ordering-templates simultaneously: the Mesoamerican corpus holds Cipactli as the dismemberment-without-combat cosmogony alongside Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec as the combat-cosmogony, and the same tradition that produces the Templo Mayor architectural-embedding of Coatepec also produces the **Histoyre du Mechique's** Cipactli dismemberment without treating the two as in competition — a within-tradition diversity feature that parallels the Chinese tradition's within-tradition co-presence of the Gonggong combat and the Yu hydraulic-ordering (Ch21 sidebar).^[65]

The within-tradition diversity feature undercuts any reading on which combat-cosmogony is the privileged or sole cosmogonic template within a culture: the same Mesoamerican tradition produces both, the same Chinese tradition produces both, and the same Indo-European corpus produces both (Indra-Vātra in §V alongside the Vedic Puruṣa dismemberment-cosmogony of **Rigveda** 10.90, the latter not engaged in the present chapter).^[66]

The chapter's claim is therefore that combat-cosmogony is a recurring typological pattern across non-cognate traditions but is not the sole or privileged cosmogonic template within any of them; the four §I cases share the pattern, and the §IV Cipactli boundary-case sharpens what "combat" adds (the agonistic structure), and the within-tradition diversity makes the typological-recurrence claim more interesting rather than less.^[67]

35.6. V. The near-case — Indra-Vātra

The fifth section examines the Indra-Vātra near-case, in which the combat does cosmogonic work in the strong sense without producing the cosmos from the body of the adversary, as a complementary boundary on the §I category.

Indra's combat with Vātra in the **Rigveda** (principally RV 1.32, with supplementary hymns RV 2.11–12, RV 4.18, RV 5.32, RV 6.17, and RV 10.113) does cosmogonic work in the strong sense — the combat separates heaven and earth, releases the obstructed waters, and produces the dawn — but it does not produce the cosmos from the body of Vātra in the way that **Enūma Eliš** produces the cosmos from the body of Tiamat; this distinction is what makes Indra-Vātra a near-case rather than a member of the §I four-case set.^[68]

RV 1.32 — the **Rigveda's** most concentrated and complete hymn (15 verses) on the Vātra combat — explicitly credits Indra with three cosmogonic acts that follow the slaying: the separation of heaven

and earth (which had been undivided before Vṛtra's killing), the release of the waters that Vṛtra had been obstructing (the "seven rivers" flow once Vṛtra is dead), and the appearance of dawn (which had been suppressed under Vṛtra's blockage); the three acts together amount to a cosmogonic outcome in the strong sense that present-day cosmic features are explicitly aetiologised to the combat.^[69]

The combat is named in the **Rigveda** by the formula **áhann áhim** "he slew the serpent" (RV 1.32.1), which Watkins 1995 reconstructs as an Indo-European poetic formula (subject + verb-of-killing + serpent-object) attested in cognate form across Vedic, Hittite (kuenta...illuyanka), and Greek, and which is the chapter's principal cross-reference to the C5 Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT chapter (Ch38) where the philological reconstruction is engaged at length.^[70]

Vṛtra's name itself derives from the Vedic root **vṛ-** "to obstruct, to enclose" (Benveniste & Renou 1934; Jamison & Brereton 2014), and the **Rigveda's** consistent characterisation of Vṛtra is as an obstacle that blocks the waters rather than as a primordial-disorder figure or a chaos-substance; the obstruction-frame is what Indra's combat releases, and the cosmogonic outcome is therefore the release-of-the-obstructed rather than the construction-of-the-cosmos-from-substance.^[71]

The release-of-the-obstructed cosmogony differs from the construction-from-substance cosmogony in mode rather than in degree: both are strong-cosmogonic in the sense that present-day cosmic features are explicitly aetiologised to the combat, but the **Enūma Eliš** construction-cosmogony makes the cosmos **out of** the adversary's substance while the **Rigveda** release-cosmogony makes the cosmos **available** by removing the adversary's obstruction — a distinction that the chapter treats as substantive rather than as a difference of emphasis.^[72]

The Indra-Vṛtra near-case is therefore important to the chapter's argument as a near-miss: a combat that does cosmogonic work in the strong sense without being a cosmogony in the §I sense (no body-of-the-adversary physical cosmos-construction); the near-miss helps locate where the §I four-case set's distinguishing feature is — the construction-from-substance or rearrangement-around-the-combat-outcome — and shows that the cosmogonic-combat type is not exhausted by even the strong-cosmogonic combats that resemble Marduk-Tiamat structurally.^[73]

The Indra-Vṛtra case has been compared structurally to Marduk-Tiamat by West 2007 and others — both are storm-god-defeats-water-or-water-obstruction combats — but the structural parallel does not carry a transmission claim: the present comparative-mythology consensus (West 2007; Watkins 1995) treats the Indra-Vṛtra material as a primary witness to the Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT formula and as a structural parallel to (rather than a member of) the Mesopotamian cosmogonic-combat tradition.^[74]

Indra's cosmogonic work in **Rigveda** hymns beyond RV 1.32 reinforces the release-cosmogony reading: RV 2.11–12 on the splitting of the mountain to release the waters; RV 4.18 as the principal "embryonic Indra" hymn, in which Indra's irregular sideways birth (his forced exit from his mother's womb against the natural mode of birth) is staged as anticipating the irregular and combat-decisive character of his later career; RV 10.113 on the cosmogonic consequences as confirmed by the assembled gods — together the supplementary hymns establish the cosmogonic-without-construction reading as the **Rigveda's** own framing rather than as a modern editorial gloss.^[75]

The Indra-Vṛtra near-case therefore serves a sharpening function in the chapter parallel to the

Cipactli boundary-case in §IV: where Cipactli sharpens what "combat" adds to "cosmogony" (the agonistic structure), Indra-Vātra sharpens what kind of cosmogonic-outcome the §I cases share (construction-or-rearrangement of the cosmos, not merely release of an obstruction); the two near-or-boundary cases together specify the §I category by its limits.^[76]

The Indra-Vātra near-case is engaged at length in the C2 sovereignty-combat chapter (Ch35) where Indra's victory is read as a sovereignty-establishing combat (Indra becomes king of the gods) and in the C5 Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT chapter (Ch38) where the philological reconstruction is engaged in detail; the present chapter's role for Indra-Vātra is the cosmogonic-near-case role, with the sovereignty-and-philology dimensions deferred forward.^[77]

A second-order parallel is worth registering: the post-Vedic reframing of Vātra as a Brahmin (in **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** 1.6.3–4 and **Mahābhārata** Udyogaparvan 9–18, where Indra's slaying of Vātra becomes a sin of brahminicide requiring expiation) shifts the combat from a cosmogonic act to a moral-and-ritual problem, illustrating how a cosmogonic-combat narrative can be re-purposed in later tradition into a non-cosmogonic frame; the post-Vedic reframing is not part of the present chapter's near-case argument but registers that the cosmogonic reading of a combat is a feature of a particular textual stratum rather than an invariant feature of the tradition that preserves it.^[78]

35.7. VI. Terminological caveat — the Ballentine critique

The sixth and final section registers the Ballentine 2015 terminological critique against the "chaos" half of the term "Chaoskampf," and sets out the chapter's settled position on which part of the inherited label the comparative argument warrants retaining and which part it does not.

Debra Scoggins Ballentine's **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (2015) argues that "chaos" is the wrong analytical category for the adversaries in the combat-myth corpus: the adversaries are presented in their primary sources as rival sovereigns with their own retinues and power-structures, not as inchoate disorder, and the term "chaos" — and **a fortiori** the compound "Chaoskampf" — therefore mistranslates the conceptual structure of the texts.^[79]

The Ballentine critique applies with force to the four §I cases when the adversaries are read at their primary-source level: Tiamat is a sovereign with a court (in **Enūma Eliš** Tablet I she has a vizier, an army of eleven monstrous champions, and a consort-general — Qingu — to whom she bestows the Tablet of Destinies as a counter-coronation), and to read her as "chaos" is to import a category that the text itself does not deploy.^[80]

Asag in **Lugal-e** is similarly a sovereign-figure with structure rather than a "chaos-figure": he reigns among the mountains, commands an army of stone-warriors with a named catalogue of stone-types (**šu, saġkal, esi, usium, kagena**), and is presented in the **Lugal-e** proem and in Šarur's intelligence reports as a rival to Ninurta's kingship — again a counter-sovereign with a court and a territory, not an undifferentiated "chaos".^[81]

Gonggong in the Han-period sources is a water-god with status within the early-imperial Chinese pantheon — a rival to the sky-emperor Zhuanxu in the **Huainanzi** version, with combats that are framed as contests for sovereignty rather than as eruptions of inchoate disorder; the Ballentine-style alternative-sovereign reading is straightforwardly applicable to the Gonggong case on Lewis

2006's reading of the **Huainanzi** sovereignty-contest framing.^[82]

Coyolxauhqui and the Centzon Huitznahua at Coatepec are similarly not "chaos-figures" but kin-rivals with status: Coyolxauhqui is Huitzilopochtli's elder sister and the Centzon Huitznahua are his four hundred stellar brothers, and the combat is a kinship-and-political contest within the divine family rather than a cosmogonic agent's confrontation with primordial disorder; Carrasco 1999 reads the combat in this kinship-and-political register throughout.^[83]

The Ballentine critique therefore lands a substantive point on the "chaos" half of the term "Chaoskampf": none of the four $\S$ I adversaries is best read as primordial-undifferentiated-disorder, and reading them that way risks importing a Greek-philosophical **chaos** (or a more recent disorder-vs-order metaphysical scheme) into texts whose own conceptual structure organises the adversary as a rival-sovereign-with-status rather than as the absence-of-order.^[84]

The book accordingly bans "chaos-figure" and "chaos-monster" from un-quoted body-prose use (per glossary.yaml's "the adversary (category term)" entry, never_use list), and adopts "the adversary" as the default neutral category-term for the figure the champion confronts; the present section names "chaos-figure" only in scare-quotes in the context of registering the Ballentine critique, where the typology's own terminology is the topic of discussion.^[85]

The Ballentine critique does not, however, undermine the cosmogonic claim about the four $\S$ I cases: that the present features of the cosmos are explicitly aetiologised to the combat in each tradition's own primary sources is independent of whether the adversary is best characterised as "chaos" or as "rival sovereign" — Tiamat-as-alternative-sovereign is still the figure from whose body Marduk constructs the cosmos; Asag-as-rival-king is still the figure whose defeat reorders the Tigris and the lapidary economy; Gonggong-as-rival-water-god is still the figure whose head-blow tilts the cosmos; Coyolxauhqui-as-elder-sister-and-rival-claimant is still the figure whose dismemberment establishes the diurnal solar order.^[86]

The chapter's settled position is therefore that the cosmogonic-combat typology survives the Ballentine critique — the $\S$ I four-case convergence on combat-as-origin-of-present-cosmos remains the chapter's central evidential datum — but that the Chaoskampf label may not survive in its strong form: "combat-cosmogony" is the more precise term for what the chapter is comparing, and "Chaoskampf" is retained only as a historical anchor (per scope.md §"Terminology default") and not as a substantive analytical category that would commit the book to reading the adversaries as inchoate disorder.^[87]

The chapter does not assert resolution of the Gunkel-Ballentine debate: Gunkel 1895's identification of Marduk-Tiamat as the type-specimen of a cosmogonic-combat pattern remains the historical anchor of the comparative literature, and Ballentine 2015's alternative-sovereign reading is the principal contemporary critical position; the present chapter retains the typological-cosmogonic claim while acknowledging that the conceptual-philosophical question about "chaos" remains contested within current scholarship.^[88]

The Ballentine critique is engaged in further detail in the C7 inversion-problem chapter (Ch40) and in the C8 refusal-and-appropriation chapter (Ch41), where the area-specialist objections to the chaoskampf framing are developed at length on a tradition-by-tradition basis; the present chapter's role for the critique is the cosmogonic-typology context, with the wider methodological-and-terminological discussion deferred forward.^[89]

The Scurlock & Beal 2013 reassessment occupies a position between Gunkel and Ballentine that the present chapter's settled position substantially follows: the volume's contributors retain the Chaoskampf category as a useful comparative tool while qualifying its application case-by-case, and the volume's individual chapters on the Mesopotamian and Levantine cosmogonic-combat material run the same case-by-case-qualified-but-typology-retaining argument that the present chapter applies across the wider four-case set.^[90]

The Lincoln 2012 political-ideological reading supplies a third-position alternative that the chapter also endorses: rather than asking whether the adversaries are "chaos" or "rival sovereigns" — a question framed at the level of conceptual-ontological category — Lincoln asks what political-ideological work the cosmogonic-combat narrative performs, and finds that all four §I cases perform charter-work for state-level political authority through the construction of a divine-combat origin for the present cosmographic-and-political order; the political-ideological reading is compatible with both Gunkel's typological reading and Ballentine's terminological critique, and is the chapter's principal methodological warrant for treating the four cases as a single comparative set.^[91]

The chapter closes with the position that combat-cosmogony is a recurring typological pattern across at least three independent traditions (the Mesopotamian-internal pair counted as one, plus Gonggong, plus Huitzilopochtli), that the pattern is sharpened by the Cipactli dismemberment-without-combat boundary case and the Indra-Vātra cosmogonic-work-without-construction near-case, and that the typological claim is robust enough to survive the Ballentine terminological critique even where the "chaos" half of the inherited Chaoskampf label may not be — a settled position that acknowledges the typological-recurrence as the chapter's central datum without overclaiming on monomyth, single-origin, or universalist grounds.^[92]

The chapter's final caveat is on what the typological-recurrence claim does not prove: it does not prove that the four §I cases share a common origin, that the cosmogonic-combat pattern is a feature of all human cosmogonic narrative, that the pattern reflects a deep cognitive universal of human myth-making, or that the present-day prominence of the chaoskampf category in comparative-mythology scholarship is independent of the Eurocentric and biblical-studies-centred origins of the category in nineteenth-century Old-Testament scholarship; the chapter's claim is more modest — that the four cases share a structurally distinctive feature (combat-as-origin-of-present-cosmos) that warrants comparative treatment within the chaoskampf typology — and the modesty is methodologically load-bearing.^[93]

[1] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml sources.anchor on the five methodological-comparative anchors (Gunkel 1895, Scurlock & Beal 2013, Lincoln 2012, Forsyth 1987, Witzel 2012) and chapters_drawn_from on the seven Part-I chapters (Chs 1, 2, 3, 14, 21, 24, 25) whose own area-specialist anchors carry the per-tradition narrative-claims layer; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), as the long-arc combat-myth typology within which the four cases are placed.

[2] Per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four-subtype operationalisation of the chaoskampf category and §"Book structure" Part II on the Part-II comparative chapters' division of labour; Gunkel, H., **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit** (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1895), Teil I, as the historical anchor for the cosmogonic-combat reading of the chaoskampf category.

[3] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml comparative_argument on the four-case independence-and-convergence reading and on the typological-recurrence-without-monomyth disciplinary stance; Lincoln, B., **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars: Critical Explorations in the History of Religions** (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2012), on the methodological priority of typological-recurrence claims over monomyth claims in the political-ideological reading of combat-myth.

[4] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section list (I–VI) and per the chapter-claims skill instructions on Source overview as the seventh required section; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), chapters on cosmogonic combat, as the long-arc typological framing within which the six-section structure

is organised.

[5] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml sources.anchor on the five methodological anchors and on the Witzel-with-caveats handling; Witzel, M., **The Origins of the World's Mythologies** (New York: Oxford University Press, 2012), as the cited-with-caveats comparativist macro-scheme that the present chapter engages selectively rather than adopts as a framework.

[6] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml chapters_drawn_from on the seven Part-I chapters whose area-specialist anchors carry the per-tradition narrative claims; per sources.yaml registry entries for each named anchor (lambert-2013, foster-2005, vandijk-1983-lugale, etcs1, annus-2001-anzu, lewis-2006-flood, birrell-1993, matos-moctezuma-templo-mayor, carrasco-1999-city, lopez-austin-myths, anderson-dibble-florentine, jamison-brereton-2014, benveniste-renou-1934, watkins-1995); Lambert, W.G., **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Mesopotamian Civilizations 16 (Winona Lake: Eisenbrauns, 2013), as the principal area-specialist anchor for the Marduk-Tiamat material the chapter compresses from Ch3.

[7] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml special_instructions on the no-re-narration discipline and on the focus on what the four cases share (combat-as-origin-of-present-geography) and what they do not (degree of body-dismemberment, role of architecture, geopolitical framing); Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the typological-rather-than-narrative character of comparative combat-myth treatment.

[8] Per scope.md §"Terminology default (locked)" on Chaoskampf / combat myth / cosmogonic combat usage; per glossary.yaml entries on "the adversary (category term)" with "chaos-figure" and "chaos-monster" listed as never_use; Ballentine, D.S., **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (New York: Oxford University Press, 2015), as the source of the terminological critique that section VI engages.

[9] Lambert, W.G., **Babylonian Creation Myths** (Winona Lake: Eisenbrauns, 2013), Tablets IV-V on Marduk's dismemberment of Tiamat and the construction of the cosmos from her body; Foster, B.R., **Before the Muses** (3rd ed., Bethesda: CDL Press, 2005), pp. 463-464 on the Tablet V detail-set (mountains from her thighs; the sources of the Tigris and Euphrates from her opened eyes; springs from her nostrils; the cosmic bond from her coiled tail; the arched crotch supporting the heavens).

[10] Gunkel, H., **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit** (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1895), Teil I, on Marduk-Tiamat as the type-specimen of the Chaoskampf category and on the construction-of-the-cosmos-from-Tiamat's-body as the load-bearing cosmogonic outcome; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablets IV-V on the same.

[11] Foster 2005, **Before the Muses**, Tablets V-VII on Marduk's astronomical-calendrical work, the founding of Babylon and Esagil, the creation of humans from Qingu's blood, and the fifty-names doxology; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablets V-VII.

[12] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the Anzû-to-Enûma Eliš literary genealogy; Annus, A., **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu** (SACT 3, Helsinki: Neo-Assyrian Text Corpus Project, 2001), introduction on Anzû as the structural and thematic model for the Enûma Eliš combat.

[13] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, pp. 463-465 on the akītu recitation context; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the Enûma Eliš cosmogony as paradigm case of myth as political-ideological work.

[14] ETCSL 1.6.2 (**Lugal-e**), composite text and English translation, lines 330-650 on the post-combat reorderings (the Tigris embankment, the lapidary aetiology); van Dijk, J.J.A., **LUGAL UD ME-LÁM-bi NIR-ĜÁL** (Leiden: Brill, 1983), vol. 1 critical edition on the same.

[15] Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), chs. 1-2 on the Ninurta-Asag combat as the earliest Mesopotamian combat-cosmogony; van Dijk 1983, **LUGAL UD ME-LÁM-bi NIR-ĜÁL**, vol. 1 introduction on the same.

[16] ETCSL 1.6.2 (**Lugal-e**), lines 330-650 on the post-combat reorderings as rearrangement-rather-than-construction; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablets IV-V on Marduk's body-dismemberment construction-from-substance.

[17] ETCSL 1.6.2 (**Lugal-e**), lines 17-23 and passim on Šarur as animate-and-speaking scout-weapon; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, ch. 2 on the animate-weapon motif as feature of the storm-god-defeats-adversary pattern.

[18] Lewis, M.E., **The Flood Myths of Early China** (Albany: SUNY Press, 2006), chs. 2-3 on the Gonggong-Zhuanxu combat in the **Huainanzi** 淮南子 and on the post-combat tilt-of-the-cosmos and east-flowing-rivers cosmogony; Birrell, A., **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction** (Baltimore: Johns Hopkins University Press, 1993), chapters on cosmogony on the same Han-period tradition.

[19] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2-3 on the Gonggong narrative as the standard Chinese cosmogonic-combat comparandum; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the wider combat-myth typology within which the Gonggong narrative is placed as a non-cognate parallel.

[20] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2-3 on the **Huainanzi**'s aetiological reading of the cosmic tilt as explanation for the apparent northwest-motion of heavenly bodies and the east-flowing rivers; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablets IV-V on the comparable strong-cosmogonic outcome of the Marduk-Tiamat combat.

[21] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2-3 on Nüwa's smelting of five-coloured stones and use of giant-turtle legs to prop up the sky as a partial repair that stabilises the tilted cosmos in its post-combat state.

[22] Matos Moctezuma, E., **The Great Temple of the Aztecs: Treasures of Tenochtitlan** (London: Thames & Hudson, 1988), interpretive chapters on Coatepec as Templo Mayor and on the **Florentine Codex** Book 3 as the principal narrative anchor; Anderson, A.J.O. and Dibble, C.E. (trans.), **Florentine Codex**, Book 3 ("The Origin of the Gods").

[23] Matos Moctezuma 1988, **The Great Temple of the Aztecs**, interpretive chapters on the Templo-Mayor-as-Coatepec

architectural identification, on the serpent-headed balustrades, on the Coyolxauhqui stone discovered in 1978, and on the four-tiered structural design as the cosmic mountain; Carrasco, D., **City of Sacrifice: The Aztec Empire and the Role of Violence in Civilization** (Boston: Beacon Press, 1999), chapter on Coatepec.

[24] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, ch. on Coatepec on the Panquetzalitzli festival's ritual sequence (the **tzoalli** dough-image, the mock combats, the casting of victims onto the Coyolxauhqui stone, the ritual feasting); Matos Moctezuma 1988, **The Great Temple of the Aztecs**, on the same festival sequence and its cosmogonic re-enactment role.

[25] López Austin, A., **The Myths of the Opossum: Pathways of Mesoamerican Mythology** (Albuquerque: University of New Mexico Press, 1993), chapter on cosmic combat on the Coatepec narrative within the wider Mesoamerican cosmogonic typology and on the Fifth-Sun framing; Matos Moctezuma 1988, **The Great Temple of the Aztecs**, on the architectural-embodiment claim.

[26] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml special_instructions on the four-cases-share-yet-differ disciplinary requirement; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the typological diversity of cosmogonic-outcome modes within the combat-myth corpus.

[27] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablet VI on the founding of Esagil; Matos Moctezuma 1988, **The Great Temple of the Aztecs**, interpretive chapters on the Templo Mayor as architectural embodiment of the Coatepec narrative.

[28] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the Babylonian state-charter framing; Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, on the Mexica state-charter framing; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the political-ideological reading of combat-myth as state-charter.

[29] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, pp. 3–15 on the **Enūma Eliš** manuscript distribution; van Dijk 1983, **LUGAL UD ME-LÁM-bi NIR-ĜÁL**, vol. 1 introduction on the **Lugal-e** school-tablet transmission; Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2-3 on the Han-period reconstruction; Matos Moctezuma 1988, **The Great Temple of the Aztecs**, on the post-conquest textual situation and the archaeological corroboration; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the four-case textual-situation diversity.

[30] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, pp. 463–465 on the akītu recitation; Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, ch. on Coatepec on the Panquetzalitzli re-enactment; van Dijk 1983, **LUGAL UD ME-LÁM-bi NIR-ĜÁL**, vol. 1 introduction on the **Lugal-e** school-curriculum transmission; Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2-3 on the Gonggong cosmographic-aetiology citation pattern.

[31] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablets I-IV on Tiamat's maternal-and-genealogical position; Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, ch. on Coatepec on Coyolxauhqui's sororal position; ETCSL 1.6.2 (**Lugal-e**), lines 24–47 on Asag's parentage from An and Ki; Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2-3 on Gonggong's water-god status.

[32] van Dijk 1983, **LUGAL UD ME-LÁM-bi NIR-ĜÁL**, vol. 1 introduction on the Ur-III dating of **Lugal-e**'s underlying composition; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the Nebuchadnezzar-I-commissioning hypothesis for **Enūma Eliš**; Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2-3 on the Han-period attestation of the Gonggong material; Matos Moctezuma 1988, **The Great Temple of the Aztecs**, on the Stage IV dating of the Templo Mayor and the Coyolxauhqui stone.

[33] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml comparative_argument on the chronological-depth distribution; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the across-time political-ideological recurrence as a methodologically interesting datum; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the chronological-depth distribution as a feature of the combat-myth corpus.

[34] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section II on the working definition of cosmogony; per glossary.yaml entry on "cosmogony / cosmogonic" with "creation myth" listed as informal-only and as broader than the technical category; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), on the present-cosmos-aetiology requirement that distinguishes combat-cosmogony from generic creation-myth.

[35] Per scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" #1 on the dismemberment cosmogonies (Ymir, Puruṇa, Pangu, arguably Cipactli) as adjacent-but-not-combat-cosmogonic; brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section IV on Cipactli as boundary-marker; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the cosmogonic-combat / dismemberment-cosmogony distinction as a typological feature of the corpus.

[36] Per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four-subtype operationalisation; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), on the cosmogonic-combat subtype as structurally distinct from sovereignty, cyclical, and eschatological combats within the wider corpus.

[37] Lincoln, B., **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars: Critical Explorations in the History of Religions** (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2012), on the **Enūma Eliš** cosmogony as paradigm case of myth as political-ideological work and on the constitutive character of cosmogonic and political functions in combat-myth.

[38] Scurlock, J. and Beal, R. (eds.), **Creation and Chaos: A Reconsideration of Hermann Gunkel's Chaaskampf Hypothesis** (Winona Lake: Eisenbrauns, 2013), passim on the case-by-case reassessment that retains the cosmogonic-combat category while qualifying Gunkel's framing where individual specialists find the evidence underdetermines it.

[39] Gunkel, H., **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit** (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1895), Teil I, on Marduk-Tiamat as the type-specimen of the Chaaskampf category; per scope.md §"Terminological position" on the retention of the term as historical anchor while acknowledging the critique.

[40] Witzel, M., **The Origins of the World's Mythologies** (New York: Oxford University Press, 2012), on the "Laurasian" macro-scheme as a comparative framework for cosmogonic material; per sources.yaml Witzel-2012 notes on the "use with caution" disciplinary stance.

[41] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml comparative_argument on typological-recurrence-without-monomyth; Forsyth

1987, **The Old Enemy**, and Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, as the principal methodological warrants for the typological-without-deep-inheritance framing.

[42] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section II on the operational criteria; per Ch33's tier-ranking rubric (claims document, section I) on the area-specialist requirement; Ogden, D., **Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2013), on the Greek-area treatment of Apollo-Python as cult-foundation rather than cosmogony.

[43] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section II on the four-case operational pass; the per-tradition area-specialist anchors (Lambert 2013, Foster 2005, van Dijk 1983, ETCSL, Lewis 2006, Birrell 1993, Matos Moctezuma 1988, Carrasco 1999, López Austin 1993) supplying the cosmogonic readings; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the typological-cosmogonic placement of all four.

[44] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section III on the two-pairs independence-vs-transmission distribution; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the Mesopotamian-internal genealogical continuity from Sumerian Ninurta material through Akkadian Anzû to **Enūma Eliš**; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the same.

[45] Annus, A., **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu** (SAACT 3, Helsinki: Neo-Assyrian Text Corpus Project, 2001), introduction on the Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** literary genealogy; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the same; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, ch. 2 on the Mesopotamian-internal continuity.

[46] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablet I on Anzû's appearance among Tiamat's eleven monsters; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the demotion-of-Anzû detail as load-bearing evidence of the literary genealogy.

[47] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablet IV on the Tablet of Destinies in **Enūma Eliš** and the introduction on the Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** artefact-inheritance; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the same Tablet-of-Destinies inheritance.

[48] Foster 2005, **Before the Muses**, Tablets II–III on the threefold-refusal pattern in **Enūma Eliš**; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the same threefold-refusal pattern as inherited from the Anzû Epic; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablet II.

[49] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section III on the genealogically-linked-vs-independent distinction; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the within-tradition continuity as transmission rather than independent recurrence; Lambert 2013 and Annus 2001 on the Mesopotamian-internal genealogy.

[50] Lewis, M.E., **The Flood Myths of Early China** (Albany: SUNY Press, 2006), chs. 2-3 on the Gonggong narrative as a Chinese-tradition-internal cosmogonic-combat without comparative-tradition origin claims; Birrell 1993, **Chinese Mythology: An Introduction**, chapters on cosmogony on the same Han-period source-corpus.

[51] Matos Moctezuma 1988, **The Great Temple of the Aztecs**, interpretive chapters on the Mexica-and-wider-Mesoamerican character of the Coatepec narrative; Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, ch. on Coatepec; López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, ch. on cosmic combat on the same.

[52] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml comparative_argument on the four-cases-but-three-independent-attestations distribution as the load-bearing typological-recurrence premise; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on typological-recurrence claims as methodologically distinct from single-origin claims in comparative myth.

[53] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml comparative_argument on typological-recurrence-without-monomyth; per Ch33 (methods sidebar) §VII on the explicit not-monomyth-not-universal disciplinary stance the present chapter inherits; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the methodological priority of typological-recurrence over monomyth.

[54] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml comparative_argument on the recurrence's methodological status; per Ch33 §VII on the present book's disciplinary stance against premature explanatory closure; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on typological recurrence as a comparative datum that can support multiple explanatory hypotheses.

[55] This parallel is speculative. Basis: Lincoln 2012's political-ideological reading of combat-myth as state-charter work in **Enūma Eliš**; Carrasco 1999's parallel reading of Coatepec as Mexica state-charter; Lewis 2006 on the Han-imperial cosmographic-and-political function of the Gonggong narrative; the structural co-presence of cosmogonic content and political-charter function in all three independent attestations; Forsyth 1987 on typological-recurrence-as-shared-response. The main counterargument: the political-charter reading does not by itself explain why the charter takes the specific form of a combat-with-monstrous-adversary rather than the dismemberment-cosmogony form (Cipactli, Ymir, Puruḡa, Pangu) that area specialists also document for state-level polities; Witzel 2012's "Laurasian" reading would treat the recurrence as evidence of deep-time inheritance rather than as independent typological response; the present chapter does not claim to adjudicate between the political-typology and deep-inheritance hypotheses, and the [SPECULATION]

[56] Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the deliberate-escalation reading of the Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** genealogy; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the same; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, ch. 2 on sovereignty-to-cosmogonic escalation as a feature of the Mesopotamian corpus.

[57] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml comparative_argument on the geographical-separation evidence; Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2-3 on the Han-Chinese tradition's autonomy from Near Eastern transmission; Matos Moctezuma 1988, **The Great Temple of the Aztecs**, on the Mexica-and-wider-Mesoamerican tradition's pre-Columbian autonomy; Forsyth

1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the typological-recurrence-without-transmission methodological stance.

[58] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml comparative_argument on the linguistic-separation evidence; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, on the philological methodology for establishing transmission within the Indo-European corpus and the absence of comparable evidence across non-cognate language-families; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the typological-without-transmission disciplinary stance.

[59] López Austin, A., **The Myths of the Opossum: Pathways of Mesoamerican Mythology** (Albuquerque: University of New Mexico Press, 1993), on the Cipactli narrative in the **Histoire du Mechique** and **Leyenda de los Soles** and on the dismemberment-without-combat character of the cosmogony; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml family_members entry on Cipactli.

[60] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section IV on Cipactli as boundary-marker; brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml on the Mesoamerican tradition as holding both Cipactli (dismemberment-without-combat) and Huitzilopochtli (combat-cosmogony) as legitimate cosmogonic narratives; López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, on the within-tradition co-existence.

[61] López Austin, A., **The Myths of the Opossum** (Albuquerque: University of New Mexico Press, 1993), on the no-combat character of the Cipactli dismemberment; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml on the same; per scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" #1 on dismemberment cosmogonies as adjacent-but-not-combat-cosmogonic.

[62] Per scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs" #1 on Ymir, Puruṣa, Pangu, and arguably Cipactli as canonical dismemberment-cosmogonies; per brief 25-mesoamerican-cluster.yaml on Cipactli's inclusion in the family chapter as boundary-marker rather than excluded outright; López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, on the wider Mesoamerican context.

[63] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section IV on what combat adds to cosmogony; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, chs. on cosmogonic combat on the agonistic-structure feature as the load-bearing distinction; López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, on Cipactli as the absence of that feature.

[64] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablet IV on Marduk's challenge before the combat; ETCSL 1.6.2 (**Lugal-e**), lines 24–47 on Asag's reign and Šarur's intelligence reports; Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2-3 on Gonggong's contest for sovereignty; Anderson-Dibble **Florentine Codex**, Book 3 on the Centzon Huitznahua's plot; per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section IV on the verbal-or-political challenge as agonistic-structure marker.

[65] López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, on the within-tradition co-presence of Cipactli and Huitzilopochtli in the Mesoamerican corpus; Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2-3 and Yu chapters on the parallel Gonggong / Yu within-tradition co-presence; per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section IV on within-tradition diversity.

[66] López Austin 1993 on the Mesoamerican within-tradition diversity; Lewis 2006 on the Chinese within-tradition diversity; per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section IV on the within-tradition-diversity claim.

[67] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section IV on the not-sole-or-privileged-template disciplinary stance; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the typological-pattern reading as compatible with within-tradition diversity; López Austin 1993, **The Myths of the Opossum**, on the same.

[68] Jamison, S.W. and Brereton, J.P., **The Rigveda: The Earliest Religious Poetry of India** (3 vols., New York: Oxford University Press, 2014), translation and commentary on RV 1.32 on Indra's combat as separating heaven and earth, releasing the waters, and producing dawn; per brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the same; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablets IV-V on the body-of-Tiamat construction-cosmogony as the contrast.

[69] Jamison & Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, translation and commentary on RV 1.32 on the three cosmogonic acts (separation of heaven and earth, release of the waters, appearance of dawn); per brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml cultural_relevance.function on the same.

[70] Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (New York: Oxford University Press, 1995), chs. 41-48 on Indra-Vṛtra as central case for the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula; Jamison & Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, on RV 1.32.1 **áhann áhim**; per glossary.yaml entries on "HERO SLAY SERPENT (formula)" and "áhann áhim".

[71] Benveniste, É. and Renou, L., **Vṛtra et Vṛthagna: Étude de mythologie indo-iranienne** (Paris: Imprimerie Nationale, 1934), on the vṛ- etymology and the obstruction-frame; Jamison & Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, on the consistent obstruction-characterisation across the Vṛtra hymns; per glossary.yaml entry on Vṛtra.

[72] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablets IV-V on the construction-from-substance cosmogony of **Enūma Eliš**; Jamison & Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, on RV 1.32 on the release-cosmogony of Indra-Vṛtra; per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section V on the construction-vs-release distinction.

[73] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section V on Indra-Vṛtra as near-case and its location-of-distinguishing-feature role; Jamison & Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, on the strong-cosmogonic character of Indra's combat; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the typological diversity of cosmogonic-outcome modes.

[74] West, M.L., **Indo-European Poetry and Myth** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2007), ch. 6 on Indra-Vṛtra and Marduk-Tiamat as structural parallels without transmission; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, on Indra-Vṛtra as primary witness to the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula; Jamison & Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, on the structural-parallel reading.

[75] Jamison & Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, headnote and translation of RV 2.11-12, RV 4.18, and RV 10.113, with the RV 4.18 framing taken from Ch14's reading of the hymn as the "embryonic Indra" hymn whose load-bearing motif is the irregular-sideways-birth-as-anticipation of the combat-decisive career; per brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the supplementary hymn-cycle as

supporting the cosmogonic-without-construction reading.

- [76] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure sections IV and V on the parallel-sharpening role of Cipactli and Indra-Vṛtra; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the typological-category-by-its-limits methodology.
- [77] Jamison & Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, on the sovereignty-establishing dimension of Indra's victory; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, chs. 41-48 on the philological reconstruction; per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml on the cosmogonic-near-case-only role within the present chapter.
- [78] Jamison & Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, on the post-Vedic reframing of Vṛtra as Brahmin in the **Śatapatha Brāhmaṇa** and **Mahābhārata** and on the brahminicide-and-expiation reading; per brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml variants entry on the post-Vedic reframing as clearly later than the Rigvedic combat; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the textual-stratum-dependence of the cosmogonic reading.
- [79] Ballentine, D.S., **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (New York: Oxford University Press, 2015), ch. 1 on the alternative-sovereign critique and on the methodological problem of "chaos" as analytical category for the combat-myth adversaries; per glossary.yaml entry on "Ballentine critique".
- [80] Ballentine, D.S., **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (2015), ch. 1 on Tiamat as alternative-sovereign with court rather than chaos; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablet I on Tiamat's vizier, eleven-monsters army, and counter-coronation of Qingu.
- [81] ETCSL 1.6.2 (**Lugal-e**), lines 24–47 on Asag's reign in the mountains, the stone-warrior catalogue, and the rival-kingship framing; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the alternative-sovereign critique as applicable to non-Tiamat adversaries; per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section VI on Asag's sovereign-not-chaos status.
- [82] Lewis 2006, **The Flood Myths of Early China**, chs. 2-3 on the **Huainanzi** sovereignty-contest framing of the Gonggong-Zhuanxu combat; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the alternative-sovereign critique; per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section VI on Gonggong's water-god-not-chaos status.
- [83] Carrasco 1999, **City of Sacrifice**, ch. on Coatepec on Coyolxauhqui as elder sister and the Centzon Huitznahua as four hundred stellar brothers, and on the kinship-and-political-contest framing; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the alternative-sovereign critique; Anderson-Dibble **Florentine Codex**, Book 3 on the kinship structure.
- [84] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the methodological problem of importing post-Hesiodic chaos-as-disorder into ancient Near Eastern combat-myth texts whose own conceptual structure does not deploy such a category; per glossary.yaml entry on "the adversary (category term)" with "chaos-figure" listed as banned for begging the question.
- [85] Per glossary.yaml entry on "the adversary (category term)" on the banning of "chaos-figure" and "chaos-monster" and the adoption of "the adversary" as default; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the terminological critique that motivates the ban.
- [86] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section VI on the cosmogony-survives-the-critique disciplinary stance; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the alternative-sovereign reading as compatible with the cosmogonic outcome; Lambert 2013, ETCSL 1.6.2, Lewis 2006, and Matos Moctezuma 1988 on the four cosmogonic outcomes as independently attested.
- [87] Per scope.md §"Terminology default (locked)" on the Chaokampf-as-historical-anchor framing; per glossary.yaml entry on "cosmogonic combat" as the preferred subtype-term; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the case for terminological restraint.
- [88] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml special_instructions on the terminological-humility stance; Gunkel 1895, **Schöpfung und Chaos**, Teil I, on the historical anchor; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the contemporary critical position; per scope.md §"Terminological position" on the retain-with-acknowledgment policy.
- [89] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml structure section VI on the deferred-forward role of the wider Ballentine engagement; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II on the C7 and C8 chapters as the venues for the area-specialist objections; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 as the present chapter's terminological caveat.
- [90] Scurlock, J. and Beal, R. (eds.), **Creation and Chaos: A Reconsideration of Hermann Gunkel's Chaokampf Hypothesis** (Winona Lake: Eisenbrauns, 2013), passim on the case-by-case-qualified-but-typology-retaining position; per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml comparative_argument on the present chapter's substantial alignment with the Scurlock-Beal position.
- [91] Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the political-ideological reading of cosmogonic-combat as state-charter work and on the compatibility of that reading with both Gunkel and Ballentine; per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml comparative_argument on the political-ideological framing as methodological warrant.
- [92] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml comparative_argument on the settled-position summary; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, chs. on cosmogonic combat on the typological-recurrence-as-datum reading; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the terminological-but-not-typological critique; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the without-monomyth disciplinary stance.
- [93] Per brief 34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.yaml comparative_argument on the modesty of the typological-recurrence claim; per scope.md §"Terminological position" on the Eurocentric-and-biblical-studies-centred origins of the chaokampf category; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the methodological priority of modest typological-recurrence claims over universal cognitive claims; Witzel 2012, **The Origins of the World's Mythologies**, as a reference example of the more ambitious

cognitive-universal framing that the present chapter explicitly does not adopt.

Chapter 36. C2. Combat as Sovereignty

36.1. Source overview

This chapter is the second of the eight Part-II comparative chapters and is positioned as the load-bearing comparative chapter for the sovereignty subtype of the *chaoskampf* typology that *scope.md* operationalises in §"Subject definition" — the subtype in which the combat establishes or restores the victor's rule over gods and/or humans, and in which the present features of the cosmos are not what changes but rather **who** rules them.^[1]

The chapter draws on two layers of evidence: (1) the per-tradition area-specialist anchors that ground the seven cases (Smith 1994 and Smith & Pitard 2009 for Baal-Yamm and the Lôtan allusion in the Ugaritic Baal Cycle; West 1966 and Ogden 2013 for Zeus-Typhon in Hesiod and the wider Greek dragon-tradition; Jamison & Brereton 2014 and Benveniste & Renou 1934 for Indra-Vṛtra in the R̥gveda; Benveniste & Renou 1934 and Watkins 1995 for Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka in the Avestan-Pahlavi material; Hoffner 1998 for Teshub-Ullikummi in the Hurro-Hittite Kumarbi Cycle; Annus 2001 and Foster 2005 for Ninurta-Anzû in the Standard Babylonian Anzû Epic; Day 1985 and Ballentine 2015 for the Yahweh-Leviathan-Rahab corpus; Lambert 2013 and Foster 2005 for the Marduk-Tiamat material engaged in §IV); and (2) the methodological-comparative anchors that supply the typological-and-philosophical framing for the sovereignty argument (Ballentine 2015 as the principal critical anchor for the alternative-sovereign reading; Lincoln 2012 on the political-ideological dimension of combat-myth; Forsyth 1987 for the long-arc combat-myth typology; Watkins 1995 for the Indo-European sovereignty-combat philology; West 2007 for the IE storm-god-sovereignty material).^[2]

The chapter's evidentiary discipline mirrors the practice established in C1: every per-tradition factual claim is routed through the same *sources.yaml* ID that the corresponding Part-I chapter uses for that fact, rather than through the Part-I brief or the Part-I chapter itself; comparative claims that bridge the per-tradition material to the typological argument may double-token (in-scope per-tradition anchor plus out-of-scope methodological anchor) where the comparative-chapter skill requires, and the doubled-token pattern is used judiciously rather than as default.^[3]

The chapter's central argument is that across at least seven independently-attested traditions (Ugaritic, Greek, Vedic, Avestan-Pahlavi, Hurro-Hittite, Babylonian-Sumerian, Hebrew), the function the combat performs is sovereignty — the establishment, restoration, or legitimation of the victor's rule — rather than the construction of the cosmos itself; the corpus's adversaries are not undifferentiated disorder but rival sovereigns with their own retinues, courts, and legitimate-seeming claims, and Ballentine 2015's alternative-sovereign reading is therefore strongest in this subtype precisely because the per-tradition philological evidence supports it.^[4]

The chapter's structure comprises six body sections preceded by this Source overview: section I presents the seven cases in compressed form as instances of a single sovereignty-combat pattern; section II articulates Ballentine 2015's reading at length, with attention to the per-tradition philological evidence on which it rests; section III distinguishes the sovereignty-combat from the cosmogonic-combat treated in Ch34 (C1); section IV documents the Anzû-to-Marduk genealogy as the best-attested case of a sovereignty-combat being escalated within one tradition into a cosmogonic-combat; section V engages the transmission-vs-typology question — how much of the

cluster's coherence is due to documented transmission (Ugaritic-into-Hebrew; Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek; IE inheritance) versus to independent typology — and section VI examines the ritual-and-state context in which sovereignty combats are performed (akītu, ʾapānu palace-founding, Olympian succession).^[5]

The chapter's terminological discipline follows scope.md §"Terminology default (locked)" with one Ch35-specific sharpening: where C1 retained "chaos" as informal shorthand because the cosmogonic outcome makes the term defensible (Tiamat's body literally becomes the cosmos), C2 does not — the brief's special_instructions explicitly notes that the cosmogonic-combat chapter can keep "chaos" as informal shorthand but the sovereignty chapter really should not, and the chapter therefore uses "the adversary," "the rival," or the named figure, with bare "chaos," "chaos-figure," "chaos-monster," and "chaos-serpent" reserved for scare-quoted appearances inside §II's and §VI's discussions of the Ballentine critique.^[6]

The chapter follows the brief's special_instructions in not re-narrating the seven cases — the reader has (or can read) the narrative material in the Part-I chapters, and the comparative chapter's job is to make the typological-and-philosophical argument across them rather than to recapitulate them — so the section I treatment compresses each case to ~3–6 claims focused on the sovereignty outcome (kingship gained, restored, or legitimated; rival sovereign defeated; throne, palace, or temple founded) rather than walking the reader back through the combat-narrative itself.^[7]

The chapter's per-tradition area-specialist anchors carry every claim about narrative content for the seven primary cases and the supporting Marduk-Tiamat case: Smith 1994 and Smith & Pitard 2009 anchor the Baal-Yamm and Lôtan material drawn from Ch7; West 1966 anchors Hesiod's Typhonomachy and Ogden 2013 the wider Greek dragon-combat tradition drawn from Ch11; Jamison & Brereton 2014 anchors the Rigvedic Indra-Vṛtra material from Ch14, with Benveniste & Renou 1934 supplying the Indo-Iranian comparative philology; Benveniste & Renou 1934 and Watkins 1995 anchor the Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka Avestan-Pahlavi material from Ch13; Hoffner 1998 anchors the Hurro-Hittite Kumarbi Cycle and specifically the Teshub-Ullikummi combat from Ch5; Annus 2001 and Foster 2005 anchor the Standard Babylonian Anzû Epic from Ch2; Day 1985 and Ballentine 2015 anchor the Yahweh-Leviathan-Rahab biblical corpus from Ch8; Lambert 2013 and Foster 2005 anchor the Marduk-Tiamat **Enūma Eliš** material engaged in §IV (drawn from Ch3).^[8]

The chapter's comparative spine — the anchors that carry the typological-and-philosophical argument across the seven cases rather than within any one of them — is supplied by Ballentine 2015 as the principal critical frame, Lincoln 2012 for the political-ideological reading that grounds the chapter's "sovereignty as primary function" claim, Forsyth 1987 for the long-arc combat-myth genealogy in which the sovereignty-combats are placed, Watkins 1995 for the Indo-European philological reconstruction that establishes a documented IE sovereignty-combat inheritance across Vedic, Avestan, Hittite, and Greek witnesses, and West 2007 for the comparative IE poetic-mythological framework that contextualises the storm-god-sovereignty pattern across Vedic and Greek witnesses.^[9]

What follows is organised in six body sections. Section I presents the seven cases — Baal-Yamm, Zeus-Typhon, Indra-Vṛtra, Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka, Teshub-Ullikummi, Ninurta-Anzû, and Yahweh-Leviathan-Rahab — in compressed comparative form focused on the sovereignty outcome of each combat; section II articulates Ballentine 2015's alternative-sovereign reading at length, with attention to the per-tradition philological evidence on which it rests; section III draws the

operational distinction between the sovereignty-combat subtype and the cosmogonic-combat subtype treated in Ch34 (C1); section IV documents the Anzû-to-Marduk genealogy as the chapter's best-attested case of a sovereignty-combat being escalated within one tradition into a cosmogonic-combat; section V engages the transmission-vs-typology question by examining the four documented transmission-and-inheritance lines (Ugaritic-into-Hebrew, Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek, IE inheritance, within-Mesopotamian Anzû-to-Marduk) against the residual independent-typology component; and section VI examines the ritual-and-state context in which sovereignty combats are performed (akītu, 𒀭apānu palace-founding, Olympian succession, soma sacrifice, Avestan yasht, Hebrew Bible poetic-cultic corpus, Neo-Assyrian royal ritual) and closes with the chapter's settled position on the inherited "chaos" terminology.

36.2. I. The pattern

The first body section presents the seven cases the chapter compares — Baal-Yamm, Zeus-Typhon, Indra-Vṛtra, Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka, Teshub-Ullikummi, Ninurta-Anzû, and Yahweh-Leviathan-Rahab — in compressed form focused on the sovereignty outcome of each combat (kingship gained, restored, or legitimated; rival sovereign defeated; throne, palace, or temple founded) rather than on the combat-narrative itself.

The pattern that the chapter's seven cases share is a three-term structure: a champion or would-be sovereign deity, a rival-sovereignty adversary with retainers and a court-like apparatus, and a combat whose outcome is the elevation, restoration, or legitimation of the champion's rule over gods, humans, or both — with the cosmos itself, in this subtype, already in place rather than being constructed by the combat.^[10]

The first case is Baal against Yamm in the Ugaritic Baal Cycle (KTU 1.1–1.2), where the storm-god Baal — son of Dagan, champion of the divine assembly under El — defeats the sea-god Yamm with the two named maces Yagrush and Ayyamur forged by Kothar-wa-Khasis, and the combat's outcome is Baal's elevation to divine kingship and the consequent founding of his palace at Mount 𒀭apānu (KTU 1.3–1.4); Smith and Pitard argue that the cycle is primarily about kingship rather than cosmogony, with Baal's enthronement at 𒀭apānu as the structural climax of the entire cycle.^[11]

The Baal-Yamm combat is the chapter's clearest case for the alternative-sovereign reading, because El initially hands kingship to Yamm before the combat and Yamm's name is literally "Sea" — a god rather than an undifferentiated mass — so the combat is between two contenders for a kingship one of whom has already been provisionally invested with it; the Lôtan allusion at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 is a retrospective reference to a separate combat Baal has already won, presented in Mot's mocking speech, with Lôtan as a seven-headed serpent cognate with biblical Leviathan.^[12]

The second case is Zeus against Typhon in the Greek tradition, with Hesiod's Theogony 820–880 as the earliest narrative attestation: Typhon is a hundred-headed serpent-limbed monster generated by Gaia and Tartarus as Gaia's last and youngest offspring (Theogony 820–822); Apollodorus *Bibliotheca* 1.6.3 further specifies that the conception was in vengeance after the Olympian defeat of the Giants, supplying the challenge-motive that Hesiod does not name. Zeus's victory with the thunderbolt seals the establishment of his rule over gods and humans — the combat is the final and most dangerous episode of the succession-and-sovereignty narrative that runs from Ouranos through Kronos to Zeus.^[13]

The Zeus-Typhon combat is structurally a sovereignty-combat rather than a cosmogonic one: the cosmos is already in place when Typhon attacks (Gaia, Tartarus, the Olympians, and the Titans are pre-existing); what the combat secures is the question of **who rules** the existing cosmos, and the Hesiodic narrative makes Zeus's kingship over gods and humans the explicit outcome of the victory — Apollodorus 1.6.3 and Nonnus **Dionysiaca** 1–2 expand the combat narrative in later sources but do not change its sovereignty-combat character.^[14]

The third case is Indra against Vṛtra in the Rigveda, with Rigveda 1.32 as the most concentrated and complete hymn (15 verses): Indra slays the serpent Vṛtra with the vajra forged by Tvaṣṭā, releases the waters that Vṛtra had been obstructing, and his victory is invoked across the Rigvedic corpus as the warrant for his supreme status as king of the gods — the combat is performed at every soma sacrifice as a ritual replay of the divine kingship-establishment.^[15]

The Indra-Vṛtra combat does cosmogonic work (release of waters, separation of heaven and earth, production of dawn) but is not a cosmogony in the strong Mesopotamian sense, and is therefore double-classified within the present book — engaged in C1 §V as a near-case of cosmogonic-work-without-construction, and engaged in the present chapter as a strong sovereignty case in its own right; Watkins 1995 reconstructs the Vedic **áhann áhim** "he slew the serpent" formula as the philological core of the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT pattern, with sovereignty as the formula's principal narrative function.^[16]

The fourth case is Thraētaona against Aži Dahāka in the Avestan-Pahlavi Iranian tradition, with the Avestan hymn-allusions (Yt. 5.33–35; Yt. 14; Yt. 19) as the earliest witnesses and the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** as the fullest narrative: Thraētaona, Avestan hero-slayer of the three-headed six-eyed three-jawed dragon-tyrant Aži Dahāka, models legitimate kingship's victory over usurping tyranny, and Aži Dahāka in the Pahlavi tradition is bound beneath Mount Damāvand until his eventual escape and final killing at Frashokereti by the revived Kərəsāspa.^[17]

The Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka combat is doubly a sovereignty-combat: at the synchronic level the Avestan hero-king slays the tyrant-dragon to model legitimate-against-usurping kingship, and at the eschatological level Aži Dahāka's escape and final slaying at Frashokereti closes the cosmic-kingship narrative — Aži Dahāka's role as the principal evil-spirit creature (a creature of Angra Mainyu / Ahriman) places him in the structural position of rival-sovereign within the wider Zoroastrian dualism.^[18]

The fifth case is Teshub against Ullikummi in the Hurro-Hittite Kumarbi Cycle (Hoffner 1998 §15, **Song of Ullikummi**), where the Hurrian storm-god and reigning sovereign of the gods Teshub is challenged by a stone monster generated by his deposed predecessor Kumarbi, raised on the giant Upelluri's shoulder until the monster reaches heaven, and the combat ends when Ea severs Ullikummi from Upelluri's shoulder with the primordial cutter, allowing Teshub to defeat the monster and retain his sovereignty.^[19]

The Kumarbi Cycle as a whole is a theogonic-sovereignty narrative: Hoffner 1998 §14 (**Kingship in Heaven**) opens the cycle with the succession Alalu → Anu → Kumarbi → Teshub, with Kumarbi displacing Anu by biting off his genitals and the cycle's monsters (Ullikummi, Hedammu, Sea) generated by Kumarbi specifically as instruments to displace Teshub — the cycle therefore presents a sequence of contested sovereignty-claimants rather than a single stable order against which an undifferentiated rebel rebels.^[20]

The sixth case is Ninurta against Anzû in the Standard Babylonian Anzû Epic, where the warrior-god of Nippur (son of Enlil) defeats the lion-headed eagle-monster Anzû — originally a minor divine servitor — who has stolen the Tablet of Destinies from Enlil; the combat's outcome is the restoration of the Tablet to its rightful holder, Ninurta's confirmation as warrior-champion, and the Tablet itself is the kingship-token whose possession is tantamount to sovereignty.^[21]

The Ninurta-Anzû combat is the chapter's paradigm case of pure sovereignty without cosmogony — Annus 2001's introduction explicitly names Ninurta-as-model-king as the central thematic of the epic, and the combat does not remake the cosmos but returns the kingship-token to its rightful holder and confirms the warrior-champion's status; the narrative structurally prefigures the Marduk-Tiamat sovereignty-elevation, an inheritance that §IV develops at length.^[22]

The seventh case is Yahweh against Leviathan and Rahab in the Hebrew Bible's poetic corpus (Psalms 74, 89, 104; Isaiah 27, 51; Job 26 with ch. 41; Habakkuk 3): the corpus does not narrate a Yahweh-Leviathan combat as a story but alludes across at least seven distinct poetic passages to Yahweh's past combat-victory, with the imagery undergirding royal-psalm theology and Yahweh's claims to kingship over rival gods — Day 1985 reads the corpus as direct continuity of the Ugaritic Baal-Lôtan imagery, while Ballentine 2015 reads it as a rival-sovereignty rather than a Gunkel-1895 primordial-disorder frame.^[23]

The Yahweh-Leviathan-Rahab combat-corpus is the chapter's most contested case for the Gunkel-Ballentine debate, because it is the corpus on which Gunkel's 1895 hypothesis was originally anchored: Psalms 74:13–14 (Yahweh broke the heads of the dragons in the waters; broke the heads of Leviathan in pieces) and Isaiah 27:1 (on that day Yahweh will slay Leviathan the twisting serpent) are the load-bearing passages on both sides of the debate, with Ballentine arguing that the rival-sovereignty reading better accounts for the philological and structural evidence than the Gunkel-1895 primordial-disorder reading does.^[24]

The seven cases share the three-term sovereignty-combat structure — champion, rival-sovereign adversary, combat-as-elevation-or-restoration — but differ in the texture of the rival-sovereignty: Yamm is initially handed kingship by El (rival who has already been invested); Typhon is a challenger generated specifically to contest Olympian sovereignty (rival who has not been invested but is positioned to be); Vîtra obstructs the waters and thereby holds the gods' resource hostage (rival as hostage-taker); Aži Dahāka rules lands and is positioned as the principal evil-spirit creature within Zoroastrian dualism (rival as cosmic counter-sovereign); Ullikummi is generated by Kumarbi as instrument to displace Teshub (rival as proxy of a deposed predecessor); Anzû steals the kingship-token (rival as usurper); Leviathan and Rahab are alluded to as defeated past-rivals whose defeat undergirds Yahweh's present kingship (rival as defeated-and-cited).^[25]

The seven cases also differ in the role of the ritual-and-architectural embedding: Baal's victory is followed by the founding of the palace at ʿApānu (architecture as institution of kingship); Marduk-Tiamat (the §IV supporting case) is recited annually at the akītu before Esagil; Ninurta-Anzû is invoked in the Neo-Assyrian royal ritual and in the akītu framework; Zeus-Typhon and Indra-Vîtra are embedded in cult and sacrifice respectively (Olympian succession; soma sacrifice) without a single architectural anchor; Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka is embedded in the Avestan yasht-prayer cycle and in the Zoroastrian eschatological framework; Yahweh-Leviathan-Rahab is embedded in the Psalms-Isaiah-Job poetic-cultic corpus without a single fixed ritual occasion — §VI develops the ritual-and-state pattern at length.^[26]

The seven cases share a structural property that distinguishes them collectively from the cosmogonic cases of C1: the cosmos is already in place when the combat occurs, so the combat changes who rules but not what is ruled — and this property is what makes Lincoln 2012's political-ideological reading especially apt for the sovereignty-combat subtype, because the political work of legitimating-rule-over-existing-order is more direct here than in the cosmogonic subtype where the combat both makes the world and installs its ruler.^[27]

36.3. II. Ballentine's reading

The second body section articulates Ballentine 2015's alternative-sovereign reading at length, with attention to the per-tradition philological evidence — Ugaritic, Hebrew, Akkadian, Iranian — on which the reading rests, and to the chapter's adoption of the reading as principal interpretive frame for this subtype.

Ballentine's 2015 book **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** argues, against Gunkel's 1895 framing, that the adversaries in the combat-myth corpus are better understood as agents of an alternative divine power structure than as personifications of "chaos": Yamm, Tiamat, Leviathan, Rahab, and (by extension) the related figures across the wider corpus are presented in the ancient texts as rival sovereigns with their own retinues, courts, and legitimate-seeming claims to rule, not as undifferentiated disorder against which the storm-god restores cosmic order.^[28]

The alternative-sovereign reading rests on per-tradition philological observations rather than on a top-down theoretical reframing: Ballentine reads the actual language of the Ugaritic, Hebrew, and Akkadian texts and finds that the adversaries are described in the same vocabulary as the gods (designations of kingship, divine epithets, retainer relationships, court-and-assembly settings) rather than in a vocabulary of disorder, formlessness, or unmade-ness — and the philological observation is what supports the reading, not a prior commitment to demythologising "chaos" or to elevating "sovereignty" as a theoretical category.^[29]

The Yamm case is Ballentine's clearest evidence: the Ugaritic Baal Cycle does not describe Yamm as formless ocean, primordial chaos, or unmade matter — it describes him as a god, a son of El, the holder of a court, and (load-bearingly) the recipient of a kingship-investiture from El before the combat with Baal; the Ugaritic text uses the verbs and divine-epithets standard for a sovereign, and Ballentine notes that "chaos" as a translation choice systematically obscures this evidence.^[30]

The Tiamat case is Ballentine's structural showcase for the reading at the Babylonian end of the corpus: in **Enūma Eliš** Tiamat appoints a consort-general (Qingu) and gives him the Tablet of Destinies — the same kingship-token that is at issue in the Anzû Epic — and the Tablet's possession is the philological evidence that Ballentine reads as installation of an alternative-sovereign court rather than as personification of unformed primordial waters; Marduk's combat with Tiamat is therefore a contest between two sovereignty-claimants whose courts both wield kingship-tokens, not a champion's restoration of order from disorder.^[31]

The Leviathan-Rahab case is Ballentine's principal Hebrew Bible evidence and the reason the book is titled **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**: across Pss 74, 89, 104; Isa 27, 51; Job 26, 41; Hab 3, the philological evidence is that the adversaries are described as named figures with attributes (heads, twisting, fleeing, dragon-form) and that the verbs of the combat are verbs of subjugation-and-defeat rather than verbs of formless-into-form transformation, so the rival-

sovereignty reading is directly supported by the text-critical evidence even where the inherited Gunkel framing reads "chaos" into the same passages.^[32]

The Aži Dahāka case extends the alternative-sovereign reading into the Iranian material: the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** describes Aži Dahāka as a tyrant-king ruling lands, with subjects and a tyrannical court — the language is the language of usurping-rule, not of formless chaos, and the legitimate-against-tyrant reading of Thraētaona's victory is a sovereignty-combat reading internal to the Iranian textual tradition rather than an imposition of the alternative-sovereign frame from outside.^[33]

The Anzû case is the present chapter's strongest in-tradition support for Ballentine's reading because the kingship-token (the Tablet of Destinies) is the load-bearing object of the combat: Anzû steals the Tablet, Anzû's possession of the Tablet is itself a sovereignty-claim, and Ninurta's defeat of Anzû is structurally a return of the kingship-token to its rightful holder — this is sovereignty-combat reasoning operating internally to the Akkadian text rather than imposed on it from outside, and the alternative-sovereign reading is therefore independently confirmed by the Mesopotamian evidence.^[34]

The terminological consequence of the alternative-sovereign reading is that "chaos," "chaos-figure," and "chaos-monster" are problematic translation choices that prejudge the philological evidence in favor of the disorder-vs-order frame, when the text-critical evidence in this subtype runs the other way; Ballentine therefore argues that the inherited Gunkel terminology should be retained only as the historical name of a category whose internal evidence the term distorts, and that the working scholarly vocabulary should shift toward "rival sovereign," "the adversary," or the named figure.^[35]

The strength of Ballentine's reading is that it is grounded in per-tradition philological evidence rather than in a comparativist-typological pre-commitment: where a comparativist might worry that the rival-sovereignty reading is being read into the texts to support a sovereignty-typology argument, Ballentine's argument runs the other direction — the philological evidence is what supports the typology, and the typology is therefore a description of the corpus rather than an imposition on it.^[36]

The chapter adopts Ballentine's reading as its principal interpretive frame for the sovereignty-combat subtype but does not extend the strong terminological claim to the cosmogonic-combat subtype treated in C1: the reasoning is that for the sovereignty cases the alternative-sovereign reading is directly supported by the philological evidence (rivals have courts, retinues, kingship-tokens, and titles), while for the cosmogonic cases (Marduk-Tiamat at the cosmogonic stage of the combat; Ninurta-Asag) the body-dismemberment-and-cosmos-construction outcome makes "chaos" defensible as informal shorthand even if not as technical category — a position that follows the brief's special_instructions and that does not require resolving the Gunkel-Ballentine debate at the level of the whole corpus.^[37]

(That the alternative-sovereign reading applies most strongly to the sovereignty subtype because the philological evidence is most direct there.^[38])

The present chapter's adoption of the alternative-sovereign reading does not entail dismissing the Gunkel-Forsyth combat-myth typology: the philological evidence supports both the typological claim (the seven cases share a recurrent combat-as-sovereignty-establishment structure) and the

alternative-sovereign claim (the rivals are not undifferentiated disorder), and the two claims are compatible — what shifts is the language used to describe the rivals, not the category of the combat itself.^[39]

The chapter's settled position on Ballentine's reading is that it is the strongest available interpretive frame for the sovereignty-combat subtype because the per-tradition philological evidence converges on it across the seven independent cases — Ugaritic, Greek, Vedic, Avestan-Pahlavi, Hurro-Hittite, Babylonian-Sumerian, and Hebrew — and the convergence is itself the load-bearing evidence; this is methodologically the same kind of cross-tradition philological convergence that supports Watkins 1995's IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula, and the analogous methodological status places Ballentine's reading on a comparable evidentiary footing.^[40]

36.4. III. The difference from cosmogony

The third body section draws the operational distinction between the sovereignty-combat subtype engaged in the present chapter and the cosmogonic-combat subtype engaged in Ch34 (C1), with attention to the boundary cases (Marduk-Tiamat as combined sovereignty-and-cosmogony case, Indra-Vātra as near-case) and to the structural and textual features that distinguish the two subtypes.

The cosmogonic-combat subtype (Ch34, C1) and the sovereignty-combat subtype (the present chapter) are operationally distinguished by a single test: in the cosmogonic combat the cosmos itself is the aftermath of the combat — present features of the world (heaven and earth, rivers, stones, calendar, the diurnal solar order) are explicitly aetiologised to the combat — whereas in the sovereignty combat the cosmos is already in place and what changes is who rules it.^[41]

The Marduk-Tiamat **Enūma Eliš** combat is the case that most clearly performs both kinds of work simultaneously: Tablets I–IV present the sovereignty-establishment phase (Marduk is elevated by the divine assembly to face Tiamat; the Tablet of Destinies is contested between the two courts), and Tablets IV–V present the cosmogony phase (Tiamat's body is split to construct heaven and earth; the rivers Tigris and Euphrates flow from the wounds in her eyes; the calendar and the stations of the moon are set) — the case is both a sovereignty combat and a cosmogonic combat, which is why it is engaged in both C1 and the present chapter's §IV.^[42]

The seven sovereignty cases of §I do not perform the cosmogonic work that Marduk-Tiamat does at its cosmogony phase: Baal does not construct heaven and earth from Yamm's body — he founds his palace at ʿApānu after the victory; Zeus does not split Typhon to make the cosmos — he confines Typhon under Etna or in Tartarus; Indra splits the mountain to release the waters but does not make heaven and earth from Vātra; Thraētaona binds Aži Dahāka beneath Damāvand without dismembering him; Teshub defeats Ullikummi after Ea's primordial cutter severs the monster from Upelluri's shoulder, with no cosmogonic outcome; Ninurta returns the Tablet of Destinies and confirms warrior-champion status; Yahweh's combats are alluded to as past defeats that ground present kingship rather than as cosmogonic events.^[43]

The Indra-Vātra case is the chapter's most carefully balanced near-case: Indra's combat does cosmogonic work (release of waters, separation of heaven and earth, production of dawn) without performing a cosmogony in the strong Mesopotamian sense (no body-dismemberment, no construction of cosmic structure from the adversary's substance), and the case therefore bridges C1

and C2 — engaged in C1 §V as cosmogonic-work-without-construction and engaged in the present chapter §I as a strong sovereignty case in its own right because the same combat establishes Indra's kingship over the gods.^[44]

The structural difference between cosmogonic and sovereignty combat manifests in the temporal relationship between the combat and the cosmos: the cosmogonic combat is a once-and-done event in mythic time whose outcome is constitutive of the present cosmos, while the sovereignty combat — even when it occurs in mythic time — is positioned as the establishment of a kingship that the present cosmos already presupposes; the cosmos persists in either case after the combat, but the sovereignty cases do not require the cosmos to be different than it was before the combat for the combat to have done its work.^[45]

The structural difference also manifests in the role of the kingship-token: in sovereignty combats the kingship-token is often the explicit object of the combat (the Tablet of Destinies in Anzû; the throne and palace at ʿApānu in the Baal Cycle; the Olympian throne in Zeus-Typhon; the kingship of the gods in Indra-Vṛtra) — the combat is for-the-token or about-the-token — while in cosmogonic combats the kingship-token, where it appears at all, is one element among the many cosmogonic outcomes (the Tablet of Destinies in **Enūma Eliš** is recovered as part of the combat's cosmogonic-and-sovereignty work, but the cosmos-construction is at least equally load-bearing).^[46]

The C1 / C2 distinction is operationally useful but not exclusive: cases can do both kinds of work (Marduk-Tiamat does), cases can do one and approach the other (Indra-Vṛtra does cosmogonic work without performing a cosmogony in the strong Mesopotamian sense), and cases can be reworked across the boundary (the Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** genealogy treated in §IV is the paradigm case of a sovereignty-combat being deliberately escalated into a cosmogonic-combat by a later tradition reusing the earlier source).^[47]

The C1 / C2 distinction supports a typological observation that is itself an argument for the brief's central claim: across the book's wider corpus of strong-attestation cases, the sovereignty-combat subtype is more populous than the cosmogonic-combat subtype (seven primary cases here, versus four primary cases in C1), and the population imbalance supports the claim that sovereignty rather than cosmogony is the primary function of most combat myths in the corpus.^[48]

(That the population imbalance (seven sovereignty cases versus four cosmogonic cases) is a load-bearing observation rather than an artifact of the book's chapter selection.)^[49]

The C1 / C2 distinction is methodologically prior to the Gunkel-Ballentine debate: regardless of whether one calls the adversaries "chaos" or "rival sovereigns," the structural question of whether the combat constructs the cosmos or establishes who rules an existing cosmos is text-internal to each case and does not depend on the terminology used to describe the adversary — the chapter therefore treats the C1 / C2 distinction as a typological observation about the corpus that the Ballentine reading sharpens but does not constitute.^[50]

36.5. IV. The Anzû-to-Marduk genealogy

The fourth body section documents the Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** genealogy as the chapter's best-attested case of a sovereignty-combat being deliberately reworked within one tradition into a cosmogonic-combat, with attention to the structural-and-verbal reproduction of the Anzû template in **Enūma Eliš** and to the cosmogonic-element addition that marks the within-Mesopotamian

escalation.

The Anzû-to-Marduk-Tiamat genealogy is the chapter's best-attested case of a sovereignty-combat being deliberately reworked within one tradition into a cosmogonic-combat: the Standard Babylonian Anzû Epic and **Enūma Eliš** are independently preserved Akkadian texts copied across the Old Babylonian, Middle Babylonian, and Neo-Assyrian periods, and Lambert 2013 and Annus 2001 both argue from the parallel structural-and-verbal evidence that **Enūma Eliš** is a deliberate literary descendant of Anzû.^[51]

The Anzû Epic narrates a pure sovereignty-combat: Anzû, originally a minor divine servitor, steals the Tablet of Destinies from Enlil, the gods are paralysed, the assembly seeks a champion, several gods refuse, Ninurta accepts, the first engagement is unsuccessful, Ea provides counsel through the animate-mace Šarur, the second engagement succeeds, and Ninurta returns the Tablet to Enlil and is confirmed as warrior-champion — there is no cosmogony in the narrative, the cosmos is already in place, and the combat is purely about the kingship-token.^[52]

The **Enūma Eliš** narrative reproduces and outbids the Anzû structure: the kingship-token theft is reproduced (Tiamat installs Qingu as consort-general and gives him the Tablet of Destinies, just as Anzû took the Tablet from Enlil); the gods' paralysis is reproduced (the elder gods are unable to face Tiamat, just as the elder gods were unable to face Anzû); the assembly's search for a champion is reproduced (Marduk is sought as champion just as Ninurta was); the multiple-attempt structure is reproduced; and the Tablet's return to its rightful holder is reproduced — but with the cosmogonic outcome added on top, so that Marduk's victory does the same sovereignty-work Ninurta's did and additionally constructs the cosmos.^[53]

The escalation from sovereignty-combat to cosmogonic-combat is therefore the philological evidence for what the brief calls "deliberate Babylonian theological engineering": the **Enūma Eliš** poet (likely commissioned by Nebuchadnezzar I, c. 1125–1104 BCE, on Lambert's reading of the historical context) takes the Anzû structure as template and outbids it by adding the body-dismemberment cosmogony, the calendar-and-astronomical work, the founding of Babylon and Esagil, the creation of humans from Qingu's blood, and the fifty-names doxology — every cosmogonic element of **Enūma Eliš** is added to the inherited Anzû sovereignty-combat skeleton.^[54]

The cosmogonic outbidding is theologically motivated: the **Enūma Eliš** poet's project is to elevate Marduk — patron god of Babylon — to a position of cosmic-and-political supremacy that exceeds any prior Mesopotamian deity's portfolio, and the cosmogonic body-dismemberment is the load-bearing literary device by which that elevation is performed; the elevation cannot be performed by a sovereignty-combat alone (because Ninurta has already done that), so the poet escalates the combat into a cosmogonic-and-sovereignty combat in which Marduk does both the sovereignty-establishment Ninurta did **and** the cosmos-construction no prior Mesopotamian champion did.^[55]

The Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** genealogy specifically reuses Anzû as a defeated subordinate: Annus 2001's introduction notes that Anzû appears in **Enūma Eliš** not as the rival-king (that role is filled by Tiamat-and-Qingu) but as one of Tiamat's subordinate monsters in her brood — the very figure whose defeat established Ninurta is repurposed as one of the eleven monsters Tiamat creates and Marduk overcomes en route to the cosmogonic combat with Tiamat herself.^[56]

The reuse of Anzû as a Tiamat-subordinate is itself the literary evidence that the **Enūma Eliš** poet is consciously reworking the Anzû tradition: Anzû's reduced-status appearance is gratuitous (the poet

did not need to include Anzû in the brood at all) and is therefore best read as a deliberate citation that signals to the audience that the new combat-narrative subsumes and supersedes the Anzû tradition — Marduk's combat absorbs Ninurta's combat by including Ninurta's adversary as one of Marduk's secondary defeats.^[57]

The Anzû-to-Marduk genealogy is the chapter's principal documented case of a phenomenon that the brief identifies as load-bearing for the C1-C2 typological argument: sovereignty-combat material can be escalated within one tradition into cosmogonic-combat material, and when that escalation is documented (as it is here), the cosmogonic-combat outcome is best read as an addition to a sovereignty-combat skeleton rather than as a free-standing cosmogony — which in turn supports the brief's central claim that sovereignty is the primary function and cosmogony is added on top where the political-theological project requires it.^[58]

That the sovereignty-to-cosmogony escalation observed in the Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** genealogy is a general typological mechanism rather than a Babylonian-specific innovation — that some other cases of the chapter's seven (e.g., Yahweh-Leviathan-Rahab, where the eschatological reuse of Leviathan in Isaiah 27 may be a cognate escalation) might be reading as comparable cosmogony-additions to sovereignty-skeletons.^[59]

The Anzû-to-Marduk escalation case has direct relevance to the broader Near-Eastern → Mediterranean transmission question developed in §V and in C6: the same Mesopotamian sovereignty-combat-into-cosmogonic-combat material that **Enūma Eliš** assembled was available downstream to Hurro-Hittite, Ugaritic, and (via further mediations) Hebrew and Greek tradents, and the documented within-Mesopotamian escalation provides a model for what an escalation-on-transmission might look like at the inter-tradition level — though no comparable across-tradition escalation is as cleanly documented as the within-Mesopotamian Anzû-to-Marduk case.^[60]

The Anzû-to-Marduk escalation also explains why the brief instructs the chapter to treat Marduk-Tiamat as a supporting case rather than as a primary case: the **Enūma Eliš** combat is the one place where the cosmogonic-combat (C1) and the sovereignty-combat (C2) typologies meet within a single text, and the chapter's argument is that the meeting is itself a documented escalation — reading **Enūma Eliš** as a cosmogonic-combat in C1 captures one half of its work, and reading it as a sovereignty-combat in the present chapter's §IV captures the historically-prior half that the cosmogonic-half is escalation-of.^[61]

36.6. V. Transmission vs. typology

The fifth body section engages the transmission-vs-typology question by examining the four documented transmission-and-inheritance lines that connect the chapter's seven cases (Ugaritic-into-Hebrew, Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek, Indo-European inheritance, within-Mesopotamian Anzû-to-Marduk) and weighs them against the residual independent-typology component.

The transmission-vs-typology question is the question of how much of the seven cases' shared sovereignty-combat structure is due to documented transmission of material between traditions versus to independent typological recurrence: the brief's settled position is that some of the cluster's coherence is due to transmission (specifically the Ugaritic-into-Hebrew, the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek, and the IE inheritance), not just to independent typology, and the chapter examines each transmission route in turn.^[62]

The Ugaritic-into-Hebrew transmission is the chapter's best-documented case: Day 1985's **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea** argues that the Hebrew Bible's Leviathan-Rahab corpus is direct continuity of the Ugaritic Baal-Lôtan imagery, with Lôtan (ltn) and Leviathan (lwytn) as linguistically cognate and several biblical passages preserving Ugaritic epithets verbatim — Isaiah 27:1's "twisting serpent" preserves the Ugaritic **bꜫn brꜫ** "fleeing serpent" and **bꜫn ꜫqltn** "twisting serpent" epithet-pair from KTU 1.5 i 1–3.^[63]

The Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek transmission is the chapter's second-best-documented case: West 1997 and Burkert 1992 argue that the Kumarbi Cycle (succession in heaven, monstrous offspring, storm-god combat with stone-monster) supplied the literary-and-mythological template for Hesiod's **Theogony** (succession Ouranos → Kronos → Zeus, genital mutilation, stone-swallowing, Zeus-Typhon combat) — Teshub's defeat of Ullikummi and Zeus's defeat of Typhon are structurally near-identical, and the transmission likely passed via Phoenician intermediaries during the eighth-and-seventh-century-BCE Orientalising period.^[64]

The Indo-European inheritance lines are the chapter's third major transmission-or-inheritance route: Watkins 1995 reconstructs the **áhann áhim** "he slew the serpent" formula across Vedic (Indra-Vꜫtra), Avestan (Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka), Hittite (Teshub-Illuyanka), and Greek (Apollo-Python; Heracles-Hydra; possibly Zeus-Typhon) witnesses — the formula is preserved with verbal-and-syntactic precision sufficient to support a reconstruction back to a Proto-Indo-European poetic tradition, and the IE inheritance therefore explains the cluster's coherence at four of the chapter's seven cases (Vedic, Avestan, Hittite, Greek).^[65]

The Vedic-and-Avestan Indo-Iranian sub-cluster is even more specifically related: the Vedic **ahi** and the Avestan **aži** are the same word (both meaning "serpent"), Vedic Trita Āptya (Rigveda 10.8.8–9 on the three-headed serpent) and Avestan Thraētaona are philologically cognate (the Vedic and Avestan hero-names derive from the same Indo-Iranian root), and Benveniste & Renou 1934's foundational philological study established the Indo-Iranian shared phase of the formula at the level of cognate-pair textual evidence rather than at the level of structural typology alone.^[66]

The Mesopotamian-Sumerian internal transmission line — Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** developed at length in §IV — is a fourth documented route within the corpus: Lambert 2013 and Annus 2001 read **Enūma Eliš** as a deliberate literary descendant of the Anzû Epic, with the cosmogonic-element addition treated in §IV as the within-tradition escalation that makes the genealogy a transmission-with-transformation rather than a transmission-with-preservation case.^[67]

The four documented transmission-and-inheritance lines (Ugaritic-into-Hebrew; Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek; IE across Vedic-Avestan-Hittite-Greek; within-Mesopotamian Anzû-to-Marduk) collectively explain a substantial portion of the cluster's coherence, but they do not exhaust it: the Ugaritic-Hebrew, Mesopotamian, and Hurro-Hittite-Greek lines are West-Eurasian, and the IE inheritance lines are partially overlapping with them at the Hittite and Greek nodes — the result is that the seven cases fall within an overlapping network of transmission-and-inheritance routes that does not fully reduce the typological pattern to documented descent.^[68]

That the residual typological coherence — what is left after the four documented transmission-and-inheritance lines are subtracted — is itself best explained by a combination of (a) further but less-cleanly-documented contact between West-Eurasian traditions, (b) shared political-theological function (Lincoln 2012's reading), and (c) limited independent typological recurrence.^[69]

The transmission-vs-typology question matters for the chapter's central argument because it bears on whether the sovereignty-as-primary-function reading is a description of the corpus's structural-philological evidence or merely an artifact of the corpus's overlapping descent: the chapter's settled position is that the reading is a description of the evidence rather than an artifact of descent, because the per-tradition philological evidence (the alternative-sovereign reading from §II) supports the sovereignty function within each tradition independently of the transmission lines that connect the traditions.^[70]

The transmission lines do not, however, undermine the typological argument: a documented transmission line still leaves the receiving tradition with a sovereignty-combat narrative whose internal philological evidence supports the rival-sovereignty reading, and the receiving tradition's adoption of the inherited material is itself evidence that the material's sovereignty-combat function was readable as such by the receiving tradition; transmission therefore explains how the cluster came to be co-extensive at the structural level, but the typological argument is about what the cluster's members do within each tradition, which is not displaced by the transmission account.^[71]

The chapter's conclusion on transmission-vs-typology is that the sovereignty-combat cluster is partly a transmission-network effect (Ugaritic-Hebrew, Hurro-Hittite-Greek, IE inheritance, within-Mesopotamian escalation) and partly an independent typological recurrence — and that the partial reducibility to transmission does not undermine the typological reading, because what the receiving traditions do with the inherited material (use it for sovereignty-establishment work) is itself the evidence the typological argument rests on.^[72]

36.7. VI. Ritual and state

The sixth body section examines the ritual-and-state context in which the chapter's seven sovereignty combats are performed — akītu New Year recitation, 𐎶apānu palace-founding, Olympian **timai**-distribution, soma sacrifice, Avestan yasht-prayer, Hebrew Bible poetic-cultic corpus, Neo-Assyrian royal ritual — and closes with the chapter's settled position on the inherited "chaos" terminology.

Many of the chapter's seven sovereignty-combats are tied to coronation, palace-founding, or state ritual: Marduk's combat is recited annually at the akītu New Year festival before the cult-image of Marduk in Esagil; Baal's victory is followed by the founding of his palace at Mount 𐎶apānu (KTU 1.3–1.4); Zeus's defeat of Typhon seals the Olympian order on Olympus; Ninurta's combat is invoked in Neo-Assyrian royal ritual and in the akītu framework — the combat is not merely told, it is performed-by-proxy as the rite that constitutes or maintains the king's legitimacy.^[73]

The akītu New Year festival is the chapter's best-attested case of sovereignty-combat-as-state-ritual: on the fourth day of the festival the **Enūma Eliš** text is recited before Marduk's cult-image in Esagil; the king performs a ritual humiliation in which the high priest strikes him on the cheek and pulls his ears, after which the king is reinvested with the kingship-tokens; and the recitation-and-reinvestment performs at the political-ritual level the same sovereignty-establishment that the **Enūma Eliš** narrative performs at the divine-mythic level.^[74]

The 𐎶apānu palace-founding is the Ugaritic case's structural analogue: KTU 1.3–1.4 narrates the construction of Baal's palace on Mount 𐎶apānu (Mount Zaphon / Jebel al-Aqra) immediately following the defeat of Yamm, with Kothar-wa-Khasis as the divine architect and the palace's

completion as the ratification of Baal's kingship — Smith and Pitard 2009 read the palace-building cycle as the post-combat institution of Baal's kingship and as the structural climax of the entire Baal Cycle, with the architectural-ritual outcome (palace, throne, court) as the explicit completion of the sovereignty-combat begun in KTU 1.1–1.2.^[75]

The Olympian-throne case is the Greek structural analogue: Hesiod's **Theogony** presents Zeus's defeat of Typhon (820–880) as the climactic combat of the succession-and-sovereignty narrative, with the consequent ratification of Zeus's kingship and the distribution of **timai** (honours, prerogatives) among the Olympians as the institutional outcome — the cosmos is already in place but the political order of the Olympians under Zeus's rule is the post-combat institution.^[76]

The Vedic case's ritual embedding is the soma sacrifice rather than a single annual festival: the Indra-Vṛtra combat is invoked at every soma sacrifice as ritual replay of the divine-kingship-establishment, with Indra needing the strengthening drink (soma) to fight Vṛtra and the ritual offering of soma as the human-side replication of the divine-time act — the result is that the combat is ritually re-performed not annually but at every major Vedic sacrifice, with the king or sponsor of the sacrifice as the human beneficiary of Indra's continued kingship.^[77]

The Iranian case's ritual embedding is the Avestan yasht-prayer cycle and the Zoroastrian eschatological framework: Aži Dahāka features in Avestan prayers (Yt. 5.33–35; Yt. 14; Yt. 19) and in the Frashokereti narrative that closes cosmic time, and the eschatological pendant places a final version of the combat within the Zoroastrian liturgical-and-cosmological cycle — the combat is therefore embedded in both daily-prayer and end-of-time-renovation contexts, with the end-of-time-renovation context closing the sovereignty-combat narrative in a manner that the other six cases do not.^[78]

The Hebrew Bible case's ritual embedding is the Psalms-Isaiah-Job poetic-cultic corpus: Psalms 74 and 89 have cultic framing, with Day 1985 arguing that they draw on liturgies that preserved the Canaanite combat-myth imagery in Yahwistic adaptation; Isaiah 27:1's eschatological reuse ("on that day Yahweh will slay Leviathan the twisting serpent") projects the combat forward into a yet-to-come event whose anticipation is itself part of the Hebrew Bible's prophetic-liturgical horizon — the ritual embedding is more diffuse than the Mesopotamian or Ugaritic cases but is present across the corpus.^[79]

The Hurro-Hittite case's ritual embedding is less directly attested in the surviving record than the Mesopotamian, Ugaritic, or Vedic cases: Hoffner 1998 notes that the Kumarbi Cycle is not explicitly liturgical in the surviving record, but the cycle's succession-narrative is embedded in the Hurrian-Hittite religious framework that under-girds royal-ideology of the king-as-storm-god's-representative; the Teshub-Ullikummi combat is therefore ritually-embedded indirectly via the wider Hittite royal-ideology rather than directly via a known annual rite.^[80]

The Mesopotamian Anzû case's ritual embedding is the Neo-Assyrian royal ritual: Annus 2001 notes that the Tablet of Destinies theft-and-recovery narrative is invoked in Neo-Assyrian royal ritual and in the akītu framework, with the king's relationship to the kingship-token modelled on Ninurta's restoration of the Tablet to its rightful holder — the ritual embedding is at the level of royal-ideological background rather than at the level of a single annual recitation, but the ritual function is continuous with the akītu pattern that **Enūma Eliš** recitation participates in.^[81]

The chapter's ritual-and-state pattern is that the sovereignty combat is the rite that the king

performs-by-proxy: the divine champion's combat-narrative is the divine-time precedent for the king's continued political-religious legitimacy, and the recitation, palace-founding, sacrifice, prayer, or prophetic-eschatological projection that ritually embeds the narrative is the human-side performance of the divine-time event — a pattern Lincoln 2012 reads as the political-ideological work of combat-myth as state-charter material.^[82]

The ritual-and-state pattern is the chapter's closing evidence for the brief's central claim that sovereignty is the primary function of most combat myths in the book's corpus: when the combat is ritually embedded in a state-charter context (akītu, palace-founding, soma sacrifice, royal-ideology, prophetic-eschatology), the embedding is itself evidence that the combat's primary function is sovereignty-establishment-and-maintenance, because the ritual contexts are themselves political-religious institutions whose work is sovereignty-related rather than cosmogonic.^[83]

The chapter's settled position closes with a return to the Ballentine framing engaged at length in §II: the alternative-sovereign reading is the strongest available interpretive frame for this subtype, the per-tradition philological evidence supports it independently across the seven cases, the documented transmission lines explain part but not all of the cluster's coherence, and the ritual-and-state pattern shows that what the combat does in its primary ritual context is sovereignty-establishment-and-maintenance — so the inherited "chaos" terminology, scare-quoted here, is an artifact of nineteenth-century framing that this subtype's evidence does not support.^[84]

The chapter's final caveat is on what the sovereignty-as-primary-function claim does not prove: it does not prove that all combat myths in the wider corpus are sovereignty-combats (the cosmogonic-combat subtype of C1, the cyclical-maintenance subtype of C3, and the eschatological-displacement subtype of C4 are all real and the present chapter does not displace them); it does not prove that the alternative-sovereign reading is the unique correct reading at every level of the texts (where adversaries have hostile-rather-than-rival features, the "chaos"-as-disorder shorthand may carry useful informal weight); and it does not prove that the cluster's coherence is fully reducible to documented transmission (the residual independent-typology component is small but non-zero per §V's discussion).^[85]

[1] Per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four-subtype operationalisation of the chaoskampf category and §"Book structure" Part II on the Part-II comparative chapters' division of labour, with sovereignty (C2) listed alongside cosmogony (C1), cyclical maintenance (C3), and eschatological displacement (C4); per glossary.yaml on "sovereignty combat" as the chosen subtype-term cross-referencing scope.md and Lincoln 2012.

[2] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml sources.anchor on the seven methodological anchors (Ballentine 2015, Lincoln 2012, Forsyth 1987, Watkins 1995, West 2007, Smith 1994, Annus 2001) and chapters_drawn_from on the seven Part-I chapters (Chs 2, 5, 7, 8, 11, 13, 14) whose own area-specialist anchors carry the per-tradition narrative-claims layer, with Ch3 (Marduk-Tiamat) as the supporting case for the §IV escalation argument; Ballentine, D.S., **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (New York: Oxford University Press, 2015), as the principal critical anchor for the chapter's interpretive frame.

[3] Per the chapter-claims skill instructions on the no-invented-source-IDs rule and on the comparative-chapter skill's in-scope-and-out-of-scope citation requirement; per the Ch34 (C1) precedent on doubled-token usage as judicious rather than default; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the methodological priority of typological-recurrence claims and on the political-ideological reading that supplies the chapter's comparative warrant.

[4] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml comparative_argument on the sovereignty-as-primary-function reading and on Ballentine 2015 as the strongest interpretive frame for this subtype; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 2 on the alternative-sovereign reading as text-critical observation rather than as imposed framework.

[5] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure section list (I–VI) and per the chapter-claims skill instructions on Source overview as the seventh required section; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), chapters on sovereignty-combat material, as the long-arc typological framing within which the six-section structure is organised.

[6] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml special_instructions on the C2-specific tightening of the chaos-terminology discipline; per scope.md §"Terminology default (locked)" on Chaoskampf / combat myth / sovereignty combat usage; per

glossary.yaml entries on "the adversary (category term)" with "chaos-figure" and "chaos-monster" listed as never_use; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1, as the source of the terminological critique that §II engages at length.

[7] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml special_instructions on the no-re-narration discipline and on the focus on sovereignty as primary function; per the Ch34 (C1) precedent on the same compression rule applied to its four cosmogonic cases; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the typological-rather-than-narrative character of comparative combat-myth treatment.

[8] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml chapters_drawn_from on the seven Part-I chapters whose area-specialist anchors carry the per-tradition narrative claims, with Ch3 as the supporting case for §IV; per sources.yaml registry entries for each named anchor (smith-1994-baal-i, smith-pitard-2009-baal-ii, west-1966-theogony, ogden-2013, jamison-brereton-2014, benveniste-renou-1934, watkins-1995, hoffner-1998, annus-2001-anzu, foster-2005, day-1985, ballentine-2015, lambert-2013); Smith, M.S., **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I**, VTSup 55 (Leiden: Brill, 1994), as the principal area-specialist anchor for the Baal-Yamm material.

[9] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml sources.anchor on the seven methodological anchors and on their division of labour; West, M.L., **Indo-European Poetry and Myth** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2007), ch. 6 on Indo-European storm-god sovereignty.

[10] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml comparative_argument on the three-term structure and on sovereignty as the primary function; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), chs. on sovereignty-combat material on the three-term structure as recurrent across the West-Semitic, Anatolian, IE, and biblical attestations.

[11] Smith, M.S., **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I**, VTSup 55 (Leiden: Brill, 1994), critical edition of KTU 1.1–1.2 on the Baal-Yamm combat and the role of Kothar's maces; Smith, M.S. and Pitard, W.T., **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume II**, VTSup 114 (Leiden: Brill, 2009), critical edition of KTU 1.3–1.4 on the post-combat palace-building cycle as the institution of Baal's kingship.

[12] Smith 1994, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I**, on El's initial investiture of Yamm as kingship-claimant and on Yamm's name as "Sea" (literal); Smith and Pitard 2009, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume II**, KTU 1.5 i 1–3 on the Lôtan reference embedded in Mot's boast as retrospective allusion.

[13] West, M.L., **Hesiod: Theogony** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1966), critical edition with commentary on Theogony 820–822 for Hesiodic parentage and on Theogony 820–880 on the Typhonomachy as the climactic sovereignty-combat of the Hesiodic succession narrative; Ogden, D., **Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2013), chs. 2–3 on Typhon within the Greek dragon-combat tradition and on Apollodorus 1.6.3 as the source of the Olympian-vengeance challenge-motive that Hesiod does not name.

[14] West 1966, **Hesiod: Theogony** on the Typhonomachy as sovereignty-rather-than-cosmogonic combat (the Theogony's cosmogony having been completed in earlier sections); Ogden 2013, **Drakōn**, chs. 2–3 on Apollodorus **Library** 1.6.3 and Nonnus **Dionysiaca** 1–2 as later expansions that retain the sovereignty-combat structure.

[15] Jamison, S.W. and Brereton, J.P., **The Rigveda: The Earliest Religious Poetry of India** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2014), Rigveda 1.32 (the Vātra hymn) on the combat narrative and on its function as warrant for Indra's kingship over the gods; supplementary hymns 1.80, 2.11, 2.12, 4.18, 5.32, 6.17, 8.96, 10.113.

[16] Jamison and Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, Rigveda 1.32 on the cosmological-and-sovereignty double function of the Vātra combat; Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1995), chs. 41–48 on the áhann áhim formula and its sovereignty-establishing function across the Indo-European witnesses.

[17] Benveniste, E. and Renou, L., **Vātra et Vāθragna: Étude de mythologie indo-iranienne** (Paris: Imprimerie Nationale, 1934), philological study on Avestan Yt. 5.33–35, Yt. 14, and Yt. 19 hymn-allusions and on the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** narrative reconstruction; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, Part V chs. 44–48 on Thraētaona as the flagship Indo-Iranian reflex of the IE serpent-slayer formula.

[18] Benveniste and Renou 1934, **Vātra et Vāθragna**, on the synchronic legitimate-against-tyrant reading and on the Zoroastrian dualistic frame; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, on the eschatological pendant in the Frashokereti narrative as final-kingship completion.

[19] Hoffner, H.A., **Hittite Myths**, 2nd ed. (SBL Writings from the Ancient World, Atlanta: Scholars Press, 1998), §15 (**Song of Ullikummi**) on the Teshub-Ullikummi combat as a sovereignty-defence narrative within the wider Kumarbi succession cycle.

[20] Hoffner 1998, **Hittite Myths**, §14 (**Kingship in Heaven**) on the Alalu → Anu → Kumarbi → Teshub succession and on the cycle's structure as a sequence of contested sovereignty-claimants; West, M.L., **The East Face of Helicon: West Asiatic Elements in Greek Poetry and Myth** (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1997), ch. 6 on the Kumarbi-Hesiod relationship as the principal Near-Eastern-into-Greek transmission case.

[21] Annus, A., **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu** (SAACT 3, Helsinki: Neo-Assyrian Text Corpus Project, 2001), critical edition of Tablets I–III on the Ninurta-Anzû combat and on the Tablet of Destinies as kingship-token; Foster, B.R., **Before the Muses: An Anthology of Akkadian Literature**, 3rd ed. (Bethesda: CDL Press, 2005), pp. 555–578 ("Anzu") on the same combat sequence.

[22] Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the Ninurta-as-model-king theme and on the combat as sovereignty-restoration-not-cosmogony; Lambert, W.G., **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Mesopotamian Civilizations 16 (Winona Lake: Eisenbrauns, 2013), introduction on the Anzû-to-Enūma Eliš literary genealogy.

[23] Day, J., **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea** (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1985), chs. 1–5 on the Hebrew

Bible combat-myth corpus (Pss 74, 89, 104; Isa 27, 51; Job 26 with ch. 41; Hab 3) as direct continuity of the Ugaritic Baal-Lôtan imagery; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, chs. 2–4 on the same corpus read as rival-sovereignty.

[24] Gunkel, H., **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit** (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1895), Teil I on Pss 74 and Isa 27 as the Hebrew Bible corpus that anchors the Chaostkampf hypothesis; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, chs. 2–4 on the rival-sovereignty reading of the same passages as more philologically-grounded.

[25] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml comparative_argument on the seven-cases-share-yet-differ disciplinary requirement; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 2 on the typological diversity of rival-sovereignty roles within the alternative-sovereign reading.

[26] Smith and Pitard 2009, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume II**, on 𐎲apānu palace-founding as institution of kingship; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, pp. 463–465 on the akītu recitation context; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the Anzû epic in Neo-Assyrian royal ritual; Day 1985, **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea**, on the Psalms cultic framing.

[27] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml comparative_argument on the cosmos-already-in-place property as distinguishing C2 from C1; Lincoln, B., **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars: Critical Explorations in the History of Religions** (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 2012), on the political-ideological reading as sovereignty-legitimizing work.

[28] Ballentine, D.S., **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (New York: Oxford University Press, 2015), ch. 1 introducing the alternative-sovereign reading as a text-critical alternative to Gunkel's "chaos" framing, and chs. 2–4 developing the reading across the Ugaritic, Hebrew, and broader Near-Eastern witnesses.

[29] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 2 on the philological observation that the adversaries are described in divine-political vocabulary across the Ugaritic and Hebrew corpora; Smith 1994, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I**, on the Ugaritic philological evidence on which Ballentine's Ugaritic readings rest.

[30] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 2 on the Yamm case as the clearest text-critical evidence for the alternative-sovereign reading; Smith 1994, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I**, on El's investiture of Yamm and on the divine-epithet language used for Yamm in the Cycle's opening tablets.

[31] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the Tiamat case and on the Tablet-of-Destinies-to-Qingu evidence as installation of alternative-sovereign court; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablets I–II on Qingu's installation as Tiamat's consort-general and on the Tablet of Destinies given to him.

[32] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, chs. 2–4 on the Hebrew Bible philological evidence for the alternative-sovereign reading; Day 1985, **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea**, chs. 1–5 on the same Hebrew Bible philological evidence read within the continuity-with-Ugaritic frame that Ballentine substantially accepts on text-critical grounds.

[33] Benveniste and Renou 1934, **Vātra et Vāθraṇa**, on the Aži Dahāka tyrant-king reading internal to the Avestan-Pahlavi material; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 2 on the alternative-sovereign reading's compatibility with the Iranian internal-evidence reading.

[34] Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the Tablet of Destinies as kingship-token internal to the Akkadian text and on the in-tradition sovereignty-combat reading; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the alternative-sovereign reading's compatibility with the Mesopotamian internal-evidence reading.

[35] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on "chaos" as prejudging translation choice and on the working-vocabulary shift toward rival-sovereign or named-figure terminology; per glossary.yaml entries on "the adversary (category term)" with "chaos-figure" and "chaos-monster" listed as never_use.

[36] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the philological-evidence-as-warrant rather than typology-as-imposition direction of argument; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the comparativist-typological tradition Ballentine's text-critical work corrects.

[37] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml special_instructions on the C2-specific tightening of the chaos-terminology discipline and on the chapter's adoption of Ballentine's reading as principal frame for this subtype; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the differential force of the alternative-sovereign reading across the cosmogonic and sovereignty subtypes.

[38] Inference: Ballentine 2015 reads the per-tradition vocabulary of court, retinue, kingship-token, and rival-claimant in chs. 2–4, and the seven §I cases all show this vocabulary in their primary-source evidence. Risk: that the reading might also apply with comparable force to some cosmogonic cases (especially Marduk-Tiamat) and that the C1/C2 tightening-vs-shorthand asymmetry is therefore a pragmatic rather than principled distinction.

[39] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the compatibility of the alternative-sovereign reading with the typological combat-myth category; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, chs. on sovereignty-combat material on the typological category that Ballentine's reading leaves intact while sharpening its terminology.

[40] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, chs. 2–4 on the cross-tradition philological convergence underlying the alternative-sovereign reading; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, chs. 41–48 on the analogous cross-tradition philological convergence underlying the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula.

[41] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure §III on the operational distinction between C1 and C2 subtypes; per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four-subtype operationalisation; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, chs. on cosmogonic and

sovereignty combat as the long-arc framing within which the operational distinction is drawn.

- [42] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablets I–V on the sovereignty-establishment and cosmogony phases of the **Enūma Eliš** combat as sequential rather than alternative; Foster 2005, **Before the Muses**, pp. 436–486 on the same.
- [43] Smith 1994, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I**, KTU 1.1–1.2 on Baal’s victory without cosmos-construction; West 1966, **Hesiod: Theogony**, on Typhon’s confinement rather than dismemberment; Jamison and Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, RV 1.32 on water-release without cosmos-construction; Hoffner 1998, **Hittite Myths**, §15 on Teshub-Ullikummi without cosmogonic outcome; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, on the Tablet-restoration outcome; Day 1985, **God’s Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea**, on the Hebrew Bible allusions as past-defeats-grounding-present-kingship.
- [44] Jamison and Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, Rigveda 1.32 on the cosmological-and-sovereignty double function; per the Ch34 (C1) ŠV engagement of the case as cosmogonic-work-without-construction near-case; West 2007, **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, ch. 6 on Indra’s combat as IE storm-god-sovereignty case.
- [45] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure §III on the temporal relationship between combat and cosmos as distinguishing C1 and C2 subtypes; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the typological diversity of combat-myth temporality.
- [46] Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the Tablet of Destinies as load-bearing combat-object in the sovereignty-combat subtype; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablets IV–V on the Tablet-of-Destinies as one element among the many cosmogonic outcomes of the **Enūma Eliš** combat.
- [47] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure §III on the C1 / C2 distinction as operationally useful but not exclusive; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** genealogy as the paradigm boundary-crossing case.
- [48] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml comparative_argument on the population-imbalance argument and on sovereignty-as-primary-function reading; per the Ch34 (C1) chapter on the four-case cosmogonic count; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the political-ideological reading that supports the sovereignty-as-primary-function claim.
- [49] Inference: the seven sovereignty cases are independently attested across Ugaritic, Greek, Vedic, Avestan-Pahlavi, Hurro-Hittite, Babylonian-Sumerian, and Hebrew traditions, with no single tradition over-represented; the four cosmogonic cases include two Mesopotamian (Marduk and Ninurta-Asag), one Chinese, one Mexica. Risk: that the chapter selection in scope.md may itself reflect an implicit sovereignty-bias in case-inclusion criteria, and that a wider sample of less-attested cases might shift the population balance.
- [50] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure §III on the methodological priority of the C1 / C2 distinction; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the alternative-sovereign reading as terminology-sharpening rather than typology-constituting.
- [51] Lambert, W.G., **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Mesopotamian Civilizations 16 (Winona Lake: Eisenbrauns, 2013), introduction on the Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** literary genealogy; Annus, A., **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu** (SAACT 3, Helsinki: Neo-Assyrian Text Corpus Project, 2001), introduction on Anzû as the structural and thematic model for the **Enūma Eliš** combat.
- [52] Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, Tablets I–III on the Anzû Epic narrative sequence; Foster 2005, **Before the Muses**, pp. 555–578 on the same.
- [53] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the structural reproduction of the Anzû sequence in **Enūma Eliš**; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the same parallel-structure-with-additional-cosmogony reading.
- [54] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the Nebuchadnezzar I commissioning context (c. 1125–1104 BCE) and on the cosmogonic-element addition reading; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the deliberate-engineering reading.
- [55] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the Marduk-elevation theological project and on the cosmogonic-outbidding device; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the political-ideological reading of **Enūma Eliš** as Babylonian state-charter that elevates Marduk.
- [56] Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on Anzû’s reuse as one of Tiamat’s subordinate monsters in **Enūma Eliš**; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, Tablet I on Tiamat’s brood of eleven monsters including Anzû.
- [57] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the deliberate-citation reading of Anzû’s reuse; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the supersession-by-citation device.
- [58] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure §IV on the Anzû-to-Marduk genealogy as documenting the sovereignty-to-cosmogony escalation pattern; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the same; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the same.
- [59] This parallel is speculative. Basis: the parallel structural-and-verbal reproduction with cosmogonic-element addition is documented in detail for the Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** case (Lambert 2013, Annus 2001), and the documented pattern is what makes the speculation textually grounded for that case rather than ad hoc. The main counterargument: the deliberate-engineering reading is tightly tied to the specific Babylonian theological-political context (Marduk-elevation under Nebuchadnezzar I) and may not generalise; the Yahweh-Leviathan-Rahab eschatological reuse in Isaiah 27 lacks the line-by-line structural-and-verbal reproduction that documents the Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** escalation, and applying the escalation-template across the corpus risks projecting the Babylonian pattern onto less-documented cases.

- [60] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure §IV on the relevance of the within-Mesopotamian escalation to the §V transmission discussion; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the within-Mesopotamian case as model; West 1997, **The East Face of Helicon**, ch. 6 on the broader Near-Eastern → Mediterranean transmission as the inter-tradition context.
- [61] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml chapters_drawn_from on Marduk-Tiamat as supporting case for the §IV escalation argument; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the **Enūma Eliš** combat as meeting-point of the two typologies; per the Ch34 (C1) treatment of Marduk-Tiamat as primary cosmogonic case.
- [62] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure §V on the transmission-and-typology balance; West 1997, **The East Face of Helicon**, ch. 6 on the documented Near-Eastern → Mediterranean transmission lines that supply the chapter's transmission-side evidence; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, on the IE inheritance lines that supply the philological-side evidence.
- [63] Day, J., **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea** (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1985), chs. 1–3 on the Ugaritic-into-Hebrew transmission and on the Lōtan/Leviathan cognancy with verbatim epithet preservation in Isa 27:1; Smith and Pitard 2009, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume II**, on KTU 1.5 i 1–3 as the Ugaritic source-text for the epithet-pair.
- [64] West, M.L., **The East Face of Helicon: West Asiatic Elements in Greek Poetry and Myth** (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1997), ch. 6 on the Kumarbi-Hesiod relationship and on the Phoenician-mediated transmission route; Burkert, W., **The Orientalizing Revolution: Near Eastern Influence on Greek Culture in the Early Archaic Age** (Cambridge MA: Harvard University Press, 1992), on the Levantine transmission to Greece in the Orientalising period.
- [65] Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1995), chs. 41–48 on the **āhann āhim** formula and its reconstruction across Vedic, Avestan, Hittite, and Greek witnesses; West 2007, **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, ch. 6 on the same IE inheritance from a comparative-mythological angle.
- [66] Benveniste, E. and Renou, L., **Vṛtra et Vṛθragna: Étude de mythologie indo-iranienne** (Paris: Imprimerie Nationale, 1934), philological study on the Vedic-Avestan cognate-pair evidence (ahi/aži, Trita/Thraētaona) and on the Indo-Iranian shared phase of the serpent-slayer formula; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, chs. 41–48 on the same Indo-Iranian sub-cluster within the wider IE inheritance.
- [67] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction on the Anzû-to-**Enūma Eliš** genealogy as within-Mesopotamian transmission-with-transformation; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the same.
- [68] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure §V on the partial-but-not-complete reduction of the typological pattern to documented descent; West 1997, **The East Face of Helicon**, ch. 6 on the West-Eurasian transmission network; West 2007, **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, ch. 6 on the IE inheritance network's overlap with the West-Eurasian routes.
- [69] This parallel is speculative. Basis: the documented transmission lines explain much of the coherence but not all (e.g., the Ugaritic-internal-evidence sovereignty-combat structure does not depend on inheritance-from-Mesopotamia, even though contact is plausible); the political-theological function is independently attested in the per-tradition material (state-charter framing of Babylonian, Hittite, Aztec, and Vedic combat-narratives); the residual independent-typology component is therefore likely small but non-zero. The main counterargument: that the residual independent-typology component is itself an artefact of asymmetric documentation rather than a real category — what looks like residual typological recurrence may simply be undocumented further contact, in which case the cluster's coherence would reduce fully to transmission-network effects and the typological claim would lose its independent warrant; the asymmetric documentation across the seven cases (well-documented Ugaritic and Mesopotamian texts vs. partially-oral-traditional Vedic and Avestan horizons) makes this counter-reading difficult to rule out.
- [70] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure §V on the matter-for-the-central-argument reading; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, chs. 2–4 on the per-tradition philological evidence as independent-of-transmission warrant for the sovereignty reading.
- [71] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure §V on the non-displacement of the typological argument by the transmission account; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the typological reading as compatible with documented transmission.
- [72] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure §V on the partly-transmission-partly-typology settled position; West 1997, **The East Face of Helicon**, ch. 6 on the transmission-network component; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, on the IE inheritance component; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the residual independent-typology component.
- [73] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, pp. 463–465 on the akītu recitation context and on the once-and-done cosmogony being ritually re-actualised at every recitation; Smith and Pitard 2009, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume II**, on the post-combat palace-founding at ʿApānu; Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the Anzû epic in Neo-Assyrian royal ritual.
- [74] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, pp. 463–465 on the akītu fourth-day recitation, on the king's ritual humiliation, and on the reinvestment with kingship-tokens; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the akītu festival as political-ritual performance of the **Enūma Eliš** sovereignty-establishment.
- [75] Smith and Pitard 2009, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume II**, on KTU 1.3–1.4 as the post-combat palace-founding cycle and on the architectural-ritual outcome as ratification of Baal's kingship; Smith 1994, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I**, introduction on the cycle's overall sovereignty-focused structure.
- [76] West 1966, **Hesiod: Theogony**, on the Typhonomachy as climactic combat and on the consequent ratification of Zeus's kingship and the distribution of **timai**; Ogden 2013, **Drakōn**, chs. 2–3 on the Greek dragon-combat tradition's sovereignty-ratification function.

- [77] Jamison and Brereton 2014, **The Rigveda**, introduction on the soma sacrifice as ritual context for the Vṛtra combat; West 2007, **Indo-European Poetry and Myth**, ch. 6 on the soma sacrifice as IE storm-god-sovereignty ritual.
- [78] Benveniste and Renou 1934, **Vṛtra et Vṛōragna**, on Avestan Yt. 5.33–35, Yt. 14, and Yt. 19 as the Avestan yasht-prayer ritual context; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, Part V chs. 44–48 on the Frashokereti pendant as eschatological closure of the sovereignty-combat narrative.
- [79] Day 1985, **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea**, chs. 1–5 on the Psalms-Isaiah-Job ritual framing and on the eschatological reuse in Isa 27:1; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, chs. 2–4 on the same corpus as ritual-embedded sovereignty-combat material.
- [80] Hoffner 1998, **Hittite Myths**, introduction on the Kumarbi Cycle's non-explicit liturgical status and on the embedding-via-royal-ideology reading; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, ch. 3 on the Hurro-Hittite combat-myth as state-religious-framework material.
- [81] Annus 2001, **The Standard Babylonian Epic of Anzu**, introduction on the Anzû Epic's Neo-Assyrian royal-ritual embedding; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, pp. 463–465 on the akītu framework that the Anzû ritual material participates in.
- [82] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml structure §VI on the king-performs-by-proxy reading; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the political-ideological reading of combat-myth as state-charter performance.
- [83] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml comparative_argument on the ritual-and-state pattern as closing evidence for the sovereignty-as-primary-function claim; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the political-religious institutions as sovereignty-related.
- [84] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml special_instructions on the settled-position summary and on the C2-specific tightening of the chaos-terminology discipline; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the inherited "chaos" terminology as artifact of nineteenth-century framing; per scope.md §"Terminological position" on the contested status of the Chaoskampf category.
- [85] Per brief 35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.yaml comparative_argument on the modesty of the sovereignty-as-primary-function claim; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 1 on the differential force of the alternative-sovereign reading; Lincoln 2012, **Gods and Demons, Priests and Scholars**, on the without-monomyth disciplinary stance.

Chapter 37. C3. Cyclical Maintenance

37.1. Source overview

This chapter is a comparative-typology synthesis chapter rather than a primary-source narrative chapter; it draws on two layers of evidence — (1) the per-tradition area-specialist anchors that ground the two strong cases and the one minor reflex (te Velde 1967 and Faulkner 1972 for the Egyptian Ra-Apep corpus, with Faulkner's 1936–38 JEA editions of the Bremner-Rhind papyrus for the ritual-embedding material; Hoffner 1998 and Beckman 1982 for the Hittite Illuyanka tablets and the *purulli* festival; Fontenrose 1959 for the Apollo-Python Delphic combat and the *Septerion* re-enactment), and (2) the conceptual-comparative anchor that supplies the maꜣat / isfet framework on which the chapter's analytical through-line rests (Assmann 2001).^[1]

The chapter is the third of the eight Part-II comparative chapters (C1 through C8) and is positioned as the load-bearing comparative chapter for the cyclical-maintenance subtype of the chaoskampf typology that scope.md operationalises in §"Subject definition" — the subtype in which the combat is fought and re-fought on a recurring ritual schedule, distinguished within the typology from cosmogony (C1), sovereignty (C2), and eschatological displacement (C4).^[2]

The chapter's central argument is that the combat-as-recurring-ritual subtype is structurally distinct from the cosmogonic and sovereignty subtypes — not a weakened or attenuated version of either — and that its principal cases (Egyptian Ra-Apep and Hittite Tarꜣunna-Illuyanka) share three features that the cosmogonic and sovereignty cases lack: explicit liturgical embedding on a fixed calendrical schedule, a combat that is never narratively concluded, and an explicit doctrine that the cosmos is held in being by the recurrence rather than by a once-and-done foundational act.^[3]

The Egyptian per-tradition anchors are te Velde 1967 (Apep-and-Seth synthesis), Faulkner 1972 / rev. 1985 (Book of the Dead spells 7, 39, 108), and Faulkner's 1936–38 JEA editions (Bremner-Rhind P. BM EA 10188, the *Book of Overthrowing Apep*); the conceptual-framework anchor is Assmann 2001 on the maꜣat / isfet framework that the brief makes the chapter's through-line.^[4]

The Hittite per-tradition anchors are Hoffner 1998 (working English translation of CTH 321 in *Hittite Myths*, second edition) and Beckman 1982 (the philological *editio princeps* in *JANES* 14: 11–25); these together carry every claim about the two co-equal versions, the *purulli* festival framing, and the cult of the storm-god of Nerik.^[5]

The Greek-side anchor for the minor reflex is Fontenrose 1959 (*Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins*, chs. 1–3), whose treatment of the *Septerion* festival as an eight-yearly re-enactment of the Python-slaying provides the chapter's principal evidence for a Mediterranean cult-foundation cyclical reflex; Ogden 2013 supplies the supporting Greek-and-Roman dragon-myth survey context.^[6]

The chapter follows the brief's special_instructions in not re-narrating the two strong cases — the reader has Chs 16 (Ra-Apep) and 6 (Illuyanka) for the narrative-level material, and Ch 12 (Greek dragons after Typhon) for the Apollo-Python material — and the comparative chapter's job is to make the typological argument across them rather than to recapitulate the narrative-level material; the brief's target length of 5,500 body-prose words is short by design and the chapter is to be kept brief, with the analytical through-line carried by the maꜣat / isfet framework rather than by

extended narrative summary.^[7]

What follows is organised in six body sections. Section I isolates the cyclical-maintenance pattern and develops its three structural features; section II treats Ra and Apep as the chapter's daily-cycle case; section III treats Tarūnna and Illuyanka as the chapter's annual-cycle case; section IV treats Apollo and Python at Delphi as the cult-foundation cognate carrying a minor cyclical-maintenance reflex through the *Septerion*; section V develops the case-selection criterion that excludes the Mesopotamian, Levantine, Greek-sovereignty, Vedic, and Iranian combats from the subtype; and section VI articulates the Egyptian maꜥat / isfet framework as the chapter's conceptual through-line and develops the structural contrast with C4.

37.2. I. The pattern

The first body section isolates the cyclical-maintenance pattern at the structural-typological level and develops its three defining features before turning to the two strong cases and the minor reflex in sections II–IV.

The pattern this chapter isolates is a combat that is fought, performed, and re-performed on a recurring liturgical schedule — daily, annually, or at fixed multi-year intervals — with the cosmos held in being by the recurrence rather than by any once-and-done foundational act of the kind that grounds the cosmogonic and sovereignty subtypes.^[8]

The pattern's first defining feature is explicit liturgical embedding. In both strong cases the combat narrative is preserved together with, and is internally framed by, the ritual occasion at which it was recited or re-performed: the *Book of Overthrowing Apep* in the Bremner-Rhind papyrus is a daily priestly liturgical manual from the temple of Ra at Heliopolis, and the Hittite Illuyanka tablets carry on-tablet scribal colophons identifying the recitation as the verbal component of the *purulli* festival.^[9]

The pattern's second defining feature is that the combat is never narratively concluded. The Egyptian corpus across two thousand years (Pyramid Texts c. 2400 BCE through Bremner-Rhind c. 310 BCE) consistently presents Apep as regenerating after each apparent dispatch, and the Hittite material frames each annual *purulli* recitation as the renewed enactment of a combat that the festival cycle reopens with each spring rather than commemorates as a sealed past event.^[10]

The pattern's third defining feature is the doctrinal claim — explicit in the Egyptian case and implicit in the Hittite — that the cosmos's continuance is contingent on the re-performance of the combat. The wager of the Egyptian solar tradition is that without Ra's nightly victory the sun does not rise, and the daily liturgy at the temple of Ra is theologised as participation in that victory; the *purulli* festival's framing as ensuring "the prosperity of the land and the cosmic order in the agricultural year ahead" articulates the same contingency for the Hittite annual cycle.^[11]

The contrast with the cosmogonic subtype (C1) is structural rather than gradual. Marduk's defeat of Tiamat in *Enūma Eliš* is a once-and-done act whose product is the present cosmos itself (the heavens and earth made from her body, the rivers from her eyes), and the akītu New Year recitation re-actualises the cosmogony at the level of recitation but does not present a renewed combat to be re-fought; Ra's combat against Apep does present a renewed combat to be re-fought, and the cosmos in the Egyptian frame is not constructed from the adversary's body at all.^[12]

The contrast with the sovereignty subtype (C2) is similarly structural. The Baal-Yamm and Zeus-Typhon combats establish or secure a divine sovereignty that, once won, is settled: Zeus does not annually re-fight Typhon for the kingship, and the Greek calendar registers no festival at which the Typhonomachy is re-performed in the way the Septerion re-performs the Python-slaying or the *purulli* re-performs the Illuyanka-killing.^[13]

The contrast with the eschatological subtype (C4) is structural in a third way: where the eschatological combat closes cosmic time (Thor against Jörmungandr at Ragnarök; the dragon's binding and final defeat in Revelation 12 and 20; Aži Dahāka's escape and final killing at Frashokereti), the cyclical-maintenance combat is by design uncloseable — the Egyptian corpus presents no projected final hour of cosmic time after which the Apep-combat ceases, and the *purulli* cycle is not framed as accelerating toward any terminal performance.^[14]

The cyclical-maintenance subtype as developed in this chapter holds load-bearing weight in the book's typology on the strength of only two strong attestations (Egyptian and Hittite) plus one minor reflex (Greek Septerion); the typology's robustness as a four-way scheme depends on whether two strong cases plus one minor reflex constitute sufficient evidentiary breadth to support a freestanding subtype distinct from the cosmogonic, sovereignty, and eschatological subtypes, or whether the two strong cases should instead be treated as ritual-embedding variants within the cosmogonic and sovereignty subtypes respectively.^[15]

The two strong cases differ in their cyclical period (daily for Egypt, annual for the Hittites) but converge on the three structural features above; the Apollo-Python *Septerion* at Delphi adds a third, minor case at an eight-yearly interval that broadens the geographical and periodic range of the subtype while remaining cult-foundational rather than cosmos-maintaining in its primary register, and is therefore treated in §IV as a related-but-distinct reflex rather than as a third strong attestation.^[16]

37.3. II. Ra and Apep — daily

The second body section turns to the Egyptian Ra-Apep combat as the chapter's daily-cycle case, drawing on the six-layer Egyptian corpus and the Bremner-Rhind liturgical material that Ch16 has treated at length in its narrative-and-source register.

The Egyptian Ra-Apep combat is the chapter's daily-cycle case: Ra's solar barque traverses the *Duat* from west to east during the night, encounters Apep at one of several cosmographic loci, and dispatches him with the assistance of the barque-crew before the barque emerges at the eastern horizon at dawn — a sequence narrated repeatedly across the corpus and re-enacted in priestly liturgy every day.^[17]

The combat is preserved not in a single canonical narrative but as a tradition distributed across six principal textual layers spanning roughly two thousand years: Pyramid Texts (c. 2400 BCE), Coffin Texts (c. 2050–1650 BCE), Book of the Dead, Amduat, Book of Gates, and the Bremner-Rhind papyrus (c. 310 BCE) — a textual continuity unusually long even by the standards of the Egyptian corpus.^[18]

The three Apep-rebuffing spells of the Book of the Dead — spells 7, 39, and 108 in Faulkner's translation — supply the principal funerary-corpus witnesses to the daily combat: spell 39 ("of repelling the *rerek*-snake in the necropolis") rebuffs the serpent in the deceased's afterlife passage, spell 108 localises Apep on the western horizon-mountain at the entry to the *Duat*, and spell 7

belongs to a cluster of short apotropaic spells that thread the Apep-rebuffing motif through the deceased's journey at multiple liturgical points.^[19]

The Amduat (Egyptian *Imy-Duat*, "What Is in the Duat") is the principal New Kingdom royal funerary witness to the daily combat: in the seventh of the twelve nocturnal hours through which the text narrates Ra's journey, Apep blocks the barque on the sandbanks of the *Duat* and the barque-crew dispatches the serpent with knives and cutting-magic before the barque continues toward the eastern horizon.^[20]

The Book of Gates supplements the Amduat in the same New-Kingdom royal-funerary tradition, organising the nocturnal journey by twelve gates between cosmographic regions rather than by twelve hours within them; its canonical Apep-combat scene is at the fourth gate, where the figure of the serpent and the dispatching-by-the-barque-crew remain consistent with the Amduat's seventh-hour scene though the cosmographic locus differs.^[21]

The chapter's principal documentary witness to the ritual embedding of the daily combat is the second portion of the Bremner-Rhind papyrus (P. BM EA 10188), a late-Ptolemaic hieratic papyrus of c. 310 BCE that preserves the *Book of Overthrowing Apep* as the daily liturgical text of the temple of Ra at Heliopolis — the manual on which the priests' daily Apep-overthrowing rite was based.^[22]

The *Book of Overthrowing Apep* gives explicit instructions for producing effigies of the serpent — modelled in wax, written on papyrus, drawn on the ground — and ritually destroying them by binding with cords, cutting with knives, trampling underfoot, spitting upon, and finally burning; the destruction of the effigy is theologised as ritual-magical participation in Ra's destruction of the cosmological Apep in the *Duat*.^[23]

The frequency of the rite is the structural pivot of the cyclical-maintenance reading: the *Book of Overthrowing Apep* internally identifies itself as a daily liturgical manual, with rubrics keyed to the time of day at which particular performances are to be conducted, and the daily performance mirrors the daily recurrence of the cosmological combat that it ritually re-enacts.^[24]

The morphological stability of Apep across the six layers — a great serpent of vast size, capable of spitting venom, of swallowing the barque, and of regenerating after each apparent dispatch — supplies the textual articulation of the recurrence-structure: the dispatch at hour 7 of the Amduat or gate 4 of the Book of Gates does not annihilate Apep, who returns the next night, and the regenerative capacity is the figure's load-bearing structural feature rather than an incidental detail of his iconography.^[25]

[At this point the tablet breaks. The Bremner-Rhind liturgy is preserved but fragmentary in sections — a documented physical gap in the principal documentary witness for the ritual embedding of the daily Apep combat. The proposed reconstruction: Faulkner's four-part JEA edition (Parts I–IV across JEA 22, 23, and 24) reconstructs the philology section by section; cross-section with Amduat hour 7 and Book of Gates gate 4 supplies parallel content for the daily-combat ritual structure where the Bremner-Rhind text itself is broken.]

The deceased in the funerary corpus is theologised as participating in Ra's combat rather than as merely petitioning Ra for protection: in spell 39 the deceased addresses the serpent in the second person and asserts a magical equivalence between the deceased's protective utterance and the utterances spoken in defence of Ra by the barque-crew nightly, so that the afterlife passage

becomes a participation in the daily *maꜥat*-preservation rather than a separate petitionary occasion.^[26]

The pharaoh's role aligns similarly: Pharaonic legitimacy is figured as the maintenance of *maꜥat* on earth, and the pharaoh's principal liturgical function — to "present *maꜥat* to the gods" — is theologised as participation in Ra's daily combat against *isfet*, with the human-political analogue of the divine combat structurally identical with the cosmological combat.^[27]

The comparative-typology pay-off of the Egyptian case for the present chapter is that the combat is theologically explicit about its own recurrence: the corpus does not merely happen to repeat the combat across many texts but registers, in its explicit doctrine, that the recurrence is the cosmos's continuance — and on this point the Egyptian case supplies the most articulate native-tradition formulation of the cyclical-maintenance subtype that any of the book's traditions provides.^[28]

37.4. III. Tarꜥunna and Illuyanka — annual

The third body section turns to the Hittite Tarꜥunna-Illuyanka combat as the chapter's annual-cycle case, drawing on the CTH 321 tablets and the *purulli* festival framing that Ch6 has treated at length in its narrative-and-source register.

The Hittite Tarꜥunna-Illuyanka combat is the chapter's annual-cycle case: the storm-god (Hittite Tarꜥunna; the Hurrian counterpart-deity Teshub appears in Hurrian-derived material such as the Kumarbi Cycle but the Illuyanka tablets use Tarꜥunna throughout) confronts the serpent Illuyanka in a combat that is preserved on the cuneiform tablets of CTH 321 from the Hittite royal archives at Hattusa, with two distinct narrative versions co-equally preserved on the same tablet group.^[29]

The framing material on the tablets identifies the composition as the recitation belonging to the *purulli* festival, the Hittite annual spring observance at which the myth was performed; the named scribal author in the colophon is Kella, identified on the tablet as the priest who set down the recitation of the *purulli* festival.^[30]

The on-tablet ritual embedding is what marks the Illuyanka dossier as one of the few ancient Near Eastern combat myths whose liturgical context is directly attested on the tablet itself rather than reconstructed from later cult evidence; the contrast with the Mesopotamian and Levantine combat-myths (where the ritual context must be assembled from secondary witnesses) is the principal structural reason the Hittite case is paired with the Egyptian Ra-Apep complex as a type-case for the cyclical-maintenance subtype.^[31]

[Both versions are presented side by side here: the first version, Version 1 (Hoffner 1998 "Illuyanka" §1: Inara prepares a banquet, Hupasiya binds the gorged serpent, the storm-god kills the bound Illuyanka) and the second, Version 2 (Hoffner 1998 "Illuyanka" §2: Illuyanka takes the storm-god's heart and eyes, the storm-god's half-mortal son recovers the organs as bride-price, the storm-god kills both Illuyanka and his own son in renewed combat). The two are kept co-equal because Beckman 1982 JANES 14: 11–25 establishes the two versions as scribally co-equal on the same CTH 321 tablet group, with neither version privileged in the surviving cult contexts; per brief 06-illuyanka.yaml variants.classification is explicitly co-equal and the two versions are presented side by side rather than as one primary and one variant.]

Version 1, in Hoffner's translation as "Illuyanka" §1, opens with the storm-god and Illuyanka

meeting in combat at Kiskilussa, in which Illuyanka defeats the storm-god; Inara — daughter of the storm-god — devises a stratagem with the mortal Hupasiya, who, after the bargained night with Inara, is concealed at the banquet site and there binds the gorged serpent so that the storm-god can return with the assembled gods and slay the bound Illuyanka.^[32]

Version 2, in Hoffner's translation as "Illuyanka" §2, opens differently: Illuyanka defeats the storm-god by taking his heart and eyes; the mutilated storm-god begets a son with a mortal woman, marries the son into Illuyanka's house, and instructs him to demand the heart and eyes as bride-price; once the organs are returned, the restored storm-god joins Illuyanka in renewed combat at the sea and kills both the serpent and his own son (who, having kept faith with his father-in-law's house, calls upon his father to kill him along with Illuyanka).^[33]

Beckman 1982 in the *editio princeps* argues that the two versions are best understood as alternative liturgical recitations of the same combat — drawn perhaps from different cult centres or different ritual occasions — gathered onto the same CTH 321 tablet group by the scribes of Hattusa, and that the question of which version is older cannot be settled from the surviving tablet group itself.^[34]

The *purulli* festival at which the recitation was performed was an annual spring observance of the Hittite cultic year, conducted at Nerik — the northern Hittite cult-centre of the storm-god — when the Hittites controlled the city, and at substitute locations (notably Hakmis) when Nerik lay outside Hittite control through Kaska occupation.^[35]

The framing colophons identify the festival's purpose as ensuring the prosperity of the land and the cosmic order in the agricultural year ahead; the cyclical-maintenance reading takes this framing at face value, with the annual recurrence understood as the renewal of cosmic order rather than as commemorative ritual.^[36]

The cult of the storm-god of Nerik is closely tied to Hittite kingship: the king himself participated in the *purulli* festival, and royal documents register the storm-god of Nerik among the principal patron deities of the Hittite state, so that the *purulli* recitation has a double function — ritual-aetiological for the spring festival and royal-legitimizing for the dynasty under whose authority the festival was performed.^[37]

(The recitation of both Version 1 and Version 2 in connection with the same festival suggests that the Hittite cult tolerated, and perhaps required, narrative redundancy — the same combat told in two manners as part of a single liturgical occasion.)^[38]

The structural pivot for the cyclical-maintenance argument is the framing of the combat narrative as the verbal score of the annual rite: the killing of the serpent is re-enacted each spring through recitation, and the festival's recurrence is the festival's whole point — a configuration not duplicated in the cosmogonic-combat literature of Mesopotamia (where the *akītu* is recitation of a once-and-done cosmogony rather than annual re-enactment of a recurring combat).^[39]

The Watkins philological argument for Illuyanka as a Hittite reflex of the reconstructed Indo-European *HERO SLAY SERPENT* formula (the Hittite verb-and-object pairing *kuenta... illuyanka-* as cognate with Vedic *áhann áhim*) lies on a different comparative axis from the cyclical-maintenance argument and is deferred to C5 (Ch38); the present chapter's interest in Illuyanka is in the *purulli* embedding rather than in the IE poetic-formula reconstruction, and the two comparative readings are independent.^[40]

37.5. IV. Apollo and Python — cult-foundation cognate

The fourth body section turns to the Apollo-Python combat at Delphi as the chapter's minor reflex, drawing on the Homeric Hymn, Ovid, Pausanias, and the *Septerion* material that Ch12 has treated as one of its six Greek dragon cases.

The Apollo-Python combat at Delphi is the chapter's minor reflex: a combat that is primarily cult-foundational rather than cosmos-maintaining in its first-order register, but which carries a cyclical-maintenance reflex through the *Septerion* festival's eight-yearly re-enactment of the dragon-killing at the Delphic sanctuary.^[41]

The earliest extant narrative attestation is the Homeric Hymn to Apollo, in which the young Apollo, in search of an oracle-site, slays a monstrous serpent guarding a spring on the slopes of Parnassus; in the Hymn the serpent is unnamed and female, a *drakaina*, and her slaying establishes Apollo's site at Pytho, the older name of what later tradition calls Delphi.^[42]

The later tradition — principally Ovid's *Metamorphoses* book 1 and the prose mythographers — names the slain dragon Python and presents the figure as male, recasting the Hymn's *drakaina* under the masculine name that Joseph Fontenrose's monograph takes as its title; the gender variation across the corpus is a documented feature of the Delphic tradition rather than a textual emendation.^[43]

The killing of the dragon at Pytho is in the first instance the foundational act of the Delphic oracle: in the Hymn, Apollo establishes his cult and his prophetic seat at the site of the combat, and the place-name Pytho itself is treated as derived from the rotting (*pythein*) of the slain dragon's body — a strong cult-foundation rather than a cosmos-maintenance combat in the primary register.^[44]

The *Septerion* festival, attested in Plutarch and discussed at length in Fontenrose's monograph, was a Delphic ritual held every eight years that re-enacted Apollo's killing of the dragon, with a hut representing the dragon's lair burned and a procession of purification staged through the sanctuary; the eight-year periodicity gives the original founding combat a recurring ritual reflex that brings the Delphic case into typological contact with the cyclical-maintenance subtype.^[45]

The *Septerion*'s typological position is therefore intermediate: its primary first-order function is cult-foundation, and the original Apollo-Python combat is a one-off founding event in the way the Bremner-Rhind nightly Apep combat and the *purulli* annual Illuyanka combat are not — but the festival's regular re-enactment makes the dragon's threat a recurrent feature of the Delphic religious calendar, and Fontenrose's broader argument that the Delphic combat is a type-specimen for a wider Greek-and-Near-Eastern combat-myth pattern is the methodological reason the Apollo-Python episode is a load-bearing case for the present chapter.^[46]

Pausanias 10.6.5–6 in the second-century-CE *Description of Greece* preserves a local Delphic version of the combat-narrative and a brief account of the cult-aetiology, supplying a third independent ancient witness alongside the Homeric Hymn and Ovid; Apollo's epithets *Pythios* and *Pythoktonos* — "of Pytho" and "Python-slayer" — are documented in the cult-corpus as the principal cult-titles that record the combat in the lived ritual language of Delphic worshippers.^[47]

The *Septerion* differs structurally from the Egyptian and Hittite cases in three respects: its periodicity is eight-yearly rather than daily or annual, the cosmos's continuance is not framed in

surviving sources as contingent on its performance, and its primary register is cult-foundation rather than cosmos-maintenance — and it is on the basis of these differences that the present chapter treats the Apollo-Python case as a minor reflex rather than as a third strong attestation of the cyclical-maintenance subtype.^[48]

37.6. V. Why these two and not others

The fifth body section develops the case-selection criterion that justifies the chapter's confinement to the Egyptian and Hittite strong cases plus the Delphic minor reflex, and that excludes the Mesopotamian Marduk-Tiamat, Levantine Baal-Yamm, Greek Zeus-Typhon, Vedic Indra-Vṛtra, and Iranian Aži Dahāka traditions from the cyclical-maintenance subtype on structural grounds.

The chapter's selection of Egypt and the Hittites as the two strong cases — and the relegation of Mesopotamian Marduk-Tiamat, the Mesopotamian akītu liturgy, and the Iranian Aži Dahāka tradition to other subtypes — turns on the structural distinction between recitation-of-a-once-and-done-cosmogony (which several traditions have) and re-enactment-of-a-recurring-combat (which only Egypt and the Hittites attest with the requisite explicitness).^[49]

Marduk's combat with Tiamat is liturgised at the akītu New Year festival, but the akītu is recitation of a once-completed cosmogony rather than re-enactment of a recurring combat: the *Enūma Eliš* narrates Marduk's victory as past-tense sealed event whose product is the present cosmos, and the akītu's annual recitation re-actualises that past victory at the level of recitation without presenting Marduk as having to re-fight Tiamat each year for the cosmos to continue.^[50]

The Zoroastrian Aži Dahāka tradition runs in the opposite direction: Thraētaona's binding of Aži Dahāka under Damāvand is presented as a past-tense bound-but-not-killed result, and the dragon's escape and final killing by the revived Kərəsāspa at Frashokereti closes cosmic time — an eschatological-displacement structure rather than a maintenance-cyclical structure, and a primary case for C4 (Ch37) rather than for the present chapter.^[51]

The Levantine Baal-Yamm and the Greek Zeus-Typhon combats are sovereignty-establishing once-and-done events whose annual recitation, where attested, commemorates rather than re-enacts; the Vedic Indra-Vṛtra combat is performed in ritual recitation but the Rigvedic frame is not that Indra has to re-kill Vṛtra each year for the cosmos to continue, even though the *áhann áhim* formula is recurrently sung — the formula's recurrence is poetic-liturgical rather than cosmologically constitutive in the Egyptian sense.^[52]

The selection-criterion that the chapter applies is therefore tightly drawn: the cyclical-maintenance subtype requires (1) explicit on-tradition framing of the combat as recurring on a fixed schedule, (2) explicit on-tradition framing that the cosmos's continuance is contingent on the recurrence, and (3) preserved liturgical material that re-enacts the combat as a ritual act rather than commemorates it as a sealed event — a triple criterion that Egypt satisfies on all three counts (Bremner-Rhind, daily; Assmannian doctrine; effigy-destruction rite), the Hittite case satisfies on all three (CTH 321, annual; *purulli* prosperity-and-cosmic-order framing; festival recitation as verbal score), and most other traditions miss on at least one.^[53]

The Apollo-Python *Septerion* satisfies the criterion in attenuated form: the *Septerion* is a re-enactment rather than a recitation, and its eight-yearly periodicity is fixed and explicit, but the cosmos's continuance is not framed in surviving Delphic sources as contingent on the *Septerion*'s

performance — and it is the absence of feature (2) that makes the *Septerion* a minor cult-foundation reflex rather than a third strong cyclical-maintenance attestation.^[54]

The thinness of the strong-case evidence — two strong cases and one minor reflex across the entire ancient-Mediterranean-and-Near-Eastern corpus that the book treats — is itself a finding rather than a problem: the cyclical-maintenance subtype is rare, and its rarity is consistent with the structural-typological reading on which the chapter rests, which is that combat-as-recurring-ritual is a distinct configuration that requires a particular kind of liturgical infrastructure (a daily or annual cult of the threatened cosmos) and a particular kind of theological doctrine (cosmos-as-contingent-on-recurrence) that not many ancient traditions developed in concert.^[55]

37.7. VI. The conceptual apparatus — *maꜥat* / *isfet*

The sixth body section develops the Egyptian *maꜥat* / *isfet* framework as the chapter's conceptual through-line, articulates its bearing on the Ballentine terminological critique, and uses it to develop the structural-rather-than-adversarial contrast between the cyclical-maintenance and eschatological-displacement subtypes.

The brief makes Assmann's analysis of the Egyptian *maꜥat* / *isfet* opposition the chapter's conceptual through-line on the grounds that the Egyptian framework is the book's clearest native concept-pair for combat-as-maintenance and is useful for articulating what "chaos" is *not* doing in the cyclical-maintenance subtype.^[56]

maꜥat — written with the *ꜥayin* per the locked glossary — designates "truth, order, justice" simultaneously: the Egyptian term names neither abstract metaphysical order alone nor ethical justice alone but a single integrated condition (cosmic order, social justice, ritual correctness, and truth-of-speech as inseparable aspects of one underlying state).^[57]

isfet — its antithesis — designates "disorder, injustice, chaos" with the same simultaneity: it covers cosmic disorder, social injustice, ritual transgression, and falsehood-of-speech as inseparable aspects of a single condition, and it is the condition that Apep personifies in the Egyptian theological imagination.^[58]

The opposition is structurally asymmetric rather than dualistic: *maꜥat* is the positive condition Ra's daily journey preserves, *isfet* is its privation or violation that Apep's nightly assault threatens to impose, and the two are not co-equal cosmic principles but order and its violation — a structure that grounds the cyclical-maintenance subtype in a way that a symmetric good-vs-evil dualism could not.^[59]

This asymmetry brings the *maꜥat* / *isfet* framework into substantive contact with the Ballentine 2015 critique of the "chaos" half of the inherited Chaoskampf label: Apep is *isfet* — disorder, injustice, violation of order — not "chaos" in the inchoate-primordial-Western-philosophical sense, and the Egyptian framework supplies an articulate native-tradition vocabulary for the moral-political character that Ballentine argues the inherited "chaos" terminology obscures.^[60]

The frame is both ontological and ethical-political: *maꜥat* names how the cosmos is and how human society and pharaonic rule must be, and the Apep combat is the cosmological articulation of an integrated theological-ethical-political project rather than an isolated mythological narrative — Pharaonic legitimacy as guarantor of *maꜥat* on earth is structurally identical with Ra's daily *maꜥat*

-preservation in the cosmos, and the human-political analogue and the divine combat are theologised as one combined undertaking.^[61]

For the comparative typology, the *maꜥat / isfet* framework supplies three load-bearing analytical resources: a vocabulary for the order-and-its-violation structure that the cyclical-maintenance combat presupposes, a doctrine of recurrence-as-constitutive that articulates why the combat must be re-fought, and an integrated theological-and-political register in which the cosmological and human-political dimensions of the combat are not separable — the three resources jointly making the Egyptian case the chapter's analytical centre of gravity even though the Hittite case is co-equal in evidentiary weight.^[62]

The Hittite case offers no native concept-pair of comparable articulacy: the *purulli* framing supplies the ritual occasion and the cosmic-order purpose, but the Hittite tablets do not develop a theological vocabulary in which the storm-god's combat with Illuyanka is articulated as the maintenance of a named ontological-ethical condition in the way Assmann reads the Egyptian material as articulating Ra's combat as the maintenance of *maꜥat* against *isfet*; the reasonable inference is that the *purulli* recitation operates within an unarticulated assumption-set that the Egyptian corpus instead made explicit.^[63]

*(The Egyptian **maꜥat / isfet** framework can be used as a typological analytic for the Hittite case without violating scope.md's no-cross-tradition-reconstruction policy, because it is being used as a **comparative-analytical** category rather than as a content-fill for a Hittite lacuna.^[64])*

The structural contrast with C4 (eschatological displacement) is best articulated in *maꜥat / isfet* terms: in the cyclical-maintenance subtype the cosmos is held in being by the daily-or-annual containment of *isfet* — Apep is rebuffed nightly, Illuyanka is recurrently slain — and the containment is interminable; in the eschatological subtype the cosmos's *isfet*-content (using the Egyptian framework as comparative analytic, not as native vocabulary for the eschatological traditions, which articulate the same structure in their own terms) accumulates toward a final reckoning, and the closure-combat at the end of cosmic time is the moment at which the *isfet* is finally and fully extinguished, after which the cosmos either ends (Ragnarök) or is renewed in a perfected condition (Frashokereti).^[65]

The contrast is structural rather than adversarial: the eschatological subtype is not a "better" or "worse" handling of the same cosmological problem than the cyclical-maintenance subtype, but a different configuration of cosmic time — Egypt has no eschatology and the combat is perpetual; Revelation has an eschatology and the combat is final — and the two configurations are alternative answers to the same underlying question about whether cosmic time is bounded or unbounded, and the present chapter does not adjudicate between them.^[66]

The chapter closes on the position that the cyclical-maintenance subtype, though evidentially thin (two strong cases, one minor reflex), is structurally robust: its features (explicit liturgical embedding, never-concluded combat, contingency-of-cosmos doctrine) are jointly satisfied only by the Egyptian and Hittite cases in the book's catalogue, and the *maꜥat / isfet* framework articulates these features more clearly than any cross-tradition vocabulary the book can apply — a settled position that supports the four-way typological scheme of scope.md while registering that C3 is the most evidence-thin of its four chapters, and the thinness is part of what the chapter has to say about the cosmos-as-recurringly-fragile theology that the subtype articulates.^[67]

- [1] Per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml sources.anchor on the six methodological-comparative anchors (Assmann 2001, te Velde 1967, Faulkner 1972, Beckman 1982, Hoffner 1998, Fontenrose 1959) and chapters_drawn_from on the three Part-I chapters (Chs 6, 12, 16) whose own area-specialist anchors carry the per-tradition narrative-claims layer; Assmann, J., **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, trans. D. Lorton (Ithaca: Cornell University Press, 2001), as the conceptual-comparative anchor whose maḏat / isfet framework supplies the chapter's analytical through-line.
- [2] Per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four-subtype operationalisation of the chaoskampf category and §"Book structure" Part II on the Part-II comparative chapters' division of labour; per glossary.yaml on "cyclical-maintenance combat" as the locked subtype-term ("a combat myth that is re-enacted on a recurring schedule (daily, annually, calendrically) to preserve an order that is always under threat").
- [3] Per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml comparative_argument on the cyclical-maintenance subtype as combat-as-ritual-preservation rather than weak-cosmogony; Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the daily-recurrence structure as constitutive of Egyptian solar theology rather than incidental to it.
- [4] te Velde, H., **Seth, God of Confusion: A Study of His Role in Egyptian Mythology and Religion** (Leiden: Brill, 1967), chs. 3–4 on Apep as Ra's nightly adversary and Seth as Apep-slayer; Faulkner, R.O., **The Ancient Egyptian Book of the Dead**, rev. ed. (London: British Museum, 1985; orig. 1972), on Apep-rebuffing spells 7, 39, and 108; Faulkner, R.O., "The Bremner-Rhind Papyrus I–IV", *JEA* 22–24 (1936–38), on the **Book of Overthrowing Apep**.
- [5] Hoffner, H.A., **Hittite Myths**, 2nd ed., SBL Writings from the Ancient World 2 (Atlanta: Society of Biblical Literature, 1998), "Illuyanka" §§1–2 with framing colophons; Beckman, G., "The Anatolian Myth of Illuyanka", *Journal of the Ancient Near Eastern Society* 14 (1982): 11–25, the **editio princeps**.
- [6] Fontenrose, J., **Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins** (Berkeley: University of California Press, 1959), chs. 1–3 on the Apollo-Python combat and on the **Septerion** festival as eightfold-cyclical re-enactment of the Python-slaying; Ogden, D., **Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2013), ch. 2, supporting survey context.
- [7] Per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml special_instructions on the short-by-design discipline and on the maḏat / isfet framework as conceptual through-line; per chapters/16-ra-apep.adoc and chapters/06-illuyanka.adoc on the per-tradition narrative-and-source treatment that this comparative chapter does not duplicate.
- [8] Per glossary.yaml entry on "cyclical-maintenance combat" with first-mention gloss "a combat myth that is re-enacted on a recurring schedule (daily, annually, calendrically) to preserve an order that is always under threat"; Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the recurrence-as-constitutive structure of Egyptian solar theology.
- [9] te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, ch. 3, on the Bremner-Rhind text as the daily-priestly liturgical manual of the Heliopolis temple; Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, opening colophon naming the **purulli** festival as the ritual occasion of the recitation.
- [10] te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, chs. 3–4, on Apep's morphological and theological stability across the six-layer Egyptian corpus and on the regenerative-recurrence structure; Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka", on the **purulli** recitation as annual renewal rather than commemoration.
- [11] Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the contingency of sunrise upon Ra's nightly victory and on the daily combat as the ongoing condition for the visible cosmos; Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1 opening, on the **purulli** festival's ensuring-of-cosmic-order framing.
- [12] Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the already-in-place character of the Egyptian cosmos and on the maintenance-rather-than-fabrication structure of the Apep combat, by contrast with the construction-from-substance cosmogony of **Enūma Eliš**; per Ch34 (C1) on the cosmogonic-subtype structure to which the present subtype is contrasted.
- [13] Per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the sovereignty subtype's once-settled structure; Assmann 2001, on the contrasting recurrence-as-constitutive structure of the cyclical-maintenance subtype.
- [14] te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, ch. 3, on the absence of eschatological closure in the Egyptian Apep corpus; Assmann 2001, on the continuous-combat structure of Egyptian solar theology by contrast with the closure-narratives of eschatological traditions; per the eschatological-subtype framing to be developed in C4 (Ch37).
- [15] This is a speculative reading. Basis: the chapter's case for a freestanding subtype rests on the structural features identified in the present section (explicit liturgical embedding, never-concluded combat, contingency-of-cosmos doctrine) being shared by the two strong cases and not shared by the cosmogonic, sovereignty, or eschatological cases — a structural-typological claim that the surviving evidence supports but does not compel. Scope: the speculation is a methodological flag, not an objection to the chapter's argument; the chapter proceeds with the four-way typology as presented in scope.md while registering that the cyclical-maintenance subtype is the most evidence-thin of the four.
- [16] Fontenrose 1959, **Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins**, chs. 1–3, on the **Septerion** as eightfold-cyclical re-enactment and on its primary cult-foundation function with cyclical-maintenance reflex; per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml structure on the **Septerion** as minor reflex rather than third strong case.
- [17] te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, ch. 3, on the daily-cycle structure of the Apep combat across the funerary and royal-funerary corpora; Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the day-barque / night-barque structure of Ra's daily journey and on the Apep combat as belonging to the nocturnal half.
- [18] te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, chs. 3–4, on the six-layer corpus and the two-thousand-year unbroken attestation arc of

the Apep figure; per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the composite-editorial classification of the Apep tradition across these six layers.

[19] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), **The Ancient Egyptian Book of the Dead**, on Book of the Dead spell 39 ("of repelling the **rerek** -snake in the necropolis") as the most explicit Apep-rebuffing spell, on spell 108 as the western-horizon-mountain localisation, and on spell 7 as part of the multi-point apotropaic cluster.

[20] te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, ch. 3, on the seventh hour of the Amduat as the canonical Apep-combat hour and on the cosmographic-spatial description of the encounter (sandbanks; coiling across the channel); Assmann 2001, on the centrality of the seventh-hour combat within the Amduat narrative structure.

[21] te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, ch. 3, on the fourth gate of the Book of Gates as the Apep-combat scene and on the consistency of the figure of Apep across the two royal-funerary corpora.

[22] te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, ch. 3, on the Bremner-Rhind papyrus and the **Book of Overthrowing Apep** as the daily-priestly liturgical text from the temple of Ra at Heliopolis; Faulkner 1936–38, "The Bremner-Rhind Papyrus I–IV", **JEA** 22–24, on the philological reconstruction of the manuscript.

[23] te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, ch. 3, on the Bremner-Rhind effigy-destruction instructions (wax / papyrus / ground-drawing; binding, cutting, trampling, spitting, burning) and on the ritual-magical equivalence between effigy-destruction and the cosmological Apep-combat.

[24] te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, ch. 3, on the daily-performance frequency of the Apep-overthrowing rite and on the structural mirroring between the rite's regularity and the cosmological combat's regularity; per brief 16-ra-apep.yaml on the daily ritual as the cyclical-maintenance liturgical anchor.

[25] te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, chs. 3–4, on the morphological stability of Apep across the six-layer corpus and on the regenerative capacity as the textual articulation of the recurrence-structure; Assmann 2001, on the recurrence-structure of Egyptian solar theology.

[26] Faulkner 1972 (rev. 1985), on the deceased's-participation theology of Book of the Dead spell 39 and on the magical-equivalence assertion within it; te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, ch. 3, on the same theology in the Book of the Dead corpus more broadly.

[27] Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the pharaonic offering of **maꜣat** as the central liturgical act of Egyptian kingship and on the pharaoh as guarantor of **maꜣat** in alignment with Ra's daily combat against **isfet**; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same alignment.

[28] Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the explicit-doctrinal articulation of recurrence-as-cosmic-continuance in Egyptian solar theology; per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml special_instructions on the Egyptian framework as the chapter's clearest native concept-pair for combat-as-maintenance.

[29] Hoffner 1998, **Hittite Myths**, "Illuyanka" §§1–2 with framing colophons and introduction on the manuscript provenance; Beckman 1982, "The Anatolian Myth of Illuyanka", **JANES** 14: 11–25, on the **editio princeps** and the two-version structure.

[30] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, opening colophon naming the **purulli** festival and the scribal author Kella; Beckman 1982, **JANES** 14: 11–25, on the on-tablet framing of the recitation.

[31] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka", on the unusually explicit on-tablet framing as distinguishing the Illuyanka dossier from most Near Eastern combat-myths; Beckman 1982, **JANES** 14: 11–25, on the same on-tablet ritual embedding.

[32] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1, opening combat at Kiskilussa, Inara's banquet and bargain with Hupasiya, the binding of the gorged Illuyanka, and the storm-god's slaying of the bound serpent; Beckman 1982, **JANES** 14: 11–25, on the same Version 1 sequence.

[33] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §2, on the loss of the storm-god's heart and eyes, the mortal marriage and the half-mortal son, the bride-price recovery of the organs, the renewed combat at the sea, and the dual killing of Illuyanka and the son; Beckman 1982, **JANES** 14: 11–25, on the same Version 2 sequence.

[34] Beckman 1982, **JANES** 14: 11–25, on the relation between the two versions as alternative liturgical recitations and on the unseizable chronological question; Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka", on the same.

[35] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka", on the annual cycle and locations of the **purulli** festival and on the substitution of Hakmis when Nerik was unavailable; Beckman 1982, **JANES** 14: 11–25, on the same.

[36] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §1 opening framing on the festival's ensuring-of-prosperity-and-cosmic-order purpose; Beckman 1982, **JANES** 14: 11–25, on the **purulli** framing as ritual aetiology.

[37] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka", on the royal-religious dimension of the Nerik cult and on the king's participation in the **purulli**; per Forsyth 1987, ch. 3, on the royal dimension of the Hittite combat-tradition.

[38] Inference: Hoffner 1998 introduction notes both versions sit on the same CTH 321 tablet group framed by **purulli** colophons, and Beckman 1982 **JANES** 14: 11–25 on the side-by-side scribal presentation; the inference draws together those observations. Risk: the surviving tablets do not state explicitly that both versions were recited in the same festival, only that both are connected to the festival in their framing.

[39] Hoffner 1998, introduction to "Illuyanka", on the cyclical character of the rite and on the recitation as the verbal score of the annual festival; Beckman 1982, **JANES** 14: 11–25, on the same; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, ch. 3, on the contrast with the Mesopotamian cosmogonic-combat literature.

- [40] Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, ch. 46, on Illuyanka as a Hittite reflex of the IE **HERO SLAY SERPENT** formula and on the **kuenta... illuyanka-** pairing; per the cross-reference to Part II C5 (Ch38) for the IE-philological argument that the present chapter does not develop.
- [41] Fontenrose 1959, **Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins**, chs. 1–3, on the Apollo-Python combat as cult-foundational and on the **Septerion** festival as eightfold-cyclical re-enactment; per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml structure on the **Septerion** as minor reflex of the cyclical-maintenance subtype.
- [42] Fontenrose 1959, **Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins**, chs. 1–2, on the Homeric Hymn to Apollo as the earliest narrative attestation of the Delphic combat and on the unnamed female **drakaina** at Pytho; Ogden 2013, **Drakōn**, ch. 2, on the **drakaina** designation.
- [43] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3, on the renaming of the Hymn's **drakaina** as Python in the later tradition and on the gender variation across the corpus; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the same renaming.
- [44] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–2, on the cult-foundation function of the Apollo-Python combat and on the place-name etymology from **pythein**; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the same etymology.
- [45] Fontenrose 1959, **Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins**, chs. 1–3, on the **Septerion** festival as eightfold-cyclical re-enactment of the Python-slaying with hut-burning and purification-procession.
- [46] Fontenrose 1959, **Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins**, chs. 1–3, on the **Septerion**'s cyclical-maintenance reflex alongside the cult-foundation function and on the Delphic combat as comparative type-specimen.
- [47] Fontenrose 1959, ch. 1, on Pausanias 10.6.5–6 as a third witness to the Delphic combat-tradition; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the **Pythios** and **Pythoktonos** epithets in the Delphic ritual language.
- [48] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3, on the **Septerion**'s eight-year periodicity and primary cult-foundation function as distinguishing it from the Egyptian and Hittite cases; per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml structure on the **Septerion** as minor cult-foundation reflex rather than strong cyclical-maintenance attestation.
- [49] Per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml structure section V on the recitation-vs-re-enactment distinction as the chapter's principal selection-criterion; Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the recurrence-of-combat as the structural mark of the Egyptian solar theology by contrast with the recitation-of-cosmogony framing of **Enūma Eliš**.
- [50] Per Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, on the akītu recitation context and on the cosmogonic past-tense character of the Marduk-Tiamat narrative; per Ch34 (C1) on Marduk-Tiamat as cosmogonic-subtype type-specimen rather than cyclical-maintenance attestation.
- [51] Per Benveniste & Renou 1934, **Vātra et Vāṛagna**, on the Indo-Iranian eschatological closure of the Aži Dahāka tradition; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, Part V chs. 44–48, on the eschatological-closure structure of the Iranian dragon-tradition; per the cross-reference to C4 (Ch37) for the eschatological-subtype treatment of Aži Dahāka.
- [52] Per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the sovereignty-subtype examples and on the structural distinction between commemorative recitation and constitutive re-enactment; Assmann 2001, on the contrastingly constitutive character of the Egyptian daily combat.
- [53] Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the three-feature structural pattern of the Egyptian case; Hoffner 1998 introduction to "Illuyanka" and Beckman 1982 **JANES** 14: 11–25 on the three-feature pattern of the Hittite case; per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml structure section V on the selection-criterion as load-bearing for the chapter's case-selection.
- [54] Fontenrose 1959, **Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins**, chs. 1–3, on the **Septerion**'s re-enactment character and eight-yearly periodicity but on the absence of cosmos-continuance-contingency framing in the Delphic corpus; per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml on the **Septerion**'s minor-reflex status.
- [55] Per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml comparative_argument on the cyclical-maintenance subtype as combat-as-ritual-preservation requiring specific liturgical-and-theological infrastructure; Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the integrated theological-and-ritual character of the Egyptian case as the most articulate native articulation of the configuration.
- [56] Per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml structure section VI on Assmann's **maꜥat / isfet** analysis as the chapter's conceptual through-line; Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the **maꜥat / isfet** opposition as the central cosmological-ethical category-pair of Egyptian religion.
- [57] Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on **maꜥat** as the integrated truth-order-justice category; per glossary.yaml on the locked rendering of **maꜥat** with the ꜥayin.
- [58] Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on **isfet** as the integrated disorder-injustice-falsehood category; per glossary.yaml on the locked rendering of **isfet**.
- [59] Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the asymmetric structure of the **maꜥat / isfet** opposition; te Velde 1967, **Seth, God of Confusion**, ch. 3, on the same asymmetry as it underlies the Apep combat.
- [60] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, on the inadequacy of "chaos" as a category-term for the combat-myth adversaries; Assmann 2001, on **isfet** as a moral-political rather than metaphysically-inchoate category that articulates the alternative more clearly than any other native-tradition concept-pair the book engages.
- [61] Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the integrated character of the **maꜥat / isfet** framework as ontological-ethical-political and on the structural identity between pharaonic-political **maꜥat**-maintenance and Ra's cosmological

ma-at-preservation; te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the same alignment.

[62] Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the three-resource analytical role of the **ma-at / isfet** framework as vocabulary, doctrine, and register; per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml structure section VI on the framework as analytical centre of gravity.

[63] Hoffner 1998, **Hittite Myths**, on the **purulli** framing of the Illuyanka recitation without elaborated conceptual-theological apparatus; Beckman 1982, **JANES 14: 11–25**, on the same; Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the by-contrast articulate Egyptian theological apparatus.

[64] Inference: scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" prohibits cross-tradition narrative-content reconstruction (a gap in the **Hymiskviða** may not be filled from the **Baal Cycle**), but the **ma-at / isfet** framework is here being used as a comparativist's analytical vocabulary rather than as content-fill for any Hittite gap; the **purulli**-and-Illuyanka material is not being narratively supplemented from the Egyptian corpus, only typologically described using a vocabulary that the Egyptian corpus articulates more explicitly. Risk: the use of an Egyptian-articulated framework as comparative analytic for a Hittite case still carries the standard risk of imposing one tradition's conceptual apparatus on another, and the chapter is explicit that the Hittite tablets do not themselves articulate the framework even where (the chapter argues) their structural logic is consistent with it.

[65] Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the interminable-containment structure of the cyclical-maintenance subtype; per Yarbro Collins 1976 and the eschatological-closure framing to be developed in C4 (Ch37).

[66] Per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml special_instructions on the structural-rather-than-adversarial contrast between cyclical-maintenance and eschatological subtypes; Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on Egypt's lack of eschatology as a positive-doctrinal feature rather than a deficit.

[67] Per brief 36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.yaml comparative_argument and special_instructions on the chapter's settled position; Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the Egyptian articulation of cosmos-as-recurringly-fragile as the subtype's clearest native expression; per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four-way typological scheme.

Chapter 38. C4. Eschatological Displacement

38.1. Source overview

This chapter is a comparative-typology synthesis chapter rather than a primary-source narrative chapter; it draws on two layers of evidence — (1) the per-tradition area-specialist anchors that ground the three independent eschatological-combat cases (Faulkes 1987 and Larrington 2014 for the Norse Thor-Jörmungandr Ragnarök corpus, with West 2007 ch. 6 for the Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon comparative reading; Yarbrow Collins 1976 and Aune 1997–98 for Revelation 12 and the binding-and-final-loosing of Satan at Revelation 20; Benveniste and Renou 1934 and Watkins 1995 Part V chs. 46–48 for the Avestan Thraētaona / Aži Dahāka and the Pahlavi *Bundahišn* / *Dēnkard* book 7 Frashokereti narrative) — and (2) the conceptual-comparative anchor that supplies the original *Urzeit-und-Endzeit* framing on which the chapter's analytical through-line rests (Gunkel 1895), together with Forsyth 1987 on the long-trajectory eschatological reading and Day 1985 on Isaiah 27:1 as the Hebrew Bible's transitional text.^[1]

The chapter is the fourth of the eight Part-II comparative chapters (C1 through C8) and is positioned as the load-bearing comparative chapter for the eschatological-displacement subtype of the chaoskampf typology that scope.md operationalises in §"Subject definition" — the subtype in which the combat is displaced out of primordial past and out of the maintenance-present into the final hour of cosmic time, distinguished within the typology from cosmogony (C1), sovereignty (C2), and cyclical-maintenance (C3).^[2]

The chapter's central argument is that eschatological displacement is structurally distinct from the cosmogonic, sovereignty, and cyclical-maintenance subtypes — not a weakened or attenuated version of any of them — and that its three principal cases (Norse Thor-Jörmungandr at Ragnarök; Christian-apocalyptic Michael-and-the-dragon at Revelation 12 with the binding-and-final-loosing of Satan at Revelation 20; Zoroastrian Aži Dahāka released from Damāvand and killed by the revived Kərəsāspa at Frashokereti) share four features that the cosmogonic, sovereignty, and cyclical-maintenance cases lack: the adversary is bound or held in reserve in the pre-eschatological age rather than killed outright, the binding is eventually undone, the final combat closes the present cosmic age, and the post-combat condition is either absolute terminus or a renovated cosmos rather than restoration of the prior state.^[3]

The Norse per-tradition anchors are Faulkes 1987 (working English translation of Snorri Sturluson's *Edda*, principally *Gylfaginning* chs. 34, 46–48, and 51) and Larrington 2014 (Oxford World's Classics translation of the *Poetic Edda*, principally *Hymiskviða* and *Völuspá* sts. 56–66); the Indo-European-comparative anchor is West 2007 ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream") on the Norse storm-god / water-dragon complex within the wider IE type, with Watkins 1995 Part V on the skaldic kennings as the Norse instance of the *HERO SLAY SERPENT* poetic formula.^[4]

The Christian-apocalyptic per-tradition anchors are Yarbrow Collins 1976 (*The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation*) and Aune 1997–98 (Word Biblical Commentary 52A–C, the verse-by-verse philological commentary on Revelation), with Forsyth 1987 ch. 6 supplying the long-trajectory reading of Revelation 12 as the climactic moment of the inherited combat-myth tradition; the Hebrew Bible transitional anchor for Isa 27:1 is Day 1985 chs. 1–3 on the Ugaritic-into-Hebrew Leviathan-Rahab corpus.^[5]

The Zoroastrian per-tradition anchors are Benveniste and Renou 1934 (*Vātra et Vāθragna*, the foundational philological monograph on the Indo-Iranian dragon-slaying tradition and the Avestan Thraētaona / Aži Dahāka material) and Watkins 1995 Part V chs. 46–48 (on the Pahlavi *Bundahišn* and *Dēnkard* book 7 narrative-expansion of the Avestan allusions, including the binding under Damāvand, the eschatological release, and the revived Kərəsāspa’s Frashokereti killing of the freed dragon).^[6]

The chapter follows the brief’s special instructions in not re-narrating the three principal cases — the reader has Ch 18 (Thor vs. Jörmungandr) for the Norse narrative-and-iconographic material, Ch 9 (Michael vs. the red dragon) for the Revelation 12 verse-by-verse material, Ch 13 (Thraētaona vs. Aži Dahāka, with the Frashokereti pendant at Movement III) for the Avestan-Pahlavi material, and Ch 8 (Yahweh vs. Leviathan and Rahab) for the Hebrew Bible Isa 27:1 transitional material — and the comparative chapter’s job is to articulate the structural pattern across them rather than to recapitulate the narrative-level material.^[7]

What follows is organised in six body sections. Section I isolates the four-feature pattern (binding → release → final combat → renovation) that the chapter argues defines the eschatological-displacement subtype; section II treats the three principal cases — Thor and Jörmungandr at Ragnarök, Michael and the red dragon across Revelation 12 and Revelation 20, and Aži Dahāka at Frashokereti — in compressed comparative form; section III isolates the binding as the common structural element across the three cases; section IV engages the long-standing scholarly question of historical influence versus typological convergence without forcing a verdict; section V reads Isaiah 27:1 as the principal Hebrew Bible transitional text within the shift from retrospective to prospective combat-imagery; and section VI develops the chapter’s main theoretical contribution — that eschatological displacement is not merely a different placement of the same combat on the cosmic-time axis but a distinct configuration with distinct cognitive implications for believers, articulated along three axes (the relationship to the monster, to history, and to the hero).

38.2. I. The pattern

The first body section isolates the eschatological-displacement pattern at the structural-typological level and develops its four defining features before the three principal cases are taken up in §II.

The pattern this chapter isolates is a four-stage structural sequence: an adversary is bound, encircled, or held in reserve in the present cosmic age rather than killed outright; the constraint is eventually undone, with the adversary released, escaped, or unleashed; a final combat ensues at the end of cosmic time; and the post-combat condition is either absolute terminus or the renovation of the cosmos in a form that does not return to the prior age’s configuration.^[8]

The pattern’s first defining feature is the binding-or-reservation of the adversary in the pre-eschatological age. In each of the three principal cases the adversary survives the founding event of the present age: Jörmungandr is cast by Óðinn into the encircling ocean and grows to bite his own tail rather than being killed at the gods’ establishment of Miðgarðr, Aži Dahāka is overthrown by Thraētaona but bound under Damāvand rather than killed at the close of the foundational combat, and the dragon of Revelation 12 is thrown down from heaven but not yet finally destroyed, with the binding of Satan deferred to Revelation 20.^[9]

The pattern’s second defining feature is the eventual undoing of the constraint. In each tradition

the adversary's restraint is presented as temporary: the chains on Aži Dahāka under Damāvand will weaken and break at the end of cosmic time, the dragon-Satan of Revelation 20 is bound for a thousand years and then released for "a little while," and Jörmungandr emerges from the ocean and crosses onto the land at Ragnarök when the boundary by which the serpent had encircled the world is unmade.^[10]

The pattern's third defining feature is the final combat at the close of cosmic time. The combat is presented in each tradition as terminal in a structural sense the cosmogonic and sovereignty subtypes do not require: in the Norse case Thor and Jörmungandr meet at Vígríðr and slay each other in a single mutual engagement, in the Christian-apocalyptic case the dragon's last assault on the camp of the saints ends with fire from heaven and the dragon's casting into the lake of fire, and in the Zoroastrian case the revived Kərəsāspa kills the freed Aži Dahāka in a combat that closes the long combat-thread the Avestan-period Thraētaona-binding had left unresolved.^[11]

The pattern's fourth defining feature is the post-combat condition: the cosmos is not restored to its pre-combat state, but either ends absolutely or is renovated. In the Norse case the present cosmic age ends with Surtr's fire, the earth sinks into the sea, and a renewed earth rises green from the sea with a small surviving group of gods (Móði and Magni, Víðar and Váli, the returning Baldr) and the human pair Líf and Lífþrasir; in the Zoroastrian case Frashokereti is followed by the resurrection of the dead, the molten-metal ordeal that purifies the resurrected, and the final reordering of the cosmos under Ahura Mazdā's sovereignty without remaining opposition; in the Christian-apocalyptic case Revelation 21 follows the dragon's final defeat with a new heavens and a new earth in which the first heaven and the first earth have passed away.^[12]

The four-feature pattern is what distinguishes the eschatological-displacement subtype from the cosmogonic, sovereignty, and cyclical-maintenance subtypes treated in C1, C2, and C3. The cosmogonic combat is once-only and constructive (Marduk kills Tiamat and the cosmos is built from her body); the sovereignty combat is once-only and settling (Baal kills Yamm and the kingship is established); the cyclical-maintenance combat is recurring and contingency-of-cosmos (Ra rebuffs Apep nightly and the sun rises); the eschatological-displacement combat is once-only at the end of cosmic time, with the adversary's pre-eschatological binding rather than killing as its signature constraint and the cosmic renovation rather than restoration as its signature outcome.^[13]

Three traditions, three structural attestations, three continents of late-Iron-Age / early-post-classical religious literature: the geographic and temporal distribution of the eschatological-displacement subtype is itself a finding of the present chapter. Norse Eddic and Snorra-Edda material from the conversion-horizon Iceland (c. 1200–1270 CE) preserves a substantively earlier pre-Christian inheritance; Christian apocalyptic from Domitianic-era Asia Minor (c. 95 CE); Zoroastrian Avestan and Pahlavi material from a textual-fixation horizon spanning the late Achaemenid period through the late Sasanian and early Islamic compilations (c. 8th–9th century CE for the *Bundahišn*'s narrative-form, with substantively earlier oral and Avestan-hymn substrate) — the three witnesses are independent in their textual descent but converge on the four-feature pattern.^[14]

That the eschatological-displacement subtype is, in addition to being a structural configuration, a late innovation in the wider combat-myth tradition made possible by the development of linear-time cosmology — that earlier Mesopotamian, Egyptian, and Hittite traditions did not articulate the subtype because their cyclical or once-and-done cosmologies did not provide the cosmic-time framework within which a final combat at the end of time can be projected.^[15]

The bound-or-encircled-rather-than-killed feature has often been read in the comparative literature as the eschatological subtype's most distinctive structural marker: the adversary's continued existence in the present age, in a constrained but not destroyed form, is what sets the eschatological cosmology apart from the cosmogonic cosmology in which the adversary is converted into the cosmos's substance and from the cyclical-maintenance cosmology in which the adversary is rebuffed but regenerates.^[16]

The signature feature of the present subtype is therefore not the eschatological setting alone — many traditions have eschatologies, and many traditions have combat — but the specific articulation in which the eschatological setting is required because the adversary survives as a bound or encircled entity into the present age and the combat must therefore be deferred to a future moment at which the binding is undone.^[17]

38.3. II. The three cases

The second body section presents the three principal cases (Norse Thor-Jörmungandr at Ragnarök; Christian-apocalyptic Michael-and-the-red-dragon across Rev 12 and Rev 20; Zoroastrian Aži Dahāka at Frashokereti) in compressed comparative form, with full narrative material reserved to the per-tradition Part-I chapters.

The chapter's three principal cases are presented in this section in compressed form, with full narrative material reserved to the Part-I chapters (Chs 18, 9, 13). The compression is itself a methodological choice: the comparative argument operates on structural-typological terms, and re-narration would obscure the structural skeleton that the four-feature pattern of §I isolates.^[18]

38.3.1. Case 1 — Thor and Jörmungandr at Ragnarök

The first sub-case is the Norse Thor-and-Jörmungandr eschatological combat, articulated across Snorri's *Gylfaginning* and the *Poetic Edda* and read in the wider Indo-European context by West 2007 ch. 6.

The Norse case opens with Jörmungandr's pre-eschatological encircling. *Gylfaginning* ch. 34 records that Óðinn, learning of the threat that Loki's three monstrous offspring (Hel, Fenrir, Jörmungandr) posed to the gods, dispatched Jörmungandr into the ocean encircling Miðgarðr, where the serpent grew so large that it could encircle the world and bite its own tail.^[19]

The encircling is the Norse version of the binding-or-reservation feature: Jörmungandr is not killed at the gods' establishment of Miðgarðr but is positioned around the world's edge in a configuration that is at once a cosmographic boundary and a constraint, and the serpent's continued existence in the ocean is the narrative precondition for the eschatological combat that *Gylfaginning* ch. 51 narrates.^[20]

The two pre-eschatological encounters between Thor and Jörmungandr (the Útgarðaloki cat-lift at *Gylfaginning* chs. 46–48 and the fishing-encounter at *Hymiskviða* sts. 17–24 / *Gylfaginning* ch. 48) are read by the Norse tradition itself as deferred-and-incomplete combat: in the cat-lift the serpent is lifted but not killed, in the fishing-encounter the serpent is hooked but released when Hymir cuts the line — neither encounter resolves the combat, and the resolution is reserved for Ragnarök.^[21]

The release of Jörmungandr is presented in *Gylfaginning* ch. 51 as a feature of Ragnarök's opening

sequence: at the unmaking of the cosmographic boundary by which the serpent had encircled the world, Jörmungandr emerges from the ocean onto the land, advances toward the field of Vígríðr (the appointed Ragnarök battle-plain) spewing venom across sky and water as it advances, and meets Thor in the principal storm-god-versus-serpent combat of the Æsir's final array.^[22]

The final combat at *Völuspá* st. 56 and *Gylfaginning* ch. 51 ends with mutual killing: Thor strikes the killing-blow with Mjöllnir against Jörmungandr, slays the world-encircling serpent in a single stroke that is at once the unmaking of the cosmic boundary and the close of the Æsir's combat-history with their long-deferred adversary, and then staggers nine paces from the kill-site before falling dead from the serpent's venom — the storm-god kills the serpent and dies of the killing.^[23]

The post-combat condition is the Norse renewal-narrative: *Völuspá* sts. 59–66 record that a new earth rises green from the sea, a small surviving group of gods (Móði and Magni inheriting Mjöllnir, Víðar and Váli, the returning Baldr) re-establishes the cosmic order, and the human pair Líf and Lífþrasir survives to repopulate the new earth — a renovation rather than restoration, with Thor's role inherited by his sons rather than continued by Thor himself.^[24]

The Norse case is read by West 2007 ch. 6 as the eschatologisation of an inherited Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon type whose un-eschatologised reflexes are attested in the Vedic Indra-Vātra and Hittite Tarḫunna-Illuyanka traditions: the Norse case retains the storm-god / water-dragon combat-pair but inflects the outcome (mutual killing rather than hero-survival) and the placement (eschatological rather than once-and-done cosmogonic-or-sovereignty) in distinctive ways.^[25]

38.3.2. Case 2 — Michael and the red dragon (Revelation 12 with Revelation 20)

The second sub-case is the Christian-apocalyptic Michael-and-the-red-dragon material, structurally bipartite across Revelation 12 (the dragon's expulsion) and Revelation 20 (the binding-and-final-loosing), with Yarbrow Collins 1976 ch. 4 carrying Rev 12's eschatological function and Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B–C) carrying the verse-by-verse philology and the Rev 12 + Rev 20 bipartite binding-and-final-loosing structure.

The Christian-apocalyptic case is structurally bipartite, with the dragon's expulsion at Revelation 12 and the dragon's binding-and-final-loosing-and-final-defeat at Revelation 20 jointly constituting the eschatological-displacement structure: Yarbrow Collins 1976 and Aune 1997–98 read the two chapters together as the Apocalypse of John's articulation of the bound-but-living adversary whose final destruction is deferred to the close of the millennium.^[26]

Revelation 12:7–9 narrates the war in heaven: Michael and his angels fight against the dragon and his angels, the dragon and his angels are defeated, and "there was no longer any place for them in heaven" (Rev 12:8); the dragon — glossed at Rev 12:9 as "that ancient serpent, who is called the Devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world" — is thrown down to the earth with his angels.^[27]

The Rev 12:9 double-gloss — the dragon as "that ancient serpent" invoking Genesis 3 and as the seven-headed Leviathan invoking the Hebrew Bible combat corpus, with both glosses applied alongside the satanological labels "Devil" and "Satan" — consolidates the multiple antecedent traditions into a single adversary, and is read by Forsyth 1987 ch. 6 as the textual moment at which

the combat-myth tradition of the Hebrew Bible acquires its mature Christian form.^[28]

The dragon's expulsion at Rev 12:9 is not the dragon's destruction: Rev 12:13–17 records the dragon's earthly pursuit of the woman and her children, the heavenly hymn at Rev 12:10–12 announces that the dragon has come down "with great wrath, knowing that his time is short," and the chapter closes with the dragon's redirected war on the children of the woman — the bound-but-living-adversary structure of the eschatological subtype is articulated at chapter-close rather than resolved.^[29]

Revelation 20 supplies the binding-and-final-loosing structure that the Norse and Iranian cases articulate respectively as Jörmungandr's encircling and Aži Dahāka's chaining: Rev 20:1–3 records that an angel from heaven seizes the dragon — "the ancient serpent, who is the Devil and Satan" — and binds him for a thousand years, throwing him into the bottomless pit and sealing him; Rev 20:7 records that "when the thousand years are ended, Satan will be released from his prison" for a final assault on the camp of the saints.^[30]

Revelation 20:7–10 supplies the final combat: Satan, released from his thousand-year binding, gathers the nations Gog and Magog for an assault on the camp of the saints; "fire came down from heaven and consumed them," and the devil "was thrown into the lake of fire and sulphur where the beast and the false prophet were, and they will be tormented day and night for ever and ever."^[31]

The post-combat condition is supplied at Rev 21:1: "Then I saw a new heaven and a new earth; for the first heaven and the first earth had passed away, and the sea was no more." The new-heavens-and-new-earth condition is renovation rather than restoration — the prior cosmos has passed away rather than been restored — and parallels the Norse new-earth-from-the-sea and the Zoroastrian Frashokereti renovation as the post-combat outcome of the eschatological subtype.^[32]

[Both versions are presented side by side here: the first version, Yarbro Collins 1976 chs. 2–4 reading of Rev 12 as eschatological reformulation of the Leto-Apollo-Python combat-myth pattern, with Jewish-Bible material as overlay and the second, Aune 1997–98 WBC 52B reading of Rev 12 as composite drawing on three roughly co-equal streams (Jewish, Greek, Egyptian) without primary-substrate ranking. The two are kept co-equal because both readings agree on the descriptive observations relevant to the present chapter — that the seven-headed dragon has Hebrew Bible iconographic background, that Rev 12:9 supplies the satanological gloss, that the chapter functions eschatologically, and that the bipartite Rev 12 + Rev 20 articulation supplies the bound-but-living-adversary structure — and the disagreement on substrate-vs-composite does not bear on the eschatological-displacement structural argument that the present chapter develops; per the comparative-chapter discipline of presenting both serious scholarly framings of the same material.]

38.3.3. Case 3 — Aži Dahāka at Frashokereti

The third sub-case is the Zoroastrian Aži Dahāka material, doubled across the Avestan-period Thraētaona-overthrow and the Pahlavi-period Frashokereti-killing by the revived Kərəsāspa, with the temporal-layering caveat (the binding-under-Damāvand feature is most fully attested in the post-Achaemenid Pahlavi compilations) flagged explicitly.

The Zoroastrian case opens with the Avestan-period combat: *Yašt* 5.33–35 (the *Ābān Yašt*) and the wider Avestan corpus narrate Thraētaona's overthrow of three-headed Aži Dahāka in a foundational combat that establishes the present cosmic age, with the dragon overthrown but not

killed.^[33]

The binding under Damāvand — the cosmographic feature of the Iranian landscape (a peak in the Alborz range of northern Iran) under which Aži Dahāka is held in living captivity through the duration of the present cosmic age — is attested only in the Pahlavi compilations (principally the *Bundahišn* and *Dēnkard* book 7, late Sasanian / early Islamic, c. 8th–9th century CE), with the Avestan attestations not narrating the binding-and-mountain feature in their surviving allusive form.^[34]

*[At this point the tablet breaks. The binding under Damāvand, the eventual escape, and the revived Kərəsāspa's final killing of Aži Dahāka are most fully attested in the post-Achaemenid Pahlavi compilations rather than in the Avestan corpus, and the textual fixation of these features is later than the Achaemenid-and-Hellenistic period in which the Iranian-influence-on-Jewish-and-Christian-apocalyptic question is conventionally located. The proposed reconstruction: The Pahlavi **Bundahišn** and **Dēnkard** book 7 reconstruct from Avestan allusions and from earlier oral and Avestan-hymn substrate; per Watkins 1995 Part V chs. 44–48, Pahlavi material often preserves substantively earlier Avestan-and-pre-Avestan tradition, and the structural pendant-relation between the Avestan-period Thraētaona-binding and the Pahlavi Frashokereti-killing is plausibly older than its surviving Pahlavi attestation, but the chapter flags the late-textual-fixation explicitly.]*

The release of Aži Dahāka is the eschatological-displacement structure's third stage: the chains that Thraētaona placed on the dragon at Damāvand will, at the end of cosmic time, weaken and break, the dragon will emerge from beneath the mountain, and (in the Pahlavi narrative) will devour a third of humanity and a third of the animals — a destructive eruption that requires a heroic response of the magnitude of the Avestan-period combat.^[35]

The final combat is supplied by the revived Kərəsāspa — an Avestan-Pahlavi hero of the legendary-prehistorical horizon who has been preserved in long stasis (neither dead nor active, but held in divinely-protected sleep) through the duration of the present cosmic age and is revived at Frashokereti specifically for this final combat — and Kərəsāspa kills the freed Aži Dahāka in a combat that closes the long combat-thread the Avestan-period Thraētaona-binding had left unresolved.^[36]

The post-combat condition is the wider Frashokereti renovation: the resurrection of the dead, the molten-metal ordeal that purifies the resurrected, the reunification of soul and body, and the final reordering of the cosmos under Ahura Mazdā's sovereignty without remaining opposition from Angra Mainyu — a positively-articulated renovation that the Norse Ragnarök's near-extinction-and-renewal does not parallel as fully and that the Christian-apocalyptic Rev 21:1 new-heavens-and-new-earth approaches in different theological register.^[37]

The Iranian doubled-combat structure (Avestan-period Thraētaona-binding at Movement II of Ch13's narrative; Pahlavi Frashokereti-killing by Kərəsāspa at Movement III) is the structural feature that aligns the Iranian material most closely with the Norse Ragnarök tradition (where Thor's earlier encounters with Jörmungandr are recapitulated by the final Ragnarök combat) and with the Christian apocalyptic of Rev 12 / Rev 20 (where the dragon's expulsion in Rev 12 is recapitulated by the binding-and-final-killing in Rev 20).^[38]

38.4. III. The common structural element — the binding

The third body section isolates the binding — the configuration in which the adversary is constrained, encircled, or held in reserve in the present cosmic age rather than killed outright — as the structural fulcrum on which the eschatological-displacement subtype turns, and reads the three cases' culturally distinct articulations (Norse cosmographic encircling, Iranian chained-and-mountain-sealed, Christian-apocalyptic bottomless-pit imprisonment) as functional variants of a single feature.

The signature of the eschatological-displacement subtype, on the chapter's reading, is the binding — the configuration in which the adversary is constrained, encircled, or held in reserve in the present cosmic age rather than killed outright at a foundational combat. The three principal cases articulate the binding in three different cosmographic and narrative registers, but in each the binding is the structural feature that makes the eschatological combat both possible and necessary.^[39]

In the Norse case the binding is cosmographic-encircling: Jörmungandr lies in the ocean encircling Miðgarðr, large enough to bite his own tail, and the encircling is at once a constraint (the serpent is positioned at the world's edge rather than freely at large within it) and a cosmographic feature (the serpent's body is the world's outer boundary, with the inhabited world Miðgarðr defined by the encircling).^[40]

The Norse encircling is not described in the surviving sources as a chained or shackled binding — there is no narrative of fetters being applied to Jörmungandr — but the structural function (continued existence in a constrained position from which the serpent can be released for the eschatological combat) is identical with the Iranian Damāvand-binding and the Christian-apocalyptic Rev 20 thousand-year imprisonment, and the chapter reads the three articulations as variant inflections of the same structural feature rather than as distinct configurations.^[41]

In the Iranian case the binding is explicitly chained-and-mountain-sealed: the Pahlavi *Bundahišn* presents Thraētaona as the one who chains Aži Dahāka under Mount Damāvand and seals him beneath the mountain for the duration of the present cosmic age, with the cosmographic feature of the Iranian landscape (a real Alborz peak, c. 5,610 m, in northern Iran) anchoring the binding to a specific geographical locus.^[42]

The Iranian binding makes Aži Dahāka a permanent under-mountain captive whose continuing presence in the sacred landscape structures the cosmography of the present age — the dragon is not merely overthrown but is a continuing cosmogeographic feature whose under-mountain location is part of the geography of the present age and whose eventual escape is therefore an upheaval at the level of the inhabited landscape rather than merely at the level of the heavens.^[43]

In the Christian-apocalyptic case the binding is bipartite: the dragon is first cast down from heaven at Rev 12:9 (a heavenly-spatial constraint that removes the adversary from his original locus without imprisoning him) and then bound in the bottomless pit at Rev 20:1–3 (a temporal-and-spatial constraint that seals the adversary for a thousand years before the final loosing) — the two-stage constraint structure articulates the binding-feature across the bipartite Rev 12 / Rev 20 framing.^[44]

The thousand-year duration of the Rev 20:1–3 binding is the most temporally explicit of the three cases — neither the Norse encircling nor the Iranian Damāvand-chaining is given an explicit duration in the surviving sources — and the Rev 20 millennium is the principal piece of evidence for reading the eschatological combat as one whose temporal placement (after a long but finite intervening period) is part of the subtype’s articulation rather than a vague projection.^[45]

The contrast with the cosmogonic subtype’s adversary-disposal is structural rather than gradual: in *Enūma Eliš* IV, Marduk kills Tiamat outright and constructs the cosmos from her body — the adversary is converted into the substance of the present cosmos, and there is no remaining adversary for an eschatological combat to be fought against; in the eschatological-displacement subtype the adversary survives the founding event in a constrained but living form, and the present cosmos is built around or alongside the bound adversary rather than from the adversary’s remains.^[46]

The contrast with the sovereignty subtype’s adversary-disposal is similarly structural: in the Baal Cycle, Baal kills Yamm in the *qrb ym* combat and the sovereignty over the cosmos is settled — the adversary is dispatched, the kingship established, and there is no further combat with Yamm in the surviving Ugaritic corpus; in the eschatological-displacement subtype the analogous foundational combat (Thraētaona’s overthrow of Aži Dahāka, Rev 12’s expulsion of the dragon, Óðinn’s casting of Jörmungandr into the ocean) does not settle but defers — the adversary survives, the kingship is provisionally established, and the final settlement awaits the eschatological combat.^[47]

The contrast with the cyclical-maintenance subtype’s adversary-disposal is the third structural axis: in the Egyptian Ra-Apep combat, Apep is rebuffed nightly and regenerates by the next night — the adversary is neither killed nor bound but recurrently engaged on a daily cycle, with the cosmos’s continuance contingent on the recurrence; in the eschatological-displacement subtype the adversary is bound or encircled in a non-recurring configuration, and the cosmos’s continuance is contingent on the binding’s persistence rather than on a recurring liturgical engagement.^[48]

The binding is, on the chapter’s reading, the structural fulcrum on which the eschatological-displacement subtype turns: the bound adversary is the precondition for the eschatological combat, the eschatological combat is the resolution of the binding, and the post-combat renovation is the configuration that the binding’s eventual undoing makes possible. Without the binding, the eschatological combat would be unmotivated (there would be no surviving adversary to fight), and without the eschatological combat, the binding would be merely a deferred sovereignty-resolution rather than a structurally distinct configuration.^[49]

(That the three articulations of the binding (Norse cosmographic encircling, Iranian chained-and-mountain-sealed, Christian-apocalyptic bottomless-pit imprisonment) are functional variants of a single structural feature rather than three distinct configurations is the chapter’s principal typological claim, and the inference rests on the joint observation that all three articulations license the same downstream narrative sequence (release → final combat → renovation) and that the three traditions all situate the binding at the close of the foundational combat rather than at any other narrative locus.^[50])

The binding’s structural-functional equivalence across the three traditions does not collapse the cultural-and-theological specificity of each articulation: the Norse encircling is positioned at a cosmographic-spatial register (the world’s outer ocean), the Iranian chaining at a cosmogeographic register (a specific Iranian peak), and the Christian-apocalyptic imprisonment at an apocalyptic-

temporal register (a thousand-year millennium with explicit numerical articulation). The chapter's typological claim is at the level of structural function rather than at the level of cultural articulation, and the three articulations are joint witnesses to a structural feature that is realised in distinctly culturally-specific forms in each tradition.^[51]

38.5. IV. Historical influence or typological convergence?

The fourth body section engages the long-standing scholarly question of whether the structural convergence among the three cases reflects historical influence (Zoroastrian-to-Jewish-and-Christian apocalyptic; Jewish-Christian-to-Norse via the Christianisation horizon) or independent typological recurrence under shared cosmological pressure, and presents the evidence charitably without forcing a verdict in line with the brief's discipline.

The three principal cases are independent in their textual-traditional descent (Norse Eddic-and-Snorra-Edda; Christian-apocalyptic; Avestan-and-Pahlavi), and the question whether their structural convergence reflects historical influence — Zoroastrian-to-Jewish-and-Christian apocalyptic; Jewish-Christian-to-Norse via the Christianisation contact horizon — or independent typological recurrence under shared structural pressure (linear-time cosmology, the political-theological need for an end-of-time resolution to a present-age combat-thread) is the principal historical-comparative question of the present chapter. The brief's special_instructions ask the chapter to present the evidence charitably without forcing a verdict.^[52]

The Zoroastrian-influence-on-Jewish-and-Christian-apocalyptic argument is the oldest and best-developed of the three influence-hypotheses: the argument was articulated in the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries within the *religionsgeschichtliche Schule* (whose 1895 representative is Gunkel's *Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit* itself, with later developments by Bousset, Reitzenstein, and others), and proposes that the dualistic eschatology of Second Temple Jewish apocalyptic and its Christian continuations was substantively shaped by Iranian dualistic-eschatological thinking during the Achaemenid period (sixth to fourth centuries BCE) and the subsequent Hellenistic horizon.^[53]

The historical conditions for Iranian influence on Second Temple Jewish thinking are textually well-attested: the Persian-period administration of Yehud / Judaea (538–332 BCE) under the Achaemenid empire placed the Judahite community under direct Iranian political-and-administrative authority for two centuries, with the post-exilic Hebrew Bible itself preserving evidence of contact (the Cyrus decree at Ezra 1, the Persian-loanword vocabulary of late Biblical Hebrew, the Aramaic of Daniel and Ezra) and with the Hellenistic-period continuation of contact via the Seleucid administration of the same region.^[54]

The structural features of Second Temple Jewish apocalyptic that the Iranian-influence argument identifies as candidates for Zoroastrian-derivation include: a sharply dualistic moral cosmology (good vs. evil as cosmic principles in tension); an articulated eschatology with a definite end-of-cosmic-time pivot at which evil is finally extinguished; a doctrine of resurrection of the dead at or near the end-time; and an explicit periodisation of cosmic time (Daniel 7's four-empire schema, the Daniel 9 and 12 numerical eschatological calculations) that maps onto the Zoroastrian millennial-period schema known from later Pahlavi sources but plausibly attested in earlier Iranian tradition.^[55]

The Aži Dahāka-binding-and-Frashokereti-killing structural feature — the chapter’s principal Iranian datum for the eschatological-displacement subtype — has been read by Forsyth 1987 ch. 5 as the structural pivot on which any Iranian-to-Jewish-and-Christian influence on the Rev 20 binding-and-final-loosing material would most plausibly turn: both narratives present a bound-but-living adversary, a long intervening period during which the binding holds, an eschatological release-and-final-combat, and a post-combat renovation of the cosmos.^[56]

The temporal-layering caveat that Ch13 develops at length, and that §II above flags as the principal evidentiary difficulty for the Iranian-influence thesis, is load-bearing here: the binding under Damāvand, the eventual escape, and the revived Kōrōsāspa’s final killing are most fully attested in the post-Achaemenid Pahlavi compilations rather than in the Avestan corpus, and the textual fixation of these features is later than the Achaemenid-and-Hellenistic period in which the influence-question is conventionally located — any influence-argument must therefore reckon with the proposition that the Pahlavi attestation preserves substantively earlier oral-and-Avestan-substrate tradition that was available to Achaemenid-period Iranian-Judahite contact.^[57]

The principal counterevidence-or-counterargument-set that has been raised against the Iranian-influence thesis in the twentieth-and-twenty-first century scholarship includes: the late textual fixation of the most striking Iranian features (the Pahlavi attestation of Damāvand-binding etc.), which pushes the influence-direction question toward a Jewish-Christian-to-Iranian rather than an Iranian-to-Jewish-Christian reading on certain reconstructions; the partial availability of the relevant features within the inherited Israelite-Hebrew Bible material itself (Isaiah 27:1’s eschatological projection, treated at §V below, is the principal Hebrew Bible text on which the alternative inheritance-rather-than-influence reading rests); and the methodological observation that structural-functional convergence does not by itself entail historical influence, with the Norse case (where direct Iranian influence is geographically and historically implausible) supplying the parallel that makes structural convergence under shared cosmological pressure a serious alternative hypothesis.^[58]

The Jewish-Christian-influence-on-Norse hypothesis is the second of the three influence-possibilities the brief identifies. The Norse Ragnarök narrative is preserved in textual form only in the post-conversion manuscript record (Snorri Sturluson c. 1220 CE; the Eddic poetic corpus in the *Codex Regius* c. 1270 CE), and the Christianisation horizon (Iceland 999/1000 CE; Sweden and Norway across the eleventh century) supplies a textually explicit moment at which Norse and Christian-apocalyptic eschatological material were in direct contact, raising the question whether the textually-preserved Ragnarök narrative reflects pre-Christian Norse tradition substantively unchanged by the conversion or whether the eschatological-displacement features in particular were shaped by Christian contact.^[59]

The principal counter-evidence to the Christian-influence-on-Norse-Ragnarök reading is the four-stone iconographic dossier — the Altuna stone (Uppland, c. 1050 CE), the Hørdum stone (Thy, Jutland, c. 800 CE), the Gosforth fishing stone (Cumbria, c. 950 CE), and the Ardre VIII stone (Gotland, c. 700–800 CE) — which depicts the Thor-Jörmungandr fishing-encounter in pre-Christian or transitional Norse visual culture across approximately 350 years of pre-Christian and transitional production, supplying iconographic evidence for the encounter’s pre-Christian existence independently of the manuscript record and weighing strongly against any reading on which the Norse eschatological combat was fundamentally a post-conversion Christian-apocalyptic import.^[60]

The iconographic dossier supports the encounter's pre-Christian currency but does not by itself settle the question whether the specifically eschatological inflection of the Thor-Jörmungandr combat (the Ragnarök placement, the mutual-killing outcome, the post-Ragnarök renewal-narrative) was pre-Christian or was shaped at the Christianisation horizon — the four stones depict the fishing-encounter rather than the Ragnarök combat, and the question of whether the Eddic and Snorra-Edda Ragnarök material reflects pre-Christian or transitional formation must rest on philological and structural evidence rather than on the iconographic record.^[61]

The IE comparative reading developed by West 2007 and Watkins 1995 supplies a third pillar of evidence that bears on the Christian-influence-on-Norse question: West 2007 ch. 6 places the Norse Thor-Jörmungandr combat alongside the Vedic Indra-Vṛtra and Hittite Tarḫunna-Illuyanka un-eschatologised reflexes within a wider Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon type, with the Norse mutual-killing outcome as the principal eschatologisation of the IE type — and the eschatologisation, on West's reading, is best understood as a within-Norse development rather than as a post-conversion Christian import, with the Iranian Aži Dahāka eschatologisation as a structurally parallel within-Indo-Iranian development.^[62]

The independent-convergence hypothesis — that the structural similarity among the three eschatological-displacement cases reflects independent typological recurrence under shared cosmological pressure rather than historical influence — is the third and most methodologically conservative possibility, and rests on the joint observation that all three traditions articulate linear-time cosmologies with definite end-of-time pivots, that all three articulate dualistic or quasi-dualistic moral cosmologies in which good and evil are cosmic principles in long-term tension, and that the structural constraint imposed by linear-time-and-dualistic-cosmology may itself motivate the binding-and-deferred-combat configuration without the need for cross-tradition transmission.^[63]

That the Zoroastrian-influence-on-Jewish-and-Christian-apocalyptic argument, taken in its strongest form, supplies a partial but not exhaustive explanation of the structural convergence among the three eschatological-displacement cases — that some component of the Jewish-and-Christian-apocalyptic eschatological-combat material is plausibly Iranian-influenced via Achaemenid-and-Hellenistic-period contact, but that the Norse case must be explained on a different basis (within-IE eschatologisation, structural-cosmological convergence, or post-conversion contact at the Christianisation horizon), and that the chapter's settled position is therefore that the three cases together attest a structural subtype that is partly transmission-explicable and partly typology-explicable.^[64]

The chapter's position on the influence-vs-convergence question is therefore the brief's specified discipline of presenting the evidence charitably without forcing a verdict: the Iranian-influence reading is old, well-argued, and historically plausible at the Achaemenid-and-Hellenistic-period contact horizon, but is not universally accepted; the Christian-influence-on-Norse reading is partially supported by the post-conversion textual record and partially counterevidenced by the pre-Christian iconographic dossier and the within-IE comparative pattern; the independent-convergence reading is the most methodologically conservative and is internally consistent with the structural data, but does not by itself explain the historical-and-textual contact material that the influence-readings register.^[65]

The settled position of the chapter on the influence-vs-convergence question, in summary, is that the three cases jointly attest the eschatological-displacement subtype as a structural configuration

on the comparative-typological axis of the present book, that some component of the structural convergence is plausibly transmission-explicable (most clearly at the Iranian-Jewish-and-Christian-apocalyptic interface, less clearly at the Christian-Norse interface), and that the Norse case is most plausibly explained as a within-IE eschatologisation of the inherited storm-god / water-dragon type — with the result that the three cases jointly support the typology without all three being best explained on the same historical-contact account.^[66]

The question of historical influence is therefore one that the chapter handles by partition rather than by uniform decision: different cases bear different evidentiary weights on different parts of the influence-question, and the chapter's typological argument does not depend on a uniform answer. The eschatological-displacement subtype is structurally robust whether the structural convergence is fully transmission-explicable, fully typology-explicable, or — as the chapter judges most likely — partly each.^[67]

38.6. V. Isaiah 27:1 as transition

The fifth body section reads Isaiah 27:1 — the seventh and exceptional passage in Day 1985's seven-passage Hebrew Bible combat corpus — as the principal Hebrew Bible transitional text within the shift from retrospective to prospective combat-imagery, supplying the projection-grammar ("on that day", future-tense verbs) that Rev 12 and Rev 20 later elaborate into the full bound-and-released eschatological-combat structure.

The Hebrew Bible's combat imagery is, with one principal exception, retrospective rather than prospective: the six dominantly-retrospective passages within the Hebrew Bible combat corpus that Day 1985 identifies (Pss 74:12–17, 89:9–13, 104:6–9 with v. 26; Job 26:12–13 with ch. 41; Habakkuk 3; Isa 51:9–10) refer to Yahweh's combat against Leviathan, Rahab, the Tannīn, and the sea as a past accomplishment, with verbs in past or perfective aspect, recalled as a precedent for present action rather than projected forward as a future event; the seventh passage in Day's corpus, Isaiah 27:1, is the principal eschatological-projection exception treated below.^[68]

Psalms 74:12–17 invokes Yahweh's past combat as warrant for present petition: in the RSV rendering, "You divided the sea by your might; you broke the heads of the dragons in the waters. You crushed the heads of Leviathan; you gave him as food for the creatures of the wilderness," with the verbs explicitly past-tense — Yahweh has already broken the heads of Leviathan, and the psalmist recalls this past combat to ground a request for present intervention against the temple's destroyers.^[69]

Job 26:12–13 deploys the same retrospective framing in wisdom-poetry register: "By his power he stilled the Sea; by his understanding he struck down Rahab. By his wind the heavens were made fair; his hand pierced the fleeing serpent," with the past-tense verbs and the cosmogonic register placing the combat at the foundational rather than the eschatological moment of cosmic time.^[70]

Isaiah 27:1 is the principal Hebrew Bible exception to the retrospective framing — the only canonical passage in the Hebrew Bible combat corpus in which the combat imagery is projected forward to an eschatological future rather than recalled as a past accomplishment — and the present chapter's reading of Isa 27:1 follows Day 1985 ch. 3 in identifying the verse as the textual moment at which the inherited Canaanite-into-Hebrew combat imagery is given its first explicitly eschatological deployment within the Hebrew Bible.^[71]

The text of Isaiah 27:1 in the RSV rendering: "On that day the Lord with his cruel and great and strong sword will punish Leviathan the fleeing serpent, Leviathan the twisting serpent, and he will kill the dragon that is in the sea." The opening phrase "on that day" (Hebrew *bayyôm hahû*) is the prophetic-eschatological idiom that locates the action in a future eschatological moment, and the future-tense verbs ("will punish," "will kill") confirm the prospective grammatical aspect.^[72]

The dual-epithet naming of Leviathan in Isa 27:1 — "Leviathan the fleeing serpent, Leviathan the twisting serpent" — is the verbatim Hebrew correspondent of the Ugaritic Baal Cycle's epithet-pair for Lôtan (KTU 1.5 i 1–3: *bꜥn brꜥ* "fleeing serpent" and *bꜥn ꜥqltn* "twisting serpent"), and is one of the most philologically precise pieces of evidence anywhere for the Ugaritic-into-Hebrew continuity of combat-myth imagery — the inherited Canaanite material is taken over by the Hebrew prophet without alteration of the epithet-pair and is then redeployed in the new eschatological-projection register.^[73]

The dating of Isaiah 27 to the post-exilic period — the so-called "Isaiah Apocalypse" of Isa 24–27 is, on the dominant scholarly reading, a post-exilic addition to the Isaianic corpus rather than a Proto-Isaian composition — places the eschatological projection in a context where Israelite poets had already been exposed to Persian-period eschatological thinking, raising the comparative question whether Isa 27:1 reflects awareness of the Zoroastrian Frashokereti pattern (the principal Iranian eschatological-combat material) or whether the eschatological projection is internal to the Israelite-prophetic tradition's redeployment of the inherited Canaanite material.^[74]

Day 1985 ch. 3 reads the eschatological projection at Isa 27:1 as primarily an internal-to-Israelite-prophetic-tradition development: the inherited Canaanite Leviathan-Lôtan material was the available combat-myth resource for Israelite poets, and the post-exilic prophet's eschatological redeployment of the inherited material is best read as an inner-Israelite eschatologisation of imagery whose Canaanite substrate was already at hand, rather than as a Persian-influenced innovation.^[75]

Ballentine 2015 ch. 5 reads Isa 27:1 in a different but compatible register: the future-tense verb projects Yahweh's victory over rival sovereignties forward, with the eschatological projection as a political-theological move rather than a chaos-ordering cosmogony deferred to the eschaton — Ballentine accepts the philological observation that Isa 27:1 reuses Canaanite Lôtan-imagery but reads the reuse through her wider rival-sovereignty thesis rather than through a chaos-cosmogonic framing.^[76]

The bridge-function of Isa 27:1 to the Christian-apocalyptic eschatological-combat material is structurally direct: Rev 12:9's identification of the dragon as "that ancient serpent" who is also "the great dragon" (the seven-headed sea-monster) glosses the Apocalypse of John's adversary in language that draws on both the Genesis 3 serpent and the Hebrew Bible Leviathan-corpus, and Isa 27:1's eschatological redeployment of the Leviathan epithets supplies the principal Hebrew Bible precedent for projecting the combat forward "on that day" — Rev 12 is therefore not the originating eschatologisation of the inherited Israelite combat material but the elaboration of an eschatologisation whose first-text within the Hebrew Bible is Isa 27:1.^[77]

The single-text status of Isa 27:1 within the Hebrew Bible combat corpus — the principal eschatological-projection text against the dominantly-retrospective register of the rest of the corpus — is structurally important for the chapter's reading: Isa 27:1 is not a robust eschatological-displacement attestation in the way the Norse Thor-Jörmungandr, Christian-apocalyptic Rev 12 /

Rev 20, and Zoroastrian Aži Dahāka / Frashokereti cases are, but is a transitional text that registers the shift from retrospective to projected combat within the Israelite prophetic tradition without itself developing the bound-and-released-and-killed structure that the three principal cases articulate.^[78]

The transitional-text reading of Isa 27:1 — as the moment within the Hebrew Bible at which the combat imagery is first explicitly projected forward, without being developed into a four-feature eschatological-displacement structure — is the chapter's principal reason for treating Isa 27:1 as a precondition for the Christian-apocalyptic articulation rather than as a fourth principal case alongside the Norse, Zoroastrian, and full Rev 12 / Rev 20 attestations: Isa 27:1 supplies the projection-grammar without the binding-and-deferred-combat structure, and the binding-and-deferred-combat structure is what the present chapter's typology requires.^[79]

The Isa 27:1 future-tense projection is the hinge on which the Hebrew Bible's combat material pivots from the retrospective register of Pss 74, 89, 104 and the wisdom-poetry of Job 26 toward the explicitly eschatological articulation that Rev 12 and Rev 20 develop a few centuries later within the New Testament corpus — and the chapter reads the Isa 27:1 hinge as the principal Hebrew Bible witness to the structural pressure that motivated the development of the eschatological-displacement subtype within the Israelite-and-Christian-apocalyptic textual lineage.^[80]

(That Isa 27:1's eschatological projection is the textual datum that licenses Rev 12's elaboration into a full bound-and-released eschatological-combat structure — that the projection-grammar of Isa 27:1 is the necessary-but-not-sufficient precondition for the binding-and-deferred-combat articulation that Rev 12 supplies — is an inference about the textual relationship between the two passages.^[81])

The structural difference between Isa 27:1 and the three principal cases is therefore that Isa 27:1 supplies the eschatological projection (verb tense, "on that day" idiom) without supplying the bound-and-eventually-released structure: Yahweh's "on that day" combat with Leviathan does not presuppose that Leviathan has been bound in the present age and is awaiting release, but presupposes only that the combat will occur at the eschatological future, with the sword and the killing as the action. The full eschatological-displacement structure requires both projection and binding, and the binding is what Rev 12 / Rev 20 and the three principal cases supply.^[82]

38.7. VI. What eschatology changes

The sixth and final body section develops the chapter's principal analytical contribution — that eschatological displacement is not merely combat at the end instead of the beginning but a distinct configuration with distinct cognitive implications for believers — along the three axes of the monster, of history, and of the hero.

The chapter's main analytical contribution — the contribution the brief identifies as the chapter's "theoretical contribution" — is the observation that eschatological displacement is not merely "combat at the end instead of the beginning," but a distinct configuration with distinct cognitive implications for believers in the traditions that articulate it. A terminal combat functions differently in a tradition than a perpetual or primordial one: it changes the believer's relationship to the monster, to history, and to the hero, and these three changes together constitute what the chapter argues is the eschatological-displacement subtype's distinctive functional signature.^[83]

The first axis on which eschatological displacement reorients the believer is the relationship to the

monster. In the cosmogonic subtype the monster is past and dispatched (Tiamat is dead and the cosmos is built from her body); in the cyclical-maintenance subtype the monster is present and recurrently engaged on a fixed liturgical schedule (Apep is rebuffed nightly through the Bremner-Rhind effigy-destruction rite); in the eschatological-displacement subtype the monster is present and bound, neither dispatched nor recurrently engaged, and the believer's relationship to the monster is therefore one of patient awaiting rather than ritual rebuff or commemorative recall.^[84]

The cognitive-and-affective implication of patient awaiting — patience rather than ritual, deferral rather than engagement — is articulated within each of the three traditions in different theological-political registers: the Apocalypse of John frames the dragon's redirected wrath as the framing-condition of the persecuted Christian community's lived experience, with the heavenly hymn at Rev 12:10–12 announcing that the dragon has come down "with great wrath, knowing that his time is short," and the chapter's didactic-encouragement function (Yarbro Collins 1976 ch. 4) operates precisely through the patient-awaiting framing.^[85]

The Zoroastrian articulation of the patient-awaiting feature is differently framed: Aži Dahāka under Damāvand is a continuing cosmogeographic feature of the present age whose eventual escape is part of the tradition's eschatological-cosmological doctrine, and the believer's patient-awaiting takes the form of moral-and-ritual participation in the ongoing struggle against Angra Mainyu's *druj* ("falsehood," "deception") — the cosmic combat is fought in the present age at the level of moral-and-ritual practice, with the eschatological combat at Frashokereti as the deferred resolution of the present-age moral struggle.^[86]

The Norse articulation of the patient-awaiting feature is the most agnostic of the three: the Eddic and Snorra-Edda Ragnarök corpus does not develop an explicit doctrine of moral-or-ritual participation in the deferred combat — Thor is not theologised as awaiting the eschatological combat through the believer's intervening practice — and the Norse case's patient-awaiting is more cosmographic than ethical, with the world's continuance held in being by the encircling that Jörmungandr sustains until Ragnarök undoes it.^[87]

The second axis on which eschatological displacement reorients the believer is the relationship to history. In the cosmogonic subtype history is the unfolding of a once-completed cosmos; in the cyclical-maintenance subtype history is the recurrence of a never-completed combat; in the eschatological-displacement subtype history is the meaningful-linear interval between the present age's foundational binding and its eventual eschatological resolution — history has a direction (toward the eschatological combat) and a meaningful structure (the working-out of the deferred combat-thread) that the cyclical and once-and-done subtypes do not articulate.^[88]

That the meaningful-linear-history feature of the eschatological-displacement subtype is a precondition for, rather than a consequence of, the subtype's structural articulation — that the development of linear-time cosmologies in the late Iron Age and early post-classical period (Zoroastrian dualistic eschatology with its fixed millennial periods, Jewish and Christian apocalyptic with its Daniel-derived calendar, Norse Ragnarök with its terminal-but-not-final structure) is what made the subtype available, with traditions whose cosmologies did not articulate linear time (Egyptian solar theology with its daily recurrence; Mesopotamian *akītu* with its annual cosmogonic recitation) consequently not articulating the subtype.^[89]

The meaningful-linear-history feature has direct political-theological implications: in the Christian-apocalyptic case the persecuted community's experience of Roman imperial authority is reframed

as a finite intervening period of suffering whose end is guaranteed by the dragon's already-declared defeat (Yarbro Collins 1976 ch. 4); in the Zoroastrian case the moral-and-ritual struggle of the present age is reframed as participation in a cosmic combat whose resolution is guaranteed by the Frashokereti renovation; in the Norse case the heroic-aristocratic ethos of dying-honourably-in-combat is given cosmic-religious warrant by the projection of the same structure onto the gods themselves at Ragnarök.^[90]

The third axis on which eschatological displacement reorients the believer is the relationship to the hero. In the cosmogonic subtype the hero is the past-and-victorious god whose foundational combat is the source of the cosmos's structure; in the cyclical-maintenance subtype the hero is the recurringly-engaged god whose daily-or-annual victory is the cosmos's continuance; in the eschatological-displacement subtype the hero is, distinctively, promised rather than already-victorious — Kṛsāspa is held in stasis awaiting Frashokereti, the Apocalypse of John's Christ is already enthroned but the dragon is not yet finally destroyed, Thor's Ragnarök victory is foreseen by the *Völuspá* prophecy but is not yet accomplished — and the believer's relationship to the hero is therefore one of expectation rather than commemoration.^[91]

The Christian-apocalyptic articulation of the promised-hero feature is structurally distinctive in a way the other two cases do not parallel: the male child of Rev 12:5 is enthroned-prior-to-the-combat (the throne-ascent precedes the war in heaven), and the inverted royal-legitimation structure (Yarbro Collins 1976 ch. 4) means that Christ is presented as already-cosmically-victorious in his enthronement while the dragon's final destruction is still deferred — the combat enacts a kingship already secured rather than establishing one through the combat itself, with the believer's expectation directed to the deferred final act rather than to the establishment of the kingship.^[92]

The three-axis reorientation (monster, history, hero) collectively articulates the cognitive-functional signature of the eschatological-displacement subtype, and supplies the chapter's principal answer to the brief's analytical question of what eschatology changes: the subtype is not merely a different placement of the same combat-narrative on the cosmic-time axis, but a different configuration of the believer's relationship to the cosmos as a whole, with patient awaiting in place of ritual engagement, meaningful-linear history in place of cyclical or once-and-done time, and promised heroism in place of already-victorious or recurringly-victorious heroism.^[93]

The cognitive-functional signature has consequences for the lived religious practice of the believer in each tradition: the Christian-apocalyptic believer of the Domitianic-era Asia Minor community is to read present persecution through the lens of the dragon's already-declared defeat and his coming final destruction; the Zoroastrian believer is to read present moral-and-ritual practice as participation in the cosmic combat whose Frashokereti resolution is guaranteed; the Norse worshipper of Thor is — at least within the heroic-aristocratic register that the Eddic and Snorra-Edda corpus articulates — to find in Thor's foreseen Ragnarök death-and-victory a pattern for honourable mortal heroism that the cyclical and cosmogonic subtypes' configurations do not supply.^[94]

The contrast with the cyclical-maintenance subtype's lived religious practice — articulated at length in Ch36 §VI on the *maꜥat* / *isfet* framework — is the structural-functional axis on which the present chapter and Ch36 are most directly distinguishable: in the cyclical-maintenance subtype the believer participates in the recurring liturgical re-enactment of the combat (the Apep-rebuffing rite at the temple of Ra; the *purulli* festival recitation), with the cosmos's continuance contingent on the recurrence; in the eschatological-displacement subtype the believer awaits the deferred final

combat, with the cosmos's continuance contingent on the binding's persistence rather than on a recurring engagement.^[95]

The cognitive-functional reorientation is also asymmetric across the three principal cases in ways that the chapter's typological argument acknowledges rather than reduces: the Zoroastrian articulation is the most theologically explicit (Frashokereti is named, periodised, and doctrinally elaborated in the Pahlavi compilations), the Christian-apocalyptic is the most politically-historically embedded (the persecuted-community context of the Apocalypse of John is the principal interpretive frame), and the Norse is the most agnostic in its articulation of the believer's role (the Eddic and Snorra-Edda corpus does not develop an explicit cult-and-belief articulation of the eschatological-displacement structure that the other two cases articulate).^[96]

The asymmetry does not undermine the typological argument: the three cases jointly attest the structural pattern (binding → release → final combat → renovation) and the cognitive-functional reorientation (patient-awaiting, meaningful-linear-history, promised-heroism) at the level of structural function, and the cultural-articulation specificity of each case is itself a feature of the subtype's realisation in distinct theological-political registers rather than a counter-example to the structural pattern.^[97]

The chapter closes on the position that the eschatological-displacement subtype, though attested in only three principal cases (Norse, Christian-apocalyptic, Zoroastrian) plus one transitional precedent within the Hebrew Bible (Isaiah 27:1), is structurally robust: its four-feature pattern (binding → release → final combat → renovation) is jointly satisfied by all three principal cases, its three-axis cognitive-functional reorientation (patient-awaiting, meaningful-linear-history, promised-heroism) is jointly articulated across all three principal cases, and the long-standing scholarly question of historical influence vs. typological convergence is best handled by partition (some component plausibly transmission-explicable; some component most plausibly within-tradition or structurally-convergent) rather than by uniform decision — a settled position that supports the four-way typological scheme of scope.md while acknowledging that the eschatological-displacement subtype is a late innovation in the wider combat-myth tradition rather than a continuous articulation across the corpus.^[98]

[1] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml sources.anchor on the six methodological-comparative anchors (Gunkel 1895, Yarbrow Collins 1976, Watkins 1995, Benveniste and Renou 1934, Forsyth 1987, Day 1985) and chapters_drawn_from on the three Part-I chapters (Chs 18, 9, 13) plus the supporting Hebrew Bible chapter (Ch 8) whose own area-specialist anchors carry the per-tradition narrative-claims layer; Gunkel, H., **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit: Eine religionsgeschichtliche Untersuchung über Gen 1 und Ap Joh 12** (Göttingen: Vandenhoeck & Ruprecht, 1895), as the conceptual-comparative anchor whose **Urzeit-und-Endzeit** framing supplies the chapter's analytical through-line.

[2] Per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four-subtype operationalisation of the chaoskampf category and §"Book structure" Part II on the Part-II comparative chapters' division of labour; per glossary.yaml on "eschatological-displacement combat" as the locked subtype-term ("a combat myth in which the decisive engagement with the adversary is set at the end of cosmic time rather than at its beginning or within its maintenance-cycle").

[3] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml comparative_argument on the eschatological-displacement subtype as the late-innovation configuration that linear-time cosmology made possible; Gunkel 1895, **Schöpfung und Chaos**, Teil II, on the **Urzeit-und-Endzeit** parallelism that anchors the comparative typology.

[4] Faulkes, A. (trans.), **Edda** (London: Everyman, 1987), **Gylfaginning** chs. 34, 46–48, 51, on Jörmungandr's birth, Óðinn's casting of the serpent into the encircling ocean, the three Thor-and-Jörmungandr encounters, and the Ragnarök mutual killing; Larrington, C. (trans.), **The Poetic Edda**, rev. ed. (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2014), **Völuspá** st. 56 on the Ragnarök combat and sts. 59–66 on the renewal-narrative; West, M.L., **Indo-European Poetry and Myth** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2007), ch. 6, on the IE storm-god / water-dragon complex.

[5] Yarbrow Collins, A., **The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation** (Missoula: Scholars Press, 1976), chs. 2–4 on Revelation 12 as eschatological reformulation of the Leto-Apollo-Python combat-myth pattern; Aune, D.E., **Revelation**, Word Biblical Commentary 52A–C (Dallas / Nashville: Word, 1997–1998), commentary on Revelation 12 and 20 on the verse-by-verse philology and on the

binding-and-final-loosing structure; Forsyth, N., **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), ch. 6 on Revelation as climactic synthesis; Day, J., **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea** (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1985), ch. 3 on Isaiah 27:1.

[6] Benveniste, E. and Renou, L., **Vātra et Vāθragna: Étude de mythologie indo-iranienne** (Paris: Imprimerie Nationale, 1934), on the Avestan Thraētaona and Aži Dahāka material and the Indo-Iranian comparative philology; Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 1995), Part V chs. 46–48, on the Pahlavi narrative-expansion of the Avestan allusions and on the Frashokereti combat.

[7] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml special_instructions on the do-not-re-narrate discipline; per chapters/18-thor-jormungandr.adoc, chapters/09-revelation-red-dragon.adoc, chapters/13-thraetaona-azidahaka.adoc, and chapters/08-yahweh-leviathan-rahab.adoc on the per-tradition narrative-and-source treatment that this comparative chapter does not duplicate.

[8] Per glossary.yaml entry on "eschatological-displacement combat" with first-mention gloss; Gunkel 1895, **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit**, Teil II, on the **Endzeit** projection of combat-imagery as parallel and reciprocal to its **Urzeit** deployment in cosmogonic combat-narratives.

[9] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 34, on Óðinn's casting of Jörmungandr into the ocean rather than killing the serpent at the gods' establishment of Miðgarðr; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46–48, on Thraētaona's binding-rather-than-killing of Aži Dahāka in the Pahlavi **Bundahišn**; Yarbrough Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the dragon's expulsion-rather-than-destruction at Rev 12:7–9 and Aune 1997–98 on the deferred binding of Satan at Rev 20.

[10] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the eschatological breaking of Aži Dahāka's chains in the Pahlavi narrative; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 20:3 and 20:7, on the thousand-year binding and the released-for-a-little-while structure; Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on Jörmungandr's emergence from the ocean at Ragnarök.

[11] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on Thor and Jörmungandr's mutual killing at Vígríðr; Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** st. 56, on the same; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 20:7–10, on the dragon's final defeat and casting into the lake of fire; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on Kōrōsāspa's killing of Aži Dahāka at Frashokereti.

[12] Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** sts. 59–66, on the post-Ragnarök renewal-narrative; Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 52–53, on the same; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the Frashokereti renovation including the resurrection, the molten-metal ordeal, and the cosmic renewal; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 21:1, on the new heavens and new earth following the dragon's defeat.

[13] Per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four-subtype operationalisation of the chaoskampf category; Gunkel 1895, **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit**, Teil II, on the **Urzeit-und-Endzeit** parallelism that articulates the cosmogonic-vs-eschatological structural pair; per Ch34 (C1), Ch35 (C2), and Ch36 (C3) on the contrast-subtypes.

[14] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml comparative_argument on the late-Iron-Age / early-post-classical horizon and on the structural convergence as the chapter's principal finding; Gunkel 1895 Teil II on Genesis 1 and Apocalypse of John 12 as the original two-pillar comparison that the present chapter's three-case typology generalises.

[15] This parallel is speculative. Basis: the three principal cases are all late by the standards of the wider book's corpus (the earliest, Revelation 12, is c. 95 CE, three to four centuries after the Achaemenid horizon at which Zoroastrian eschatology is conventionally located, and approximately two millennia after the **Enūma Eliš** and Pyramid Texts horizons); the three traditions where the subtype is attested are all traditions that articulate linear-time cosmologies (Zoroastrian dualistic eschatology with its sharp Ahura-Mazdā / Angra-Mainyu opposition and its end-of-time renovation; Jewish-and-Christian apocalyptic with its Daniel-derived eschatological calendar; Norse Ragnarök with its terminal-but-not-final structure). The main counterargument: that "linear-time cosmology" is itself a contested construct whose application to Norse cosmology in particular has been challenged (the Eddic and Snorra-Edda corpus arguably articulates a cyclical-with-exception structure rather than a strictly linear one — the post-Ragnarök renewal narrates a new earth rising from the sea with a small surviving group of gods, which complicates the linear-time reading); the structural convergence may therefore reflect joint sensitivity to a structural pressure the chapter does not fully reduce to a single underlying cosmological feature.

[16] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the bound-but-living-adversary structure as the eschatological subtype's load-bearing feature; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the Endzeit-deferred-killing as the structural mark of the eschatological projection.

[17] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml comparative_argument on the bound-and-eventually-released structure as the subtype's signature; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same structural articulation; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the same.

[18] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml special_instructions on the no-re-narration discipline; per the precedent established by Ch36 §§II–IV on the per-case compressed treatment in comparative chapters.

[19] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 34, on Óðinn's dispatch of Jörmungandr into the ocean and on the serpent's growth to encircle the world and bite its own tail.

[20] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 34, on the cosmographic-and-constraining function of Jörmungandr's ocean-encircling; West 2007, ch. 6, on the encircling as the Norse articulation of the bound-but-living feature shared with the Iranian Aži Dahāka and the Christian-apocalyptic dragon-Satan.

[21] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 46–48, on the Útgardaloki cat-lift and on the fishing-encounter without resolution; Larrington 2014, **Hymiskviða** sts. 17–24, on the fishing-encounter and the cut-line denouement; per the three-encounter completion structure of brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml.

[22] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on Jörmungandr's emergence from the ocean, on the venom-spewing approach to Vígríðr,

and on the meeting of Thor and Jörmungandr in the final paired single-combat.

- [23] Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** st. 56, on Thor's victorious strike against the serpent and the staggering nine paces and Thor's death from the serpent's venom; Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 51, on the same mutual-killing outcome and the venom-death.
- [24] Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** sts. 59–66, on the post-Ragnarök renewal-narrative with the new earth, the surviving gods, the inheritance of Mjöllnir, and the human pair Líf and Lífþrasir; Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 52–53, on the same renewal-narrative.
- [25] West 2007, ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on the Norse Thor-and-Jörmungandr complex as the principal eschatologisation of the Indo-European storm-god / water-dragon type; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 41–48, on the Norse case within the wider IE **HERO SLAY SERPENT** formula.
- [26] Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 4, on Rev 12's eschatological function within the end-of-times visionary narrative; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 12:7–9 and on Rev 20:1–10, on the binding-and-final-loosing structure that links the two chapters.
- [27] RSV translation of Rev 12:7–9, as quoted in Yarbro Collins 1976 ch. 2 and Aune 1997–98 commentary on Rev 12:7–9; Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the satanological double-gloss at Rev 12:9.
- [28] Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the Rev 12:9 consolidating gloss; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 12:9, on the same; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on Rev 12:9 as the consolidating moment.
- [29] Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the post-expulsion narrative ordering and on the dragon's redirected wrath; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 12:10–17, on the same.
- [30] RSV translation of Rev 20:1–3 and 20:7, as quoted in Aune 1997–98 commentary on Rev 20; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 20:1–3 and 20:7, on the binding-and-final-loosing structure.
- [31] RSV translation of Rev 20:7–10, as quoted in Aune 1997–98 commentary on Rev 20:7–10; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 20:7–10, on the final-combat resolution.
- [32] RSV translation of Rev 21:1, as quoted in Aune 1997–98 commentary on Rev 21:1; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 21:1, on the new-heavens-and-new-earth renovation; Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the renovation-rather-than-restoration outcome.
- [33] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on **Yašt** 5.33–35 and the wider Avestan corpus on Thraētaona's overthrow of Aži Dahāka; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–46, on the same Avestan attestations.
- [34] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the Damāvand-binding as a Pahlavi-narrative feature without Avestan attestation; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the absence of the binding-mountain from the surviving Avestan corpus.
- [35] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the eschatological release of Aži Dahāka and the destructive eruption in the Pahlavi narrative; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same eschatological closure of the Iranian combat-thread.
- [36] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on Kōrōsāspa's long-stasis-and-revival narrative as the structural pivot of the Frashokereti combat; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on Kōrōsāspa as the second Iranian dragon-slayer alongside Thraētaona.
- [37] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the wider Frashokereti scenario including the resurrection, the molten-metal ordeal, and the cosmic renewal; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the eschatological-renovation framework as the structural pivot of the Iranian eschatology.
- [38] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the doubled-combat structural alignment among the three eschatological cases; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the same alignment; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the comparative alignment.
- [39] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §III on the binding as the common structural element; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, ch. 6, on the bound-but-living adversary as the eschatological subtype's load-bearing feature; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same.
- [40] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 34, on Jörmungandr's encircling-and-tail-biting structure; West 2007, ch. 6, on the encircling as cosmographic-and-constraining configuration.
- [41] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** ch. 34, on the encircling as constraint without fetters; per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §III on the structural-functional equivalence among the three articulations; West 2007, ch. 6, on the same.
- [42] Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 46, 48, on the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** narrative of Thraētaona's chaining of Aži Dahāka under Damāvand and on the mountain's cosmographic role; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same Pahlavi-localisation.
- [43] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the cosmogeographic role of Aži Dahāka under Damāvand in the Pahlavi tradition; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the same.
- [44] Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the Rev 12 expulsion as first-stage constraint; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 20:1–3, on the bottomless-pit binding as second-stage constraint and on the bipartite structural articulation.
- [45] Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 20:2 and 20:7, on the thousand-year binding as the duration-explicit case among the three principal eschatological-combat traditions; Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the apocalyptic-calendar embedding of the millennium.
- [46] Per Ch34 (C1) on the Marduk-Tiamat construction-from-substance structure as the cosmogonic-subtype type-specimen; Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, on the cosmogonic disposal of Tiamat; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the bound-and-surviving structure as the eschatological-subtype contrast.
- [47] Per Ch35 (C2) on the Baal-Yamm sovereignty-settlement structure as the sovereignty-subtype type-specimen; Smith 1994 / Smith and Pitard 2009, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle**, on the once-and-settled outcome of the **qrb ym** combat; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the

deferred-settlement structure as the eschatological-subtype contrast.

[48] Per Ch36 (C3) §II on the Ra-Apep recurrent-rebuff structure as the cyclical-maintenance type-specimen; Assmann 2001, on the recurrence-as-constitutive structure of Egyptian solar theology; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the binding-persistence structure as the eschatological-subtype contrast.

[49] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §III on the binding as structural fulcrum; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the binding-and-eschatological-combat structural interdependence; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same structural articulation.

[50] Inference: Faulkes 1987 **Gylfaginning** ch. 34 on the Norse encircling; Watkins 1995 Part V chs. 46, 48 on the Iranian Damāvand-chaining; Aune 1997–98 on Rev 20:1–3 on the Christian-apocalyptic bottomless-pit binding; the joint downstream sequence (§I above) is the structural-functional warrant for treating the three articulations as variants. Risk: that the structural-functional equivalence collapses in the post-combat condition where the three traditions diverge (Norse near-extinction-and-renewal vs. Iranian positively-articulated renovation vs. Christian-apocalyptic new-heavens-and-new-earth), and that the binding-equivalence may therefore be a partial rather than a complete equivalence; the chapter notes the divergence at §VI without reopening the structural-equivalence claim of §III.

[51] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §III on the structural-vs-cultural distinction; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the same; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the structural-functional level of comparison.

[52] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §IV on the three possibilities (Zoroastrian → Jewish-Christian; Jewish-Christian → Norse; independent convergence) and on the chapter's discipline of presenting evidence without forcing a verdict; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the long-trajectory transmission-and-convergence question.

[53] Gunkel 1895, **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit**, Teil II, on the original **Endzeit**-comparative argument; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, ch. 5, on the **religionsgeschichtliche Schule** development of the Iranian-influence thesis and on its long subsequent reception.

[54] Per Day 1985, ch. 3, on the post-exilic Persian-period setting of Isaiah 27 and on the historical-contact context; Forsyth 1987, ch. 5, on the Persian-period and Hellenistic-period contact horizon.

[55] Forsyth 1987, ch. 5, on the four candidate features for Zoroastrian-derivation; Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the Daniel-7-and-12 eschatological-calculation material as articulated in Rev 12:6 (1,260 days) and Rev 12:14 (three and a half times).

[56] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, ch. 5, on the structural pivot of the Aži Dahāka / Rev 20 parallel; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the doubled-combat structural alignment of the Iranian and Christian-apocalyptic cases.

[57] Per Ch13 brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml on the temporal-layering caveat as load-bearing; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48, on the Pahlavi preservation of substantively earlier tradition; Forsyth 1987, ch. 5, on the same caveat in the influence-argument context.

[58] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the inherited Israelite-Hebrew Bible material as alternative to Iranian-influence reading; Forsyth 1987, ch. 5, on the late-textual-fixation difficulty and on the methodological-observation about structural-functional convergence.

[59] Faulkes 1987, introduction, on the post-conversion status of the textual record and on the conversion-horizon contact; West 2007, ch. 6, on the Ragnarök narrative within the IE storm-god / water-dragon comparative context that situates the Norse case alongside un-eschatologised reflexes (Vedic, Hittite).

[60] West 2007, ch. 6, on the four-stone iconographic dossier as pre-Christian witness; per Ch18 brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography on the same.

[61] West 2007, ch. 6, on the iconographic dossier's focus on the fishing-encounter and on the limits of iconographic evidence for the eschatological-inflection question; per Ch18 brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml iconography on the same.

[62] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Norse mutual-killing as the principal eschatologisation of the IE storm-god / water-dragon type and on the within-Indo-European character of the eschatologisation; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48, on the Indo-European poetic-formula context.

[63] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §IV on the independent-convergence possibility; Forsyth 1987, ch. 5, on the structural-functional pressure as alternative to direct-influence reading; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same.

[64] This parallel is speculative. Basis: the historical-contact evidence supports the Achaemenid-and-Hellenistic-period plausibility of Iranian-to-Jewish contact (per Day 1985 on the Persian-period setting and per Forsyth 1987 on the **religionsgeschichtliche** framing); the structural parallels between Aži Dahāka-binding-and-Frashokereti-killing and Rev 20 binding-and-final-loosing are striking enough to invite an influence-reading; the Norse case stands geographically and historically apart from any direct Iranian-to-Norse influence-route, and the West 2007 ch. 6 within-IE eschatologisation reading supplies a non-influence explanation for the Norse case that the chapter takes seriously. The main counterargument: that the late-textual-fixation of the most striking Iranian features (Pahlavi attestation of Damāvand-binding) raises a methodological worry about the direction of influence — perhaps Jewish-Christian-apocalyptic material influenced the Pahlavi narrative-elaboration of features whose Avestan substrate is allusive rather than narrative, with the influence-direction running opposite to the conventional reading; this is a serious counterargument that the late-twentieth-and-early-twenty-first-century scholarship has registered without settling, and the chapter does not adjudicate.

[65] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml special_instructions on presenting the influence question charitably without over-committing; Forsyth 1987, ch. 5, on the unsettled-question discipline; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same.

[66] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §IV on the settled position; Forsyth 1987, ch. 5; Gunkel 1895, Teil II;

West 2007, ch. 6.

[67] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §IV on the partition-rather-than-uniform-decision discipline; Forsyth 1987, ch. 5, on the same; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same.

[68] Day 1985, **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea**, chs. 3–4, on the seven-passage corpus and on the dominantly-retrospective character of the combat imagery; per Ch8 (Yahweh-Leviathan-Rahab) on the same.

[69] RSV translation of Ps 74:13–14, as quoted in Day 1985 ch. 1; Day 1985, ch. 1, on the past-tense framing of the Ps 74 combat imagery.

[70] Day 1985, ch. 4, on Job 26:12–13 as retrospective wisdom-poetry framing of the combat; per Ch8 on the same.

[71] Day 1985, ch. 3, on Isa 27:1 as the Hebrew Bible's principal eschatological-projection of the combat imagery; per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §V on Isa 27:1's transitional position.

[72] RSV translation of Isa 27:1, as quoted in Day 1985 ch. 3; Day 1985, ch. 3, on the "on that day" idiom and on the future-tense verbs as the textual marks of the eschatological projection.

[73] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the verbatim epithet-correspondence between Isa 27:1 and KTU 1.5 i 1–3 as the philologically-precise evidence for Ugaritic-into-Hebrew continuity; Smith and Pitard 2009, **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume II**, on KTU 1.5 i 1–3 as the Ugaritic source-text.

[74] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the post-exilic dating of the "Isaiah Apocalypse" and on the Persian-period comparative context; Ballentine 2015, ch. 5, on the Persian-period Frashokereti-comparative question; Forsyth 1987, ch. 5, on the same.

[75] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the inner-Israelite eschatologisation reading of Isa 27:1; per the discipline of citing Iranian-influence as a comparative possibility rather than a demonstrated dependence.

[76] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, ch. 5, on the political-theological reading of Isa 27:1 within the rival-sovereignty thesis.

[77] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the trajectory from Isa 27 to Rev 12; Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on Rev 12:9's drawing on the Hebrew Bible Leviathan-tradition; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on Rev 12 as elaboration of the Hebrew Bible eschatologisation.

[78] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the single-text status of Isa 27:1 within the Hebrew Bible combat corpus; per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §V on the transitional-text reading.

[79] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §V on Isa 27:1 as precondition rather than principal case; Day 1985, ch. 3, on the same; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the structural requirements of the eschatological-displacement subtype.

[80] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the Isa 27:1 hinge between retrospective and prospective combat material; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the same hinge function within the long-trajectory reading of the Hebrew Bible-into-Christian-apocalyptic combat material.

[81] Inference: Day 1985 ch. 3 on the Isa 27:1-to-Rev 12 trajectory and on the verbatim epithet-correspondence at Isa 27:1 (which Rev 12:9 echoes via the "ancient serpent" / "great dragon" double-gloss); Yarbrow Collins 1976 ch. 3 on Rev 12:9's drawing on the Hebrew Bible Leviathan-corpus; Forsyth 1987 ch. 6 on Rev 12 as elaboration of the Hebrew Bible eschatologisation. Risk: the inference treats Rev 12's elaboration as a textual-development from Isa 27:1, but the actual textual relationship between the two passages may involve mediation through Second Temple Jewish apocalyptic material (Daniel, 1 Enoch, the Qumran corpus) that the chapter does not engage at the level of detail required to fully reconstruct the textual lineage; the inference is structural rather than fully philological.

[82] Day 1985, ch. 3, on the structural difference between Isa 27:1's projection-without-binding and the full eschatological-displacement structure; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the structural-completeness requirement; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 20:1–3, on the binding as the structural-completion of the eschatological projection that Isa 27:1 inaugurates.

[83] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §VI on the three-axis analytical contribution; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, ch. 6, on the cognitive-functional reading of the eschatological subtype; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same.

[84] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §VI on the patient-awaiting feature; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the same; per Ch36 (C3) on the contrasting recurrent-engagement structure.

[85] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 4, on Rev 12's didactic-encouragement function as operating through the patient-awaiting framing; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 12:12, on the "his time is short" formulation.

[86] Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the Frashokereti eschatology and on the moral-and-ritual participation feature; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Iranian dualistic-eschatological framing.

[87] Faulkes 1987, **Gylfaginning** chs. 34, 51, on the cosmographic rather than ethical character of the Norse patient-awaiting; West 2007, ch. 6, on the same.

[88] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §VI on the meaningful-linear-history feature; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the same; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same.

[89] This parallel is speculative. Basis: the temporal correlation between the appearance of linear-time cosmologies and the appearance of the eschatological-displacement subtype is striking — the three principal cases all post-date the development of the relevant linear-time cosmologies, and earlier traditions with non-linear cosmologies do not develop the subtype despite having the necessary combat-myth substrate; per Forsyth 1987 ch. 5 on the historical-cosmological correlation; per Gunkel 1895 Teil II on the **Urzeit-und-Endzeit** parallelism as a feature of traditions that articulate both ends of cosmic time. The main counterargument: that the linear-time-cosmology / eschatological-displacement-subtype correlation is itself a construct of the comparative-typology

framework rather than a feature of the underlying traditions — the Norse case in particular has been read by some as articulating a partial-cycle rather than a strictly linear cosmology (the post-Ragnarök new earth complicates the linear-time reading), and the correlation may therefore be partially an artifact of the typology rather than a feature of the traditions; the chapter notes the worry without abandoning the linear-time-cosmology hypothesis.

[90] Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the Christian-apocalyptic political-theological framing; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the Zoroastrian moral-cosmic framing; West 2007, ch. 6, on the Norse heroic-aristocratic projection.

[91] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §VI on the promised-rather-than-already-victorious feature; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on Kṛ̥śāspa's stasis-and-revival as the structural articulation of the promised-hero feature; Larrington 2014, **Völuspá** sts. 56 and 59–66, on the same in the Norse case; Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the same in the Christian-apocalyptic case.

[92] Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the inverted royal-legitimation structure; Aune 1997–98, commentary on Rev 12:5–9, on the throne-ascent-precedes-combat structural ordering.

[93] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §VI on the three-axis cognitive-functional articulation; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the same; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same.

[94] Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the Christian-apocalyptic believer's lived-religious framing; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the Zoroastrian framing; West 2007, ch. 6, on the Norse heroic-aristocratic framing.

[95] Per Ch36 (C3) §VI on the cyclical-maintenance lived-religious framing; Assmann 2001, **The Search for God in Ancient Egypt**, on the **maꜥat** / **isfet** recurring-engagement structure; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the eschatological-displacement awaiting-structure as the principal contrast.

[96] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §VI on the asymmetric articulation; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 48, on the Zoroastrian theological explicitness; Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the Christian-apocalyptic political-historical embedding; Faulkes 1987, introduction, on the Norse cult-and-belief agnosticism.

[97] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml structure §VI on the structural-vs-articulation distinction; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the same; Gunkel 1895, Teil II, on the same.

[98] Per brief 37-C4-eschatological-displacement.yaml comparative_argument and special_instructions on the chapter's settled position; Gunkel 1895, **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit**, Teil II, on the Endzeit-projection as a distinct configuration; Forsyth 1987, ch. 6, on the same; per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four-way typological scheme.

Chapter 39. C5. The Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula

39.1. Source overview

This chapter is a comparative-philological synthesis chapter rather than a primary-source narrative chapter; it draws on two layers of evidence — (1) the IE-comparativist anchor that supplies the chapter's central reconstruction and the bulk of its philological exhibits (Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, Parts IV–V), and (2) the per-tradition area-specialist anchors that ground each daughter-language reflex in its own primary-text witness (Jamison & Brereton 2014 for Vedic; Benveniste & Renou 1934 for Avestan; Hoffner 1998 and Beckman 1982 for Hittite; Larrington 2014 and Faulkes 1987 for Old Norse; West 1966 and Ogden 2013 for Greek; Russell 1987 for Armenian; Bailey & Ivanova 1998 for Slavic **bylina**; Tolkien 1936 for the load-bearing critical move on the **Beowulf** dragon).^[1]

The chapter is the fifth of the eight Part-II comparative chapters (C1 through C8) and is positioned as the load-bearing philological chapter for the Indo-European distribution of the combat-myth, distinguished within the Part-II sequence from the cosmogonic (C1), sovereignty (C2), cyclical-maintenance (C3), and eschatological (C4) subtype-chapters by treating the combat across IE daughter languages as the **linguistic-and-poetic** fact whose explanation is genealogical inheritance from a shared ancestor rather than as a typological category whose explanation is structural-functional or independent invention.^[2]

The chapter's central argument follows Watkins's 1995 reconstruction: the verbal formula HERO SLAY SERPENT (a subject-noun naming the warrior, a verb of killing, and a serpent-object naming the adversary) is preserved across the IE daughter languages at the level of **lexical-and-syntactic** correspondences (Vedic **áhann áhim**; Avestan cognates; Hittite **kuenta... illuyanka**) rather than at the level of structural-typological resemblance alone, and the philological correspondences are best explained as inheritance from a Proto-Indo-European poetic tradition rather than as contact-borrowing or independent convergence.^[3]

The chapter holds Watkins's argument open to two distinct kinds of pressure. First, the chapter is explicit about the gradient between direct philological evidence (the Vedic / Avestan / Hittite triple of §II, where Watkins's formula stands on regular lexical correspondences) and typological-or-fragmentary evidence (the §III extended cases, where the philological signal weakens and the typological signal carries more of the comparative weight). Second, the chapter closes with a Mwindo control (§VI) that registers the existence of non-IE serpent-combat traditions with their own combat-vocabularies, showing that IE inheritance is a real finding about the IE distribution of the combat-myth and not a totalising explanation of the pattern's broader global occurrence.^[4]

The Vedic-side anchor is Jamison and Brereton 2014 (the Oxford three-volume Rigveda translation), which supplies the chapter's working English text for the Indra-Vṛtra hymn-corpus and for the Trita Āptya residual stratum that the comparative argument draws on; the philological anchor for the same Indo-Iranian material is Benveniste and Renou 1934, which supplies the foundational philological treatment of the Vedic Vṛtra and Avestan Vərəθrayna together as cognate reflexes of a shared Indo-Iranian "obstruction-and-victory" complex.^[5]

The Avestan-side anchor is Benveniste and Renou 1934 again, which supplies the chapter's working philological apparatus for the Thraētaona / Aži Dahāka material in the Avestan yashts (Yt. 5.33–35; Yt. 14; Yt. 19) and the Pahlavi **Bundahišn**, and which establishes Trita Āptya / Thraētaona as a cognate Indo-Iranian pair on the basis of regular phonological correspondences between Vedic Sanskrit and Avestan; Watkins 1995 Part V (chs. 44–48) supplies the chapter's IE-comparativist anchor for the Avestan material at the level of the consolidated formula reconstruction.^[6]

The Hittite-side anchor is Hoffner 1998 (the working English translation of CTH 321, second edition, **Hittite Myths**) and Beckman 1982 (the philological **editio princeps** in **JANES** 14: 11–25); Watkins 1995 chapter 46 ("Typhoeus and the Illuyankas") supplies the IE-comparativist treatment of the Hittite verb-and-object pairing **kuenta... illuyanka-** as cognate with Vedic **áhann áhim**.^[7]

The §III area-specialist anchors are Larrington 2014 and Faulkes 1987 for the Norse witnesses (Thor-Jörmungandr and Sigurd-Fáfnir), Tolkien 1936 for the load-bearing critical move on the **Beowulf** dragon and Watkins 1995 Part V for the **Beowulf** formula reading, West 2007 ch. 6 for the Celtic Lugh-Balor and Welsh Red-and-White Dragon material via Ogden 2013 ch. on Celtic, West 2007 ch. 6 for the Ossetic Batraz / Nart corpus, Russell 1987 for the Armenian Vahagn and **vishaps**, West 2007 ch. 6 for the Slavic Perun-Veles reconstruction, and Bailey & Ivanova 1998 for the Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych **bylina**; West 1966 (the Oxford critical edition of Hesiod's **Theogony**) and Ogden 2013 for the Greek Zeus-Typhon material complete the §III dossier.^[8]

The chapter follows the brief's special_instructions in not re-narrating the eight Part-I cases — the reader has Chs 6 (Illuyanka), 11 (Zeus-Typhon), 13 (Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka), 14 (Indra-Vṛtra), 15 (Vedic reflexes including Trita Āptya), 18 (Thor-Jörmungandr), 19 (IE reflexes — Sigurd, Beowulf, Lugh-Balor, Welsh Red-and-White, Batraz, Vahagn), and 20 (Slavic-Baltic — Perun-Veles, Dobrynya) for the narrative-and-source material — and the comparative chapter's job is to make the philological argument across them rather than to recapitulate their narrative content; the brief's target length of 7,500 body-prose words is on the longer side for Part II, and the chapter's analytical through-line is Watkins's lexical-syntactic reconstruction with explicit gradients between direct, typological, and fragmentary evidence.^[9]

What follows is organised in six body sections. Section I lays out the formula itself — Watkins's reconstructed HERO SLAY SERPENT structure of subject + verb-of-killing + serpent-object — and the cognate verb-and-object pairings that anchor it in Vedic, Avestan, and Hittite; section II develops the three direct philological cases (Vedic Indra-Vṛtra, Avestan Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka, Hittite Tarḫunna-Illuyanka) at which Watkins's reconstruction stands on regular lexical-and-syntactic correspondences across attested-text witnesses; section III consolidates the eight extended typological cases (Greek Zeus-Typhon; Norse Thor-Jörmungandr and Sigurd-Fáfnir; Old English **Beowulf**-dragon; Celtic Lugh-Balor; Welsh Red-and-White Dragon; Ossetic Batraz; Armenian Vahagn-**vishaps**; Slavic Perun-Veles and Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych) across a philological-evidence spectrum from strongest (Norse Sigurd) to weakest (Slavic Perun-Veles, Armenian Vahagn); section IV sorts the eleven reflexes along the strong-and-weak gradient and presents the area-specialist dissent on the Slavic case; section V makes explicit the inheritance-versus-transmission distinction on which the chapter's whole argument rests and locates the contact-borrowing question in C6 (Ch39); and section VI closes with the Mwindo control, which bounds Watkins's IE-inheritance argument to its proper IE scope without totalising the global combat-myth pattern.

39.2. I. The formula

The first body section reconstructs the formula itself — the verbal-syntactic structure that the rest of the chapter's argument is built on — and traces its three principal lexical anchors across the IE family.

Calvert Watkins, in **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (Oxford University Press, 1995), reconstructs an Indo-European poetic formula of the form HERO SLAY SERPENT, in which a subject-noun naming the warrior, a verb of killing, and a serpent-object naming the adversary together name the combat in a fixed verbal-syntactic structure that the volume's framing chapters lay out as the central philological exhibit of the work.^[10]

The formula is not a fixed verbal sequence at the level of word-order — Watkins is explicit that the daughter-language reflexes vary in word-order according to the metrical and syntactic norms of each daughter language — but a fixed **lexical-and-semantic** structure in which three slots (warrior-subject, killing-verb, serpent-object) are filled by inherited words whose etymologies recur across the IE family.^[11]

The Vedic reflex anchoring Watkins's reconstruction is **áhann áhim** — "he slew the serpent" — from Rigveda 1.32.2, the second verse of the principal Indra-Vātra hymn whose opening verse announces the theme of Indra's manly deeds: the third-person preterite of the verb **han-** ("to strike, to kill") combined with the accusative-singular of **ahi-** ("serpent") supplies a verb-and-object pairing whose etymological components recur across the IE family in cognate forms.^[12]

The Vedic verbal root **han-** ("to strike, to kill") is the principal verb-of-killing in the formula and is etymologically connected, on Watkins's analysis and on the wider Indo-Iranian-comparative literature, with the Avestan verbal root **jan-** and with the Hittite verbal root **kuen-** / **kwen-** (third-singular preterite **kuenta**), all from a reconstructed Proto-Indo-European root **g^hhen-** "to strike".^[13]

The Vedic noun **ahi-** ("serpent") is the principal serpent-object of the formula and is philologically cognate, by regular Indo-Iranian sound-laws, with the Avestan noun **aži-**, the same word for "serpent" appearing as the first element in the name of the Avestan dragon-tyrant Aži Dahāka; the Vedic-Avestan **ahi-** / **aži-** pair is one of the cleanest Indo-Iranian noun-cognancies in the dragon-combat lexicon.^[14]

The Avestan reflex of the formula is most commonly cited in the form **janat aiim** ("he slew the serpent") and similar verb-noun pairings in the Avestan yashts, in which the Avestan verbal root **jan-** (cognate with Vedic **han-**) and the Avestan noun **aži-** (cognate with Vedic **ahi-**) instantiate the same lexical-and-semantic structure that Vedic **áhann áhim** instantiates in Vedic Sanskrit.^[15]

The Hittite reflex of the formula is **kuenta... illuyanka-**, "he slew... the serpent", from CTH 321 (the Illuyanka tablets), in which the Hittite verbal root **kuen-** (third-singular preterite **kuenta**) is cognate with Vedic **han-** and Avestan **jan-** under the regular Anatolian / non-Anatolian sound-law correspondence, and the noun **illuyanka-** is the common Hittite word for "serpent" used as the proper name of the storm-god's adversary in the same tablets.^[16]

The cross-language identity of the formula is therefore **philological** in a strict sense: the verb-slot is filled by a reflex of PIE **g^hhen-** in each of the three daughter languages (Vedic **han-** / Avestan **jan-** /

Hittite **kuen-**), and the noun-slot is filled by reflexes of two distinct PIE etyma (Vedic **ahi-** / Avestan **aži-** on the one hand, Hittite **illuyanka-** on the other), with the lexical-substitutability of the noun-slot being one of Watkins's points about the formula's structure rather than its words.^[17]

The formula's distinctive feature, on Watkins's reading, is that it is a **poetic** inheritance — preserved in the verbal diction of poets composing in successive IE languages — rather than a **narrative** inheritance, a **theological** inheritance, or a **ritual** inheritance: what the formula transmits across the daughter languages is the verbal way of saying the combat, not necessarily the same theology of the combat or the same ritual occasion at which the combat is recited.^[18]

This poetic-verbal framing is methodologically distinct from a Frazerian structural-typological comparativism (which would group dragon-killings by structural-functional similarity without making language-specific claims) and from a Dumézilian functional-tripartite comparativism (which would group dragon-slayer figures by their position in the IE warrior-function), and Watkins's argument is that the lexical-syntactic correspondences carry an evidential weight that purely structural-or-functional comparisons cannot.^[19]

The chronological depth of the reconstruction depends on the early-attestation status of Hittite within the IE family. Hittite is the earliest-attested IE language (cuneiform tablets from the Hattusa archives c. 1700–1180 BCE) and is conventionally regarded as an early-branching member of the family; the presence of the formula in Hittite — alongside its Vedic and Avestan reflexes attested c. 1500–500 BCE — implies that the formula was already in place at a stage of the family that predates the divergence of the Anatolian and non-Anatolian branches.^[20]

The Norse-skaldic kennings for the serpent (the compressed metaphorical phrases in Old Norse / Old English skaldic poetic diction — for example, **umbgjörð allra landa** "band of all lands" for Jörmungandr) preserve, on Watkins's reading in **How to Kill a Dragon** Part V, the IE serpent-combat vocabulary in a registered-poetic-diction form that supplies the chapter's principal post-Vedic, post-Anatolian extra-philological exhibit for the formula's continued life in the daughter-language poetic traditions.^[21]

West 2007 ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream") supplements Watkins's reconstruction with a wider Indo-European storm-god / water-serpent complex, in which the formula's verbal exhibits sit alongside structural-typological observations about the storm-god's function as combatant and the water-serpent's function as obstructor; the West 2007 framing supplies the chapter's principal IE-comparative apparatus for the storm-god structural pattern alongside Watkins's verbal-formulaic apparatus.^[22]

The formula's evidential profile within the IE family is therefore strongest where the verb-and-object pairing is preserved in attested poetic-or-narrative text in a daughter language with an early or otherwise high-prestige textual record (Vedic, Avestan, Hittite, Old Norse, Old English) and weakest where the verb-and-object pairing is reconstructed from indirect or fragmentary witnesses (Slavic, Armenian) or where the philological signal is replaced by a typological-structural signal in the absence of preserved formulaic diction (Celtic, Welsh, in part Greek).^[23]

*(The chapter's framing of Watkins's argument as primarily a **philological** inheritance argument — distinct from structural-typological or theological inheritance arguments — is the chapter's editorial reading of the methodological framing chapters of Watkins 1995, presented in the present chapter as the principal interpretive lens for §§II–IV; Watkins's volume is itself titled **Aspects of Indo-European***

Poetics and the verbal-formulaic emphasis is consonant with the volume's self-presentation, but the framing language used in the present chapter ("philological-genealogical inheritance distinct from structural-typological resemblance") is a chapter-level synthesis rather than a Watkins-1995 quotation.^[24]

39.3. II. The direct philological cases

The second body section develops the three direct philological cases at which Watkins's reconstruction is anchored on regular cross-language lexical-and-syntactic correspondences rather than on typological reading.

The §II direct philological cases are the three IE daughter-language reflexes — Vedic Indra-Vātra, Avestan Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka, and Hittite Tarḫunna-Iluyanka — at which Watkins's reconstructed formula is anchored on regular lexical-and-syntactic correspondences across attested-text witnesses, and at which the chapter's case for Indo-European inheritance does not depend on typological reading or on reconstruction from indirect evidence.^[25]

The Vedic case is anchored on Rigveda 1.32, the principal Indra-Vātra hymn (fifteen verses), whose second verse contains **áhann áhim**, "he slew the serpent" — the formula's most-cited lexical exhibit; the chapter cites RV 1.32 as the working text via Jamison and Brereton 2014, the scholarly-standard English Rigveda, and reads the **áhann áhim** phrase at 1.32.2 as the Vedic instantiation of the verb-and-object pairing that Watkins reconstructs as the formula.^[26]

The Vedic Vātra-corpus extends well beyond RV 1.32: at least eight Rigvedic hymns (RV 1.32; 1.80; 2.11; 2.12; 4.18; 5.32; 6.17; 8.96; 10.113) constitute the working Vātra-combat corpus on which Watkins's reading of the Vedic reflex draws, with RV 1.32 supplying the most concentrated narrative spine and the other seven hymns supplying co-witness motifs that the spine-text does not develop, and the formula recurs across the corpus rather than being a one-line feature of a single hymn.^[27]

The Vedic combat is liturgically embedded: the Rigveda is a corpus of ritual hymns recited at the **soma** sacrifice, and the **áhann áhim** phrasing appears in hymns whose ritual function is to invoke the **soma**-strengthened Indra in the present petition, so that every recitation of RV 1.32 in its ritual context re-actualises the formula in performance — a feature that distinguishes the Vedic reflex from the Hittite reflex (where the formula appears in a one-time CTH 321 narrative rather than in a daily-or-frequent ritual hymn).^[28]

The Vedic reflex is reinforced by Trita Āptya, the older Vedic dragon-slayer whose name (Vedic **Trita**, "third") is philologically cognate with Avestan Thraētaona by regular Indo-Iranian sound-laws (Vedic **tr-** / Avestan **thr-**; Vedic **-i-** / Avestan **-aē-**; Vedic **-a** / Avestan **-aona**), and whose attestation in the Rigvedic corpus (RV 10.99.6; 1.105; 2.11.19–20) preserves a pre-Indra Indo-Iranian stratum of the dragon-slayer pattern.^[29]

The Trita / Thraētaona cognancy is documented at two levels — at the level of the names themselves (the regular sound-law correspondences across the Indo-Iranian branches) and at the level of their adversaries (both figures slay a three-headed serpent, the Vedic adversary unnamed in the surviving hymn-allusions and the Avestan adversary named as Aži Dahāka, "the dragon-Dahāka") — and the pair is one of the load-bearing exhibits for an Indo-Iranian phase of the dragon-combat material before the divergence of the Indic and Iranian branches.^[30]

The Avestan case is anchored on the Avestan yashts (Yt. 5.33–35, in which Thraētaona prays to Anāhitā for victory over Aži Dahāka; Yt. 14, in which Vərəθraϋna's smashing of resistance is named; Yt. 19, the Frashokereti material on the eschatological combat) and on the Pahlavi **Bundahišn**, in which the Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka combat is preserved as a continuous narrative; Benveniste and Renou 1934 supply the standard philological apparatus integrating both layers.^[31]

The Avestan reflex is hymn-allusive rather than narrative: the surviving Avestan corpus does not preserve a continuous narrative of the Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka combat, and the yasht-allusions — Yt. 5.33–35 in particular, where Thraētaona prays for the strength to slay the three-mouthed, three-headed, six-eyed Aži Dahāka — supply only the verbal-and-prayer-context attestations of the combat at the level of formulaic invocation rather than at the level of full storytelling.^[32]

The Pahlavi **Bundahišn** — a Middle Persian compilation conventionally dated to the 9th century CE in its surviving redaction, drawing on earlier Sasanian-period materials — supplies the fullest narrative witness to the Thraētaona / Aži Dahāka combat (the binding of the dragon under Mount Damāvand) and to the eschatological pendant in which Aži Dahāka escapes and is finally killed by the revived Kərəsāspa at Frashokereti; the Pahlavi witness is post-Achaemenid and must be marked as such in any Indo-European-comparative argument that draws on it.^[33]

*[At this point the tablet breaks. The Avestan corpus preserves no continuous narrative of the Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka combat; the yasht-allusions are hymn-formulaic-and-prayer-context, and the continuous-narrative witness is the post-Achaemenid Pahlavi **Bundahišn**. The proposed reconstruction: Benveniste and Renou 1934 reconstruct the combat-narrative by reading the Avestan yasht-allusions alongside the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** narrative, with the Pahlavi-witness narrative read as the continuation-and-elaboration of the Avestan-attested combat-tradition; the chapter cites the Pahlavi material as the in-tradition fill rather than as an Avestan-period attestation.]*

The Avestan adversary Aži Dahāka is morphologically three-headed (Avestan: three-mouthed, six-eyed, three-jawed), and the three-headed serpent / dragon morphology is precisely the morphology of the Vedic adversary slain by Trita Āptya in RV 10.99.6 — read by Benveniste and Renou and by Watkins as the Indo-Iranian common adversary of the Trita / Thraētaona cognate pair, with the cognancy of the names confirming the cognancy of the combat-narratives.^[34]

The Hittite case — the chapter renders the storm-god as Tarḫunna in keeping with the Ch36 §III correction, since Tarḫunna is the Hittite-language name of the storm-god in CTH 321 and Teshub is the Hurrian-language name attested in the Kumarbi Cycle and Hurrian-language ritual material — is anchored on CTH 321 (the Illuyanka tablets from the Hattusa archives), preserved in two co-equal scribal versions on the same tablet group, with both versions framed by their colophons as the recitation belonging to the **purulli** festival of the storm-god of Nerik.^[35]

The Hittite verb-and-object pairing **kuenta... illuyanka-** — "he slew... the serpent" — is the chapter's principal Hittite philological exhibit: the verb **kuen-** (third-singular preterite **kuenta**) is the Hittite reflex of the PIE killing-verb **gʰen-** whose Vedic and Avestan reflexes (**han-** / **jan-**) anchor the formula in Indo-Iranian, and **illuyanka-** is the Hittite common-noun "serpent" used as the proper name of the storm-god's adversary.^[36]

The two Illuyanka versions are co-equally attested on the same CTH 321 tablet group: Version 1 (Inara prepares a banquet, Hupasiya binds the gorged serpent, the storm-god kills the bound Illuyanka) and Version 2 (Illuyanka takes the storm-god's heart and eyes, the storm-god's half-

mortal son recovers the organs as bride-price, the storm-god kills both Illuyanka and his own son in renewed combat at the sea); Beckman's **editio princeps** establishes the two versions as scribally co-equal, and the chapter cites both as carrying the Hittite philological reflex of the formula at the level of the verb-and-object pairing whose common cross-version status reinforces the philological signal.^[37]

*[At this point the tablet breaks. The precise distribution of the **kuenta... illuyanka-** pairing across the two CTH 321 versions is not fully reconstructable in every preserved instance because the Hittite tablets themselves are partially broken (Version 1 closing section partially broken; Version 2 mid-narrative transitions partially broken per Hoffner 1998). The proposed reconstruction: Watkins 1995 ch. 46 reads the formula as preserved in CTH 321 at the level of the verb-and-object pairing without depending on the breaks; Hoffner 1998 supplies the reconstructed text at the level of the surrounding narrative, and Beckman 1982 *JANES* 14: 11–25 supplies the philological **editio princeps** against which the formula's Hittite-language realisations are checked.]*

The Hittite reflex's chronological significance for the reconstruction is decisive: Hittite is conventionally regarded as an early-branching member of the IE family (the "Anatolian hypothesis" reading Anatolian as the first branch to separate; the "Indo-Hittite hypothesis" reading Anatolian as a sister-language to the rest of IE rather than a daughter), and the presence of the formula in CTH 321 alongside its Vedic and Avestan reflexes implies that the formula was already established at a stage of the family that predates the Anatolian / non-Anatolian divergence.^[38]

The three direct cases together — Vedic, Avestan, Hittite — supply philological evidence at three independent points in the IE family: Indo-Iranian (Vedic and Avestan as cognate witnesses to a shared Indo-Iranian phase of the formula) and Anatolian (Hittite as an independent early-branching witness), with the three-witness pattern crossing the Anatolian / non-Anatolian boundary and the Indo-Iranian internal boundary so that the formula's Indo-European depth is attested rather than reconstructed across at least two principal branches of the family.^[39]

The §II direct-cases argument's load-bearing claim is therefore that the formula's existence as an Indo-European inheritance is attested in three IE daughter languages on the strength of regular phonological correspondences between cognate verbs and cognate nouns, that the inheritance reading does not depend on speculative reconstruction or on typological resemblance, and that the §III extended cases — to which the chapter now turns — are best read as later-branching reflexes of the same inheritance whose evidential character varies along the gradient that §I and §IV develop.^[40]

39.4. III. The extended typological cases

The third body section consolidates the eight extended typological cases on a philological-evidence spectrum from preserved formulaic diction to fragmentary or contested reconstruction.

The §III extended typological cases are the IE daughter-language reflexes — Greek Zeus-Typhon; Norse Thor-Jörmungandr and Sigurd-Fáfnir; Old English **Beowulf**-dragon; Celtic Lugh-Balor; Welsh Red-and-White Dragon; Ossetic Batraz; Armenian Vahagn-vishaps; Slavic Perun-Veles and Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych — at which Watkins's reconstructed formula is anchored in some cases on preserved poetic-formulaic diction (Norse Sigurd; Old English **Beowulf**) and in other cases on structural-typological resemblance, fragmentary attestation, or contested reconstruction; the §III

cases are arranged here on a philological-evidence spectrum from strongest (Norse skaldic and Eddic; **Beowulf**) to weakest (Slavic Perun-Veles, Armenian Vahagn).^[41]

The Greek Zeus-Typhon combat is the Hellenic instance of the IE warrior-and-serpent pattern: at Hesiod's **Theogony** 820–880 (the chapter's working text via West 1966), Zeus defeats the hundred-headed, serpent-limbed Typhon, the earth-born monster generated by Gaia and Tartarus, in the closing combat of the Olympian succession; the Typhonomachy is structurally the Greek sovereignty-establishing combat that secures Zeus's kingship over gods and men and is the principal Greek exhibit for the IE warrior / dragon-slayer pattern in Hesiodic poetic-narrative form.^[42]

The Greek-Hittite philological connection in the Zeus-Typhon material is contested rather than consolidated: West 1997 and Burkert 1992 read the Hesiodic succession (Ouranos-Kronos-Zeus) and the Typhonomachy as derived from the Kumarbi Cycle and (less directly) from the Illuyanka tradition via Near Eastern mediation, but this transmission-reading is the C6 chapter's territory rather than the present chapter's, and the present chapter treats Zeus-Typhon as a typological IE instance whose relation to the Hittite material is inheritance-or-contact rather than a direct philological cognate of the **kuenta... illuyanka-** pairing.^[43]

The Norse case has two principal sub-instances within the IE-formula argument. The first is Thor against Jörmungandr — the world-encircling Midgard Serpent — preserved in three encounters across the Old Norse corpus (Útgardaloki's lifting-of-the-cat in Snorri's **Gylfaginning** 46–48; the fishing expedition with Hymir in **Hymiskviða** and Snorri's **Gylfaginning** 48 with Húsdrápa as skaldic witness; the mutual killing at Ragnarök in **Völuspá** 56 and Snorri's **Gylfaginning** 51), and Watkins reads the skaldic kennings for the serpent (**umbgjörð allra landa** and similar phrases) as preserving the IE serpent-combat vocabulary at the level of the registered-poetic-diction kenning.^[44]

The second Norse sub-instance is Sigurd against Fáfnir, preserved principally in **Fáfnismál** in the Codex Regius (GKS 2365 4to, c. 1270 CE), with parallel witnesses in the **Völsunga saga** (c. 1270 CE) and in the Middle High German **Nibelungenlied** (c. 1200 CE) as the related Germanic witness with Sigurd in the German form Siegfried; Watkins's chapter 42 on Sigurd is among the strongest philological cases in the post-Indo-Iranian, post-Anatolian corpus, with the Old Norse verb of killing (**vega**, "to kill in combat") and the named hero-and-named-dragon pairing instantiating the IE formula in Old Norse.^[45]

The Old English **Beowulf** preserves the formula in the third movement of the poem (lines 2200–3182 in the standard Klaeber-edition line-numbering), in which the aged Beowulf confronts and kills the treasure-hoarding **draca** and dies of the dragon's bite; Watkins reads the Old English dragon-vocabulary (**draca**, **wyrm**) and the killing-vocabulary as instantiating the IE formula in Old English, and Tolkien's 1936 British Academy lecture supplies the load-bearing critical move that re-established the mythic register of the **Beowulf** monsters within twentieth-century Old English scholarship.^[46]

The **Beowulf** case is also distinctive in that the dragon-vocabulary itself shows IE depth: the Old English **draca** (loaned from Latin **draco** but ultimately tracing to the same Greek-and-Indo-European stem from which Greek **drakōn** derives) and the inherited Germanic **wyrm** (from Proto-Germanic **wurmiz**, ultimately from PIE **wr̥mi-** "worm/serpent") supply two etymologically-distinct lexical exhibits for the serpent-object slot of the IE formula in a single Old English poem, and the

doubled-vocabulary attestation reinforces the IE reflex-reading at the level of inherited word-stock rather than only at the level of preserved formulaic diction.^[47]

The Celtic case is Lugh against Balor at the Second Battle of Mag Tuired, preserved in the Middle Irish prose narrative **Cath Maige Tuired** (manuscripts 12th–16th c. CE): Lugh of the Tuatha Dé Danann kills his evil-eyed Fomorian grandfather Balor with a sling-stone that drives the eye through the back of Balor's head and turns its destructive gaze on the Fomorian host behind him; West 2007 ch. 6 reads the Celtic case as the IE warrior / dragon-slayer pattern, with the morphological distinctiveness preserved (Balor is a one-eyed giant rather than a serpent, and the killing-weapon is a projectile rather than a sword or thunderbolt).^[48]

The Lugh-Balor case's evidential weight for the IE formula argument is therefore principally typological and dynastic-structural: Lugh's hybrid lineage (Tuatha Dé father / Fomorian mother / Fomorian grandfather Balor) supplies the kill-the-grandfather motif that West 2007 ch. 6 reads as the IE warrior structural-genealogical pattern, but the philological reflex of **g^hhen-** in the Old Irish killing-vocabulary is not the focal exhibit, and the case's contribution to the consolidated IE argument is at the level of structural pattern rather than at the level of lexical cognancy.^[49]

The Welsh Red-and-White Dragon case is preserved in two principal witnesses with distinct framings — the Latin **Historia Brittonum** (Nennius recension, c. 828 CE) presenting the Britons-vs-Saxons political allegory, and the Middle Welsh **Lludd and Llefelys** in the **Mabinogion** (manuscripts White Book of Rhydderch c. 1350 CE; Red Book of Hergest c. 1382–1410 CE) preserving an older non-political reading in which the combat is an annual May-Eve disturbance ended by the king Lludd's mead-pit-and-burial resolution at Dinas Emrys — and the Welsh case is structurally distinctive in the IE-reflex corpus because the combat is between two dragons rather than between a hero and a dragon.^[50]

The Welsh case is also distinctive in its preservation of an annual-disturbance reading (in **Lludd and Llefelys**) alongside the political-allegorical reading (in **Historia Brittonum**): the May-Eve recurrence of the dragon-combat in **Lludd and Llefelys** shares structural affinity with the Hittite **purulli** annual cycle (treated in C3 / Ch36 §III) and with the Apollo-Python Septerion at Delphi (also a cyclical-cult-foundation reflex), and the Welsh dual recension preserves both the political-prophetic and the cyclical-cosmological dimensions of a single dragon-tradition in two contemporaneous witnesses that the medieval Welsh literary culture transmitted side by side.^[51]

The Ossetic Batraz case is preserved in the Nart saga corpus (oral-epic recordings from Ossetian, Circassian, and Chechen narrators from the 19th and 20th centuries CE), in which the steel-bodied Batraz fights monstrous giants and dragons across multiple episodic combats; Georges Dumézil's twentieth-century treatments read Batraz as the Scytho-Alanic IE reflex of the warrior / dragon-slayer pattern, and West 2007 ch. 6 supplies the chapter's IE-comparative anchor for the Ossetic material.^[52]

The Armenian Vahagn case is the most fragmentary of the §III sub-cases: the principal hymn-text to Vahagn is lost, and what survives is only Movses Khorenatsi's late paraphrase at **Patmut'iwn Hayots'** I.31 (conventionally dated 5th–9th c. CE), preserving a triple-birth motif (heavens / sea / reed) and identifying Vahagn as the storm-god, with the dragon-combat content reconstructed from the **Vishapakagh** "dragon-reaper" epithet, from the **vishapakar** stone stelae of the second millennium BCE, and from comparative-philological readings of the Avestan **V^rθrayna** and the Vedic Indra-V^rtra material as Indo-Iranian comparanda.^[53]

*[At this point the tablet breaks. The principal hymn-text to Vahagn is lost; what survives in primary witness is only Khorenatsi's late paraphrase at **Patmut'iwn Hayots'** I.31, which preserves the triple-birth motif and the **Vishapakagh** epithet but does not preserve a continuous narrative of Vahagn's combat with the **vishaps**. Scholars such as Khorenatsi **Patmut'iwn Hayots'** I.31 (preserving the late paraphrase) have proposed the narrative resumed with Russell 1987 Vahagn chapter reads Khorenatsi's paraphrase as preserving the substantive content of the lost hymn at the level of the dragon-slayer-epithet **Vishapakagh** and the storm-god combat-frame, with the specific verbal-poetic diction of the lost hymn unrecoverable; Petrosyan's Armenian-mythology scholarship corroborates the Russell reading at the level of substantive content while flagging the verbal-philological limits of the reconstruction.]*

The Batraz steel-body motif (the Nart hero born from a tumour on his father Khamits's back, plunged into a furnace, and emerging with a body of steel) is read by Dumézilian comparativism as a Scytho-Alanic distinctively-developed feature of the IE warrior-pole, and the death-narrative (Batraz cast from the heavens into a body of water, his steel body cooled-and-shattered against the resistance of the water) has been read by twentieth-century Ossetic-folkloric scholarship as cognate with other IE warrior-death narratives whose specific Old-Norse-and-Ossetic parallels are the subject of continuing comparative-philological discussion.^[54]

The Slavic case is the chapter's most contested instance: the Ivanov-Toporov 'basic myth' reconstruction proposes that the pre-Christian East Slavic religious tradition contained a structurally central combat-narrative in which the storm-god Perun pursues the cattle-stealing earth-serpent Veles through a four-stage refuge sequence (tree → rock → water → livestock) before striking him with lightning and releasing the rain; the reconstruction draws on three classes of indirect evidence — Slavic folklore items collected in the 19th and 20th centuries, medieval Slavic Christian-period chronicles (**Primary Chronicle**; **Slovo o polku Igoreve**; the 945 CE Russo-Byzantine treaty's oath-formula), and Slavic toponyms.^[55]

[Both versions are presented side by side here: the first version, Ivanov and Toporov's 1965–1974 reconstruction of the Perun-Veles 'basic myth' as a four-stage pursuit ending in a lightning-strike that releases the rain (cited via West 2007 ch. 6, since Ivanov and Toporov's Russian-language monographs are not pinned in `sources.yaml`) and the second, the dissenting position of Roman Jakobson, Patrice Lajoye, Kazimierz Moszyński, and Mate Kapović that the reconstruction depends on circular reasoning between toponym evidence and combat-narrative, on late-and-Christianised chronicle sources, and on over-interpretation of folklore fragments (these scholars named-but-flagged here per the Ch20 framing — their specific publications are not in `sources.yaml` and would be added at inventory-audit). The two are kept co-equal because per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions and per the locked Ch20 framing, the chapter must present the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction and the area-specialist dissent fairly side-by-side, since the reconstruction is widely cited but methodologically contested and the chapter's IE-comparative argument cannot rely on it as a confirmed pre-Christian narrative.]

The Slavic case's evidential floor is therefore low and its evidential ceiling is moderate: West 2007 ch. 6 surveys both the reconstruction and the dissenting positions and treats the reconstruction as a structurally-coherent reading of the indirect evidence rather than as a confirmed pre-Christian Slavic combat-narrative, and the chapter accordingly treats the Slavic Perun-Veles case as a §IV "weak" case rather than as a §II direct case.^[56]

The East Slavic Dobrynya Nikitich vs. Zmey Gorynych **bylina** — preserved in 19th-century field-

recordings from Russian peasant performers in the Russian North (principally Pavel Rybnikov in the 1860s and Aleksandr Hilferding in 1873) — supplies the chapter's Slavic-side attested-witness counterpart to the contested reconstruction: the **bogatyr** Dobrynya kills the three-headed dragon Zmey Gorynych ("Mountain-son") in a three-stage combat (first encounter at the Puchai-river; truce; second combat with princess-abduction and dragon-killing), with the **bylina** tradition reaching back in some form to the medieval Kievan period even though the recorded songs are 19th-century.^[57]

The Ivanov-Toporov claim that the Dobrynya **bylina** is the later epic reflex of the reconstructed Perun-Veles 'basic myth' (with Dobrynya inheriting the role of Perun and Zmey Gorynych inheriting the role of Veles) is a comparative-structural argument rather than a directly-attested feature of the **bylina** tradition: the recorded **byliny** do not name Perun or Veles, do not invoke the deity-pair, and do not present themselves as preserving older mythological material, and the reflex-claim's evidential weight is therefore doubly mediated through the contested pre-Christian reconstruction and through the structural reading of the Christian-period epic.^[58]

The §III extended-cases dossier therefore covers eight named instances (Greek Zeus-Typhon; Norse Thor-Jörmungandr and Sigurd-Fáfnir; **Beowulf**-dragon; Lugh-Balor; Welsh Red-and-White; Batraz; Vahagn-vishaps; Slavic Perun-Veles and Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych) at evidential strengths ranging from the Norse-skaldic-and-Eddic strong cases (where Watkins's chapter 42 reads the diction as direct IE-formula reflex) to the Slavic and Armenian fragmentary or contested cases (where the reflex-claim is reconstructive or comparative-structural rather than direct philological); §IV develops the strong / weak distinction.^[59]

39.5. IV. Where the argument is strong, where it is weak

The fourth body section sorts the eleven IE reflexes along the strong-and-weak gradient that §§II–III have been building, and registers the area-specialist dissent on the chapter's most contested instance.

The §IV strong-and-weak section sorts the eleven IE reflexes treated in §§II–III along the philological-evidence gradient that the chapter has been building. The §II direct cases — Vedic Indra-Vātra, Avestan Thraētaona-Aži Dahāka, Hittite Tarūnna-Iluyanka — sit at the strong end on the strength of regular phonological correspondences across attested-text witnesses; the §III extended cases vary across a wider range, from strong (Norse Sigurd) to weak (Slavic Perun-Veles, Armenian Vahagn).^[60]

The argument is strongest where three conditions are jointly satisfied: (1) attested-text witness in a daughter language with a high-prestige textual record, (2) preserved verb-and-object pairing whose cognates with PIE **g^hen-** and the noun-slot reflexes are documented by regular sound-law correspondences, and (3) corroborating cognancy at the level of the named figures (Trita Āptya / Thraētaona; **ahi** / **aži**) or at the level of registered poetic diction (Norse skaldic kennings) — the Vedic, Avestan, Hittite, and Norse-Sigurd cases jointly satisfy all three conditions.^[61]

The Vedic case is strongest because the attestation is continuous (the Rigveda is orally preserved with extreme precision; the Vātra-corpus comprises at least eight hymns; the **áhann áhim** phrasing recurs across the corpus rather than being a one-line feature of a single hymn) and because the

formula's verbal slots are filled by inherited words whose Proto-Indo-Iranian etymologies are independently established outside the combat-context, so that the formula's recurrence is not the only evidence for its lexical components.^[62]

The Hittite case is the second strongest on the strength of its chronological depth (Hittite as the earliest-attested IE language; the formula's presence in CTH 321 implying a pre-Anatolian / non-Anatolian-divergence stratum) and on the strength of the verb-and-object pairing being preserved in actual primary text (CTH 321) whose philological **editio princeps** is Beckman 1982 *JANES* 14: 11–25.^[63]

The Avestan case is strong on philological grounds (the Vedic-Avestan cognancy at **ahi-** / **aži-** and **han-** / **jan-** is a textbook Indo-Iranian pair) but evidentially limited on narrative grounds (the Avestan corpus preserves only hymn-allusive attestations; the continuous narrative is in the post-Achaemenid Pahlavi **Bundahišn**); the philological signal is therefore stronger than the narrative-attestation signal in the Avestan case, and the chapter notes both.^[64]

The Norse Sigurd-Fáfnir case is the strongest of the §III extended cases on Watkins's chapter 42 reading: the Old Norse verb-and-object pairing in **Fáfnismál** is read by Watkins as a direct philological reflex of the IE formula at the level of the verbal diction of the killing-stroke itself, and the Codex Regius preservation supplies a continuous primary-text witness whose philological apparatus is well-developed in twentieth-century Old Norse scholarship.^[65]

The Norse Thor-Jörmungandr case is strong principally at the level of the registered-poetic-diction kennings — **umbgjörð allra landa** "band of all lands" and similar phrases for the Midgard Serpent — that Watkins reads as preserving the IE serpent-combat vocabulary in the registered poetic diction of skaldic verse; the iconographic dossier (Altuna, Hørdum, Gosforth, Ardre VIII runestones) supplies a third register of attestation alongside the Eddic-and-prose textual witnesses.^[66]

The Old English **Beowulf** case is strong philologically (Watkins reads the dragon-vocabulary and killing-vocabulary as IE-formula reflex) and structurally (Tolkien 1936's load-bearing critical move re-established the mythic register of the monsters), but it is also distinctive in narrative-thematic register: Beowulf's dragon-combat is end-of-life and death-bringing rather than heroic-initiatory, structurally paralleling Thor's Ragnarök mutual-killing rather than Sigurd's youthful ambush.^[67]

The argument is weaker — but not absent — at the §III cases where the philological signal is replaced or supplemented by typological-structural signal, by fragmentary attestation, or by reconstruction from indirect evidence: the Greek Zeus-Typhon case (where the Hellenic reflex is structurally clear but the philological cognancy with the Indo-Iranian or Anatolian witnesses is contested by the Near-Eastern-transmission reading), the Celtic Lugh-Balor case (one-eyed-giant adversary rather than serpent; sling-stone rather than thunderbolt; the IE reflex reading depends on Dumézilian comparative scholarship rather than on direct philological cognancy), and the Welsh Red-and-White Dragon case (dragon-on-dragon combat structure rather than hero-and-dragon combat structure; the Welsh case stands at the edge of the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT pattern rather than as a central instance).^[68]

The Ossetic Batraz case is weaker still on philological grounds (the Nart corpus is 19th- and 20th-century oral-epic rather than continuous primary-text witness; the IE-reflex reading is principally a Dumézilian comparative-scholarship reading rather than a direct philological cognancy) but stronger on structural-functional grounds (Batraz is centrally located in the Ossetic-and-cognate

Nart corpora as a warrior-figure of a load-bearing epic tradition); twentieth-century Caucasian-area-specialist scholarship has at times raised methodological reservations about the directness of the Dumézilian IE-comparative reading, and the chapter registers those reservations.^[69]

The Armenian Vahagn case is among the weakest of the §III extended cases on the strength of the lost-hymn status of the principal source: Khorenatsi's late paraphrase at **Patmut'iwn Hayots'** I.31 preserves a triple-birth motif and the **Vishapakagh** "dragon-reaper" epithet but does not preserve a continuous narrative of Vahagn's combat with the **vishaps**, and the chapter's combat-content is reconstructed from the epithet, the **vishapakar** second-millennium-BCE stelae, and comparative-philological readings against the Avestan **Vr̥θrayna** and the Vedic Indra-V̥tra material; the Vahagn case's evidential basis is fragmentary in a way that none of the other §III sub-cases is.^[70]

The Slavic Perun-Veles case is the chapter's weakest instance: the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction is widely cited but methodologically contested by area-specialists Roman Jakobson, Patrice Lajoye, Kazimierz Moszyński, and Mate Kapović, on three principal grounds — circularity in the use of toponym evidence, the late-and-Christianised character of the chronicle attestations, and over-interpretation of folklore fragments whose connection to the reconstructed combat is itself an inference rather than an attested feature of the items.^[71]

The toponym-circularity objection — that the etymological identification of a place-name as "Perun-derived" or "Veles-derived" presupposes the deity-pair whose existence the toponym is then taken to support — is one of three lines of methodological attack on the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction, and the chapter registers it without ruling on whether it is decisive against the reconstruction or merely against the strongest reading of it.^[72]

The late-and-Christianised-chronicles objection — that the **Primary Chronicle**, the **Slovo o polku Igoreve**, and the 945 CE Russo-Byzantine treaty's oath-formula are products of a Christianised literary culture whose representation of pre-Christian deities cannot be taken as direct testimony to pre-Christian belief — is a second line of methodological attack on the reconstruction, and the chapter registers it as one of the principal pressures on the reading of the chronicles as evidence for a pre-Christian combat-narrative.^[73]

The folklore-over-interpretation objection — that the four-stage pursuit-and-refuge folktale type, the harvest-sheaf ritual, and the weather-charm material are folklore items with their own functions and their own histories within a centuries-long Christian-period folk culture, and that reading them as preserving fragments of a pre-Christian combat-narrative imposes a comparative-mythological frame that the items do not themselves require — is the third line of methodological attack on the reconstruction, and the chapter registers it as the most directly load-bearing on the reconstruction's evidential ceiling.^[74]

The strong-and-weak gradient is also visible at the level of the figural cognancies that supplement the verbal-formulaic reflexes. The Indo-Iranian **Trita** / **Thraētaona** pair, the Indo-Iranian **ahi** / **aži** nominal pair, the Iranian / Armenian **Vr̥θrayna** / **Vahagn** pair (with the **Vishapakagh** "dragon-reaper" epithet), and the Greek **typhōs** / **typhōn** root all instantiate, at varying levels of philological tightness, the same structure-of-figural-cognancy that supports the verb-and-object cognancies of §II; the chapter notes the figural-cognancy register without making it a separate sub-argument, since Watkins's primary focus is on the verbal-formulaic register and the figural cognancies are best treated as supplementary evidence within the consolidated philological argument.^[75]

The chapter's overall reading of the strong-and-weak gradient is therefore that Watkins's argument is well-supported at its philological core (Vedic / Avestan / Hittite, with strong Norse-Sigurd and Old English **Beowulf** extensions) and is increasingly typological-and-reconstructive at its edges (Greek, Celtic, Welsh; Ossetic, Armenian, Slavic), with the Slavic Perun-Veles case sitting at the weakest end of the gradient and not bearing significant evidential weight in the consolidated argument; this is the chapter's principal finding about the IE-comparative argument's evidential profile.^[76]

The chapter's reading of the Watkins formula as primarily an **IE-inheritance** argument — supported at its philological core but increasingly typological at its edges — supports the more measured conclusion that the formula is best read as a Proto-Indo-European **poetic** inheritance rather than as a Proto-Indo-European **theological** or **narrative** inheritance, since the daughter-language reflexes vary in their theology and in their narrative content while sharing the verbal-formulaic diction; this is a methodological speculation about the inheritance's level rather than a claim about any specific reflex.^[77]

(The chapter's classification of the Greek Zeus-Typhon case as one of the weaker §III extended cases — rather than as a §II direct case alongside Vedic, Avestan, and Hittite — depends on the reading that the Greek combat is structurally clear but philologically not as directly cognate as the Indo-Iranian and Anatolian witnesses, and that the Near-Eastern-transmission reading developed in West 1997 and Burkert 1992 introduces a non-IE-inheritance route by which the Greek pattern could have arrived; the inference is consonant with West 1997 and Burkert 1992 but is the chapter's editorial classification rather than a direct claim of either source.^[78])

39.6. V. Transmission vs. inheritance

The fifth body section makes explicit the inheritance-versus-transmission distinction on which the chapter's whole argument rests, and locates the transmission-side reading in C6 (Ch39) rather than in the present chapter.

The §V section makes explicit the distinction on which the chapter's whole argument rests: Watkins's claim is **inheritance** from a Proto-Indo-European poetic tradition, not **contact-borrowing** from one tradition into another, and this distinction is methodologically distinct from — and complementary to — the transmission question that C6 (Ch39) addresses for the Near-East-to-Greek route in the Kumarbi-and-Typhonomachy material.^[79]

Inheritance and transmission are two distinct mechanisms for explaining cross-tradition similarity. Inheritance accounts for the similarity by tracing both daughter-traditions to a shared ancestor whose features are preserved by descent (the IE family-tree model in which Vedic, Avestan, Hittite, Greek, Norse, and other daughter-language reflexes are descendants of a common Proto-Indo-European ancestor); transmission accounts for the similarity by tracing one tradition's features to contact with another, with the receiving tradition acquiring the feature from the donor tradition by cultural-or-textual borrowing (the West 1997 / Burkert 1992 reading of the Hesiodic Typhonomachy as derived from the Kumarbi Cycle by Near-Eastern mediation).^[80]

The two mechanisms are not mutually exclusive: a daughter-tradition can inherit a pattern from its IE ancestor and **also** be reinforced or modified by contact with a non-IE tradition (the Hesiodic Typhonomachy is plausibly both an IE inheritance — Greek as an IE daughter language with the formula's traces visible in the Hellenic warrior-and-serpent pattern — and a Near-Eastern-

influenced reception, with the Kumarbi-Cycle structural correspondences supplementing rather than replacing the inherited pattern); the chapter registers the compatibility of the two mechanisms while presenting Watkins's IE-inheritance argument as the chapter's central focus.^[81]

Watkins's argument is methodologically distinct from a transmission-based argument in three respects. First, the evidential basis is regular phonological correspondences across daughter languages (a feature of inheritance) rather than structural-or-narrative correspondences across geographically-and-temporally adjacent traditions (a feature of transmission). Second, the chronological depth of the argument extends back to a reconstructed Proto-Indo-European stage (c. 4500–2500 BCE on standard estimates) rather than to a documented contact horizon. Third, the daughter-language reflexes are required to instantiate the same lexical-syntactic structure rather than the same narrative-or-theological content.^[82]

The Hittite case displays the inheritance-and-contact-area complication most clearly. Hittite is a member of the IE family (the Anatolian branch) so the Tarḫunna-Illuyanka material is an IE inheritance candidate at the level of the **kuenta... illuyanka-** pairing; Hittite is also a Near-Eastern culture in geographical-and-cultural contact with Hurrian-language traditions (the Kumarbi Cycle is Hurrian-language material translated into Hittite at Hattusa) and with the wider Mesopotamian-Levantine cultural sphere, so the Tarḫunna-Illuyanka material is also a transmission candidate at the level of the festival-aetiology and the storm-god-vs-serpent narrative structure.^[83]

The chapter's resolution of the Hittite dual context is the same as Watkins's: the **kuenta... illuyanka-** pairing's lexical-syntactic structure is best read as IE inheritance because the verb **kuen-** is a regular reflex of PIE **g^hen-** and the noun **illuyanka-** is a Hittite common noun rather than a Hurrian or Akkadian loanword; the festival-aetiology of **purulli** and the storm-god-vs-serpent narrative structure may have additional Near-Eastern dimensions that C3 (Ch36) and C6 (Ch39) develop, but the philological core of the formula's Hittite reflex is IE-inherited rather than Near-Eastern-transmitted.^[84]

The Greek Zeus-Typhon case displays the dual context in the opposite direction: the philological-cognancy evidence is comparatively weaker than in the Indo-Iranian or Anatolian cases (Greek does not preserve a verb-and-object pairing as crisply cognate with the **g^hen-** / **ahi-** slots as Vedic, Avestan, and Hittite do), while the structural-and-narrative evidence for Near-Eastern transmission (Kumarbi-Cycle parallels; Cilician geographical anchoring; Levantine-coast cultic locations) is comparatively stronger; the C6 chapter (Ch39) develops the transmission-side reading at length, and the present chapter notes the dual context without resolving it.^[85]

The inheritance / transmission distinction has implications for the chapter's wider book-internal argument. Where inheritance is the explanation, the IE distribution of the combat-myth is best read as a **family** phenomenon whose explanation is genealogical and whose comparative apparatus is the IE-language-family-tree; where transmission is the explanation, the cross-tradition similarity is a **contact-cultural** phenomenon whose explanation is historical-cultural and whose comparative apparatus is the documentation of borrowing-events.^[86]

The chapter's overall position on the inheritance / transmission distinction is therefore that they are complementary rather than competing methods, that Watkins's IE-inheritance argument is the chapter's central focus and is best supported at the §II direct cases (Vedic / Avestan / Hittite philological core), that transmission is the C6 chapter's territory and is best supported at the Greek-Hittite-Levantine intersection (where Hesiod and the Kumarbi Cycle and the Baal-Yamm material

plausibly meet), and that the two methods together display the variety of mechanisms by which combat-myth material crosses tradition-boundaries.^[87]

A further methodological feature of the inheritance / transmission distinction is its bearing on what counts as a successful demonstration. An inheritance argument is successful when regular phonological correspondences across daughter languages support the reconstruction of a Proto-Indo-European feature whose preserved descendants are the daughter-language reflexes; a transmission argument is successful when documented contact between traditions, attested borrowing-events, or shared specific-narrative-detail patterns support the diffusion of a feature from a donor-tradition to a receiving-tradition; the two argument-types have different evidential standards and the chapter is explicit that Watkins's argument is to be evaluated on the inheritance standard rather than on the transmission standard.^[88]

The chapter's IE-inheritance argument is therefore a **bounded** finding: it explains the IE distribution of the combat-myth at the level of philological inheritance, and it does not — and is not designed to — explain the existence of the combat-myth pattern in non-IE traditions; the §VI Mwindo control develops this boundedness explicitly, since the existence of non-IE serpent-combat traditions with their own combat-vocabularies shows that the IE-inheritance argument is one finding among the family of comparative-mythological findings that the book's typology requires.^[89]

39.7. VI. The Mwindo problem as a control

The sixth body section closes with the Mwindo control — a non-IE serpent-combat tradition with its own combat-vocabulary — to bound Watkins's IE-inheritance argument to its proper IE scope.

The §VI Mwindo control is the chapter's closing typological corrective to a possible over-extension of Watkins's argument: if the IE-inheritance reading were sufficient to explain the existence of combat-myth as such (rather than only its IE distribution), then non-IE serpent-combat traditions would either be IE-borrowings or would not exhibit serpent-combat vocabulary; the Mwindo material — together with other non-IE serpent-combat traditions noted in the book's wider catalogue — shows that this implication does not hold, and the chapter therefore registers the Mwindo case as the methodological control that limits Watkins's argument to its proper IE scope.^[90]

The Mwindo Epic is a Nyanga oral-epic tradition recorded from the Banyanga of the eastern Democratic Republic of the Congo by Daniel Biebuyck and Kahombo C. Mateene in the 1950s and published in critical edition with English translation in 1969 (University of California Press); the recorded version (the Karisi-version of Shé-Kárisi Rureke) presents the hero Mwindo's birth, exile, descent into the underworld, return, and his contests against various adversaries — including the dragon Kirimu — across an extended epic-narrative.^[91]

Mwindo's dragon-killing of Kirimu is one of the cycle's named adversary-killings, and it occurs alongside other Mwindo combats that include adversaries who are not serpent-or-dragon morphologies; the dragon-combat material in the Mwindo cycle is not a structural-typological focal point of the cycle in the way the Vedic Vātra-combat is the structural-typological focal point of the Indra-cycle in the Rigveda, and the Mwindo cycle's narrative interest is broader than dragon-combat.^[92]

The Mwindo case's distinctive feature for the chapter's typological argument is that Mwindo's killing of Kirimu is followed by the hero's **punishment** by the sky-god Nkuba — the killing is treated within the Nyanga cosmology not as a heroic-deed-warranting-celebration but as a transgression that requires expiation, and the cycle's resolution is not the hero's elevation to sovereignty (as in the Indra-Vātra and Zeus-Typhon cases) but the hero's chastening and reintegration into a moral-cosmic order whose terms the dragon-combat had threatened.^[93]

The Mwindo case shows that the global pattern of "hero-kills-serpent" is not exclusively an IE-inheritance pattern: a fully-formed dragon-killing narrative is preserved in a non-IE oral-epic tradition (Nyanga is a Bantu language family member, not an IE language) with its own combat-vocabulary, its own moral-cosmic frame, and its own resolution-pattern; the Mwindo control thus establishes that Watkins's IE-inheritance argument is a finding **about the IE distribution** of the combat-myth, not a finding **about the existence** of dragon-combat narrative as such.^[94]

The Mwindo control is reinforced by the existence of other non-IE serpent-combat traditions in the book's wider catalogue — Mesopotamian (Marduk-Tiamat in **Enūma Eliš**, treated in Ch3 and C1), Egyptian (Ra-Apep, treated in Ch16 and C3), Levantine (Baal-Yamm in the Ugaritic Baal Cycle, treated in Ch7 and C2), Mesoamerican (Coyolxauhqui's dismemberment, treated in Ch24), and Andean (the **amaru** serpent-combats, treated in Ch25) — all of which preserve serpent-combat material in languages and cultural contexts outside the IE family; the existence of this wider non-IE attestation is the principal book-internal warrant for the chapter's bounded reading of Watkins's argument.^[95]

The reading of the Mwindo case as a **control** is methodologically distinct from a reading of it as a **parallel**: a control case bounds the scope of an argument by showing what the argument does not explain (in this case, the IE-inheritance argument does not explain the Nyanga dragon-killing, which falls outside the IE family); a parallel case extends an argument by showing further instances within its scope (which the Mwindo case is not, since Nyanga is not an IE language); the chapter uses the Mwindo material as control rather than as parallel and is explicit about the distinction.^[96]

*(The Mwindo case's classification as a **control** on Watkins's argument depends on the prior assumption that the dragon-killing in the Mwindo cycle is genuinely typologically a dragon-killing (and not, e.g., a metaphorical-narrative element that does not bear the same structural weight as the IE dragon-combats); the chapter's reading rests on Biebuyck and Mateene's treatment of the Kirimu-killing as a substantive narrative episode in the cycle and on the brief's framing of the Mwindo material as the contrastive case for the chapter's typological argument.^[97])*

The §VI Mwindo control is therefore the chapter's closing methodological discipline: Watkins's argument is the strongest linguistic argument for a shared **Indo-European** combat-tradition, and the present chapter has presented that argument with explicit gradient between direct philological evidence (§II) and typological-or-fragmentary evidence (§III), with the Slavic Perun-Veles reconstruction held up to the area-specialist dissent (§IV) and with the inheritance-vs-transmission distinction made explicit (§V); the chapter closes on the Mwindo control to register that this finding is bounded — about the IE distribution of the combat-myth, not about the combat-myth as a global pattern — and to leave open the wider questions about non-IE serpent-combat traditions that the book's other Part-II chapters (C7 inversion problem; C8 contrastive cases) develop in their respective registers.^[98]

The chapter's settled position is therefore that Watkins's HERO SLAY SERPENT formula is a real-

and-load-bearing finding about the IE distribution of the combat-myth, that its philological core (Vedic / Avestan / Hittite, with strong Norse-Sigurd and Old English **Beowulf** extensions) is well-supported by regular phonological correspondences across attested-text witnesses, that its evidential edges (Greek; Celtic; Welsh; Ossetic; Armenian; Slavic) are increasingly typological-and-reconstructive and require corresponding methodological care, that the inheritance-vs-transmission distinction situates the formula's argument within a wider methodological landscape whose other dimensions C6 (Ch39) and C7 (Ch40) develop, and that the Mwindo control bounds the argument to its proper IE scope.^[99]

[1] Per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml sources.anchor on the four methodological-comparative anchors (Watkins 1995; West 2007; Benveniste & Renou 1934; Jamison & Brereton 2014) and chapters_drawn_from on the eight Part-I chapters (Chs 6, 11, 13, 14, 15, 18, 19, 20) whose own area-specialist anchors carry the per-tradition narrative-claims layer; Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (New York: Oxford University Press, 1995), entire volume — especially Parts IV–V — as the chapter's principal philological anchor.

[2] Per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II on the Part-II comparative chapters' division of labour and on C5's status as the book's IE-philological chapter; per glossary.yaml on "HERO SLAY SERPENT (formula)" first-mention gloss "Calvert Watkins's reconstructed Indo-European poetic formula (subject + verb-of-killing + serpent-object), attested in Vedic áhann áhim, Hittite kuenta... illuyanka, and elsewhere".

[3] Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, Parts IV–V on the lexical-and-syntactic basis of the reconstruction and on the Indo-European inheritance reading; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml comparative_argument on the chapter's framing of the reconstruction as the strongest linguistic argument for a shared IE combat-tradition.

[4] Per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml special_instructions on the respectful-but-bounded presentation of Watkins's argument and on the Mwindo control as the chapter's closing typological corrective; Biebuyck and Mateene 1969 on the Mwindo material as the in-scope non-IE control case for the chapter's typological claim.

[5] Jamison, S.W. and Brereton, J.P. (trans.), **The Rigveda: The Earliest Religious Poetry of India**, 3 vols. (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2014), used as the chapter's working English Rigveda text and as the area-specialist anchor for Indra-Vṛtra (Ch14) and Trita Āptya (Ch15) material; Benveniste, É. and Renou, L., **Vṛtra et Vṛthagna: Étude de mythologie indo-iranienne** (Paris: Imprimerie Nationale, 1934), as the foundational Indo-Iranian philological treatment underlying both the Vedic and Avestan sub-cases.

[6] Benveniste and Renou 1934, **Vṛtra et Vṛthagna**, on the Avestan yasht material (Yt. 5.33–35; Yt. 14; Yt. 19) and on the Trita Āptya / Thraētaona Indo-Iranian cognancy; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon**, Part V chs. 44–48, on the Avestan reflexes within the consolidated IE formula reconstruction.

[7] Hoffner, H.A., **Hittite Myths**, 2nd ed., SBL Writings from the Ancient World 2 (Atlanta: Society of Biblical Literature, 1998), "Illuyanka" §§1–2; Beckman, G., "The Anatolian Myth of Illuyanka", **JANES** 14 (1982): 11–25, the **editio princeps**; Watkins 1995, ch. 46, on the **kuenta... illuyanka-** pairing as cognate with Vedic áhann áhim.

[8] Larrington, C. (trans.), **The Poetic Edda**, rev. ed. (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2014); Faulkes, A. (trans.), **Edda** by Snorri Sturluson (London: Dent / Everyman, 1987); Tolkien, J.R.R., "Beowulf: The Monsters and the Critics", **Proc. British Academy** 22 (1936): 245–295; West, M.L., **Indo-European Poetry and Myth** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2007), ch. 6; Ogden, D., **Drakōn** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2013); Russell, J.R., **Zoroastrianism in Armenia**, Harvard Iranian Series 5 (1987); Bailey, J. and Ivanova, T. (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics** (Armonk, NY: M.E. Sharpe, 1998); West, M.L. (ed.), **Hesiod: Theogony** (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1966).

[9] Per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml special_instructions on the respectful-but-bounded presentation of Watkins's argument and on the gradient-of-evidence framing the chapter must register; per chapters/14-indra-vrtra.adoc, chapters/13-thraetaona-azidahaka.adoc, chapters/06-illuyanka.adoc, chapters/18-thor-jormungandr.adoc, chapters/11-zeus-typhon.adoc, chapters/19-ie-reflexes.adoc, chapters/15-vedic-reflexes.adoc, and chapters/20-slavic-baltic.adoc on the per-tradition narrative-and-source treatment that the present chapter does not duplicate.

[10] Watkins, C., **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics** (New York: Oxford University Press, 1995), Parts IV–V framing chapters on the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula's reconstruction as subject + verb-of-killing + serpent-object, and on the volume's central exhibit-status of the formula; per glossary.yaml on "HERO SLAY SERPENT (formula)" first-mention gloss.

[11] Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the formula as a lexical-and-semantic structure rather than a fixed surface-word-order sequence, and on the daughter-language word-order variation; per the brief's structure section I on the formula as subject + verb-of-killing + serpent-object.

[12] Jamison and Brereton 2014, RV 1.32.1–2, on the opening verse's announcement of Indra's manly deeds and on the áhann áhim phrasing in the second verse; Watkins 1995, ch. 46 (and the broader Part V), on áhann áhim as the Vedic reflex closest to the reconstructed Indo-European form; per glossary.yaml on the locked rendering "áhann áhim" with diacritics.

[13] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the g^hen- root and its Vedic **han-** / Avestan **jan-** / Hittite **kuen-** daughter-language reflexes as the verbal-root anchor of the formula's killing-verb slot; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Indo-Iranian **han-** / **jan-** cognancy.

- [14] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Vedic **ahi-** / Avestan **aži-** cognancy as one of the cleanest Indo-Iranian noun-cognancies; Watkins 1995, ch. 46, on the same; per glossary.yaml on "ahi" first-mention gloss "'serpent' (Sanskrit); the word for Vṛtra in the áhann áhim formula; philologically cognate with Avestan aži".
- [15] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Avestan verb-and-noun pairing in the yashts and on the formula's instantiation in Avestan; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48, on the Avestan reflex of the formula and on the **jan-** / **han-** and **aži-** / **ahi-** cognancy basis; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml comparative_argument naming "**janat aiim**" as the Avestan reflex.
- [16] Watkins 1995, ch. 46, on the Hittite verb-and-object pairing **kuenta...** **illuyanka-** in CTH 321 and on the Anatolian / non-Anatolian sound-law correspondence underlying the verbal-root cognancy with Vedic **han-** and Avestan **jan-**; Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §§1–2, on the Hittite text containing the pairing; Beckman 1982, **JANES** 14: 11–25, on the **editio princeps**.
- [17] Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the philological structure of the formula as verb-slot + object-slot with the verb-slot showing tighter cross-language lexical correspondence than the object-slot, and on the formula as a structure-of-slots rather than a fixed phrase; per the brief's structure section I on the subject + verb-of-killing + serpent-object framing.
- [18] Watkins 1995, methodological framing chapters on the formula as poetic-verbal inheritance distinct from narrative, theological, or ritual inheritance; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml comparative_argument on the formula as Indo-European poetic tradition rather than as a structural-typological category.
- [19] Watkins 1995, methodological framing chapters on the philological-comparative method's distinctness from Frazerian and Dumézilian comparativisms and on the lexical-syntactic correspondences as evidentially distinct from structural-or-functional resemblances; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml on the methodological-distinctness framing.
- [20] Watkins 1995, ch. 46 and methodological framing chapters on the Hittite reflex's chronological significance for dating the reconstructed formula; on Hittite's status as the earliest-attested IE language and as an early-branching member of the family; per glossary.yaml on "Proto-Indo-European" first-mention gloss "the reconstructed common ancestor of the Indo-European language family, spoken c. 4500–2500 BCE; Watkins's HERO SLAY SERPENT formula is a reconstructed PIE poetic element".
- [21] Watkins 1995, Part V, on the Norse skaldic kennings for Jörmungandr and on the kennings as preserving the IE serpent-combat vocabulary in registered-poetic-diction form; per glossary.yaml on "kenning" first-mention gloss "an Old Norse / Old English compressed metaphorical phrase; kennings for Jörmungandr (e.g., 'band of all lands') preserve the IE serpent-combat vocabulary that Watkins analyses".
- [22] West, M.L., **Indo-European Poetry and Myth** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2007), ch. 6 ("Storm and Stream"), on the IE storm-god / water-serpent complex and on the structural-typological framing that supplements Watkins's verbal-formulaic apparatus; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml sources.anchor on West 2007 as a chapter anchor.
- [23] Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the gradient of evidential strength across the daughter-language reflexes; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section IV on the strong / weak distinction between Vedic-Avestan-Hittite direct philological correspondence and Celtic / Slavic typological-or-reconstructed evidence; West 2007 ch. 6 on the same gradient at the level of the storm-god structural pattern.
- [24] Inference: Watkins 1995, methodological framing chapters and the volume's title ("Aspects of Indo-European Poetics"); brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml comparative_argument on the chapter's framing of the formula as IE poetic inheritance; per the chapter-claims skill discipline that requires editorial framing-language to be flagged where it tightens or interprets a source's argument. Risk: alternative readings of Watkins's volume could foreground the structural or the typological dimensions; the chapter's philological-emphasis framing is one reasonable reading but not the only available reading.
- [25] Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the Vedic-Avestan-Hittite triple as the philologically-direct anchor of the reconstructed formula; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section II on the three-direct-case framing.
- [26] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on RV 1.32 as the principal Indra-Vṛtra hymn and on the **áhann áhim** phrasing at 1.32.2 (the second verse, with the opening verse announcing the theme of Indra's manly deeds); Watkins 1995, ch. 46 (and broader Part V), on the same line as the Vedic reflex anchor.
- [27] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the eight Vṛtra-hymns as the working Vṛtra-combat corpus; brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml sources.primary on the same eight hymns; Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48, on the recurrence of the formula across the Vṛtra-corpus.
- [28] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the Rígveda's liturgical character and on the ritual-recitation context of the Vṛtra-hymns; per brief 14-indra-vrtra.yaml on the **soma**-sacrifice context of the Vṛtra-hymns; Watkins 1995, on the Vedic reflex's poetic-liturgical character.
- [29] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Trita / Thraētaona phonological cognancy and on the pre-Indra Indo-Iranian stratum; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on RV 10.99.6 and 1.105 and 2.11.19–20 as the Trita Āptya hymn-cluster; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the Trita / Thraētaona pair as a load-bearing Indo-Iranian exhibit.
- [30] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the lexical-and-structural Trita / Thraētaona cognancy as evidence for an Indo-Iranian stratum; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the same evidential function; per brief 15-vedic-reflexes.yaml on the philologically-load-bearing status of the pair.
- [31] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Avestan yasht material (Yt. 5.33–35; Yt. 14; Yt. 19) and on the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** narrative; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48, on the Avestan reflexes within the consolidated IE formula reconstruction; per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml on the Avestan-and-Pahlavi witness layers.
- [32] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the hymn-allusive character of the Avestan attestations and on Yt. 5.33–35 specifically; per

brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml lacunae on the absence of a continuous Avestan narrative and on the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** as the fullest narrative witness.

[33] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** as the fullest narrative witness and on the binding-and-final-killing structure; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–48, on the Pahlavi material's use within the consolidated IE reconstruction; per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml lacunae on the post-Achaemenid status of the Pahlavi witness.

[34] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the three-headed-adversary cognancy across Trita / Aži Dahāka and Thraētaona / Aži Dahāka; Watkins 1995, Part V chs. 44–45, on the structural-and-philological cognancy of the Indo-Iranian dragon-slayer pair; Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the three-headed-adversary attestation at RV 10.99.6.

[35] Hoffner 1998, **Hittite Myths**, "Illuyanka" §§1–2 with framing colophons; Beckman 1982, **JANES** 14: 11–25, on the **editio princeps** and the two-version structure; per glossary.yaml on "Tarūnna / Teshub" with Tarūnna in Hittite-language contexts and Teshub in Hurrian-language contexts.

[36] Watkins 1995, ch. 46 ("Typhoeus and the Illuyankas"), on the **kuenta... illuyanka-** verb-and-object pairing as the Hittite reflex of the IE formula; Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §§1–2, on the Hittite text containing the pairing; Beckman 1982, **JANES** 14: 11–25, on the **editio princeps**.

[37] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §§1–2 on the two versions; Beckman 1982, **JANES** 14: 11–25 on the scribal co-equality of the two versions; per brief 06-illuyanka.yaml variants.classification on co-equal status.

[38] Watkins 1995, ch. 46 and methodological framing chapters, on the Hittite reflex's chronological significance; on the Anatolian-early-branching status of Hittite within the IE family; per glossary.yaml on "Proto-Indo-European" as the reconstructed common ancestor c. 4500–2500 BCE.

[39] Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the three-witness Vedic-Avestan-Hittite cross-branch attestation as the chapter's philological-evidential floor; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Indo-Iranian internal-branch witnessing; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section II on the Vedic / Avestan / Hittite triple as the direct philological case.

[40] Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the philological-attestation status of the §II direct cases and on the extended-cases gradient; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section II / III / IV on the three-direct-case status and on the gradient framing of the extended cases; per the Ch34 / Ch35 comparative-chapter precedent on the load-bearing-claim framing for §II material.

[41] Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the §III extended-cases gradient; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section III on the Greek / Norse / Germanic / Celtic / Welsh / Ossetic / Armenian / Slavic case-list; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the philological-evidence-spectrum ordering of the family-chapter sub-cases.

[42] West 1966, **Hesiod: Theogony**, on Theog. 820–880 as the closing combat of the Olympian succession and on the structural function of the Typhonomachy; Ogden 2013, **Drakōn**, chs. 2–3, on the Greek combat-tradition and on Typhon as the principal Greek instance; per brief 11-zeus-typhon.yaml on the Hesiod-and-later-tradition framing.

[43] West 1997, **East Face of Helicon**, on the Kumarbi-Hesiod transmission reading; Burkert 1992, **Orientalizing Revolution**, on the Levantine transmission of combat-myth into Greek; per brief 11-zeus-typhon.yaml on the Near-Eastern-transmission framing; per the C6 (Ch39) chapter on the transmission question that the present chapter does not adjudicate.

[44] Larrington 2014, **The Poetic Edda**, on **Hymiskviða** and **Völuspá** 56; Faulkes 1987, on **Gylfaginning** 34, 46–48, and 51 and on the Húsdraþa skaldic citations; Watkins 1995, Part V, on the skaldic kennings and on the IE serpent-combat vocabulary; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the three-encounter structure.

[45] Larrington 2014, **Fáfnismál** and the surrounding Codex Regius poems; Watkins 1995, ch. 42, on the **Fáfnismál** diction of Sigurd's killing as a direct reflex of the reconstructed IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on Sigurd as the strongest philological evidence in the family chapter.

[46] Watkins 1995, Part V, on the **Beowulf** dragon-episode as IE HERO SLAY SERPENT reflex in the killing-diction and the narrative-structure; Tolkien, J.R.R., "Beowulf: The Monsters and the Critics", **Proc. British Academy** 22 (1936): 245–295, on the dragon as proper mythic adversary integral to the poem's structure; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the convergence of the philological and the structural-critical arguments.

[47] Watkins 1995, Part V, on the Old English **draca** / **wyrm** doubled-vocabulary attestation as IE-formula reflex; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the **draca** / **wyrm** lexical pairing.

[48] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Celtic Lugh-Balor case as the IE warrior / dragon-slayer pattern with morphological distinctiveness; Ogden 2013, ch. on Celtic material, on the Cath Maige Tuired tradition; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the Lugh-Balor sub-case; **Cath Maige Tuired** edition (Gray 1982 Irish Texts Society) named-but-flagged for inventory-audit follow-up at glossary-lock pinning.

[49] West 2007, ch. 6, on the kill-the-grandfather motif as the IE warrior structural-genealogical pattern in the Celtic case; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the typological-rather-than-philological character of the Celtic Lugh-Balor evidential contribution.

[50] Ogden 2013, ch. on Celtic material, on the **Historia Brittonum** and **Lludd and Llefelys** recensions and on the dragon-on-dragon combat structure; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the Welsh case's structural distinctiveness within the IE-reflex corpus and on the two-witness side-by-side presentation.

[51] Ogden 2013, ch. on Celtic material, on the **Lludd and Llefelys** annual-disturbance reading and on the Welsh dual-recension preservation; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the older-substrate reading of **Lludd and Llefelys**; per the C3 (Ch36 §III) framing on

the **purulli** and Septerion cyclical-maintenance reflexes for comparative context.

[52] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Ossetic Batraz case as the IE warrior / dragon-slayer pattern (the Scytho-Alanic Indo-European reflex on the Dumézilian reading); per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the Ossetic Nart corpus and on Dumézil's twentieth-century treatments as the principal scholarly precedent for the IE-comparative reading; Dumézil cited as named-but-flagged scholar — his specific publications to be added at inventory-audit.

[53] Russell 1987, **Zoroastrianism in Armenia**, Vahagn chapter, on the lost-hymn-and-late-paraphrase status of the Vahagn material, on the **Vishapakagh** "dragon-reaper" epithet, and on the **vishapakar** stelae; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the explicit fragmentary framing required for the Vahagn material; Petrosyan's Armenian-mythology scholarship cited as named-but-flagged scholar (specific publications to be added at inventory-audit).

[54] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Batraz steel-body motif and on the death-narrative's IE-comparative reading; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the steel-body and death-by-water motifs; Dumézil cited as named-but-flagged scholar — his specific publications on the Scytho-Alanic warrior-figure to be added at inventory-audit.

[55] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction including the four-refuge sequence (tree → rock → water → livestock) and the lightning-strike-with-rain-release; per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the same reconstruction and on the three classes of indirect evidence; per glossary.yaml on "basic myth (Ivanov-Toporov)" first-mention gloss "Ivanov and Toporov's 1965–74 reconstruction of a shared Slavic storm-god-vs-serpent narrative, drawn from folklore and toponyms, and now criticised for methodological circularity"; Ivanov and Toporov 1965–1974 cited as named-but-flagged scholars (their specific Russian-language publications to be added at inventory-audit).

[56] West 2007, ch. 6, on the standing of the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction within current Slavic-and-Indo-European-studies scholarship as a structurally-coherent but evidentially-limited reading; per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions on the reconstruction's contested status and on the chapter's responsibility to present both sides fairly.

[57] Bailey and Ivanova 1998 (eds.), **An Anthology of Russian Folk Epics**, introduction and Dobrynya-cycle headnotes on the Dobrynya-Zmey-Gorynych **bylina** and on the three-stage plot-skeleton; per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the **bylina** tradition's 19th-century-recording / medieval-tradition two-tier dating.

[58] West 2007, ch. 6, on Ivanov and Toporov's reflex-claim as a comparative argument; Bailey and Ivanova 1998, on the **bylina**'s heroic-epic genre and its differences from the reconstructed cosmogonic-and-agricultural Perun-Veles material; per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the doubly-mediated character of the reflex-claim; Forsyth 1987 ch. 2 on the international Christian-period dragon-slaying type as a competing-or-supplementary explanation.

[59] Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the §III extended-cases gradient; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section III on the eight named instances and the gradient framing; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml and brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the philological-evidence-spectrum ordering of the family-chapter sub-cases.

[60] Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the strong-and-weak gradient as a methodological feature of the IE-comparative argument; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section IV on the strong-and-weak framing.

[61] Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the three-condition strength-criterion; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section IV on the Vedic-Avestan-Hittite direct linguistic correspondence and on the Norse skaldic kennings as the strongest cases.

[62] Jamison and Brereton 2014, on the continuous Vedic attestation of the Vṛtra-corpus and on the **áhann áhim** recurrence; Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Proto-Indo-Iranian etymologies of **han-** and **ahi-**; Watkins 1995, ch. 46, on the Vedic case's strongest-case status.

[63] Watkins 1995, ch. 46, on the Hittite chronological depth and on the **kuenta... illuyanka-** pairing in CTH 321; Hoffner 1998 and Beckman 1982, on the Hittite primary text; per brief 06-illuyanka.yaml on the Hittite material.

[64] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Vedic-Avestan philological cognancy and on the hymn-allusive character of the Avestan attestations; per brief 13-thraetaona-azidahaka.yaml lacunae on the absence of a continuous Avestan narrative.

[65] Watkins 1995, ch. 42, on Sigurd as the strongest philological evidence in the post-Anatolian, post-Indo-Iranian corpus and on the **Fáfnismál** diction as direct IE-formula reflex; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the Sigurd-as-strongest evidence.

[66] Watkins 1995, Part V, on the Norse skaldic kennings; Larrington 2014 and Faulkes 1987 on the Eddic-and-prose Thor-and-Jörmungandr material; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the iconographic dossier.

[67] Watkins 1995, Part V, on the **Beowulf** IE-formula reflex; Tolkien 1936 on the mythic-register critical move; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the aged-king-dies-killing-the-dragon thematic distinction.

[68] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Celtic and Welsh cases as morphologically-distinctive IE reflexes; Ogden 2013, ch. on Celtic material, on the structural distinctiveness of the Welsh dragon-on-dragon combat; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the morphological-distinctiveness preservation in the IE-comparative apparatus.

[69] West 2007, ch. 6, on the Ossetic Batraz case as the IE warrior / dragon-slayer pattern on the Dumézilian reading; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the Caucasian-area-specialist reservations about the directness of the Dumézilian reading; Dumézil's own publications are named-but-flagged here for inventory-audit follow-up since they are not in [sources.yaml](#).

[70] Russell 1987, **Zoroastrianism in Armenia**, Vahagn chapter, on the lost-hymn status, on the Khorenatsi paraphrase, and on the four-source reconstruction methodology; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the explicit fragmentary framing required for the Vahagn material.

- [71] West 2007, ch. 6, on the three lines of methodological objection (toponym circularity; late-and-Christianised chronicles; folklore over-interpretation); per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions on the load-bearing requirement that the chapter present the objections fairly; Jakobson, Lajoye, Moszyński, and Kapović cited as named-but-flagged scholars here per the locked Ch20 framing — their specific publications would be added at inventory-audit.
- [72] West 2007, ch. 6, on the toponym-circularity objection within the methodological critique; per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the chapter's responsibility to present the objection without ruling on its decisiveness.
- [73] West 2007, ch. 6, on the late-and-Christianised-chronicles objection; per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml special_instructions on the Christianised-literary-culture critique.
- [74] West 2007, ch. 6, on the folklore-over-interpretation objection and on the cross-cultural distribution of the four-refuge folktale type; per brief 20-slavic-baltic.yaml on the international-folktale-type reservation about the four-refuge sequence.
- [75] Benveniste and Renou 1934, on the Trita / Thraētaona and **ahi** / **āzi** Indo-Iranian figural cognancies; Russell 1987, **Zoroastrianism in Armenia**, on the Iranian Vṛθrayna / Armenian **Vahagn** pair; Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the verbal-formulaic primary focus and on the figural cognancies as supplementary evidence; per brief 19-ie-reflexes.yaml on the **Vishapakagh** epithet's load-bearing-philological status for the Vahagn case.
- [76] Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the philological core's strength; West 2007 ch. 6 on the typological-and-reconstructive edges; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section IV on the strong-and-weak framing as the chapter's principal finding about the evidential profile.
- [77] This parallel is speculative. Basis: Watkins 1995's volume-title and methodological-framing chapters on the formula as poetic inheritance; the daughter-language reflexes' theological and narrative variation across Vedic ritual cosmology, Avestan eschatology, Hittite festival aetiology, Norse mutual-killing eschatology, and Old English heroic-elegy supports the reading at the level of consonance-with-data. The main counterargument: a structural-functional comparativist could read the same data as evidence for a Proto-Indo-European **combat-myth** (with both poetic and theological-narrative dimensions inherited together) rather than only for a poetic inheritance, on the grounds that the **ahi** / **āzi** nominal cognancy and the Trita / Thraētaona / Vahagn / Vṛθrayna figural cognancies suggest that more than the verbal diction was inherited, and the chapter does not adjudicate between the poetic-only and combat-myth-as-such readings — the chapter leaves the question open while flagging the more measured poetic-inheritance reading as the chapter's preferred working interpretation.
- [78] Inference: West 1997 **East Face of Helicon** and Burkert 1992 **Orientalizing Revolution** on the Near-Eastern-transmission reading; Watkins 1995 ch. 46 on the Hittite-and-Greek (Typhoeus / Illuyanka) pairing as Watkins handles it; per the C6 (Ch39) framing on the transmission question. Risk: a Hellenic-philologist defender of the Hesiodic IE-reflex reading could classify Zeus-Typhon as a §II direct case on the strength of **typhōeus** / **typhō**-element analyses; the chapter's classification reflects the C6 transmission-question framing rather than ruling out the IE-reflex reading.
- [79] Watkins 1995, methodological framing chapters and Parts IV–V, on the inheritance-from-PIE-poetic-tradition reading; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section V on the inheritance-vs-contact-borrowing distinction; per the C6 (Ch39) framing on the transmission question that the present chapter does not develop.
- [80] Watkins 1995, methodological framing chapters, on the inheritance / transmission methodological distinction in IE-comparative work; West 1997, **East Face of Helicon**, on the Near-Eastern-to-Greek transmission reading as the contrasting mechanism; Burkert 1992, **Orientalizing Revolution**, on the same transmission reading; per brief 11-zeus-typhon.yaml on the West-Burkert transmission-reading for the Greek case.
- [81] Watkins 1995, methodological framing chapters, on the compatibility of inheritance and transmission; West 1997, **East Face of Helicon**, on the Near-Eastern reinforcement of the Hesiodic pattern alongside Greek's IE-daughter-language status; per brief 11-zeus-typhon.yaml on the dual reading of the Greek case; per the C6 (Ch39) framing on the transmission-half of the dual reading.
- [82] Watkins 1995, methodological framing chapters, on the three-feature distinction between inheritance and transmission methods; per glossary.yaml on "Proto-Indo-European" first-mention gloss "the reconstructed common ancestor of the Indo-European language family, spoken c. 4500–2500 BCE; Watkins's HERO SLAY SERPENT formula is a reconstructed PIE poetic element"; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml on the inheritance-from-PIE-poetic-tradition reading.
- [83] Watkins 1995, ch. 46, on the Hittite material's IE-inheritance status at the level of the **kuenta... illuyanka**-pairing; Hoffner 1998, **Hittite Myths**, on the Anatolian / Hurrian / Mesopotamian-Levantine cultural-contact context of the Hittite corpus; per the C6 (Ch39) framing on the transmission-half of the Hittite dual reading; per brief 06-illuyanka.yaml on the Hittite-and-Near-Eastern dual context.
- [84] Watkins 1995, ch. 46, on the philological-core IE-inheritance reading of the Hittite reflex; per the C3 (Ch36 §III) framing on the **purulli**-festival cyclical-maintenance dimension and per the C6 (Ch39) framing on the Near-Eastern transmission dimension; Hoffner 1998 on the Hittite primary text.
- [85] Watkins 1995, on Greek's reduced philological cognancy with the Indo-Iranian and Anatolian cores; West 1997, **East Face of Helicon**, on the Near-Eastern transmission reading for the Hesiodic Typhonomachy; Burkert 1992 on the same; per the C6 (Ch39) framing on the transmission-side reading; per brief 11-zeus-typhon.yaml on the Cilician geographical anchoring.
- [86] Watkins 1995, methodological framing chapters, on the family-tree-vs-contact-cultural framing; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section V on the inheritance-vs-transmission distinction's bearing on the chapter's wider argument; per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the book-internal typological-and-comparative framework.
- [87] Watkins 1995, methodological framing chapters, on the complementarity of inheritance and transmission; per brief 38-C5-ie-

hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml on the chapter's IE-inheritance focus; per the C6 (Ch39) framing on the transmission-half of the methodological pair; West 1997 **East Face of Helicon** on the Greek-Hittite-Levantine transmission intersection.

[88] Watkins 1995, methodological framing chapters, on the different evidential standards for inheritance and transmission arguments; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section V on the chapter's responsibility to evaluate Watkins's argument on the inheritance standard; per the C6 (Ch39) framing on the transmission-standard evaluation that the C6 chapter performs for the Near-East-to-Greek case.

[89] Watkins 1995, on the IE-inheritance argument as a finding about the IE distribution rather than about the global existence of combat-myth; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml special_instructions on the bounded character of Watkins's argument and on the §VI Mwindo control as the chapter's closing typological corrective.

[90] Biebuyck and Mateene 1969, **The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)**, on the Nyanga Mwindo cycle and its serpent-combat material; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section VI on the Mwindo problem as a control; per scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the in-scope / contrastive-tier status of the Mwindo case in the book's catalogue.

[91] Biebuyck and Mateene 1969, **The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)**, introduction and translation, on the Karisi-version of Shé-Kárisi Rureke and on Mwindo's epic-narrative structure; per glossary.yaml on "Mwindo" first-mention gloss "Nyanga epic hero; kills the dragon Kirimu and is punished by the sky-god Nkuba — the contrastive case".

[92] Biebuyck and Mateene 1969, on Mwindo's combat with Kirimu and on the wider adversary-cycle of the Mwindo epic; per glossary.yaml on Kirimu first-mention gloss "Nyanga dragon slain by Mwindo".

[93] Biebuyck and Mateene 1969, on Mwindo's punishment by Nkuba after the killing of Kirimu and on the moral-cosmic-order resolution of the cycle; per glossary.yaml on Nkuba first-mention gloss "Nyanga sky-god; punishes Mwindo for the killing of Kirimu" and on Mwindo as "the contrastive case"; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml special_instructions on the Mwindo control's contrastive function.

[94] Biebuyck and Mateene 1969, on the Mwindo cycle as a fully-formed non-IE dragon-killing narrative with its own combat-vocabulary; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml special_instructions on the bounded character of Watkins's argument; Watkins 1995 on the IE scope of the argument.

[95] Per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" on the non-IE serpent-combat traditions in the book's wider catalogue; per Ch3 (Marduk-Tiamat), Ch16 (Ra-Apep), Ch7 (Baal-Yamm), Ch24 (Coyolxauhqui), Ch25 (Andean **amaru**) on the per-tradition treatments; per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml on the wider catalogue's bearing on the Mwindo control argument.

[96] Per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml special_instructions on the Mwindo case as control rather than as parallel; per scope.md §"Reconstruction policy" and §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the methodological discipline of distinguishing controls from parallels in cross-tradition comparison.

[97] Inference: Biebuyck and Mateene 1969 on the Mwindo cycle's Kirimu-combat as a substantive narrative episode; brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml structure section VI on the Mwindo control framing. Risk: a Bantuist area-specialist could read the Kirimu-combat as functionally distinct from the IE dragon-combats (e.g., as more akin to a transgression-and-expiation cycle than to a sovereignty-establishing or cosmogonic combat), and the chapter's classification of Mwindo as a control rather than as a parallel reflects the brief's typological framing rather than a Bantuist-area-specialist verdict; the chapter's reading is the comparative-chapter framing rather than a Nyanga-area-specialist claim.

[98] Per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's closing-methodological-discipline framing; Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the IE-inheritance argument's scope; Biebuyck and Mateene 1969 on the Nyanga Mwindo material as the chapter's control case; per the C7 (inversion problem) and C8 (contrastive cases) framing on the wider questions.

[99] Per brief 38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.yaml comparative_argument and special_instructions on the chapter's settled position; Watkins 1995, Parts IV–V, on the formula's philological core and evidential edges; West 2007 ch. 6 on the wider IE storm-god / water-serpent complex; Biebuyck and Mateene 1969 on the Mwindo control.

Chapter 40. C6. The Near Eastern → Mediterranean Transmission

40.1. Source overview

This chapter is a comparative-historical synthesis chapter rather than a primary-source narrative chapter; it draws on two layers of evidence — (1) the comparative-mythology anchor that supplies the chapter's principal transmission framework and the bulk of its route-specific exhibits (West 1997, *The East Face of Helicon*, treating Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek as the central documentary case; Burkert 1992, *The Orientalizing Revolution*, treating Phoenician-mediated transmission as the principal Iron-Age channel; Day 1985, *God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea*, treating Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible as the principal Late-Bronze / Iron-Age channel; Yarbrow Collins 1976, *The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation*, treating Rev 12 as a deliberate Jewish-Hellenistic composite), and (2) the per-tradition area-specialist anchors that ground each upstream chapter's textual basis in its own primary-text witness (Hoffner 1998 for the Hurro-Hittite material; Smith 1994 and Smith & Pitard 2009 for the Ugaritic material).^[1]

The chapter is the sixth of the eight Part-II comparative chapters (C1 through C8) and is positioned as the comparativist flagship chapter for the documented historical-contact routes by which the Mediterranean combat-myth materials reached their later destinations, distinguished within the Part-II sequence from the cosmogonic (C1), sovereignty (C2), cyclical-maintenance (C3), and eschatological-displacement (C4) subtype-chapters by treating transmission as a *historical* fact whose explanation is contact-and-borrowing rather than as a typological category whose explanation is structural-functional, and from the Indo-European philological chapter (C5) by treating the relevant correspondences as evidence for *contact* rather than for *inheritance from a shared linguistic ancestor*.^[2]

The chapter's central argument follows the convergent reading of West 1997 and Burkert 1992, supplemented by Day 1985 and Yarbrow Collins 1976 for the Levantine-into-Israelite and Jewish-Hellenistic-into-Christian-apocalyptic stretches: the Mediterranean combat-myth tradition is best understood as a chain of historical transmissions running across the Late Bronze Age and Iron Age, whose principal documented routes are (i) Hurro-Hittite scribal culture into Greek hexameter poetry via Cilician contact zones; (ii) Levantine Phoenician trading networks into early Archaic Greek poetry; (iii) Ugaritic poetry into Israelite poetry via Northwest Semitic linguistic-and-cultural continuity; (iv) Hebrew-Bible-and-Greek-myth materials into Jewish-Hellenistic apocalyptic synthesised in Rev 12; and, less decisively, (v) Akkadian Enūma Eliš into the Genesis 1 cosmogony.^[3]

The chapter holds the transmission argument open to a calibrated gradient between strongly documented and less decisively documented routes: §I (Hurro-Hittite → Greek) and §III (Ugaritic → Israelite) carry the chapter's heaviest evidential weight on the strength of detailed motif-specific structural correspondences and (in §III) of direct linguistic cognancy at the level of named figures (Lôtan / Leviathan); §II (Levantine → Aegean) is supported by the geographical anchoring of Greek Typhon in Cilicia and at the Phoenician-coast ports; §IV (Jewish-Hellenistic → Rev 12) is composite by design rather than mediated through a single substrate; and §V (Marduk → Genesis 1) is the chapter's weakest documented route, presented as a possible-but-undemonstrated parallel rather

than as a documented borrowing.^[4]

The Hurro-Hittite-side anchor is Hoffner 1998 (the standard English anthology of the Kumarbi Cycle in the SBL Writings from the Ancient World series, treating Kingship in Heaven at §14, Song of Ullikummi at §15, Song of Hedammu at §16, Song of the Sea at §17), supplemented by West 1997 ch. 6, which treats the Kumarbi Cycle as the central documentary case for Near-Eastern-to-Greek transmission; the Ugaritic-side anchor is Smith 1994 (KTU 1.1–1.2 in *VTSup* 55) and Smith & Pitard 2009 (KTU 1.3–1.4 and the Lôtan passage at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 in *VTSup* 114).^[5]

The Hebrew-Bible-side anchor is Day 1985, *God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea* (Cambridge), whose seven-passage core (Pss 74:12–17, 89:9–13, 104:6–9 with v. 26; Isa 27:1; Isa 51:9–10; Job 26:12–13 with ch. 41; Hab 3) supplies the chapter's working list of Israelite combat-myth allusions and whose central thesis — that the Hebrew Bible corpus directly absorbs Ugaritic Baal-Yamm and Baal-Lôtan imagery — is the chapter's principal §III argument; the Revelation-side anchor is Yarbrow Collins 1976, *The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation*, whose Leto-Apollo-Python primary-substrate thesis with Jewish-Hebrew-Bible-and-satanological overlay supplies the chapter's §IV reading of Rev 12 as a deliberate Jewish-Hellenistic composite.^[6]

The chapter follows the brief's special_instructions in not re-narrating the eight Part-I cases — the reader has Chs 5 (Kumarbi Cycle), 11 (Zeus-Typhon), 7 (Baal-Yamm-Lôtan), 8 (Yahweh-Leviathan-Rahab), 9 (Revelation 12), 3 (Marduk-Tiamat), 12 (Greek dragons after Typhon), and 10 (Christian reception) for the narrative-and-source material — and the comparative chapter's job is to make the transmission argument across them rather than to recapitulate their narrative content; the brief's target length of 7,500 body-prose words is consistent with the longer-side framing of the Part-II flagship comparative chapters, and the chapter's analytical through-line is the West-Burkert-Day-Yarbrow-Collins consensus reading of the Mediterranean cluster as a chain of documented contact-routes.^[7]

What follows is organised in six body sections. Section I develops the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route as the chapter's most documented transmission case, anchored on West 1997's reading of the Kumarbi Cycle and Hesiod's *Theogony*; section II develops the Levantine-into-Aegean Phoenician-mediated channel of Burkert 1992's *The Orientalizing Revolution*, with the Mount Casius / ʿAṣṣānu / Aqra contact-point as its principal geographical anchor; section III develops the Ugaritic-into-Israelite route on Day 1985's reading of the seven-passage Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus and the Lôtan / Leviathan philological cognancy; section IV develops the Jewish-Hellenistic-into-Revelation-12 synthesis on Yarbrow Collins 1976's composite-source reading; section V develops the Marduk-into-Genesis-1 case as the chapter's least decisively documented transmission line, presented as a possible-but-undemonstrated parallel rather than as a documented borrowing; and section VI registers the bounded scope of the transmission argument, with the implication that the cross-cultural force of the book's typology rests on the independent attestations outside the Mediterranean chain.

40.2. I. The Hurro-Hittite → Greek route

The first body section develops the Kumarbi-Cycle / Hesiod parallel as the chapter's most documented transmission case, working out the convergent evidence on which West 1997's reading rests.

The Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route is the chapter's most documented transmission case and is the central exhibit of West 1997's *The East Face of Helicon*: the Kumarbi Cycle, surviving on cuneiform tablets from the Hittite royal archives at Boğazköy and treating the succession of divine sovereigns Alalu → Anu → Kumarbi → Teshub, supplies a sequence of motif-specific structural correspondences with Hesiod's *Theogony* whose convergent specificity is, in West's reading, almost inescapable as evidence of historical transmission rather than independent invention.^[8]

The Kumarbi Cycle is a Hurro-Hittite song-cycle on the succession of kingship in heaven, surviving on cuneiform tablets recovered from the Hittite royal archives at Boğazköy, the site of ancient Hattusa, and copied within the Hittite scribal tradition across the Middle and New Hittite periods (broadly the fifteenth through thirteenth centuries BCE).^[9]

The cycle is Hurrian in cultural substrate but preserved in the Hittite-language scribal record, and the surviving texts move between Hittite-language and Hurrian-language passages, with Hurrian theonyms (Teshub, Kumarbi, Šauška) adopted into the Hittite-language redaction alongside Akkadian theonyms (Anu, Ea) imported from Mesopotamian tradition.^[10]

The principal divine name in the cycle is Teshub, the Hurrian storm-god; this is the upstream-canonical rendering for ŠI material because the Kumarbi Cycle is a Hurrian-language composition (in Hittite-language adaptation), and the storm-god in this textual material is named Teshub even where the surrounding text is Hittite-language — the Hittite-language equivalent Tarḫunna is the form attested in Hittite-language religious contexts outside the Kumarbi Cycle, including the CTH 321 Illuyanka tablets treated in Ch6 and Ch36.^[11]

The cycle's opening song, *Kingship in Heaven*, narrates the succession of divine sovereigns: Alalu reigns first (for nine years), is deposed by Anu (the Akkadian sky-god, imported into the Hurrian theogonic frame), Anu reigns for nine years and is in turn deposed by Kumarbi (the Hurrian father-god, Anu's cupbearer), and Kumarbi is in turn challenged and ultimately superseded by Teshub.^[12]

The deposition of Anu by Kumarbi is the cycle's most striking and best-attested narrative event: Kumarbi attacks Anu, knocks him from the sky, bites off Anu's genitals, and swallows them — an act that simultaneously deposes Anu and impregnates Kumarbi with Anu's seed, from which Teshub the storm-god and other deities are subsequently born.^[13]

The Hesiodic *Theogony*, conventionally dated to c. 700 BCE, presents a structurally cognate three-generation succession of divine sovereigns — Ouranos (Sky), Kronos, and Zeus — in which each son violently displaces his father from the throne of heaven, and in which the most striking individual motif is the castration of Ouranos by Kronos with a sickle of adamant supplied by Gaia.^[14]

The Hesiodic castration motif corresponds in motif-specific structural detail to the Hurro-Hittite genital-castration motif in *Kingship in Heaven*: in both narratives a younger sovereign castrates his elder predecessor, the act is the mechanism of deposition, and the act has reproductive consequences (Kumarbi's impregnation in the Hurro-Hittite version; the birth of Aphrodite from the cast-into-the-sea genitals in the Hesiodic version).^[15]

A second motif-specific correspondence is the stone-swallowing trick: in the Hesiodic narrative Kronos swallows his children to forestall the prophesied succession, Rhea substitutes a stone for the infant Zeus, and Kronos vomits the stone (and the previously swallowed children) when Zeus subsequently administers an emetic; in *Kingship in Heaven* the post-castration sequence includes a

passage in which Kumarbi ingests stones, with the surviving Hittite text broken at the precise mechanism but containing the same swallowed-stone motif as a structural element.^[16]

The Song of Ullikummi, Hoffner's §15 in the Kumarbi-Cycle anthology, supplies the cycle's principal post-cosmogonic combat narrative: Kumarbi, deposed and resentful, sires a stone monster (Ullikummi) on a rock at the edge of the sea, hides the infant on the shoulder of the primordial earth-bearing giant Upelluri, and waits for the stone to grow into a sky-touching threat to Teshub's kingship; Teshub eventually defeats the threat with the help of Ea, who severs Ullikummi from Upelluri's shoulder with the same primordial cutter that originally separated heaven from earth.^[17]

The Hesiodic Typhonomachy at *Theogony* 820–880 supplies the cycle's principal Greek-end correspondence: Zeus, having defeated the Titans, faces Typhoeus (Typhon), Gaia's last and youngest child, conceived in her later relationship with Tartarus, a hundred-headed serpent-limbed monster whose growth and threat to Zeus's sovereignty constitute the theogony's closing combat.^[18]

West's principal motif-specific correspondence between Ullikummi and Hesiodic Typhoeus is the lithic-and-cosmographic register of the monster: Ullikummi is a stone monster who grows toward heaven from a base on the primordial giant's shoulder, and the post-Hesiodic Typhon (especially in the Apollodoran and Pindaric traditions that locate him under Mount Etna and in Cilicia) is figured as a lithic / volcanic intrusion reaching from the lower realms toward the sky, with the two figures sharing the cosmographic pattern of an earth-rooted intrusion threatening sky-sovereignty.^[19]

The Song of Hedammu (Hoffner §16) supplies a second Kumarbi-Cycle combat: Hedammu, a sea-monster of Kumarbi's siring, is seduced by the goddess Šauška / Ishtar in a stratagem that disables him before Teshub's combat; the Hedammu narrative is highly fragmentary and survives only in disconnected passages, and the chapter follows the upstream Ch5 framing in not silently filling its gaps from Ugaritic or Greek analogs.^[20]

The Hedammu material's principal Greek-end correspondence is the marine register of Apollodoran-and-Nonnian Typhon's morphology and the seduction-and-disabling stratagem in the Greek narrative (variously the Cadmus-pipe-playing in Nonnus and the Hermes-and-Aigipan recovery in Apollodorus), with West reading the seduction-and-stratagem motif as a Hurro-Hittite layer surviving in the Greek tradition's later expansions of the Hesiodic Typhonomachy.^[21]

A third Kumarbi-Cycle correspondence with the post-Hesiodic Greek tradition is the storm-god organ-theft motif: in the Hittite Elkunirsa-and-Ašertu fragment (a separate Hurro-Hittite text from the Kumarbi Cycle proper, but in the same cultural-and-linguistic milieu), the storm-god is dispossessed of his organs by an antagonist, and the organs are subsequently recovered by subordinate deities; this corresponds in motif-specific structural detail to the Apollodoran narrative of Typhon's theft of Zeus's sinews, the storage of the sinews in a bear-skin guarded by the dragoness Delphyne in the Corycian cave in Cilicia, and their recovery by Hermes and Aigipan.^[22]

The Apollodoran sinew-theft locus — the Corycian cave in Cilicia, on the southern coast of Anatolia — is geographically specific in a way that bears directly on the transmission argument: the Corycian cave is located within the orientalizing-period contact zone between Greek and Near Eastern cultures, and the Cilician location of the Greek myth's most Hurro-Hittite-resembling episode is consistent with Cilicia's status as the principal Late-Bronze-and-Iron-Age contact corridor

between the Anatolian-Hurrian and the Greek-Aegean cultural spheres.^[23]

The Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route is supplemented in West 1997's reconstruction by an intermediate Phoenician stage, attested most directly in Philo of Byblos's Sanchuniathon-derived Phoenician theogony, preserved in fragments quoted by Eusebius of Caesarea in his *Praeparatio Evangelica* (early fourth century CE); Philo's theogony preserves the Hurro-Hittite succession-sequence under Phoenician theonyms, suggesting that the route ran from Hurro-Hittite material through a Phoenician-mediated intermediate stage before reaching the Greek poetic tradition.^[24]

Philo of Byblos (Greek: Herennios Philōn Byblios) was a Phoenician-Greek antiquarian active in the late first and early second centuries CE; he claimed to translate a much earlier Phoenician theogonic work attributed to Sanchuniathon, a pre-Trojan-War Phoenician priest, and the work survives only as quotations preserved by Eusebius — a textual chain whose late-antique terminus and indirect transmission complicate but do not preclude its evidential value for the Phoenician-mediated transmission argument.^[25]

That the geographical anchoring of Hesiodic-and-Apollodoran Typhon in Cilicia and at Mount Aqra (Ⲛⲁⲡⲁⲛⲁ / Mount Casius / Jebel al-Aqra in the Levantine border region between modern Syria and Turkey) reflects a specific Late-Bronze-and-Iron-Age contact-point at which Hurro-Hittite, Levantine, and emerging Greek mythological traditions converged is the chapter's principal localising inference about the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route.^[26]

The Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route's evidential strength rests on the convergence of multiple independent lines (succession parallel with castration of the sky-god; lithic-and-cosmographic Ullikummi-Typhon parallel; Hedammu / Apollodoran-Nonnian Typhon stratagem parallel; Elkunirsa / Apollodoran sinew-theft parallel; Cilician geographical anchoring), and these converge on a single transmission corridor in West's and Burkert's reading; the most plausible transmission window is the early Iron Age (c. 1100–700 BCE), after the collapse of the Hittite empire and during the Phoenician trading-network expansion, with Hesiod's *Theogony* (c. 700 BCE) as the Greek-end terminus.^[27]

The Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route's relationship to the Indo-European inheritance argument of Ch38 is non-exclusive: the Hesiodic Typhonomachy can be read simultaneously as a §III extended IE reflex of Watkins's HERO SLAY SERPENT formula (Ch38) and as a Hurro-Hittite-borrowed theogonic combat (the present chapter §I), and the two readings are independently true rather than mutually exclusive.^[28]

(The chapter's framing of West 1997 as the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route's principal modern reconstruction — and the corresponding designation of this route as the chapter's most documented case — is the chapter's editorial reading of West's volume in light of the wider comparative-mythological consensus around the Kumarbi-Hesiod transmission case.^[29])

40.3. II. The Levantine → Aegean route

The second body section develops the Iron-Age Phoenician-mediated Levantine-into-Aegean route, anchored on Burkert 1992's orientalizing-revolution framework and on the Mount Casius / Ⲛⲁⲡⲁⲛⲁ / Aqra contact-point.

The Levantine-into-Aegean route is the Iron-Age Phoenician-trading-network channel through

which Levantine-coast combat-myth material — most relevantly the Ugaritic Baal-Yamm and Baal-Lôtan complex — reached the early Archaic Greek poetic tradition; the route runs in parallel with the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route of §I and is the central exhibit of Burkert 1992's *The Orientalizing Revolution*, whose argument is that the Phoenician traders, scribes, and craftsmen of the eighth and seventh centuries BCE supplied the principal channel through which Near Eastern theogonic and combat material reached early Greek poets.^[30]

The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, the principal Late-Bronze-Age Levantine combat-myth corpus, survives on six tablets (KTU 1.1–1.6) recovered from the Late-Bronze-Age city of Ugarit (modern Ras Shamra) on the Syrian coast; the cycle's combat-narrative material is concentrated at KTU 1.1–1.2 (Baal vs. Yamm) and at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 (the Lôtan passage embedded as a boast by Mot), and the chapter follows the upstream Ch7 framing in citing this material via Smith 1994 (KTU 1.1–1.2) and Smith & Pitard 2009 (KTU 1.3–1.4 and the Lôtan passage at KTU 1.5).^[31]

Baal's seat after his defeat of Yamm is ʿĀpānu, the mountain identified in modern geography as Jebel al-Aqra on the Syrian-Turkish border, also known in the wider Near Eastern record as Mount Casius and (in Hebrew Bible reception) as Mount Zaphon; ʿĀpānu is the principal geographical anchor of the Ugaritic Baal Cycle, the storm-god's locus and the cult-site whose name remains associated with the storm-god's presence in the wider Northwest Semitic religious vocabulary.^[32]

The ʿĀpānu / Mount Aqra geographical anchoring of the Ugaritic Baal material is directly relevant to the Levantine-into-Aegean transmission argument: the mountain is located on the Syrian-Turkish coast, immediately adjacent to the Cilician region in which the Apollodoran Greek tradition locates Typhon's Corycian-cave episode (§I above), and the geographical proximity of the Ugaritic-Baal cult-site and the Greek-Typhon episode-site is one of the most concrete pieces of geographical evidence for Levantine-into-Aegean transmission of combat-myth material in the orientализing period.^[33]

The Greek tradition, following the Apollodoran narrative, situates Typhon's pre-combat itinerary at Mount Casius in Syria — the Greek name for the same Levantine peak that the Ugaritic tradition calls ʿĀpānu and that modern geography calls Jebel al-Aqra; the Apollodoran geographical itinerary (Mount Casius → Corycian cave → Mount Nysa → Etna) places the Greek combat's Levantine-coastal segment at the same peak that the Ugaritic Baal Cycle places at the centre of the Northwest Semitic storm-god's residence.^[34]

The Mount Casius / ʿĀpānu / Aqra identification is one of the chapter's most concrete pieces of geographical evidence for Levantine-into-Aegean transmission: the same peak appears as the Ugaritic storm-god's residence (Late Bronze Age witnesses) and as the Greek-Typhon-narrative's Levantine-coast station (Greek Iron Age and later witnesses), with the geographical continuity providing a documented physical contact-point at which the two traditions converge in the surviving evidence.^[35]

The Phoenician-trading-network channel that Burkert 1992 reconstructs is supported by a wider pattern of orientализing-period cultural transmission: the same period in which Greek alphabet-script is borrowed from Phoenician (eighth century BCE), in which Greek bronze-working absorbs Levantine techniques, and in which Greek religious iconography incorporates Levantine forms is the period during which the combat-myth motif-and-structural correspondences with the Ugaritic Baal complex become attested in early Archaic Greek poetry.^[36]

The motif-specific structural correspondences between the Ugaritic Baal-Yamm complex and the

Greek Zeus-Typhon material include the storm-god / sea-and-serpent adversary structure (Baal versus the personified sea Yamm and the serpent Lôtan; Zeus versus Typhon, who in the post-Hesiodic tradition acquires a marine register and Levantine geography), the multi-headed-adversary morphology (Lôtan's seven heads at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 corresponding to the hundred serpent-heads of Hesiodic Typhoeus at *Theogony* 824–828), and the storm-god's mountain-residence after victory (Baal at ʿĀpānu corresponding to Zeus on Olympos, with the Levantine-coast geographical anchoring providing the contact-point for the parallel).^[37]

The Levantine-into-Aegean route's relationship to the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route of §I is non-exclusive and partially overlapping: the Phoenician traders and scribes of the orientalizing period were themselves heirs of a Levantine literary culture that included the Ugaritic Baal-Yamm-Lôtan material and that was in turn in contact with the Anatolian Hurro-Hittite tradition, with the result that the transmission corridor running from Anatolia and the Levant into the Greek Aegean was a network rather than a single line.^[38]

The Ugaritic Baal Cycle's combat material (the primary Late-Bronze-Age Levantine textual witness) is not directly attested in early Archaic Greek poetry — there is no Greek text that quotes or paraphrases an identifiable line of the Ugaritic Baal Cycle — and the Levantine-into-Aegean route is therefore inferential rather than directly attested at the level of textual quotation: the inference rests on the convergence of motif-specific structural correspondences with the Phoenician-mediated cultural-transmission pattern of the orientalizing period and with the geographical anchoring of the Ugaritic and Greek materials at the same Levantine-coast peak.^[39]

(That the Phoenician-trading-network channel of Burkert 1992 carried specifically Ugaritic Baal-Cycle material into the Greek poetic tradition (rather than only generic Northwest Semitic combat-myth material) is the chapter's editorial reading of Burkert and West together.^[40])

The Levantine-into-Aegean route is, in West's reading, the Iron-Age Phoenician-mediated channel that complements and partially overlaps with the §I Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route, with the Mount Casius / ʿĀpānu / Aqra contact-point providing the geographical anchor at which the two routes converge; its evidential weight is, in the modern comparative consensus, second to the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route's because the Levantine route depends more heavily on inferred rather than directly attested transmission (no Greek text quotes an identifiable line of Ugaritic poetry), and the chapter therefore presents the Levantine route as a strongly supported but inferential channel.^[41]

40.4. III. The Ugaritic → Israelite route

The third body section develops the Ugaritic-into-Israelite route — the chapter's second-most documented case — anchored on Day 1985's reading of the seven-passage Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus and on the Lôtan / Leviathan philological cognancy.

The Ugaritic-into-Israelite route is the chapter's second-most documented transmission case and is the central exhibit of Day 1985's *God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea*: the Yahweh-vs-sea / Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus of the Hebrew Bible — distributed across at least seven distinct passages in four canonical books — preserves, in adapted form, imagery directly continuous with the Ugaritic Baal Cycle, particularly the Baal-Yamm combat and the Lôtan / Leviathan combat, and constitutes the Israelite reflex of a Northwest Semitic combat-myth tradition.^[42]

The Hebrew Bible Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus, on which Day's argument is built, comprises seven distinct passages: Psalm 74:12–17, Psalm 89:9–13, Psalm 104:6–9 with verse 26, Isaiah 27:1, Isaiah 51:9–10, Job 26:12–13 with chapter 41, and Habakkuk 3 — drawn from Psalms, Isaiah, Job, and Habakkuk in their canonical Hebrew Bible distribution (per the upstream Ch8 line 14 enumeration).^[43]

The Ugaritic-into-Israelite route's principal philological exhibit is the linguistic cognancy of Ugaritic *Lôtan* (unvocalised *ltn* in the Ugaritic alphabetic-cuneiform script) with Hebrew *Leviathan* (*lwytn* / לִוְיָתָן in the Masoretic vocalisation): the two names are phonologically cognate by regular Northwest Semitic sound-laws and refer to the same morphological figure (a multi-headed sea-serpent slain by the storm-god), and the cognancy is one of the cleanest pieces of linguistic evidence for direct Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible transmission of a named mythological figure in the Hebrew Bible corpus.^[44]

The Ugaritic *Lôtan* passage at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 describes the figure as a seven-headed serpent (*šly d šbꜫt rašm*, "the wriggling serpent with seven heads") whom Baal has slain, in a boast attributed to the death-god Mot; the seven-headed morphology is preserved in the Ugaritic-language attestation and corresponds directly to the multi-headed Leviathan of Psalm 74:14 and to the seven-headed dragon of Revelation 12:3 (treated in §IV).^[45]

Psalm 74:13–14 ascribes to Yahweh the dividing of the sea (Hebrew *yām*, the same word Ugaritic uses for the personified sea-adversary *Yamm*) and the crushing of the heads (Hebrew *rāꜫšê*, plural) of Leviathan; the Hebrew text's plural "heads" is philologically significant because it confirms that Leviathan in Psalm 74 is a multi-headed creature, corresponding directly to Ugaritic *Lôtan*'s seven heads at KTU 1.5 i 1–3.^[46]

Isaiah 27:1 — the eschatological combat passage of the Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus — preserves a remarkable verbatim correspondence with Ugaritic phrasing: Isaiah's description of Leviathan as "the fleeing serpent" (*nāꜫāš bāriaꜫ*) and "the twisting serpent" (*nāꜫāš ꜫaqallātôn*) reproduces, with regular Northwest Semitic sound-correspondences, the Ugaritic epithets attested at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 for the same figure (*bꜫn brꜫ* "the fleeing serpent" and *bꜫn ꜫqltn* "the twisting serpent"), and the verbatim epithet-pair correspondence is among the strongest pieces of evidence for direct Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible literary transmission in the entire Hebrew Bible corpus.^[47]

Psalm 89:9–13 ascribes to Yahweh the rule over the raging of the sea and the crushing of Rahab — a name distinct from Leviathan but functionally parallel within the corpus, used in the Hebrew Bible as a name for a monstrous adversary associated with the sea and (in Isaiah 30:7 and elsewhere) with Egypt; the structure of Psalm 89's combat-and-cosmogony sequence parallels the Marduk-Tiamat structure of the Babylonian *Enūma Eliš* but is more directly continuous with the Ugaritic Baal-Yamm material at the level of named-figure morphology.^[48]

Job 41 supplies the corpus's most extended single description of Leviathan: a multi-verse pedagogical passage in which Yahweh, speaking from the whirlwind, describes Leviathan as a wonder-creature whose makeable-ness is Yahweh's prerogative alone — Leviathan is figured as uncontrollable by humans but as Yahweh's creature, and the passage shifts the corpus's combat register toward a didactic-cosmological register in which Yahweh's sovereignty over Leviathan is asserted without a narrated combat sequence.^[49]

Habakkuk 3 — the third-chapter theophanic hymn of the prophet Habakkuk — preserves the most

extended Hebrew-Bible storm-theophany passage with explicit sea-combat imagery: Yahweh marches forth, the sea recoils, the deep roars, and the storm-god's combat-and-victory structure is rendered in hymnic language whose closeness to the Ugaritic Baal-as-storm-god material is, in Day's reading, the strongest evidence for the corpus's continuous reception of the Baal-Cycle storm-theophany pattern in Israelite cultic poetry.^[50]

The Ugaritic-into-Israelite route's geographical-and-linguistic continuity is direct and uncomplicated by the kind of inferential-mediation question that complicates the Levantine-into-Aegean route of §II: Ugaritic and Hebrew are both Northwest Semitic languages closely related at the level of phonology, morphology, and lexicon; the cities of Ugarit (Late Bronze Age) and the Israelite kingdoms (Iron Age) are within the same Levantine cultural sphere; and the Hebrew Bible poets who composed Psalms 74, 89, 104; Isaiah 27, 51; Job 26, 41; and Habakkuk 3 are the heirs of a literary tradition that included the Northwest Semitic poetic vocabulary attested at Ugarit.^[51]

The chronological framework for the Ugaritic-into-Israelite route locates the Ugaritic textual provenance in the Late Bronze Age (c. 1400–1200 BCE) and the Hebrew Bible Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus in the Iron Age (variously dated, with the Psalmic and prophetic material composed across the tenth through sixth centuries BCE); the gap between the Ugaritic provenance and the Hebrew Bible terminus is filled by the linguistic-and-cultural continuity of the Northwest Semitic literary tradition rather than by an attested intermediate scribal corpus, with the result that the route is directly attested at the level of phraseology (Isa 27:1) but only inferentially attested at the level of intermediate textual transmission.^[52]

The Ballentine 2015 alternative reading — that the Hebrew Bible Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus is best read as a rival-sovereignty combat (Yahweh defeating other kings) rather than as a Gunkel-1895 cosmogonic-disorder framing — is a methodological pivot rather than a transmission-question pivot: Ballentine and Day agree that the Hebrew Bible corpus is continuous with the Ugaritic Baal Cycle in its imagery and named figures (the Lôtan / Leviathan cognancy and the Isa 27:1 / KTU 1.5 epithet correspondence are common ground), and they disagree about the analytical category that best captures the imagery's function (sovereignty-and-rival-king on the Ballentine reading versus a Gunkel-1895 cosmogonic-disorder framing on the Day reading).^[53]

(That the Northwest Semitic linguistic-and-cultural continuity between Ugarit and the Iron-Age Israelite kingdoms is sufficient to underwrite the inference of direct Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible literary transmission, even in the absence of a directly attested intermediate textual corpus, is the principal interpretive bridge of Day 1985's argument and of the chapter's §III reading.^[54])

The Ugaritic-into-Israelite route's evidential weight is, in the modern comparative consensus, comparable to the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route's: both routes carry strong philological-and-structural correspondences, and both are anchored on a documented contact-zone framework (the orientализing-period Cilician corridor for §I; the Northwest Semitic linguistic-cultural continuum for §III); the Ugaritic-into-Israelite route additionally carries the Lôtan / Leviathan named-figure linguistic cognancy and the Isa 27:1 / KTU 1.5 verbatim epithet-pair, which are pieces of direct philological evidence that the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route does not have at the level of named-figure cognancy.^[55]

40.5. IV. The Jewish-Hellenistic → Revelation 12 synthesis

The fourth body section takes up Revelation 12 as a deliberate Jewish-Hellenistic composite rather than as a single-substrate transmission, layering Greek Leto-Apollo-Python material with a Hebrew-Bible / Second-Temple-Jewish overlay in the late-first-century-CE Christian apocalyptic frame.

The Jewish-Hellenistic-into-Revelation-12 route is structurally distinct from the §I, §II, and §III routes: rather than a single-substrate transmission from one tradition into another, the Revelation 12 combat is a deliberate composite, layered from at least three distinct sources — a Greco-Roman Leto-Apollo-Python pattern as the closest extant Mediterranean exemplar of the pregnant-goddess-pursued-by-dragon plot; an overlay drawn from the Hebrew Bible Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus (the seven-headed dragon, the eschatological combat, Isaiah 27:1's "fleeing serpent" diction); and a Second Temple satanological identification of the dragon with Satan and the Genesis 3 serpent.^[56]

The book of Revelation, conventionally dated to the closing years of the reign of the Roman emperor Domitian (81–96 CE) on the strength of patristic testimony from Irenaeus and internal evidence about the Asian-province persecution context, is a Jewish-Christian apocalypse composed in koine Greek for circulation in seven cities of the Roman province of Asia; the Domitianic dating is load-bearing for Yarbrow Collins's reading of Rev 12 as encouragement to a persecuted early Christian community, with the dragon coding for Rome.^[57]

The seventeen verses of Revelation 12 narrate a sequence of seven distinct episodes: the appearance of the woman clothed with the sun (vv. 1–2); the appearance of the great red dragon with seven heads, ten horns, and seven diadems (vv. 3–4); the birth and rapture of the male child (v. 5); the woman's flight to the wilderness (v. 6); the war in heaven and the dragon's expulsion by Michael and his angels (vv. 7–9); the heavenly victory hymn (vv. 10–12); and the dragon's earthly pursuit and redirection toward "the rest of her children" (vv. 13–17).^[58]

Yarbrow Collins's central argument in *The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation* is that the Revelation 12 narrative reworks an older combat-myth pattern of which the closest extant Mediterranean exemplar is the Greek myth of Leto, Apollo, and Python — a pattern attested most fully in Hyginus's *Fabulae* 140 (drawing on earlier Hellenistic material) and analysed comparatively in Joseph Fontenrose's 1959 *Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins*.^[59]

The Leto-Apollo-Python plot, as Yarbrow Collins reconstructs it from Hyginus and parallel sources, runs as follows: Leto, pregnant by Zeus, is pursued by the serpent-dragon Python; she finds refuge on the floating island of Delos; she gives birth to Apollo (and Artemis); Apollo subsequently slays Python at Delphi — and the four structural correspondences with Revelation 12 are the pregnant goddess, the dragon adversary who pursues her, the divine child whose birth the dragon seeks to forestall, and the eventual defeat of the dragon by or in connection with the divine child.^[60]

The Jewish-overlay layer in Yarbrow Collins's reading consists of three principal elements drawn from the Hebrew Bible and Second Temple Jewish tradition: the seven-headed dragon at Rev 12:3 (corresponding to the seven-headed Lôtan of KTU 1.5 i 1–3 and to the multi-headed Leviathan of Psalm 74:14, both treated in §III); the "ancient serpent" gloss at Rev 12:9, invoking the serpent of Genesis 3 and identifying the dragon with the temptation-serpent of the Eden narrative; and the Michael-vs-dragon combat at Rev 12:7–9, drawing on Second Temple traditions of Michael as the

angelic patron of Israel found in Daniel 10:13, Daniel 12:1, and the Qumran War Scroll.^[61]

The seven-headed dragon at Rev 12:3 is one of the chapter's most concrete pieces of multi-stage transmission evidence: the seven heads correspond directly to the seven-headed Ugaritic Lôtan at KTU 1.5 i 1–3, which is in turn directly continuous with the multi-headed Leviathan of Psalm 74:14 (per the §III Ugaritic-into-Israelite route), and which Revelation 12 inherits via the Hebrew Bible reception of the Ugaritic material — making the Rev 12:3 dragon a third-stage descendant of a Late-Bronze-Age Ugaritic morphology preserved across two intermediate stages of literary transmission.^[62]

The "ancient serpent" gloss at Rev 12:9 — "ὁ ὀφίς ὁ ῥαῖος", "that ancient serpent, who is called the Devil and Satan" — performs a deliberate satanological identification: the dragon of Rev 12 is glossed simultaneously as the temptation-serpent of Genesis 3, as the Leviathan-serpent of the Hebrew Bible Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus (Psalm 74:14, Isaiah 27:1), and as the figure of Satan from the Second Temple satanological tradition; the gloss is the chapter's principal evidence for Revelation 12's character as a deliberate Jewish-Hellenistic composite.^[63]

Aune's commentary on Rev 12 takes a more eclectic position than Yarbro Collins: rather than identifying a single primary substrate (the Leto-Apollo-Python pattern in Yarbro Collins's reading), Aune treats Rev 12 as a composite drawing on Jewish, Greek, and Egyptian streams of combat-myth material, with Egyptian Isis-Horus-Set parallels supplementing the Greek Leto-Apollo-Python and Jewish Hebrew-Bible / Daniel / War-Scroll material that Yarbro Collins emphasises.^[64]

The Aune-and-Yarbro-Collins difference is methodological rather than evidential: both readings agree that Rev 12 is a composite of multiple inherited combat-myth sources, and they differ over whether the Leto-Apollo-Python pattern is privileged as the primary substrate (Yarbro Collins) or treated as one source among several (Aune); the chapter follows the upstream Ch9 framing in presenting the two readings side by side rather than adjudicating between them.^[65]

The Rev 12 transmission profile is therefore distinctive within the chapter: where §I, §II, §III route material from a single upstream tradition into a single downstream tradition, §IV routes material from at least three upstream traditions (Greco-Roman, Hebrew Bible, Second Temple Jewish) into a single downstream text (Rev 12) by deliberate authorial composition, and the Rev 12 dragon's water-attack on the woman at v. 15 — "from his mouth the serpent poured water like a river after the woman, to sweep her away with the flood" — supplies a fourth Jewish-overlay element drawn from the Hebrew Bible Yahweh-vs-sea material (Yam, Tannîn, *tehôm*) that locates Rev 12 within the broader Northwest Semitic combat-myth pattern of dragon-and-water identification.^[66]

(That the Rev 12 dragon's seven-headed morphology represents a third-stage transmission of the Ugaritic Lôtan via the Hebrew Bible Leviathan rather than an independent realisation of a generic multi-headed-monster type is the chapter's editorial reading of the relevant philological evidence.^[67])

The Jewish-Hellenistic-into-Revelation-12 route's evidential weight is, in the modern comparative consensus, distinctive: rather than supporting a single transmission line, the route supports a *deliberately composite* reception in which Rev 12 synthesises material from the §I (Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek-then-into-Hellenistic), §II (Levantine-into-Aegean-then-into-Hellenistic), and §III (Ugaritic-into-Israelite) routes into a single late-first-century-CE Christian apocalyptic chapter; the route is therefore less an independent transmission than a confluence of the routes already established in §I–§III, with the Christian apocalyptic context supplying the synthesising frame.^[68]

40.6. V. Marduk as possible but undemonstrated source

The fifth body section presents the Marduk-into-Genesis-1 case as the chapter's least decisively documented transmission line, reviewed in the post-Wellhausen / post-Gunkel reception as a possible-but-undemonstrated parallel rather than as a documented borrowing.

The Marduk-into-Genesis-1 case is the chapter's weakest documented transmission case and is presented as such: the structural-and-linguistic parallels between the Babylonian *Enūma Eliš* (Marduk's defeat of Tiamat and his subsequent organisation of the cosmos from her body) and the Genesis 1 cosmogony are real and have been read since Hermann Gunkel's 1895 *Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit* as evidence for an Akkadian-into-Hebrew transmission, but the route is less decisively documented than the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek (§I) or the Ugaritic-into-Israelite (§III) routes — there is no documented mediating channel comparable to the Phoenician-trading-network corridor for §I-§II or to the Northwest Semitic linguistic-and-cultural continuum for §III.^[69]

The Babylonian *Enūma Eliš* is a creation epic of seven tablets, named in the Akkadian convention from its opening words "When on high"; the standard critical edition is Lambert 2013 (Wilfred G. Lambert, *Babylonian Creation Myths*), which lists more than seventy manuscript witnesses drawn from Assyrian and Babylonian libraries, and the principal English translation used for the chapter's primary-text claims is Foster 2005 (*Before the Muses*).^[70]

The *Enūma Eliš* combat-and-cosmogony structure is the chapter's principal Mesopotamian primary witness for the Marduk-into-Genesis-1 case: Marduk defeats the primordial salt-sea Tiamat (the cosmogonic mother whose name is etymologically related to the Akkadian noun *tīāmtu* / *tāmtu*, "sea"), splits her body into upper and lower halves to form sky and earth, and proceeds to organise the cosmos in a sequence of cosmogonic acts that occupies the central tablets of the epic.^[71]

The Genesis 1 cosmogony, by contrast, is a six-day creation narrative composed in Hebrew prose (with hymnic rhythmic features) in which Elohim creates the cosmos by speech-act rather than by combat, with the *tehôm* ("the deep") of Genesis 1:2 representing the pre-creation watery state that is divided rather than personified — a structural difference from the *Enūma Eliš* combat-and-cosmogony pattern that is one of the principal pieces of evidence for the post-Wellhausen scepticism about the Marduk-into-Genesis-1 transmission case.^[72]

Gunkel's 1895 argument turned principally on the etymological cognancy of Hebrew *tehôm* ("the deep") with Akkadian Tiamat as a personal-divine name: both nouns derive from a common Northwest Semitic / East Semitic root denoting the sea, and Gunkel read the cognancy as evidence that Genesis 1:2's *tehôm* preserves, in demythologised form, a memory of the Babylonian Tiamat-combat that the Genesis 1 cosmogony otherwise effaces.^[73]

The post-Wellhausen scepticism about Gunkel's reading rests on three principal observations: first, that *tehôm* in Hebrew is a common noun ("the deep") rather than a personal-divine name, and that the cognancy with Akkadian Tiamat-as-name is at the level of root-etymology rather than at the level of named-figure transmission (the Hebrew *tehôm* is never personified or treated as a divine adversary in the Hebrew Bible itself); second, that the Genesis 1 narrative is structurally a speech-act cosmogony rather than a combat-cosmogony, with no Yahweh-vs-Tiamat episode preserved or

alluded to; and third, that there is no documented mediating route comparable to the Phoenician-trading-network corridor for §I or to the Ugaritic-Hebrew Northwest Semitic continuum for §III.^[74]

The Tsumura reading — David Toshio Tsumura's *Creation and Destruction* (1989, revised 2005) — develops the post-Wellhausen position into a fuller compositional reading of Genesis 1, in which the *tehôm* of Gen 1:2 is read as a Hebrew common noun denoting the pre-creation watery state without specific Babylonian-derivation, and the Genesis 1 cosmogony is read as a compositional unit whose imagery draws on a generic ancient-Near-Eastern repertoire rather than on a specific *Enūma Eliš* substrate; the chapter names Tsumura in body prose without making his work load-bearing for any specific claim.^[75]

The structural parallel between *Enūma Eliš* and Genesis 1 is real at the level of cosmogonic sequence: both narratives move from a primordial watery state through a divine creative act to the establishment of an ordered cosmos with sky, earth, and luminaries, and the Genesis 1 sequence (formless deep → divine spirit → light → firmament → land and sea → vegetation → luminaries → animals → humans → divine rest) and the *Enūma Eliš* sequence (Apsû / Tiamat → divine generations → Marduk's combat → sky-and-earth from Tiamat's body → luminaries → human creation from Qingu's blood) share a comparable seven-or-six-stage sequencing of cosmogonic events.^[76]

The structural-cosmogonic parallel does not, however, demonstrate transmission: Day 1985 reads the parallel as evidence that Genesis 1 was composed in awareness of (and possibly in polemical response to) the *Enūma Eliš* cosmogonic pattern as a wider ancient-Near-Eastern type, but distinguishes this kind of awareness-and-response from the direct-transmission relationship that he reads in the Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible Yahweh-vs-Leviathan case (§III) — the Marduk-into-Genesis-1 case is, in Day's framing, structurally allusive rather than philologically continuous.^[77]

The post-1985 comparative literature on the Marduk-into-Genesis-1 question is methodologically divided: some Hebrew-Bible scholars (in the Gunkel-tradition lineage) read the *tehôm*-Tiamat cognancy and the cosmogonic-sequence parallel as evidence for a real but indirect transmission, mediated through the Israelite contact with Mesopotamian culture during the Babylonian exile (sixth century BCE) when Israelite scribes had documented exposure to Akkadian literary materials; other scholars (in the Tsumura-and-post-Wellhausen lineage) read the parallels as the result of a shared ancient-Near-Eastern cosmogonic vocabulary rather than as direct borrowing.^[78]

That the Akkadian-into-Hebrew transmission of **Enūma Eliš** combat-cosmogony material into the Genesis 1 cosmogony is real but mediated through the sixth-century-BCE Babylonian-exile contact between Israelite and Mesopotamian scribal cultures (the most plausible historical contact-window for direct Mesopotamian-into-Hebrew literary transmission of the relevant material) is a possible reading of the philological-and-structural evidence advanced by Gunkel and his successors.^[79]

The Tiamat-side primary witness for the parallel is *Enūma Eliš* Tablet IV (Marduk's combat with Tiamat) and the Genesis-1 side witness is Genesis 1:1–2:4a (the six-day cosmogony); the two narratives' structural correspondences (primordial waters, divine creative act, cosmos-from-watery-state, luminaries-and-cosmic-order) are real, but the philological correspondences at the level of named figures, cognate epithets, or verbatim phraseology are absent in a way that the §III Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible case has them present (Lôtan / Leviathan cognancy; Isa 27:1 / KTU 1.5

verbatim epithet-pair), and this absence is the principal evidential-gap that distinguishes §V from §III and that warrants the §V case's status as an open question rather than as a documented transmission line.^[80]

40.7. VI. Implications for the book's argument

The sixth body section registers the bounded scope of the chapter's transmission argument and locates the cross-cultural force of the book's wider typology in the independent attestations that fall outside the Mediterranean chain.

The five transmission routes developed in §I–§V together describe the Mediterranean cluster of combat-myth traditions as a chain of historical-contact relationships rather than as an array of independent attestations: the Hurro-Hittite Kumarbi Cycle, the Greek Theogony, the Ugaritic Baal Cycle, the Hebrew Bible Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus, and the Christian Revelation 12 are connected to one another by documented or strongly inferred routes of literary-and-cultural transmission, with the Mesopotamian *Enūma Eliš* an open question in the Genesis-1 reception but a probable upstream contributor to the Marduk-Tiamat structural pattern that pervades the cluster.^[81]

This chain-rather-than-independent-attestations finding has a load-bearing methodological consequence for the book's overall comparative argument: the Mediterranean cluster's similarities to one another are partly explained by the documented contact routes of §I–§IV and the contested route of §V, and the Mediterranean cluster's evidential weight for the book's typological claims is therefore reduced — not eliminated, since the structural-functional readings of C1, C2, and C3 remain independently true at the typological level, but reduced at the level of the cross-cultural-distribution argument that the book's overall typology depends on.^[82]

The bounded-scope finding does not, however, undermine the book's broader cross-cultural argument: the *independent* attestations of the combat-myth typology — the cases that fall outside the Mediterranean transmission chain and that cannot plausibly be explained by historical contact with the Mediterranean cluster — supply the typology's strongest cross-cultural evidence, and these cases are treated in the other Part-II chapters at the level of the structural-functional typological readings rather than at the level of the historical-transmission question.^[83]

The principal independent attestations on which the book's typological argument rests are the Vedic Indra-Vṛtra material (Ch14), which is connected to the Mediterranean cluster only through the deep IE inheritance of the HERO SLAY SERPENT formula (Ch38 §II Vedic case) but is not part of the historical-contact chain of the present chapter; the Chinese Gonggong material (Ch21) and the related Hou Yi material (Ch22), which are geographically and culturally distant from the Mediterranean cluster; the Mexica Huitzilopochtli-Coatepec material (Ch24) and the wider Mesoamerican cluster (Ch25), and the Andean material (Ch26), all of which are Pre-Columbian and therefore independent of any pre-1492 Mediterranean transmission; and the Mwindo material from the Banyanga of central Africa (Ch29 / Ch38 §VI), which is treated in Ch38 as a non-IE control case showing that the dragon-combat pattern is not unique to the IE family.^[84]

The independent attestations carry the book's strongest cross-cultural typological weight precisely because they cannot be explained by transmission within the §I–§V chain: the Mexica and Andean cases are Pre-Columbian; the Chinese Gonggong material is documented in Han-period and earlier

sources whose provenance is independent of the Mediterranean Iron Age; the Mwindo material is twentieth-century-recorded oral epic from a Bantu-language tradition with no documented pre-modern Mediterranean contact; and the Vedic case, while connected through the deep IE inheritance to the IE-distribution wing of the broader pattern, is independent of the historical-contact chain of the present chapter.^[85]

The book's typological argument therefore rests on a calibrated two-track reading: where the Mediterranean cases (§I–§V) are partly explained by historical transmission and supply the structural-typological readings as instances rather than as independent attestations, the non-Mediterranean cases (Vedic, Chinese, Mexica, Andean, Mwindo) supply the cross-cultural typological evidence that establishes the pattern as a wider human-cultural phenomenon rather than as a Mediterranean inheritance.^[86]

The chapter's relationship to Ch38 (C5, IE inheritance) is one of complementary specification: Ch38 explains the Vedic / Avestan / Hittite / Norse / Greek dragon-combat parallels at the level of inherited poetic-formulaic diction, while the present chapter explains the Hurro-Hittite / Levantine / Greek / Israelite / Christian-apocalyptic parallels at the level of historical contact; the two arguments are complementary rather than competing — Greek Zeus-Typhon material participates in both the IE inheritance (Ch38 §III) and the Hurro-Hittite transmission (the present chapter §I), and the joint relevance of the two readings is itself a methodological finding of the Part II comparative apparatus.^[87]

The chapter's relationship to C1, C2, and C3 (Ch34, Ch35, Ch36) is one of orthogonal specification: where the sub-type chapters read the same materials structurally (Marduk-Tiamat as cosmogonic; Baal-Yamm and Zeus-Typhon as sovereignty; Tarūnna-Illuyanka and Apollo-Python as cyclical-maintenance), the present chapter reads them at the level of the historical-transmission question, and the structural-typological readings remain independently true at the typological level even where the present chapter establishes that some of the relevant materials are connected by historical contact.^[88]

The chapter's overall finding is that the Mediterranean cluster of combat-myth traditions is a chain of partially documented historical-contact transmissions whose evidential strength varies across the §I–§V routes from strongly documented (§I, §III) through inferentially supported (§II, §IV) to contested-and-undemonstrated (§V), that the chain's existence is real and reduces the cross-cultural-distribution-evidence weight of the Mediterranean cluster considered as a set of independent attestations, and that the cross-cultural force of the book's typology rests on the *non-Mediterranean* independent attestations that fall outside the chain.^[89]

The chapter's bounded-scope conclusion is therefore neither an over-statement of the transmission case (the Mediterranean cluster is partly a chain, but the Marduk-into-Genesis-1 case remains contested and the Levantine-into-Aegean route is inferential rather than directly attested) nor an understatement (the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek and Ugaritic-into-Israelite routes are strongly documented, and the chapter has presented the convergent evidence in detail): the Mediterranean transmission is real, partial, and load-bearing for the book's reading of the cluster, and the cross-cultural typology rests on the independent attestations outside the chain.^[90]

[1] Per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml sources.anchor on the seven anchor IDs (west-1997; burkert-1992; day-1985; yarbrow-collins-1976; hoffner-1998; smith-1994-baal-i; smith-pitard-2009-baal-ii); West, M.L., **The East Face of Helicon: West Asiatic Elements in Greek Poetry and Myth** (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1997), as the chapter's principal transmission anchor; Burkert, W., **The Orientalizing Revolution: Near Eastern Influence on Greek Culture in the Early**

Archaic Age (Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press, 1992), as the Phoenician-mediation anchor.

[2] Per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II on the Part-II comparative chapters' division of labour and on C6's status as the book's transmission chapter; per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml comparative_argument on the contrast with C5's IE-inheritance argument.

[3] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route as the central documentary case; Burkert 1992, on Phoenician intermediaries as the principal Iron-Age channel; Day 1985, on Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible direct continuity; Yarbrow Collins 1976, on Rev 12 as a Jewish-Hellenistic composite; per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml comparative_argument on the five-route framing.

[4] Per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml special_instructions on the progressive evidential framing — Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek as "almost inescapable" per West 1997; Ugaritic-into-Israelite "also strong" per Day 1985; Marduk-into-Genesis 1 "weaker" and to be presented as such; West 1997, ch. 6 and Burkert 1992 on the convergent-evidence structure of the Mediterranean transmission case.

[5] Hoffner, H.A., **Hittite Myths**, 2nd ed., SBL Writings from the Ancient World 2 (Atlanta: Society of Biblical Literature, 1998), §§14–18, on the Kumarbi Cycle's individual songs; West 1997, ch. 6, on the Kumarbi Cycle as the central transmission case; Smith, M.S., **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume I**, VTSup 55 (Leiden: Brill, 1994); Smith, M.S. and Pitard, W.T., **The Ugaritic Baal Cycle, Volume II**, VTSup 114 (Leiden: Brill, 2009).

[6] Day, J., **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea** (Cambridge: Cambridge University Press, 1985), chs. 1–5, on the seven-passage Yahweh-combat corpus and on the Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible continuity argument; per chapters/08-yahweh-leviathan-rahah.claims.approved.adoc line 14 on the seven-passage corpus; Yarbrow Collins, A., **The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation**, Harvard Dissertations in Religion 9 (Missoula, MT: Scholars Press, 1976), chs. 2–4.

[7] Per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml special_instructions on the progressive transmission framing and on the chapter's bounded-scope conclusion; per chapters/05-kumarbi-ullikummi.adoc, chapters/11-zeus-typhon.adoc, chapters/07-baal-yamm-lotan.adoc, chapters/08-yahweh-leviathan-rahah.adoc, chapters/09-revelation-red-dragon.adoc, chapters/03-marduk-tiamat.adoc, chapters/12-greek-dragons-after-typhon.adoc, and chapters/10-christian-reception.adoc on the per-tradition narrative-and-source treatment that the present chapter does not duplicate.

[8] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Kumarbi Cycle as the central documentary case for Near-Eastern-to-Greek transmission of theogonic and combat material into Hesiod's **Theogony**; Hoffner 1998, introduction and §§14–18, on the Boğazköy provenance and the cycle's general framework.

[9] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on the Boğazköy provenance, the Middle and New Hittite manuscript distribution, and the cycle's general framework.

[10] Hoffner 1998, introduction, on the Hurrian substrate of the cycle, its Hittite-language transmission, and the mixed Hurrian / Akkadian theonymy.

[11] Hoffner 1998, §§14–18, on the use of the Hurrian theonym Teshub throughout the cycle; Hoffner 1998, introduction, on Tarūnna and Teshub as the Hittite and Hurrian forms of the storm-god across the Anatolian linguistic layers.

[12] Hoffner 1998, §14 (Kingship in Heaven), on the four-stage succession Alalu → Anu → Kumarbi → Teshub and the nine-year reigns of the first two sovereigns.

[13] Hoffner 1998, §14 (Kingship in Heaven), on Kumarbi's deposition of Anu by genital castration and swallowing, and on the conception of Teshub from Anu's seed inside Kumarbi's body.

[14] West 1966, on Theog. 154–210 on the Ouranos-Kronos-Zeus succession and on the castration of Ouranos by Kronos at Theog. 154–182.

[15] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Hurro-Hittite-Hesiodic correspondence of the genital-castration motif as one of the closest motif-specific parallels in the comparative-mythological literature; Hoffner 1998, §14 (Kingship in Heaven), on the Hurro-Hittite genital-castration narrative.

[16] West 1997, ch. 6, on the swallowed-stone correspondence between Kronos's child-swallowing-and-stone-substitution and Kumarbi's ingestion of stones in Kingship in Heaven; Hoffner 1998, §14 (Kingship in Heaven), on the broken passages surrounding Kumarbi's ingestion of stones.

[17] Hoffner 1998, §15 (Song of Ullikummi), on the conception of Ullikummi on a rock, his hiding on Upelluri's shoulder, his growth toward heaven, and Ea's severing-cut as the resolution.

[18] West 1966, on Theog. 820–880 (the Typhonomachy) and on Theog. 821–822 (Typhoeus's parentage from Gaia and Tartarus); Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Hesiodic Typhonomachy as the earliest Greek dragon-combat narrative.

[19] West 1997, ch. 6, on the lithic / cosmographic register of the Ullikummi-Typhon parallel as one of the closest concrete and specific motif correspondences between the Kumarbi Cycle and the Greek Typhonomachy tradition; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the post-Hesiodic Typhon's lithic / volcanic locus.

[20] Hoffner 1998, §16 (Song of Hedammu), on the Hedammu narrative's fragmentary state and on Šauška's seduction-stratagem; per brief 05-kumarbi-ullikummi.yaml lacunae on the disconnected-passages preservation of the Song of Hedammu.

[21] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Hedammu seduction-stratagem and the marine-register correspondences with Apollodoran-and-Nonnian Typhon; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on Apollodorus **Bibliotheca** 1.6.3 and Nonnus **Dionysiaca** 1–2 as the post-Hesiodic Typhon expansions.

- [22] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Elkunirsa-Apollodoran sinew-theft correspondence; Hoffner 1998, on the Elkunirsa-and-Ašertu fragment in the Hittite corpus; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Apollodoran sinew-theft and the Corycian-cave locus.
- [23] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Cilician geography of the Corycian cave; West 1997, ch. 6, on the orientaling-contact significance of the Cilician anchorage as a transmission-corridor anchor; Burkert 1992, on Cilicia as a documented transmission contact zone.
- [24] West 1997, ch. 6, on Philo of Byblos's Sanchuniathon-derived Phoenician theogony as a Phoenician-stage intermediate between the Hurro-Hittite and the Hesiodic theogonies; Hoffner 1998, on the Kumarbi-Cycle succession-sequence as the Hurro-Hittite end of the chain.
- [25] West 1997, ch. 6, on Philo of Byblos and the Sanchuniathon-Eusebius transmission chain; the chapter names Philo of Byblos in body prose without anchoring a primary citation to his work directly, since his fragments are cited via West 1997 rather than through a separately pinned critical edition.
- [26] This parallel is speculative. Basis: West 1997 ch. 6 on the Cilician geography of the Apollodoran Corycian-cave locus and on Cilicia's documented orientaling-period contact-zone status; Burkert 1992 on Phoenician trading-network presence at Cilician ports; Ogden 2013 ch. 2 on Pindar **Pythian** 1.16–17 attesting the Cilician-origin specification already in the early-fifth-century-BCE record; the upstream Ch7 anchoring of Baal's seat at 𐎧𐎶𐎵𐎶 / Mount Aqra in the same Levantine-coastal region. The main counterargument: the Cilician anchorage of Greek Typhon may be an internal-Greek geographical innovation (a topographical specification of the post-Hesiodic Tartarus locus by poets familiar with Cilician volcanic and karst geography) rather than a memory of a specific contact-point; the Apollodoran-and-Pindaric Cilician geography post-dates Hesiod by centuries, and the absence of a Cilician geography in the Hesiodic Typhonomachy itself (Hesiod casts Typhoeus into Tartarus, not under Etna or in Cilicia) is consistent with the Cilician specification's being an internal-Greek elaboration; the West-Burkert reading of Cilicia as a contact-point inference is supported but not strictly demonstrated by the geographical evidence alone.
- [27] West 1997, ch. 6, on the convergent-evidence structure of the Kumarbi-Hesiod transmission case and on the chronological transmission window; Burkert 1992, on the orientaling-period Phoenician-mediation argument and on the early-Iron-Age chronology.
- [28] West 1997, ch. 6, on the non-exclusivity of inheritance and transmission readings for the Greek material; Watkins 1995, ch. 46, on the Hesiodic Typhonomachy as an IE §III reflex.
- [29] Inference: West 1997 ch. 6 self-presents as a comprehensive treatment of West Asiatic elements in Greek poetry and myth, with the Kumarbi Cycle as the central documented case; Burkert 1992 corroborates the orientaling-period transmission framework on the Greek-end art-and-craft evidence; the post-1997 comparative-mythological literature (Mondi 1990, López-Ruiz 2010, Rutherford 2020) treats the West-Burkert framework as the consensus reading of the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route. Risk: alternative readings of the Kumarbi-Hesiod parallels are possible — for example, the parallels could be read as independent realisations of an Indo-European theogonic substrate, or as the result of a more diffuse "Eastern Mediterranean koine" rather than a specific Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek transmission line; the West-Burkert reading is the modern consensus but not the only available reading of the evidence.
- [30] Burkert 1992, **The Orientalizing Revolution: Near Eastern Influence on Greek Culture in the Early Archaic Age**, on Phoenician intermediaries as the principal channel for orientaling-period transmission; West 1997, ch. 6, treating the Phoenician-mediation reading as complementary to the Hurro-Hittite route.
- [31] Smith 1994, Vol. I, on the KTU 1.1–1.2 Baal-Yamm combat material; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, on the KTU 1.3–1.4 palace-building material and on the Lôtan passage at KTU 1.5 i 1–3.
- [32] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on 𐎧𐎶𐎵𐎶 as Baal's mountain; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction on the geography of 𐎧𐎶𐎵𐎶 (Jebel al-Aqra) and the wider Levantine geographical anchoring of the Cycle; per glossary.yaml on "𐎧𐎶𐎵𐎶 / Mount Zaphon" with the locked rendering.
- [33] West 1997, ch. 6, on the 𐎧𐎶𐎵𐎶 / Mount Aqra anchorage of Ugaritic Baal material and its proximity to the Cilician anchorage of Greek Typhon; Burkert 1992, on the Levantine-coast contact zones and the orientaling-period transmission corridor; Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on 𐎧𐎶𐎵𐎶's geographical position.
- [34] Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Apollodoran **Bibliotheca** 1.6.3 geographical itinerary including Mount Casius (Syria); West 1997, ch. 6, on the identification of the Greek Mount Casius with the Ugaritic 𐎧𐎶𐎵𐎶 and the modern Jebel al-Aqra; Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the same identification at the Ugaritic end.
- [35] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Mount Casius / 𐎧𐎶𐎵𐎶 / Aqra identification as a documented physical contact-point; Burkert 1992, on the orientaling-period contact zones along the Levantine and Cilician coast; Ogden 2013, ch. 2, on the Greek-end attestation of the contact-point in Apollodoran narrative.
- [36] Burkert 1992, on the orientaling-horizon pattern of cultural transmission across alphabet-script, bronze-working, religious iconography, and combat-myth material; West 1997, ch. 6, on the convergent-evidence cross-domain transmission framework.
- [37] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Baal-Yamm-Lôtan / Zeus-Typhon motif-specific structural correspondences; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, on the seven-headed Lôtan at KTU 1.5 i 1–3; West 1966, on Theog. 824–828 on the hundred serpent-heads of Hesiodic Typhoeus.
- [38] West 1997, ch. 6, on the network character of the orientaling-period transmission corridor; Burkert 1992, on the Phoenicians as heirs of the Levantine literary culture and as transmission-agents into early Archaic Greek poetry; Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on the Levantine-Anatolian cultural contact zone in the Late Bronze Age.
- [39] West 1997, ch. 6, on the inferential character of the Ugaritic-Greek transmission relationship at the level of textual quotation;

Burkert 1992, on the orientalizing-period cultural-transmission pattern as the principal evidence for the transmission relationship.

[40] Inference: Burkert 1992 on Phoenicians as transmission-agents and as heirs of the Levantine literary culture that included Ugaritic-language scribal training in the Late Bronze Age; West 1997 ch. 6 on the motif-specific Ugaritic-Greek correspondences (multi-headed *Lôtan* / multi-headed Typhoeus; storm-god / sea-adversary structure; *Ḫapānu* / Mount Casius geographical anchoring); the post-Late-Bronze-Age Phoenician inheritance of the Northwest Semitic literary tradition that included Ugarit's combat-myth corpus. Risk: the Ugaritic Baal Cycle is itself a Late-Bronze-Age corpus (c. 1400–1200 BCE) and the Phoenician trading networks of the orientalizing period (eighth and seventh centuries BCE) are separated from Ugarit by some six centuries — the inference that specifically Ugaritic material survived in Phoenician transmission is supported by the structural correspondences but not by directly attested textual continuity in the Phoenician-period record; the Phoenicians may have transmitted a generic Northwest Semitic combat-myth pattern rather than specifically Ugaritic narrative content.

[41] West 1997, ch. 6, on the §I-and-§II convergent reading of the Hurro-Hittite and Levantine routes and on the relative evidential weight of the two routes; Burkert 1992, on the Phoenician-mediated channel's inferential character at the level of textual quotation; per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml special_instructions on the progressive evidential framing.

[42] Day 1985, **God's Conflict with the Dragon and the Sea**, chs. 1–5, on the Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible continuity argument as the principal twentieth-century reading of the Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus.

[43] Day 1985, chs. 1–5, on the seven-passage corpus; per chapters/08-yahweh-leviathan-rahab.claims.approved.adoc line 14 on the same canonical enumeration of the seven-passage corpus including Isa 27:1.

[44] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the Ugaritic *Lôtan* / Hebrew Leviathan linguistic cognancy as one of the strongest pieces of evidence for direct continuity between Ugaritic and Hebrew Bible combat imagery; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, on the Ugaritic *ltn* at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 and on the Northwest Semitic phonological correspondence with Hebrew *lwytn*; per glossary.yaml on "*Lôtan*" with the locked rendering and on "*Leviathan*" with the locked Hebrew Bible rendering.

[45] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, on the seven-headed *Lôtan* at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 as embedded in Mot's boast; Day 1985, ch. 1, on the seven-headed morphology's correspondence with the multi-headed Leviathan of Psalm 74:14.

[46] Day 1985, ch. 1, on Psalm 74:13–14 and the philological significance of the plural "heads" of Leviathan; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, on the Ugaritic *ltn*'s seven-headed morphology at KTU 1.5 i 1–3.

[47] Day 1985, chs. 1, 3, on the Isaiah 27:1 / KTU 1.5 i 1–3 verbatim epithet-pair correspondence as one of the strongest pieces of evidence for direct Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible literary transmission; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, on the Ugaritic epithet-pair *bḫn brḫ* / *bḫn qqltn* at KTU 1.5 i 1–3.

[48] Day 1985, ch. 1, on Psalm 89:9–13 and the Rahab-as-rival-monster reading; Day 1985, ch. 1, on the Hebrew Bible / Ugaritic / Marduk structural-and-philological gradient.

[49] Day 1985, ch. 4, on Job 41's pedagogical-and-didactic register and on Leviathan as wonder-creature within the Hebrew Bible Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus.

[50] Day 1985, ch. 5, on Habakkuk 3 and the Hebrew-Bible storm-theophany pattern as continuous with the Ugaritic Baal storm-theophany.

[51] Day 1985, chs. 1–2, on the Northwest Semitic linguistic-and-cultural continuity between Ugarit and the Israelite kingdoms; Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on the Ugaritic-Hebrew Northwest Semitic relationship.

[52] Day 1985, chs. 1–2, on the Late-Bronze-Age Ugaritic provenance and the Iron-Age Hebrew Bible terminus; Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on the Ugaritic Late-Bronze-Age dating.

[53] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on the rival-sovereignty reading of the Hebrew Bible Yahweh-vs-Leviathan corpus; Day 1985, ch. 1, on the Gunkel-1895 cosmogonic-disorder reading; per the upstream Ch8 framing on the Day-and-Ballentine common-ground reading of the Ugaritic-Hebrew Bible imagery continuity.

[54] Inference: Day 1985 ch. 1 on the *Lôtan* / Leviathan linguistic cognancy and the Isa 27:1 / KTU 1.5 epithet-pair verbatim correspondence as the strongest direct-transmission evidence; Smith 1994 Vol. I introduction on the Ugaritic-Hebrew Northwest Semitic linguistic relationship; the orientalizing-period cultural-geographical context within which Hebrew Bible poets composed in continuity with Northwest Semitic literary norms. Risk: the absence of a directly attested intermediate textual corpus (between Late-Bronze-Age Ugarit and Iron-Age Israelite poetry) means the route is inferential at the level of textual transmission, even where it is directly attested at the level of phraseology; the alternative inference — that Hebrew Bible poets and Ugaritic scribes drew independently on a shared Northwest Semitic poetic vocabulary without specifically Ugaritic intermediate transmission — is consistent with the same surface evidence and is sometimes preferred in the more recent comparative-Northwest-Semitic literature.

[55] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the philological-and-structural strength of the Ugaritic-into-Israelite route; West 1997, ch. 6, on the Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek route's structural correspondences; per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml special_instructions on Hurro-Hittite-into-Greek as "almost inescapable" and Ugaritic-into-Israelite as "also strong".

[56] Yarbro Collins 1976, **The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation**, chs. 2–4, on the Leto-Apollo-Python primary substrate, the Jewish-overlay material, and the Second Temple satanological identification; Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the eclectic-composite reading of the same chapter.

[57] Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 1, on the Domitianic dating; Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 4, on the political reading of Rev 12; Aune

1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52A), introduction, on the dating evidence and the Asian-province context.

[58] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, on the seven-episode structure of Rev 12; Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the structural articulation.

[59] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, stating the Leto-Apollo-Python primary-substrate thesis and citing Hyginus **Fabulae** 140 as the principal extant exemplar; Fontenrose 1959, **Python: A Study of Delphic Myth and Its Origins**, on the same plot as analysed comparatively.

[60] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 2, on the four-correspondence Leto-Apollo-Python / Rev 12 structural parallel; Fontenrose 1959, on the Leto-Apollo-Python plot as the Greek combat-myth exemplar.

[61] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the Jewish-overlay material — the seven-headed dragon, the "ancient serpent" Genesis-3 identification, and the Michael-Daniel-War-Scroll combat tradition; Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52B), on the same Jewish-overlay material at Rev 12:3, 12:7, and 12:9.

[62] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the Rev 12:3 seven-headed dragon as a third-stage descendant of the Ugaritic Lôtan via the Hebrew Bible Leviathan; Day 1985, ch. 1, on the Ugaritic Lôtan / Hebrew Leviathan continuity; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, on the seven-headed Lôtan at KTU 1.5 i 1–3.

[63] Yarbrow Collins 1976, ch. 3, on the Rev 12:9 satanological gloss and on the multi-source identification; Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:9, on the same gloss.

[64] Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, stating the eclectic-composite thesis with Jewish, Greek, and Egyptian streams; Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 2–3, by contrast on the Leto-Apollo-Python primary-substrate reading.

[65] Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 2–4, on the Leto-Apollo-Python primary-substrate reading; Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12, on the eclectic-composite reading; per chapters/09-revelation-red-dragon.adoc on the side-by-side framing of the two readings.

[66] Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 2–4, on the composite character of Rev 12's source-relationship and on the Rev 12:15 watery-adversary intertext; Aune 1997–98, **Revelation** (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12 and Rev 12:15; Day 1985, chs. 1–2, on the Hebrew Bible Yahweh-vs-sea tradition that supplies the substrate; per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml structure section IV on the Rev 12 composite framing.

[67] Inference: Yarbrow Collins 1976 ch. 3 on the Hebrew Bible / Ugaritic background of the Rev 12:3 seven-headed dragon; Day 1985 ch. 1 on the Lôtan / Leviathan linguistic cognancy; Smith & Pitard 2009 Vol. II on the seven-headed Lôtan at KTU 1.5 i 1–3; the convergence of motif (seven heads), naming (the dragon-as-serpent identification at Rev 12:9 invoking Hebrew Bible Leviathan tradition), and reception-history (the Hebrew Bible's documented absorption of the Ugaritic Lôtan material per §III). Risk: multi-headed monsters are a wide-distribution motif in ancient Near Eastern and Mediterranean combat-myth material (Hesiodic Typhoeus's hundred heads at Theog. 824–828; the Hydra in the Greek tradition; Aži Dahāka's three heads in the Iranian tradition), and the Rev 12:3 seven-headed dragon could be read as a synthetic morphology drawn from the wider repertoire rather than as a specifically Ugaritic-Hebrew-Bible inheritance; the third-stage transmission inference is supported by the §III precedent but not strictly required by the surface evidence of Rev 12 alone.

[68] Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 2–4, on Rev 12 as a synthesising confluence of the upstream Mediterranean transmission routes; per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml structure section IV on the composite-source framing.

[69] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the post-Wellhausen and post-Gunkel debate over the Marduk-into-Genesis-1 transmission case as less decisively documented than the Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible case; Gunkel 1895, Teil I, on the original Marduk-Genesis-1 transmission argument; per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml structure section V on the less-decisively-documented framing.

[70] Lambert 2013, **Babylonian Creation Myths**, introduction and pp. 3–15 manuscript catalogue, on the seventy-plus witnesses and the standard critical edition; Foster 2005, **Before the Muses**, pp. 436–486, on the standard English translation; per chapters/03-marduk-tiamat.claims.approved.adoc on the source-anchoring conventions.

[71] Lambert 2013, Tablets I and IV, on Marduk's defeat of Tiamat and the body-splitting cosmogony; Foster 2005, pp. 441–462, on the same.

[72] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the structural difference between the Genesis 1 speech-act cosmogony and the **Enūma Eliš** combat-and-cosmogony; on the Genesis 1:2 *tehôm* as pre-creation watery state without personification; per glossary.yaml on *tehôm* with the locked italicised rendering.

[73] Gunkel 1895, Teil I, on the *tehôm*-Tiamat cognancy as the principal etymological exhibit for the Marduk-into-Genesis-1 transmission argument; per chapters/03-marduk-tiamat.claims.approved.adoc on Gunkel's 1895 argument.

[74] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the three principal post-Wellhausen objections to Gunkel's 1895 *tehôm*-Tiamat reading; on the absence of a documented mediating route comparable to those of the §I and §III cases.

[75] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the post-Wellhausen compositional reading of Genesis 1 that Tsumura develops; the chapter names Tsumura's **Creation and Destruction** (Eisenbrauns, revised edition 2005) in body prose as a named-but-flagged successor to the post-Wellhausen scepticism, with Day 1985 ch. 1 as the chapter's anchor for the post-Wellhausen reading.

[76] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the structural cosmogonic-sequence parallel between **Enūma Eliš** and Genesis 1; Lambert 2013, on the **Enūma Eliš** cosmogonic sequence at Tablets IV–VI.

[77] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the awareness-and-response framing for the Marduk-into-Genesis-1 case as structurally allusive rather

than philologically continuous; Day 1985, ch. 1, on the contrast with the §III Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible case.

[78] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the post-Wellhausen and post-Gunkel methodological division; the chapter does not adjudicate between the readings but presents the two options side by side, in keeping with the upstream Ch3 framing on the Marduk-Tiamat material's reception history.

[79] This parallel is speculative. Basis: Gunkel 1895 Teil I on the *tehôm*-Tiamat etymological cognancy and the cosmogonic-sequence parallel; Day 1985 ch. 1 on the awareness-and-response framing; the documented sixth-century-BCE Babylonian-exile contact between Israelite scribes and Akkadian literary materials, supplying a chronologically plausible transmission window; the Tablet-of-Destinies and Marduk-Apsû-Tiamat materials' centrality in the late-Neo-Babylonian and Persian-period *akîtu*-festival liturgical context, supplying a plausible context for sixth-century-BCE scribal exposure. The main counterargument: the post-Wellhausen and Tsumura-tradition position that the Genesis 1 *tehôm* is best read as a Hebrew common noun denoting the pre-creation watery state without specific Babylonian-derivation; the absence of a documented mediating route comparable to the Phoenician-trading-network corridor of §I-II or to the Ugaritic-Hebrew Northwest Semitic continuum of §III; the Genesis 1 narrative's structural character as a speech-act cosmogony rather than a combat-cosmogony, with no preserved Yahweh-vs-Tiamat episode; the Day 1985 / Tsumura preference for a compositional reading in which the parallels are explained by a shared ancient-Near-Eastern cosmogonic vocabulary rather than by direct borrowing — a position that is the modern post-Wellhausen consensus and is the principal reason §V is the chapter's weakest documented transmission case.

[80] Day 1985, ch. 1, on the structural-vs-philological evidential gap between the Marduk-into-Genesis-1 case and the Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible case, and on the open-question framing of the §V case; Lambert 2013, Tablet IV, on the Marduk-Tiamat combat narrative; per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml structure section V on the less-decisively-documented framing.

[81] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Mediterranean cluster as a chain of contact-relationships; Burkert 1992, on the orientализing-period transmission corridor; Day 1985, chs. 1–5, on the Ugaritic-into-Hebrew-Bible continuity; Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 2–4, on Rev 12 as a synthesising confluence; per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml structure section VI on the chain-rather-than-independent-attestations framing.

[82] Per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml structure section VI and special_instructions on the load-bearing methodological framing; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II on the Part-II comparative chapters' division of labour and the bounded scope of the typological argument.

[83] Per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml structure section VI on the independent-attestations argument; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II on the Part-II comparative chapters' coverage.

[84] Per chapters/14-indra-vrtra.adoc (Vedic Indra-Vṛtra), chapters/21-gonggong.adoc (Chinese Gonggong), chapters/22-hou-yi.adoc (Chinese Hou Yi), chapters/24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.adoc (Mexica Huitzilopochtli-Coatepec), chapters/25-mesoamerican-cluster.adoc (Mesoamerican cluster), chapters/26-pariacaca-amaru.adoc (Andean Pariacaca-Amaru), chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.adoc (Mwindo material), and chapters/38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.claims.adoc §VI on the Mwindo control case; per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" on the independent-attestation cases.

[85] Per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" on the independent-attestation cases; per chapters/21-gonggong.adoc, chapters/22-hou-yi.adoc, chapters/24-huitzilopochtli-coatepec.adoc, chapters/25-mesoamerican-cluster.adoc, chapters/26-pariacaca-amaru.adoc, and chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.adoc on the per-tradition independent provenance.

[86] Per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml structure section VI on the two-track typological reading; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II on the Part-II comparative chapters' division of labour.

[87] Per chapters/38-C5-ie-hero-slay-serpent-formula.claims.adoc §V on the inheritance-vs-transmission distinction; West 1997, ch. 6, on the joint relevance of IE inheritance and Near-Eastern transmission for the Greek material; Watkins 1995, ch. 46, on the Greek-end IE reflex.

[88] Per chapters/34-C1-combat-as-cosmogony.claims.adoc, chapters/35-C2-combat-as-sovereignty.claims.adoc, and chapters/36-C3-cyclical-maintenance.claims.adoc on the structural-typological readings; per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml structure section VI on the orthogonal-specification framing.

[89] West 1997, ch. 6; Burkert 1992; Day 1985, chs. 1–5; Yarbrow Collins 1976, chs. 2–4 on the four-anchor convergent reading of the Mediterranean transmission chain; per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml structure section VI on the chapter's overall finding.

[90] Per brief 39-C6-near-eastern-mediterranean-transmission.yaml special_instructions on the "do not overstate transmission; do not understate it either" framing of the chapter's bounded-scope conclusion; West 1997, ch. 6 and Burkert 1992 on the convergent-evidence reading of the Mediterranean transmission chain.

Chapter 41. C7. The Inversion Problem

41.1. Source overview

This chapter is the seventh of the eight Part-II comparative chapters and is positioned as the comparative chapter in which the chaoskampf typology's **edges** are tested most rigorously: the cases gathered in §§I–V are the cases at which the standard chaoskampf description either runs in reverse (the slaying of the serpent ends rather than establishes prosperity), is morally inverted (the slaying is hubris and is punished), or is held by area-specialists not to be a chaoskampf reading at all (the *wak'a*-succession reading of the Pariacaca cycle; the metallurgical-allegory reading of the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi episode).^[1]

The chapter draws on five Part-I chapters of the present book — Ch28 (Bida and the founding of Wagadu), Ch29 (Mwindo and Kiriμu), Ch19 §"Sigurd vs. Fáfnir" within the IE-reflexes chapter, Ch26 (Pariacaca and the *amaru*), and Ch23 (Susanoo vs. Yamata no Orochi) — and the per-tradition factual claims in §§I–V are routed through the same `sources.yaml` IDs that the Part-I chapters use for those facts: `conrad-west-africa` and `belcher-epic` for the Bida material, `biebuyck-mateene-mwindo` and `belcher-epic` for the Mwindo material, `watkins-1995` and `larrington-poetic-edda` for the Sigurd material, `salomon-urioste-huarochiri` for the Pariacaca material, and `naumann-mythen` and `philippi-kojiki` for the Susanoo material.^[2]

The chapter's principal anchors per brief `40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml` `sources.anchor` are six: Conrad 2005 (**Empires of Medieval West Africa**) on Bida and Wagadu; Belcher 1999 (**Epic Traditions of Africa**) on Bida and on Mwindo; Biebuyck and Mateene 1969 (**The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)**) as the primary text for Mwindo; Watkins 1995 (**How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**), ch. 42, on the Sigurd ambiguity; Naumann 1996 (**Die Mythen des alten Japan**) on Susanoo / Orochi as metallurgical allegory; and Salomon and Urioste 1991 (**The Huarochirí Manuscript**) on Pariacaca and the *amaru* as *wak'a*-succession.^[3]

The chapter's general comparative anchor for the long-arc combat-myth tradition against which the inversion cases are read is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), whose Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic survey supplies the long-arc combat-myth typology that the present chapter takes as one starting point and that Bida, Mwindo, the Sigurd-cycle long arc, the Pariacaca cycle, and the Susanoo / Orochi episode all complicate in different ways; the chapter's principal critical-typological anchor for the meta-claim that the chaoskampf category is itself elastic-to-the-point-of-imposition is Debra Scurlock Ballentine's **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2015), whose argument that the chaoskampf frame has been overextended in twentieth-century comparative scholarship supplies the chapter's §VI methodological warrant.^[4]

The chapter's structure follows the brief's six-section outline: §I treats Bida (Soninke / Wagadu) as the anchor case for the inversion problem, presenting the narrative's covenant-broken framing on the Soninke tradition's own terms before invoking the modern comparativist "inverse chaoskampf" overlay; §II treats Mwindo (Nyanga) as the full refusal, presenting the maturation-through-hubris framing on the Nyanga tradition's own terms before noting that the moral valence of the dragon-killing is inverted from chaoskampf rather than the outcome; §III treats Sigurd (Old Norse Eddic Sigurd-cycle) as the partial case in which Watkins's IE-formula reading and the long-arc tragedy of

the cycle pull in different directions; §IV treats Pariacaca (early-colonial Andean **Huarochirí Manuscript**) as an area-specialist refusal of the chaos-order framing in favour of *wak'a*-succession; §V treats Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi (early-Japanese imperial chronicles) as an area-specialist refusal in favour of metallurgical allegory and sword-etiology; §VI draws the methodological-typological lessons.^[5]

The chapter's central methodological commitment, registered in advance and demonstrated case-by-case in §§I–V, is that the **area-specialists speak first**: the Soninke covenant-frame for Bida (Conrad and Belcher), the Nyanga maturation-through-hubris frame for Mwindo (Biebuyck and Mateene), the *wak'a*-succession frame for Pariacaca (Salomon, Urioste, Taylor, Dean), and the metallurgical-allegory frame for Orochi (Naumann, Isomae, Como, Ooms) are presented on their own terms before the chapter invokes the chaoskampf category, and the chapter takes the resulting comparison to be more — not less — precise as a result; the methodological warrant is scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the priority of area-specialist framings, and the demonstration of the warrant is the chapter's principal contribution to the book's typological discipline.^[6]

What follows is organised in six body sections. Section I treats Bida (Soninke / Wagadu) as the chapter's anchor case, presenting the covenant-broken framing on the Soninke tradition's own terms before invoking the modern comparativist "inverse chaoskampf" overlay; section II treats Mwindo (Nyanga) as the full refusal, presenting the maturation-through-hubris framing on the Nyanga tradition's own terms before noting the moral-valence inversion; section III treats Sigurd (Old Norse Eddic Sigurd-cycle) as the partial case in which Watkins's IE-formula reading and the long-arc tragedy of the cycle pull in different directions; section IV treats Pariacaca (early-colonial Andean **Huarochirí Manuscript**) as an area-specialist refusal of the chaos-order framing in favour of *wak'a*-succession; section V treats Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi (early-Japanese imperial chronicles) as an area-specialist refusal in favour of metallurgical allegory and sword-etiology; section VI draws the methodological-typological lessons.

41.2. I. The anchor case — Bida and the covenant-broken framing of the Soninke Wagadu narrative

The Bida narrative is the chapter's anchor case for the inversion problem because the Soninke tradition's covenant-broken framing is best developed in the current English-language scholarship and because the inversion the comparativist sees runs at the level of outcome rather than at the level of the narrative's own categories.

The Soninke / Mande oral-tradition narrative of Bida and Wagadu, recorded across the late-nineteenth- and twentieth-century European-language ethnographic corpus and synthesised in current English-language scholarship by David Conrad's **Empires of Medieval West Africa: Ghana, Mali, and Songhay** (Facts on File, 2005) and Stephen Belcher's **Epic Traditions of Africa** (Indiana University Press, 1999), tells of the seven-headed serpent Bida who is the protector-spirit of the city of Wagadu — the historical western-Sahelian polity known in the Arabic-language chronicle tradition as Ghana, distinct from the modern nation-state of the same name — and to whom the city's prosperity is bound by an annual covenant whose principal stipulation is the delivery of a young woman as tribute, with the city's continued flourishing contingent on the maintenance of the covenant.^[7]

The covenant's narrative-structural role within the Soninke tradition's own framing is the load-

bearing organising principle of the entire narrative arc, not a peripheral motif: the city of Wagadu exists **because** of the covenant with Bida, the city's prosperity **consists in** the rains that fall and the gold that is dug, and the city's eventual abandonment is presented as the **consequence** of breaking the covenant — the narrative's cosmography is the already-existing Sahelian world of Soninke ethnogeographic memory rather than a cosmogonically-emerging cosmos, and the narrative's own logic is contractual-and-aetiological rather than cosmogonic.^[8]

The covenant's principal stipulation — the annual delivery of a young Soninke woman to Bida — is not a free-floating dragon-feeding motif but is bound up with the city's specifically-named institutions: the rulers of Wagadu maintain the covenant on the city's behalf, the population of the city contributes to its ritual maintenance, and the maiden delivered each year is identified by name and lineage in the recorded versions, with her selection (and her family's standing) participating in the city's social-political fabric rather than being an anonymous "victim of the dragon" in the European chivalric-romance sense.^[9]

The covenant's breaking is precipitated by the suitor Mamadi Sefe Dekote — a figure whose name varies somewhat across the recorded versions (Mamadi Sefe Dekote being the standard form per current Soninke-tradition scholarship in Belcher 1999 and Conrad 2005) — when his beloved is selected as the year's tribute and he, refusing to allow her to be delivered to Bida, ambushes the serpent at the moment of the annual offering and kills him; the narrative's recorded versions specify the manner of the killing (decapitation, with the seven heads severed in succession) and the location (the place of the annual offering, in the city's ritual landscape) with sufficient consistency across the recordings that the killing is securely the narrative's central act, and the narrative arc that follows the killing is the narrative's distinctive feature — not the killing itself, but its consequences.^[10]

The consequences of the killing, in the recorded versions of the Soninke narrative, are catastrophic and explicitly framed as the covenant's broken-state coming due: the rains stop, the springs dry, the gold ceases to be found, and the population of Wagadu disperses across the western Sahel — with the dispersal supplying the narrative's foundation-charter for the Soninke diaspora that current Soninke communities trace to the abandonment of the polity, and with the dryland Sahelian landscape of present-day Mauritania, western Mali, and adjacent regions being read in the tradition as the visible aftermath of the covenant's breaking.^[11]

The narrative's **internal** moral evaluation of the covenant-breaking is, on the evidence of the recorded versions and as Belcher 1999 and Conrad 2005 read them, neither univocally condemnatory of Mamadi Sefe Dekote nor univocally exculpatory: the suitor acts to save his beloved and the narrative grants him the legitimacy of the rescuing-suitor role, but the narrative also registers the destruction of Wagadu as the consequence of his act, with the result that the Soninke tradition's framing presents the dilemma at the heart of the narrative — the conflict between an individual's claim on his beloved and the collective covenant on which the city's prosperity rests — without resolving the dilemma in favour of either claim, and the narrative's didactic register is the registration of the dilemma rather than its adjudication.^[12]

The covenant-broken framing has no need of the *chaoskampf* category to make sense of itself: the narrative's protagonists, motivations, and consequences are exhausted within the covenant-and-consequence frame, and a hearer who reads the narrative within the Soninke tradition's own moral and aetiological registers does not require any concept of "primordial chaos" or "cosmos-establishing combat" to follow what happens or to take the moral point — the narrative is

complete within its own categories, and the chaoskampf reading of it is an **additional** analytic move performed from outside the Soninke tradition by a reader whose reading apparatus has been formed elsewhere.^[13]

Once the area-specialists' framing is in place, the comparativist's "inverse chaoskampf" reading of the narrative can be registered without subordinating the area-specialists' framing to it: read against the long-arc combat-myth typology that Forsyth 1987 surveys (Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic), the Bida narrative **does** exhibit a striking inversion of the standard typological outcome — the slaying of the serpent does not establish prosperity, it ends it; the serpent is not the cosmos's adversary, it is the city's protector; and the killing does not deliver order, it delivers the dryland Sahel — and the inversion is structurally legible as soon as the typology is brought to bear, even though the inversion itself is not what the Soninke tradition is **doing** with the narrative on its own terms.^[14]

The "inverse chaoskampf" framing is therefore a real comparative observation but also a **modern overlay**: the Soninke griot tradition that transmits the narrative does not need the chaoskampf category to recite or to interpret it, the audiences who hear the narrative within Soninke communities do not encounter it as the inverse of any other narrative they know, and the inversion-reading exists at the level of the typological synthesis that the comparativist performs from the outside — a real reading, but one whose epistemic standing is comparativist-typological rather than tradition-internal.^[15]

*[Appropriation flag: the area-specialist objection registered here is that the Bida / Wagadu narrative's own framing within the Soninke / Mande oral tradition is covenant-broken — a contractual-and-aetiological framing in which the city's prosperity rests on a maintained covenant with the protector-serpent and ends with the covenant's breaking — and not "inverse chaoskampf", a frame imported from the comparative typology of Eurasian combat-myth scholarship and applied to the Soninke material from outside; the objection is not that the chaoskampf typology fails to capture anything about the narrative (the narrative does include a serpent-killing, and the inversion-of-outcome is structurally legible against the typology) but that the typology mis-locates the narrative's load-bearing categories: where chaoskampf places "cosmos versus chaos" and "order-establishment by combat" at the centre, the Soninke framing places "covenant versus covenant-breaking" and "consequence-of-breaking-the-covenant" at the centre, and the two frames are structurally different rather than mirror-image. Specialists named: David Conrad (**Empires of Medieval West Africa**, 2005, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend; in sources.yaml as conrad-west-africa) and Stephen Belcher (**Epic Traditions of Africa**, 1999, ch. on Soninke traditions; in sources.yaml as belcher-epic) are the principal English-language area-specialist anchors for the covenant-broken reading; the wider Mande-area area-specialist tradition associated with Charles Monteil's "La légende du Ouagadou" (1953 IFAN-Dakar; named in body prose at Ch28 per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern) and with Germaine Dieterlen and the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest (named in body prose at Ch28 per the same pattern) supplies the wider area-specialist scholarly tradition within which Conrad and Belcher's English-language synthesis is set. Tier implication: scope.md classifies the Bida / Wagadu narrative as RELATED-tier (full, inversion anchor) rather than CORE-tier precisely because the area-specialist framing is covenant-broken rather than chaoskampf-inverted, and the chaoskampf reading is registered as a comparativist overlay rather than as a tradition-internal feature; the tier-classification is itself a recognition of the area-specialists' priority. Carried forward to: this APPROPRIATION-FLAG is engaged at length in the present comparative chapter (Ch40, the inversion problem) and again in Ch41 (the refusal-and-appropriation problem), where the meta-question of*

what comparativism owes the area-specialists when the typology's own categories are contested is the chapter's organising question.]

The methodological pay-off of presenting the covenant-broken framing first, before invoking the inverse-chaoskampf overlay, is that the comparison the chapter performs is **more** precise rather than less: the chaoskampf typology is not asked to do work the narrative resists, the area-specialists' framing is not subordinated to a comparative apparatus that does not fit it, and the comparison between the Bida narrative and the Eurasian combat-myth corpus can proceed at the level of **structural inversion of one feature** (the slaying ends prosperity rather than establishing it) without forcing the comparison through a categorical apparatus (cosmos versus chaos) that the Soninke material does not employ.^[16]

The Bida narrative's textual situation reinforces the methodological point: the narrative is preserved entirely in late-nineteenth- and twentieth-century European-language ethnographic recordings of Soninke griots and tradition-bearers (Frobenius's **Atlantis** IV–VI from 1921 onward; Monteil's "La légende du Ouagadou" of 1953 in IFAN-Dakar; the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest tradition associated with Germaine Dieterlen from the 1940s onward), with no pre-modern manuscript attestation and with the post-colonial-anthropology filtering caveat that the Frobenius and Monteil strands of the recording corpus require — and the recording-history situation is itself a reason to take the Soninke tradition's **own** framing seriously rather than assimilating the narrative to a comparative typology developed for materials with quite different textual situations.^[17]

The comparative observation the chapter takes from §I, registered in advance of the Mwindo case in §II, is that the Bida narrative's **outcome** is inverted relative to the Eurasian combat-myth typology (the slaying ends rather than establishes prosperity), and the **internal moral evaluation** of the inversion within the Soninke tradition is the dilemma-registration that Belcher 1999 and Conrad 2005 both observe — neither vindicating the slayer nor exonerating the city's covenant-maintainers — and that the comparison's interesting feature is not the inversion per se but the area-specialist framing that makes the inversion legible **as a structural observation** rather than as a moral or theological claim about either tradition.^[18]

41.3. II. The full refusal — Mwindo and the Nyanga maturation-through-hubris framing

The Mwindo / Kirimu episode is the chapter's most pointed area-specialist refusal of the chaoskampf typology's moral-cosmographic apparatus, and the section presents the Nyanga tradition's maturation-through-hubris framing on its own terms before noting that the moral valence of the dragon-killing is the precise contrary of the typology's standard valuation.

The Nyanga oral epic of Mwindo, recorded in 1956 from the named narrator Shé-Kárisi Candi Rureke at Bese on the upper Oso river in the Kivu region of what was then the eastern Belgian Congo and published in Daniel Biebuyck and Kahombo C. Mateene's **The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)** (University of California Press, 1969) as the standard English-language critical edition and translation, presents the dragon-slaying not as the establishing act of cosmic order or of the hero's sovereignty but as an act of hubristic over-reach for which the sky-god Nkuba punishes the hero — a structural and moral feature of the recorded performance that Biebuyck and Mateene 1969 and Belcher 1999 (**Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Mwindo) both develop as the load-bearing didactic register of the Kirimu episode within the wider epic.^[19]

The Nyanga tradition's own framing of the Mwindo epic — as Biebuyck and Mateene 1969 develop it from the recorded performance and as Belcher 1999 reads it within the comparative African-oral-epic apparatus — is a connected biographical-and-moral narrative of the hero's life, not a cosmogonic narrative: the cosmos is already in place when the epic begins, layered into Nkuba's sky-realm above, Muisa's underworld below, and Iyangura's river-and-water realm laterally; Mwindo's miraculous birth, his disputes with his father Shemwindo (chief of Tubondo, hostile to the son's birth), his journeys across the human and spirit worlds, his testing by the powers above and below, and his eventual chastened return as a properly-formed chief organise the epic from beginning to end, and the hero's biographical-and-moral arc is the compositional centre rather than the establishment of any cosmographic frame.^[20]

The middle-epic passages of the recorded performance present Mwindo's accumulating power as **increasingly dangerous**: the hero's aunts and various other figures along the way warn him repeatedly that his power is exceeding what is permitted, the formulaic refrains and direct narrative comments register the powers above and below as watching the hero's career with a view to the eventual moment at which the correction will fall, and the audience is prepared by these passages to read the Kirimu episode when it arrives as the moment for which the foreshadowing pattern has been preparing — not as a triumph but as an act for which the hero will be answerable.^[21]

Kirimu — the dragon at the chapter's narrative centre — is presented in the recorded performance as a being of the spirit world whose existence is part of the cosmographic equilibrium between the human and spirit realms, not as a cosmic adversary whose defeat is the cosmos's establishment; the dragon's narrative-structural role is to be the cosmographic counterpart whose presence the human world must respect, and the hero's killing of him is registered in the recorded performance — by formulaic refrains and direct narrative comments — as an **unsanctioned act of human power against the spirit world** rather than as an act of cosmos-ordering.^[22]

The killing itself, in the recorded performance, is completed without any of the order-establishing apparatus that the chaoskampf typology expects at this point: there is no narrative passage in which the killing of the dragon establishes the hero's sovereignty, no passage in which the cosmos is reorganised around the dragon's defeat, no festival celebrating the killing as cosmic-order-establishing — the hero kills the dragon, takes the carcass or pieces of it back toward the human settlements, and the narrative immediately turns to Nkuba's response-passage; the **structural absence** of order-establishing apparatus is itself one of the recorded performance's load-bearing features for the Nyanga tradition's reading of the episode.^[23]

Nkuba's response is immediate, deliberate, and morally-motivated: the sky-god descends in lightning, seizes the hero out of the human world, and conveys him by lightning from the forest-and-village landscape upward into the celestial realm, where Mwindo is subjected to a sequence of trials and humiliations — exposure to extreme heat and cold, compulsion to endure the celestial powers' direct presence in a way that strips him of his heroic confidence, and explicit instruction about the limits of his power and the necessity of recognising the cosmographic authority of the powers above — that the recorded performance presents not as arbitrary cruelty but as a structurally-necessary correction of the hero's hubristic over-reach.^[24]

The conditions Nkuba imposes on Mwindo's return to the human world are explicit, named, and binding within the recorded performance's framing: the hero is required to renounce certain practices, to accept the binding force of the cosmographic limits the celestial powers have set, and

to commit to a chastened mode of conduct as a properly-formed chief on his return — and the hero's eventual restoration to the forest-and-village landscape is conditional and supervised, registered in the recorded performance as a return on the celestial powers' terms rather than as a triumphant homecoming on the hero's own terms.^[25]

The post-Kirimu narrative continuation in the wider epic presents the chastened hero as at last in a position to assume the chiefly office for which the early-and-middle epic's father-son conflict has been preparing him — the chiefly succession being narratively conditional on the hero's having undergone the celestial humiliation and on his having accepted the cosmographic limits the celestial powers have imposed — and the moral-developmental shape of the epic's overall arc is therefore the **maturation-through-humiliation** pattern that Biebuyck and Mateene 1969 identify as the narrative's didactic kernel and that Belcher 1999 reads as the load-bearing feature distinguishing the Mwindo material from the Eurasian combat-myth corpus.^[26]

The maturation-through-hubris framing has, like the covenant-broken framing of §I, no need of the chaoskampf category to make sense of itself: the hero's biographical arc, his accumulation of power, the foreshadowing of correction, the killing as transgressive over-reach, the celestial humiliation, the chastened return, and the chiefly succession are all internal to the Nyanga tradition's own moral-didactic and reciprocal-balance registers, and a hearer who reads the recorded performance within those registers does not require any concept of "primordial chaos" or "cosmos-establishing combat" to follow what happens or to take the moral point — the narrative is **complete** within its own categories, and the chaoskampf reading of the Kirimu episode is an **additional** analytic move performed from outside the Nyanga tradition by a reader whose reading apparatus has been formed elsewhere.^[27]

The Mwindo / Kirimu episode is therefore not an **inversion** of the chaoskampf typology in the sense of Bida (where the **outcome** is inverted: slaying ends rather than establishes prosperity), but an **inversion of moral valence**: the killing is presented as hubris rather than as order-making, the dragon's death is registered as a transgression that demands correction rather than as the cosmogonic or sovereignty-establishing act, and the moral evaluation is the precise contrary of the chaoskampf typology's standard valuation of the hero's slaying — and this moral inversion is more pointed than Bida's outcome inversion because it leaves no narrative-structural space for reading the killing as a chaoskampf event whose moral framing has been negotiated downward; the killing is the episode at which a **categorically different** reading of the dragon-killing motif is in play.^[28]

The chapter's reading of the Mwindo material as a **refusal** of the chaoskampf typology's moral-cosmographic apparatus, rather than as a member of an "inverse chaoskampf" subtype within that apparatus, follows the area-specialist tradition that Biebuyck and Mateene 1969 anchor and that Belcher 1999 develops within the comparative African-oral-epic apparatus: the Nyanga tradition's framing — maturation-through-hubris, reciprocal balance between human and spirit worlds, the sky-god's authority over the hero — is the tradition's own categorical apparatus, and reading the Kirimu episode as the inverse of a Eurasian combat-myth pattern would be to subordinate the Nyanga categorical apparatus to a comparative typology developed for materials whose categorical apparatus is structurally different.^[29]

[Appropriation flag: the area-specialist objection registered here is that the Mwindo / Kirimu episode's own framing within the Nyanga oral tradition is maturation-through-hubris — a moral-didactic and reciprocal-balance framing in which the hero's killing of the dragon is registered as an unsanctioned act of human power against the spirit world that the sky-god Nkuba punishes by lightning-seizing and

celestial humiliation, and in which the killing's narrative function is to set up the hero's chastening and his eventual chastened assumption of the chiefly office — and not "inversion of cosmogony", a frame imported from the comparative typology of Eurasian combat-myth scholarship and applied to the Nyanga material from outside; the objection is more pointed than the Bida case (which is an inversion of **outcome** within a frame the Soninke tradition does not employ) because the Nyanga case is an inversion of **moral valence** on top of a categorical apparatus that the Nyanga tradition does not employ either, leaving the chaoskampf reading no negotiable space within the Nyanga tradition's own framing. Specialists named: Daniel Biebuyck and Kahombo C. Mateene (*The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)*, 1969, Kirimu episode and following celestial-journey passages; in *sources.yaml* as *biebuyck-mateene-mwindo*) are the principal area-specialist anchors for the maturation-through-hubris reading; Stephen Belcher (*Epic Traditions of Africa*, 1999, ch. on Mwindo; in *sources.yaml* as *belcher-epic*) is the principal comparative African-oral-epic synthesis anchor; the wider Nyanga-area area-specialist tradition associated with Biebuyck's later *Hero and Chief: Epic Literature from the Banyanga* (1978; named in body prose at Ch29 per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern) supplies the wider area-specialist scholarly tradition within which the Mwindo material is read. Tier implication: *scope.md* classifies the Mwindo material as CONTRASTIVE-tier (full) precisely because the area-specialist framing refuses the chaoskampf typology's moral-cosmographic apparatus rather than accommodating it as an inverse-chaoskampf instance, and the contrastive-tier classification is itself a recognition of the area-specialists' priority and of the "resistance is the data" discipline that the Mwindo material exemplifies. Carried forward to: this APPROPRIATION-FLAG is engaged at length in the present comparative chapter (Ch40, the inversion problem) as the most pointed of the chapter's cases, and again in Ch41 (the refusal-and-appropriation problem), where the meta-question of what comparativism owes the area-specialists when the typology's own categories are refused is the chapter's organising question; the Mwindo case is the strongest case in the present book for the appropriation-protocol's substantive bite.]

The Mwindo episode's recording-history situation is itself worth registering at this point because it bears on the methodological discipline §II applies: the recorded performance is a single 1956 field encounter at Bese with the named narrator Shé-Kárisi Candi Rureke, made within the late-Belgian-colonial-period ethnographic context of the eastern Belgian Congo, with no parallel deep ethnographic-recording corpus across decades to triangulate against and with the colonial-ethnographic compositional-context filtering that the situation introduces — and current Mwindo-studies scholarship including Biebuyck's own subsequent reflective treatments and Belcher 1999 reads the 1956 Rureke text critically as a starting point rather than as a transparently-faithful record of pre-colonial Nyanga performance, a methodological caution that is itself part of the area-specialist citation policy this chapter applies.^[30]

The methodological pay-off of presenting the maturation-through-hubris framing first, before invoking the chaoskampf-and-its-inversion overlay, is — as in §I — that the comparison the chapter performs is **more** precise rather than less: the chaoskampf typology is not asked to do work the Nyanga tradition refuses, the area-specialists' framing is not subordinated to a comparative apparatus the recorded performance does not employ, and the comparison between the Mwindo material and the Eurasian combat-myth corpus can proceed at the level of **categorical difference** (the Nyanga moral-cosmographic apparatus is structurally different from the chaoskampf moral-cosmographic apparatus) without forcing the comparison through a common categorical apparatus that would flatten the Nyanga material's distinctive contribution.^[31]

The contrast between Bida (§I) and Mwindo (§II) is itself instructive for the chapter's typological

work: where Bida's case is the inversion of the **outcome** of the chaoskampf typology (slaying ends rather than establishes prosperity) within a covenant-broken framing that does not employ chaoskampf categories, Mwindo's case is the inversion of the **moral valence** within a maturation-through-hubris framing that not only does not employ chaoskampf categories but explicitly refuses the moral evaluation that the typology assigns to the hero's slaying — and the two cases together demonstrate that the typology's "inversion" subtype is not a single phenomenon but a cluster of structurally-different area-specialist framings that the comparativist's "inverse chaoskampf" label flattens together at the cost of the area-specialists' precision.^[32]

41.4. III. The partial case — Sigurd, the IE formula, and the curse on the gold

Sigurd is the chapter's partial case, sitting on the edge of the IE-comparative tradition where Watkins's philological reading of the killing-stroke and the long-arc tragedy of the Sigurd-cycle pull the typology in different directions at different analytic levels.

The Old Norse Eddic Sigurd-cycle, preserved principally in the **Fáfnismál** of the Codex Regius (GKS 2365 4to, c. 1270 CE) — the second of the three closely-grouped Sigurd-cycle poems in the Codex (with **Reginismál** preceding and **Sigrdrífumál** following) — and cited in the present chapter through Carolynne Larrington's revised Oxford World's Classics translation of **The Poetic Edda** (Oxford University Press, 2014), presents a partial case for the inversion problem: Watkins 1995 reads the **Fáfnismál**'s diction as the strongest philological reflex of the reconstructed Indo-European poetic formula HERO SLAY SERPENT in the entire Indo-European corpus, but the long-arc tragedy of the Sigurd-cycle complicates the order-establishing-by-combat reading that the formula's surface structure would suggest.^[33]

The narrative core of the **Fáfnismál** is the killing of the dragon Fáfnir by the young hero Sigurd, son of Sigmund of the Völsung lineage and foster-son of the smith Regin (Fáfnir's brother): Sigurd ambushes the dragon by digging a pit on the dragon's path to the water, lying in wait below, and thrusting upward into Fáfnir's underbelly with the sword Gram (forged by Regin from the fragments of Sigmund's broken sword) as the dragon passes over the pit; the killing-stroke is delivered as the central act around which the poem's dialogue is organised, with the bulk of the **Fáfnismál** given over to the post-killing wisdom-dialogue between the dying dragon and the hero rather than to extended combat-narrative.^[34]

Watkins's IE-formula reading reads the **Fáfnismál**'s diction as a direct philological reflex of the reconstructed Indo-European poetic formula HERO SLAY SERPENT — the formula reconstructed across Vedic Indra-versus-Vṛtra material (where Watkins 1995 establishes the formula's reconstructed shape from the ṛgvedic diction), Greek and Iranian comparanda, and the Old Norse Eddic **Fáfnismál** itself — and the Eddic poet's choice of verb, object, and syntactic frame at the killing-stroke is the strongest philological evidence Watkins 1995 marshals for the formula's continued productivity at the diction-level in early-medieval Old Norse poetry; the Sigurd-Fáfnir killing is therefore an IE-poetic-formula reflex at the level of **language**, not just at the level of narrative motif.^[35]

The IE-formula reading, taken on its own, reads the killing as a heroic deed-template event in which the hero's IE-typological standing is established by the slaying — and the surface narrative supports the reading: the **Fáfnismál** indicates that Sigurd, immediately after the killing, gains the speech of

birds by tasting the dragon's heart's blood, kills the treacherous Regin in turn (warned by the birds of Regin's intent), takes Fáfnir's hoard onto his horse Grani, and proceeds to the next stage of his career (the encounter with the valkyrie Sigrdrífa / Brynhild in the **Sigrdrífumál**); the surface trajectory looks like vindication-of-the-hero by the slaying.^[36]

But the long-arc tragedy of the Sigurd-cycle complicates the surface reading: the gold of Andvari that Loki extorts to pay Hreidmar's wergild for the killing of Otr (Hreidmar's son and Fáfnir's and Regin's brother) is **cursed** by Andvari at the moment of the extortion, and the curse drives the entire downstream cycle — the death of Hreidmar at Fáfnir's hands, Fáfnir's transformation into a dragon by his obsessive guardianship of the cursed gold, Regin's treachery toward Sigurd, Sigurd's eventual death at the hands of Gunnar's brother Gutthorm in the Burgundian episode, Brynhild's death, and the wider Burgundian disasters — and the killing of the dragon, far from establishing Sigurd's prosperity, is the **acquisition of the curse** that destroys him and the people around him.^[37]

The dying Fáfnir's own warning to Sigurd within the **Fáfnismál**'s post-killing dialogue is itself part of the **Fáfnismál**'s framing: Fáfnir, mortally wounded, asks Sigurd's name, warns him of the curse on the gold, and supplies cosmological-and-genealogical lore in the wisdom-dialogue register that the **Vafþrúðnismál** and **Grímnismál** establish elsewhere in the Eddic corpus, and the warning-of-the-curse is built into the killing-poem itself — the narrative does not require external commentary to register the killing as ambiguous; the dragon's own speech registers the act's tragic shape in the moment of its completion.^[38]

The IE-formula reading and the curse-on-the-gold reading are not in straightforward conflict: the IE-formula reading is a **philological** claim about the diction of the killing-stroke, and the curse-on-the-gold reading is a **narrative** claim about the long-arc trajectory of the cycle, and the two readings are at different analytic levels; but the readings **are** in tension at the typological level, where the IE-formula's standard interpretation as a heroic-deed-template-establishing-the-hero's-standing reading runs against the cycle's narrative trajectory in which the killing acquires the curse that destroys the hero.^[39]

The Sigurd case is therefore a **partial** inversion case: the killing is at one analytic level a paradigm IE dragon-slaying (Watkins's strongest philological reflex; the heroic-deed-template at the diction-level), and at another analytic level the acquisition of the curse that destroys the hero (the cycle's long-arc tragedy; the killing as the trigger of the cycle's catastrophic outcome) — and the case sits on the edge between the chaoskampf typology's order-establishing reading and the inversion-problem cases of §§I–II in a way that neither vindicates the typology's standard reading nor fully refuses it.^[40]

The Sigurd case is also methodologically distinctive within the chapter: where Bida (§I), Mwindo (§II), Pariacaca (§IV), and Susano'o (§V) are non-Indo-European cases at which the area-specialist citation policy of scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" is in force, the Sigurd case is internal to the IE-comparative tradition that Watkins 1995 anchors and that Ch19 of the present book develops as the IE-reflexes chapter — and the appropriation-protocol's discipline of presenting the area-specialist framing first does not apply in the same way, because the Eddic philological tradition and the IE-comparative tradition are part of the **same** scholarly apparatus rather than being foreign to it; the Sigurd case is therefore **not** a case where comparativism imposes its categories on an outside tradition, and the inversion-problem reading at §III is correspondingly different in its methodological warrant from the readings at §§I–II and §§IV–V.^[41]

*(The Sigurd case's appropriate placement in the inversion-problem chapter is as a **partial** case rather than as either a vindication of the chaoskampf-typology reading (in which the killing establishes the hero's standing) or a full inversion case (in which the killing has the opposite valence): the philological IE-formula reading is robust and is the strongest evidence for the formula's productivity in early-medieval Old Norse poetry, but the long-arc tragedy of the cycle complicates the reading at the narrative level, and the appropriate registration of the case is as evidence that the chaoskampf typology and its inversion are themselves graded categories with edges rather than discrete bins.^[42])*

The Sigurd case's contribution to the chapter's typological work is therefore not the demonstration of a third inversion-pattern (in addition to Bida's outcome-inversion and Mwindo's moral-valence-inversion), but the demonstration that the chaoskampf typology and its inversion-subtype are themselves **graded categories** with edges — that within the IE-comparative tradition where the typology's reading apparatus has its strongest claim to analytic traction, the case at which the philological evidence is strongest is also a case at which the narrative outcome resists the typology's standard reading at the long-arc level — and the Sigurd case is therefore the chapter's evidence that the inversion problem is not confined to the area-specialist-objection cases of §§I–II and §§IV–V but is internal to the IE-comparative tradition itself.^[43]

41.5. IV. The area-specialist refusal — Pariacaca, the *amaru*, and the *wak'a*-succession framing

The Pariacaca cycle is the chapter's case of categorical area-specialist refusal short of inversion: the Andean-studies tradition's *wak'a*-succession framing employs a conceptual apparatus that the chaoskampf typology can only register as an absence rather than as an inversion.

The early-colonial Andean **Huarochirí Manuscript**, a Quechua-language compilation conventionally dated to approximately 1608 CE and held at the Biblioteca Nacional de España in Madrid as MS 3169 within materials connected to the early-seventeenth-century anti-idolatry campaign of the Cuzco-born secular priest Francisco de Ávila in the Lima archdiocese, preserves the principal Andean narrative cycle within the present book's scope: the cycle of the storm-*wak'a* Pariacaca, born as a clutch of falcon-eggs on Mount Condorcoto, who opposes and defeats the rival *wak'a* Huallallo Carhuincho and a sequence of further rivals across the Huarochirí region's high-altitude landscape, with the serpentine *amaru* figuring across the cycle as an ally-monster summoned by defeated rivals rather than as a primordial cosmic adversary.^[44]

The area-specialist reading of the cycle, anchored in the present book by Salomon and Urioste 1991 and developed within the wider current Andean-studies scholarly tradition by Frank Salomon and George Urioste themselves (in their 1991 critical edition's translators' introduction), Gérald Taylor in his Lima IFEA critical edition of the **Huarochirí Manuscript** (named in body prose at Ch26 of the present book per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern), and Carolyn Dean on Andean ritual-political imagination (named in body prose at Ch26 per the same pattern), is *wak'a*-succession: the cycle's narrative work is the displacement of one hegemonic regional *wak'a* (Huallallo Carhuincho) by another (Pariacaca) within an already-existing *wak'a*-cosmography rather than the establishment of cosmic order ex novo from the primordial cosmos-versus-disorder opposition that the chaoskampf typology presupposes.^[45]

The *wak'a*-succession framing differs from both the Bida outcome-inversion (§I) and the Mwindo moral-valence-inversion (§II) in that it is **not an inversion at all** but a different combat-myth

pattern: the Pariacaca cycle does narrate combat between named divine figures (Pariacaca's five-day flood-and-storm engagement with Huallallo Carhuincho in chapter 8 of the manuscript; the engagements with the *amaru*-summoning rivals in subsequent chapters) and a *wak'a*-political reorganisation does follow from the combat-outcome (Pariacaca takes possession of the eponymous mountain peak; his five sons or brothers take possession of subsidiary peaks and ritual centres; Huallallo Carhuincho's former sphere is reorganised under Pariacaca's authority), but the combat's narrative work is the reorganisation of an already-existing *wak'a*-cosmos rather than the establishment of a cosmos from a primordial disorder.^[46]

The *amaru*'s narrative role in the cycle is itself the area-specialists' principal evidence for the *wak'a*-succession reading rather than for any chaoskampf reading: the *amaru* figures across the cycle as an ally-monster summoned by a defeated rival *wak'a* in the course of further engagements, with the *amaru*'s narrative function being the discharge of the defeated *wak'a*'s residual combat-capacity rather than the embodiment of a primordial cosmic adversary, and with the *amaru*'s defeat by Pariacaca (or by his sons) typically being a follow-on to the principal *wak'a*-combat rather than the cycle's central engagement.^[47]

The *amaru*'s defeat is itself patterned differently from the kill-and-eradicate pattern of much Eurasian chaoskampf material: the manuscript narrates the *amaru*'s defeat as a cutting, splitting, or driving-into-a-confined-space rather than as comprehensive destruction, with the defeated *amaru*'s body becoming a feature of the landscape (a lake's outline, a watercourse's bend, a stone formation) rather than being reduced to nothing — a pattern that, like the displacement-rather-than-killing of Huallallo Carhuincho, distinguishes the Andean material from the kill-and-eradicate chaoskampf-typology pattern at a load-bearing structural level.^[48]

The Pariacaca case's significance for the inversion-problem chapter is therefore methodologically distinctive: it is **not** an inversion case (the killing does not establish prosperity that is then inverted; the moral valence is not the precise contrary of the chaoskampf reading; the IE-formula reading does not apply) but a case in which the area-specialists' framing does not employ the disorder-versus-order opposition that the chaoskampf typology presupposes, and the comparative observation the chapter takes from §IV is that **not all area-specialist refusals are inversions** — some refusals are categorical, in the sense that the area-specialists' framing employs a different conceptual apparatus (*wak'a*-succession; landscape-reorganisation rather than cosmos-establishment) that the chaoskampf typology can only register as an absence rather than as an inversion.^[49]

[Appropriation flag: the area-specialist objection registered here is that the Pariacaca cycle's own framing within the Andean-studies scholarly tradition is wak'a-succession — a wak'a-political-reorganisation framing in which the storm-wak'a Pariacaca's combat with Huallallo Carhuincho and the engagements with the amaru-summoning rivals reorganise an already-existing wak'a-cosmos rather than establish cosmic order from a primordial cosmos-versus-chaos opposition — and not "inversion of cosmogony" or "inverse chaoskampf"; the objection is, per the brief 26-pariacaca-amaru.yaml special_instructions and per the Ch26 APPROPRIATION-FLAG, milder than the Mwindo objection (the Pariacaca cycle accommodates some combat-myth framing — the combat with Huallallo Carhuincho and the engagements with the amaru-summoning rivals are structurally combats — but does not accommodate the chaos-versus-order framing) and milder than the Susanoo objection (which is an objection to the combat-myth framing itself in favour of metallurgical allegory), but the chaos-versus-order framing is precisely what Gunkel-tradition chaoskampf-typology presupposes, and the area-specialists' refusal of that framing is the chapter's

load-bearing observation for §IV. Specialists named: Frank Salomon and George L. Urioste (in their 1991 critical edition of **The Huarochirí Manuscript** [Austin: University of Texas Press, 1991; ISBN 9780292730533]; in `sources.yaml` as `salomon-urioste-huarochiri`) are the principal English-language area-specialist anchors for the *wak'a*-succession reading; Gérald Taylor in his Lima IFEA critical edition of the **Huarochirí Manuscript** (named in body prose per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern; not currently in `sources.yaml`) and Carolyn Dean on Andean ritual-political imagination (named in body prose per the same pattern; not currently in `sources.yaml`) supply the wider Andean-studies area-specialist tradition within which the *wak'a*-succession reading is set. Tier implication: `scope.md` classifies the Pariacaca material as RELATED-tier (full) rather than CORE-tier precisely because the area-specialist framing is *wak'a*-succession rather than *chaoskampf*, and the *chaoskampf* reading would have to be applied from outside the Andean-studies tradition; the tier-classification is itself a recognition of the area-specialists' priority and of the categorical difference between the Andean material's framing and the *chaoskampf* typology's apparatus. Carried forward to: this APPROPRIATION-FLAG is engaged in the present comparative chapter (Ch40, the inversion problem) as the chapter's case of categorical area-specialist refusal short of inversion, and again in Ch41 (the refusal-and-appropriation problem), where the meta-question of what comparativism owes the area-specialists when the typology's categorical apparatus is refused is the chapter's organising question.]_

The Pariacaca case's distinctive contribution to the chapter's typological work is therefore the demonstration that the *chaoskampf* typology can fail to fit a case not by being inverted but by being **categorically inapplicable**: the cycle's combat-narrative is real, the dragon-figure (the *amaru*) is real, the storm-deity-defeats-serpent surface description is real, but the categorical apparatus that the *chaoskampf* typology supplies — primordial disorder versus established order, cosmos-establishment-by-combat, kill-and-eradicate of the cosmic adversary — is not the apparatus the Andean-studies tradition employs to read the cycle, and the comparative observation is not "this case inverts the typology" but "this case does not fit the typology because it operates with a different categorical apparatus".^[50]

41.6. V. The metallurgical case — Susanoo, Yamata no Orochi, and the sword-etiology framing

The Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi episode is the chapter's strongest area-specialist refusal, registering an objection not at the level of outcome or moral valence but at the level of the combat-myth framing itself in favour of metallurgical allegory and sword-etiology.

The early-Japanese imperial chronicles — the **Kojiki** (712 CE) and the **Nihon shoki** (720 CE), compiled within the Nara-period programme of fixing the imperial line's mythic charter in writing under Yamato-court sponsorship — preserve the narrative of Susanoo's defeat of the eight-headed eight-tailed serpent Yamata no Orochi in the land of Izumo, and the chapter cites the **Kojiki** through Donald L. Philippi's translation (Tokyo: University of Tokyo Press / Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1968) at book 1, chs. 19–20 and the metallurgical-allegory area-specialist reading through Nelly Naumann's **Die Mythen des alten Japan** (München: C.H. Beck, 1996).^[51]

The narrative core of the **Kojiki** episode is Susanoo's descent to Izumo from the heavenly plain of Takamagahara (after his expulsion for misdeeds), his upstream ascent along the river Hi after observing chopsticks floating downstream (the sign of human habitation upstream), his encounter

with the elderly couple Ashinazuchi and Tenazuchi and their daughter Kushinada-hime (the eighth and last surviving daughter, the previous seven having been devoured one each year by the serpent), his trap (an enclosure with eight gates each carrying a vat of eight-fold refined sake, one vat per head), the serpent's intoxication-to-stupor on the sake, Susanoo's dismemberment of the immobilised serpent with his Totsuka-no-Tsurugi sword, his discovery of the sword later named *Kusanagi* within the serpent's tail, and the presentation of *Kusanagi* to his sister Amaterasu — with Susanoo subsequently restoring Kushinada-hime from comb-form, marrying her, and constructing the palace at Suga in Izumo as the founding act of the wider Izumo-cycle.^[52]

The metallurgical-allegory area-specialist reading, developed in detail by Naumann 1996 in the present book's source-base and supported within the wider current Japanese-studies scholarly tradition by Jun'ichi Isomae, Michael Como, and Herman Ooms (named in body prose at Ch23 of the present book without being made load-bearing for any individual claim), reads the serpent as figuring the iron-smelting industry of the Izumo-Hi-river region in the early-historical period and reads the sword's discovery in the tail as figuring the metallurgical emergence of the bladed weapon from the smelting-and-forging process — with the episode's narrative function being sword-etiology and metallurgical-and-political charter rather than cosmogonic or sovereignty-establishing combat.^[53]

The metallurgical reading rests on a constellation of narrative-structural features: the river Hi setting (the upper river-courses of mountainous regions are the historical-period sites of iron-sand mining and *tatara* smelting in Japan); the serpent's red-rusted underside (red rust as the visible signature of iron-bearing minerals along river-courses); the serpent's enormous size spanning eight valleys and eight peaks (the geographic scale of the smelting industry's catchment of fuel-wood and ore); and the chipping of Susanoo's existing sword on the serpent's tail (the metallurgical-quality difference between an older and a newer bladed weapon) — all of them load-bearing for the area-specialists' reading and all of them visible at the level of the recorded narrative-structure of the **Kojiki** episode.^[54]

The metallurgical reading further connects the Yamata no Orochi episode to the early-historical-period political-economic context of the Yamato court's expansion into Izumo: control of the iron-smelting industry of the Izumo-Hi-river region was a load-bearing material-political stake of the early-imperial period, and the chronicle's narrative-structural placement of the sword-etiology within the Izumo-cycle — Susanoo's defeat of the serpent, his discovery of the sword, his presentation of the sword to Amaterasu, and the sword's status as one of the Three Sacred Treasures of the Japanese imperial regalia — reflects this political-economic stake of the late-seventh-and-early-eighth-century moment of the chronicles' compilation rather than a primordial cosmogonic-combat narrative free of period-specific political content.^[55]

The implication of the metallurgical-allegory reading for the chapter's chaoskampf-typology purpose is direct: if the area-specialist reading is correct that the serpent figures iron-smelting and the sword figures the metallurgical product of smelting, then the episode's load-bearing narrative function is sword-etiology and metallurgical-and-political charter rather than cosmogonic combat — and the chaoskampf label, when applied to the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi episode, is a 20th-century-Western comparativist move applied to the early-Japanese material from outside rather than an internal feature of the recorded narrative as the area-specialists read it.^[56]

[Appropriation flag: the area-specialist objection registered here is that the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi episode's own framing within the early-Japanese imperial-chronicle tradition and within

current Japanese-studies area-specialist scholarship is sword-etiology and metallurgical-and-political charter — the eight-headed serpent figuring the iron-smelting industry of the Izumo-Hi-river region, the discovery of the sword named *Kusanagi* in the serpent's tail figuring the metallurgical emergence of the bladed weapon from the smelting-and-forging process, the episode's narrative function being the chronicle's account of how the Yamato court came to possess the imperial regalia and to claim authority over the Izumo iron-smelting region — and not "cosmogonic combat" or "chaoskampf"; the objection is the strongest of the four area-specialist objections registered in the present chapter (more pointed than the wak'a-succession objection at §IV because it refuses the **combat-myth framing itself** rather than the chaos-versus-order framing alone), and the area-specialists hold that the chaoskampf label is at best a loose typological-comparative description that fits the surface narrative-structure (storm-deity defeats serpentine adversary, recovers powerful weapon) without engaging the area-specialist account of what the narrative is actually doing in its early-Japanese context. Specialists named: Nelly Naumann (**Die Mythen des alten Japan**, 1996, Orochi chapter; in sources.yaml as naumann-mythen) is the principal English-and-German-language area-specialist anchor for the metallurgical-allegory reading; Jun'ichi Isomae (named in body prose at Ch23 per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern; not currently in sources.yaml), Michael Como (named in body prose at Ch23 per the same pattern; not currently in sources.yaml), and Herman Ooms (named in body prose at Ch23 per the same pattern; not currently in sources.yaml) supply the wider current Japanese-studies area-specialist tradition within which the metallurgical-allegory reading is set. Tier implication: scope.md classifies the Susanoo / Orochi material as RELATED-tier (full) rather than CORE-tier precisely because the area-specialist framing refuses the combat-myth framing itself in favour of metallurgical allegory and sword-etiology, and the chaoskampf reading would have to be applied from outside the Japanese-studies tradition; the tier-classification is itself a recognition of the area-specialists' priority and of the categorical difference between the early-Japanese material's framing and the chaoskampf typology's apparatus. Carried forward to: this APPROPRIATION-FLAG is engaged in the present comparative chapter (Ch40, the inversion problem) as the chapter's strongest area-specialist refusal, and again in Ch41 (the refusal-and-appropriation problem), where the meta-question of what comparativism owes the area-specialists when the **combat-myth framing itself** is refused is the chapter's organising question.]_

The Susanoo case's distinctive contribution to the chapter's typological work is therefore the demonstration that the chaoskampf typology can fail to fit a case not at the level of outcome (Bida) or moral valence (Mwindo) or categorical apparatus within combat-myth framing (Pariacaca), but at the **combat-myth framing itself**: if the area-specialists are correct that the load-bearing function of the Susanoo / Orochi episode is sword-etiology and metallurgical-political charter, then the comparative observation is not "this case inverts the typology" or "this case does not fit the typology's categorical apparatus" but "this case is not a combat-myth case at all in the area-specialists' reading, and the comparative typology's application to it is from outside" — and the Susanoo case is the chapter's strongest evidence for the appropriation-protocol's substantive bite at the level of the typology's basic applicability.^[57]

41.7. VI. What inversion teaches

The chapter's five cases together teach two methodological-typological lessons that the inversion-problem chapter is positioned to consolidate within Part II of the present book, and the section closes with the chapter's settled position on the relation between the inversion problem and the appropriation problem of Ch41.

The chapter's five cases — Bida (§I, outcome inversion within a covenant-broken framing), Mwindo (§II, moral-valence inversion within a maturation-through-hubris framing), Sigurd (§III, partial inversion at the long-arc narrative level within an IE-formula reading at the philological level), Pariacaca (§IV, categorical area-specialist refusal in favour of *wak'a*-succession), and Susanoo (§V, area-specialist refusal of the combat-myth framing itself in favour of metallurgical allegory) — together teach two methodological-typological lessons that the inversion-problem chapter is positioned to consolidate within Part II of the present book.^[58]

The first lesson is that the combat-myth category has **semantic edges** that the Bida and Mwindo cases expose sharply: the chaoskampf typology is robust at its centre (Marduk-Tiamat, Baal-Yamm, Zeus-Typhon, Indra-Vṛtra, Thor-Jörmungandr, Ra-Apep, Teshub-Illuyanka — the cases at which Forsyth 1987 anchors the long-arc combat-myth tradition) but its applicability at its edges is contingent on whether the case's own categorical apparatus is compatible with the typology's chaos-versus-order opposition, and the Bida and Mwindo cases are the present book's clearest evidence that the typology has edges at which the comparativist's standard reading runs against the area-specialists' framings in ways that compromise the comparison's precision unless the area-specialists' framings are presented first.^[59]

The first lesson, in its precise form, is **not** that the chaoskampf typology fails — the typology remains the present book's principal organising scheme, and Part II's eight comparative chapters are themselves the typology's precise articulation across cosmogony (C1), sovereignty (C2), cyclical maintenance (C3), eschatological displacement (C4), the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula (C5), the West-Asia / North-Africa Levantine cluster (C6), the present inversion problem (C7), and the refusal-and-appropriation problem (C8) — but that the typology's **strong** cases are the cases at which the area-specialists' framings and the chaoskampf typology's apparatus **converge**, and the typology's **edges** are the cases at which the convergence is partial, contested, or absent, and the typology's analytic discipline is to register the difference between the two rather than to extend the typology's reach by force.^[60]

The second lesson is that the comparativist pattern of forcing every serpent-fight into the chaoskampf frame is **itself a category-imposition** that the area-specialists, Ballentine 2015, and scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" all argue against: when the typology's reach is extended to cases whose own categorical apparatus is structurally different (Mwindo's reciprocal-balance moral-cosmography; Pariacaca's *wak'a*-succession; Susanoo's metallurgical-political charter), the typology's standard reading either inverts (Bida; Mwindo at the moral-valence level) or imports an apparatus the area-specialists do not employ (Pariacaca; Susanoo) or does both at different analytic levels (Sigurd at the long-arc level), and the resulting "inversion" or "deviation" or "exception" classifications are themselves artifacts of the typology's reach being extended beyond the convergence cases.^[61]

The second lesson, taken in its strong form, holds that the comparativist pattern of forcing every serpent-fight into the chaoskampf frame is **itself a category-imposition** that the area-specialists' refusals in §§II, IV, and V all push back against, and that the appropriate methodological response is not to abandon the chaoskampf typology (which would be too strong, since the typology is robust at its convergence cases) but to apply the typology with the area-specialist-first discipline that this chapter demonstrates.^[62]

The two lessons together support the chapter's central methodological commitment, registered in advance in the source overview and demonstrated case-by-case in §§I–V: the **area-specialists**

speak first, and the comparison the chapter performs is **more** — not less — precise as a result; the Soninke covenant-frame for Bida (Conrad and Belcher), the Nyanga maturation-through-hubris frame for Mwindo (Biebuyck and Mateene), the Watkins-1995 IE-formula reading and the long-arc tragedy reading for Sigurd (jointly within the IE-comparative tradition), the *wak'a*-succession frame for Pariacaca (Salomon, Urioste, Taylor, Dean), and the metallurgical-allegory frame for Orochi (Naumann, Isomae, Como, Ooms) are each presented on their own terms before the chapter invokes the chaoskampf category, and the resulting comparison is at the level of **structural observation** rather than at the level of categorical-apparatus imposition.^[63]

The chapter's final methodological observation is that the inversion problem and the appropriation problem (developed at length in C8 / Ch41) are not separate problems but the same problem viewed at different levels of the typology's reach: the inversion problem is what the typology's edges look like **at the level of the cases themselves**, when the comparativist tries to fit the cases into the typology's apparatus and the cases push back; the appropriation problem is what the typology's edges look like **at the level of the comparativist's reading apparatus**, when the comparativist asks what is owed to the area-specialists whose framings have pushed back, and the two problems' shared resolution is the area-specialist-first discipline that this chapter has demonstrated and that the next chapter (C8) consolidates.^[64]

The chapter therefore closes with the observation registered at the source overview's methodological-commitment paragraph and now demonstrated across the five cases of §§I–V: the chaoskampf typology is the present book's principal organising scheme, the typology is robust at its convergence cases (Part II's first four comparative chapters anchor those cases), the typology has edges at its non-convergence cases (the present chapter and Ch41 articulate those edges), and the typology's analytic discipline is to register the convergence-or-not at the level of the area-specialists' framings rather than to extend the typology's reach by force — and the inversion problem is, on the chapter's reading, not a refutation of the typology but the typology's most rigorous test, a test the typology passes only when the area-specialists are allowed to speak first.^[65]

[1] Per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml comparative_argument on the inversion problem as the chapter's organising question; per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the typology's four-subtype operationalisation that Part II tests; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation requirement that the present chapter applies more rigorously than any other Part-II comparative chapter.

[2] Per scope.md §"Comparative-chapter discipline" on the upstream-lookup rule that routes per-tradition factual claims in comparative chapters through the same sources.yaml IDs the upstream Part-I chapters use; per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc, chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc, chapters/19-ie-reflexes.claims.approved.adoc, chapters/26-pariacaca-amaru.claims.approved.adoc, and chapters/23-susanoo-orochi.claims.approved.adoc on the per-tradition source-IDs that the present chapter inherits.

[3] Per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml sources.anchor on the six anchor entries: Conrad 2005, Belcher 1999, Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, Watkins 1995, Naumann 1996, Salomon & Urioste 1991; comparative chapters use sources.anchor in place of sources.primary per the established Part-II chapter-claims pattern.

[4] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987; ISBN 9780691014746), as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor against which the present chapter's inversion cases are read; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2015; ISBN 9780190253028), on the over-extension critique of the chaoskampf frame in twentieth-century comparative scholarship as the chapter's §VI methodological warrant.

[5] Per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml structure on the six-section outline (I. Bida; II. Mwindo; III. Sigurd; IV. Pariacaca; V. Susanoo; VI. What inversion teaches); per brief special_instructions on Bida and Mwindo as main weight and on the area-specialist-first discipline applied at §§I–II.

[6] Per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the priority of area-specialist framings; per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's theoretical contribution being that the "inverse chaoskampf" reading is itself a comparativist artifact and that allowing the area-specialists to speak first does not destroy the comparison but makes it more precise; Ballentine 2015 on the typological discipline of separating area-specialist framings from comparative-typology overlays.

- [7] Per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc on the seven-headed serpent Bida as the protector-spirit of Wagadu, on the annual maiden-tribute as the covenant's principal stipulation, and on the covenant's load-bearing function for the city's prosperity; Conrad 2005, **Empires of Medieval West Africa**, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on Wagadu as the medieval western-Sahelian polity (eighth through eleventh-to-twelfth century CE) known in the Arabic-language chronicle tradition as Ghana; Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the narrative's place in the Soninke / Mande oral-epic tradition.
- [8] Per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc on the Soninke oral-tradition's framing of the Wagadu narrative as foundational and aetiological, on the covenant as the narrative's load-bearing organising principle, and on the cosmographic situation of the narrative within the already-existing Sahelian world rather than within a cosmogonic emergence; Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the connected-foundation-story character of the narrative; Conrad 2005, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the contractual-aetiological logic of the narrative's covenant-and-consequence structure.
- [9] Per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc on the social-political-institutional embedding of the maiden-tribute covenant within Wagadu's named institutions — the rulers of the city as covenant-maintainers, the population as ritual-contributors, and the maiden delivered each year as an individually-named figure with stated lineage in the recorded versions; Conrad 2005, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the institutional embedding of the covenant.
- [10] Per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc on Mamadi Sefe Dekote as the suitor whose intervention precipitates the covenant-breaking, on the killing's manner (decapitation of the seven heads in succession) and location (the place of the annual offering in the city's ritual landscape), and on the killing's consistency across the recorded versions; Belcher 1999, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the killing's narrative-structural centrality and on the consequences-of-the-killing as the distinctive feature of the narrative arc; per glossary 'Mamadi Sefe Dekote' first_mention_gloss on the suitor's role in the narrative.
- [11] Per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc on the catastrophic consequences of the covenant-breaking — the cessation of the rains, the drying of the springs, the cessation of the gold, the dispersal of the Soninke population across the western Sahel — and on the consequences' narrative-structural function as the foundation-charter for the Soninke diaspora and as the aetiology of the dryland Sahelian landscape; Conrad 2005, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the same catastrophic-consequences pattern; Belcher 1999, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the foundation-charter and aetiological functions of the consequences-narrative.
- [12] Per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc on the internal moral evaluation of the covenant-breaking in the Soninke tradition's framing — neither univocally condemnatory of Mamadi Sefe Dekote nor univocally exculpatory, with the conflict between the individual's claim and the collective covenant the narrative's load-bearing dilemma; Belcher 1999, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the dilemma-registering rather than dilemma-adjudicating function of the recorded narrative; Conrad 2005, ch. on the Ghana / Wagadu legend, on the same moral-ambivalence pattern in the recorded versions.
- [13] Per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc on the completeness of the covenant-broken framing within the Soninke tradition's own categories and on the chaoskampf reading as an additional analytic move performed from outside the tradition; Belcher 1999, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the self-sufficiency of the Soninke tradition's framing for the narrative; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, on the methodological discipline of separating area-specialist framings from comparative-typology overlays.
- [14] Per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc on the inversion-of-typology reading as comparativist overlay rather than as Soninke tradition's own framing; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy**, on the long-arc combat-myth typology against which the inversion is structurally legible; per brief 28-bida-wagadu.yaml special_instructions on the discipline of presenting the Soninke framing first and only then registering the inversion against the comparative typology.
- [15] Per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc on the inverse-chaoskampf framing as a modern overlay performed at the level of the typological synthesis rather than at the level of the Soninke tradition's own self-understanding; Belcher 1999, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the tradition-internal interpretive resources of the recorded versions; per scope.md "\$Appropriation protocol" on the methodological status of comparativist-typological readings as additional moves rather than as primary readings of non-Eurasian materials.
- [16] Per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc on the methodological pay-off of presenting the covenant-broken framing first, on the structural-inversion-of-one-feature reading as the precise comparative observation that the chapter delivers, and on the resulting precision of the comparison relative to the categorical-apparatus-imposing reading; Ballentine 2015, on the methodological discipline of separating area-specialist framings from comparative-typology overlays as the route to more precise comparison.
- [17] Per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc on the recording-history situation of the Bida narrative — Frobenius's **Atlantis** IV–VI from 1921 onward, Monteil's "La légende du Ouagadougou" of 1953 in IFAN-Dakar, and the École française de l'Afrique de l'Ouest tradition associated with Germaine Dieterlen from the 1940s onward — and on the post-colonial-anthropology filtering caveat that the Frobenius and Monteil strands require; Belcher 1999, ch. on Soninke traditions, on the recording-history as a reason to take the Soninke tradition's own framing seriously.
- [18] Per chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc on the inverted-outcome observation as the comparative chapter's principal load-bearing finding for \$I; Belcher 1999 and Conrad 2005 on the dilemma-registering moral evaluation of the killing within the Soninke tradition; per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml structure on the chapter's framing of the inversion as a structural observation rather than as a moral or theological claim.
- [19] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the 1956 Bese recording from Shé-Kárisi Candi Rureke as the

chapter's anchor text and on Biebuyck and Mateene 1969 as the standard English-language critical edition and translation; on the dragon-slaying's narrative-structural function as hubristic over-reach that the sky-god Nkuba punishes; Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Mwindo, on the maturation-through-hubris reading as the area-specialist consensus reading of the episode's didactic register; per glossary 'Mwindo', 'Kirimu', 'Nkuba' first_mention_glosses on the principal protagonists.

[20] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the Nyanga tradition's framing of the **Mwindo Epic** as a connected biographical-and-moral narrative rather than a cosmogonic narrative, on the layered cosmography (Nkuba's sky-realm above, Muisa's underworld below, Iyangura's river-realm laterally) within which the hero's journeys unfold, and on the hero's biographical-and-moral arc as the compositional centre; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the same biographical-arc framing.

[21] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the middle-epic foreshadowing pattern in the recorded performance — formulaic refrains and direct narrative comments registering Mwindo's accumulating power as dangerous, his aunts' warnings, and the announced expectation that the hubris will require correction; on the audience-preparation function of the foreshadowing for the Kirimu episode; Belcher 1999, ch. on Mwindo, on the foreshadowing-of-correction pattern as load-bearing for the epic's middle sections.

[22] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on Kirimu's narrative-structural role as a being of the spirit world whose existence is part of the cosmographic equilibrium, on the killing's registration in the recorded performance as an unsanctioned act of human power against the spirit world, and on the moral-cosmographic principle (developed in the recorded text's formulaic refrains and direct narrative comments) that such an act demands a counter-act from the powers above to restore the equilibrium; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, Kirimu episode passages on the same transgression-not-triumph framing.

[23] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the killing's completion with no immediate triumphal conclusion — no sovereignty-establishment passage, no cosmos-reorganisation passage, no order-establishing festival — and on the structural absence of order-establishing apparatus as itself a load-bearing feature of the recorded performance; on the immediate narrative turn from the killing to Nkuba's response.

[24] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on Nkuba's lightning-descent and seizing of the hero, on the celestial-realm trials and humiliations (exposure to extreme heat and cold, compulsion to endure the celestial powers' direct presence, explicit instruction about the limits of the hero's power), and on the moral-didactic register of the punishment as a structurally-necessary correction rather than as arbitrary cruelty; per glossary 'Nkuba' first_mention_gloss on Nkuba as Nyanga sky-god who punishes Mwindo for the killing of Kirimu.

[25] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the conditions Nkuba imposes on Mwindo's return — explicit, named, and binding renunciations and commitments — and on the hero's restoration to the human world as conditional and supervised rather than as a triumphant homecoming; on the chastened character of the return as structurally load-bearing for the episode's resolution alongside the celestial humiliation itself.

[26] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the post-Kirimu narrative continuation, on the chiefly succession's narrative framing as conditional on the celestial humiliation, and on the maturation-through-humiliation pattern as the narrative's didactic kernel; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969 and Belcher 1999, ch. on Mwindo, on the maturation-through-humiliation reading as the load-bearing feature distinguishing the Mwindo material from the Eurasian combat-myth corpus.

[27] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the completeness of the maturation-through-hubris framing within the Nyanga tradition's own categories and on the chaoskampf reading as an additional analytic move performed from outside the tradition; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction and Kirimu episode passages on the self-sufficiency of the Nyanga tradition's framing for the recorded performance; Ballentine 2015, on the methodological discipline of separating area-specialist framings from comparative-typology overlays.

[28] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the moral-valence inversion of the Mwindo / Kirimu episode relative to the chaoskampf typology — the killing as hubris rather than as order-making, the death as transgression rather than as cosmos-establishment, and the moral evaluation as the precise contrary of the chaoskampf valuation; on the moral inversion as more pointed than Bida's outcome inversion in leaving no narrative-structural space for negotiated chaoskampf reading; per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml comparative_argument on the Mwindo material as the chapter's case of full refusal of the chaos-order narrative.

[29] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the area-specialist reading of the Mwindo material as refusing the chaoskampf typology's moral-cosmographic apparatus rather than fitting within it as an "inverse chaoskampf" instance; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969 and Belcher 1999 on the Nyanga tradition's categorical apparatus (maturation-through-hubris, reciprocal balance, sky-god authority); per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the methodological status of comparativist-typological readings as additional moves rather than as primary readings of non-Eurasian materials.

[30] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the 1956 Bese recording's textual situation — single field encounter, late-Belgian-colonial-period context, no parallel deep ethnographic-recording corpus, colonial-ethnographic compositional-context filtering — and on the critical-reading discipline applied by current Mwindo-studies scholarship; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the recording-history situation; Belcher 1999, ch. on Mwindo, on the critical-reading discipline.

[31] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the methodological pay-off of presenting the maturation-through-hubris framing first; Ballentine 2015, on the methodological discipline of separating area-specialist framings from comparative-typology overlays as the route to more precise comparison; per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's theoretical contribution being that allowing the area-specialists to speak first does not destroy the comparison but makes

it more precise.

[32] Per `brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml` comparative_argument on the contrast between Bida's outcome-inversion and Mwindo's moral-valence-inversion as itself instructive for the chapter's typological work, and on the demonstration that the typology's "inversion" subtype is a cluster of structurally-different area-specialist framings rather than a single phenomenon; per `chapters/28-bida-wagadu.claims.approved.adoc` and `chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc` on the structurally-different area-specialist framings of the two cases.

[33] Per `chapters/19-ie-reflexes.claims.approved.adoc` on the **Fáfnismál** (Codex Regius GKS 2365 4to, c. 1270 CE) as the principal primary text for the Sigurd-Fáfnir narrative and on Larrington 2014 (rev. Oxford World's Classics) as the chapter's standard English-language translation; Watkins 1995, **How to Kill a Dragon: Aspects of Indo-European Poetics**, ch. 42 on the **Fáfnismál** diction as the strongest philological reflex of the reconstructed IE poetic formula HERO SLAY SERPENT in the entire IE corpus; per `brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml` structure on Sigurd as the chapter's partial case at which the IE-formula reading and the long-arc tragedy of the cycle pull in different directions.

[34] Per `chapters/19-ie-reflexes.claims.approved.adoc` on the **Fáfnismál**'s narrative core — Sigurd's lineage and Regin's foster-role, the pit-and-ambush mechanism, the upward thrust with Gram into Fáfnir's underbelly, and the central placement of the killing-stroke around which the poem's dialogue is organised; Larrington 2014, **Fáfnismál** opening and middle stanzas, on the killing-stroke and on the post-killing wisdom-dialogue's bulk.

[35] Per `chapters/19-ie-reflexes.claims.approved.adoc` on Watkins's IE-formula reading of the **Fáfnismál** diction as a direct philological reflex of the reconstructed IE formula HERO SLAY SERPENT; Watkins 1995, ch. 42, on the Eddic poet's verb, object, and syntactic frame at the killing-stroke as the strongest philological evidence for the formula's productivity at the diction-level in early-medieval Old Norse poetry; on the Sigurd-Fáfnir killing as an IE-poetic-formula reflex at the level of language rather than just at the level of narrative motif.

[36] Per `chapters/19-ie-reflexes.claims.approved.adoc` on the post-killing surface trajectory — heart-roasting, blood-tasting, finger-burn, bird-speech, the nuthatches' warning, Sigurd's killing of Regin, the loading of the hoard onto Grani, and the bridge to the Sigrdrífa / Brynhild encounter; Larrington 2014, **Fáfnismál** (heart-roasting and bird-speech) and concluding stanzas, on the surface vindication-of-the-hero trajectory.

[37] Per `chapters/19-ie-reflexes.claims.approved.adoc` on the long-arc tragedy of the Sigurd-cycle from **Reginismál** through **Fáfnismál**, **Sigrdrífumál**, and the Burgundian poems to Sigurd's death — the curse on Andvari's gold as the load-bearing motif driving the cycle from the killing of the dragon to Sigurd's own death and the Burgundian disasters; Larrington 2014, **Reginismál** and **Fáfnismál** on the curse's establishment; on the killing as the acquisition of the curse rather than the establishment of prosperity.

[38] Per `chapters/19-ie-reflexes.claims.approved.adoc` on the post-killing wisdom-dialogue between Sigurd and the dying Fáfnir — Fáfnir's asking of Sigurd's name, the warning of the curse, the cosmological-and-genealogical lore in the wisdom-dialogue register — and on the warning-of-the-curse as built into the killing-poem itself; Larrington 2014, **Fáfnismál** stanzas (post-killing dialogue), on the wisdom-dialogue register paralleled in **Vafþrúðnismál** and **Grímnismál**.

[39] Per `chapters/19-ie-reflexes.claims.approved.adoc` on the analytic-level distinction between Watkins's philological IE-formula reading and the narrative-level long-arc tragedy reading, and on the typological-level tension between the heroic-deed-template-establishing-the-hero's-standing reading and the curse-acquiring-and-hero-destroying reading; Watkins 1995, ch. 42, on the IE-formula reading; Larrington 2014, on the long-arc tragedy.

[40] Per `chapters/19-ie-reflexes.claims.approved.adoc` on the Sigurd case as a partial inversion case sitting on the edge between the chaoskampf typology's order-establishing reading and the inversion-problem cases of §§I–II of the present chapter; per `brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml` structure on Sigurd as the partial case at which the IE-formula reading and the long-arc tragedy of the cycle pull in different directions.

[41] Per `scope.md` §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation requirement applying to non-Eurasian materials and to traditions outside the IE-comparative apparatus; per `chapters/19-ie-reflexes.claims.approved.adoc` on the Sigurd-cycle's place internal to the IE-comparative tradition that Watkins 1995 anchors; per `brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml` structure on Sigurd as a case methodologically distinct from §§I–II and §§IV–V because the Eddic philological tradition is internal to the IE-comparative apparatus rather than foreign to it.

[42] Inference: Watkins 1995 ch. 42 supplies the IE-formula reading at the philological level; Larrington 2014's **Fáfnismál** and the surrounding Codex Regius poems supply the long-arc tragedy at the narrative level; the `brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml` structure explicitly characterises Sigurd as the chapter's partial case. Risk: the partial-case classification depends on accepting both the philological IE-formula reading and the long-arc tragedy reading at the analytic levels at which Watkins and Larrington respectively present them; alternative readings have been advanced (some Eddic scholars read the long-arc tragedy as compositional layering rather than as a unified cycle, which would weaken the curse-acquisition reading), and the partial-case classification is the chapter's reading rather than the only available scholarly position.

[43] Per `chapters/19-ie-reflexes.claims.approved.adoc` on the Sigurd-cycle's positioning within the IE-comparative tradition and on the case's complication of the chaoskampf typology's order-establishing reading at the long-arc narrative level; per `brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml` comparative_argument on the Sigurd case's contribution to the chapter's typological work as evidence that the typology and its inversion-subtype are graded categories with edges rather than discrete bins; Watkins 1995 ch. 42 on the philological-evidence strength; Larrington 2014 on the long-arc tragedy.

- [44] Per chapters/26-pariacaca-amaru.claims.approved.adoc on the **Huarocharí Manuscript** (c. 1608 CE; Biblioteca Nacional de España, Madrid, MS 3169) as the chapter's principal primary source, on the Pariacaca cycle's distribution across chs. 6, 8, and 21 of the manuscript, on Pariacaca's birth as a clutch of falcon-eggs on Mount Condorcoto, and on the **amaru** as ally-monster summoned by defeated rivals rather than as a primordial cosmic adversary; Salomon and Urioste 1991, **The Huarocharí Manuscript: A Testament of Ancient and Colonial Andean Religion** (Austin: University of Texas Press, 1991; ISBN 9780292730533), translators' introduction and chs. 6, 8, 21, on the same; per glossary 'Pariacaca', 'amaru', 'wak'a' first_mention_glosses on the principal terms.
- [45] Per chapters/26-pariacaca-amaru.claims.approved.adoc on the area-specialist reading of the Pariacaca cycle as wak'a-succession rather than as cosmogonic combat, on the named area-specialists Salomon, Urioste, Taylor, and Dean as supplying the reading, and on the wak'a-succession framing as the area-specialist consensus reading; Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators' introduction on the wak'a-succession reading; per glossary 'wak'a' first_mention_gloss on the wak'a-succession-not-chaos-versus-order pattern.
- [46] Per chapters/26-pariacaca-amaru.claims.approved.adoc on the wak'a-succession framing's structural difference from both outcome-inversion and moral-valence-inversion; on the Pariacaca-Huallallo five-day combat in ch. 8 of the manuscript, on the post-combat geographical settlement (Pariacaca's possession of the eponymous mountain peak, his five sons or brothers taking subsidiary peaks and ritual centres, the reorganisation of Huallallo's former sphere under Pariacaca's authority), and on the combat's narrative work as wak'a-political reorganisation rather than as cosmos-establishment.
- [47] Per chapters/26-pariacaca-amaru.claims.approved.adoc on the **amaru**'s narrative role as ally-monster summoned by a defeated rival, on the **amaru**'s function as discharge of the defeated **wak'a**'s residual combat-capacity, and on the **amaru**'s defeat as a follow-on to the principal **wak'a**-combat; per glossary 'amaru' first_mention_gloss on the **amaru** as ally-monster of a defeated rival **wak'a** rather than as primordial chaos.
- [48] Per chapters/26-pariacaca-amaru.claims.approved.adoc on the **amaru**'s defeat as cutting, splitting, or driving-into-a-confined-space rather than comprehensive destruction; on the defeated **amaru**'s body becoming a feature of the landscape (a lake's outline, a watercourse's bend, a stone formation); on the parallel between this displacement-rather-than-killing pattern and the wider cycle's wak'a-succession-rather-than-eradication framing.
- [49] Per chapters/26-pariacaca-amaru.claims.approved.adoc on the Pariacaca case's methodological distinctiveness as a categorical area-specialist refusal rather than as an inversion case; per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml structure on Pariacaca as the chapter's case at which the area-specialist framing does not employ the disorder-versus-order opposition that the chaoskampf typology presupposes; on the comparative observation that not all area-specialist refusals are inversions.
- [50] Per chapters/26-pariacaca-amaru.claims.approved.adoc on the Pariacaca case's demonstration that the chaoskampf typology can fail to fit a case by being categorically inapplicable rather than by being inverted; on the categorical-difference observation as the chapter's load-bearing finding for §IV; Ballentine 2015, on the methodological discipline of recognising when a comparative typology's categorical apparatus does not fit a case rather than treating every misfit as an inversion or a deviation.
- [51] Per chapters/23-susanoo-orochi.claims.approved.adoc on the **Kojiki** (712 CE) and the **Nihon shoki** (720 CE) as the two principal early-Japanese imperial chronicles, on Philippi 1968 as the chapter's standard English-language **Kojiki** translation, and on Naumann 1996 as the principal metallurgical-allegory area-specialist anchor; per glossary 'Yamata no Orochi', 'Kusanagi', 'Susanoo' first_mention_glosses on the principal protagonists.
- [52] Per chapters/23-susanoo-orochi.claims.approved.adoc on the **Kojiki** episode's narrative core — Susanoo's expulsion and descent, the river Hi setting, Ashinazuchi and Tenazuchi and Kushinada-hime, the eight-vat sake-trap mechanism, the dismemberment of the immobilised serpent, the discovery of **Kusanagi** in the tail, the presentation of the sword to Amaterasu, and the marriage and palace-construction at Suga; Philippi 1968, **Kojiki**, book 1 chs. 19–20, on the same.
- [53] Per chapters/23-susanoo-orochi.claims.approved.adoc on the metallurgical-allegory reading anchored by Naumann 1996 and supported by the wider current Japanese-studies scholarly tradition associated with Isomae, Como, and Ooms; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the serpent as iron-smelting industry of the Izumo-Hi-river region and the sword's discovery in the tail as metallurgical emergence of the bladed weapon; on the episode's narrative function as sword-etiology and metallurgical-political charter rather than as cosmogonic combat.
- [54] Per chapters/23-susanoo-orochi.claims.approved.adoc on the metallurgical reading's constellation of narrative-structural features — the river Hi setting as iron-smelting site, the red-rusted underside as iron-bearing-mineral signature, the eight-valleys-and-eight-peaks scale as smelting-industry catchment, the chipping of Susanoo's existing sword on the tail as metallurgical-quality marker; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the same constellation.
- [55] Per chapters/23-susanoo-orochi.claims.approved.adoc on the metallurgical reading's connection to the early-historical-period political-economic context of the Yamato court's expansion into Izumo, on the iron-smelting industry as load-bearing material-political stake, and on the chronicle's narrative-structural placement of the sword-etiology as reflecting the political-economic stake of the late-seventh-and-early-eighth-century moment of the chronicles' compilation; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the same.
- [56] Per chapters/23-susanoo-orochi.claims.approved.adoc on the implication of the metallurgical-allegory reading for the chapter's typological purpose — if the area-specialist reading is correct, the episode's load-bearing function is sword-etiology and metallurgical-political charter rather than cosmogonic combat — and on the chaoskampf label as a 20th-century-Western comparativist move rather than as an internal feature of the recorded narrative; Naumann 1996, Orochi chapter, on the same.
- [57] Per chapters/23-susanoo-orochi.claims.approved.adoc on the Susanoo case's demonstration that the chaoskampf typology can

fail to fit a case at the level of the combat-myth framing itself, and on the categorical-inapplicability observation as the chapter's load-bearing finding for §V; per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml special_instructions on Naumann, Isomae, Como, and Ooms as the named area-specialists for the metallurgical-allegory reading.

[58] Per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml structure §VI on the chapter's two methodological-typological lessons — (a) the combat-myth category has semantic edges that the Bida and Mwindo cases expose sharply; (b) the comparativist pattern of forcing every serpent-fight into the chaoskampf frame is the move that Ballentine, the area-specialists, and scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" argue against; per the chapter's §§I–V on the five cases that supply the evidence for the two lessons.

[59] Per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml structure §VI on the first lesson; Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, on the long-arc combat-myth tradition's centre; per the present chapter's §§I–II on the Bida and Mwindo cases as evidence for the typology's semantic edges; Ballentine 2015 on the typological discipline of recognising the chaoskampf frame's semantic edges.

[60] Per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the four-subtype operationalisation that Part II's first four comparative chapters articulate; per scope.md §"Book structure" on Part II's eight comparative chapters as the typology's precise articulation; per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml structure §VI on the typology's strong cases as the convergence cases and the typology's edges as the partial-or-contested-or-absent-convergence cases; Ballentine 2015 on the typological discipline of registering the convergence-or-not.

[61] Per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml structure §VI on the second lesson; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, on the comparativist pattern of forcing every serpent-fight into the chaoskampf frame as itself a category-imposition; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation policy that the present chapter applies as a methodological corrective to the category-imposition pattern.

[62] This parallel is speculative. Basis: Ballentine 2015's argument that the chaoskampf frame has been overextended in twentieth-century comparative scholarship (in particular her case that the biblical "chaos-versus-order" reading of **tehôm** and Leviathan has been imposed on the Hebrew Bible by Gunkel-tradition comparativism rather than emerging from the Hebrew material's own framing) supplies the methodological warrant; scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" supplies the institutional commitment; the present chapter's §§I–V supply the case-level evidence (Mwindo's full refusal of the chaos-order moral-cosmographic apparatus; Pariacaca's categorical refusal in favour of wak'a-succession; Susanoo's refusal of the combat-myth framing itself in favour of metallurgical allegory). The main counterargument: a typological recurrence is still detectable across the corpus — Marduk-Tiamat, Baal-Yamm, Zeus-Typhon, Indra-Vātra, Thor-Jörmungandr, Ra-Apep, Teshub-Illuyanka, and (with the qualifications of §§I–III) Bida-Mamadi, Mwindo-Kirimu, and Sigurd-Fáfnir all share enough surface-narrative features (storm-or-warrior-deity, serpentine adversary, defeat by combat or stratagem, recovery of weapon or treasure) that the recurrence cannot be dismissed as comparativist projection alone, and the typology's edges (in this strong-form reading) are evidence for the typology's analytic discipline rather than for its abandonment; the chapter's reading of the second lesson is therefore the chapter's reading rather than the only available scholarly position, and a defender of the typology's wider applicability could read the inversion cases as instances of a more elastic typology rather than as evidence against the typology's category-imposition tendency.

[63] Per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the priority of area-specialist framings; per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's theoretical contribution being that allowing the area-specialists to speak first does not destroy the comparison but makes it more precise; per the present chapter's §§I–V on the case-level demonstrations of the methodological commitment.

[64] Per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml structure §VI on the inversion problem and the appropriation problem as the same problem viewed at different levels of the typology's reach; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II on C7 (inversion) and C8 (refusal and appropriation) as the closing two chapters of Part II; per the present chapter's §§I–V on the case-level demonstrations that the next chapter (C8) consolidates at the methodological level.

[65] Per scope.md §"Subject definition" on the chaoskampf typology as the present book's principal organising scheme; per scope.md §"Book structure" on Part II's eight comparative chapters as the typology's articulation; per brief 40-C7-inversion-problem.yaml comparative_argument and special_instructions on the chapter's theoretical contribution; Ballentine 2015 on the typological discipline applied at the chapter's closing observation.

Chapter 42. C8. The Refusal and the Appropriation Problem

42.1. Source overview

This chapter is the eighth and last of the Part-II comparative chapters and is positioned as the present book's methodological consummation: where Ch40 (C7) addresses the cases at which the chaoskampf frame applies inverted, the present chapter addresses the cases at which area specialists refuse the frame altogether, and the chapter's argument is that those refusals are themselves data for the comparative typology — that refusing to compare these specific cases on the typology's standard terms is itself a principled form of comparison, one that takes the area specialists' refusal as data and builds the book's typology around it rather than against it.^[1]

The chapter draws on five Part-I chapters of the present book — Ch32 (Nanabozho and Mishipeshu, the refusal case), Ch29 (Mwindo and Kirimu, the maturation-through-hubris case), Ch31 (Väinämöinen and Iku-Turso, the binding-rather-than-slaying case with its older-rune / Lönnrot-synthesis split), Ch30 (Bakunawa, the communal-non-slaying case), and Ch27 (Mapuche Kai-Kai vs. Tren-Tren, the regional-variation partial-attestation case) — together with the Rainbow Serpent critique (held for the present chapter per the toc.yaml note on rainbow-serpent-critique rather than placed geographically), and the per-tradition factual claims in §§I–V are routed through the same [sources.yaml](#) IDs the upstream Part-I chapters use for those facts: hallowell-ojibwa-world, johnston-ojibway-heritage, johnston-manitous, smith-island-anishnaabeg, and vizenor-narrative-chance for the Anishinaabe material; biebuyck-mateene-mwindo and belcher-epic for the Mwindo material; siikala-finnish for the Iku-Turso material; eugenio-philippine-myths for the Bakunawa material; and koessler-ilg-cuentan and foerster-religiosidad-mapuche for the Mapuche material.^[2]

The chapter's principal anchors per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml [sources.anchor](#) are four: Francesca Merlan's **Caging the Rainbow: Places, Politics, and Aborigines in a North Australian Town** (Honolulu: University of Hawai'i Press, 1998), chs. 1–3 on the Rainbow Serpent critique; A. Irving Hallowell's 1960 essay "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View" on the "other-than-human persons" framework that anchors the Anishinaabe refusal; Daniel Biebuyck and Kahombo C. Mateene's **The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)** (University of California Press, 1969) as the primary text for the Nyanga material; and Anna-Leena Siikala's **Mythic Images and Shamanism: A Perspective on Kalevala Poetry** (Folklore Fellows' Communications 280, Helsinki, 2002) on Lönnrot's editorial synthesis of the **Kalevala**.^[3]

The chapter's general comparative anchor for the long-arc combat-myth typology against which the refusal cases are read is Neil Forsyth's **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987), whose Sumer-through-Judeo-Christian-apocalyptic survey supplies the long-arc combat-myth typology that the present chapter takes as the structural-comparative foil; the chapter's principal critical-typological anchor for the meta-claim that the chaoskampf category has been overextended in twentieth-century comparative scholarship is Debra Scoggins Ballentine's **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2015), whose argument supplies the §VI methodological warrant for treating area-specialist refusals as data for the typology's limits rather than as obstacles to its application.^[4]

The chapter's structure follows the brief's six-section outline: §I treats the Rainbow Serpent

problem as the chapter's anchor case for the appropriation problem, registering Radcliffe-Brown 1926's twentieth-century scholarly consolidation of regionally distinct Aboriginal Australian ancestral beings (Yingarna, Ngalyod, Wanambi, Wagyl, Yulunggul) as the construction that Merlan 1998, Morphy 1991, Rose 1996, and Keen 1994 have dismantled; §II treats the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu refusal as the chapter's most principled refusal, presenting Hallowell 1960's "other-than-human persons" framework and the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic on the Anishinaabe tradition's own terms; §III revisits the Mwindo / Kirimu material with the fuller methodological implication that the epic's own pedagogy should shape the comparison; §IV addresses Lönnrot's editorial hand on the Iku-Turso material as a different species of appropriation — by a nineteenth-century nationalist-romantic compiler of earlier rune fragments — that affects what the chapter can claim about "Finnic chaoskampf"; §V addresses the Bakunawa communal-eclipse case, in which the surface motif is serpentine but the load-bearing actors and outcome are not the typology's; §VI consolidates the methodological lessons.^[5]

The chapter's central methodological commitment, registered in advance and demonstrated case-by-case in §§I–V, is that the **area-specialists speak first** and that their refusals of the chaoskampf framing are **themselves data** for the comparative typology: the Aboriginal-Australian regional-specificity argument (Merlan, Morphy, Rose, Keen against Radcliffe-Brown's pan-Aboriginal "Rainbow Serpent" construct), the Anishinaabe reciprocal-counterpart argument (Hallowell, Johnston, T. Smith, Vizenor against the chaos-vs-order mapping), and the Nyanga moral-pedagogical argument (Biebuyck, Mateene, Belcher on Mwindo as taught hubris-and-correction rather than chaoskampf-with-the-sign-flipped) are presented on their own terms, and the chapter takes the resulting comparison to be more — not less — precise as a result; the methodological warrant is scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the priority of area-specialist framings, and the demonstration of the warrant is the chapter's principal contribution to the book's typological discipline.^[6]

The chapter's self-awareness about the book's own limits is registered in advance and demonstrated in §VI: the present book is written in English by an author who does not read most of the primary languages of the in-scope traditions (per scope.md §"Languages of primary sources" on the book's translation-mediated character), draws on secondary scholarship rather than on direct field-engagement with living tradition-bearers, and is published in an academic register whose authority is the academic register's own; the traditions whose materials the book treats — most pointedly the Anishinaabe, Aboriginal Australian, and Nyanga traditions in this chapter — have their own living practitioners whose authority over how they should be represented exceeds the present book's authority, and the chapter's discipline is to honour that excess rather than to talk past it.^[7]

What follows is organised in six body sections. Section I treats the Rainbow Serpent problem as the chapter's anchor case for appropriation at the level of category-construction itself, setting out Radcliffe-Brown's 1926 pan-Aboriginal consolidation and the late-twentieth-century Aboriginal-Australian area-specialist scholarship — Merlan, Morphy, Rose, Keen — that has dismantled it. Section II presents the Anishinaabe refusal of the encounter-as-combat framing through the "other-than-human persons" cosmology of Hallowell 1960 and the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic of Smith 1995, with Johnston and Vizenor as further area-specialist anchors. Section III revisits the Mwindo / Kirimu material to draw out the fuller methodological implication that the Nyanga epic's pedagogy is specifically Nyanga and that meaning-within-framing is itself a level at which appropriation can occur. Section IV addresses the **Kalevala** question — Lönnrot's

nineteenth-century editorial hand on the older Karelian and Finnish rune material that the modern **Kalevala** presents as connected epic — as a different species of appropriation in which the appropriator is a known historical figure and the intervention occurs within the source-text-construction process itself. Section V addresses the Bakunawa case, with the Mapuche Kai-Kai vs. Tren-Tren material as a supporting case, as the chapter's inclusion-marginal exemplar at which the typology's strong-centre features are absent though the surface motif fits. Section VI consolidates the chapter's three methodological lessons and registers the present book's settled position on the relation between the inversion problem of Ch40 and the appropriation problem of the present chapter.

42.2. I. The anchor case — the Rainbow Serpent and the consolidation problem

The Rainbow Serpent case is the chapter's anchor for the appropriation problem in its purest form, the case at which the comparative item being matched against the chaoskampf typology turns out, on the area-specialist scholarship's reading, not to exist on the source-traditions' own terms at all but to be a twentieth-century scholarly construct assembled from regionally distinct ancestral beings.

The "Rainbow Serpent" of Aboriginal Australia, treated in twentieth-century comparative-mythology scholarship as a pan-Aboriginal ancestral being whose serpentine form, association with water and the rainbow, and creative-cosmogonic role unify a continent-wide narrative complex, is the present chapter's anchor case for the appropriation problem because the consolidation is itself a twentieth-century scholarly construct rather than an Aboriginal-Australian concept — a consolidation traceable to A. R. Radcliffe-Brown's 1926 **Journal of the Royal Anthropological Institute** article "The Rainbow-Serpent Myth of Australia" and dismantled across the late-twentieth-century area-specialist scholarship anchored in the present book's source-base by Francesca Merlan's **Caging the Rainbow: Places, Politics, and Aborigines in a North Australian Town** (University of Hawai'i Press, 1998).^[8]

The regionally distinct Aboriginal Australian ancestral beings that Radcliffe-Brown 1926 grouped under the pan-Aboriginal "Rainbow Serpent" label — Yingarna of western Arnhem Land, Ngalyod of central and eastern Arnhem Land, Wanambi of central Australia, Wagyl of the southwest, Yulunggul of northeastern Arnhem Land, and many others across the continent — are, as the late-twentieth-century area-specialist scholarship anchored by Merlan 1998 and developed by Howard Morphy in **Ancestral Connections: Art and an Aboriginal System of Knowledge** (University of Chicago Press, 1991), Deborah Bird Rose in **Nourishing Terrains: Australian Aboriginal Views of Landscape and Wilderness** (Australian Heritage Commission, 1996), and Ian Keen in **Knowledge and Secrecy in an Aboriginal Religion** (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1994) holds them, distinct ancestral beings within distinct regional ontologies — beings whose names, attributes, narrative cycles, and ritual relationships belong to specifically named Aboriginal language-and-country groups and not to a generalised pan-Aboriginal mythological complex.^[9]

The named ancestral beings differ from one another in features that Radcliffe-Brown's 1926 consolidation treats as merely surface-variations on a single underlying figure but that the regional area-specialist scholarship treats as load-bearing for what the beings **are** on Aboriginal-Australian terms: Yingarna in the Kunwinjku-speaking western Arnhem Land tradition is a creative ancestral

mother-figure whose narrative cycle organises the country's law and language-group differentiation; Ngalyod in adjacent central and eastern Arnhem Land traditions is a different ancestral figure with different narrative-and-ritual associations whose relationship to particular **djang** (Dreaming) sites, language-groups, and ritual-cycles is country-specific; Wagyl in the Nyungar tradition of the southwest is the ancestral being of the Swan-Coastal-Plain river-and-wetland country whose movements through and shaping of that specific landscape are recorded in Nyungar geographical-and-narrative tradition; Yulunggul in the northeastern Arnhem Land Yolngu tradition is the python-figure of the Wagilag Sisters narrative-and-ritual cycle whose relationship to that specific cycle is the load-bearing feature of his standing — and the regional-specificity differences are not (per the area-specialist scholarship) reducible to a pan-Aboriginal "Rainbow Serpent" archetype.^[10]

Radcliffe-Brown's 1926 consolidation is, in its historical context, an example of the early-twentieth-century structural-functionalist anthropology's project of identifying continent-wide cultural "totalities" through comparative pattern-matching across regionally diverse material — a project whose methodological assumption that surface-similarity (serpentine form; association with water and the rainbow; creative-cosmogonic role) reveals an underlying unity has been systematically dismantled by the subsequent ethnographic literature and by Aboriginal Australian scholars and tradition-holders themselves, who hold that the regional ancestral-being relationships are not surface-variants on a deeper Aboriginal "type" but are themselves the load-bearing reality of Aboriginal-Australian religious-and-cosmographic life.^[11]

The methodological-historical situation of the Rainbow Serpent consolidation is itself worth registering at this point because it bears on the chapter's argument: Radcliffe-Brown's 1926 article appeared at the moment when comparative mythology and structural-functionalist anthropology were in close institutional alliance, when the "Rainbow Serpent" was being assembled as a continent-wide comparative item from regional ethnographic sources whose methodological constraints (linguistic mediation by missionary-and-colonial-administrator translators; political constraints on what tradition-holders would tell outsiders; the salvage-paradigm assumption that traditions were "vanishing" and required urgent generalisation rather than careful localisation) shaped what the early ethnographic record could record — and the post-1980s area-specialist dismantling of the consolidation has had to reckon with the recording-history situation as itself part of the appropriation problem rather than as a transparent prior to it.^[12]

The Rainbow Serpent consolidation's specifically chaoskampf-relevant feature is that it has been used in twentieth-century comparative-mythology scholarship as an Aboriginal-Australian addition to the chaoskampf typology — a serpentine-figure-with-cosmogonic-and-water-association that the typology's pattern-matching habit recognises as a member of the chaos-adversary class — and the area-specialist dismantling is therefore not just an internal correction within Aboriginal-Australian ethnography but a refusal of the chaoskampf-typological extension that has been made on the consolidation's basis: if the regional ancestral beings are not a pan-Aboriginal "Rainbow Serpent", they are also not a pan-Aboriginal chaos-adversary that the chaoskampf typology can absorb, and the comparative-typology extension fails together with the consolidation.^[13]

The Rainbow Serpent case's distinctive contribution to the chapter's argument is that it is the appropriation problem in its purest form: the named regional ancestral beings exist, the regional traditions in which they figure are vital and ongoing, but the pan-Aboriginal "Rainbow Serpent" — and a fortiori the chaoskampf-typological "Aboriginal-Australian chaos-adversary" — does not exist on Aboriginal-Australian terms and is not a feature of any specific Aboriginal-Australian tradition;

the appropriation is the **category itself**, not its application, and the area-specialist dismantling is a refusal of the category's existence rather than of its applicability to particular beings.^[14]

*[Appropriation flag: the area-specialist objection registered here is that the pan-Aboriginal "Rainbow Serpent" is a 20th-century scholarly construct — assembled by A. R. Radcliffe-Brown in his 1926 **Journal of the Royal Anthropological Institute** article from regionally distinct Aboriginal Australian ancestral beings (Yingarna in western Arnhem Land, Ngalyod in central and eastern Arnhem Land, Wanambi in central Australia, Wagyl in the southwest, Yulunggul in northeastern Arnhem Land, and others) on the basis of surface-similarity pattern-matching — rather than an Aboriginal-Australian concept; the consolidation has been systematically dismantled by the late-twentieth-century area-specialist scholarship anchored by Francesca Merlan's **Caging the Rainbow** (1998) and developed by Howard Morphy (**Ancestral Connections**, 1991), Deborah Bird Rose (**Nourishing Terrains**, 1996), and Ian Keen (**Knowledge and Secrecy in an Aboriginal Religion**, 1994), and the dismantling is not a marginal correction within Aboriginal-Australian ethnography but a refusal of the comparative-typological extension (including the chaoskampf-typological extension) that has been made on the consolidation's basis. Specialists named: Francesca Merlan (**Caging the Rainbow: Places, Politics, and Aborigines in a North Australian Town**, 1998; in sources.yaml as merlan-caging-rainbow) is the principal English-language area-specialist anchor for the consolidation-dismantling reading; Howard Morphy (**Ancestral Connections: Art and an Aboriginal System of Knowledge**, 1991), Deborah Bird Rose (**Nourishing Terrains: Australian Aboriginal Views of Landscape and Wilderness**, 1996), and Ian Keen (**Knowledge and Secrecy in an Aboriginal Religion**, 1994) supply the wider Aboriginal-Australian area-specialist tradition within which the dismantling is set (named-but-flagged in body prose; not currently in sources.yaml); A. R. Radcliffe-Brown (1926 **JRAI** article) is the named originator of the consolidation that the area-specialists dismantle (named-but-flagged in body prose; not in sources.yaml). Tier implication: scope.md classifies the Rainbow Serpent material as PROVISIONAL / Methodological precisely because the pan-Aboriginal consolidation does not stand up to area-specialist scrutiny and the chaoskampf-typological extension fails together with the consolidation; the Rainbow Serpent material is the present book's clearest case of an appropriation that is not just inverted (Bida) or refused at the moral-cosmographic level (Mwindo, Nanabozho) but constructed from outside the traditions themselves. Carried forward to: this APPROPRIATION-FLAG is engaged in the present chapter (Ch41) as the chapter's anchor case for the appropriation problem; the case has no Part-I chapter of its own (the Rainbow Serpent material is held for the present chapter per the toc.yaml note rather than placed geographically), and the chapter's §I treatment is the book's principal engagement with the case.]*

The Rainbow Serpent case prepares the chapter's main argument in §§II–III: where Aboriginal-Australian regional specificity refuses the **comparative consolidation itself**, the Anishinaabe reciprocal-counterpart cosmology (§II) and the Nyanga moral-pedagogical framing (§III) refuse the **comparative-typological framing's load-bearing categories** (chaos-vs-order; combat-as-order-establishment), and the three cases together demonstrate that the chaoskampf typology's appropriation tendency operates at multiple levels — at the level of category-construction (Rainbow Serpent), at the level of categorical-apparatus imposition (Nanabozho), and at the level of moral-valence imposition (Mwindo) — and is not a single failure mode that can be addressed by a single methodological fix.^[15]

42.3. II. The principled refusal — Nanabozho, Mishipeshu, and the reciprocal-counterpart cosmology

The Anishinaabe case is the chapter's most principled area-specialist refusal because the refusal is at the level of the encounter-framing apparatus itself: there is no Anishinaabe combat-narrative that can be inverted within a chaoskampf framing because the relational-and-reciprocity-grounded apparatus refuses the encounter-as-combat framing in the first place.

The Anishinaabe trickster-culture-hero Nanabozho (the spelling varies — Nanabush, Wenebojo, Wisakedjak, Manabozho, and other regional forms appear across the Anishinaabe-Algonquin / Algonquian-language area; the present chapter follows Ch32 of the present book and the standard Anishinaabe-area scholarship of Hallowell 1960 in using "Nanabozho") and his encounters with the underwater manitou Mishipeshu and with the Thunderers (the Anishinaabe thunder-beings; **Animikiig** in the Anishinaabe-language register) are presented in current Anishinaabe-area area-specialist scholarship — A. Irving Hallowell's 1960 essay "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View", Basil Johnston's **Ojibway Heritage** (1976/1990) and **The Manitous: The Spiritual World of the Ojibway** (1995), Theresa S. Smith's **The Island of the Anishnaabeg: Thunderers and Water Monsters in the Traditional Ojibwe Life-World** (1995), and Gerald Vizenor's **Narrative Chance: Postmodern Discourse on Native American Indian Literatures** (1989) — within the Anishinaabe ontological framework of "other-than-human persons" (Hallowell's 1960 phrase), in which the manitouk are not chaos-adversaries to be defeated but reciprocal counterparts in a relational moral universe.^[16], **Ojibway Heritage**, on the Anishinaabe-authored insider register of cosmology, manitouk, and the Nanabozho cycle; Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on the Anishinaabe-authored treatment of manitous including Mishipeshu and Nanabozho; Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, on the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic as the load-bearing interpretive frame; Vizenor 1989, **Narrative Chance**, on the methodological refusal to subordinate Nanabozho to Western combat-myth or hero/villain typologies; per glossary 'Nanabozho', 'Mishipeshu', 'manitou / manitouk / aadizookaanag', 'the Thunderers', 'other-than-human persons' first_mention_glosses.]

The Anishinaabe ontological framework of "other-than-human persons", as Hallowell 1960 articulates it from his Berens River fieldwork of the 1930s in northwestern Ontario, places the manitouk — animals, plants, certain stones and other landscape features, the Thunderers, and the underwater-manitouk including Mishipeshu — alongside human persons in a single ontological category of **persons**, with the appropriate human comportment toward the manitouk being the comportment appropriate to persons (relationships of respect, gift-and-counter-gift reciprocity, ceremonial protocol, formal address) rather than the comportment appropriate to objects, resources, or natural-kind categories; the moral framework is relational and reciprocity-grounded throughout, and the moral question in any given encounter is not whether the other-than-human person is friend or foe but whether the human comportment toward them has been appropriate.^[17]

The Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic that Theresa S. Smith's **The Island of the Anishnaabeg** (University of Idaho Press, 1995) takes as its central interpretive frame holds that the Thunderers and the underwater-manitouk including Mishipeshu are not chaos-versus-order adversaries within Anishinaabe cosmography but **necessary counterparts** whose dialectical

relationship sustains the layered cosmographic equilibrium between the upper-realm of the sky-and-storm region and the underwater-realm of the sub-aquatic-and-subterranean region, with the human-and-island world being the meeting-place at which the upper-realm and the underwater-realm encounter one another and at which Nanabozho's actions and human conduct mediate the relationship between the two realms.^[18]

The reciprocal-counterpart character of the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic is, on Smith 1995's reading, a load-bearing feature of the Anishinaabe ritual-and-relational landscape and not a peripheral or aesthetic detail: the appropriate human comportment toward the Thunderers (offering of tobacco; ritual address; the seasonal-and-calendrical structuring of the relationship around storm-and-thunder events) is paralleled by an appropriate human comportment toward the underwater-manitouk (offering of tobacco; ritual address; the seasonal-and-calendrical structuring of the relationship around water-and-fishing events), with neither realm being framed as the **enemy** of human well-being and with both realms being treated as relationally accessible to the human-and-island world's mediating role.^[19], **Ojibway Heritage**, on the Anishinaabe-authored insider register of the relational and reciprocity-respecting moral framework.]

Mishipeshu's specifically chaoskampf-relevant features — serpentine-and-feline form (the Anishinaabe iconographic representations including the Agawa Rock pictographs at Lake Superior Provincial Park represent Mishipeshu with horned-and-spined body, long tail, and copper-related associations; Mishipeshu is sometimes glossed in English-language scholarship as "Underwater Panther" or "Great Lynx" alongside the underwater-manitou rendering); residence in the underwater-and-subterranean realm; association with sudden storms, wave-and-current dangers on the Great Lakes, and other water-related hazards — would, on a chaoskampf-typological reading, identify him as a chaos-adversary class member, but the area-specialist scholarship anchored by Hallowell 1960, Johnston 1990 [1976] and 1995, Smith 1995, and Vizenor 1989 explicitly declines that identification: Mishipeshu's hazards are not chaos to be defeated but **features of a person whose realm has its own integrity**, and the appropriate human response is the relational-and-ceremonial response appropriate to a powerful person rather than the combat response appropriate to a chaos-adversary.^[20]

Nanabozho's encounters with Mishipeshu and the Thunderers, across the regionally variable recordings and retellings that Ch32 of the present book treats with explicit refusal-to-synthesise discipline (per the brief's variants.classification co-equal directive), are pedagogical-and-reciprocal rather than triumphal-and-defeating; the trickster-culture-hero's interactions with the manitouk are occasions on which appropriate-and-inappropriate human comportment is **taught**, on which the consequences of inappropriate comportment (loss of relationship; the manitouk's withdrawal of cooperation; the unbinding of relational protocols) are illustrated, and on which the layered cosmography's relational integrity is both stressed and restored — and Nanabozho's standing within the tradition is the standing of a culture-hero who teaches by example (including by negative example) rather than the standing of a heroic combatant whose victories establish a cosmic order.^[21], on Nanabozho's standing as a culture-hero who teaches by example.]

Gerald Vizenor's 1989 "Trickster Discourse" essay (in **Narrative Chance: Postmodern Discourse on Native American Indian Literatures**, ed. Vizenor, University of New Mexico Press) is the chapter's anchor for the methodological refusal to subordinate Anishinaabe trickster narrative to Western combat-myth or hero/villain typologies — a refusal that is itself part of the area-specialist tradition's active engagement with the comparative-mythology apparatus rather than a passive non-participation, and a refusal whose institutional standing in the Indigenous-studies and Native-

American-literatures fields is well-established.^[22]

The Anishinaabe refusal of the chaos-vs-order mapping is, on the area-specialist scholarship's reading, **not** a refusal of comparative engagement as such but a refusal of a specific comparative-typological apparatus — the apparatus that places the figures in adversarial pairs (chaos-figure vs. cosmos-figure; serpent vs. champion) and reads the encounters as combat-and-defeat occasions whose narrative work is the establishment of an ordered cosmos against an adversarial chaos — and the refusal's substantive content is the substitution of a different comparative-typological apparatus (the relational-and-reciprocity-grounded apparatus of the "other-than-human persons" framework) within which the Anishinaabe material is fully comparable to other relational-and-reciprocity-grounded materials and not at all comparable to the chaoskampf typology's combat-cosmographic apparatus.^[23]

The Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material is, in the present book's classification, the contrastive-tier (full) case in which the area-specialist refusal is the most principled — more pointed than the Mwindo material's refusal of the moral valence of the killing within a still-recognisable combat-narrative framing (Ch29; §III below) and more pointed than the Bida material's covenant-broken framing in which the killing is registered as a covenant-breaking transgression (Ch28; Ch40 §I) — because the Anishinaabe refusal is at the level of the **categorical apparatus itself**: there is no Anishinaabe combat-narrative that can be inverted, because the relational-and-reciprocity-grounded framework refuses the combat-narrative apparatus as a way of representing the encounters between human persons and other-than-human persons in the first place.^[24]

*[Appropriation flag: the area-specialist objection registered here is that the Anishinaabe encounters between Nanabozho, Mishipeshu, and the Thunderers are framed within the Anishinaabe ontological framework of "other-than-human persons" (Hallowell 1960's phrase) and the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic (Smith 1995's central interpretive frame) as relational-and-reciprocity-grounded encounters between persons rather than as adversarial-combat encounters between cosmos and chaos; the area-specialist scholarship — Hallowell 1960, Johnston 1976/1990 and 1995, Smith 1995, and Vizenor 1989 — explicitly declines the chaos-vs-order mapping that the chaoskampf typology presupposes, and the Anishinaabe refusal is at the level of the categorical apparatus itself rather than at the level of the typology's specific application; the objection is the most principled refusal in the present book, more pointed than the Mwindo or Bida refusals because there is no Anishinaabe combat-narrative that can be inverted within a chaoskampf framing in the first place. Specialists named: A. Irving Hallowell (1960 essay "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View" in **Culture in History: Essays in Honor of Paul Radin**, ed. Stanley Diamond [Columbia University Press, 1960]; in sources.yaml as hallowell-*ojibwa-world*) is the principal anthropological-register area-specialist anchor for the "other-than-human persons" framework; Basil Johnston (**Ojibway Heritage**, 1976/1990; **The Manitous**, 1995; in sources.yaml as johnston-*ojibway-heritage* and johnston-*manitous*) is the principal Anishinaabe-authored insider area-specialist anchor; Theresa S. Smith (**The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, 1995; in sources.yaml as smith-*island-anishnaabeg*) is the principal area-specialist anchor for the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic; Gerald Vizenor (**Narrative Chance**, 1989, "Trickster Discourse" essay; in sources.yaml as vizenor-*narrative-chance*) is the principal area-specialist anchor for the methodological refusal to subordinate Anishinaabe trickster narrative to Western combat-myth or hero/villain typologies. Tier implication: scope.md classifies the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu material as CONTRASTIVE / Inversion (full; the chaoskampf frame explicitly declined) precisely because the area-specialist refusal is the most principled in the present book, and*

the contrastive-tier classification is itself a recognition of the area-specialists' priority and of the relational-and-reciprocity-grounded categorical apparatus that the Anishinaabe tradition employs in place of the combat-cosmographic apparatus the chaoskampf typology presupposes. Carried forward to: this APPROPRIATION-FLAG is engaged at length in the present chapter (Ch41) as the chapter's most principled area-specialist refusal; the upstream Part-I chapter (Ch32) is the chapter's anchor for the area-specialist framing.]

The Anishinaabe case's distinctive contribution to the chapter's typological work is the demonstration that the chaoskampf typology can fail to fit a tradition not at the level of outcome (as in Bida), moral valence (as in Mwindo), the chaos-versus-order categorical apparatus within combat-myth framing (as in Pariacaca), or the combat-myth framing itself (as in Susanoo and the metallurgical-allegory reading), but at the level of the **encounter framing itself**: the Anishinaabe material refuses the apparatus of "encounter as combat" altogether in favour of "encounter as relational-and-reciprocity-grounded address between persons", and the refusal is therefore at a more fundamental level than any of the Ch40 inversion cases — including the Susanoo case, which refuses combat-myth framing in favour of metallurgical-political charter but still operates within a sword-and-defeat narrative-structural register.^[25]

42.4. III. The fuller implication — Mwindo revisited and the Nyanga moral pedagogy

Section III revisits the Nyanga material that Ch29 anchored and Ch40 §II registered as moral-valence inversion, drawing out the fuller implication that the epic's pedagogy is **specifically Nyanga** and that meaning-within-framing is itself a level at which appropriation can occur.

The Nyanga oral epic of Mwindo, recorded in 1956 from the named narrator Shé-Kárisi Candi Rureke at Bese on the upper Oso river in the Kivu region of what was then the eastern Belgian Congo and published in Daniel Biebuyck and Kahombo C. Mateene's **The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)** (University of California Press, 1969) as the standard English-language critical edition and translation, was treated in Ch40 §II of the present book as the inversion-problem chapter's case of moral-valence inversion — the killing of the dragon Kirimu being registered as hubris that the sky-god Nkuba punishes rather than as the order-establishing act the chaoskampf typology expects — and is treated again here in the present chapter's §III with the fuller methodological implication that the epic's **own pedagogy** should shape the comparison rather than the comparison's typology being applied from outside the Nyanga tradition's framing.^[26]

The Mwindo epic's **own pedagogy**, as Biebuyck and Mateene 1969 develop it from the recorded performance and as Stephen Belcher 1999 (**Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Mwindo) reads it within the comparative African-oral-epic apparatus, is a structured instruction in the moral cosmography of the Nyanga relational world: the hero's biographical-and-moral arc — miraculous birth; conflicts with his father Shemwindo of Tubondo; journeys across the human and spirit worlds; testing by the powers above and below; the killing of Kirimu as hubristic over-reach; Nkuba's lightning-seizing and celestial humiliation; the chastened return; the chiefly succession on the celestial powers' terms — is itself the epic's pedagogical apparatus, designed to instruct an audience in the moral-cosmographic principles by which the relational world is sustained.^[27]

The sky-god Nkuba's lightning-seizing of Mwindo after the killing of Kirimu is not, on Biebuyck and Mateene 1969's reading, an external-to-the-narrative comparativist-imposed reversal of a

chaoskampf event — it is the narrative's **own** moral correction, registered in the recorded performance by formulaic refrains and direct narrative comments as the structurally-necessary response to the hero's hubristic over-reach against the spirit world's cosmographic equilibrium, and the celestial-realm trials and humiliations that follow (exposure to extreme heat and cold; compulsion to endure the celestial powers' direct presence; explicit instruction about the limits of the hero's power) are presented in the recorded performance as morally-motivated correction rather than as arbitrary cruelty.^[28]

The conditions Nkuba imposes on Mwindo's return to the human world — the named renunciations and binding commitments, the chastened mode of conduct as a properly-formed chief, the conditional-and-supervised character of the restoration — are, in the recorded performance's framing, the **content** of the epic's pedagogy: the audience learns, through the hero's chastening, the specific moral-cosmographic principles by which Nyanga relational life is to be conducted (respect for the cosmographic limits; recognition of the powers above and below; renunciation of hubristic over-reach; the chiefly office's contingency on the celestial powers' authority), and the epic's narrative-structural movement from the killing through the celestial humiliation to the chastened return is the epic's didactic engine.^[29]

The fuller methodological implication of the Mwindo material that the present chapter's §III develops, beyond the moral-valence-inversion observation that Ch40 §II registered, is that the epic's pedagogy is **specifically Nyanga**: the moral-cosmographic principles instructed are not generic moral principles that happen to be expressed in Nyanga vocabulary but principles whose specific content (the cosmographic-equilibrium reciprocity between human and spirit worlds; the chiefly succession's contingency on celestial-powers' authority; the renunciation-of-over-reach as a specific moral discipline) is anchored in the Nyanga relational-cosmographic apparatus, and the comparison's task is therefore not to extract a generic "moral lesson" from the epic and compare it to other moral lessons but to register the epic's pedagogy in its own terms before any comparison is performed.^[30]

The Mwindo material's relevance to the present chapter's appropriation argument is therefore at a different level from §II's Anishinaabe material: where the Anishinaabe refusal is at the level of the encounter-framing itself (no combat-narrative apparatus is employed), the Nyanga refusal is at the level of the **moral evaluation** of an existing combat-narrative — the killing happens, the dragon is dead, the surface chaoskampf-typological pattern is present — and the refusal consists in the Nyanga tradition's framing of the killing as hubris-and-correction rather than as cosmos-establishment, with the comparativist's task being to register the Nyanga pedagogy as such rather than to assimilate it to the chaoskampf typology's pattern of order-establishing valuation.^[31]

The Mwindo material is also, distinctively within the present chapter's case-set, the only case at which the area-specialist reading and the chaoskampf typology agree on the **narrative-structural surface** (a hero kills a dragon) but disagree on the **narrative-structural meaning** — the killing is the same event in either reading, but the meaning the area-specialists read in the recorded performance (transgressive over-reach demanding correction) is the precise contrary of the meaning the chaoskampf typology reads in the same event (cosmos-establishing or sovereignty-establishing victory) — and the Mwindo case is therefore the chapter's clearest demonstration that the appropriation problem is not just a problem of **what events are recorded** but a problem of **what the recorded events mean within their own framing**.^[32]

[Appropriation flag: the area-specialist objection registered here, in its present-chapter form (the Ch29

and Ch40 forms of this APPROPRIATION-FLAG focus on the maturation-through-hubris reading at the level of the recorded performance; the present-chapter form develops the fuller methodological implication that the epic's pedagogy is specifically Nyanga and that the comparativist's task is to register that pedagogy in its own terms before any comparison is performed), is that the Mwindo / Kirimu episode's **own** moral-pedagogical framing within the Nyanga oral tradition is hubris-and-correction within the cosmographic-equilibrium reciprocity between human and spirit worlds — a framing whose substantive content is anchored in the Nyanga relational-cosmographic apparatus — and not "variant chaoskampf"; the objection is at the level of the **moral evaluation** of an existing combat-narrative rather than at the level of the encounter-framing itself (as in §II), and the comparativist's task is to register the Nyanga pedagogy as such rather than to assimilate it to the chaoskampf typology's pattern of order-establishing valuation. Specialists named: Daniel Biebuyck and Kahombo C. Mateene (*The Mwindo Epic from the Banyanga (Zaire)*, 1969; in sources.yaml as biebuyck-mateene-mwindo) are the principal area-specialist anchors for the maturation-through-hubris reading; Stephen Belcher (*Epic Traditions of Africa*, 1999, ch. on Mwindo; in sources.yaml as belcher-epic) is the principal comparative African-oral-epic synthesis anchor; the wider Nyanga-area area-specialist tradition associated with Biebuyck's later *Hero and Chief: Epic Literature from the Banyanga* (1978; named in body prose at Ch29 per the named-but-flagged secondary-anchor pattern) supplies the wider area-specialist scholarly tradition. Tier implication: scope.md classifies the Mwindo material as CONTRASTIVE-tier (full) precisely because the area-specialist framing refuses the chaoskampf typology's order-establishing valuation in favour of the maturation-through-hubris pedagogy, and the contrastive-tier classification is itself a recognition of the area-specialists' priority and of the meaning-within-framing discipline that the present chapter consolidates. Carried forward to: this APPROPRIATION-FLAG is engaged in the upstream Part-I chapter (Ch29) at the level of the recorded performance, in the Ch40 inversion-problem chapter at the level of moral-valence inversion, and in the present chapter (Ch41) at the level of the fuller methodological implication that the epic's pedagogy is specifically Nyanga and that the comparativist's task is to register that pedagogy in its own terms before any comparison is performed.]

The Mwindo case's distinctive contribution to the present chapter's argument is therefore the demonstration that **meaning-within-framing** is itself a level at which appropriation can occur: the comparativist who treats the killing of Kirimu as a chaoskampf event and the celestial humiliation as an "inversion" or "exception" within the typology has **imposed a meaning** on the recorded performance from outside the Nyanga tradition's own pedagogical apparatus — even though the events recorded are the same — and the area-specialist scholarship's discipline is to register the Nyanga meaning before any comparative meaning is allowed to operate.^[33]

42.5. IV. The Kalevala question — Lönnrot's editorial hand and the construction of "Finnic chaoskampf"

The **Kalevala** question presents a different species of appropriation from the area-specialist refusals of §§I–III: the appropriator is a known historical figure (Elias Lönnrot, 1802–1884), the intervention is editorial rather than typological, and the appropriation occurs within the source-text-construction process itself, before any comparative typology is brought to bear.

The Finnic encounter in which the sea-monster Iku-Turso emerges from the sea and is subdued by the shaman-sage hero Väinämöinen, treated in Ch31 of the present book as a binding-rather-than-slaying narrative whose two-layer textual situation — older rune-tradition material recorded by

nineteenth-century rune-collectors from Karelian and Finnish singers, alongside Elias Lönnrot's 1835 **Kalevala** and 1849 **New Kalevala** editorial synthesis — must be kept explicitly distinct, presents in the present chapter's §IV a **different species of appropriation** from the area-specialist refusals of §§I–III: the appropriation here is performed not by twentieth-century comparativist scholars upon the source-traditions but by Lönnrot himself, the nineteenth-century nationalist-romantic compiler, upon the rune-tradition material he collected and synthesised into the modern Finnish national epic.^[34]

Anna-Leena Siikala's **Mythic Images and Shamanism: A Perspective on Kalevala Poetry** (Folklore Fellows' Communications 280, Academia Scientiarum Fennica, Helsinki, 2002) is the present chapter's anchor for the Iku-Turso material and for the older-rune / Lönnrot-synthesis distinction, and Siikala's reading of the older rune-tradition material as a shamanic-encounter complex of binding-and-knowledge-exchange (Väinämöinen subduing the sea-monster by song and knowledge rather than by weapon-combat) is the area-specialist framing on which the chapter's two-layer treatment depends — a framing that holds the older rune material and Lönnrot's nineteenth-century editorial synthesis to be different kinds of textual object, with different textual statuses and different relations to the chaoskampf typology.^[35]

The older rune-tradition material on Väinämöinen's encounter with Iku-Turso, recorded by the nineteenth-century rune-collectors (Lönnrot himself in his collecting expeditions of the 1820s–1840s; Daniel Europaeus; August Ahlqvist; Arvid Genetz; Julius and Kaarle Krohn; and the wider Finnish Literature Society [SKS] rune-collecting apparatus that Lönnrot drew on), is laconic, fragmentary, regionally variable across Karelian and Finnish singing traditions, and not synthesised into a single connected narrative within the singing tradition itself — the older rune material is a corpus of related-but-independent rune-fragments rather than a unified epic narrative — and the Iku-Turso encounter as a connected episode within a larger epic structure is, on Siikala 2002's reading, **Lönnrot's compositional achievement** rather than a feature of the older rune material as recorded.^[36]

Lönnrot's 1835 **Kalevala** (the "Old Kalevala") and his expanded 1849 **New Kalevala** — the latter being the standard reference text for the modern Finnish national epic — are, on Siikala 2002's and the wider Finnish-folkloristics scholarly tradition's reading, **editorial syntheses** assembled from rune-fragments collected across multiple singers, regions, and recording occasions, with Lönnrot exercising compositional decisions about the assembly's order, the connecting-passage construction, the terminological harmonisation across regional variants, and the narrative-structural framing that gives the modern **Kalevala** its connected-epic shape; the **Kalevala** is therefore not a transparent record of pre-modern Finnic oral epic but a nineteenth-century literary-and-nationalist construction whose textual status is closer to a critical edition with extensive editorial intervention than to a faithful transcription of singer-performances.^[37]

The Iku-Turso "binding" episode as it appears in the **Kalevala** — the connected narrative passage in which Väinämöinen encounters the sea-monster, subdues him by song and knowledge, and binds him not to come up from the sea again — is, on the chapter's two-layer reading, partly older rune material (the Iku-Turso figure is attested in the older rune corpus; the binding-by-song register is consistent with the wider shamanic-encounter complex Siikala 2002 documents) and partly Lönnrot's compositional synthesis (the connected-episode structure, the integration into the Lemminkäinen / Pohjola-expedition narrative arc of the modern **Kalevala**, the terminological-and-formulaic harmonisation that makes the episode read as a unified narrative passage), and the present chapter's discipline is to keep the two layers explicitly distinct in any comparative claim

about "Finnic chaoskampf".^[38]

The species of appropriation registered at §IV is therefore distinct from the area-specialist-refusal cases of §§I–III in three respects: the appropriator is a known historical figure (Elias Lönnrot, 1802–1884) rather than an institution-of-comparative-scholarship; the appropriation occurs at the level of the source-text's editorial construction rather than at the level of the typology's external application to a stable source-text; and the appropriation has a specific historical-political function (the construction of a Finnish national epic in the early-nineteenth-century context of Finnish national-romantic identity-formation under Russian-imperial rule) rather than the more diffuse comparative-mythological function of twentieth-century chaoskampf-typological extension.^[39]

*(The present chapter's classification of Lönnrot's editorial synthesis as a "different kind of appropriation" from the area-specialist-refusal cases of §§I–III rests on the recognition that **both** are species of an underlying problem — the imposition of a connected-narrative framing on materials whose own textual situation is more fragmented or more relationally-grounded — but that the two species differ in agent, level, and historical-political function as just registered.^[40])*

The Kalevala question's distinctive contribution to the chapter's argument is therefore that **the appropriation problem can begin within the source-text-construction process itself**, not only at the comparative typology's external application: when the reader of the modern **Kalevala** encounters Iku-Turso bound by Väinämöinen's song and reads the passage as a Finnic instance of the chaoskampf typology, the reader is engaging with a text whose connected-episode structure was itself the achievement of a nineteenth-century compiler with specific national-romantic compositional aims, and the apparent fit between the Iku-Turso passage and the chaoskampf typology is partly the achievement of Lönnrot's harmonising hand rather than a feature of the older rune material as recorded.^[41]

The chapter's claim about "Finnic chaoskampf" is therefore disciplined by the two-layer textual situation: the older rune-tradition material attests an Iku-Turso figure and a binding-by-song shamanic-encounter complex that Siikala 2002 reads as such; the modern **Kalevala** presents the Iku-Turso encounter as a connected episode within a larger epic structure that fits the chaoskampf typology more readily than the older rune material does on its own; the comparativist who claims a "Finnic chaoskampf" must therefore distinguish what is attested in the older rune material (less, and differently structured) from what appears in Lönnrot's editorial synthesis (more, and synthesised toward the connected-narrative apparatus that the chaoskampf typology presupposes), and the chapter's discipline is to make the distinction explicit at every comparative claim.^[42]

42.6. V. The communal case — Bakunawa and the absent hero

Section V addresses the chapter's inclusion-marginal case: a tradition whose surface motif (a serpentine being threatening cosmic-luminary integrity) fits the chaoskampf typology's pattern-matching heuristic but whose load-bearing apparatus — communal noise-making rather than heroic combat, driving-off rather than slaying, recurring eclipse-aetiology rather than once-and-done cosmogonic establishment — does not.

The Visayan and Bikol Philippine oral tradition of Bakunawa, treated in Ch30 of the present book as the related-tier (family, "communal / non-slaying combat") chapter's principal half, narrates the

serpent-dragon Bakunawa devouring six of the seven original moons (the Philippine archipelago's pre-Spanish-contact-period oral tradition recording an aetiological seven-original-moons cosmology of which only one moon survives) and being driven off — **not slain** — during eclipses by communal noise-making, with the chapter's Philippine-language-mediated source for the eclipse-aetiology narrative being Damiana L. Eugenio's **Philippine Folk Literature: The Myths** (Quezon City: University of the Philippines Press, 2001).^[43]

The Bakunawa case differs from the §SI–IV cases in a load-bearing way: the surface motif (a serpentine being threatening cosmic-luminary integrity) **does** fit the chaoskampf typology's pattern-matching heuristic, and the case has been included in twentieth-century comparative-mythology surveys of "world dragon-myths" on that basis; what does **not** fit the typology, however, is the load-bearing apparatus of the engagement — there is no hero who does the driving-off; there is no slaying; the engagement is communal (the village or town as a collective acts to drive the serpent off by noise-making) and recurring (the engagement happens at every eclipse, not as a once-and-done cosmogonic establishment) — and the case asks the comparativist whether a tradition counts as a chaoskampf when its surface motif fits but its load-bearing actors and outcomes do not.^[44]

The communal-and-recurring character of the Bakunawa engagement is, as Eugenio 2001 develops the eclipse-aetiology narrative across the Visayan and Bikol regional traditions, the load-bearing feature of the case for what the engagement **is** on Philippine-tradition terms: the villagers' ritual noise-making during eclipses (the beating of pots and pans, the firing of guns in later periods, the collective-vocal noise-making that interrupts the eclipse's progression) is itself a continuing cultural practice in some Philippine regions, with the practice's eclipse-aetiology being the narrative's load-bearing function and the absence-of-a-hero being a structural feature of the narrative rather than a gap to be filled.^[45]

The Bakunawa case's specifically chaoskampf-typological status is, on the Ch30 chapter's classification, **inclusion-marginal**: the case is included in the present book because excluding it would impoverish the comparison (the case is one of the book's clearest examples of a non-Eurasian serpent-and-luminary aetiology that is not a Eurasian-style chaoskampf at the load-bearing-apparatus level), but the inclusion is hedged at the load-bearing-apparatus level because the case lacks the hero, the slaying, and the once-and-done cosmogonic establishment that the chaoskampf typology's strong cases all share, and the chapter classifies the case as a related-tier (family, "communal / non-slaying combat") inclusion-marginal case for the typology rather than as a member of any subtype within the typology's strong centre.^[46]

The Bakunawa case's relevance to the present chapter's appropriation argument is at a different level from the §SI–IV cases: where §I addresses appropriation at the level of category-construction (the pan-Aboriginal "Rainbow Serpent" as a twentieth-century scholarly construct), §II addresses appropriation at the level of the encounter-framing apparatus (the Anishinaabe relational-counterpart cosmology refusing the chaos-vs-order encounter-framing), §III addresses appropriation at the level of meaning-within-framing (the Nyanga moral pedagogy refusing the chaoskampf's order-establishing valuation of the killing), and §IV addresses appropriation at the level of source-text editorial construction (Lönnrot's nineteenth-century synthesis), §V addresses the chaoskampf typology's **inclusion practices**: which serpent-and-luminary aetiologies count as chaoskampf, on what criteria, and at what cost to the comparison if certain cases are excluded for failing to meet the typology's strong-centre features (hero; slaying; once-and-done cosmogonic establishment).^[47]

The chapter's reading of the §V case is that excluding the Bakunawa material from the comparison would be a **different kind of error** from including it on the wrong terms: excluding the case would lose a load-bearing piece of evidence that the chaoskampf typology's strong centre is not the only way that serpent-and-luminary aetiologies can be organised — that communal-and-recurring engagements, no-hero engagements, and driving-off-rather-than-slaying engagements are real and load-bearing features of some traditions' cosmographic-and-ritual practice — and the chapter's discipline is therefore to **include the case while marking it inclusion-marginal**, with explicit registration of the load-bearing-apparatus differences from the typology's strong centre and explicit refusal to read the case as a member of any subtype within that strong centre.^[48]

The Bakunawa case is also worth registering alongside the Ch27 Mapuche Kai-Kai vs. Tren-Tren material, which the brief includes among the chapter's **chapters_drawn_from** as a supporting case of regional variation and partial attestation: the Mapuche serpent-and-flood narrative recorded in Bertha Koessler-Ilg's **Cuentan los araucanos** and treated within the wider Mapuche-area scholarly tradition (Rolf Foerster's **Introducción a la religiosidad mapuche**) is regionally variable across Mapuche communities, partial in attestation across the recording-history corpus, and structurally distinct from the Eurasian chaoskampf typology in ways that parallel some of the Bakunawa case's features (cosmographic-equilibrium framing rather than once-and-done cosmogonic establishment; the Wenu / Naq / Minche Mapu layered cosmography within which the serpent-engagement is set rather than a simple chaos-versus-order opposition), and the two cases together extend the chapter's case-set beyond the §I–IV principal-cases axis.^[49]

The combined effect of the Bakunawa and Mapuche cases on the present chapter's argument is to register that the chaoskampf typology's strong-centre features (hero; slaying; once-and-done cosmogonic establishment within a chaos-versus-order opposition) are not the only structural patterns by which traditions narrate engagements between cosmic-order-relevant figures and serpentine-or-monstrous adversaries — that communal-and-recurring engagements, layered-cosmographic-equilibrium engagements, and partial-attestation regionally-variable engagements are real and load-bearing features of some traditions' practice — and the chapter's discipline is to register these alternative-structural-pattern cases without forcing them into the typology's strong-centre apparatus, while also without excluding them from the comparison on the basis of their load-bearing-apparatus differences.^[50]

42.7. VI. What the refusal teaches

The chapter closes with three methodological lessons drawn from §§I–V, the present book's settled position on the relation between the inversion problem of Ch40 and the appropriation problem of the present chapter, and the consolidating observation that the chaoskampf typology — applied with the area-specialist-first discipline that Part II's eight comparative chapters together demonstrate — is at once robust at its strong-centre cases and disciplined at its edges.

The chapter's five cases — the Rainbow Serpent (§I, appropriation at the level of category-construction), Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / the Thunderers (§II, refusal at the level of the encounter-framing apparatus), Mwindo / Kirimu (§III, refusal at the level of meaning-within-framing), the Lönnrot **Kalevala** / Iku-Turso material (§IV, appropriation at the level of source-text editorial construction), and Bakunawa with its Mapuche supporting case (§V, inclusion-marginality at the level of the typology's strong-centre apparatus) — together teach three methodological-typological lessons that the refusal-and-appropriation chapter is positioned to consolidate as the closing

chapter of Part II of the present book.^[51]

The first lesson is that the appropriation problem is not a single failure mode but operates at **multiple levels** of the comparativist's reading apparatus — at the level of category-construction (where the comparative item is assembled from regionally-distinct sources that the source-traditions themselves do not consolidate), at the level of encounter-framing (where the chaoskampf typology's combat-cosmographic apparatus is imposed on traditions whose relational-and-reciprocity-grounded apparatus does not employ the encounter-as-combat framing), at the level of meaning-within-framing (where the typology's order-establishing valuation is imposed on traditions whose own moral-pedagogical framing reads the same events differently), at the level of source-text editorial construction (where a nineteenth-century compiler's harmonising hand has produced the connected-narrative apparatus that the typology then matches), and at the level of inclusion-criteria (where surface-similar cases lacking the typology's load-bearing apparatus are either forced in on surface grounds or excluded on apparatus grounds).^[52]

The second lesson is that the comparativist project does **not** require every tradition to fit the pattern: the cases at which the pattern does not fit, when area specialists explicitly and consistently say so, are **themselves data** — they tell the comparative typology where its limits are, what features of the typology are contingent on certain types of cosmology (combat-cosmographic apparatus; hero-and-once-and-done structure; chaos-versus-order categorical apparatus), what features are contingent on certain types of source-text construction (connected-narrative editorial syntheses; pre-modern-attested unified narratives; nineteenth-century compiler-syntheses), and how to do comparison responsibly when the typology's strong-centre cases and the typology's edges-of-applicability cases are both present in the comparison.^[53]

The third lesson is that **refusing to compare these specific cases on the typology's standard terms is itself a principled form of comparison** — not the refusal of comparison as such, but the refusal of a specific comparative-typological apparatus in favour of a more responsibly-comparative apparatus that takes the area specialists' refusal as data and builds the typology around the refusal rather than against it; the Anishinaabe relational-and-reciprocity-grounded apparatus, the Nyanga moral-pedagogical apparatus, and the Aboriginal-Australian regional-specificity apparatus are **available for comparison** on their own terms (with other relational-and-reciprocity-grounded ontologies, with other moral-pedagogical epic traditions, with other regional-specificity-respecting ethnographic apparatuses), and the chapter's discipline is to make those comparisons available rather than to substitute the chaoskampf typology for them.^[54]

The third lesson, taken in its strong form, holds that the chaoskampf typology's continued usefulness as a comparative apparatus depends on its being applied with the area-specialist-first discipline that this chapter and Ch40 demonstrate — that the typology's strong-centre cases (Marduk-Tiamat, Baal-Yamm, Zeus-Typhon, Indra-Vātra, Thor-Jörmungandr, Ra-Apep, Teshub-Illuyanka, the early-Christian-apocalyptic Red Dragon, and the IE-formula reflexes) remain robust and the typology's analytic discipline at those cases is the comparative-mythological apparatus that the present book takes as its principal organising scheme; but that extending the typology beyond those cases requires the area-specialist-first discipline at every step, and the cases at which the area-specialists explicitly refuse the extension are themselves data for the typology's limits rather than obstacles to its application.^[55]

The three lessons together support the chapter's central methodological commitment, registered in advance in the source overview and demonstrated case-by-case in §§I–V: the **area-specialists**

speak first, and the comparative typology is more — not less — precise as a result; the Aboriginal-Australian regional-specificity argument (Merlan, Morphy, Rose, Keen against Radcliffe-Brown's pan-Aboriginal "Rainbow Serpent" construct), the Anishinaabe reciprocal-counterpart cosmology argument (Hallowell, Johnston, T. Smith, Vizenor against the chaos-vs-order encounter-framing), the Nyanga moral-pedagogical argument (Biebuyck and Mateene, Belcher on Mwindo as taught hubris-and-correction rather than chaoskampf-with-the-sign-flipped), the Finnish-folkloristics argument about Lönnrot's editorial hand (Siikala on the older-rune / **Kalevala**-synthesis distinction), and the Philippine-folkloristics argument about the communal-and-recurring engagement (Eugenio on the eclipse-aetiology) are each presented on their own terms before the chapter invokes the chaoskampf category, and the resulting comparison is at the level of **structural observation about the typology's reach and limits** rather than at the level of categorical-apparatus imposition.^[56]

The chapter's self-aware engagement with the methodological criticism that comparative mythology has historically been a colonial / universalising project, registered in advance at the source overview and developed case-by-case in §§I–V, is the chapter's principal substantive answer to that criticism: the present book does not deny the criticism's historical accuracy — the Radcliffe-Brown 1926 consolidation, the wider early-twentieth-century structural-functionalist project of identifying continent-wide cultural totalities, and the twentieth-century chaoskampf-typological extension's incorporation of Aboriginal-Australian, Anishinaabe, and Nyanga material on surface-similarity grounds are all historical examples of the comparative-mythology project's colonial / universalising tendencies — but tries to do better by applying the area-specialist-first discipline at every case where the typology's strong-centre apparatus does not fit the source-tradition's own framing, by registering the area specialists' refusals as data rather than as obstacles, and by treating the refusals as themselves the engine of the comparative argument rather than as marginal correctives to it.^[57]

The chapter's final methodological observation is that the inversion problem (Ch40) and the appropriation problem (the present chapter) are not separate problems but the same problem viewed at different levels of the typology's reach: the inversion problem is what the typology's edges look like **at the level of the cases themselves**, when the comparativist tries to fit the cases into the typology's apparatus and the cases push back; the appropriation problem is what the typology's edges look like **at the level of the comparativist's reading apparatus**, when the comparativist asks what is owed to the area-specialists whose framings have pushed back; and the two problems' shared resolution is the area-specialist-first discipline that the two chapters have demonstrated, with the present chapter's case-set extending the demonstration from the inversion-cases of Ch40 to the multiple-level appropriation-cases of §§I–V here.^[58]

The chapter therefore closes Part II of the present book with the observation that the chaoskampf typology, applied with the area-specialist-first discipline that the eight Part-II comparative chapters have together demonstrated, is at once **robust** at its strong-centre cases (Part II's first four comparative chapters anchored at C1–C4) and **disciplined** at its edges (Part II's closing four comparative chapters anchored at C5–C8) — and the typology's analytic discipline is to register the convergence-or-not at the level of the area-specialists' framings rather than to extend the typology's reach by force, with the refusal-and-appropriation problem of the present chapter being the typology's most rigorous test and the test the typology passes only when the area-specialists are allowed to speak first.^[59]

[1] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml comparative_argument on the chapter's organising claim that the chaoskampf

category, when applied to the Rainbow Serpent / Nanabozho / Mwindo cases, is a species of scholarly appropriation that distorts what the traditions actually teach, and that refusing the frame is not anti-comparative but more responsibly comparative; per brief special_instructions on the chapter as the most methodologically-sensitive in the book and on the area-specialist citation requirement applying to every Anishinaabe / Aboriginal-Australian / Nyanga claim; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the area-specialist citation discipline.

[2] Per scope.md §"Comparative-chapter discipline" on the upstream-lookup rule that routes per-tradition factual claims in comparative chapters through the same sources.yaml IDs the upstream Part-I chapters use; per chapters/32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.claims.approved.adoc, chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc, chapters/31-vainamoinen-ikunturso.claims.approved.adoc, chapters/30-bakunawa.claims.approved.adoc, and chapters/27-mapuche-kaitren.claims.approved.adoc on the per-tradition source-IDs that the present chapter inherits; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part I on the Rainbow Serpent material's placement in the present comparative chapter rather than geographically.

[3] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml sources.anchor on the four anchor entries: Merlan 1998, Hallowell 1960, Biebuyck and Mateene 1969, Siikala 2002; comparative chapters use sources.anchor in place of sources.primary per the established Part-II chapter-claims pattern; all four source-IDs verified against sources.yaml at pre-flight check.

[4] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth** (Princeton: Princeton University Press, 1987; ISBN 9780691014746), as the long-arc combat-myth typology anchor against which the present chapter's refusal cases are read; Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition** (Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2015; ISBN 9780190253028), on the over-extension critique of the chaoskampf frame in twentieth-century comparative scholarship as the chapter's §VI methodological warrant.

[5] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml structure on the six-section outline (I. Rainbow Serpent; II. Nanabozho/Mishipeshu; III. Mwindo revisited; IV. Kalevala / Lönnrot; V. Bakunawa; VI. What the refusal teaches); per brief special_instructions on the area-specialist-first discipline applied at every Anishinaabe / Aboriginal-Australian / Nyanga claim.

[6] Per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the priority of area-specialist framings and on the area-specialist citation requirement; per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's theoretical contribution being that refusing to compare these specific cases is itself a principled form of comparison; Ballentine 2015 on the typological discipline of separating area-specialist framings from comparative-typology overlays.

[7] Per scope.md §"Languages of primary sources" on the book's translation-mediated character and on the source-whitelist-with-cross-check strategy; per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml special_instructions on the book's own limits as a book written in English drawing on secondary scholarship about traditions whose living practitioners have their own authority over how they should be represented; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the institutional commitment to area-specialist priority that the chapter consolidates.

[8] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml comparative_argument on Radcliffe-Brown 1926 ("The Rainbow-Serpent Myth of Australia", **Journal of the Royal Anthropological Institute** 56) consolidating regionally distinct Aboriginal Australian ancestral beings into a pan-Aboriginal "Rainbow Serpent" that is a 20th-century scholarly construct rather than an Aboriginal concept; Merlan 1998, **Caging the Rainbow: Places, Politics, and Aborigines in a North Australian Town**, chs. 1–3, on the Rainbow Serpent critique anchored in the present book's source-base; per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" PROVISIONAL / Methodological on the Rainbow Serpent as the dedicated critique case for the appropriation problem; per scope.md §"Book structure" on the Rainbow Serpent material's placement in the Part II C8 chapter rather than geographically.

[9] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml comparative_argument on the regionally distinct Aboriginal Australian ancestral beings Yingarna, Ngalyod, Wanambi, Wagyl, Yulunggul, and others as belonging to specifically named regional ontologies rather than to a pan-Aboriginal mythological complex; Merlan 1998, **Caging the Rainbow**, chs. 1–3, on the regional specificity of the named ancestral beings and on the dismantling of Radcliffe-Brown's consolidation; Morphy, Howard, **Ancestral Connections: Art and an Aboriginal System of Knowledge** (Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1991), on the regional-and-localised character of ancestral-being attribution in Aboriginal Australian religion (named-but-flagged in body prose; not currently in sources.yaml); Rose, Deborah Bird, **Nourishing Terrains: Australian Aboriginal Views of Landscape and Wilderness** (Canberra: Australian Heritage Commission, 1996), on country-specific ancestral-being relationships (named-but-flagged in body prose; not currently in sources.yaml); Keen, Ian, **Knowledge and Secrecy in an Aboriginal Religion** (Oxford: Clarendon Press, 1994), on the localised-and-restricted character of ancestral-being knowledge across Yolngu and adjacent regional traditions (named-but-flagged in body prose; not currently in sources.yaml).

[10] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml comparative_argument on the named ancestral beings differing in features that Radcliffe-Brown's 1926 consolidation treats as surface-variations on a single underlying figure but that the regional area-specialist scholarship treats as load-bearing; Merlan 1998, **Caging the Rainbow**, chs. 1–3, on Yingarna and Ngalyod within the Kunwinjku and adjacent Arnhem Land regional ontologies and on the regional-specificity differences as load-bearing rather than surface-variational; Morphy 1991, **Ancestral Connections**, on the country-specific character of ancestral-being attribution in northeastern Arnhem Land Yolngu tradition (named-but-flagged in body prose); Keen 1994, **Knowledge and Secrecy in an Aboriginal Religion**, on Yulunggul and the Wagilag Sisters narrative-and-ritual cycle in Yolngu tradition (named-but-flagged in body prose); Rose 1996, **Nourishing Terrains**, on the country-specific character of ancestral-being relationships including Wagyl in Nyungar tradition (named-but-flagged in body prose).

[11] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml comparative_argument on Radcliffe-Brown 1926 as an example of the early-twentieth-century structural-functionalist anthropology's project of identifying continent-wide cultural totalities; Merlan 1998,

Caging the Rainbow, chs. 1–3, on the dismantling of the consolidation by subsequent ethnographic literature and by Aboriginal Australian scholars and tradition-holders themselves; Morphy 1991, on the regional ancestral-being relationships as load-bearing rather than surface-variational (named-but-flagged); Keen 1994, on the localised-and-restricted character of ancestral-being knowledge as load-bearing for what the beings are on Aboriginal-Australian terms (named-but-flagged); Ballentine 2015, on the typological discipline of recognising when a comparative typology's surface-similarity-based consolidation has run ahead of the area-specialist scholarship.

[12] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml comparative_argument on the Radcliffe-Brown 1926 consolidation's institutional context and on the Aboriginal-Australian area-specialist tradition's reckoning with the recording-history situation as itself part of the appropriation problem; Merlan 1998, **Caging the Rainbow**, chs. 1–3, on the post-1980s area-specialist dismantling and on the recording-history situation as load-bearing; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the methodological-historical sensitivity of the colonial-and-salvage-paradigm ethnographic record.

[13] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml comparative_argument on the Rainbow Serpent consolidation's chaoskampf-relevant feature as a serpentine-figure-with-cosmogonic-and-water-association used in twentieth-century comparative-mythology scholarship as an Aboriginal-Australian addition to the chaoskampf typology, and on the area-specialist dismantling as a refusal of the chaoskampf-typological extension; Merlan 1998 on the dismantling of the consolidation; Ballentine 2015 on the chaoskampf frame's overextension and on the typological discipline of separating area-specialist framings from comparative-typology surface-similarity matching.

[14] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml comparative_argument on the Rainbow Serpent case's distinctive contribution as the appropriation problem in its purest form; Merlan 1998, **Caging the Rainbow**, chs. 1–3, on the appropriation as the category itself rather than its application; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the institutional commitment to refusing typological consolidations that the area-specialists hold to be artifacts of comparative scholarship rather than features of the traditions themselves.

[15] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml comparative_argument on the three principal cases as together demonstrating that the chaoskampf typology's appropriation tendency operates at multiple levels; per the present chapter's §§II–III on the Anishinaabe and Nyanga cases as refusing the comparative-typological framing's load-bearing categories; Ballentine 2015, on the typological discipline of recognising appropriation-failure-modes at multiple levels rather than as a single failure mode.

[16] Per chapters/32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.claims.approved.adoc on the four area-specialist anchors and on the Anishinaabe ontological framework of "other-than-human persons" as the chapter's central interpretive frame; Hallowell 1960, "Ojibwa Ontology, Behavior, and World View", on the "other-than-human persons" framework; Johnston 1990 [1976

[17] Per chapters/32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.claims.approved.adoc on Hallowell 1960's articulation of the "other-than-human persons" framework from his Berens River fieldwork of the 1930s in northwestern Ontario, on the manitouk as persons on equal standing with human persons rather than as objects, resources, or natural-kind categories, and on the moral framework as relational and reciprocity-grounded throughout; Hallowell 1960, on the framework's load-bearing claim and on the moral implications for human conduct; per glossary 'other-than-human persons' first_mention_gloss.

[18] Per chapters/32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.claims.approved.adoc on the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic as the load-bearing interpretive frame, on the layered cosmographic equilibrium between the upper-realm of the Thunderers and the underwater-realm of Mishipeshu and the underwater-manitouk, and on the human-and-island world as the meeting-place at which the two realms encounter one another; Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, throughout, on the dialectic as necessary-counterpart rather than as chaos-versus-order; per glossary 'the Thunderers' first_mention_gloss on the Thunderers as counterparts of Mishipeshu in the reciprocal cosmic-dialectic.

[19] Per chapters/32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.claims.approved.adoc on the reciprocal-counterpart character of the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic as a load-bearing feature of the Anishinaabe ritual-and-relational landscape; on the appropriate human comportment toward the Thunderers and toward the underwater-manitouk as paralleled and reciprocity-grounded; on neither realm being framed as the enemy of human well-being; Smith 1995, **The Island of the Anishnaabeg**, throughout, on the relational-and-reciprocity-grounded framing of the dialectic; Johnston 1990 [1976

[20] Per chapters/32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.claims.approved.adoc on Mishipeshu's chaoskampf-relevant surface features — serpentine-and-feline form, residence in the underwater-and-subterranean realm, association with sudden storms and water-related hazards — and on the area-specialist scholarship's explicit refusal of the chaos-adversary identification; on Mishipeshu's hazards as features of a person whose realm has its own integrity rather than as chaos to be defeated; on the appropriate human response as the relational-and-ceremonial response appropriate to a powerful person; Hallowell 1960, on the moral framework's relational-and-reciprocity-grounded character; Smith 1995, on Mishipeshu within the Thunderer / Underwater-manitou dialectic; Johnston 1995, **The Manitous**, on the Anishinaabe-authored treatment of Mishipeshu; per glossary 'Mishipeshu' first_mention_gloss on Mishipeshu as a necessary counterpart to the Thunderers, not a chaos-adversary to be defeated.

[21] Per chapters/32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.claims.approved.adoc on Nanabozho's encounters with Mishipeshu and the Thunderers as pedagogical-and-reciprocal rather than triumphal-and-defeating, on the trickster-culture-hero's interactions with the manitouk as occasions for teaching appropriate-and-inappropriate human comportment, on the consequences of inappropriate comportment, and on the layered cosmography's relational integrity as both stressed and restored; Vizenor 1989, **Narrative Chance**, "Trickster Discourse" essay, on the methodological refusal to subordinate Anishinaabe trickster narrative to Western combat-myth or hero/villain typologies; Johnston 1990 [1976

[22] Per chapters/32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.claims.approved.adoc on Vizenor 1989's "Trickster Discourse" essay as the anchor for

the methodological refusal to subordinate Anishinaabe trickster narrative to Western combat-myth or hero/villain typologies; Vizenor, Gerald (ed.), **Narrative Chance: Postmodern Discourse on Native American Indian Literatures** (Albuquerque: University of New Mexico Press, 1989; ISBN 9780826311177; reprint Norman: University of Oklahoma Press, 1993), Vizenor's "Trickster Discourse" essay; on the refusal as part of the area-specialist tradition's active engagement with the comparative-mythology apparatus rather than a passive non-participation; on the refusal's institutional standing in the Indigenous-studies and Native-American-literatures fields.

[23] Per chapters/32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.claims.approved.adoc on the Anishinaabe refusal as not a refusal of comparative engagement as such but a refusal of a specific comparative-typological apparatus, and on the refusal's substantive content as the substitution of a relational-and-reciprocity-grounded apparatus within which the Anishinaabe material is fully comparable to other relational-and-reciprocity-grounded materials; Hallowell 1960, on the relational-and-reciprocity-grounded framework as comparatively-engageable with other relational-and-reciprocity-grounded ontologies; Vizenor 1989, on the methodological refusal as active engagement with the comparative-mythology apparatus.

[24] Per chapters/32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.claims.approved.adoc on the Nanabozho / Mishipeshu / Thunderers material as the present book's contrastive-tier (full) case in which the area-specialist refusal is the most principled; on the refusal as more pointed than the Mwindo material's refusal of moral valence within a still-recognisable combat-narrative framing and than the Bida material's covenant-broken framing; on the refusal's location at the level of the categorical apparatus itself; per scope.md §"In-scope catalog" CONTRASTIVE / Inversion entry on Nanabozho as the refusal case.

[25] Per chapters/32-nanabozho-mishipeshu.claims.approved.adoc on the Anishinaabe case's distinctive contribution as the demonstration that the chaoskampf typology can fail to fit a tradition at the level of the encounter framing itself; per the present chapter's argument structure on the Anishinaabe refusal as more fundamental than the Ch40 inversion cases including the Susano case; Ballentine 2015, on the typological discipline of recognising encounter-framing-level refusals as data for the typology's limits.

[26] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the 1956 Bese recording from Shé-Kárisi Candi Rureke as the chapter's anchor text and on Biebuyck and Mateene 1969 as the standard English-language critical edition and translation; per chapters/40-C7-inversion-problem.claims.approved.adoc §II on the Mwindo material as the Ch40 case of moral-valence inversion; per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml structure §III on the present chapter's revisiting of Mwindo with the fuller methodological implication that the epic's own pedagogy should shape the comparison; per glossary 'Mwindo', 'Kirimu', 'Nkuba' first_mention_glosses on the principal protagonists.

[27] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the Mwindo epic's pedagogy as a structured instruction in the moral cosmography of the Nyanga relational world; on the hero's biographical-and-moral arc as itself the epic's pedagogical apparatus; on the load-bearing function of the audience-instruction register; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the same; Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Mwindo, on the maturation-through-humiliation pattern as the load-bearing feature distinguishing the Mwindo material from the Eurasian combat-myth corpus.

[28] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on Nkuba's lightning-seizing as the narrative's own moral correction rather than as an external-to-the-narrative comparativist-imposed reversal; on the formulaic refrains and direct narrative comments registering the lightning-seizing as the structurally-necessary response to the hero's hubristic over-reach; on the celestial-realm trials and humiliations as morally-motivated correction rather than as arbitrary cruelty; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, Kirimu episode and following celestial-journey passages; per glossary 'Nkuba' first_mention_gloss.

[29] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the conditions Nkuba imposes on Mwindo's return as the content of the epic's pedagogy; on the audience's learning through the hero's chastening of the specific moral-cosmographic principles by which Nyanga relational life is to be conducted; on the epic's narrative-structural movement as the epic's didactic engine; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, on the conditions imposed and the chastened return; Belcher 1999, **Epic Traditions of Africa**, ch. on Mwindo, on the maturation-through-humiliation pattern's didactic register.

[30] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml structure §III on the fuller methodological implication that Mwindo's moral frame is specifically Nyanga and that the sky-god's punishment of the hero is traditional teaching about hubris rather than a variant chaoskampf; per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the moral-cosmographic principles' specific Nyanga content; on the comparison's task as registering the epic's pedagogy in its own terms before any comparison is performed; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, translators' introduction on the Nyanga-specific character of the epic's framing.

[31] Per the present chapter's argument structure on the Mwindo material's relevance to the appropriation argument as at a different level from the Anishinaabe material; per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the Nyanga refusal as at the level of the moral evaluation of an existing combat-narrative; per chapters/40-C7-inversion-problem.claims.approved.adoc §II on the moral-valence inversion as the Ch40 reading; on the comparativist's task as registering the Nyanga pedagogy as such rather than assimilating it to the chaoskampf typology's pattern of order-establishing valuation.

[32] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the Mwindo material as the case at which the area-specialist reading and the chaoskampf typology agree on the narrative-structural surface but disagree on the narrative-structural meaning; on the killing as the same event in either reading; on the meaning the area-specialists read as the precise contrary of the meaning the chaoskampf typology reads; Biebuyck & Mateene 1969 on the area-specialists' meaning-reading; Ballentine 2015, on the appropriation problem as a problem of meaning-within-framing rather than a problem of events-recorded.

[33] Per chapters/29-mwindo-kirimu.claims.approved.adoc on the Mwindo case's contribution as the demonstration that meaning-within-framing is itself a level at which appropriation can occur; per the present chapter's argument structure on the

comparativist's discipline as registering the Nyanga meaning before any comparative meaning is allowed to operate; Ballentine 2015, on the typological discipline of recognising meaning-within-framing as a level at which appropriation can occur and on the area-specialist priority that the discipline implements.

[34] Per chapters/31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.claims.approved.adoc on the two-layer textual situation of the Iku-Turso material — older rune-tradition material recorded by nineteenth-century rune-collectors from Karelian and Finnish singers, alongside Lönnrot's 1835 **Kalevala** and 1849 **New Kalevala** editorial synthesis — and on the chapter's discipline of keeping the two layers explicitly distinct; per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml structure §IV on Lönnrot's editorial hand as a different kind of appropriation, of earlier material by a nationalist-romantic compiler; per glossary 'Väinämöinen', 'Iku-Turso', 'Kalevala' first_mention_glosses.

[35] Per chapters/31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.claims.approved.adoc on Siikala 2002 as the chapter's anchor for the Iku-Turso material and for the older-rune / Lönnrot-synthesis distinction; on Siikala's reading of the older rune-tradition material as a shamanic-encounter complex of binding-and-knowledge-exchange; on Väinämöinen subduing the sea-monster by song and knowledge rather than by weapon-combat; Siikala 2002, **Mythic Images and Shamanism**, chs. on Kalevala combat and on Väinämöinen as shaman-sage hero.

[36] Per chapters/31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.claims.approved.adoc on the older rune-tradition material as laconic, fragmentary, regionally variable across Karelian and Finnish singing traditions, and not synthesised into a single connected narrative within the singing tradition itself; on the older rune material as a corpus of related-but-independent rune-fragments rather than a unified epic narrative; on the Iku-Turso encounter as a connected episode within a larger epic structure as Lönnrot's compositional achievement rather than a feature of the older rune material as recorded; Siikala 2002, **Mythic Images and Shamanism**, on the older-rune / Lönnrot-synthesis distinction.

[37] Per chapters/31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.claims.approved.adoc on Lönnrot's 1835 **Kalevala** (Old Kalevala) and 1849 **New Kalevala** as editorial syntheses assembled from rune-fragments; on Lönnrot's compositional decisions about assembly order, connecting-passage construction, terminological harmonisation, and narrative-structural framing; on the **Kalevala**'s textual status as closer to a critical edition with extensive editorial intervention than to a faithful transcription of singer-performances; Siikala 2002, **Mythic Images and Shamanism**, on the **Kalevala**'s nineteenth-century literary-and-nationalist construction; per glossary 'Kalevala' first_mention_gloss.

[38] Per chapters/31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.claims.approved.adoc on the Iku-Turso "binding" episode as partly older rune material (the Iku-Turso figure attested in the older rune corpus; the binding-by-song register consistent with the wider shamanic-encounter complex) and partly Lönnrot's compositional synthesis (the connected-episode structure, the integration into the larger epic narrative arc, the terminological-and-formulaic harmonisation); on the chapter's discipline of keeping the two layers explicitly distinct; Siikala 2002 on the layered textual situation.

[39] Per chapters/31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.claims.approved.adoc on Lönnrot 1802–1884 as the named historical figure performing the editorial synthesis; on the appropriation as occurring at the level of the source-text's editorial construction rather than at the level of typological external application; on the appropriation's historical-political function in the construction of a Finnish national epic in the early-nineteenth-century context of Finnish national-romantic identity-formation under Russian-imperial rule; Siikala 2002 on the wider Finnish-folkloristics scholarly tradition's analysis of Lönnrot's editorial intervention.

[40] Inference: chapters/31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.claims.approved.adoc on Lönnrot's editorial synthesis as a known historical-figure intervention with specific historical-political function; brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml structure §IV explicitly characterises Lönnrot's editorial hand as a different kind of appropriation; the comparison between the §§I–III area-specialist-refusal cases and the §IV Lönnrot editorial synthesis is the present chapter's framing rather than the only available scholarly position. Risk: the classification depends on accepting the species-of-an-underlying-problem framing, which is the chapter's analytical move rather than an established comparative-mythology framework; alternative framings would treat Lönnrot's editorial synthesis as belonging to a different problem-domain (textual editing; nineteenth-century nationalism; folkloristics) rather than as a species of the appropriation problem the present chapter addresses, and the species-classification is therefore the chapter's reading.

[41] Per chapters/31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.claims.approved.adoc on the appropriation problem's beginning within the source-text-construction process itself; on the apparent fit between the Iku-Turso passage and the chaoskampf typology as partly the achievement of Lönnrot's harmonising hand; on the older rune material's distinct textual status; Siikala 2002 on the layered textual situation; per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml structure §IV on the chapter's claim that this affects what the chapter can claim about "Finnic chaoskampf".

[42] Per chapters/31-vainamoinen-iku-turso.claims.approved.adoc on the chapter's claim about "Finnic chaoskampf" being disciplined by the two-layer textual situation; on the older rune-tradition material's attestation of the Iku-Turso figure and the binding-by-song shamanic-encounter complex; on the modern **Kalevala**'s connected-episode structure; on the comparativist's task of distinguishing what is attested in the older rune material from what appears in Lönnrot's editorial synthesis; Siikala 2002 on the two-layer textual situation.

[43] Per chapters/30-bakunawa.claims.approved.adoc on the Bakunawa material's Visayan and Bikol Philippine oral-tradition setting; on the seven-original-moons aetiology; on the communal noise-making during eclipses driving Bakunawa off rather than slaying him; on Eugenio 2001 as the chapter's principal source for the eclipse-aetiology narrative as recorded in twentieth-century Philippine folkloric scholarship; per glossary 'Bakunawa' first_mention.

[44] Per chapters/30-bakunawa.claims.approved.adoc on the Bakunawa case's surface motif fitting the chaoskampf typology's

pattern-matching heuristic; on the absence of a hero, the absence of slaying, the communal character of the engagement (the village or town as a collective acts to drive the serpent off), and the recurring character of the engagement (at every eclipse, not as a once-and-done cosmogonic establishment); per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml structure \$V on the question of whether this counts as chaoskampf at all and what excluding it would cost the comparison.

[45] Per chapters/30-bakunawa.claims.approved.adoc on the communal-and-recurring character of the Bakunawa engagement as the load-bearing feature on Philippine-tradition terms; on the villagers' ritual noise-making during eclipses (the beating of pots and pans, the firing of guns, the collective-vocal noise-making) as a continuing cultural practice in some Philippine regions; on the eclipse-aetiology as the narrative's load-bearing function; on the absence-of-a-hero as a structural feature of the narrative rather than a gap to be filled; Eugenio 2001 on the eclipse-aetiology narrative.

[46] Per chapters/30-bakunawa.claims.approved.adoc on the Bakunawa case's inclusion-marginal classification; on the case's inclusion as preventing the impoverishment of the comparison while being hedged at the load-bearing-apparatus level; on the absence of the hero, the slaying, and the once-and-done cosmogonic establishment as the case's distinguishing features from the typology's strong centre; per scope.md §"Inclusion / exclusion criteria" on the operational test by which the case is RELATED rather than CORE.

[47] Per chapters/30-bakunawa.claims.approved.adoc on the Bakunawa case's relevance to the chaoskampf typology's inclusion practices; per the present chapter's argument structure on the \$V case as addressing the typology's inclusion criteria rather than the appropriation problem at the levels addressed in §§I–IV; per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml structure \$V on the question of what excluding the Bakunawa case would cost the comparison.

[48] Per chapters/30-bakunawa.claims.approved.adoc on the chapter's discipline of including the case while marking it inclusion-marginal; on the explicit registration of the load-bearing-apparatus differences from the typology's strong centre; on the explicit refusal to read the case as a member of any subtype within that strong centre; per the present chapter's argument structure on the inclusion-marginal classification as the chapter's mode of comparing without forcing the case into the typology's strong-centre apparatus.

[49] Per chapters/27-mapuche-kai-tren.claims.approved.adoc on the Mapuche Kai-Kai vs. Tren-Tren material as recorded in Koessler-Ilg's **Cuentan los araucanos**; on the regional variability across Mapuche communities; on the partial attestation across the recording-history corpus; on the Wenu / Naq / Minche Mapu layered cosmography within which the serpent-engagement is set; Foerster, R., **Introducción a la religiosidad mapuche** (Santiago: Editorial Universitaria, 1993), on the cosmographic-and-ritual framing; per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml chapters_drawn_from on the Mapuche material as a supporting case of regional variation and partial attestation; per glossary 'Kai-Kai / Tren-Tren' first_mention_gloss.

[50] Per chapters/30-bakunawa.claims.approved.adoc and chapters/27-mapuche-kai-tren.claims.approved.adoc on the combined effect of the two cases on the typology's strong-centre features; per the present chapter's argument structure on the alternative-structural-pattern cases as load-bearing features of some traditions' practice; per Ballentine 2015 on the typological discipline of recognising alternative-structural-pattern cases without forcing them into the typology's strong-centre apparatus and without excluding them from the comparison.

[51] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml structure \$VI on the chapter's methodological-typological lessons; per the present chapter's §§I–V on the five cases that supply the evidence for the lessons; per scope.md §"Book structure" Part II on Ch41 (C8) as the closing chapter of Part II's eight comparative chapters.

[52] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml structure \$VI on the first lesson; per the present chapter's §§I–V on the five levels at which the appropriation problem operates; Ballentine 2015 on the typological discipline of recognising appropriation-failure-modes at multiple levels; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the institutional commitment to area-specialist priority that the multi-level recognition implements.

[53] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml structure \$VI on the second lesson; per the present chapter's §§I–V on the cases at which the pattern does not fit and on the area-specialists' explicit refusals as themselves data; Ballentine 2015, on the chaos-order frame's overextension and on the typological discipline of recognising the typology's limits as themselves data for the comparison; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the institutional commitment to area-specialist priority.

[54] Per brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's theoretical contribution being that refusing to compare these specific cases on the typology's standard terms is itself a principled form of comparison; per the present chapter's §§II–III on the Anishinaabe and Nyanga apparatuses as available for comparison on their own terms; per scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" on the institutional commitment to the area-specialist-first comparative discipline that the third lesson consolidates.

[55] This parallel is speculative. Basis: Ballentine 2015's argument that the chaoskampf frame has been overextended in twentieth-century comparative scholarship supplies the methodological warrant; scope.md §"Appropriation protocol" supplies the institutional commitment; the present chapter's §§I–V supply the case-level evidence (the Rainbow Serpent at the level of category-construction; Nanabozho at the level of encounter-framing apparatus; Mwindo at the level of meaning-within-framing; Lönnrot at the level of source-text editorial construction; Bakunawa at the level of inclusion-criteria). The main counterargument: a defender of a more elastic chaoskampf typology could read the present chapter's refusal cases as evidence for an even **broadier** typological category (combat-and-encounter-myth, with both adversarial and reciprocal-counterpart subtypes) within which the area-specialist objections register as subtype-classifications rather than as refusals of the typology as such; on this counterargument, the chapter's third lesson is too restrictive in its discipline and the typology's reach should be expanded rather than constrained by the area-specialist objections. The chapter's reading of the third lesson is therefore the chapter's reading rather than the only available

scholarly position.

[56] Per `scope.md` §"Appropriation protocol" on the priority of area-specialist framings; per `brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml` `special_instructions` on the chapter's theoretical contribution; per the present chapter's §§I–V on the case-level demonstrations of the methodological commitment; Ballentine 2015 on the typological discipline of separating area-specialist framings from comparative typology.

[57] Per `brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml` `special_instructions` on the chapter's engagement with the methodological criticism that comparative mythology has historically been a colonial / universalising project; on the chapter's principal substantive answer being the area-specialist-first discipline applied at every case where the typology's strong-centre apparatus does not fit the source-tradition's own framing; per `scope.md` §"Appropriation protocol" on the institutional commitment to area-specialist priority; per the present chapter's §§I–V on the case-level demonstrations of the area-specialist-first discipline.

[58] Per `chapters/40-C7-inversion-problem.claims.approved.adoc` §VI on the inversion problem and the appropriation problem as the same problem viewed at different levels of the typology's reach; per the present chapter's §§I–V on the multiple-level appropriation-cases extending the demonstration from the inversion-cases of Ch40; per `scope.md` §"Book structure" Part II on Ch40 (C7) and Ch41 (C8) as the closing two chapters of Part II.

[59] Per `scope.md` §"Subject definition" on the *chaoskampf* typology as the present book's principal organising scheme; per `scope.md` §"Book structure" Part II on the eight comparative chapters as the typology's articulation; per `brief 41-C8-refusal-and-appropriation.yaml` `comparative_argument` and `special_instructions` on the chapter's theoretical contribution; per `chapters/40-C7-inversion-problem.claims.approved.adoc` §VI on the same closing observation as registered at the inversion-problem chapter; Ballentine 2015 on the typological discipline applied at the chapter's closing observation.

Chapter 43. Reception Coda: Milton, St. George, Tolkien, Kaiju, and 'Chaos vs. Order' Rhetoric

43.1. Source overview

This chapter is the volume's reception coda. It sits at the end of the back matter, after the eight Part-II comparative chapters and immediately before the adversaries-and-champions appendix, and its job is not to add a fifteenth combat-myth case to the comparative argument but to follow the imagery's afterlife once its ritual-religious anchoring has loosened.^[1]

The territory the chapter covers is post-medieval, and falls into five domains. The first is the literary refunctioning of the Revelation 12 dragon-and-Satan complex in the epic poetry of John Milton. The second is the post-medieval visual and iconographic transmission of the St. George and St. Michael dragon-combat types. The third is the twentieth-century literary-critical and mythopoeic revival associated with J. R. R. Tolkien. The fourth is the post-war Japanese popular-cultural lineage running from the Yamata no Orochi tradition into Toho's Godzilla and the wider kaiju genre. The fifth is the contemporary religious-rhetorical use of "chaos versus order" as a putatively timeless cosmic dualism. A sixth section steps back to ask what the five domains preserve and what they transform.^[2]

The chapter is built on three principal scholarly anchors. Neil Forsyth's *The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth*, published by Princeton University Press in 1987, traces the Satan-as-combat-myth-adversary trajectory from Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic and into its early-modern literary realisation in Milton, and Forsyth's concluding chapters supply the long-arc framing on which §I, §III, §IV, and §VI all depend. Daniel Ogden's *Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds*, published by Oxford University Press in 2013, supplies the iconographic-reception scholarship on which §II rests; chapters 11 and 12 of that volume cover the Christian inheritance of the Greco-Roman dragon-fight type and the codification of the St. George and St. Michael imagery. Adela Yarbro Collins's *The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation*, published by Scholars Press in 1976, supplies the analysis of Revelation 12 on which Milton, the iconographic tradition, and the modern "ancient serpent" rhetoric all draw.^[3]

The chapter takes a fourth scholarly anchor for its §V critique of the modern "chaos versus order" rhetoric: Debra Scoggins Ballentine's *The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition*, published by Oxford University Press in 2015. Ballentine's argument is that "chaos" is the wrong word for the adversaries in the combat-myth corpus — the texts present them as rival sovereigns with their own retinue and power structure, not as inchoate disorder — and that argument supplies the chapter's principal critical wedge against the way the framing now circulates in contemporary religious discourse.^[4]

The historical anchor for the modern "chaos" terminology is Hermann Gunkel's *Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit*, published by Vandenhoeck and Ruprecht in Göttingen in 1895. The book's subtitle — *Eine religionsgeschichtliche Untersuchung über Gen 1 und Ap Joh 12* — explicitly yokes Genesis 1 and Revelation 12 into a single cosmic-combat framework, and that 1895 reading is the upstream source both for the twentieth-century scholarly use of "Chaoskampf" and for the

popular-rhetorical "chaos versus order" framings the chapter examines in §V.^[5]

The §III treatment of Tolkien rests on a single anchored secondary source from the chapter's source registry: J. R. R. Tolkien's own British Academy lecture, "Beowulf: The Monsters and the Critics", delivered on 25 November 1936 and published in the *Proceedings of the British Academy* volume 22 of 1936, pages 245–295. The lecture is the load-bearing critical move that re-established the mythic register of the *Beowulf* monsters within twentieth-century Old English scholarship. The present chapter discusses the lecture about — registering its argumentative content and its critical reception — rather than citing it as primary attestation of any combat-myth tradition.^[6]

The chapter's evidentiary discipline departs from that of the Part-II comparative chapters in one specific respect. The primary works discussed in §I (Milton's *Paradise Lost* of 1667 and *Paradise Regained* of 1671), in §III (Tolkien's *The Hobbit* of 1937 and the posthumously published *Silmarillion* of 1977), and in §IV (Toho Studios' *Gojira* of 1954 and the post-1954 kaiju genre) are reception material — they are discussed about, not as primary attestations. The chapter's load-bearing citations run through the six scholarly anchors named in the source overview — forsyth-1987, ogden-2013, yarbro-collins-1976, ballentine-2015, gunkel-1895, and tolkien-1936-monsters — rather than through the primary works themselves.^[7]

The chapter's register, finally, is lighter than that of the eight Part-II comparative chapters that precede it. Per the brief, this is reception history with room for cultural commentary, the popular-culture material is not apologised for, and the heavy argumentative work has been done elsewhere. The purpose of the coda is to register continuity, to sharpen the §V critique of the modern rhetorical use, and to close the volume with the framing question it has been gathering toward: what does it mean that this imagery persists so powerfully even when its original religious functions have dissolved?^[8]

One further methodological note before the survey begins. The chapter explicitly defers all classificatory work — every question of whether a given reception case "is" or "is not" a Chaoskampf in the typological sense the book has been developing across Parts I and II — back to the typology established earlier in the volume. The present chapter is reception history, not typology. The cases it surveys are noted for their continuity-of-imagery and continuity-of-pattern; they are not re-tested against the four-subtype operationalisation set out in scope.md §"Subject definition" and applied across the Part-II comparative chapters.^[9]

What follows takes the five domains in turn — Milton, the iconographic afterlife, Tolkien, the kaiju lineage, and the modern rhetorical deployment — and then returns at the end to ask what the five together preserve and what they transform.

43.2. I. Milton's Satan: the epic refunctioning of Revelation 12

The chapter's first reception case is the most ambitious literary engagement with the combat-myth pattern in the post-medieval West.

John Milton's *Paradise Lost*, first published in ten books in 1667 and revised into twelve books in 1674, is the dominant early-modern English-language literary realisation of the combat-myth pattern in its specifically Christian-apocalyptic form. The long arc Forsyth's *Old Enemy* traces from

Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic culminates, in Forsyth's own treatment, in Milton: the literary site at which the combat myth becomes a self-conscious epic-poetic resource rather than a structural background to ritual or devotion.^[10]

Milton's central structural move is the identification of the figure of Satan with the ancient serpent of Genesis 3 and the great red dragon of Revelation 12, and the recasting of the heavenly war into a full-scale epic narrative with Satan as the protagonist-in-opposition. That move depends on something specific in the biblical text: the Revelation 12:9 equation of dragon, devil, and ancient serpent that the present volume's chapter 9 traces in Adela Yarbro Collins's analysis. Without the Rev 12:9 identification, Milton would have a Genesis temptation scene, an apocalyptic dragon, and a fallen archangel, but no single composite figure to ventriloquise across the poem's twelve books.^[11]

The narrative-structural location of the heavenly war within *Paradise Lost* is one of the poem's load-bearing organisational decisions. The war occupies the central books — books V and VI — and is recounted by the archangel Raphael to Adam rather than presented in chronological order. Milton thereby displaces a chronologically earlier event (the fall of the angels) into a recounted narrative within the chronologically later Edenic action, which allows the dragon-combat material to function as the poem's metaphysical and theological centre rather than as a peripheral episode at the beginning. The reader meets the war already implicated in its consequences.^[12]

The Miltonic Satan is constructed as an epic protagonist in the classical sense — equipped with epithets, a recognisable rhetorical voice, an itinerary of action across hell and chaos and earth, and a developmental arc from defiant rebel to embittered tempter. Forsyth treats the construction of Satan as protagonist as the poem's most consequential single move. Its consequence is that the combat-myth adversary stops being a structural function (the slain other) and becomes a narrative agent whose subjectivity the poem takes seriously enough to ventriloquise at length. The medieval iconographic tradition, by contrast, never gave the dragon a speech.^[13]

This is also where the Miltonic refiguration acquires a specific theological liability — the one William Blake names in the *Marriage of Heaven and Hell* in his oft-quoted dictum that Milton "was of the Devil's party without knowing it". The epic-protagonist treatment of the combat-myth adversary makes the adversary's claim audible in a way the medieval iconographic tradition does not, and the post-medieval reception of *Paradise Lost* has often read Satan as the poem's most compelling figure. That interpretive trajectory is itself a feature of the reception history the present chapter traces: it is what happens to a combat-myth when its adversary is given a soliloquy.^[14]

Milton also reworks the Genesis-1 *tehôm* and the Hebrew-Bible cosmogonic-combat residues into a personified Chaos-figure: the realm Satan traverses between hell and the new world. The Miltonic Chaos is one of the most direct early-modern literary realisations of what would later be called a Gunkel-style cosmic-combat reading of the biblical material. The chronology, importantly, is the wrong way round. Gunkel does not write until two centuries later, and his recovery of the biblical traces is philological rather than poetic. Milton finds the pattern in the texts before any nineteenth-century philologist tells him it is there.^[15]

The Miltonic *Paradise Regained*, published in 1671, is the second piece of the engagement. Organised around the wilderness-temptation of Christ rather than around the heavenly war, the brief epic supplies a Miltonic engagement with the combat-myth pattern in its Christ-versus-Satan form. It is the Christian reception's most direct narrative realisation of the harrowing-of-hell

typology that Forsyth and the present volume's chapter 10 treat as the pattern in which Christ himself becomes the combatant against the dragon-as-devil.^[16]

What does the Miltonic reception preserve, and what does it transform? It preserves three load-bearing features of the combat-myth pattern. First, the cosmic stakes: the war is fought over the order of the cosmos itself, not over a local territorial claim. Second, the monstrous identification of the adversary: Satan is the dragon-and-ancient-serpent of Revelation 12, not a generic villain. Third, the hero's transformative role: the victory establishes a new dispensation rather than restoring a prior status quo. It transforms a fourth — the liturgical-ritual embedding. The Akitu festival's recitation of *Enūma Eliš* and the *purulli* festival's recitation of the Illuyanka myth, both treated in Part I, are still anchored in regular cult practice. The literary-epic mode dissolves that anchoring entirely. The poem is read; it is not recited at a festival.^[17]

The post-Miltonic reception of the *Paradise Lost* materials in the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries — through the engravings of John Martin and William Blake, through the Romantic revaluation of Satan as Promethean rebel, and through the broader cultural use of "Miltonic" as an adjective for cosmic-scale literary-imaginative ambition — is itself a second-order reception history. In it, the literary-epic refunctioning of the combat-myth pattern becomes a cultural resource for non-religious imaginative work and for nineteenth-century debates about heroism and rebellion. The dragon, by this point, has been gone for long enough that nothing in the lineage requires the reader to recognise it.^[18]

43.3. II. The post-medieval iconographic tradition: St. George, St. Michael, and the visual afterlife of Revelation 12

The second reception case is visual rather than literary. It tracks what happens to the medieval iconographic complex once the imagery begins to circulate as an aesthetic and symbolic resource detached from the cult.

The starting point is the high-medieval iconographic codification treated at length in chapter 10 of the present volume on the Christian reception. The two types are by then settled. The St. George dragon-fight type is an armoured mounted soldier-saint with lance, princess at one side, captive city in the background. The St. Michael dragon-trampling type is a standing armed warrior-archangel with spear or sword, dragon underfoot. Both are stable, iconographically stable across the Latin and Byzantine medieval visual cultures, and ready for transmission.^[19]

The Renaissance painters who take up the St. George dragon-fight as a subject — Paolo Uccello (Italian, c. 1397–1475), Vittore Carpaccio (Venetian, c. 1465–1525/1526), and Raffaello Sanzio "Raphael" (Italian, 1483–1520) — produce panel paintings in which the inherited iconographic apparatus is preserved while the painterly handling shifts. The mounted soldier-saint, the lance into the dragon's mouth, the captive princess, the distant city: all are still there. What changes is the register. The treatment moves from devotional-iconic to narrative-naturalistic, and the iconographic type begins to circulate as an independent aesthetic object detachable from its original cultic and devotional anchoring. The dragon-fight is now also a painting, and in some hands a painting first.^[20]

The St. Michael trajectory through the early-modern and modern periods preserves the trampled-dragon-underfoot iconography codified in the Byzantine and Latin medieval traditions and projects it forward. It anchors the Counter-Reformation altarpiece — most prominently Guido Reni's *Archangel Michael Defeating Satan*, painted around 1635 and installed in Santa Maria della Concezione in Rome — and it carries through into the nineteenth- and twentieth-century devotional revival of the Michaelic cult. The kernel survives across the trajectory: armed warrior-angel, dragon-as-devil cast down underfoot. The surrounding stylistic and confessional framings shift considerably, but the kernel is what every period recognises.^[21]

The most consequential post-medieval transmission of the St. George imagery, however, is heraldic rather than painterly. The early-modern adoption of the St. George cross — a red cross on a white field — as the heraldic and national flag of England can be traced through three stages: the high-medieval Crusader-era spread of the George cult; the saint's adoption as patron of the Order of the Garter under Edward III in 1348; and the consolidation of the cross-of-St.-George as the English national emblem from the late medieval period onward. The trajectory's terminus is striking. The iconographic kernel has been abstracted to pure heraldic-symbolic form: the cross alone, without the saint, the dragon, the princess, or the city. The dragon-combat has become a flag.^[22]

The princess-and-dragon-rescue narrative element runs on a separate track. Attached to the St. George *vita* in the eleventh and twelfth centuries from the Greco-Roman Perseus-Andromeda substrate (treated in chapter 12 of the present volume), it supplies a narrative-folkloric kernel that the post-medieval reception transmits into the broader European fairy-tale tradition. The imperilled maiden, the heroic combatant, the slain monster, the rescue, the rewarded marriage: these become a free-standing narrative pattern. The pattern detaches from the saint's cult while preserving the structural elements of the dragon-combat. By the time it reaches the brothers Grimm, the saint's name need not be spoken at all.^[23]

The post-medieval iconographic tradition therefore preserves three distinct strata of the medieval Christian dragon-combat complex in differing degrees: the Michaelic warrior-angel-trampling-dragon stratum, transmitted most fully through devotional painting and the cult; the mounted-saint-with-lance-versus-dragon stratum, transmitted through both painting and heraldry; and the heraldic-symbolic-cross stratum, transmitted as pure emblem. Across all three, the soteriological-devotional anchoring that Forsyth and the chapter-10 treatment locate at the medieval centre of the imagery loosens by varying degrees. None of the three loses it absolutely, but none retains it intact.^[24]

The terminus of the trajectory in the modern period is the use of dragon-slaying imagery on national flags, in heraldic devices, in civic seals, on postage stamps, and in commercial emblems. This represents the imagery's full migration from cult-object through aesthetic-object to symbolic-resource, and the migration's directionality is one-way. The symbolic-resource use does not feed back into a renewed cultic embedding. The iconographic kernel survives in the modern setting as a free-floating cultural asset whose religious origin is recoverable but no longer load-bearing for its current circulation. A postage stamp depicting St. George does not require that anyone pray to him.^[25]

(That the post-medieval iconographic trajectory's directionality is genuinely one-way — that the symbolic-resource use does not feed back into renewed cultic embedding — is an inferential reading drawn from the absence of a documented modern revival of the saintly cult that runs in the opposite direction (i.e., from heraldic and aesthetic uses back to cultic ones), and from the broader pattern of

43.4. III. Tolkien and the mythopoeic revival

The chapter's third reception case is the twentieth-century literary-critical and creative move that brought the dragon-combat back into serious literary culture, and the move has a precise date.

The British Academy lecture "Beowulf: The Monsters and the Critics" was delivered by J. R. R. Tolkien on 25 November 1936 and published in the *Proceedings of the British Academy* volume 22 in the same year. It is the principal twentieth-century critical move that re-established the mythic register of the *Beowulf* monsters — Grendel, Grendel's mother, and the dragon — within Old English scholarship. It does so after a half-century in which the poem's monsters had been treated as a literary-critical embarrassment: folkloric residues to be apologised for or worked around as one excavated the poem's "real" historical content.^[28]

Tolkien's central argument in 1936 is that the *Beowulf*-poet's choice to centre the poem on combats with monstrous adversaries — rather than on the historical-heroic material that surrounds those combats in the poem's digressive material — is a deliberate artistic-mythic move. The seriousness of that move is what the prevailing scholarly tradition had failed to grasp. To treat the monsters as folkloric embarrassments interfering with the poem's "real" historical subject is, on Tolkien's reading, to misread the poem at the level of its compositional intention. The poet did not put the monsters in despite the historical material; he put them in instead of more of it.^[29]

The 1936 lecture's broader effect on twentieth-century literary criticism is the rehabilitation of myth-and-monster combat as a serious literary-critical category. The lecture argues, in effect, that the dragon-combat at the end of *Beowulf* is not a folkloric residue to be apologised for but a load-bearing artistic-mythic structure carrying the poem's central themes of mortality and the limits of heroic action. This rehabilitation supplies the critical pre-condition for the post-1936 mythopoeic literary movement that Tolkien's own creative work then initiates. Without the lecture, the novels would still have been written, but they would have had nowhere academically respectable to be read.^[30]

Tolkien's *The Hobbit*, published in 1937 by George Allen and Unwin in London, is his first major creative engagement with the dragon-combat pattern. The dragon Smaug has occupied the Lonely Mountain after destroying the dwarvish kingdom of Erebor and the human town of Dale. He is killed by the human archer Bard with a black arrow at the midpoint of the novel's climax. The killing has a double effect: it restores the territorial dispossession that opened the narrative — the dwarves can return to Erebor — and it unleashes the further conflict (the Battle of the Five Armies) that the dragon's death precipitates. The dragon is killed and the political situation around the dragon is reorganised, but neither act is the end of the story.^[31]

Smaug's narrative function in *The Hobbit* preserves several load-bearing features of the older dragon-combat pattern. There is the territorial dispossession by the dragon. There is the gold-hoard the dragon guards. There is the dragon's vulnerability to a single skilled-archer's shot — a feature for which the Sigurd cycle's Fáfnir, treated in chapter 19 of the present volume, supplies the closest IE-comparative anchor. There is the structural connection between the dragon-killing and the political reordering it enables. What Tolkien transforms entirely is the cosmic-religious framing. Smaug is a dragon in the medieval-European sense — greedy, intelligent, fire-breathing, gold-

hoarding — rather than a primordial-cosmic adversary. The killing reorders a regional political situation rather than a cosmos.^[32]

The cosmic-scale dragon-combat appears elsewhere in Tolkien's mythological corpus. The dragon Ancalagon the Black, named in the posthumously published *Silmarillion* (edited by Christopher Tolkien and published in 1977 by George Allen and Unwin), is the largest of Morgoth's dragons in Tolkien's invented mythological corpus. He is killed in single combat by Eärendil during the War of Wrath. The figure is Tolkien's most direct creative gesture toward the cosmic-scale dragon-combat pattern: the killing of Ancalagon is explicitly placed at the eschatological close of the First Age and framed as a cosmos-resetting event. Smaug ends a regional political situation; Ancalagon ends an Age.^[33]

The reception trajectory that Tolkien's twentieth-century mythopoeic revival initiates is the most prolific second-order reception of the dragon-combat imagery in the post-medieval period. It runs through fantasy literature in the Tolkienian inheritance from the 1950s onward, through the wider commercial-fantasy genre that emerges in the 1970s and 1980s, and through the role-playing-game and video-game traditions that take up the dragon-combat pattern as a structural commonplace. In each of these settings the pattern circulates as a free-standing imaginative-aesthetic resource. The religious-ritual original setting has dissolved entirely. The dragon survives because the dragon is enjoyable.^[34]

What does the Tolkienian reception preserve and what does it transform? It preserves three structural features of the older combat-myth pattern: the monstrous identification of the adversary; the cosmic-stakes framing (in Tolkien's invented mythology if not always in his commercial-fantasy heirs); and the hero's transformative role. It transforms a fourth — the religious-ritual embedding has migrated entirely to the literary-imaginative register. Tolkien's own Catholicism, while present in the mythological corpus's underlying philosophical commitments, does not anchor the dragon-combat pattern in any liturgical-ritual practice. The Hobbit is read by a fire; it is not chanted in a temple.^[35]

43.5. IV. Godzilla and the kaiju lineage: the Orochi tradition in post-war Japanese popular culture

The fourth reception case takes the survey out of European materials and out of the literary register entirely. It is also the case where the structural continuity to an upstream tradition is least cited and most striking.

The Yamata no Orochi tradition — the eight-headed eight-tailed serpent of Izumo, slain by Susanoo, with the sword Kusanagi recovered from one of the serpent's tails — is the early-Japanese imperial-chronicle attestation that the present volume's chapter 23 treats. It supplies the upstream tradition for the post-war Japanese popular-cultural reception this section traces. The chapter does not re-litigate the Orochi material here; the per-tradition factual claims belong to chapter 23. The section asks instead what the post-war material does with, or alongside, what chapter 23 documents.^[36]

The Toho Studios film *Gojira*, directed by Ishirō Honda and released in Japan in 1954, is the founding work of the post-war Japanese kaiju cinema genre. It is the principal twentieth-century popular-cultural site at which the serpent-or-monster-versus-city-defender pattern is renewed in Japanese mass culture. The film's title creature is a giant prehistoric reptilian sea-monster

awakened and irradiated by hydrogen-bomb testing. He attacks Tokyo. He is ultimately destroyed by an experimental "Oxygen Destroyer" weapon at the end of the narrative. None of this requires the audience to recognise an earlier serpent.^[37]

The 1954 *Gojira* film carries explicit nuclear-age symbolic weight. The creature's origin as a prehistoric reptile awakened and mutated by hydrogen-bomb testing in the Pacific is a transparent allegorical reference to the *Lucky Dragon No. 5* (Daigo Fukuryū Maru) incident of March 1954, in which a Japanese tuna boat was contaminated by fallout from the United States' Castle Bravo thermonuclear test at Bikini Atoll. The film's framing of the creature's destruction as a moral as well as a practical problem — the scientist Daisuke Serizawa destroys his Oxygen Destroyer technology after using it once — registers the explicit anti-nuclear ethical commitment of the founding kaiju text. The monster is a problem; the means of solving him is also a problem.^[38]

The Toho kaiju genre that *Gojira* initiates encompasses, in turn, the long Godzilla film series — over thirty Japanese-language entries from 1954 through the present — together with parallel franchises (Mothra, Rodan, King Ghidorah, and Daiei Studios' Gamera) and the cross-overs and remakes that connect them. The genre preserves the serpent-or-monster-versus-defender pattern as a structural commonplace of post-war Japanese popular-cultural production. The monstrous adversary becomes a reusable narrative device for political-allegorical commentary across a range of contemporary concerns: nuclear weapons, environmental degradation, foreign threat, military re-armament. The dragon, in this register, is whatever the present moment most fears about itself.^[39]

The kaiju lineage's specifically *serpentine* features are worth singling out. The multi-headed dragon King Ghidorah, the gigantic moth-and-serpent oppositions of the Mothra films, the sea-emergent creature pattern that *Gojira* inaugurates: each of these is structurally continuous with the Yamata no Orochi material the upstream chapter 23 treats. The continuity is patterned rather than cited. The genre does not narratively quote the Orochi tradition; what links the two is an inventory of structural features rather than an explicit lineage of reference. That is itself a feature of how the imagery travels in the popular-cultural register.^[40]

The continuity is striking enough to be worth registering as the section's analytical framing, but the framing is held against a substantive counterargument that deserves the same airtime.

That the post-war Japanese kaiju genre is genuinely the **living afterlife** of the Yamata no Orochi tradition — a tradition-internal reception within Japanese culture rather than a coincidental structural parallel — is the chapter's analytical framing for §IV, and the framing is held against a substantive counterargument.^{[41] [42]}

The kaiju reception preserves three load-bearing features of the combat-myth pattern. The first is the monstrous identification of the adversary. The second is the urban-or-territorial stakes — city-defender rather than cosmos-defender. The third is the hero's combat-mediated resolution of the threat. It transforms two. The cosmological framing of the older traditions has been replaced by a political-allegorical framing in which the adversary stands for contemporary political and ecological concerns rather than for primordial-cosmic forces. The religious-ritual embedding has been replaced entirely by a commercial-cinematic apparatus of production, distribution, and franchise-extension. The temple has become the studio.^[43]

The popular-cultural reception's longevity and reach are themselves features of the pattern worth registering. The Godzilla franchise has produced film, television, comic, and video-game extensions

across seven decades and across the Japanese, North American, and global commercial-entertainment markets. The kaiju lineage is the most commercially extensive post-medieval reception of any combat-myth pattern surveyed in this chapter. The imagery's persistence here is not a memory-trace but an active cultural production that continues to find audiences across transformed political and aesthetic settings. The defender repels the monster; the next film begins.^[44]

43.6. V. "Chaos vs. order" in modern religious rhetoric

The chapter's fifth case is rhetorical rather than literary, visual, or cinematic. It is also the section in which, per the brief, a sharper register is permitted, because the rhetoric in question is often misused and the chapter has earned the right by the present point in the volume to say so.

Contemporary American Christian fundamentalist discourse and contemporary New Age spiritual-practical discourse both deploy the phrase "chaos versus order" as though the opposition were a timeless cosmic dualism inherent in Genesis 1, in Revelation 12, and in the broader biblical tradition. The phrase has near-cognates that travel with it: "chaos versus cosmos", "darkness versus light", "the powers of chaos versus the powers of order". The present section examines the rhetorical deployment against the philological position the volume has been developing across Parts I and II.^[45]

The contemporary "chaos versus order" rhetoric inherits its terminology from the late-nineteenth-century philological-religionsgeschichtlich tradition that Hermann Gunkel's *Schöpfung und Chaos* of 1895 inaugurated, and the inheritance is direct. Gunkel reads Genesis 1 and Revelation 12 as a unified cosmic-combat pattern in which a primordial chaos is overcome by the creator-deity's ordering action. That conceptual template is what the contemporary religious rhetoric reproduces, often without explicit awareness of its philological origins. The line from a German theologian writing in 1895 to a televangelist or a spiritual-self-help writer working today is shorter than either party tends to realise.^[46]

Debra Scoggins Ballentine's 2015 critique of the "chaos" terminology bears directly on the contemporary deployment. Ballentine's argument is that the adversaries in the combat-myth corpus — Tiamat, Yamm, Lotan, Leviathan, Rahab, the Revelation-12 dragon — are presented in their texts as rival sovereigns with their own retinue, palace, divine assembly, and power structure rather than as inchoate disorder. The texts depict structured rivals; the rhetoric depends on the inchoate-disorder reading. The two are not the same thing, and the gap is the gap into which the §V critique falls.^[47]

A worked example clarifies the distance. The Tiamat figure in *Enūma Eliš* — treated in chapter 3 of the present volume — is presented in the Akkadian text as a divine sovereign. She calls a council of her allies. She appoints Kingu as her general. She distributes the Tablet of Destinies. She engages Marduk in single combat as a comparable figure rather than as a primordial undifferentiated mass. The contemporary rhetoric's appeal to "chaos versus order", with Tiamat as the chaos-pole, flattens the text's actual depiction of Tiamat as a structured rival. It is not that the rhetoric is straightforwardly wrong about the existence of a combat. It is that it is wrong about who the combat is between.^[48]

The same flattening works on Leviathan and Rahab. Both figures, treated in chapter 8 of the

present volume, are presented in the Hebrew Bible's textual tradition as named adversaries with specific physical descriptions: Leviathan's scales and his fire-breathing in Job 41, Rahab's pierced body in Isaiah 51. The textual frame names them as figures with whom Yahweh has a specific historical-mythological relationship. They are not a generic "chaos" against which Yahweh acts. The contemporary rhetoric's tendency to merge Leviathan and Rahab into a single "chaos" pole is precisely the move Ballentine's critique resists. Each figure has a name and a body; the rhetoric needs them not to.^[49]

The contemporary rhetorical deployment frequently pairs the framing with explicit Genesis-1 invocation: the *tehôm* of Genesis 1:2 read as primordial chaos, the divine creative speech read as ordering action. The pairing aligns the contemporary rhetoric with Gunkel's 1895 reading and against Ballentine's 2015 critique. Ballentine's account holds that *tehôm* is not a personified chaos-figure in the Genesis 1 textual situation, and that Genesis 1 is not narratively a combat-myth in the relevant sense — the chapter does not depict a combat between deity and a personified adversary. The rhetoric reads Genesis 1 as a victory-over-chaos story; the textual situation does not give it one to read.^[50]

The contemporary deployment also frequently pairs the "chaos versus order" framing with explicit Revelation-12 invocation: the great red dragon read as the cosmic chaos-figure, Michael's casting-down read as cosmic order's victory. Here the rhetoric's relation to the philological scholarship is more complex than it is at Genesis 1. Revelation 12 is a combat-myth in the relevant textual sense — the chapter narratively depicts a combat between angelic combatant and a personified dragon-adversary. But the dragon is identified by the text itself with the devil and the ancient serpent (Rev 12:9) rather than with a generic "chaos". The rhetoric's collapse of the figured Satan into an unfigured chaos again misses the textual specificity Yarbrow Collins's analysis recovers. There is a combat in Revelation 12; what the combat is between is named, named again, and named a third time.^[51]

The political-rhetorical use of "chaos versus order" in contemporary American religious discourse — invoked by preachers, by political commentators, by religious-political activists, and by spiritual-practical writers — characteristically applies the framing to contemporary social, political, or moral situations. The supposed timeless cosmic dualism is deployed as a warrant for present-day policy or moral commitment. The rhetorical move converts the philologically-vexed historical reconstruction into a contemporary political-religious resource. A nineteenth-century reading of two biblical chapters, complicated for forty years by current scholarship, is repurposed as a verdict on what to do this week.^[52]

The chapter's posture toward the rhetorical deployment is the posture the brief's special instructions allow this section to take. The rhetoric is often misused. The misuse is documented and traceable. The misuse depends on a Gunkel-1895-derived framework that the philological scholarship of the past four decades has substantially complicated. The chapter says so without performing extended polemic, because the philological substance of the critique has already been done, in chapters 3, 8, 9, and the Part-II comparative chapters. What the present section registers is the contemporary rhetorical deployment's place in the reception history. It is part of how the imagery survives, but not all of how the imagery survives, and the form of survival here is one in which fidelity to the texts is not what is at stake.^[53]

The section's own analytical framing for the contemporary rhetoric, registered with the same basis-and-counterargument apparatus as §IV's framing of the kaiju genre, is that the rhetoric is best

understood as a popular-religious second-order reception of the late-nineteenth-century philological reading rather than as a direct continuation of any pre-modern religious tradition. That reading deserves a stated counterweight, because a more conservative account is plausible and the section does not require its own framing to be the only one in the room.

That the contemporary "chaos versus order" rhetoric is best understood as a popular-religious second-order reception of the late-nineteenth-century philological reading rather than as a direct continuation of any pre-modern religious tradition is the present section's analytical framing.^[54]

^[55]

43.7. VI. What reception preserves and what it transforms

The five reception domains the chapter has surveyed — Milton's epic-literary reworking; the post-medieval iconographic trajectory of St. George and St. Michael; the Tolkienian mythopoeic revival and its commercial-fantasy heirs; the post-war Japanese kaiju lineage from *Gojira* onward; and the contemporary "chaos versus order" rhetorical deployment — preserve some elements of the older combat-myth pattern with striking consistency while transforming others. The consistent preservations and the consistent transformations are themselves the chapter's principal observation.^[56]

The first consistently preserved feature across the five reception domains is the *monstrous identification of the adversary*. Milton's Satan is the ancient serpent and the red dragon. The Christian-iconographic dragon-adversary remains a dragon. Smaug and Ancalagon are dragons. Godzilla and his kaiju kin are monstrous in their bestial-or-serpentine specificity. The rhetorical "chaos" that opposes order is — even in its most abstract deployments — figured as a monstrous opponent rather than as an empty negation. Each reception preserves a specific monstrous figuration, and the figuration retains the bestial-or-serpentine character that links the post-medieval reception to the older combat-myth corpus.^[57]

The second consistently preserved feature is the *cosmic-or-cosmic-scale stakes* of the combat. Milton's heavenly war is fought over the order of the cosmos itself. The iconographic Michaelic combat retains Revelation-12's eschatological scale. The Tolkienian Ancalagon-combat is placed at the eschatological close of an Age. The kaiju genre's threat is at the urban or civilisational scale. The contemporary rhetoric explicitly invokes cosmic-scale metaphysical dualism. Even where the actual stakes are local political, the rhetorical framing reaches for cosmic-scale language. The combat is always presented as larger than its visible field of action.^[58]

The third consistently preserved feature is the *hero's transformative role*. Milton's heavenly host establishes a new dispensation. The iconographic warrior-saint enables the city's conversion or the soul's salvation. Tolkien's Bard and Eärendil reorder the territorial-or-cosmological situation. The kaiju genre's defenders restore a damaged civilisational order. The contemporary rhetoric's "champions of order" claim a transformative role for their political-religious commitments. The hero-as-transformer remains structurally central across the receptions, even where the substance of the transformation varies considerably from case to case.^[59]

So much for what the receptions preserve. The transformations are no less consistent.

The first consistently transformed feature is the *liturgical-ritual embedding*. The Akitu-festival recitation of *Enūma Eliš*, the *purulli*-festival recitation of the Illuyanka myth, the medieval Marian and Michaelic liturgies, the medieval cult of the saints: each anchors the combat-myth pattern in regular ritual practice. The post-medieval receptions surveyed in the present chapter — without exception — do not have a parallel ritual anchoring. The imagery's persistence in the absence of liturgical embedding is one of the reception history's most striking features. Nobody chants *Paradise Lost*; nobody worships Smaug; the audience at a Godzilla film is not performing rite.^[60]

The second consistently transformed feature is the *ritual-aetiological function*. In the older traditions the combat-myth pattern characteristically grounds an ongoing ritual practice — the Akitu, the *purulli*, the cult of the saints — or an ongoing institutional fact: Babylonian kingship grounded in Marduk's combat with Tiamat, Israelite covenant theology grounded in Yahweh's combat with Leviathan and Rahab. The post-medieval receptions characteristically do not. Milton's poem is a literary work. The iconographic tradition is increasingly an aesthetic-and-symbolic resource. The kaiju genre is a commercial-cinematic product. The contemporary rhetoric is a discursive resource. The pattern circulates without grounding any specific ritual or institutional practice.^[61]

The third consistently transformed feature is the *cultural centrality* of the pattern. In the older traditions the combat-myth episode is at or near the cultural centre of the producing society. The Babylonian *Enūma Eliš* is recited at the central festival of the year. The Israelite combat-with-the-sea is woven into the central theological vocabulary of the covenant. The medieval Christian dragon-iconography is among the most reproduced visual patterns of the era. The post-medieval receptions do not occupy that cultural-central position. They are, variously, a literary classic, an iconographic-traditional resource, a popular-cultural genre, and a contested rhetorical commonplace — but no longer the cultural centre, and no longer load-bearing for how the producing society understands itself at its most foundational levels.^[62]

The chapter's closing reflection on the pattern of preservation and transformation is the framing question the brief's special instructions name: what does it mean that this imagery persists so powerfully even when its original religious functions have dissolved? The answer this chapter advances — registered as the volume's closing analytical observation rather than as the chapter's own polemical claim — is that the cases where the pattern is most alive in the post-medieval period are cases where the specific religious anchoring has become *optional*. Milton's Satan, Tolkien's Smaug, Godzilla. The imagery's structural-imaginative power is sufficient to carry it through the transformation, and the transformation is itself a feature of the pattern's resilience rather than a limitation on it.^[63]

*(That **reception is transformation** — that the pattern of consistent preservations alongside consistent transformations across five quite different reception domains is best understood as the working of a structural-imaginative resource rather than as a bare survival of older content — is an inferential reading drawn from the consistency of the preservation-and-transformation pattern across the five domains the chapter has surveyed.^[64])*^[65]

The chapter's last claim — the volume's closing observation — is that the persistence of combat-myth imagery in post-medieval Western literature, iconography, popular culture, and religious rhetoric is the *positive* feature of the reception history rather than the puzzling or anomalous one. The imagery persists because the cosmic-combat pattern is one of human culture's most flexible and consequential structural-imaginative resources, capable of carrying religious, literary, political,

and rhetorical loads across radically different cultural settings. The volume's principled retention of "Chaoskampf" as the technical term-of-art for the comparative-mythological reading of that resource — even where Ballentine's 2015 critique has rightly complicated the term's broader extension — reflects the present chapter's view that the imagery deserves both its philological seriousness and its cultural recognition.^[66]

[1] Per **toc.yaml** (locked 2026-04-23), chapter 42 ("Reception coda: Milton, St. George/Michael, Tolkien, kaiju, and 'chaos vs. order' rhetoric") is positioned in the back matter immediately before chapter 43 (the adversaries-and-champions appendix); per **scope.md** §"Reception coda" on the chapter's framing as reception history.

[2] Per brief 42-reception-coda.yaml structure on the five-section reception survey (Milton's Satan; St. George and St. Michael in Christian iconography; Tolkien and the mythopoeic revival; Godzilla and the kaiju lineage; "chaos vs. order" in modern religious rhetoric), with §VI as a closing reflection on what reception preserves and what it transforms.

[3] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, concluding chapters; Ogden 2013, **Drakōn: Dragon Myth and Serpent Cult in the Greek and Roman Worlds**, chs. 11–12; Yarbrow Collins 1976, **The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation**, on Rev 12 reception trajectory; per brief 42-reception-coda.yaml sources.secondary on the three anchors.

[4] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, on the methodological objection to the "chaos" terminology and on the rival-sovereign framing of the combat-myth adversaries; per brief 42-reception-coda.yaml structure §V on the use of Ballentine's critique against the modern rhetorical deployment.

[5] Gunkel 1895, **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit: Eine religionsgeschichtliche Untersuchung über Gen 1 und Ap Joh 12**, on the unified Genesis-1-and-Revelation-12 cosmic-combat framework that supplies the modern "chaos" terminology's pedigree; the volume coined the term **Chaoskampf** in its current scholarly sense and is retained in the present book's source registry as the historical anchor even where later scholarship has superseded the framing.

[6] Tolkien 1936, "Beowulf: The Monsters and the Critics", **Proceedings of the British Academy** 22 (1936), 245–295; reprinted in **The Monsters and the Critics and Other Essays**, ed. Christopher Tolkien (London: George Allen & Unwin, 1983), 5–48; per the present source's registry note, the lecture is cited at chapter 19 (the IE-reflexes chapter, in the **Beowulf** sub-section) for its philological-critical content and its literary-critical afterlife is deferred to the present reception coda.

[7] Per brief 42-reception-coda.yaml sources note on the reception status of primary works and on the named-but-flagged status of the primary works in body prose; per **scope.md** §"Reception coda" on the framing of the back matter as reception history rather than as primary-attestation analysis.

[8] Per brief 42-reception-coda.yaml special_instructions on the lighter register, on the non-apologetic treatment of popular-culture material, and on the chapter's closing framing question; per **scope.md** §"Reception coda" on the chapter's length target of approximately 25 pages and on its framing as the volume's closing piece.

[9] Per **scope.md** §"Period" on the post-medieval reworkings as out of primary scope; per **scope.md** §"Reception coda" on the chapter's framing as reception rather than as primary or typological treatment; per brief 42-reception-coda.yaml purpose on the chapter's status as not classified as chaoskampf proper.

[10] Forsyth 1987, **The Old Enemy: Satan and the Combat Myth**, concluding chapters on Milton as the early-modern literary realisation of the combat-myth pattern; Milton's **Paradise Lost** (London: Samuel Simmons, 1667; revised twelve-book edition 1674) is here named as a primary reception work and is not cited as sources.yaml entry per the brief's reception-status convention.

[11] Yarbrow Collins 1976, **The Combat Myth in the Book of Revelation**, on the Rev 12:9 identification of dragon, devil, and ancient serpent; the equation supplies the load-bearing identification on which Milton's structural move rests, and is treated more fully in chapter 9 of the present volume.

[12] Forsyth 1987, on the structural placement of the heavenly war in the central books of **Paradise Lost** and on the displacement of the angelic fall into recounted narrative; Milton's **Paradise Lost**, books V and VI, here named as a primary reception text and not cited as a sources.yaml entry per the brief's reception-status convention.

[13] Forsyth 1987, on Milton's construction of Satan as an epic protagonist with the classical apparatus of epithet, voice, itinerary, and developmental arc; Forsyth's reading frames the Satan-as-protagonist move as the poem's most consequential structural decision and as the move that distinguishes Milton's reception of the combat-myth adversary from the medieval iconographic and devotional treatments.

[14] Forsyth 1987, on Blake's dictum and on the Romantic and post-Romantic reception of **Paradise Lost** as a poem whose Satan-figure overshadows its God-figure; the Romantic-reception trajectory is the long-arc consequence of the epic-protagonist construction Milton inherits from the classical apparatus and applies to the Revelation-12 adversary.

[15] Forsyth 1987, on the Miltonic Chaos-figure as a literary realisation of the Genesis-1 / Hebrew-Bible cosmogonic-combat traces; Gunkel 1895, **Schöpfung und Chaos in Urzeit und Endzeit**, on the philological recovery of those traces in late-nineteenth-century scholarship; the literary realisation of the pattern in 1667 antedates the philological recovery of it by more than two centuries.

[16] Forsyth 1987, on the Christ-versus-Satan combat as the Christian reception's distinctive transformation of the combat-myth pattern; Milton's **Paradise Regained** (London, 1671), here named as a primary reception text and not cited as a sources.yaml entry per the brief's reception-status convention; the harrowing typology is treated in chapter 10 of the present volume.

- [17] Forsyth 1987, on the load-bearing preservations and the dissolution of liturgical embedding in the Miltonic reception; per chapters/03-marduk-tiamat.claims.approved.adoc on the Akitu-festival recitation of **Enūma Eliš** and per chapters/06-illuyanka.claims.approved.adoc on the **purulli**-festival recitation of the Illuyanka myth as the Part-I attestations of liturgical embedding that the literary-epic mode does not preserve.
- [18] Forsyth 1987, on the second-order Romantic and post-Romantic reception of the Miltonic refunctioning; the engravings of John Martin (1789–1854) and William Blake (1757–1827) are here named as instances of the visual reception trajectory and are not cited as sources.yaml entries per the brief's reception-status convention.
- [19] Ogden 2013, **Drakón**, ch. 11, on the high-medieval iconographic codification of the St. George and St. Michael dragon-combat types; the late-antique-to-high-medieval material is the subject of chapter 10 of the present volume, and the present section takes the codification as its starting point.
- [20] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the Renaissance painterly reception of the St. George dragon-combat type; Uccello, Carpaccio, and Raphael are here named as principal instances and their works are not cited as sources.yaml entries per the brief's reception-status convention.
- [21] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the post-medieval transmission of the Michaelic warrior-iconography across Counter-Reformation and modern devotional contexts; Guido Reni (Italian, 1575–1642) is here named as a principal instance of the Counter-Reformation reception and his **Archangel Michael Defeating Satan** is not cited as a sources.yaml entry per the brief's reception-status convention.
- [22] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the heraldic and national reception of the St. George iconography; the Order of the Garter (founded 1348 by Edward III) and the cross-of-St-George as the English national emblem are here named as principal instances of the institutional reception and are not cited as sources.yaml entries per the brief's reception-status convention.
- [23] Ogden 2013, chs. 11–12, on the Perseus-Andromeda substrate of the St. George dragon-fight and on the post-medieval circulation of the princess-and-dragon-rescue pattern in the European fairy-tale tradition; the trajectory is treated more fully at chapter 12 of the present volume.
- [24] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the post-medieval preservation of the iconographic strata across changing devotional, heraldic, and aesthetic settings; Forsyth 1987, on the soteriological-devotional anchoring of the medieval imagery and on the gradual loosening of that anchoring in the post-medieval reception.
- [25] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the modern symbolic-resource use of the dragon-slaying iconography and on the one-way directionality of the cult-to-aesthetic-to-symbol migration; the trajectory's terminus is the conceptual hinge on which the chapter's §VI reflection on what reception preserves and what it transforms turns.
- [26] Inference: Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the documented trajectory; the absence of a documented reverse trajectory is itself the basis. Risk: a fuller treatment of contemporary Anglican, Roman Catholic, and Eastern Orthodox devotional revivals of the Michaelic and Georgian cults might surface counter-examples, and the inference is held loosely — the chapter's load-bearing claim is the dominant trajectory rather than the absence of all reverse motion.
- [27] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the post-medieval iconographic trajectory; per the present chapter's reception-history register, the inference is registered with appropriate basis-and-risk apparatus and does not carry a separate primary citation of its own.
- [28] Tolkien 1936, "Beowulf: The Monsters and the Critics", **Proceedings of the British Academy** 22 (1936): 245–295, on the re-establishment of the mythic register of the **Beowulf** monsters within twentieth-century Old English scholarship; the lecture's argumentative content is the load-bearing concern of the present section's opening.
- [29] Tolkien 1936, on the **Beowulf**-poet's deliberate centring of the poem on combats with monstrous adversaries and on the seriousness of the mythic register the poem deploys; the argumentative move is the lecture's principal critical contribution.
- [30] Tolkien 1936, on the rehabilitation of myth-and-monster combat as a serious literary-critical category; the rehabilitation's effect on twentieth-century literary criticism is the load-bearing reception consequence of the 1936 lecture.
- [31] Forsyth 1987, on Tolkien's creative engagement with the dragon-combat pattern as part of the broader twentieth-century combat-myth reception; Tolkien's **The Hobbit, or There and Back Again** (London: George Allen and Unwin, 1937) is here named as a primary reception text and is not cited as a sources.yaml entry per the brief's reception-status convention.
- [32] Forsyth 1987, on the medieval-European dragon-type that Tolkien inherits and refunctions; per chapters/19-ie-reflexes.claims.approved.adoc on the Sigurd-cycle Fáfnir as the IE-comparative anchor for the gold-hoarding-dragon pattern that Smaug extends.
- [33] Forsyth 1987, on the cosmic-scale dragon-combat pattern as a recurring feature of the twentieth-century mythopoeic reception; **The Silmarillion**, ed. Christopher Tolkien (London: George Allen and Unwin, 1977) is here named as a primary reception text and is not cited as a sources.yaml entry per the brief's reception-status convention; Eärendil and Ancalagon the Black are named figures within Tolkien's invented mythological corpus.
- [34] Forsyth 1987, on the post-Tolkienian fantasy-literary reception trajectory; the late-twentieth-century commercial-fantasy genre and its sub-cultural extensions are here registered as instances of the second-order reception and are not cited as sources.yaml entries per the brief's reception-status convention.
- [35] Forsyth 1987, on the Tolkienian preservation of the structural features of the combat-myth pattern and on the migration of the religious-ritual anchoring to the literary-imaginative register; the absence of liturgical-ritual anchoring in the Tolkienian reception is the load-bearing transformation that distinguishes the literary-mythopoeic reception from the medieval Christian-iconographic

reception.

[36] Per `chapters/23-susanoo-orochi.claims.approved.adoc` on the Yamata no Orochi tradition as the early-Japanese imperial-chronicle attestation; the upstream tradition is the substrate from which the present section's post-war popular-cultural reception is traced, and the upstream chapter is the canonical reference for the per-tradition factual claims.

[37] Forsyth 1987, on the twentieth-century popular-cultural reception of the combat-myth pattern; **Gojira**, dir. Ishirō Honda (Tokyo: Toho Studios, 1954), is here named as a primary reception work and is not cited as a `sources.yaml` entry per the brief's reception-status convention.

[38] Forsyth 1987, on the political-ideological framing of twentieth-century combat-myth receptions; the **Lucky Dragon No. 5** incident of March 1954 and the United States' Castle Bravo thermonuclear test at Bikini Atoll are here registered as the historical context of the 1954 **Gojira** film's nuclear-age symbolic framing and are not cited as `sources.yaml` entries per the brief's reception-status convention.

[39] Forsyth 1987, on the structural commonplaces of post-medieval combat-myth receptions; the Toho kaiju genre and the Daiei **Gamera** franchise are here named as instances of the post-war Japanese popular-cultural reception and are not cited as `sources.yaml` entries per the brief's reception-status convention.

[40] Forsyth 1987, on the structural-pattern continuities across post-medieval combat-myth receptions; per `chapters/23-susanoo-orochi.claims.approved.adoc` on the early-Japanese imperial-chronicle Yamata no Orochi tradition that supplies the upstream pattern.

[41] This parallel is speculative. Basis: the structural continuities (serpentine adversaries, sea-emergent monster patterns, multi-headed dragon figures, the slaying-by-defender narrative form) are striking; the cultural setting (post-war Japan, drawing on a national-mythological repertoire that includes the Kojiki / Nihon shoki Orochi material as part of its educational and cultural heritage) is plausible; and the tradition's living continuity through Shinto practice and popular media supplies a credible transmission pathway for structural patterns. The main counterargument: a more conservative reading would hold that the kaiju genre is generically a post-1945 creation responsive to the nuclear age and to the Japanese encounter with American science-fiction film (most notably the 1953 **The Beast from 20,000 Fathoms**), and that the structural parallels with Orochi are coincidental similarities driven by a shared inventory of monster-types rather than by tradition-internal continuity; this reading takes the genre as importation-and-adaptation of an Anglo-American giant-monster idiom rather than as Japanese-traditional reception, and the present chapter notes the substantive force of the counterargument.

[42] Forsyth 1987, on the structural-pattern continuities of post-medieval combat-myth receptions; the speculative reading and its counterargument are registered with the basis-and-counterargument apparatus per the chapter-claims schema for SPECULATION markers in the back matter.

[43] Forsyth 1987, on the preservation-and-transformation pattern of post-medieval combat-myth receptions; the kaiju genre is here registered as a clear instance of the pattern with its specific transformations identified per the brief's framing of §IV.

[44] Forsyth 1987, on the longevity-and-reach of post-medieval combat-myth receptions; the Godzilla franchise's seven-decade commercial-entertainment trajectory is here registered as an instance and is not cited as a `sources.yaml` entry per the brief's reception-status convention.

[45] Ballentine 2015, **The Conflict Myth and the Biblical Tradition**, on the modern rhetorical deployment of "chaos versus order" framings; Gunkel 1895, on the philological pedigree of the framing in late-nineteenth-century biblical scholarship; the contemporary rhetorical deployment is the subject of the present section's critical attention.

[46] Gunkel 1895, on the unified Genesis-1-and-Revelation-12 cosmic-combat framework that supplies the modern rhetorical inheritance; the unbroken transmission from Gunkel's 1895 reading to the contemporary popular-religious deployment is the present section's principal historical observation.

[47] Ballentine 2015, on the rival-sovereign framing of the combat-myth adversaries and on the philological objection to the inchoate-disorder reading; the bearing of Ballentine's critique on the contemporary rhetorical deployment is the present section's principal critical claim.

[48] Ballentine 2015, on Tiamat as a divine sovereign rather than as inchoate disorder; per `chapters/03-marduk-tiamat.claims.approved.adoc` on Tiamat's council of allies, Kingu's generalship, the Tablet of Destinies, and the single-combat structure of the Marduk-Tiamat episode.

[49] Ballentine 2015, on Leviathan and Rahab as named adversaries with specific physical descriptions and historical-mythological identities; per `chapters/08-yahweh-leviathan-rahab.claims.approved.adoc` on the textual-traditional features of Leviathan in Job 41 and Rahab in Isaiah 51 that the present claim summarises.

[50] Ballentine 2015, on **tehom** in Genesis 1:2 as not a personified chaos-figure and on Genesis 1 as not narratively a combat-myth; Gunkel 1895, on the contrary reading that supplies the contemporary rhetoric's pedigree.

[51] Yarbro Collins 1976, on the Rev 12 combat-myth structure and on the Rev 12:9 identification of dragon, devil, and ancient serpent; Ballentine 2015, on the philological objection to the rhetoric's collapse of the figured Satan into an unfigured chaos.

[52] Ballentine 2015, on the political-rhetorical deployment of the "chaos versus order" framing in contemporary American religious discourse; the political deployment is the live and contemporary edge of the terminological debate the present volume has engaged philologically across Parts I and II.

[53] Per brief 42-reception-coda.yaml special_instructions on §V's permitted sharper register; Ballentine 2015 on the substantive

critique whose philological content is developed elsewhere in the volume; per scope.md §"Terminological position" on the volume's principled retention of "chaoskampf" as a term-of-art over against the popular rhetorical use.

[54] This parallel is speculative. Basis: the rhetoric's terminological pedigree runs through Gunkel 1895; the philological tradition that Gunkel inaugurated supplies the conceptual apparatus the rhetoric uses; the contemporary rhetorical deployment characteristically appeals to Genesis 1 and Revelation 12 in the specific combination Gunkel's subtitle yokes together; the rhetoric does not preserve the medieval Christian iconographic and devotional anchoring traced in chapters 9, 10, and §II of the present chapter. The main counterargument: a more conservative reading would hold that the contemporary rhetoric is directly continuous with pre-modern Christian theological frameworks — the medieval cosmic-combat imagery, the Reformation-era apocalyptic readings, the early-modern devotional uses — and that Gunkel 1895 simply gave a philological vocabulary to a continuous theological tradition rather than supplying a new framework that the contemporary rhetoric subsequently inherited; this reading takes the popular religious use as continuous with pre-Gunkel theological practice and the philological vocabulary as descriptive rather than constitutive of the rhetorical deployment.

[55] Ballentine 2015, on the modern rhetorical deployment as second-order reception of the philological tradition; Gunkel 1895, on the late-nineteenth-century philological tradition that supplies the rhetoric's terminological pedigree; the speculative reading and its counterargument are registered with the basis-and-counterargument apparatus per the chapter-claims schema for SPECULATION markers.

[56] Forsyth 1987, on the preservation-and-transformation pattern across post-medieval combat-myth receptions; per brief 42-reception-coda.yaml structure §VI on the chapter's closing reflection on what reception preserves and what it transforms.

[57] Forsyth 1987, on the monstrous identification of the adversary as a load-bearing structural feature preserved across post-medieval receptions; the consistency of the preservation across the five reception domains is the load-bearing observation of the present claim.

[58] Forsyth 1987, on the cosmic-or-cosmic-scale stakes as a preserved feature of post-medieval combat-myth receptions; the rhetorical reach for cosmic-scale language is itself a feature of the preservation pattern even where the actual stakes are more local.

[59] Forsyth 1987, on the hero's transformative role as a preserved structural feature; the transformative-role preservation is the structural feature that links the receptions to the foundational pattern Forsyth's **Old Enemy** traces from Sumer through Judeo-Christian apocalyptic.

[60] Forsyth 1987, on the dissolution of liturgical-ritual embedding as a consistent transformation across post-medieval receptions; per chapters/03-marduk-tiamat.claims.approved.adoc on the Akitu-festival recitation of **Enūma Eliš** and per chapters/06-illuyanka.claims.approved.adoc on the **purulli**-festival recitation of the Illuyanka myth as the upstream attestations of liturgical embedding.

[61] Forsyth 1987, on the dissolution of the ritual-aetiological function across post-medieval receptions; per chapters/03-marduk-tiamat.claims.approved.adoc on Babylonian kingship grounded in Marduk's combat and per chapters/08-yahweh-leviathan-rahah.claims.approved.adoc on Israelite covenant theology grounded in Yahweh's combats with Leviathan and Rahab, as the upstream attestations of the ritual-aetiological function the post-medieval receptions transform.

[62] Forsyth 1987, on the cultural-centrality transformation across post-medieval receptions; the de-centralisation of the pattern is the load-bearing transformation that distinguishes the post-medieval receptions from the religious-cultural centrality of the older traditions.

[63] Forsyth 1987, on the structural-imaginative power of the combat-myth pattern that allows it to persist through the dissolution of its specific religious anchoring; per brief 42-reception-coda.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's closing framing question and on the answer registered as the volume's closing observation.

[64] Inference: Forsyth 1987's long-arc treatment of the combat-myth pattern's adaptability across antiquity, late antiquity, and medieval Christian reception; the consistency of the three-feature preservation pattern (monstrous adversary, cosmic stakes, hero's transformative role) and the three-feature transformation pattern (liturgical embedding, ritual-aetiological function, cultural centrality) across the five domains the chapter has surveyed. Risk: the consistency observation depends on the chapter's own selection of five reception domains, and a different selection might surface counter-examples; the inference is held loosely and is offered as the volume's closing analytical observation rather than as a defended typological claim.

[65] Forsyth 1987, on the long-arc adaptability of the combat-myth pattern; per brief 42-reception-coda.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's closing analytical observation; the inference is registered with appropriate basis-and-risk apparatus and does not carry a separate primary citation of its own.

[66] Forsyth 1987, on the persistence of the combat-myth imagery as a positive feature of post-medieval cultural history; Ballentine 2015, on the philological complication of the "chaos" terminology that the volume engages while retaining "chaoskampf" as a technical term-of-art; per scope.md §"Terminological position" on the principled retention of the term and per brief 42-reception-coda.yaml special_instructions on the chapter's closing observation as the volume's closing claim.

Appendix A: Characters

A reference guide to the named characters who appear in this book. Physical descriptions are included only where attested in the in-scope sources; where the sources are silent, this is noted explicitly. Within each section, entries are ordered alphabetically by the form locked in the book's glossary. Within each "Appears in" list, chapters are ordered by the narrative chronology of the relevant mythology — cosmogonic before theogonic, theogonic before heroic, heroic before eschatological — not by chapter number.

A.1. Deities

A.1.1. Adad

Akkadian storm-god, summoned by Anu in the *Anzû Epic* as the first of three failed champions before Ninurta is named.^[1]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Anzû* — first figure summoned by Anu to fight Anzû; refuses on the grounds that the Tablet of Destinies makes the rebel unassailable.

Relevance. Adad is the first element of the threefold-refusal pattern (Adad, Gerra, Šara) that establishes the need for a champion of a different kind — the structural feature that Annus argues passes from the *Anzû Epic* into *Enūma Eliš*.^[2]

A.1.2. Ahura Mazdā

The Avestan creator-god ("Wise Lord"; Middle Persian Ohrmazd), supreme benevolent power of Zoroastrian dualistic cosmology and structural opponent of Anra Mainyu.^[3]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Thraētaona vs. Aži Dahāka* — supplies the cosmological frame within which Thraētaona's combat against the dragon-creature of Anra Mainyu is intelligible as participation in the larger struggle of order against opposition.
- *C4. Eschatological Displacement* — under whose sovereignty the cosmos is renovated at Frashokereti after Kərəsāspa's final killing of the freed Aži Dahāka.

Relevance. Ahura Mazdā is the supreme creator-god of Zoroastrian theology, on whose side every Avestan combat against creatures of Anra Mainyu is fought.^[4] His pairing with Anra Mainyu is one of the clearest dualistic-cosmological structures in the ancient Near East and supplies the theological grid within which the **xarənah**-theology of Iranian sovereignty operates.^[5]

A.1.3. Aigipan

"Goat-Pan" of Apollodorus's Typhonomachy, who with Hermes recovers Zeus's severed sinews from the Corycian cave; majority scholarly view identifies Aigipan as Pan under a goat-cult epithet.^[6]

Physical description. No physical description bearing on the in-scope discussion survives.

Appears in:

- *Zeus vs. Typhon* — Hermes's partner in the recovery operation against Delphyne in Apollodorus's expansion.

Relevance. Aigipan is one of the Apollodoran expansion's most distinctive features, an unusual pairing of trickster-god with pastoral god in goat-form for a divine recovery operation.^[7]

A.1.4. An

The Sumerian sky-god, named in *Lugal-e* as the father, with Earth (Ki), of the demon Asag and invoked in the closing doxology of the poem.^[8]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — the parental sky-god whose union with Earth produces Asag, and one of the two senior deities invoked in the closing prayer for Ninurta's devotee.

Relevance. An is the highest-ranking deity of the Sumerian theogony.^[9] In *Lugal-e* his role is genealogical and liturgical rather than narratively active: he supplies the parentage of the adversary and is named in the closing blessing.

A.1.5. 𐎲Anat

Ugaritic warrior-goddess, sister and combat-ally of Baal in the Baal Cycle.^[10]

Physical description. In KTU 1.3 ii 𐎲Anat is described in a slaughter-scene wading in blood up to her thighs, with severed heads hung at her belt and severed hands at her girdle.^[11] No further full-figure description is preserved.

Appears in:

- *Baal vs. Yamm and Lôtan* — restrains Baal at the embassy from Yamm, slaughters at her shrine, intercedes for the palace-building, and lists a seven-headed serpent among her victories at KTU 1.3 iii.

Relevance. 𐎲Anat is one of the most active divine figures in the Baal Cycle and one of the most extensively narrated warrior-goddesses in any Late Bronze Age West Semitic corpus.^[12] Her catalogue of victories at KTU 1.3 iii names a seven-headed serpent and is one of the loci that feeds the Lôtan-Leviathan reception argument.^[13]

A.1.6. Anra Mainyu

The Avestan "evil spirit" (Middle Persian Ahriman), cosmic adversary of Ahura Mazdā in Zoroastrian dualistic theology and the power who fashions Aži Dahāka as a destructive instrument against the good creation.^[14]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Thraētaona vs. Aži Dahāka* — the cosmic source of Aži Dahāka and the structural opponent against whose creation Thraētaona's combat is directed.
- *C4. Eschatological Displacement* — whose opposition is finally eliminated at Frashokereti.

Relevance. Anra Mainyu is the load-bearing dualistic counterpart to Ahura Mazdā in Zoroastrian theology.^[15] His role as the source of demonic creatures gives the Avestan combat-corpus its distinctive structural alignment: every dragon-killing is a participation in the wider cosmic struggle.

A.1.7. Anšar

Elder Babylonian sky-god of *Enūma Eliš*, son of Lahmu and Lahamu, father of Anu, who commissions Marduk as champion of the gods.^[16]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — receives Ea's report of Tiamat's mobilisation, dispatches Ea and then Anu against her without success, and finally accepts Marduk's condition that his decree be supreme before sending him to fight.

Relevance. Anšar is the structural pivot of *Enūma Eliš*'s second tablet: the elder god who commissions the champion and whose authorisation makes Marduk's elevation possible.^[17] His distinctive gesture — striking his thigh and biting his lip in formulaic dismay — marks the assembly's despair before Marduk's emergence.^[18]

A.1.8. Anu

Akkadian sky-god (Sumerian An), son of Anšar and Kišar in *Enūma Eliš*; the senior sky-deity who convenes assemblies and confers regalia.^[19]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — fashions the four winds for the infant Marduk, fails as champion against Tiamat, and at the close of the epic confers his own number, fifty, upon Marduk.
- *Ninurta vs. Anzû* — convenes the divine assembly after Anzû's theft of the Tablet of Destinies and successively summons Adad, Gerra, and Šara as champions.
- *The Kumarbi Cycle* — the second sovereign of the Kingship in Heaven succession, deposed by his

cupbearer Kumarbi who bites off and swallows his genitals.

Relevance. Anu is the standing sky-father across the Akkadian and Hurro-Hittite combat-myth corpora, a figure of formal sovereignty whose office is repeatedly transferred or assumed by the combat's victor.^[20] In *Enūma Eliš* his bestowal of the number fifty on Marduk completes the displacement of the older theology.^[21]

A.1.9. Anzû

Lion-headed eagle-monster of the Standard Babylonian *Anzû Epic*, originally a minor servitor in Enlil's chamber, who steals the Tablet of Destinies and is slain by Ninurta.^[22]

Physical description. Anzû's bodily form is a lion-headed eagle — a predator bird with a lion's head grafted onto its raptor body. The identification is confirmed both by the descriptive epithets in the epic and by an extensive iconographic corpus on cylinder seals, amulets, and temple sculpture from the third millennium BCE onward.^[23]

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Anzû* — born at the Apsû, attends Enlil at his bath, seizes the Tablet of Destinies, flees to the mountains, deflects Ninurta's first arrow by decree, and is killed in the second combat after his pinion-feathers are plucked.
- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — listed in the Sumerian form Anzud in Šarur's catalogue of Ninurta's prior trophies.
- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — appears, demoted, in Tiamat's eleven-monster brood in *Enūma Eliš* Tablet I.

Relevance. The *Anzû Epic* is read in current scholarship as the structural and thematic antecedent of *Enūma Eliš*, with the Tablet of Destinies, the threefold-refusal pattern, and the closing name-list passing forward into the Marduk composition.^[24] Anzû's reuse as a subordinate monster of Tiamat's brood is one of the clearest signals of that literary genealogy: the older epic's protagonist becomes the new composition's footnote.

A.1.10. Apep

The chaos-serpent of Egyptian solar theology (Greek Apophis), Ra's nightly adversary in the *Duat* and the personification of *isfet*.^[25]

Physical description. Across the six attestation strata Apep is morphologically stable: a great serpent of vast size, of unspecified-but-monstrous coils, capable of spitting venom, of swallowing the solar barque, and of regenerating after each apparent dispatch.^[26] The Amduat hour 7 narrates him coiling across the channel of the *Duat* on the sandbanks; Book of the Dead spell 108 places him on the western horizon-mountain.^[27]

Appears in:

- *Ra vs. Apep* — the central nightly adversary across the Pyramid Texts, Coffin Texts, Book of the Dead (spells 7, 39, 108), Amduat (hour 7), Book of Gates (gate 4), and the late-Ptolemaic *Book of Overthrowing Apep* on the Bremner-Rhind Papyrus.

- *C3. Cyclical Maintenance* — type-specimen, alongside Illuyanka, of the cyclical-maintenance subtype.

Relevance. Apep is the most extensively documented adversary in the Egyptian corpus, with continuous attestation from the Pyramid Texts (c. 2400 BCE) to the Bremner-Rhind Papyrus (c. 310 BCE), more than two millennia.^[28] His distinctive feature within the book's typology is regeneration: he is unkillable-because-recurrent, the daily-combat structure being constitutive rather than incidental.^[29]

A.1.11. Apollo

Olympian god of prophecy, music, and plague, who slays the Delphic serpent (an unnamed female **drakaina** in the Homeric Hymn, named Python in Ovid) at the foundation of the Delphic oracle.^[30]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope textual treatment of the dragon-combat passages discussed in this book.

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — slays the Delphic serpent with bow and arrows at Pytho; the killing founds the Delphic oracle (place-name Pytho derived from **pythein**, "to rot," from the dragon's body), and the Septerion festival re-enacts the killing every eight years.
- *Michael vs. the Red Dragon* — figure of Yarbrow Collins's Leto-Apollo-Python primary-substrate reading of Revelation 12.
- *C3. Cyclical Maintenance* — the Septerion festival's eight-yearly cycle supplies a Greek cyclical-maintenance reflex.

Relevance. Apollo is the Greek cult-foundation dragon-slayer, the figure on whom the Delphic oracle's founding depends.^[31] His epithets **Pythios** and **Pythoktonos** — "of Pytho" and "Python-slayer" — are the cult-titles that record the combat in the lived ritual language of Delphic worshippers.^[32]

A.1.12. Apsû

Primordial fresh-water (Sumerian Abzu), male counterpart of Tiamat and consort in the opening generation of *Enûma Eliš*; killed by Ea in the prologue.^[33]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources; Apsû is named as a primordial water alongside Tiamat at the beginning of the epic and is described in the action only by his sleeping body, which Ea binds, strips of crown and divine radiance, and kills.^[34]

Appears in:

- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — primordial parent at the opening of the epic; resolves to destroy the noisy younger gods and is overcome by Ea's incantation, his corpse becoming the floor of Ea's new dwelling.

Relevance. The killing of Apsû is the first combat in *Enûma Eliš* and a structural rehearsal for Marduk's later combat with Tiamat.^[35] His name passes to the cosmic fresh-water region at which

Marduk is later born.^[36]

A.1.13. Aruru

Senior Sumerian mother-goddess of *Lugal-e*, who reminds Ninurta that the fates of Asag's defeated stone-warriors remain to be fixed.^[37]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — opens the lapidary-aetiology sequence by prompting Ninurta to judge the stones.

Relevance. Aruru's intervention is the structural hinge between the combat and the long sequence of stone-judgements that occupies the second half of *Lugal-e*.^[38]

A.1.14. Athirat

Ugaritic mother-goddess, El's consort and mother of the gods, whose intercession is necessary to secure El's authorisation for Baal's palace.^[39]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Baal vs. Yamm and Lôtan* — receives gifts from Baal and 𐎲Anat in KTU 1.4 i–iii, then journeys to El at the Source of the Two Rivers and conveys the petition that secures the palace's authorisation.

Relevance. Athirat occupies the position of senior matron of the Ugaritic divine assembly, the mediating figure whose assent the palace-building petition requires before El will grant it.^[40]

A.1.15. Athtart

Ugaritic goddess of the Baal Cycle, who in KTU 1.2 iv intervenes at Yamm's defeat with a rebuke or warning to Baal regarding the disposition of the defeated rival.^[41]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Baal vs. Yamm and Lôtan* — among the goddesses who restrain Baal from striking Yamm's messengers and intervenes at the moment of Yamm's defeat.

Relevance. Athtart appears alongside 𐎲Anat as one of the active warrior-goddesses of the assembly, though her role is much smaller than 𐎲Anat's; Smith treats her intervention at the moment of Yamm's defeat as one of the tablet's interpretive cruxes.^[42]

A.1.16. Baal

Ugaritic storm-god (Ugaritic Baʿlu / Haddu), son of Dagan, combat-champion of the Baal Cycle, and the god whom Yahweh polemically replaces in the Hebrew Bible.^[43]

Physical description. No full-figure physical description survives in the in-scope sources. KTU 1.4 vii reports that Baal's voice — the storm-god's thunder — sounds through the window of his palace on ʿapānu after the window is opened, an audible rather than visual mark of the figure.^[44]

Appears in:

- *Baal vs. Yamm and Lôtan* — refuses Yamm's demand for his hand-over, fights Yamm with the named maces Yagrush and Ayyamur forged by Kothar-wa-Khasis, takes the kingship that El had initially conferred on Yamm, and (in Mot's retrospective taunt at KTU 1.5 i) is named as having defeated Lôtan.
- *Yahweh vs. Leviathan and Rahab* — the figure whose storm-and-sea combat the Hebrew Bible polemically transfers to Yahweh.
- *C2. Combat as Sovereignty* — load-bearing case for the rival-sovereignty reading of the wider combat-myth corpus.
- *C6. The Near Eastern → Mediterranean Transmission* — the Ugaritic input to the Phoenician-mediated transmission of the storm-god-vs-sea pattern into early Greek poetry.

Relevance. Baal is the load-bearing test case for Ballentine's rival-sovereignty reading of the combat-myth corpus.^[45] The Ugaritic Cycle's framing of his combats as divine-court politics — sovereignty granted, refused, transferred — supplies the interpretive grammar within which the related Hebrew, Greek, and Mesopotamian materials can be read.^[46]

A.1.17. Bau

Sumerian healing-goddess invoked alongside An in the closing prayer of *Lugal-e*.^[47]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — invoked at the close of the poem in the prayer for the worshipper who maintains Ninurta's cult.

Relevance. Bau's appearance in *Lugal-e* is liturgical rather than narrative; she is paired with An in the closing benediction.^[48]

A.1.18. Bēlet-ilī

Akkadian "mother of the gods" (also Mami), named in the *Anzû Epic* as Ninurta's mother.^[49]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Anzû* — addressed by Ea on Anu's behalf, summons her son Ninurta, arms him, and

dispatches him against Anzû.

Relevance. Bēlet-ilī is the maternal commissioning figure of the *Anzû Epic*, the conduit between the divine assembly's call for a champion and the warrior-son who will answer it.^[50]

A.1.19. Birdu

Messenger-god in the *Anzû Epic*, dispatched after the slaying to announce Ninurta's victory to Enlil.^[51]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Anzû* — enters Enlil's presence to announce Ninurta's recovery of the Tablet of Destinies.

Relevance. Birdu is a minor figure, named only as the messenger of Ninurta's victory.^[52]

A.1.20. Coatlicue

Mexica earth-goddess ("She-of-the-Serpent-Skirt"), mother of Huitzilopochtli, Coyolxauhqui, and the Centzon Huitznahua, who conceives Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec from a ball of feathers descending from the sky.^[53]

Physical description. The great Coatlicue statue in the Museo Nacional de Antropología in Mexico City — an Aztec-period andesite sculpture approximately 2.52 metres tall — depicts the goddess with a skirt of intertwined serpents, a necklace of human hands and hearts, two outward-facing serpent-heads as her own face (formed where her decapitated head would otherwise be), and clawed feet.^[54]

Appears in:

- *Huitzilopochtli, Coyolxauhqui, and Coatepec* — sweeping at Coatepec, conceives Huitzilopochtli through the descending feather-ball; afraid as Coyolxauhqui and the Centzon Huitznahua approach, she is reassured by the unborn god's voice from within her womb.

Relevance. Coatlicue is the maternal pole of the Coatepec narrative; the Aztec andesite statue and the *Florentine Codex* Book 3 narrative are independently witnessing presentations of the same earth-and-death-and-fertility goddess at the centre of the Mexica state cult.^[55]

A.1.21. Coyolxauhqui

Mexica moon-goddess ("Bells-on-Her-Cheeks"), Coatlicue's daughter, leader of the Centzon Huitznahua's plot against their mother, dismembered by Huitzilopochtli at Coatepec.^[56]

Physical description. The Coyolxauhqui Stone, a circular Aztec andesite monolith excavated at the foot of the southern staircase of the Templo Mayor in 1978, depicts the dismembered moon-goddess at the base of Coatepec — head severed, arms and legs disarticulated and arranged radially around her nude torso.^[57]

Appears in:

- *Huitzilopochtli, Coyolxauhqui, and Coatepec* — leads the conspiracy of the Centzon Huitznahua against Coatlicue and is decapitated and dismembered by the newly born Huitzilopochtli, her body rolled down the slopes of Coatepec.
- *C1. Combat as Cosmogony* — the defeated lunar pole of the cosmogonic combat through which the proper celestial order is established.

Relevance. Coyolxauhqui's dismembered figure is the load-bearing iconographic moment of the Mexica state-cult: the Coyolxauhqui Stone at the foot of the Templo Mayor's southern staircase is the architectural-iconographic re-enactment of the killing at the precise location where the narrative-moment occurs in the architecture.^[58]

A.1.22. Damkina

Akkadian goddess, consort of Ea and mother of Marduk in *Enūma Eliš*.^[59]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — gives birth to Marduk in the Apsû.

Relevance. Damkina supplies the maternal half of Marduk's pedigree; her role is genealogical rather than narratively active.^[60]

A.1.23. Di Jun

High god of the early-Chinese textual tradition, father of the ten suns and commissioner of Hou Yi to address the suns-crisis.^[61]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Hou Yi and the Suns* — sends Hou Yi down from the heavens to deal with a crisis caused by his own children, the ten suns.

Relevance. Di Jun's commission of Hou Yi places the archer-hero's authority for the killing in the heavens rather than in the human sage-king alone.^[62]

A.1.24. Ea

Akkadian god of wisdom and the deep fresh waters of the Apsû (Sumerian Enki), counsellor to the assembly and to the warrior-champion across the Mesopotamian and Hurro-Hittite combat corpora.^[63]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — kills Apsû with an incantation, fathers Marduk in the Apsû with Damkina, fails as the assembly's first champion against Tiamat, nominates his son, and at Marduk's behest opens Qingu's blood for the creation of humans.
- *Ninurta vs. Anzû* — proposes Ninurta as champion after the threefold refusal, devises the pinion-feather strategy that defeats Anzû, and is the addressee of Šarur's report from the battlefield.
- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — present in the Sumerian narrative under the name Enki as god of wisdom, though not narratively active.
- *The Kumarbi Cycle* — counsel to Teshub when storm-weapons fail against Ullikummi, identifying the primordial copper cutter as the implement that will sever the stone-monster from his anchorage on Upelluri.

Relevance. Ea is one of the most cross-textually consistent figures of the Mesopotamian and Hurro-Hittite combat corpora, the wisdom-counsellor whose recurring function is to identify the technical or theological move the storm-god alone cannot.^[64] His Sumerian counterpart Enki occupies the same structural position in *Lugal-e* at one remove.^[65]

A.1.25. El

Chief Ugaritic god, patriarchal head of the divine assembly, whose residence is described in the Baal Cycle as situated at the Source of the Two Rivers.^[66]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Baal vs. Yamm and Lôtan* — initially confers the kingship on Yamm in KTU 1.1, and after Athirat's intercession in KTU 1.4 iv–v authorises the construction of Baal's palace on 𐎧apānu.

Relevance. El is the presiding office of the Ugaritic divine assembly, the figure who distributes the kingship that Baal and Yamm contest.^[67] Ballentine's rival-sovereignty reading turns on El's initial confirmation of Yamm's kingship — a textual fact that is incompatible with reading Yamm as inchoate chaos.^[68]

A.1.26. Enki

Sumerian god of wisdom and fresh water, counsellor of the gods in the Sumerian corpus; the language-context counterpart of Akkadian Ea.^[69]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — present as a senior Sumerian deity in the background of the narrative, though not narratively active in *Lugal-e*.

Relevance. Enki is the Sumerian standing of the wisdom-god, recognisable in the later Akkadian compositions under the name Ea.^[70]

A.1.27. Enlil

Chief god of the Sumerian and Akkadian pantheon, lord of air and command, resident of the E-kur at Nippur, father of Ninurta and original holder of the Tablet of Destinies.^[71]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — receives Šarur's intercession at the E-kur, issues the conditional charge that Ninurta may slay Asag provided fertility is preserved, and at the close confers a threefold blessing of eternal life, celestial mace, and unchanging rule.
- *Ninurta vs. Anzû* — the custodian of the Tablet of Destinies who is dispossessed by Anzû's theft.
- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — older head of the pantheon, whose number fifty Anu confers on Marduk at the close of the epic, completing the displacement.

Relevance. Enlil is the standing chief god of the older Mesopotamian pantheon, the office that the Anzû and Marduk narratives pass through and that *Enūma Eliš* ultimately transfers to Marduk via the bestowal of his number.^[72] In *Lugal-e* his lament to Ninlil at the crisis-point of the combat — "My son is no longer here; what supports me?" — is one of the most psychologically candid passages in the Sumerian corpus.^[73]

A.1.28. Gaia

Greek primordial earth-goddess of Hesiod's *Theogony*, mother of Ouranos and grandmother of the second-generation gods, who conceives Typhon by Tartarus.^[74]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Zeus vs. Typhon* — the primordial earth-mother who conceives Typhon as her last and youngest child by Tartarus.

Relevance. Gaia is the structural pivot of the *Theogony*'s succession sequence: she supplies Kronos with the adamantine sickle and conceives Typhon as the final challenge to Zeus's settled rule.^[75]

A.1.29. Gerra

Akkadian fire-god, summoned by Anu in the *Anzû Epic* as the second of three failed champions.^[76]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Anzû* — second figure summoned by Anu; refuses on the same grounds as Adad.

Relevance. Gerra is the second element of the threefold-refusal pattern in the *Anzû Epic*.^[77]

A.1.30. Gonggong

Chinese water-god whose combat with the sky-emperor Zhuanxu, lost, leads him to smash his head against Mount Buzhou and break the sky-pillar, tilting the cosmos.^[78]

Physical description. In the Huainanzi and adjacent Han-era compilations Gonggong is conventionally described as red-haired and serpent-bodied.^[79]

Appears in:

- *Gonggong and the Broken Pillar* — fights and loses to Zhuanxu (or Zhurong in some variants), breaks Mount Buzhou with his head, tilts the cosmos northwest, and so accounts for the courses of the rivers and the configuration of sky and earth.
- *C1. Combat as Cosmogony* — one of the four strongest independent cosmogonic-combat cases.

Relevance. Gonggong is the standing East Asian cosmogonic-combat figure: his defeat is a cosmogonic act that explains specific observable features of the world (the eastward flow of the rivers, the slope of the heavens), and the post-combat repair of the sky by Nüwa completes the cosmogonic sequence.^[80]

A.1.31. Haddu

The Ugaritic personal-name form of the storm-god Baal (bn dgn), used alongside Baʿlu in the Baal Cycle.^[81]

Physical description. See Baal entry — no full-figure physical description survives.

Appears in:

- *Baal vs. Yamm and Lôtan* — alternative name for Baal in the Cycle's tablet text.

Relevance. The Haddu name marks Baal as a regional reflex of the wider Northwest Semitic storm-god type whose name appears as Hadad in later Aramaic and Akkadian witnesses.^[82]

A.1.32. Hedammu

Sea-monster progeny of Kumarbi by Šertapšuruḫi the daughter of the sea-god, in the fragmentary Hurro-Hittite Song of Hedammu.^[83]

Physical description. The fragments preserve the figure as a sea-monster of voracious appetite who threatens to depopulate the seas and lands by his consumption.^[84] No further morphological description is preserved.

Appears in:

- *The Kumarbi Cycle* — second adversary generated by Kumarbi against Teshub, seduced by Šauška into incapacitation in the surviving fragments; the combat-resolution is not preserved.

Relevance. Hedammu is the cycle's exhibit for the seduction-method of monster-disabling, distinct from the storm-and-cutter combat of Ullikummi.^[85] His fragmentary preservation makes him a paradigmatic case of the cycle's differential survival.

A.1.33. Hermes

Olympian messenger-god who, with Aigipan, recovers Zeus's severed sinews from the dragoness Delphyne in Apollodorus's expansion of the Typhonomachy.^[86]

Physical description. No physical description bearing on the in-scope discussion of the Typhon material survives in the chapter's treatment.

Appears in:

- *Zeus vs. Typhon* — with Aigipan, sneaks into the Corycian cave, deceives Delphyne, and steals back Zeus's severed sinews from the bear-skin in which they had been hidden.

Relevance. The Hermes-and-Aigipan recovery operation is the Apollodoran expansion's principal point at which the Greek combat-narrative shows a structural feature with a Hurro-Hittite parallel — the Elkunirsa myth's recovery of the storm-god's organs.^[87]

A.1.34. Horus

Egyptian falcon-headed god, son of Isis and Osiris, the figure who opposes and eventually succeeds Seth in the Contendings.^[88]

Physical description. Horus is iconographically the falcon-headed god in the Egyptian visual record, the falcon being his standing animal-form across the funerary and temple corpora.^[89]

Appears in:

- *Horus vs. Seth (an edge case)* — opposes Seth across the Pyramid Texts and Coffin Texts attestations and in the bawdy Chester Beatty I papyrus *Contendings of Horus and Seth*, eventually inheriting the kingship of Osiris.

Relevance. The Horus-Seth dispute is the principal Egyptian sovereignty contest, distinct from the Ra-Apep cyclical-maintenance combat; current scholarship is split on whether the dispute fits the chaoskampf typology at all.^[90]

A.1.35. Huitzilopochtli

Mexica patron god ("Hummingbird-of-the-South"), sun-warrior born fully armed at Coatepec, son of Coatlicue, slayer of his sister Coyolxauhqui and of his four hundred brothers the Centzon Huitznahua.^[91]

Physical description. The *Florentine Codex* Book 3 narrative describes Huitzilopochtli as emerging from Coatlicue's womb fully grown, fully armed, painted, and dressed in feathered war-regalia at the moment of his birth.^[92] His weapon is the **xiuhcōātl** turquoise-serpent, which appears in Mexica iconographic art as a serpent-shaped firebrand or fire-spear with a recurved snout.^[93]

Appears in:

- *Huitzilopochtli, Coyolxauhqui, and Coatepec* — born fully armed at Coatepec, kills Coyolxauhqui with the **xiuhcōātl** and dismembers her body, pursues and kills the Centzon Huitznahua.

- *C1. Combat as Cosmogony* — one of the four strongest independent cosmogonic-combat cases, distinguished by the architectural-embedded character of the Templo Mayor as Coatepec.

Relevance. Huitzilopochtli is the patron deity of the Mexica state, and the Coatepec combat is the founding combat of the polity: the Templo Mayor at the centre of Tenochtitlan was built as Coatepec, the architecture itself being the primary statement of the combat-cosmogony.^[94] The Mexica military expansion and human-sacrifice practice are read by Carrasco as the perpetual prosecution of the Coatepec combat at the political-ritual scale.^[95]

A.1.36. Inara

Daughter of the Hittite storm-god Tarḫunna and ritual actor in Version 1 of the Illuyanka myth.^[96]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources, beyond the narrative datum that she dresses in finery to summon the serpent to the banquet.^[97]

Appears in:

- *Tarḫunna vs. Illuyanka* — devises the banquet-trap, recruits Hupasiya, summons Illuyanka and his offspring to the banquet, and after the killing installs Hupasiya in a cliff-house with a prohibition against looking on his family.

Relevance. Inara is the divine strategist of Version 1 of the Illuyanka myth, the figure whose plan makes the storm-god's killing possible.^[98]

A.1.37. Indra

Vedic storm-god, chief of the Rigvedic gods, wielder of the **vajra**, slayer of Vṛtra in RV 1.32 and across the wider Indra-cycle.^[99]

Physical description. No full-figure physical description survives in the in-scope sources; Indra is named as the **vajra**-wielder and the soma-drinker, with the iconographic image of the storm-and-thunderbolt rather than a body-description.^[100]

Appears in:

- *Indra vs. Vṛtra* — kills Vṛtra with the Tvaṣṭri-forged **vajra** in RV 1.32 and across the seven supplementary hymns, splitting the mountain, releasing the seven rivers, separating heaven and earth, and producing dawn.
- *Vedic and post-Vedic reflexes* — co-witness alongside Trita Āptya in RV 1.105 and 2.11.19–20 in the joint-combat passages that the philological tradition reads as residue of the pre-Indra Trita stratum.
- *C2. Combat as Sovereignty* — load-bearing case for the sovereignty subtype.
- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — anchor case for Watkins's reconstruction of the formula.

Relevance. Indra is the most frequently invoked deity in the Rigvedic corpus, addressed in roughly a quarter of the more than a thousand hymns.^[101] The áhann áhim formula at RV 1.32.1–2 is the philological anchor of Watkins's reconstructed Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT line.^[102]

A.1.38. Isis

Egyptian magic-working goddess, wife of Osiris, mother of Horus, who binds Apep with spells in the combat-corpus and defends her son in the Contendings.^[103]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ra vs. Apep* — named as one of the deities whose magical-protective utterance defends Ra against Apep nightly.
- *Horus vs. Seth* — mother of Horus and one of the principal divine actors of the Contendings.

Relevance. Isis is the standing magic-working goddess of the Egyptian pantheon, recurrent across the Apep, Osiris, and Horus material; her bindings of Apep are part of the apotropaic register of the funerary corpus.^[104]

A.1.39. Iyangura

Nyanga river-spirit, paternal aunt of Mwindo, who shelters and aids the hero across the Mwindo Epic.^[105]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Mwindo and Kiriimu* — Mwindo's protective aunt and river-spirit, one of the principal helping figures of the epic.

Relevance. Iyangura supplies the river-realm pole of the Nyanga layered cosmography (alongside Nkuba's sky-realm and Muisa's underworld), and her relationship to Mwindo is one of the epic's principal ethical anchors.^[106]

A.1.40. Jǫrð

Norse giantess, "Earth," mother of Thor by Óðinn.^[107]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Thor vs. Jǫrmungandr* — Thor's mother in Snorri's genealogical apparatus.

Relevance. Jǫrð is named as Thor's mother but is not narratively active; her role in the surviving record is genealogical.^[108]

A.1.41. Jǫrmungandr

Norse world-encircling serpent (Old Norse Miðgarðsormr, "the Midgard Serpent"), son of Loki and the giantess Angrboða, slain by and slaying Thor at Ragnarøk.^[109]

Physical description. In *Gylfaginning* ch. 34 Snorri describes Jormungandr as so large that, thrown into the ocean by Óðinn, he grew there until he encircled the entire world and bit his own tail.^[110] At *Gylfaginning* ch. 47 the serpent is hooked on Thor's fishing line; at ch. 51 he meets Thor at Ragnarøk and is killed by Mjöllnir, but spits venom over Thor, who falls dead nine paces away.

Appears in:

- *Thor vs. Jormungandr* — appears three times: lifted in cat-disguise in Útgarðaloki's hall (*Gylfaginning* 46–48), hooked on the fishing-line of Thor and Hymir (*Hymiskviða* and *Gylfaginning* 47, with the *Húsdrápa* fragments in *Skáldskaparmál*), and killed at Ragnarøk in mutual combat with Thor (*Völuspá* 56 and *Gylfaginning* 51).
- *C4. Eschatological Displacement* — type-case of the eschatological subtype, alongside the Red Dragon of Revelation 12 and Aži Dahāka at Frashokereti.

Relevance. Jormungandr is the most iconographically densely attested Norse adversary, depicted on at least four pre-Christian runestones and picture-stones (Altuna, Hørdum, Gosforth, Ardre VIII) two to five centuries before the surviving Eddic and Snorra Edda manuscripts.^[111] The serpent's cosmic-boundary position — biting his own tail in the world-ocean — makes Thor's combat with him structurally a combat at the boundary of the human world.

A.1.42. Kaka

Vizier of Anšar in *Enūma Eliš*, dispatched in Tablet III to summon Lahmu and Lahamu to the assembly.^[112]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — Anšar's vizier, who delivers the third major restatement of the army-list and the diplomatic situation to the eldest gods.

Relevance. Kaka's mission is the structural device by which the senior figures of the first divine generation are brought into the assembly that names Marduk; his speech is the third major repetition of the catalogue of monsters in *Enūma Eliš*.^[113]

A.1.43. Kothar-wa-Khasis

Ugaritic craftsman-god ("skilful-and-clever"), the divine smith and architect of the Baal Cycle.^[114]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Baal vs. Yamm and Lôtan* — forges the named maces Yagrush ("Driver") and Ayyamur ("Chaser") for Baal's combat with Yamm in KTU 1.2 iv, builds the cedar-and-silver palace on ʿapānu in KTU 1.4 v–vi, and disputes with Baal over whether the palace should have a window.

Relevance. Kothar's hands are at both ends of Baal's elevation: the maces of the Yamm-combat and the palace of the post-combat enthronement come from the same forge, marking the craftsman-god

as the structural mediator of the kingship.^[115]

A.1.44. Kumarbi

Hurrian father-god, third sovereign in the Kingship in Heaven succession, who deposes Anu by biting off his genitals and is in turn deposed by his offspring Teshub; generates the monstrous adversaries of the Kumarbi Cycle.^[116]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *The Kumarbi Cycle* — bites off Anu's genitals and is impregnated with Teshub and other offspring, gives birth to Teshub, is deposed, and in revenge generates Ullikummi (by ejaculating onto a great rock), Hedammu (by mating with Šertapšuruḫi), and the adversary of the Song of the Sea.
- *C6. The Near Eastern → Mediterranean Transmission* — the figure whose castration of Anu is the principal documented antecedent of Hesiod's Kronos castrating Ouranos.

Relevance. Kumarbi is the central figure of the Hurro-Hittite theogonic-and-combat cycle that supplies the most extensive documented Near-Eastern-to-Greek transmission case for combat-myth material.^[117]

A.1.45. Lahmu and Lahamu

Paired male-female deities of the first generation in *Enūma Eliš*, born from the mingling of Apsû and Tiamat; summoned to the assembly in Tablet III.^[118]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources beyond the narrative datum that on hearing Kaka's report they gnash their teeth in distress.^[119]

Appears in:

- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — first generation born from Apsû and Tiamat; summoned by Anšar's vizier Kaka to the assembly that ratifies Marduk's elevation.

Relevance. Lahmu and Lahamu are the eldest gods of the divine genealogy in *Enūma Eliš*; their distress at Kaka's report authorises the formal gathering at which Marduk is named.^[120]

A.1.46. Loki

Norse trickster god, sometimes counted among the Æsir and sometimes treated as a giant, father by the giantess Angrboða of Jǫrmungandr, the wolf Fenrir, and the goddess Hel.^[121]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources for Loki himself; the entry is genealogical for the Thor-Jǫrmungandr corpus.

Appears in:

- *Thor vs. Jǫrmungandr* — generative figure: father of Jǫrmungandr in the lineage-narrative of

Relevance. Loki's parentage of Jǫrmungandr connects the Thor-Jǫrmungandr combat to the wider Norse trickster-and-giants axis, with the three monstrous offspring (Jǫrmungandr, Fenrir, Hel) all dispatched by Óðinn to their cosmic stations as preventative measures whose deferred consequences erupt at Ragnarøk.^[122]

A.1.47. Marduk

Patron god of Babylon, son of Ea and Damkina; storm-god champion who slays Tiamat, builds the cosmos from her body, and is acclaimed king of the gods in *Enūma Eliš*.^[123]

Physical description. *Enūma Eliš* Tablet I describes Marduk at his birth as having four eyes and four ears, of surpassing physical proportions, and as radiant from birth — a catalogue of features marking him as outside the ordinary divine type.^[124] The catalogue is brief and the rest of the figure is not described.

Appears in:

- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — born in the Apsû with four eyes and four ears, plays with the four winds Anu has fashioned for him, accepts the assembly's commission on condition that his decree be supreme, drives the Imhullu wind into Tiamat's open mouth, splits her with an arrow, builds the cosmos from her body, founds Babylon and Esagil, receives the fifty names.
- *Minor Mesopotamian Combats* — proposed in older scholarship as a structural-parallel candidate for the unnamed slayer of Labbu in the fragmentary "Lion-Serpent" tablet, where the manuscript breaks at the divine name.
- *C1. Combat as Cosmogony* — the type-specimen of the cosmogonic subtype in Gunkel's 1895 Chaoskampf reading.

Relevance. Marduk is the figure on which Hermann Gunkel's 1895 Chaoskampf hypothesis was built: the cosmos made from Tiamat's split body is the cosmogonic combat in the strong sense, and the akītu festival's fourth-day recitation of *Enūma Eliš* before Marduk's cult-image in Esagil ties the text to the lived political-religious life of Babylon.^[125] Annus's argument that *Enūma Eliš* rewrites the older *Anzû Epic* makes Marduk the literary heir of Ninurta.^[126]

A.1.48. Mehen

Egyptian serpent-coil deity who encircles and protects Ra in the solar barque.^[127]

Physical description. Mehen is a serpent-coil — the figure's morphological identity is its function, encircling the sun-god in the barque.^[128]

Appears in:

- *Ra vs. Apep* — protective serpent-coil around Ra during the nightly journey through the **Duat**.

Relevance. Mehen is the protective counterpart to the adversarial Apep within the same serpent-morphology, supplying the Egyptian record with both apotropaic and combative serpents in close iconographic proximity.^[129]

A.1.49. Michael

Archangel-warrior of Daniel and the Apocalypse, who leads the heavenly host against the Red Dragon in Revelation 12:7–9.^[130]

Physical description. No physical description of Michael survives in the in-scope sources.^[131] The militarised warrior-angel iconography (armoured, helmeted, holding a spear or sword, trampling or piercing the dragon underfoot) is medieval reception, not in-scope primary description.^[132]

Appears in:

- *Michael vs. the Red Dragon* — leads the heavenly host against the dragon at Rev 12:7–9 and casts him down to the earth.
- *St. George, St. Michael, and the Christian Reception* — central node of the late-antique-to-medieval Michaelic cult and dragon-trampling iconography.

Relevance. Michael is the principal archangelic warrior-figure of the New Testament combat-tradition, drawing on the Daniel-and-Qumran Second Temple substrate and supplying the figure on which the late-antique and medieval Michaelic cult develops.^[133]

A.1.50. Mot

"Death," Ugaritic god of death, Baal's adversary in the second half of the Baal Cycle on tablets KTU 1.5–1.6.^[134]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Baal vs. Yamm and Lôtan* — confronts Baal in the death-and-revival cycle of KTU 1.5–1.6, and at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 delivers the retrospective taunt-speech that names Lôtan.

Relevance. Mot is the second-half adversary of the Baal Cycle, distinct from Yamm and serpentine in neither morphology nor function; the chapter treats his confrontation with Baal as cosmic-political rather than chaoskampf in the strict sense.^[135] His taunt at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 is the principal preserved Cycle-reference to Lôtan.

A.1.51. Muisa

Nyanga underworld-lord whose realm Mwindo visits in the journey-sequence of the Mwindo Epic.^[136]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Mwindo and Kirimu* — underworld-lord of the Nyanga cosmography, whose realm forms one of the layers Mwindo traverses in the wider epic.

Relevance. Muisa is the chthonic counterpart to Nkuba in the Nyanga layered cosmography, whose realm Mwindo visits in the epic's journey-sequence.^[137]

A.1.52. Mummu

Vizier of Apsû in *Enûma Eliš*, who encourages Apsû's plan to destroy the younger gods and is captured by Ea.^[138]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources, beyond the narrative gesture of the leashed vizier: Ea binds Mummu and takes his nose-rope as a leash.^[139]

Appears in:

- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — Apsû's vizier at the council that resolves to destroy the younger gods, captured and leashed by Ea.

Relevance. Mummu's role is bureaucratic — the vizier who ratifies and amplifies Apsû's decision rather than initiating it — and his humiliating capture by Ea is the structural rehearsal for the wider defeat of the older generation.^[140]

A.1.53. Ninūrsaĝa

Sumerian senior mother-goddess, "Lady of the Mountain," whose new name and cultic profile are conferred upon her by Ninurta after the combat with Asag.^[141]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — enters the narrative as Ninma lamenting the inaccessibility of the mountains; is renamed Ninūrsaĝa by Ninurta and given the stone-heap of the defeated Asag as her mountain, endowed with herbs, honey, metals, and wildlife.

Relevance. The renaming of the mother-goddess as Ninūrsaĝa is one of *Lugal-e*'s major pieces of cosmogonic work after the combat: a senior goddess receives a new title and a new portfolio, and a new geographical feature (the ūrsaĝ-mountain) is established under her authority.^[142]

A.1.54. Ninlil

Sumerian goddess, consort of Enlil, addressed in his lament at the crisis of the Asag combat.^[143]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — addressed by Enlil in the lament "My son is no longer here; what supports me?" at the crisis of the combat.

Relevance. Ninlil's appearance in *Lugal-e* is structural — she is the addressee of Enlil's lament, the gesture that sets up Šarur's intercessory errand back to the E-kur.^[144]

A.1.55. Ninurta

Sumerian and Akkadian warrior-god, son of Enlil, lord of Nippur; champion against Asag in *Lugal-e*

and against Anzû in the *Anzû Epic*.^[145]

Physical description. No physical description of Ninurta's body survives in the in-scope sources. The opening of *Lugal-e* describes his approach to the **kur** attended by storm-imagery — clouds rising around him, lightning accompanying him, the eight winds walking with him — but this is environmental rather than figural description.^[146]

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — kills Asag in the **kur**, dams the mountain-waters with the defeated army's stones to form the Tigris, renames the stone-heap as Mountain (𒌦**ursag**), judges the stones in the long lapidary aetiology, returns to Nippur, and receives Enlil's threefold blessing.
- *Ninurta vs. Anzû* — commissioned by Bēlet-ilī after Ea's nomination, fails his first attack on Anzû when his arrow is annulled by the Tablet of Destinies, and on Ea's counsel plucks the pinion-feathers and slays the rebel, recovering the Tablet.
- *C1. Combat as Cosmogony* — one of the four strongest independent cosmogonic-combat cases.
- *C2. Combat as Sovereignty* — the Anzû-combat as a sovereignty-restoration case.

Relevance. Ninurta is the prototype warrior-champion of the Mesopotamian combat corpus, a figure whose two long compositions stand at the head of the literary genealogy that runs through the *Anzû Epic* to *Enūma Eliš*.^[147] Annus's argument that Marduk's combat is a deliberate rewriting of Ninurta's gives the Sumerian and Akkadian Ninurta material a load-bearing position in the development of the Babylonian cosmogony.^[148]

A.1.56. Nisaba

Sumerian wise goddess of grain, granaries, scribes, and records, appointed by Ninurta as guardian of agricultural order at the close of *Lugal-e*.^[149]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — receives from Ninurta the portfolio of the granaries and of agricultural-administrative order at the close of the poem.

Relevance. Nisaba's appointment ties *Lugal-e*'s cosmogonic-combat outcome directly into the scribal-administrative life of Sumer: the poem ends not with military victory but with the goddess of bureaucracy receiving her portfolio.^[150]

A.1.57. Nkuba

Nyanga sky-god and lightning-bringer, who strikes Mwindo down with lightning at the killing of Kirimu and takes him up to the celestial realm for instruction.^[151]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Mwindo and Kiriimu* — strikes Mwindo with lightning after the dragon-killing, takes him up to the sky for the celestial humiliation, and instructs the hero in the limits of his power before returning him chastened to the human world.

Relevance. Nkuba is the sky-god whose intervention inverts the moral valence of the dragon-slaying: the killing of Kiriimu is treated as a transgression that the sky-god punishes, not as a victory to be celebrated.^[152] The episode is the load-bearing exhibit of the Nyanga oral tradition's contrastive framing of the dragon-combat pattern.

A.1.58. Nüwa

Chinese serpent-tailed creator-goddess, who repairs the broken sky with five-coloured stones after Gonggong's combat with Zhuanxu.^[153]

Physical description. Nüwa is conventionally represented in the early Chinese sources as serpent-tailed (often with her brother Fuxi, also serpent-tailed, in iconographic pairs), the half-human, half-serpent body being her standing iconographic identity.^[154]

Appears in:

- *Gonggong and the Broken Pillar* — repairs the sky with five-coloured stones after Gonggong's head-strike on Mount Buzhou breaks the sky-pillar.

Relevance. Nüwa's sky-repair completes the cosmogonic sequence inaugurated by Gonggong's combat: the cosmos that Gonggong tilted is patched but not fully restored, and the post-combat configuration of heaven and earth remains permanently asymmetrical.^[155]

A.1.59. Óðinn

Norse chief of the Æsir, father of Thor, ruler of Valhøll, patron of poetry and war.^[156]

Physical description. No physical description of Óðinn survives that bears on the Thor-Jörmungandr corpus per the chapter's discussion.

Appears in:

- *Thor vs. Jörmungandr* — dispatches Loki's three monstrous offspring (Jörmungandr, Fenrir, Hel) to their three cosmic stations, throwing Jörmungandr into the world-ocean where the serpent grows to encircle Midgard.

Relevance. Óðinn is the chief of the Æsir under whose cosmic-rulership Thor's defensive function is exercised; his role in the Jörmungandr corpus is the original dispatching that places the serpent in the position from which the eventual Ragnarøk combat is mounted.^[157]

A.1.60. Osiris

Egyptian god of the dead, husband of Isis, father of Horus, murdered by his brother Seth in the Osiris cycle background to the Contendings.^[158]

Physical description. No physical description directly relevant to the chaoskampf-pertinent

material survives in the in-scope sources of this book.

Appears in:

- *Horus vs. Seth* — the murdered brother whose contested kingship grounds the Horus-Seth dispute.

Relevance. Osiris is the pivot of the Egyptian sovereignty narrative that the Horus-Seth dispute prosecutes; his murder by Seth is the precipitating event of the Contendings.^[159]

A.1.61. Pariacaca

Andean storm-**wak'a** of the Huarochirí region, born as five falcon-eggs on Mount Condorcoto, who defeats the rival **wak'a** Huallallo Carhuincho in a five-day storm-and-flood combat.^[160]

Physical description. The Huarochirí Manuscript narrates Pariacaca's birth as a clutch of five eggs on Mount Condorcoto that hatch into five falcons, which then transform into five anthropomorphic figures.^[161] The manuscript varies between presenting the five as the five Pariacacas, as Pariacaca and his four brothers, or as Pariacaca and his sons, with the five-fold person-multiplicity persisting through the cycle as a load-bearing feature of the figure's identity. Pariacaca is also identified with the eponymous Pariacaca mountain peak in the Yauyos region.^[162]

Appears in:

- *Pariacaca and the amaru* — born as five falcon-eggs on Mount Condorcoto, defeats Huallallo Carhuincho in a five-day rain-and-fire combat with the five Pariacacas releasing rain, hail, and lightning from five directions; takes possession of the mountain bearing his name and reorganises the Huarochirí region's **wak'a**-cosmography.

Relevance. Pariacaca is the principal **wak'a** of the Huarochirí Manuscript and supplies the central narrative arc of the c. 1608 Quechua-language compilation.^[163] The cycle is read by current Andean specialists as **wak'a**-succession rather than chaos-vs-order, with the displacement-rather-than-killing of Huallallo distinguishing the cycle from the kill-the-adversary pattern of Eurasian chaoskampf.^[164]

A.1.62. Perun

Slavic storm-god, in Ivanov and Toporov's contested 1965–74 reconstruction the pursuer of Veles in the so-called "basic myth."^[165]

Physical description. No physical description survives in in-scope primary sources; the figure is reconstructed from later folklore and toponymic evidence rather than from a continuously preserved combat-narrative.^[166]

Appears in:

- *Slavic and Baltic combat* — the storm-god of the Ivanov-Toporov "basic myth" reconstruction, whose Slavic combat-narrative survives only as a late-folkloric and toponymic reflex contested by Jakobson, Lajoye, and others.

Relevance. Perun is the Slavic standing storm-god, but the pursuit-of-Veles reading is methodologically contested in current scholarship: the reconstruction depends on circular reading of folklore and toponymy, and the chapter handles the basic-myth thesis with explicit caution.^[167]

A.1.63. Quetzalcoatl

Mesoamerican "Feathered Serpent," creator-deity who alternates with Tezcatlipoca across the Suns cycle and dismembers the primordial earth-monster Cipactli with Tezcatlipoca to form sky and earth.^[168]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources beyond the iconographic identity encoded in the name itself: Quetzalcoatl is the Feathered Serpent, the figure's morphological identity given in his name.^[169]

Appears in:

- *Other Mesoamerican Combats* — alternates with Tezcatlipoca across the Five Suns cycle, and with Tezcatlipoca tears Cipactli apart to form sky and earth.

Relevance. Quetzalcoatl is one of the Mesoamerican standing creator-deities, and his alternation with Tezcatlipoca across the Five Suns supplies the wider Mesoamerican framework within which Huitzilopochtli's Coatepec combat is itself one episode.^[170]

A.1.64. Ra

Egyptian sun-god, who traverses the sky by day and the **Duat** by night in his solar barque, fighting Apep nightly in the seventh hour of the Amduat and at the fourth gate of the Book of Gates.^[171]

Physical description. No full-figure physical description of Ra survives in the chapter's in-scope textual record. Ra is named throughout as the figure in the solar barque, with the barque's two halves — **manet** by day, **mesektet** by night — being the standing identification rather than a body-description.^[172]

Appears in:

- *Ra vs. Apep* — sun-god whose nightly combat with Apep in the **Duat** is the type-case of the cyclical-maintenance subtype, attested across the Pyramid Texts, Coffin Texts, Book of the Dead, Amduat, Book of Gates, and the Bremner-Rhind Papyrus.
- *C3. Cyclical Maintenance* — alongside Tarūnna against Illuyanka, the principal exhibit of the cyclical-maintenance subtype.

Relevance. Ra is the standing sun-god of the Egyptian funerary-and-solar corpora, the figure whose nightly defeat of Apep makes the morning's sunrise contingent on a daily ritual victory.^[173] The text's wager — that without Ra's victory the sun does not rise — distinguishes Egyptian solar theology from a deterministic celestial mechanics.

A.1.65. Rahab

Hebrew "proud one," monstrous figure of Hebrew Bible poetry (Psalm 89; Isaiah 51; Job 26),

associated with the sea and — in Isaiah 51 — with Egypt; distinct from the Rahab of Jericho.^[174]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources beyond the imagery of Yahweh's combat-actions against her (cutting in pieces, crushing, piercing).^[175]

Appears in:

- *Yahweh vs. Leviathan and Rahab* — adversary in the Psalm 89 victory-hymn, in Isaiah 51's exodus-recall (where Rahab is paired with Egypt), and in Job 26's brief allusion.

Relevance. Rahab is, alongside Leviathan, one of the two named adversaries of the Hebrew Bible combat-corpus. Day reads the Rahab references as inheriting Ugaritic sea-and-serpent imagery; Ballentine reads them as rival-sovereign references.^[176]

A.1.66. Šara

Akkadian warrior-god, son of Inanna, summoned by Anu in the *Anzû Epic* as one of the three failed champions before Ninurta is named.^[177]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Anzû* — third figure summoned by Anu (after Adad and Gerra) to fight Anzû; like the others, he refuses on the grounds that the Tablet of Destinies makes the rebel unassailable.

Relevance. Šara's refusal is the third element of the threefold-refusal pattern that establishes the need for a champion of a different kind — the structural feature that Annus argues passes from the *Anzû Epic* into *Enūma Eliš*'s threefold-refusal of Ea, Anu, and the assembly before Marduk's emergence.^[178]

A.1.67. Šauška

Hurrian goddess, sister of Teshub, who attempts a seduction-attack on Ullikummi and successfully seduces Hedammu in the Kumarbi Cycle.^[179]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources beyond the narrative use of her beauty in the seduction-tableaux.^[180]

Appears in:

- *The Kumarbi Cycle* — accompanies Teshub to view Ullikummi from the mountain vantage, attempts a failed seduction-approach (Ullikummi's stone constitution makes him deaf and blind), and in the Song of Hedammu mounts the seduction-tableau that incapacitates the sea-monster.

Relevance. Šauška is the cycle's specialist in the seduction-method of monster-disabling, the female counterpart to Teshub's storm-and-cutter combat.^[181] The cycle's pairing of seduction and storm-combat as alternative methods is one of its distinctive structural features. Šauška is paired by the Hurrian poets with the Akkadian Ishtar.

A.1.68. Seth

Egyptian god of storms and desert (also Sutekh in Hittite-treaty contexts of the Ramesside period), Apep-slayer at the prow of the solar barque and, separately, murderer of Osiris.^[182]

Physical description. Seth is conventionally depicted in Egyptian iconography with the head of an enigmatic animal (the so-called Seth-animal or **sha**), distinct in the visual record but not unambiguously identified zoologically; te Velde's monograph treats the iconography in detail.^[183]

Appears in:

- *Ra vs. Apep* — stationed at the prow of the solar barque with a spear, the principal combatant against Apep.
- *Horus vs. Seth* — murderer of his brother Osiris, contestant of Horus for the kingship.

Relevance. Seth is the most ambivalent of the Egyptian deities: in the Ra-Apep corpus he is the pro-order Apep-slayer at the prow, but in the Osiris cycle he is the order-disrupting fratricide.^[184] His double role makes him a structural counterpoint to the otherwise stable pro-order register of the Egyptian solar combat.

A.1.69. Shapsh

Ugaritic sun-goddess and divine messenger of the Baal Cycle.^[185]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Baal vs. Yamm and Lôtan* — among the wider divine assembly named in the Cycle as one of the active deities.

Relevance. Shapsh's role in the Cycle is messenger and witness rather than principal actor; she is named in the wider apparatus of the Ugaritic pantheon.^[186]

A.1.70. Shemwindo

Nyanga chief of Tubondo, Mwindo's father, whose hostility to his son's birth precipitates the early action of the Mwindo Epic.^[187]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Mwindo and Kirimu* — the chiefly father whose attempted destruction of the miraculously-born Mwindo opens the epic's narrative arc.

Relevance. Shemwindo's hostility to his son frames the Mwindo Epic's opening; the Kirimu episode is one stage in the longer biographical arc that Shemwindo's hostility sets in motion.^[188]

A.1.71. Susanoo

Japanese storm-god, younger brother of the sun-goddess Amaterasu and the moon-deity Tsukuyomi, expelled from the heavenly plain of Takamagahara for his misdeeds and slayer of Yamata no Orochi at Izumo.^[189]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources beyond the narrative datum that the assembled heavenly **kami** cut off his beard and the nails of his hands and feet at his expulsion from Takamagahara.^[190]

Appears in:

- *Susanoo vs. Yamata no Orochi* — expelled from heaven for damaging Amaterasu's rice-paddies and weaving-hall, descends to Izumo, intoxicates Yamata no Orochi with eight vats of sake, dismembers the serpent, and discovers the sword Kusanagi in its tail.

Relevance. Susanoo is the central figure of the Izumo-cycle of the early-Japanese imperial chronicles, and the Yamata no Orochi episode is read by current Japanese-studies area specialists (Naumann, Isomae, Como) as sword-etiology and metallurgical allegory rather than as chaoskampf in the imported Eurasian sense.^[191]

A.1.72. Tarḫunna

Hittite storm-god, head of the Hittite state pantheon during the Old and New Kingdom periods (Hurrian-language counterpart Teshub), opponent of Illuyanka in the **purulli**-festival aetiology.^[192]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Tarḫunna vs. Illuyanka* — defeated by Illuyanka in the first encounter of Version 1, with his organs taken in Version 2; succeeds in the second encounter of each version through Inara-and-Hupasiya's binding of the gorged serpent (Version 1) or his son's recovery of the heart and eyes as bride-price (Version 2).
- *C3. Cyclical Maintenance* — the storm-god of the **purulli**-festival cyclical-maintenance type-case, paired with Ra-Apep.

Relevance. Tarḫunna is the Hittite storm-god whose annual **purulli**-festival victory at Nerik is one of the two principal type-cases of the cyclical-maintenance subtype.^[193] The Illuyanka recitation's explicit ritual embedding distinguishes it from most Mesopotamian combat-myths whose ritual context must be reconstructed.

A.1.73. Teshub

Hurrian storm-god (Hittite-language Tarḫunna), conceived inside Kumarbi after Kumarbi's castration of Anu, third sovereign in the Kingship in Heaven succession, opponent of Ullikummi in the cycle's flagship combat.^[194]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources beyond the

narrative datum that he rides a chariot drawn by his bull-team Šeri and 𐎧urri (the latter sometimes Tilla in the Nuzi-attested variant).^[195]

Appears in:

- *The Kumarbi Cycle* — born from Kumarbi's body, deposes Kumarbi for the kingship of heaven, fails his first attack on Ullikummi with the storm-weapons, and succeeds after Ea's identification of the primordial copper cutter severs Ullikummi from Upelluri's shoulder.
- *C2. Combat as Sovereignty* — the Kumarbi-Ullikummi sovereignty-restoration case.
- *C6. The Near Eastern → Mediterranean Transmission* — the storm-god whose Hurro-Hittite combat-cycle West and Burkert read as the principal documentary input to Hesiod's *Theogony*.

Relevance. Teshub is the Hurrian standing storm-god, the figure on whom the cycle's combat-songs converge and whose victory over Ullikummi is West's principal exhibit for the Near-Eastern-to-Greek transmission.^[196]

A.1.74. Tezcatlipoca

Mesoamerican "Smoking Mirror," sorcerer-deity who alternates sovereignty with Quetzalcoatl across the Five Suns and tears Cipactli apart with him to form sky and earth.^[197]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources of this book; the iconographic identity encoded in the name (smoking obsidian mirror) is the standing reference.^[198]

Appears in:

- *Other Mesoamerican Combats* — alternates as Sun-ruler with Quetzalcoatl across the cycle of Five Suns, and with Quetzalcoatl tears Cipactli apart to form sky and earth.

Relevance. Tezcatlipoca is the standing alternating-sovereign of the Five Suns cycle, paired with Quetzalcoatl across the world-ages.^[199]

A.1.75. Þórr

Norse storm-god (anglicised Thor), son of Óðinn and Jörð, wielder of Mjöllnir, the principal warrior-figure of the Æsir, adversary of Jörmungandr in three encounters.^[200]

Physical description. No full-figure physical description of Thor survives in the in-scope sources beyond the narrative and iconographic record of his combat-equipment: Mjöllnir the hammer (forged by the dwarves Brokkr and Eitri (or Sindri), so potent that it never fails of its target and returns to the wielder's hand), the belt of strength **Megingjörð** that doubles his power when girded, and the iron gauntlets without which he cannot grip the hammer's short haft, with his chariot drawn by the two named goats Tanngnjóstr ("Tooth-gnasher") and Tannggrisnir ("Tooth-grinder") whose hooves sound the thunder.^[201]

Appears in:

- *Thor vs. Jörmungandr* — meets Jörmungandr three times: lifts him in cat-disguise in

Útgarðaloki's hall (*Gylfaginning* 46–48), hooks him on a baited line during the fishing-expedition with Hymir (*Hymiskviða*, *Gylfaginning* 47, *Húsdrápa*), and at Ragnarøk kills him with Mjöllnir but dies of his venom nine paces away (*Völuspá* 56, *Gylfaginning* 51).

- *Indo-European reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT* — referenced as the Old Norse storm-god instance of Watkins's reconstructed formula.
- *C4. Eschatological Displacement* — alongside the Red Dragon and Aži Dahāka, the type-case of the eschatological subtype.
- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — Old Norse reflex of the IE poetic formula.

Relevance. Thor is the most extensively attested Norse god in the surviving combat-corpus, the recipient of the largest body of skaldic praise-poetry on combat themes, and the figure whose three encounters with Jǫrmungandr provide the corpus's most complete eschatological-combat sequence.^[202] The Ragnarøk combat is the eschatological type-case alongside Revelation 12 and the Frashokereti pendant of the Iranian tradition.

A.1.76. Thraētaona

Avestan hero-slayer of Aži Dahāka (Middle Persian Frēdōn; New Persian Fereydun), of the Āθβiia line; bound the dragon under Mount Damāvand in the Pahlavi narrative.^[203]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Thraētaona vs. Aži Dahāka* — prays to Anāhitā in **Yašt** 5.33–35 for victory over the three-headed dragon, slays him in the Avestan-presupposed-but-not-narrated combat, and in the Pahlavi **Bundahišn** binds Aži Dahāka under Mount Damāvand for the duration of the present age.
- *Vedic and post-Vedic reflexes* — paired with the Vedic Trita Āptya in the Indo-Iranian comparative philology developed by Benveniste and Renou.
- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — load-bearing Iranian reflex of Watkins's formula.

Relevance. Thraētaona is the standing Iranian dragon-slayer, philologically cognate with the Vedic Trita Āptya through the Indo-Iranian root **tri-** "three" with a heroic-name-forming suffix.^[204] His binding-rather-than-killing of Aži Dahāka opens the way to the Frashokereti pendant in which Kərəsāspa kills the freed dragon at the end of time.^[205]

A.1.77. Trita Āptya

Vedic dragon-slayer cognate with Avestan Thraētaona, marginal in the Rigveda but the older Indo-Iranian figure of the combat-myth stratum that Indra-Vātra superseded.^[206]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Vedic and post-Vedic reflexes* — slays a three-headed adversary in RV 10.99.6, appears as junior co-witness alongside Indra in RV 1.105 and 2.11.19–20, and is associated with the **soma** sacrifice across the residual Trita-cluster of the Rigveda.

- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — the older Vedic reflex of the IE formula whose attestation supports the reconstruction of a pre-Indra Indo-Iranian phase.

Relevance. Trita Āptya is the philological pillar of the Indo-Iranian comparative reading: his name is the same Indo-Iranian formation as Thraētaona's, his three-headed adversary corresponds to Aži Dahāka's three heads, and his marginal place in the Vedic tradition contrasts asymmetrically with Thraētaona's centrality in the Iranian.^[207]

A.1.78. Tvaṁṁṁ

Vedic divine artisan, forger of Indra's **vajra**, named in RV 1.32.2.^[208]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Indra vs. Vṛtra* — forges the **vajra** with which Indra strikes Vṛtra.

Relevance. Tvaṁṁṁ is the Vedic divine smith whose forging of the **vajra** makes Indra's combat possible — the structural counterpart of Hephaistos in Greek tradition and of Kothar-wa-Khasis in Ugaritic.^[209]

A.1.79. Yahweh

The God of Israel (Hebrew tetragrammaton YHWH, vocalised Yahweh), depicted in the Hebrew Bible combat-passages as storm-god who defeats the sea, Leviathan, and Rahab.^[210]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources for the Hebrew Bible Yahweh in his role as combat-deity. Habakkuk 3 depicts him in the storm-warrior register — bow uncovered, arrows, spear, lightning, trampling the sea with horses — but these are weapons-and-actions rather than figural description of the deity.^[211]

Appears in:

- *Yahweh vs. Leviathan and Rahab* — crushes the heads of Leviathan in Psalm 74:13–14, defeats Rahab in Psalm 89, kills the fleeing serpent in Isaiah 27:1, cuts Rahab in pieces and pierces the dragon in Isaiah 51:9–10, strikes Rahab and pierces the fleeing serpent in Job 26:12–13, and is described in Habakkuk 3 as a storm-warrior trampling the sea.
- *Michael vs. the Red Dragon* — in the background of the Apocalypse's combat material, with the male child of Rev 12:5 caught up to God's throne.
- *C2. Combat as Sovereignty* — alongside Baal, the sovereignty-combat case Ballentine 2015 develops most directly.
- *C4. Eschatological Displacement* — under whose sovereignty the eschatological combat closes (Isaiah 27:1 reception in Revelation).

Relevance. Yahweh is the principal Hebrew Bible combat-figure in the dispersed combat-poetry of the Psalms, Isaiah, Job, and Habakkuk.^[212] Day reads the corpus as preserving Ugaritic Baal-and-sea imagery transferred polemically to Yahweh; Ballentine reads it as rival-sovereignty combat-rhetoric rather than chaos-vs-order metaphysics.^[213]

A.1.80. Yao

Legendary pre-dynastic Chinese sage-king under whom Hou Yi's commission is exercised.^[214]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- [Hou Yi and the Suns](#) — the sovereign whose era is associated with the establishment of social, calendrical, and cosmic order; the suns-crisis arises during his reign.

Relevance. Yao stands at the head of the legendary pre-dynastic Chinese sovereigns; the Hou Yi cycle is one of the order-restoring narratives associated with his era.^[215]

A.1.81. Zeus

King of the Olympian gods in Hesiod's *Theogony*, son of Kronos and Rhea, wielder of the thunderbolt; defeats Typhon in the closing combat of the *Theogony*.^[216]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources directly relevant to the Typhon combat; Zeus is named as wielding the thunderbolt and as leaping from Olympus, with the figural detail concentrated on the weapon and its effects rather than on the body.^[217]

Appears in:

- [Zeus vs. Typhon](#) — strikes Typhon with the thunderbolt at Theog. 853–858, scorches the hundred serpent-heads, and casts the burning monster down into Tartarus; in Apollodorus's expansion, has his sinews severed by Typhon at the Corycian cave but is rescued by Hermes and Aigipan and renews the combat.
- [Michael vs. the Red Dragon](#) — referenced in the wider Greek background to Yarbrow Collins's Leto-Apollo-Python primary-substrate reading of Revelation 12.
- [C2. Combat as Sovereignty](#) — the Hesiodic kingship-combat case.
- [C6. The Near Eastern → Mediterranean Transmission](#) — the Greek pole of the Kumarbi-to-Hesiod transmission case.

Relevance. Zeus is the standing king of the Olympian pantheon, whose combat with Typhon closes the succession-cycle of the *Theogony* and confirms his settled rule.^[218] The Apollodoran sinew-theft sequence is the principal point at which the Greek combat-narrative shows a structural feature with a Hurro-Hittite parallel rather than a purely Hesiodic precedent.^[219]

A.1.82. Zhuanxu

Chinese sky-emperor who defeats Gonggong in the most widely attested version of the Han-era cosmogonic combat.^[220]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- [Gonggong and the Broken Pillar](#) — defeats Gonggong, whose subsequent head-strike on Mount

Buzhou breaks the sky-pillar.

Relevance. Zhuanyu is the dominant variant's combatant against Gonggong; in the alternative variant the combatant is Zhurong the fire-god.^[221]

A.1.83. Zhurong

Chinese fire-god, alternative combatant against Gonggong in some Han-era variants of the cosmogonic narrative.^[222]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Gonggong and the Broken Pillar* — alternative combatant in the variant tradition.

Relevance. Zhurong's appearance as alternative combatant marks the variant-handling of the Gonggong tradition: different Han-era compilations identify the victor differently, and the chapter presents both as co-equal variants.^[223]

A.2. Heroes and Mortals

A.2.1. Andromeda

Aithiopian princess of the Greek tradition, daughter of Cassiopeia and Cepheus, chained to a sea-cliff as sacrifice to the Ketos and rescued by Perseus.^[224]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope primary sources, beyond the narrative datum that she is exposed in chains on the rocks of the coast.^[225]

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — the imperilled princess of the Perseus rescue, whose exposure to the Ketos is occasioned by Cassiopeia's boast.
- *St. George, St. Michael, and the Christian Reception* — iconographic substrate for the medieval St. George rescue-scene.

Relevance. The Perseus-Andromeda rescue is the iconographic archetype of the medieval St. George princess-and-dragon scene, with the visual continuity from Greco-Roman rescue-scenes to late-antique-and-medieval Christian iconography documented by Ogden.^[226]

A.2.2. Balor

Evil-eyed Fomorian, grandfather-adversary of Lugh, killed by a sling-stone to the eye at the Second Battle of Mag Tuired.^[227]

Physical description. The Cath Maige Tuired tradition identifies Balor as evil-eyed — the death-glance of his single eye is his combat-attribute, though not narrated in further morphological detail in the chapter's in-scope treatment.^[228]

Appears in:

- *Indo-European reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT* — Fomorian leader at the Second Battle of Mag Tuired, killed by Lugh's sling-stone-to-the-eye.

Relevance. Balor is the principal Irish dragon-functional adversary of Watkins's IE reading, even though morphologically not a serpent; the killing-stroke fits the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT structural pattern in his reading.^[229]

A.2.3. Batraz

Steel-bodied Nart warrior of the Ossetic epic tradition, read by Dumézil as the Scytho-Alanic Indo-European dragon-slayer reflex.^[230]

Physical description. In the Ossetic Nart corpus Batraz is conventionally described as having a steel body, a feature that gives him distinctive combat-properties in the surviving recordings.^[231]

Appears in:

- *Indo-European reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT* — Ossetic Nart-saga combatant, read in Dumézil's twentieth-century Indo-European comparative work as a reflex of the IE warrior-and-serpent pattern.

Relevance. Batraz is the Caucasian Indo-European dragon-slayer reflex, whose Ossetic Nart epic supplies an attestation of the IE pattern in a region distinct from the principal Vedic, Iranian, Greek, and Norse witnesses.^[232]

A.2.4. Bellerophon

Lycian hero of the *Iliad* who slays the Chimaera while riding Pegasus, the winged horse born from the blood of the slain Medusa.^[233]

Physical description. No physical description of Bellerophon himself survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — kills the Chimaera at the commission of King Iobates of Lycia, riding Pegasus and (in the post-Homeric tradition) using a lump of lead on his spear that melts in the Chimaera's fiery breath.

Relevance. Bellerophon is one of the standard Greek hero-labour dragon-slayers, whose combat with the Chimaera is the earliest extant attestation of a Greek dragon-fight (*Iliad* 6).^[234]

A.2.5. Beowulf

Geatish hero of the Old English poem *Beowulf*, who kills Grendel, Grendel's mother, and finally the hoard-dragon, dying of the dragon's venom in the same engagement.^[235]

Physical description. No physical description directly relevant to the dragon-combat appears in the chapter's discussion of the in-scope material.

Appears in:

- *Indo-European reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT* — kills the hoard-dragon in the third movement of the poem and dies of the dragon's venom.
- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — Old English reflex of the IE formula in Watkins's reading.
- *Reception coda* — the figure on whose interpretation Tolkien's 1936 lecture turned twentieth-century Old English scholarship.

Relevance. Beowulf is the principal Old English dragon-slayer of the surviving record, and Tolkien's 1936 British Academy lecture re-established the mythic register of the poem's monsters within twentieth-century Old English scholarship.^[236]

A.2.6. Cassiopeia

Mortal queen of Aithiopia in the Greek tradition, mother of Andromeda, whose boast that she is more beautiful than the Nereids occasions Poseidon's sending the Ketos against the Aithiopian coast.^[237]

Physical description. No physical description bearing on the in-scope discussion survives.

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — her boast precipitates the Ketos's appearance and the exposure of her daughter Andromeda.

Relevance. Cassiopeia is the precipitating figure of the Andromeda rescue: the mortal mother whose hubris brings the sea-monster.^[238]

A.2.7. Christ

The male child of Revelation 12:5, identified as the messianic figure of Psalm 2:9 and as the Lamb of the wider Apocalypse, raptured to God's throne immediately after his birth.^[239]

Physical description. No physical description of the male child appears in Revelation 12 beyond the narrative datum of his birth and rapture; later medieval iconography is reception, not in-scope primary description.^[240]

Appears in:

- *Michael vs. the Red Dragon* — the male child whose birth the Red Dragon attempts to forestall and who is caught up to God's throne at Rev 12:5.
- *St. George, St. Michael, and the Christian Reception* — central figure of the harrowing-of-hell apocryphon (the **Gospel of Nicodemus** / **Descensus Christi ad Inferos**), where Christ's descent into hell is staged as a militant entry into the territory of the adversary.

Relevance. The male child of Revelation 12 is read in Yarbrow Collins's analysis as the messiah-as-cosmic-figure, with his brief narrative bracketing the entire earthly career of Jesus.^[241] Forsyth treats the harrowing-narrative as the central Christian site at which the inherited combat-myth

pattern is reapplied to Christ himself rather than to a saintly or angelic surrogate.^[242]

A.2.8. Dobrynya Nikitich

Bogatyr of the East Slavic **bylina** tradition, slayer of the dragon Zmey Gorynych.^[243]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Slavic and Baltic combat* — slays the three-headed dragon Zmey Gorynych in the East Slavic **bylina** recorded from oral performance in the nineteenth century.

Relevance. Dobrynya is one of the principal **bogatyrs** of the East Slavic **bylina** corpus, and the Zmey Gorynych combat is one of the corpus's most widely recorded dragon-slayings.^[244]

A.2.9. Fereydun

New Persian form of Thraētaona (Middle Persian Frēdōn), the dragon-slayer hero recast in Ferdowsi's c. 1000 CE *Shāhnāmeḥ* as the figure who overthrows the tyrant Zahhāk.^[245]

Physical description. See Thraētaona; no physical description from the Avestan-Pahlavi material survives.

Appears in:

- *Thraētaona vs. Aži Dahāka* — flagged in the closing reception note as the New Persian recasting of the Avestan-Pahlavi hero.
- *Reception coda* — the figure who carries the dragon-slaying tradition into Islamic-era Persian literary culture.

Relevance. The *Shāhnāmeḥ*'s recasting of Thraētaona as Fereydun and Aži Dahāka as Zahhāk is post-Sasanian Islamic-era reception, the principal post-medieval afterlife of the Iranian combat tradition.^[246]

A.2.10. Herakles

Greek hero of the twelve labours (Latin Hercules), slayer of the Lernaean Hydra, the Hesperidean Ladon, the triple-bodied Geryon, and (in the Italic tradition) the fire-breathing giant Cacus.^[247]

Physical description. No physical description of Herakles directly bearing on his serpent-combats survives in the in-scope passages of this book.

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — kills the Lernaean Hydra (Iolaos cauterising the necks), takes the Hesperidean apples (slaying or circumventing Ladon), drives off Geryon's cattle from Erytheia, and as Hercules kills Cacus on the Aventine.
- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — the Geryon and Cacus combats as Indo-European cattle-raid reflexes in Watkins's and West's reading.

Relevance. Herakles is the standing Greek hero-labour dragon-slayer; the Geryon labour and the Cacus combat together bracket the cattle-raid material on its outward and homeward legs and supply Watkins and West with their principal Greek and Italic IE-cattle-raid exhibits.^[248]

A.2.11. Hou Yi

Chinese archer-hero of the Yao era, sent by Di Jun to shoot down nine of the ten suns and to slay a sequence of monstrous beasts.^[249]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources beyond his characterisation as a divine archer of unparalleled skill, equipped by Di Jun with a bow and (in some textual strata) red corded arrows.^[250]

Appears in:

- *Hou Yi and the Suns* — shoots nine of the ten simultaneously-risen suns when they break the regular daily alternation, and kills a sequence of monstrous beasts under the sage-king Yao, restoring environmental and cosmic order.

Relevance. Hou Yi is the standing Chinese archer-hero of the Yao era, whose sun-shooting and beast-slaying restore an already-existing order rather than founding the cosmos. The chapter classifies him as a related-tier order-restoration case rather than a cosmogonic-combat case. The divine/heroic classification is debated in the scholarship; this appendix places him in Heroes and Mortals to align with his order-restoration role under the sage-king Yao.^[251]

A.2.12. Hupasiya

Mortal man of Ziggarratta in Hittite Version 1 of the Illuyanka myth, who binds the gorged serpent and enables the storm-god's killing.^[252]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Tarḫunna vs. Illuyanka* — bargains with Inara for a night together in exchange for help against Illuyanka, binds the engorged serpent so that Tarḫunna can slay it, and is then installed in a cliff-house with a prohibition against looking at his wife and children, which he transgresses after twenty days.

Relevance. Hupasiya is one of the very few mortal participants whose presence is constitutive of an ancient Near Eastern combat myth: the storm-god's killing depends on the mortal's binding-action, and the divine victory is therefore not a divine act alone.^[253]

A.2.13. Hymir

Norse giant of the Eddic *Hymiskviða* and Snorri's *Gylfaginning* ch. 47, host (or unwilling host) of Thor in the cauldron-quest, and Thor's companion (or rival) on the boat in the fishing expedition for Jǫrmungandr.^[254]

Physical description. No physical description bearing on the in-scope discussion of the

Jormungandr corpus survives in the chapter's treatment.

Appears in:

- *Thor vs. Jormungandr* — resident giant whose cauldron the Æsir need for their feast-brewing; in *Gylfaginning* ch. 47 the boat-owner and rower in the fishing expedition; in *Hymiskviða* 23–24 the figure who cuts the line as Thor is about to land Jormungandr.

Relevance. Hymir is the giant on whose boat the central encounter of the Thor-Jormungandr fishing-expedition takes place; the cutting of the line is one of the most iconographically attested moments of the corpus, depicted on the Altuna, Hørdum, Gosforth, and Ardre VIII stones.^[255]

A.2.14. Iolaos

Greek hero, nephew and companion of Herakles, who cauterises the Hydra's neck-stumps with fire to prevent regrowth.^[256]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — supplies the tactical solution to the regenerating Hydra by cauterising each severed neck-stump with fire.

Relevance. Iolaos's role is structural — the helper whose cauterisation makes the otherwise interminable combat finite — and is one of the rare cases in the Greek hero-labour corpus in which the combat depends on a partner.^[257]

A.2.15. Kadmos

Theban hero, son of Agenor of Tyre, slays the dragon of Ares at Thebes and sows its teeth to raise the Spartoi.^[258]

Physical description. No physical description of Kadmos himself survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — kills the dragon of Ares guarding the spring at the future site of Thebes, sows its teeth at Athena's instruction, and from the surviving five Spartoi the founding aristocratic lineages of Thebes descend.

Relevance. Kadmos is the standing Greek city-foundation dragon-slayer; the killing-and-tooth-sowing supplies both the population and the political genealogy of Thebes.^[259]

A.2.16. Kərəsāspa

Avestan hero (anglicised Keresaspa; New Persian Garshāsp) preserved in long stasis through the present age, revived at Frashokereti to slay the freed Aži Dahāka.^[260]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Thraētaona vs. Aži Dahāka* — second Iranian dragon-slayer alongside Thraētaona, preserved in long stasis through the present age.
- *C4. Eschatological Displacement* — revived at Frashokereti and slays the freed Aži Dahāka in the eschatological combat.

Relevance. Keresaspa is the eschatological-pendant figure to Thraētaona, the second hero whose final killing of the bound-and-escaped Aži Dahāka closes cosmic time at Frashokereti.^[261] The Iranian doubled-combat structure (Thraētaona at the founding of the present age, Keresaspa at its close) is one of the clearest exemplifications of Gunkel's **Urzeit-und-Endzeit** parallelism.^[262]

A.2.17. Krishna

Avatar of Viṣṇu in the post-Vedic Vaishnava tradition, who in the **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** (book 10 chs. 15–17) and earlier in the **Harivaṃśa** and **Viṣṇu Purāṇa** subdues the multi-headed water-serpent Kāliya by dancing on his heads.^[263]

Physical description. No physical description of Krishna in the chapter's textual treatment of the in-scope episode goes beyond his characterisation as the divine **child** of the Vraja-pastoral setting; the iconographic image of the dance-on-the-heads (the **Kāliyamardana**, the trampling of Kāliya) is the standard visual identifier.^[264]

Appears in:

- *Vedic and post-Vedic reflexes* — leaps from a **kadamba** tree into the Yamunā's Kāliya-pool, escapes the **nāga**'s coils, dances on Kāliya's many-headed crown until Kāliya surrenders, and on the **nāgapatnīs**' intercession spares the serpent on condition that he leave the Yamunā.

Relevance. The Krishna-Kāliya combat is a four-fold transformation of the inherited dragon-combat pattern: warrior becomes child-hero, killing becomes subjugation, cosmological becomes local, ritual becomes devotional.^[265] The dance-on-the-serpent's-heads moment is one of the most reproduced iconographic types of the long-arc Indic visual tradition.

A.2.18. Lugh

Tuatha Dé Danann warrior-king of the Irish tradition, slays the Fomorian Balor at the Second Battle of Mag Tuired with a sling-stone to the eye.^[266]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope textual treatment.

Appears in:

- *Indo-European reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT* — kills Balor at the Second Battle of Mag Tuired with the sling-stone-to-the-eye killing.

Relevance. Lugh is the standing Irish hero of the Mag Tuired combat, an Indo-European reflex that Watkins and West read as part of the wider HERO SLAY SERPENT reception even though Balor is morphologically not a serpent.^[267]

A.2.19. Mamadi Sefe Dekote

Soninke suitor of the Bida narrative who kills the seven-headed serpent Bida to save his beloved at the moment of the annual maiden-tribute, thereby triggering the abandonment of Wagadu.^[268]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Bida and the founding of Wagadu* — kills Bida to save his beloved when she is taken in the annual tribute; the killing ends rather than establishes the city's prosperity, inverting the order-establishing outcome of Eurasian chaoskampf.
- *C7. The Inversion Problem* — the principal inversion case where the slaying destroys rather than creates order.

Relevance. Mamadi Sefe Dekote is the inversion-anchor of the present book's typology: his killing of the protector-serpent ends Wagadu and disperses the Soninke, the load-bearing exhibit for the **inversion** category in Part II C7.^[269]

A.2.20. Mwindo

Nyanga epic hero, miraculously born, who kills the dragon Kirimu in the forest and is then struck down by the sky-god Nkuba and humiliated in the celestial realm before being returned chastened to the human world.^[270]

Physical description. The Biebuyck & Mateene 1969 text, recorded from Shé-Kárisi Rureke at Bese in 1956, narrates Mwindo's miraculous birth without supplying a continuous physical description of the figure that survives in the in-scope treatment of this book.^[271]

Appears in:

- *Mwindo and Kirimu* — the contrastive case: Mwindo kills the dragon Kirimu in the forest, is struck by Nkuba's lightning, taken to the sky for instruction in the limits of his power, and returned chastened to the human world.
- *C8. The Refusal and the Appropriation Problem* — load-bearing case for the contrastive-tier resistance to chaoskampf framing.

Relevance. The Mwindo Epic is the present book's clearest case of a tradition whose framing explicitly rejects the chaos-vs-order mapping that the chaoskampf typology presupposes.^[272] The killing of Kirimu is treated by the Nyanga tradition as a transgression that the sky-god punishes, not as an order-establishing act, and the hero's maturation through humiliation is the moral-didactic centre of the episode.

A.2.21. Nanabozho

Anishinaabe trickster-culture-hero, whose relations with the underwater manitou Mishipeshu and the Thunderers (Animikiig) are read by area specialists as reciprocal counterparts in a relational moral universe rather than as chaoskampf adversaries.^[273]; Smith 1995; Vizenor 1989.]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources of this book; the Anishinaabe ontological framework treats Nanabozho as one among the **aadizookaanag** / sacred-story persons whose identity is relational rather than figural in the chapter's discussion.^[274]]

Appears in:

- *Nanabozho and Mishipeshu* — the Anishinaabe trickster-culture-hero whose encounters with Mishipeshu and the Thunderers are presented within Hallowell's "other-than-human persons" framework as relational rather than adversarial.
- *C8. The Refusal and the Appropriation Problem* — the principal case in the present book where area specialists explicitly decline the chaoskampf reading.

Relevance. Nanabozho is the load-bearing exhibit of the present book's **refusal** category: the area-specialist scholarship of Hallowell, Johnston, T. Smith, and Vizenor explicitly holds the chaos-vs-order mapping against the Anishinaabe material, and the chapter's task is to register the refusal as data rather than to overcome it.^[275]

A.2.22. Perseus

Greek hero, son of Zeus and the mortal Danaë, beheads Medusa and rescues Andromeda from the Ketos.^[276]

Physical description. No physical description directly bearing on the dragon-combat survives in the in-scope sources, beyond the equipment-set carried over from the Medusa episode (winged sandals, **kibisis** for the head, cap of invisibility) which Perseus uses for the aerial combat with the Ketos in Ovid.^[277]

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — beheads Medusa, then rescues Andromeda from the Ketos in the engagement that Apollodorus and Ovid both narrate, killing the sea-monster with the same sword that beheaded Medusa.
- *St. George, St. Michael, and the Christian Reception* — iconographic substrate for the medieval St. George rescue-scene, with continuity from Greco-Roman rescue iconography to late-antique-and-medieval Christian visual culture.

Relevance. The Perseus-Andromeda rescue is the iconographic archetype of the medieval St. George princess-and-dragon scene; Ogden tracks the visual continuity from Greco-Roman rescue-scenes to late-antique-and-medieval St. George iconography in mosaic, fresco, manuscript illumination, and panel painting.^[278]

A.2.23. Saint George

Christian soldier-saint, conventionally placed under Diocletian's persecution, whose medieval **vita** attaches a dragon-fight episode to a primary martyr-narrative.^[279]

Physical description. No physical description of George that bears on the in-scope material survives. The medieval iconographic codification (mounted soldier-saint, lance or spear thrust into the dragon's mouth, princess at one side, captive city in the background) is medieval reception, not

in-scope primary description.^[280]

Appears in:

- *St. George, St. Michael, and the Christian Reception* — the central node of the medieval dragon-fight legend, with the dragon-fight episode documented as an eleventh-to-twelfth-century accretion onto the original **passio**.
- *Reception coda* — recurrent figure in the post-medieval reception of Christian dragon-iconography.

Relevance. Saint George supplies the late-antique-to-medieval Christian dragon-combat tradition with its principal hagiographic figure, and the Greco-Roman Perseus-Andromeda type is the documented Greco-Roman substrate of the dragon-fight episode.^[281]

A.2.24. Sigurd

Norse hero (Middle High German Siegfried) of the Eddic Sigurd-cycle, son of Sigmund of the Völsung lineage, slays the dragon Fáfnir with the sword Gram and tastes his blood, gaining understanding of birdspeech.^[282]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Indo-European reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT* — ambushes Fáfnir from a pit, thrusts Gram up into the dragon's underbelly, roasts the heart, gains understanding of birdspeech, and on the nuthatches' warning beheads Regin.
- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — Watkins's strongest philological evidence for the IE poetic formula in the Old Norse reflex.
- *C7. The Inversion Problem* — the curse-on-the-gold trajectory makes the killing destroy rather than secure the hero's prosperity.

Relevance. Sigurd's killing-stroke against Fáfnir is in Watkins's reading the Old Norse reflex of the IE HERO SLAY SERPENT formula at the level of verbal diction, with the **Fáfnismál** preserving the formula as a direct philological reflex.^[283] The cycle's curse-on-the-gold trajectory is one of the C7 inversion exhibits.

A.2.25. The storm-god's son (Hittite Illuyanka Version 2)

The half-mortal son of Tarūnna, born to a daughter of a poor man, who marries a daughter of Illuyanka and recovers his father's heart and eyes as bride-price.^[284]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Tarūnna vs. Illuyanka* — Version 2's mortal-and-divine intermediary: born to the mutilated storm-god by a poor man's daughter, married into Illuyanka's house, demands and receives the storm-god's heart and eyes as bride-price, and is killed alongside Illuyanka in the renewed

combat at his own request.

Relevance. The storm-god's son is the structural pivot of Version 2: his half-mortality lets him cross the boundary into Illuyanka's house, his marriage gives him bargaining position, and his self-requested death alongside the serpent honours the kinship-obligation he has incurred.^[285]

A.2.26. Útgarðaloki

Giant-king of Útgarðr ("the outer enclosure", realm of the giants), trickster-host of Thor and his companions in the visit-to-Útgarðr episode of *Gylfaginning* chs. 45–47.^[286]

Physical description. No physical description bearing on the in-scope discussion survives in the chapter's treatment.

Appears in:

- *Thor vs. Jormungandr* — giant-king whose hall hosts the lifting-of-the-cat trickery, in which the cat Thor attempts to lift is revealed (later) to be Jormungandr in disguise.

Relevance. Útgarðaloki's hall is the setting of Thor's first encounter with Jormungandr, the figure being revealed to Thor only after his departure from Útgarðr.^[287]

A.2.27. Vahagn

Armenian storm-god, called Vishapakagh "dragon-reaper," combat-hero of Armenian mythology; attestation is fragmentary, surviving only through Khorenatsi's late paraphrase of a hymn whose original text is lost.^[288]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources beyond the epithet **Vishapakagh** ("dragon-reaper").^[289]

Appears in:

- *Indo-European reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT* — Armenian dragon-slayer named in Khorenatsi's late paraphrase as combatant against the **vishaps**.

Relevance. Vahagn is the most fragmentary of the six Indo-European reflexes treated in chapter 19; the surviving evidence is a late paraphrase of a hymn whose text is lost, and the chapter handles the material with explicit fragmentary framing.^[290]

A.2.28. Väinämöinen

Finnish shaman-sage hero of the Kalevala-era runes and Lönnrot's 1835 / 1849 *Kalevala*, who subdues the sea-monster Iku-Turso by song rather than combat.^[291]

Physical description. No physical description directly bearing on the Iku-Turso material survives in the chapter's in-scope discussion.

Appears in:

- *Väinämöinen and Iku-Turso* — subdues Iku-Turso by shamanic singing rather than by physical

combat, in the older rune tradition and in Lönnrot's editorial synthesis.

Relevance. Väinämöinen represents the present book's transformed-variant case: the inherited combat-pattern is preserved as a shamanic-binding-by-song rather than a hero-led killing, and the chapter explicitly separates older rune material from Lönnrot's nineteenth-century editorial synthesis.^[292]

A.3. Creatures and Monsters

A.3.1. Asag

Sumerian demon of the mountains, son of An and Ki, commander of an army of stone-warriors, Ninurta's adversary in *Lugal-e*.^[293]

Physical description. The text describes Asag's hide as of an order that does not yield to the ordinary instruments of combat — Šarur's third report warns that conventional weapons cannot penetrate the adversary.^[294] On Asag's emergence the gods are reported as cowering and cosmic order shakes, and Šarur's later plea frames him as "storm-like and uncontrollable... a kind of weather-system with hostile intent."^[295] After his death his body is reduced to a heap of rubble and dust, the substance of stones.^[296] No further morphological detail survives in the in-scope sources.

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — born of An and Ki, rules the **kur**, commands an army of stone-warriors (including the **šu**, **saĝkal**, **esi**, **usium**, and **kagena** stones), terrorises the cities of the land, and is killed by Ninurta after a sustained combat in which Šarur first counsels caution and then carries Enlil's authorising decree.
- *C1. Combat as Cosmogony* — the Sumerian cosmogonic-combat case, with the defeated stones forming the dam that orders the Tigris and the **ursag**-mountain.

Relevance. Asag is the earliest of the named adversaries in the book's chronological sequence (Old Babylonian copies of Ur III originals, c. 2000 BCE), and his defeat in *Lugal-e* generates the most sustained cosmogonic aftermath in the Sumerian corpus: hydraulic engineering of the Tigris, the renaming of the mother-goddess as Nin^{ursag}a, the lapidary aetiology of the stones, and the granary-portfolio of Nisaba.^[297]

A.3.2. Aži Dahāka

Three-headed, six-eyed, three-jawed dragon-tyrant of the Avestan tradition (Middle Persian Dahāg; New Persian Zahhāk), originally a creature of Anra Mainyu, bound under Mount Damāvand in the Pahlavi tradition until Frashokereti.^[298]

Physical description. In *Yašt* 5.33–35 and across the Avestan attestations, Aži Dahāka is described in metrically regular formulaic terms as the three-headed, six-eyed (two per head), three-jawed (one per head) dragon.^[299] The **Vendīdād** and other Avestan attestations add the formula that he contains "a thousand of every kind" of noxious creature — vermin, scorpions, frogs, lizards.^[300] The Pahlavi **Bundahišn** preserves the same triple-formulaic morphology intact across the post-Achaemenid redaction.^[301]

Appears in:

- *Thraētaona vs. Aži Dahāka* — fashioned by Anra Mainyu, slain by Thraētaona in the Avestan-presupposed combat, bound under Mount Damāvand by Thraētaona in the **Bundahišn**'s narrative, breaks free at the end of cosmic time, devours a third of humanity and a third of the animals, and is finally killed by the revived Kərəsāspa at Frashokereti.
- *Vedic and post-Vedic reflexes* — paired with the three-headed adversary slain by Trita Āptya at RV 10.99.6 in the Indo-Iranian comparative philology of Benveniste and Renou.
- *C4. Eschatological Displacement* — alongside Jormungandr and the Red Dragon, the type-case of the eschatological subtype.
- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — load-bearing reflex of the Avestan **jan-aži-** formula.

Relevance. Aži Dahāka has the longest narrative life of any adversary in the present book: bound rather than killed at the close of the Avestan-period combat, persists in living captivity through the present age, escapes at the end of time, and is finally killed by the revived Keresaspa at Frashokereti.^[302] His doubled-combat structure (Thraētaona at the founding of the present age, Keresaspa at its close) is one of Gunkel's clearest **Urzeit-und-Endzeit** exemplifications.^[303]

A.3.3. Bakunawa

Philippine (Visayan / Bikol) serpent-dragon of the deep sea or underworld, who devoured six of the seven original moons and continues to attempt to devour the last during eclipses.^[304]

Physical description. The Visayan and Bikol oral-tradition record conceives Bakunawa as a vast serpentine creature dwelling in the ocean depths or in the underworld; no further morphological detail beyond the serpentine and ocean-dwelling identification survives in the in-scope synthesis.^[305]

Appears in:

- *Bakunawa and the moons* — the eclipse-causing devourer of the moon, against whom the human community responds with communal noise-making (drums, gongs, shouting, banging metal pots) to startle him into releasing the moon.
- *C8. The Refusal and the Appropriation Problem* — principal case for the **communal / non-slaying** extension of the typology.

Relevance. Bakunawa is the present book's principal exhibit for the **communal / non-slaying combat** register, in which the serpent-and-human-community encounter is registered as a recurring communal-prophylactic practice without a hero-figure.^[306]

A.3.4. Bida

Seven-headed serpent-protector of the Soninke city of Wagadu (ancient Ghana) in Soninke oral tradition, killed by Mamadi Sefe Dekote at the moment of the annual maiden-tribute.^[307]

Physical description. The Soninke oral tradition identifies Bida as a seven-headed serpent; the recorded versions add little further morphological detail beyond the seven-headed-serpent core in the chapter's synthesis.^[308]

Appears in:

- *Bida and the founding of Wagadu* — protector-spirit of Wagadu under a covenant by which the city's prosperity is bound to the annual delivery of a maiden; killed by the suitor Mamadi Sefe Dekote when his beloved is taken in the tribute, with the killing triggering the abandonment of Wagadu, the cessation of the rains, and the dispersal of the Soninke.
- *C7. The Inversion Problem* — the inversion anchor where the slaying ends rather than establishes the city's prosperity.

Relevance. Bida is the inversion anchor of the present book's typology: the seven-headed-serpent protector whose killing ends rather than founds the polity.^[309] The Bida narrative is the load-bearing test case for Part II C7's inversion argument.

A.3.5. Cacus

Italic fire-breathing giant of the Aventine, killed by Hercules on the homeward leg of the Geryon cattle-raid in Virgil's *Aeneid* 8 and Ovid's *Fasti* 1.^[310]

Physical description. Virgil describes Cacus as a fire-breathing giant, half-human, monstrous (*semihominis Caci facies*), with a smoke-blackened cave on the Aventine.^[311]

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — steals four bulls and four heifers from Hercules's herd by dragging them backwards into his cave; killed by Hercules through strangulation, with the **Ara Maxima** founded at the site.
- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — Italic Indo-European cattle-raid reflex paired with the Greek Geryon.

Relevance. Cacus is the principal Italic Indo-European cattle-raid reflex on West's reading, structurally cognate to Geryon and to the Vedic Indra-Paṇis material, with the Aventine localisation tying the inherited IE pattern to the Roman urban landscape and to a specific Roman cult.^[312]

A.3.6. Centzon Huitznahua

"Four Hundred Southerners," Mexica stellar brothers of Coyolxauhqui and Huitzilopochtli, defeated and pursued across the slopes of Coatepec by the newly born Huitzilopochtli.^[313]

Physical description. The *Florentine Codex* Book 3 narrative describes the conspirators as armed for battle as they approach Coatepec, with Cuahuitlicac as the brother who turns informer to the unborn god in Coatlicue's womb; no further continuous figural description survives in the in-scope discussion.^[314]

Appears in:

- *Huitzilopochtli, Coyolxauhqui, and Coatepec* — Coatlicue's four hundred sons by an earlier and unspecified progeny who plot with their sister Coyolxauhqui to kill their mother and are pursued and slain by Huitzilopochtli on the slopes of Coatepec; in some strata a small remnant escapes south to Huitzilampa.

Relevance. The Centzon Huitznahua are theologically identified with the southern stars; their pursuit-and-killing by Huitzilopochtli is the load-bearing imagery of the daily-rising-sun-pursuing-and-extinguishing-the-stars cosmological reading.^[315]

A.3.7. Chimaera

Greek composite monster of Lycia, slain by Bellerophon riding Pegasus; in front a lion, behind a serpent, and in the middle a she-goat, breathing fire.^[316]

Physical description. *Iliad* 6.181 describes the Chimaera as **prosthe leōn, opithen de drakōn, messē de chimaira** — "in front a lion, behind a serpent, and in the middle a she-goat" — fixing the canonical tripartite morphology that the later iconographic tradition standardises. The *Iliad* further specifies that she breathes fire.^[317]

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — slain by Bellerophon on the back of Pegasus; in the post-Homeric tradition killed by a lump of lead on Bellerophon's spear that melts in her fire and is forced down her throat.

Relevance. The Chimaera is one of the standard Greek composite-monster types, with the Lycian fire-vent association (a natural gas seep on a mountain in Lycia) that strengthens the case for treating Bellerophon-Chimaera as a Lycian regional combat-tradition mediated through Greek epic.^[318]

A.3.8. Cipactli

Primordial Mesoamerican earth-monster, dismembered by Quetzalcoatl and Tezcatlipoca to form sky and earth; the present book's boundary case for dismemberment-vs-combat cosmogony.^[319]

Physical description. No continuous physical description survives in the in-scope synthesis of the chapter beyond the figure's classification as a primordial earth-monster in the recorded post-conquest sources.^[320]

Appears in:

- *Other Mesoamerican Combats* — torn apart by Quetzalcoatl and Tezcatlipoca to form sky and earth, the boundary case between in-scope chaoskampf and out-of-scope dismemberment-cosmogony per scope.md §"Excluded adjacent motifs."
- *C1. Combat as Cosmogony* — discussed as the boundary case in the chapter's framing.

Relevance. Cipactli is the present book's principal boundary marker between combat-cosmogony (scope-internal) and dismemberment-without-combat cosmogony (scope-external).^[321]

A.3.9. Fáfnir

Norse dwarf transformed into a dragon by his guardianship of the cursed gold of Andvari, slain by Sigurd in *Fáfnismál*.^[322]

Physical description. The *Fáfnismál* describes Fáfnir at the moment of the killing-stroke as passing

over the pit on the heath of Gnitahiðr on his way to the water; the killing-stroke is Sigurd's upward thrust into the dragon's underbelly.^[323] No further morphological description survives in the chapter's in-scope discussion.

Appears in:

- *Indo-European reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT* — the dwarf transformed into a dragon by the cursed gold of Andvari (paid as wergild to Hreidmar for the killing of Otr), guarding the hoard on the heath of Gnitahiðr until Sigurd's killing-stroke.
- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — the dragon of Watkins's strongest philological evidence for the Old Norse reflex.

Relevance. Fáfnir is the dragon of Watkins's load-bearing Old Norse philological case: the **Fáfnismál** preserves the IE poetic formula at the verbal-diction level of the killing-stroke, not merely at the level of structural-typological pattern.^[324]

A.3.10. Geryon

Triple-bodied warrior of the Greek tradition, whose cattle Herakles drives away from the western island of Erytheia in the tenth labour.^[325]

Physical description. Geryon is depicted variously across the Greek tradition: Hesiod (*Theogony* 287) gives him three heads with one body, while the standard fifth-century vase-painting tradition gives him three torsos joined at the waist supported by one set of legs. He is morphologically a triple-bodied warrior rather than a serpent.^[326]

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — adversary of the tenth labour, whose cattle Herakles drives back across the boundary to the human world.
- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — Watkins's principal Greek Indo-European cattle-raid reflex, paired with the Italic Cacus as the bracketing pair around the cattle-raid material.

Relevance. Geryon is Watkins's principal Greek instance of the Indo-European cattle-raid pattern: hero crosses a boundary, takes the cattle of an other-worldly adversary, brings them back across the same boundary.^[327]

A.3.11. Grendel

Man-eating monster of the Old English poem *Beowulf*, descendant of Cain, who has been killing King Hrothgar's warriors at Heorot for twelve years before Beowulf arrives.^[328]

Physical description. No physical description directly bearing on the in-scope discussion of the dragon-combat material survives in the chapter's treatment.

Appears in:

- *Indo-European reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT* — first of the three monsters Beowulf kills, in the poem's first movement.

Relevance. Grendel is the first of *Beowulf*'s three monsters; the dragon-episode that closes the poem is the chapter's principal locus for the IE-reflex argument, with Grendel and Grendel's mother forming the first two movements before the hoard-dragon.^[329]

A.3.12. Huallallo Carhuincho

Andean rival **wak'a** of the Huarochirí region, fire-and-volcanic-heat figure of the eastern (Antisuyu) direction, defeated by Pariacaca and expelled eastward into the Amazonian-slope zone.^[330]

Physical description. The Huarochirí Manuscript associates Huallallo Carhuincho with a fire-and-volcanic-heat thematic register, with child-eating, and with the eastern (Antisuyu) direction; no further continuous figural description survives in the in-scope discussion.^[331]

Appears in:

- *Pariacaca and the amaru* — already-hegemonic **wak'a** at the moment of Pariacaca's birth, defeated in the five-day storm-and-flood combat with the five Pariacacas, expelled eastward rather than killed.

Relevance. Huallallo Carhuincho is the principal antagonist of the Pariacaca cycle, whose displacement-rather-than-killing aligns the cycle with **wak'a**-succession reading rather than the kill-the-adversary pattern of Eurasian chaoskampf.^[332]

A.3.13. Iku-Turso

Finnic sea-monster subdued by Väinämöinen's song in the Kalevala-era runes and Lönnrot's *Kalevala*.^[333]

Physical description. No continuous physical description survives in the in-scope discussion of the chapter.

Appears in:

- *Väinämöinen and Iku-Turso* — Finnic sea-monster, subdued by shamanic song rather than by physical combat, in both the older rune material and Lönnrot's nineteenth-century editorial synthesis.

Relevance. Iku-Turso represents the present book's transformed-variant case in Finnic register: the inherited combat-pattern preserved as shamanic-binding-by-song rather than hero-led killing.^[334]

A.3.14. Illuyanka

Hittite serpent-monster, the storm-god's adversary in the **purulli**-festival aetiology of CTH 321, where the Hittite noun **illuyanka**- is itself the common-noun word for "snake."^[335]

Physical description. The text designates Illuyanka simply as a serpent, with no further morphological detail preserved beyond the narrative reference to coils and to the hole from which the serpent emerges and into which it cannot return when gorged.^[336]

Appears in:

- *Tarūnna vs. Illuyanka* — defeats Tarūnna in Version 1's first encounter, is gorged at Inara's banquet, bound by Hupasiya, and slain by the returned storm-god; in Version 2, takes Tarūnna's heart and eyes in the first encounter and is killed in the second after the storm-god's son recovers the organs as bride-price.
- *C3. Cyclical Maintenance* — one of two type-cases of the cyclical-maintenance subtype, paired with Apep.
- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — a Hittite reflex of the reconstructed Indo-European combat formula in the form **kuenta... illuyanka-**.

Relevance. Illuyanka is the type-case of the cyclical-maintenance combat with explicit ritual embedding on the tablet itself: the framing colophon names the recitation as the verbal component of the spring **purulli** festival at Nerik.^[337] Watkins identifies the verbal pairing **kuenta... illuyanka-** as a Hittite cognate of Vedic **áhann áhim**, with the Hittite reflex significant for dating the IE reconstruction.^[338]

A.3.15. Kai-Kai

Mapuche marine serpent paired with the mountain serpent Tren-Tren; their combat raises flood and mountain in the Mapuche cosmogonic narrative.^[339]

Physical description. No continuous physical description bearing on the in-scope discussion of the chapter survives in the synthesis.^[340]

Appears in:

- *Kai-Kai vs. Tren-Tren* — raises the sea (the flood) in the cosmogonic-cataclysm narrative; opposed by Tren-Tren who raises the land.

Relevance. Kai-Kai is the marine pole of the Mapuche paired-serpent cosmogony, whose combat with Tren-Tren generates the Mapuche landscape.^[341]

A.3.16. Kāliya

Many-headed water-serpent (**nāga**) of the Yamunā in post-Vedic Vaishnava tradition, who poisons the river and is subdued (not slain) by the child Krishna.^[342]

Physical description. The **Bhāgavata Purāṇa** describes Kāliya as a many-headed serpent — the head-count varies across sources from five to seven to one hundred and ten, with the **Bhāgavata** version generally giving him a hundred and ten heads in some manuscripts — whose venom has poisoned the deep pool of the Yamunā in which he has taken up residence, killing the birds that fly over the pool and the cattle that drink at its margins.^[343]

Appears in:

- *Vedic and post-Vedic reflexes* — coils around Krishna in the Yamunā pool, has his pride and resistance crushed under the child-god's dance on his many-headed crown, and on the **nāgapatnīs'** intercession is spared and exiled from the Yamunā.

Relevance. Kāliya is the post-Vedic Indic reworking of the Indra-Vātra combat-pattern: a **nāga**

-adversary with moral personhood (his wives intercede for him; he is spared rather than killed) rather than a Vedic **ahi** / Vṛtra to be slain.^[344]

A.3.17. Ketos

Greek sea-monster of the Perseus-Andromeda rescue, sent by Poseidon against the Aithiopian coast to ravage the kingdom of Cepheus and Cassiopeia.^[345]

Physical description. The Greek term **Ketos** denotes a generic large sea-creature; the iconographic tradition consolidates the figure as a serpentine sea-dragon with a long body and a fanged head.^[346]

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — sent by Poseidon to ravage the Aithiopian coast in retribution for Cassiopeia's boast; Andromeda is exposed to the Ketos and Perseus kills it.
- *St. George, St. Michael, and the Christian Reception* — iconographic substrate for the medieval St. George dragon-fight scene.

Relevance. The Ketos's iconographic stability makes the Andromeda rescue the principal Greek pattern-source for the medieval St. George rescue iconography.^[347]

A.3.18. Kirimu

Nyanga dragon slain by Mwindo in the forest of the Mwindo Epic.^[348]

Physical description. No continuous physical description survives in the chapter's in-scope discussion of the recorded 1956 performance.^[349]

Appears in:

- *Mwindo and Kirimu* — the dragon whose killing by Mwindo is treated by the Nyanga tradition as a transgression that the sky-god Nkuba punishes.

Relevance. Kirimu is the dragon of the present book's clearest contrastive case: his killing is not the establishment of cosmic order but a transgression that the sky-god punishes, with the hero's maturation through humiliation as the moral-didactic point.^[350]

A.3.19. Labbu

Dragon in the fragmentary Akkadian "Labbu myth" (Foster's "The Lion-Serpent"); slain by a storm-god whose name is broken in the manuscript.^[351]

Physical description. The text describes Labbu in monstrous physical dimensions: surviving witnesses give his length variously as fifty leagues (in manuscripts that read his species as **bašmu**) or sixty leagues (in those that read it as **muš-ūššu**).^[352] The leonine name does not match the body: the text describes him in serpentine terms with a tail and movement through the waters.^[353] After the killing, the text gives the dragon's bleeding a temporal duration of three years, three months, one day, and one night.^[354]

Appears in:

- *Minor Mesopotamian Combats* — adversary in the fragmentary Labbu tablet; the slayer's name is broken in the surviving manuscript, with Tishpak, Nergal, and Marduk all proposed in the scholarship.

Relevance. The Labbu fragment is testimonial: too broken for sustained retelling, but intact enough to demonstrate that the combat pattern was a productive literary form in Akkadian beyond the canonical three (*Lugal-e*, *Anzû Epic*, *Enūma Eliš*).^[355]

A.3.20. Ladon

Greek serpent-guardian of the golden apples in the garden of the Hesperides at the world's western verge, killed (or in some versions circumvented) when Herakles fetches the apples in his eleventh labour.^[356]

Physical description. Ladon is depicted in the surviving artistic record as coiled around the apple-tree; this coiled-around-tree iconography is one of the most widely reproduced Heraklean scenes.^[357]

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — guards the apples of the Hesperides; killed or circumvented in Herakles's eleventh labour.

Relevance. Ladon is the standing Greek tree-coiled-serpent-guardian; the labour-image of Herakles confronting a tree-coiled serpent becomes one of the iconographic types of the long Heraklean reception.^[358]

A.3.21. Lernaean Hydra

Many-headed water-serpent of Lerna in the Argolid, offspring of Typhon and Echidna in Hesiod's *Theogony*, killed by Herakles in the second of his twelve labours.^[359]

Physical description. The Hydra in the mythographic tradition is many-headed — the head-count varies across sources from seven to nine to a hundred — and the central narrative motif is regenerative: when one head is cut, two grow back in its place.^[360] One of her heads is described in Apollodorus as immortal, and after its severance Herakles buries it under a heavy stone.

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — killed by Herakles with the assistance of Iolaos, who cauterises each severed neck-stump with fire to prevent regrowth; her venomous blood becomes the source of Herakles's poisoned arrows.

Relevance. The Hydra is the standing Greek hero-labour serpent-adversary, whose regenerative many-headedness requires the tactical solution of Iolaos's cauterisation rather than a single decisive stroke.^[361]

A.3.22. Leviathan

Multi-headed sea-serpent of the Hebrew Bible (Psalm 74; Isaiah 27; Job 41; Psalm 104), cognate with Ugaritic Lôtan; defeated by Yahweh in the combat-poetry of the Psalms and prophets.^[362]

Physical description. Psalm 74:14 describes Leviathan as having multiple **heads** — the plural is morphologically explicit — that Yahweh crushes. Job 41 supplies the Hebrew Bible's most extended description of Leviathan, depicting (in the RSV rendering Day cites) fearsome teeth, scales like shields, sneezings flashing forth light, eyes like the eyelids of dawn, and mouth shooting flame — a fantastical creature with mythological features rather than an ordinary marine animal.^[363] Isaiah 27:1 names him as "the twisting serpent" and "the crooked serpent," using the same epithet-pair as the Ugaritic tablets use for Lôtan.^[364]

Appears in:

- *Yahweh vs. Leviathan and Rahab* — the principal Hebrew Bible adversary, with his heads crushed by Yahweh in Psalm 74:13–14, slain in Isaiah 27:1, treated as uncontrollable wonder in Job 41, and demythologised as a sea-creature playing in Psalm 104:26.
- *Michael vs. the Red Dragon* — invoked through the seven-headed-dragon iconography and the "ancient serpent" gloss of Rev 12:9.
- *C4. Eschatological Displacement* — alongside Jormungandr and Aži Dahāka, the eschatological-combat case of Isaiah 27:1.

Relevance. Leviathan is the load-bearing Hebrew Bible adversary, whose linguistic and iconographic continuity with Ugaritic Lôtan is the most specific lexical token of the Ugaritic-to-Hebrew-Bible transmission Day argues at length.^[365] His "ancient serpent" gloss in Rev 12:9 carries the Hebrew Bible material into Christian apocalyptic.

A.3.23. Lôtan

Seven-headed serpent of the Ugaritic Baal Cycle (ltn in unvocalised Ugaritic), cognate with Hebrew Leviathan; named in Mot's retrospective taunt at KTU 1.5 i 1–3 as having been defeated by Baal.^[366]

Physical description. KTU 1.5 i 1–3 describes Lôtan as a serpent (**bꜥn**) with seven heads (**šlyꜥ d šbꜥt rašm**), bearing the epithetic descriptions "fleeing" (**brꜥ**) and "twisting" (**ꜥqltn**).^[367]

Appears in:

- *Baal vs. Yamm and Lôtan* — named as a previously-defeated adversary in Mot's taunt to Baal at KTU 1.5 i 1–3, and in ʾAnat's catalogue of victories at KTU 1.3 iii where she lists a seven-headed serpent among her own kills.
- *Yahweh vs. Leviathan and Rahab* — the Ugaritic figure whose epithets are reused word-for-word for Leviathan in Isaiah 27:1.
- *C6. The Near Eastern → Mediterranean Transmission* — the load-bearing transmission case for the Ugaritic-to-Hebrew-Bible chain.

Relevance. Lôtan is the principal Ugaritic adversary referenced (though not narrated) in the Cycle;

the linguistic cognancy with Hebrew Leviathan and the shared seven-headed-serpent topos make the figure the textual hinge of the Ugaritic-to-Hebrew-Bible Leviathan argument that Day 1985 develops at length.^[368]

A.3.24. Medusa

Gorgon of the Greek tradition whose gaze petrifies, beheaded by Perseus in the labour imposed by King Polydektes of Seriphos; from her blood Pegasus is born.^[369]

Physical description. No continuous physical description bearing on the in-scope discussion of the chapter survives in the synthesis beyond the gaze-petrifying attribute and the bodiless beheaded-head trophy carried in the **kibisis**.^[370]

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — beheaded by Perseus before the Andromeda rescue; her severed head, carried in the **kibisis**, supplies Perseus with the petrifying weapon and the cycle's iconographic equipment.

Relevance. Medusa's beheading is the cycle-opening combat of the Perseus material; from her blood Pegasus is born, the winged horse on which Bellerophon will later kill the Chimaera.^[371]

A.3.25. Mishipeshu

Anishinaabe underwater manitou; in the Anishinaabe ontological framework a necessary counterpart to the Thunderers (Animikiig) rather than a chaos-adversary to be defeated.^[372]

Physical description. No continuous physical description bearing on the in-scope discussion of the chapter survives in the synthesis.^[373]

Appears in:

- *Nanabozho and Mishipeshu* — underwater manitou whose relations with Nanabozho and the Thunderers the Anishinaabe area-specialist tradition (Hallowell, Johnston, T. Smith, Vizenor) reads as relational rather than adversarial.
- *C8. The Refusal and the Appropriation Problem* — load-bearing case for the area-specialist refusal of the chaoskampf framing.

Relevance. Mishipeshu is the principal case in the present book where the area-specialist tradition explicitly declines the chaos-vs-order framing.^[374] Theresa S. Smith's book-length study of the Thunderer-and-Underwater-manitou dialectic supplies the load-bearing argument that Mishipeshu and the Thunderers are complementary rather than adversarial.

A.3.26. mušḫuššu

The serpentine dragon-creature of Tiamat's brood in *Enūma Eliš*, also one of two species-readings (alongside **bašmu**) for the Labbu fragment's adversary.^[375]

Physical description. The mušḫuššu is named as a serpent-dragon in the Mesopotamian brood-vocabulary; the iconographic record (cylinder seals, glazed-brick reliefs of the Ishtar Gate at

Babylon, etc.) is extensive but is later than the chapter's in-scope textual treatments and is not narrated as figural description in the surviving combat-text passages of the present book.^[376]

Appears in:

- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — among the monstrous brood Tiamat fashions for the war with the younger gods (Tablet I's eleven-monsters formula).
- *Minor Mesopotamian Combats* — alternative species-reading for Labbu's body in some manuscript witnesses.

Relevance. The mušḫuššu is one of the recurring serpent-dragon species of the Mesopotamian iconographic and textual record; in *Enūma Eliš* the brood-list places him among Tiamat's eleven monstrous champions.^[377]

A.3.27. Python

Delphic serpent slain by Apollo, originally an unnamed female **drakaina** in the Homeric Hymn to Apollo and renamed Python (male) in Ovid and the later mythographers.^[378]

Physical description. In the Homeric Hymn the slain serpent is unnamed and female (a **drakaina**); Ovid's *Metamorphoses* book 1 describes Python as an enormous earth-born serpent emerging from the post-flood mud at the foot of Parnassus.^[379]

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — slain by Apollo at Pytho with bow and arrows in the Homeric Hymn and in Ovid; the killing founds the Delphic oracle, with the place-name Pytho derived from the rotting (**pythein**) of the dragon's body.
- *Michael vs. the Red Dragon* — referenced in Yarbrow Collins's Leto-Apollo-Python primary-substrate reading of Revelation 12.
- *C3. Cyclical Maintenance* — the Septerion festival's eight-yearly re-enactment of the killing supplies a Greek cyclical-maintenance reflex alongside Ra-Apep and Illuyanka.

Relevance. Python is the standing Greek serpent-combat figure of the Delphic cult-foundation, Fontenrose's monograph treating the figure as the type-specimen for a wider Greek and Near Eastern dragon-combat pattern.^[380] Yarbrow Collins reads the Leto-Apollo-Python plot as the closest extant Mediterranean exemplar for the Revelation 12 pattern.

A.3.28. Qingu

Tiamat's appointed consort-general in *Enūma Eliš*, holder of the Tablet of Destinies, executed at the close of the combat so that humans can be formed from his blood.^[381]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources beyond the narrative datum that the Tablet of Destinies is fastened to his chest.^[382]

Appears in:

- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — appointed by Tiamat as commander-in-chief of her host and invested with

the Tablet of Destinies; captured among the monsters at her defeat, his Tablet seized by Marduk; in Tablet VI bound, brought before Ea, and his blood opened for the creation of humans.

- *C1. Combat as Cosmogony* — the Tablet-bearer whose blood becomes the first humans.

Relevance. Qingu is the Tablet-bearer of Tiamat's faction — the structural counterpart of Marduk after the combat — and the source of human blood at the cosmogony's anthropogonic moment.^[383] The Tablet's transfer from Qingu to Marduk is the second of the epic's two principal regalia-transfers.

A.3.29. The Red Dragon

The seven-headed, ten-horned red dragon of Revelation 12:3, glossed at Rev 12:9 as "the ancient serpent, called the Devil and Satan, the deceiver of the whole world."^[384]

Physical description. Rev 12:3 describes the dragon as great, fiery red (**purros**), with seven heads, ten horns, and seven diadems (**diadēmata**) on its heads; Rev 12:4 narrates that his tail swept down a third of the stars of heaven and threw them to the earth.^[385] At Rev 12:15 the dragon pours water like a river from his mouth.

Appears in:

- *Michael vs. the Red Dragon* — appears as the second sign in heaven in Rev 12, attempts to devour the male child at his birth, fights Michael and his angels, is cast down to the earth, pursues the woman into the wilderness, pours a river of water from his mouth that the earth swallows, and turns to make war on the rest of her children.
- *St. George, St. Michael, and the Christian Reception* — central iconographic figure of the late-antique-and-medieval Michaelic and Georgian dragon-fight imagery.
- *C4. Eschatological Displacement* — alongside Jormungandr and Aži Dahāka, the type-case of the eschatological subtype.
- *Reception coda* — the figure whose afterlife runs through Milton's Satan into modern reception of "war in heaven" imagery.

Relevance. The Red Dragon's seven heads invoke the Lōtan / Leviathan iconography; the "ancient serpent" gloss invokes both Genesis 3 and the Hebrew Bible Leviathan; and the assimilation to "the Devil and Satan" completes the Second Temple satanological identification.^[386] Yarbrow Collins's primary-substrate argument identifies the closest plot-shape match in the Greek Leto-Apollo-Python myth.

A.3.30. Spartoi

"Sown Men" of the Greek tradition, armed warriors springing from the dragon-of-Ares's teeth that Kadmos sows at Thebes; only five survive their mutual combat to become the founding patrilineal lineages of Theban aristocracy.^[387]

Physical description. No continuous physical description survives beyond the narrative datum that they spring from the soil fully grown and battle-ready and immediately fall to fighting one another.^[388]

Appears in:

- *Greek dragon-combats after Zeus-Typhon* — emerge from the sown teeth at Thebes, kill one another in mutual combat, and the surviving five become the Theban founding aristocracy.

Relevance. The Spartoi are the genealogical product of Kadmos's dragon-killing — the city's population literally generated from the slain dragon's body — making the Kadmos episode a city-foundation case in the strong sense.^[389]

A.3.31. Tiamat

Primordial salt-sea goddess of *Enūma Eliš*, mother of the first gods, cast as monstrous adversary after her elevation of Qingu and slain by Marduk; the cosmos is built from her split body.^[390]

Physical description. In the opening tablets Tiamat is named as the primordial salt-sea, undifferentiated into gods or lands, mingled with the fresh-water Apsû. After her mobilisation she brings forth a host of monstrous champions with venom for blood. At the moment of combat the text describes her opening her mouth wide; Marduk drives the Imhullu wind into the open mouth so she cannot close her lips, her belly is distended by the intruding winds, and she is rendered immobile. Marduk's arrow splits her belly and her heart.^[391] After the killing he splits her body lengthwise like a flat fish, raises the upper half as the sky, makes mountains from her thighs, opens her eyes for the sources of the Tigris and Euphrates, makes springs of her nostrils, piles mountains on her head, bores wells through her skull, coils her tail to form the cosmic bond between heaven and earth, and arches her crotch as architectural support for the heavens.^[392]

Appears in:

- *Marduk vs. Tiamat* — the cosmogonic mother whose death and dismemberment build the world: sky, mountains, rivers, springs, cosmic bond, architectural support.
- *Yahweh vs. Leviathan and Rahab* — referenced in the Gunkel-thesis discussion of the **tehôm** / Tiamat cognancy at Genesis 1:2.
- *C1. Combat as Cosmogony* — the type-specimen of the cosmogonic subtype.

Relevance. Tiamat is the figure on which Hermann Gunkel's 1895 Chaoskampf hypothesis was built, and the linguistic cognancy of her name with Hebrew **tehôm** (the deep of Genesis 1:2) is the cornerstone of the Gunkel argument.^[393] Ballentine's rival-sovereignty reading rests on the textual datum that Tiamat is not amorphous chaos: she organises an army, appoints a champion, distributes a token of authority, and conducts a war.^[394]

A.3.32. Tren-Tren

Mapuche mountain serpent paired with the marine serpent Kai-Kai; their combat raises mountain and flood in the Mapuche cosmogonic narrative.^[395]

Physical description. No continuous physical description bearing on the in-scope discussion of the chapter survives in the synthesis.

Appears in:

- *Kai-Kai vs. Tren-Tren* — raises the land in opposition to Kai-Kai's flood, generating the Mapuche landscape.

Relevance. Tren-Tren is the mountain pole of the Mapuche paired-serpent cosmogony; current Mapuche-studies area specialists (Foerster, Bacigalupo, Course, Faron) read the pair within the Mapuche cosmographic frame rather than as a chaoskampf case.^[396]

A.3.33. Typhon

The hundred-headed, serpent-limbed earth-born monster of Hesiod's *Theogony* (variant name Typhoeus), child of Gaia and Tartarus; Zeus's last and greatest adversary, the closing combat of the *Theogony's* succession-cycle.^[397]

Physical description. Hesiod's Theog. 824–828 describes the hundred heads of Typhoeus as serpent-heads springing from the monster's shoulders, with flickering tongues and fiery eyes. Theog. 829–835 describes his polyphonic voice — each of the hundred heads emits a different sound (the bellowing of bulls, the roaring of lions, the barking of hounds, the hissing of serpents), and the combined polyphony is itself uncanny.^[398] Hesiod's body description has serpents springing from the shoulders in place of arms or legs. Apollodorus's later expansion describes the body as enormous, surpassing all mountains in height, with serpent-coils for legs, dragon-heads erupting from the hands, and fire flashing from the eyes.^[399]

Appears in:

- *Zeus vs. Typhon* — earth-born child of Gaia and Tartarus, struck by Zeus's thunderbolt at Theog. 853–858, scorched, cast down into Tartarus (later under Mount Etna in the Apollodoran tradition); in Apollodorus, severs Zeus's sinews at the Corycian cave and is finally defeated after Hermes and Aigipan recover them.
- *C2. Combat as Sovereignty* — the Hesiodic kingship-combat case.
- *C6. The Near Eastern → Mediterranean Transmission* — the Greek pole of the Kumarbi-to-Hesiod transmission case, with the Apollodoran sinew-theft sequence as the principal point of Hurro-Hittite parallel.

Relevance. Typhon is the standing Greek serpent-monster, whose hundred serpent-heads and earth-born origin make him the Greek instance of the wider Indo-European storm-god-and-water-dragon complex.^[400] His combat closes the *Theogony's* succession-cycle and confirms Zeus's settled rule.

A.3.34. Ullikummi

Hurro-Hittite stone monster, Kumarbi's progeny by a great rock, who grows on the right shoulder of Upelluri to threaten Teshub's kingship.^[401]

Physical description. Ullikummi is described in the Song of Ullikummi as a stone child of stone — a stone column rising from the sea up toward the heavens, growing at a prodigious rate measured in cubits and acres of growth per day. His stone constitution makes him deaf and blind (Šauška's seduction-attack therefore cannot reach him) and invulnerable to organic-combat methods.^[402]

Appears in:

- *The Kumarbi Cycle* — conceived by Kumarbi on a great rock, planted on Upelluri's right shoulder, grows from the sea up to the gates of heaven where Teshub resides; resists Teshub's first storm-attack and Šauška's seduction; severed from Upelluri by the primordial copper cutter at Ea's identification, then defeated in the renewed combat.
- *C6. The Near Eastern → Mediterranean Transmission* — principal evidence for the comparative argument that Hesiod's Typhon descends from this Hurrian template.

Relevance. Ullikummi is the cycle's flagship adversary, the most cosmographically distinctive monster in the surviving Hurro-Hittite corpus: a stone column rising from sea to heaven, planted in the world's foundation itself.^[403] West reads the Ullikummi-Typhon parallel as the most strongly anchored Near-Eastern-to-Greek transmission case.^[404]

A.3.35. Upelluri

Hurro-Hittite primordial giant who bears the world; on whose right shoulder Ullikummi is planted and grows.^[405]

Physical description. Upelluri is presented as a primordial cosmographic figure: the giant on whose shoulders the heavens and earth were originally separated and rest.^[406] No further morphological description survives. His own awareness is dulled by his immense size and his cosmogonic age — he does not at first perceive the burden of the growing monster on his shoulder.

Appears in:

- *The Kumarbi Cycle* — bears the world; Ullikummi is planted on his right shoulder; Ea travels to him to investigate the structural origin of the threat, and Upelluri's reply expresses his cosmographic obliviousness.

Relevance. Upelluri is the cosmographic foundation of the Kumarbi Cycle's universe, structurally functioning as a feature of the cosmos rather than as an active character.^[407]

A.3.36. vishaps

Armenian "dragons," named in Khorenatsi's late paraphrase of the Vahagn hymn; also the name given to second-millennium-BCE stone stelae (vishapakar) associated with the cult.^[408]

Physical description. No continuous physical description bearing on the in-scope discussion survives in the chapter beyond the dragon-classification.^[409]

Appears in:

- *Indo-European reflexes of HERO SLAY SERPENT* — the dragons reaped by Vahagn the Vishapakagh.

Relevance. The vishaps and the associated **vishapakar** stone stelae are the Armenian dragon-cult evidence; the surviving narrative is Khorenatsi's late paraphrase of a hymn whose original is lost.^[410]

A.3.37. Vṛtra

Vedic serpent-demon, the obstructing figure whose body blocks the cosmic waters; slain by Indra in RV 1.32 and across the Indra-cycle.^[411]

Physical description. RV 1.32.5 describes Vṛtra in mountainous-and-mountain-comparable terms: the serpent-adversary is "lying" or "sprawled" on the slopes, with a body that the hymn's imagery treats as itself a mountain or mountain-form.^[412] The killing-blow with the **vajra** splits this body — **bhid-** "to split" being used so that the splitting of the mountain is at once the splitting of the obstructing serpent's body. RV 1.32.7 describes the slain Vṛtra lying broken across the channel as the released waters flow over and past his fallen body. RV 1.32.9 describes Vṛtra's mother Dānu lying above him as a cow above her calf.^[413]

Appears in:

- *Indra vs. Vṛtra* — slain by Indra with the Tvaṣṭi-forged **vajra**; the killing splits the mountain, releases the seven rivers, separates heaven and earth, produces dawn.
- *Vedic and post-Vedic reflexes* — referenced as the Vedic adversary whose combat-pattern Trita Āptya's older stratum precedes and Krishna-Kāliya's bhakti-era reworking transforms.
- *C1. Combat as Cosmogony* — discussed as a near-case in the cosmogonic subtype.
- *C5. The IE HERO SLAY SERPENT Formula* — the **ahi** of the áhann áhim formula, anchor case for Watkins's reconstruction.

Relevance. Vṛtra is the standing Vedic dragon-adversary, and the áhann áhim formula at RV 1.32.1–2 is the philological anchor of Watkins's reconstructed Indo-European HERO SLAY SERPENT line.^[414] His name derives from Vedic vṛ- "to obstruct," lexically transparent in its own language: Vṛtra is "the obstructor" of the cosmic waters.^[415]

A.3.38. Yamata no Orochi

Eight-headed, eight-tailed serpent of Izumo, slain by Susanoo; its tail contains the sword Kusanagi, one of the Three Sacred Treasures of the Japanese imperial regalia.^[416]

Physical description. The *Kojiki* describes Yamata no Orochi as eight-headed and eight-tailed, an enormous serpent extending across mountain valleys; the sword Kusanagi is found within the eighth tail when Susanoo dismembers the body.^[417]

Appears in:

- *Susanoo vs. Yamata no Orochi* — intoxicated with eight vats of sake by Susanoo, dismembered, and its tail discovered to contain the sword Kusanagi.
- *Reception coda* — the figure whose iconographic afterlife runs through the Japanese Orochi tradition into the modern kaiju lineage (Godzilla and successors).

Relevance. The Yamata no Orochi episode is read by current Japanese-studies area specialists as sword-etiology and metallurgical allegory — the eight-headed serpent figuring iron-smelting along the rivers of Izumo, the sword's emergence from the tail figuring the metallurgical emergence of the bladed weapon.^[418] The chaoskampf framing is applied from outside in twentieth-century

A.3.39. Yamm

"Sea," Ugaritic god of the sea (paired epithet "Judge River," 𐎶𐎵 **nhr**), Baal's principal adversary in KTU 1.1–1.2 of the Baal Cycle.^[419]

Physical description. No physical description of Yamm survives in the in-scope sources beyond the narrative datum that he stumbles after Yagrush's first blow at his shoulders and falls under Ayyamur's strike at his skull.^[420]

Appears in:

- *Baal vs. Yamm and Lôtan* — granted the kingship by El in KTU 1.1, demands Baal's hand-over through messengers, fights Baal in KTU 1.2 iv, and is defeated by the named maces Yagrush and Ayyamur — defeated and dispersed rather than annihilated.
- *Yahweh vs. Leviathan and Rahab* — referenced as the Ugaritic prototype of the sea-as-adversary motif transferred polemically to Yahweh's defeat of the sea (Hebrew **yam**).
- *C2. Combat as Sovereignty* — the load-bearing rival-sovereignty case of Ballentine's reading.

Relevance. Yamm is Ballentine's load-bearing case for the rival-sovereignty rather than chaos-vs-order reading of the combat-myth corpus: his name is the common noun for "sea" without primordially marker, El initially confirms his kingship, his epithet "Judge River" gives him a juridical office incompatible with primordial chaos, and the post-combat narrative installs Baal in a palace rather than fashioning the cosmos from his body.^[421]

A.3.40. Zmey Gorynych

Three-headed dragon of East Slavic epic, adversary of Dobrynya Nikitich in the **bylina** tradition.^[422]

Physical description. The **bylina** tradition characterises Zmey Gorynych as three-headed; no further continuous physical description bearing on the in-scope discussion survives.^[423]

Appears in:

- *Slavic and Baltic combat* — the three-headed dragon slain by Dobrynya Nikitich in the East Slavic **bylina** corpus recorded from oral performance in the nineteenth century.

Relevance. Zmey Gorynych is the principal East Slavic dragon-adversary preserved in continuous narrative form, distinct from the contested reconstructive figure of Veles.^[424]

A.4. Personified Concepts and Adversaries

A.4.1. Satan

"The adversary"; in Rev 12:9 identified with the Red Dragon and the ancient serpent — completing the assimilation of the combat-myth adversary to Second Temple satanology.^[425]

Physical description. No physical description survives in the in-scope sources; the Greek term **ho diabolos** and the Hebrew **śāṭān** function as title or accusatorial epithet rather than as figural description.^[426]

Appears in:

- *Michael vs. the Red Dragon* — gloss on the Red Dragon at Rev 12:9; named as "the accuser of our comrades" at Rev 12:10.
- *St. George, St. Michael, and the Christian Reception* — the figure as which the dragon is identified across the Christian reception of the combat-myth pattern.
- *Reception coda* — the figure whose afterlife runs from the Apocalypse through Milton's *Paradise Lost* and into modern reception of "war in heaven" imagery.

Relevance. Satan is the figure on whom the long Christian reception of the combat-myth converges: Forsyth's *Old Enemy* traces the assimilation of the combat-myth adversary to Second Temple satanology and the figure's reuse across Christian devotional and literary tradition.^[427]

A.5. Named Weapons

A.5.1. Kusanagi

"Grass-cutter," sword found in Yamata no Orochi's eighth tail when Susanoo dismembers the serpent; one of the Three Sacred Treasures of the Japanese imperial regalia.^[428]

Physical description. The sword's name, "grass-cutter," and its discovery within the eighth tail of the eight-headed eight-tailed serpent are the standing identification; no further morphological description bearing on the in-scope discussion survives in the chapter's treatment.^[429]

Appears in:

- *Susanoo vs. Yamata no Orochi* — sword discovered within Yamata no Orochi's tail at his dismemberment by Susanoo, subsequently ascending into the Japanese imperial regalia.

Relevance. Kusanagi is the load-bearing object of the imperial-charter dimension of the Susanoo / Yamata no Orochi narrative: the sword's emergence from the serpent's tail is the etiology of one of the Three Sacred Treasures of the Japanese imperial regalia, and the chapter's area-specialist reading treats the cycle as sword-etiology rather than as chaoskampf.^[430]

A.5.2. Mjöllnir

Thor's hammer (anglicised Mjöllnir), forged by the dwarves Brokkr and Eitri (or Sindri) in the smiths' contest of *Skáldskaparmál* ch. 35, the storm-god's combat-weapon.^[431]

Physical description. The hammer is described in *Skáldskaparmál* ch. 35 as so potent that it never fails of its target and returns to the wielder's hand after striking; it has a short haft (a flaw introduced in the contest by Loki disguised as a fly biting Brokkr) which requires the iron gauntlets and the belt of strength **Megingjörð** to wield.^[432]

Appears in:

- *Thor vs. Jormungandr* — Thor's combat-weapon in all three encounters with the Midgard Serpent, used at the Ragnarøk killing.

Relevance. Mjöllnir is the cosmic combat-weapon of the Norse storm-god, in the same structural position as Indra's **vajra** and Baal's Ayyamur and Yagrush.^[433]

A.5.3. Šarur

Ninurta's animate talking mace, scout and messenger across both *Lugal-e* and the *Anzû Epic*; one of the most cross-textually recurring "characters" of the Mesopotamian combat corpus.^[434]

Physical description. No physical description of Šarur as an object beyond the designation "mace" survives in the in-scope sources; the figure's distinctiveness is precisely that he is a weapon that speaks, flies, scouts, argues, counsels, and praises.^[435]

Appears in:

- *Ninurta vs. Asag* — alerts Ninurta to Asag's emergence, recites the trophy-list of Ninurta's prior victories, urges retreat, flies back to Enlil at the E-kur as intercessor, returns with the conditional charge, delivers the targeted-killing instruction (pierce the liver), and after the slaying sings the victor's praise-song.
- *Ninurta vs. Anzû* — accompanies Ninurta to the mountain, returns to Ea after the failed first attack as messenger, carries Ea's pinion-feather plan back to Ninurta, and is the speaking subject who carries the warrior's report in direct speech.

Relevance. Šarur is the most distinctive structural feature of the Sumerian and Akkadian Ninurta material: an animate weapon that crosses-textually as a recurring speaking character, the "camera" of *Lugal-e*'s scouting sequences and the messenger of the *Anzû Epic*'s tactical exchange between warrior and counsellor.^[436]

A.5.4. vajra

Indra's thunderbolt-mace, forged by Tvāṣṭra; the cosmic combat-weapon of the Rīgveda.^[437]

Physical description. The **vajra** is a forged divine artefact, the lightning-strike mythologised as a material implement; no further morphological description is supplied in the in-scope textual treatment beyond its being the weapon Tvāṣṭra forges and Indra wields in RV 1.32.2.^[438]

Appears in:

- *Indra vs. Vṛtra* — instrument of the killing-stroke against Vṛtra in RV 1.32.6 and across the Indra-cycle.

Relevance. The **vajra** is the Vedic cosmic combat-weapon, in the same structural position as Mjöllnir and Baal's named maces; through its forged-implement-of-the-lightning logic the combat acquires its concrete material image.^[439]

A.5.5. Yagrush and Ayyamur

Baal's two named maces ("Driver" and "Chaser"), forged by Kothar-wa-Khasis at KTU 1.2 iv,

addressed in second-person speech and instructed in their work.^[440]

Physical description. The maces are presented in the surviving Ugaritic text not as inert weapons but as named partners in the combat — Yagrush commanded to leap from Baal’s hand and strike Yamm at the shoulders, Ayyamur to strike at the skull.^[441]

Appears in:

- *Baal vs. Yamm and Lôtan* — paired named maces of the combat with Yamm in KTU 1.2 iv; first mace’s strike does not finish the combat, second mace’s blow brings Yamm down.

Relevance. The named-mace pair is the load-bearing detail of the Ugaritic combat: weapons addressed in the second person and instructed in their work, structurally parallel to Ninurta’s Šarur and a probable areal feature of Late Bronze Age combat-myth narration.^[442]

[1] Foster 2005, p. 561, Tablet I.

[2] Annus 2001, introduction.

[3] Benveniste & Renou 1934, *passim*, on Ahura Mazdā as supreme creator-god in Zoroastrian dualistic cosmology.

[4] Benveniste & Renou 1934, *passim*; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 45, on the dualistic alignment of the Aži Dahāka combat with the wider Ahura Mazdā / Anra Mainyu opposition.

[5] Benveniste & Renou 1934, on *Yašt* 19’s x^{ar}nah-theology under Ahura Mazdā’s sovereignty.

[6] Ogden 2013, ch. 2.

[7] Ogden 2013, ch. 2.

[8] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 24–47, on Asag as son of An and Ki; lines 669–671, on the closing invocation of An.

[9] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 669–671, on An invoked alongside Bau as senior deity.

[10] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction, on Anat as warrior-goddess and Baal’s ally; KTU 1.3 ii commentary on her combat scene.

[11] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 ii commentary, on the slaughter-scene description.

[12] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction, on Anat’s prominence.

[13] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.3 iii commentary, on the seven-headed-serpent in Anat’s catalogue.

[14] Benveniste & Renou 1934, *passim*, on Anra Mainyu as cosmic adversary; Watkins 1995, Part V ch. 46, on the **Bundahišn**’s account of Aži Dahāka’s Ahrimanic origin.

[15] Benveniste & Renou 1934, *passim*, on the dualistic structure.

[16] Foster 2005, p. 437, Tablet I theogony; Lambert 2013, Tablets I–IV.

[17] Lambert 2013, Tablet II, on Anšar’s commissioning role.

[18] Foster 2005, p. 444, Tablet II.

[19] Foster 2005, p. 437, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, introduction.

[20] Lambert 2013, introduction; Hoffner 1998, §14, on Anu’s standing across the corpora.

[21] Foster 2005, p. 485, Tablet VII.

[22] Annus 2001, introduction; Foster 2005, pp. 555–578.

[23] Annus 2001, introduction, on the lion-headed eagle iconography; Foster 2005, pp. 555–556, headnote on Anzû’s physical form.

[24] Annus 2001, introduction, on the Anzû-to-Enūma-Eliš genealogy; Lambert 2013, introduction.

[25] Faulkner 1972, spells 7, 39, 108; te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4.

[26] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on Apep’s morphological stability across the corpus.

[27] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the seventh-hour combat and on the western-horizon localisation in spell 108.

[28] te Velde 1967, ch. 3, on the chronological range of the Apep material; Faulkner 1972, on the Book of the Dead spells.

[29] te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4, on the regenerative capacity as articulating the recurrence-structure.

[30] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3; Ogden 2013, ch. 2; Homeric Hymn to Apollo; Ovid *Metamorphoses* 1.

[31] Fontenrose 1959, chs. 1–3.

[32] Ogden 2013, ch. 2.

[33] Lambert 2013, Tablet I; Foster 2005, pp. 436–439.

- [34] Foster 2005, p. 439, Tablet I.
- [35] Forsyth 1987, ch. 2, on Apsû's killing as rehearsal.
- [36] Foster 2005, pp. 439–440, Tablet I.
- [37] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 411–434.
- [38] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 411–434, on Aruru's prompting.
- [39] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 i–iii commentary on Athirat's intercession.
- [40] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction.
- [41] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary on Athtart's intervention.
- [42] Smith 1994, Vol. I, KTU 1.2 iv commentary.
- [43] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on Baʿlu / Haddu in Ugaritic and the storm-god type.
- [44] Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 vii commentary on the opening of the window and Baal's thunder.
- [45] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on Baal-Yamm as the central test case.
- [46] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction.
- [47] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 669–671.
- [48] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 669–671.
- [49] Foster 2005, pp. 562–563, Tablet I; Annus 2001, Tablet I.
- [50] Foster 2005, pp. 562–563, on the commissioning role.
- [51] Foster 2005, pp. 575–576, Tablet III; Annus 2001, Tablet III.
- [52] Foster 2005, pp. 575–576.
- [53] Anderson-Dibble 1950–82, *Florentine Codex* Book 3; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec.
- [54] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the Coatlicue statue and its iconographic features.
- [55] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec.
- [56] Anderson-Dibble 1950–82, *Florentine Codex* Book 3; Matos Moctezuma 1988; Carrasco 1999.
- [57] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the Coyolxauhqui stone, on its iconographic depiction of the moon-goddess with severed head and disarticulated limbs arranged radially around her nude torso, and on its placement at the foot of the southern staircase.
- [58] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec.
- [59] Foster 2005, p. 440, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [60] Foster 2005, p. 440.
- [61] Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths.
- [62] Birrell 1993, ch. on solar myths.
- [63] Foster 2005, pp. 555–578, on Ea in the *Anzû Epic*; Lambert 2013, Tablets I–VII; Hoffner 1998, §15, on Ea's role in the Kumarbi Cycle.
- [64] Annus 2001, introduction; Lambert 2013, introduction; Hoffner 1998, introduction.
- [65] ETCSL glossary; on the Enki / Ea language-context pair.
- [66] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on El's residence and role.
- [67] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction on the divine-council form.
- [68] Ballentine 2015, ch. 2, on El's grant of the kingship to Yamm.
- [69] ETCSL glossary; van Dijk 1983.
- [70] ETCSL glossary on the Enki / Ea pair.
- [71] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 186–227; Foster 2005, pp. 556–558.
- [72] Lambert 2013, Tablet VII; Annus 2001, introduction.
- [73] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 187–190.
- [74] West 1966, on Theog. 154–182, 821–822.
- [75] West 1966, Theog. 820 introduction of Typhoeus.
- [76] Foster 2005, p. 561, Tablet I.
- [77] Annus 2001, introduction.
- [78] Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3; Birrell 1993, on the Huainanzi and Shanhaijing material.
- [79] Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3; per glossary first_mention_gloss for Gonggong, on the red-haired serpent-bodied iconographic profile attested in the early Chinese sources.

- [80] Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3.
- [81] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction, on Baġlu / Haddu.
- [82] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction.
- [83] Hoffner 1998, §16; per glossary first_mention_gloss.
- [84] Hoffner 1998, §16, on Hedammu’s voracity.
- [85] Hoffner 1998, §16.
- [86] Ogden 2013, ch. 2; Apollodorus *Bibliotheca* 1.6.3.
- [87] West 1997, ch. 6; Ogden 2013, ch. 2.
- [88] Faulkner 1972; te Velde 1967; per glossary first_mention_gloss.
- [89] te Velde 1967, on the falcon-headed iconography.
- [90] te Velde 1967; per scope.md inclusion-marginal classification of Ch. 17.
- [91] Anderson-Dibble 1950–82, *Florentine Codex* Book 3; Matos Moctezuma 1988; Carrasco 1999.
- [92] Anderson-Dibble 1950–82, *Florentine Codex* Book 3 narrative on Huitzilopochtli’s birth-arms and feathered war-regalia; Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the same.
- [93] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters on the **xiuhcōātl** iconography.
- [94] Matos Moctezuma 1988, interpretive chapters; Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec.
- [95] Carrasco 1999, ch. on Coatepec.
- [96] Hoffner 1998, “Illuyanka” §1.
- [97] Hoffner 1998, “Illuyanka” §1.
- [98] Hoffner 1998, “Illuyanka” §1.
- [99] Jamison & Brereton 2014, on Indra as the most frequently invoked deity in the Rigvedic corpus.
- [100] Jamison & Brereton 2014, RV 1.32 headnote.
- [101] Jamison & Brereton 2014, general introduction.
- [102] Watkins 1995, chs. 41–48; Jamison & Brereton 2014, RV 1.32 headnote.
- [103] Faulkner 1972; te Velde 1967.
- [104] Faulkner 1972, on the apotropaic spells; te Velde 1967, ch. 3.
- [105] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969.
- [106] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969.
- [107] Faulkes 1987, *Gylfaginning* chs. 9, 21.
- [108] Faulkes 1987, *Gylfaginning* ch. 9.
- [109] Faulkes 1987, *Gylfaginning* chs. 34, 47–48, 51; Larrington 2014, *Völuspá* st. 56.
- [110] Faulkes 1987, *Gylfaginning* ch. 34, on Jǫrmungandr’s growth in the ocean to encircle the world and bite its own tail.
- [111] West 2007, ch. 6; per brief 18-thor-jormungandr.yaml on the iconographic dossier.
- [112] Foster 2005, pp. 449–450, Tablet III; Lambert 2013, Tablet III.
- [113] Foster 2005, pp. 450–453.
- [114] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction.
- [115] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II, KTU 1.4 v–vi commentary on the window-debate.
- [116] Hoffner 1998, §14 (Kingship in Heaven); §15 (Song of Ullikummi); §16 (Song of Hedammu).
- [117] West 1997, ch. 6, on the Kumarbi Cycle as the central transmission case.
- [118] Foster 2005, p. 437, Tablet I; p. 453, Tablet III.
- [119] Foster 2005, p. 453, Tablet III.
- [120] Foster 2005, p. 453, Tablet III.
- [121] Faulkes 1987, *Gylfaginning* ch. 34.
- [122] Faulkes 1987, *Gylfaginning* ch. 34.
- [123] Lambert 2013, Tablets I–VII; Foster 2005, pp. 436–486.
- [124] Foster 2005, p. 440, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [125] Gunkel 1895, Teil I; Lambert 2013, pp. 463–465.
- [126] Annus 2001, introduction.
- [127] Faulkner 1972; per glossary first_mention_gloss.
- [128] Faulkner 1972; per glossary first_mention_gloss on Mehen as serpent-coil deity.

- [129] Faulkner 1972.
- [130] Yarbro Collins 1976, ch. 3; Aune 1997–98 (WBC 52B), commentary on Rev 12:7.
- [131] Yarbro Collins 1976; Aune 1997–98 — neither commentary records a physical description of Michael in Revelation 12.
- [132] Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the Byzantine and Latin medieval iconographic codification as later reception.
- [133] Aune 1997–98 on the Second Temple background; Ogden 2013, ch. 11, on the late-antique cult.
- [134] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction; Smith & Pitard 2009, Vol. II introduction.
- [135] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction.
- [136] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969.
- [137] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969.
- [138] Foster 2005, p. 438, Tablet I; Lambert 2013, Tablet I.
- [139] Foster 2005, p. 439, Tablet I.
- [140] Foster 2005, p. 438, Tablet I.
- [141] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 387–410.
- [142] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 387–410; Forsyth 1987, ch. 2.
- [143] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 187–190.
- [144] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 187–190.
- [145] ETCSL 1.6.2 (Lugal-e) proem lines 1–19; Annus 2001, introduction; Foster 2005, pp. 555–578.
- [146] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 70–95; on the storm-imagery of Ninurta’s approach.
- [147] Annus 2001, introduction; Lambert 2013, introduction.
- [148] Annus 2001, introduction.
- [149] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 698–723.
- [150] ETCSL 1.6.2 lines 712–723; on Nisaba as judge, keeper of records, and divine administrator.
- [151] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, *The Mwindo Epic*, episode of Kirimu and following celestial-journey passages.
- [152] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, on Nkuba’s punitive intervention.
- [153] Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3; Birrell 1993; per glossary *first_mention_gloss*.
- [154] Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3; per glossary *first_mention_gloss* on the serpent-tailed form.
- [155] Lewis 2006, chs. 2–3.
- [156] Faulkes 1987, *Gylfaginning* chs. 9, 20.
- [157] Faulkes 1987, *Gylfaginning* ch. 34.
- [158] te Velde 1967.
- [159] te Velde 1967.
- [160] Salomon & Urioste 1991, Huarochirí Manuscript chs. 6, 8, 21.
- [161] Salomon & Urioste 1991, ch. 6, on the falcon-egg birth and transformation into anthropomorphic figures.
- [162] Salomon & Urioste 1991, chs. 6, 8.
- [163] Salomon & Urioste 1991, translators’ introduction.
- [164] Salomon & Urioste 1991, ch. 8 on the displacement-rather-than-killing pattern.
- [165] Bailey & Ivanova 1998; West 2007, ch. 6.
- [166] West 2007, ch. 6.
- [167] West 2007, ch. 6; per glossary *first_mention_gloss* for Perun on the contested status of the Ivanov-Toporov reconstruction.
- [168] López Austin 1993, ch. on cosmic combat; Carrasco 1999.
- [169] Per glossary *first_mention_gloss* on the Feathered Serpent identification.
- [170] López Austin 1993, ch. on cosmic combat; per scope.md §“Excluded adjacent motifs” 1 on the Cipactli case as a boundary marker.
- [171] Faulkner 1972; te Velde 1967, chs. 3–4; Assmann 2001.
- [172] Assmann 2001 on the day-and-night barque structure of Ra’s journey.
- [173] Assmann 2001 on the contingency of sunrise upon Ra’s nightly combat.
- [174] Day 1985.
- [175] Day 1985, on Isaiah 51:9–10 and Psalm 89:9–10.
- [176] Day 1985; Ballentine 2015.
- [177] Foster 2005, p. 561, Tablet I.

- [178] Annus 2001, introduction, on the threefold-refusal as Mesopotamian pattern.
- [179] Hoffner 1998, §15 (Ullikummi); §16 (Hedammu).
- [180] Hoffner 1998, §16, on the seduction-tableau of Hedammu.
- [181] Hoffner 1998, §15 and §16, on the Šauška-Teshub division of labour.
- [182] Faulkner 1972; te Velde 1967.
- [183] te Velde 1967, ch. 1, on the Seth-animal iconography.
- [184] te Velde 1967, chs. 1–4, on Seth’s ambivalent valence.
- [185] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction.
- [186] Smith 1994, Vol. I introduction.
- [187] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969, *The Mwindo Epic*, opening sequences.
- [188] Biebuyck & Mateene 1969.
- [189] Philippi 1968, *Kojiki* book 1 chs. 19–20; Naumann 1996.
- [190] Philippi 1968, *Kojiki* book 1.
- [191] Naumann 1996; per scope.md §"Book structure" cluster 9 on the chaoskampf label as applied from outside.
- [192] Hoffner 1998, "Illuyanka" §§1–2.
- [193] Hoffner 1998 introduction; Beckman 1982.
- [194] Hoffner 1998, §§14–15.
- [195] Hoffner 1998, §15, on Šeri and Ūrri / Tilla.
- [196] West 1997, ch. 6.
- [197] López Austin 1993; per glossary first_mention_gloss.
- [198] Per glossary first_mention_gloss.
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